

THE NORTHERN EPICS

The Poetic Edda and Other Old Germanic Alliterative Poetry

edited and translated by

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THE BOOK IS A WORK IN PROGRESS AND THIS
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Corrections and questions are gratefully accepted at
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Om drömmar skola rinna bort, som snö,
när lyktas vintern, åter blottas Jord,
från sinne sömnomhöljt, och dermed dö,
jag båd' att efter lefde dessa ord.
Dem tage, hålle hon som intet vet,
om fällde i sin ovetenskap blott en
fullärlig tår—men skedde icke det,
då bränn dem under Månens klara sken,
att det som sjungits utan kraft och mod
förglömmes, och ej mer förnedrar dem
som förr för intet mer utguto blod
än yrig dröm om himmelrikets hem.
Ty knappt ens Månen skiner för vår skull
om vi förblifva halfva—och han full.

Lífir hann of allar aldir ok stjórnað öllu ríki sínu ok ræðir öllum hlutum, stórum ok smám. [...] Hann smíðaði himin ok jörð ok loptin ok alla eign þeira. [...] Hitt er þó mest, er hann gerði manninn ok gaf honum þund þá, er lífa skal ok aldri týna=sk, þótt lík-amr fúni at moldu eða brenni at ösku; ok skulu allir menn lífa, þeir er rétt eru síðaðir, ok vera með honum sjölfum þar sem heitir Gim-lé eða Vin-gólf.

Gylfa ginning 3:7–11

Deyr fé, · dýja frændr,
deyr sjalfr hit sama;
ek veit einn · at aldri=gi deyr
dómr of dauðan hvern.

Háva mál 77

Meðal-snotr · skyli manna hverr,
éva til snotr séi;
því't snotrs manns hjarta · verðr sjaldan glatt,
ef sá's al-snotr es á.

Háva mál 106

Ullar hylli · hefr ok allra goða
hverr's tegr fyrstr á funa
því't opnir heimar · verða umb ása sonum,
þá's hefja af hvera.

Grímnis mál 43

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Abbreviations

Languages and language families

- AS = Anglo-Saxon
- Eng. = Modern English
- Ger. = Modern German
- Got. = Gotnish (or Gothic)
- IE = Indo-European
- Lomb. = Lombardic
- MHG = Middle High German
- NGmc. = North Germanic
- ODan. = Old Danish
- OE = Old English
- OF = Old Frisian
- OHG = Old High German
- OI = Old Indian
- OIr. = Old Irish
- ON = Old Norse
- OS = Old Saxon
- OSwe. = Old Swedish
- PGmc. = Proto-Germanic
- PIE = Proto-Indo-European
- PN = Proto-Norse

- PNWGmc. = Proto-North-West Germanic
- PWGmc. = Proto-West Germanic
- WGmc. = West Germanic

General abbreviations

- 1st = first-person
- 2nd = second-person
- 3rd = third-person
- abbrev. = abbreviated
- acc. = accusative case
- add. = is added
- adj. = adjective
- approx. = approximately
- c. = century
- ca. = circa
- cert. = certainly
- cf. = *confere*; compare
- corr. = corrected in the ms.
- cpd. = compound
- dat. = dative case
- e. = excerpt (not the whole stanza)
- ed. = edition, edited (by)
- e.g. = *exemplio gratia*; for instance
- emend. = emendation, emended (by)
- esp. = especially
- f. = feminine
- fol., foll. = folio, folios
- gen. = genitive case
- id. = *idem*; the same

- i.e., = *id est*; that is
- imper. = imperative mood
- ind. = indicative mood
- instr. = instrumental case
- l, ll. = line, lines
- lit. = literal, literally
- m. = masculine
- metr. emend. = emended based on metrical criteria
- ms., mss. = manuscript, manuscripts
- n. = and note, (see) note to aforementioned passage
- nom. = nominative case
- norm. = normalised from the ms. spelling
- ntr. = neuter
- om. = omitted by
- p., pp. = page, pages
- pl. = plural number
- pr. = *principium*; the unnumbered introductory paragraph of a section or speech marker before a stanza
- pres. = present
- pres. ed. = present edition
- prob. = probably
- rev. = reversed (of lines or words)
- sens. emend. = emended due to lack of sense
- sg. = singular number
- st., sts. = stanza, stanzas
- subj. = subjunctive mood
- s.v. = *sub verbo*; under the word
- tr. = translation, translated (by)
- viz. = *videlicet*; namely, to wit
- wo. = without
- wrt. = with regard to
- < = (deriving) from
- > = whence

Primary sources

For ease of reference, those texts which are included in the present edition are marked in bold text.

- *AB* = *Aitareyá Bráhmaṇa*
- *Akv* = *Atla kvíða* ('Lay of Attle')
- *Alv* = *Alvíss mól* ('Speeches of Allwise')
- *Am* = *Atla mól* ('Speeches of Attle')
- *AV* = *At^aarva-vēdá*, in the *Śā́unaka* recension unless otherwise specified
- *Bdr* = *Baldrs draumar* ('Dreams of Balder')
- *Beow* = *Beowulf*
- *Birth* = Three Galders for Birth
- *Brot* = *Brot af Sig-urðar kvíða* ('Fragment of a Lay of Siward')
- *Cadman* = Cadman's Hymn
- *Cant* = Canterbury Galder
- *ContVerm* = *Contra Vermes* ('Against Wyrms')
- *Déor* = *Déor* ('Deer')
- *Dweorb* = *Wið dweorb* ('Against a Dwarf')
- *Eb* = *Eyr-byggja saga* ('Saw of the Ere-dwellers')
- *Eddbr* = *Brot ór Snorra Edda* ('Fragments from Snorre's Edda')
- *Eirm* = *Ei-ríks mól* ('Speeches of Eric'), Anon *Eirm* in SkP 1
- *Fáfn* = *Fáfnis mól* ('Speeches of Fathomer')
- *Fbr* = *Fóstr-bróðra saga* ('Saw of the Foster-brothers')
- *Finn* = The Fight at Finnsbury
- *Frost* = *Frostaþings lög* ('Law of the Frost-Thing'), ed. NGL I (pp. 119–258)
- *Fornk* = *Sögu-brot af nokkurum forn-konungum í Dana- ok Svía-veldi* ('Fragment of a Saw from Some Ancient Kings in the Danish and Swedish Realms')
- *Férst* = *Wið Fér-stice* ('Against a Sudden Stitch')
- *Gautr* = *Gaut-reks saga* ('Saw of Geatric')

- *Gldr* = *Glym-drápa* ('Glim-Drape'), Þhorn *Gldr* in SkP 1
- *Ghv* = *Guð-rúnar hvot* ('Instigation of Guthrun')
- *Gr* = *Grettis saga* ('Saw of Grettir')
- *Grg* = *Gróu galdr* ('Galder of Growe')
- *Grip* = *Grípis spó* ('Spae of Griper')
- *Grm* = *Grímnis mól* ('Speeches of Grimner')
- *Grot* = *Grotta sngur* ('Song of Grotte')
- *1 Guðr* = *1 Guð-rúnar kviða* ('First Lay of Guthrun')
- *2 Guðr* = *2 Guð-rúnar kviða* ('Second Lay of Guthrun')
- *3 Guðr* = *3 Guð-rúnar kviða* ('Third Lay of Guthrun')
- *Gula* = *Gula-þings lög* ('Law of the Gole-Thing'), ed. NGL I (pp. 1–118)
- *Gut* = *Guta saga* ('Saw of the Gutes')
- *Gylf* = *Gylfa ginning* ('Beguiling of Yilver')
- *HákGóð* = *Hq-konar saga góða* ('Saw of Hathkin the Good')
- *Hákm* = *Hq-konar mól* ('Speeches of Hathkin'), Eyv *Hák* in SkP 1
- *Hálf* = *Hálfs saga ok Hálfs rekka* ('Saw of Hathwolf and Hathwolf's Champions')
- *Hált* = *Há-leygja tal* ('Tally of the Highlies'), Eyv *Hál* in SkP 1
- *Hamð* = *Ham-ðis mól* ('Speeches of Hamthew')
- *Hárþ* = *Hár-barðs ljóð* ('Leeds of Hoarbeard')
- *Haustl* = *Haust-löng* ('Harvest-Long'), Þjóð *Haustl* in SkP 3
- *Háv* = *Hóva mól* ('Speeches of the High One')
- *Hdl* = *Hyndlu ljóð* ('Leeds of Hindle')
- *Heiðr* = *Her-varar saga ok Heið-reks* ('Saw of Harware and Heathric')
- *Heli* = *Heliand*
- *Helr* = *Hel-reið Bryn-bildar* ('Hell-ride of Byrnchild')
- *HHj* = *Hęlga kviða Hęr-varðs-sonar* ('Lay of Hallow Harwardson')
- *1 HHund* = *1 Hęlga kviða Hundings-bana* ('First Lay of Hallow Hundingsbane')

- **2 HHund** = 2 *Hēlga kviða Hundings-bana* ('Second Lay of Hallow Hundingsbane')
- **Hild** = *Hildebrandslied* ('Lay of Hildbrand')
- **Hrafnk** = *Hrafn-kels saga* ('Saw of Ravenkettle')
- **Húsdr** = *Hús-drápa* ('Drape for a House'), ÚlfrU *Húsdr* in SkP 3
- **Hym** = *Hymis kviða* ('Lay of Hymer')
- **RunI** = The Icelandic Rune Poem
- **Il** = Homer's Ἰλιάς (*Iliad*)
- **Ldn** = *Land-náma bók* ('Book of Land-Claims')
- **Lok** = *Loka senna* ('Flyting of Lock')
- **MB^b** = *Mabáb^bārata*
- **Mers** = The Merseburg galders
- **Mbkv** = *Máls-bátta kvæði* ('Poem of Sayings'), Anon *Mbkv* in SkP 3
- **Norn** = *Norna-Gests þátr* ('Strand of Norn-Guest')
- **Nwyrtr** = *Nigon wyrta galdor* ('Galder of Nine Worts')
- **Od** = Homer's Ὀδύσσεια (*Odyssey*)
- **Oddr** = *Odd-rúnar grátr* ('Weeping of Ordrun')
- **ProNessia** = *Pro Nessa* ('For Nesse')
- **Rdr** = *Ragnars drápa* ('Drape of Rainer'), Bragi *Rdr* in SkP 3
- **Reg** = *Regins mól* ('Speeches of Rein')
- **R̥V** = *R̥g-vēdā*, with translations from Jamison and Brereton (2014) unless otherwise specified
- **Rþ** = *Rígs þula* ('Thule of Righ')
- **SaxGen** = Old Saxon Genesis
- **Sigrdr** = *Sigr-drífu mól* ('Speeches of Syedrive')
- **Sigsk** = *Sig-urðar kviða in skamma* ('Short Lay of Siward')
- **Skí** = *Skirnis mól* ('Speeches of Shirner')
- **Skm** = *Skald-skapar mól* ('Matter of Scoldship')
- **SKVR** = *Suomen kansan vanhat runot* ('Ancient Songs of the Finnish People')

- *Sól* = *Sólar-ljóð* ('Leeds of the Sun'), Anon *Sól* in SkP 7
- *Sont* = *Sona-tor-rek* ('Grievous Loss of Sons'), Egill *Sont* in SkP 5
- *Sqrla* = *Sqrla þátrr* ('Strand of Sarle')
- *Styrb* = *Styr-bjarnar þátrr Svía-kappa* ('Strand of Stirbern Champion of the Swedes')
- *Theog* = Hesiod's Θεογονία ('*Theogony*, Birth of the Gods'), West (1966) ed.
- *Vafþ* = *Vafþrúðnis mól* ('Speeches of Webthrithner')
- *Vatn* = *Vatns-dóla saga* ('Saw of the Waterdellings')
- *Vkv* = *Vqlundar kvíða* ('Lay of Wayland')
- *Vqls* = *Vqlsunga saga* ('Saw of the Walsings')
- *Vqlsa* = *Vqlsa þátrr* ('Strand of Walse')
- *Vqlsbr* = *Brot ór Vqls* ('Fragments from *Vqls*')
- *Vsp* = *Vqlu spó* ('Spae of the Wallow')
- *Wald* = *Wald-þere* ('Walder')
- *Wessobrunn* = The Wessobrunn Hymn
- *Wid* = *Wid-siþ* ('Widsith')
- *Wulf* = *Wulf and Éad-wacer* 'Wolf and Edwaker'
- *Ymbe* = *Wið Ymbe* ('Against a Swarm')
- *Yng* = *Ynglinga saga* ('Saw of the Ingling')
- *Yt* = *Ynglinga tal* ('Tally of the Ingling'), Þjóð *Yt* in SkP 1
- *Æcer* = *Æcer-bót* ('Acre-Boot')
- *Þiðr* = *Þið-reks saga* ('Saw of Thedric')
- *Þdr* = *Þórs drápa* ('Drape of Thunder')
- *Þrk* = *Þryms kvíða* ('Lay of Thrim')

Manuscripts

For the sigla of manuscripts see the introductions to various sections.

Bibliography

List of Abbreviations

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General Introduction (incomplete!)

Note

What is this book? It is a book of poems, really, of songs—songs dating to the first millennium CE or some time thereafter. What is their nature? They were sung by the Germanic peoples about their Gods and heroes through Dark Ages, through the fall of Rome and the volcanic winter of 536, in ships and shores of England, in frozen settlements on Iceland and Greenland, in Danish fields, Swedish forests, and Norwegian firths, in English monasteries and the ear of Charlemagne.

Compared to the epic traditions of Classical Antiquity the Germanic songs of heroes do not tell of a very ancient past. On the contrary, many of them concern events documented in contemporary Classical sources far more accurate than these illiterate ballad-singers working centuries after-the-fact could ever aspire to be. But their goal was never historical accuracy. For them the old times were long past; who could faithfully recall them but the High One, the One-Eyed Himself? These were bards and storytellers and prophetesses, keepers of an ancient poetic tradition far predating the subjects with which it dealt. This was a tradition infused with the Indo-European spirit of the unending steppes and the snowcapped mountains, the soaring eagle and the galloping steed. In their stoic fatalism, in their tales of great love and struggle, deprivation and human tragedy, heroic friendship and betrayal, these stories were far older than the more factually correct mediæval chroniclers which chronologically predated them. In this way they were, in their oft rough-hewn simplicity, as old as Homer, as old as the Vedas—or maybe older still.

The Northern epics are the songs the Germanic-speaking West for many centuries forgot. We forgot them when we became just that, Westerners—Christians, Romans. It was Alcuin, the English scholar, who in a letter upbraided his less learned English brethren who would rather sing pagan Saxon songs about Ingeld than the Psalms of David—“what does Ingeld have to do with Christ?” he asked. It was Louis the Pious, king of the Franks, who burned his father Charlemagne’s great collection of German epic poetry. For these new men steeped in Roman learning, whose souls were circumcised, even if their bodies were not, the ethos of the old folk-songs was too warlike, too fatalistic, in a word, too *pagan*.

The echoes of the same stories in time suffered a tragic fate in England and the Continent. The heavily damaged copies written in idioms and hands far too archaic to be understood by later ages were cut up and used for their thick leather as covers for younger, more modern books. And yet measuring fate would not have it that they were, like so many other European pagan traditions, forever lost. It was on Iceland, that northern island outpost on the edge of the known world, where the songs of Gods and heroes lived longest upon the lips of hoary upholders of tradition. It was that most distant offshoot of Germandom, whose unyielding settlers sailed as far as Greenland and North America, which in time came to preserve what the center had lost.

The Codex Regius of the Poetic Edda, the last surviving storehouse of the songs of the Germanic gods, was rediscovered in Iceland in 1642. Together with the Prose Edda it laid the ground for the new field of the study of Germanic antiquity, which over time developed in lockstep with the evolution of Western science and culture in general and that of philology and linguistics in particular. Over the centuries it was joined by the rediscoveries of *Beowulf*, the Exeter Book, *Hildebrandslied*, the Merseburg charms, the Gallehus horns and countless other minor sources.

No work could aim to give a complete overview of all scholarly efforts since the 17th century. The goal of the present edition must only be to provide a small selection of previous insights, together with some new ones, which (it is hoped) may inspire the curiosity of the English-speaking reader and increase his or her understanding and respect for these very important, frequently very difficult texts.

The historical and cultural context

It is presupposed throughout this book that the Germanic-speaking peoples—the English, Scandinavians, Dutch, Frisians, and Germans—were originally united by much more than their languages alone; that these nations, although greatly splintered by the turns of history, ultimately share not only language, but a common ancestral culture, religion, and origin.

All Germanic languages—like the Romance languages from Latin—ultimately descend from Proto-Germanic. Unlike its contemporary Classical Latin, Proto-Germanic is a reconstructed language attested only in a few borrowed names and short, late runic inscriptions. Still, we have enough data to be able to reconstruct it confidently, and such reconstructions will appear throughout the book.

Proto-Germanic in turn derives from the wholly unattested Proto-Indo-European, from which also spring the Albanian, Armenian, Baltic and Slavic, Celtic, Greek, Italic, and Indo-Iranian tongues along with the now-extinct Anatolian and Tocharian and a likely myriad other now-lost languages. The Germanic branch most likely broke away from its closest known Indo-European linguistic relatives in the early 3rd millennium BCE and has developed on its own since, undergoing important changes in its sounds, word-heap, word-order, and grammar.

Around the start of the first millennium CE the Germanic family itself broke apart into three branches: the Northern, Western, and Eastern. Only the first two are presently extant. To the first belong the Scandinavian languages descended from Old Norse; to the second English, Frisian, Dutch, Low and High German (including Yiddish); to the third the extinct Gothic. It is generally held to be the case on the basis of a number of common innovations that Northern and Western branches form a single subclade, Northwest Germanic, to the exclusion of East Germanic (Kim 2024). Since the Wielbark culture, which is probably to be identified with the early ancestors of the Gots, emigrated from Scandinavia around 50 BCE, this forms a useful reference point for the time of the splintering of the Germanic language family.

The cultural affinities of the Germanic-speaking peoples are of course greater the further back in time one looks. During the Migration Period there was something of a cultural flow between all Germanic peoples, especially those who were not yet Christianized, as seen both archeologically and in later literary sources like *Wid* (Neidorf 2013). Customs like the husband's "morning-gift" to his wife on the day of their wedding or the twelve-man jury were spread far and wide by these expanding tribes, as was the two-stemmed naming system also found among other Indo-Europeans (in English e.g. Edwin < Old English *Ēad-wine* < Proto-Germanic **Auda-winiz* 'Friend of Wealth').

Nor were these affinities entirely lost on the tribes themselves. Both Gots and Longbeards (i.e., Lombards) remembered their old homeland of Scandinavia and many of the related tribes living there (Jordanes, *Getica* 10, 16–25; *Origo Gentis Langbardorum* 1, edited under the appendix to *Grm*); the Anglo-Saxons, too, never forgot that they had come from Northern Germany and Jutland (Gretzinger et al. 2022), nor that there were still related people living there (Neidorf 2013, pp. 173–176).

As for the religion, the worship of many Gods (the Eese, ON *ęsir*, OE *ēse*, Gothic *Ansis* in Jordanes, *Getica* 78, 79; cf. *Hamð* 25/1 n.) is attested throughout the historical and geographic range of the Germanic peoples, as are the use of sacred rings (the Gothic 'holy' ring of Pietroassa (Antonsen 2002, p. 280; MacLeod and Mees 2006, pp. 173–174), cf. Ambrose of Milan's letter 10:9 which suggests the wearing of bracelets by Gothic priests (Capelle 2010, p. 425); *Háv* 110, *Hild* 32), animal sacrifices, and certain forms of ritual warfare (*Vsp* 23 n.). Also widely attested is the worship of the gods Woden, Ing, and Thunder, the former of whom appears in His name Geat at the head of both Gothic and Anglo-Saxon genealogies (*Hamð* 25/1 n.).

Turning to shared ancestry, recent genetic advances have shown that the lines of linguistic expansion line up with signals of genetic kinship, and have in effect confirmed what earlier scholars of the 19th and early 20th centuries presumed, namely that speakers of related languages always ultimately descend, to greater or lesser degree, from a single group of speakers of a proto-language.

What the genetics show us is that the Germanic peoples originate in Northern Europe, chiefly Scandinavia and Northern Germany, and that the speakers of Proto-Germanic were genetically indistinguishable from mod-

ern indigenous Scandinavians. They in turn derived much of their ancestry from the early Indo-Europeans of the Pontic-Caspian steppe, who mixed with Early European Farmers to the west to form the Corded Ware Culture, which over time expanded in all directions (McColl et al. 2024).

In the West this early Indo-European culture formed the Bell Beakers who conquered Ireland and Iberia; in the South it formed the Italic peoples who eventually became the Romans; in the East it formed the Sintashta culture, or Proto-Indo-Iranians, whose descendants became the Iranians and Vedic Indians who founded the Zoroastrian and Vedic religions; in the North-east it formed the Balts and Slavs; and in Scandinavia it formed the Battle Axe and Single Grave cultures which eventually gave way to the Nordic Bronze Age, the ancestors of the Germanic peoples.

In all cases, including Scandinavia, the expansion of the Indo-Europeans was that of a warlike and patriarchal culture not unlike its later descendants, whether Roman or Germanic. Indeed, present-day native Scandinavians, who are largely the direct biological descendants of the Nordic Bronze Age, carry almost no ancestry from the Stone Age Scandinavian Hunter Gatherers that preceded them (Allentoft et al. 2024).

Although the genes for light eyes and hair colour were present already on the Pontic-Caspian steppe, it was in the later Corded Ware that the heavy selection for these traits was effected (Wilde et al. 2014; Ju and Mathieson 2021; Perretti et al. 2025), traits which to this day reach their highest frequency in Northern Europe (Frost 2006).

Germanic alliterative poetry

The historical and literary significance of the poetry in this edition may be thought of in two ways: as the beginning of documented Germanic literature and also as the last stage of an ancient oral tradition with distant Indo-European roots.

On the one hand, alliterative verse is the medium for the oldest indigenous Germanic-language literary monuments (the Gothic literature, chiefly consisting of Wulfila's translation of the Bible, being wholly foreign in origin). It is our earliest native source of knowledge about the Iron Age folk-life of Northern Europe and our most important source for the pre-Christian Germanic religion; it represents the worldview of the Germanic peoples in their earliest historical stages. As the earliest recorded medium for the transmission of song and story amongst the ancestors of numerous great nations it has to some extent influenced all later Germanic languages and literatures. The alliterative poetry, albeit together with Latin, Greek, and Hebrew models, laid the ground for the German *Minnessänger*, the *Nibelungenlied*, and Chaucer, which in turn precede such great writers as Goethe, Wagner, and Shakespeare.

On the other hand, this poetic genre is hardly a new art-form by the time we first encounter it in manuscript form in the 7th century Cadman's Hymn, nor is its characteristic feature, alliteration between initial sounds.

In the 1st century CE Tacitus (*Germania* 2) speaks shortly of the ‘ancient songs’ in which the Germani documented their mythology and history. He mentions the myth of three brothers, the sons of *Mannus* ‘Man’, who founded three tribes, the *Ingaevones*, *Herminones* and *Istaevones*. In their Proto-Germanic forms the names of the three tribes all begin with a vowel, and this is thus the earliest secure example of alliteration.

Tacitus may also give us the earliest example of the Germanic long-line, the same meter as *Beow* and the Poetic Edda, when he (*Germania* 40) lists the following tribes as worshipping *Nerthus*: *Reudigni*, *Aviones*, *Anglii*, *Varini*, *Eudoses*, *Suardones*, *Nuithones*. If *Nuithones* is emended to **Unithones*, which unlike *Nuithones* actually looks like a Germanic word, the list may be arranged into two long-lines, both with vowel-alliteration (Malone 1934; Malone 1936):

Reudigni, Aviones, · Anglii, Varini,
*Eudoses, Suardones, · *Unithones.*

A more secure example of the same phenomenon is found in the 2nd century, when Ptolemy (*Geography* 2, 11:7) lists the following tribes on the Cimbrian peninsula: *Saxones*, *Sigulones*, *Sabalingii*, *Cobandi*, *Chali*, *Phunusii*, *Charudes*. This example has the advantage of not requiring any emendation, and forms two clean long-lines with typical alliterative patterns (a a : a x, a x : a [x]) (Malone 1936; Neidorf 2013, p. 179):

Saxones, Sigulones, · Sabalingii, Cobandi,
Chali, Phunusii, · Charudes.

The most likely explanation for these early alliterations is rather straightforward: the Germanic informers recited the tribes in the order they had learnt them, namely as alliterative lists or rigamaroles not unlike what we find in later texts like *Wid* or the Icelandic poetic lists, the so-called *pulur* ‘thules’ (Malone 1936).

The earliest indisputable native attestations of the long-line are in runic inscriptions from the early centuries CE, the oldest of which is an early 3rd century sword-chape from Thorsberg moor in Schleswig. These inscription are edited in the pres. ed. under Runic Poetry.

In these finds we see not just the fully formed long-line but also examples of stylistic traits common to all later Germanic alliterative poetry. Thus the 5th century Tjurkö bracteate (DR IK184) calls gold *walþa-kurné* (dat. sg.) ‘Roman grain’, a kenning-like reference to the melting of Roman solidi; the 3rd century Thorsberg chape (DR 7) expresses being ‘famous’ with the litotes *ni waje-márir* ‘not ill-famed’ (cf. *Akv* 13/1); and the 6th century Noleby stone (Vg 63) mirrors the formula *rúnó ragína-kundó* (acc. sg.) ‘rune born of the Gods’ later found in the 9th century *Hǫva mól*, st. 80.

Of course, a far greater trove of rich expressions and images, many of great antiquity, is found in the extensive corpus of poetry written in mediæval manuscripts. In *Beow* and the Edda ‘sea-stallions’ sail across the ocean like in Homer; in *Grm* 38 the sun is drawn across Heaven in her chariot like in *RV*

and the Trundholm Sun Chariot; in *Beow*, *Heli*, *Akv* and other poems feasts are held in great chiefly 'mead-halls', not unknown from the archæology of the Nordic Bronze and Iron Ages.

The richness of the poetic tradition is expressed through a language of kennings, stock phrases and exclusive synonyms found only in poetry. Many of these synonyms are quite ancient, being Indo-European words otherwise extinct in all Germanic languages which find their last refuge in poetry. Such are the Old English *eoh*, Old Norse *jór*, corresponding to the Sanskrit *áśva*, Latin *equus*, all meaning 'horse'; Old Norse *týr*, corresponding to Sanskrit *dēvā*, Latin *deus*, all meaning 'god'; Old English *folde*, Old Norse *fold*, corresponding to Sanskrit *pr̥thivī*, all meaning 'land, (mother) earth'. The fact that many of these relate to the cult perhaps suggests that the Germanic religion was not as innovative as is commonly supposed.

What a comparative investigation reveals is thus that these poetic motifs and words are seldom uniquely mediæval, nor even inventions of the first centuries CE; instead they time and time again find parallels in texts and archaeological finds as old as the Bronze Age. The poems themselves are clearly much younger than this, but still not so young that their undoubtedly unlatinized authors could have been influenced by texts like the *Iliad*, which were still yet unknown in Northern Europe. Rather, they seem to retain ancient traditions which must have been passed down through an unbroken chain of poetry going back far into prehistory, to when the Indo-Europeans were still nomadic steppe-pastoralists and much of Europe was still covered by thick forest and marshlands.

Structure

To describe the structure of Germanic alliterative poetry it is first necessary to describe the general characteristics of the common Germanic alliterative meter as found in the earliest runic inscriptions, West Germanic poetry, and Norse Eddic poetry in the meter Ancient-words-law. The following description is thus not exhaustive, but does describe the bulk of the corpus.

Alliterative poetry has two primary structural elements: *stress* and *alliteration*. The exact count of syllables is less important, and end-rhyme is only used as a sporadic flourish.

Based on alliteration, words are grouped into *lines*.

Stress

Each syllable is classed as having primary stress (p), secondary stress (s), or no stress (x). Syllables with p and s are stressed syllables, those with x are unstressed syllables.

Primary stress is reserved for the root syllable in a word, which is not always the same as the first syllable. Compare the English word *beginning*, where the stress pattern is xPx; the primary stress falls on the syllable *ginn*-. Note that not all primary stresses are equal; the general rule is that nouns and adjectives have stronger stress than verbs.

Secondary stress falls on the second element in a compound word, e.g. *hęimr* in *jötun-hęimr* ‘Ettin-ham’.

No stress falls on inflectional syllables, pronouns and prepositions. The exception for pronouns and prepositions is that they can take primary stress if it coincides with semantic stress, e.g. in a statement like “It was *you!*”, or when a preposition is placed after the noun it modifies (e.g. *Beow* 19b: *Scędelandum in* ‘in the Northern lands’).

Alliteration

Alliteration is the resonance between two stressed syllables beginning with the same phoneme, e.g. *sand* with *receive*, or *great* with *begin*.

Any vowel or diphthong can alliterate with any other vowel or diphthong. *s* and the clusters *sk*, *sp* and *st* are counted as four distinct “sounds”.

Further, in West Germanic poetry, *g* and *j* can alliterate with each other.

In Norse poetry *j* and *v* can alliterate with vowels, the former always, the latter sporadically.

In the present edition alliterating sounds are marked with red font.

Positions

The smallest metrical division is the *position*, a concept related but not identical to the syllable. The position must be understood as broader than the syllable as several syllables can fill one position, whereas a single syllable can never fill multiple positions.

A short syllable followed by another syllable can resolve into a single position. Likewise several unstressed syllables can count as a single position.

Verses

A *verse* or *half-line* is made up of 4 positions—typically 2 stressed, 2 unstressed—arranged according to set patterns. These patterns form the core of Sievers’ description of alliterative poetry, and is the description followed here.

TODO: Sieversian types.

Lines

2 verses are linked together by shared alliteration to form a couplet or *long-line* (often simply *line*). They are separated by a short pause or *cæsura*.

It is not uncommon for editions of Old Norse poetry to print each verse on its own line, e.g. *Vsp* 2/1-2:

Ek man jötna
 ár of borna,
 þá’s forðum mik
 fōdda hofðu;

Editions of West Germanic poetry typically print each long-line on its own line separated by a space to designate the *cæsura*:

Ek man jǫtna ár of borna,
þá's forðum mik fǫdda hǫfðu;

The present edition follows the latter convention for all alliterative poetry, Norse or West Germanic, but replaces the space with the interpunct:

Ek man jǫtna · ár of borna,
þá's forðum mik · fǫdda hǫfðu;

The first verse (or *a-verse*) may have 1 or 2 alliterations, with preference for alliteration on its first position over the second.

The second verse (or *b-verse*) must have exactly 1 alliteration, almost always on its first stressed position.

Fits and stanzas

The long-line is the highest metrical division, but long-lines can be combined into complete poems according to either a *stichic* or *stanzaic* manner.

West Germanic poetry is typically *stichic*. This means that long-lines simply follow one other, often with enjambment, so that a new sentence begins in the b-verse.

In longer epic poems lines may be grouped into *fits* which are sections or cantos. The fit does not have a fixed length, but is generally around 70–85 lines long. The 3182-line *Beow* is divided into 42 numbered fits for an average of 76 lines per fit; the surviving 5983 lines of *Heli* are divided into 71 for an average of 84 lines per fit. It is probably not a coincidence that the length of the fit is similar to the length of shorter legendary poems like *3 Guðr* or *Hild*.

In *Heli* a new fit can begin on a b-verse. This does not happen in *Beow*.

North Germanic poetry is always more or less *stanzaic* and does not have fits. Each *stanza* consists of several long-lines, and enjambment is rare. The regularity of the stanzas varies by poem and meter, but there is a general trend towards stanzas of exactly 4 lines.

In 4-line stanzas there is generally a semantic division between lines 2 and 3; each group of 2 lines (4 verses) form a *helming* or *half-stanza*.

The corpus

The scope of the present corpus is large, and encompasses most of the alliterative poetry extant in Old Germanic languages. The poetry is divided into the following categories:

1. **Norse Mythic poetry**, i.e., that which directly treats the Germanic mythology. This category is exclusively Norse for the simple reason that no West Germanic or Gothic mythic narrative poetry survive.
2. **Norse Heroic poetry**, specifically the whole second half of the Codex Regius and then a few other works. With a few exceptions, subject matter outside of the Walsing cycle is not included.

3. **West Germanic Heroic Poetry** in Old English, Old Saxon, and Old High German.
4. **Poetry on Christian subjects.** This category includes explicitly Christian poems where the new religion or its mythology is at the core of the work. Christian heroic poems depicting native legends, like *Beow* and *Hild*, are not included.
5. **Galders**, i.e., alliterative spells and charms, both from runic inscriptions and mediæval manuscripts.
6. **Runic Poetry**, apart from that already edited under Galders above.

Exclusions

All Norse Scaldic poetry is excluded, as is the Eddic poetry found in the Saws of Icelanders and Saws of Antiquity (*forn-aldar sögur*). Three reasons justify this exclusion. First, these two categories of poetry have already been edited by the SkP series, in the case of the Scaldic poetry admirably so. Second, the underlying poetry is often impossible to take out of its prose context. Third, it is doubtful whether most of the Eddic poetry embedded in prose contexts ever had a life of its own or whether it was composed along with the prose. For these reasons I would only edit the poetry in its original context, that is, edit the whole Saws, which is an undertaking that falls far outside of the scope of the present edition as an edition of Eddic poetry.

Most non-legendary Old English poems are excluded. This includes poems on historical subjects embedded in the Anglo-Saxon Chronicle, the *Riddles of the Exeter Book*, and the Biblical epics.

Manuscripts

See the introduction to each category.

Old English poetry

The edited Old English poetry primarily derives from a few manuscripts. Particularly important are the Exeter Book (E) and *Lâcn*.

Old Saxon and High German poetry

There are no collections or anthologies of alliterative poetry in these languages; instead the manuscript situation will be discussed in the introduction to each individual text.

Dating

Ways of dating poetry, which naturally differ greatly for each text and tradition, will be brought up in the respective introductions to sections or poems as seen fit.

The general methodology for dating adopted by the present edition is however one that prioritises linguistic criteria rather than literary analysis or vague historical speculation. It has been shown for both the Eddic (TODO: cite Males) and Old English poetic traditions (TODO: cite Neidorf Dating of Beowulf) that mediæval scribes did not possess the necessary linguistic knowledge to produce archaizing poetry, or even to reproduce metrically required archaic features (e.g. the consonant cluster *vr-* in ON, for which see *Háv* 26/2 n.), and a text that displays linguistic features belonging to a certain century is thus taken to have been composed during that century. In this way the present methodology aligns closer with that upheld by scholars like Finnur Jónsson, R. D. Fulk, Leonard Neidorf, and Mikael Males and differs from that of Klaus von See or the “Toronto school” of Beowulf.

The presentation of the text

The present edition is divided into two equally large parts, presented side by side. Each stanza or group of verse lines is presented first in the original language, and immediately below in English translation. In the right margin is a list of manuscript witnesses for the particular passage. Below the English translation are two layers of notes. The first contains critical notes, and the second contains all other notes and commentary. Broader commentary or particularly important critical notes are linked to ALL, while more specific notes are linked to separate lines and lemmas.

The Old Germanic text

The present edition encompasses texts in four Old Germanic languages: Old Norse, Old English, Old Saxon, and Old High German. All texts have been normalized according to the author’s standardised orthography for the respective language. The orthographies are designed to follow three core principles:

1. A faithfulness to the spoken language at the time when the texts were written, and the distinctions demonstrably found therein.
2. A respect for the etymological origin of words, and their distinctions.
3. A striving for a uniform orthography across the various languages, so that the same sound, where possible, should be written with the same character.

These choices often stand in conflict with the orthography of the original manuscripts and with most earlier philological tradition, whence there is some reason to justify them. My goal is to render the texts themselves in a manner that gives as much philological information to the reader as possible—not to present a facsimile edition for students of paleography. This follows the philological methods used for printing e.g. the *RV*, which is generally printed in an entirely scholarly latinized orthography, not the original

Devanāgarī. Regardless, such important traits of the original manuscript tradition as the long *f*, arbitrary punctuation, arbitrary spelling, and lack of line breaks, are seldom reproduced in modern editions of Old Germanic poetry.

General orthographic conventions

The following orthographic conventions are applied for all Old Germanic languages:

1. The voiceless dental fricative is always written with the letter *þ*, never *th*.
2. Long vowels are marked with the acute accent, never the macron or circumflex;
3. Excepting those long vowels which have their origin in earlier diphthongs, which are written with the circumflex.
4. In compounds where the first element has primary stress the elements are separated with a dash (-);
5. But where the first element is a preposition or unstressed prefix they are separated with an interpunct (·).
6. Non-inflectional suffixes and derivations are marked with a double oblique hyphen (=).

Below follow specifications for each specific language.

Normalization of Old Norse

My Old Norse orthography is inspired by Finnur Jónsson (1932) in that it strives for a more archaic form than that of the surviving mss.; a form that instead represents the poetry as it may (in many cases, must) originally have looked. For this reason, it often has more in common with the proposed orthography of the First Grammatical Treatise than with the standard Old Icelandic orthography seen in most editions. The following list describes the differences from the standard Old Icelandic orthography:

1. I distinguish between short *e* (from etymological short *e*) and short *ę* (from etymological short *a* + *i*-umlaut).
2. I distinguish between long *á* and *ǫ́*, as done by the First Grammatical Treatise.
3. I use *ó* and *ę́* rather than the usual *œ* and *æ*, to represent the vowels descended from Proto-Norse *ó* and *ǫ́* after *i*-umlaut (cf. the short *ø*, *ę* < *o*, *a* + *i*-umlaut).
4. I distinguish long nasal *ǣ*, *ę́*, *ǿ*, *ǹ* from long oral *á*, *ę́*, *ǫ́*, *ú*, as done in the First Grammatical Treatise.

5. I restore the old *s* (which in modern Scandinavian and even in most Old Norse manuscripts has become *r*, but which is found in old manuscripts such as AM 237 a fol (c. 1150) and fossilized in forms like *þaz* (i.e., *þat*ʒ) in **R**) in the words *es* ‘which, that, where, when’, and in inflections of *vesa* (later *vera*) such as *es* ‘is’ (3rd sg. pres. ind.) and *vas* (3rd sg. pret. ind.). The following forms of *vesa* retain the *r*, as it is there the result of Verner’s law, and not of this (much younger) sound change: the pl. pres. ind. (*erum* etc.), the pl. pret. ind. (*vörum* etc.), and the pl. pret. subj. (*vérim* etc.)
6. When metrically benefactor, I contract *ek* ‘I’, *eru* ‘are’, and *es* ‘which; is’ to *’k*, *’ro* and *’s*, respectively.
7. I resolve *z* to *ts*, *ds*, *þs* or *ðs* depending on its underlying elements;
8. *x* is however still used instead of *ks*;
9. I follow Finnur Jónsson (1932) in distinguishing between the relative particle *es* and the verb *es*: the particle is appended to the previous word with only an apostrophe (e.g. *hann’s* ‘he who’), while the verb is separated by a space (e.g. *hann s* ‘he is’).
10. Where metrically beneficent personal pronouns are removed, often silently (cf. Scaldic poetry, *Vkv* 21/1–2 vs. 23/3–4, 1 *HHund* 32 vs. 2 *HHund* 18)

Normalization of Old Swedish and Danish

I generally employ the same conventions as those described for Old Norse above, including the marking of *u*-mutated *a* > *ø*. That this indeed occurred in the Eastern Nordic dialects is most proven by the third-person personal pronoun, which shows *u*-mutation in such forms as Swedish *honom* ‘him’ < *hōnum*, *hon* ‘she’ < *hōn*).

A few changes are specific to OSwe and ODan. According to rule 3 in the general orthographic conventions above, I distinguish between *ó* (< *ō*) vs. *ø* (< *au*, *ey*), *é* (< *ē*) vs. *ê* (< *ēi*).

Where all unstressed vowels have been reduced to a schwa-like sound, this is written with *e*.

Normalization of Old English

I spell fronted or brightened etymological *a* and *á* with *æ* and *ǣ*, for instance in *dæg* ‘day’ (< **dagar*) and *rǣd* ‘advice, counsel’ (< *ráðar*). These are contrasted with *ē* and *ǣ*, which represent *i*-mutated *a* and *á*, e.g. in *ellen* ‘zeal, courage’ (< **aljanq*).

An assimilated *n* is marked with an overpoint, like in rule 3 of Old Norse above.

Normalization of Old Saxon

Normalization of Old High German

The English translation

There is now a very large number of translations of the most popular alliterative poetic texts, namely *Beow* and the *Poetic Edda*. These generally fall into two camps:

1. *poetic* translations, which distort the precise meaning of the text for the sake of meter, often quite radically; and
2. *prose* translations, which nowise preserve the style or feeling of the original.

Almost all translations, of both types, also tend toward the following inadequacies: obscuring or glossing over difficult technical and cultural terminology; rendering identically repeated phrases and words (formulae) differently at various places; and simplifying or rewriting kennings and other poetic expressions. Even worse this is often done with little in the way of notes or commentary, to a point where the reader is sometimes left entirely oblivious to the sense of the original text.

What sets my translation apart from previous English translations is that it aims to closely follow the style and register of the original text, without sacrificing the literal sense of the words, e.g., by removing or inserting matter where it is not present in the original. The downside of this is that literality and consistency at times must come at the cost of fluid idiomatic English, but it has the advantage of giving the reader a good idea not just of *what* the original text says, but *how* it says it. The reader should keep in mind that he is venturing in a foreign land, that he is reading ancient and obscure words—not *The New York Times* or *The Guardian*.

Maybe this over-literality is a pointless effort? One could argue that a translation always is a betrayal, and that those truly interested in the exact sense of every word in the original text should study it in its original language. While I do agree that the sufficiently interested reader should learn the languages in which these texts were written (something greatly helped by the present parallel edition, with its notes and clear orthography), it is still a “hard ask” for those readers who are not philologically or linguistically inclined, but instead students and scholars of history, comparative mythology, religion, anthropology, or literature—those who, for whatever reason, are interested in exploring the oldest poetic heritage of the Germanic peoples of Northern Europe.

The proper nouns

The single most idiosyncratic part of the present translation will undoubtedly be its handling of proper nouns. I have opted to render all cultural and religious terms, names of places, heroes, gods, and other entities by their natural

English cognates (e.g., *Thunder* for Old Norse *Þórr*); and, where such do not exist, by their philologically expected English (so-called “English”) forms (e.g., **wallow* for Old Norse *vǫlva*). Due to the parallel original-language edition and index, it is hoped that no vital information will be lost by this decision; the reader wishing to know the original form of Webthrithner can either look in the Old Norse, or, if the case endings confuse him, peruse the index.

There are three reasons behind this choice. The first is ideological. It is my belief that the Old Germanic myths and poems and gods and heroes are a shared Northern European heritage. When one compares these mediæval texts from Germany, England, and Scandinavia, one cannot but notice the striking similarity of their diction, the reoccurrence of figures and formulae, and the common worldview. Likewise, the personages are frequently the same: the Scandinavian hero *Vǫlundr* is the same character as the English *Wēlund*, the Norse god *Óðinn* is the same as the English *Wōden*, and this is how they were understood by the native speakers of the old tongues. Since English is a Germanic language and its speakers the linguistic heirs of the Anglo-Saxons and Norse—in many case their direct descendants—and since these varying names are ultimately mere distinctions in pronunciation which reflect shared underlying forms, it was felt important and valuable to render them in the English translation by their natural or expected English reflexes. The forms of the names thereby serve to reflect the continuity between the speakers of modern English and those of the Old Germanic languages.

The second reason is one of consistency. If we are to restore well-attested names like Weden and Thunder, it would not be consistent to retain others in an unadapted form (e.g., to have Weden conversing with *Vafþrúðnir*, or Thunder with *Hárbarðr*), which would produce a highly discordant effect. Since the English names are to be restored in some places, consistency requires that they be restored in all, even where they do not survive in modern English (or even in Old English).

The third reason is one of linguistic aesthetics. It is an indisputable fact that the commonly accepted forms like *Odin*, *Thor*, *Midgard* et c. are debased. They do not even represent the Old Norse pronunciation as accurately as would be possible within the constraints of English orthography (e.g., *Odin* would be better anglicized as *Othin*). What is more, they are often difficult for English speakers to pronounce and lead to absurd errors and mispronunciations. The fluent reader of Old Norse cannot but shudder when he hears *ǣsir* and *ǫs-garðr* pronounced as /aɪˈsɪr/ and “ass-guard”, or when he sees *Jǫrmun-gandr* spelled “Jormangander”. The native English forms, on the other hand, fit well within English orthography, and their pronunciation is immediately recognisable.

Introduction to Eddic Poetry

The following two sections (Norse Mythic Poetry and Norse Heroic Poetry from the Walsing-Cycle) contain the bulk of preserved Old Norse Eddic poetry, most of which is preserved in only one manuscript, **R**. For this reason some notes about Eddic Poetry in general are in order.

Character

Old Norse poetry is conventionally divided into two categories: the Eddic and the Scaldic.

Eddic poetry is anonymous, composed in one of three meters (Ancient-words-law, Leeds-meter, Speeches-meter), and free from regular assonance or end-rhyme. It is easy to understand, uses kennings sparsely, and generally deals with heroic or mythological subjects.

By contrast, Scaldic poetry is usually attributed to named poets, is composed in a greater variety of meters (which apart from the three Eddic meters include the exclusively Scaldic Lay-meter and Court-spoken meter), and employs regular assonance or end-rhyme. It revels in purposeful obscurity by making great use of complex kennings and circumlocutions, and usually deals with historical or biographical subjects. It typically serves as praise poetry for a living king or other chieftain.

Although this categorization is not explicitly made in any Norse primary source, it is not entirely a philological construct, for it is clearly observed in Snorre's Edda. In the first book, *Gylf*, we find almost exclusively citations made from Eddic poems (68 out of 70 sts.) while the second book, *Skm*, has the inverse distribution (TODO).

Dating

Since Eddic poetry represents a mostly unified genre in a single language, it is useful to discuss some recent scholarly advancements in how this type of poetry can be dated. Dating the original time of composition is important, since it allows us to tell whether the religious or cultural ideas in these texts do in fact represent the views—indeed, the very words—of Germanic Heathens,

or whether they are the recollections—in the worst case, the fantasies—of Christian antiquarians.

Before we discuss the dating, we must, however, clarify what we mean by a *poem*. We shall assume that the poems exist as authorial works independent of their manuscript form, that is, that a copy of a given poem in a certain manuscript represents a single written documentation of a poem, but is not synonymous or to be conflated with the poem itself. The poem was composed as a single work by a single author; it can exist in multiple copies, and has most likely been transmitted both orally and scribally. On the other hand, scribes make errors, and are not authors in their own right (Males 2023b; Males 2024a; Haukur Þorgeirsson 2020). Even if they were, it is the primary goal of the present work to attempt get back to the wording of the original authors, be they Heathen or Christian, for it is due to *them* alone that these texts fascinate us so much more than the contemporary output of the same scribes.

The ways of dating Eddic poetry can be divided into two categories. External ways of dating rely on circumstances outside of the poems themselves. These are citations in securely dateable texts, the lifetimes of the original authors or other documented circumstances of composition, and the dates of the individual manuscripts. Unfortunately, the bulk of Eddic poetry is not cited in any texts older than Snorre's Edda (composed ca. 1220); we have no surviving information about the original authors nor the compositional circumstances (beyond the attributed Greenlandish origin of *Akv* and *Am*); and even if we were able to use scribal characteristics to trace the origins of certain poems back to the very beginning of Icelandic vernacular scribal tradition—and Iceland is where all surviving Eddic manuscripts were produced—that tradition does not commence until the 12th century, which post-dates the time of conversion by over a century.

Internal ways of dating instead rely on the language, meter, allusions, and ideas of the poems themselves, and it is in these ways that the chief scholarly advancements of the last few decades have occurred. These criteria can also allow us to distinguish different layers within a given poem. For example, we can say that the Dwarf-tallies, *Vsp* 11–15, are later inserts into that poem.

To pinpoint the absolute date of when a certain linguistic or metrical change has occurred we require some external reference point, but, fortunately, this is found in the Scaldic corpus, which unlike the Eddic corpus is largely ascribed to named authors working within clear historical contexts. It turns out that the Scaldic poems ascribed to the oldest poets likewise show the greatest concentration of archaic traits, and that some of these traits only occur in poems composed before certain dates. Comparison with Scaldic poetry is therefore our best bet to date the Eddic corpus. A landmark study in this direction is Sapp (2022), which, although certainly not perfect, has generally been favourably received, and shown that fruitful results can be obtained at scale from applying linguistic dating criteria derived from Scaldic poetry to Eddic.

The most important linguistic criteria are the alliteration between etymological *vr-* and *v-* rather than *r-* (pointing to composition before ca. 1000

CE, Haukur Þorgeirsson 2017), the use of *of* in prenominal positions analogous to West Germanic *ga-* (pointing to composition before ca. 1030 CE, Males 2025b), the frequency of the particle *of* in prenominal or preverbal positions analogous to West Germanic *ga-* (a trait strongly correlated with *vr-*, Haukur Þorgeirsson 2016, p. 54), the frequency of syntactical V2 violations in Ancient-words-law (a trait correlated with other early features, Haukur Þorgeirsson 2012), and the use of metrically required hiatus forms like *saa*, *fríi*, *séi* (pointing to composition before ca. 1150 CE). In addition to these, the forms of certain individual words (e.g. *haufuð* for *hofuð*, **Sig-vörðr* for *Sig-urðr*, *ffl* for *fflð*) can also point to an earlier date.

When it comes to content-based criteria, namely allusions to other texts and religious and cultural conceptions, these vary greatly from poem to poem and can hardly all be discussed here. One notable criteria is, however, the use of pagan god-names. It has been noted (TODO: cite) that the use of pagan kennings (e.g. *Hákm* 8/3: *Óðins veðr* ‘Weden’s storm [BATTLE]’) diminishes drastically in Scaldic poetry immediately following the conversion, and only rises in frequency with the Icelandic antiquarian revival of the 12th century. This observation can, however, be qualified further: while the names of gods like *Njǫrðr* ‘Nearth’ and *Ullr* ‘Wolder’ remain in use in kennings after conversion, not a single dateable Scaldic stanza composed after 1000 CE uses the name *Óðinn* ‘Weden’ in a kenning of any type, nor indeed in any other way save explicitly condemning the god. This is not the case for synonyms for Weden like *Yggr* ‘Ug (= Weden)’, and so it seems that there was a unique concern, not to say fear, about using the name Weden in particular.

Of course, Scaldic poetry has different purposes to Eddic poetry, and it makes far more sense for a 12th century antiquarian poet to insert the god Weden into his own heroic Eddic composition than for an 11th century praise-poet to mention the god in his pious eulogy for a Christian Norwegian king. Even so, it seems likely that little poetry containing this name would have been composed in the period intervening between the conversion of Iceland (1000 CE) and the antiquarian revival (beginning in ca. 1150 CE). Therefore, a heroic poem which shows both old linguistic features and the presence of this theonym likely must be quite old.

This illustrates an important point, namely that all content-based criteria must be considered critically alongside linguistic traits. We should not label poems late out of hand simply because they, for instance, portray pre-Christian gods in a humorous fashion (e.g. *Hárþ*, *Lok*), nor should the presence of an archaic archeological object like the ring-sword (*HHj* 9, *Sigsk* 68) make us conclude that the poem itself must go back to the Migration Period, when such swords were in active use. We cannot assume that pre-Christian poets never depicted the gods humorously (indeed, both *II* and *RV* do, and they are undoubtedly pre-Christian), nor that a 12th century antiquarian poet could not have known about ring-swords even if he himself had not personally seen them.

To illustrate the methodology, I wish to conclude with two complementary examples of content-based and linguistic criteria working together. When the term “burned” is used as a neutral synonym for “dead” in *Háv* 71/3, 81/1—

a poem which also features prenominal *of* and *vr*—it should be taken as a sign of pre-Christian composition, since cremation was a strong taboo in the post-conversion period (Males 2024b, pp. 93–96). Inversely, when *Am*—a poem displaying the sound change *vr* > *r*—and a very low occurrence of preverbal *of*—links cremation to stoning as a severe punishment befitting an evil woman (a practice belonging to Judeo-Christian religion) and mentions Greenlandish fauna like polar bears, it clearly shows itself to be a late poem composed after the conversion to Christianity and the settlement of Greenland (both ca. 1000 CE).

Manuscripts

Codex Regius (R)

By far the most important manuscript of Norse Eddic Poetry is GKS 2365 4to (siglum **R**), the so-called Codex Regius. It dates to around 1270 and consists of 45 surviving foll., containing 29 poems. **R** is fragmentary, however, and would originally have consisted of 53 foll.; see below.

R ought properly to be divided into two parts or sections: the first, on foll. 1–20, contains 11 poems (*Vǫsp–Grm*, *Ski–Alv*) dealing chiefly with mythology; the second, on foll. 20–45, contains 18 poems (*1 HHund–Ghv*) dealing with heroic legend from the Walsing cycle. Distinct scribal and orthographic characteristics show that these two parts have been copied from two separate source manuscripts, likely by the scribe of **R** itself (Lindblad 1980, esp. pp. 160–163). Their distinct origin is supported by the characteristic that **R** introduces the first poem in each part, *Vǫsp* and *1 HHund*, with a particularly large initial (Lindblad 1980, p. 166).

If we are to look for relatives of these two source manuscripts, it seems likely that **A**, described below, is a collection of mythological poems of the same kind as that underlying the first half of **R**. Likewise, a manuscript closely related to the heroic half of **R** has clearly served as the main source for large swathes of the younger *Vǫls*.

R is not a mere anthology of poems, but shows substantial editorial input in the form of prose segments, likely accumulated over time. A short prose section (*Lok* P1) ties two of the mythological poems together into a loose overarching narrative, though it is clear from their meter, style, and language that they are separate works composed by various poets over time. When it comes to the heroic poems long prose segments occur both within and between them, creating a saw-like prosimetrical form where the prose sometimes comes to dominate the poetry. The two long prose segments *2 Guðr* P1 and *Brot* P1–*1 Guðr* P1 are often edited as separate works.

As noted above, a large gap famously occurs in the heroic half, the so-called Great Lacuna. Between foll. 32 and 33 one quire, consisting of 8 foll., has gone missing (Lindblad 1977, 6 n. 2). Its contents are mostly unknown, but it would at least have included the end of *Sigrdr* and the beginning of *Brot*, alongside other now-lost poems or prosimetra linking together these two

poems. Some of the stanzas likely contained in the Lacuna may be restored from citations in *Vǫls*, and these are edited under *Vǫlsbr*.

AM 748 I a 4to (A)

Second in importance stands AM 748 I a 4to (siglum A). It dates to around 1300 and is in fragmentary state, consisting of just 6 foll. The beginning and end are absent, and between foll. 2 and 3 there is a lacuna, so that at least 3 (but probably more) foll. are missing.

A contains seven poems. On 1r–2v are found in succession the latter half of *Hárþ*, the full *Bdr*, and the first half of *Ski*. There is then the lacuna—Finnur Jónsson guesses that just one fol. is missing—and on 3r–6v are found in succession most of *Vafþ*, all of *Grm* and *Hym*, and the introductory prose to *Vkv*. Among mediæval mss., *Bdr* is only attested in A, while the other six poems are also found in the first, mythological, half of R. The order of the poems varies drastically between A and R.

A has no trace of R's frame narrative tying together *Hym* and *Lok* (and indeed the latter poem leaves no trace in A), but otherwise A and R do share a substantial amount of prose (*Grm* P1–P3, *Ski* P1, *Vkv* P1), a fact which proves that the two, rather than being independent witnesses of poems based on oral tradition, stem from a common manuscript archetype.

A is written in the same hand and on the same parchment as A_b (see below), a manuscript containing grammatical and poetic texts with which A was originally bundled.

Manuscripts of Snorre's Edda

Snorre's Edda or the Prose Edda consists of three sections. The first two—*Gylf* and *Skm*—contain quotations from several Eddic poems. Snorre reproduces stanzas from the mythological *Vsp*, *Vafþ*, *Grm*, *Ski*, *Lok*, and *Hdl* in *Gylf* and stanzas from *Alv* in *Skm*. In addition he cites several otherwise unknown stanzas in Eddic meters, of which at least some appear to derive from now-lost mythological poems. These fragments are all edited at the end of the present section under *Eddbr*.

The four main mss. for the Prose Edda are:

1. **S**: Codex Regius of the Prose Edda (GKS 2367 4to), dating to 1300–1350 CE.
2. **T**: Codex Trajectinus (Traj 1374), a ca. 1595 paper copy of a ms. closely related to S.
3. **W**: Codex Wormianus (AM 242 fol.), dating to 1340–70. **W** also contains the *Rþ* and the four Icelandic grammatical treatises.
4. **U**: Codex Upsaliensis (DG 11), dating to 1300–25.

When all four mss. agree on a reading, the abbreviation G is used synonymously with STWU.

Of these mss. S and T form their own stemmatic clade to the exclusion of W and U. Stematically, U is the most archaic ms., but unfortunately it has been heavily abbreviated and is filled with errors. This makes it a questionable source, especially for poetry. For detailed discussion on their internal stemmatics and origins I refer to Haukur Þorgeirsson (2017).

Parts of *Skm* are also preserved in three independent manuscripts:

- **A_b**: AM 748 I b 4° (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/AM04-0748-Ib>)
- **B**: AM 757 a 4° (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/AM04-0757a>)
- **C**: AM 748 II 4° (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/AM04-0748-II>)

The first two of these also preserve the short poetic treatise known as the *Lítla skálda* ‘Little Scalda’, which cites three mythological Eddic stanzas: *Grm* 41–42 and *Eddbr* VIII 1.

A_b also contains the Third Grammatical Treatise and a copy of the *Íslendingadrápa*, all written in the same hand. **A_b** is written in the same hand and on the same parchment as **A**, and it is clear that the two originally made up a single manuscript, something confirmed by the fact that they were found tied together into a codex alongside the unrelated **C**.

TODO: **B** and **C**.

Other manuscripts

A few other Eddic-style poems from various sources are also included in the present section, both under Mythic Poetry. As noted above, *Rþ* is attested in **W**. *Hdl* is found in **F**. In addition, a younger redaction of *Vþp* is found in **H**.

Abbreviations

The following abbreviations are relevant for the preservation of Eddic poems and will be used in the critical notes. Some stanzas are cited on their own in unrelated texts, especially saws, preserved in various other manuscripts; these will be discussed in their individual places.

- **A** = AM 748 I a 4° (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/da/AM04-0748-I-a>)
- **A_b** = AM 748 I b 4° (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/AM04-0748-Ib>)
- **B** = AM 757 a 4° (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/AM04-0757a>)
- **C** = AM 748 II 4° (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/AM04-0748-II>)

- **F** = *Flateyjarbók*, GKS 1005 fol. (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/GKS02-1005>)
- **H** = *Hauksbók*, AM 544 4° (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/en/AM04-0544>)
- **G** = STWU
- **N** = NKS 1824 b 4°, the main ms. of *Vǫls* (<https://onp.ku.dk/onp/onp.php?m9641>)
- **R** = Codex Regius of the Poetic Edda, GKS 2365 4° (<https://eae.ku.dk/q?p=eae/vols/text/1>)
- **S** = Codex Regius of the Prose Edda, GKS 2367 4° (<https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/GKS04-2367>)
- **T** = Codex Trajectinus, Traj 1374^x
- **U** = Codex Upsaliensis, DG 11
- **W** = Codex Wormianus, AM 242 fol. (<https://clarino.uib.no/menota/text/menota/AM-242-fol>)

Norse Mythic Poetry

Introduction to Norse Mythic Poetry

The present section contains almost all extant narrative poetry concerning the pre-Christian Germanic gods, most of which is found in the first half of *R*, and all of which is in Old Norse. Of all genres of Germanic poetry, the mythological is in fact the one of which we have the earliest mention. Tacitus, in *Germania*, ch. 2, talking about the ancient Germani, says that: *Celebrant carminibus antiquis, quod unum apud illos memoriae et annalium genus est, Tuistonem deum terra editum*. 'They celebrate in ancient songs, which is the only kind of memory and history among them, the earth-born god Tuisto.' In spite of this fact it is not due to any decision on the part of the editor that this type of poetry is exclusively in Old Norse, for outside of Iceland there survive no examples of this undoubtedly ancient genre. This must obviously not be taken to say that no such poetry existed, something disproven by the Tacitean quote above. In fact, as we shall see, many of the myths and gods dealt with in this genre are attested throughout the Germanic speech-area for a period of many centuries; in addition they show deep parallels to religious traditions as distant as Mesopotamia, India, and Egypt. And how should they have been told and transmitted through unreckoned illiterate ages if not in poetic form?

The poems

Types of poetry

The poems in the present section may be placed on an axis between the narrative on the one end and the gnomic on the other. Although almost every poem has some type of narrative progression, this distinction must be based on the nature of the bulk of the content and whether the narrative exists merely as a frame or whether it fills an important purpose in its own right. I will not classify each poem as gnomic or narrative, although the reader may easily do so himself. It may be said that on the far end of the narrative side stand *Þrk* and *Hym*, on the far end of the gnomic side *Háv* and *Alv*.

Exclusions

A few Eddic-style poems which one may encounter in other editions have been excluded from the present ed. It must be stressed that none of these texts should be relied upon for knowledge of the authentic pre-Christian culture and religion.

The main exclusion found in most modern eds. is the antiquarian *Svip-dags mǫl* ‘Speeches of Swedday’, which properly consists of the two poems *Fjöl-svinns mǫl* and *Grg*. Although found only in post-reformation Icelandic paper mss., both parts probably date to the antiquarian period of the 13th century; their late origin is proven by the fact that they contain allusions to Christianity and post-conversion language (e.g. *Fjöl-svinns mǫl*: 46/3 *jartegn* ‘evidence’, *Grg* 13/3: *kristin dauð kona* ‘a dead Christian woman’). The mythological references they do contain appear to be largely fabricated or derivative of earlier texts and therefore likely to introduce much confusion about the mythology on the part of the reader. They have also been translated by Pettit (2023) which justifies their exclusion; all references to them will be based on his ed.

Apart from *Svip-dags mǫl*, two other exclusions found in some older, though not in most modern eds., also merit discussion. The *Sólar-ljóð* ‘Leeds of the Sun’ is clearly late and Christian and is edited and translated by Carolyne Larrington and Peter Robinson in SkP 7. The *Hrafná-galdr Óðins* ‘Raven-Galder of Weden’ is undoubtedly a post-reformation pastiche as seen by its late meter and use of the Low German loanword *mál-tíð* ‘meal time’.

Short summaries

This section consists of fourteen poems.

Vǫp is the spae of a wallow, a Germanic seeress, brought back from the dead by the chief god Weden. She begins by narrating the events of creation, of the earth and the heavens and of dwarfs and men, before moving on to the coming destruction of the world and lastly its rebirth. The poem is mystical and contains numerous allusions to important myths; it serves as the major source for Snorre’s *Gylf*.

Háv is the god Weden’s wisdom, consisting of practical life advice about friends, wealth, wisdom and women, two romantic escapades, and lastly stanzas about runes and galders. It is by far the longest poem in R.

Vafþ describes Weden’s visit to the ettin Webthritner and the ensuing wisdom-contest between them as they wager their heads. The two ask each other numerous mythological and cosmological questions and in the mouth of Weden these soon turn to the subject of the end times; expectedly the god eventually comes out on top with an unknowable question.

Grm follows Weden as he sets out to test the hospitality of his former protégé King Garfrith as part of a wager with his wife Frie. The king is less than friendly and unwittingly tortures the god between two fires; Weden is however relieved by the king’s son, and in exchange gives him a great deal of gnomonic wisdom about the dwellings of the gods, sacred locations and objects,

the creation of the world, and finally his own nature. At the end the king dies by his own sword and his son is made king after him.

Bdr is a very short poem which sees Woden set out to find answers about why his son Balder is having ominous dreams; he brings a wallow back to life and asks her a few questions.

Ski sees the lovesick god Frey send his servant Skirnir in order to win him the hand of the beautiful ettin-woman Gerd; he does so by means of a curse.

Hárþ is a long argument between the god Thor and his father Woden, disguised as the ferryman Hœnir. The two stand on opposite sides of a sound and Thor begs to be let over; he is, of course, refused.

Hym is a humorous poem that tells how the god Thor and his companion Tívi set out to find a huge cauldron for the gods to drink out of. The two find themselves on a strange adventure as they go fishing with the cauldron's owner Hymer and Thor nearly pulls up the Míddensvartnir in what was undoubtedly one of the most popular myths of the Viking Age.

Lok sees the evil god Loki berate the other gods at a feast, giving personal and often quite graphic insults to each one and alluding to a number of less favourable myths; at last he is banished, caught and placed to be tortured until the end of days like a Northern Προμηθεύς.

Þrk is another humorous poem about Thor where the god's hammer is stolen by the ettin Thrym; in order to retrieve it he has to dress up as the goddess Freyja and pretend to marry the ettin, yet the poem ends with a great killing as soon as the hammer is brought out.

Vkv is properly a heroic poem, but is placed in this section as it is in R. The poem tells the story of the masterful supernatural smith Wayland, who is kidnapped and hamstrung by the tyrant Nithad and forced to make jewels for him and his family. Wayland takes his gruesome revenge by killing the tyrant's sons, impregnating his daughter, Beadhild, and flying away in a flight-suit of his own design.

Alv is a short poem where a dwarf asks for the hand of Thor's daughter. Thor tricks him that he will win her if he can only tell him the various poetic names for things (beer, sun, clouds, and the like); the dwarf does so, but in his foolish lust continues for so long that eventually the sun rises and he turns to stone.

Rþ tells of the fathering of the three social castes, the thralls, churls, and earls at the hands of the mysterious god Rígh, and the eventual establishment of kingship and elite runic knowledge. The poem is unfortunately incomplete.

Hdl describes how the goddess Freyja asks the mysterious Hindle to reveal the genealogy of Freyja's lover Óttar so that he will be able to claim his legitimate inheritance; the poem takes a mythological turn as Hindle briefly recounts the coming destruction of the world.

Following these poems I offer 11 fragmentary Eddic mythological stanzas or half-stanzas cited in *Gylf* and *Skm* under the section Fragments from Snorre's Edda (abbrev. *Eddbr*), where they are edited along with their sur-

rounding prose contexts. Many of them have likely belonged to now-lost Eddic poems and their inclusion completes the corpus.

Table of manuscripts

The following table shows the manuscript attestation for the included poems and their relative position in each manuscript. A *q* in *Gylf/Skm* represents one or more stanzas attested in quotation; for exact details see the individual poems.

Signum	R	A	W	H	F	<i>Gylf/Skm</i>
<i>Vsp</i>	1	-	-	+	-	<i>q</i>
<i>Háv</i>	2	-	-	-	-	<i>q</i>
<i>Vafþ</i>	3	4	-	-	-	<i>q</i>
<i>Grm</i>	4	5	-	-	-	<i>q</i>
<i>Skí</i>	5	3	-	-	-	<i>q</i>
<i>Hárþ</i>	6	1	-	-	-	-
<i>Hym</i>	7	6	-	-	-	-
<i>Lok</i>	8	-	-	-	-	<i>q</i>
<i>Þrk</i>	9	-	-	-	-	-
<i>Vkv</i>	10	7	-	-	-	-
<i>Alv</i>	11	-	-	-	-	<i>q</i>
<i>Bdr</i>	-	2	-	-	-	-
<i>Rþ</i>	-	-	+	-	-	-
<i>Hdl</i>	-	-	-	-	+	<i>q</i>

Spae of the Wallow

(*Vǫlu spjó*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.865)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Spae of the Wallow** (ON *Vǫlu spjó*, abbrev. Voluspa) is undoubtedly the most important Norse mythological text surviving from Heathen times. It is a spae (*spjó* ‘prophecy’) told by a wallow (*vǫlva* ‘seeress, sibyl, prophetess’) who has been summoned by Woden, the chief of the Gods, in order to relate the mythic history of the World.

Origin and parallels

As a repository of mythic lore *Vǫsp* resembles *Vǫlþ*, *Grm*, *Bdr*, and *Alv*, but it differs from most of the aforementioned works in two key ways: *Vǫsp* is a tightly structured spae rather than a motley collection of scattered mythological lore, and a monologue rather than a dialogue or riddle contest. The unique importance of this poem lies in the fact that it offers a complete chronological overview of the Norse mythic timeline of the World from its creation to its coming destruction and rebirth.

The understanding of this timeline is, unfortunately for the study of Norse mythology, troubled by several factors. The first is that the wallow continually speaks in the most obscure terms and relates the myths in an allusive fashion which presupposes that the audience is already familiar with them. The second lies in the way we have to understand these allusions, for while some are entirely unknown to us, we can connect most of them to more complete narratives in Snorre’s Edda. Snorre’s Edda is, however, not a perfect source and since Snorre is often relying on *Vǫsp* we risk running into circular reasoning. What is worse, in at least one instance (st. 38/1) Snorre shows willingness to alter the wording of *Vǫsp* in citation in order to fit his own narratives, which calls his reliability into question. The third factor is that

the witness manuscripts disagree over the order and inclusion of numerous stanzas.

In order to properly elucidate the myths and their broader religious and cosmic significance, we therefore have to take into account all available resources: comparative mythology, folkloristics, linguistics, historical sources, and archæology, and nowhere is this more important than in *Vǫsp*. Although the body of Norse pre-Christian poetry is rather small, the available material for a broader comparative study is truly vast, and since there is still a tremendous amount of work to be done there will undoubtedly creep in both omissions and errors. Even so, it is hoped that the present commentary along with that of the other poems included in this edition will provide new and interesting perspectives to the general reader, student, and scholar, not just of Germanic mythology but of the history of religions in general.

The wallow

As noted above, *Vǫsp* is narrated by a wallow. This figure represents the northern European belief that women, especially in elder age, were invested with a unique psychic or prophetic foresight, a power which became even greater when they died and might come into possession of truly hidden knowledge—knowledge perhaps unknown even to the chief god Woden Himself. In *Vǫsp* this ability of sight is reflected in the continual repetition of the phrase *sá hōn* ‘she saw’, or, in the later part of the poem, *sér hōn* ‘she sees’. In her trance the wallow *sees* the past and the future as if they were before her very eyes.

Accounts of famous northern European seeresses are found from the time of our earliest Roman sources. During the Batavian rebellion of the late 1st c. CE, the seeress Veleda (a Celtic word, cf. OIr. *filed* ‘seer’, Middle Welsh *gwelet* ‘id.’) of the Bructeri made herself famous for her *spaes*. Tacitus, *Germania* 8, mentions her by name when talking about the Germanic respect for women: *Inesse quin etiam sanctum aliquid et providum putant, nec aut consilia earum aspernantur aut responsa neglegunt. Vidimus sub divo Vespasiano Veleadam diu apud plerosque numinis loco habitam*. ‘Moreover, they think that there is in them something holy and prophetic, and they neither despise their counsels nor disregard their responses. We saw, under the deified Vespasian, that Veleda was held in the place of a deity for a long time among the multitude.’

In Jordanes, *Getica* 121, we find mention of the Gothic witches known as the *haliurunnæ*, thought to be the ancestors of the hostile Huns. Their name is clearly cognate with OE *helli-rūne* ‘witch, sorceress’, formed from *hēll* ‘hell, Underworld’ + *rūne* ‘whisperess, confidante’, thus signifying ‘those who convene with the dead’.

The Longbeards, too, were once led by a prophetic woman, Gambara, as told in their 7th c. *Origo* (see Appendix to *Grm*).

Woden

It was to acquire their knowledge that Woden in his incessant quest for wisdom undertook frequent journeys in order to question wallows and hell-

whisperers alike about events past and future, and *Vsp* is not the only Eddic poem reflecting that motif. The closest parallel is *Bdr*, wherein Woden summons a wallow from her grave in order to find out why the god Balder is having ominous nightmares. Woden's journeys to convene with the dead are also alluded to in *Háv* 158 and *Hárþ* 44–45.

For the god's general quest for knowledge there are numerous parallels: Woden's wisdom contest against the wise ettin Webthritner (*Vaff*), his theft of the mead of poetry (*Háv* 103–110), his self-hanging and acquisition of the runes (*Háv* 138, 139), and his giving up his eye to Mimer in exchange for wisdom (*Vsp* 28).

Cycles and eschatology

As has been impressively shown by Eliade (2005), pre-Abrahamic religions are centered around cycles and the power of *being* inherent in their return; they are based around cyclical mythic time rather than linear history. The sun at dawn, the new moon, the daylight at the winter solstice, the warmth of spring—traditional man did not think the return of these things certain. Rather, the sun, moon, year, and indeed the world itself had to be strengthened and re-established through rituals harkening back to mythic time and re-establishing Creation. So it is that modern man thinks little of that which traditional man worried about with great fright and consequently heralded with great rejoicing.

In the traditional worldview the world consists of nested cycles, a series of ever-revolving epicycles of rises and declines: the day, the month, the year, the human lifetime, and the world itself. Each must rise and fall, decline and be regenerated. In this way history is not linear, but cyclical; everything that is done has already been done before and in fact it is just this precedent which gives the present occurrence its realness.

Vsp focuses on the greatest cycle, that of the World itself, from its beginning as formless matter (3) through its Creation by the Gods (4–6) and Golden Age (7–8) to its gradual decline (8–42), destruction (43–55) and re-birth (56–62). Although the poem is not explicit about it, there is a hint that the seed of evil is not entirely defeated in the next world (cf. 62 n.), leaving the possibility open for yet another repetition of the cycle.

TODO: mention Indian yuga-s, Zoroastrian texts.

The Wiking Age eschatological fixation

One of the most important developments of the Germanic religion when compared with other Indo-European religions is its unique obsession with eschatology. Although the relevant myths are preserved only in the Norse literature, likely traces of the same are found on continental West Germanic territory in the form of the OHG *Musp* and the OS *Heli*, both of which use the likely pre-Christian inherited term *Muspilli*, also found in ON as *Muspell*; see st. 49/1 n. below, *Musp* 56 n.

To be clear, what distinguishes the Germanic (and specifically Norse) religion from other Indo-European systems is not the mere presence of ideas

of the destruction and rebirth of the World, which as discussed above are also found in Indo-Iranian sources, but specifically a fixation with the imminent Destruction of the World and most of the Gods at the hands of the evil cosmic forces during the so-called Rakes of the Reins (*ragna røk*).

We find allusions to the Destruction in a large number of pre-Christian Norse texts: many of the mythological poems (*Vsp* 43–55, *Vafþ* 17–18, 44–53, *Grm* 4/4, 17, 24, 40, *Bdr* 14, *Lok* 10/1, 39, 41–42, *Hdl* 41, 43), two Scaldic eulogies (*Hákm* 20–21, *Eirm* 7), and a few poetic pre-Christian runestones (Sö 154 Skarpåker, perhaps also Vg 119 Sparlösa and Ög 136 Rök).

The monsters of the Rakes of the Reins also figure iconographically, e.g. on the 10th c. Gosforth cross, which shows the god Wider slaying the Middenyardswyrn (*Vsp* 52, *Vafþ* 53). A common motif on pre-Christian memorial runestones is that of a single ravenous wolf, e.g. on N 84 Vang and DR 285 and 286 Hunnestad, perhaps the wolf Fenrer. Sometimes this wolf is accompanied by a ship (perhaps Nailfare, *Vsp* 48/4 n.), e.g. on DR 271 Tullstorp (Figure 1, p. 23) and Ög 181 Ledsberg. These pictorial funerary motifs should be considered in light of the literary evidence, most clearly in Sö 154, *Hákm* 20–21, and *Eirm* 7, which connects the destruction of the world to the personal grief felt by the individual mourner.

In the ubiquity of these allusions, including on memorial runestones, we see that the Rakes of the Reins were not a mere literary construct. The worry about the impending destruction of the world was felt acutely on a personal level by the practitioners of the pre-Christian religion. It is clear that the Heathens thought that the calamity was imminent and could come, as it were, “like a thief in the night” (cf. *Heli* 4358–61, pulling on Matthew 24:43, 1 Thessalonians 5:2). It is notable that the association is particularly strong in contexts relating to death, whether they be runestones for dead family members, raised by more or less normal people, or funerary poems for beloved kings, composed by elite poets. We do not know whether the practitioners of the religion found consolation in these eschatological events, but it is hard not to be moved by the feeling of the father who, having buried his own son, laconically proclaims that “Earth and Up-heaven shall be rent” (Sö 154).

The climate catastrophe of 536 CE

If we are to look for a historical explanation for the above-mentioned eschatological fixation, the most likely candidate is undoubtedly the climate catastrophe of 536–537 CE. TODO. Gräslund (2008).

Although ideas of the Destruction probably existed before 536, the plague, massive depopulation and accompanying social upheaval, perhaps alongside Christian apocalypticism spreading from the converted Gots and Vandals, likely led to a new form of religious expression.

Textual preservation and transmission

Vsp is attested in three independent recensions, R, H and G.

The most important recension, **R**, is the second oldest (ca. 1275 CE). This is the complete version of *Vsp* preserved in **R** on foll. 1r–3r, where *Vsp* is the first poem.

The other complete recension, **H**, is the youngest (ca. 1310 CE). This is the version of *Vsp* preserved in **H** (foll. 20r–21r), where the poem is found in the middle of an impressive collection of native Norse-Icelandic saws and learned Catholic works.

The third recension, **G**, is the oldest (ca. 1225 CE), and represents the stanzas of *Vsp* (3, 5, 9, 10–13, 15, 18, 24–25, 28, 37–40, 44–46, 48–54, 61) cited in *Gylf*, the first part of Snorre's Edda. This recension is fragmentary, though many now-lost stanzas belonging to it may be gleaned through Snorre's paraphrases of them. At times the paraphrases can provide important critical readings and serve as a tiebreaker for variants that differ between **R** and **H**, e.g. in st. 19/2, where *sal* 'hall' in the *Gylf* paraphrase agrees with **H** against **R** sę 'lake'. For the four mss. of *Gylf* (**S**, **T**, **W** TODO, and **U**) see the Introduction to Mythic Poetry above.

Table of stanzas

The order of stanzas varies greatly across the three recensions and is best illustrated by a table.

Stanzas cited in *Gylf* have been handled in the following way: those cited independently are marked with a plus sign, while those belonging to a sequence of several stanzas are marked with an incrementing letter based on the sequence and a number for its position, so that *A1* is the first stanza in the first sequence, *B1* the first stanza in the second sequence, and so forth.

When a stanza found in a manuscript is strongly divergent (e.g. st. 10, where *Gylf* 14:15 omits the first two half-lines), its mark is followed by a star.

The stanzas beginning with the formula *Þá gingu regin öll* 'Then went all the Reins' et c. are represented by the immediately following half-line.

<i>pres. ed.</i>	R	H	STW	U
1	Hljóðs bið'k allar	1	–	–
2	Ek man jǫtna	2	–	–
3	Ár vas alda	3	+	+
4	áðr Burs synir	4	–	–
5	Sól varp sunnan	5	+	+
6	... nǫtt ok niðjum	6	–	–
7	Hittu=sk ęsir	7	–	–
8	Tęflǫu ĩ tųni	8	–	–
9	... hveęr skyldi dverga	9	B1	B1
10	Þar vas Móð=sognir	10	B2*	B2*
11–15	<i>Dwarf=tallies</i>	11–15	+	+
16	Und's þrir kvǫmu	16	–	–
17	Qnd þau né ǫttu	17	–	–
18	Ask veit'k standa	18	+	+
19	Þaðan koma meęjar	19–20	–	–

	<i>pres. ed.</i>	R	H	STW	U
20	Þat man hōn folk-víg	21-22	27	-	-
21	Heiði hana hétu	23	28	-	-
22	... hvárt skyldu ęsir	24	29	-	-
23	Fleygði Óðinn	25	30	-	-
24	... hvęrr hefði lopt alt	26	22	C1	C1
25	Þörr ęinn þar vá	27	23	C2*	C2*
26	Veit hōn Heim-dalar	28	24	-	-
27	Ęin sat hōn úti	29	-	-	-
28	Alt veit'k, Óðinn	29	-	+	+
29	Valði hęnni Hęr-fęðr	30	-	-	-
30	Sá hōn val-kyrjur	31	-	-	-
31	Ek sá Baldri	32	-	-	-
32	Varð af meiði	33	-	-	-
33	Þó ęva hęndr	34	-	-	-
34	þar sitr Sigyn	35	32*	-	-
35	Ó fęllr austan	36	-	-	-
36	Stóð fyr norðan	36	-	-	-
37	Sal sá hōn standa	37	36	E1	E1
38	Sá hōn þar vaða	38	37	E2*	E2*
39	Austr býr hin aldna	39	25	A1	A1
40	Fylli=sk fęrvi	40	26	A2	A2
41	Sat þar á haugi	41	34	-	-
42	Gól of ęsum	42	35	-	-
43, 47, 55	Geyr (nú) Garmr mjøk	43, 46, 55	33, 38, 43, 48, 51	-	-
44	Bróðr munu bęrja=sk	44	39	-	-
45	Leika Mims synir	45	40	D1*	D1*
46	Hvat 's með ęsum?	49	42	D2	D2*
48	Hrymr ękr austan	47	44	D3	-
49	Kjöll fęrr austan	48	45	D4	-
50	Surtr fęrr sunnan	50	46	+, D5 (n.)	+
51	Þa kōmr Hlinar	51	47	D6	-
52	Þa kōmr hinn mikli	52	-	D7	-
53	Þa kōmr hinn męri	53*	49*	D8	-
54	Sól tēr sortna	54	50	D9	-
56	Sér hōn upp koma	56	52	-	-
57	Finna=sk ęsir	57*	53	-	-
58	Þar munu ęptir	58	54	-	-
59	Munu ó-sánir	59	55	-	-
60	Þa kná Hōnir	60	56	-	-
61	Sal sér hōn standa	61	57	+	+
62	Þar kōmr hinn dimmi	62	59	-	-
H31	Þa kná Váli	-	31	-	-
H41	Hręða=sk allir	-	41	-	-
H48	Ginn lopt yfir	-	48	-	-
H58	Þa kōmr hinn ríki	-	58	-	-

Summary

On the basis of its refrains and content, the poem may be divided into the following rough sections: introduction (1–2), Creation and the early age of the World (3–17), cosmological and mythological exposition and decline (18–42), Destruction (43–55), and Rebirth (56–62).

It seems that immediately prior to the poem's beginning, Weden has awakened the wallow out of her grave. He commands her to speak. The wallow's *spae* begins with a bid for silence, addressing Weden directly (1). She next recalls her earliest memories of being raised amongst ettins in the world of yore (2).

The mythic history of the world itself begins with the Creation (3–6) and the following Golden Age (7–8), which was brought to an end by the intrusion of three unidentified ettin-maidens (8). After this, the wallow describes the making of the dwarfs (9–10), whose names are listed in several separate *dwarf-tallies* which are without doubt later inserts (11–15). She mentions how the Gods next gave life and intelligence to the first human beings (16–17), and then describes the Ash of Ugdrassle (18) and the three norns living under it, who give orlay (fate) to mankind (19).

After st. 19, the order of the stanzas in the two full recensions—**R** and **H**—diverges significantly, and does not come to agree again until st. 43. With a single exception (st. 46), the order adopted for the present edition is that of **R**, but since it is hard to decide which one is more original both are summarised here.

In **R**, the wallow recalls how a woman named Goldwey was sacrificed and reborn three times (20), and how she, under the name Hode, practiced sorcery and witchcraft (21). She then recalls the first war in the world, between the Eese and Wanes (22–23), and the killing of the smith who was promised Frow and the sun and moon in exchange for building the wall of Osyard (24–25). This is followed by a cryptic verse describing the Well of Mimer (26). She then seems to tell of her own origin; how she was approached by Weden, who gave her rings and jewels in exchange for her wisdom (27–29). She then tells of the walkirries (30) and relates the death of Balder (31–33) and the subsequent binding of Lock (34). After this, she describes a sword-river (35) and two beer-halls (36), then the torture of criminals in the afterlife by Nithehewer (37–38). She sees Ironwood in the East, where the wolves who will swallow the Sun and Moon are being reared (39–40). She foresees the crowing of three cocks: one in Ironwood (41), the other among the Gods, and the third in Hell or the Underworld (42). After this, we get the first occurrence of the refrain-stanza of the destruction; it describes how the wolf breaks free, and is repeated several times throughout the part of the *spae* that deals with the destruction of the world (43).

In **H** the structure is quite different. The Eese immediately go to decide what action to take regarding the Master Builder (24–25), and the Well of Mimer is described (26). Then follow the two stanzas about the wolves which will swallow the sun and moon (40–41), and the story of Goldwey and the war between the Eese and Wanes (20–23). The stanzas about Goldwey's origin

(27–29), the walkirries (30), and the death of Balder (31–33) are left out of **H**, along with the sword-river and beer-halls (35–36), but it does describe the binding of Lock (34). Next we get the first occurrence of the refrain-stanza (43), then the crowing of the three cocks (41–42), and lastly the punishment of criminals (38–39). **H** then repeats the refrain-stanza a second time, and **R** and **H** are now almost completely aligned for the rest of the poem.

The Destruction of the world begins with numerous catastrophes and a decay in human morality: kinslaying, incest, adultery, and great wars become widespread (44). Homedall blows the great Yellhorn, the Ash of Ugdrassle is set ablaze, and a trapped ettin comes loose (45). The Eese, Elves, and Dwarfs are all distressed (46). Here the refrain-stanza is repeated again (47). Now the enemies of the Gods launch their attack: the ettin Rim drives from the east, the wyrm Ermingand writhes in the sea and propels huge waves, and the ship Nailfare comes loose (48). The ship drives from the east and is led by Lock and the Wol, both of whom have at last come free (49). From the south Surt brings a flaming sword to set fire to the world; there is a crack in Heaven and Hell is joined by many men (50). Weden goes out to fight the Wolf and falls, as does Free against Surt (51). Wider avenges Weden by killing the Wolf (52), while Thunder and the Wyrms kill each other; the great battle leaves the world uninhabited (53). Instead of 52, **H** has a stanza describing how the Wyrms gapes over the entire world, and how Thunder will ‘meet its venom’ (H48). The Destruction culminates in the sun turning black, the stars disappearing, and the earth sinking into the sea. The whole world burns (54). The refrain-stanza repeats a final time (55).

The world is reborn. The earth rises from the sea and soon turns green again; the cycle of nature is renewed (56). The surviving Eese find each other on the Idewold, where they had first settled, and reminisce (57). A new Golden Age begins (58). The fields grow high without toil and Hath and Balder reconcile (59). Heener becomes the head priest of the Gods and the sons of Hath and Balder settle the sky (60). The wallow sees a fair, golden hall in which virtuous generations reside (61), but her vision concludes with the sight of a flying, dusky dragon—it is Nithehewer, carrying corpses in its mouth, a sign that there is still a seed of evil left in the new world. With this portent she sinks back down into her grave (62).



Figure 1: The Tullstorp stone (DR 271), showing a wolf above a ship, perhaps the Fenrerswolf and Nailfare. The inscription is a memorial and not related to the iconography. Wiking Age, ca. 1000 CE. © Jorchr. CC BY-SA 4.0. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Tullstorpstenen,_DR_271,Tullstorp_1-1,_Runristning.jpg

Text

- 1 „Hljóðs bið'k allar · hēlgar kindir, [R 1r/2, H 20r/1]
 2 mēiri ok minni · mōgu Hēim·dalar;
 vilt at, Val-fōðr, · vēl fram tēlja'k
 4 forn spjōll fira, · þau's frēmt of man.

“FOR HEARING I ASK all holy tribes [GODS],
 [and] the greater and lesser sons of Homedall [MEN].
 Thou wouldst, O Walfather, that I well tell forth
 the ancient sayings of men, the earliest I recall.

1 Hljóðs | The H is an ornamented initial 5 lines in height, noticeably taller than any other initial save the one introducing 1 HHund, in R; introduced by a small initial 2 lines in height in H. 1 hēlgar ‘holy’ | so H; om. R

ALL | The wallow has just been awoken from her grave (cf. st. 62/4b below) and commences her speech by asking for the silence of gods and men, a meristic expression (West 2007, pp. 99–100). The whole introductory formula has Indo-European parallels; see West (2007, pp. 63, 92–93, 312).

1 Hljóðs bið'k ‘For hearing I ask’ | This is the only call for hearing found in an Eddic poem, but many parallels are found in Scaldic praise poetry, most often involving the related words *hljóð* ‘hearing’ and *hlýða* ‘hear, listen’ (Wood 1960, pp. 424, 250). Examples abound (see Wood 1960), but most notably among them, the same introductory expression is found in Eyel’s Head-ransom (Egill Hfl 2 in SkP 5): *hljóðs biðjum þann* ‘for hearing we [I] ask him’.

1 hēlgar ‘holy’ | That the omission of this word in R is nothing more than a scribal error is clearly shown by the meter; the a-verse in *Hljóðs bið ek · allar kindir* is only three syllables long and has highly unnatural alliteration on the unstressed pronoun *ek* rather than the first nominal *hljóðs*.

2 mēiri ok minni ‘greater and lesser’ | It is ambiguous to which noun phrase these adjectives belong. It can either be (a) “all greater and lesser holy tribes”, which might be equivalent to the phrase Eese and Elves (earthly and heavenly supernatural beings; see Index for occurrences), or (b) “the greater and lesser sons of Homedall”. (b) is preferred as the simpler reading since it avoids enjambment. The sense of “greater or lesser” is then more likely to be literal and physical (i.e., the younger and older members of the audience) rather than figurative (i.e., the varying social classes).

2 mōgu Hēim·dalar ‘sons of Homedall [MEN]’ | Usually interpreted as a kenning for MEN on the basis of *Rþ*, according to which Homedall sired the three social classes of mankind. This convention is followed here as it is felt to give the better sense and conforms to the Indo-European poetic phrase “gods and men” (see note to ALL), but such a kenning is otherwise unparalleled. A more typologically likely interpretation, following Meissner (1921, pp. 23, 252), would be to see *mēgir* in the sense ‘lads, comrades’. This makes the kenning equivalent to *Hropts mēgir* ‘Roft’s lads’ (*Lok* 45/3), *allar áttir Ingvi-Frēys* ‘all the kin of Ing-Free [GODS]’ (*Haustl* 10), *Njarðar niðjar* ‘Nearth’s kinsmen’ (Hfr Lv 10 in SkP 5).

3 Val-fōðr ‘Walfather’ | That is, the ‘Father of the Slain’, a name for Weden. The wallow probably uses this name since Weden, acting in his role as necromancer and psychopomp, has just awoken her out of her grave (perhaps with a *val-galdr* ‘slain-galder’ as in *Bdr* 4/3 and *Háv* 158).

4 þau's frēmt of man ‘which I earliest recall’ | Cf. *Vafþ* 34–35 with similar phrasing.

- 2 Ek man jōtna · ár of borna, [R 1r/4, H 20r/2]
 2 þa's forðum mik · fōdda hōfðu;

4 níu man'k hęima, · níu ĩ-viðjur,
 mјot-við męran · fyr mold neðan.

I recall Ettins born of yore,
those who formerly had reared me.
I recall nine Homes, nine Inwithies,
the famed Measure-Tree beneath the soil.

3 ĩ-viðjur | so RH; previously read 'iviði' in R, but this was made obsolete by an x-ray scan undertaken by Stefan Karlsson (1979) which revealed a previously overlooked abbrev. mark standing for -ur.

3 níu ... hęima 'nine Homes' | Or 'nine realms'. The identity of these is by no means clear nor is there any canonical list of which realms are supposed to be included.

3 ĩ-viðjur 'Inwithies' | Evil-working women or ogresses; their identity is by no means clear. The f. jón-stem ĩ-viðja also appears in a list of poetic synonyms for trollwomen (Þul Trollkvenna 3 in SkP 3). A commonly suggested etymology is í 'in' + viðr 'tree, forest' (i.e., 'tree, forest-dwellers'), but this would be an unusual formation and leaves the -j- unexplained. A more plausible etymology is a derivative of *ĩ-við 'malice', attested in the cpd. ĩ-við-gjarn 'malicious' (Vkv 28). This derivation can also explain the -j-, since the WGmc. cognates OE *in-wid*, OS *in-wid*, and OHG *in-wit* show it to be a neutr. *ja*-stem.

4 mјot-við męran · fyr mold neðan. 'the famed Measure-Tree beneath the soil.' | Probably the Ash of Ugdrassle, still but a seed. The sense of mјot-viðr 'Measure-Tree' is not clear. It is probably not the mјotuðr in 45/1 below.

2 3 Ár vas alda · þar's Ymir byggði,
 vas=a sandr né sęr, · né svalar unnir;
 jorð fann=sk ęva · né upp-himinn;
4 gap vas ginnunga, · ęn gras hvęr=gi,

It was early of ages where Yimer dwelled;
there was not sand nor sea nor cool waves.
Earth was never found nor Up-heaven;
there was the gap of hawks [AIR/MIDSPACE] but grass nowhere,

[R 1r/6, H 20r/4,
S 2r/25, T 3r/2,
W TODO, U TODO]

1 alda | halda S 1 þar's Ymir byggði 'where Yimer dwelled' | þat's ękki vas 'when nothing was' STW; þar's ękki vas 'where nothing was' U 2 sęr | sjár W; sjór HU 2 svalar unnir | †sva†, with a large space following T 3 ęva 'never' | ęigi 'not' STU 4 hvęr-gi 'nowhere' | ękki 'not' HSTW

ALL | The wallow begins her retelling of the mythic history of the World. Told in sts. 3–4 is the creation of the Earth and the Heavens. Other Norse poetic sources for the creation are *Grm* 41–42 and *Vafþ* 21. A Christian creation hymn apparently drawing on older pagan sources is the OHG *Wessobrunn* edited below under Poetry on Christian Subjects; cf. also the more thoroughly Christian *Cadman* in the same section. The beginning of the Norse creation narrative is treated at length in *Gylf* 4–5, according to which the world first consisted of two extremities: the frozen Nivelham in the north and the burning Muspellsham in the south. From Nivelham the icy venomous rivers called the Ilewaves rushed forth until they lost their momentum and froze to ice, while from Muspellsham flowed burning lava. The ice and the lava met in the Gap of Hawks (*Ginnunga-gap*, which *var svá blętt sem lopt vind-laust* 'was as calm as windless air', *Gylf* 5:7) and there combined to form the first being, Yimer.

1 Árvas alda ‘It was early of ages’ | By these words the wallow begins her narrative in mythic time, in the earliest age (*gld.* cf. st. 44/4–5 below), *in illo tempore*. It is formulaic for a mythological or heroic-legendary Eddic poem to begin with *ár* ‘of yore, early’; cf. *Hym* 1/1, *1 HHund* 1/1 (which likewise has *Árvas alda*, prob. borrowed from the pres. st.), *1 Guðr* 1/1, *1 Sigsk* 1/1.

1 Ymir ‘Yimer’ | The first ettin, from whom the rest were begotten, at first a- or ambisexually. Yimer was the Heaven and Earth conjoined and as such hermaphroditic, containing both a male (heavenly) and female (earthly) aspect. He is described in *Gylf* 5:8: *Ok þá er móttisk brimin ok blér hita’ns súa at bráðnaði ok draup, ok af þeim kviku-dropum kviknaði með krapti þess er til sendi hita’nn, ok varð manns líkandi, ok var sá nefndr Ymir.* ‘And when the rime-frost and hot air from the heat met so that it thawed and dripped, then from those flowing droplets there arose a life with the power which brought the heat and became the likeness of a man, and he was named Yimer.’ The comparative mythological idea of Yimer as the reflex of a PIE cosmic twin must be disregarded, for his name derives from PIE **ymH-yós*, which, although ultimately from the root **yemH-* ‘twin’ (whence OI *Yamá* ‘twin’), is most closely related to Latvian *jumis* ‘paired couple, double fruit’ (Kroonen 2013, p. 274) and thus seems to suggest hermaphroditism or the union of the copulating Earth-Heaven. Yimer is probably (so *Gylf* 5:9) to be identified with the ambisexually reproducing first ettin Earyelmer in *Vafþ* 30–33. Comparatively he corresponds to the sexually joined *Oûpavós* (‘Heaven’) and *Γαῖα* (‘Earth’) prior to the castration of the former at the hands of their son *Kpóvos* (‘the Cutter’; *Theog* 159–172), who was only later identified through folk etymology with *Xpóvos* (‘Time’). This violent separation ended the primæval hermaphroditic begetting and ushered in the patriarchal rule of the male Sons of Byre; it is of note that Yimer, like *Oûpavós*, is described as evil (*Gylf* 5:15).

Yimer further resembles the Vedic *Puruṣa* and the Chinese *Pangu* in his role as the primæval being from whose body parts the World is shaped (Witzel 2017). Cf. *Vafþ* 21, *Grm* 43 n.

3 þorð ... né upp-himinn ‘Earth ... nor Up-heaven’ | A well-attested formulaic cosmological word-pair found in all four Old Germanic languages with alliterative poetic traditions (ON, OE, OS, and OHG), especially in the context of the creation and destruction of the world. See Index: Earth and Up-heaven.

4 gap was ginnunga ‘there was the gap of hawks [AIR/MIDSPACE]’ | *gap ginnunga* ‘gap of hawks’ has usually been interpreted on the basis of the cosmogony in *Gylf* 4–5, where Snorre presents the *Ginnunga-gap* ‘Gap of Hawks’ as a primordial physical location where cold and hot elements combine to form the first differentiated cosmic being, Yimer, in the place where the Earth will later be situated. For this reason the phrase is typically rendered in translation simply as “Ginnungagap” and explained as a sort of supernatural void. The present stanza, however, is the only conjunction of the words *gap* and *ginnunga* outside of Snorre’s Edda, and his cosmogony is very peculiar. There is therefore good reason to reexamine these two words in the present context in order to determine the exact nature of the ‘gap’.

To begin with, we must reject the traditional renditions “yawning gap” or “supernatural void” as unlikely. The former may be eliminated immediately since the off-connected ON verb *gína* ‘yawn, gape’ has a different root (*gin-*) than *ginnunga* (*ginn-*) and since there is no clear derivation from *gína* to *ginnunga*, which in any case must be a noun, not an adjective and certainly not a participle. *ginnunga* has been explained variously. Finnur Jónsson (1932) sees it as gen. sg. of **ginnungi* (from the lost equivalent to OE *ginne* ‘wide, spacious’ + the nominal suffix *-ungi*). This is, however, a strange and decidedly non-Norse construction, especially since the suffix *-ungi* forms masculine nominals with animate senses, not abstract nouns. A more common explanation is to see *ginnunga* as gen. of a pl. **ginnungar* ‘supernatural beings’, derived from *ginn-* ‘yin-’ in expressions like *ginn-rúnar* ‘yin-Runes’, *ginn-þeilog* *goð* ‘yin-holy Gods’, and *ginn-regin* ‘yin-Reins’. It is not at all clear that *ginn-* means ‘supernatural’; it is more likely to be cognate with OE *ginne* ‘wide, spacious’, and thereby serves to strengthen the nouns it follows (e.g. ‘vast runes’, etc.). This explanation also requires us to assume the existence of nebulous ‘supernatural beings’ called ginnings in the primæval nothingness, an idea for which there is no support.

I find a much more natural reading in Meissner, who sees *gap ginnunga* as a kenning ‘gap of hawks [AIR/MIDSPACE]’, where *ginnunga* is gen. pl. of the well-attested poetic word *ginnungr* ‘hawk’. The proposed kenning is conventional and belongs to the type “land, path of the bird [AIR]” (Meissner 1921, p. 108). Indeed, the determinant *ginnungr* is also found in a sky-kenning in *Haustl* 15: *gll endi-lög ginnunga vé* ‘all the low mansions of hawks [SKIES] from end to end’. This interpretation is confirmed by an underappreciated passage in *Skm* 74 which lists *ginnunga-gap* among poetic synonyms for the air: *Lopt heitir ginnunga-gap ok meðal-beimr, fogl-beimr, veðr-beimr*. ‘Air is called *ginnunga-gap* (‘gap of hawks’) and middle-home, bird-home, weather-home.’ The sense of *Vsp*’s *gap ginnunga* ‘gap of hawks’ is thus the same as *Haustl*’s *vé ginnunga* ‘mansions of hawks’, viz. ‘air, atmospheric sky’.

Having determined the likely sense of the phrase, we should consider its significance in the present context. This requires a cosmological excursion. The Old Germanic pagan cosmology, like that of many other ancient religions (e.g. the Vedic with its two *ródasi* ‘World-Halves’, *ṚV* 1.10.8, 5.85.3, 7.86.1, et c.) sees the cosmos as consisting of two world-halves: Earth and Up-heaven, the land of Men and the land of Gods. The Earth is held to be a flat disc, while the Heaven (or Firmament) is a round dome above it, held up by four dwarfs (ON *dvergar* ‘dwarfs’ can also mean ‘structural pillars’) lest it fall down (*Gylf* 8:10; cf. *Arn Þorfr* 24 in *SkP* 2). Both Earth and Heaven are believed to be physically solid realms and made out of different parts of Yimer’s body: the Earth from his torso, the Heaven from his skull (*Grm* 41, *Vafþ* 21). Like the Biblical Firmament, the Heaven is made out of stone (cf. *Hárþ* 15), which also explains the falling of meteors.

Between the two solid World-halves are the atmospheric skies, the Air (ON *lopt*) or the Midspace (ON *meðal-beimr* ‘middle-home’) equivalent to the *antárikṣam* of the Vedic hymns (e.g. *ṚV* 4.40.5, 5.85.3), wherein the clouds—Yimer’s brains—float (*Grm* 42). The important distinction between the empty skies and the solid Up-heaven or Firmament is seen in the aforementioned *Haustl*, which distinguishes between the ‘low SKIES’ (*Haustl* 15) and *upp-himinn* ‘Up-heaven’ (*Haustl* 16).

To conclude, the primordial state expressed in the present stanza is one where there is only emptiness or Chaos (cf. *Vafþ* 25/2 n.), while Earth and Stoney Heaven are still monstrously conjoined in the body of Yimer.

- 4 áðr Burs synir · bjǫðum of ypðu,
2 þeir es Mið-garð · męran skópu;
 sól skęin sunnan · á salar stęina;
4 þá vas grund gróin · grǫnum lauki.

[R 1r/8, H 20r/5]

before the Sons of Byre raised the flatlands,
they who created famed Middenyard.
The sun shone from the south on the stones of the hall;
then was the ground grown with green leek.

ALL | The Sons of Byre, the first Gods, came to life subsequent to Yimer. They sacrificed the primordial ettin through decapitation and created the World out of his body, as told in *Grm* 41–42, *Vafþ* 21, and *Gylf* 6–8.

1 Burs synir ‘the Sons of Byre’ | In *Gylf* 6:8–10 identified as the three brothers Weden (ON *Óðinn*), Will (*Vili*), and Wigh (*Ve*), the first Gods. For their identities cf. st. 16/2: *ęsir* n. below.

1 bjǫðum of ypðu ‘raised the flatlands’ | The verb *yppa* is a causative derived from ON *upp* ‘up’, *uppi* ‘above, up, on high, remembered’ (cf. below st. 15/6a). In poetry it typically means ‘extol, lift up, announce’. Its OE cognate *yppan* means ‘bring up, bring forth, reveal’.

There is an apparent contradiction here, since the verb seems to imply that the earth was covered by the sea, something clearly stated in st. 56 below. This is problematic since st. 3/2 say plainly that there was neither earth nor sea before the lifting. With this in mind the present verse can be understood in two ways. (1) According to *Gylf* 7:3–5, the killing of Yimer flooded the world with so much blood that it drowned all the ettins save for Bearyelmer and his family, who survived by taking refuge on his canoe (*lúðr*, see *Vafþ* 35 for discussion on this word and a citation of the relevant passage). Thus, the present verse would likewise allude to this primæval post-sacrificial flood and the subsequent raising of the Earth, Yimer's blood-covered body. (2) If the G version of l. 3/1b (*þat's ekki vas* 'when nothing was') is authorial, the wallow may not have intended to allude to the myth of Yimer at all, but may instead have been thinking of something like Genesis 1:2, 9–10, where Elohim makes the dry land rise up from the deep Waters. Something similar is found in *Il* 14.201 and 246, which state that Ὠκεανός, Ocean, is the origin of all Gods and, indeed, of all things. The problem with explanation (2) is that it does not resolve the contradiction: st. 3/2 still states plainly that there was not yet any sea before the Sons of Byre, and the boundless sea should still count as a sea. The parallels also fall: Greek Ocean is equivalent to the Illeaves, the primæval venomous waters whence himself Yimer originated (*Vafþ* 31), and the Biblical Creation myth is certainly a secondary development from earlier pagan mythology. As such, (1) should be preferred.

2 *Mið-garð* 'Middenyard' | The Middle Enclosure, which was created as the home of Men (*Grm* 42).

4 *grønnum lauki* 'green leek' | A sign of the golden age, for the leek (in the Old Germanic languages referring more broadly to any plant of the genus *Allium*) was in ancient times held to be the noblest plant. See Index.

- 5 **Sól** varp **sunnan**, · **sinni** Mána,
2 **hendi** hinni **hógr**i · of **himin-jöður**;
 Sól þat né vissi, · hvar hön **sal**i átti;
4 **Máni** þat né vissi, · hvat hann **meggins** átti;
 stjörnur þat né vissu, · hvar þér **staði** óttu.

[R 1r/11, H 20r/7,
S 3r/21, T 4r/2,
W TODO, U TODO]

The Sun cast from the south—the Moon's companion—
her right hand over heaven's rim.
The Sun knew not where halls she had;
the Moon knew not what sort of might he had;
the Stars knew not where seats they had.

1–2 *Sól* ... *himin-jöður* 'The Sun ... heaven's rim' | *om.* G. 2 of *himin-jöður* 'over heaven's rim' | *composite*; of *himin-þiodyr†* R; of *jöður* H. 4–5 *Máni* ... *óttu* 'the Moon ... they had.' | *These lines are reversed (i.e., Sun, Stars, Moon) in RH.*

ALL | The Sun lifts herself up over the horizon and rises for the first time, but she does not know her proper course. The heavenly bodies are thus in a state of confusion and chaotic disorder.

1 *sinni* Mána 'Moon's companion' | At times mistranslated as 'her moon', understanding *sinni* as dat. sg. f. of *sinn* 'its (reflexive)'. This cannot be correct since ON possessives are inflected based on the gender of the noun possessed, not the gender of the possessor. *máni* 'moon' is masculine, and so 'her moon' would be **sinum Mána*.

2 of himin-jǫður ‘over heaven’s rim’ | A problematic line. (1) The reading of **R** may be normalised as *of himin-jǫ-dýr* ‘over the heaven-horse-beast(s)’ (so some recent eds., e.g. Pettit 2023), but such a compound is nonsensical and gives the whole verse the otherwise unattested stress pattern *x#pxSS*. On the other hand, the reading of **H** (*of iǫður* ‘over the rim, edge’) is clearly deficient, since it lacks the necessary alliteration on *b-*. (2) If we instead see **R**’s ‘*iodyr*’ as corrupted from an archetypal **iodyr*, we can restore to *of *himin-jǫður*, as is done here (so also e.g. Finnur Jónsson 1932, Jónas Kristjánsson and Vésteinn Ólason 2014, p. 292). Although the better reading, (2) also has problems, for in *Vsp* a type C verse with resolution on the first lift cannot have a short second lift, which *of *himin-jǫður* (*x#pxsx*) has (Males 2024a, p. 161).

4 Máni þat né vissi, · hvat hann megin átti ‘the Moon knew not what sort of might he had’ | For a concrete example of this “might” cf. *Háv* 137/7, where the moon is to be invoked in a blood feud. A belief in the power of the moon is found in most ancient religions. Its influence on the human mind was remarked already by Pliny (1855), 2.102, 18.75 and is witnessed in folklore by the influence of the full moon on the werewolf; cf. in English the word *lunacy* (from Latin *lūna* ‘moon’). It is known that women are particularly affected by the moon through the synchronisation of the monthly and menstrual cycles (the two in fact being doublets, “menstrual” deriving from Latin *mēnsis* ‘month’, originally ‘moon’) likely caused by the moon’s gravitational pull on the body, as proven by modern science (Helfrich-Förster et al. 2025).

- 6 Þá gingu regin ǫll · á rǫk-stóla,
2 ginn-heiðog goð, · ok umb þat gǣttu=sk.
Nǫtt ok niðjum · nǫfn of gǫfu,
4 morgin hétu · ok miðjan dag,
undurn ok aptan, · ǫrum at telja.

[R 1r/13, H 20r/9]

Then went all the Reins onto their council-seats:
the yin-holy Gods, and from each other took counsel of that.
To the night and the moon-phases they gave names;
morning they named and mid-day:
afternoon and evening the years for to tally.

ALL | The Gods continue with their creative ordering of the World. They assemble at their Thing and solve the problem of the disorder of the heavenly bodies by appointing them to turn around in the Heavens, each according to its proper course (cf. *Vafþ* 22–25, *Grm* 38). Thereafter they establish the reckoning of time by giving names to the newly arisen cycles. This name-giving, the establishment of norms, is a part of the Godly ordering of the universe and therefore also done to the weal of mankind (Nordberg 2020, p. 737). In fact it is the very act of naming and thereby categorising these phenomena which sets them apart from the disordered Chaos. Thus the categories and norms, rather than being arbitrarily invented by Man, are seen as stemming directly from the Gods (Eliade 2005, pp. 21–22). It should be said that this view is not exactly identical to the modern, Christian scientific attitude towards nature, which is centered around understanding the order in the perfect design of an all-knowing Creator. In the Pagan Indo-European worldview, the raw matter already exists before the Gods in the chaotic form of Yimer and the other Ettins (cf. *Vafþ* 31) or in the confused heavenly bodies. The Creation thus consists in *shaping* or directing this matter according to the Godly Will, that is, the heroic masculine creative intellect.

1–2 Þá... gǣttu=sk ‘Then... of that.’ | The first refrain (*stef*) of the poem, describing the convening of the Thing of the Gods repeated below in sts. 9/1–2, 22/1–2, and 24/1–2. The establishment of the Thing of the Gods is further described in *Gylf* 14:2–7 as cited in st. 7 below; the Thing is also mentioned in st. 46/2 below, *Hym* 39/1, *Grm* 29–30, *Bdr* 1/1–3, *Þrk* 14/1–3, and *Haustr* 10/3.

A similar group of lines describing the convening of the Thing is found in *Bdr* 1/1-3 and *Prk* 14/1-3, which follow the same structure as the present refrain. In every occurrence of either refrain outside of the present stanza, the demonstrative pronoun *þat* 'this, that' clearly refers to an immediately following question introduced by a *hv*-word, which describes a problem the Gods have to deal with (e.g. *Prk* 14/3-4: 'and of this counseled the mighty Tews: how they Loride's hammer might find.') Following this pattern, we would expect to find such a question following *umb þat gëttu-sk* 'took counsel of that' in the present stanza, and so it seems reasonably plausible (though not certain) that one has been lost in transmission.

1 *regin* *qll* 'all the Reins' | All the Gods (*rggin* 'Reins', i.e., 'Powers, Counsels', a pantheistic word), here acting as one body. According to *Skm* 1 twelve Gods were present at the Thing, apart from Weden; these were Thunder, Nearth, Free, Tew, Homedall, Bray, Wider, Wonnel, Wolder, Heener, Foresitter, and Lock. However, Wonnel and Lock can hardly have been seated at the Thing at the same time, since Wonnel was born to avenge Balder and Lock was bound soon after Balder's death (cf. st. 34 below, *Lok* P8). After Balder's death, the Gods at the Thing thus numbered twelve, including Weden, as attested in the late *Gautr* 7. The number twelve clearly belongs to historical Germanic Thing-proceedings and is the origin of the English twelve-man jury; cf. *Bdr* 1/1-3 n.

1 *rök-stóla* 'council-seats' | This word is only found in the present refrain but corresponds to the *sëti* 'seats' (*Gylf* 14:2, 4, 11) and *dóm-stólar* 'judgment-seats' (*Gylf* 42:18, *Skm* 43) in Snorre's prose.

2 *ginn-heilög* *goð* 'yin-holy Gods' | A reverent epithet, 'the vast holy (i.e., inviolable) Gods'. The adj. *ginn-heilagr* 'yin-holy' is composed of the augmentative prefix *ginn-* 'yin-' (cf. OE *ginn* 'wide, vast, ample') + *heilagr* 'holy, inviolable'. Outside of this refrain, *ginn-heilagr* only has one other occurrence in the Norse corpus, *Lok* 11/2: *qll ginn-heilög goð* 'all yin-holy Gods'.

3 *Nótt* *ok niðjum* 'the night and the moon-phases' | Also found in *Vafþ* 24/4.

5 *órum* *at tēlja* 'the years for to tally' | Cf. *Vafþ* 22-25, where it is said that the Gods made the sun and moon turn round in heaven and created the moon-phases *glám* *at ár-tali* 'for mankind's tally of years'.

- 7 Hittu=sk *ęsir* · *á* *İða-vęlli*,
2 þęir's *hęrg* *ok* *hof* · *hę*-timbruðu;
 afla *lęğðu*, · *auð* *smiðuðu*,
4 *tangir* *skópu* · *ok* *tól* *ęrðu*.

[R 1r/16, H 20r/10]

The Eese met each other on the Idewold,
they who timbered on high harrow and hove.
Hearths they laid; wealth they forged;
tongs they shaped and tools they made.

2 þęir's *hęrg* *ok* *hof* · *hę*-timbruðu 'they who timbered on high harrow and hove' | *afls* *kosuðu*
· *alls* *freistuðu* 'they exerted strength, they tried everything' H

ALL. | The Gods build their settlement. —

The whole st. is clearly a source for *Gylf* 14:2-7: *Hárr męlti: „Í upp-bafi setti bann stjórnar-menn í sęti ok beiddi þá at dōma með sęr ęr-lęg manna ok ráða um skipun borgar'innar. Þat var þar, sem heitir İða-vęllr í miðri borg'inni. Var þat bit fyrsta þęira verk at gera bof þat, er sęti þęira tólft standa í ęnnur en há-sętit, þat er Al-fęðr á. Þat þús er betst gert á jęrðu ok mest. Allt er þat útan ok innan svá sem gull eitr. Í þeim stað kalla menn Glads-beim. Annan sal gęrðu þęir; þat var bęrg, er gęðjur'nar áttu, ok var bann all-fęgr. Þat þús kalla menn Vin-gólf. Þar nęst gęrðu þęir þús, er þęir lęğðu afla í, ok þar til gęrðu þęir hamar ok tęng ok stęđja ok þaðan af qll tól ęnnur.*

‘High spoke: “In the beginning He [= Weden, the Allfather] set men of authority in seats and summoned them to judge the orlays of men alongside Him and to rule the arrangements of the stronghold. It [= the judgment-place] was at the place called the Idewold in the middle of the stronghold. It was the first of their works to make the hove wherein there stand twelve seats of theirs other than the high-seat which Allfather owns. That house is the best one made upon the earth and the greatest. It is all without and within as if it were of gold alone. That place men call Gladsham. Another hall they made; it was a harrow, which the giddens owned, and it was all-fair. That house men call Wingolf. Thereafter they made houses wherein they laid hearths, and thereto they made a hammer and tongs and an anvil and with those all other tools.’

1 Iðavelli ‘the Idewold’ | Dat. sg. of *Iða-völlr* ‘the Plain of Industry.’

2 þeir’s horg ok hof · hót-timbruðu ‘they who timbered on high harrow and hove’ | Two formulae. — *horg ok hof* ‘harrow and hove’ is a merism, i.e., ritual structures made of stone and wood; cf. *Vafþ* 38 and *HHj* 4, as well as the Saw of Anlaf Trueson in *F*, which says that King Anlaf lét [...] *brenna hof en brjóta horga ok reisa í staðinn kirkjur* ‘had hoves burnt and harrows broken and churches raised in their stead’. — *hót-timbra* ‘timber on high’ is a rare compound. Its only other occurrence in the ON corpus is in *Grm* 16 where it describes a harrow ruled by Nearth. — This passage has often been wondered at. Why would the Gods themselves make cultic buildings? Whom do they worship? Let it be added to the present instance that they are also said to partake in the ritual sacrifice of animals, divining with their blood and feasting on their flesh (e.g. *Vsp* 61, *Hym* 1, 39, *Lok*, *Haustl* 2). This question is really not as difficult as it is made out to be, however, since the answer must surely be that the behaviour of the Gods serves as the model for virtuous human behaviour and justifies the ideology of settlement. Colonising new lands, tilling the earth, building houses and enclosures and ritual structures, sacrificing animals—if these are virtuous for humanity, they must find their model among the Gods, for “Man constructs according to an archetype” and all settlements reenact Creation (Eliade 2005, pp. 10, 76–78). This does not mean that the Gods worship themselves (or anything else); the Gods operate on the level of the macrocosm, and it is from them that the Godly Will flows. Humans connect with this Godly Will through imitating the Gods on the level of the microcosm by sacrifice and settlement; so the sacrifice of Yimer and the enclosing of “the famous Middenyard” are reenacted through the sacrifice of horses and oxen within ritual and settlement enclosures (Lincoln 1986, *passim*). See further *Grm* 41–43 and notes.

3 afla ‘Hearths’ | More specifically forges, by which we should understand that the Gods established fire in their settlement.

The civilising role of fire is found in Norse sources in the description of Icelandic settlers carrying fire around their land-claims, so e.g. *Ldn* 3.6: *En meðan Sé-mundur fór eldi um land-nám sitt* ‘But while Seamund went with fire around his land-claim’, 5.3: *Þat land fór Þorunndr eldi ok lagði til bófs* ‘Earwind went with fire throughout that land and laid it under the hove’, *Eb* 4: *för Þór-ólfr eldi um land-nám sitt* ‘Thurolf went with fire around his land-claim’. In *Ldn* 5.1 the practice is framed as a rule put in place by King Harold Fairhair to prevent Icelandic settlers claiming excessive tracts of land: *engi skyldi víðara nema en bann métti eldi yfir fara á degi með skipperjum sinum. Menn skyldu eld gera, þá er sól væri í austri. Þar skyldi gera aðra reyki, svá at hvára sei frá þórum, en þeir eldar, er gervir váru, þá er sól var í austri, skyldi brenna til nætr. Síðan skyldu þeir ganga til þess, er sól væri í vestri, ok gera þar aðra elda.* ‘No one was to claim more [land] than that over which he might bring fire in a day with his shipmates. Men were to kindle fire when the sun was in the east. There they were to make other smoke-fires so that each fire could be seen from the other, but the fires which were made when the sun was in the east were to burn till night. Thereafter they were to walk until the sun was in the west and there make other fires.’

It seems likely that this explanation of the fire-ritual as a mere rule set down to prevent the excessive claiming of land is a later historicised explanation developed after the original reason behind the use of fire had been forgotten. The ancient roots of the practice is demonstrated by the account of the legendary Gotlandish civilising founder, Thelver, in *Gut* 1: *Gut-land bitti fyrsti maðr þann, sum Þielvarr hét. Þá var Gut-land so elusti, et þet dagum sank ok náttum var uppi. En þann maðr kvam fyrsti eldi á land, ok síðan sank þet aldrí.* ‘Gotland was first discovered by the man who was named Thelver. At that time Gotland was so uncanny [?] that it sank during the days and was up during the nights. But that man was the first who brought fire to the land, and thereafter it never sank.’ Here we see that the bringing of fire fills a role in exorcising the land and making it civilised, that is, making it conform with the natural order. This use of fire in settlements has Vedic parallels (Eliade 2005, p. 11) and fire also features prominently in Norse ritual; cf. *Grm* 43/2.

- 8 Tęflðu i tūni, · tętir vōru,
 2 vas þeim vęttir-gis · vant őr golli,
 und's þrjár kvōmu · þursa meýjar,
 4 ăm-ăt=kar mjōk, · őr Jōtun-heimum.

[R 1r/18, H 20r/12]

They played Tables in the courtyard; merry were they;
 for them was nothing golden wanting—
 until three maidens of Thurses came,
 most uncanny, out of the Ettinhomes.

ALL | After having settled down, the Gods are merry and content without troubles until their joy is spoiled by the coming of Ettin-women. — The whole stanza is paraphrased in *Gylf* 14:8–10, which explicitly identifies this period as the Golden Age (cf. l. 2 n.): *Ok því nęst smiđuðu þeir málrn ok stein ok trę ok svá gnóg-liga þann málrn, er gull beitr, at ęll þús-gogn ok ęll reiði-gogn þęfðu þeir af gulli, ok er sú ęld kęlluð gull-aldr, ăđr en spillti-sk af til-kváuđu kvinna'nna; þęr kómu őr Jōtun-heimum.* 'And thereafter they forged metal and stone and wood, and so abundantly [did they forge] that metal which is called gold that all their household tools and riding tools were golden. And that age is called the golden age, before it was spoiled by the arrival of the women; they came out of the Ettinhomes.'

1 Tęflðu 'played Tables' | 3rd pl. pret. ind. of *tęfla*, a causative verb derived from *tafl* 'Tables, board game', an old borrowing from Latin *tabula*. 'Tables' is used as a cognate translation; the exact type of board game referred to is unimportant, although it is certainly a game of strategy (e.g. *hnęfa-tafl* or nine men's morris) rather than one of chance. For *hnęfa-tafl* (which held the role as the chief board game in Scandinavia before the introduction of chess in the C12th) and its relatives see Murray (1952, pp. 55–64).

2 vas þeim vęttir-gis · vant őr golli 'for them was nothing golden wanting' | Indeed, even the bricks they played with were of gold (cf. st. 58). The Golden Age at the initial fulfillment of Creation is found in many mythologies (Eliade 2005, pp. 9, 112, 122, 127, 132, 135–136, 149, 154).

2 vęttir-gis 'nothing' | An archaic gen. of *vętt=ki* 'nothing', the *-ir-* representing a fossilized *i*-stem gen. sg., as ON *vęttir* 'thing' comes from PN **wiþtir*. The only other occurrence of this form is in the notably archaic old Icelandic Homily Book (ms. Holm perg 15 4°, fol. 36v/30).

3 þrjár ... þursa meýjar 'three maidens of Thurses' | These three maidens are never mentioned again (unless they are taken to be the three norns in st. 19, but they would then be introduced twice). It is possible that an additional stanza giving further information about them has been lost. If it originally existed, it was already absent in the version used for *Gylf*, since no additional information is found there.

4 ăm-ăt=kar 'uncanny' | The word *ăm-ăt=igr* has a clear association with supernatural ettins. It occurs in four other places in R: in *Grm* 11, *Śki* 10, and *HHj* 17 it is paired with *jōtunn* 'ettin', while in *HHj* 14 it is used by the daughter of an ettin to refer to a human hero, a clear inversion of its usual use.

- 9 Þă gingu ręgin ęll · ă rōk-stōla,
 2 ginn-ęęilōg goð, · ok umb þat gęttu-sk:
 Hvęrr skyldi dverga · drōtt of skępja
 4 őr Brimis blōði · ok őr Bláins lęggjum?

[R 1r/20, H 20r/14,
 S 4v/3, T TODO,
 W TODO, U TODO]

Then went all the Reins onto their council-seats:
 the yin-holy Gods, and from each other took counsel of this:
 Who should shape the troop of Dwarfs
 out of Brimmer's blood and out of Blown's legs?

3 Hværr skyldi dverga ‘Who should ... of dwarfs’ | so RWU; at skyldi dverga ‘That they should ... of dwarfs’ ST; hverir skyldu dvergar ‘Which Dwarfs should [shape the troops out of ...]’ H 3 drótt ‘the troop’ | so G; drotin ‘the lord’ R; dróttir ‘the troops’ H 3 of | so G; om. RH 3 skepja ‘shape’ | spekja (norm.) ‘soothe’ U 4 Brimis blóði ‘Brimmer’s blood’ | so RT; brimi blóðgu ‘the bloody surf’ HSWU. 4 Bláins ‘Blown’s’ | so HW; †bláms† (corrupted from *Bláins) STU; blǫum (‘blám’) ‘blue-black’ R.

ALL | After the Golden Age is spoiled, the Gods must get their gold in some other way. For this they need the Dwarfs, who are associated with precious metals and ore-veins, and make many great treasures for the Gods (e.g. Glapner, *Eddbr VIII*, and Shidebladner, *Grm 44*). The conception of spontaneous generation is clearly also at play; according to the prevalent view in antiquity maggots and worms were thought to spontaneously generate in rotting flesh and earth, and the dwarfs were apparently likewise thought to have spontaneously generated in stone. As much is stated in *Gylf 14:11–14*, which continues with its paraphrase:

Þar nést settu-sk goð’in upp í séti sín ok réttu dóma sína ok minntu-sk, hvaðan dvergar höfðu kviknat í mold’inni ok niðri í jörðu’nni, svá sem maðkar í holdi. Dvergar’nir höfðu skipat-sk fyrst ok tekit kviknun í holdi Ymis ok váru þá maðkar, en af at-kvðum goða’nna urðu þeir vitandi mann-vits ok höfðu manns líki ok búa þó í jörðu ok í steinum. Móð-sognir var öðstr ok annarr Durinn.

‘Thereafter the Gods set themselves high in their seats and made their judgments and remembered whence the Dwarfs had come to life in the ground and down in the earth like maggots in flesh. The dwarfs had first taken shape and come to life in Yimer’s flesh and were then maggots, but by the decrees of the Gods they became knowing of manwit and had the forms of a man, and yet they live in the earth and in stones. Moodsowner was the first in rank, and second was Dorn.’

Immediately after this passage, *Gylf 14:15* quotes the present st. and st. 10/3–4 in sequence, introduced by the words *svá segir í Völu-spá*: ‘so it says in the Spae of the Wallow’.

4 ór Brimis blóði · ok ór Bláins leggjum ‘out of Brimmer’s blood and out of Blown’s legs’ | The adopted reading for this line is a composite, but is based on the distributions of variants across the mss. and the principle that the more difficult reading is the likelier. Both *brimi blóðgu* ‘the bloody surf’ and *blǫum* (‘blám’) ‘blue-black’ are thus to be taken as instances of trivialisation due to the confusion of rarely attested proper names (Males 2023b, pp. 196–197; Males and Myrvoll n.d., pp. 16–17).

The blood and legs are taken to be those of Yimer. From his bones were made the rocks and from his blood the sea (*Grm 41*, *Vafþ 21*). Explaining the creation of dwarfs from Yimer’s legs is easy, for dwarfs dwell in rocks (cf. e.g. *Yi 2*, where the Swedish king Swayther (ON *Sveigðir*) runs into a rock in pursuit of a dwarf). More difficult to explain is how the dwarfs would be made out of the sea. One suggestion is that this may be referring to the formation of salt-stones by means of evaporating salty sea-water. Another interpretation is that we are dealing with the motif of underwater stones which may have been thought to have spontaneously generated in the sea; cf. Scaldic rock-kennings like *Hált 2*: *sévar bein* ‘bone of the sea’ and *Þdr 16*: *fiarð-æpli* ‘firth-apple’ (Meissner 1921, p. 90).

4 Brimis blóði ‘Brimmer’s blood’ | Brimmer is perhaps a name for an ettin in st. 36/4 below, in which case it should be taken as a generic name here, i.e., ‘out of the ettin’s blood’.

4 Bláins ‘Blown’s’ | *Bláinn* ‘Blown’ (from *blár* ‘blue, black’) has usually been read as a poetic name for the ettin Yimer, and this is assumed here, although it is not attested as a name for him anywhere else. It is, however, attested as a dwarf-name in *Þul Dverga 1* (SkP 3). Following Gurevich (SkP 3, p. 693), we may therefore take the b-verse as a kenning ‘the legs of Blown [dwarf] [STONES]’, but this suffers from the fact that the dwarfs have not yet been created at this point in the narrative.

- 10 Þar vas Móð-sognir · mētstr of orðinn
2 dverga allra, · en Durinn annarr;
þeir man-líkun · mǫrg of gørðu,
4 dvergar i jørðu, · sem Durinn sagði.

[R 1r/21, H 20r/15,
S 4v/5, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

There was Moodsowner made the chiefest
of all Dwarfs, but Dorn the second.
Those Dwarfs made many man-likenesses
in the earth, as Dorn said.

1–2 Þar ... annarr ‘There ... second’ | *om.* G 1 Þar vas Móð-sognir | *so* H, (*in the paraphrase*) G ;
Þar Mót-sognir vitnir ‘there Mootsowner wolf(?)’ R. 3 þeir man-líkun · mǫrg of gǫrðu | *so* RHU;
þar man-líkun · mǫrg of gǫrðu=sk STW 4 i ‘in’ | *so* HG; ór ‘out of’ R 4 sem Durinn sagði ‘as
Dorn said’ | *so* RHSW; sem þdur mennþ sagði ‘as door-men(?) said’ T; sem þþeim dyrinn kendiþ
‘as the beasts(?) taught them’ U

ALL | Ll. 3–4 are cited in *Gylf* 14:15, immediately following st. 9 (see there).

1–2 Þar ... annarr ‘There ... second’ | These lines are not found in *Gylf*, but the author must have had the full stanza since *Gylf* 14:14 (“Moodsowner was the first in rank, and second was Dorn”, see st. 9) clearly derives from ll. 1–2. They were likely omitted by the author of *Gylf* as superfluous.

3 man-líkun ‘man-likenesses’ | The Dwarfs were in the shape of men, but not quite human. In the creation of the Dwarfs before men, we may find a reflex of a motif common throughout world mythology: the creation of several failed or incomplete generations of sentient beings by the God(s) prior to the current race of humanity. These failed or ancient generations are typically created out of other materials than those used for present humanity, display non-human features and uncanny abilities, and are either destroyed or turned into sprites or animals. Mythological parallels include the five ages of man (*viz.* the Golden Age, Silver Age, Bronze Age, Heroic Age, and Iron Age) in Hesiod’s *Works and Days* 109–201; the jinn in Islam, created out of smokeless fire prior to the creation of Man out of clay (*Qur’ān* 15:26–27); and the several attempts at creating humans in the pre-Columbian Mayan *Popol Vuh*, where the first generation was made out of earth and mud, but destroyed for its weakness (ll. 434–517), the second out of effigies of carved wood, becoming the spider monkeys (518–837), while the third and successful creation of humanity was out of maize (4822–4939) (Christenson 2007, pp. 64–75, 178–181). The Norse Dwarfs fit surprisingly well into this typology. They are created out of stone (whereas the first humans are made out of wood), are described in sources as unusually lustful and greedy, but also as masterful craftsmen, and are a form of sprite or earthly daemon.

3–4 þeir ... sagði ‘Those ... said.’ | The mss. readings offer two conflicting versions of the creation of the dwarfs. (1) STW: The dwarfs arise on their own through spontaneous generation; this is supported by the prose of *Gylf* 14:11–14 (see note to previous st.) and by the form of the stanza quoted there in the non-U mss., but it may have been changed to correspond to the author’s vision (*cf.* st. 38/3 n. below). (2) RHU: the dwarfs Moodsowner and Dorn shape “man-likenesses”, most likely lesser Dwarfs, out of the soil. For stemmatic reasons, the present ed. adopts (2).

(For sts. 11–15—the *Dwarf-tallies*—see Appendix to the poem.)

- 16 Und’s þrír kvǫmu · ór þvi liði
2 qfl=gir ok ǫst=kir · ęsir at húsi;
fundu à landi · líttr megandi
4 Ask ok Eṁblu · ęr-log-lausa.

[R 1v/1, H 20r/26]

Until three came out of that host,
strong and loving Eese along the settlement.
They found on the land the little availing
Ash and Emble, or lay-less.

1 þrír | *emend.*; þrjár RH 1 ór því liði | so R; þussa brúðir H. 2 qfl-gir ok öst-kir 'strong and loving' | öst-kir ok qfl-gir 'loving and strong' H

ALL | Sts. 16–17 are paraphrased in *Gylf* 9:3–7:

Þá er þeir gengu með sévar-ströndu Burs synir, fundu þeir tré tvau ok tóku upp tré'n ok skopuðu af menn. Gaf inn fyrsti ond ok lif, annarr vit ok bráring, þriði á-sjónu, mál ok heyrn ok sjón; gáfu þeim klæði ok nøfn. Hét karl-maðr'inn Askr, en kona'n Embla, ok ólsk þaðan af mann-kind'in, sú er byggð'in var gefinn undir Mið-garði.

'When the sons of Byre (cf. n. to l. 2: *ęsir*) were walking along the sea-shore they found two pieces of wood (*tré*) and they took up the pieces of wood and shaped men out of them. The first [god] gave breath and life; the second [gave] intelligence and movement; the third [gave] outward appearance, speech and hearing and sight. They gave them clothes and names. The man was called Ash and the woman Embla, and from them was begotten mankind, to whom the settlement within Middenyard was given.'

Based on the just-cited passage, the Gods are generally understood to have created mankind out of pieces of driftwood, and that is most likely what is being referred to by Snorre. Yet no such detail is found in the present stanza; it may, therefore, instead be a later Icelandic or Snorronean reinterpretation. As pointed out by Hultgård (2006), the evidence from comparative mythology in fact suggests that the first humans were originally thought of as being made out of living, growing trees.

The descent of humans from trees is probably the reason behind the extensive use of words for trees in kennings for men and women in Norse poetry (see SkP I, p. lxxv ff., Meissner 1921, pp. 245, 266–272, 410). This kenning-type is most common in Scaldic poetry, but at times also appears in Eddic poetry (e.g. *Sigrdr* 5: *bryn-þings apaldr* 'apple-tree of the byrnie-Thing [BATTLE > WARRIOR]').

1 Und's 'Until' | The first line, beginning with the conjunction *und's* 'until', is clearly supposed to connect syntactically to an immediately preceding stanza describing some ongoing action, as in st. 4/1 above: *áðr* 'before'. For other instances of sts. beginning with *und's* cf. *Hym* 30, *Sigs* 3, 51, 2 *Gúðr* 3; in SkP: *Haustl* 11, *Þdr* 10, *Anon Pl* 31.

If the dwarf-tallies (sts. 11–15) are later inserts, the preceding stanza would be st. 10, in which case the creation of men is probably to be understood as following and surpassing the creation of the dwarfs; cf. note to st. 10/3: *man-likun*.

1 þrír kvömu · ór því liði 'three came out of that host' | Both mss. show corruption from st. 8 in their use of the f. *þrjár* 'three' for the m. **þrír*. H goes further in replacing the b-verse *ór því liði* 'out of that host' with *þussa brúðir* 'brides of thurses'. That this is nothing other than corruption is clearly shown by the m. pl. *qfl-gir ok öst-kir ęsir* 'strong and loving Eese' in l. 2.

2 öst-kir 'loving' | The Wallow depicts the creation of Mankind as an act of love. For our benefit, the Gods also created Middenyard (*Vsp* 4/2, *Grm* 42), the sun, and the moon with its phases (*Vsp* 6, *Vafþ* 22–25).

2 ęsir 'Eese' | Weden, Heener, and Lothar. This stands in contradiction to *Gylf* 9:3–4 which tells us that the gods who made the first men were the sons of Byre, in *Gylf* 6:8–10 (cf. st.4) identified with Weden, Will, and Wigh. If we are to reconcile this difficulty we would have to see Heener and Lothar as the equivalents of the latter two, but that identification is rather unlikely.

To begin with, not even the notoriously systematising *Gylf* equates Heener with Will or Wigh, nor does it mention Lothar at all. In Scaldic poetry the two gods Heener and Lothar are found in a few kennings for Weden, but unlike kennings involving Will, these are always of the type 'friend of Lothar/Heener' [= Weden] and never 'brother of Lothar/Heener' [= Weden]. Heener and Lothar instead seem to be distinct gods. See further the notes to their names in st. 17.

2 at húsi 'along the settlement' | Lit. 'along the house.' An adverbial; the Gods were walking on the outskirts of their settlement.

3–4 lítt megandi ... or-log-lausa 'little availing ... orlay-less' | Prior to the gifts from the Gods the human beings were immobile and without orlay (fate, destiny), which is thus seen to be one of the distinguishing features of mankind.

4 Ask ok Eṃblu ‘Ash and Emble’ | The ancestors of all human beings; cf. Life and Lafthrasher who repopulate the world after its rebirth (*Vafþ* 44–45). Ash (nom. *Ask*) is easily identified with the same-named wood species (*Fraxinus excelsior*), but the form Emble (nom. *Eṃbla*) is more difficult. Her name is often translated as “Elm”, but the ON word for that tree (*Ulmus glabra*) is the m. *almr*. A possible etymology is metathesis from earlier **Eṃla* (< PN **almilō* ‘young elm tree’), a f. *n*-stem derivative of the same type as *þella* ‘young fir tree’ (< PN **þallilō*) ~ *þell* ‘fir tree’ (< PN **þallu*), although the *-b-* remains unexplained.

- 17 Qnd þau né ǫttu, · ǫð þau né hǫfðu,
2 lǫ né lėti · né litu góða;
qnd gaf Ǫðinn, · ǫð gaf Hǫnir,
4 lǫ gaf Lóðurr · ok litu góða.

[R 1v/3, H 20r/27]

Breath they had not; wode they had not,
not guile nor sound nor goodly hues.
Weden gave breath; Heener gave wode;
Lothar gave guile and goodly hues.

1 Qnd ‘Breath’ | The breath of life or life force which sets living beings apart from dead matter. The word *qnd* originally means simply ‘breath’ (cf. Gothic *uz-anan* ‘to breathe out’), but the semantic development BREATH > VITALITY is by no means unparalleled, as seen by the Latin root-cognate *animus* ‘life force, vitality; (later) soul’ vs. the Greek ἀνεμος ‘wind, breeze’. All these words are ultimately from PIE **b₂enb₂*- ‘breathe’ (Kroonen 2013, pp. 26–27).

After the conversion to Christianity, ON *qnd* takes on the derived sense ‘spirit, soul’, as seen on Scandinavian memorial runestones where it is used interchangeably with the Anglo-Saxon borrowing *sól* ‘soul’ (e.g. Sö 10 *Guð hjalpi qnd hans* ‘God help his breath’ vs. Sö 8 *Guð hjalpi sól hans* ‘God help his soul’) and paired with it in at least 14 separate inscriptions (e.g. U 358 *Guð hjalpi hans qnd ok sól* ‘God help his breath and soul’). This new semantic, probably calqued from the Latin *spiritus* ‘breath; spirit’, is also charted in the Scaldic corpus, where *qnd* (regardless of sense) makes its first securely dateable appearance in Hallfrith’s memorial poem to Anlaf Trueson (Hfr *Erföl* 27 in SkP 1) dated to ca. 1001 CE.

The lack of pre-Christian Scaldic attestations of *qnd* may lead one to question the authenticity of the sense ‘life (force)’ in the pagan period, but I think that it must have existed to begin with in order for the new sense of ‘spirit’ to have been acceptable to the Norse converts. If *qnd* had meant merely ‘respiration’ it would probably have been displaced entirely by the Christian loan-word *sól* ‘soul’ rather than have seen acceptance even amongst former pagan poets like Hallfrith. In any case the sense ‘life’ is attested in the most likely pre-Christian Eddic poem *Sigsk* 33, 53 (*qndu látir* ‘lost his life’), 60 (*qndu tyna* ‘id.’). Also in later poetry a person who dies is often said to *lata* or *tyna qndu* (cf. *HHf* 37; in SkP *Ótt Knútdr* 9, *Þorm Lv* 13, *ÞSjár Þórdr* 3, *Ív Sig* 30, *Esk Geisl* 60, *Bjbp Joms* 41, *Þórðh Lv* 9, *QrvOdd Evdr* 12, 39, *Anon Brúðv* 27), whereas it is not said once of the *sól*; a Christian could hardly say that a person who dies “loses his soul”.

The use of *qnd* in *Gylf* 3:10—printed at the beginning of this book for its simple beauty—is distinctly in the Christian sense ‘spirit’: *Hitt er þó mest, er bann gerði mann’inn ok gaf bonum qnd þá, er lifa skal ok aldri tyna-sk, þótt líkam’inn fíni at moldu eða brenni at qsku* ‘Yet the greatest thing is when He [= Weden, the Allfather] made the man and gave him the “breath” which shall live and never perish although the body may moulder to dust or burn to ashes.’

1 ǫð ‘wode’ | Outside of the present st., ON *ǫðr* ‘wode’ (gen. sg. *ǫðar*) is used only in Scaldic poetry or in prose dealing with Scaldic poetry and then always with the sense ‘poem, poetry’. This is most likely also its sense in the cpd. *Ǫð-rórir* ‘Woderearer’, one of the vats in which the Mead of Poetry was kept (*Háv* 107).

The present stanza thus gives us the word’s only Eddic attestations, but its exact sense in the present st. is unlikely to be merely ‘poetry’ (which was after all given by Weden, not Heener, and that at a later time; see *Háv* 103–110). To determine the proper sense of ‘wode’ we ought to consider its etymology.

As a m. *u*-stem the noun *ōðr* must derive from PGmc. **wōþuz*. PGmc. words from the same root include the nouns **wōdaz* ‘madness, fury’ (> OE *wōd* ‘madness’, OHG *uuot* ‘fury’) and **wōþó* (> OE *wōþ* ‘song’) and the adj. **wōdaz* ‘mad, furious’ (> ON *ōðr* ‘id.’, OE *wōd* ‘mad, rabid’, Gothic *wōds* ‘possessed with the devil’).

Two Germanic theonyms are clearly derived from the root: Weden (ON *Óðinn* < PGmc. **Wōdanaz*) and Wode (ON *Óðr* < PGmc. **Wōdaz*). Weden literally means ‘lord, possessor of wode’ (suffixed with PIE **-nós* ‘lord, master of’, cf. his name *Herjann* < PGmc. **harjanaz* < PIE *kor-yo-nos* ‘lord of hosts, chieftain’ > Greek *κοιράνος* ‘king, ruler’), while Wode (unlike the noun *ōðr* an *a*-stem as seen by Vsp 24) is probably a nominalisation of the adjective and thus means ‘mad, frenzied, inspired’.

The PIE root, which is found only in Germanic, Italic, and Celtic, is **wēb₂t-* and the alternation between the senses ‘poetry’ ~ ‘fury’ is also seen in the other branches. PGmc. **wōþuz* derives from PIE **wēb₂t-u-s* (> OIr. *fúib* ‘cause, motive, subject, prophecy, composition’, Old Welsh *gwaur* ‘song of praise’). Also related are Latin *vātēs* ‘prophet, seer; poet’ and Gaulish *ōuātēs* ‘a type of priest’ (pl., found in Strabo’s *Geography* 4.4.4) (Kroonen 2013, p. 592).

The IE root sense, clearly retained in Celtic and Germanic, thus appears to be a state of frenzied poetic inspiration, *furor poeticus*, but the sense in the present stanza may also cleave closer to ‘intelligent thought, mind’, or the power to express one’s thoughts with words, which is unique to man.

2 *lō* ‘guile’ | The exact sense of this word is uncertain. It is otherwise found referring to seawater near the shore, poetically to the ‘sea’, for which reason its sense here has sometimes been interpreted as ‘blood’. *Skm* 85 gives *lō* as a poetic synonym for ‘hair’, but it seems unlikely that hair would be mentioned next to the breath of life and intellect. I tentatively take it to be an otherwise unattested variant of the poetic word *lē* ‘guile, deceit’, here in the sense ‘skill, craft, cunning’. For the vowel alternation cf. *bré* ‘corpse’ (declined identically and rhyming with *lē*) < PGmc. **braiwaq*, irregularly metathesised from PIE **krow(h₂)-yóm* (Kroonen 2013, p. 242) vs. *brár* ‘raw, bloody’ < **brauaz* < PIE **krow(h₂)-os* (Kroonen 2013, p. 244).

2 *litu* *gōða* ‘goodly hues’ | The ruddy complexion of the living in contrast to the pallor of the dead. — The reading *litu* *gōða* ‘hues of the Gods’ must be rejected for metrical reasons since the lift in *gōða* cannot be short (Males 2024a, p. 161); cf. st. 5/2 n. above.

3 *Hönir* ‘Heener’ | An obscure god; he is one of the twelve Eese present at the Thing of the Gods (*Skm* 1) and takes over the role as *sacerdos civitatis* of the Gods after Weden dies, for which cf. Vsp 60 below. His name is found thrice in Scaldic poetry, all in kennings for Lock of the type ‘FRIEND/COMPANION of Heener [= Lock]’ (*Haustr* 3/4b, 7/4a, 12/2a).

Heener plays a minor role in the mythology. In *Yng* 4 he is one of the gods sent as a hostage from the Eese to the Wanés alongside Mimer, the wisest of the Eese; the Wanés in turn give over Quasher, their wisest man. Heener is soon made a chieftain among the Wanés but is not very clever, and when present at the Thing without Mimer, the only thing he can say is *ráði aðrir* ‘let others decide’.

Heener further figures in two adventures alongside Weden and Lock, viz. in the encounter with Thedse (*Haustr* 1–13, *Skm* 2–3) and in the origin of the Nivling hoard (*Reg* P1–9, *Skm* 46), but he plays no active role in either narrative.

Rydberg (1886, p. 552) convincingly argues that Heener is connected with the stork, deriving his name from the same root as Greek *κόκκος* ‘swan’ and Sanskrit *śakuná* ‘bird of omen’ (cf. Kroonen 2013, p. 240), and noting that his epithets *langi fótr* ‘long foot’ and *aur-konungur* ‘mud-king’ (both found in *Skm* 22) accurately describe that bird. According to Rydberg, Heener’s giving of wode would then be associated with the later folk-myth of the stork that brings children to their parents, just as it is Heener who gives humans their mental faculties and thereby their unique human aspect.

4 *Lóður* ‘Lother’ | An even more obscure god than Heener; his name is not found in the Poetic Edda and only twice in Scaldic poetry (*Hátt* 8/4a (SkP 1) and *HaukrV Íslðr* 1/1b (SkP 4)), in both cases in the kenning *vinr Lóðurs* ‘friend of Lother [= Weden]’. Lother is possibly to be identified with the obscure figure *logabore* ‘(flame-)darer(?)’ who appears alongside the two gods *wodan* (*Wōdan*, ‘Weden’) and *wigiponar* ‘(battle(?)-Thunder’) on the 6th c. German Nordendorf fibula I (KJ 151) from near Augsburg, Bavaria, although this is uncertain (Turville-Petre 1975, p. 143). Since the triad Weden, Heener, and Lock figures in other sources, Lother may also be identified with Lock, whose name may well be a nickname formed from the older Lother (Turville-Petre 1975, pp. 143–144). This identification is strongly supported if the above conjecture is right that Lother’s gift *lō* is an alternative form of *lē* ‘guile, deceit’, a word closely associated with Lock.

- 18 Ask veyt'k standa, · heitir Ygg·drasils,
 2 hór baðmr, ausinn · hvíta auri;
 þaðan koma döggyvar · þér's i dala falla;
 4 stendr é yfir grónn · Urðar brunni.

[R 1v/5, H 20r/29,
 S 5r/30, T TODO,
 W TODO, U TODO]

An ash I know standing; it is called Ugdrassle's,
 a high tree sprinkled with white mud.
 Thence come the dew-drops which fall in the dales;
 it stands ever green over the Well of Weird.

1 standa 'standing' | so RHU; ausinn 'sprinkled' STW 1 Ygg·drasils | so S; Ygg·drasill all others
 2 baðmr 'tree' | borinn 'born' (wo. doubt corrupt) U. 2 ausinn 'sprinkled' | heilag 'holy' G 3
 þér's | es ST 3 dala | dali STU 4 é | om. U 4 grónn | †grvnn† S; †grein† U

ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf* 16:13, introduced by the words *Svá sem hér segir* 'Just as it says here'.
Gylf 16:10–12 provides context:

Enn er þat sagt, at nornir þér, er byggja við Urðar brunni, taka hvern dag vatn í brunni'num ok með aur'inn þann, er liggir um brunni'nn, ok ausa upp yfir ask'inn, til þess at eigi skuli limar hans tréna eða fína. En þat vatn er svá beilagt, at allir blutir, þeir er þar koma í brunni'nn, verða svá hvítir sem hinna sú, er skjall heitir, er innan liggir við egg-skurn.

'It is Furthermore said that the Norns who dwell by the Well of Weird fetch water in the Well every day, and along with it the mud which lies around the well, and they sprinkle it up over the Ash so that its branches should not harden or rot. But that water is so holy that all things which come into the well turn as white as the membrane called the shell-membrane which lies inside the eggshell.'

Following the st. *Gylf* 16:14–15 continues: *Sú dagg, er þaðan af fellr á jörð'ina, þat kalla menn hunang-fall, ok þar af fjðask bý-flugur. Fuglar tveir fjðask í Urðar brunni. Þeir heita svanir, ok af þeim fuglum hefir komit þat fugla-kyn, er svá heitir.* 'That dew which falls thereof onto the earth do men call 'honey-fall', and thereof bees feed themselves. Two fowls feed themselves in the Well of Weird. They are called 'swans', and from those fowls has come the race of fowls so called.'

1 Ask ... Ygg·drasils 'Ash ... Ugdrassle's' | The Ash of Ugdrassle, the World Tree. That the Ash stands in the very center of the world is shown by *Grm* 26/4, where we learn that all waters run their course from it, and *Grm* 31, which tells us that its roots reach and wrap around the world of Men, the Underworld, and the Ettinhomes.

2 ausinn · hvíta auri 'sprinkled with white mud' | Cf. st. 26/3–4 below.

- 19 Þaðan koma meyjar · margs vitandi
 2 þrjár ór þeim sal · es und þolli stendr;
 Urð hétu eina, · aðra Verðandi,
 4 —sköru á skíði— · Skuld ina þriðju
 þér lög lögðu, · þér líf kœru,
 6 alda börnum, · ør-lög seggja.

[R 1v/8, H 20r/31]

Thence come maidens, much-knowing:
 three out of the hall which stands beneath the tree.
 Weird they called one, the other Werthing
 —they scored billets—Shild the third.
 They laid down laws; they chose lives
 for the children of men, the orlay of youths.

2 sal ‘hall’ | so H, (in the paraphrase) G ; sé ‘lake’ R 2 und ‘under’ | á ‘on’ H 6 seggia ‘of youths’ | at segja ‘to say’ H

ALL | This st. is paraphrased in *Gylf* 15:26–29: *Þar stendr salr einn fagr undir aski’n um við brunni’n, ok ór þeim sal koma þrjár meyjar, þær er svá beita: Urðr, Verðandi, Skuld. Þessar meyjar skapa mönnum aldr; þær kllum vér nornir.* ‘There stands a single fair hall beneath the ash-tree by the well, and out of that hall come three maidens who are called thus: Weird, Werthing, Shild. These maidens shape the ages of men; we call them Norns.’

For the three Norns, we may compare a strikingly similar description in the late ancient Gallo-Roman source *De medicamentis* (TODO: cite), which relates a traditional Celtic myth of a tree standing in the middle of the sea, kept by three virgins. A similar motif is found on numerous syncretic Gallo-Roman altars from western Germany, which depict the three *Matronae Andrusteibae* ‘Tree-Standing Mothers’ next to a great tree (TODO: cite). The three Norns also correspond closely to the Greek Μοῖραι, the three weavers of fate (cf. 1 *HHund* 3/1 n.).

2 þolli ‘tree’ | Literally ‘fir’, but the word is only used for the alliteration and the species is generic. The same may perhaps apply to *askr* ‘ash’ above.

3 Urð ‘Weird’ | Acc. of *Urðr* ‘fated course of events,’ lit. ‘that which has become’. The cognates of this word feature prominently in a fatalistic context in West Germanic poetry (TODO).

3 Verðandi ‘Werthing’ | ‘That which is becoming,’ the pres. participle of *verða* ‘to become, happen’. The name is only found here and in *Gylf* 15:27.

4 sköru á skiði ‘they scored billets’ | *skið* refers to a thin piece of split wood, esp. as used for firewood, but can also mean ‘plank’ or ‘ski’. The sense here is most likely that the norns cut notches for the number of years allotted to each human being. This notion is unparalleled (TODO: is it?) in mediaeval literary sources, but the method of time keeping may represent a predecessor of the mediaeval calendars used by the Northern European peasantry to track the lunar cycle and the Catholic feast-days. These consist of carved wooden sticks where each day is represented either by a notch (in Norway and England) or by a rune of the futhark (in Sweden and Estonia) and go under a variety of names; *primstav* in Norway, *runstav* in Sweden, *sirvilaud* in Estonia, and clog almanac in England. Although these later wooden calendars are undoubtedly influenced by the timekeeping of the Church, the present line may just about hint that there existed a native, pre-Christian Germanic calendrical tradition.

4 Skuld ‘Shild’ | Acc. of *Skuld(r)* ‘that which shall be’. The nom. should probably have an *-r*, though that is not attested in *Gylf* 15:27. The name is only found here and in *Gylf* 15:27.

5 lög ‘laws’ | With this word we should understand ‘decisions, decrees,’ for pre-Christian Scandinavian Law was based on custom and precedent. Similar legalistic vocabulary for fate is found in the *dómar* ‘judgments’ and *kviðir* ‘decrees, rulings’ of the Norns (*Fáfn* 11/1, *Hamð* 30/4).

20 Þat man hōn folk-víg · fyrst i hēimi,
2 es Goll-vēigu · gēirum studdu
ok i hōll Hāars · hāna brēnndu,
4 þrysvar brēnndu · þrysvar borna,
opt, ò-sjaldan, · þó hōn ęnn lifir.

[R 1v/11, H 20v/5]

That troop-conflict she recalls first in the Home
when Goldwey they impaled with spears
and in the hall of Hougher (= Weden) [= Walhall] burned her.
Thrice they burned the one thrice born,
often, unseldom—yet she liveth still.

3 Hāars | Hārs RH 4 þrysvar brēnndu | written twice H

ALL | A very cryptic stanza. The name Goldwey is not mentioned in any other source, nor is the underlying story, but she was apparently slain, burned, and reborn three times. Goldwey is perhaps to be identified with the wallow of the poem herself, which would explain the cryptic “yet she lives still”.

1 folk-vig ‘troop-conflict’ | *folk* here carries its older meaning ‘troop, band’, as seen e.g. in the Slavic borrowing exemplified by Russian полк ‘regiment, host, army’.

3 Háars ‘Hougher’ | Hiatus must be restored for metrical reasons; cf. Males (2023a, pp. 265–266). *Háarr*, usually normalised as *Hǫarr*, is a name for Weden also found in Scaldic poetry, perhaps < **haiþa-barjar* ‘one-eyed warrior’. It should not be confused with Weden’s names *Hárr* ‘Hoary’ and *Hǫr* ‘High’.

3 hāna | The meter requires the pronoun to have a long syllable.

- 21 Heiði hétu, · hvar’s til húsa kom,
2 völu vef-spáa, · vitti ganda;
seïð hön hvar’s hön kunni, · seïð hön hug leikinn;
4 é vas hön angan · illrar brúðar.

[R 1v/13, H 20v/7]

Hode they called her where to houses she came,
the well-spaeing wallow; she bewitched gands.
She ensorcelled where she could; she ensorcelled deluded minds;
she was always the delight of an evil bride.

1 kom, | *add.* ok H 3 hvar’s hön | *so* H; *om.* R 3 hug | *so* H; *om.* R

1 Heiði ‘Hode’ | Acc. sg. of **Heiðr* ‘bright, splendid’.

2 ganda ‘gands’ | Familiar spirits. TODO: elaborate.

- 22 Þa gingu regin öll · á rok-stóla,
2 ginn-heiðog goð, · ok umb þat gëttu=sk:
Hvárt skyldu ésir · af-ráð gjalda,
4 eða skyldu goð’in öll · gildi eiga?

[R 1v/16, H 20v/9]

Then went all the Reins onto their council-seats:
the yin-holy Gods, and from each other took counsel of this:
Whether the Eese should yield tribute
or all the Gods should hold a banquet?

ALL | Sts. 22–23 deal with the obscure war between the Eese and the Wanes, the two tribes of the Gods. It is most fully described in *Yng 4*, which also features a long description of the hostages: *Óðinn fór með her á bendr Vönum, en þeir urðu vel við ok vörðu land sitt, ok þegðu ymsir sig; berjuðu hvárir á land annarra ok gerðu skaða. En er þat leiddi=sk hvárum-tveggjum, lögðu þeir milli sín séttar-stefnu, ok gerðu frið ok seldu=sk gíslar.* ‘Weden went with a host against the Wanes, but they responded well and defended their land, and both sides had alternating victories; either side raided the land of the other and did harm. But when that seemed loathsome to both sides, they held a conciliatory settlement between them and made peace and traded hostages.’

The war is also alluded to in *Gylf* 23:6 (edited in the pres. ed. under *Eddbr* II), which mentions how Nearth was one of the hostages sent by the Wanes, and *Skm* 5, which explains the origin of the mead of poetry (for which cf. *Háv* 103–110): *Þat váru upp-böf til þess, at goðin höfðu ó-sétt við þat folk, er Vanir heita. En þeir lögðu með sér frið-stefnu ok settu grið á þá lund, at þeir gengu hvárir-tveggju til eins kers ok spýttu í bráka sínum* ‘This was the origin of it, that the Gods had hostile relations with the folk called the Wanes. But they held a peace-settlement amongst each other and made a truce by the following means, that each of them went to a vat and spit their spittle into it.’

As the relevant sources (the Prose Edda and *Yng*) are closely related and probably both written by the same author, Snorre, the Eese-Wane war and indeed the very existence of the Eese and the Wanes as distinct tribes (rather than synonyms for the Gods as a collective) has been quite powerfully argued by Simek (2010) to be a Snorronean learned concoction as part of his learned pre-history of Scandinavia. This is supported by data from Frog and Roper (2011), showing that the ON term *vanir* ‘Wanes’ is used only in Eddic poetry and exclusively in alliterative positions. Even so, a straightforward reading of *Vsp* 33/3–4 does see the ‘Wanes’ breaking down the fortification of the ‘Eese’, and when compared with *Vafþ* 38–39 which explicitly contrasts the ‘Wanes’ and the ‘Eese’ they do in fact seem to be distinct groups also in the Poetic Edda.

4 goð’in qll ‘all the Gods’ | The clitic definite *-in* is very rare in older ON poetry. This is its only occurrence in *Vsp*, but it should be understood in the context of preceding the adjective *qll*, for which cf. *Lok* 52/4. — Here “all the Gods” (viz., the Eese and the Wanes) seem to be contrasted with the Eese, a subset.

- 23 Fleygði Óðinn · ok i folk of skaut;
 2 þat vas enn folk-víg · fyrr i heim;
 brotinn vas borð-veggj · borgar ása,
 4 knóttu vanir víg-spó · völlu sporna.

[R 1v/17, H 20v/11]

Weden hurled and shot into the troop;
 that was yet a troop-conflict earlier in the Home.
 Broken was the plank-wall of the stronghold of the Eese;
 the Wanes by a war-spae did tread the fields.

2 fyrr ‘earlier’ | so H; fyrst ‘first’ R

1 Fleygði Óðinn · ok i folk of skaut ‘Weden hurled and shot into the troop’ | The object, a spear, is understood. — This first spear-throw was ritually reenacted during battle, so *Eb* 44: *þá skaut Steinþórr spjóti at fornum sið til heilla sér yfir flokk Snorra* ‘then Stanthur shot a spear according to ancient custom for his fortune over Snorre’s troop’ and *Styrb* 2, where the Swedish king Eric devotes himself as a sacrifice within a period of ten years in exchange for victory. In return, Weden gives him a reed and tells him to hurl it into the opposing host with the phrase *Óðinn á yðr alla* ‘Weden owns you all!’ Eric does so, and the reed turns into a spear in the air (for this motif cf. *Gautr* 7 as summarized in *Háv* 138 n.). As it flies over his foes they are stricken by terror and blindness before being buried in a landslide.

It was customary among the Germanic pagans that the battle-slain (*valr*) were devoted to Weden; cf. *Phorn Harkv* 12 (SkP 1): *Valr lá þar á sandi · vitinn inum ein-eggja // Friggjar faðm-byggvi* ‘The slain lay there on the sand set apart for the one-eyed bosom-dweller [HUSBAND] of Fric [= Weden]’. The consecration could also be done as a thank-offering after a victory, as in *Heiðr* 7: *Heið-rekr kvæð-sk nú gjalda fyrir son sinn þetta lið allt, er drept var, ok gaf hann nú þennan val Óðni* ‘Heathric now declares that he, in exchange for his son[s] life], pays up the whole part of the army which was killed, and he now gave these battle-slain to Weden.’ In the afterlife these men would join the god as Onearriers in Walhall (cf. *Grm* 14, *Hárb* 24, runic inscription N B380 edited below under Galders). The sacrifice also included captives, which were at times executed by hanging (*Háv* 138 n.) and which may be the reason why Weden is also called *Hapta-guð* ‘God of Captives’ (*Gylf* 20:10). As seen below, even the weapons of the vanquished were part of the sacrifice.

This type of devotion of an entire army was not uncommon in Germanic antiquity and is securely attested in both history and archeology. Among historical sources I particularly wish to mention Orosius, *History* 5.16.5–6, describing the battle of Arausio fought in 105 BCE between the Romans and the Germanic tribes of the Cimbri and Teutons: “After capturing the two Roman camps and a vast amount of booty, the enemy destroyed everything that they had laid their hands on in some new, unexpected form of curse. 6 Clothing was ripped up and discarded, gold and silver thrown into the river, the men’s armour was torn apart, the horses’ harness scattered and the horses themselves drowned in the river, while the men had nooses tied round their necks and were hanged from trees. In this way the victor knew no booty nor the vanquished any mercy.” (Orosius 2010, p. 235).

The most relevant archeological finds are the various Northern European bogs and wetlands where horses and arms, presumably belonging to defeated foes, have been mutilated and defaced (e.g. by whipping the horses, bending the swords) before their submersion. This defacing is to be explained by the fact that the objects, having been devoted and made holy unto the god, had to be made materially worthless and unusable to men, thereby releasing their inherent worldly power. This is confirmed by Tacitus, *Annals* 13.57 who describes how the Chatti, *victores diversam aciem Marti ac Mercurio sacravere, quo voto equi, viri, cuncta occidioni dantur* ‘had devoted, in the event of victory, the enemy’s army to Mars and Mercury, a vow which consigns horses, men, everything indeed (on the vanquished side) to destruction.’ For Germanic devotional sacrifice cf. further Jens Peter Schjødt (2020b, p. 617), Jens Peter Schjødt (2020a, pp. 1166–1168), for bog burials cf. *Vsp* 38 n. below, for human sacrifice to Woden generally cf. *Háv* 138 n.

Outside of the Germanic sphere similar customs of holy war were practiced among the Romans (Latin *devotio*), as told in cf. Livy 8.9–10 where the Roman consul of 340 BCE, Publius Decius Mus, (like king Eric in *Stryð*) devotes not just the opposing legions but also himself, although Livy comments that this self-devotion was not strictly necessary for the ritual. Similarly, the Jews, as part of their martial rites (Hebrew קָרַב *q̄r̄b*; Lohfink 1986), would devote entire cities or nations to YHWH (Deuteronomy 20:16–17, Joshua 6:17–21, Joshua 8:1–29; note in Joshua 8:18 the detail of the god-given spear that leads to victory), after which, like in the Germanic bog deposits, also the arms and property of the vanquished were to be destroyed or set aside for the god (Leviticus 27:28–29).

2 fyrr ‘earlier’ | The R reading can hardly be correct, as this st. is describing a different war than the first (that of st. 20); it has probably arisen due to the similarity with st. 20/1.

3 borð-veggir ‘plank-wall’ | A dis legomenon in the Old Norse corpus; its only other occurrence is in *Þloft Glævu* 6 (SkP 1) from ca. 1032, where it describes some kind of wooden structure in which church-bells ring, probably a part of a stave-church. I take it to refer to the wooden fortification of the stronghold of the Eese, i.e., Osyard. Cf. note to st. 24.

4 vīg-spó ‘war-spae’ | The Wanes used a magic prophecy (*spó* ‘spae’) to win the battle and sack Osyard, the stronghold of the Eese.

- 24 Þà gingu **r**egin ǫll · à **r**ok-stóla,
 2 **g**inn-**h**ejlög **g**oð, · ok umb þat **g**ëttu=sk:
 Hvërr **h**efði lopt alt · lëvi blandit
 4 eða **é**tt **j**otuns · Óðs meý gefna?

[R 1v/19, H 20r/34,
 S 10v/25, T TODO,
 W TODO, U TODO]

Then went all the Reins onto their council-seats:
 the yin-holy Gods, and from each other took counsel of this:
 Who had blended all the air with deceit,
 or to the ettin’s lineage given Wode’s maiden [= Frow]?

ALL | After the wooden stronghold of the Eese, protected only by a plank-wall (*borð-vegg*), has been sacked by the Wanæs, they decide to build stronger fortifications. This leads into the story of the Master Builder as told at length in the following way in *Gylf* 42, which concludes by citing *Vsp* 24–25: An ettin craftsman arrives at Osyard and offers to build the Eese a great wall in exchange for Frow's hand and the Sun and Moon. He further promises that he will finish the entire wall alone over a single winter, or else the contract will be void. This seems reasonable to the Eese, who assume that he cannot possibly finish it in time, but things go awry when the ettin asks for permission to have the help of his workhorse Swaddlefare. Lock grants him this without first consulting the other Gods, after which the agreement is sealed with strong oaths. The horse turns out to be unexpectedly strong, and when only three days remain before summer, the wall is almost finished. The panicked Eese blame Lock and threaten him with violence if he does not get rid of the horse. His solution is to turn into a mare and distract it. The trick works and the two stay out all night; Lock is made pregnant, later giving birth to Slopner. When the ettin realises that he has been tricked he comes into his greatest ettin wrath, at which point the Eese call on Thunder who shortly appears and kills him.

4 Óðs mey 'Wode's maiden [= Frow]' | According to *Gylf* 35:7 and *Skm* 28, 44 Óðr 'Wode' (not to be confused with Óðinn 'Weden') was Frow's husband. — The ettins seem to have a particular obsession with abducting Frow, as seen also in *Prk* 8. This may be explained if Frow is the Indo-European dawn-goddess, something suggested not only by her association with the Sun and Moon in the Master Builder myth, but also by her weeping of golden tears (*Gylf* 35:9, *Skm* 40, 44; possibly a poetic description of the dawn), her epithet Meredall (*Mar-döll* 'Sea-brilliant', another likely poetic description; for the second element see *Vafþ* 25), and her possession of the fire-symbolic Blaze-Necklace (*brisinga-mæn*, cf. *Prk* 13/3 n.).

For the attempted theft of the sun and moon we may compare *Kalevala* (songs 47–49), where the evil witch *Loubi* of the Underworld steals the sun, moon, and fire and thereby deprives the world of its light; for further Finnic parallels cf. the Introduction to *Prk*. The attempted abduction of the Dawn has a more distant parallel in the Vedic *Valá*-myth (part of which is told in *RV* 10.108; Brereton and Jamison 2020, pp. 70, 71). In that myth the enemies of the Gods, the *Pani*-s, hide the Dawns in the form of kine in the *Valá*-cave and thereby prevent the natural cycle between Night and Day. With his great song the Storm-god *Indra* breaks open the cave, killing *Valá* and releasing the dawns. The common thread in these narratives is the fear that evil forces will steal away the light and warmth of the world, which in the Norse mythology reflects itself as the Fimblewinter, for which cf. *Vafþ* 44/3–4 n.

- 25 Þórr einn þar vá · þrunginn móði,
2 hann sjaldan sitr · es s-likr of fregn;
á gingu=sk eiðar, · orð ok sóri,
4 mól qll megin=lig, · es á meðal fóru.

[R 1v/20, H 20r/36,
S 10v/27, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

Thunder alone fought there, urged by wrath;
he seldom sits when of such he learns.
Trampled were oaths, speeches, and vows,
all the mighty treaties which between them had gone.

ALL | *The order of the lines follows RH; the two helmlings are reversed (i.e., 3–4, 1–2) in G.* 1 þar vá 'fought there' | so HTU; þar var 'was there' R; þat vann 'accomplished it' S; þat vá 'fought it out' W 3–4 á ... fóru. | om. W 4 fóru 'had gone' | vöru 'had been' HT

2 hann sjaldan sitr · es s-likr of fregn; 'he seldom sits when of such he learns' | When he learns of an ettin encroaching on the Gods (see note to st. 24). Thunder, as the defender of the Gods (*Prk* 18, Þdis Þórr in *Skp* 3), is willing to break even the strongest oaths if the safety of the Gods require it (cf. *Lok* 57–64).

- 26 Veið hōn Hēim·dalar · hljóð of folgit
 2 und hēið-vōnum · hēlgum baðmi;
 á sér hōn ausa=sk · aurgum forsi
 4 af vęði Val-fōðrs. · Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat?

[R 1v/23, H 20v/1]

She knows Homedall's sound [= Yellhorn] hidden
 beneath the shady, holy tree [= the Ash of Ugdrassle].
 She sees it being sprinkled with a muddy torrent
 from Walfather's pledge [= the Well of Mimer]. *Know ye yet, or what?*

ALL | The purpose of the stanza is quite obscure, but it appears to cryptically describe the Well of Mimer, into which Weden deposited his eye.

Cf. *Gylf* 15:10–13, about the roots of the Ash of Ugdrassle: *En undir þeirri rót, er til brim-þursa borfir, þar er Mímis-brunnr, er spekð ok mann-vit er í folgit, ok heitir sá Mímir, er á brunn'inn. Hann er fullr af vísendum, fyrir því at hann drekkir ór brunni'num af borni'nu Gjallar-borni. Þar kom Al-fjör ok beiddi=sk eins drykkjar af brunni'num, en hann fékk eigi, fyrr en hann lagði auga sitt at vęði. 'But enwrapped by the root which turns towards the Rime-Thurses there is the Well of Mimer. Wisdom and manwit are hid within, and he who owns the well is called Mimer. He is full of wise sayings, for he drinks from the Well out of the horn Yellhorn. Thither Allfather came and asked for a single drink from the well, but He did not get it before He laid down his eye as a pledge.' Immediately after this passage *Gylf* 15:14 quotes st. 28; cf. there.*

1 Hēim·dalar · hljóð 'Homedall's sound' | Interpreted by Snorre (see note to ALL) as the Yellhorn, for which cf. st. 45 below.

2 hēið-vōnum 'shady' | Literally 'light-less', *hēiðr* referring especially to the light of a clear sky.

3–4 á ... Val-fōðrs 'She sees ... pledge' | The interpretation of these lines is ambiguous, as 'á' R, 'aa' H can be read either (1) as the preposition 'on' or (2) as the noun 'river'. In the latter case, the lines would mean "She sees a river being fed by a muddy torrent from Walfather's pledge". Note that this ambiguity is not intentional, since the distinction between nasal and oral vowels and between long *á* and *ǿ* was still upheld in the 12th century (*FGT* 1950). (1) is adopted here since it is clearly the interpretation preferred by Snorre, who, in his prose, has the Norns *ausa* 'sprinkle, pour' *aur'inn* 'the mud' over the ash (*Gylf* 16:10–11, cited in st. 19 n. above). Since Snorre's version of the poem may theoretically have preserved the distinction, and since he was a native speaker of the language, his opinion is deferred to.

3 aurgum 'muddy' | Most likely the same mud (*aurr*) as in st. 19, there said of the Well of Weird.

4 vęði Val-fōðrs 'Walfather's pledge' | Weden's eye, which he gave up in exchange for a sip from the Well.

4 Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat? 'Know ye yet, or what?' | I.e., 'Do you, Weden, still know what I am saying, or what more do you want?' The second refrain (*steff*) of the poem, repeated in 28, 33, 34, 38, 40, 46, 59, and 60. Similar refrains are found in *Bdr* 7/4 et c., *Hdl* 17/4 et c.

- 27 Eīn sat hōn úti, · þá's hinn aldni kom
 2 yggjungr asa · ok i augu leið:
 [Vǫlva:] ,Hvers fregnið mik? · hví freistið mīn?

[R 1v/25]

Alone she sat outside when the Olden One came,
 the Frightener of the Eese [= Weden], and looked into her eyes.
 [The wallow:] 'Of what ask ye me? Why tempt ye me?'

ALL | Stanzas 27–29 appear to relate how the wallow was summoned by Weden.

1 Eín sat hön úti ‘Alone she sat outside’ | ON *sitja úti* ‘sit outside’ has a cultural connotation of meditating in order to communicate with the otherworld; cf. the noun *úti-seta*. — This line is directly repeated in *Sígsk* 6/1a.

3 freístið ‘tempt’ | *fręista* ‘tempt’ has a sense of testing someone, especially intellectually. Cf. *Háv* 26, *Vafþ* 3, 5.

- 28 Alt veit’k, Óðinn, · hvar auga falt
2 ĩ inum męra · Mímis brunni;
 drekkr mjōð Mimir · morgin hverjan
4 af vęði Val-fōðrs.‘ · Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat?

[R 1v/26, S 4v/27,
T TODO, W TODO,
U TODO]

I know it all, Weden: where thine eye thou hidst
in the famed Well of Mimer.
Mimer drinks mead every morning
from Walfather’s pledge. *Know ye yet, or what?*

1 falt | *add., but marked with erasure dots* þitt R 2 ĩ inum męra ‘in the famed’ | so RW; ĩ þeim enom meira ‘in the greater’ T; ĩ þeim enum męra ‘in the famed’ U; úr þeim enum męra ‘out of the famed’ S 4 vęði ‘pledge’ | þveistiþ S

ALL | This st. is quoted in *Gylf* 15:14, introduced by the words *svá segir í Völu-spá*: ‘so it says in the Spae of the Wallow’. For the immediately preceding prose description of the Well of Mimer (*Gylf* 15:10–13) see note to st. 26 above.

- 29 Valði hęnni Hęr-fōðr · hringa ok męn,
2 fekk spjōll spak=lig · ok spá-ganda;
 sá vítt ok of vítt · umb ver-ōld hverja.

[R 1v/29]

Host-Father chose for her rings and necklaces;
he got foresighted tidings and spae-gands—
she saw far and yet further through every world.

2 fekk spjōll spak=lig ‘got foreseen tidings’ | *emend.*; ‘fe spjōll spacig’ R

2 fekk spjōll spak=lig ‘got foreseen tidings’ | The reading of R may be interpreted either as (1) *fe-spjōll spak=lig* ‘foresighted wealth-tidings’ or (2) *fe, spjōll spak=lig* ‘wealth, foresighted tidings’. Both are metrically deficient; (1) since a second element in a cpd. like *fe-spjōll* cannot carry alliteration, and (2) since it has three strongly stressed nominals. In both cases the first nominal *fe* would be metrically expected to carry the alliteration. The word *fe* ‘wealth, cattle’ also makes little sense in context, since there is no transaction; Weden would be giving her expensive golden jewellery, of which he himself has no lack, in exchange for more gold. The emendation replaces *fe* with the verb *fekk* ‘got, received’. Verbs carry less stress than nominals, and the line thus becomes metrically equivalent to 28/3b *drekkr mjōð Mimir*. Semantically we get a parallel to st. 1, where the wallow likewise says that she will relate *spjōll* ‘tidings, sayings’ (cf. English *gospel*, lit. ‘good news’ which originally translates the Greek εὐαγγέλιον). For further discussion on the metrics see Haukur Þorgeirsson (2020, pp. 51–53), Males (2023b, p. 16).

2 spá-ganda ‘spae-gands’ | Spirits (familiar, gands; cf. st. 21/2 above) sent out in order to gather hidden wisdom.

- 30 Sá hōn val-kyrjur · vítt of komnar, [R 1v/30]
 2 gōrvar at ríða · til goð-þjóðar:
 Skuld hélt skildi, · en Skōgul ōnnur,
 4 Gunnr, Hildr, Gōndul · ok Gēir-skōgul;
 nú eru talðar · Nōnnur Hērjans,
 6 gōrvar at ríða · grund, val-kyrjur.

She saw Walkirries come from afar,
 ready to ride to the folk of men.
 Shild held a shield and Shagle another,
 Guth, Hild, Gandle and Goresghale—
 now are tallied the Nans of Harn (= Weden),
 Walkirries ready to ride o'er the earth.

2 goð-þjóðar 'folk of men' | The sense is uncertain, for in **R** the difficult cluster *þ* in *got-þjóð* (attested with *-t-* in *Heiðr* st. 94/8b, SkP 8) has been changed to *ð*. This means that the word *goð-þjóð* may contain either (1) *goti* 'Got, man' (thus 'folk of the Gots' or 'folk of men') or (2) *goð* ('folk of the Gods'). Of these two alternatives, the element *goti* in the sense 'man' is preferable, since the walkirries are presumably thought to be gathered in Walhall, ready to fly out into the world of men in order to attend battles and claim the best warriors for Weden (cf. *Hákm* 1). The present reading thus sees the cpd. as semantically identical to *ver-þjóð* 'folk of men', *Lok* 24/3. The Walkirries do also have a particular association with the Gots, who were remembered as having fought the greatest battles of the Migration Period (cf. note to *Vkv* 1/1). For the formally identical *Gát-þjóð* 'folk, land of the Gots' see *Helr* 8/1 n.

3–6 Skuld ... val-kyrjur. 'Shild ... earth.' | Judging especially by the phrase *nú eru talðar* 'now are tallied', these four lines seem to be a later insert from a thule counting the Walkirries.

5 Nōnnur Hērjans 'Nans of Harn (= Weden)' | *Nanna* 'Nan' (the name itself is a nursery word) was the wife of Balder, but the word is here certainly being used to refer generically to 'maidens, women'. Cf. *Þul Ásynja* (SkP 3), where the Walkirries are kenne'd *Óðins meyrjar* 'Weden's maidens'.

- 31 Ek sá Baldri, · blóðgum tífur, [R 2r/2]
 2 Óðins barni, · ør-lōg folgin;
 stóð of vaxinn · vōllum héri
 4 mjōr ok mjōk fagr · mistil-tēinn.

I saw Balder's, the bloody victim's,
 Weden's child's orlay hid:
 there stood grown higher than the plains
 a slender and most fair mistletoe.

3 vōllum | vōllu (with omitted abbreviation mark for -m) **R**

ALL | Told allusively in sts. 31–33 is the myth about Balder's death. The outline of this myth is as follows: Balder, the son of Weden and Frie, was killed by a mistletoe shot by his blind half-brother Hath, whose hand was guided by Lock. As Balder's father, it was Weden's duty to avenge him, yet he could not kill Hath who was also his son. Weden thus devised a plan and through sorcery seduced the woman Wrind (so *KormQ Sigdr* 3, SkP 3: *sēið Yggr til Rindar* 'Ug won Wrind through sorcery'). Wrind gave birth to Wonnē, who grew up fast, and after just one day was big enough to kill Hath and avenge Balder.

Other sources for Balder's death include the poems *Bdr* 8–11, *Lok* 28, and *Hdl* 28 and the prose texts *Gylf* 49 and Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 3.4.1–8. For the punishment of Lock for his role in the killing see sts. 34 and H31 below along with *Lok* P8.

The most similar text to *Vsp* 31–33 is *Bdr* 8–11, with which it is clearly textually related (cf. st. 32/4 n.). The chief narrative difference between the two passages is that *Bdr* 11/1 mentions Wrind, who is not found in *Vsp*.

Balder's death is treated at greater length in *Gylf* 49:3–25, which may be briefly summarised as follows: Balder has terrible nightmares about his own death, and so his mother Frie makes all sorts of things (fire, water, venom, metals, stones, trees, diseases, animals) swear oaths not to harm him. After this, the Eese make sport of shooting and cutting him since he cannot be harmed. Lock is annoyed by the spectacle and tricks Frie into telling him that there was one thing that did not swear the oath—the mistletoe, which was thought too young. Lock makes a mistletoe-arrow and gives it to the blind god Hath, guiding his hand towards Balder. Hath shoots and Balder dies. After this, *Gylf* 49 describes Balder's funeral, treated poetically in *Húdr*, at some length, alongside how the Eese failed to “weep Balder out of hell” (see *Eddbr* V). The binding of Lock is described in *Gylf* 50 (cf. st. 34 below). Most notably, *Gylf* 49 neglects to mention both Wonnell and Wrind. That part of the myth may have been left out of the Prose Edda for moral reasons due to its motifs of rape and kinslaying, but that it was known to the author is proven by two passages: *Gylf* 30:1–2: *Áli eða Váli heitir einn, sonr Óðins ok Rindar. Hann er djarfr í orrostum ok mjök happ-skeytr.* ‘Onnel or Wonnell is the name of one, the son of Weden and Wrind. He is brave in battles and a very lucky shot.’ *Skm* 19: *Hvernig skal kenna Vála? Svá, at kalla hann son Óðins ok Rindar, [...] hefni-ós Baldrs, dólg Haðar ok bana hans [...]* ‘How shall one ken Wonnell? Namely, by calling him the son of Weden and Wrind, [...] avenging os of Balder, the foe of Hath and his bane [...]’

The other lengthy prose retelling of the myth is Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 3.4, which relates the revenge narrative in typical euhemerized form, turning the gods Hath and Balder into flawed human rulers. The outline of that version is as follows: After Balder (Latin *Valderus*) has succumbed to a mortal wound dealt to him by Hath (*Høtherus*) with a treacherous sword, his father Weden (*Othbinus*) takes counsel from a group of wizards. One of them, Horsethief the Finn (*Rostiophus Phinnicus*), foresees that Wrind (*Rinda*), daughter of the Russian king, will bear him a son to avenge Balder.

Weden soon enlists in the Russian king's army and leads it to great victories, but he is spurned by his daughter. He tries various disguises but is continually refused, until at last he disguises himself as an old witch and volunteers himself as her private physician. When Wrind becomes ill, he binds her, ostensibly in order to administer a certain foul potion, but instead rapes her, implicitly with her father's consent. Their son Bo grows up to become a fierce raider. One day Weden summons him and reminds him of his duty to avenge his half-brother Balder; Bo slays Hath in a fierce duel but soon himself perishes from his wounds. It is worth noting that the seduction of Wrind as told by Saxo Grammaticus is unlikely to be a fantasy of that author, but on the contrary seems to derive from a now-lost West Norse source. The narrative bears a particular structural resemblance to Shinner's coercion of Gird in *Ski* 19–36; see further *Ski* 19 n., Brate (1913).

1 tífur ‘victim’s’ | This word is rather difficult and possibly corrupt. (1) It has been connected with *týr* ‘tew, god’, but the dat. sg. of *týr* is *tívi* and the intrusive *r* is unexplained. (2) A better explanation is given by CV, which connects it with OE *tiber*, *tifer* ‘victim, hostage’, but this also has problems. *blóðgum* ‘bloody’ is m. dat. sg., but OE *tiber* is neuter. If we are dealing with a m. noun **tífurr* with the same declension as *jofurr*, we would expect dat. sg. **tífri*— not *tífur* (which would, however, be the expected acc. sg.).

2 folgin ‘hid’ | The sense is either that it is Balder's orlay to be hid, that is, in the Underworld, whither he goes after his death (see *Eddbr* V), or that his orlay is metaphorically sealed and unalterable. The verb *fela* ‘hide, conceal’, of which *folgin* is the n. acc. pl. past participle, is used in poetry to describe burial in mounds, as in *Yf* 24 (“[...] And afterwards the victory-raisers hid (*fölu*) the ruler on Borrey”) and the 10th c. Karlevi runestone (Öl 1, ed. below under Runic Poetry from Sweden and Gotland).

- Baldrs bróðir vas · of borinn snimma,
 4 sá nam, Óðins sonr, · ein-néttr vega.

There came from that tree which looked so slender
 a baneful harm-flier—Hath took to shoot.
 Balder's brother [= Wönnel] was born early;
 he took, Woden's son, one night old, to fight.

4 sá nam, Óðins sonr, · ein-néttr vega | The three lines making up *Vsp* 32/4–33/2 are found near-identically (but with different tense) as *Bdr* 11/2–4. The direction of influence is unclear, since both poems appear fairly old. It is also plausible that both are borrowing from a now-lost third source dealing with Balder's death; that such a text must have existed is proven by the stanza in *Eddbr* V.

- 33 Þó éva hēndr · né hōfuð ķembðī,
 2 áðr á bál of bar · Baldrs and-skota;
 ķn Frigg of grét · ī Fķn-sqlum
 4 vō Val-hallar. · Vituð ér ķnn eða hvat?

[R 2r/6]

He ne'er washed his hands nor combed his head
 before onto the pyre he bore Balder's opponent [= Hath],
 but Frie lamented in the Fenhalls
 the woe of Walhall. *Know ye yet, or what?*

1–2 Þó ... and-skota 'He washed ... opponent' | Found near-identically in *Bdr* 11/3–4; see note to st. 32/4 above.

1 Þó ... ķembðī 'washed ... combed' | A collocation; see note to *Háv* 61 for discussion and other examples. Wönnel, being bound by the sworn mission to avenge his brother, could not engage in such acts of personal vanity. For the motif of a warrior bound not to engage in acts of personal hygiene until having fulfilled a vow we may compare the famous vow of Harold Fairhair, *at aldri* [...] *sķera bār mitt né ķemba, fyrr en ek hefī eignat-sk allan Nóreg með sköttum ok skyldum ok for-ráði, en deįja at ķðrum kosti*. 'never to cut my hair nor comb it before I have come to own all of Norway with taxation and duties and stewardship, but to die otherwise.' (*Haralds saga ins bār-fagra*, 4).

3 Fķn-sqlum 'the Fenhalls' | Never mentioned elsewhere in poetry, but *Gylf* 35:1–2 explains: *Þá mēlti Gangleri: „Hverjar eru ķsynjurnar?“ Hárr segir: „Frigg er óðst. Hon á þann bó, er Fēn-salir heita, ok er hann all-veg-ligr*. 'Then spoke Gangler: "Which are the Ossens?" High says: "Frie is the noblest. She owns the dwelling which is called the Fenhalls, and it is all glorious. [...]"

4 vō Val-hallar 'the woe of Walhall' | The deaths of two sons: Balder and Hath.

- 34 Hapt sá hōn liggja · und Hvera-lundi
 2 lē-gjarns líki · Loka á-þekkjan;
 þar sitr Sigyn · þey=gi of sínum
 4 veri vēl-glýjuð. · Vituð ér ķnn eða hvat?

[R 2r/8, H 20v/13]

A captive she saw lying beneath Wharlund:
 a guile-eager man's form, recognised as Lock.
 There sits Syein, not at all cheerful,
 o'er her husband. *Know ye yet, or what?*

1–2 Hapt ... á þekktan 'A captive ... Lock' | *om. and replaced by H31 H.* 2 lē-gjarns | *gramm. emend.*; lē-gjarn (*acc. sg.*) R

ALL | After Balder was avenged, the Eese went to catch his true killer, Lock, as told in *Lok* P8 and *Gylf* 50:3–25. They bound him with his own son's intestines and a snake was placed above his face to drool venom onto it. His wife, Syein, sat over him and collected the venom in a small basin, but when she had to empty it, he shook so furiously from the pain of the acidic venom that the earth shook.

2 lē-gjarns 'guile-eager' | An epithet of Lock, who is strongly associated with lē 'guile, deceit'. His name more often occurs paired with the adjective lē-viss 'guile-wise', so *Hym* 37/4, *Lok* 54/5, and *Sprla* 2.

- 35 **Ǫ** fellr austan · umb **E**itr-dala [R 2r/10]
2 sǫxum ok sverðum, · Slíðr heitir sú.

A river falls from the east through the Atterdales,
[a river] of saxes and swords; Slide it is called.

ALL | Having recounted the death of Balder and the binding of Lock, the wallow moves on to describing the places of evil in the world (sts. 35–41). The world has lost its innocence and the forces of chaos and disorder in the east and north plot its destruction. The present stanza is somewhat obscure, likely because half of it is missing. It is not in any way alluded to in *Gylf*; nor is it found in *H.* The river Slide is also mentioned in the long list of rivers in *Grm* 28/4.

2 Slíðr 'Slide' | An adjective describing a blade so sharp that the finger is cut when slid across it. Cf. *Akv* 23: saxi slíðr-þeitu (*dat. sg.*) 'slide-biting sax'.

- 36 Stóð fyr norðan · á Niða-vøllum [R 2r/11]
2 salr ór golli · Sindra étta;
 en annarr stóð · á Ö-kólni,
4 bjór-salr jøtuns, · en sá Brimir heitir.

To the north on the Nithwolds stood
a golden hall, of Sinder's lineage [DWARFS],
but another one stood on Uncolner,
an ettin's beer-hall, and he/it is called Brimmer.

ALL | Sts. 36–38 are paraphrased in *Gylf* 52:1–10, describing the world after its destruction and rebirth:

Þá mælti Gangleri: „Hvat verðr þá eptir, er brenndr er himinn ok jörð ok heimr allr; ok dauð goðin öll ok allir Ein-berjar ok alt mann-folk, ok hafið ér áðr sagt, at hverr maðr skal lifa í nokkvörum heimi um allar aldir?“ Þá svarar Þriði: „Margar eru þá vistir goðar ok margar illar; batst er þá at vera á Gim-léi á himni, ok all-gótt er til goðs drykkjar þeim, er þat þykkir gaman, í þeim sal, er Brimir beitir; bann stendr ok á himni. Sá er ok góðr salr, er stendr á Niða-fjellum, gorr af rauðu gulli; sá beitir Sindri. Í þessum solum skulu byggja góðir menn ok sið-látir. Á Ná-ströndum er mikill salr ok illr ok horfa norðr dyrr; bann er ok ofinn allr orma-bryggjum sem vanda-bús, en orma befið öll vitu inn í bús'it ok blása eitri, svá at eptir sal'num renna eit-rár, ok vaða þér ár eið-rofar ok morð-vargar, svá sem bér segir:“

‘Then spoke Gangler: “What will then happen thereafter when the heaven and the earth and the whole world are burned, and the Gods all are dead and all the Oneharriers and all man-kind—and [yet] ye have said earlier that every man will live in a certain home for all ages?” Then answers Third: “Many good dwellings are there then, and many evil ones; then it is best to be in Gemlee in the heaven. And in the hall which is called Brimmer it is fully furnished with good drink for those who find it pleasurable; that one also stands on the heaven. Another good hall is the one which stands on the Nithfells, made out of red gold; it is called Sinder. In these halls shall dwell good and virtuous men. On Neestrland there is a great hall and evil, and its doors face north. It is all interlaced with the spines of serpents like a wicker-house, but the heads of the serpents all face into the house and blow venom so that there run through the hall rivers of venom, and in those rivers wade oath-breakers and murder-wargs, just as it says here:”

After this passage *Gylf* cites sts. 37 and 38/1-2, followed by the prose: *En í Hver-gelmi er verst* ‘But in Wharyelmer it is the worst’, and a citation of st. 38/4.

It ought to be noted that the placement and contents of sts. 36–38 most likely exclude them from being descriptions of the cosmology of the world to come. That interpretation instead seems to be one of Snorre’s own inventions, as is strongly supported by the grammatical form *męin-svara* in st. 38/2.

1 *Niða-vøllum* ‘Nithwolds’ | ‘The dark plains’. The paraphrase of this st. in *Gylf* 52:6 suggests that the version of *Vsp* used by Snorre had the reading **Niða-fjellum* ‘Nithfells’ (cf. st. 62). The first element is, in any case, *nið* ‘the waning of the moon’ and refers to great darkness; cf. the adjective *niða-myrkr* ‘pitch darkness’.

4 *en sá Brimr heitir* ‘and he/it is called Brimmer’ | It is syntactically ambiguous whether Brimmer is the name of the ettin or the hall itself. *Gylf* 52:5 clearly considers it the name of the hall.

- 37 **S**al sá hōn standa · **s**ólu fjarri
2 **N**á-strōndu ā, · **n**orðr horfa dyrr;
 falla **ę**itr-dropar · **i**nn umb ljóra,
4 sá ’s **u**ndinn salr · **o**rma hryggjum.

[R 2r/13, H 20v/19,
S 17v/1, T TODO,
W TODO, U 18v/19]

A hall she saw standing far from the sun
on Neestrland; north face its doors.
Venom-drops fall in through its smoke-vent;
that hall is wound with the spines of snakes.

1 sá hōn ‘she saw’ | vęit’k ‘I know’ G.

ALL | Cited in *Gylf* 52; see st. 36 above.

- 38 **S**á hōn þar vaða · þunga strauuma
2 **m**ęnn **m**ęin-svara · ok **m**orð-varga
 ok þann’s **a**nnars gleþr · **ę**yra-rūnu.
4 Þar saug **N**íð-hōggr · **n**ái fram-gingna;
 slęit **v**argr **v**era. · **V**ituð ér ęnn eða hvat?

[R 2r/15, H 20v/21,
S 17v/2, T TODO,
W TODO, U 18v/21]

There she saw wading through heavy streams
false-swearing men and murder-wargs
and him who seduces another man’s ear-whisperess [WIFE].
There Nithehewer sucked passed-on corpses;
the warg tore apart men. *Know ye yet, or what?*

1 Sá hōn 'she saw' | so R; sér hōn 'she sees' H; skulu 'shall [wade]' G 2 mēin-svara ok morð--varga | *corr. from morð-varga mēin-svara ok by an inversion mark in same band* R. 2 mēin-svara | mēins-vara R; mēin-svarar U 2 morð-varga 'murder-wargs' | morð-vargar (*nom. pl.*) RSTW; morðingjar 'murderers' U. 3 ok þann's annars glępr · çyra-rúnu. | *om. G.* 3 çyra-rúnu | †çyrna runa† H 4 saug 'sucked' | so H; †svę† R; kvęlr 'torments' G

ALL | LL 1-2, 4 are cited in *Gylf* 52; see st. 36 above. — This st. takes a distinctly moralising tone otherwise rare in pre-Christian poetry; cf. st. 44 below. The crimes are what one might expect in a source from Germanic antiquity: perjury, murder and adultery. In Scandinavian and Anglo-Saxon laws the perpetrator of such crimes held the dishonourable title of nothing, that is, one afflicted with *niðe* ('evil, shame'), and was thereby stripped of his personal rights. It is fitting, then, that such *niðings* should be tortured by a creature named *Nithehewer* ('*Nithe-striker*'). For the crimes we may cf. the list of *ú-dáðar-męnn* ('criminals', lit. 'men of misdeeds') not eligible for burial in church grounds according to *Gula* 23: *dróttins-svikar* 'traitors to their lord', *morð-vargar* 'murder-wargs', *trygg-rafar* 'truce-breakers', *þjófar* 'thieves', and those men who *sjálfir spilla önd sinni* 'themselves destroy their spirit', i.e., commit suicide. According to that law these men were instead to be buried in a *flóðar-mál* 'flood-mark', where *sér móti-sk ok grón torfu* 'see and green turf meet' (NGL I, p. 13), something which also has clear parallels in the *Lex Frisionum* (TODO). The practice of burying criminals deemed particularly shameful not just in unhallowed ground but specifically in bogs and flood-marks is well attested both in archeology and in literary sources relating to the Germanic peoples from Tacitus (*Germania*, ch. 12) onwards. Upon examining these parallels together, it is hard not to see the *þungir straumar* 'heavy streams' of the present stanza as a reflex of such customs, so that the whole st. in fact appears to describe the Heathen religious belief about bog burials, namely that those buried in them were punished by a watery dragon in the afterlife.

Watery punishment in the afterlife is also described in *Reg* 3-4 and possibly in *Grm* 21, and a perjurious woman is drowned in a bog in *3 Guðr* 10. The argument is pursued at at greater length in *RosenbergForthcoming*.

2 mēin-svara 'false-swearing' | Acc. pl. of **mēin-svari* or **mēin-svarr*, an otherwise unattested adj. Related words are *mēin-sóri* 'false oath, perjury' and *mēin-svari* m. 'perjurer'. This adjective is in the acc. pl. in 3/4 mss. of *Gylf*, but this is grammatically irregular since the G version of line 1 has the verb *skulu* 'shall [wade]' which takes a nominative subject. The most likely explanation for this is that Snorre, when quoting the present stanza, deliberately changed the first words of l. 1 from an archetypal **sér/sá hōn* 'she sees/saw' (shared with RH) to *skulu* in order to make the poetry fit better with his eschatological interpretation (cf. st. 36 n.). In doing so he overlooked the grammatical form of the object phrase *męnn mēin-svara*, probably due to the rarity of the adjective. This has important consequences for our evaluation of Snorre's reliability when citing Eddic verse since it shows an instance of his deliberately changing the wording of a stanza to conform to his prose. Even so, the present instance should probably be considered exceptional, since most other textual variants in Eddic sts. cited in *Gylf* are better explained as resulting from scribal or oral transmission.

2 morð-varga 'murder-wargs' | Men outlawed for murder, which is not all instances of the taking of human life, but specifically when done clandestinely or in ways deemed particularly reproachable.

3 çyra-rúnu 'ear-whisperess' | Acc. sg. of *çyra-rúna*, with the second element derived from *rún* 'whisper, secret'; cf. the masculine (*of*) *rúni* 'friend, confidant', OE *ge-rúna* 'counselor'. This word is also used in *Háv* 115 which likewise contains a warning not to seduce another man's wife.

4 Nið-höggr 'Nithehewer' | Also appearing in st. 62 below and further in *Grm* 36/4.

39 Austr býr hin aldna · ÿ Ēarn-viði
2 ok fōðir þar · Fęnris kindir;
verðr af þeim ǥllum · çinna nøkkurr
4 tungls tјјgari · ÿ trolls hami.

[R 2r/17, H 20v/2,
S 4r/10, T TODO,
U 5r/27, W TODO]

In the east dwells the old hag in Ironwood
and there rears the brood of Fenrer [WOLVES].
Out of them all one becomes—I know not which—
a snatcher of the moon in a troll's hame.

1 býr 'dwells' | so HG; sat 'sat/stayed' R 1 aldna 'old' | arma 'wretched' U 1 Ēarn-viði 'Ironwood' | metr. emend.; Járn-viði R HSWU; Járn-viðjum 'Ironwoods' T 2 fōðir 'rears' | so HG; fōddi 'reared' R 3 af | ór ST 4 tjúgari 'snatcher' | †tuigan† T; tregari 'troubler' U.

ALL | The old hag, who is not identified in any other source, raises the cubs of the wolf Fenrer. One of these wolves, identified by Snorre as Moongarm (*Mána-garmr*), will eventually swallow the moon. For the myth of the wolves that chase the sun and moon cf. *Grm* 40, according to which the sun is chased by the wolf Sholl, while another wolf, Hate, runs in front of it, and *Vafþ* 46–47, where the sun is said to be swallowed by Fenrer. It is likely that even the Heathen poets themselves were not entirely in agreement about the exact details of these future events; for further “wolfish” confusion, cf. st. 43/1–2 below.

These wolves are dealt with in *Gylf* 12, which synthesizes from *Vsp* 39–40 along with the two aforementioned sources. Relevant for the present sts. is *Gylf* 12:7, 9–12:

Gýgr ein býr fyrir austan Mið-garð i þeim skógi, er Járn-viðr heitir. [...] In gamla gýgr fōðir at sonum marga jóna ok alla i vargs líkjum, ok þaðan af eru komnir þessir ulfar. Ok svá er sagt, at af étu'inni verðr sá einna máttkastr, er kallaðr er Mána-garmr. Hann fylli-sk með fjörvi allra þeira manna, er deýja, ok hann gleypir tungl, en stökkvir blóði himin ok loft qll. Þaðan týnir sól skini sínu, ok vindar eru þá ó-kyrrir ok gnýja beðan ok bandan.

'A lonely ogress lives to the east of Middenyard in the forest called Ironwood. The old ogress raises many ettins as her sons, all in the likenesses of wolves, and thereof these wolves [= Sholl and Hate] come. And so it is said that from that lineage a single one becomes the mightiest, and he is called Moongarm. He fills himself with the life of all those men who die and he swallows the moon and stains the heaven and all the air with blood. Thereof the sun loses her shine and then the winds are violent and howl hither and thither.'

Immediately after this passage *Gylf* 12:13 quotes *Vsp* 39–40, introduced by the words *svá segir í Völu-spá*: 'so it says in the Spæ of the Wallow'.

1 Austr 'In the east' | The cardinal direction associated with ettins and other fiendish creatures; cf. *Hym* 5/1 n.

1 hin aldna 'the old hag' | Comparatively, the 'hag' (an insertion in the translation to clarify the gender of ON *aldna*) appears to correspond to the Finnish *Loubi*, the toothless mistress of *Pohjola* (the Northland). In *Kalevala* 47–49 she steals away the sun, moon, and fire (see st. 24 n. above). Both women are part of the evil forces that constantly struggle against the Gods by disrupting the natural cosmic order and its cycles.

4 tjúgari 'snatcher' | Hapax, generally understood as either **tjúga* 'drag, pull' or *tjúga* f. 'pitchfork' + *-ari* 'er'. The agentive suffix *-ari* is a young feature found nowhere else in the poem, and it is therefore possible that this word is corrupt. Note that U's *tregari* 'troubler' is metrically impossible and prob. an instance of trivialisation from **tjúgari*, as found in the other mss. of *Gylf* (Males 2023b, pp. 181, 194). If the word is corrupt, it must have occurred early in transmission, since *tjúgari* is found in all three recensions (RHG).

- 40 Fylli=sk fjörvi · fēigra manna,
2 rýðr ragna sjot · rauðum dreýra,
svort verða sól-skin · of sumur eptir,
4 veðr qll vá-lynd. · Vituð ér enn eða hvat?

He fills himself with the lifeblood of fey men;
he reddens the abode of the Reins [HEAVEN] with red gore.

[R 2r/19, H 20v/4,
S 4r/11, T TODO,
U 5r/28, W TODO]

Black do the sun's rays turn in the summers thereafter,
the winds all woeful. *Know ye yet, or what?*

3 svört verða sól-skin 'Black turn the sun's rays' | so HG; svart var þá sól-skin 'Black was then the sun's shine' R 4 vá-lynd | †va. ly.† U

3 svört verða sól-skin 'Black turn the sun's rays' | As part of the Fimblewinter; see *Vafþ* 44/3–4 n. — The reading of R, although semantically meaningful, is outvoted by the other mss. It is also unlikely on its own merit, since the past tense of *var* 'was' disagrees with the present tense of the other verbs in this st. For this reason, R's 'ú þa' (resolving as *var þa* 'was then') is most likely a scribal error, where the archetypal **úþa* (resolving as **verþa*, so SU) was miscopied as **úþa* (resolving as **varþa*), and then reinterpreted as *var þa* by the addition of a space.

- 41 Sat þar á haugi · ok sló hǫrpu
2 gýgjar hirðir, · glaðr Eggþér;
gól umb hǫnum · i Gagl-viði
4 fagr-rauðr hani, · sá's Fjalarr heitir.

[R 2r/21, H 20v/16]

There he sat on the mound and struck the harp,
the gow's herdsman, glad Edgethew.
For him crowed in Gaggleswood
the fair-red cock who is called Feller.

1 Sat þar á haugi 'There he sat on the mound' | The motif of ettins sitting on burial mounds is also found in *Þrk* 6 and *Ski* 11. The precise significance of this is uncertain, but mounds are liminal spaces where the worlds of the dead and the living are particularly close, and they feature prominently in pre-Christian ritual (TODO: PCRN-HS reference).

3 gól umb hǫnum 'For him crowed' | The crowing of three cocks—the first in Ettinham, the second in Walhall, the third in Hell—heralds the destruction of the world.

3 Gagl-viði 'Gaggleswood' | An otherwise unknown location; the first element is *gagl* 'wild goose'. Gaggleswood is perhaps the same as Ironwood.

- 42 Gól umb ǫsum · Gollin·kambi,
2 sá vękr hǫlða · at Hęrja-fǫðrs,
ęn annarr gęlr · fyr jǫrð neðan
4 sót-rauðr hani · at sǫlum Hęljar.

[R 2r/23, H 20v/18]

For the Eese crowed Goldencomb;
he wakes the heroes at the Father of Hosts',
but another one crows beneath the earth:
a soot-red cock in the halls of Hell.

1 Gollin-kambi 'Goldencomb' | This cock may be depicted on two of the 11th or 12th c. tapestries from Överhogdal, Härjedalen in Sweden. The relevant tapestries show a great tree surrounded by a mass of animals, and on the top of the tree stands a bird; the pre-Christian nature of their symbolism is confirmed by the depiction of an eight-legged horse, certainly to be identified with Weden's horse Slopner.

2 at Hęrja-fǫðrs 'at the Father of Hosts' | In Weden's hall, Walhall, where the Onecharriers reside.

- 43 Geyr Garmr mjök · fyr Gnipa-helli,
 2 festr mun slitna, · en freki rinna;
 fjöld veit hön fróða, · framm sé'k lengra
 4 of ragna rök, · rømm sig-tíva.

[R 2r/25]

Garm barks loudly before the Gnip-Caves;
 the rope will snap and the Wolf will run.
 She knows much lore; I see further ahead
 about the mighty Rakes of the Reins, of the Victory-Tews [GODS].

ALL | The first occurrence of the third refrain (*stef*), repeated several times in the section of the poem dealing with the Rakes of the Reins (ON *ragna rök*), culminating with st. 55. The destruction of the world, involving the deaths of all major Gods save Balder, is treated at length in *Gylf* 51. Furthermore, it is the subject of a wisdom contest in *Vafþ* 44–53 and alluded to in *Lok* 39, 41.

1–2 Garm ... rinna ‘Garm ... run’ | *Gylf* 51 distinguishes between the Fenrerswolf fought by Weden and the wolf Garm fought by Tew. Yet this is probably the result of later systematizing. The wolf which is said to come loose in the present stanza must surely be the Fenrerswolf, and since in *Gylf* 34:10–42 it is primarily Tew who deals with the Fenrerswolf, we would naturally expect him to fight it during the Rakes of the Reins as well, just like Thunder fights his rival, the Midden-yardswyrn, and Lock fights Homedall (*Gylf* 51:48; see *Þrk* 13/3 n.). *Vsp* 51, however, sees Weden fight the Wolf instead, and this requires a separate wolf for Tew to fight, hence Garm. It is thus likely that these two wolves were originally not distinct creatures. For the story of the Fenrerswolf see *Lok* 38/3–4; for further “wolfish” confusion, cf. st. 39 above.

3 sé'k ‘I see’ | In R the use of the present tense *sé'k*, *sér* ‘I see, she sees’ marks a shift from the past tense (*sá* ‘saw’) of the Balder-episode (31–34) and the description of Nestrand (37–38), a subtle but important change. The use of the present tense continues for the rest of the poem. Note that in H the verb is found in the present tense already in 37–38, and we lack the Balder-episode to compare with.

- 44 Bróðr munu berja=sk · ok at bõnum verða=sk,
 2 munu systrungar · sífjum spilla;
 hart 's i hēimi, · hór-dómr mikill,
 4 skeggj-öld, skalm-öld, · skildir klofnir,
 vind-öld, varg-öld, · áðr ver-öld steypi=sk
 6 mun engi maðr · qðrum þyrma.

[R 2r/28, H 20v/24,
 S 16r/34, T TODO,
 W TODO, U TODO]

Brothers will fight and become each other's banes;
 the children of sisters will defile their kinship.
 It is hard in the Home! Great whoredom,
 axe-age, sword-age—shields split asunder—
 wind-age, warg-age. Before the man-age tumbles
 no man will spare another.

2 systrungar ‘the children of sisters’ | †stystrungar† T 3 i hēimi ‘in the Home’ | so RHU; með hōðum ‘among men’ STW 4 skildir ‘shields’ | add. ‘ro ‘are’ R 4 klofnir ‘split’ | klofna ‘become split’ U 5 áðr ‘before’ | unz (norm.) ‘until’ U 5 steypi=sk ‘tumbles down’ | add. after this l. grundir gjalla · gífr fljúgandi (norm.) ‘foundations shrill, fiends flying’ H 6 mun engi maðr · qðrum þyrma. ‘no man will spare another’ | om. STW 6 engi | †enn† U

ALL | St. 44 is cited in *Gylf* following *Gylf* 51:5–7, which puts the stanza in the context of three winters of war preceding the three winters that make up the Fimblewinter: *En áðr ganga svá aðrir þrír vetr, at þá er um alla veröld orrostur miklar. Þá drepa-sk bróðr fyrir á-girni sakar, ok engi þyrmir fœður eða syni í mann-dröpum eða sífa-sliti. Svá segir í Völu-spó*: ‘But before them come three other winters when throughout all the world there are great battles. Then do brothers slay each other for reasons of covetousness, and no man spares his father or son in murder of men or destruction of kinship. So it says in the Spae of the Wallow’. For the Fimblewinter, as described in *Gylf* 51:2–4, see *Vafþ* 44.

This stanza takes a noticeably moral tone, which may be compared with st. 38 above. In the view of the wallow, human moral failures accompany the decline and ultimate destruction of the World, and perhaps even hasten its arrival. This moralising may be seen as a sign of Christian influence (cf. e.g. *Musp* 59 for a similar condemnation), but the crimes listed both here and in st. 38 (perjury, murder, adultery, kinslaying, and incest) were all undoubtedly also forbidden in pre-Christian Germanic law. In the pre-Christian worldview a threat to the established social order was thus also seen as a threat to the very existence of the World itself.

2 sífum spilla ‘defile their kinship’ | I.e., ‘commit incest’, apparently referring to marriages between first cousins, which are prohibited in all mediæval Scandinavian law codes. Compare related words found in the laws, like *frænd-semis-spell* ‘incest’ and especially *sífa-spell* ‘id.’ — The idea of incest as a sign of later ages is also found in *R̥V* 10.10.10a–b (norm. and tr., N. S. Dwibhashyam.): *Á gʷā tā gacʰān · útārā yugāni, // yātra jāmāyah · kṛnāvann ājāmi* ‘There shall come indeed those later ages when relatives shall do (acts) not (fit for) relatives.’

5 vind-öld ‘wind-age’ | In H the *v* is capitalized, marking the beginning of a new stanza.

5 ver-öld ‘man-age’ | Translated as such since it stands next to various other compounds with the second element *öld* ‘age’. ON *ver-öld* is cognate with English “world” (cf. 29/3 above), but in ON the sense ‘cosmos, universe’ is usually expressed by *heimr* (e.g., in l. 3 of the present stanza).

- 45 Leika Míms synir, · en mjötuðr kyndi=sk
2 at hinu galla · Gjallar-horni;
 hött bléss Heim-dallr, · horn ’s á lopti;
4 mēlir Óðinn · við Míms höfuð;
 skelfr Ygg-drasils · askr standandi,
6 ymr it aldna tré, · en jötunn losnar.

[R 2r/32, H 20v/27,
S 17r/7, T TODO,
W TODO, U 18v/7]

Mime’s sons [ETTINS] play and the Measurer advances
at [the sounding of] the shrill Yellhorn.
Homedall blows high; the horn is aloft;
Weden speaks with Mime’s head.
The Ash of Ugdrassle quakes, standing:
the old tree whines and the ettin comes loose.

1–2 Leika ... Gjallar-horni; ‘Mime’s ... Yell.’ | *om.* G 2 hinu | *so* H; †en† R. 4 mēlir ‘speaks’ | †mey† S; †nie† T 4 Míms | Mímis TU 5–6 | *These lines are reversed in* R. 6 en jötunn losnar ‘and the ettin comes loose’ | çsir ’ro á þingi U 6 losnar | *add. H41* H.

1 mjötuðr kyndi=sk ‘the Measurer advances’ | The sense seems to be that the destruction swiftly comes to pass through the great predestined calamities, but both words require some elucidation. ON *mjötuðr* ‘the Measurer’ often means merely ‘Fate’ (e.g. *Sigsk* 71), but is a m. agent noun and as such is not entirely impersonal, perhaps rather referring to an overarching fate-principle. In OS poetry the cognate *metod* means ‘fate’ (*Heli* 128, 511) and also occurs in the cpds. *metod-gi-skafi*, *metod(o)-gi-skapu* ‘shapes of the Measurer’, i.e., ‘decrees of fate’ (*Heli* 2190, 2210, 4827; cf. *reggin(o)-gi-skapu* ‘shapes of the Reins’, *Heli* 2593, 3347, *wurd-gi-skapu* ‘shapes of Weird’, *Heli* 127, 3692); in OE poetry *meotod* comes to refer to the Christian God (e.g. *Cadman* 2). *kyndi=sk* ‘advances’ must be in the pres. sg. and is a form of *kynda=sk* ‘be kindled, be set ablaze’, which is here understood to refer metaphorically to the swift rising of the calamity. CV suggests emending to *kynni=sk* ‘makes itself known’. The literal sense ‘is kindled’ could be used to argue for an emendation of *mjötuðr* to *mjöt-viðr* ‘Measuring-Tree’ (cf. st. 2/4 above), but this would yield an A1 verse with anacrusis, which is not metrically acceptable in *Vsp*.

2 Gjallar-horni ‘Yellhorn’ | Or the ‘Horn of Yell’, viz. the river *Gjöll* ‘Yell’ as mentioned in *Grm* 28/6. The root of the river’s name is the same as English “yell”.

- 46 Hvát ’s með þúsum? · hvat ’s með þlfum?
2 gnýr allr Jötun-heímr, · ęsir ’ro à þingi,
stynja dvergar · fyr stęin-durum
4 vęgg-bergs vísir. · Vituð ęr ęnn eða hvat?

[R 2v/8, H 20v/30,
S 17r/9, T TODO,
W TODO, U 18v/9]

What is with the Eese? What is with the Elves?
All Ettinham roars; the Eese are at the Thing.
The Dwarfs groan before gates of stone,
the lords of the cliff-side. *Know ye yet, or what?*

1 þlfum ‘Elves’ | ęsynjum ‘Ossens’ U 2 gnýr ... þingi | om. U 3 stęin-durum | stęins dýrum
U; stęin-dýrum HW 4 vęgg-bergs vísir | om. U 4 vęgg-bergs | vęg-bergs HTW

1 Hvát ’s með þúsum? · hvat ’s með þlfum ‘What is with the Eese? What is with the Elves?’ | A line indicating cosmic distress. It also occurs in *Þrk* 7/1, where it is answered by *Illt ’s með þúsum, · illt ’s með þlfum!* ‘Tis ill with the Eese! ’Tis ill with the Elves!’. This is certainly the implication of the present stanza.

2 þingi ‘the Thing’ | The Thing of the Gods, where the Gods assemble in times of distress; see note to st. 6/1–2 above.

- 47 Gęyr nú Garmr mjøk · fyr Gnipa-hęlli,
2 fęstr mun slitna, · ęn freki rinna;
fjølð vęit hön fróða, · framm sé’k lęngra
4 of ragna røk, · rømm sig-tíva.

[R 2v/4, H 20v/32]

Now Garm barks loudly before the Gnip-Caves;
the rope will snap and the Wolf will run.
She knows much lore; I see further ahead
about the mighty Rakes of the Reins, of the Victory-Tews [GODS].

- 48 Hrymr ękr austan, · hęf=sk lind fyrir,
2 sný=sk Jörmun-gandr · i Jötun-móði,

[R 2v/4, H 20v/32,
S 17r/11, T TODO,
W TODO]

ormr knýr unnir, · en ari hlakkar,
 4 slitr nái nef-fölr; · Nagl-far losnar.

Rim drives from the east; he holds his shield before him;
 Ermengand writhes in ettin-wrath.

The Wyrn drives forth the waves and the eagle screams,
 the pale-beak tears at corpses; Nailfare comes loose.

3 en ari hlakkar ‘and the eagle screams’ | örn mun hlakka ‘the eagle will scream’ ST

4 Nagl-far ‘Nailfare’ | The ship on which the fiends sail from the east. It is described in *Gylf* 51:13–16: *Þá geysisk haf’it á lönd’in, fyrir því at þá sný-sk Mið-garðs-ormr í jötun-móð ok sókir upp á land’it. Þá verðr ok þat, at Nagl-far losnar, skip þat, er svá heitir. Þat er gert af nögglum dauðra manna, ok er þat fyrir því varnunar vert, ef maðr deyr með ó-skornum nögglum, at sá maðr eykr mikit efni til skips’ins Nagl-fars, er goð’in ok menn vildi seint, at gert yrði. En í þessum sývar-gang flýtr Nagl-far: ‘Then the sea surges onto the lands because the Middenyardswyrn writhes in ettin-wrath and attacks the land. Then it also happens that Nailfare comes loose—the ship which is called thus; it is made from the nails of dead men, and therefore it is worth a warning if a man dies with uncut nails, that that man greatly increases the material for the ship Nailfare, which the Gods and men would rather were not done. But in this motion of the sea Nailfare floats.’*

The motif of the Devil rowing a boat made out of improperly discarded nail clippings is widespread in Scandinavian and Finnish folklore (Krohn 1912), and thus the “nail-ship” cannot be a mere Snorronian invention. Specific rituals for disposing cut nails (and hair) are found in many Indo-European cultures, and clearly described ramifications for not observing them are also found in Zoroastrianism (*Videvdāt* 17.2–3: “[W]hen one arranges and cuts his hair and clips his nails and then lets them fall into holes in the earth or into furrows, [...] demons come forth, and from these improprieties monsters come forth from the earth which mortals call lice and which devour the grain in the fields and the clothes in the closets”) (Lincoln 1977). Beyond the Indo-Europeans, Judaism also has a taboo against discarding nail-clippings wherever a pregnant woman might walk, lest they supernaturally cause her to miscarry.

An interesting psychological commonality presents itself in all three traditions, namely that the improper clipping or disposal of nails is thought to threaten the fundamental stability of the cosmos by bringing about the principal fear of each culture. In Judaism, singularly concerned with the fertility of its adherents (witness its famous ban on masturbation, *Šbulchan Arukh, Even HaEzer* 23:1: **ועון זה חמור מכל עבירות שבתורה** ‘more severe than all Torah transgressions’) it is the miscarriage; in the dualistic Zoroastrianism, the proliferation of demons; and in the Germanic religion, with its Wiking Age eschatological obsession (cf. Introduction to the poem), it is the End Times.

49 Kjóll ferr austan · koma munu Mú-spells
 2 of lög lýðir, · en Loki stýrir;
 fara flfl-męgir · með freka allir,
 4 þęim es bróðir · Bý-lęists i fęr.

The ship fares from the east—come will Muspell’s
 subjects o’er the sea—and Lock steers it.
 The devil-lads all fare with the Wolf;
 with them comes the brother of Bilast [= Lock] along.

1 Kjól ‘The ship’ | Nailfare, as mentioned in the previous st.

1–2 Mú-spells ... lýðir ‘Muspell’s subjects’ | According to *Gylf* 4:5–8 *Mú-spell* ‘Muspell’ or *Mú-spells-heimr* ‘Muspellsham’ is the name of the primordial realm of fire in the South, ruled over by Surt (cf. note to st. 3 above).

[R 2v/6, H 20v/34,
 S 17r/13, T TODO,
 W TODO]

During the destruction the world will be assailed by the nebulous *Mú-spells-synir* ‘Muspell’s sons’ (*Lok* 42, *Gylf* 13:9, 37:19, 51:21, 51:28) or *Mú-spells-megir* ‘Muspell’s lads’ (*Gylf* 13:6, 51:25), who are to be identified with *Mú-spells lýðir* and the *fiðr-megir* ‘devil-lads’ in the pres. st.

ON *Mú-spell* has West Germanic cognates in OHG *Mú-spilli* (*Musp* 56) and OS *Mú-spelle* (*Heli* 2591, 4358), both referring to the destruction of the world in a Christian context. For the etymology see *Musp* 56 n.

- 50 **S**urtr ferr sunnan · með sviga lévi,
2 skínn af sverði · sól val-tíva;
 grjót-björg gnata, · en gífr rata,
4 troða halir hæl-veg, · en himinn klofnar.

[R 2v/10, H 20v/36,
S₁ 2r/35, S₂ 17r/15,
T₁ 3r/11,
W TODO, U TODO]

Surt fares from the south with the twig’s betrayer [FIRE];
from the swords of the slain-Tews ⟨gods⟩ [it] shines [like] the sun.
Rocky cliffs clash, but the fiends roam;
men tread the Hellway, but the Heaven cracks.

1 Surtr | Svartr U 3 gífr rata ‘the fiends roam’ | guðar hrata ‘the gods(?) stagger’ (wo. doubt corrupt) U

ALL. | This st. is cited twice in all mss. of *Gylf* save U. The second citation is in the sequence of sts. 45–54 cited in *Gylf* 51:50 (see st. 45 n.), but the first is alone, introduced by *Gylf* 4:5–9:

Þá mælti Þriðji: „Fyrst var þó sá heimr í suðr-hálftu, er Múspell heitir. Hann er ljós ok heitr. Sú átt er logandi ok brennandi. Er hann ok óförr þeim, er þar eru út-lendir ok eigi eigu þar óðul. Sá er Surtr nefndr, er þar sitr á lands-enda til land-varnar. Hann hefir loganda sverð, ok í enda ver-aldar mun hann fara ok herja ok sigra öll goð’in ok brenna allan þeim með eldi. Svá segir í Völuspö:

‘Then spoke Third: “Yet, first there was the home in the southern half which is called Muspell. It is hot and bright. That domain is blazing and burning. It is also unpassable to those who are foreigners and do not have their home there. Surt is he called who sits there at the border of the land to defend the land. He has a blazing sword, and in the end of the world he will go and harry and vanquish all the Gods and burn all the Home with fire. So it says in the Spae of the Wallow.’

2 skínn af sverði · sól val-tíva ‘from the swords of the slain-Tews ⟨gods⟩ [it] shines [like] the sun’ | A difficult line. As the sun has been blackened (st. 40) the world is instead lit up by the flashing swords of the Gods as they head into the battle with Surt. Snorre instead interprets it as a reference to Surt’s sword, *Gylf* 51:22–23: *Surtr riðr fyrst ok fyrir bonum ok eptir bæði eldr brennandi. Sverð hans er gott mjök; af því skínn hjartara en af sólu.* ‘Surt rides first and both ahead of and behind him is a burning fire. His sword is very good; from it, it shines brighter than the sun.’

The main difficulty lies in the fact that *val-tíva* may be read either (1) as gen. pl. of the attested *val-tívar* ‘the slain-Tews [GODS]’ (so La Farge and Tucker (1992); cf. below st. 59 (n.) and *Hym* 1/1) or (2) as gen. sg. of an unattested m. *n*-stem **val-tívi* ‘the slaughter-Tew [= Surt]’ (so CV, Fritzner, and presumably also Snorre). Reading 1 is adopted here as the simpler explanation because it does not presuppose an otherwise unattested *n*-stem derivative of *týr* ‘tew, god’—especially as Surt is not a god—and because the pl. *val-tívar* demonstrably occurs elsewhere in the poem.

A second issue arises over whether the gen. *val-tíva* modifies (a) *sverði* ‘sword’ or (b) *sól* ‘sun’.

In readings 1a and 2a the sense would prob. be that the flashing sword shines like the sun, reflecting the intensity of the battle. Although one may expect a pl. *sverðum* ‘swords’ for 1a, that is not a major problem, since sg. forms are often used with pl. possessors in the Old Germanic languages (e.g. *Hárþ* 39/3). Case 1b does not seem very likely since ‘sun of the GODS’ is not a known kenning-type. If 2b is adopted we may see a kenning “sun of Surt [FIRE]”, but “from his sword shines the [FIRE]” seems excessively repetitive when compared to l. 1. In conclusion, my preferred reading is 1a.

3 gífr rata ‘the fiends roam’ | The reading of U is certainly corrupt; the anachronistic m. pl. ending *-ar* is proof enough, for the word *goð* ~ *guð* ‘gods’ was always neuter in heathen times.

4 tröða halir heil-veg ‘men tread the Hellway’ | The Hellway is the road between Earth and the Underworld (Hell) upon which one has to travel after death to reach one’s final resting place (cf. the story told in *Helr*). The verse may thus be understood as ‘men die off’.

On the other hand, according to *Gylf* 51:27, Lock is followed by *allir Heljar sinnar* ‘all Hell’s companions’ who are presumably thought to be some sort of revenants, so that may instead be what is being referred to here.

4 himinn klofnar ‘the Heaven cracks’ | As discussed above (st. 3) Heaven is thought of as a solid dome made out of stone (cf. *Hárb* 15/2 n.); its cracking in two is therefore a horrible sight. Cf. the prophetic line in *Sö* 154 Skarpåker (edited below under Runic Poetry from Sweden and Gotland).

51 Þá kœmr Hlinar · harmr annarr framm,
2 es Óðinn ferr · við ulf vega,
—en bani Bēlja · bjarttr at Surti—
4 þá mun Friggjar · falla angan.

[R 2v/13, H 20v/37,
S 17r/17, T TODO,
W TODO]

Then comes Line’s second sorrow to pass,
when Weden goes to fight against the Wolf
—but the bane of Bellow [Free], bright, towards Surt—
then will Frie’s beloved [= Weden] fall.

4 falla | *om.*, but *add. above line in same hand* S 4 angan | *so* HSTW; angantyr R

ALL | Sts. 51–53 describe the deaths of the major gods Weden, Thunder, and Free as they fight against their respective enemies: the Fenrerswolf, the Middenyardswyrn, and Surt. The battle takes place on the great plain Wighride as told in *Vafþ* 18.

The fight between the Wolf and Weden is also mentioned in *Vafþ* 53, which further mentions his subsequent avenging by Wider, and *Grm* 24/3–4, which mentions that he is aided by the Onecharriers.

The relevant part of the battle is described in *Gylf* 51:34–38: *Ésir her-væða sik ok allir Ein-berjar ok sákja fram á völlu’na. Riðr fyrstr Óðinn með gull-hjalm’inn ok fagra brynju ok geir sinn, er Gungnir beitir; stefnir hann móti Fenris-ulf, en Þórr fram á aðra blið bonum, ok má hann ekki duga bonum, því at hann befir fullt fang at berja-sk við Mið-garðs-orm. Freyr ber-sk móti Surti, ok verðr harðr sam-gangr, áðr Freyr fellr. Þat verðr hans bani, er hann missir þess ins góða sverðs, er hann gaf Skirni.* ‘The Eese and all the Onecharriers clothe themselves for war and rush forth on the plains. Weden rides first with the golden helmet and fair byrnie and his spear which is called Gungner; he faces against the Fenrerswolf, but Thunder goes forth on one of his sides; and he cannot avail him, for he has his hands full in fighting against the Middenyardswyrn. Free fights against Surt and it becomes a hard-fought struggle before Free falls. It will be his bane that he is missing the good sword which he gave Shinner.’

1 Hlinar · harmr annarr ‘Line’s second sorrow’ | The first sorrow being the death of Balder. Line (*Hlin*) is described in *Gylf* 35:19 as a minor goddess *sett til gétslu yfir þeim mönnum, er Frigg vill forða við háska nokkurum* ‘placed to watch over those men whom Frie wants to save from any particular danger’. In spite of this, almost all modern translators and editors have understood Line as synonymous with Frie and posited that her existence as a distinct goddess is a systematizing invention of *Gylf*. Hopkins (2017) convincingly argues that this need not be the case. As Frie’s servant put in charge of protecting those dearest to her mistress, Line’s two sorrows would consist in her failure to protect both Frie’s son and husband.

3 en bani Bēlja · bjarttr at Surti ‘but the bane of Bellow [Free], bright, towards Surt’ | In this inset line the wallow relates the death of Free; cf. note to ALL. Free’s obscure fight against Bellow (ON *Bēli*) is mentioned in *Gylf* 37:16–19, which also contains the important detail that Free will be without his sword:

„Þessi spk er til þess, er Freyr var svá vápn-lauss, er hann barði-sk við Belja ok drap hann með hjartar-borni.“ Þá mælti Gangleri: „Undr mikít, er því-likr höfðingi sem Freyr er vildi gefa sverð, svá at hann átti eigi annat jafn-gott. Geysi-mikit mein var bonum þat, þá er hann barði-sk við hann, er Beli heitir. Þat veit trúa mín, at þeirar gjafar myndi hann þá iðra-sk.“ Þá svarar Hárr: „Lítit mark var þá at, er þeir Beli bittu-sk. Drepa mátti Freyr hann með bendi sinni. Verða mun þat, er Frey mun þykkja verr við koma, er hann missir sverðs-ins, þá er Múspells synir fara at berja.“

“This event is the reason for why Free was so unarmed when he fought against Bellow and slew him with a hart’s antler.” Then spake Gangler: “It is a great wonder that such a chieftain as Free would give away his sword for which he had nothing as good. It was a huge harm for him when he fought with the one called Bellow. It is my true belief that he would come to regret that gift.” Then answers High: “It was of little harm when he and Bellow met each other. Free could have slain him with his hand. Yet a thing will come to pass which will seem far worse to Free: that he is missing his sword when the Sons of Muspell come harrying.”

Cf. *Ski* 8, *Lok* 42, and *Gylf* 37:1–15 (edited as an appendix to *Ski*).

- 52 Þá kœmr hinn mikli · mœgr Sig-fœður,
2 Víð·arr vega · at val-dýri;
lêtr mœgi Hveðrungs · mund of standa
4 hjör til hjarta; · þá ’s heft fœður.

[R 2v/15, S 17r/19,
T TODO, W TODO]

Then comes the great son of Syefather,
Wider, to fight that slaughter-beast.
He lets his hand through Whethring’s lad [= the Wolf]
drive the sword to the heart—then is the father avenged!

1 Þá kœmr hinn mikli · mœgr Sig-fœður ‘Then comes the great son of Syefather’ | Gœngr Óðins sonr · við ulf vega ‘Weden’s son goes the Wolf to fight’ STW. 2 vega | of veg STW

1 Sig-fœður ‘Syefather’ | ‘The Father of Victory’, a name found only here and in *Lok* 58/4, likewise in the context of the battle with the Wolf.

3 Hveðrungs ‘Whethring’s’ | Gen. of *Hveðrungr*, an obscure name for Lock, whose son is the Fen-rerswolf. The name otherwise appears as a name of Lock in a kenning for Hell (*Yt* 24: *Hveðrungs mēr* ‘Whethring’s daughter’). It is also found in a later antiquarian list (thule) of names of individual Ettins (*Pul Jotna* I 1, SkP 3), and in a thule of names for Weden (*Pul Óðins* 5, SkP 3), but both of these may derive from misinterpretations of the present stanza.

- 53 Þá kœmr hinn méri · mœgr Hlœðynjar,
2 gœngr fet níu · Fjörgynjar burr
nœppr frá naðri · niðs ó-kviðnum;
4 munu halir allir · hœim-stoð ryðja
es af móði drepr · Mið·garðs Véurr.

[R 2v/17, H 20v/41,
S 17r/20, T TODO,
W TODO]

Then comes the famed son of Lathyn [= Thunder].
Nine steps takes Firgyn’s son,
pained, away from the Adder unfearing of enmity.
All men will clear their homesteads
when Middenyard’s Wighward strikes out of wrath.

ALL. | The present form of the stanza is an amalgamation of all three recensions (R, H, and G) based most closely on H and G, which have the last 3 lines in the same order. R has the lines in the order 1, 5, 4,

2, 3 and inserts an additional line between 1 and 5. 1 Þá kómr hinn mérí · mögr Hlōðynjar, ‘Then comes the famed lad of Lathyn’ | *om.* H; *add.* gengr Óðins sonr við ulf (*pro* ‘orm’) vega. ‘Weden’s son goes the Wolf (error for ‘Wýrm’) to fight.’ R. 1 Þá kómr ‘Then comes’ | Gengr ‘Goes’ STW 2 gengr fet niu · Fjörgynjar burr ‘nine steps takes Fírgyn’s son’ | *om.* STW. 4 hēim-stōð | hēim-†steið† 5 es af móði drepr | drepr hann af móði R

ALL | Thunder and the Middenyardswyrm kill each other, fulfilling their previous abortive encounter during the Fishing Trip (see *Hym*). From a comparative perspective, it is notable that the Norse religion makes the ancient *Chaoskampf*; the motif of a Storm God slaying a watery Serpent as part of Creation, a key part of its eschatology instead. It is surely for this reason that the Wýrm is not slain during the Fishing Trip (as it must have been originally, and as it actually is in *Húsdr*, one of the early Scaldic retellings; see Introduction to *Hym*), since it must remain alive to fight at the Rakes of the Reins. —

This st. is paraphrased in *Gylf* 51:41–42: Þórr berr banaorð af Mið-garðs-ormi ok stigr þaðan braut niu fet. Þá féllr hann dauðr til jarðar fyrir eitri því, er ormr’inn bléss á hann. ‘Thunder bears the bane-word from the Middenyardswyrm and strides nine steps away from it. Then he falls dead to the earth from the venom (*eitri*) which the Wýrm blows on him.’ Cf. also st. H48 below.

2–3 Hlōðynjar, Fjörgynjar ‘Lathyn, Fírgyn’ | Both names for the Earth, who is Thunder’s mother.

3 niðs ó-kviðnum ‘unfearing of enmity’ | *Dat.* sg., modifying *naðri* ‘adder, serpent’. Numerous eds. emend to *ó-kviðinn (*nom.* sg.), referring to Thunder.

4 munu halir allir · hēim-stōð ryðja ‘All men will clear their homesteads’ | After Thunder is slain the realm of men is no longer habitable. Cf. *Hárð* 23, *Þrk* 18.

5 Mið-garðs Véurr ‘Middenyard’s Wighward’ | Thunder, literally “the Sanctuary-Defender of Middenyard”, a fitting kenning.

54 Sól tér sortna, · sígr fold i mar,
2 hverfa af himni · hēiðar stjörnur;
geisar eimi · við aldr-nara;
4 leikr hōr hiti · við himin sjalfan.

[R 2v/20, H 21r/1,
S 17r/22, T TODO,
W TODO, U 18v/10]

The Sun doth blacken; the land sinks into the sea;
from heaven fade the twinkling stars.
Smoke billows from the nourisher of life [FIRE];
the high heat licks against the very heaven.

1 tér ‘doth’ | mun ‘will’ G 1 sígr fold i mar | †sigrföldinar† (*för* ‘sigr fold i mar’) U, cf. *Males* (2023b, 194, 198 n. 25) 1 sígr ‘sinks’ | sökkr STW 3 við ‘from’ | ok ‘and’ HG 3 aldr-nara | aldr-nari (*nom.* sg.) HG

ALL. | This st. is verbally alluded to in Arn *Þorfrðr* 24/1–2 (SkP 2, ca. 1060 CE) in an instance of *adynaton*: Björt verðr sól at svartri; · sökkr fold i mar dökkvan; / brestr erfðið Austrá; · allr glymr sēr á fjöllum ‘Bright, the sun turns black; the land sinks into the dark sea; // Eastre’s toil [HEAVEN] shatters; all the sea roars over the fells’. Another allusion is possibly found in SnSt *Hr* 13/2, 4 (SkP 3), which may, however, also be a reference to the Biblical deluge: Stóð sēr á fjöllum; [...] skaut jörð ór geyma. ‘The sea stood over the fells; the earth shot up from the ocean.’

1 sígr fold i mar ‘the land sinks into the sea’ | The stemmatically excluded reading *sökkr* ‘sinks’ is probably influenced by Arn *Þorfrðr* 24/1b (SkP 2).

3 aldr-nara ‘nourisher of life’ | A rare FIRE-kenning only found here and in the thules or poetic lists of synonyms (*Pul Elds* 3 in SkP 3). — It is notable that fire has two conflicting natures: it nourishes life but it also consumes it; here a kenning reflecting the former is used in the context of the latter.

- 55 Geyr nú Garmr mjök · fyr Gnipa-helli,
 2 festr mun slitna, · en freki rinna;
 fjöld veit hön fróða, · framm sé'k lengra
 4 of ragna rök, · rømm sig-tíva.

[R 2v/22, H 21r/2]

Now Garm barks loudly before the Gnip-Caves;
 the rope will snap and the Wolf will run.
 She knows much lore; I see further ahead
 about the mighty Rakes of the Reins, of the Victory-Tews [GODS].

ALL | With the sinking of the earth into the sea and the blackening of the heaven, the destruction has reached its climax, as signalled by the final repetition of the refrain stanza. To indicate the dramatic pause, which was likely indicated in some way in the original oral performance, a page break has been inserted.

- 56 Sér hön upp koma · qðru sinni
 2 jorð ór égi · iðja-gröna;
 falla forsar, · flýgr qrn yfir,
 4 sás á fjalli · fiska veiðir.

[R 2v/23, H 21r/4]

She sees coming up for a second time
 the Earth from the ocean, ever green anew.
 Torrents fall; o'er them flies the eagle
 which in the fells catches fish.

ALL | Sts. 56–59 are paraphrased in *Gylf* 53:1–9:

Dá mælti Gangleri: „Hvart lifa nokkur goðin þá, eða er þá nokkur jorð eða himinn?“ Hárr segir: „Upp skýtur jörðunni þá ór sænum, ok er þá grön ok fjög. Vaxa þá akrar ósánir. Við-arr ok Váli lifa, svá at eigi hefir sér inn ok Surt-logi grandat þeim, ok byggja þeir á Iða-velli, þar sem fyrr var Ós-garðr, ok þar koma þá synir Þórs, Móði ok Magni, ok bafa þar Mjöllni. Því nést koma þar Baldr ok Höðr frá Heljar, setja-sk þá allir samt, ok tala-sk við, ok minna-sk á rúnar sínar, ok ræða of tíðendi þau, er fyrrum boððu verit, of Mið-garðs-orm ok of Fenris-ulf. Þá finna þeir i grasi'nu gull-toflur þér, er ésir'nir boððu átt.“
 “Then spoke Gangler: “Do any Gods live then, or is there then any earth or heaven?” High says: “The earth then shoots up from the sea and it is then green and fair. Then acres grow unsown. Wider and Wonnel live, for the sea and Surt's flame have not scathed them, and they settle on the Idewold where Osyard once stood. And then come thither Thunder's sons, Mood and Main, and they have Millner with them. Next come Balder and Hath out of Hell. Then they all sit down together and make speech and think back on their runes and speak about the events of antiquity, about the Middenyardswyrn and the Fenrerswolf. Then they find in the grass those golden game-bricks which the Eese had owned.”

After this passage *Gylf* cites *Vafþ* 51. For more traditions of the world to come, cf. *Vafþ* 44–47.

1 qðru sinni ‘a second time’ | The first time probably being the lifting of the Earth in st. 4.

3–4 falla ... veiðir ‘Torrents ... fish.’ | The unusually vivid description paints a beautiful picture of the mountain-climate of Norway and Iceland. The sense is that the serene beauty of nature is restored from the fire of the destruction.

- 57 Finna=sk ésir · á Iða-velli
 2 ok umb mold-þinur · mötkan dōma,
 ok minna=sk þar · á mēgin-dōma
 4 ok á Fimbul-týs · fornar rúnar.

[R 2v/24, H 21r/5]

The Eese find each other on the Idewold
 and of the mighty Earth-Cord [= Middenyardswyrn] speak,
 and there think back on mighty verdicts
 and on Fimble-Tew's (= Weden's) ancient runes.

1 Finna=sk ‘find each other’ | hitta=sk H 3 ok minna=sk þar · á mēgin-dōma ‘and there think back on mighty verdicts’ | so H; om. R

1 Finna=sk ‘find each other’ | The H reading provides closer parallelism with 7/1 above, but for the same reason it may also have replaced an earlier *finna=sk*, as found in R.

2 mold-þinur ‘Earth-cord’ | Cf. the kenning for the Middenyardswyrn in *Húsdr* 4: *stirð-þinull storðar* ‘the stiff cord of the land [= Middenyardswyrn]’.

- 58 Þar munu eptir · undr-sam=ligar

[R 2v/26, H 21r/7]

- 2 gollnar tǫflur · i grasi finna=sk,
þér's *ęsir* i ár-daga · áttar hǫfðu.

There will again the wondersome
golden game-bricks in the grass be found,
which in days of yore the Eese had owned.

1 ęptir 'again' | *ęsir* 'the Eese' H 2 finna=sk 'be found' | finna 'find' H 3 *ęsir* | om. RH

ALL | A fine literary device. In st. 8 the golden age of the Eese, exemplified by their playing board games, was spoiled by the three ettin-women. The rediscovery of the golden board game then betokens a new golden age.

3 *ęsir* 'the Eese' | The verb *hǫfðu* 'had' requires a plural subject, and this is found in the paraphrase of this st. in *Gylf* 53:9: *Þá finna þeir i grasi'nu gull-tǫflur þęr, er ęsir'nir hǫfðu átt* (see st. 56 n. above).

- 59 Munu ó-sánir · akrar vaxa,
2 bǫls mun alls batna, · mun Baldr koma;
búa Hǫðr ok Baldr · Hropts sig-toptir,
4 vęl val-tívar. · Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat?

[R 2v/28, H 21r/9]

Unsown will acres grow;
the bale will all be bettered; Balder will come.
Hath and Balder settle Roft's (= Weden's) victory-plots
well, the slain-Tews. *Know ye yet, or what?*

2 bǫls 'the bale' | The evil of Hath's slaying Balder (cf. sts. 31–34 above). It will be forgotten as the two brothers reconcile and live alongside each other.

4 val-tívar 'the slain-Tews' | A rare epithet otherwise only found in 50/2 above and *Hym* 1/1; it is not found in Snorre's Edda or in Scaldic poetry. The first element is most likely *valr* 'the battle-slain'. This term probably originally referred exclusively to Hath and Balder, since just these are the two slain gods; it would later have been semantically widened to refer to the Gods in general (so *Vsp* 50/2, *Hym* 1/1).

- 60 Þa kná Hönir · hlaut-við kjósa
2 ok burir byggva · bróðra tveggja
vind-heim víðan. · Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat?

[R 2v/30, H 21r/11]

Then does Heener choose the leat-wood,
and the sons of the two brothers settle
the wide wind-home [SKY/HEAVEN]. *Know ye yet, or what?*

1 hlaut-við kjósa 'choose the leat-wood' | Foresee the future by means of lots, specifically twigs drenched in the blood of beasts killed during the blood; cf. *Hym* 1. According to Tacitus (*Germania*, ch. 10) such divination was done *publice consultetur, sacerdos civitatis, sin privatim, ipse pater familiae* 'in public questions [by] the priest of the particular state, in private [by] the father of the family'. In later Scandinavian society the positions of high Gid (*goði*) and chieftain or king were largely synonymous, and so this would mean that in the world to come, the peaceful Heener takes over the role of the chief of the Gods after the more warlike Weden. I thank John Newman for this observation.

2 bróðra tveggja ‘of the two brothers’ | The present translation takes *tveggja* to be the gen. pl. of *tveir* ‘two’. The two brothers are presumably Hath and Balder, mentioned in the previous stanza. Since the original mss. do not capitalize proper nouns, we could also read *bróðra Tveggja* ‘the brothers of Tway (= Weden)’, but although Weden’s brothers are attested in *Gylf* 6:10 as Will and Wigh (cf. st. 4/1 above) they are never said to have children.

- 61 Sal sér hön standa · sólu fegra,
2 golli þakðan, · á Gim-léi;
þar skulu dyggvar · dróttir byggva
4 ok umb aldr-daga · ynðis njóta.

A hall she sees standing fairer than the sun,
thatched with gold on Gemlee.
There faithful folk shall settle
and in their days of life enjoy delights.

1 sér hön ‘she sees’ | veit’k ‘I know’ G 2 golli þakðan ‘thatched with gold’ | golli þetra ‘better than gold’ ST 2 Gim-léi | metr. emend. by restoration of hiatus; Gim-lé RHG 3 þar ‘there’ | þann ‘[in] that [ball]’ TW

ALL | This stanza is cited immediately following *Gylf* 17:10–12, which read: *Á sunnan-verðum himins enda er sá salr er allra er fegrstr ok bjartari en sól’in, er Gim-lé heitir. Hann skal standa þá er bæði himinn ok jörð hefir farit-sk, ok byggja þann stað góðir menn ok rétt-látir of allar aldir. Svá segir í Völu-spó: ‘At the southern end of heaven is the hall which is the fairest of all and brighter than the sun, which is called Gemlee. It shall stand when both the heaven and the earth have been destroyed, and that place is settled by good men and righteous throughout all ages. So it says in the Spae of the Wallow.’*

Gylf 17:13–16 continues: *Þá mælti Gangleri: „Hvat gétir þess staðar, þá er Surta-logi brennir himin ok jörð?“ Hárr segir: „Svá er sagt, at annarr himinn sé suðr ok upp frá þessum himni, ok heitir sá And-langr, en inn þriðri himinn sé enn upp frá þeim, ok heitir sá Við-bláinn, ok á þeim himni byggjum vér þenna stað vera. En Ljós-alfar einir, byggjum vér, at nú byggvi þá staði.“* “Then spoke Gangler: “What protects that place when the flame of Surt burns the heaven and the earth?” High says: “So it is said, that there is another heaven southwards and upwards from this heaven and that one is called Endlong, but the third heaven is even further upwards from them and that one is called Wideblown, and on that heaven we think this place is. But Light-Elves alone, we think, do now inhabit those places.”

- 62 Þar kómr hinn dimmi · dręki fljúgandi,
2 naðr fránn neðan · frá Niða-fjöllum;
berr sér i fjöðrum · —flýgr völl yfir—
4 Nið-hoggr náí; · nú mun hön sökva=sk.“

Then comes the dusky Dragon flying,
the gleaming Adder up from the Nithfells.
He carries in his feathers—he flies o’er the field—
Nithehewer, corpses. Now will she sink!”

ALL | The function of the final st. is disputed. Earlier eds. see the last half-line as a reference to Nithehewer sinking down into the abyss, permanently ridding the world of evil and resulting in an everlasting world-to-come—a clearly Christian conception. Yet this interpretation requires either emending *hön* ‘she’ in l. 4 to *bann* ‘he’ (so Finnur Jónsson 1932) or removing it entirely (Sijmons and Gering, III, 77–78).

[R 2v/31, H 21r/12,
S 5v/12, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

[R 3r/2, H 21r/15]

I instead agree with Jens P. Schjødtt (1981) in seeing the last half-line as part of the frame of the wallow's recitation and taking the rest of the stanza as a reference to the pre-Christian Indo-European cyclical conception of the world. The presence of Nithehewer illustrates that the next world is still not entirely free from ills, for although most of the fiends have been slain in the great battle, a seed of evil still remains. The Dragon will infest the *axis mundi* (*Grm* 36) in the next world also, and the fact that he still has corpses to eat further shows that evil in mankind has not been eradicated (st. 38 above). Since there is still evil in the next world it too must at some point fall, be destroyed, and be reborn in the endless cosmic cycle; see Introduction to the poem above.

4 nú mun hōn sökva-sk 'Now will she sink' | The spae is concluded and the wallow, referring to herself in the third person, descends back down into the grave whence Woden woke her. Cf. *Helr* 14/4b, the very last half-line of that poem: *sökkst-u, gýgjar-kyn* 'sink, thou gow's kin!'

Appendix

Dwarf-tallies (sts. 11–15)

The following sts. (11–15) contain two or three originally distinct lists of dwarf-names. They interrupt the flow of the whole poem so much that they have been moved to the Appendix. Their nature as a later insertion is in any case confirmed by their faulty meter (Males 2025a, p. 373).

That the lists themselves are originally distinct from each other is seen by the repetition of names (13/4, 15/4: *Ēikin-skjaldi* ‘Oakenshield’; 11/4, 15/3: *Ái* ‘Great-grandfather’) and the existence of two formulaic conclusions (12/3–4, 15/6–7). Sts. 11–13, having no repeated names, seem to belong together. If this is the case, st. 12, which contains the formulaic conclusion to the list, should probably switch places with 13.

Sts. 14–15 form a second group, having an introduction and a conclusion which both mention the dwarf Loffer.

NOTE: The variants from the four *Gylf* manuscripts have not yet been collated.

- 11 **N**ýi ok **N**iði, · **N**orðri, Suðri,
2 **A**ustri, Vestri, · **A**lþjófr, Dvalinn,
 Bífur, **B**öfur, · **B**ömburr, Nóri,
4 **Á**nn ok **Á**narr, · **Á**i, Mjóð-vitnir.

[R 1r/23, H 20r/17,
S TODO, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

New and Nithe, Norther and Souther,
Easter and Wester, Allthief, Dwollen,
Biber, Babber, Bamber, Noor,
Own and Owner, Great-grandfather, Meadwitner.

ALL | Sts. 11–12 are cited in *Gylf* 14:16, introduced by the words *Ok þessi segir hón ngfi þeira* ‘And in this way she says their names’.

1–2 Norðri, Suðri, Austri, Vestri ‘Norther and Souther, Easter and Wester’ | According to *Gylf* 8:10, these four dwarfs were placed by the gods to hold up the Heaven, Yimer’s skull, one in each cardinal direction; cf. st. 3/4 n. above.

- 12 **V**eiðr ok Gand·alfr, · **V**ind·alfr, Þráinn,
2 **Þ**ekkr ok **Þ**orinn, · **Þ**rór, Vitr ok Littr,
 Nár ok **N**ý·ráðr, · —**n**ú hef’k dvergá—
4 **R**eginn ok **R**áð·sviðr · —**r**étt of talða.

[R 1r/25, H 20r/18,
S TODO, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

Wey and Gandelf, Windelf, Thrown,
Thetch and Thorn, Threw, Wit and Lit,
Nee and Newred—now have I the dwarfs—
Rain and Redswith—rightly tallied.

3 **n**ú hef’k dvergá | *om.* G 4 **r**étt of talða | *om.* G

3–4 nú hef’k dverga ... rétt of talða ‘now have I the dwarfs ... rightly tallied’ | An inset clause; since it does not list the names of any dwarfs, it was omitted by Snorre in *Gylf*.

- 13 Fíli, Kíli, · Fundinn, Náli,
2 Hepti, Víli, · Hannarr, Svíurr,
Frár, Horn·bori, · Frégr ok Lóni,
4 Aur·vangr, Jari, · Eikin·skjaldi.

[R 1r/28, H 20r/20,
S TODO, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

Filer, Chiler, Found and Needler,
Hefter, Wiler, Hanner, Swigher,
Fraw, Hornborer, Fray and Looner,
Earwong, Earer, Oakenshield.

2 Svíurr | †Sviðrr†, / Nár ok Náinn, · Nípingr, Dáinn / Billings, Brúni · Bildr ok Búri ‘... *Nee and Nowen, Nípng, Dowen, Billing, Brown, Bild and Boor*’ H

- 14 Mál es dverga · i Dvalins liði
2 ljóna kindum · til Lofars tēlja,
þeir es sóttu · frá salar stēini
4 Aur·vanga sjot · til Joru·valla.

[R 1r/30, H 20r/22]

It is time to tally the dwarfs in Dwoilen’s troop
back to Loffer for the race of men;
they who sought, from the stone of the hall,
the seat of the Earwongs unto the Erwolds.

3 þeir | þeim H

ALL | This st. is paraphrased in *Gylf* 14:18 by the words: *En þessir kómu frá Svarins-baugi til Aur-vanga á Joru-völlu, ok er kominn þaðan Lofarr*. ‘But these ones came from Swornshigh to the Earwongs on the Erwolds, and from them Loffer is come.’ After this passage, *Gylf* cites st. 15/3–5.

1–2 Mál es ... tēlja ‘It is time ... of men’ | A variant of a standard genealogical introduction; cf. *Hátt* 1: *meðan hans étt ... til góða tēljum* ‘while we tally his line ... back to the Gods’. The patrilineal line of dwarfs is to be counted back to their progenitor, Loffer. This possibly disagrees with st. 10 where Moodsowner is said to be the foremost (and presumably the oldest) of the dwarfs, and Loffer is not mentioned, but consistency in such details can probably not be expected.

- 15 Þar vas Draupnir · ok Dolg·þrasir,
2 Hár, Haug·spori, · Hlé·vangr, Glói,
Skirfir, Virfir, · Ská·fiðr, Ái,
4 Alfr ok Yngvi, · Eikin·skjaldi,
Fjalarr ok Frosti, · Finnrr ok Ginnarr;
6 Þat mun é uppi, · meðan qld lifir,
lang-niðja-tal · Lofars hafat.

[R 1r/32, H 20r/24]

There was Dreepner and Dollowthrasher,
 High, Highspurer, Leewong, Glower,
 Sherver, Werver, Showfind, Great-grandfather,
 Elf and Ing, Oakenshield,
 Feller and Frost, Finn and Ginner.
 That will ever be remembered while the age lives,
 the recited tally of the ancestors of Loffer.

6 **ĕ** | so H; om. R

ALL | The dwarf-names in this st. are split up across several sections in *Gylf* 14. In *Gylf* 14:17, variants of the names in ll. 1–2 are cited, followed by four names not found in *Vsp* and then by the names in st. 13/2. That name-list is introduced by the words *En þessir eru ok dvergar ok búa í steinum, en inir fyrri í moldu*: ‘But these ones are also dwarfs and dwell in stones, but the former ones in the earth.’ The names of ll. 3–5 are cited in *Gylf* 14:19 immediately following a paraphrase of st. 14, introduced by the words *þessi eru nafn þeira* ‘these are their names’. Although these name-lists cannot be considered citations of this stanza proper, the variants of the names have been included (TODO!) in the critical edition.

6 Þat mun **ĕ** uppi, · meðan öld lifir ‘That will ever be remembered while the age lives’ | Both verse-halves are formulaic, though their use in a list of dwarf-names is unparalleled. For the first cf. *Heiðr* 119 (in SkP 7): *þat mun **ĕ** uppi; · illr es dómr norna!* ‘That will always be remembered; evil is the judgement of the norns!’ For the second cf. runic inscription U 323 Sälma (ca. 980–1015 CE), edited under Runic Poetry from Sweden and Gotland. What is essentially a Scaldic rewrite of the whole line is found in *Þstf Stuttodr* 5/1–2 (SkP 2): *Ey mun uppi · Endils, meðan stendr // sól-borgar salr, · svor-góðis for* ‘Ever will be remembered—while the hall of the sun’s stronghold [SKY/HEAVEN > EARTH] stands—the journey of the fattener of Andle’s bird [RAVEN/EAGLE > WARRIOR].’

7 Lofars hafat | This line would be unmetrical in the rest of the poem since the first lift is on a short syllable (Males 2025a, p. 373). This strongly suggests that the Dwarf-tally section is a later insert.

Stanzas from *Hauksbók*

H has a few substantial insertions and variants not found in R. The following four stanzas, H31, H41, H48, H58, are the only instances longer than a single line (but cf. st. 7/2 n. above).

The style and content of H41, H48, and especially H58, comes off as rather different from the rest of the poem; they are therefore unlikely to be authorial. H31 may, however, be genuine.

H31 Þá kná **Váli** · **vig**-bønd snúa;
 2 **h**ęldr vöru **harð**-gør · **h**øpt ór þørmum.

[H 20v/12]

Then did Wonnell the war-bonds twist:
 the most sturdy fetters were made from entrails.

1 Váli ‘Wonnell’ | Vála H

ALL | These two lines replace the present 34/1–2 in H. —

Lock was bound by Weden's son Wonnell, who thus avenged Balder by punishing both of those responsible for his death: he killed Hath (who held the weapon) and bound Lock (who guided Hath's hand). Cf. *Gylf* 50:20–22: *Þá vöru teknir synir Loka, Váli ok Nari eða Narfi. Brugðu Ésir Vála í vargs líki ok reif bann í sundr Narfa, bróður sinn. Þá tóku ésir þarma hans ok bundu Loka með yfir þá þrjá egg-steina. Stendr einn undir herðum, annarr undir lendum, þriði undir knés-fötum, ok urðu þau bönd at járne.* ‘Then were taken Lock's sons, Wonnell and Nare or Narve. The Eese turned Wonnell into the likeness of a wolf and he tore apart Narve, his brother. Then the Eese took his intestines and with them they bound Lock over three sharp stones. One stands under his shoulder-blades, the other under his lower back, the third under his houghs; and those bonds turned into iron.’

It is likely that Snorre's version of *Vsp* contained this st. and also had the oblique sg. form **Vála* in l. 1, which led him to misinterpret Wonnell as the name of one of Lock's sons, rather than the name of Weden's son Wonnell, the avenger of Hath. No other source attests Wonnell as the name of a son of Lock. Cf. the version of the binding of Lock found in *Lok* P8.

H41 **Hrēðaða=sk allir · à heḷ-vegum** [H 20v/28]
2 **aðr Surtar þann · sefi of gleypir.**

All are frightened on the Hell-ways
before Surt's kinsman devours it.

ALL | St. 45 is followed by these lines in H, in effect forming another four-line stanza with 45/5–6. In context, the lines seem to be referring to an ettin swallowing the World Tree.

H48 **Gönn lopt yfir · lindi jarðar,** [H 20v/39]
2 **gapa ýgs kjaptar · orms í hēðum;**
 mun Óðins son · ęitri móta
4 **vargs at dauða · Við·ars niðja.**

Over the air yawns the Girdle of the Earth [= Middenyardswyrn];
the jaws of the fierce Wyrn gape in the heights.
Weden's son [= Thunder] will meet the venom
of the Warg, after the deaths of Wider's kinsmen [= the Eese].

ALL | *The last part of the stanza is almost completely illegible in the ms. I have relied on the transliteration of Jón Helgason (1971, pp. 13, 44 ff.). 3 ęitri ‘venom’ | emend.; ormi ‘Wyrn’ H. 4 dauða | ‘da...’ H*

ALL | This stanza appears between 52 and 53 in H. It is not found in the sequence of stanzas cited in *Gylf* 51:50, but some details in the preceding paraphrase are not entirely dissimilar. *Gylf* 51:18–20: *En Fenris-ulfr ferr með gapandi munn, ok er inn neðri kjoptur við jörðu, en in ofri við himin. Gapa myndi bann meira, ef rúm væri til. Eldar brenna ór augum hans ok nǫsum. Mið-garðs-ormr bléss svá eitri’nu, at bann dreifir lopt ǫll ok lög, ok er bann all-ógur-ligr, ok er bann á aðra blíð ulfi’num.* ‘But the Fenrerswolf fares with gaping mouth; and the lower jaw is on the earth, but the upper is in the heaven; he would gape yet broader if there were room for it. Fires burn from his eyes and nostrils. The Middenyardswyrn blows the venom so far that it covers the whole air and sea, and he is most terrible, and he is by the side of the Wolf.’

3 ęitri ‘venom’ | Cf. *Gylf* 51:41–42, cited in the notes to st. 53 above.

H58 **Þá kœmr hinn ríki · at rēgin-dómi** [H 21r/14]

2 ǫflugr ofan · sá's ǫllu réðr.

Then comes the powerful one to the Great Judgment,
strong down from above, he who rules everything.

ALL | This half-stanza appears between sts. 61 and 62 in **H**. It is generally held to be a late Christian insert, since it betrays Christian theological sentiments. An omnipotent God coming down from above to the Great Judgment (*regin-dómr*)—none of these elements are found in the pre-Christian religion. Cf. *Hdl* 43, which is likely drawing on the present stanza.

Speeches of the High One

(*Háva mól*)

Dating: Likely varying, see below.

Meter: majority: Leeds-meter;
minority: Speeches-meter, Ancient-words-law.

Introduction

The **Speeches of the High One** (abbrev. *Háv*) is a wisdom poem, most likely a collection of several poems, bound together by a common attribution to the Germanic god of wisdom, Woden.

Textual preservation and transmission

Háv is the second poem of **R** (foll. 3r/4–7v/9), where it follows *Vǫp* and is followed by *Vǫfþ*. **R** is the only independent manuscript witness for the poem, but several isolated sts. (1, 58, 76–77, 84) are cited or alluded to in other texts.

Contents

Háv is, as it comes down to us in **R**, a motley collection. It contains two or three poems of practical life advice, two mythological narratives, scattered gnomic poetry about runes, and a list of galdrs. Thematically these materials are united by their direct attribution to the high god Woden, or as he is called in sts. 109, 111, and 166, *Hövi* ‘the High One’.

In the direct attribution of the totality of the poem to a god *Háv* stands utterly alone among Norse poetry, for although Woden also has much to say in *Vǫfþ*, *Grm*, and *Bdr*, in those poems his speech is reported speech enclosed in a narrative frame. Though internal frame-like devices do appear in sts. 1–2, 111, and 166, *Háv* has no external narrative frame. The poem is, as it were, the very Words of the High One.

Sections of the poem

On the basis of meter, style, content, and later manuscript tradition, I identify the following major strands, excluding various isolated sts. (e.g. 80) that are probably later inserts. In the present edition each is given its own short introduction:

1. The Guests' Strand (1–77, with 78–79 being later additions)
2. Various scattered sts. of advice (81–90)
3. Weden's tryst with Billing's daughter (91–102)
4. Weden's obtaining of the Mead of Poetry (103–110)
5. The Speeches of Loddfathomer (111–137)
6. The Rune-Tally; sts. about runes and ritual (138–146)
7. The Leed-Tally; Weden's listing of 18 galders (146–165)

It can hardly be stated that every strand was originally its own poem. Weden's two romantic adventures (91–102 and 103–110), for instance, have much in common stylistically and individually seem too short to have ever stood on their own.

On the other hand it seems highly unlikely that the Guests' Strand (1–77) and the Speeches of Loddfathomer (111–137) were ever a single composition, for they differ very much in tone, in style, and in structure.

The Guests' Strand is down to earth and sceptical, never mentions women (st. 79 is prob. a later insert), gives its advice in the form of maxims and similes and by reference to the behaviour of a "wise" or "unwise man", never makes use of the second imperative (and only thrice of the verb *skalt* '(thou) shalt', 44/3, 45/3, 46/3), and has a perfectly fitting conclusion in sts. 76–77.

On the other hand the Speeches of Loddfathomer places great emphasis on magical ideas (113–114, 126, 129, 137) and women (113–115, 118, 130, 131/5), gives its advice directly by means of the second imperative and never with reference to the behaviour of the "(un)wise man", and is much less clearly structured, concluding with a long list of folk magical remedies in st. 137.

There is direct repetition between the two sections (most notably between sts. 44 and 119), which would be redundant if both were originally a single work. In addition to notable differences in content there are also notable linguistic differences, for which cf. the section on Dating below.

Prehistory and redaction into a single text

Since the full *Háv* almost certainly consists of at least two originally separate compositions two questions naturally arise: *how* were these materials redacted into a single poem, and *why*? No answers to these problems can be certain and so the following is only the translator's own speculation.

To answer either question we first need to determine in what context the redaction took place: whether in an oral or scribal tradition, in a Heathen

hove or a Catholic monastery. St. 166, given that it explicitly mentions the title of the poem, must probably be associated with the final layer of the redaction, and so is of particular use. Its blessing of the reciter, hearers, and learners indicates that the poem was to be chanted and learned by heart, and its description of the contents of the poem (which includes unambiguous Heathen ritual advice like st. 145) as *all-þorrf* ‘most useful’ to Men and *ó-þorrf* ‘harmful’ to Ettins invokes the Heathen dichotomy between the Gods and Ettins as friends and enemies of Mankind, respectively (cf. Introduction to *Hym*).

Thus, on the basis of the final stanza and the pagan contents of the rest of the poem, we can say that *Háv* was probably redacted into something very close to its present form no later than the early 11th century, in an oral, Heathen context.

Moving on to the *how*, it is certain that in an oral transmission additions and inserts need not have happened all at once, but could have taken place successively in the form of layers appended to an original core. Thus the original Guests’ Strand probably ended at st. 77, but sts. 78–90 may have been added shortly afterwards, later the two narratives about Weden’s romantic escapades, thereafter the Speeches of Loddfathomer, the Rune-tally, and the Leeds. Even after the basic structure was obtained, stanzas such as 73 could have been inserted where they were felt most fitting in order to make the poem more “complete” in the eyes of the inserter. These inserts may well have continued into the period of scribal transmission.

For the *why*, we should consider what reason someone would have for redacting numerous materials into a single poem. St. 166, as discussed above, suggests that the main reason was utilitarian rather than antiquarian, and a picture then emerges of a redactor arranging a corpus of traditional poetry, selected both for its traditional attribution to the god Weden and for its *usefulness*—whether as practical life advice or as mythological and religious lore—into a single long poem meant to be learned by heart as a whole and recited for magical purposes. In practice this final redaction served as sort of Odinic “ark” (or “Hoardmimer’s wood”, *Vafþ* 45/2) in which the bulk of surviving pre-Christian Norse advice poetry was transmitted until it could be written down. Forever lost were whichever stanzas were not included in it—and many such must have existed.

Meter and stanza

Háv consists of 722 lines (365 long-lines, 355 full-lines/c-verses, 2 unusual verses) distributed across 166 sts. It is the single longest preserved Norse poem of any genre, Eddic or Scaldic (the two parts of Guthley’s *Merlinus spó* I and II together consist of 171 sts. but are two distinct poems; three other particularly long poems are *Hug-svinns mól* at 149 sts., Snorre’s *Hátta-lykill* at 102 sts., the anonymous *Lilja* at 100 sts.).

Leeds-meter

The meter of *Háv* is varied but primarily consists of varying configurations of Leeds-meter (1-72, 74-80, 84, 88, 91-108, 109/3-124/2, 129/1-3, 130-131/3, 132-137/3, 137/8-138/6, 140-141/2, 142-143, 145, 147/1-2, 148-166).

The most common configuration of the Leeds-meter stanza is the archetypal *abc abc* (2-5, 7-26, 28-72, 75-79, 84, 88, 91-101, 104, 106-108, 110, 114, 118, 123, 133, 136, 140, 149, 151-155, 159-162). A likely defective variant of this configuration is *abc ab* (145).

Also found is the syncopated configuration *abc* (148, 163) and the extended *abc abc abc* (6 sts.: 6, 27, 102-103, 138, 165).

Galders-law

Configurations with repeated full-lines are also represented. These fall under the label Galders-law, although they are not properly a different meter. These may be seen as extended variants of the three basic Leeds-meter-types *abc*, *abc abc*, and *abc abc abc*.

Extensions of *abc* are *abccc* (143), *abcccc* (164), and *abccccc* (142).

Extensions of *abc abc* are *abc abcc* (105, 150, 156, 158), *abc abccc* (157), *abcc abc* (12 sts.: 1, 74, 112-113, 115-116, 120, 122, 127-128, 132, 135), and *abcc abcc* (125, 166).

Extensions of *abc abc abc* are *abc abc abccc* (111), *abcc abc abc* (117, 119, 121, 126, 130), and *abcc abc abccc* (134).

Unusual verses

In addition to this there are two Leeds-meter-stanzas containing unusual verses, viz. verses that only carry one alliterating stave connecting to a previous long-line of type *ab*. The two stanzas are 61 (*abc abcx*) and 80 (*abxccc*), where *x* marks the unusual verse.

Other meters

A minority meter is Speeches-meter (73, 81-83, 85-87, 89-90, 109/1-2, 124/3-4, 129/4, 131/4-6, 137/4-7, 141/3-4, 147/3-4). With the exception of the likely interpolated st. 73, stanzas composed exclusively in Speeches-meter are found only in the section sts. 81-90.

Several stanzas in sections 4-7 (sts. 103-165) mix Speeches-meter and Leeds-meter by having long-lines (*ab*) not directly followed by a *c*-verse. With the Speeches-meter lines bracketed the relevant configurations are: [*ab ab*] *abc* (109), *abc* [*ab ab*] (124, 141, 147), *abcc* [*ab*] *abc* (129), *abcc* [*ab ab ab*] (131), and *abcc* [*ab ab ab ab*] *abc* (137).

The Rune-Tally section (146-165) attests a few examples of Ancient-words-law (139, 144, 146).

Dating

Having above determined that the redaction of the poem most likely took place in pagan times, we should try to arrive at a more detailed dating of the individual strands.

On the purely linguistic side most archaic features are concentrated in the Guests' Strand (sts. 1–77). Old *vr-* alliterates with *v-* 2 times in non-formulaic word pairs (sts. 26/2, 32/2) and the particle *of* appears 3 times before nominals (4/3: *of óðis*, 21/4: *of mál*, 38/4: *of þorfr*). That these archaic traits are all found in the Guests' Strand is notable but does not definitely prove that it is much older than the rest of the poem, since clear diagnostics like old *vr-* alliterating with *r-* are uncertain (though cf. 106/1).

The frequency of the old particle *of* before verbs and nouns varies by section. It is found at a rate of 0.363 occurrences per 10 unique lines in sections 1–4 (sts. 1–110) and a near-identical 0.385 in sections 6–7 (sts. 138–166), but only 0.137 in section 5 (sts. 111–137) (Sapp 2022, p. 70). Together with the notably different stylistic traits of this section compared to the Guests' Strand this observation strongly supports the hypothesis of *Háv* as a composite.

Content-based criteria for dating, chiefly the poem's unabashed endorsement of paganism, have been discussed above, but a few more can be mentioned briefly. As Males (2024b, pp. 93–96) points out, sts. 71 and 81 of the poem treat being “burned” as synonymous with being “dead” just like modern English “six feet under” assumes a custom of burials. This synonymity convincingly suggests a pagan date since cremation was strongly taboo in mediæval Christianity and reserved for criminals and heretics (cf. *Am* 84 n.). Since these passages are merely giving neutral life-advice they should be expected to conform to their contemporary cultural context, and as such the neutral statement of “praising a woman when she is burned” (st. 81) is unlikely to belong to the Christian period.

Text

1. The Guests' Strand (1-79)

The Guests' Strand (ON *Gęsta-pátttr*) is a wisdom poem, taking its outset in the scene of a lone Wanderer's arriving as a stranger at a farmstead; this Wanderer appears to be the speaker of the section, and will be entitled as such.

The Strand begins by discussing the mutual responsibilities between guest and host, before moving on to describing proper conduct in human interactions more broadly, with a particular focus on drinking, speech, and friendship; it lastly turns towards death and legacy. Themes not dealt with are religious beliefs, folk magic, and women (except in 79), but that the speaker is in fact the god Weden and not just any wise old man is ascertained by sts. 13-14.

The Strand is not clearly divided into thematic sections, but there is a tendency towards groups of stanzas dealing with certain subjects and a noticeable progression from the initial subject of the guest-host relationship to increasingly more abstract concerns like friendship, fate, wisdom, legacy, and finally death. In this progression the Wanderer often makes use of transitions in order to move from one theme to another (e.g. between sts. 4-5, or 10-11), but even still, previous subjects often reappear after having been dropped for a few stanzas.

The spirit of the advice is consistent throughout, and at all turns the poem counsels shrewdness, caution, and moderation. Of particular importance is the idea of "manwit" (*man-vit*), or knowledge about the proper conduct in various situations; this encompasses being silent rather than speaking nonsense, not indulging in food or drink, and so forth. The emphasis on wisdom is also found in the way the advice itself is given, namely through examples of the proper conduct of a wise man and the bad behaviour of an unwise man.

It seems very likely that the original Guests' Strand ended with sts. 76-77. This finds internal support in the thematic conclusion of death (whereas sts. 78 and 79 deal with wealth and women, and st. 80 with runic magic) and external support in *Hákm* 21, which most likely borrows its first two lines (*deȝyr fę · deȝja fręndr* 'kine die, kinsmen die') from *Háv* 76-77 and likewise uses them in a context of finality.

- 1 **G**ättir allar · áðr **g**angi frammm
 2 of **skoða**=sk **skyli**,
 of **skyggna**=sk **skyli**;
 4 því't **ò**-víst 's at vita, · hvar **ò**-vinir
 sitja á **f**lęti **f**yrim.

[R 3r/4, S 2r/3,
 T TODO, W TODO,
 U TODO]

ALL DOORWAYS—before one might go forth—
 he should spy round;
 he should pry round,

for it is unsure to know where enemies
sit on the benches within.

2 of skoða=sk skyli, | *om.* G

2–3 of skoða=sk skyli / of skyggna=sk skyli ‘he should spy round / he should pry round’ | I have borrowed the English translation of these two lines from Bray (1908).

- 2 **G**efendr heilir, · gęstr ’s inn kominn, [R 3r/6]
 hvar skal sitja sjá?
 2 Mjok es bráðr · sá’s á brøndum skal
 4 sins of freista frama.
 O givers, hail! A guest is come in;
 where shall this one sit?
 Most anxious is he who on the wood-pile shall
 test his furtherance.
-

ALL | The speaker, who may be the guest himself, announces to the hosts (the ‘givers’) that a guest, frozen, wet and tired, is sitting outside waiting to be let in. With this stanza the frame of the guest arriving at a farmstead begins; it is from this scenario that the following advice gradually branches out.

3 á brøndum ‘on the wood-pile’ | Many interpretations have been offered for this line, chiefly owing to the varied senses of ON *brandr* ‘fire, firewood, sword’. I agree with Evans (1986, p. 77) that the best explanation is attained by reference to a Norwegian folk custom attested from much later times, wherein the guest would *sitja i brondo*, i.e., sit down on the wood-pile outside the door, waiting until being let in.

4 sins of freista frama ‘test his furtherance’ | Try his luck, see how far he gets. The same line is also found in *Vafþ* 11, 13, 15, 17.

- 3 **E**lds es þorǫf · þeim’s inn es kominn [R 3r/8]
 ok á knéi kalinn,
 matar ok váða · es manni þorǫf,
 4 þeim’s heǫf of fjall farit.
 Fire is needful for him who has come inside
 and is cold about his knees.
 Food and of clothing are needful for the man
 who over the fell has fared.

- 4 **V**ats es þorǫf · þeim’s til verðar kǫmr, [R 3r/10]
 þęrru ok þjóð-laðar,
 góðs of óðis, · —ef sér geta mętti—
 4 orðs ok ęndr-þęgu.
 Water is needful for him who comes for a meal,
 [and] a towel and a hearty welcome,

a good mood—if he might get it—
a word, and silence in return.

ALL | There is a good train of thought throughout the st.: the guest must first wash and dry himself, then be welcomed to sit and eat at the table. After the host has furnished him with these amenities the expectation of proper conduct now shifts onto the guest, who should introduce himself and speak wisely.

3 of óðis ‘mood’ | An instance of prenominal *of*, an archaic feature. *of óði* appears once in a Scaldic poem, Egill *Arkv* 2 (in SkP 5). Cf. st. 21/4 below.

4 *ændr-þögu* ‘silence in return’ | One may note that the verb *þegja* ‘shut up, hush, be silent’—of which **þaga*, which only appears in the present cpd, is a derivative formed in the same way as *saga* ‘saw, history’ to *segja* ‘say, speak’—and the related noun *þegn* ‘silence’ are frequently used at the beginning of Scaldic poems (e.g. Arn *Magnr* 1: *þegi sçim-brotar* ‘may gold-breakers [GENEROUS MEN] be silent’, Egill *Berdr* 1: *hyggi ... til þagnar þinn ljör* ‘may thy retinue focus on silence’, Glúm *Gráf* 1: *biðjum vér þagnar* ‘we ask for silence’).

5 Vits es þorfr · þeim’s víða ratar;
2 dēlt es hēima hvat;
at auga-bragði · verðr sá’s ekkí kann
4 ok með snotrum sitr.

[R 3r/12]

Wit is of use for him who widely roams;
everything is easy at home.
The subject of glances becomes he who nothing knows
and among the clever sits.

3 *auga-bragði* ‘The subject of glances’ | Idiomatic. *auga-bragð* literally means ‘blink of an eye, moment’ (so st. 78/3 below), and the sense here is thus something like ‘a quick glance of derision’.

6 At hyggjandi sinni · skyli=t maðr hrósinn vesa,
2 hēldr gētinn gēði,
þá’s horskr ok þögull · kōmr hēimis-garða til,
4 sjaldan verðr víti vörum,
því’t ó-brigðra vin · fēr maðr aldri=gi,
6 an man-vit mikit.

[R 3r/14]

Of his thinking should man not be boastful,
rather guarding of his senses
when sharp and silent he comes to a homestead;
sudden harm seldom strikes the wary,
for a less fickle friend man never gets
than great manwit.

5 maðr ‘man’ | In R abbreviated with the rune Ψ m, whose ON name is *maðr* ‘man’; the first of 45 such instances in the present poem. Whereas Anglo-Saxon Latin-script mss. use several runes ideographically (e.g. $\mathfrak{X}$ o for OE *ððel* ‘homeland, patrimony’), there do not seem to be any Scandinavian examples with runes other than Ψ . The tradition of ideographic runes goes back to the Runic period itself, as shown by the pre-Christian inscriptions from Stentofen (DR 357) and Ingelstad (Ög 43); DR 357 uses the rune $\mathfrak{S}$ j for *ár* ‘year, good harvest’ and Ög 43 uses $\mathfrak{M}$ d for *dagr* ‘day’. For the names of the runes see the Three Rune Poems, edited below under Runic Poetry.

6 man-vit ‘manwit’ | The first introduction of this very important concept. The word is difficult to translate (which is why it has been calqued), but seems to refer to the opposite of Scandinavian ‘blue-eyed’ naïveté, viz., shrewdness, situational awareness, and familiarity with the correct behaviour in varied social contexts.

- 7 Hinn vari geðstr · es til verðar kœmr, [R 3r/17]
 2 þunnu hljóði þegir;
 eyrum hlýðir, · en augum skoðar,
 4 svá nýsi=sk fróðra hværr fyrir.

The wary guest who comes for a meal
 with sharp hearing shuts up.
 With ears he listens and with eyes he watches;
 so looks each learned man ahead.

2 þunnu hljóði ‘with sharp hearing’ | Lit., ‘with thin silence’.

2 þegir ‘shuts up’ | The importance of silence and not speaking frivolously is very important in the poem, and is further brought up in sts. 17, 19, 22, 26–31, 45, 46, 63, 65, 73, 103, 117, 124, 125, and 132–135.

4 nýsi=sk ... fyrir ‘looks ... ahead’ | This phrasal verb underlies the noun *for-njón* as found in *Sigrdr* 25, which offers similar advice.

- 8 Hinn es séll, · es sér of getr [R 3r/19]
 2 lof ok líkn-stafi;
 ó·della ’s við þat, · es ęiga skal
 4 annars brjóstum ĩ.

This one is blessed, who for himself does earn
 goodwill and friendly words.
 It is less easy with that which one shall own
 in another man’s breast.

2 lof ‘goodwill’ | Or ‘praise’, but *lof* here carries the specific sense of the favour or goodwill one earns through generous acts.

2 líkn-stafi ‘friendly words’ | A cpd. of *líkn* + *stafr*. *líkn* is defined by ONP as: ‘mercy, compassion, relief, comfort, help’; cf. its two other occurrences in the present poem: st. 120 and especially st. 123, where it is likewise paired with *lof* ‘goodwill, praise’.

- 9 Sá es séll, · es sjalfr of á [R 3r/20]

- 2 lof ok vit meðan lifir;
 því't ill rōð · hefr maðr opt þegit
 4 annars brjóstum ór.

*That one is blessed, who himself does have
 goodwill and wits while he lives,
 for ill counsel has man oft taken
 out of another man's breast.*

1 Sá 'That one' | Contrasting with *hinn* 'this one' in the previous stanza.

- 10 Byrði bętri · berr=at maðr brautu at, [R 3r/22]
 2 an séi man-vit mikit;
 auði bętra · þykkir þat i ó-kunnum stað;
 4 s-líkt es vá-laðs vera.

*A better burden bears man not on the road
 than much manwit.
 In an unknown place it seems better than wealth;
 such is the destitute man's shelter.*

- 11 Byrði bętri · berr=at maðr brautu at, [R 3r/24]
 2 an séi man-vit mikit;
 veg-nest verra · vegr=a vęlli at,
 4 an séi of-drykkja ęls.

*A better burden bears man not on the road
 than much manwit.
 Worse way-provision he drags not along on the plain
 than an overdrinking of ale.*

3 vęlli at 'on the plain' | I.e., 'in the wilderness, outside', in contrast to the safety of one's home village. The word *vęllr* 'plain, (uncultivated) field' is used in the same sense in sts. 38 and 49 below. It is easily understood that the wild heaths and plains of Iron Age Norway were particularly unsafe places whereon a traveller needed to keep his wits about him, lest he fall prey to highwaymen (so st. 38).

- 12 Es=a svá gótt, · sęm gótt kveða,
 2 ęl alda sonum;
 því't fęra vęit, · es fleira drekk,
 4 sins til gęðs gumi.

*It is not so good as they call it good,
 ale, for the sons of men,
 for the less he knows as the more he drinks
 man of his own sense.*

[R 3r/25]

- 13 Ó-minnis-*hægri* *h*ęitir, · *s*á's *yfir* *q*lðrum þrumir, [R 3r/27]
 2 hann steln *g*ęđi *g*uma;
 þęss *f*ogls *f*jððrum · *ek* *f*jðtraðr *v*as'k
 4 *ĩ* *g*arði *Gunn-laðar*.

Forgetfulness-heron is he called who hovers over ale-feasts;
 he robs man of his senses.
 By that bird's feathers I was fettered
 in Guthlathe's yard.

1 Ó-minnis-*hægri* 'Forgetfulness-heron' | Lit., 'unmemory-heron', the personification of drunkenness as a hovering bird.

3–4 þęss *f*ogls *f*jððrum · *ek* *f*jðtraðr *v*as'k *ĩ* *g*arði *Gunn-laðar* 'By that bird's feathers I was fettered in Guthlathe's yard.' | The first use of the first-person pronoun in the poem. — The myth alluded to is Weden's theft of the Mead of Poetry from Sutting's daughter, Guthlathe (*Gunn-lęð*). For this myth see introduction to sts. 103–110 below. In the version told in *Skm* Weden does indeed drink all of the Mead, but he soon spits it out again and shows no adverse effects. On the other hand the implication behind the present stanza seems to be that the Mead had the drawbacks of normal alcohol. If this be the case it might lend support to the theory that the Guests' Strand and the later parts of *Háv* were originally separate compositions since no drunkenness is found in *Háv* 103–110, although it could also be taken symbolically since too great wisdom is not a good thing (cf. sts. 53–56 below). Cf. the following st. 14.

- 14 *Q*lr *ek* *v*arð, · *v*arð *ofr-qlvi*, [R 3r/29]
 2 at hins *fróða* *F*jalars;
 því *es* *q*lðr *batst**, · at *aptr* of *h*ęimtir
 4 *hvęrr* *sitt* *g*ęð *g*umi.

Drunk I became—became the dead-drunkest—
 at the learned Fealer's.
 Thus that ale-feast is best where every man
 gets back to his senses.

3 *batst** | *gramm. emend.*; *batstr* (*m. nom. sg.*) R

1–2 *Q*lr *ek* *v*arð ... at hins *fróða* *F*jalars 'Drunk I became ... at the learned Fealer's' | Possibly another reference to the Mead of Poetry, for Fealer was one of the two dwarfs who slew Quasher and made the mead. Again the sense seems to be that Weden got drunk on it, but since Weden (in the attested versions of the myth) never meets the two dwarfs the mention of them may be metaphorical. Fealer may also be a variant name for Sutting, Guthlathe's father.

- 15 *Þ*agalt *ok* *h*ugalt · *skyli* *þjóðans* *barn* [R 3r/31]
 2 *ok* *vig-djarft* *vesa*;
*g*laðr *ok* *reifr* · *skyli* *g*umna *hvęrr*,
 4 *und's* *sinn* *bíðr* *bana*.

Silent and thoughtful should the king's child be
 and battle-bold.

Glad and cheerful should every man be
till he suffers his bane.

- 16 Ó·snjallr maðr · hygg=sk munu ey lifa,
2 ef við víg vara=sk;
en elli gefr hönnum · engi frið,
4 þó'tt hönnum gëirar gefi.

[R 3v/1]

The unvalorous man thinks he will live for ever
if he is wary of war,
but old age gives him no peace
though the spears might give it to him.

ALL | The coward may have been spared pain by the spears, but he cannot avoid the suffering of infirm old age (which in a world before modern medicine was even greater than today, consider just as one example the loss of all teeth). *It* will never spare him. The subtext is that since death is unavoidable it is better to live an honourable life and die young than a cowardly one and die of old age. This appears related to the negative view of the *strá-dauði* 'straw-death' (actually a hapax, only attested in *Korm* 85, SkP 5), i.e., death in bed from old age or sickness. Compare the speech attributed to the 10th century warrior Eyel Woolserk before a battle, in *HákGóð* 23: *þat óttuðumk ek um brið, er friðr þessi inn mikli var, at ek mynda verða elli-dauðr inni á þall-strám mínum; en ek vilda heldr falla í orrostu ok fylgja þofðingja mínum; kann nú vera, at svá megí verða*. 'I long feared while this great peace lasted that I would die of old age indoors upon my straw bed, but I would rather fall in battle and follow my chieftain; now it may be that it turns out so.' A similar contempt for life as mere living is common in the older heroic literature (e.g., *Fjáfn* 10, *Akv* 23–27), written as it was to celebrate (the lives of) young kings and warriors. Even so, it must be said that *Háv* is uniquely nuanced in this regard (cf. especially sts. 69–71 below), not unlikely since its author was himself an old man, rather than a young warrior-poet.

- 17 Kópir af-glapi, · es til kynnis kómr,
2 þyl=sk hann umb eða þrumir;
allt es senn, · ef sylg of getr,
4 uppi 's þa gëð guma.

[R 3v/3]

The oaf gapes when he comes to visit;
he mumbles about or loiters.
All at once if a sip he gets
exposed is the mind of the man.

- 18 Sá einn vëit, · es víða ratar
2 ok hëfr fjölð of farit,
hvęrju gëði · stýrir gumna hvęrr,
4 sá es vitandi 's vits.

[R 3v/5]

He alone knows who widely roams
and has journeyed much,
which sort of mind every man wields,
who is knowing of his wits.

ALL | Only he who has seen the world knows how a wise man should think and conduct himself.

2 hefr fjöld of farit ‘has journeyed much’ | Cf. *Vafþ* 3, 44, et.c., where Weden repeats: *Fjöld ek fór, fjöld freistada’k, // fjöld ek reynda rugin* ‘Much I journeyed, much I tried, much I tested the Reins.’

- 19 **H**aldi=t maðr á keri, · drikki þó at **h**ófi mjöð,
 2 mēli þarft eða þegi;
 ó·kynnis þess · váar þik **ę**ngi maðr,
 4 at þú gangir **s**nimma at **s**ofa.

[R 3v/7]

Man ought not to hold onto the cask, ought yet to drink mead in moderation;
 he ought to speak the needful or shut up.
 For that uncouthness will no man blame thee
 that thou go early to sleep.

1 Haldi=t maðr á keri ‘Man ought not to hold onto the cask’ | This line has been variously interpreted, but is generally understood as referring to a type of toast (cf. Olsen 1938, pp. 158–165). Finnur Jónsson suggests that we are dealing with a *svęitar-drykkja* ‘company-toast’, where the drinking vessel would be passed around in a circle and each recipient would drink in turn (Olsen 1938, pp. 160–161). Such toasts were drunk for a long time in Northern Europe, and are the likely origin of the Scandinavian toasting-word, *skål* ‘prosit, cheers!’, lit. ‘bowl!’ “Holding onto” the vessel (and not letting the next person drink) would surely be seen as very rude, so the sense is that one should drink his share, but not too much; indeed, in 1519 a man in Jämtland was killed in an argument resulting from his refusal to pass on the bowl during a similar toast (Sjöberg 1907). Olsen (1938) [161–165], who was not aware of the 1519 legal proceeding, doubts that such a delay could happen, and in any case thinks that it would not be common enough to justify a general warning against it in an advice-poem. He instead argues that the line refers to a type of drinking where each man is holding his own smaller legless horn, which cannot be put down except emptied. “Holding onto” the horn would thus be referring to holding a half-full horn in one’s hand rather than drinking up and refilling it in order to keep partaking in the toasts. The sense of the whole stanza would then be that when one is at a party it is best to keep with the festive spirit and drink, rather than act “uncouthly” by sitting with a half-full horn and refusing to toast. One should still not drink too much, but, rather than “holding onto” a horn, it is better simply to go to sleep when one feels he has drunk enough; that is a lesser uncouthness than refusing to toast.

2 mēli þarft eða þegi ‘he ought to speak the needful or shut up’ | This line occurs identically in *Vafþ* 10/2.

- 20 **G**róðugr halr, · nema gęðs viti,
 2 **e**tr sér aldr-trega;
 opt fęr **hl**ógis, · es með **h**orskum kęmr,
 4 **m**anni hęmskum **m**agi.

[R 3v/9]

The gluttonous man—unless he know his sense—
 eats himself a life-sorrow.
 Oft the belly when among the sharp he comes
 brings the foolish man ridicule.

2 etr sér aldr-trega ‘eats himself a life-sorrow’ | Or, ‘eats himself to death.’

- 21 Hjarðir þat vitu, · nér hëim skulu,
 2 ok ganga þà af grasi;
 3 en ò·sviðr maðr · kann ẽva=gi
 4 sïns of mál* maga.

[R 3v/11]

Herds know it when they shall turn home
 and then part from the grass,
 but the unwise man never knows
 his own belly's measure.

4 mál* | gramm. emend.; máls R

- 22 Ve-sall maðr · ok illa skapi
 2 hlér at hví-vetna;
 3 hitt=ki hann vẽit, · es vita þyrpti,
 4 at hann es=a vamma vanr.

[R 3v/13]

The wretched man and ill turned out
 laughs at anything,
 yet he knows not what he would need to know:
 that he is not free of blemishes.

4 es=a | sens. emend.; es R

ALL | The sense is that the wretched man laughs at the flaws of others, not realizing that these are found just as much in himself.

4 hann es=a vamma vanr 'he is not free of blemishes' | Formulaic, cf. *Lok* 30: *es=a þér vamma vant* 'thou art not free of blemishes'.

- 23 Ò·sviðr maðr · vakir umb allar nêtr
 2 ok hyggr at hví-vetna;
 3 þà es móðr, · es at morni kømr;
 4 alt es víl sëm vas.

[R 3v/14]

The unwise man is awake for all nights
 and thinks about anything.
 Then he is weary when the morning comes;
 all the trouble is as it was.

- 24 Ò·snotr maðr · hyggr sér alla vesa
 2 við·hléjendr vini;
 3 hitt=ki hann fiðr, · þó'tt of hann fãr lesi,
 4 ef með snotrum sitr.

[R 3v/16]

The unclever man thinks all those
 who laugh with him are his friends,

yet he does not find that they make sport of him,
if among the clever he sits.

25 Ó·snotr maðr · hyggr sér alla vesa

[R 3v/18]

2 við·hléjendr vini;
þá þat fiðr · es at þingi kómr,
4 at á for·mélendr fáa.

The unclever man thinks all those
who laugh with him are his friends.
Then he finds when to the Thing he comes
that he has spokesmen few.

4 á for·mélendr fáa ‘has spokesmen few’ | Repeated in st. 62; cf. note there. The Thing was the Germanic legal assembly, where small disputes could easily turn into deadly feuds, so the import is that true friends are proven in conflict, not in drunken revelry.

26 Ó·snotr maðr · þykki=sk allt vita,

[R 3v/20]

2 ef á sér i vø veru;
hitt=ki hann vøit, · hvat skal við kveða,
4 ef hans fræista firar.

The unclever man seems to know everything
if he takes shelter in a nook,
yet he knows not what he shall answer
if men test him.

2 vø ‘nook’ | From earlier *vrø; cf. Swedish vrå ‘corner, nook’, rare English wroo ‘id.’ The present stanza is one of two Norse attestations of this word in the form vø (the other being *Sigsö 29/3*), featuring an irregular West Norse sound change from vr- > v-. The normal change vr- > r- yields rø, which is the form this word otherwise takes in prose. This includes *FGT 1950* where rø is brought up as an example of a word with nasal ø and contrasted with the oral ø in rø ‘sailyard’. It is plausible that vø be a form of earlier *vrø after alliteration between vr- and v- had become impossible due to the sound change vr- > r-. Since old vr- is never found in dateable Scaldic poetry composed after ca. 1000 CE, and only twice in poetry composed ca. 900 CE (*Egill Frag 1* and *Eil Þór 22*, both in SkP 3) this serves as a dating criterion for the present stanza, even moreso since there is nothing to suggest that the word pair *vrø and vera was ever formulaic. For a more certain instance of alliterating vr- and v- cf. *Háv 32/2* below; for discussion of the validity this criterion see Haukur Þorgeirsson (2016), Males (2024b, pp. 87–92).

27 Ó·snotr maðr · es með aldir kómr,

[R 3v/21]

2 þat 's batst at hann þegi;
engi þat vøit, · at hann ekki kann,
4 nema hann méli til mart;
vøit=a maðr, · hinn's vøt=ki vøit,
6 þó'tt hann méli til mart.

The unclever man who comes amidst folk—
 it is best that he shut up.
 No one knows that he nothing knows
 unless he speak too much;
 the man who knows nothing does not know
 that he speaks too much.

1 *maðr* | *sens. emend.; om. R.*

28 Fróðr sá þykk**i*=sk, · es fregna kann,

[R 3v/24]

2 ok segja hit sama,
 3 ey-vitu leyna · megu ýta synir
 4 því es gengr of guma.

Learned seems he who can ask
 and answer in the same way.
 In no way may the sons of men hide
 that which eludes an earthling.

1 þykk**i*=sk | ‘þyciriz’ (*with erroneous abbrev. mark for -ir-*) R

1–2 fregna ... segja ‘ask ... answer’ | Perhaps specifically in the context of a riddling contest of wisdom.

3–4 ey-vitu ... guma. ‘In no way ... earthling.’ | I.e., ‘in no way may man hide his ignorance’ when asked a question to which he does not know the answer; the mixing of singular and plural is unusual but not unparalleled in ON.

29 Ørna mēlir, · sá’s éva þegir,

[R 3v/26]

2 stað-lausu stafi;
 3 hrað-mélt tunga, · nema haldendr egi,
 4 opt sér ógótt of gēlr.

He who never shuts up speaks plenty
 utterings of absurdity.
 A quick-spoken tongue—unless it be held in place—
 oft sings evil [into being] for itself.

3–4 hrað-mélt ... of gēlr ‘A quick-spoken ... for itself’ | Likely formulaic or proverbial. Cf. *Lok* 31.

3 nema haldendr egi ‘unless it be held in place’ | Lit. ‘unless holders own it’ or ‘unless it own holders’ (both words are grammatically ambiguous), the “holders” perhaps being the teeth which hold the tongue in place. Cf. the modern Scandinavian idiom Swedish *hålla tand för tunga*, Danish *holde tand for tunge* ‘keep one’s mouth shut’, lit. ‘hold tooth before tongue’.

30 At auga-bragði · skal=a maðr annan hafa,

[R 3v/28]

2 þótt til kynnis komi;

4 margr fróðr þykki=sk, · ef freginn es=at
ok nái þurr-fjallr þruma.

Into the subject of glances shall man not make another,
although he comes to his home.
Many a one seems learned if he is not asked
and gets to loiter about dry-skinned.

4 þurr-fjallr ‘dry-skinned’ | I.e., ‘untested’, equivalent to the English idiom *get one’s feet wet*. The word *fell* ~ *fjall* ‘skin, pelt’ is rare in Old Norse literature and only occurs in cpds, e.g. *Vkv* 11: *ber-fjall* ‘bear-pelt’. It survives in modern Swedish *fjäll* ‘scale (on fish and reptiles)’

31 Fróðr þykki=sk · sá’s flótta tēkr
2 gęstr at gęst hęðinn;
vęit=a gęr=la · sá’s of verði glissir,
4 þó’tt með grōmum glami.

[R 3v/30]

Learned seems he who takes to flight,
the guest, from a hostile guest.
He knows not clearly when he grins over the food
though he be flirting with fiends.

2 hęðinn ‘hostile’ | *metr. emend.*; hęðinn ‘scoffing’ R

ALL | The situation hinted at in sts. 31–32 is that two guests, each unknown to the other, have come to the same homestead. The sense of st. 31 is that when mocked by a stranger it is best not to engage since the dealing may quickly turn violent. Cf. sts. 122, 123, and 125.

2 hęðinn ‘hostile’ | The short vowel is metrically required since a Leeds-meter c-verse cannot end in a trochée where the first syllable is long. The pres. ed. follows Finnur Jónsson (1932) in seeing an otherwise unattested **hęðinn* derived from *hęðr* ‘battle’, but most eds. retain the R form *hęðinn* ‘scoffing’.

32 Gumnar margir · eru=sk gagn-hollir,
2 ęn at vir*ði vreka=sk;
aldar róg · þat mun ę vesa;
4 órir gęstr við gęst.

[R 4r/1]

Many men are well true to each other,
but over food drive each other away.
The strife of mankind will that for ever be;
guest raves against guest.

2 vir*ði | ‘virijþi’ (*with confused abbrev. mark for -ri-*) R

2 at vir*ði vreka=sk ‘over food drive each other away’ | The archaic initial *vr-* in *vreka=sk* must be restored for metrical reasons; cf. *Háv* 26/2 n. above. This is a demonstrably archaic feature since the pairing *verðr* ‘food, a meal’, *vreka* ‘drive away’ does not appear to be formulaic and since *reka* (< *vreka*) alliterates exclusively with *r-* in the extant Scaldic corpus.

- 33 **Ár**=liga verðar · skyli maðr opt fää,
 nema til kynnis komi;
 sitr ok snópir, · léttr sëm solginn séi,
 ok kann fregna at fðu.

[R 4r/3]

An early meal should man oft get
 unless he should come to visit;
 he sits and sulks, sounds as if starved,
 and can ask about little.

- 34 **Af**hvarf mikít · es til ills vinar,
 þó'tt á brautu búí,
 en til góðs vinar · liggja gagn-vegir,
 þó'tt hann séi firr farinn.

[R 4r/4]

A great off-turn it is to a bad friend
 though on the road he live,
 but to a good friend lie pleasant ways
 though he be far travelled.

- 35 **G**anga skal, · skal=a gęstr vesa
 ey í ęinum stað;
 ljúfr verðr lęđr, · ef lęngi sitr
 annars flętjum á.

[R 4r/6]

One shall go on; one shall not be a guest
 for ever in one place.
 The loved becomes loathed if for long he sits
 on another man's benches.

1 skal | *sens. emend.; om. (by parablepsis)* R

ALL | It is best not to outstay one's welcome. The customary length of stay in old times was three nights, as noted in *Eg*, ch. 78: *þat var engi siðr, at sitja lengr en þrjár nætr at kynni* 'it was not customary to stay longer than three nights when visiting.' Compare a much more recent Jutlandish saying: *en tredje dags gjæst stinker* 'a third day's guest stinks', which closely resembles a contemporary American maxim popularly attributed to Benjamin Franklin: "Guests, like fish, begin to smell after three days." It is probably inspired by such proverbs that Auden and Taylor translate the last two lines of this stanza as "He starts to stink who outstays his welcome, / in a hall that is not his own."

- 36 **B**ú es bętra, · þó'tt lítit séi,
 halr es hęima hvērr;
 þó'tt tvęr gęitr ęigi · ok taug-ręptan sal,
 þat 's þó bętra an bón.

[R 4r/7]

A dwelling is better though small it be;
 each is a hero at home.
 Though two goats he own and a cord-roofed hall,
 that is yet better than begging.

1 Bú es bętra, · þó'tt lítit séi | The b-verse of the first line is missing the necessary alliteration, but no good emendation suggests itself and the sense is perfect.

1 bętra 'better' | I.e., better than the alternative.

3 taug-reptan sal 'a cord-roofed hall' | A shack with the birch-bark shingles (cf. st. 60) hung on ropes rather than on proper wooden rafters.

37 Bú es bętra, · þó'tt lítit séi, [R 4r/9]
 2 halr es hęima hvęrr;
 blóðugt es hjarta · þęim's biðja skal
 4 sér i mál hvęrt matar.

A dwelling is better though small it be;
 each is a hero at home.
 Bloody is the heart in him who shall beg
 for his every meal of food.

38 Vópnum sīnum · skal=a maðr vęlli á [R 4r/10]
 2 feti ganga framarr,
 því't ó-vist's at vita, · nęr verðr á vegum úti
 4 gęirs of þorf guma.

From his weapons shall man on the plain
 not take one step further,
 for it is unsure to know when on the ways outside
 man comes in need of a spear.

1 vęlli á 'on the plain' | Formulaic, see note to st. 11.

2 feti ganga framarr 'take one step further' | Formulaic c-line, also occurring in *Lok* 1/2 (*feti gangir framarr*) and *Ski* 40/2 (*stęgir feti framarr*).

4 of þorf 'need' | The pronominal particle *of* is an archaic feature (cf. st. 4/3 above), but it does not appear to correspond to a prefix in West Germanic or Gothic.

39 Fann'k=a mildan mann · eða svá matar góðan, [R 4r/12]
 2 at vęri=t þiggja þęgi;
 eða sīns fęar · svá=gi [...],
 4 at lęið séi laun, ef þęgi.

I found no generous man nor one so good of meat
 that a gift would not be accepted,

nor one with his money so not [stingy]
that repayments would be loathed if he might get them.

ALL | The Wanderer has found no man so generous that he would refuse a gift formally presented to him, nor decline a small present as thanks for his generosity.

1 matar góðan ‘good of meat’ | A positive Viking Age expression also found in memorial inscriptions on Swedish runestones; see Index.

3 féar ‘money’ | The base sense of ON *fé* is ‘cattle, livestock’, but it also has the sense ‘money, movable property’ which is how it is used in the present stanza; see Index: *fee*. In the translation of the present poem the English word ‘money’ exclusively stands for ON *fé*, which however is also translated as ‘kine’.

3 [...] ‘[stingy]’ | It is doubtless that a word has been lost here, although no gap is indicated in R. Both meter and sense require a word, likely an adjective in the m. acc. sg. Finnur Jónsson (1932) suggests *glöggvan* ‘miserly, stingy’, giving a litotes ‘so not stingy’, i.e., ‘so generous’, and this is adopted in the translation.

- 40 Féar sïns, · es fengit hęfr, [R 4r/14]
2 skyli=t maðr þorfr þola;
opt sparir lęiðum · þat’s hęfr ljufum hugat;
4 mart gengr verr an varir.

Of his own money which he has earned
should man not suffer need.
Oft one saves for the loathed what one has meant for the loved;
much goes worse than one expects.

ALL | The sense is that it is bad to hoard one’s savings to the point of deprivation since one never knows quite how things will turn out.

- 41 Vöpnum ok vöðum · skulu vinir glęðja=sk; [R 4r/16]
2 þat ’s á sjölfum sýnst;
viðr-gefęndr ok ęndr-gefęndr · eru=sk vinir lęngst,
4 ef þat bíðr at verða vęl.

With weapons and garments shall friends gladden each other;
that is best seen on oneself.
Givers-back and givers-again are friends for the longest
if it awaits to turn out well.

ALL | Friends are supposed to help each other and strengthen their capacity for violence so that they may come to each other’s aid in the future. Friendship requires both giving and receiving. With this stanza the Wanderer turns towards the subject of friendship, its nature and importance.

1 Vöpnum ok vöðum ‘With weapons and garments’ | I.e., with arms, for the *váðir* ‘garments’ are probably no women’s silks. This alliterative word-pair is formulaic and in other occurrences exclusively refers to implements of war; cf., e.g., *Beow* 39, where Shield’s pyre-ship is loaded with *hilde-wępnum* · *ęndr beaðo-wędum* ‘war-weapons and battle-garments’.

2 þat ’s á sjölfum sýnst ‘that is best seen on oneself’ | I.e., in one’s own lived experience.

4 þat ‘it’ | The friendship.

- 42 **V**in sínum · skal maðr **vinr** **vesa**, [R 4r/18]
 2 ok **g**jalda **g**jof við **g**jof;
 hlátr við **h**látri · skyli **h**olðar taka,
 4 en **l**ausung við **l**ygi.

With his friend shall man be a friend
 and pay gift against gift;
 laughter for laughter should men employ—
 but duplicity for lie.

- 43 **V**in sínum · skal maðr **vinr** **vesa**, [R 4r/19]
 2 þeim ok þess **vin**;
 en **ó**·vinar síns · skyli **e**ngi maðr
 4 **v**inar **vinr** **vesa**.

With his friend shall man be a friend,
 with him and with his friend,
 but his enemy's, should no man,
 friend's friend be.

- 44 **V**eitst, ef þú **vin** átt, · þann's **v**el trúir [R 4r/21]
 2 ok vilt af hönnum **g**ótt **geta**,
 gæði skalt við þann · ok **g**jofum skipta,
 4 **f**ara at **f**inna opt.

Thou knowest, if thou hast a friend whom thou trustest well
 and wilt get good things from him:
 thoughts and gifts shalt thou exchange with him;
 journey to find him oft.

ALL | Stanzas 44–46 are structurally identical. Lines 1 and 4 are repeated near-identically in st. 119 below.

3 skalt ‘shalt thou’ | This verb (also found in sts. 45/3 and 46/3) is the only direct admonition to the listener in the Guests’ Strand, which, unlike the Speeches of Loddfathomer (sts. 111–137), entirely avoids imperative verbs; cf. Introduction to *Háv* above.

- 45 **E**f þú átt **annan**, · þann's **i**lla trúir, [R 4r/23]
 2 vilt af hönnum þó **g**ótt **geta**,
 fagrt skalt mæla við þann, · en **f**látt hyggja
 4 ok gjalda **l**ausung við **l**ygi.

If thou hast another whom thou trustest ill,
 yet thou wilt get good things from him:
 fairly shalt thou speak with him, but think falsely
 and pay duplicity for lie.

3 fagrt ... mēla, flátt hyggja ‘fairly ... speak, think falsely’ | Formulaic pair, cf. sts. 90, 91.

- 46 Þat ’s **ę**nn umb þann, · es þú **illa** trúir [R 4r/25]
 2 ok þér es **ę**runr at **ę**ęði,
hlęja skalt við þeim · ok umb **hug** mēla;
 4 **ę**-lík skulu **ę**öld **ę**jöfum.

This is yet about him whom thou trustest ill
 and about whom thou hast doubt:
 laugh shalt thou with him, and speak with care;
 repayments shall be equal to gifts.

- 47 Ungr vas’k **f**örðum, · **f**ör’k ęinn saman, [R 4r/28]
 2 þá varð’k **villr** vega;
auðigr þótt=umk, · es **annan** fann’k,
 4 **maðr** es **manns** gaman.

Young was I once; I journeyed alone;
 then I became lost of ways.
 Wealthy I thought me when another I found;
 man is man’s pleasure.

ALL | This rightly acclaimed stanza serves to nuance the transactional view of friendship seen in sts. 42–46. Companionship is important in its own right.

- 48 **Mildir** fróknir · **męnn** batst lifa, [R 4r/29]
 2 **s**jaldan **sút** ala;
ęn ó-snjallr **maðr** · **u**ggir hvat-vetna,
 4 **sýtir** **ę** **ę**löggr við **ę**jöfum.

Generous, brave men live best;
 seldom they nourish sorrow—
 but the unvalorous man is frightened by anything,
 the stingy always grieves over gifts.

3–4 ó-snjallr, **ę**löggr ‘unvalorous, stingy’ | Contrasting respectively with *frókn*, *mildr* ‘brave, generous’ in the first half of the stanza; a very fine parallelism.

4 **sýtir** **ę** **ę**löggr við **ę**jöfum ‘the stingy always grieves over gifts’ | After receiving a gift, one was culturally obliged to give something back. Cf. sts. 39, 145.

- 49 Váðir münar · gaf'k velli at
 2 tveim tré-mönnum;
 ríkkar þat þöttu=sk, · es rípt hofðu;
 4 neiss es nokkviðr halr.

[R 4r/31]

My garments I gave upon the plain
 to two tree-men.

Champions they seemed when cloaks they had;
 shameful is the naked hero.

ALL | This stanza is somewhat difficult, but I see in it the following scene: The Wanderer comes walking along on the plain when he sees the two unadorned tree-men. Taking pity for the sorry-looking stick figures, he lends them some clothes, and from afar they now look like imposing warriors. Just such a frail, freezing figure, thinks he, is man in his naked state; it is his clothes that afford the hero his status, and even the weak stick-man can look like a champion. Clearly this is quite a different view from the pre-Christian Greek celebration of the naked body, but in the cold Northern climes there was hardly room for public nakedness.

2 tré-mönnum 'tree-men' | Man-shaped wooden figures. Much has been made of their appearance here, including seeing them as cultic idols, but whatever the case, the tone in the stanza is more pessimistic than reverent. Cf. the three stanzas spoken by a tree-man in *Ragn* (*Ragn* 38–40 in SkP 8) and notes there.

4 halr 'hero' | The use of *halr* 'hero, warrior' (cf. sts. 36, 37) rather than the more neutral *maðr* 'man, person' is probably intentional.

- 50 Hrørnar þoll, · sú's stendr þorpi á,
 2 hlýr=at henni þörkr né barr;
 svá es maðr, · sá's mann=gi ann;
 4 hvat skal hann lengi lifa?

[R 4r/33]

Withers the pine that stands on the yard;
 her shields no bark nor leaf.

So is the man who loves no man—
 why shall he live for long?

2 hlýr=at | 'hlyrar' R

ALL | Ll. 1–2 give an analogical example taken from the natural world, which is then equated to the world of humans in ll. 3–4. The same stylistic trick is also used below in sts. 57 (fire) and 62 (the eagle).

2 hlýr=at henni þörkr né barr 'her shields no bark nor leaf' | For her (ON *þoll* 'pine' is feminine) leaves and branches are eaten by the fourfoot, her bark stripped by the twofoot, perhaps for the making of bark-flour, as was done during hard times into the 19th century.

- 51 Eldi hēitari · brinnr með illum vinum
 2 friðr fimm daga,
 en þa sloknar, · es hinn sétti kōmr,
 4 ok versnar allr vin-skapr.

[R 4v/2]

Hotter than fire among bad friends burns
 love, for five days,
 but then goes out when the sixth one comes
 and all the friendship worsens.

2 *fimm daga* ‘for five days’ | I.e., “for a week”, which was originally five days long. The sense is that the bad friends quickly tire of each other when staying together for an extended period of time. See also st. 74 and Index: five days.

- 52 Mikit ęitt · skal= a manni gefa;
 2 opt kaupir sér i lítlu lof;
 með hqlfum hleif · ok með hqlllu kęri
 4 fekk ek mér fę-laga.

[R 4v/4]

Much at once shall one not give a man;
 oft one buys himself goodwill for little.
 With half a loaf and a sloping cask
 I got myself a fellow.

4 *fę-laga* ‘fellow’ | A business partner or companion, one with whom one participates in a *fę-lag* ‘fellowship, common financial venture’. This word, which appears not infrequently on rune-stones, has been described as the single most important word for understanding the Wiking Age, when social ties were weakened and groups of sworn companions embarked on piratical and mercenary expeditions. Cf. Khlevov (2025).

- 53 Lítilla sanda, · lítilla séva,
 2 lítil eru gęđ guma;
 því’t allir męnn · urđu=t jafn-spakir;
 4 hqlf es qlđ hvar.

[R 4v/6]

Of small sands, of small seas:
 small are the senses of man.
 For all men have not become evenly wise;
 man is everywhere half.

3 því’t | því R

ALL | With this stanza the subject of the advice shifts from friendship to wisdom, carried through sts. 53–57.

1 *Lítilla sanda, · lítilla séva* ‘Of small sands, of small seas’ | Most likely a partitive genitive, but the sense is not certain; in any case, the genitive excludes the translation “where sands are small, seas are small”. I find the most likely reading to be a declaration of the smallness of man’s horizons; the world will always be far greater than he, and there will always be much of which he is unwise.

3–4 *því’t allir męnn · urđu=t jafn-spakir; hqlf es qlđ hvar*. ‘For all men have not become evenly wise; man is everywhere half.’ | I find the interpretation of Guđmundur Finnbogason (1929) most convincing: intellectual faculties have not been distributed evenly among men, and so every one has his own strengths and weaknesses; all men are “half” (or “incomplete”, for it should be noted that ON *halfr* ‘half’ has a sense of “incompleteness” not always found in its modern English cognate). This interpretation accords well with sts. 71 and 132 below. In the hyperspecialized modern world it is probably truer than ever.

54 **Meðal-snotr** · skyli **manna** hværr, [R 4v/7]
 éva til **snotr** **séi**;
 2 þeim es **fyrða** · **fegrst** at lifa,
 es **væl** mart **vit**u.
 4
 Middle-clever should each man be;
 never too clever.
 For those folk it is fairest to live,
 who know well enough.

55 **Meðal-snotr** · skyli **manna** hværr, [R 4v/9]
 éva til **snotr** **séi**;
 2 því't **snotrs** manns hjarta · verðr **sjaldan** glatt,
 ef sá 's **al-snotr** es **á**.
 4
 Middle-clever should each man be;
 never too clever,
 for the clever man's heart is seldom glad,
 if its owner is all-clever.

56 **Meðal-snotr** · skyli **manna** hværr, [R 4v/10]
 éva til **snotr** **séi**;
 ør-lög sîn · viti **engi** maðr fyrir;
 2 þeim es **sorga-lausastr** **sefi**.
 4
 Middle-clever should each man be;
 never too clever.
 His own orlay ought no man to know ahead;
 his is the most sorrowless mind.

3 *ør-lög* 'orlay' | One's predetermined fate or course of life. See *Vsp* 19 n.

4 þeim es *sorga-lausastr* sefi 'his is the most sorrowless mind.' | His, who is ignorant of his fate. It is surely fitting that Weden should say this, having knowledge of the inevitable destruction of both the world and himself at the Rakes of the Reins (*Vsp* 51, *Vafþ* 52–53).

57 **Brandr** af **brandi** · **brinnr** und's **brunninn** es, [R 4v/11]
 funi kvęyki=sk af **funa**;
 2 **maðr** af **manni** · verðr at **máli** kuðr;
 ęn til **dólskr** af **dul**.
 4
 Fire from fire burns till it is burned;
 flame is quickened by flame.
 Man to man makes himself known through speech,
 but the too boorish from folly.

ALL | For the stylistic device see st. 50 n. — The sense of the advice is not entirely clear; I take it to mean that a wise man uses careful speech to introduce himself and state his needs, whereas the fool speaks too much and thereby reveals his inexperience and naive character, in a word, his lack of manwit.

4 *dólskr* ‘boorish’ | Derived from an ablaut variant of *dalr* ‘valley, dale’ + *-iskr* ‘-ish’, the sense being ‘provincial, not having left his (home) valley’; cf. English hillbilly. The same ablaut underlies the Icelandic tribal names *vatns-dólr* and *lang-dólr* ‘inhabitants of Waterdale (*Vatns-dalr*), Longdale (*Lang-dalr*)’.

58 *Ár* skal rísa, · *sá’s* annars vill

[R 4v/13]

2 *fé* eða *fjör* hafa;
saldan liggjandi ulfr · *lér* of getr,
4 *né* sofandi maðr sigr.

Early shall he rise who another man’s
money or life will have.
Seldom the resting wolf gets the thigh,
or the sleeping man victory.

1 *sá’s* | *emend. by analogy* (st. 59/1); *es* (‘er’, for *‘sa er’, by *parablepsis*) R.

ALL | A close analogue to this stanza is found in Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 5.7.3: *Pernox enim et pervigil esse debet alienum appetens culmen. Nemo stertendo victoriam cepit, nec luporum quisquam cubando cadaver invenit.* ‘Whoever intends to scale another’s pinnacle must be watchful and wakeful. Nobody has ever won victory by snoring, nor has any sleeping wolf found a carcass.’

2 *fé* eða *fjör* ‘money or life’ | A formulaic word-pair found over 30 times in Norse prose, especially in laws (ONP). The expression is also found in mediæval English and Frisian laws, as OE *feoh and feorb*, OF *fia ande ferech*.

59 *Ár* skal rísa, · *sá’s á* yrkjendr fáa,

[R 4v/15]

2 ok ganga síns verka á vit;
mart of dvęlr · þann’s umb *morgin* sefr,
4 *halfr* es auðr und *hvøtum*.

Early shall he rise who has workmen few,
and go his work to meet.
Much is kept back from him who sleeps through the morning;
a half wealth is due the brisk.

4 *halfr* es auðr und *hvøtum* ‘a half wealth is due the brisk’ | The brisk man has already claimed a half fortune by waking up early.

60 *Purra* skíða · ok *þakinna* néfra,

[R 4v/17]

2 þess kann *maðr* *mjot*,
ok þess *viðar*, · *es* *vinna*=sk megi

4 mál ok misseri.

Of dry billets and thatching birch-bark—
of this man knows the measure,
and of that wood of which he may make use
for a season and a half-year.

3 ok | †ðc† R

ALL | The sense is that man best knows those things on which he depends for his survival.

1 þakinn néfra 'thatching birch-bark' | Birch-bark used for roof-shingles.

4 mál ok misseri 'for a season and a half-year' | Over nine months.

61 Þvegin ok mætt · ríði maðr þingi at,
2 þótt séi=t véddr til vël;
skúa ok bróka · skammi=sk engi maðr
4 né hests in heldr,
þótt hann hafi=t góðan.

[R 4v/19]

Washed and fed ought man to ride to the Thing,
although he be not clothed too well.
Of his shoes and breeches ought no man to be ashamed,
nor the more of his horse,
although he haven't a good one.

1 Þvegin ok mætt 'Washed and fed' | A formulaic collocation. Cf. *Reg* 25 (*kembör* 'combed', *þvegin* 'washed', *mætt* 'fed') and *Vsp* 33: (*þó* 'washed', *kemböi* 'combed'). These examples attest to the importance of personal hygiene in the culture, something further seen by the ubiquity of combs in pre-Christian graves (TODO: archeological reference). The stanza reminds of the following passage from Tacitus *Germania* ch. 22: *Statim ē somnō, quem plerumque in diem extrahunt, lavantur, saepius calidā, ut apud quōs plurimum biems occupat. Lauti cibum capiunt: separatae singulis sedēs et sua cuique mēsa. Tum ad negōtia nec minus saepe ad convivia prōcēdunt armāti.* 'On waking from sleep, which they generally prolong to a late hour of the day, they take a bath, oftenest of warm water, which suits a country where winter is the longest of the seasons. After their bath they take their meal, each having a separate seat and table of his own. Then they go armed to business, or no less often to their festal meetings (*convivia*, i.e., the Things).'

5 þótt hann hafi=t góðan 'although he haven't a good one' | A metrically unusual line. Without it, l. 4 can be scanned straightforwardly as a c-verse, but then l. 5 comes off as an isolated b-verse. Finnur Jónsson (1932) explains it away by considering l. 5 an interpolation, which is certainly a possibility since its content is entirely superfluous. In that case the interpolator would have interpreted l. 4 (the c-verse) as an a-verse and added l. 5 as a corresponding b-verse. It is also possible that it is an authorial, but rare verse-type, for which cf. st. 80/1–2 n.

62 Snapir ok gnafir, · es til sévar kómr,
2 qrn á aldinn mar;
svá es maðr, · es með mǫrgum kómr
4 ok á for-méðendr fāa.

[R 4v/22]

It snatches and stoops when to the sea it comes,
 the eagle on the ancient ocean.
 So is the man who comes among the many
 and has spokesmen few.

ALL | *Sts. 62–63 are reversed in R, but a symbol at the start of each indicates that they should switch places.*

ALL | The naturalistic likeness is impressive. For an illustration of the situation alluded to, see *Hrafnk* 8–11, where two men try to find the support of powerful men on the Icelandic All-Thing for a suit against a chieftain who has slain their young relative.

4 á for-męłęndr fáa ‘has spokesmen few’ | Shared with st. 25.

63 Fregna ok segja · skal fróðra hvern,

[R 4v/21]

2 sá’s vill hęitinn horskr;

ęinn vita · né annarr skal,

4 þjóð vęit ef þrír ‘ro.

Ask and answer shall each learned man
 who wishes to be called sharp.

One shall know—not another;
 people know if there are three.

4 þjóð ‘people’ | By which we should understand ‘many people, everybody’.

64 Ríki sitt · skyli ráð-snotra

[R 4v/24]

2 hvern i hófi hafa;

þá þat finnr, · es með fróknum kómr,

4 at ęngi es ęinna hvatastr.

His own power should each counsel-clever
 man use in moderation.

This he then finds when among the brave he comes:
 that none is boldest of all.

ALL | Man, regardless of his station, should never abuse his power. No height of political power or physical strength will make him invincible, and such abuses will only earn him enemies. Of course the historical examples of great men brought down for misuse of their power are myriad. In Germanic legend a notable example is Ermenric, who ruled the vast realm of the Gots with an iron fist (*Déor* 5), but was maimed by two young boys after he had their sister trampled by horses (*Ghv*, *Hamð*, *Jordanes Getica* 129).

Consider the similar thought of Hobbes ([1651] 1996), ch. 13: “Nature hath made men so equall, in the faculties of body, and mind; as that though there bee found one man sometimes manifestly stronger in body, or of quicker mind then another; yet when all is reckoned together, the difference between man, and man, is not so considerable, as that one man can thereupon claim to himselfe any benefit, to which another may not pretend, as well as he. For as to the strength of body, the weakest has strength enough to kill the strongest, either by secret machination, or by confederacy with others, that are in the same danger with himselfe.”

3–4 þá ... çinna hvatastr ‘then ... boldest of all’ | Almost identical to *Fáfn* 17/3–4, which however has *flëirum* ‘more men’ instead of *fróknun* ‘the brave’.

- 65 Orða þęira, · es maðr qðrum sęgir, [R 4v/25]
 2 opt hann gjöld of getr.
 For those words which man says to another
 he oft gets recompense.

ALL | This half-stanza is an orphan. It may plausibly be connected to the previous st. to form a 6-line Leeds-meter st., for which cf. sts. 6, 27, 102, 103, 138, 165.

- 66 Mikils til/ snimma · kom’k i marga staði, [R 4v/26]
 2 ęn til síð i suma;
 qł vas drukkit, · sumt vas ó-lagat;
 4 sjaldan hittir lęiðr i lið.
 Much too early I came to many places,
 but too late to some:
 The ale was drunk up, some was unbrewed—
 seldom finds the loathed his place.

1 Mikils til ‘Much too’ | *emend.*; mikilsti R

ALL | In reality, there was never anything wrong with the ale; it was a mere pretext for dismissing the speaker. There are no wrong times, only wrong people, and it is bad to waste one’s time where one is unwanted.

- 67 Hér ok hvar · myndi mér hęim of boðit, [R 4v/28]
 2 ef þyrpta’k at mólun=gi mat,
 eða tvau lęr hęngi · at hins tryggva vinar,
 4 þar’s ek hafða ęitt etit.
 Here and there would I be invited to a home
 if at meal-time I needed no food,
 or if two hams should hang at the trusty friend’s,
 where I had eaten one.

ALL | People are often stingy, especially with food, which was scarce and closely watched among the Norse subsistence farmers. The Wanderer sarcastically notes that even the “trusty friend” would invite him over oftener if he brought more food than he ate; how good of a friend is he, if he’s not willing to share his food?

- 68 Ełdr es batstr · með ýta sonum [R 4v/30]
 2 ok sólar sýn,
 hęil-yndi sitt, · ef maðr hafa náir,

4 án við lōst at lifa.

Fire is best among the sons of men,
and the sight of the sun,
a man's good health if he gets to keep it,
[and] living free from vice.

ALL | Sts. 68–77 largely form a thematic unit, reflecting on life, legacy, and lastly death. — The Wanderer celebrates simplicity in life. The best pleasures are not power and wealth, but a hot hearth, the bright rays of the sun in springtime, and staying in good health.

4 lōst ‘vice’ | Used of an illicit sexual encounter in st. 98 below, but it may also refer to a physical blemish.

69 Es=at maðr alls ve-sall, · þó'tt séi illa heill,

[R 4v/32]

2 sumr es af sonum sēll,

sumr af frændum, · sumr af fē órnu,

4 sumr af verkum vël.

Man is not all unblessed though he be of poor health:
someone becomes blessed from sons,
someone from kinsmen, someone from ample kine,
someone from works done well.

ALL | The strain of thought continues from the previous stanza. Even the man whose health is failing can find joy in something. At the same time there is a difference in the pleasures of the old and the young. In youth good health is taken for granted, but the comforts of infirm old age—sons, kinsmen, kine, and good works—are things one must obtain through work. Thus, the man who neglects his work cannot expect happiness or fortune in old age; indeed, in the end there is no happiness without effort.

1 ve-sall ‘unblessed’ | I have elsewhere translated *ve-sall* as ‘wretched’, but in the present stanza I render it literally in order to show the etymological relationship to *sēll* ‘blessed’ used elsewhere in the stanza. The form *-sall* lacks i-umlaut due to a shortening of the vowel before the umlaut became phonemic; the ancestral Proto-Norse form would be **wajē-sāli*, for which cf. *Þǫðm-Mírlī* *wajē-maris* ‘infamous’ on the Tjurkö bracteate, where the second element is the ancestor of ON *mērr* ‘renowned, famous’; the expected descendant of that word, ON ***ve-marr*, is not attested.

I translate *sēll* as ‘blessed’, based on the fact that it carries a certain sense of innateness largely foreign to post-Enlightenment Western culture, though it could also be rendered as ‘lucky’ or ‘fortunate’. We may compare the idea of the king’s ‘luck’ (ON *gipr*), which is thought to emanate from his person and shine over his land; in this vein a king whose land experiences bountiful harvests (*ár*) is said to be *ár-sēll* ‘blessed with harvests’, while one whose reign is one of peace (*fríðr*) is said to be *fríð-sēll* ‘blessed with peace’. Thus the state of the realm is not due to uncontrollable environmental or political factors, nor due to the king’s personal choices, but rather arises from the kingly person to the degree that he is favoured and blessed by the Gods. This is thought true also of the private person’s life. Similar conceptions are found amongst many other peoples, e.g. the Chinese political concept of the “mandate of Heaven”. (TODO: Reference PCRN chapter).

2–3 sonum ... frændum ‘sons ... kinsmen’ | Cf. st. 72 below, which stresses the importance of sons and kinsmen. The male perspective may be noted.

70 Bętra ’s lifðum, · an séi ó-lifðum,

[R 5r/2]

2 ęy getr kvíkr kú;

4 ẽld sák upp brinna · auðgum manni fyr,
 ẽn úti vas dauðr fyr durum.

It is better for the living than it may be for the unliving:
 always the quick gets a cow.
I saw a fire burning high for a wealthy man,
 but outside he was dead before the doors.

1 an sêi ô-lifðum | *emend.*; ‘j fẽl lifðom’ R.

1 an sêi ô-lifðum ‘than it may be for the unliving’ | The reading of R, which would be normalized as *ok sêl-lifðum* ‘and for the blessed living’, is metrically defect, since *sêl-* is strongly stressed and should carry alliteration. For the original form of the line we have a close parallel in *Fáfn* 30: *Hvortum ’s betra · an sé ô-hvortum* ‘It is better for the brisk than it may be for the unbrisk’, on which the pres. ed. is based. The corruption has probably happened in the following way: **en*’ (younger form of *an* ‘than’) in the prototype was misinterpreted as ‘en’ ‘and, but’ and copied as ‘j’ (the tironian *et*), while **sêi ôlifðom*’ (probably with the words cramped together) became ‘*sêl lifðom*’.

2 ẽy getr kvikr kú ‘always the quick gets the cow’ | I.e., “new opportunities always present themselves for the living”. A reference to the cattle-based economy (see also st. 76), the cow being used as a metonym for any means of subsistence. For “quick”, cf. churchly English “the quick and the dead”, i.e., “the *living* and the *dead*”.

3–4 ẽld ... durum. ‘A fire ... the doors.’ | The fire may be taken to be the man’s funeral pyre burning on his farm, on which a considerable amount of his wealth has been spent—according to ibn Fadlan’s 10th c. account of the Rus a third of a dead chieftain’s wealth was spent on his funeral clothes and another third on alcohol for the wake (Lunde and Stone 2012, p. 49)—yet in spite of the great fire he is just as dead. The following stanza continues this thought. The fire has also been taken as referring to the burning hearth of the wealthy home, whose owner has died outside it. Another reasonable reading is presented by Evans (1986, p. 107), who sees *dauðr* as the noun ‘death’, and renders ll. 3–4 as “I saw the fire blazing (on the hearth) in front of the rich man; but (unknown to him) death was outside the door.” As he notes, the expression *dauði er fjyrir durum* ‘death is at the door’ is attested.

71 Haltr ríðr hrossi, · hjörð rekr handar vanr,
2 daufr vegr ok dugir;
 blindr es bẽtri · an brẽnndr sêi;
4 nýtr mann=gi nás.

[R 5r/3]

A halt man rides a horse; a handless drives a herd;
 a deaf man fights and avails.
Blind is better than to be burned;
 no man has use for a corpse.

1 handar | *sens. and gramm. emend.*; hundar R

3 brẽnndr ‘burned’ | On the funeral pyre. The word ‘burned’ here means ‘dead’, in the same way as “six feet under” in modern English; each expression refers to the typical custom of dealing with human remains in the respective culture. This synonymy is an important argument for dating *Háv* to the pre-Christian period, since cremation was reserved for criminals and adulterers in the mediaeval Catholic religion (cf. *Am* 84/1), whereas it in *Háv* seems to be the commonly accepted way of disposing the dead (Males 2024b, pp. 93–96). Cf. Introduction to the poem above and the same semantics in st. 81 below.

72 Sonr es bętri, · þó'tt séi síð of alinn

[R 5r/5]

- 2 eptir ginginn guma;
sjaldan bautar-steinar · standa brautu nęr,
4 nema reęsi niðr at nið.

A son is better though he late be born
after a passed man.

Seldom beat-stones near the highway stand,
save by kinsman for kinsman raised.

ALL | It is a boon and a blessing for a man to have an heir, even if he should die before the son is born. The son will inherit and carry on his father's name, lineage, and memory in a way few non-relatives can, as exemplified by the raising of a stone memorial. In a broader context we may consider how it is only a tiny few out of the great human masses who will leave behind any kind of lasting personal legacy beyond their direct familiar relations. The current generation must soon die off, and even those who in their lifetimes see influence and success in their fields are soon forgotten by posterity and relegated to the footnotes of the annals of history if they have no descendants to carry their names into future ages. It is rare for strangers to tend one's grave.

3 bautar-steinar 'beat-stones' | Uninscribed standing stones (sometimes arranged geometrically) raised in memory of the dead, which appear frequently in Norse literature. Cf. *Yng* 8, which describes the laws instituted by the euhemerized Woden: *en eptir alla þá menn, er nękkut manns-mót var at, skyldi reisa bauta-steina, ok beld-sk sjá síðr lengi síðan*. 'but in memory of all those men who had possessed masculine virtue beat-stones should be raised, and that custom was upheld for a long time since'. Standing stones are very common throughout Scandinavia and are not infrequently found near grave-mounds.

It must be noted that the raising of such unmarked beat-stones long precedes the rune-stone boom of the Wiking Age. The older, unmarked beat-stones are also more often found in direct funerary contexts. This is rarely the case with Wiking Age rune-stones, which, instead, tend to be placed near important roads or waterways as memorials. It should be noted that in Norway during the Migration Period this distinction between beat-stone and rune-stone was somewhat blurred, and a number of rune-stones from around 3rd to 5th centuries are placed near grave fields. Unlike the later Wiking Age inscriptions, these stones often hold only single personal names or genitive phrases, like KJ 90 from Sunde in Sunnfjord, western Norway: *ÞIDMXXFTIY widugastir* 'Woodguest', or KJ 78 from Bø in Rogaland, southwestern Norway: *NTFEMF NTNF hnabdas hlaiwa* 'Naved's grave'. Others do have longer inscriptions, e.g. KJ 75 from Kjøllevik, also in Rogaland: *NFMNNTFY TYNFXNTFY NTNFIPIDMFXMHTT hadulaikaz ekhagustadaz hlaiwidomaguminino* 'Handlac [lies here]. I, Haystald, buried my lad.'

73 Tveir 'ro ęins hęrjar, · tunga es hęfuðs bani;

[R 5r/7]

- 2 es męr i heðin hveęn · handar vęni.

Two belong to one host; the tongue is the head's bane;
in every cloak I expect a hand.

ALL | The tongue and head belong to the same body, but the former often leads to the demise of the latter, and thereby itself; it is best to be cautious with one's words. — This st. is most likely a later insert. It is composed in Speeches-meter (unlike all surrounding sts., which are in Leeds-meter), its style is unusual, and its content fits poorly in the context, which at this point in the poem has moved away from the theme of cautious speech.

1 Tveir 'ro ęins hęrjar 'Two belong to one host' | Lit. 'two are of one host'. — *hęrjar* is an inflected form of *hęrr* 'host, army', but its function is ambiguous; it can either be (1) the gen. sg., as adopted here, or (2) the nom. pl. 'harriers, raiders' (cf. *ęin-hęrjar* 'Oneharriers') which would translate as 'two are the destroyers of one', i.e., "the tongue and head often lead to the demise of the body".

1 tunga es höfuðs bani ‘the tongue is the head’s bane’ | Formulaic or proverbial. Cf. the Old Swedish “Heathen Law”, which describes how a duel should be conducted following an insult to a man’s honour (my norm. and trans. following Löffler (1879)): *Fallr þann orð haur givit—glópr orða verstr; tunga hövuð-bani—liggi í ú-gildum akri* ‘If he who has given the [insulting] word falls—mockery is the worst of words; the tongue the head-bane—may he lie in an unenclosed field.’

2 handar ‘a hand’ | Holding a dagger.

- 74 Nött verðr feginn, · sá’s nesti trúir,
 2 skammar ’ro skips ráar,
 hverf es haust-gríma;
 4 fjöld of viðrir · à fimm dögum,
 en meirr à mánaði.

[R 5r/8]

At night he rejoices who trusts in his provisions;
 short are the ship’s sail-yards;
 shifty is the stormy fall night.
 The winds blow far in five days;
 even more in a month.

ALL | It is best to rely on things in one’s control, here the provisions you carry with you when at sea (cf. sts. 11, 116). The man at the mercy of the forces of nature can never sleep safe and sound at night. — In ll. 3–4 two names of Weden, a notoriously fickle god (cf. st. 110), may be subtextually implied, and the st. may then also be taken as a warning against resigning one’s fate totally to the gods, who are perhaps not always fully trustworthy.

2 skammar ’ro skips ráar ‘short are the ship’s sail-yards’ | Also found in *Mbkv* 12/1a: *skips láta menn skammar ráar* ‘men say the ship’s sail-yards are short’ or ‘men make the ship’s sail-yards short.’ The sail-yards (ON *ráar*) are the arms on the mast from which the sails are set, but the sense of the l. is unclear and interpretations vary; for an overview see *Mbkv* 12 in SkP 3 and Evans (1986, pp. 110–111). In any case it would appear by the sense of ll. 3–5 that this l. should also refer to something untrustworthy; one suggestion is that during a shipwreck the man clinging onto the sail-yards would wish them longer.

3 haust-gríma ‘stormy fall night’ | Lit. ‘fall-mask’, a cpd. of *haust* ‘fall, autumn’ + *gríma* ‘mask’. The word paints an image of the dark cloudy evening or night-sky, the thick dusky clouds being the metaphorical ‘mask’. Cf. Weden’s names *Grímr* ‘Grime; Mask’, *Grímnir* ‘Grimner; the Masked One’ (*Grm* 47, 50).

4 fjöld of viðrir ‘The winds blow far’ | I.e., ‘the weather changes much’. ON (*of*) *viðra* is a causative verb derived from *veðr* ‘wind, storm’. Cf. Weden’s name *Viðrir* ‘Withrer; Stormer, Man of the Storm’, which is most likely an agent noun formed to the same verb.

4 fimm dögum ‘five days’ | I.e., ‘a week’ (which was originally five days long), paralleling ‘month’ in the next line. See note to st. 51 above.

- 75 Væt=a hinn, · es vêt=ki vêt,
 2 margr verðr af *au*rum api;
 maðr es auðigr, · annarr ò-auðigr,
 4 skyli=t þann vítká vðar.

[R 5r/10]

The one who knows nothing does not know:
 many a one is made an ape by silver.

A man is wealthy, another not wealthy;
one ought not to curse him for his woe.

2 af *au*rum ‘by silver’ | *emend. from meaningless †aflaðrom†* R

2 margr verðr af *au*rum api ‘many a one is made an ape by silver’ | Cf. *Sól* 34/4: *margan befr auðr apat* ‘wealth has made an ape of many a one’, which also lends support to the emendation in the line.

76 Deyr fé, · dęyja fręndr,
2 dęyr sјalfr hit sama;
 ęn orðs-tírr · dęyr aldri=gi
4 hvęim’s sér góðan getr.

[R 5r/12]

Kine die, kinsmen die,
oneself dies the same.
But a word-glory never dies
for whomever gets himself a good one.

ALL. | It is likely that sts. 76–77 concluded the original Guests’ Strand. This is supported internally by their tone of finality and their reflections on death, and externally by the fact that *Hákm* (composed ca. 961 CE) borrows the first line of its final stanza 21 (*dęyr fé · dęyja fręndr*) from their refrain. The sense of both stanzas is that the whole of man’s earthly power will pass away with him, but a good reputation, fame and glory, will linger on.

The idea of “undying fame”, as stressed in these two sts. through the repetition of *dęyr aldri=gi* ‘never dies’, is an ancient Indo-European conception. Similar expressions feature prominently in sources including Homer, the Greek lyric poets, the *RV*, and the Irish saga-cycles (West 2007, pp. 396–98, 406–10). The common idea is that of fame as a living entity, which can be bestowed or laid upon (but also flee from) a man, and which can linger on above the earth after his death. The same idea is expressed in numerous ways throughout the IE languages, but of particular note is the formulaic expression ‘imperishable fame’, which is found in both Vedic OI *śrávaḥ ... ākṣitam* (*RV* 1.9.7bc) and Greek κλέος ἀφθιτον (*Il* 9.413, et c.; a list of attestations is found in West 2007, p. 408). Since these two phrases are directly cognate, the ancestral PIE formula can be reconstructed as **k̑léwos ḡ·dʰǵʷitom* (West 2007, pp. 406–10; Watkins 1995, pp. 173–178).

1 fé ... fręndr ‘Kine ... kinsmen’ | In the early Germanic farming society a man’s wealth was reckoned in heads of cattle (note that the Norman loan-word *cattle* is itself the same word as *capital*) and his socio-political power by the number of able male kinsmen and friends ready to side with him in conflict (cf. sts. 62, 72 above). For Indo-European poetic analogues, cf. West (2007, pp. 99–100).

77 Deyr fé, · dęyja fręndr,
2 dęyr sјalfr hit sama;
 ek vęit ęinn · at aldri=gi dęyr:
4 dómr umb dauðan hvęrn.

[R 5r/13]

Kine die, kinsmen die,
oneself dies the same.
I know one that never dies:
the Doom o’er each man dead.

4 dómr ‘Doom’ | In ON this word otherwise means nothing other than ‘judgment’, but here it carries the unique sense ‘fame’. This latter sense should probably not be taken as a semantic development of the former, but rather as an independent reflex of the original sense of the PIE ancestor **dʰobʰ-mos* ‘thing put’, from the verbal root **dʰebʰ-* ‘to put, place, lay’ (Orel 2003, p. 73, Kroonen 2013, p. 98—though neither discuss the sense ‘fame’). In Greek and Indo-Iranian the root **dʰebʰ-* is in fact used formulaically with the object **kléwos* ‘fame’, which may be ‘laid’ on a man either by himself or the Gods (West 2007, pp. 397–98; Watkins 1995, pp. 177–78). Thereby, we may see in the semantic development from PIE **dʰobʰ-mos* ‘thing put’ > PGmc. **dōmaz* > ON *dómr* ‘fame’ a periphrastic expression or kenning standing in for the lost word PGmc. **blewaz* ‘fame’ (only attested in compound names like DR 12 Gallehus: *Hlewa-gastiz* ‘Leeguest’, i.e., ‘Fame-guest’), originally deriving from the Pre-Germanic equivalent of the formula **dʰebʰ- kléwos*.

Within Germanic, the sense ‘fame’ is also found in the cognates OE *dóm*, OS *dóm*, which are most often used to refer specifically to fame after death. In *Heli* the best example is ll. 3996b–4002a, especially 4001b–4002a: *þan lēbot ús þob duom after, / guod word for gumon* ‘Then our Doom will still remain afterwards, the good words for men’. In *Beow* there are several examples. The best is 1384–1389, where Bewolf consoles King Rothgar after Grendel’s mother has slain his trusted advisor Asher (*Æsc-heri*): *Ni sorgē snotr gumá! · Sólré bið óg-bwēm, / þet bé bis friond wreceð · þan bé felu murné. / Úser óg-bweli scēl · endi gi-bidan / wer-ældé libes; · wyrce sé þi móté / dómæs ár deaðé; · þet bið dryht-guman / un-libjendum · æfter sólist*. ‘Grieve not, O wise man! It is better for each that he avenge his friend than that he mourn for long. Each one of us shall suffer the end of life in this world. Let him who can win a Doom before death; that is for the unliving warrior afterwards the best.’ Other illustrative examples in *Beow* include 884b–887a: [...] *Sig-mundé gi-sprang / æfter deað-degðé · dóm un-lýtil, / siððan wiges bærd · wyrn á-cwaldé / bordæs hi’ndi* [...] ‘For Syemund sprang up after his death-day an unlittle [great] Doom, since he, hard in conflict, defeated the Wyrn, the keeper of the hoard’, and 953b–955a: [...] *þú þé selb bæbes / dædum gi-fremid · þet þin dóm libæð / áwá ti aldré, (...)* ‘Thou hast for thyself by deeds accomplished that thy Doom shall live for ever and ever’.

78 Fullar grindr · sák fyr Fitjungs sonum,

[R 5r/14]

- 2 nú bera þeir vānar vǫl;
svá es auðr · sēm auga-bragð,
4 hann es valtastr vīna.

Full pens I saw with Fitting’s sons;
now they bear the staff of want.
So is wealth like the blink of an eye:
it is the ficklest of friends.

ALL | Sts. 78–80 are poorly placed and seem quite like later inserts. 78–79 at least resemble the general content of the Guests’ Strand (although see 79/2 n.), but 80 is a true enigma.

1 Fullar grindr ‘Full pens’ | Filled with sheep or cattle.

1 Fitjungs sonum ‘Fitting’s sons’ | Wholly unknown figures, perhaps a reference to a long-lost old folk-tale?

2 vānar vǫl ‘the staff of want’ | A beggar’s staff.

3 sēm auga-bragð ‘like the blink of an eye’ | I.e., it may be gone in the blink of an eye.

79 Ó-snotr maðr · es ęigna-sk getr

[R 5r/16]

- 2 fē eða fljóðs mun-úð;
metnaðr hönnum þróa-sk, · ęn man-vit aldri=gi;

4 framm gęngr hann drjúgt i dul.

The unclever man who comes to own
money or a maid's loving grace:
his pride flourishes, but never his manwit;
he goes forth far in folly.

2 fljóðs 'maid' | The poem's first mention of the fair sex, which indicates that this st. does not in fact belong to the original Guests' Strand.

80 Þat 's þa ręynt, · es þú at rúnum spyrr,
2 hinum ręgin-kunnum,
þęim's gørðu ginn-ręgin
4 ok fáði Fimbul-þulr;
þa hęfr hann batst, ef hann þęgir.

[R 5r/18]

Proven is then what thou learnest from the runes
born of the Reins—
from those which the Yin-Reins made
and the Fimblethyle painted.
Then he has it best, if he shuts up.

ALL | This st. with its strange meter and its subject of runic magic does not fit well in its current place. It would have fit better in the Rune-Tally (*Háv* 138–146), with whose stanzas it also shares formulaic expressions. The last line with its shift in person is especially curious and possibly a later insert.

1–2 rúnum ... hinum ręgin-kunnum 'the runes born of the Reins' | 'Runes of Godly origin', namely through Weden's Self-Hanging (sts. 138–139 below). The expression is formulaic and very old, for it also appears on the ca. C5th Noleby stone (in the acc. sg. *rúnó ragina-kundó* 'a rune born of the Reins'); an undeniable proof of the antiquity of some of the runic lore preserved in Norse poetry. See also Index: rune. — *binum ręgin-kunnum* is unusual but need not be corrupt; cf. the similar form of *Hárþ* 4/2, 6/2, 13/3. Related is possibly the form of following a c-verse by another line that joins it in alliteration, so st. 61/5 above, *Ski*.

3–4 þęim's gørðu ginn-ręgin / ok fáði Fimbul-þulr 'those which the Yin-Reins made and the Fimblethyle painted' | Cf. st. 142 where these two lines occur almost identically, but in reverse order.

3 ginn-ręgin 'Yin-Reins' | The 'vast, broad Gods', a pantheistic word.

4 Fimbul-þulr 'Fimblethyle' | 'The great thyle', i.e., 'the great chanter', a name for Weden in his role as master of lore. For *þulr* 'thyle' cf. st. 111 below, *Vǫfþ* 9/4 n.

2. Scattered stanzas of practical advice (81–90)

The following stanzas are distinguished by a common subject matter (especially women, sts. 81, 82, 84, 86, 90) and style, and by a prevalence of Speeches-meter.

81 At kveldi skal dag lęyfa, · konu es bręnnð es,
2 męki es ręyndr es, · męy es gefin es,

[R 5r/20]

ís es yfir kómr, · ǫl es drukkit es.

By evening shall one praise a day, a woman when she is burned,
a sword when it is tried, a maiden when she is given,
ice when one comes over it, ale when it is drunk up.

ALL | Nothing shall be praised in advance since things often turn out differently than one may expect; the poet gives six examples.

2–3 konu ... mey ‘a woman ... a maiden’ | The mention of women marks a new section in *Háv*, since the Guests’ Strand proper (sts. 1–77), although certainly composed by a man for men (cf. esp. sts. 69, 72) steers entirely clear of the subject (but cf. st. 79). The perspective is clearly a man’s, and the theme of not trusting women continues throughout the rest of the poem.

1 brænd ‘burned’ | On the funeral pyre as ‘burned’ is here a neutral way of saying ‘dead’; cf. Introduction to the poem and st. 71/3 above.

2 mey es gefin ‘a maiden when she is given’ | A young unmarried woman’s chastity should not be praised until she has been given in marriage and is proven a virgin (*mét*).

- 82 Í vindi skal við höggva, · veðri á sé róa,
2 myrkri við man spjalla: · mǫrg ’ro dags augu;
á skip skal skriðar orka, · en á skjöld til hlífar,
4 mēki til höggs, · en mey til kossa.

[R 5r/22]

In wind shall one cut wood, in good weather row at sea,
in darkness speak with a maiden—many are the eyes of day.
A ship shall one have for speed and a shield for protection,
a sword for striking and a maiden for kisses.

ALL | Sts. 82–83 list various things or actions and their fitting place or context. They bear very close resemblance to the two OE poems titled *Maxims*, particularly *Maxims II*, and one is inclined to think that such lists were likely an important part of Proto-Germanic poetry.

1 veðri ‘good weather’ | The word *veðr* typically means ‘storm’, but that can hardly be the sense here.

- 83 Við ǣld skal ǫl drikka, · en á ísi skriða,
2 magran mar kaupá, · en mēki saurgan,
heima hest fēita, · en hund á búi.

[R 5r/24]

By fire shall one drink ale, but skate on ice,
buy a starved steed and a rusty sword,
fatten the horse at home and the hound on the farmstead.

2 mar ... mēki ‘steed ... sword’ | Formulaic pair, also occurring in *Lok* 12/1, *Vkv* 33/3, *Akv* 7/3.

3 heima hest fēita, · en hund á búi | The exact sense of this advice is unclear.

- 84 Męjar orðum · skyli mann=gi trúa,
2 né því’s kveðr kona;

[R 5r/26,
Thott 1768 4°
210r/22–210v/2]

- því't á hverfanda hvéli · vöru þeim hjörtu sköpuð,
4 brigð i brjóst of lagit.

A maiden's words should no man trust,
nor that which a woman speaks.
For on a whirling wheel their hearts were shaped,
fickleness laid in their breasts.

3 því't | *om.* 1768 3 vöru þeim hjörtu sköpuð 'their hearts were shaped' | er þeim hjarta skapat
'their heart is shaped' 1768 4 brigð | ok brigð 1768 4 lagit | lagin 1768

3–4 því't ... lagið | Quoted in slightly divergent form in *Fbr* (ms. Thott 1768 4°, fol. 210r–v),
where it is introduced with the words: *Kom bonum þá í bug kvíðlingr sá, er kveðinn hafði verit
um lausungar-konur:* 'And then he remembered the ditty which had been composed about loose
women.'

- 85 Bristanda boga, · brinnanda loga,
2 gínanda ulfi, · galandi kröku,
rýtanda svíni, · röt-lausum víði,
4 vaxanda vági, · vellanda katli,

[R 5r/28]

In bursting bow, in burning flame,
in yawning wolf, in crowing crow,
in roaring swine, in rootless tree,
in waxing wave, in boiling kettle,

ALL | Sts. 85–87 and 89 list a variety of things one should not trust. The things are a curious mix
of natural phenomena, animals, tools, and people and together give a vivid insight into the lifestyle
of Iron Age Norway.

- 86 fljúganda flęini, · fallandi böru,
2 ísi ęin-nétum, · ormi hring-legnum,
brúðar bæð-mólum · eða brotnu sverði,
4 bjarnar leiki · eða barni konungs,

[R 5r/30]

in flying spear, in falling billow,
in one-night old ice, in coiled-up serpent,
in bride's bed-speech, or in broken sword,
in bear's play, or in king's child,

4 eða | †eð† R

- 87 sjúkum kalfi, · sjalf-ráða þréli,
2 völu vil-męli, · val ný-fældum.

[R 5r/32]

in sick calf, in self-willing thrall,
in wallow's pleasing speech, in newly felled corpses,

2 völu vil-méli 'in wallow's pleasing speech' | I.e., in a too favourable prophecy (spae).

- 89 **bróður-bana** sīnum · þótt á **brautu** móti, [R 5v/2]
 2 **húsi** half-brunnu, · **hęsti** al-skjótum,
 þá 's **jór** ó-nýtr, · ef **ęinn** fót brotnar;
 4 verðr-it maðr svá **trygg**r · at þęssu trúi ęllu!
 in one's brother's bane though on the road ye meet,
 in half-burned house, in all-fleet horse—
 the steed is useless if one foot breaks.
 No man will be so trusting that he trust in all this!

ALL | The numbering of the sts. in the pres. ed. follows **R**, where sts. 88, 89 come in the reversed order from how they are printed here. They have been reversed as it seems apparent from its Speeches-meter meter and the dative case of the words that 89 should follow 87, and with its last line it nicely concludes the sequence begun in 85–87. On the other hand st. 88 with its Leeds-meter meter and self-enclosed form seems to be a separate composition; it has probably been inserted after 87 due to its first line (*akri ár-sónum* 'In an early sown field'), which in the dat. sg. superficially resembles the structure of 85–87, 89.

- 88 **Akri** ár-sónum · trúi **ęngi** maðr, [R 5r/33]
 2 né til **snimma** syni;
 veðr rēðr akri, · **ęn** vit syni;
 4 **hętt** es þęira **hvárt**.
 In an early sown field ought no man to trust,
 nor too soon in a son.
 The weather rules the field and the wits the son:
 there is risk to them both.

- 90 Svá 's **friðr** kvinna · þęira's **flátt** hyggja, [R 5v/4]
 2 sęm **aki** **jó** ó-bryddum · á ísi **hólum**
 tęitum, **tvę**-vetrum · ok **sęi** **tamr** illa,
 4 **ęða** ĩ **byr** óðum · **bęiti** stjórñ-lausu,
 ęða skyli **haltr** **hęnda** · **hręin** ĩ þá-fjalli.
 So is the love of those women who falsely think
 like one rode an unshod horse on slippery ice—
 a wild one, two winters old and ill-tamed—
 or in mad wind tacked a rudderless ship,
 or a halt man should catch a reindeer on a thawing fell.

5 ĩ þá-fjalli 'on a thawing fell' | I.e., in springtime, when the melting ice on the ground is most slippery.

3. Weden's tryst with Billing's daughter (91–102)

The following two sections (sts. 91–102 and 103–110), which may be called Weden's love-adventures, are united by their narrative style, their composition in Leeds-meter, and their content; together they constitute a clear sub-poem within *Háv.* Properly, sts. 91–94 do not belong to the first adventure, but instead introduces the whole sub-poem. Both episodes (sts. 95–102, 103–110) describe Weden's romantic adventures in the first person, the first seeing the god be the victim of deception, the second seeing him as the deceiver. Their complementary and highly symmetrical structure has been shown well by McKinnell (2005), whose structural analysis is generally followed here, although his inclusion of st. 84 in the introduction is not considered since 91 is thought to provide a natural introduction to both sections. Like the two human sexes, the two adventures form a complementary pair. Each one begins with a reflecting, gnomic stanza (95, 103), has 6 central narrative stanzas (96–101, 104–109), and concludes with a final stanza reflecting on the situation as a whole (102, 110). Sts. 95–102 describe how Weden, a man, is deceived by Billing's daughter, a woman, while in 103–110 the roles are reversed and it is Weden who deceives the woman, Guthlathe.

The two adventures are introduced by the 4 general gnomic stanzas about love and sexual relations (91–94) which properly do not belong to the first adventure, although they are here included under it. 91 describes how men can be just as fickle and dishonest towards women as women towards men, setting up the two symmetrical episodes. This theme is continued in st. 92. 93–94 go on to describe the folly of love, and how even the wisest often fall victim to it.

The first adventure (sts. 95–102) begins with a gnomic stanza setting up the episode by detailing the danger and loneliness of forbidden or unreciprocated love (95). Sts. 96–101 describe how Weden was falsely promised a night with Billing's daughter. She instead summoned a mob, and when he returned in the morning, she had tied a bitch to the bed as a last insult. St. 102 concludes with the statement that many good women are fickle towards men. The underlying myth—if one existed—is completely unknown, and Billing and his daughter are not known from any other source (for the name *Billing* cf. 97/1 n.) Attempts to connect the myth to natural phenomena or later heroic ballads have not been convincing.

- 91 **B**ert nú mǣli'k, · því't **b**ǣði veit'k,
 2 brigðor es karla hugr **k**onum,
 þá **f**ęgrst mǣlum, · es flást hyggjum;
 4 þat tǣlir **h**orska **h**ugi.

[R 5v/7]

Plainly I now speak, for I know them both:
 fickle are men's minds towards women.
 Fairest we speak when falsest we think;
 that entraps sharp minds.

1 bæði ‘them both’ | The natures of both sexes; *bæði* is neutr. pl., which in ON is used for mixed-sex groups. The poet, a man (cf. sts. 69, 81) declares that he will not attack the fair sex unfairly; he is also aware of men’s faults. This sets up the balanced structure of the following two sections (see above).

3 fegrst mælum ... flást hyggjum ‘Fairest we speak ... falsest we think;’ | Formulaic word-pair. Cf. st. 45.

4 þat tælir horska hugi ‘that entraps sharp minds’ | Love (or sexual infatuation—the poet does not distinguish between them) turns even wise men into liars or otherwise dishonest persons. Cf. *Mbkv* 20/1–2, which is probably partly based on this stanza: *Óst-blindir ‘ro seggir svá · sumir, at þykkja mjök fás gá; // þannig verðr um man-söng mælt: · marga befr þat hyggna tælt.* ‘Some men are so love-blind that they seem to heed very little; // for that sake it is said about love-song: many thinking men has it entrapped.’

- 92 **F**agrt skal mæla · ok **fé** bjóða, [R 5v/9]
 2 sá’s vill fljóðs öst fæa,
 líki leyfa · hins ljósa mans,
 4 sá fær, es fríar.
 Fairly shall he speak and offer money,
 whoso will win a lady’s love:
 praise the body of the bright girl—
 he wins, who woos.

1 Fagrt skal mæla ‘Fairly shall he speak’ | Formulaic. Cf. st. 45.

4 sá fær, es fríar ‘he wins, who woos’ | Only he who courts her will win her hand.

- 93 **A**star firna · skyli engi maðr
 2 annan aldri=gi;
 opt fæa á horskan, · es á hẽmskan né fæa,
 4 lost-fagrir litir.
 Over love should no man
 ever upbraid another;
 oft they seize the sharp when they seize not the foolish,
 the lust-fair hues.

4 lost-fagrir litir ‘lust-fair hues’ | A woman with a countenance so beautiful that men cannot help but lust after her.

- 94 **E**y-vitar firna, · es maðr annan skal, [R 5v/12]
 2 þess es of margan gengr guma;
 hẽmska ór horskum · gerir hõlða sonu
 4 sá hinn mott=ki munr.
 In no way shall man blame another
 for that which happens to many a man;

from sharp to fools are the sons of men
made by this mighty thing, love.

3 horskum | *gramm. emend.*; horskan (*m. acc. sg.*) R

- 95 Hugn ęinn þat vęit, · es býr hjarta nér, [R 5v/14]
2 ęinn es hann sér umb sęfa;
 ęng es sótt verri · hvęim snotrum manni
4 an sér ęngu at una.

The mind alone knows what dwells close to the heart;
it is alone with its thoughts.
No sickness is worse for each clever man
than with nothing to be content.

1 Hugn ‘The mind’ | ON *hugr* refers to the seat of emotions in the breast, which English “mind” does not entirely capture. Normally it could be translated by English “heart”, but since the present stanza uses *hjarta* ‘heart’ to refer specifically to the organ that would be very confusing for the reader.

- 96 Þat þá ręynda’k, · es ĩ ręyri sat’k, [R 5v/16]
2 ok vętta’k mĳns munar,
 hold ok hjarta · vas mér hin horska męr,
4 þęy=gi hana at hęldr hęf’k.

That I found out when I sat in the reeds
and awaited my love.
My own flesh and heart that sharp maiden was—
I have her none the more.

- 97 Billings męy · ek fann bęðjum á [R 5v/18]
2 sól-hvĳta sofa;
 jarls ynði · þótti mér ękki vesa
4 nema við þat lik at lifa.

Billing’s maiden I found on the beds,
sun-white, asleep.
An earl’s pleasure seemed me naught to be,
save living alongside that body.

1 Billings ‘Billing’s’ | An unidentified dwarf or ettin. In the **H** manuscript of *Vǫp* 13 Billing appears as a dwarf, and he may also be mentioned on the cryptic C9th Malt runestone (SJy 38): **bilikr** (error for ***bilikr** *Billingr*?). He also appears in a Scaldic kenning for **POETRY** (*Ormr Woman* 2, SkP 3: *full burar Billings* ‘the cup of Billing’s son’), but this does not narrow down his identity since he is merely standing in as a generic **DWARF/ETIN** (Meissner 1921, p. 428). Support for his being an ettin is found in the fact that his name is clearly similar to Gilling, an ettin who plays a part in the story of the Mead of Poetry (see introduction to sts. 103–110 below), and that a god lusting for a dwarf-maiden (to the degree they even exist) is a nonexistent motif, whereas the gods very frequently desire the daughters of the ettins (most famously in *Ski*).

1 mēy ‘maiden’ | I.e., unmarried (virgin) daughter.

[Billings mēr:] 98 „Auk nēr aptni · skalt Óðinn koma,
2 ef vilt þér mēla man,
allt eru ó-sköpp, · nema ęin vitim
4 s·líkan lōst saman.“ [R 5v/20]

[Billing’s maiden:] “And by evening shalt thou, Weden, come,
if thou wilt win for thee the girl [me]!
The Shapes are all evil if we two alone might not know
such a vice together.”

3 allt eru ó-sköpp ‘The Shapes are all evil’ | Lit. ‘the evil Shapes are everything’, that is ‘the Shapes (i.e., fates, destinies) are all awry’. See Index: shape.

99 Aptr ek hvarf · ok unna þótt=umk
2 vísun vilja frá;
hitt ek hugða, · at hafa mynda’k
4 gēð hennar allt ok gaman. [R 5v/22]
Back I turned, and thought myself in love,
away from my wise will,
yet I thought that I would have
her senses all, and pleasure.

2 vísun vilja frá ‘away from my wise will’ | I.e., ‘against my better judgment’. The wise choice would have been to walk away, rather than fall into the girl’s trap.

100 Svá kom’k nēst, · at hin nýta vas
2 víg-drótt ęll of vakin,
með brinnęndum ljósum · ok bornum viði,
4 svá vas mér víl-stígr of vitaðr. [R 5v/23]
So next I came when the useful
war-troop was all awake
with burning lights and brandished clubs;
so for me a sad path was marked.

1 nýta ‘useful’ | Sarcastic. Billing’s daughter has summoned a lynch mob.

3 bornum viði ‘brandished clubs’ | Lit. ‘with carried wood’.

4 vil-stígr ‘sad path’ | Ambiguous, referring either to the beating he would have received at the hands of the mob, or to his walk of shame away from the hall. The latter is perhaps more likely.

101 Auk nér morni, · es vas’k ɛnn of kominn,

[R 5v/25]

2 þá vas sal-drótt of sofin;

grɛy ɛitt þá fann’k · hinnar góðu konu

4 bundit beðjum á.

And by morning when I had come again,
then was the hall-troop asleep.

A lone bitch I then found, by that good woman
bound upon the beds.

1 Auk nér morni ‘And by morning’ | Mirroring the beginning of st. 97 above.

3 grɛy ɛitt ‘A lone bitch’ | The insult is clearly understood; Weden is likened to a horny dog and mockingly asked to relieve his desire on the bitch instead of Billing’s daughter—‘this is all you get, you dog!’

3 góðu ‘good’ | Perhaps not sarcastic, but rather referring to her chastity; cf. 102/1.

102 Mǫrg es góð mǣr, · ef gǫrva kannar,

[R 5v/27]

2 hug-brigð við hali;

þá þat rɛynda’k, · es hit ráð-spaka

4 rɛygðá’k á flérðir fljóð;

hóðungar hvęrrar · lęitaði mǣr hit horska man

6 ok hafða’k þęss vętt=ki* vífs.

Many a good maiden—if one comes to know her well—
is heart-fickle towards men.

I found that out when the counsel-wise
lady I lured into sins;
every disgrace that sharp girl sought out for me,
and I had naught of the woman.

6 vętt=ki* | vęttkis R

1 góð mǣr ‘good maiden’ | The ‘goodness’ here likely refers to faithfulness and chastity. Cf. *Ski* 12.

4. Weden’s theft of the Mead of Poetry (103–110)

Sts. 103–110 contain Weden’s second love adventure in *Háv* and deals with his theft of the Mead of Poetry from the ettin Sutting and his daughter Guth-lathe.

Unlike the previous adventure (sts. 95–102), the underlying myth of this one is very well known and merits more extensive discussion. The main source for the narrative is *Skm* 5–6, which may be summarized as follows, with minor details left out:

Chapter 5:

After the war between the Eese and the Wanes (cf. *Vsp* 22–23), the two tribes reconcile through spitting into a vat. Not wanting to discard this token of their truce, they instead make a man out of the spit and call him Quasher (*Kvasir*). He is so wise that he can answer any question posed to him, and so he travels around the world in order to share his learning with men.

Quasher eventually comes to the dwelling of two dwarfs, Fealer and Galer (*Fjalarr ok Galarr*). They kill him and drain his blood into three vessels: the two vats Soon (*Són*) and Bothem (*Boðn*), and the cauldron Woderearner (*Óð-rórir*). They mix the blood with honey, and from the mixture they brew a mead which will make whomever drinks from it a *skald* *œða fróða-maðr* ‘a scald or man of learning’. The dwarfs lie to the Eese about the murder, telling them that Quasher drowned in his own wisdom for a lack of good questions.

Some time later, the dwarfs murder the ettin Gilling (*Gillingr*) and his wife. Gilling’s son, Sutting (*Suttungr*), learns of this and prepares to drown the dwarfs. In exchange for their lives and as weregild for Sutting’s parents, the dwarfs offer him the *mjóð’inn dýra* ‘dear mead’ (cf. sts. 105 and 140). Sutting accepts the payment and brings the mead home with him. He places his daughter Guthlathe (*Gunn-lqð*) in a cave to guard it.

Chapter 6:

Weden is wandering through the world when he finds nine thralls mowing hay. He lends them aid by sharpening their scythes with a special whetstone, and they now cut much faster. He throws the whetstone into the air and the greedy thralls fight to the death over it, leaving none alive. By evening Weden comes to their master, Baye (*Baugi*), Sutting’s brother. Baye laments the death of his workmen, and so Weden, calling himself Baleworker (*Ból-verkr* ‘evil-doer’), offers to do their work over the summer in exchange for one drink of the mead. Baye tells the disguised god that Sutting alone owns the mead, but that he will accompany him to Sutting’s to ask.

In fall, the two arrive at Sutting’s, who as expected refuses to give any part of the mead away. Weden then tells Baye that he will get to it anyway. He takes out the drill Wrate (*Rati*) and tells Baye to drill through the mountains into the cave where the mead is stored. Baye first attempts to trick him by only drilling halfway through, but eventually creates a narrow passage. Weden turns himself into a snake and crawls through it; as he does, Baye tries to strike him with the drill, but misses. On the other side, Weden finds Guthlathe watching over the mead. She is taken by him, and promises him three sips of the mead in exchange for sleeping with her for three nights. Weden sleeps with her and then takes his reward. With each sip he swallows the contents of one of the three vessels, so that all the mead ends up in his belly.

Having drunk the mead, he dons his eagle-hame and flies away from the mountain. Sutting sees him, takes on his own eagle-hame, and gives chase. The Eese see the chase overhead and set out several large vats on the ground, into which Weden, still flying, spits out the mead. At this point Sutting has almost caught up with him, and so Weden in eagle-form “sends back” (*senda aptr*, viz. from behind) some of the mead, presumably into Sutting’s face. The text does not say, but it seems likely that Sutting crashes down and dies.

After the chase is over and Weden is back he distributes the mead. That part caught in the three vats is given to the Eese and to *heim mǫnnum*, *er yrkja kunnu* ‘those men who can compose verse’, but the portion which was “sent back” becomes the *skald-fífla blutr* ‘lot of poet-fools’.

Surprisingly, the narrative core of this longwinded myth appears to go back at least as far as the Bronze Age. A close parallel is found in the Vedic myth of the origin of the psychoactive ritual drink *sóma*, which in Vedic mythology is also a god (*Sóma*) in its own right. The earliest version of that story is found in the two hymns *RV* 4.26–27, which tell how *Sóma* is held inside ‘a hundred bronze forts’ (4.27.1c: *ṣatám púras āyasis*) by the archer *Kṛṣānu*, before being stolen by the sweeping, mighty Eagle who brings it to *Mānu*, the first human sacrificer and ancestor of the Aryans. The guardian *Kṛṣānu* does not himself give chase, but shoots his arrows at the Eagle, missing.

Later Vedic texts clearly identify the Eagle with *Agní* (the god of fire), specifically in his form as the *gāyatrí* meter (Bloomfield 1896). One text in particular (*AB* 3.25–27) is interesting in its etiological function: “What (the *gāyatrí*) seized with her right foot, that became the morning pressure (*prātaḥ-savanam*). ... What she seized with her left foot became the noon pressure (*mādhyaṃdinam savanam*). ... What she seized became the third pressure (*trtīyam savanam*).” (Bloomfield 1896, p. 6). I may here note that Bloomfield in the same article offers a naturalistic explanation of the myth, which may be of interest since such explanations are much more rarely encountered for Norse myths: the Eagle is *Agní* in the form of lightning, who shoots forth “from the womb of the cloud; as the lightning shoots from the cloud, the heavenly fluid, the Soma, streams down upon the earth.”

The close relation between the Norse and Vedic origin myths for the sacred drink may be explained in two ways: through common inheritance from the Indo-Europeans, or through Iranian steppe influence, which may have taken place as late as the Migration Period (probably by way of the Sarmatians, cf. the originally Iranian loanword “path” which must have entered Germanic after Grimm’s Law, Kroonen (2013, p. 396)). It should here be said that linguistic and botanical facts preclude the Indo-Iranian *sóma* cult’s being originally Indo-European; it instead appears to have been borrowed in the late 3rd millennium BCE from the Central Asian Bactria-Margian Archaeological Complex or BMAC (Lubotsky 2001, pp. 3–4, 6).

The original Proto-Indo-European sacred Drink was probably the Drink of Undying (OI *a-mṛta*, Greek ἀμβροσία < PIE **h₂-mṛtós* ‘undying, immortal’; Greek νέκ-τᾱρ ‘death-overcoming’), which in the Greek mythology is brought to Ζεύς (Zeús) by doves (*Od* 12.62–63: πέλειαι τρήρωνες, ταί τ’ ἀμβρο-

σὴν Διὶ πατρὶ φέρουσιν ‘the trembling doves which bring ambrosia to Father Zeus’) and in the Irish mythology was brewed for the Gods (OIr. *Tuath Dé* or *Tuatha Dé Danann*) by the smith *Goibniu* (Dobbs 1929, p. 193; MacKillop 1998, p. 228).

It seems probable from the Greek, Norse, and Irish attestations that this bird-brought Drink was originally mythological and believed to be the mystery behind the immortality of the Gods. In this vein it would likely have been invoked in the symbolic poetic language of the ritual toasts drunk by the PIE chieftains (probably originally consisting of fermented honey-wine—mead).

It was in the Indo-Iranian tradition that this symbolic language, together with the myth of the eagle stealing it from the mountains, was uniquely integrated into the borrowed cult of the *sóma*, for which *a-mṛta* ‘undying’ became a poetic epithet (e.g. *RV* 5.2.3c). Perhaps unlike the earlier alcoholic drinks, this one was believed to really make its human drinkers immortal, as famously seen in the ecstatic *RV* 8.48.3: *Á-pāma sómam, a-mṛtā a-bhūma, / á-ganma jyótir, á-vidāma dēvān. / Kim nūnām asmān kṛṇavad árāṭiḥ / kim u d’būrtir a-mṛta mártiyasya?* ‘We have drunk the soma; we have become immortal; we have gone to the light; we have found the gods. What can hostility do to us now, and what the malice of a mortal, o immortal one?’

Having briefly discussed the non-Norse parallels to the relevant myth, we may now turn to its form in the present stanzas, and how this differs from *Skm* and other Norse poetry. To begin with, the biggest difference between the treatment of the myth in *Skm* 5–6 and *Háv* 103–110 is that the present stanzas are very allusive; far from being a linear retelling of events, the narrative thread is actually quite difficult to follow, especially without the help of *Skm*.

Notably, the Eagle, one of the key details shared between *Skm* and the Vedic hymns, is not found in *Háv*. Other important *Skm* elements, like Quasher, the two dwarfs, and Baye, are also missing. It is thus clear that Snorre’s narrative cannot be exclusively based on *Háv*, but must in addition rely either on other, now-lost sources, or on his own imagination. That the former hypothesis is the correct one is proven by the large number of kennings for POETRY found in the Scaldic corpus, which hint at a similar narrative to that told in *Skm* 5–6, yet predate that text (ca. 1220 CE) by up to four centuries.

Scaldic kennings reference the following details from *Skm* not found in *Háv* (Meissner 1921, pp. 427–430; all citations from SkP):

- The draining of Quasher’s blood (Eskál Vell 1: *Kvasis dreyra* ‘Quasher’s blood [POETRY]’);
- The ransom of the two dwarfs (Eyy Hál 1: *gjöld Gillings* ‘the payments for Gilling [POETRY]’, Anon (*SnE*) 1: *seín-fyrnð skip dverga* ‘the late forgotten ships of dwarfs [POEMS]’);
- Weden’s companion Baye (Egill Arkv 22: *söku-nautr Sónar hvinna* ‘adversary of the thieves of Soon <mythical vat> [= Weden and Baye

(*Bauga* (gen. sg.) = *bauga* (gen. pl.) ‘rings’) > GENEROUS MAN]—this kenning is not mentioned by Meissner due to his reliance on an earlier ed.);

- The theft by the Eagle (Egill *Berdr* 1: *qrð arnar kjapta* ‘produce of the eagle’s beak [POETRY]’);
- And its “sending back” of a certain part of the mead (Þstf Lv 3: *lęirr ara ins gamla* ‘dung of the ancient eagle [BAD POETRY]’).

On the other hand there are elements found in *Háv* 103–110 which do not appear in *Skm* 5–6. The focus of *Háv* is squarely on Weden’s visit to (and particularly his betrayal of) Sutting and his daughter Guthlathe, and the emphasis *Háv* places on Weden’s *betrayal* contrasts sharply with the transactional and seemingly unemotional three-night affair in *Skm*. It is possible that the version of the myth underlying *Háv* even saw Weden marry Guthlathe, receiving the mead as a dowry. A marriage between them is supported by the unique legal expression *bins bindra dags* (st. 109), and would explain Weden’s broken oath (110), which is not mentioned in *Skm*. The recipient of the oath may even have been Sutting, the father of the bride himself, as suggested by the description of him as *svikvinn* ‘betrayed’ and by the possibility that he hosted a banquet for Weden (110). An internal problem with that idea is that Weden is still said to have had to bore through the mountains (107), presumably to reach Guthlathe, in which case it comes off as unlikely that he would *then* have asked Sutting for her hand, rather than have sworn the oath to her, before or after seducing her then-and-there in her chamber. Further, the betrayer of Sutting need not be Weden directly but could of course also be Guthlathe, who broke her father’s trust when she gave away the mead. See further notes to the individual stanzas.

Two other motifs to be considered with regard to Weden’s dealings with Guthlathe are the beautiful ettin’s daughter coveted by a god (cf. Billing’s maiden above, Gird in *Ski*, and Rind in Saxo Grammaticus, *Vsp* 31 n.) and the horny ettin’s daughter who attempts to seduce a young hero (cf. *HHj* P6–30).

Háv 103–110 begin with some social advice (103), after which the narrative is retold in non-linear fashion by Weden himself. He visits Sutting’s home, but does not receive a good reception (104). Guthlathe falls in love with him and gives him a drink of the Mead, for which he cruelly repays her (105). In order to get to her chamber Weden has to bore through the mountains with the drill Wrate (106). Weden has “bought” the Mead “well”; probably a euphemistic reference to sleeping with Guthlathe for it, and given it to mankind (107). Weden slept with Guthlathe and worries that he would not have made it out alive without her aid (108). “The following day” a group of Rime-Thurses come to Weden’s hall to ask him whether Baleworker (presumably the name he gave Guthlathe) is among the Gods or whether he has been slain by Sutting (109). Weden, talking about himself in the third person, answers that he “thinks” that Weden has sworn an oath, but that his words cannot be trusted; after the simble he betrayed Sutting and made Guthlathe weep (110).

- 103 Heima glaðr gumi · ok við gæsti reifr, [R 5v/30]
 2 sviðr skal umb sik vesa;
 minnigr ok mólugr, · ef vill marg-fróðr vesa;
 4 opt skal góðs geta;
 fimbul-fambi heitir, · sá's fátt kann segja;
 6 þat es ósnotrs aðal.

At home shall man be glad and giving with his guest,
 wise about himself.
 Of good memory and speech if he wishes to be many-learned;
 oft shall he speak of good.
 A fimble-fool is he called who can say little;
 that is the unclever man's nature.

- 104 Hinn aldna jötun sóttá'k, · nú em'k aprt of kominn; [R 5v/33]
 2 fátt gat'k þegjandi þar;
 mǫrgum orðum · mēlta'k ĩ minn frama
 4 ĩ Suttungs solum.

The old ettin [= Sutting] I sought out; now am I come back;
 I got little hearing there.
 Many words I spoke to my furtherance,
 in the halls of Sutting.

- 105 Gunn-løð mér of gaf · gollnum stóli á [R 6r/2]
 2 drykk hins dýra mjaðar;
 ill ið-gjöld · lét'k hana ęrtir hafa
 4 síns hins hęila hugar,
 síns hins svára sefa.

Guthlathe gave me on the golden throne
 a drink of the dear mead;
 evil recompense I let her have afterwards,
 for her whole heart,
 for her heavy affection.

2 drykk hins dýra mjaðar 'a drink of the dear mead' | The same expression appears in *Skm* 5 and in st. 140/3 below.

- 106 Rata munn · lét=umk rúms of fāa [R 6r/4]
 2 ok umb grjót gnaga;
 yfir ok undir · stóðu=mk jötna vegir,
 4 svá hętta'k hǫfði til.

Wrate's mouth I made to bring me room
 and gnaw its way through the rocks.
 Above and below me stood the roads of ettins [MOUNTAINS];
 so I risked my head.

1 Rata 'Wrate's' | According to *Skm* 6 (see above), *Rati* 'Wrate' was the drill used by Weden to bore through the mountain into the room where Guthlathe sat over the mead. The etymology of this term is uncertain (cf. Ásgeir Blöndal Magnússon 1989, s.v. *rati*), but if it is a cognate with Old Danish *vråde* 'to rummage, bore' then this would be an instance of alliteration between old *vr-* and *r-*, suggesting a later date for Weden's love adventures than the Guests' Strand (cf. sts. 26/2, 32/2). On the other hand, if *Rati* is derived from the verb *rata* (5/1, 18/1), the present instance is non-diagnostic.

107 Vəl keypts *blutar* · hef'k vəl notit;
 2 fās es fróðum vant;
 því't Óð·rórir · es nú upp kominn
 4 á alda vés jaðar.

[R 6r/6]

The well bought thing have I used well;
 little do the learned lack,
 for Woderearer has now come upon
 the rim of the wigh of men [= Middenyard].

1 *blutar* 'thing' | *litar* 'hue/colour' R

ALL | Weden has made good use of the Mead of Poetry by bringing it to the realm of men where those with skill and wisdom may now enjoy it.

1 Vəl keypts *blutar* 'The well bought thing' | The Mead of Poetry, which was "well bought" in that the price Weden paid for it was three nights with Guthlathe, who should likely be thought of as very beautiful.

3 Óð·rórir 'Woderearer' | One of the vessels in with the Mead of Poetry was held (see introduction to sts. 103–110 above), here standing as a *pars pro toto* for all the Mead.

4 jaðar 'rim' | metr. emend.; *jaðar* R has a long root-syllable, and does not fit grammatically.

108 Ifi 's mér á, · at véra'k enn kominn
 2 jøtna gørdum ór,
 ef Gunn·laðar né nytta'k, · hinnar góðu konu,
 4 es lögð=umk arm yfir.

[R 6r/8]

I harbour doubt that I would yet have come
 out of the yards of the Ettins,
 if I had not made use of Guthlathe, that good woman
 over whom I laid my arm.

1 Ifi 's mér á 'I harbour doubt' | Lit. 'There is doubt upon me'.

4 es lögð=umk arm yfir 'over whom I laid my arm' | Cf. *Lok* 20/4 (*lagðir lér yfir*).

- 109 Hins hindra dags · gingu hrīm-þursar
 2 Hóva ráðs at fregna, · Hóva hollu ĩ,
 at Ból-verki spurðu, · ef véri með bõndum kominn
 4 eða hefði hõnum Suttungr of sóit.

[R 6r/9]

The following day the Rime-Thurses went
 to ask for the High One's counsel, in the High One's hall.
 About Baleworker they asked, whether he had come into the midst of the
 Bonds,
 or if Sutting had slain him.

1 Hins hindra dags ‘The following day’ | This is the only occurrence of the comparative *bindra* ‘following, next’ in the whole Old Norse-Icelandic corpus. The superlative *bindstr* ‘last, final’ does occur (e.g. *indsta sinni* ‘the last time’, with loss of the *b-*; see CV: *bindri*), and the possible derivative *bindar-dags* ‘day after tomorrow, two days after’ is found twice, both times in the *Gula*, chh. 37 and 266. In the broader Scandinavian sphere, however, we find in the Swedish provincial laws an exact equivalent of the present phrase, namely OSwe. *bindra-dagber*, a law-word referring specifically to the ‘day after the wedding night’, used both on its own and in the expression *bindra-dags gief* ‘morning gift’ (LMNL). If ‘the day after the wedding night’ is in fact the sense of *bindra dagr* in the present stanza, two interpretations are possible: (1) Weden refers sarcastically to the day after he slept with Guthlathe, as would be done during the wedding night. (2) Weden actually married, or promised to marry, Guthlathe. The latter interpretation may find further support in the “bigh-oath” of st. 110, but Guthlathe is never referred to in any surviving Norse sources as Weden’s wife, only his lover (Steinþ Frag 1 (SkP 3)).

3 bõndum ‘the Bonds’ | The Gods.

- 110 Baug-ęið Óðinn · hyggt at unnit hafi,
 2 hvat skal hans tryggðum trúa?
 Suttung svikvinn · hann lét sumbli frá
 4 ok gróttu Gunn-lõðu.

[R 6r/12]

A bigh-oath I judge that Weden has sworn—
 how shall one trust his truces?
 Leaving the simble, he left Sutting betrayed
 and Guthlathe brought to tears.

ALL | The exact narrative referred to in the stanza is hard to pin down. One possibility is that Weden swore an oath on a bigh (an arming) to marry Guthlathe; Sutting then hosted a banquet (simble) for the couple (cf. *bins bindra dags* in st. 109), and Weden slept with her and then stole the mead. The mention of Sutting as betrayed could however also be a reference to Guthlathe’s betrayal of him, so that the sense is that Weden left both the father and daughter upset and weeping: the father furious over the loss of his mead and the harlotry of his daughter, the daughter heartbroken over the flight of her false lover.

5. The Speeches of Loddfathomer (111–137)

The so-called **Speeches of Loddfathomer** (ON *Loddfáfnismól*) is a series of advice stanzas addressed to Loddfathomer, an otherwise unknown figure

who is clearly fictional. His name is a compound of *lodd-*, apparently related to ON *loddari* ‘juggler, tramp’, OE *loddere* ‘pauper, beggar’ + *Fáfnir* ‘Fathomer’, literally ‘embracer’, the name of the famous gold-hoarding wyrm. The name thus paints the picture of an archetypal greedy fool in desperate need of the wisdom taught by Weden, his intellectual superior.

Loddfathomer reappears in st. 164, which reveals that the galders of 147–165 are also addressed to him, but he is not found outside of *Háv*. If he belongs to a lost mythological or legendary episode he most likely played a similar role to King Heathric in *Heiðr* 10 or the ettin Webthrithner in *Vafþ*, namely as an arrogant challenger of Weden’s wisdom soon bested by him.

The content of the advice in this section is generally similar and sometimes identical to that found in the Guests’ Strand (1–79), but the focus is not identical. We here find items of a superstitious or religious nature (e.g. 113–114, 126, 129, 137) and advice regarding women (113–115, 118, 130, 131/5), both topics the Guests’ Strand proper entirely avoids.

Most stanzas (112, 113, 115–117, 119–122, 125–132, 133–135, 137) are introduced by a repeated three-line refrain (*stef*) of type *abcc*.

111 Mál ’s at þylja · þular stóli á;

[R 6r/14]

2 Urðar brunni at
sá’k ok þagða’k, · sá’k ok hugða’k,
4 hlýdda’k á manna mál;
umb rúnar heyrða’k dóma, · né umb rǫðum þogðu
6 Hǫva hǫllu at,
Hǫva hǫllu i
8 heyrða’k sǣgja svá:

It is time to chat upon the thyle’s throne.

At the Well of Weird

I saw and I shut up; I saw and I thought;

I listened to the matters of men.

Of runes I heard them speak, nor did they shut up their counsel,

at the High One’s hall,

in the High One’s hall,

I heard them say so:

1 Mál | *The body of the M takes up a single line in height, but the right leg curves down to the line below; the letter is noticeably thicker than the capitals introducing individual sts., yet smaller than the initials introducing separate poems in R.*

ALL | This stanza serves as an internal framing device and introduces the section.

1 þylja ‘chant’ | The verb corresponding to *þulr* ‘thyle’.

1 þular ‘thyle’ | The reciter, chanter of ancient lore. See Index.

112 Rǫð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · at rǫð nemir,
2 njóta munt ef nemr,

[R 6r/17]

- þér munu góð ef getr:
 4 nött þú rís=at, · nema à njósn séir,
 eða leitir þér innan út staðar.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer, that thou learn the counsels;
 thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
 they will be good for thee if thou gettest:
 Rise not at night unless thou be scouting
 or looking to ease thyself outside.*

1 Rǫð=umk 'I counsel' | The use of the reflexive is unusual. It may derive from a hypercorrection of 1pl. pres. ind. *rǫðum*, which is not uncommonly used in a singular sense in poetry.

5 leitir þér innan út staðar 'looking to ease thyself outside' | Lit. 'looking for thy place outside'. To *leita sér staðar* 'look for one's place' is euphemistic; the same expression is used by Snorre in *Yng* 11.

- 113 Rǫð=umk þér Lodd-fáfnir, · at rǫð nemir,
 2 njóta munt ef nemr,
 þér munu góð ef getr:
 4 fjöl-kunnigri konu · skal=at-tu ï faðmi sofa,
 svá't hön lyki þik liðum.

[R 6r/19]

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer, that thou learn the counsels;
 thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
 they will be good for thee if thou gettest:
 In a manicunning woman's arms shalt thou never sleep,
 lest she lock thee in her limbs.*

4 fjöl-kunnigri 'manicunning' | F. dat. sg. of *fjöl-kunnigr* 'sorcerous', an adj. used of both men and women.

5 svá't hön lyki þik liðum 'lest she lock thee in her limbs' | The image of the seductress physically binding the man in her arms is not uncommon cross-culturally and is famously used in the Bible, Ecclesiastes 7:26: "And I find woman more bitter than death. For she is all snares, and nets her heart, and fetters her arms. He who is good before God will escape her, and an offender will be trapped by her." (Alter 2018).

- 114 Hön svá gørir · at gair eigi
 2 þings né þjóðans máls;
 mat þú vill=at · né manns=kis gaman
 4 ferr þú sorga-fullr at sofa.

[R 6r/21]

*She makes it so that thou nowise heedest
 the Thing nor the ruler's speech;
 thou wilt not have food nor any man's pleasure;
 thou goest sorrowful to sleep.*

1 gair 'heedest' | The nasal vowel in this verb is attested in Elfdalian *gǻ*.

- 115 Róð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · at róð nemir, [R 6r/22]
 2 njóta munt ef nemr,
 þér munu góð ef getr:
 4 annars konu · tēyg þér aldri=gi
 eyra-rúnu at.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer, that thou learn the counsels;
 thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
 they will be good for thee if thou gettest:
 Another man's wife do never entice
 into becoming thy ear-whisperess [LOVER].*

5 eyra-rúnu 'ear-whisperess [LOVER]' | This word is also used in *Vsp* 38, in which male seducers of married women are among those being forced to wade through heavy streams in the afterlife. Cf. also st. 131/5 below.

- 116 Róð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · en róð nemir, [R 6r/23]
 2 njóta munt ef nemr,
 þér munu góð ef getr:
 4 á fjalli eða firði, · ef þik fara tíðir,
 fā=sk-tu at virði vël.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;
 thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
 they will be good for thee if thou gettest:
 on fell or firth if thou desirest to journey—
 furnish thyself well with food.*

4 á fjalli eða firði 'on fell or firth' | Hiking through mountains or sailing along the shore; an expression just as well at home on Iceland as in western Norway. This word pair is a formulaic merism, and although this is its only poetic attestation it is also found several times in the Old Norwegian laws (e.g. *Gula* 73 (NGL I, p. 38), *Frost* 32 (NGL I, p. 142); see ONP for further occurrences).

- 117 Róð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · en róð nemir, [R 6r/24]
 2 njóta munt ef nemr,
 þér munu góð ef getr:
 4 illan mann · lát aldri=gi
 ó·höpp at þér vita,
 6 því't af illum manni · fēt aldri=gi
 gjöld hins góða hugar.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;
 thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
 they will be good for thee if thou gettest:
 Never let an evil man*

know of thy mishaps,
for from an evil man wilt thou never get
recompense for thy good heart.

5 ð-hopp at þér vita | An unambiguous instance of *v* alliterating with a vowel.

118 Ofar=la bíta · sá'k ęinum hal

[R 6r/26]

2 orð illrar konu,
flá-rðð tunga · varð hönnum at fįr-lagi
4 ok þęy=gi umb sanna sðk.

I saw sorely biting at a lonely man
the words of an evil woman;
a false-counseling tongue brought his life to its end
and yet nowise o'er a truthful charge.

1 Ofar=la 'sorely' | Contraction of *ofar=liga* 'CV: high up, in the upper part', presumably meaning that the words were particularly grievous or insulting and cut him deeply. Whether the man was murdered or committed suicide is not clear.

3 flá-rðð tunga 'a false-counseling tongue' | Cf. *Lok* 31/1: *flø 'þér tunga* 'false is thy tongue'.

119 Rðð=umk þér Lodd-fáfnir, · ęn rðð nemir,

[R 6r/28]

2 njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu gðð ef getr:
4 vęitst, ef vin átt, · þann's vęl trúir,
far þú at finna opt;
6 því't hrísi vęx · ok hðu grasi
vegr, es vęt=ki trøðr.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

Thou knowest, if thou hast a friend whom thou trustest well
journey to find him oft,
for with brushwood and with tall grass grows
the way which no one treads.

4–5 vęitst ... oft 'Thou knowest ... oft' | Near-identical to st. 44/1, 4 above.

6 hrísi vęx · ok hðu grasi 'with brushwood and with tall grass grows' | Identical to *Grm* 17/1.

120 Rðð=umk þér Lodd-fáfnir, · ęn rðð nemir,

[R 6r/30]

2 njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu gðð ef getr:

- 4 góðan mann · teyg þér at gaman-rúnum
 ok nem líknar-galdr meðan lífir.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

Draw a good man toward thee with pleasure-runes
and learn galders of kindness while thou livest.

4 gaman-rúnum 'pleasure-runes' | Here "rune" appears to carry its root meaning of 'whisper, counsel, speech', thus 'pleasing speech'. Cf. st. 129 where this word reoccurs.

5 líknar-galdr 'galders of kindness' | Metaphorical, i.e., ways of speaking which will make one liked; cf. the similar use of the related verb *gala* in 29/4 above.

- 121 Róð=umk þér Lodd-fáfnir, · en róð nemir,

[R 6r/31]

- 2 njóta munt ef nemr,
 þér munu góð ef getr:
4 vin þinum · ves aldri=gi
 fyrri at flaum-slitum.
6 sorg etr hjarta, · ef þú segja né náir
 ein-hverjum allan hug.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

With thy friend never be the first
to tear the relation apart.
Sorrow eats thy heart if thou canst not tell
anyone thy whole mind.

6–7 segja ... ein-hverjum allan hug 'tell anyone thy whole mind' | Cf. st. 124 which uses almost the same expression.

- 122 Róð=umk þér Lodd-fáfnir, · en róð nemir,

[R 6r/33]

- 2 njóta munt ef nemr,
 þér munu góð ef getr:
4 orðum skipa · skalt aldri=gi
 við ó-svinna apa,

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

Words shalt thou never exchange
with unwise apes,

ALL | Cf. st. 125 below which gives similar advice.

5 ó-svinna apa ‘unwise apes’ | Formulaic; cf. *Grm* 33, *Fáfn* 11.

123 því't af illum manni · munt aldri=gi [R 6r/34]

2 góðs laun of geta,
 2 en góðr maðr · mun þik gørva mega
 4 líkn-fastan at lofi.

for from an evil man wilt thou never
 get a reward for thy goodness,
 but a good man will know to make thee
 firmly liked through his goodwill.

1–2 því't ... geta ‘For ... praise’ | Cf. st. 117/6–7.

4 líkn-fastan ‘firmly liked’ | The first element *líkn* ‘liking’ is somewhat difficult; see st. 8 for definitions. For the cpd. La Farge and Tucker (1992) give a tentative ‘assured of favour’, while CV gives ‘fast in goodwill, beloved’.

124 Siðjum 's þá blandit · hværr es segja réðr [R 6v/2]

2 einum allan hug;
 alt es bættra · an séi briggðum at vesa:
 4 es=a sá vinr qðrum · es vilt eitt segir.

Kinship is mingled whenever one resolves to tell
 one man his whole mind.
 Everything is better than to be with the fickle;
 he's no friend to another who speaks pleasantries alone.

1–2 segja ... einum allan hug ‘tell one man his whole mind’ | Cf. st. 121 which uses almost the same expression.

125 Róð=umk þér Lodd-fáfnir, · en róð nemir, [R 6v/4]

2 njóta munt ef nemr,
 þér munu góð ef getr:
 4 þrimr orðum senna · skal=at-tu þér við verra mann;
 opt hinn bættri bilar,
 6 þá's hinn verri vegr.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;
 thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
 they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

With three words shalt thou not flyte with a worse man;
 oft the better one breaks
 when the worse one strikes.

4 þrímur orðum ‘With three words’ | I.e., ‘not even with three words’. If one understands *orð* in its sense ‘speech’ we may understand that if one man says something (the first speech) to which another responds with an insult (the second speech), the first man should not retaliate (the third speech) and escalate the dispute.

126 Róð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ɛn rjóð nemir, [R 6v/5]

- 2 njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
4 skó-smiðr þú vesir · né skępti-smiðr,
nema sjölfum þér séir.
6 Skór ’s skapaðr illa · eða skapt séi rangt,
þá ’s þér bqls beðit.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:
Be not a shoe-maker nor a shaft-maker
unless thou be one for thyself.
If the shoe is ill shaped or the shaft be crooked—
then for thee a bale is summoned.*

ALL. | The plain sense is that the customer will place a curse on the maker if he dislikes his wares.

127 Róð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ɛn rjóð nemir, [R 6v/7]

- 2 njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
4 hvar’s bql kant, · kveð þér bqlvi at
ok gef=at þinum fiondum frið.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:
Wherever thou knowest a bale call it baleful against thee,
and give thy foes no peace.*

ALL. | If somebody reveals himself to be your enemy (e.g. by putting a curse on you), then acknowledge it and act decisively. Do not tolerate minor or underhanded insults, for the disrespect afforded to you may soon escalate if it is not nipped in the bud. — This st. has often been interpreted as a command to call out evil or injustice, even when committed towards somebody else, and while there is nothing that speaks decisively against such a reading, it cannot be said to agree with the cautious and shrewd spirit of *Háv.*

128 Róð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ɛn rjóð nemir, [R 6v/8]

- 2 njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:

4 illu feginn · ves aldri=gi,
 en lát þér at góðu getit.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:
In the bad do never rejoice,
but let thyself be pleased by the good.*

ALL | No person would rejoice in that which is bad for him, and so the sense should be that one should not take joy in the misfortunes of others, but rather take pleasure in that which is good and true.

5 en lát þér at góðu getit ‘but let thyself be pleased by the good’ | This construction is equivalent to CV: *geta*, A. IV. with acc.

12n Rǫð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · en rǫð nemir,
2 njóta munt ef nemr,
 þér munu góð ef getr:
4 upp líta · skal=at-tu i orrostu;
 —gjalti g·líkir · verða gumna synir—
6 síðr þitt of heilli halir.

[R 6v/9]

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:
Look upward shalt thou not in battle
—alike to a madman become the sons of men—
lest warriors bewitch thee.*

ALL | An obscure superstition; the interpretation hinges on the etymology of the word *gjalti* ‘madman’ dat. sg., also found in the closely related phrase *verða at gjalti* ‘turn into a madman’. (a) CV explains it as an old dative of *goltr* ‘boar, hog’. This necessitates an irregular breaking of *ja* < *ę*, since *goltr* (< Proto-Norse **galtur*) is an u-stem and should have a dat. sg. *geltri* (< PN **galtiu*; cf. *kunimudiu*, dat. sg. of **Kunimundur*, on the Tjurkö I bracteate). (b) The generally accepted explanation in modern scholarship seems to be a borrowing from Old Irish *geilt* ‘insane, mad’ (so La Farge and Tucker (1992) and others). A close Irish parallel to the present stanza is found in the C12th or 13th Gaelic tale of *Suibhne mac Colmáin* who was cursed by saint *Rónán Finn* to become mad. The curse took effect when he looked into the sky during a battle, after which he was known as *Suibhne geilt*. Since earlier versions of the same story are attested as early as the 840s (Males 2024b, p. 100), this word cannot be used to argue for a C13th dating for the Speeches of Loddfathomer section of *Háv*, but its Irish roots hint at an Icelandic rather than Norwegian origin for this part of the poem.

6 halir ‘warriors’ | Some sort of “supernatural sky warriors”, to quote Pettit (2023); perhaps even the Oneharriers.

130 Rǫð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · en rǫð nemir,
2 njóta munt ef nemr,
 þér munu góð ef getr:

[R 6v/11]

- 4 Ef vilt þér góða konu · kvęðja at gaman-rúnum
ok fáa fǫgnuð af,
6 fǫgru skalt heita · ok láta fast vesa;
leiði=sk mann=gi gótt ef getr.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

If thou wilt address a good woman with pleasure-runes
and get good cheer from her,
a fair thing shalt thou promise and let it stand firm;
no one loathes a good thing if he gets it.

4 gaman-rúnum 'pleasure-runes' | While easily interpreted as 'sexual intercourse', the word is used in st. 120 in a decidedly non-sexual sense. Its base meaning is probably 'good conversation'.

- 131 Rǫð=umk þér Lodd-fáfnir, · en rǫð nemir,
2 njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
4 varan bið'k þik vesa · ok ęigi of-varan,
ves við ǫl varastr, · ok við annars konu
6 ok við þat hit þriðja, · at þjófar né leiki.

[R 6v/13]

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

I bid thee be wary, and not overly wary;
be wariest with ale and with another man's woman,
and with this the third: that thieves do not outplay thee.

- 132 Rǫð=umk þér Lodd-fáfnir, · en rǫð nemir,
2 njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
4 at háði né hlátri · haf aldri=gi
gęst né ganganda.

[R 6v/15]

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

With scorn or laughter never treat
a guest or wanderer.

- 133 Opt vitu ǫ-gǫr=la, · þęir's sitja inni fyrir,
2 hvęs þęir 'ro kyns es koma;

[R 6v/16]

es=at maðr svá góðr · at galli né fylgi,
 4 né svá illr at einu=gi dugi.

Oft they who sit within do not clearly know
 of what kind are those who come;
 there is no man so good that no flaw follows
 nor so bad that he avails for nothing.

134 Róð=umk þér Lodd-fáfnir, · en róð nemir,
 2 njóta munt ef nemr,
 þér munu góð ef getr:
 4 at hōrum þul · hlé aldri=gi,
 opt 's gótt þat's gamlir kveða,
 6 opt ór skōrpum þelg · skilin orð koma
 þeim's hangir með hōum
 8 ok skollir með skrōum,
 ok váfir með vil-mōgum.

[R 6v/17]

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;
 thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
 they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

At a hoary thyle never laugh;
 oft is good that which old men sing;
 oft from a scorched leather-bag come discerning words;
 from him who hangs amidst hides
 and dangles amidst dry skins
 and sways amidst calf-stomachs.

6 skōrpum þelg 'from a scorched leather-bag' | Metaphor for an ancient, thick-wrinkled man.

9 vil-mōgum 'calf-stomachs' | A compound of *vil* 'cattle-entrails' + *magar* 'stomachs'. A reading *vil-mōgum* 'lads of toil [THRALLS]' is possible but gives no reasonable sense that adds to the description of a hanging leather-bag.

135 Róð=umk þér Lodd-fáfnir, · en róð nemir,
 2 njóta munt ef nemr,
 þér munu góð ef getr:
 4 gęst þú né gęy=a · né à grind hrękir;
 get þú vō-luðum vęl.

[R 6v/20]

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;
 thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
 they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

At the guest do not bark nor spit at the gate;
 furnish the destitute well.

4 né geyj=a ‘At the guest do not bark’ | Note the occurrence of the archaic double verbal negation *né* ... =*a(t)* which otherwise sees no use in *Háv* (probably for metrical-syntactical reasons, since *né* cannot occur at the start of a line or clause). *né* is the original Germanic negation placed directly before the verb (cf. Gothic *nī*, OE *ne*) while =*a(t)* (also *-i*) is a West Norse innovation probably originally deriving from a shortening of *vættr* ‘wight, thing’ (cf. English “not” < *n-á-wiht* ‘nothing’, originally *ne* + *á-wiht*). In an instance of Jespersen’s cycle (whereby a strengthening adverb eventually displaces the original negative; e.g. archaic French *je ne sais* ‘I do not know’ > modern standard *je ne sais pas* ‘id.’, lit. ‘I do not know a step’ > modern colloquial *je sais pas* ‘I don’t know’) ON =*a(t)* comes to be the main productive negator in poetry, whereas both older *né* and intermediate *né* ... =*a(t)* are marginalized (Jespersen [1917] 2025). For an overview of Norse negations in poetry see Sapp (2022, pp. 83–89).

4 né á grind hrękir ‘nor spit at the gate’ | The guest is presumably standing in front of the gate waiting for the farmer to open it and let him in.

- 136 Rammt es þat tré, · es ríða skal
2 ǫllum at upp-loki;
 baug þú gef · eða þat biðja mun
4 þér lēs hvers á liðu.

[R 6v/21]

Strong is that wood which shall swing
to open up for all.
Give a high or it will summon
every kind of guile onto thy limbs.

ALL | This stanza is rather difficult, but due to the lack of a separate refrain most likely relates to the advice in st. 135. The sense is then that a man’s house (symbolised by its gate) will be strengthened by generosity, but weakened and cursed by greed and inhospitality, whether from the wrath of denied travellers or supernaturally from the anger of the gods (for which cf. *Grm* P2).

- 137 Róð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ęn róð nemir,
2 njóta munt ef nemr,
 þér munu góð ef getr:
4 hvar’s ǫl drekkir · kjós þér jarðar męgin,
 því’t jorð tekr við ǫlðri, · ęn ęldr við sóttum,
6 ęik við ab·bindi, · ax við fjol·kyngi,
 hǫll við hý·rógi; · heiptum skal Mána kvęðja,
8 bęiti við bit·sóttum, · ęn við bǫlvi rúnar;
 fold skal við flóði taka.

[R 6v/23]

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer, that thou learn the counsels;
thou wilt profit if thou learnest,
they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*

Wherever thou drinkest ale choose for thee the earth’s might,
for earth takes against drunkenness and fire against sicknesses,
oak against dysentery, the ear of corn against manicunningness,
elder against married strife—in feuds shall one hail Moon—

heather against bite-sicknesses and runes against a bale;
earth shall be taken against flood.

6 við | 'viþið' (with corrupt abbreviation mark for -iþ-) R

ALL | This stanza gives a rare glimpse into Wiking Age folk medicine. The exact application of the listed cures is highly uncertain; is the drunk man, for example, supposed to ingest earth, rub it against his belly, or invoke the personified Earth in some way?

6 fjöl-kyngi 'manicunningness' | Sorcery.

7 holl við hý-rógi 'elder against married strife' | Both nouns are hapax legomena. *holl* (ms. 'hall') is tentatively connected by Ásgeir Blöndal Magnússon (1989, s.v. 2 *böll*) to Danish *hyld* 'elder tree, elderberry', New Norse *hyll* 'id.', OHG *boluntar* 'id.', although the phonology is irregular. *hý-rógi* (dat. sg. of **hý-róg*) is transparently a cpd. of *hý-* 'married couple, household' (cf. *Ski* 42/n.) + *róg* 'strife, slander'. The exact way the elderberry will help is unclear, but I see the present half-line as connecting to the following one since both deal with conflict: the former domestic, the latter violent. — CV (s.v. *haull*) consider this half-line corrupt and suggest the emendation **við haulvi hý-rógr* 'spurred rye (ergot of rye) against hernia'. Although interesting and closer in sense to the rest of the stanza their emendation is too conjectural to be adopted here.

7 heiptum skal Mána kvæðja 'in feuds shall one hail Moon' | That the Moon had a certain "might" is also attested in *Vsp* 5; it is presumably for this might which he is invoked here, that he may give strength to the man in conflict. For *kvæðja* 'hail, invoke' cf. *Lok* P4.

6. The Rune-Tally (138–146)

This group of stanzas is introduced by a large initial in R, marking the beginning of a new section. In younger paper manuscripts they have the header *Rúna-tals þátr* 'Strand of the Rune-Tally'.

Outside of *Háv* 138–146 (but cf. st. 80 above which would fit seamlessly into the present section) there are a few other manuscript attestations of similar Runic magic, but none of them show the unabashed heathendom of the present stanzas.

Somewhat similar poetry preserved in R is *Sigrdr* 36 and *Sigrdr* 5–17, although there are signs that point towards the latter being a later antiquarian composition, something sts. 138–146 are likely not.

138 Vei't'k at ek hekk · vin*ga-meiði á

[R 6v/27]

2 nêtr allar níu,
gęiri undaðr · ok gefinn Óðni,
4 sjalfr sjölfum mér,
á þeim meiði, · es mann=gi veit,
6 hvęs af rótum rinnr.

I KNOW THAT I HUNG on the hanging tree
for all nights nine,
wounded by a spear and given to Weden,
Myself to Myself
on that tree where no man knows
of whose roots it runs.

1 Veið'k | V has a descending initial with a height of two lines. 1 vin*ga-meiði 'the hanging tree' | 'vindga meiði' R

ALL | The myth of Weden's self-sacrifice ("the Hanging") is told only here and nowhere else. Still, the god has a strong association with hanging throughout the Norse corpus. Weden is known by names like *Hangi* 'Hanged One' (Tindr *Hákr* 1/5 in SkP 1, cf. note there), *Hanga-týr* 'Tew (i.e., god) of the Hanged' (Skm 7), and *Hanga-guð* 'God of the Hanged' (Gylf 20:10), and in st. 158 below he speaks of bringing a hanged man's corpse back to life.

The method of the sacrifice in the present st. bears remarkably close resemblance to an episode in *Gautr* 7. In exchange for good wind, king Wiker and his men, among which is Weden's protégé Starked, agree to hang one of their own number as a sacrifice to Weden. They draw lots and they fall upon king Wiker. Troubled by this they decide to honour their oaths by performing a mock hanging, and Starked, whom Weden has secretly given a spear disguised as a reed, is to carry it out. The rest is best repeated in full:

Þar stóð fura ein hjá þeim ok stofn einn hár nér furu'nni. Neðar-liga af furu'nni stóð einn kvistr mjór ok tók í lim'it upp. Þá hjuggu þjónustu-sveinar mat manna, ok var kálfr einn skorinn ok krufðr. Starkaðr lét taka kálfs-þarma'na. Síðan steig Starkaðr upp á stofni'n ok sveigði ofan þann inn mjóva kvist'inn ok knýtti þar um kálfs-þarmu'num. Þá mælti Starkaðr til konungs: „Nú er hér biðinn þér gálgi, konungr, ok mun sýnast eigi all-mann-bétt-ligr. Nú gakk-tu þingat, ok mun ek leggja snöru á háls þér.“ Konungr mælti: „Sé þessi um-bið ekki mér bétu-ligri en mér sýnist, þá vœnti ek, at mik skaði þetta ekki, en ef þöru-vís er, þá mun auðna ráða, hvat at gerist.“ Síðan steig hann upp á stofni'n, ok lagði Starkaðr virgul'inn um háls bonum ok steig síðan ofan af stofni'num. Þá stakk Starkaðr sprota'num á konungi ok mælti: „Nú gef ek þik Öðni.“ Þá lét Starkaðr lausan furu-kvist'inn. Reyfr-sprot'inn varð at geir, ok stóð í gegnum konung'inn. Stofninn fell undan fótum bonum, en kálfs-þarmar'nir urðu at viðju sterkri, en kvistr'inn reis upp ok hóf upp konung'inn við limar, ok dó hann þar.

'There stood a tall pine close to them and a tall stump next to the pine. At the lower part of the pine there was a thin branch and it curved upwards into the leafage. Then the servant-boys made food for the men and a calf was cut by its throat and opened up. Starked had the calf-intestines taken. Thereafter Starked stepped onto the stump and pulled down the thin branch and tied around it the calf-intestines. Then Starked spoke to the king: "Now a gallows is readied for thee, O king, and it will not seem of risk to any man. Now come hither and I will lay the rope onto thy neck." The king spoke: "If this undertaking be of as little risk to me as it looks then I expect that this will not injure me, but if it is otherwise then fortune will decide what happens afterwards." Thereafter he stepped onto the stump and Starked laid the noose around his neck and thereafter stepped down from the stump. Then Starked stabbed the reed into the king and spoke: "Now I give thee to Weden." Then Starked let go of the pine-branch. The reed turned into a spear and it pierced through the king. The stump fell away from under his feet, but the calf-intestines became a strong withy, but the branch rose up and lifted the king up into the leafage, and there he died.'

Several motifs from the just-quoted passage are attested in other Norse sources. In *Styrb* 2 Weden gives king Eric a reed which upon the uttering of a devotional formula turns into a spear and inaugurates a large-scale human sacrifice in the form of a landslide burying an enemy host (cf. *Vsp* 23 n.); in 2 *HHund* P11 Weden lends Day his spear; in Saxo Grammaticus (2015, p. 77) 1.8.27 the Odinic king Harding ends his life by hanging himself before his people (for the Odinic nature of this sacrifice see Jens Peter Schjødt 2020a, pp. 1158, 1162, 1174–76); and in *Yng* 9 Weden marks himself with a spear on his deathbed and is followed by Nearth, who continues the practice by "marking" himself (presumably with a spear) to Weden before his own death.

With these parallels in mind it seems likely that the method of sacrifice described in the present st. has its origin in authentic pre-Christian ritual. It is only fitting that a sacrifice to Weden—even if the victim be the god himself—should be carried out in the way such sacrifices ought to be, and the past mythological actions of gods tend to serve as the basis for present human ritual (*Vsp* 7 n., *Grm* 41–43 n.). Further instances of hanging-sacrifices include Adam of Bremen (2002, p. 208) who mentions the hanging of nine men in a grove at the Temple of Upsele, and although the god to whom they are sacrificed is not named, it can only really be Weden. For discussion of the devotion of armies and war-captives to Weden, cf. *Vsp* 23 n.

Against the interpretation of a simple sacrifice, Sundqvist (2010) argues convincingly that the present stanza is the etiology behind an initiatory ritual likely used to initiate cultic leaders, so-called thyles (*þulir*) or gids (*göðar*). According to his view, the nine nights are the liminal period during which Weden is being remade, halfway between the land of the living and the land of the dead, and his deprivation represents a passage ritual. When Weden reemerges, he has become initiated: he has learned the arts of runic writing, Scaldic poetry, and blood.

1 vin*ga-meðr ‘the hanging tree’ | The ms. form *vindga meðr* is generally understood to be a form of *vinga-meðr* ‘hanging tree, gallows tree’, a word found in three Scaldic stanzas (SkP: Egill Lv 14, Eyv Hál 5, Anon (*FoGT*) 17). The form *vindga* ‘windswept, windy’ is most likely a folk etymological substitution for *vinga*-, which has nothing to do at all with wind but is better interpreted as ‘swaying’ (related to words like Swedish *vingla* ‘sway, wobble’, German *wanken* ‘sway, stagger’, cf. *Prk* 1/1 n.). This reading is further strengthened by *vindga* being in the unusual weak form rather than the expected strong dat. sg. m. **vindgum*. The original sense of *vinga-meðr* is thus the ‘tree which sways back and forth’, viz. under the weight of the hanged man’s body. —

The tree is probably the Ash of Ugdrassle (the World Tree), which is named after this hanging, being the “ash-tree of Ug’s (Weden) gallows”. The unknown origin of its roots clearly adds to the mystery of the self-sacrifice. Here we may compare with the description of the three roots of the tree in *Grm* 31, one going into the Underworld, the other into the land of the Ettins, the third into the land of Men. By hanging on the Ash while hovering between life and death, Weden was thus directly connected to the Underworld, which likely makes this episode an instance of the god’s convening with the dead for wisdom (see Introduction to *Vsp*).

2 nētr allar níu ‘for all nights nine’ | TODO: magical number

139 Við hleifi mik sóldu=t · né við horni=gi;

[R 6v/29]

2 nýsta ek niðr, · nam’k upp rúnar,
óþandi nam, · fell’k aþtr þaðan.

With no loaf they relieved Me, nor with any horn.
I peered down; I took up the runes;
screaming I took—I fell back thence.

1 Við hleifi mik sóldu=t · né við horni=gi ‘With no loaf they relieved Me, nor with any horn’ | i.e., ‘I got neither bread to eat nor ale to drink.’

140 Fimbul-ljóð níu · nam’k af hinum frégja syni

[R 6v/31]

2 Bólþorns, Bęstlu fōður,
ok ek drykk of gat · hins dýra mjaðar
4 ausinn Óð-róri.

Nine fimble-leeds I learned from the famous son
of Balethorn, Bestle’s father—
and a drink I got of the dear mead
poured from Woderearer.

ALL | Here the poem moves away from the subject of the Hanging to the subject of how Weden learned his galders (ll. 1-2) and the art of poetry (3-4).

1 Fimbul-ljóð níu ‘Nine fimble-leeds’ | Nine very great chants or spells (galders); compare the eighteen (9 times 2) leeds in *Háv* 147-165 below.

1–2 hinum frégja syni / Bólþorns, Bestlu fǫður ‘the famous son of Balethorn, Bestle’s father’ | According to *Gylf* 6:9–10: *Hann fékk þeirar konu, er Bestla hét, dóttir Bólþorns jǫtuns, ok fengu þau þrjá sonu; hét einn Óðinn, annarr Vili, þriðji Vē.* ‘He [= Byre] got to wife the woman called Bestle, the daughter of the ettin Balethorn, and they had three sons. One was called Weden, the other Will, the third Wigh.’ This passage makes Balethorn’s son Weden’s maternal uncle and the present stanza is thus an example of the old Germanic custom of sending sons away to be fostered by the mother’s male relations. This custom, not uncommon in the later saws, is attested already by Tacitus, *Germania* 20: *Sorum filiis idem apud avunculum qui ad patrem bonor. Quidam sanctiorem artioremq̃ue hunc nexum sanguinis arbitrantur et in accipiendis obsidibus magis exigunt, tamquam et animum firmitus et domum latius teneant.* ‘The sons of sisters are held in the same esteem by their maternal uncle as by their father. Some even consider this bond of blood to be more sacred and more binding, and prefer to demand nephews when taking hostages, reasoning that they secure a firmer hold on the mind and a wider hold on the family.’

- 141 Þā nam’k fréva=sk · ok fróðr vesa
 2 ok vaxa ok vęl hafa=sk;
 orð mér af orði · orðs leitaði
 4 verk mér af verki · verks leitaði.

[R 6v/33]

Then I began to flourish and be wise,
 and grow and have it well.
 Word from word provided Me a word;
 work from work provided Me a work.

ALL | There is something reminiscent of the Aristotelian εὐδαιμονία in the whole stanza. After Weden attained his wisdom he flourished; his good speeches and deeds multiplied.

1 nam’k fréva=sk ‘I began to flourish’ | *fréva=sk* is a reflexive verb derived from *fré* ‘seed (of plants)’.

- 142 Rúnar munt finna · ok ráðna stafi,
 2 mjök stóra stafi,
 mjök stinna stafi,
 4 es fáði Fimbulþulr
 ok gørðu ginn-regon
 6 ok reist Hroptr ragna.

[R 6v/35]

Runes wilt thou find and interpreted staves,
 very great staves,
 very stiff staves,
 which the Fimblethyle painted,
 and the Yin-Reins made,
 and Roft of the Reins (= Weden) carved.

6 ragna ‘of the Reins’ | ‘rogna’ R

1 Rúnar munt finna · ok ráðna stafi ‘Runes wilt thou find and interpreted staves’ | A close parallel is found in the long-line on the mediæval runestone N 13: *rúnar ek rist · ok ráðna stafi* ‘runes I carve and interpreted staves.’

143 Óðinn með ǫsum, · en fyr ǫlfum Dáinn,

[R 7r/2]

2 Dvalinn dvergum fyrir,

Ásviðr jǫtnum fyrir,

4 ek reist sjalfr sumar.

Weden among the Eese but Dowen for the Elves,
Dwollen for the Dwarfs,
Oswith for the Ettins;
I myself carved some.

4 ek 'I' | The identity of the speaker is unclear, but, judging by line 1, it is apparently not Weden.

144 Veitst, hvé rísta skal? · Veitst, hvé ráða skal?

[R 7r/3]

2 Veitst, hvé fáa skal? · Veitst, hvé freista skal?

Veitst, hvé biðja skal? · Veitst, hvé blóta skal?

4 Veitst, hvé sēnda skal? · Veitst, hvé sóa skal?

Knowest thou how one shall carve? Knowest thou how one shall read?
Knowest thou how one shall paint? Knowest thou how one shall try?
Knowest thou how one shall ask? Knowest thou how one shall blout?
Knowest thou how one shall send? Knowest thou how one shall waste?

ALL | The first four verbs refer to runes: carving, interpreting, colouring, and divining, the latter four to sacrifice: praying, worshipping, sending (the sacrifice or the prayer), and slaying (the victim). — The variation of the verbs in a formulaic structure bears some resemblance to Vg 216, the Högstena galder; see there under Galders.

4 sóa 'waste' | I.e., kill the victim, as was done through stunning and decapitation (Vafþ 21/4 n.). This rare verb is never used in prose, and outside of *Háv* only in a single other poem, *Yr*, in st. 5 in the context of human sacrifice, and in st. 18 about the ambush of a king.

145 Bętra 's ǫ·beðit · an séi of·blótit,

[R 7r/5]

2 ęy sér til gildis gįř;

bętra 's ǫ·sęnt · an séi of·sóit;

4 [...]

It is better unasked than over-blooded;
a gift always looks for recompense.
It is better unsent than over-wasted;
[...]

ALL | An identical progression of four verbs suggests a close relation with the previous st. I agree with Males (2024b) on the interpretation of this stanza: since a gift always requires recompense, an excessive sacrifice imposes an excessive debt on the part of the god to whom it is addressed, which might upset the sacrificer's relationship with the god. Males draws an analogy to an episode in *Eg* 78, where a rival poet leaves an expensive shield for the protagonist Eyel before riding off; the latter understands this as a demand to compose a poem about the shield and is greatly insulted.

The gift cycle between Gods and Men, of which the present st. is a Germanic attestation, is a very important concept in Indo-European pagan religions. The idea that sacrifices create (moral, if not legal) contractual obligations for recompense is prevalent in the Roman religion and summarized by the ritual concept *dō ut dēs* ‘I give that thou might give’ (Rüpke 2007, pp. 102, 149). A similar expression is found in an OI sacrificial prayer (*Taittiriya Samhitā* 1.8.4.1, during the *Rāja-siya* or consecration of a king): *Dēbī mē, dādāmi tē; nī mē d’ēbī, nī tē dad’ē; nī-bāram in nī mē barā, nī-bāram* ‘Give to me, I give to thee; bestow upon me, I bestow upon thee; bring gain indeed to me, [I bring] gain [to thee]’.

4 [...] | No gap is indicated in the ms., but the meter requires a c-verse in this position. Its loss is most unfortunate since the pres. st. is an unusual look into pre-Christian religious attitudes.

146 Svá Þundr of reġst · fyr þjóða røk,
2 þar’s upp of reġs, · es aþtr of kom.

[R 7r/7]

So Thound (= Weden) carved before the histories of the nations
where he rose up when he came back.

ALLL | This stanza is obscure and the section to which it belongs is unclear; *svá* ‘so, thus’ may be referring back to the preceding sts. or to the ones ahead. Regardless of which section it is referring to, it describes its contents as the verses Weden wrote down immediately after learning the runes during the Hanging (sts. 138–139 above) and places this at a time long predating human history.

1 Þundr ‘Thound’ | A common poetic name for Weden with an opaque etymology, unrelated to English “Thunder” (which in fact corresponds to ON *Þorr*). Based on the genitive *Þundar* it must be an *i*- or an *u*-stem (< PGmc. **Þundiz* or **Þunduz*). I find the most promising etymology to be a derivative of the IE root **ten-* ‘stretch, extend’ (surviving in the causative as ON *þenja* ‘to stretch’) extended with *-d-* (cf. Latin *tendō* ‘to stretch’). A direct cognate for **Þunduz* is obtained in Lithuanian *tandūs* ‘lazy, sloppy’ < **ténd-u-s* ~ **tūd-ūw-s*, with Germanic regularizing the oblique zero-grade stem to all cases (for which cf. e.g. PGmc. **burþiz* ~ **burþiz* ‘birth’ < PIE **bʰértis* ~ **bʰrétis*). The sense of the name would thus be ‘stretched’, probably referring to his neck during the Hanging.

7. The Leed-Tally (147–165)

The final section of *Háv*, the so-called the Leed-Tally (*Ljóða-tal*), is not separated from the preceding Rune-Tally but is usually taken as separate since it is a self-contained list not much concerned with runes. The speaker, certainly Weden, once again addresses Loddfathomer and lists eighteen galders.

The spells themselves are not given, but only their purpose. They are aristocratic and Odinic in character and deal with such things as battle (galders 3, 4, 5, 8, 11, 13), healing (1, 2, 12), countering sorcery (6, 10), controlling the elements (7, 9), and seduction (16, 17). The 18th and last spell is a mystery; not even its purpose is told, and it is known only by Weden and the women closest to him.

Uniquely in this section we find Weden as a healer—a side of the god which is otherwise largely absent from the Old Norse literary corpus, where he rather chiefly takes on the role of War-God. On the other hand this aligns well with the god’s appearance in West Germanic healing charms like the English *Nwyr* 11 and the High German *Mers II*. Still we need not look in vain for West Germanic influence in the present section; this difference of

character is most likely simply a matter of which genres of texts have survived from the different regions of the Germanic religious sphere.

Several of the numbered galders are reminiscent of other known Germanic spells. The fourth (st. 150) bears a strong likeness to *Grq* 10, and its effect (removing fetters) is shared with the High German *Mers I*, ostensibly an actual galder of that type (but cf. the Introduction there). The mysterious eighteenth spell (st. 165) finds an interesting numerological parallel in the unknowable eighteenth question posed by Weden in *Vafþ* 54.

147 Ljóð þau kann'k, · es kann=at þjóðans kona [R 7r/8]

2 ok manns=kis mögr.

Hjǫlp heitir ęitt, · þat þér hjalpa mun

4 við sorgum ok sǫkum, · ok sútum gǫrv-ǫllum.

Those leeds I know which the king's wife knows not,
and no man's lad.

Help is one called; it will help thee
against sorrows and suits and all griefs entire.

148 Þat kann'k annat, · es þurfu ýta synir, [R 7r/10]

2 þeir's vilja lęknar lifa.

This I know second, which those sons of men need
who wish to live as leechers.

1 þurfu ýta synir 'those sons of men need' | Cf. the similar wording in 166/2.

2 lęknar 'leechers' | Physicians. A relation to 'leech' is likely but the direction of influence is unclear (Kroonen 2013, p. 331); the physicians may be named after the tool of their trade (leeches, for bloodletting), or the leeches named after the physicians.

149 Þat kann'k þriðja, · ef mér verðr þorǫf mikil [R 7r/11]

2 hapt við mīna heipt-mǫgu,

ęggjar deýfi'k · mīnna and-skota,

4 bíta=t þeim vǫpn né vęlir.

This I know third, if I come in great need
of hindrance against my feud-lads [FOES]:

I dull the blades of my enemies;
for them bite not weapons nor staffs.

4 vęlir 'staffs' | Plural of *vǫlr*, here referring to the magic staff or sceptre used by witches and warlocks; the word *vǫlva* 'wallow' (seeress, prophetess) is probably derived from this word. The reading *vęlir* 'wiles, tricks, deceipts' must be excluded for metrical reasons, since a c-verse in Leeds-meter cannot end in a trochée.

150 Þat kann'k fjórða, · ef mér fyrðar bera [R 7r/13]

- 2 **b**ond at **b**óg-limum,
 svá ek **g**el, · at **g**anga mǫ́k,
 4 sprettr mér af **f**ótum **f**jöturr,
 en af **h**öndum **h**apt.

This I know fourth, if men bear
 bonds onto my shoulder-limbs [ARMS]:
 so do I gale that I may walk;
 springs from my feet the fetter,
 and from my hands the bond.

ALL | Cf. *Grg* 10, which is very similar to the present stanza, and *Mers I* (edited below under Galders), a galder that seems actually to have been used for loosening fetters.

- 151 Þat kann’k **f**imta, · ef sé’k af **f**ári skotinn [R 7r/15]
 2 **f**lejn i folki vaða,
 flýgr=a svá **s**tint, · at **s**töðvi’g=a’k,
 4 ef hann **s**jónum of sé’k.

This I know fifth, if I see a dangerously shot
 arrow in the troop wading:
 it flies not so stiff that I cannot stop it
 if I see it in my sights.

- 152 Þat kann’k **s**étta, · ef mik **s**érir þegn [R 7r/16]
 2 á **r**ótum **r**ás viðar,
 þann **h**al, · es mik **h**eipta kveðr,
 4 þann eta **m**ein heldr an **m**ik.

This I know sixth, if athane wounds me
 on the roots of a raw/sappy tree:
 that man who sings hatred against me—
 him the harms hurt instead of me.

3 þann hal ‘that man’ | ok þann hal ‘and that man’ R

1–2 ef mik sérir þegn á rótum rás viðar ‘if a thane wounds me on the roots of a raw/sappy tree’ | I.e., “if a man carves a runic curse against me”.

2 á rótum rás | The alliteration of this line is problematic since the normal form of the adj. *rár* is *brár* (so *Ski* 32), but the required alliteration with *rótum* makes that an impossibility. Another alternative is to emend **v-* in **vrótum* for a line ***á vrótum brás viðar*. The emendation relies on an etymological relation between ON *rót* and OE *wyr*t, but as Kroonen (2013, pp. 597, 601) points out *rót* has an initial *r-* even in East Nordic which otherwise consistently preserves old *vr-*. This circumstance calls the existence of an early West Nordic form **vrót* into question. Furthermore *rót* alliterates with *r-* in st. 138 above.

2 rás ‘raw/sappy’ | The sappy wood was apparently of importance for the curse; cf. the curious account of *Gr* 79, where a hag curses Grettir in the following way: after finding a small tree and planing a small smooth surface onto a scorched side of it, she carves runes in its roots and reddens them with her own blood. She then chants galders while walking counter-clockwise around it. Lastly she pushes it out to sea, praying for it to drift to Grettir’s homestead and curse him. Cf. also *Ski* 32 where Shirner goes to a *brár víðr* ‘raw/sappy tree’ to get a certain magic stick.

4 eta ‘hurt’ | Properly ‘eat’, but the verb here means ‘hurt, injure’.

- 153 Þat kann’k sjaunda, · ef sé’k hōvan loga [R 7r/18]
 2 sal of sess-mōgum,
 brinnr=at svá breitt, · at hōnum bjargi’g=a’k;
 4 þann kann’k galdr at gala.

This I know seventh, if I see a high hall
 blazing over seat-lads [WARRIORS]:
 it burns not so broadly that I cannot save it—
 that galder I can gale.

1 loga ‘blazing’ | The word order makes this word look like the acc. of the m. noun *logi* ‘flame’ (i.e., “if I see a high flame”), but the noun modified by the adj. *hōvan* ‘high’ is in fact *sal* ‘hall’, and *loga* is the verb ‘blaze, burn’.

4 galdr ‘galder’ | The use of this word reveals the synonymity of *galdr* ‘galder’ and *ljóð* ‘leed’.

- 154 Þat kann’k átta, · es qllum es [R 7r/20]
 2 nyt-sam=ligt at nema,
 hvar’s hatr vęx · með hildings sonum,
 4 þat má’k bóta brátt.

This I know eighth, which for all men is
 useful to learn:
 wherever hatred grows among the sons of a prince,
 it I may shortly mend.

3 hatr ‘hatred’ | Viz., over their father’s inheritance. As any reader of European history will know, such conflicts were a constant source of war and kinslaying, both in the mediæval Germanic-founded kingdoms and in the Roman Empire that went before them.

- 155 Þat kann’k níunda, · ef mik nauðr of stęndr [R 7r/22]
 2 at bjarga fari mínu á floti,
 vind ek kyrrí · vági á
 4 ok svęfi’k allan sé.

This I know ninth, if I come in need
 of saving my ship as it floats:
 the wind I calm upon the wave,
 and put all the sea asleep.

156 Þat kann'k títunda, · ef sé'k tùn-riður

2 lēika lopti á,

ek svá vinn'k, · at þér villar fara

4 sinna hēim-hama

sinna hēim-huga.

This I know tenth, if I see fence-rideresses
playing aloft:

I work it so that they go astray
of their home-hames,
of their home-minds.

3 þér villar fara 'they (f) go astray (f)' | *gramm. emend.*; þeir villir fara 'they (m.) go astray (m.)'
R

ALL | The stanza requires explanation. To begin with, the *tùn-riður* 'fence-rideresses' are generally understood to be shape-shifting witches who have detached from their bodies and are now flying around tormenting the people (Wallenstein 2019, p. 398). This concept has anthropological parallels in the idea of the "soul-flight", found in Saami, Siberian, and Native American religions and in later Scandinavian folklore (Wallenstein 2019, pp. 400–404).

The Old Norse conception of soul-flight, also found in sources outside of *Háv* (e.g., *Historia Norwegiae*), was as follows: the witches were thought able to *ham-bleypa* 'hame-leap', i.e., to leave their original (human) *hamir* 'hames' or 'skins'. This was called a *gand-ríð* 'gand-ride', during which they would torment and injure the folk; the *gandr* 'gand' was the familiar spirit with which they would be joined when riding. When the witches were out riding their human bodies (or hames) would be lying unconscious and vulnerable; they would also retain that part of the human soul which was thought inextricably linked to the hame: the *hugr* 'mind, seat of emotions'. That the hame was not merely dead 'skin' is shown by a notable passage in *Vǫls* 8, wherein the heroes Symund and Sinfjelle find two wolf-hames, and, upon donning them, learn the speech of wolves, becoming blood-thirsty and ravenous.

A vivid description of the witches' ride, frequently compared with the present stanza, is found in the OSwe. Elder West-Geatish Law (ca. 1250 cē), RB 5:5: *Þetta eru ú-kveðins-orð konu. „lak sá, at þú rēt á kvi-grindu lās-hárað ok í trolls ham, þá allt var iam-ript nátt ok dagr.“ Kallar bana kunna firigera konu elkr ká, þet er ú-kveðins-orð. [...]* (Collin and Schlyter 1827, p. 38, my norm.) 'These are the words of insult to a woman: "I saw that thou rodest on the sheep-pen-fence loose-haired and in a troll's hame when everything was equally divided between day and night." If he says that she knows how to destroy (with magic) a woman or a cow, that is a word of insult.' It may be noted that the ms. word *quiggrindu* 'sheep-pen-fence' (dat. sg.) has also been interpreted as *kvið-grindu* 'womb-opening', i.e., the woman's (bared) nether parts, with a likely sexual implication (Sjöros 1919, pp. 224–228).

A persistent danger in any soul-flight is the "soul-loss". The flying soul (or parts of it) may be unable to return to its original body (whether by going astray or by being actively prevented from it by another magician) and this will cause pain and madness, and eventually the death of the witch or wizard (Wallenstein 2019, pp. 400–404). It is surely in this way we should read the present stanza, and here I agree with Wallenstein (2019, p. 406). With his unrivalled skill as a magician, Weden could see the rideresses. With his galder, he would prevent them from returning to their original hames or minds, eventually annihilating them. Weden brags elsewhere about doing this in *Hárð* 20, and this also mirrors his role as troll- and witch-hunter in the Wild Hunt of later folklore (TODO: cite Grimm). Since the noun *riða* on its own means 'fever, chills' (Fr, s.v. *riða*), we are also seeing Weden in his role as supernatural healer.

1 tùn-riður 'fence-rideresses' | The sense of *tùn* (cognate with English "town") is most likely 'hedged plot, courtyard', which perhaps allows us to connect it to the witch's riding on the *kvi-grindu* 'sheep-pen-fence' in the Elder West-Geatish Law (see note to ALL). Numerous cpds. exist with the same second element, e.g. *kveld-riður* 'evening-rideresses' (*HHj* 15/4) and *myrk-riður* 'dark-rideresses' (*Hárð* 20).

- 157 Þat kann'k elliþta, · ef skal'k til orrostu
 2 leiða lang-vini,
 und randir gəl'k, · ęn þęir með ríki fara,
 4 heilir hildar til,
 heilir hildi frá,
 6 koma þęir heilir hvaðan.

[R 7r/25]

This I know eleventh, if I shall into the fray
 lead old friends:
 beneath the shield-rims I gale, and they go with power
 hale to the battle,
 hale from the battle;
 they come hale anywhence.

2 lang-vini 'old friends' | Lit., 'long-friends'. In Germanic paganism the followers and protégés of a god are his friends (*vinir*). Already in *Beow* we see that the Shieldings are called the *Ing-wine* 'friends of Ing', and in *Hym 11* Thunder is called the *vinr ver-liða* 'friend of manly retinues'. Two other places where it is used of Weden's followers in particular are *Grm* 54 and *Sont* 22, where Eysel speaks about his friendship (*vin-átt*) with Weden.

- 158 Þat kann'k tolþta, · ef sé'k á tré uppi
 2 váfa virgil-ná,
 svá ek rist · ok i rúnum fá'k,
 4 at sá ęęngr gumi.
 ok męlir við mik.

[R 7r/27]

This I know twelfth, if I see in a tree up high
 sway a gallow-corpse:
 so I carve and paint in the runes,
 that that man walks
 and speaks with me.

- 159 Þat kann'k þrèt-tánda · ef skal'k þęgn ungan
 2 verpa vatni á,
 mun=at hann falla · þó'tt i folk komi,
 4 hnígr=a sá halr fyr hjęrum.

[R 7r/29]

This I know thirteenth, if on a young thane
 I shall sprinkle water:
 he will not fall though he come into battle;
 that hero will not sink before swords.

1-2 ef skal'k þęgn ungan verpa vatni á 'if on a young thane I shall sprinkle water' | A reference to the Heathen name-giving ceremony in which the infant would be sprinkled with water; cf. the attestations in *Rþ* 7, 22, 35.

- 160 Þat kann'k fjór-tánda, · ef skal'k fyrða liði [R 7r/31]
 2 tēlja tíva fyr,
 ása ok alfa · ek kann allra skil,
 4 fār kann ò·snotr svá.

This I know fourteenth, if before the troop of men
 I shall count forth the Tews:
 of all Eese and Elves I know the distinctions;
 few unwise men can do so.

3 skil 'distinctions' | Their unique attributes. Cf. *Hym* 38, where the corresponding verb *skilja* 'to discern, understand' likewise is used in the context of god-lore.

- 161 Þat kann'k fimm-tánda, · es gól Þjóð·rörir [R 7r/33]
 2 dvergr fyr Dellings durum,
 afl gól ǫsum, · en ǫlfum frama,
 4 hyggju Hropta-tý.

This I know fifteenth, which Thedrearer galed,
 the dwarf, before Dellings doors.
 Strength he galed for the Eese, but fame for the Elves,
 thought for Tew of the Rofts (= Weden).

4 Hropta-tý 'Tew of the Rofts (= Weden)' | The older dative -tívi (*Haustr* 8/1a, *Þdr* 20/3a) is not allowed for metrical reasons as a Leeds-meter c-verse cannot end in a long syllable followed by another syllable.

- 162 Þat kann'k sex-tánda, · ef vil'k hins svinna mans [R 7r/35]
 2 hafa gæð allt ok gaman,
 hugi hverfi'k · hvit-armri konu
 4 ok sný'k hennar ǫllum sefa.

This I know sixteenth, if from the wise girl I will
 have her senses all, and pleasure:
 I change the heart of the white-armed woman,
 and I twist her whole mind.

- 163 Þat kann'k sjau-tjanda · at mik seint mun firra=sk [R 7v/2]
 2 hit man-unga man.

This I know seventeenth, that I will late be shunned,
 by that girl-young girl.

- 164 Ljóða þessa · munt Lodd·fáfnir [R 7v/2]
 2 lengi vanr vesa;

þó séi þér góð ef getr,
 4 nýt ef nemr,
 þorð ef þiggr.

These leeds wilt thou, Loddfathomer,
 long be lacking!
 Though they might be good for thee if thou gettest,
 profitable if thou learnest,
 needful if thou takest.

ALL | A parathetical statement, but there is no reason why it should not be authorial. It precedes the final, unknowable spell.

165 Þat kann’k át-tjanda, · es éva kenni’k
 2 meý né manns konu,
 —allt es þetra · es çinn of kann,
 4 þat fylgir ljóða lokum—
 nema þçiri çinni, · es mik armi verr,
 6 eða mün systir séi.

[R 7v/4]

This I know eighteenth, which I will never teach
 a maiden nor man’s woman,
 (everything is better which one alone knows;
 that follows the last of the leeds!)
 save her alone who holds me in her arms,
 or is my sister.

5 mik armi verr ‘holds me in her arms’ | A similar expression is also used *Vkv* 2. The one who wraps Weden in her arm may be his wife, Frie.

166 Nú eru Hóva mól kveðin · Hóva hollu i;
 2 all-þorð ýta sonum,
 ð·þorð jøtna sonum;
 4 heill sá’s kvað, · heill sá’s kann,
 njóti sá’s nam,
 6 heilir þeir’s hlýddu.

[R 7v/7]

Now are the High One’s speeches sung in the High One’s hall,
 most useful for the sons of men,
 harmful for the sons of ettins.
 Hail him who sang! Hail him who knows!
 May he profit who learned!
 Hail those who heeded!

3 jøtna ‘ettins’ | *corr. by other hand from ýta ‘men’* R

ALL | This stanza is of great weight since it gives the whole poem a religious significance. The memorisation and recitation of the whole of *Háv* will both spiritually benefit mankind and injure the Ettins, the enemies of Gods and men; this dualistic worldview (Ettins–evil–wilderness against Gods–humans–settlement) is thoroughly pre-Christian. Cf. further Introduction to the whole poem above.

4–6 kvað, kann, nam, hlýddu ‘sang, knows, learned, heeded’ | The implicit object is the speeches. These verbs all indicate a fully oral cultural context.

Speeches of Webthrithner

(*Vafþrúðnis mól*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.894)

Meter: Leeds-meter

Introduction

The **Speeches of Webthrithner** (abbrev. *Vafþ*) describes a wisdom-contest between the god Weden and the ettin Webthrithner.

Textual preservation and transmission

Vafþ is preserved in full only in **R** (foll. 7v/9–8v/31), where it follows *Háv* and is followed by *Grm*. The latter part of the poem, from st. 20 onwards, is also preserved in **A** (fol. 3r/1–3v/22). Since the beginning of the poem has been lost in **A**, we cannot tell what text preceded it, but, as in **R**, it is followed by *Grm*.

Vafþ was clearly available to Snorre. Sts. 18, 30–31, 35, 37, 41, 45, 47, and 51 are cited in *Gylf*, and the lost form of the poem underlying *Gylf* may be called the **G** redaction. In the critical edition, **G** will refer to agreement between all four mss. of *Gylf* (**STWU**). It may be noted that st. 31 has lost its second helming (ll. 3–4) in both **R** and **A**, which points towards a shared textual relationship between **RA** to the exclusion of **G**.

Meter and stanza

Vafþ is composed in Leeds-meter and consists of 55 stanzas. Four lines may be considered defective and are irrestorable without conjectural emendation: 5/3, 34/1, 38/3 (see below), and 54/3. In addition, st. 40 is heavily emended.

The normal stanzaic configuration *abc abc* appears in 50 out of 55 sts. (1–26, 28–37, 39–41, 44–54). The singular configuration *abc* (27; see note) in the middle of the question-and-answer stanzas should undoubtedly be considered a defective variant of this configuration.

Four variant configurations are found. *abc abcc* (42) and *abcc abc* (43) are both variants of *abc abc*. They appear at an important transition in the poem, as Weden asks his last numbered question, introducing his final six questions about the end times. *abc abc abc* (55) only appears once, likewise at a charged location, namely in the final st., as Webthriðrinnr admits defeat.

A stranger variant is *abc ab abc* (38). This configuration may be taken as a mixing of Leeds-meter and Speeches-meter, but it is also possible that a c-verse has been lost following the central long-line *ab*. The fact that the long-line does not alliterate further hints at potential corruption, but it is clearly semantically crucial and cannot be removed from the stanza.

Narrative structure

The poem essentially consists of a riddle contest between the god Weden and the ettin Webthriðrinnr. Far from being a loose collection of mythic lore, it has a tight structure and logical plan throughout. The whole may be divided into four sections: the first is the prologue, where Weden takes counsel from his wife Frie and sets out for Webthriðrinnr's hall (sts. 1–10). The remaining three sections form the contest and consist of alternating stanzas where one side asks and the other answers. They are distinguished from each other by means of repeated refrains in the question stanzas and consist of Webthriðrinnr's four unnumbered questions (11–19), Weden's twelve numbered questions (20–43), and Weden's six unnumbered questions about the end times (44–55).

The following table illustrates the refrains; for stanza 40 see note there:

11–17	<i>Seg mér/þat, Gang-ráðr, · alls á golfi vill / þins of fręista frama</i>
20–42	<i>Seg þat (it) N(:a) · ... / ... Vafþrúðnir vitir</i>
44–54	<i>Fjölð ek fór, · fjölð fręistaða'k, / fjölð of ręynda'k ręgin</i>

Something ought to be said about the numerology of the questions. It is hardly a coincidence that Weden asks exactly eighteen questions, this being a multiple of the sacred number nine. It is especially notable that another Odinic list, Leed-tally (sts. 147–165) of *Háv*, also has eighteen items—even more so, since the eighteenth spell there, like the eighteenth question here, is a mystery known only to Weden himself. This circumstance reveals the care put into the structure of *Vafþ.*

Summary

The first scene of the poem assumes that the god Weden and his wife, Frie, are sitting together. Weden asks Frie for counsel, as he is curious about the ancient wisdom which the ettin Webthriðrinnr might possess (1). Frie expresses worry, since she considers Webthriðrinnr stronger than all other ettins (2), but Weden says that he has travelled far and wide and wants to know what Webthriðrinnr's hall is like (3). Frie wishes him good luck against the ettin (4), and he departs to challenge Webthriðrinnr's *orð-spęki* 'word-wisdom' (5). The god arrives at the ettin's hall and introduces himself (6);

Webthriðner promptly declares that his guest will not come out of the hall unless he be wiser than he (7). Weden introduces himself as Gangred, saying that he has come from afar in need of Webthriðner's hospitality (8). The ettin invites this Gangred to sit down (9), and the guest in turn utters a gnomic stanza (10) not unlike those of the first section of *Háv.*

Webthriðner begins by asking four mythological questions, each answered by Gangred in turn. The questions concern the horse that pulls the day (11–12), the horse that pulls the night (13–14), the river which divides the gods and ettins (15–16), and the plain where Surt and the gods will fight (17–18).

Webthriðner calls the guest learned and invites him to sit. He declares that the loser of the contest must give his head (19). The roles are now reversed, and Gangred poses twelve numbered questions to the ettin. The questions can be divided into three groups of four based on their subjects. Gangred first asks about the origins of cosmological phenomena: the earth and heaven (20–21), sun and moon (22–23), day and night (24–25), and winter and summer (26–27). His next four questions concern the earliest ettins: the ettin Earyelmer (28–29), Earyelmer's ancestry (30–31), how he reproduced without a partner (32–33), and what Webthriðner himself first remembers (34–35). The last four numbered questions are more sundry. Weden asks about the origin of the wind (36–37) and the god Nearth (38–39), about Walhall and the Oneharriers (40–41), and at last a meta-question: where Webthriðner learned such great wisdom (42–43).

The refrain and theme of the questions now change, as Gangred asks six unnumbered questions concerning the end times, all beginning with the same refrain. The disguised god asks which humans will survive the Fimblewinter (44–45), how the sun can rise after Fenrir has destroyed it (46–47), about some obscure maidens (48–49; see note), which Eese will survive after the flame of Surt goes out (50–51), and how Weden will die (52–53). Finally, he asks the unknowable question: what did Weden speak in the ear of Balder before he was burned on the pyre (54)?

Webthriðner at last understands the identity of his challenger, since only Weden himself could know the answer to that question. He laconically accepts his imminent death and the futility of his own wisdom; the poem ends with his admission that Weden will always be the wisest (55).

Dating

Vafþ displays archaic formal characteristics. The poem has an especially high frequency of the archaic particle *of*, appearing at a rate of 0.438 occurrences per 10 unique lines (Sapp 2022, p. 70). In addition, it displays alliteration between *v*- and old *vr*- (st. 53/2; Haukur Þorgeirsson 2016, p. 37), a highly archaic trait indicative of composition before ca. 1000 CE. The pre-Christian subject matter, which shows no sign of antiquarian composition, and which was likely not fully understood even by Snorre (see st. 35), also suggests an early date. In conclusion, *Vafþ* was likely composed in the 9th or 10th century—at any rate during the pre-Christian period.

Text

Vafþrúðnis mól ('The Speeches of Webthritner')

[Óðinn:] 1 „Ráð mér nú Frigg · alls mik fara tíðir [R 7v/9]
 2 at vitja Vafþrúðnis;
 for-vitni mikla · kveð’k mér á fornum stöfum
 4 við þann inn al-svinna jötun.“

[Weden:] “COUNSEL ME NOW, FRIE, as I long to journey
 to visit Webthritner.
 Great curiosity I have for the ancient staves
 of that all-wise ettin.”

3–4 for-vitni ... jötun. ‘Great ... ettin.’ | I.e., “I am very curious to learn his ancient words of wisdom.” Cf. st. 55.

[Frigg:] 2 „Hęima lętja · mynda’k Hęrja-fęðr [R 7v/12]
 2 i gęrðum gęða;
 þvít ęngi jętun · hugða’k jafn-ramman
 4 sęm Vafþrúðni vesa.“

[Frie:] “At home would I keep the Father of Hosts
 in the yards of the Gods,
 for no ettin have I judged to be
 as strong as Webthritner.”

1 Hęrja-fęðr ‘Father of Hosts’ | A name for Weden. For the second element, see *Vsp* 1/3 n.

[Óðinn:] 3 „Fjølð ek fęr, · fjølð fręistaða’k, [R 7v/13]
 2 fjølð of ręynda’k ręgin;
 hitt vil’k vita, · hvę Vafþrúðnis
 4 sala-kynni sęi.“

[Weden:] “Much I journeyed, much I tried,
 much I tested the Reins!
 One more thing I wish to know: how Webthritner’s
 halls may be.”

2 of | emend. (cf. st. 44/2); om. R

[Frigg:] 4 „Hęill þú farir, · hęill þú aprtr komir, [R 7v/15]
 2 hęill þú á sinnum sęir;
 óði þęr dugi · hvar’s skalt, Alda-fęðr,

4 orðum mēla jōtun.“

[Frie:] “Hale mayst thou journey; hale mayst thou come back;
hale mayst thou be on thy paths!
May thy wisdom avail thee where thou, Father of Mankind,
with words shalt greet the ettin!”

3 skalt | *add.* †or† R

3 Alda-fǫðr ‘Father of Mankind’ | A rare poetic name for Weden, also found in st. 53/1, but not otherwise used in Eddic poetry. Among genuine compositions, the name is only found elsewhere in the Scaldic Bragi *Þórr* 1/1 (in SkP 3), although it also appears in an antiquarian poetic list of names for Weden, *Þul Óðins* 1/2 (in SkP 3).

5 Fór þá Óðinn · at fręista orð-spęki
2 þęss ins al-svinna jōtuns;
at hǫllu hann kom, · es átti ĩms faðir;
4 inn gekk Yggr þegar.

[R 7v/17]

Then journeyed Weden to test the word-wisdom
of that all-wise ettin.
He came to the hall which Ime’s father [= Webthrithner] owned;
Ug (= Weden) went soon inside.

3 es | *emend.*; ok R

3 ĩms ‘Ime’s’ | Gen. sg. of *ĩmr*, an unknown ettin. The name is probably corrupt, since alliteration on *b-* is required by the strongly stressed *hǫllu* in the a-verse. Finnur Jónsson (1932) emends to *Hymis* ‘Hymer’s’.

4 Yggr ‘Ug’ | ‘The Terrorifer’, another name for Weden.

[Óðinn:] 6 „Heill þú nú, Vafþrúðnir, · nú em’k ĩ hǫll kominn
2 á þik sjalfan séa;
hitt vil’k fyrst vita, · ef fróðr séir
4 eða al-sviðr, jōtunn.“

[R 7v/18]

[Weden:] “Hale be thou now, Webthrithner! Now I am come into the hall
to see thy very self,
yet I wish first to know if thou be learned
or all-wise, ettin!”

[Vafþrúðnir:] 7 „Hvat ’s þat manna, · es ĩ mĩnum sal
2 verp=umk orði á?
út þú né kǫmr · örum hǫllum frá,
4 nema þú inn snotrari séir.“

[R 7v/20]

[Webthritner:] “What sort of man is this who in *my* hall
throws his word at me?
Out wilt thou not come from our halls
unless thou be the cleverer man!”

[Óðinn:] 8 „*Gang-ráðr* heiti’k, · nú em’k af *gongu* kominn,
2 þyrstr til þinna sala;
laðar þurfi · hef’k lengi farit
4 ok þinna and-fanga, jōtunn.“

[R 7v/22]

[Weden:] “Gangred I am called; now I am come from walking,
thirsty, to thy halls.
In need of a welcome I’ve journeyed for long,
and of thy reception, ettin!”

1 *Gang-ráðr* | *Gagn-ráðr* R

1 *Gang-ráðr* | ‘One who decides to walk’. The emendation is supported by the b-verse, where *gongu* (dat. sg. of *ganga* ‘walking, walk’) is probably tying back to the name. *Gang-ráðr* is also found in *Þul Óðins* 3/1 (SkP 3, Gurevich ed.). The variant *Gagn-ráðr* would mean ‘Victory-advisor’ and is not attested elsewhere. Note that Gurevich is incorrect when she states in her note to *Þul Óðins* 3/1 that *Gylf* 5:12 records the variant *Gagn-ráðr*. The relevant source mss., ST, only have the abbreviation *Þá spurði G.* ‘Then G. asked’, which clearly does not point one way or the other.

[Vafþrúðnir:] 9 „Hví þú þá, *Gang-ráðr*, · mēli=sk af *golfi* fyrir?
2 far þú i sess i sal;
þá skal fręista, · hvárr fleira viti,
4 gęstr eða inn gamli þulr.“

[R 7v/24]

[Webthritner:] “Why then, Gangred, dost thou speak from off the floor ahead?
Take a seat in the hall!
Then it shall be tried which of the two might know more:
the guest, or the old thyle.”

4 inn gamli þulr ‘the old thyle’ | Webthritner himself, the thyle being the lorekeeper whose purpose it was to recite the old wisdom poems. See Encyclopedia: thyle.

[Óðinn:] 10 „Ó-auðigr maðr, · es til auðigs kōmr,
2 mēli þarft eða þęgi;
ofr-męlgi mikil · hygg’k at illa geti
4 hveim’s við kald-rifjaðan kōmr.“

[R 7v/26]

[Weden:] “An unwealthy man who to a wealthy one comes
ought to speak the needful or shut up.
Great over-speaking I think will bring ill
for whomever comes upon a cold-ribbed man.”

2 mēli þarft eða þegi 'ought to speak the needful or shut up' | Formulaic, this line occurs identically in *Háv* 19.

4 kald-rífaðan 'cold-ribbed' | Cold-hearted, cunning.

[Vafþrúðnir:] 11 „Seg mér, Gang-ráðr, · alls á golfi vill
2 þíns ofrēista frama,
hvē hēstr hētir, · sá's hveṛjan dregr
4 dag of drótt-mögu.“

[R 7v/28]

[Webthritrner:] “Tell me, Gangred, since on the floor thou wilt
test thy furtherance,
what the horse is called which pulls every
day over the lads of the folk [MEN].”

ALL | Sts. 11–14 deal with the two horses that pull the day and night through the heavens. Their origin is discussed in *Gylf* 10:1–10 (the whole chapter): *Norvi eða Narfi hét jötunn, er byggði í Jötunheimum. Hann átti dóttur, er Nótt hét. Hon var svört ok dökk, sem þon átti elli til. Hon var gipt þeim manni, er Nagl-fari hét; þeira sonr hét Auðr. Því nést var þon gipt þeim, er Ánarr hét; Jorð hét þeira dóttir. Síðast átti bana Dellingr, ok var hann ása elli; var þeira sonr Dagr; var hann ljóss ok fagr eftir faðerni sínu. Þá tók Al-fjörðr Nótt ok Dag, son bennar, ok gaf þeim tvá besta ok tvær kerrur ok sendi þau upp á himin, at þau skulu ríða á hverjum tveim döggrum um-hverfis jörðina. Ríðr Nótt fyrri þeim best, er kallaðr er Hrim-faxi, ok at morgni hverjum döggrum hann jörðina af mál-dropum sínum. Sá best, er Dagr á, heitir Skin-faxi, ok lýsir allt lopt ok jörðina af faxi hans. 'Narrow or Narve was the name of an ettin who dwelled in the Ettin-homes. He had a daughter whose name was Night. She was black and dark like her lineage bespoke. She was married off to the man whose name was Nailfarer. Their son was Ead. Thereafter she was married off to the one whose name was Oner. Earth was the name of their daughter. Lastly Delling got her, and he was of the lineage of the Eese. Their son was Day; he was bright and fair after his father's side. Then Allfather took Night, and Day her son, and gave them two horses and two chariots and sent them up into the heaven that they should ride every two half-days a full circle around the earth. Night rides in front on the horse which is called Rimefax, and every morning he bedews the earth with the foam from his bit. The horse owned by Day is named Shinefax, and all the air and the earth is lit up by his mane.' They are mentioned again in *Skm* 72, which deals with legendary horses: *Ár-vakr ok Al-sviðr draga sólina, sem fyrr er ritat. Hrim-faxi eða Fjör-svartnir draga nóttina. Skin-faxi eða Gláðr fylgja deginum*. 'Yorewaker and Allswith pull the sun as is written earlier. Rimefax or Ferrowswartner pulls the night. Shinefax or Glad follows the day.' For Yorewaker and Allswith see *Grm* 38. The alternative names Ferrowswartner ('Life-darkener') and Glad probably derive from now-lost poetic sources.*

The motif of horses, especially mounted on chariots, pulling the heavenly bodies or day and night is very ancient, and is attested as far back as the Bronze Age. It is common in the hymns of *RV* and Greek texts, and is represented archeologically by the beautiful Trundholm Sun Chariot from Denmark of the Nordic Bronze Age, the cultural and ethnic ancestors of the Germanic peoples. See Figures 2 and 3, and cf. *Grm* 38 n.

2 þíns ofrēista frama 'test thy furtherance' | I.e., “try your luck, see how far you get”. Formulaic; cf. *Háv* 2/4.

[Öðinn:] 12 „Skin-faxi hētir, · es inn skíra dregr
2 dag of drótt-mögu;
hēsta batstr · þykkir hann með Hreið-gotum;
4 ey lýsir mön af mari.“

[R 7v/30]

[Weden:] “Shinefax is he called who pulls the pure
day over the lads of the folk.
The best of horses he seems among the Reth-Gots;
for ever that stallion’s mane lights up.”

3 *Hreið-gotum* | *metr. emend.*; ‘reið-gotom’ R

1 Skin-faxi ‘Shinefax’ | I.e., ‘the one with a shining mane’.

3 *Hreið-gotum* ‘Reth-Gots’ | An old name for the Eastern Gots around the Black Sea, also found in *Wid* 57 and *Ög* 136 *Rök*. The origin of the first element is unclear, but it appears to have a tribal significance (cf. the word *Hréd-cyning* ‘Reth-King’ in *Wid* 7). They are apparently mentioned here due to their connection with the east, the direction of the dawn. There may also be a pun present, since *goti* can mean both ‘Got’ and ‘horse’.

[Vafþrúðnir:] 13 „Seg þat, Gang-ráðr, · alls á golfi vill
2 þíns of fręista frama,
hvé jór heitir, · sá’s austan dreggr
4 nött of nýt regin.“

[R 7v/32]

[Webthrithner:] “Tell this, Gangred, since on the floor thou wilt
test thy furtherance,



Figure 2: The gilt (day) side of the Trundholm sun chariot. Nordic Bronze Age, ca. 1400 BCE. © Nationalmuseet. CC BY-SA 3.0. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Solvognen_Do_2010_1277.tif

what the steed is called which from the east does pull
the night over the bountiful Reins.”

4 nýt rēgin ‘the bountiful Reins’ | The Gods. *nýt* ‘bountiful’ is one of several positive adjectives that can stand before *rēgin*, and recurs in the same position in *Vafþ* 14/2, 25/3 below. Cf. *holl rēgin* ‘the hold Reins’ (*Lok* 4/3), *fróð rēgin* ‘the learned Reins’ (*Vafþ* 26/4), and *blíð rēgin* ‘the blithe Reins’ (*Grm* 6/1, 38/3, 42/1; sarcastically in *Lok* 32/3).

[Óðinn:] 14 „Hrīm·faxi hēitir, · es hvērja dręgr
2 nóttr of nýt rēgin;
mēl-dropa · fēllir hann morgin hvērjan;
4 þaðan kōmr dōgg of dala.“

[R 7v/33]

[Weden:] “Rimefax is he called who pulls each
night over the bountiful Reins.
Foam from his bit he lets fall each morning;
thence comes dew through the dales.”

2 of | *emend.*; ok R

1 Hrīm·faxi ‘Rimefax’ | I.e., ‘the one with a frozen mane’.

4 þaðan kōmr dōgg of dala ‘thence comes dew through the dales’ | For another explanation of the origin of dew, see *Vsp* 18.



Figure 3: The ungilt (night) side of the Trundholm sun chariot. © National-museet. CC BY-SA 3.0. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Solvogner_Do_2010_1278.tif

[Vafþrúðnir:] 15 „Seg þat, Gang-ráðr, · alls á golfi vill [R 8r/1]
 2 þins of fręista frama,
 hvé ǫ heitir, · sú's deilir með ȝotna sonum
 4 grund, ok með goðum.“

[Webthrithner:] “Tell this, Gangred, since on the floor thou wilt
 test thy furtherance,
 what the river is called which divides the land
 between the sons of Ettins and the Gods.”

[Óðinn:] 16 „Ífing heitir ǫ, · es deilir með ȝotna sonum [R 8r/2]
 2 grund, ok með goðum;
 opin rinna · hǫn skal umb aldr-daga;
 4 verðr=at íss á ǫu.“

[Weden:] “Íving is the river called which divides the land
 between the sons of Ettins and the Gods.
 Open shall it flow through its days of life;
 there forms no ice on that river.”

1 Ífing ‘Iving’ | The border river is not known by this name from any other source, not even *Gylf*, which otherwise tends to relay even the most obscure lore.

4 verðr=at íss á ǫu ‘there forms no ice on that river’ | For ice would enable the Ettins to cross over into the lands of the Gods.

[Vafþrúðnir:] 17 „Seg þat, Gang-ráðr, · alls á golfi vill [R 8r/3]
 2 þins of fręista frama,
 hvé vǫllr heitir, · es finna=sk vígi at
 4 Surtr ok in svǫsu goð.“

[Webthrithner:] “Tell this, Gangred, since on the floor thou wilt
 test thy furtherance,
 what the plain is called where they find each other at war,
 Surt and the beloved Gods.”

Óðinn: 18 „Vig-ríðr heitir vǫllr, · es finna=sk vígi at [R 8r/4, S 17r/24,
 2 Surtr ok in svǫsu goð; T TODO, W TODO]
 hundrað rasta · hann ’s á hverjan veg;
 4 sá ’s þeim vǫllr vitaðr.“

Weden: “Wighride is the plain called where they find each other at war,
 Surt and the beloved Gods.
 A hundred rests it reaches in each direction;
 for them that plain is marked out.”

3 hveṛjan | hveṛn T 4 vǫllr | add. of T

ALL | For the fight between Surt and the Gods cf. *Vsp* 48–53, *Fǫfn* 14–15. The st. is explained or paraphrased in *Gylf* 51:25: *Mú-spells megir sǫkja fram á þann vǫll er Vig-riðr heitir*. ‘The lads of Muspell make their attack on the plain which is called Wighride.’ and again in *Gylf* 51:28–29: *En Mú-spells synir hafa einir sér fylking, ok er sú björt mjök. Vǫllr’inn Vig-riðr er bundrað rasta víðr á hvern veg*. ‘But the sons of Muspell have a single formation, and it is very bright. The plain Wighride is a hundred rests wide in each direction.’ The stanza itself is cited in *Gylf* 51:51, the very end of that chapter, following the citation of *Vsp* 45–54, introduced by the words *Hér segir enn svá* ‘Here it further says so’. Note that it is omitted from U, one of the four *Gylf* mss.

3 rasta ‘rests’ | An old measurement of distance, ca. 1850 metres (CV, s.v. *rǫst*).

Vafþrúðnir: 19 „Fróðr est nú gestr, · far á þekk jǫtuns,
2 ok mǣlum=k i sessi saman;
hǫfði vęða · vit skulum hǫllu i
4 gestr, of goð-spęki.“

[R 8r/6]

Webthriðner: “Learned art thou now, guest; take the ettin’s bench
and let us speak in the seat together!
Wager a head shall we two in the hall,
O guest, over god-wisdom!”

1 Fróðr est nú gestr, · far á þekk jǫtuns ‘Learned art thou now, guest; take the ettin’s bench’ | I.e., “Thou hast proven thy learning.” Webthriðner acknowledges his guest’s wisdom and repeats his invitation for the god to sit down. Weden accepts the offer, and the contest continues; now it is Weden’s turn to ask, Webthriðner’s to answer.

Capitulum (‘New Chapter’)

Óðinn: 20 „Seg þat it ęina, · ef þitt óði dugir
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,
hvaðan jǫrð of kom, · eða upp-himinn
4 fyrst, inn fróði jǫtunn.“

[R 8r/9, A 3r/1]

Weden: “TELL THIS ONE if thy wisdom avails
and thou, Webthriðner, mightst know
whence Earth came or Up-heaven,
first, O learned ettin.”

1 Seg | S is a bold capital in R 1 óði | The first word on fol. 3r of A; from this point we have the poem in both manuscripts. 2 ok | eða A

3 jǫrð ... eða upp-himinn ‘Earth ... or Up-heaven’ | An old Common Germanic formulaic merism, referring to the whole universe. See Index of formulae: Earth and Up-heaven.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 21 „Ór Ymis holdi · vas jǫrð of skǫpuð,

[R 8r/10, A 3r/2]

2 en ór beinum björg,
 himinn ór hausi · ins hrīm-kalda jǫtuns,
4 en ór sveita sér.“

Quoth Webthrithner: “From Yimer’s flesh was the earth created,
 but from his bones the mountains;
the heaven from the skull of that rime-cold ettin,
 but from his blood the sea.”

ALL | The gods sacrificed Yimer and created the world from his body, as told more fully in *Grm* 41–42 and alluded to in *Vsp* 3–4. For Yimer, cf. sts. 30–33 below; for the deeper cosmological and religious significance of this myth see notes to *Vsp* 3–4 and also to *Grm* 43. — The whole st. bears very close resemblance to *Grm* 41; ll. 1 and 4 here are identical to ll. 1–2 there, and ll. 2 and 3a here are clearly related to ll. 3a and 4 there. Still, the sts. are distinct enough that the one cannot be a direct scribal copy of the other, and the relationship is more likely to be oral. Both have probably been composed in the same West Norwegian milieu, in turn deriving from an older Common Germanic tradition (cf. *Wessobrunn* under Poetry on Christian Subjects).

3 himinn ór hausi ‘the heaven from the skull’ | The heavens are understood as a dome, a view common to many ancient peoples. This also fits well with the floating clouds being Yimer’s brains, as told in *Grm* 42.

4 ór sveita sér ‘from his blood the sea’ | According to *Gylf* 7:3–4, the slaying of Yimer produced so much blood that it drowned the whole race of Rime-Thurses save one; see st. 35 below. For the method of slaying cf. *Sont* 3/3: *jǫtuns bals · undir þjóta* ‘the neck-wounds of the ettin [SEAS] roar’, which attests that Yimer was slain by decapitation, the typical way of wasting beasts of sacrifice (so e.g. *Hym* 15). That this is not a mere literary construct is proven by the excavation of the Viking Age site Hove-steads (*Hofstaðir*) on Iceland, where bulls were seasonally slain in what was undoubtedly ritual sacrifice: “The most likely reconstruction from the forensics of the skulls requires at least a two-person team, one of whom struck the animal between the eyes (effectively killing it and certainly stunning it into momentary immobility) while the second swung a fairly broad-bladed axe at the neck or base of the skull for a beheading stroke.” (Lucas and McGovern 2007, p. 23). After the slaying (and presumed feasting on the meat), the heads of the bulls were displayed for a prolonged period of time. Lucas and McGovern further note that swift beheading was not the usual manner of slaughtering animals on Iceland, and even has practical downsides compared to a slower cutting of the throat, e.g., splintered bones and damage to the cutting blade. On the other hand, the violent cutting and following flow of blood would have great dramatic effect, and, what Lucas and McGovern do not mention, clearly reenact the slaying of Yimer: the separation of the skull (heaven) from the body (earth), and the great flow of blood (sea-water) from the neck-wound, lastly the burial of the consumed body in the earth, and the display of the skull on high to symbolize the heaven. —

The ancients believed that the earth was surrounded on all sides by an outer sea (ON *út-bafr*); cf. *Hym* 5/1 n., 22/4 n.

4 sveita ‘blood’ | In poetry *sveiti* ‘sweat’ almost always means ‘blood’. This is shared with OE *swāt*, as seen e.g. in *Beow* 1286a: *sweord swāte fāh* ‘sword stained with “sweat”’, 2689b–2690: *hē ge-blōdegod wearð / sāwul-driore · swāt ȝeom wéoll*. ‘he was bloodied in soul-gore; the “sweat” gushed in waves’.

Öðinn kvað: 22 „Seg þat annat, · ef þitt öði dugir
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,
 hvaðan Máni of kom, · svát færr menn yfir,
4 eða Sól it sama.“

Quoth Weden: “Tell this other one, if thy wisdom avails,
 and thou, Webthrithner, mightst know

[R 8r/12, A 3r/3]

whence the Moon came which journeys over men,
or the Sun likewise.”

1–2 cf ... vitir | abbrev. as ‘c. þ. c. d. ʒ þ. v.’ R; abbrev. as ‘c. þ. c. d.’ A

ALL | For the origin of the Sun and Moon cf. *Grm* 38.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 23 „Mundil-fóri heitir, · hann ’s Mána faðir
2 ok svá Sólur it sama;
himin hverfa · þau skulu hverjan dag
4 ǫldum at ár-tali.“

[R 8r/13, A 3r/4]

Quoth Webthrithner: “Mundlefarer he is called—he is the father of the Moon,
and so of the Sun likewise.
Turn round heaven shall they every day,
for mankind’s tally of years.”

4 ár-tali | corr. in same band from ald-tali A

ALL | This st. clearly serves as a source of *Gylf* 11:1–3: *Þá mælti Gangleri: „Hversu stýrir hann gang sólar eða tungls?“ Hárr segir: „Sá maðr er nefndr Mundil-fari, er átti tvau börn. Þau voru svá fœgr ok fríð, at hann kallaði son sinn Mána, en dóttur sína Sól ok gípti bana þeim manni, er Glenr hét. [...]* ‘Then spoke Gangler: “How does He [viz. Allfather] rule the track of the sun or the moon?” High says: “There is a man named Mundlefarer who had two children. They were so fair and beautiful that he called his son ‘Moon’, but his daughter ‘Sun’, and he married her off to the man who was called Glen. [...]’ Cf. *Grm* 38 n., which cites *Gylf* 11:4–7.

1 Mundil-fóri ‘Mundlefarer’ | See Index for the etymology, which likens the cosmos to a Wiking Age flour-mill turned by a handle. His name is attested in *Gylf* 11:2 as *Mundil-fari*, which underlies the English rendition Mundlefarer.

4 ǫldum at ár-tali ‘for mankind’s tally of years’ | According to *Vsp* 6 the Gods gave names to night, the moon-phases, morning, midday, afternoon, and evening *órum at telja* ‘the years for to tally’. — Numerous examples of the chronological reckoning of the Heathen Icelanders are found in Are’s Book of Icelanders and in the Book of Land-Claims (*Ldn*). Both texts anchor the years to the Christian Common Era, but this is likely the result of later Christian learning. The counts were most likely originally based on the reigns of kings, of which many examples are found in those two books.

Óðinn kvað: 24 „Sæg þat it þriðja, · alls þik svinnan kveða
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,
hvaðan Dagr of kom, · sá’s fœrr drótt yfir,
4 eða Nøtt með niðum.“

[R 8r/15, A 3r/6]

Quoth Weden: “Tell this third, since they call thee wise,
and thou, Webthrithner, mightst know,
whence the Day came which journeys over the folk,
or the Night with the moon-phases.”

2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir | abbrev. as ‘ʒ þ. v. v.’ R 2 ok | eða A

4 Nött með niðum ‘Night with the moon-phases’ | Also found in *Vsp* 6/3.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 25 „Dellingr heitir, · hann’s Dags faðir,
2 en Nött vas Nörvi borin;
ný ok nið · skópu nýt regin
4 öldum at ár-tali.“

[R 8r/17, A 3r/8]

Quoth Webthritner: “Delling he is called; he is the father of Day,
but Night was born to Narrow.
The waxing and waning the bountiful Reins created
for mankind’s tally of years.”

1 Dellingr ‘Delling’ | A derivative of the adjective *dallr* ‘(possibly) shining, brilliant’ (cf. Old English *deal* ‘proud, exalted’) which appears in two other ON mythological names, viz. *Hegim-dallr* (the god Homedall) and *Mar-döll* (Meredall, an epithet of the goddess Frow. Also in these two instances the root appears to have connotations of light and brilliance; for Meredall see *Vsp* 24 n., *Prk* 8 n., and for Homedall see *Grm* 13, *Prk* 13/3 n., *Gylf* 27 (ed. under *Eddbr* III).

2 Nörvi ‘Narrow’ | Dat. sg. of *Nörr*, to be identified with the *Nörvi* (or *Narfi*) of *Gylf* 10:1 (see st. 11 n.). His name may be a kenning for the Gap of Hawks or primordial chaos (cf. *Vsp* 3/4 n.) and thereby equivalent to the Greek χάος ‘gap, Chaos’, father of Νύξ ‘Night’ (*Theog* 123).

3 ný ok nið ‘The waxing and waning’ | The two halves of the moon cycle, by which months (‘moon-ths’) were reckoned. The phrase also occurs in *Gut* 2: *um ný ok niðar*, *Gula* 57: *um ný bit nęsta ok niðar*, and *Gylf* 11:8: *Máni stýrir gongu tungls ok ręðr nýjum ok niðum* ‘Moon steers the track of the lunar body and rules over the waxings and wanings’. For the Norse-Germanic calendar see notes to *Vsp* 6.

Óðinn kvað: 26 „Seg þat it fjórða, · alls þik fróðan kveða,
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,
hvaðan vetr of kom · eða varmt sumar
4 fyrst með fróð regin.“

[R 8r/18, A 3r/9]

Quoth Weden: “Tell this fourth, since they call thee learned,
and thou, Webthritner, mightst know
whence the Winter came or the warm Summer,
first, amidst the learned Reins.”

1–2 alls ... vitir | *abbrev. as* ‘a. þ. f.’ RA 4 með | of A

1 fróðan ‘learned’ | It seems indisputable that the word hiding behind the abbreviated *f.* of the mss. is the m. acc. sg. of the adj. *fróðr*, but as it is not written out explicitly it must be marked by italics.

Vafþrúðnir: 27 „Vind·svalr heitir, · hann’s Vetrar faðir,
2 en Svósuðr Sumars.“
[...]

[R 8r/20, A 3r/10]

Webthritrner: “Windswale is he called; he is the father of the Winter;
but Sosuth is the Summer’s.”

ALL | This st. is paraphrased in *Gylf* 19:3–4: *Svásuðr beitir sá, er faðir Sumars er, ok er hann svá sēl-lífr, svá at af hans beiti er þat kallat svásligt, er blítt er. En faðir Vetrar er ýmist kallaðr Vind-lóni eða Vind-svalr. Hann er Vasaðar son, ok vǫru þeir óttungar grimmir ok sval-brjóstaðir, ok befir Vetr þeira skap-lyndi.* ‘Sosuth is the name of he who is the father of Summer, and he lives so joyously that from his name that which is glad is called ‘delightful’. But the father of Winter is variously called Windloon or Windswale. He is the son of Wosuth, and those kinsmen were cruel and cool-breasted, and Winter has their temperament.’

3 [...] | The second half of the st. seems to be missing. Its contents are unknown, but may be preserved in the *Gylf* paraphrase. No lacuna is indicated in the mss.

Óðinn kvað: 29 „Sæg þat it fimta, · alls þik fróðan kveða,
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,
hverr ása eldstr · eða Ymis niðja
4 yrði í ár-daga.“

[R 8r/2l, A 3r/1l]

Quoth Woden: “Tell this fifth, since they call thee learned,
and thou, Webthritrner, mightst know
who, oldest of the Eese or of Yimer’s kinsmen [ETTINS],
arose in days of yore.”

1–2 alls ... vitir | *abbrev. as* ‘a. þ. f. R; *abbrev. as* ‘a. þ. f. k.’ A

3–4 hverr ... ár-daga ‘who ... days of yore.’ | I.e., “Which was the very first being?” Cf. the question on the cryptic C9th Malt Stone (DR NOR1988;5): *huarisi : alistiąsa*, perhaps *Hvar er inn eldsti ása?* ‘Who is the eldest of the Eese?’

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 29 „Ør-ófi vetra · áðr véri jorð of sköpuð,
2 þá vas Ber-gelmir borinn;
Þrúð-gelmir · vas þess faðir,
4 en Aur-gelmir afi.“

[R 8r/22, A 3r/12]

Quoth Webthritrner: “Uncountable winters before the Earth was created,
then was Bareyelm born.
Thrithyelm was that one’s father,
and Earyelm the grandfather.”

2 vas | *om.* A

Óðinn kvað: 30 „Sæg þat it sétta, · alls þik svinnan kveða,
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,
hvaðan Aur-gelmir kom · með jötna sonum
4 fyrst, inn fróði jötunn.“

[R 8r/23, A 3r/14,
S 2v/17, T 3r/28,
W TODO]

Quoth Weden: “*Tell this sixth, since they call thee wise,
and thou, Webthritner, mightst know*
whence Earyelmer came amidst the sons of ettins,
first, O learned ettin.”

1–2 Seg ... vitir ‘Tell ... know’ | *om.* G 1 Seg þat it | *abbrev. as* ‘S. þ. þ. h.’ (*för* ‘S. þ. h.’) A
1–2 alls ... vitir | *abbrev. as* ‘a. þ. s. q.’ R; *abbrev. as* ‘a. þ. f. k.’ (*influenced by sts. 26, 28*) A

ALL | In *Gylf* 5:12, Snorre cites *Vafþ* 30/3–4 and the full 31 in support of his lengthy and embellished creation narrative, introduced by the words *En hér segir svá Vafþríúðnir jötunn*: ‘but here the ettin Webthritner says so’, though it is not certain that his vision is what the poet of *Vafþ* had in mind.

Vafþríúðnir kvað: 31 „Ör Ēli-vógum · stukku ęitr-dropar,
2 svá óx und’s ór varð jötunn;
þar örar ęttir · kómu allar saman;
4 því’s þat ę alt til atalt.“

[R 8r/25, A 3r/15,
S 2v/17, T 3r/29,
W TODO, U TODO]

Quoth Webthritner: “Out of the Ilewaves splashed droplets of venom;
so it grew until there became an ettin from it.
Thereof our lineages all came together;
therefore it is for ever all too fierce.”

1 Ör | Þá’s ór S 2 svá ‘so’ | ok ‘and’ G 2 óx und’s ór varð jötunn | vöxtr vinds ok varð jötunn
ór ‘the growth of the wind and there became an ettin from it’ (*för* ‘*óx unds varð jötunn ór’) U 2 ór
varð | *rev.* TW 3–4 þar ... atalt ‘Thereof ... fierce’ | *om.* RA. 3 þar | þer U; *add.* eru S 3
örar | þonar† T, ęinar U 3 kómu | komnar S; koma U 3 allar | *om.* U 4 því’s þat ę alt til
atalt | *om.* U 4 ę | *om.* TW 4 til | eða T; *om.* W

ALL | Over æons the splashing droplets from the primæval venomous rivers, the Ilewaves, combined until they formed a sentient being. This was Earyelmer, whom *Gylf* 5:9 (most likely correctly) identifies with Yimer, for whom cf. *Vsp* 3/1 n.

1 Ēli-vógum ‘Ilewaves’ | The wild ettin-ish rivers near the edge of the world; cf. *Hym* 5/1. The Ilewaves (*Ēli-vógar*) are likely a reflex of the primæval salty Waters found in many West Eurasian mythologies, including Genesis 1:1–3 and *ŘV* 10.129. Of those two foundational religious sources the latter agrees more closely with the present stanza and certainly holds the more archaic conception; for the Jewish Waters (Hebrew מַיִם *r’hóm*) and their Mesopotamian and Egyptian predecessors cf. Waschke (2006).

Whereas we in the Jewish narrative find a *creation out of nothing*—at the very beginning of time Elohim’s spirit is on the Waters and He makes the light shine over them—we instead find in the two Indo-European texts *Vafþ* and *ŘV* a *spontaneous emergence* of a single primæval entity long before the Gods are born, here from the violent splashing of venom, in *ŘV* 10.129.3 from “the power of heat” (OI *tápas mabíná*). This entity in turn asexually begets sexual beings—here through rubbing his limbs together (*Vafþ* 33), in *ŘV* 10.129.4 by giving rise to “desire” (*kāma*) which serves as the “primal seed of thought” (*mānasas řētas prat’amām*). It is from these beings that the world is populated by the raw matter out of which the Gods eventually create (or *shape*) the World as we know it through the Creative Act of the First Sacrifice (see st. 21 above, *Vsp* 3–4, 6–7, *Grm* 41–43). It should be noted that the Ilewaves also correspond to the Greek Earth-bounding river Ὠκεανός, especially in its earlier conception; cf. *Hym* 5/1 n.

1 ęitr-dropar ‘droplets of venom’ | This ęitr ‘venom’ of the Waves is probably to be understood as referring to extreme saltiness. Yimer’s blood gives rise to the salty sea; and the stoniness of his bones, perhaps originally thought of as salt-stone, is attested for both his skull (Heaven, the stoney Firmament; *Hárþ* 15/2) and his body (the Earth and Bedrock; st. 21/2, *Grm* 41/3). To this day, something very salty is said to be *ettersalt* in modern Swedish.

4 þat 'it' | The ettin race.

Óðinn kvað: 32 „Sæg þat it sjaunda, · alls þik svinnan kveða,
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,
hvé sá bǫrn gat · inn baldni jǫtunn,
4 es hann hafði=t gýgjar gaman.“

[R 8r/26, A 3r/16]

Quoth Woden: “Tell this seventh, since they call thee wise,
and thou, Webthriðner, mightst know
how he begot children, that stubborn ettin,
when he knew no troll-woman’s pleasure.”

1 Sæg þat it | abbrev. as ‘S. þ. h.’ A 1–2 alls ... vitir | abbrev. as ‘a. þ. s. q.’ R; abbrev. as ‘a. þ. s. k.’ A 3 baldni ‘stubborn’ | so A; aldni ‘olden’ R

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 33 „Und hendi vaxa · kvǫðu hrím-þursi
2 mey ok mög saman;
fótr við fǫti · gat ins fróða jǫtuns
4 sex-höfðaðan son.“

[R 8r/27, A 3r/17]

Quoth Webthriðner: “Under the arm of the rime-thurse, they said, did grow
a maiden and a lad together.
Foot against foot begat for the learned ettin
a six-headed son.”

3 gat | om. A

ALL | This stanza is paraphrased in Gylf 5:16–18: *Ok svá er sagt, at þá er hann svaf, fekk hann sveita. Þá óx undir vinstri bendi bönum maðr ok kona, ok annarr fótr hans gat son við þöðrum. En þaðan af kómu ęttir. Þat eru hrím-þursar.* ‘And so it is said that when he slept he began to sweat. Then grew within his left hand a man and a woman, and one foot of his begat a son by the other. But thereof come lineages. Those are Rime-Thurses.’

1–3 Und hendi ... fótr við fǫti ‘Under the arm ... Foot against foot’ | The image is masturbatory and monstrous; for its significance cf. st. 31 n.

Óðinn kvað: 34 „Sæg þat it ǫttunda, · alls þik fróðan kveða,
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,
hvat fyrst of mant · eða fremst of vęitst,
4 þú est al-sviðr jǫtunn.“

[R 8r/29, A 3r/18]

Quoth Woden: “Tell this eighth, since they call thee learned,
and thou, Webthriðner, mightst know
what first thing thou recallest or earliest knowest—
thou art all-wise, ettin!”

1 Sæg þat it | abbrev. as ‘S. þ. h.’ A 1–2 alls ... vitir | abbrev. as ‘a. þ. f.’ R; abbrev. as ‘a. þ. f. k.’ A 3^a of | om. R

1 Sæg þat it óttunda, · alls þik fróðan kveða ‘Tell this eighth, since they call thee learned’ | This line lacks the required alliteration, which has probably been lost in manuscript transmission due to the repetitive nature of the refrain. Alliteration may be obtained by replacing *alls þik fróðan kveða* with *ef þitt óði dugir* from sts. 20 and 22, or (less favourably) with *alls þik svinnan kveða* from 24, where the alliteration in the a-verse does not fall on the ordinal.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 35 „Ør·ófi vetra · áðr véri jorð of sköpuð,
2 þá vas Ber·gelmir borinn;
þat ek fyrst of man, · es inn fróði jötunn
4 á vas lúðr of lagiðr.“

[R 8r/30, A 3r/19,
S 3r/4, T 3v/20,
W TODO, U TODO]

Quoth Webthrithner: “Uncountable winters before the Earth was created,
then was Bareyelmir born.
This I first remember, when the learned ettin
on the canoe was laid.”

3 ek | er TW 3 es inn fróði | at fróða U 4 á vas | so ASWU; rev. RT

ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf* 7:6, introduced by the words *svá sem bér segir* ‘just as it says here’. The preceding *Gylf* 7:2–5 interprets it in the following way: the sons of Byre (that is, Weden, Will, and Wigh) slew the ettin Yimer, but when he died so much blood flowed from his wounds that the whole race of Ettins was drowned, save for Bareyelmir and his household, who survived by getting up on his *lúðr* (cf. note to this word below).

The flood-myth in *Gylf* 7:2–5 is clearly related to the Great Flood or Deluge as known from many mythologies, most famously Genesis 6–9. Although it may be a genuine Germanic reflex of the same ancient myth (cf. *Vsp* 4 n., 56/1 n.), it may also be Snorre’s own invention based on the Bible in an attempt to explain the present stanza, which may in fact have been as obscure to him as it is to us.

4 lúðr ‘canoe’ | In Old Norse prose *lúðr* usually means ‘trumpet, blowing horn’, less commonly ‘flour-bin’, but the underlying sense seems to be ‘hollowed-out wood’, which is why it is presently translated as ‘canoe’. As noted above Snorre seems to interpret it as a form of ark on which Bareyelmir found refuge from the flood, but considering the transitive nature of Bareyelmir’s being laid (*of lagiðr*) upon it, the stanza may instead be interpreted as speaking of a ship burial, so that the first thing Webthrithner remembers is Bareyelmir’s funeral.

Óðinn kvað: 36 „Sæg þat it níunda, · alls þik svinnan kveða,
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,
hvaðan vindr of kœmr · svá’t færr vág yfir,
4 é menn hann sjalfan of séa.“

[R 8r/32, A 3r/21]

Quoth Weden: “Tell this ninth, since they call thee wise,
and thou, Webthrithner, mightst know
whence the wind comes which fares o’er the wave—
always men see his very self.”

1 Sæg þat it | abbrev. as ‘S. þat h.’ A 1–2 alls ... vitir | abbrev. as ‘a. þ. s. q. e.’ R; ‘a. þ. s. k.’ A
4 menn hann sjalfan of séa | maðr of sjalfan hann sér A

ALL | Sts. 36–37 are paraphrased by Gylf 18:1–6: *Þá mælti Gangleri: „Hvaðan kemr vindr? Hann er sterkur, svá at hann hrérir stór bǫf, ok hann  sir eld. En svá sterkur sem hann er, þ  má eigi sj  hann; því er hann undar=liga skapaðr.“ Þ  m lti H rr: „Þat kann ek vel segja þ r.   norðan-verðum himins enda sitr j tunn s , er Hr =svelgr heitir. Hann befir arnar-ham, en er hann beinir flug, þ  standa vindar undan v ngjum hans. “Then Gangler spoke: “Whence comes the wind? It is so strong that it stirs great oceans and it fans flame. But as strong as it is yet one cannot see it. Therefore it is wondrously created.” Then High spoke: “That I can tell thee well. At the northern end of heaven sits the ettin who is called Rawswallower. He has an eagle’s hame, and when he takes to flight then the winds come from under his wings.”*

After this, st. 37 is cited in *Gylf* 18:7, introduced by the words *H r segir sv * ‘Here it says so’.

4   m nn hann sjalfan of s a ‘always men see his very self’ | Perhaps a reference to the sea which is never perfectly still, so that the wind is always seen on the waves. It is also possible that a negative clitic *-t* has been lost from the verb *s a* ‘see’, in which case the line should be interpreted as ‘never men see his very self’. The loss of an original negative is supported by *Gylf* 18:3: *m  eigi sj  hann* ‘one cannot see it’.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 37 „Hr =svelgr h itir, · es sitr   himins  nda,
2 j tunn   arnar ham;
af hans v ngjum · kve a vind koma
4 alla m nn yfir.“

[R 8r/34, A 3r/22,
S 5v/21, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

Quoth Webthritrner: “Rawswallower is he called who sits at heaven’s end,
an ettin in an eagle’s hame.
From his wings they say the wind comes
over all men.”

1 h itir | *add.* j tunn U 1 es | hann U 3 koma | standa U

1 Hr =svelgr ‘Rawswallower’ | ‘Devourer of Carrion’.

  inn kvað: 38 „S g þat it t unda, · alls þ  t va r k
2  ll Vafþr  nir vitir,
hva an Nj r r of kom · me   sa sonum;
4 hofum ok h rgum · hann r  r hund-m rgum
ok var =at hann  sum alinn.“

[R 8v/1, A 3r/24]

Quoth Weden: “Tell this tenth, since thou the rakes of the Tews
all, Webthritrner, mightst know,
whence Nearth came in the midst of the sons of the Eese.
Of hoves and harrows he rules a hundred-many,
and he was not begotten by the Eese.”

1 S g þat it | *abbrev. as* ‘S. þat h.’ A 1 alls | *abbrev. as* ‘a.’ RA 5 var =at | vas=at A

1 t va r k ‘rakes of the Tews’ | The fated events or narrations of the Gods.

3 hvaðan Njörðr of kom · með ása sonum | This line lacks both alliteration and a following c-verse, which may point towards textual corruption. Finnur Jónsson (1932) opts to change the b-verse to **með niðjum ása*, a perfectly sensible emendation, although the expected c-verse is still missing. For that reason, I instead wish to propose the following conjectural restoration: *bvaðan Njörðr of kom · af Nóa-túnum / ár með ása sonum* ‘whence Nearth of the Nowetons came of yore in the midst of the sons of the Eese’, where **af Nóa-túnum / ár* would have been omitted due to the visual similarity between **túnum* and *sonum*.

4 hofum ok horgum ‘hoves and harrows’ | A formulaic merism for cultic sites. *horgr* ‘harrow’ is a cultic place, not the agricultural implement; cf. *Vsp* 7 n. For Nearth in connection with harrows cf. *Grm* 16, where it is said that Nearth *rððr bǫ-timbruðum horgi* ‘rules the harrow timbered on high’. Also of interest is *Lok* 51, where the goddess Shede speaks of her *vé ok vangar* ‘wighs and wongs’, two terms common in religious place names. The underlying theological understanding seems to be that the god or goddess is physically present in his or her shrine as its ruler (Turville-Petre 1975, p. 238).

4 hund-morgum ‘a hundred-many’ | Probably a reference to the large number of cultic sites named after Nearth; among modern place names Brink (2007) counts 13 in Norway, 17 in Sweden, and 3 in Denmark, but those numbers must have been much greater in the pre-Christian period.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 39 „Í Vana-heimi · skópu hann vís regin
2 ok sældu at gíslingu goðum,
3 ï aldar røk · hann mun aptr koma
4 heim með vísum vǫnum.“

[R 8v/3, A 3r/26]

Quoth Webthritner: “In Wanham the wise Reins created him
and sold him as a hostage to the Gods.
In the Rakes of the Age he will come back
home amidst the wise Wanes.”

3 hann mun | *rev. A*

ALL | In later prose sources we learn that following the settlement between the Eese and the Wanes (i.e., the two tribes of Gods), Nearth, who belonged to the Wanes, was sent to the Eese as a hostage. Note however that *goð* ‘Gods’ in l. 2 here seems to refer exclusively to the Eese. For this narrative cf. *Vsp* 22 n., *Gylf* 23:6 (edited in the pres. ed. as *Eddbr* II), and *Yng* 4. *Lok* 34–35 mentions that Nearth was sent as a hostage to the Ettins, but that is certainly a different episode, although the shared motif of Nearth as a hostage is notable.

1 vís regin ‘the wise Reins’ | ON *regin* ‘the Reins, Powers’ is normally one of a number of terms used to refer to the gods as a collective (Simek 2010, pp. 10–11), but here seems to refer specifically to the Wanes in opposition to the Eese.

3 aldar røk ‘the Rakes of the Age’ | The Rakes of the Reins, the End Times.

Öðinn kvað: 40 „Sæg þat it ellipta, · ef þitt ðði dugir
2 ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir,
3 hvar allir · ýtar túnum ï
4 hoggva=sk hverjan dag.“

[R 8v/5, A 3r/28]

Quoth Weden: “Tell this eleventh, if thy wisdom avails,
and thou, Webthritner, mightst know
where all men in yards
strike each other every day.”

1 Seg þat it | abbrev. as ‘S. þ. e.’ A 1–2 ef ... vitir, | emend.; om. all. 3 allir | emend.; om. all.

ALL | This question-stanza is malformed in both R and A and thus has to be partly reconstructed on the basis of st. 41. The ms. preservation of Vafþ 40–41 is as follows: All four mss. of *Gylf* attest only st. 41 (the answer-stanza, cf. note there) with no textual variants. R has two half-stanzas which are clearly a mix between the question and the answer: *Segðu þat et .xi. hvar ytar tunom i haggvaz hverian dag. Ynom. Val þeir kjosa oc riða vígi fra sitia meirr vm sáttir saman.* Although this forms a complete stanza it stands out by lacking a refrain in the first two lines, something found in all other question-sts. in Vafþ (see Introduction). The word *Ynom* (where the ‘Y’ has a vertical line going between the two branches at the top) is unexplained. A has two half-stanzas, clearly marked by the speaker notes in the margins. The first one is by Weden: *S. þ. e. xi. allir eins heriar ödins tunum i haggvaz hverian dag.* The second by Webthritner: *Val þeir kjosa ok riða vígi fra sitia meirr vm sáttir saman.* This situation is also corrupt. In order to restore st. 40 to a full four lines, two conjectural emendations have been adopted in the pres. ed.: In lines 1b–2 the refrain *ef þitt óði dugir ok þú Vafþrúðnir vitir* ‘if thy wisdom avails, and thou, Webthritner, mightst know’ has been inserted from sts. 20 and 22, which also have ordinal numbers alliterating with vowels. In line 3a the word *allir* ‘all’ has been inserted from st. 41 to get vowel-alliteration with 3b *ýtar*.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 41 „Allir ein-herjar · Öðins túnun i
2 hoggva=sk hverjan dag;
val þeir kjósa · ok riða vígi frá,
4 sitja meirr of sáttir saman.“

[A 3r/28, S 10r/17,
T TODO, W TODO,
U TODO]

Quoth [Webthritner]: “All the Oneharriers in Weden’s yards
strike each other every day.
The slain they choose and ride from the fray,
then sit agreed once more together.”

1 ein-herjar | so G; eins herjar A

ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf* 41:5, introduced by the words *svá sem hér segir* ‘just as it says here’. The immediately preceding prose passage *Gylf* 41:1–4 provides context: *Þá mælti Gangleri: „All-mikill mann-fjöldi er i Val-höll. Svá njóta trú minnar, at all-mikill þegðingi er Óðinn, er hann stýrir svá miklum ber. Eða hvat er skemmtun Ein-berja, þá er þeir drekka eigi?“ Hárr segir: „Hvern dag, þá er þeir þafa klæðt=sk, þá ber-væða þeir sik ok ganga út i garðinn ok berja=sk, ok fellir hverr annan. Þat er leikr þeira. Ok er liðr at dögurðar-máli, þá riða þeir heim til Val-ballar ok setja=sk til drykkju. “Then spoke Gangler: “There is an all-great gathering of men in Walhall. Such makes me believe that Weden is an all-great chieftain when he wields such a great host. But what is the entertainment of the Oneharriers when they do not drink?” High says: “Every day when they have got dressed then they gear themselves up for war and go out into the yard and fight, and each one slays the other. That is their game. And when it is getting close to supper-time then they ride home to Walhall and seat themselves at their drinking.”*

For the Oneharriers cf. *Grm* 18/4, 24/3, 37/6, 53/3.

3 val þeir kjósa ‘The slain they choose’ | It is from this verbal phrase that the female agent noun *val-kyrja* ‘walkirrie’ is derived.

[Óðinn] kvað: 42 „Seg þat it tolpta, · hví þú tíva røk
2 qll Vafþrúðnir vitir?
Frá jǫtna rúnum · ok allra goða

[R 8v/6, A 3v/1]

4 þú it sannasta segir,
inn al-svinni jötunn.“

Quoth [Weden]: “Tell this twelfth, why thou the rakes of the Tews
all, Webthrithner, shouldst know?
From the runes of the ettins and all the gods
dost thou speak the truest,
O all-wise ettin!”

[Vafþrúðnir] kvað: 43 „Frá jötna rúnum · ok allra goða
2 ek kann segja satt,
því't hvæn hef'k heim of komit,
4 níu kom'k heima · fyr nífl-hel neðan;
hinig deýja ór helju halir.“

[R 8v/8, A 3v/2]

Quoth [Webthrithner]: “From the runes of the ettins and all the gods
I can speak truly,
for I have come into each Home.
Into nine Homes I came beneath Nivelhell;
that way men die out of Hell.”

4–5 níu ... halir. ‘Into nine ... of Hell’ | Apparently lower Underworlds. Cf. Snorre, who writes about Lock’s daughter Hell in *Gylf* 34:6: *Hel kastaði bann í Nífl-beim ok gaf benni vald yfir níu heimum, at hón skyldi skipta öllum vistum með þeim, er til bennar vóru sendir, en þat eru sótt-dauðir menn ok elli-dauðir.* ‘He [Weden, the Allfather] threw Hell into Nivelham and gave her dominion over nine Homes that she would deal out all provisions between those who were sent to her—but those are men dead of sickness and dead of old age.’ Finnur Jónsson (1932) considers *ór helju* ‘out of Hell’ a later interpolation, probably for metrical reasons.

Óðinn kvað: 44 „Fjölð ek fôr, · fjölð fręistaða'k,
2 fjölð of reynda'k regin;
hvat lifir manna, · þá's inn męra líðr
4 fimbul-vetr með firum?“

[R 8v/11, A 3v/4]

Quoth Weden: “*Much I journeyed, much I tried,
much I tested the Reins!*
What remains of men when the famed Fimble-Winter
passes amidst the folk?”

2 fjölð | *abbrev. as ‘f’* RA 2 of | *so A; om. R*

ALL | This question (Weden’s thirteenth) begins the third and final group of questions. The subject shifts toward eschatology and the first two lines of each question-stanza feature the refrain found in st. 3/1–2. For the events of the End Times, cf. *Vsp* 39–55 and *Gylf* 51; for the world to come, cf. *Vsp* 56–62, *Gylf* 52–53.

3–4 inn męra ... fimbul-vetr ‘the famed Fimble-Winter’ | The great winter of the end times. The Fimblewinter is not mentioned in *Vsp*’s description of the End Times, although bad weather and a blackening of the sun is mentioned in *Vsp* 40/3–4; snow during the End Times is also mentioned in *Hdl* 41/3.

Gylf 51:1–4 gives us a more detailed description of the Fimbulwinter: *Þá mælti Gangleri: „Hver tíðendi eru at segja frá um ragna-rökr? Þess hef ek eigi fyrr beyrt getit.“ Hárr segir: „Mikil tíðendi eru þaðan at segja ok mörg, þau in fyrstu, at vetr sá kemr, er kallaðr er fimbul-vefr. Þá drífr snér ór öllum áttum. Frost eru þá mikil ok vindar hvassir. Ekki nýtr sólar. Þeir vetr fara þrír saman ok ekki sumar milli. ‘Then spoke Gangler: “Which tidings are to be told about the Twilight of the Reins? I have not heard it spoken of before.” High says: “There are great tidings to be told thereof and many are they; the first that the winter will come which is called the Fimbulwinter. Then snow comes down from all directions. The cold is great then and the winds biting. The sun is of no use. Those winters pass three together and no summer between them.’ For the immediately following prose in Gylf 51:5–6 see Vsp 44 n.*

Comparatively, an eschatological winter is known also from Zoroastrian Iranian sources, as described by Hultgård (2007). In one version the great winter sees numerous men and cattle killed, with the survivors finding refuge in a shelter. Although the parallels to the Norse Fimbulwinter are not great in number, the Iranian narratives are similar enough for Hultgård (2007, pp. 116–118) to make note that they may share a common Indo-European origin with the Norse.

In recent scholarship Gräslund (2008) has identified the Fimbulwinter as a traumatic reflex of the archeologically documented volcanic winter of 536–537 CE, where a cloud of volcanic ash blocked out the light of the sun during the summer. Gräslund rejects Hultgård’s comparative explanation and argues that the details of the Fimbulwinter (the length of three years, the lack of summer, and the high mortality rate) are “highly precise” and therefore unlikely to stem from a long-lasting oral traditions (Gräslund 2008, pp. 94–95). This is undoubtedly a subjective line of argument, since the details are in fact rather sparse and not in agreement with the archeological record: all humans were not wiped out in 536, and the sun was not totally blocked out for three whole years. Gräslund also conveniently omits the prediction of three winters of violence immediately preceding the three winters of the Fimbulwinter as found in Gylf 51:5, since that can hardly be tied to his view of a historical reflex (unless we are to believe that there was a huge war in 532–534!).

As further support for his idea of historical trauma, Gräslund (2008, pp. 99–101) cites an episode from the *Kalevala* (songs 47–49) wherein the evil witch *Louhi* steals the sun, moon, and fire and hides them in the Underworld. According to Gräslund this would also be a reflex of the climate catastrophe of 536 CE, but by making this connection he in fact undermines his own argument. Gräslund is undoubtedly correct that the core concern of the Fimbulwinter is not that the winter itself is harsh, but rather that the summer itself does not come, but such fears about malevolent supernatural interruptions to vital cosmic cycles are by no means isolated to sources composed after 536 CE. As early as *RV* (ca. 1500–1200 BCE) there is the myth of the Dawns imprisoned in a cave by the enemies of the Gods, thereby preventing the natural cycle between day and night (Brereton and Jamison 2020, pp. 70–71), and the motif of Ettins trying to steal away things vital for the survival of mankind and the gods, not just the sun and moon, but also Thunder’s hammer, is found elsewhere in Norse myth (cf. Vsp 24/4 n., Introduction to *Þrk*).

It is clear that the return of the better side of the natural cycles (summer from winter, day from night, the full moon from the new) was of great concern to the ancients. Though the volcanic winter of 536–537 was exceptionally severe, it cannot be (as Gräslund claims) the historical basis of every reflex of that motif when the examples demonstrably go back as far as the Bronze Age and likely beyond. What is more, such worries could surely be fueled not just by volcanic trauma but by eclipses and cold summers (cf. Eyv Lv 12–14 in SkP 1) which have been occurring since time immemorial. To pre-modern farmers, for whom the performance of the fields meant life and death, the return of summer and daylight were by no means felt inevitable, but were rather fraught with worry and therefore heralded with great rejoicing. To conclude, I agree with Hultgård that the Fimbulwinter may well be Indo-European.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 45 „Líf ok Leifþrasir, · en þau leyna=sk munu
2 i holti Hodd-mimis;
morgin-doggvar · þau sér at mat hafa;
4 en þaðan af aldir ala=sk.“

Quoth Webthrichner: “Life and Lafthraser—but they will hide themselves in Hoardmimer’s wood.

[R 8v/13, A 3v/6,
S 17v/17, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

Morning dew will they have as food,
but thereof is mankind begotten.”

1 Leifþrasir | so ASW; Lifþrasir R; Leifþrasir T; †lifþraser† U 1 en þau leyna-sk munu | er þar leynast meyjar ‘wbo there bide, as maidens’ U 2 holti Hodd-mimis | Mimis holdi ‘Mimer’s corpse’ U 2 holti | holdi A 3 morgin-doggvar | morgin-doggva U 3 þau sér at mat hafa | þæt U 4 en þaðan af aldir | ok þar of aldr U 4 en | om. R 4 ala-sk | allar T

ALL | The coming ancestors of mankind will, like Ash and Emble (*Vsp* 16–17), emerge from wood. This st. is cited in *Gylf*, immediately following *Gylf* 53:11–13: *En þar, sem beitir Hodd-mimis-bolt, leyna-sk menn tveir í Surta-loga, er svá beita, Lif ok Leifþrasir, ok hafa morgin-doggvar fyrir mat. En af þessum monnum kemr svá mikil kyn-slóð, at byggvi-sk heimr allr. Svá sem hér segir*: ‘But there, at the place called Hoardmimer’s wood, two humans hide during the Flame of Surt, which are called Life and Lafthrasher, and they have morning dew for food. But from these humans comes such a great line of descendants that the whole Home is settled. Just as it says here.’

2 holti Hodd-mimis ‘in Hoardmimer’s wood’ | Perhaps the hollowed-out trunk of the Ash of Ugdrassle.

Öðinn kvað: 46 „Fjölð ek fôr, · fjölð fręistaða’k,
2 fjölð of ręynda’k ręgin;
hvaðan kómr sól · á inn slétta himin,
4 þá’s þessa hęfr Fęnrir farit?

[R 8v/15, A 3v/8]

Quoth Weden: “Much I journeyed, much I tried,
much I tested the Reins!

Whence comes the Sun onto the smooth heaven
when Fenrer has this one killed?”

1–2 ek ... ręgin | abbrev. as ‘e. f. f. e. f.’ A 1–2 fôr ... ręgin | abbrev. as ‘f. f. e. f.’ R 4 þá’s | so (‘þa ær’) A; ‘þa þa er’ R

4 þessa ‘this one’ | The current sun, as explained in the following st.

4 Fęnrir ‘Fenner’ | It is not certain that this is the same “Fenrerswolf” which fights against Weden (cf. st. 53 below); the word *fęnrir*, which prob. originally means ‘fen-dweller’, may here simply be a generic poetic synonym for ‘wolf’. For the wolves which chase and eventually devour the sun and moon see *Vsp* 39–40 (n.), *Grm* 40, *Gylf* 12.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 47 „Eina dóttur · berr alf-rðull,
2 áðr hana Fęnrir fari;
sú skal ríða, · þá’s ręgin deýja,
4 móður brautir męr.“

[R 8v/16, A 3v/9,
S 17v/20, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

Quoth Webthrithner: “A single daughter the Elf-wheel [SUN] bears
before Fenrer might kill her.
She shall ride when the Reins die
her mother’s roads, a maiden.”

2 hana | hęnni U 3 sú skal ríða, · þá’s ręgin deýja | sú mun renna · eða ríða (unmetrical and wo. doubt corrupt) U 4 móður | ręgin U

ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf*, immediately following *Gylf* 53:14–15: *Ok þitt mun þér undar-ligt þykkja er sól'in þefir getit dóttur eigi ó-fegri en bón er, ok ferr sú þá stigu móður sinnar. Svá sem hér segir:* ‘And it will seem wondrous to thee that the Sun has begotten a daughter no less fairer than she herself is, and that one then journeys upon her mother’s paths. Just as it says here:’ The immediately following passage *Gylf* 53:16–17 concludes the account of the world to come and the mythological section of *Gylf* as a whole: *En nú ef þú kannst lengra fram at spyrja, þá veit ek eigi, hvaðan þér kemr þat, fyrir því at engan mann beyrða ek lengra segja fram aldar-fár’it, ok njót-tu nú sem þú namt.* ‘But now, if thou canst ask further ahead then I do not know for what reason thou mightst do so, for I have heard no man tell further ahead about the progression of the world; and now enjoy what thou hast learned.’

1 *alf-rðull* ‘Elf-wheel’ | A rare poetic synonym (*hēiti*) for the sun. It occurs independently in two other places: the Eddic *Skí* 4/3a and a Scaldic loose stanza by Eanwind Finnson (Eyv Lv 9 in SkP 1). It also appears in two lists of names for the sun: *Skm* 69 and *Þul Sólár* 1/7 (in SkP 3), but these do not count as independent attestations since they are antiquarian sources drawing on earlier poetry.

Depending on the age of the cpd., *alf-* may either reflect the semantics of PIE *albʰós* ‘white’ (whence Latin *albus* ‘id.’) or ON *alfr* ‘elf’, the latter word deriving from the former and originally meaning ‘white one’. That is not to say that *alf-rðull* goes back to PIE, but only that the sense “white” must have existed at some point in Germanic prehistory. The second element, *rðull*, is not the normal ON word for ‘wheel’ (*bvél* ~ *hjól*). It is inherited from PGmc. **radulaz* ~ **raduraz* (> OE *rǣdor* ‘heaven, sky’, OS *radul*, *radur* ‘id.’), from **raþq* ‘wheel’ (> German *Rad* ‘id.’) + the nominal suffix *-*ulaz* ~ *-*uraz* ‘(habitually) doing’ and thus means something like ‘circler, turner, revolver’. The PIE root of **raþq* is **Hreth₂-* (whence also Latin *rota* ‘wheel’, Sanskrit *rátʰa* ‘chariot’; Kroonen 2013, p. 405).

Óðinn kvað: 48 Fjǫlð ek fór, · fjǫlð fręistaða’k,
2 fjǫlð of ręynda’k ręgin;
hveęjar ’ro męyjar, · es liða mar yfir,
4 fróð-gęðjaðar fara?

[R 8v/18, A 3v/10]

Quoth Woden: “Much I journeyed, much I tried,
much I tested the Reins!
Who are the maidens that pass o’er the sea?
Wise-minded they go.”

1–2 Fjǫlð ... ręgin | *abbrev. as* ‘F. e. f. f. c. f.’ A 1–2 fór ... ręgin | *abbrev. as* ‘f. f.’ R

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 49 Þríar þjóð-áar · falla þorp yfir
2 męyja Møgþrasis;
hamingjur ęinar · þęr’s i hęimi eru,
4 þó þęr með jǫtnum ala=sk.

[R 8v/19, A 3v/11]

Quoth Webthrithner: “Three great rivers fall over the house
of the maidens of Maythrasher.
They are the only Hamings in the Home,
although they are raised amidst ettins.”

3 þęr’s | *so* (‘þær ær’) A; þęira R

ALL | The identity of these maidens is entirely obscure. Considering all other questions introduced with the refrain *Fjölð ek för* ... have something to do with the end times, they ought to as well, but that hardly clarifies their function. They are probably to be identified with the maidens about which Weden asks in *Bdr* 12.

Óðinn kvað: **50** „Fjölð ek för, · fjölð fręistaða'k,
2 fjölð of ręynda'k ręgin;
hveřir ráða ęsir · ęignum goða,
4 þa's sloknar Surta-logi?“

[R 8v/21, A 3v/13]

Quoth Weden: “*Much I journeyed, much I tried,*
much I tested the Reins!
Which Eese will rule the estates of the Gods
when the flame of Surt goes out?”

1–2 Fjölð ... ręgin | *abbrev. as* ‘F. e. f. e. f. e. f.’ A 1–2 för ... ręgin | *abbrev. as* ‘f. f.’ R

4 Surta-logi ‘the flame of Surt’ | The flame which reaches up to Heaven itself and scorches the whole world; see *Vsp* 50, 54.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: **51** „Við·arr ok Váli · byggva vé goða,
2 þa's sloknar Surta-logi;
Móði ok Magni · skulu Mjöllni hafa
4 Vingnis at víg-þroti.“

[R 8v/22, A 3v/14,
S 17v/12, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

Quoth Webthritner: “Wider and Wonnell will settle the wighs of the Gods
when the flame of Surt goes out.
Mood and Main shall have Millner
after Wingner expires in war.”

3 Móði | †megi† S 4 Vingnis | ok vinna R; *add. synir* U 4 víg-þroti | †vigropi† U

ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf* 53:10, introduced by the words *Svá er sagt* ‘So it is said’. For the preceding prose passage *Gylf* 53:1–9 see *Vsp* 56 n.

4 Vingnis at víg-þroti ‘after Wingner expires in war’ | After Thunder dies in his fight against the Middenyardswyrn, for which see *Vsp* 53.

Óðinn kvað: **52** „Fjölð ek för, · fjölð fręistaða'k,
2 fjölð of ręynda'k ręgin;
hvat verðr Óðni · at aldr-lagi,
4 þa's of rjúfa=sk ręgin?“

[R 8v/24, A 3v/16]

Quoth Weden: “*Much I journeyed, much I tried,*
much I tested the Reins!
What brings Weden's life to an end
when the Reins are ripped?”

1–2 Fjölð ... rēgin | *abbrev. as* ‘F. e. f.’ **A** 1–2 fór ... rēgin | *abbrev. as* ‘f.’ **R** 4 of | *so A; om. R*

4 þá’s of rjúfa-sk rēgin? ‘when the Reins are ripped?’ | Formulaic; see note to *Bdr* 14/4.

Vafþrúðnir kvað: **53** „Ulfr gleypa · mun Alda-fǫðr,
 2 þess mun Við-arr vrekka;
 kalda kjapta · hann klyfja mun
 4 vitnis vígi at.“

[R 8v/25, A 3v/17]

Quoth Webthrithner: “The Wolf will devour the Father of Mankind;
 that will Wider avenge.
 The cold jaws he will split apart
 of the beast at the battle.”

2 vrekka | *metr. emend.*; rekka **R** 4 vitnis ‘the beast’ | *so A*; Vingnis ‘Wingner’ (*prob. influenced by st. 51*) **R**

ALL | For Weden’s fight with the Wolf and Wider’s subsequent avenging see *Vsp* 51–52, *Grm* 17, 24.

2 þess mun Við-arr vrekka ‘that will Wider avenge’ | The archaic initial *vr-* in *vrekka* must be restored for metrical reasons (Haukur Þorgeirsson 2016, p. 37). This serves as a solid dating criterion for composition before ca. 1000 CE; cf. *Háv* 26/2 n.

Óðinn kvað: **54** „Fjölð ek fór, · fjölð freistaða’k,
 2 fjölð of reynda’k rēgin;
 hvat mēlti Óðinn, · áðr á bál stigi,
 4 sjalfr i çyra syni.“

[R 8v/27, A 3v/19]

Quoth Weden: “*Much I journeyed, much I tried,
 much I tested the Reins!*
 What spoke Weden before he would step onto the pyre,
 himself, into the ear of his son?”

1–2 Fjölð ... rēgin | *abbrev. as* ‘F. e. f.’ **A** 1–2 fjölð ... rēgin | *abbrev. as* ‘f.’ **R** 3 stigi, | *add. ok A*

3–4 Hvat mēlti Óðinn ... i çyra syni? ‘What said Weden ... into the ear of his son?’ | Weden poses the eighteenth, unknowable, question. Only he himself can know what he whispered in Balder’s ear, and thus he has won the contest. For Balder’s death, cf. notes to *Vsp* 31–33 and *Bdr* 8–11. Weden asks the same question in Heathric’s Riddles in *Heiðr*, as the 37th and final riddle (for critical discussion cf. *Heiðr* 84/3 n. in *SkP* 8.). The half-stanza there is clearly related to *Vafþ* 54: *Seg þat þá fyrst, ef þú ert hverjum konungi vitrari: // Hvat mēlti Óðinn · i çyra Baldri, / áðr bann vęri á bál of þorinn?* ‘Then tell this first if thou art cleverer than every king: // What spoke Weden in Balder’s ear / before he would be borne onto the pyre?’

3 á bál stigi 'step onto the pyre' | The phrase *stíga á* 'step onto, mount' is also used to refer to one stepping aboard a ship or mounting a horse (see CV: *stíga* for citations). Its use for a person being borne onto the funeral pyre has been compared with *Beow* 1118b: *gūð-rinc á-stāb* 'the war-champion mounted [his pyre]', but the interpretation of that line is controversial. R. D. Fulk, Bjork, and Niles (2008, p. 186) instead follow Grundtvig in emending *gūð-rinc* to *gūð-réc* 'war-smoke' and compare it with *Beow* 3144b (*wudu-réc á-stāb* 'wood-smoke rose up', which also describes a cremation). Thus, the present stanza "almost certainly refers not to Baldr but to Óðinn, probably imagined to mount the pyre in order to set fire to it" (R. D. Fulk, Bjork, and Niles 2008, p. 186).

Vafþrúðnir kvað: 55 „Ey mann-gi veit, · hvat þú ǣ ár-daga
2 sagðir ǣ ęyra syni;
feigum munni · męłta'k męna forna stafi
4 ok of ragna røk;
nú við Óðin · deilda'k męna orð-spęki;
6 þú est ę vísastr vera.“

[R 8v/28, A 3v/19–22]

Quoth Webthritner: “Never will man know what thou in days of yore
spokest in the ear of thy son.
With a fey mouth I spoke my ancient staves
and about the Rakes of the Reins.
Now with Weden have I shared my word-wisdom—
thou art for ever wisest of men!”

1 mann-gi | *emend.*; manni (*dat. sg., impossible since a subject to veit is needed*) RA 3 męłta'k | *add. umb* ('um') A

1 ár-daga 'in days of yore' | Relative to the events of the poem, Balder's death has taken place in the far distant past. This therefore situates *Vafþ* in the last (and present) age of the World, namely the period of decline and degeneration immediately preceding the Rakes of the Reins.

3 feigum 'fey' | "Death-doomed", a word with fatalistic connections. Webthritner realises that he was bound to die from the moment he proposed the wager (st. 19), as no being can outwit the god of wisdom.

3 męna forna stafi 'my ancient staves' | Referencing st. 1.

5 orð-spęki 'word-wisdom' | Referencing st. 5.

6 vera 'of men' | *verr* means 'husband, man' and is here used for reasons of alliteration; it does not imply that Weden is not a God.

Speeches of Grimner

(*Grímnis mól*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.976)

Meter: Leeds-meter (1–2/2, 3–26, 27/4–27/7, 28/1–28/2, 28/6–28/7, 29–33/2, 35–45/2, 46/1–46/2, 47–48/2, 49/3–52, 54–57),
Ancient-words-law (2/3–2/4, 28/3–28/5, 33/3, 45/3–45/5, 48/3–48/4, 49/1–49/2, 53), Galders-law (27/1–27/3, 34, 46/3–46/5)

Introduction

The **Speeches of Grimner** (abbrev. *Grm*) is a mythological gnomic poem consisting of Woden's wisdom told to the young prince Ayner as the god sits bound between two fires.

Textual preservation and transmission

Grm is preserved whole in both **R** and **A**. The shared prose passages between them prove beyond any doubt that the version of *Grm* in these two manuscripts ultimately goes back to a single written archetype, which may be called ***RA**.

22 stanzas (11–15, 18–20, 23–24, 29, 34–37, 41–42, 45, 47–49) of *Grm* are preserved in citation in *Gylf*, in the case of 23, 24, and 37 explicitly attributed to *Grímnis mól*. Numerous other stanzas (6–8, TODO) are paraphrased in *Gylf*, more or less directly. These stanzas may be said to belong to a **G** redaction of the poem.

Gylf predates both **R** and **A**, and **G** must thus be distinct from both of them. Common innovations shared between **R** and **A** (e.g. st. 18/4: om. *við*, 45/4: *Bil-røst*) show that the two share a common written archetype, distinct from that of **G**. It is unclear whether **G** reflects a more distantly related written version or an alternative oral redaction of the poem.

Structure

Grm essentially consists of several nested layers. The outermost layer is the prose passages which bracket the actual poem (P1–P2, P3). It is hard to say for how long these have accompanied the poetry, but since they are found in both **R** and **A** they must go back to a now-lost manuscript archetype.

The second layer is sts. 1–3 and 53–55, which together with the prose form a narrative frame dealing with King Garfrith and his imprisonment of Weden.

At the heart of the poem stand the gnomic wisdom stanzas 4–52, which make up the bulk of the poem. The wisdom is mythological and sometimes obscure, and aligns with other Eddic verse like *Háv*, *Vafþ*, *Bdr*, *Sigrdr*, and *Alv*.

Origin and motifs

Grm consists at its core of the long speech given by the god Weden, and in this way it resembles *Háv*. Both poems may be said to fall squarely under the category of gnomic poetry, but whereas most of *Háv* deals with life-advice of a more general type, *Grm* focuses entirely on mythological and cosmological lore.

The lore found in *Grm* is very varied and most of it will be discussed at length in the notes to the individual stanzas, but a few broader motifs ought to be discussed here.

The wandering god

Like in *Háv* we here see Weden in his role as the god of travellers and strangers, for he himself is a stranger and frequently travels among mankind. In *Grm* this is made explicit as the god sets out to test the hospitality of his protégé and punishes him harshly when he fails to uphold the duties of a king, which include generosity and hospitality.

The motif of a travelling god testing the hospitality of mankind has ancient and likely Indo-European origins. It is in any case very prevalent in the related Greek tradition. Already in Homer we find it said plainly, *Od* 17.483–487: “Antinoös, you did badly to hit the unhappy vagabond: / a curse on you, if he turns out to be some god from heaven. / For the gods do take on all sorts of transformations, appearing as / strangers from elsewhere, and thus they range at large through the cities, / watching to see which men keep the laws, and which are violent.” (Homer 1965). Is it not just this wrath which we see in *Grm*, when in st. 55 the god, having assumed his true, terrible form, exclaims: “Draw near Me, if thou mayst!”

If any wandering stranger may be a god, indeed the highest god, it naturally follows that one should furnish the impoverished well, lest one incur the wrath of the god(s). This in turn confers a level of heavenly protection on the hands of the traveller and makes hospitality a sacred duty. As much is seen in the Greek epithet of Zeus, Ζεὺς ξένιος ‘Zeus of hospitality’ (Plato, *Laws* 12.953e), the term used for the high god in His role as the protector of

strangers and sacred hospitality (ξενία). With this in mind, we may rightly call Weden in this aspect **Wōdanaz* ξένιος.

The land of the Gods

TODO: the God-world, Shamanism, the Ash of Ugdrassle as the *axis mundi*. Cite: Eliade on shamanism, PCRN on the recreation of Osyard at a smaller scale.

Summary

The text begins with the frame narrative, which tells the story of the two young king's sons Ayner and Garfrith. The elder Ayner is fostered by Frie while the younger Garfrith is fostered by her husband, Weden. After their father's death, Garfrith betrays his elder brother upon the advice of Weden and becomes king after his father (P1).

One day Weden and Frie are arguing over their respective foster-sons and Frie accuses Garfrith of torturing wayfaring guests. Weden sets out to test the hospitality of his protégé. Unbeknownst to him, Frie has already sent her handmaid in disguise to warn Garfrith about the coming of a dangerous wizard. When Weden arrives, he is promptly captured and tortured between two fires in order that he will reveal his name. Garfrith's young son, Ayner (clearly named after his uncle), kindly approaches the bound god and offers him a horn of drink. Weden, assuming the name of Grimner, drinks from it and then takes to speak (P2).

Weden begins by complaining about the fires which are now burning his cloak (1); he states that for eight nights not a soul has offered him any help save Ayner, Garfrith's son, who will soon become king after his father (2). As thanks for the drink he gives him good health, and will offer him holy knowledge (3).

Here the gnomic section begins as Weden lists the individual abodes of the Gods (4–17). The named Gods are Thunder (4), Wolder and Free (5), Weden and Sey (7), Weden (8–10), Shede (11), Balder (12), Homedall (13), Frow (14), Foresitter (15), Nearth (16), and Wider (17).

After this list come several sts. relating to Weden and his hall, Walhall (18–23). Mentioned is the preparation of food in Walhall (18), Weden's wolves (19) and ravens (20), the river through which the dead have to wade (21) and the gate through which they have to pass (22), the count of doors in Walhall (23), the count of doors in Thunder's hall Bilshirner (24), and the goat and stag which stand on the hall and gnaw on the branches of the tree Leered (25–26). From the horns of the stag Oakthirner water-droplets fall into Wharyelmer, which is the origin of all rivers (26).

Next follows a list of mythic rivers (27–28), ending with the waters through which Thunder must wade on his way to Ugdrassle (29). This leads to a list of the horses ridden by the other gods on their way to Ugdrassle (31) which is followed by a description of the roots of Ugdrassle (31) and its animals (32–36).

Next follows some miscellaneous lore: a list of Walkirries (37), the horses that pull the sun (38), the shield that protects the earth from the sun's heat (39) and the wolves that chase the sun and moon, the things created from Yimer's body (41–42) with a digression on the significance of the blood (43), the creation of the ship *Shidebladner* (44) and finally a list of the noblest of several categories of things and groups (45).

After these lists Weden utters an unclear stanza invoking the gods (46), before listing his many names (47–50). He then turns to Garfrith, disappointed by the inhospitality and poor conduct of his former protégé, and foresees his imminent death (51–53). He finally reveals himself by his true name, daring Garfrith to face him (53). After this he repeats several of his names (54), and the poem ends.

Upon learning that the wizard is Weden himself, King Garfrith jumps up from his throne to take the god away from the fires, but trips and falls upon his unsheathed sword and dies. After this his son Ayner becomes king and is said to have ruled the kingdom for a long time (P3).

Text

Frá sonum Hraððungs konungs ('From the sons of king Reading')

P1 Hraððungr konungr átti tvá sonu. Hét annarr Agnarr, en annarr
 2 Geir-røðr. Agnarr var tíu vetra en Geir-røðr átta vetra. Þeir reru
 tveir á báti með dorgar sínar at smá-fiski. Vindr rak þá í haf
 4 út. Í nótt-myrkri brutu þeir við land ok gingu upp; fundu kot-
 bónda einn. Þar vöru þeir um vetr'inn. Kerling fostraði Agnar,
 6 en karl Geir-røð ok kenndi hönnum røð.. At vári fekk karl þeim
 skip. En er þau kerling leiddu þá til strandar, þá mælti karl ein-
 8 mæli við Geir-røð. Þeir fengu byr ok kvömu til stöðva fōður síns.
 Geir-røðr var fram í skipi. Hann hljóp upp á land en hratt út
 10 skipi'nu, ok mælti: „Far þú nú þar er smyl hafi þik!“ Skip'it rak
 út en Geir-røðr gekk út til bójar. Hönum var vel fagnat; þá var
 12 faðir hans andaðr. Var þá Geir-røðr til konungs tekinn, ok varð
 maðr ágættr.

[R 8v/31, A 3v/23]

King Reading had two sons. One was called Ayner and the other Garfrith. Ayner was ten winters old, but Garfrith eight winters. The two were rowing in a boat with their trolling-lines for small fishing. The wind drove them out into the sea. In the dark of night they crashed onto land and walked ashore; they found a lone cottage farmer. There they stayed over the winter. The farmer's wife fostered Ayner but the farmer [fostered] Garfrith and taught him counsel. In the spring the farmer gave them ships, but when he and his wife led them to the shore, the husband spoke private speech with Garfrith. They caught good wind, and came to their father's harbour. Garfrith was in the front of the ship. He leapt onto land and pushed out the ship, and spoke: "Go now whither the fiends may have thee!" The ship drove out but Garfrith walked towards the farm. He was welcomed well; by then was his father ended. Garfrith was then taken as king, and became an excellent man.

1 en | *add.* sonr A 1 annarr | *corr. above line in same hand* A 4 Í nótt-myrkri brutu þeir | Þeir
 brutu í nótt-myrkri A 6 karl | *add.* fostraði A 6 ok kenndi hönnum røð. | *so* A; *om.* R 7
 strandar | skips A. 10 nú | *so* A; *om.* R 10 rak | *add.* í haf A 11-12 þá var faðir hans | en
 faðir hans var þá A 12 Var þá Geir-røðr | Geir-røðr var þá A

4-5 kot-bónda einn 'a lone cottage farmer' | The farmer and his wife were Weden and Frie as is clarified by the following prose.

6 en karl Geir-røð ok kenndi hönnum røð. 'but the farmer Garfrith and taught him counsel' | The motif of Weden favouring the youngest brother is also found in *Rþ*; for Weden's counsel cf. *Háv.*

7-8 þá mælti karl ein-mæli við Geir-røð 'the husband spoke a private speech with Garfrith' | Instructing him to push his brother out to sea.

10 Far þú nú þar er smyl hafi þik! 'Go thou whither the fiends may have thee!' | The same curse is attested with *gramir* for *smyl* in *Hárþ* 60 and in a related form in *Brot* 10.

P2 Óðinn ok Frigg sǫtu í Hlið-skjölfu ok sǫ um heima alla. Óðinn
 2 mǣlti: „Sér þú Agnar fǫstra þinn, hvar hann elr börn við gýgi
 4 í helli’num? En Geir-røðr, fǫstri minn, er konungr ok sitr nú
 6 at landi.“ Frigg segir: „Hann er mat-níðingr sá at hann kvelr
 gesti sína ef hǫnum þykkja of-margir koma.“ Óðinn segir at þat
 8 er in mesta lygi. Þau veðja um þetta mál. Frigg sendi eskis-
 mey sína, Fullu, til Geir-røðar. Hón bað konung vara-sk at eigi
 10 fyr-gerði hǫnum fjol-kunnigr maðr sá er þar var kominn í land,
 12 ok sagði þat mark á at engi hundr var svá ólmr at á hann myndi
 hlaupa. En þat var inn mesti hé-gómi at Geir-røðr væri eigi mat-
 góðr ok þó léttr hann hand-taka þann mann er eigi vildu hundar
 á ráða. Sá var í feldi blǫm ok nefndi-sk Grímnir ok sagði ekki
 14 fleira frá sér þótt hann væri at spurðr. Konungr lét hann þína
 til sagna ok setja milli elda tveggja ok sat hann þar átta nǣtr.
 Geir-røðr konungr átti son tíu vetra gamlan ok hét Agnarr eptir
 16 bróður hans. Agnarr gekk at Grímnir ok gaf hǫnum horn fullt
 at drekka, sagði at konungr gerði illa er hann lét þína hann sak-
 18 lausan. Grímnir drakk af. Þá var eldr’inn svá kominn at feldr’inn
 brann af Grímnir. Hann kvað:

[R 9r/10, A 4r/3]

Weden and Frie sat in the Lithshelf and looked about all the Homes. Weden spoke: “Dost thou see Ayner, thy foster-son, where he begets children with a troll-woman in her cave? But Garfrith, *my* foster-son, is king and now rules his land.” Frie says: “He is such a meat-nithing that he torments his guests if he thinks too many are coming!” Weden says that this is the greatest lie; they make a wager over this matter. Frie sent her handmaid, Full, to Garfrith’s hall. She bade the king be wary, lest he be destroyed by the manicunning man who had come to his land; and said that his mark was that no hound was so fierce that it would rush at him. But it was the greatest falsehood that Garfrith was not good of meat; and yet he has that man bound whom the hounds would not touch. He was in a blue cloak and called himself Grimner, and did not tell anything more about himself, even though he was asked. The king had him tortured that he would speak, and set him between two fires; and he sat there for eight nights. King Garfrith had a son ten winters old, and he was called Ayner after his brother. Ayner went up to Grimner and gave him a full horn to drink, saying that the king did badly as he had him tortured without cause. Grimner drank it up. Then the fire had grown so much that the cloak burned on Grimner. Quoth he:

1 Hlið-skjölfu | Hlið-skjölf A 1 heima alla | *rev.* A 3 En Geir-røðr, fǫstri minn, er konungr |
 En er konung fǫstri minn (*corrupt*) A 3 nú | *om.* A 4 landi | lǫndum A 11 ok | en A 12
 ráða | hlaupa A 14 tveggja | *om.* A 14 hann | *om.* A 15 átti | *add.* þá A 17 drekka, |
add. ok A 17 konungr | faðir hans A 17 illa | *om.* A 17 lét þína hann | pindi þenna mann
 A

ALL | The motif of Weden and Frie sitting in their Heavenly Seat, looking out over the world and each picking a different side in a conflict is also found in the short 7th century text the Origin of the Nation of the Longbeards (i.e., the Lombards; Latin *Origo Gentis Langbardorum*). The narrative is clearly based on oral tradition brought from Northern Europe in the first centuries of the current era and as such attests the great age of the present motif. The relevant passage is edited at the end of the present poem under the Appendix.

1 Hlið-skjölflu ‘the Lithshelf’ | The lookout post of the Gods, which also appears in *Skí* P1. Cf. *Gylf* 9:11: *Þar er einn staðr; er Hlið-skjölfl beitr, ok þá er Óðinn setti-sk þar í hó-séti, þá sá hann of alla heima ok hvers manns at-hófi ok vissi alla hluti, þá er hann sá.* ‘Thereat (viz. in Osyrd) there is one place which is called the Lithshelf, and when Weden sat there in the high seat then he saw throughout all the Homes and each man’s behaviour, and knew all the things which he saw.’ and *Gylf* 17:8–9, cited in st. 6 n. below.

2–3 Sér þú Agnar fóstur þinn, hvar hann elr börn við gýgi í helli’num ‘Dost thou see Ayner, thy foster-son, where he begets children with a troll-woman in her cave?’ | This may relate to Frie’s role as love-goddess. Ayner is in any case a weak, effeminate man who devotes his life to copulation rather than war.

The Speeches of Grimner

- 1 „Hęitr est hripuðr · ok hęldr til mikill,
2 gęg=umk firr funi!
Loði sviðnar, · þó'tt á lopt bera'k;
4 brinn=umk feldr fyrir.

[R 9r/27, A 4r/17]

“HOT ART THOU, SCORCHER, and far too great—
go far from me, O flame!
My wool cape is singed though I hold it aloft;
the cloak burns before me!

3 bera'k | vera A

2 gęg=umk firr 'go far from me' | Equivalent to *gakk mér firr*. The word *gęg=umk* 'go ... from me' merits some linguistic discussion on the form of the imperative (*gęg=* rather than *gakk*) and the suffixed pronoun *=umk*. The normal 2sg imper. of ON *gęga* 'to go' is *gakk*, which goes back to a sound change in PN whereby word-final homorganic clusters were devoiced, and in the case of clusters of the form /NC/ assimilated into /C:/ . Thus PN **gęg* 'go' (cf. Got. *gęg* / *gęg* /, OHG *gęg*) > **gęk* > *gakk*, also **stand* 'stand!' > *statt*, **bind* 'bind!' > *bitt*. This sound change was only active in early PN, and only affected those clusters which were word-final before syncope of unstressed vowels; thus in the ON 1sg pres. ind. *ęk gęg*, *ęk stęnd* (< **ęk gęngu*, *ęk standu*) 'I go, I stand' et c. we find the original cluster preserved.

At some time in early PN, accusative personal pronouns were suffixed to certain verbs; those which survive into ON are 1sg *=umk* (= ON *mik*) and 3sg reflexive *=sk* (= ON *sik*). In later ON these clitics became the passive endings still found in modern North Germanic, but in archaic or poetic ON they could still serve as suffixed pronouns with a reflexive or even dative function, as is the case in this instance. The fact that the suffixion of the pronoun has prevented assimilation of the consonant cluster *ng* establishes its *terminus ante quem* as the first syncope period, the early 7th century, and since it is unlikely that such an irregular form as *gęg=umk* could have survived for long alongside *gakk*, its presence here probably allows us to conclude that *Grim* is a rather old poem.

Other instances of dative *=umk* include *Lok* 35/1a: *ęs=umk*, *Fęfi* 1/4: *stęnd=umk*, *Eddęr* II 1/1: *ęru=mk*, and *Rdr* 7/2a: *gęf=umk*.

- 2 Átta nętr · sat'k milli ęlda hęr,
svá't męr mann=gi mat né bauð
nema ęinn Agnarr, · es ęinn skal ráða,
4 Gęir-røðar sonr, · Gotna landi.

[R 9r/29, A 4r/18]

For eight nights I sat between the fires here,
while no man offered me food,
save for Ayner alone, who alone shall rule—
Garfrith's son—the land of the Gots!

- 3 Hęill skalt, Agnarr, · alls hęilan biðr
þik Vera-týr vesa;
ęins drykkjar · skalt aldri=gi
4 bętri gjöld geta:

[R 9r/31, A 4r/20]

Hale shalt thou be, Ayner, for hale
 does Were-Tew (= Weden) bid thee be.
 For a single drink shalt thou never get
 better recompense.

3 çins drykkjar ‘For a single drink’ | The horn which Ayner offered Weden (P2 above).

4 bœtri gjöld ‘better recompense’ | Namely the mythic lore which takes up sts. 4–45.

4 Land es heilag, · es liggja sé’k [R 9r/33, A 4r/22]
 2 ösum ok ölfum nér;
 çn i þrúð-heimi · skal Þórr vesa
 4 und’s of rjúfa=sk rëgin.

The land is holy which I see lying
 near the Eese and Elves,
 but in Thrithham shall Thunder dwell
 until the Reins are ripped.

4 und’s of rjúfa=sk rëgin ‘until the Reins are ripped’ | Until the Rakes of the Reins. A formulaic expression; see note to *Bdr* 14/4 for further occurrences.

5 Ý-dalir heita, · þar’s Ullr hefir [R 9v/2, A 4r/23]
 2 sér of gørva sali;
 Alf-heim Frey · gófu i ár-daga
 4 tivar at tann-féi.

Yewdales they are called where Wolder has
 made for himself a hall.
 Elfham to Free in days of yore
 the Tews as a tooth-gift gave.

4 tann-féi ‘tooth-gift’ | The gift the child receives when he sheds his first tooth.

6 Bór es sá (hinn þriði), · es blið rëgin [R 9v/3, A 4r/25]
 2 silfri þøkðu sali;
 Vala-skjölf heitir, · es vélti sér
 4 öss i ár-daga.

By is (the third) one, where the blithe Reins
 with silver thatched the halls.
 Waleshef is the name of the one which he won through wiles,
 the Os in days of yore.

ALL. | This stanza is paraphrased in *Gylf* 17:8–9: *Þar er enn mikill staðr, er Vala-skjölfr heitir. Þann stað á Óðinn. Þann gerðu goð'in ok þokðu skíru silfri, ok þar er Hlið-skjölfr'in í þessum sal, þat há-sėti, er svá heitir, ok þá er Al-fjörðr sitr í því sėti, þá sér hann of alla heima.* ‘There is yet another great place which is called Waleshelf. That place Weden owns. The Gods made it and thatched it with pure silver, and in these hall is the Lithshelf, the high-seat which is called so, and when Allfather sits in that seat then he sees throughout all the Homes.’

1 (hinn þriði) ‘(the third)’ | The first numbering of a location; the numbering continues up to st. 16. Although paralleled by other numbered poetic lists (*Háv* 147–165, *Vafþ* 20–42) some circumstances speak against the numbers in *Grm* being authorial. First, the alliteration is never reliant on the numbers, which is quite different from the numbered items in *Háv* 147–165 and *Vafþ* 20–42. Secondly the numbering is inconsistent; Thunder’s realm (st. 4) is not counted, and Wider’s land (st. 17) has no numeral (perhaps since the form of the stanza would not allow it.) Third, in *Gylf*’s citations of sts. 11–15 the numbers are missing.

1 blíð regin ‘the blithe Reins’ | A reverent epithet for the Gods, also occurring in sts. 38/3, 42/1 below. Parodied by Lock in *Lok* 32/3. For other epithets cf. *Vafþ* 13/4 n.

3 es vélti sér ‘won through wiles’ | Several previous editors and translators (e.g. Finnur Jónsson (1932), Pettit (2023), Larrington (2014)) have rendered this phrase with variants of “craftily made for himself”, where the verb *væla* would mean ‘craftily make’. To my knowledge this sense is never otherwise attested, and its common meaning is ‘defraud, trick, betray’. A simpler reading would be to see this as a reference to the myth of the ettin Master Builder who built the wall of Otyard as alluded to in *Vsp* 24–25 and told at length in *Gylf* 42. The Gods had promised him Frow and the Sun and Moon if he could build it within a year, but to slow him down they made use of various tricks. When at last it seemed like he would make it in time, they called upon Thunder who arrived and killed him.

7 Sökkva-þekkr heitir (hinn fjórði), · en þar svalar knegu

[R 9v/5, A 4r/26]

- 2 unnir glymjia yfir;
þar þau Óðinn ok Sága · drekka umb alla daga
4 glöð ór gollnum kęrum.

Sinkbench is (the fourth) one called, but there do cool
waves clash overhead;
there Weden and Sey drink for all days,
glad, out of golden casks.

2 glymjia yfir | metr. emend.; rev. RA

ALL. | This stanza is likely paraphrased in *Gylf* 35:3: *Önnur er Sága. Hón býr á Sökkva-þekki, ok er þat mikill staðr.* ‘The other [goddess] is Sey. She lives in Sinkbench, and that is a great place.’

8 Glāðs-heimr heitir (hinn fimti) · þar’s hin goll-bjarta

[R 9v/7, A 4r/28]

- 2 Val-höll víð of þrumir;
en þar Hropt · kýss hverjan dag
4 vápn-dauða vera.

Gladsham is (the fifth) one called, where the gold-bright
Walhall, wide, stands fast,
but there Roft (= Weden) chooses every day
weapon-dead warriors.

1 heitir | es A 2 of | om. A

ALL | For Gladsham see *Gylf* 14:2–7, which likely paraphrases this stanza, cited in *Vsp* 7 n.

3–4 en ... vera ‘but ... warriors.’ | For Weden’s chosing of the slain see st. 14.

- 9 Mjök ’s **auð**-kennnt · þeim’s til Óðins koma
 2 sal-kynni at **séa**,
 skoptum ’s rann rept, · skjöldum ’s salr þakiðr,
 4 brynjum of **bækki** stráat.

[R 9v/10, A 4r/30]

Very easily recognized by those who come to Weden
 is the hall to see:

With shafts is the house roofed, with shields is the hall thatched;
 with byrnies the benches strewn.

1 til | om. A

ALL | In R the order of sts. 9 and 10 is reversed, but a sign at the start of each suggests they should switch places; this is further indicated by the abbreviation of ll. 1–2 in st. 10.

3 skoptum ‘shafts’ | Spear-shafts.

3 skjöldum ’s salr þakiðr ‘with shields is the hall thatched’ | The same is said in *Gylf* 2:6–7: *Þak bennar var lagt gylldum skjöldum svá sem spán-þak. Svá segir Þjóð-ólfr inn hvín-verski, at Val-þoll var skjöldum þekð.* ‘Its roof was covered with gilt shields like a shingle-roof. So does Thedwolf the Whine-dweller say that Walhall was thatched with shields.’ After this, *Gylf* cites Þhorn *Harkv* 11/1–2, which uses the kenning *Sváfnis sal-néfrar* ‘Swebner’s hall-shingles [SHIELDS]’, where Swebner is a name for Weden (cf. st. 57 below).

- 10 Mjök ’s **auð**-kennnt · þeim’s til Óðins koma
 2 sal-kynni at **séa**,
 vargr hangir · fyr vestan dyrr
 4 ok drúpir **qrn** yfir.

[R 9v/9, A 4r/31]

Very easily recognized by those who come to Weden
 is the hall to see:

A wolf hangs before the western door,
 and an eagle droops down over it.

2 sal-kynni at séa | †sia at sia† A

3–4 vargr hangir · fyr vestan dyrr / ok drúpir qrn yfir. ‘A wolf hangs before the western door, and an eagle droops down over it.’ | Something very similar is found in Widukind of Corvey’s *History of the Saxons* 1:12. The Saxons had just conquered a fortress, and *mane [...] facto ad orientalem portam ponunt aquilam, aramque victoriae construentes secundum errorem paternum sacra sua propria veneratione venerati sunt* ‘at the coming of morning they set an eagle at the eastern gate, and, building an altar of victory, they worshipped it with their own holy worship in accordance with their ancestral error.’ The altar was pledged to Ermen, whom Widukind identifies with Mars or Hermes, certainly Weden. According to Hyltén-Cavallius (1863, p. 156) it was custom in Wärend, southern Sweden to hang the bodies of killed wolves high up in old oaks, and killed birds of prey above the stable-door.

- 11 **P**rym-heimr heitir (hinn sétti), · es **P**jatsi bjó,
 2 sá hinn **ám**-átki **j**otunn;
 3 en nú **S**kaði byggvir, · **skír** brúðr goða,
 4 **f**ornar toptir **f**oður.

Thrimham is (the sixth) one called, where Thedse dwelled,
 that uncanny ettin;
 but now Shede bedwells—the pure bride of the Gods—
 the ancient plots of her father.

1 **P**rym-heimr | Prúð-heimr U 1 (hinn sétti) 'the sixth' | *om.* G 1 es 'where' | þar nú 'where now' U 1 bjó 'dwelled' | *om.* W; býr 'dwells' U 2 **ám**-átki | mátki U 3 goða 'of the Gods' | guma 'of men' U 4 **f**ornar | forna A; †fornir† T

ALL | St. 11 is cited in *Gylf* 23:15, introduced by the words *Svá er sagt* 'So it is said' and concluding the chapter. For the rest of the chapter see *Eddbr* II.

2 **ám**-átki jotunn 'uncanny ettin' | Formulaic. See note to *Vsp* 8.

- 12 **B**reiða-blik eru (hin sjaundu), · en þar **B**aldr hefir
 2 **sér** of gǫrva **s**ali,
 3 á því **l**andi · es **l**iggja veyt'k
 4 **f**esta **f**eykn-stafi.

Broadblooks are (the seventh), but there Balder has
 made for himself a hall,
 in that land where I know lie
 the fewest wicked deeds.

1 **B**reiða-blik | Breiða (*with blik added above the line in other hand*) R; Breiða-†blio† A 1 eru (hin sjaundu) 'are (the seventh)' | heita '[they] are called' **STW**; heitir 'is one called' U. 4 **f**eykn-stafi | †feying†-stafi U

ALL | St. 12 is cited in *Gylf* 22:22, introduced by the words *Svá sem hér segir* 'Just as it says here' and concluding the chapter, which tells about Balder. *Gylf* 22:21 provides context: *Hann býr þar, sem heitir Breiða-blik. Þat er á himni. Í þeim stað má ekki vera ó-breint.* 'He [viz. Balder] lives at the place called Broadblooks. That is in Heaven. In that place may nothing be unclean.'

4 **f**eykn-stafi 'wicked deeds' | This sense of *stafir* (lit. 'staffs, staves') is common in poetry. Cf. the direct cognate in *Beow* 1018b: *fācen-stafas*, generally taken as referring to treacherous intrigues among the Shieldings (R. D. Fulk, Bjork, and Niles 2008, p. 177).

- 13 **H**imin-björg eru (hin öttu), · en þar **H**eim·dall
 2 kveða valda **v**éum;
 3 þar **v**orðr goða · drekr ĩ **v**ęru ranni
 4 **g**laðr hinn **g**óða mjöd.

Heavenbarrows are (the eighth), but there Homedall,
 they say, wields over wighs.

[R 9v/12, A 4v/2,
 S 6v/20, T TODO,
 W TODO, U TODO]

[R 9v/14, A 4v/3,
 S 6v/4, T TODO,
 W TODO, U TODO]

[R 9v/16, A 4v/5,
 S 7r/21, T TODO,
 W TODO, U TODO]

There the Watchman of the Gods drinks in the tranquil house,
glad, the good mead.

1 eru (hin öttu) ‘are (the eighth)’ | heita ‘[they] are called’ **STW**; heitir ‘is one called’ **U** 1
Hçim-dall | Hçim-dallr býr **U** 3 þar | *om.* **U** 3 vǫrðr | vǫrðum **U** 4 hinn | *so AG*; *om.* **R**

ALL | St. 13 is cited in *Gylf* 27:14, the chapter dealing with Homedall, introduced by the words: *Hér er svá sagt* ‘Here it is said so’. For the full chapter see *Eddbr* III.

3 vǫrðr goða ‘Watchman of the Gods’ | Formulaic epithet of Homedall, also occurring in *Lok* 48/4 and possibly in *Ski* 28 (*vǫrðr með goðum* ‘the Watchman among the Gods’). A similar epithet is found in *Húsdr* 2, *vári ragna* ‘Defender of the Reins’. *Gylf* 27, where the present stanza is cited, gives some further details; see *Eddbr* III.

14 Folk-vangr es (hinn níundi), · en þar Freyja réðr
2 sessa kostum i sal;
halfan val · hön kýss hverjan dag,
4 en halfan Óðinn á.

[R 9v/17, A 4v/6,
S 6v/27, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

Folkwong is (the ninth), but there Frow rules
the choice of seats in the hall;
half the slain she chooses each day,
but half does Weden own.

1 es (hinn níundi) ‘is (the ninth)’ | heitir ‘[one] is called’ **G** 2 sessa kostum i | kosta þætstum **U**
3 hverjan dag | hvern dag **U**

ALL | St. 14 is cited in *Gylf* 24:9, introduced by the words *svá sem hér segir* ‘just as it says here’. The immediately preceding *Gylf* 24:6–8 provides context: *En Freyja er á-gætust af Ósynjum. Hón á þann bó á himni er Fölk-vangar beita, ok hvar sem hón riðr til vígs þá á hón halfan val, en halfan Óðinn.* ‘But Frow is the most distinguished of the Ossens. She has the dwelling in Heaven which is called the Folkwongs, and wherever she rides into battle she owns half of the slain, but Weden [has the other] half’.

3 halfan val · hön kýss hverjan dag ‘half the slain she chooses each day’ | Apart from the paraphrase in *Gylf* this statement is unprecedented; in all other sources the battle-slain are devoted exclusively to Weden and chosen by his walkirries.

The roots of *kjósa val* ‘choose the slain’ are the same as those in *val-kyrja* ‘walkirrie’, lit. ‘chooser of the slain’), and as Frow is a prominent goddess this could be seen to make her the chief walkirrie. This is paralleled by *Sprla*, where Frow assumes the name Gandle (*Göndul*, a name attested in several lists of walkirries; see *Vsp* 30 n.) and incites the legendary never-ending Conflict of the Headenings (*Hjǫðningavíg*).

In spite of this there is reason to believe that the chief walkirrie was rather Frie, Weden’s wife. First, one of the functions of the Walkirries is to bear ale to the Oneharriers (*Grm* 37). This mirrors a real custom at Germanic banquets attested where the host’s wife or daughter would pour ale to his retainers and guests (the so-called “lady with a mead cup” ritual most famously seen in *Beow*; see Enright (1996) and Riseley (2014)). As Weden’s wife, we would expect Frie to have this role. Second, at Balder’s funeral (*Gylf* 49:49–52), Frie rides with Weden and the Walkirries while Frow rides alone with her cats; if Frow were the chief walkirrie we would probably expect her to ride at the head of them. Third, there are two separate myths where Frie and Weden contend over the fates of armies and men; these are the prose introduction to the present poem (P2 above) and the Longbeard origin myth (see Appendix below), whereas Frow and Weden do not otherwise come into conflict over the slain.

Whether the present stanza originally referred to Frie is hard to say, although confusion between Frow and Frie would probably not be expected in a source as old as *Grm*.

15 **G**litnir es (hinn tíundi), · hann 's **g**olli studdr

2 ok silfri þakðr it sama;

en þar **F**orseti · byggvir flestan dag

4 ok svéfir allar sakir.

Glitner is (the tenth): it is supported by gold,
and thatched with silver likewise,
but there Foresitter dwells for most days,
and puts all disputes to sleep.

[R 9v/19, A 4v/8,
S 7r/34, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

1 es (hinn tíundi) 'is (the tenth)' | 'h. e. x.' (fór "e. h. x.") A; hęitir salr 'a hall is called' G 1 's |
om. U 2 þakðr it | om. U 3 þar | þat ST; þá W

ALL | St. 15 is cited in *Gylf* 32:4, introduced by the words *Sú segir hér*: 'So it says here.' *Gylf* 32:2–3 provides context: *Hann á þann sal á himni, er Glitnir heitir. En allir, er til hans koma með sakarvandręði, þá fara allir sáttir á braut. Sá er dóm-staðr betstr með goðum ok męnnum*. 'He has the hall in heaven which is called Glitner. But all who come to him with difficult disputes then all go away reconciled. That is the best judgment place amongst gods and men.'

16 **N**óa-tún eru (hin ęlliptu), · en þar **N**jorðr hęfir

2 sér of gorrva sali;

manna þęngill · hinn męins-vani

4 hó-timbruðum horgi ręðr.

Nowetons are (the eleventh), and there Nearth has
made for himself a hall.

The lord of men, the guiltless one,
rules the harrow timbered on high.

[R 9v/21, A 4v/9]

3 manna þęngill · hinn męins-vani 'The lord of men, the guiltless one' | Interesting epithets probably relating to Nearth's roles in upholding the prosperity of the land and the law. Cf. my article on pre-Christian oaths (TODO).

4 hó-timbruðum horgi ręðr 'rules the harrow timbered on high' | The rare verb *hó-timbra* 'timber on high' otherwise only occurs in *Vsp* 7, likewise in connection with the *horgr* 'harrow'. The harrow is an outdoors holy place; see there. Cf. also *Vafþ* 38 where Nearth is said to rule a great many *hofum* ok *horgum* 'hoves and harrows'.

17 **H**rísi vęx · ok **h**ou grasi

2 **V**ið-ars land, viði,

en þar **m**ougr of lét=sk · af **m**ars baki

4 frókn at hęfna fęður.

With brushwood and with tall grass grows,
Wider's land, with wood,
but there the lad vows from the back of his steed,
brave, to avenge his father.

[R 9v/23, A 4v/11]

4 at | ok (‘j’) RA

ALL | At the Rakes of the Reins Wider must avenge his father, Weden. See *Vsp* 51–52, *Vafþ* 53.

1 Hrísi vęx · ok hóu grasi ‘With brushwood and with tall grass grows’ | Identical to *Háv* 119/6.

- 18 And·hrímnir · léttr í **Eld**-hrímní
2 Sę·hrímní soðinn,
flęska bęttst, · ęn þat f^{air} vitu,
4 við hvat ęin-herjar ala=sk.

Andrimner lets in Eldrimner
Sowrimner be cooked,
the best of meats, but few know this:
by what the Oneharriers are nourished.

1 And·hrímnir | And·runnir T 1 Eld·hrímní | Eld·runni T 2 Sę·hrímní | Sę·runni T 3
flęska | †fęlska† S 4 við | so G; om. RA

ALL | The poem moves away from the dwellings of the individual gods to an extended description of Walhall and its surroundings. The cook Andrimner ‘Face-sooty’ cooks the boar Sowrimner ‘Sow-sooty’ in the cauldron Eldrimner ‘Fire-sooty’; by this meat are the Oneharriers nourished. — Sts. 18–20 are cited in order in *Gylf* 38 interspersed by short prose explanations. St. 18 is cited following *Gylf* 38:6. *Gylf* 38:3, 5–6 introduces it: *En aldri er svá mikill mann-fjölði í Val-höll at eigi má þeim enda-sk flesk galtar þess er Sę-brímnir heitir. Hann er soðinn hvern dag ok heill at aptni. [...] And-brímnir heitir steikari’nn en Eld-brímnir ketill’inn. Svá er hér sagt: ‘But there is never such a great gathering of men in Walhall that they should not be fully furnished with the flesh of that boar which is called Sowrimner. He is cooked every day and is healthy and alive in the evening. [...] Andrimner is the name of the cook, but Eldrimner the kettle. So it is said here:’*

- 19 Gera ok Freka · sęðr gunn-tamiðr,
2 hróðigr Herja-fęðr,
ęn við vín ęitt · vápn-gofugr
4 Óðinn ę lifir.

Gar and Freak does the battle-accustomed
glorious Father of Hosts (= Weden) feed,
but on wine alone, esteemed of weapons,
Weden ever lives.

1 gunn-tamiðr | †gunnta midr† T 3 vápn-gofugr | vápn-gafigr ST; vápn-†gaffiþr† U 4 ę |
er T

ALL | St. 19 is cited in *Gylf* 38:10, introduced by the words *Svá segir hér*. ‘So it says here.’ *Gylf* 38:7–9 provides context: *Þá męlti Gangleri: „Hvært befir Óðinn þat sama borð-bald sem Ein-herjar?“ Hárr segir: „Þá vist, er á hans borði stendr, gefr hann tveim úlfum, er hann á, er svá heita, Geri ok Freki. En enga vist þarf hann: Vín er bonum bæði drykkir ok matr. “Then spoke Gangler: “Does Weden have the same things on his table as the Oneharriers?” High says: “The foodstuff which stands on his table he gives to the two wolves he owns, which are called thusly: Gar and Freak. But he needs no foodstuffs; for him wine is both drink and food.”*

[R 9v/24, A 4v/12,
S 9v/12, T 10r/18,
W TODO, U TODO]

[R 9v/26, A 4v/14,
S 9v/17, T 10r/23,
W TODO, U TODO]

1 Gera ok Freka ‘Gare and Freak’ | Weden’s two hounds. It is not said with what food Weden feeds them, but if we consider Weden’s relation to the common ‘beasts of battle’ motif, it is most likely the corpses of dead warriors.

3 vín ‘wine’ | The wine on which Weden himself subsists may perhaps be identified with drink offerings. For hallowing of alcohol to this god cf. the 7th c. *Vita Columbani*, ch. 53, describing a heathen rite of the Swabians (Jonas of Bobbio 1851, 1040D–1041A, my translation):

Quo cum moraretur, et inter habitatores loci illius progredieretur, reperit eos sacrificium profanum litare velle, vasque magnum, quod vulgo cupam vocant, quod viginti et sex modios amplius minusve capiebat, cervisia plenum in medio habebant positum. Ad quod vir Dei accessit, et sciscitatur quid de illo fieri vellent. Illi aiunt deo suo Vodano, quem Mercurium vocant alii, se velle litare. ‘While he was staying there and going about the dwellers of that place, he found out that they were going to offer a profane sacrifice, and a large cask called a *cupa*, which held about twenty-six measures, was filled with beer and set in their midst. When the man of God asked what they wanted to do with it they answered that they wanted to offer it to their god *Vodan*, whom others call *Mercury*.’

20 Huginn ok Muninn · fljúga hvern dag

- 2 jǫrmun-grund yfir;
ó=umk of Hugin, · at apr né komi=t;
4 þó sé=umk meirr of Munin.

Highen and Minden fly every day
over the ermen-ground [EARTH].

I worry for Highen that he might not come back,
yet I fear more for Minden.

1 hvern dag | hvern dag U 3 ó=umk | †otunk† T; †unz† U 3 of | ek G 3 né | om. TU
3 komi=t | komi ASTW; komr U

ALL | St. 20 is cited following *Gylf* 38:13, and its citation concludes the chapter. The stanza is introduced by the words *Gylf* 38:11–13 provides context: *Hrafnar tveir sitja á oxlum bónum ok segja í eyru bónum öll tíðendi, þau er þeir sjá eða heyra. Þeir beita svá, Huginn ok Muninn. Þá sendir hann í dagan at fljúga um heim allan, ok koma þeir apr at dogurðar-máli. Þar af verðr hann margra tíðenda viss. Því kalla menn hann Hrafn-guð. Svá sem sagt er:* ‘Two ravens sit upon his shoulders and tell into his ears all the tidings which they see or hear. They are called so: Highen and Minden. He sends them out at dawn to fly throughout all the Home, and they come back at supper-time; thereof he is made aware of many tidings. For this reason men call him Raven-god. As it is said:’

2 jǫrmun-grund ‘ermen-ground’ | The ‘world-ground’, i.e., ‘the whole wide world’, a poetic compound denoting the earth as a flat, spacious expanse of land, surrounded by the unbounded outer sea. In ON this word only occurs elsewhere at two places: in a kenning on the late C10th Karlevi stone (Öl 1), which refers to the unbounded sea as *Endils jǫrmun-grund* ‘Andle’s ermen-ground’ (Andle being a known sea-king), and in the C13th *Sturl Hryn* 16/2 (SkP 2), referring generically to land. A direct cognate, OE *eormen-grund*, appears only once, in *Beow* 859, where it carries the same sense as in the present stanza.

21 Þýtr Þund, · unir Þjóð-vitnis

- 2 fiskr flóði i;
áar straumr · þykkir of-mikill
4 val-glaumi at vaða.

Thound roars; Thedwitner’s fish
thrives in the flood.

[R 9v/28, A 4v/15,
S 9v/22, T 10r/28,
W TODO, U TODO]

[R 9v/30, A 4v/17]

The river-stream seems far too great
for the noisy slain host to wade.

3 þykkir | so A; om. R 4 val-glaumi | val-glaumni A

ALL | A difficult stanza. Considering the st. is in the middle of others describing Weden and Walhall, Thound is possibly the river moat which the dead warriors have to pass over to reach Walhall. The stanza may also be referring to the punishment of criminals in waters (for which see *Vsp* 38 n.).

1–2 Þjóð-vitnis fiskr ‘Thedwitner’s fish’ | Þjóð-vitnir is easily analyzed as þjóð- ‘great, main’ + vitnir ‘wolf’ and the great wolf is of course the Fenerswolf. The Wolf is called the brother of the Middenyardswyrm (*Hym* 23), and so that may be its “fish”. That the Wyrm can be called a fish is shown by *Hym* 24. The “fish” can also be Nithehewer, the dragon who tortures slain criminals (*Vsp* 38).

22 Val-grind heitir · es stendr velli á
2 heilög fyr heilgum durum;
forn ’s sú grind, · en þat fæir vitu,
4 hvé hön ’s i lás of lokin.

[R 9v/32, A 4v/18]

Walgrind it is called which stands on the plain,
holy, before the holy doors.
Old is that gate, but few know this:
how its lock is locked.

4 of | so A; om. R

1 Val-grind ‘Walgrind’ | ‘Slain-gate’, the gate standing before Walhall.

23 Fimm hundruð golfa · ok umb fjórum tögum
2 svá hygg’k Bil-skirni með bugum;
ranna þeira, · es ek reipt vita,
4 mĩns veit’k mest magari.

[R 9v/34, A 4v/22,
S 6r/24, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

With five hundred floors and around fourty—
so I judge Bilshirner altogether.
Of those houses which I might know rafted
I know my lad’s [= Thunder] is the greatest.

ALL | *Sts. 23 and 24 come in reverse order in A.* 1 umb | om. U 2 hygg’k | add. á Val-höll vesa (*ditto*graphy through homoioarcton) A 3 reipt | rēfr U 4 mĩns | †murs† T

ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf* 21, the chapter describing Thunder, immediately following *Gylf* 21:4–6, which reads: *Hann á þar ríki er Þrúð-vangar beita, en þoll hans heitir Bil-skirnir. Í þeim sal eru fimm hundruð gólfa ok fjórir tigr. Þat er hús mest svá at menn viti. Svá segir í Grimnis-mólum:* ‘He has his domain in the place called the Thrithwongs, but his hall is called Bilshirner. In that hall there are five hundred and fourty floors. That is the greatest house which men know of. So it says in the Speeches of Grimner:’.

- 25 Fimm hundruð dura · ok umb fjórum tögum,
 2 svá hygg á Val-höllu vesa;
 átta hundruð Eñ-hērja · ganga senn ór eñinum durum,
 4 þá's fara við vitni at vega.

Five hundred doors and around fourty—

so I judge there to be on Walhall.

Eight hundred Oneharriers march at once out of one door
 when to fight with the Wolf they fare.

1 hundruð | hund T 1 umb | om. AU 1 fjórum tögum | abbrev. as .xl. A; fjóra tugu 2
 hygg | kveð'k A 2 á | at R; om. T 2 Val-höllu | Val-höll ATW 3 senn | om. RU 4 fara |
 ganga U 4 við | so AWU; at R; með ST

ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf* 40:4, introduced by the words: *Hér mátt-u beyra í Grímnis-mólum*. 'Here mightst thou hear in the Speeches of Grímnir.' *Gylf* 40:1–3 provides the context *Þá mælti Gangleri: „Þetta eru undar-lig tíðendi, er nú sagðir þú. Geysi-mikit þús mun Val-höll vera. All-þröngt mun þar opt vera fyrir durum.“ Þá svarar Hárr: „Hví spyrst þú eigi þess, hversu margar dyrr eru á höllinni eða hversu stórar? Ef þú beyrir þat sagt, þá munt-u segja, at þitt er undar-ligt, ef eigi má ganga út ok inn hver; er vill. En þat er með sönnu at segja, at eigi er þröngra at skipa bana en ganga í bana*. 'Then spoke Gangler: "These are wondrous tidings which thou hast now told. An enormously great house must Walhall be. It must often be fully cramped before the doors there." Then answers High: "Why askest thou not how many doors there are on the hall or how great they are? If thou hearest that told then thou wilt say that the contrary is wondrous, that every one should not be able to go out and in as he wants to. But with truth it is to be said that it is not more crowded to be inside it than to enter it.'

3 átta hundruð 'eight hundred' | The hundred is probably here the long hundred (120, rather than 100), which gives a sum of $640 \cdot 960 = 614\,400$ Oneharriers.

4 þá's fara við vitni at vega 'when to fight with the Wolf they fare' | At the Rakes of the Reins by Weden's side. Cf. *Vsp* 51–52, *Vafþ* 53.

- 25 Heið-rún heitir geit, · es stendr höllu á (Hērja-fōðrs)
 2 ok bítr af Lē-raðs limum;
 skap-ker fylla · skal hins skíra mjaðar,
 4 kná=at sú vęig vana=sk.

Heathrune is the goat called which stands on the hall (of the Father of Hosts)
 and bites from Leered's branches.

The shape-vat she shall fill with the pure mead;
 those draughts do not wane.

ALL | This st. is paraphrased in *Gylf* 39:4–5: *Geit sú, er Heið-rún heitir, stendr uppi á Val-höll ok bítr barr af limum trés þess, er mjök er nafn-frégt, er Lē-raðr heitir, en ór spenum bennar rennr mjōðr sá, er bón fyllir skap-ker hvern dag. Þat er svá mikít, at allir Ein-herjar verða full-ðrukknir af*. 'That goat which is called Heathrune stands upon Walhall and bites the leaves from the branches of that tree which is very renowned, which is called Leedred. But out of her teats flows such mead that she fills the shape-vat every day. It is so great that all the Oneharriers become fully drunk thereof.'

1 höllu á (Hērja-fōðrs) 'on the hall of the Father of Hosts' | On Walhall. *Hērja-fōðrs* 'of the Father of Hosts' is almost certainly an unmetrical later insert in order to clarify which hall the poet is referring to and has therefore been placed in parentheses.

[R 10r/2, A 4v/20,
 S 10r/10, T TODO,
 W TODO, U TODO]

[R 10r/4, A 4v/24]

2 Lē-raðs ‘Leered’ | The Ash of Ugdrassle, as is seen by the mention of the stag in st. 26/1 and again in st. 36/3.

3 skap-ker ‘shape-vat’ | According to CV the central beer-vat, from which drinks were poured into smaller vessels.

3 hins skira mjaðar ‘the pure mead’ | The goat’s milk is mead.

- 26 Eik·þyrnir hēitir hjörtr · es stendr *høllu* à (Hērja-fōðrs) [R 10r/6, A 4v/26]
 2 ok bít af Lē-raðs limum;
 en af hans hornum · drýpr í Hver-gelmi
 4 þaðan eiga vōtn øll vega:

Oakthirner is the hart called which stands on the hall (of the Father of Hosts)
 and bites from Leered’s branches,
 but from his horns it drip into Wharyelmer;
 thence all waters have their courses:

1 *høllu à* | *emend.*; *rev.* RA 1 *høllu* | ‘hællu’ A 3 Hver-gelmi | †hvergælgji† (*fōr* *‘hvergælmī’)
 A

ALL | Gylf 39:7–8 continues with its paraphrase: *Þá mēlti Hárr: „Enn er meira mark at of hjört’inn Eik·þyrni, er stendr á Val-høll ok bít af limum þess trés, en af hornum hans verðr svá mikill dropi, at niðr kemr í Hver-gelmi,* ‘Then spoke High: “Yet a greater feature of it [viz. Walhall] is the hart Oakthirner, who stands upon Walhall and bites from the branches of that tree. But from his horns comes such great dripping that it goes down into Wharyelmer,’

- 27 Síð ok Víð, Sēkin ok Eikin, · Svøl ok Gunn·þró, [R 10r/9, A 4v/28]
 2 Fjorm ok Fimbul·þul,
 Rīn ok Rinnandi,
 4 Gipul ok Gōpul, · Gōmul ok Gēr·vimul,
 þēr hverfa umb hodd goða,
 6 Þyn ok Vin, · Þøll ok Høll,
 Grōð ok Gunn·þorin.

Side and Wide, Shin and Oaken, Swale and Guththrew,
 Ferm and Fimblethule,
 Rhine and Rinning,
 Gipple and Gapple, Gamble and Garwimble—
 they circle round the hoard of the Gods [= Osyard]—
 Tyne and Ween, Thuil and Huil,
 Gread and Guththorn.

ALL | Sts. 27–28 list numerous rivers, many of which are undoubtedly mythological. For the sake of having somewhat more natural Anglicized renditions I have taken many of the names from Cleasby and Guðbrandur Vigfússon (CV, p. 780), who identified them with real rivers in Scotland and England, although it must be said that many or all of their identifications are entirely unverifiable and probably incorrect. —

Gylf 39:9–10 immediately continues with its paraphrase (cf. sts. 25–26 above), clearly deriving from sts. 27–28: *ok þaðan af falla þér ár, er svá heita: Sið, Við, Sekin, Ekin, Svöl, Gunn-þró, Fjörm, Fimbul-þul, Gípul, Gopul, Gómul, Geir-vímul. Þessar falla um ása byggðir. Þessar eru enn nefndar: Þyn, Vin, Þoll, Hól, Gröð, Gunn-þráin, Nyt, Nöt, Nönn, Hrönn, Vína, Veg-svinn, Þjóð-numa.* ‘and thereof fall the rivers which are called so: Side, Wide, Shin, Ecken, Swale, Guththrew, Ferm, Fimblethule, Gipple, Gapple, Gamble, Garwimble. These fall around the settlements of the Eese. These are yet named: Tyne, Ween, Thuil, Huil, Gread, Guththrown, Nit, Nat, Nan, Ran, Wine, Wayswith, Thednumb!’ A similar list of rivers likewise deriving from sts. 27–28 is found in *Gylf* 4:3–4: *Þá mælti Jafn-bár: „Fyrr var þat morgum öldum en jörð var skapað er Nífl-heimr var ger; ok í bonum miðjum liggir brúðr sá, er Hver-gelmir heitir, ok þaðan af falla þér ár, er svá heita: Svöl, Gunn-þrá, Fjörm, Fimbul-þul, Slíðr ok Hríð, Sylgr ok Ylgr, Við, Leipt. Gjöll er nēst Hel-grindum.“* ‘Then spoke Evenhigh: “It was many ages before the earth was created that Nivelham was made, and in the middle of it lies the well which is called Wharyelmer, and thereof fall the rivers which are called so: Swale, Guththrew, Ferm, Fimblethule, Slide and Ride, Sellow and Wellow, Wide, Laffer. Yell is closest to the gates of Hell.”’ To distinguish the variants the manuscript is followed by a subscript number: 1 for the paraphrase in *Gylf* 4:3–4, 2 for 39:9–10, so that e.g. U₂ refers to the form of a name in *Gylf* 39:9–10 in U. TODO: Incorporate these variants into the edition.

28 **V**ina hēitir enn, · ǫnnur **V**eg-svinn,

[R 10r/12, A 5r/1]

2 þriðja Þjóð-numa;

Nyt ok Nöt, · Nönn ok Hrönn,

4 Slíð ok Hríð, · Sylgr ok Ylgr,

Víð ok Vön, · Vönd ok Strönd,

6 Gjöll ok Leipt; · þér falla gumnum nēr
en falla til hējar hēðan.

Wine is yet another called, another Wayswith,
a third Thednumb;
Nit and Nat, Nan and Ran,
Slide and Ride, Sellow and Wellow,
Wide and Ween, Wand and Strand,
Yell and Laffer—they fall near to men,
but fall hence to Hell.

1 **V**ina | ‘Viná’ R; †Viná† (fōr *Viná) A 5 **V**ön | Vöð A 7 en | so A; es R

29 **K**ǫrmt ok Qrmt · ok kēr-laugar tvēr

[R 10r/15, A 5r/4,
S 5r/1, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

2 þér skal Þörr vaða

dag hvēr · es dōma fēr

4 at aski Ygg-drasils;

því’t Ǫs-brú · brinn ǫll loga

6 hēilǫg vötn hlóa.

Carmet and Armet and the two Carlays,
these shall Thunder wade
every day, when to judge he goes
at the Ash of Uggdrassle,
for the Os-bridge [RAINBOW] all will burn with flame;
the holy waters boil.

1 Kǫrmt ok Qrmt | †kaurnit ok aurnit† T 3 dag hvern | so ASTW; rev. U; hverjan dag R 5
loga | add. en U 6 hlóa 'boil' | flóa 'turn bot' U

ALL | Thunder's movement is so powerful that he cannot ride across the rainbow bridge as this would cause it to burn up; for the violent movement of this god cf. *Þrk* 21, *Lok* 55. — St. 29 is cited in *Gylf* 15:21, the chapter about how the Gods get to their Thing, introduced by the words: *En Þórr gengr til dóms'ins ok veðr ár þér, er svá heita*: 'But Thunder walks to the Judgment and wades through the rivers which are called so'.

1 Kǫrmt ok Qrmt 'Carmet and Armet' | Two interesting river-names. *Kǫrmt* 'Carmet' is the well-attested ON name of the island Karmøy in Rogaland, Norway (e.g. *ÞSjár* Frag 1, *ESk* Lv 9, *Þul Eyja* 3 in *SkP* 3), on whose northern side the ancient royal seat Awaldsness (ON *Qg-valds-nēs*) is located. The present stanza, however, cannot be referring to the island itself but instead seems to refer to Karmsund, the sound separating the island from the mainland. (For reference, at its narrowest point—the place of the Karmsund bridge—the sound is only ca. 190 m wide, while at Ogwaldsness two km south it is ca. 300 m.)

The rhyming *Qrmt* is a hapax only otherwise found in the duplicate line in *Þul Á* 6. No descendant is attested in Norway, but Cleasby and Guðbrandur Vigfússon (CV, p. 780) connect it to the river Armet in Scotland. Still, such a geographic spread seems quite unlikely, and it is more probable that the Scottish river-name, if related at all to *Qrmt*, is taken from that of a now-lost Norwegian sound or island in the vicinity of Carmet.

Olsen (1925) derives the names from *karmr* and *armr*, terms for the parallel parts of a pen in a sheep-fold, which would give them a sense like 'low protective wall'. Olsen considers the present use of the names mythological and of likely Icelandic origin, deriving from a confusion of vaguely remembered names of real locations; he argues that the use of the island-name for the sound would be offensive to a Norwegian with good geographic awareness. And yet the likeness of the islands or their sounds to a sheep-fold fits very well geographically with the area around Karmøy, so that this argument is not entirely convincing.

1 Kǫrmt ... tvér 'Carmet ... Carlays' | This line also appears in a thule or list of poetic synonyms (*Þul Á* 6 in *SkP* 3), where however *ok* 'and' in the a-verse is replaced with the name *Leiptr* 'Lafter' as found in st. 28/6 above.

2 þér skal Þórr vaða 'these shall Thunder wade' | Thunder is commonly associated with wading; cf. *Hárþ* 13/3 n., *Eddbr* V1.

5 Qs-brú 'Os-bridge' | The Rainbow Bridge, Bivrest. Cf. st. 45/4 below.

6 hlóa 'boil' | A hapax, U's reading is unmetrical. Ásgeir Blöndal Magnússon (1989, s.v. *blóa*) connects it with the adj. *blér* 'hot, mild', and this seems likely enough.

30 Glaðr ok Gyllir, · Glær ok Skęið·brimir,
2 Silfrin·toppr ok Sinir,
Gísł ok Fal·hófnir, · Goll·toppr ok Lét·feti,
4 þeim ríða ęsir jóum
dag hvern · es dōma fara
6 at aski Ygg·drasils.

[R 10r/17, A 5r/6]

Glad and Gilder, Glare and Sheathbrimmer,
Silvrentop and Sinewer;
Yissel and Fallowhooven, Goldtop and Lightfeet;
on these horses ride the Eese
every day when to judge they go
at the Ash of Ugdrassle.

3 Fal-hófnir | ‘falæpnir’ A 5 fara | om. A

ALL | This stanza clearly serves as a source for *Gylf* 15:18–20: *Hestar ása’nna heita svá: Sleipnir er batstr, hann á Öðinn; hann hefir átta fœtr. Annarr er Gláðr, þriði Gyllir, fjórði Glenr, fimmti Skeið-brimr, sétti Silfrin-toppr, sjauundi Sinir, átti Gísil, níundi Fal-hófnir, tíundi Gull-toppr, ellipti Létt-feti. Baldrs bestr var brenndr með bönum.* ‘The horses of the Eese are called so. Slopner is the best; Weden owns him; he has eight legs. The second is Glad, third Gilder, fourth Glen, fifth Sheathbrimmer, sixth Silvrentop, seventh Sinewer, eighth Yissel, ninth Fallowhooven, tenth Goldtop, eleventh Lightfeet. Balder’s horse was burned with him.’ TODO: Incorporate variants from G.

- 31 Þrjár rótr · standa á þrjá vega
2 undan aski Ygg-drasils;
Hæl býr und einni, · annarri hrím-þursar,
4 þriðju mænnskir menn.

[R 10r/20, A 5r/8]

Three roots grow in three directions
from beneath the Ash of Ugdrassle.
Hell lives enclosed by one, by the other the Rime-Thurses,
by the third manly men.

2 undan | und A

ALL | The Ash of Ugdrassle, the World Tree, stands at the center of the World, being the *axis mundi* around which the Cosmos revolves. This is how we should understand its being the origin of the three roots going into the three realms. Through these roots it is also possible to travel from the land of men to the land of the dead (and vice-versa), and this is likely significant to the myth of Weden’s self-hanging upon the Tree (*Háv* 138). Note that the Gods are not mentioned, for the Ash stands beside Walhall as shown by sts. 25–26 above.

3 und ‘enclosed by’ | ON *undir* (short form *und*) ‘under’ can also refer to something enclosed, e.g. by a high wall, so that the residents of a walled city are said to live “under” that city. Since the roots are prob. not thought to be literally overhead above the listed worlds, this is the way the preposition ought to be translated.

- 32 Rata-toskr heitir íkorni · es rinna skal
2 at aski Ygg-drasils;
arnar orð · hann skal ofan bera
4 ok segja Nið-hoggvi niðr.

[R 10r/22, A 5r/9]

Wratetusk is the squirrel called which shall run
along the Ash of Ugdrassle.
The eagle’s words shall he carry from above,
and tell Nithehewer below.

ALL | Sts. 32–36 describe the various animals around the Ash of Ugdrassle. Religiously we ought to understand that the World Tree is under attack by the forces of evil and entropy, chief among them Nithehewer, the corpse-eating dragon of *Vsp* 38, 62. — This st. is paraphrased in *Gylf* 16:1–5: *Þá mælti Gangleri: „Hvat er fleira at segja stór-merkja frá aski’núm?“ Hár segir: „Mart er þar af at segja. Örn einn sitr í limum asks’ins, ok er bann margs vitandi, en í milli augna bonum sitr haukr sá, er beitir Vöðr-fólnir. Íkorni sá, er beitir Rata-toskr, rennr upp ok niðr eptir aski’núm ok berr qfundar orð millum arnar’ins ok Nið-boggs.* ‘Gangler spoke: “What more great signs are there to be told from the ash?” High says: “There is much to tell about it. An eagle sits in the branches of the ash and he is much knowing; but between his eyes sits the hawk called Weatherfalcon. The squirrel which is called Wratetush runs up and down along the ash and carries words of insult between the eagle and Nithehewer.”’

- 2 **33** **H**irtir ’ro ok fjórir · þeir’s af **h**éfangar á
 gag-halsir **g**naga:
 Dáinn ok **D**valinn, · **D**ún·eyrr ok **D**ura·þrór.

[R 10r/23, A 5r/11]

There are four harts, too, who from the buds thereon
 with turned necks gnaw:
 Downen and Dwoollen, Downeer and Doorthrew.

1 **h**éfangar | héfangar A 2 **g**ag-halsir | so A; ‘á gag-halsir’ R 2 **g**naga | ganga A 3 **D**ún·eyrr |
 Dyn·eyrr A 3 **D**ura·þrór | Dyrá·þrór A

ALL | This st. is paraphrased in *Gylf* 16:6, immediately following the paraphrase of the last st.: *En fjórir birtir renna í limum asks’ins ok bíta barr; þeir beita svá: Dáinn, Dvalinn, Dún·eyrr, Dura·þrór.* ‘But four harts run in the limbs of the ash and bite its leaves; they are called thus: Downen, Dwoollen, Downeer, Doorthrew.’

2 gag-halsir gnaga ‘with turned necks gnaw’ | An iconographic parallel to this line presents itself in the common Wiking Age depictions of great horned beasts turning their necks backwards, e.g. on the runestone E 2 or the round brooch from Espinge, Scania (HST 108124).

- 2 **34** **O**rmar fleiri · liggja und **a**ski **Y**gg-drasils
 an þat of **h**yggi **h**vęrr
 ö·sviðra apa:

[R 10r/25, A 5r/12,
 S 5r/24, T TODO,
 W TODO, U TODO]

More wyrms lie under the Ash of Ugdrassle
 than any one would think
 among unwise apes:

2 þat | om. A

ALL | Sts. 34–36 are cited in *Gylf* 16 in the order 36, 34, 35. 34–35 are treated as a single stanza. St. 36 is introduced by *Gylf* 16:7–8: *En svá margir ormar eru í Hvergelmi með Nið-bogg, at engi tunga má telja; svá segir þér: ‘But there are so many wyrms in Wharvelmer with Nithehewer that no tongue may tally them. So it says here:’* Between 36 and 34–35 *Gylf* 16:9 reads: *Svá er enn sagt: ‘Further it is said so:’*

- 35** **G**óinn ok **M**óinn, · þeir ’ro **G**raf·vitnis synir,

[R 10r/26, A 5r/13,
 S 5r/25, T TODO,
 W TODO, U TODO]

- 2 Grá·bagr ok Graf·völluðr,
Ófnir ok Sváfnir, · hygg'k at é skyli
4 meïðs kvistu máa.

Gowen and Mowen—they are Gravewitner's sons—
Greyback and Gravewalled.
Ovner and Swebner I think always shall
maim the branches of the tree.

1 Góinn ok Móinn | Góni ok Móni U 1 synir 'sons' | liðar 'comrades' U 2 Graf·völluðr |
Grap·völluðr W 3 Ófnir | Öpnir A 4 meïðs | meïðar A; †meðs† ST 4 kvistu | kvistum
STW; kostum U

- 36 Askr Ygg·drasils · drygir erfði
2 meïra an menn of viti:
hjótr bítr ofan · en à hliðu fúnar,
4 skęðir Nið·hoggr neðan.

The Ash of Ugdrassle suffers hardship
more than men might know:
A hart bites it from above and it rots on the side;
Nithehewer harms it from below.

2 of | so AU; om. RSTW 3 ofan | neðan (corruption from l. 4) U

[R 10r/28, A 5r/14,
S 5r/22, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

- 37 Hrist ok Mist · vil'k at mér horn beri,
2 Skeggj·öld ok Skogul,
Hildir ok Þrúðr, · Hlökk ok Hęr·fjotur,
4 Goll ok Gęira·høð,
Rand·gríð ok Ráð·gríð, · ok Ręin·leif;
6 þęr bera ęin·hęrjum ęl.

Rist and Mist I would have bring me a horn—
Shedgeld and Shagle,
Hild and Thrith, Lank and Harfetter,
Gall and Garhath,
Randgrith and Redegrith and Rainlaf—
they bring the Oneharriers ale.

2 Skeggj·öld | so RSTW; Skegg·öld AU. 3 Hildir ok Þrúðr 'Hild and Thrith' | Hildi ok Þrúði
R 3 Hęr·fjotur 'Harfetter' | Hęr·fjotra U 4 Goll | Gjoll U 4 Gęira·høð 'Garhath' | so G;
Gęir·ölul 'Garale' R; Gęir·romul 'Garramble' A. — add. ok 'and' U. 5 Rand·gríð | Rand·gríðr
U 5 Ráð·gríð | Ráð·gríðr U 5 ok | om. R 6 ęl | ęl corrected from ęl in same hand A

[R 10r/30, A 5r/16,
S 9r/4, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

ALL | St. 37 is cited following Gylf 36:2. Gylf 36:1–2 introduces it: *Enn eru þęr aðrar er þjóna skulu i Val-höll, bera drykkju ok gęta borð-búnaðar ok ęl-gagna. Svá eru þęr nefndar i Grimnis-mölum:* 'Yet there are other [heavenly] women who shall serve in Walhall, carry the drinks and prepare the table-cloth and ale-stuffs. So are they named in the Speeches of Grimmer?.'

3 Hildir ok Þrúðr ‘Hild and Thrith’ | The R reading stems from *ðz, *ðz with r rotunda being mistakenly copied as ðr, ðr and is certainly not an independent oral variant of these well-attested walkirie names. This is apparent upon viewing the facsimile images.

6 þér bera ein-herjum öl ‘they bring the Oneharriers ale’ | As cupbearers in Walhall. In Iron Age Germanic society pouring drinks at a feast was traditionally done by the ruler’s kinswomen, the most famous literary example being Rothgar’s wife and daughter in *Beow*; see Enright (1996) and Riseley (2014). The Walkirries may have been thought of as the daughters of Woden; see note to *Vsp* 30/5. For the reception of dead warriors see also note to st. 53/3 below.

- 38 **Ár**-vagr ok **Al**-sviðr, · þeir skulu upp heðan
2 svangir sól draga;
 en und þeira **bógum** · fölu blíð regin,
4 **ēsir**, ísarn-kol.

[R 10r/32, A 5r/18]

Yorewaker and Allswith—they shall upward hence,
famished, pull the sun,
but under their shoulders the blithe Reins hid,
the Eese, iron-cooling.

ALL | Sts. 38–40 deal with phenomena concerning the sun. The description of the sun as being pulled by a horse-driven chariot is attested in literature and archeology going back to the Bronze Age. A notable archeological find from the Germanic cultural area is the ca. 1400 BC Trundholm sun chariot found on Zealand, Denmark. This cultic object belonging to the Nordic Bronze Age features a large disc placed on a six-wheeled chariot pulled by a horse (figg. 2, 3, page 156). Only one side of the disc is gilt and so the chariot may also depict the horses pulling the Day and Night, for which see *Vafþ* 11–14. Indo-European literary parallels for horses pulling the sun include the Vedic *RV* 1.50.8–9, 4.13.3, 5.45.9 and the Greek Homeric Hymn to “Hἥlios. This st. is referenced in *Gylf* 11:4–7, about the origin of the Sun and Moon: *En goð’in reiddu=sk þessu of-drambi tóku þau systkin ok settu upp á himin, létu Sól keyra þá besta, er drógu kerru sólár’inna; þeir ar er goð’in bgðu skapat til at lýsa heimana af þeirri síu, er flaug ór Múspells-beimi. Þeir bestar heita súð, Ár-vagr ok Al-sviðr. En undir bógum besta’nna settu goð’in tvá vind-belgi at kóla þá, en í sumum fróðum er þat kallat ísarn-kol. ‘But the Gods were angered by this arrogance and took the two siblings and placed them up in the heaven; they let Sun drive the horses that pulled the chariot of the sun which the Gods had created to brighten the Homes from the sparks which flew out of Muspellsham. Those horses are so named: Yorewaker and Allswith. But under the shoulders of the horses the Gods placed two air bellows to cool them, but in some sources [presumably this st.] those are called iron-cooling.’ Cf. *Vafþ* 23 n., which cites *Gylf* 11:1–3.*

1 Ár-vagr ok Al-sviðr ‘Yorewaker and Allswith’ | The two horses which pull the sun-chariot also appear in *Sigrdr* 15/2; cf. note to the next st.

2 svangir ‘famished’ | M. nom. pl. of *svangr* ‘hungry, starved’. This adj. is used particularly of horses exhausted after long exertion, for which cf. *Oddr* 3/4, *I HHund* 42/4, *Sigv Austv* 11 (in SkP 1).

- 39 **Svalinn** heitir, · hann stendr **sólu** fyrir,
2 skjöldr skínanda goði;
 björg ok **brim** · vейt’k at **brinna** skulu,
4 ef hann **fēllr** í **frá**.

[R 10v/2, A 5r/20]

Swalen it is called; it stands before the sun—
a shield before the Shining God [SUN].

Crag and surf I know shall burn,
if it falls away.

1 Svalinn | *so* ('svalin') A; Svöl R

ALL | The sun-disc was apparently thought to be a translucent shield which protected the earth from the full power of the sun behind it. Without it the "crag and surf" (LAND and SEA; the totality of the earth) would burn. Cf. *Sigrdr* 15/1 which mentions the "shield that stands before the Shining God [SUN]" and is probably drawing on the present stanza.

1 Svalinn | The A reading is preferred since the shield is described by the m. *bann* in both mss., whereas R's *Svöl* looks like a feminine. *Svalinn* is confirmed by its inclusion in the poetic list of synonyms for shields, *Pul Skjaldar* 2/3 (in SkP 3).

40 Skoll heitir ulfr, · es fylgir hinu skír-leita
2 goði til varna viðar,
en annarr Hati · Hród-vitnis sonr,
4 sá skal fyr heðða brúði himins.

[R 10v/4, A 5r/21]

Sholl is the wolf called which follows the Pure-Faced
God [SUN] to the shelter of the woods,
but the other one is called Hate, Rothwitner's son;
he shall stay ahead of the bright Bride of Heaven [SUN].

2 varna | †vaurna† A 3 Hati | *add.* hann 's he is' R.

ALL | For discussion on these wolves see *Vsp* 40 n. — This stanza is closely paraphrased in *Gylf* 12:4–5, following a question about why the sun hurries so quickly: *Hárr segir: „Þat eru tveir ulfar, ok heitir sá, er eptir benni ferr, Skoll. Hann bréði-sk bón, ok hann mun taka bana. En sá heitir Hati Hród-vitnis-son, er fyrir benni bleypr, ok vill hann taka tungl'it, ok svá mun verða.“* 'High says: "It is due to the two wolves, and the one who runs behind her is called Sholl. She fears him, and he would catch her. But the one who runs ahead of her is called Hate Rothwitner's son, and he wants to catch the moon, and so it will remain."

2 til varna viðar 'to the shelter of the woods' | The sun is said to set in the forest. This is an interesting geographic detail since it points away from most of coastal (western) Norway, where the sun sets in the sea, and Iceland, which does not have any expansive forests. The description would however fit well for the Oslofjord area.

41 Ór Ymis holdi · vas jorð of sköpuð,
2 en ór sveita sjór,
björg ór beinum, · baðmr ór hári,
4 en ór hausi himinn.

[R 10v/6, A 5r/23,
S 3r/30, T 4r/10,
W TODO, U TODO,
A_b 9v/14, B 3v/11]

From Yimer's flesh was the Earth created,
but from his blood the sea,
mountains from his bones, woods from his hair,
but from his skull the Heaven.

2 sveita 'his blood' | hans sára sveita 'the blood of his wounds' A_bB 2 sjór 'sea' | *so* AUA_bB;
sér 'id.' R; sjár 'id.' STW. 3–4 björg ... himinn. | *Abbrev.* as b. or. b. b. or. h. En or. h. h.

U, cf. Mårtensson and Pálsson (2008, pp. 137, 145–146). 3 þeinum | þeinu'num T 3 baðmr | þbaðmr† A 4 ór hausi himinn 'from his skull the heaven' | himinn ór hausi hans 'the heaven from his skull' A_bB

ALL | St. 41 is clearly closely related to *Vafþ* 21; for the Creation see there and *Vsp* 3–4. — Sts. 41–42 are cited in sequence following *Gylf* 8:20–25, which describes the Earth: [...] *Hón er kring-lótt útan, ok þar útan um liggir inn djúpi sjár, ok með þeiri sjávar-ströndu göfu þeir lönd til byggðar jötna ettum. En fyrir innan á jörðu'nni gerðu þeir borg um-bverfis heim fyrir ó-fríði jötna. En til þeirar borgar hǫfðu þeir brár Ymis jötuns ok kolluðu þá borg Mið-garð. Þeir tóku ok heila hans ok kǫstuðu í lopt ok gerðu af ský'in. Svá sem hér segir.* 'It is round without and surrounding it there lies the deep sea; and along that sea-shore they [= the Gods] gave the land to the settlement by the lineages of the Ettins. But further within upon the Earth they made a stronghold around the Home against the enmity of the ettins, but for that stronghold they used the eyebrows of the ettin Yimer and they called the stronghold Middenyard. They also took his brains and cast them into the air and thereof made the clouds, just as it says here.' — Sts. 41–42 are also cited with numerous variants in *Litla Skálda*, a short text on Scaldic poetics that likely served as a source for Snorre's Edda (cf. *Eddabr* VIII).

3 björg ... baðmr 'mountains ... woods' | Formulaic alliterative pair describing the natural world in a context of creation or destruction, also found in the OHG *Wessobrunn* 3 (*paum noh perek*) and *Musp* 50 (*perga, poum*).

- 42 Țn ór hans bróum · gørðu blið regin
2 Mið-garð manna sonum,
 ȥn ór hans hȥila · vǫru þau hin harð-móðgu
4 ský ȥll of skȥpuð.

[R 10v/8, A 5r/25,
S 3r/31, T 4r/11,
W TODO, U TODO,
A_b 9v/16, B 3v/12]

But from his brows the blithe Reins made
Middenyard for the sons of men,
but from his brains were the hard-minded
clouds all created.

3 ȥn | ok U 3 hin | om. T 3 harð-móðgu 'hard-minded' | hríð-fȥldu 'stormy' A_bB

1–2 Țn ór hans bróum · gørðu blið regin / Mið-garð manna sonum 'But from his brows the blithe Reins made Middenyard for the sons of men' | The Gods fenced in Middenyard ('the Middle Enclosure') by using the strands of Yimer's eyebrows as poles, as explained in *Gylf* 8:22–23. The creation of this enclosure was a gift from the kind Gods to mankind in order to protect us from the forces of destruction without; cf. *Vsp* 16/2 n.

- 43 Ullar hylli · hȥfr ok allra goða
2 hvȥrr's tȥkr fyrstr á funa,
 þvít opnir hȥimar · verða umb asa sonum,
4 þá's hȥfa af hvera.

[R 10v/9, A 5r/26]

Wolder's holdness and that of All Gods
has whoever first kindles the fire,
for the Homes become open for the sons of the Eese [GODS],
when men lift off the cauldrons.

4 þá's | add. þȥir A

ALL. | This st. is one of the most difficult in the poem and many interpretations have been made. The traditional view (e.g. Finnur Jónsson (1932), Bellows, Sijmons and Gering p. 208) relates it to the poem's frame narrative. Weden, bound between the two fires, cryptically asks for a cauldron hanging above him from the roof to be moved aside so that the Gods will be able to see him through the smoke-vent and rescue him. This explanation, however, leaves much unexplained, namely the stanza's placement in the gnomic wisdom section of the poem, the invocation of the obscure god Wolder, the lack of mention of any cauldron elsewhere in the poem, and the question of why the gods would bestow their grace unto the person who first set the fire which is presently torturing Weden (assuming *tękr á funa* means 'kindles the fire'; see note to that phrase).

I find the interpretation of Nordberg (2005) more convincing. Nordberg argues that the st. is another piece of gnomic wisdom, referring to the cooking of the sacrificial meal in large cauldrons during the Blood. The importance of cauldrons is seen in the common name second element *-ketill* or *-kell* (cognate with English "kettle") and has textual support, e.g. in *HákGöð* 14, describing the traditional blood in the Thronclaw (*Þróncla-łog*), Norway: *At veistu þeiri skyldu allir menn ęl eiga; þar var ok drepinn alls konar smali ok svá bross, [...] en slátr skyldi sjóða til mann-fagnaðar; eldar skyldu vera á miðju gólfi i bofi'nu ok þar katlar yfir.* 'At that gathering all men were to have ale; thereafter also was every kind of small cattle slain and likewise horses, [...] and the fresh meat should be cooked for the enjoyment of men. There should be fires in the middle of the floor in the hove and kettles above them.' According to this view, the stanza is speaking of the Heavenly favour (*hylli*) earned by the ritualist who kindles the cooking fire, since that act enables the Gods to become guests at the ritual meal.

Nordberg's interpretation becomes especially interesting when one considers the immediately preceding stanzas 41–42, which describe the ordering of the world by the Gods through the killing and dismembering of Yimer, the primordial victim. That the killing of Yimer was in fact a sacrifice is supported by the manner in which it was done: beheading, which was the typical manner of slaying sacrificial bulls in the Wiking Age (cf. *Vǫfþ* 21/4 n., Lucas and McGovern 2007). In other Indo-European religions the first sacrifice of a Great Being (most famously the Vedic *Páruša*, *RV* 10.90) serves as the model for all future sacrifice, the performance of which reenacts the Creation and thereby re-establishes the continued existence of the World and upholding the social order (Lincoln 1986, *passim*; cf. *Vsp* 7/2 n.). That the purpose of the sacrifice is the re-establishment of Creation is said explicitly in the ritual language of the Vedic fire-sacrifice (Eliade 2005, pp. 11, 78–80). With this in mind we may consider how the sequence *Grm* 41–43 likely forms a unit: sts. 41–42 describe the Creation of the World through the First Blood (sacrifice) in the mythic past (*in illo tempore*) and st. 43 connects it with the Blood in the present.

1 Ullar 'Wolder's' | It is uncertain why the obscure god Wolder is invoked here but it cannot be simply for the sake of alliteration, since the much more well-known *Öðins* 'Weden's' would work just as well. It is possible that Wolder had a particular role in the setting of the ritual fire, something which finds support in the large number of fire-striker-shaped iron amulet-rings dating to ca. 660–780 CE found at the archeological site of *Lilla Ullevi* ('Wolder's little wigh') in Sweden (af Edholm 2009).

In Wiking Age and High Mediaeval sources Wolder plays a very minor role, but his earlier significance is proven by the impressive number of cultic places named after him (Brink 2007, pp. 116–118) and is, apart from the present stanza, also hinted at by *Akv* 33/4.

1 hylli 'holdness' | 'Favour, loyalty, grace'. This word, derived from the adjective *holtr* 'hold; favourable, loyal, gracious' along with the verb *hylla* 'to make hold' is used to refer to the grace of god(s) in both Heathen and Christian texts. See Index: hold and holdness.

1 allra goða 'All Gods' | Cf. *Sigrdr* 3–4, *Lok* 11, which both hail the Gods as a collective (the former as part of a genuine prayer, the latter subversively), and *Hákm* 18, where the piety of the dead king Hathkin is shown by his being greeted by *ręð ęll ok ręgin* 'all the Redes and Reins'.

The ritual use of this phrase proves that the pre-Christian Germanic religion did in fact believe in a form of Oneness of the Gods and their identity as a united body, something also seen in the idea of the Thing of the Gods (see *Vsp* 6 n.), where all the Gods gather to steer the fates of the world. Similar expressions are found in other old Indo-European religions, e.g., OI *vísęvę dęváp* 'All Gods', to Whom are dedicated numerous hymns of *RV* (Brereton and Jamison 2020, p. 68), and Greek *πávτεs θεοί* 'id.', found as early as the Mycenaean ritual inscriptions of the Bronze Age (Ziegler 1949; Ventris and Chadwick 1973, pp. 127, 303, 567; Killen 2024, pp. 860, 861, 1001).

This idea of Godly Oneness may have been the subject of dispute in the Norse world. Saxo Grammaticus (2015, pp. 53–54), 1.7.2 gives us an interesting anecdote. After Weden departs he is usurped by the obscure *Mithothin* (perhaps “With-Weden”), who reforms the cult:

Cuius secessu Mithothyn quidam prestigii celebrer, perinde ac celesti beneficio vegetatus, occasionem et ipse fingende divinitatis arripuit barbarasque mentes novis erroris tenebris circumfusus prestigiarum fama ad cerimonias suo nomini persolvendas adduxit. Hic deorum iram aut numinum violationem confusis permixtisque sacrificiis expiari negabat ideoque eis vota communiter nuncupari prohibebat, discreta superum cuique libamenta constituens. Qui cum Othino redeunte relicta prestigiarum ope latendi gratia Pheoniam accessisset, concursu incolarum occiditur.

‘A certain Mithodin, a famous illusionist, was animated at his departure as if by a kindness from heaven and snatched the chance to pretend divinity himself; his reputation for magicianism clouded the barbarians’ minds with the murk of a new superstition and led them to perform holy rites to his name. He asserted that the gods’ wrath and the profanation of their divine authority could not be expiated by confused and mingled sacrifices; so he arranged that they must not be prayed to as a group, but separate offerings (*libamenta*) be made to each deity. When Odin returned, the other no longer resorted to his conjuring but went off to hide in Funen, where he was rushed upon and killed by the inhabitants.’

It is not impossible that this obviously mythologised retelling may in fact reflect an actual theological conflict or attempted religious reform within the late Norse religion.

2 tēkr ... á funa ‘kindles the fire’ | Viz. the hallowed fire above which the holy cauldrons are hung; for the role of fire in Germanic and Vedic sacrifice see Kaliff (2005). — An otherwise unattested phrase which is here taken as equivalent with *taka ǣld* ‘kindle fire’, although this is problematic since the preposition *á* ‘on’ modifies the sense of the verb and the phrase *taka á* has a variety of idiomatic senses like ‘touch, react to, get involved in, get on’, though **taka á ǣld* is not attested. Another possibility is to read the ms. *afuna* as an error for *affuna* ‘from the fire’, which would yield the superior sense ‘whoever first takes [the cauldrons] from the fire’ (Nordberg 2005, p. 55).

3 opnir heima verða ‘the Homes become open’ | The Bloot opens up the human world to that of the Gods above. Similar language is used in several hymns of *RV* which pray for the Heavenly Doors (*dvārah devīṭh*) to open up, e.g. *RV* 1.13.6, 1.142.6, 2.3.5.

4 hvera ‘cauldrons’ | Acc. pl. of *hverr*, from PGmc. **hweraz*, from PIE **k^wer-* ‘pot, vessel’ (Kroonen 2013, p. 265). The Sanskrit cognate *carú* is occasionally used in reference to the vat from which the ritual drink *soma* is drunk (*RV* 10.167.4), but a particular religious significance for the PIE root cannot be reconstructed.

- 44 Í·valda synir · gingu i ár·daga
2 Skíð·blaðni at skapa,
skipa bætst · skírum Fręy,
4 nýtum Njarðar bur.

[R 10v/11, A 5r/28]

Iwald’s sons went in days of yore
Shidebladner for to shape:
the best of ships for the pure Free,
for the useful Son of Nearth.

ALL | The ship Shidebladner is also described in *Gylf* 43, which is quite likely pulling from the present stanza.

- 45 Askir Ygg·drasils, · hann ’s óðstr viðā
2 ęn Skíð·blaðnir skipa,
Óðinn āsa · ęn jóa Slęipnir,
4 Bif·røst brúa · ęn Bragi skalda,

[R 10v/13, A 5r/29,
S 10r/20, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

Hó-brók hauka · en hunda Garmr.

The Ash of Ugdassle—it is the noblest of trees,
and Shidebladner of ships,
Weden of the Eese and Slopner of steeds,
Bivrest of bridges and Bray of scalds,
Highbrook of hawks and Garm of hounds.

1 hann | *om.* U 4 Bif-røst 'Bivrest' | *so* G; Bil-røst 'Bilrest' RA. — *om., but add. above the line by same hand* A 5 hunda Garmr 'Garm of hounds' | *add.* en Brimir sverða 'and Brimmer of swords' A. 5 Garmr | Gramr ST

ALL | St. 45 concludes Weden's mythological wisdom with a list of the greatest things in each category. It is quite likely that this stanza concluded with *Bif-røst brúa* 'Bivrest of bridges' as a Leeds-meter c-verse and that the following verses are later interpolations in oral transmission. Unlike the previous things listed they seem more trivial. The interpolating tendency is visible in action in A which adds a final unmetrical verse at the end of the stanza. —

The stanza is cited following *Gylf* 41:6-7: *En satt er þat, er þú sagðir. Mikill er Óðinn fyrir sér. Mjög dóni finna-sk til þess. Svá er hér sagt í orðum sjálfra ásanna:* 'But true is that which thou hast said. Weden is formidable; many examples attest to that. So it is said here in the words of the Eese themselves.'

For *Gylf* 41:1-5 see *Vafþ* 41 n.

46 Svipum hefí'k nú ypt · fyr sig-tíva sonum,

[R 10v/15, A 5v/2]

2 við þat skal vil-björg vaka,
ollum ösum · þat skal inn koma
4 Égis bekki á
Égis drekku at.

My gaze I've now lifted up before the sons of the victory-Tews;
by that shall the willed rescue awake!
All the Eese shall it bring in,
upon Eagre's bench,
at Eagre's drinking.

1 nú | *om.* A

ALL | Weden announces that he has raised his gaze and made the Gods aware of his situation; they will leave their feasting at Eagre's hall (cf. *Hym* and *Lok*) and come to his rescue.

47 Hét=umk Grímr, · hét=umk Ganglæri,

[R 10v/17, A 5v/4,
S 6r/5, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

2 Hęřjann ok Hjal̥m-beri,
Þękr ok Þriði, · Þuðr ok Uðr,
4 Hęl-blindi ok Hór.

I called myself Grim; I called myself Gangler,
Harn and Helmbearer.
Theck and Third, Thith and Ith,
Hellblinder and High.

1 hét=umk | ok ASWU; om. T 1 Gangleri | so RAU; Gangari S; Gangi T; Ganglari W. 2
ok | om. G 3 ok | om. G 3 Þuðr | so AG; Þunðr ('Þvðr') R 3 ok | om. G 4 Hçl-blindi |
so RG; Hçr-blindr A 4 ok | om. G 4 Hçr | Hårr W

ALL | Weden begins his list of names which takes up sts. 47–52; more names are given in a second list in 56–57. Note that the name *Óðinn* 'Weden' itself does not appear in the first list. — The names from sts. 47–52 and 56 (but not 57) are also found in *Gylf* 20:11, introduced by the words: *ok enn befir hann nefit=sk á fleiri vega, þá er hann var kominn til Geir-röðar konungs*: 'and he has named himself in yet more ways when he was come to visit King Garfrith.' The names are given in the order they appear in each stanza and the stanzas themselves come in the order: 47, 48, 49, 51, 52, 50, 56. For the purpose of the present critical edition, variant names from the list in *Gylf* 20:11 are noted for all relevant stanzas, but only sts. 47–49 are treated as being actually cited in *Gylf*. Note that all 4 mss. of *Gylf* append *Vera-týr* to the end of the list, likely taken from st. 3 above.

- 48 **Saðr** ok **Svipall** · ok **Sann·getall**,
2 **Hçr·teitr** ok **Hnikarr**,
 Bil·eygr, **Bál·eygr**, · **Bçl·verkr**, **Fjçlnir**,
4 **Grímr** ok **Grímnir**, · **Glap·sviðr** ok **Fjçl·sviðr**.

[R 10v/19, A 5v/5,
S 6r/6, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

Sooth and Swiple and Soothgettle,
Hartote and Nicker,
Bileye, Baleeye, Baleworker, Fillner,
Grim and Grimner, Glapswith and Fellswith.

1 ok | om. G 1 ok | om. G 2 ok | om. G 4 Grímr ok | om. G 4 ok | om. G

- 49 **Síð·hçttr**, **Síð·skeggr**, · **Sig·fçðr**, **Hnikuðr**,
2 **Al·fçðr**, **Val·fçðr**, · **At·ríðr** ok **Farma·týr**;
 çinu nafni · hét=umk **aldri=gi**
4 **síðst ek með folkum fçr**.

[R 10v/21, A 5v/7,
S 6r/7, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

Sidehat, Sideshaw, Syefather, Nicked,
Allfather, Walfather, Atrider, and Farm-Tew—
by a single name I never called Myself
since among man-folk I fared.

1 Síð·hçttr | Síð·hófr T 1–2 Hnikuðr ... At·ríðr | At·ríðr, Hnikuðr, Al·fçðr U 2 Val·fçðr
'Walfather' | om. AG 2 At·ríðr | tettridr† T 2 ok | om. G 3–4 çinu ... fçr. 'by ... fared.' |
om. G 3 aldri=gi 'never' | om. A 4 með | om. A

- 50 **Grímnir** mik hétu · at **Gçir·raðar**,
2 **çn Jalk** at **Çs·mundar**;
 çn þa Kjalar · es ek **kjalka dró**,
4 **Þrórr þingum** at,
 Viður vígum at.

[R 10v/23, A 5v/9]

Grimner they called me at Garfrith's
 but Gelding at Osmund's,
 but Keller when I pulled the sled,
 Throo at Things,
 Wither in battles.

2 *Ôs-mundar* | *This name is spelled 'ôsmundar' in R, an archaic scribal feature suggesting that the poem was likely put to paper in the 12th century.* 3 *Kjalar* | *so RG; Jalk A.* 5 *Viður vígum* at 'Wither in battles' | *metr. emend. from Viður at vígum 'id.' A; om. R*

ALL | Apart from the first line, which of course refers to the present situation, the underlying stories are not known. They presumably refer to other now-lost myths involving Weden travelling in disguise. — The Weden-names in this stanza are found in *Gylf* 20:11 following those of st. 52. They appear in the order *Jalkr, Kjalarr, Viðurr, Þrór* 'Gelding, Keller, Wither, Throo' in all mss., indicating that ll. 4 and 5 were reversed in the version of the poem used by Snorre.

4 *Þrór þingum* at 'Throo at Things' | Perhaps a reference to a name under which Weden was invoked at the start of Things or legal assemblies.

5 *Viður vígum* at 'Wither in battles' | That this line is not an insertion by A is shown by the presence of *Viðurr* in the corresponding part of the name-list in *Gylf* 20:11.

51 *Ôski ok Ômi, · Jafn·høt ok Biflindi,*
 2 *Gøndlir ok Hár·barðr með goðum.*

[R 10v/24, A 5v/10]

Wisher and Omer, Evenhigh and Bivling,
 Gandler and Hoarbeard among Gods.

1 *Biflindi* | *Blindi S* 2 *Gøndlir* | *Gøldnir U*

ALL | The names in this st. appear in the list in *Gylf* 20:11 immediately following those of st. 49 in the order *Ôski, Ômi, Jafn·høt, Biflindi, Gøndlir, Hár·barðr*.

2 *Hár·barðr með goðum* 'Hoarbeard among Gods' | *Viz. in Hárþ, when conversing with the god Thunder.*

52 *Sviðurr ok Sviðrir · es ek hét at Sökk·mimis*
 2 *ok dulða'k þann hinn aldna jøtun*
þa's Mið-vitnis vas'k · hins mēra burar
 4 *orðinn çin-bani.*

[R 10v/25, A 5v/11]

Swither and Swithrer, as I was called at Sinkmimer's,
 and I deceived that olden ettin,
 when of Midwitner's famous son
 I became the lone slayer.

3 *Mið-vitnis* | *so A; Mið-viðnis R*

ALL | The two Weden-names in this st. appear in the list in *Gylf* 20:11 immediately following those of st. 51 in the order *Sviðurr, Sviðrir* with no critical variants.

- 53 Qlr est Geir-røðr, · hefr þú of-drukkít;
2 miklu est hnugginn, · es þú est mīnu gengi,
ollum ein-herjum · ok Óðins hylli.

[R 10v/28, A 5v/13]

Thou art worse for ale, Garfrith; thou hast drunk too much!
Much hast thou lost when thou hast [lost] My support,
all the Oneharriers, and Weden's holdness.

2 gengi 'support' | so R; gēði 'mind' A

ALL | Weden now turns to King Garfrith. He reproaches his former protégé and foresees his imminent death.

3 ollum ein-herjum 'all the Oneharriers' | It is important to note that Garfrith is not said to have lost the support (*gengi*) of the Oneharriers but rather the Oneharriers themselves, yet the sense is the same: by breaking the Odinic code of conduct befitting his station, Garfrith has lost Weden's favour and thus been excluded from the community of oath-bound warriors, his adopted sons, the Oneharriers. On the other hand, a righteous king could expect their truce, as was the case for Hathkin the Good according to *Hákm*, composed after his death. Thus *Hákm* 16/1-2 sees the god Bray greeting Hathkin in Walhall with the words: *ein-berja grið · skalt allra hafa; / þigg þú at þsum pl.* 'the truce of all the Oneharriers shalt thou have. Receive ale from the Eese!'

3 Óðins hylli 'Weden's holdness' | Weden's grace or favour; cf. st. 43/1 n.

- 54 Fjölð þér sagða'k, · en þú fátt of mant,
2 of þik véla vinir;
mēki liggja · sé'k mīns vinar
4 allan i dreýra drifinn.

[R 10v/30, A 5v/15]

Many things have I told thee, but thou recallest few;
'tis friends that deal with thee!
A sword I see lying, in My friend's
dreary blood all drenched.

2-3 vinir, mīns vinar 'friends, my friend' | Weden stresses his friendship with Garfrith by repeating the word *vinr* 'friend'. The followers of a god were his friends; see *Háv* 157 n.

3-4 mēki liggja · sé'k mīns vinar / allan i dreýra drifinn. 'A sword I see lying, in my friend's / dreary blood all drenched.' | A prophetic statement.

- 55 Egg-móðan val · nú mun Yggr hafa,
2 þitt vait'k líf of liðit;
varar 'ro dísir, · nú knátt Óðin séa;
4 nálga=sk mik ef þú megir!

[R 10v/31, A 5v/16]

An edge-wearied corpse will Ug now have;
I know thy life to be past.
Wary are the Dises; now dost thou see Weden.
Draw near Me, if thou mayst!

3 varar | †vvarro† A

1 Egg-móðan ‘edge-wearied’ | Euphemistic; “slain by a piercing blade.” Also found in *Hamð* 30/2a.

3 dísir ‘the Dises’ | The Norns, fates, who have determined Garfrith’s hour of death. Cf. *Fáfn* 11–13, *Am* 25/4, *Hamð* 30.

- 56 Óðinn nú heiti’k, · Yggr áðan hét’k,
 2 hét=umk Þundr fyr þat,
 Vagr ok Skilfingr, · Vöfuðr ok Hropta-týr
 4 Gautr ok Jalkr með goðum.

[R 11r/2, A 5v/18]

Weden am I now called; Ug was I called earlier;
 I called myself Thound before that;
 Wacker and Shilving, Waved and Roft-Tew,
 Geat and Gelding among the Gods.

3 Vöfuðr | so RAS; Ná-föðr (‘nafodr’) T; Vá-föðr W; om. U

ALL | The names in this st. (other than Óðinn ‘Weden’) appear in the name-list in *Gylf* 20:11 immediately following those of st. 50. They have the archetypal order *Yggr*, *Þundr*, *Vagr*, *Skilfingr*, *Vöfuðr*, *Hropta-týr*, *Gautr*, *Jalkr*, although only the ms. T keeps all names; S and W omit. *Jalkr* while U omits the first 6 names (*Yggr–Hropta-týr* ‘Ug ... Roft-Tew’) and therefore only has *Gautr*, *Jalkr* ‘Geat, Gelding’.

1 Óðinn nú heiti’k ‘Weden I am now called’ | Having dropped all disguises, the guest is no longer Grimmer but Weden himself; note that his earlier list of names did not contain this name.

- 57 Ófnir ok Sváfnir · es hygg’k at orðnir sé
 2 allir af einum mér.“

[R 11r/4, A 5v/20]

Ovner and Swebner, whom, I ween, have come
 all from Me alone.”

1 es | om. A 2 af | at A

ALL | No trace of this stanza is found in the list of names in *Gylf* 20:11 which suggests that it may be a later addition common to R and A. It is also possible that these names were left out since Snorre considered them to be serpent-names on the basis of st. 35 above, which is quoted in *Gylf* 16:9.

1 Ófnir ok Sváfnir ‘Ovner and Swebner’ | Both names are listed among poetic names of Weden in *Pul Óðins* (in SkP 3). They are also the names of two serpents in 35/3 above.

- P3 Geir-røðr konungr sat, ok hafði sverð um kné sér ok brugðit til
 2 miðs. En er hann heyrði, at Óðinn var þar kominn, stóð hann
 upp, ok vildi taka Óðin frá eldi’num. Sverð’it slapp ór hendi
 4 hónum, vissu hjólt’in niðr. Konungr drap fótí, ok steypiti=sk á-

[R 11r/5, A 5v/21]

6 fram, en sverð'it stóð í gognum hann, ok fekk hann bana. Óðinn
hvarf þá. En Agnarr var þar konungr lengi síðan.

King Garfrith sat and had a sword about his knee, and it was brandished half-way up. And when he heard that Weden had come there, he stood up and would take Weden from the fire. The sword slipped out of his hand; the hilt pointed downwards. The king lost his footing and fell forward, but the sword went through him and he received his bane. Weden then disappeared, but Ayner was king there for a long while afterwards.

2 kominn, | add. þá A 4 hönnum, | add. ok A 5 hann | þar af A 5-6 Óðinn hvarf þá. | om.
A 6 var þar | varð A 6 lengi síðan. | om. A

Appendix

Origin of the Nation of the Longbeards (*Origo Gentis Langbardorum*)

The following excerpt is the first chapter of the 7th century text dealing with the legendary prehistory of the Longbeards. It is edited here due to its close resemblance to P2 of the prologue above and since certain name-forms require discussion in a way that would not be entirely in place in a footnote.

2 ¹Est insula qui dicitur Scadanán, quod interpretatur excidia, in
partibus aquilonis, ubi multae gentes habitant; inter quos erat
4 gens parva quae Winnilis vocabatur. ²Et erat cum eis mulier
nomine Gambara, habebatque duos filios, nomen uni Ybor et
nomen alteri agio; ipsi cum matre sua nomine Gambara princi-
6 patum tenebant super Winniles. ³Moverunt se ergo duces Wan-
dalarum, id est Ambri et Assi, cum exercitu suo, ⁴et dicebant ad
8 Winniles: “Aut solvite nobis tributa, aut praeparate vos ad pug-
nam et pugnate nobiscum”. ⁵Tunc responderunt Ybor et Agio
10 cum matre sua Gambara: “Melius est nobis pugnam praeparare,
quam wandalis tributa persolvere”. ⁶Tunc Ambri et Assi, hoc
12 est duces Wandalorum, rogaverunt Godán, ut daret eis super
Winniles victoriam. ⁷Respondit Godán dicens: “Quos sol sur-
14 gente antea videro, ipsis dabo victoriam”. ⁸Eo tempore Gambara
cum duobus filiis suis, id est Ybor et Agio, rogaverunt Freám,
16 uxorem Godám, ut ad Winniles esset propitia. ⁹Tunc Freá dedit
consilium, ut sol surgente venirent Winniles et mulieres eorum
18 crines solutae circa faciem in similitudinem barbae et cum viris
suis venirent. ¹⁰Tunc luciscente sol dum surgeret, giravit Freá,
20 uxor Godán, lectum ubi recumbebat vir eius, et fecit faciem eius

22 contra orientem, et excitavit eum. ¹¹Et ille aspiciens vidit Win-
 24 niles et mulieres ipsorum habentes crines solutas circa faciem;
 et ait: "Qui sunt isti longibarbae?" ¹²Et dixit Frea ad Godan:
 26 "Sicut dedisti nomen, da illis et victoriam". ¹³Et dedit eis vic-
 toriam, ut ubi visum esset vindicarent se et victoriam haberent.
¹⁴Ab illo tempore Winnilis Langobardi vocati sunt.

¹There is an island which is called Shedeney, which is interpreted as 'destruction', in the parts of the north, where many nations dwell; among whom was a small nation which was called *Winnilis*. ²And there was with them a woman by name *Gambara*, and she had two sons, the name of one was *Ybor* and the name of the other *Agio*; they with their mother by name *Gambara* held leadership over the *Winnilis*. ³Then the princes of the *Wandali*, that is *Ambri* and *Assi*, moved with their host, ⁴and said to the *Winnilis*: "Either pay tributes to us, or prepare yourselves for battle and fight with us." ⁵Then *Ybor* and *Agio* with their mother *Gambara* answered: "It is better for us to prepare for battle than to pay tributes to the *Wandali*." ⁶Then *Ambri* and *Assi*, that is the princes of the *Wandali*, asked *Weden* that he might give to them victory over the *Winnilis*. ⁷*Weden* answered, saying: "Those whom I shall see first at the rising sun, to them I will give the victory." ⁸At that time *Gambara* with her two sons, that is *Ybor* and *Agio*, asked *Frie*, the wife of *Weden*, that she might be favorable toward the *Winnilis*. ⁹Then *Frie* gave counsel, that at the rising sun the *Winnilis* should come and their women with hair let down around the face in the likeness of a beard, and they should come with their men. ¹⁰Then as it grew light while the sun was rising, *Frie*, wife of *Weden*, turned the bed where her husband was reclining, and made his face turn toward the east, and awakened him. ¹¹And he, looking out, saw the *Winnilis* and their women having hair let down around the face; and he said: "Who are these long-beards?" ¹²And *Frie* said to *Weden*: "As thou hast given the name, give them also the victory." ¹³And he gave them victory, so that wherever it seemed [fit] they might avenge themselves and have victory. ¹⁴From that time the *Winnilis* are called *Langobardi*.

1 Scadanān, quod interpretatur excidia 'Shedeney, which is interpreted as "destruction"' | *Scadanān* 'Shedeney' is the same word as Scandinavia or Scania, *Scanza* in Jordanes. The word derives from PGmc **Skadin-awjō* 'Shede's island', where *Shede* is probably the goddess (ON *Skaði*) known from Norse sources. — The gloss reveals that the author was not unfamiliar with Germanic idiom; cf. OHG *skado* 'damage'.

12 Godan 'Weden' | A form derived from earlier *Wōdan* (attested on the runic Nordendorf fibula) through the sound change *w- > g-*.

15 Fream 'Frie' | *Weden's* wife, *Frie*. Acc. sg. of *Frea*, cognate with OHG *Frija* (*Mers II* 4), ON *Frigg*, both from PGmc. **Frijō*. *Frie* is not to be confused with the different goddess *Frow* (ON *Frøyja*, whose name, though superficially similar to *Frea*, in fact comes from PGmc. **frawijō* 'lady', corresponding to OHG *frouwa*).

24 Sicut dedisti nomen, da illis et victoriam 'As thou hast given the name, give them also the victory' | Likely an early attestation of the custom of the name-gift (ON *gefa at nafni-festr* 'give for

the fastening of a name') found in numerous later Norse Saws. Cf. *Skm* 53: *Þá svarar konungr: „Þú, sveinn, hefir gefit mér nafn, at ek skal heita Hrólfr kraki, en þat er títt, at gjöf skal fylgja nafn-festi. [...]"* "Then answers the king: "Thou, swain, hast given me a name, that I shall be called Rotholf the pole; yet it is customary that a gift should follow the fastening of a name. [...]"

Dreams of Balder

(Baldrs draumar)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.890)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Dreams of Balder** (abbrev. *Bdr*) is a short Eddic poem that sees We-
den ride down to Hell, the Underworld, to ask a dead wallow about Balder's
future.

Textual preservation and transmission

Bdr is preserved only in **A** on foll. 1v/17–2r/11. A younger redaction charac-
terised by a number of post-mediaeval inserts is transmitted in several copies
in later paper mss. Metrical characteristics make it clear that these inserts are
very late (Ragnar Ingi Aðalsteinsson 2009), and they are therefore excluded
from this edition without further comment.

Meter and stanza

Bdr is a short poem consisting of 57 long-lines across 14 stanzas. The meter is
Ancient-words-law. The typical length of the stanza is 4 (13/14: 1–10, 12–14),
and this is upheld consistently. A single stanza, 11, has 5 lines.

Origin and motifs

The main source for the death and subsequent avenging of the god Balder is
Gylf 49–50 (for a summary of which see *Vsp* 31 n.). Compared to that narra-
tive, *Bdr* corresponds only to the very beginning, namely Balder's ominous
dreams, and does not go into great depth about its subject; at just 14 sts. the
poem is the shortest surviving mythological Eddic poem. In isolation, the
purpose of *Bdr* seems somewhat unclear, and it must originally have been

part of a longer cycle of lost poetry dealing with Balder's death. That such a cycle likely existed is supported by the fragmentary stanza *Eddabr* V.

Dating

Bdr has a particularly high rate of the archaic particle *of*, with a frequency of 0.463 occurrences per 10 lines (Sapp 2022, p. 77), although it must be noted that *Bdr* is so short that this number may not be as reliable as for longer poems. St. 3/4a may require a hiatus form, suggesting a date of composition before ca. 1150 CE, but is an uncertain attestation (see note). The alliteration of *vr-* with *v-* in 11/1 suggests a date before ca. 1000 CE (Haukur Þorgeirsson 2016), but unfortunately that line is partly emended, and the presence of *vr-* in **Vrindr* (> *Rindr*) cannot be considered fully certain due to a lack of parallels. To conclude, *Bdr* is likely an old poem, but it is too short to contain clear diagnostics.

Summary

The poem begins *in medias res*: Balder has been having nightmares, which the Gods meet at their Thing to discuss (1). Weden rides down to Hell where he has an encounter with a bloody hound; he passes it and continues to “the high house of Hell” (2–3) from which he rides west to the grave of a certain wallow whom he revives using magic (4).

The wallow asks who it is that has forced her out of the grave (5) and Weden introduces himself as Waytame, before asking for whom the benches of Hell are covered with gold (6). The wallow responds that barrels of mead stand brewed for Balder and that the Gods must be very anxious (7). Weden asks her who will slay Balder (8), and she responds that it is Hath, carrying a “tall, famous wood” (9). The god next asks who will avenge Balder's death (10), and the wallow responds that Wrind will give birth to Weden's son Wonne, who will slay Hath when only one night old (11). Weden then asks about some mysterious maidens (12), which apparently betrays his identity. The wallow announces that she now knows that her accoster is Weden, not Waytame; the god in turn retorts that she is not a wallow but rather the “mother of three thurses” (13). The wallow tells him to ride home and “be renowned”, taunting him over his unavoidable death at the Rakes of the Reins (14).

Text

The Dreams of Balder

- 1 Senn vöru **ęsir** · **allir** á þingi
 2 ok **ęsynjur** · **allar** á máli,
 ok umb þat **réðu** · **ríkir** tívar:
 4 hví véri **Baldri** · **ballir** draumar?

[A 1v/18]

SOON WERE THE EESE all at the Thing,
 and the Ossens all at speech,
 and of this counseled the mighty Tews:
 Why did Balder have troubling dreams?

4 Baldri | *corr. from baldrs above line in same band A*

1–3 Senn ... tívar ‘Soon ... Tews’ | Identically shared with *Þrk* 14/1–3. —

The ‘Thing’ is the Thing of the Gods (cf. *Vsp* 6/1–2 n., *Hym* 39/1), but the detail that the male Gods (*ęsir* ‘Eese’) are á þingi ‘at, upon the Thing’, while the Goddesses (*ęsynjur* ‘Ossens’) are on the sidelines chatting requires elaboration. Being á þingi is probably to be understood as being seated within the ritual enclosure at the legal assembly. This reflects historical Norse Thing-proceedings where the judgments were decided by a select group of twelve men (sometimes several groups of twelve, a number still surviving in the twelve-man jury of English common law) seated inside a circular holy enclosure (the *vé-bönd* ‘wigh-bonds’, i.e., ‘holy cords’) into which all others were forbidden to enter. So *Eg* 56 in a description of the Gole-Thing in Norway: *En þar er dömr’inn var settir, var völlr slétt ok settar niðr besli-stengr í völl’inn í bring, en löð um útan snóri um-hverfis. Vöru þat kölluð vé-bönd. En fyrir innan í bringi’num sötu dómendr [...]; þær þrennar tylftir manna skyldu þar döma um mál manna.* ‘But where the court was established there was a smooth plain and hazelwood-poles were set down into the plain in a ring, and cords tied around them on the outside; those were called the ‘wigh-bonds’. But inside within the ring sat the judges [...]; those three groups of twelve men each would there judge the cases of men.’ The Norwegian New Law of the Land, I. 3 (NGL II, p. 14) specifies the proceedings of the Gole-Thing and notes that: *Svá er ok mælt at engi maðr þeirra er eigi er nefndr skal fyrir innan vé-bönd setjask útan or-lofs.* ‘So it is also said that no man among them who was not named shall be seated inside the wigh-bonds without permission.’

- 2 Upp reiš **Óðinn**, · **aldinn** Gautr,
 2 ok hann á **Slęipni** · **söðul** of lagði,
 reĩð **niðr** þaðan · **nifl**-hęljar til;
 4 mótti **hvelpi**, · þeim’s ór **hęlju** kom.

[A 1v/19]

Up rose Weden, the olden Geat,
 and he on Slopner the saddle did lay,
 rode down thence to Nivelhell,
 met the whelp that came out of Hell.

1 *aldinn* | *emend. (cf. 13/2 below); alda A*

2 ok hann á Slęipni · söðul of lagði ‘and he on Slopner the saddle did lay’ | Possibly formulaic; cf. *Oddr* 2/4.

4 hvelpi, · þeim's ór hēlju kom 'the whelp that came out of Hell' | An otherwise unknown dog, sometimes identified with Garm. The motif of the Hellhound guarding the underworld is well known throughout world mythology, most famously in the form of the Greek Κέρβερος (*Theog* 300–312).

- 3 Sá vas blóðugr · umb brjóst framan, [A 1v/21]
 2 ok galdrs fǫður · gól of lengi,
 framm reĩð Óðinn, · fold-vegr dunði,
 4 hann kom at hǫu · Hēljar ranni.

It was bloody at the front of its chest
 and at the father of galder [= Weden] for a long time bayed.
 Forth rode Weden—the fold-way [EARTH] resounded—
 he came to the high house of Hell.

2 gól of | 'golv' (*corruption of *gol ū*) A

2 galdrs fǫður 'the father of galder [= Weden]' | An unparalleled expression for Weden, the master of magical spells and chants (galders). Cf. *Háv* 140, 147–165.

3 framm reĩð Óðinn, · fold-vegr dunði 'Forth rode Weden—the fold-way [EARTH] resounded' | The movement of gods often causes cosmic disturbance; cf. the description of Thunder's riding in *Haustl* 14: *Ok at isarn-leiki · Jarðar sunr ok dunði ... mána vegr und þęnum* 'The Son of Earth drove to the iron-play [BATTLE] ... and the moon's way [SKY/HEAVEN] resounded beneath him'. See further *Þrk* 21.

4 hann kom at hǫu | The hiatus form in *hǫu* 'high' (**hǫfu*) A is not diagnostic for the dating since it may be due to analogy with other forms in *hǫv-* in the adjective, that is, it may be an old uncontracted *hǫu* (which would be contracted to *hǫ* post-1150), but it may also be a young analogical *hǫvu*. Regardless of the presence of the analogical glide in *hǫ(v)u*, the line may be read either as a type A1 (with stress on *hann*) or a type A3.

- 4 Þa reĩð Óðinn · fyr austan dyrr, [A 1v/22]
 2 þar's hann vissi · vǫlu leiði;
 nam hann vittugri · val-galdr kveða,
 4 und's nauðug reĩs, · nás orð of kvað:

Then Weden rode east from its doors,
 whither he knew the wallow's grave.
 He took to sing a slain-galder for the cunning woman
 until forced she rose; a corpse's words quoeth she:

3 val-galdr 'slain-galder' | A galder to quicken the dead, in this case the wallow. Cf. *Háv* 158 where Weden tells how He can bring hanged men back to life with a galder.

- 5 „Hvat 's manna þat · mér ó-kunnra, [A 1v/24]
 2 es mér hefr aukit · ęrfitt sinni?
 Vas'k snifin snjóvi, · ok slęgin regni,

4 ok drifin döggu, · dauð vas'k lengi.“

“What sort of man is this, unknown to me,
who has caused for me this toilsome journey?
I was snowed by snow and struck by rain
and bespattered by dew—dead was I for long.”

2 ęřfitt sinni ‘this toilsome journey’ | The “journey” out of the grave.

3–4 Vas'k snifin ... lengi. ‘I was snowed ... long.’ | Cf. the similar description of a buried person in 2 *HHund* 44–45.

[Óðinn kvað:] 6 „Veg·tamr ek heiti, · sonr em'k Val·tams,

[A 1v/25]

2 sęg męr őr heļu, · ek man őr heimi;
hveim eru bekkir · baugum sánir,

4 flęt fagr=liga · flóuð golli?“

[Quoth Weden:] “Waytame I am called; I am Waltame's son;
tell me [the tidings] from Hell—I will [tell those] from the Home.
For whom are the benches sown with bighs,
the floors fairly flooded with gold?”

1 Veg·tamr ek heiti, · sonr em'k Val·tams ‘Waytame I am called, I am Waltame's son’ | Neither name is attested elsewhere, but both are Odinic in character, the first alluding to Weden's role as protector of wayfarers (*Háv.*, *Grm*), the second to his role as gatherer of dead warriors (*Vǫp* 23/1, *Vafþ* 40–41, *Grm* 8–10, *Hárð* 24).

[Vǫlva kvað:] 7 „Hér stęndr Baldri · of brugginn mjǫðr,

[A 1v/27]

2 skírar vęigar, · liggr skjǫldr yfir,
ęn ős-męgir · i of-vęni;

4 nauðug sagða'k, · nú mun'k þęgja.“

[Quoth the willow:] “Here for Balder mead stands brewed,
pure draughts—a shield lies over them—
but the os-lads [= Eese] stand in great suspense—
forced I spoke, now I will shut up!”

[Óðinn kvað:] 8 „Þęgj=at-tu vǫlva, · þik vil'k fregna,

[A 1v/29]

2 und's al-kunna, · vil'k ęnn vita:
hvęrr man Baldri · at bana verða,

4 ok Óðins son · aldri ręna?“

[Quoth Weden:] “Shut not up, willow—thee I wish to ask!
Until all is known I wish yet to know:
Who will become Balder's bane
and rob Weden's son of life?”

- [Völva kvað:] 9 „Hǫðr berr hǫvan · hróðr-baðm þinig, [A 2r/1]
 2 hann man Baldri · at bana verða,
 ok Óðins son · aldri rēna;
 4 nauðug sagða’k, · nú mun’k þegja.“

[Quoth the wallow:] “Hath bears the high, famous wood [MISTLETOE] thither;
 he will become Balder’s bane
 and rob Woden’s son of life—
 forced I spoke, now I will shut up!”

1 hróðr-baðm | *emend.*; hróðr-barm A

- [Óðinn kvað:] 10 „Þegj=at-tu vǫlva, · þik vil’k fregna, [A 2r/3]
 2 und’s al-kunna, · vil’k ǣnn vita,
 hveṛr man heipt Heði · heft of vinna,
 4 eða Baldrs bana · á bál vega?“

[Quoth Woden:] “Shut not up, wallow—thee I wish to ask!
 Until all is known I wish yet to know:
 Who will avenge that evil on Hath,
 or drag onto the pyre Balder’s bane?”

- [Völva kvað:] 11 „Vrindr berr Vála · ï vestr-sǫlum, [A 2r/4]
 2 sá man Óðins sonr · ǣin-néttr vega;
 hǫnd of þvēr-at · né hǫfuð kǣmbir,
 4 áðr á bál of berr · Baldrs and-skota;
 nauðug sagða’k, · nú mun’k þegja.“

[Quoth the wallow:] “Wrind bears Wönnel in the western halls:
 he will, Woden’s son, one night old, fight.
 He washes not his hand nor combs his head
 before onto the pyre he bears Balder’s shooter—
 forced I spoke, now I will shut up.”

1 Vrindr ‘Wrind’ | *metr. emend.*; Rindr A 1 Vála ‘Wönnel’ | *required by meter and sense; om. A*
 3 at | *required by meter and sense; om. A*

1 Vrindr ‘Wrind’ | As the first nominal in the verse, ms. *Rindr* is expected to carry alliteration with *vestr-sǫlum*. This is obtained by restoring an archaic initial *vr-* cluster, for which cf. *Háv* 26/2 n. Unlike other instances of this cluster, **Vrindr* is etymologically obscure. A likely theory connects the name with Gutnish *rind* m. ‘ivy, common clubmoss’, in which case Wrind may be a minor plant goddess (Lundberg 1913). If so, there is prob. an obscure ritual significance to the notion that it is the son of the Ivy who is born to avenge the harm done by the mistletoe. Lundberg argues that worship of Wrind is indicated by the OSwe. place name *Vrinda-vi* (modern-day Vrinnéid, supposedly gen. sg. of **Vrindr* + *vi* ‘wigh, shrine’), although Sahlgren (1924, pp. 66, 78–80) considers this etymology false and instead explains the name as containing the second element OSwe. *viði* ‘wood, forest’.

1 *Vála* ‘Wonne!’ | The name must be restored. Without it the verse is only two syllables long, which is absolutely forbidden in Norse Ancient-words-law meter, and the verb *berr* ‘bears, gives birth to’ is left without an object.

2–4 *sá ... and-skota* ‘he will ... shooter’ | These lines are, apart from the tense of the verbs, almost identical to *Vǫp* 32/4–33/2. The direction of influence is unclear, and it is not impossible that both are borrowing from a now-lost third poem.

[Óðinn kvað:] 12 „Þegj=at-tu vǫlva, · þik vil’k fregna,
2 und’s al-kunna, · vil’k enn vita,
hverjar ’ro meýjar, · es at muni gráta
4 ok á himin verpa · halsa-skautum?“ [A 2r/6]

[Quoth Weden:] “Shut not up, wallow—thee I wish to ask!
Until all is known I wish yet to know:
Which are the maidens that heartily weep,
and onto heaven throw the front-sheets?”

ALL | The question in this stanza is quite obscure. If it is connected to the myth of Balder’s death in any way, it ought to be the episode where the all things in the world wept for Balder. According to *Gylf* 49:70–82 (see *Eddabr* V below), Heli promised to give Balder back to the Esei if all things in the world would weep for him. The Esei relayed this message, and all things wept for Balder, save Lock in disguise. It may thus be that these maidens were among the weepers (perhaps they were the Walkirries, and this is what reveals Weden’s identity?), but in any case their identity is otherwise unknown. They may tentatively be identified with the equally mysterious daughters of Maythrasher in *Vafþ* 49, who are also young women (*meýjar*) who appear to have something to do with the End Times.

4 á himin verpa · halsa-skautum ‘onto heaven throw the front-sheets’ | Unexplained. Perhaps an astrological allusion.

[Vǫlva kvað:] 13 „Est=at Veg-tamr, · sëm ek hugða,
2 hēldr est Óðinn, · aldinn Gautr!“
[Óðinn kvað:] „Est=at vǫlva · né vís kona,
4 hēldr est þriggja · þursa móðir!“ [A 2r/8]

[Quoth the wallow:] “Thou art not Waytame as I thought,
rather art thou Weden, the olden Geat!”—

[Quoth Weden:] “Thou art no wallow nor wise woman,
rather art thou three Thurses’ mother!”

2 aldinn | *corr. from alda above line in same hand A*

[Vǫlva kvað:] 14 „Hēim rið Óðinn · ok ves hróðigr,
2 svá komi=t manna · mēirr aprt á vit,
es lauss Loki · liðr ór þöndum
4 ok ragna røk · rjúfendr koma.“ [A 2r/9]

[Quoth the wallow:] “Ride home, Weden, and be renowned!
So may no man come again to visit

when, loose, Lock slips out of his bonds,
and at the Rakes of the Reins the rippers come.”

1 ok ves hróðigr ‘and be renowned’ | A sarcastic taunt, the sense being: “Your fame, Weden, will not save you!”

4 rjúfendr ‘rippers’ | Presumably Surt and Lock with his children, as described in *Vsp* 39–40, 48–50. The verb *rjúfa* ‘to break, rip up, break a hole in’ (CV) is used in the same context in the formulaic (*of*) *rjúfa-sk rēgin* ‘the Reins are ripped’ (*Vafþ* 52/4, *Grm* 4/4, *Lok* 41/2, *Sigrdr* 17/7).

Speeches of Shirner

(*Skírnis mól*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.897)

Meter: Leeds-meter; minority: Galders-law, Speeches-meter

Introduction

The **Speeches of Shirner** (*Skí*) is a mythological dialogue-poem dealing with Free's servant Shirner who is sent to get the hand of the beautiful ettin's daughter Gird for his master by any means necessary.

Textual preservation and transmission

Skí is attested in full in both **R** and **A**. The name *Skírnis-mól* 'Speeches of Shirner' comes from **A**; **R** instead has *För Skírnis* 'Shirner's journey'.

Meter and formal concerns

Skí consists of 178 lines (86 long-lines, 92 full-lines) across 42 stanzas. The meter of the poem is Leeds-meter, with a few lines in Speeches-meter and some irregular full-lines.

The poetry exclusively represents speech and all narrative development is conveyed in the embedded prose.

The normal Leeds-meter configuration *abc abc* is also the most common (1–9, 11, 13–14, 16–23, 25–26, 33, 36–42); likely defective variants of it are *ab abc* (12) and *abc* (15).

Configurations with consecutive *c*-verses/full-lines (what may be called Galders-law) are also found, chiefly in Shirner's curse (sts. 26–36). These are *abcc* (32), *abcc abc* (10), *abc abcc* (29), *abc abcc abc* (30), and *abc abc abcc* (35).

In addition there are the unusual configurations *abcx abc* (27, 28) and *abcxx abc* (31), where *x* stands for a verse that, although it takes the place of a normal full-line or *c*-verse, does not behave exactly as a normal type *c*-verse, e.g. by ending in a trochée or by connecting with a previous *c*-verse by alliteration rather than standing on its own.

Two sts. mix Speeches-meter and Leeds-meter according to the configurations *abc [ab ab]* (24) and *[ab ab] abc* (34), where Speeches-meter is bracketed.

Origin and motifs

Parallels

The whole of *Skí* is paraphrased in *Gylf* 37, for comparative purposes edited in full in the Appendix to this poem. *Gylf* 37:15 cites a variant form of *Skí* 42, the final stanza. It is also of note that the prose of *Skí* P1 and *Gylf* 37:1–6 share striking similarities in certain expressions like Shirner being a *skó-svæinn* ‘shoe-swain’ or Free one day having sat down in Lithshelf and looked about all the homes.

It seems near-certain that Snorre, the author of *Gylf*, had access to *Skí* directly rather than a prose retelling of the story accompanied by a solitary stanza. The most important reason for this assumption is that there is no detail in Snorre’s paraphrase that is not found in the version of the poem in RA, although there are many things found in RA not found in *Gylf*, most notably Shirner’s curse. Snorre’s prose however has many more details.

These circumstances are perhaps best explained if the version of *Skí* underlying *Gylf* 37 was available to Snorre based on oral tradition rather than a manuscript. This would explain the small variation in the final stanza and the greater variation in the introductory prose; whereas poetry is a bound form and less liable to drastic change, a prose narrative can vary greatly with each retelling. On the other hand it is also possible that Snorre chose to expand a preexisting written prose passage by adding his own details, something likely done to the prose of *Lok* P8 (see there) and then supplied the stanza with its minor variants based on his own memory. To sum up a narrative mythic poem in prose form and then quote one or two stanzas from it is something likely done elsewhere in *Gylf*; see *Eddbr* below.

Interpretations

TODO.

Fertility? Free gives away his sword for sex (st. 8).

Text

The Speeches of Shirner

- P1 Freyr, sonr Njarðar, hafði einn dag set-sk í Hlið-skjölf ok sá um [R 11r/10, A 2r/11]
 2 heima alla; hann sá í Jötun-heima ok sá þar mey fagra, þá er hón
 gekk frá skála föður síns til skemmu; þar af fekk hann hug-sóttir
 4 miklar. Skírnir hét skó-sveinn Freys. Njörðr bað hann kveðja
 Frey máls. Þá mælti Skaði:

FREE, son of Nearth, had one day sat down in the Lithshelf, and looked throughout all the Homes. He looked into the Ettinhomes and saw there a fair maiden as she walked from her father's hall to her bower; thereof he got great heart-aches. Shirner was the name of Free's shoe-swain; Nearth asked him to get Free to speak. Then Shede spoke:

1 Hlið-skjölf 'the Lithshelf' | The high lookout-post of the Gods; see note to this word in *Grm* P2.

4 skó-sveinn 'shoe-swain' | A young boy who ties the shoes for his master.

- 1 „Rís-tu nú Skírnir · ok gakk at beiða [R 11r/14, A 2r/15]
 2 okkarn mála mög,
 ok þess at fregna · hveim inn fróði séi
 4 of-reiði afi.“

“RISE NOW, SHIRNER, and go to ask
 our lad for speech,
 and to find out at whom the wise
 man might be cross.”

1 Rís-tu ... beiða 'Rise ... beg' | Alliteration is missing here. A simple solution would be to replace *gakk* 'go' with a synonym like *rinn* 'run' or *ráð* 'resolve', but this lessens the semantic mirroring with l. 2/2 below (though the verb *ganga* in the present stanza may in fact be due to influence from 2/2).

4 afi 'man' | While this word usually means 'father' or 'grandfather', it should here mean 'man' without a connotation of old age. See further CV.

- Skírnir kvað: 2 „Illra orða · es mér òn at ykkrum syni, [R 11r/15, A 2r/17]
 2 ef ek geng at mæla við mög,
 ok þess at fregna, · hveim inn fróði séi
 4 of-reiði afi.“

Quoth Shirner: “Ill words I expect from your son
 if I go to speak with the lad,

and to find out at whom the wise
man might be cross.”

Skirnir: 3 „Sæg þat Freyr, · folk-valdi goða,
2 ok ek vilja vita,
hví þú ęinn sitr · ęnd-langa sali,
4 minn dróttinn, of daga?“ [R 11r/17, A 2r/18]

Shirner: “Tell this, O Free, troop-wielder of the gods—
I too would wish to know
why thou sittest alone in the endlong halls,
my lord, during the days.”

Freyr: 4 „Hví of seġja’k þér, · seġgr inn ungi,
2 mikinn móð-trega?
því’t alf-röðull · lýsir of alla daga
4 ok þęy=gi at minum munum.“ [R 11r/19, A 2r/20]

Free: “Why should I tell thee, O young youth,
of my great heartache?
For the Elf-wheel [SUN] shines during all days
and nowise to my liking.”

3 alf-röðull ‘Elf-wheel’ | A rare poetic synonym (*þęiti*) for the sun; see note to *Vafþ* 47/1.

Skirnir: 5 „Muni þína · hykk=a svá mikla vesa,
2 at þú mér seġgr né seġir;
ungir saman · vörum i ár-daga,
4 vęl męttim tveir trúa=sk.“ [R 11r/20, A 2r/21]

Shirner: “Thy liking I do not think so great
that thou, O youth, shouldst not tell me.
Young together were we in days of yore;
we two might well trust each other.”

2 seġgr ‘youth’ | This word, which usually means simply ‘man’, here seems to have a specific connotation with daring youth. The sense of ‘young man’ is also seen in *Vkv* 23 where it is used in reference to king Nithad’s two young sons. In the present context it answers Free’s addressing Shirner as *seġgr inn ungi* ‘the young youth’; Shirner seems to point out that the two are of equal age, and so Free is as much of a young man as he.

Freyr: 6 „I Gymis gorðum · ek ganga sá
2 mér tíða mey;
armar lýstu, · ęn af þaðan [R 11r/22, A 2r/23]

4 allt lopt ok loḡr.

Free: “In Gymer’s yards I saw walking
a maiden desirable to me.
Her arms shone, but thereof too
all the air and sea.

4 lopt ok loḡr ‘air and sea’ | Formulaic word-pair and very old, also paralleled in OE. TODO.

7 Mēr ’s mēr tíðari · an manna hveim
2 ungum i ár-daga;
ása ok alfa · þat vill ęngi maðr,
4 at vit sǫtt séim.“

[R 11r/24, A 2r/24]

The maiden is more desirable to me than [a maiden] to any man
young in days of yore.
Of the Eese and Elves does no one wish
that we two should be agreed.”

1–2 Mēr ... ár-daga ‘The maiden ... of yore.’ | Free compares his own love to the great loves of earlier ages; his, he says, is far greater than theirs.

3 ęngi maðr ‘no one’ | Lit., ‘no man’, where ‘man’ means ‘person, individual’ and does not imply that the Gods are literally human beings. Cf. note to *Vafþ* 55.

Skirnir: 8 „Mar gef mér þá, · es mik of myrkvan beri
2 vísan vafr-loga,
ok þat sverð, · es sjalft vegi=sk
4 við ȝotna ęt.“

[R 11r/25, A 2r/25]

Shirner: “Then give me the steed which might bear me o’er the dark,
inevitable wavering flame,
and that sword which by itself might strike
against the race of Ettins.”

3 þat sverð ‘that sword’ | This sword appears to have filled greater function in an earlier version of the poem, since according to *Gylf* 37:16 Shirner gave it away, perhaps as a dowry to Gird, and Free did not get it back (cf. *Vsp* 51/3 and the insult in *Lok* 42). It is notable that Free, a god especially associated with the erect phallus, trades away his actual sword (a symbol of martial power) for sex.

Freyr: 9 „Mar þér þann gef’k, · es þik of myrkvan berr
2 vísan vafr-loga,
auk þat sverð, · es sjalft mun vega=sk,
4 ef sá ’s horskr es hefr.“

[R 11r/27, A 2r/27]

Free: “I will give thee that steed which bears thee o’er the dark,
inevitable wavering flame,

and that sword which by itself will strike
if he be wise who holds it.”

1–4 berr ‘bears’; mun vega=sk, ef sá ‘s horskr es hęfr ‘will strike if he be wise who holds it’ | In his response Free replaces the subjunctive verb forms (*beri* ‘might bear’, *vegi=sk* ‘might strike’) with indicative and future forms, giving a sense of certainty and authority. The steed and sword are faultless, and if Shirner fails on the mission, it would be only due to his own fault (“if he be wise who holds it.”).

P2 Skírnir męlti við hest’inn:

Shirner spoke with the horse:

- 10 „Myrkt es úti, · mál kveð’k okkr fara
2 úrig fjöll yfir
þursa þjóð yfir;
4 báðir vit komum=k · eða okkr báða tękr
sá inn ám-át=ki jętunn.“

[R 11r/29, A 2r/28]

“It is dark outside; I call it time for us to journey
over the drizzling mountains,
over the land of the Thurses.
[Either] we both make it through or he’ll take us both,
that uncanny ettin.”

3 þursa ‘of the Thurses’ | so A; ‘þyria’ R

ALL | Shirner expresses his resolute loyalty to Free. He will not abandon the horse given to him by his lord; either they both make it or both perish.

5 ám-át=ki jętunn ‘uncanny ettin’ | Formulaic; the adjective *ám-átt=igr* ‘uncanny’ is used exclusively for evil supernatural beings. See note to *Vsp* 8.

- P3 Skírnir reið i Jętun-heima til Gymis garða; þar vęru hundar
2 ólmir ok bundnir fyrir skið-garðs-hliði þess, er um sal Gerðar
var. Hann reið at þar, er fę-hirðir sat á haugi, ok kvaddi hann:

[R 11r/31, A 2v/1]

Shirner rode into the Ettinhomes toward Gymer’s yards. Thereat there were fierce hounds bound in front of the gate of the pale fence which surrounded Gird’s hall. He rode up to where a shepherd sat on a mound and greeted him:

2 Gerðar ‘Gird’ | It is only now that we find out the maiden’s name.

- 11 „Seg þat hirðir, · es á haugi sitr
2 ok varðar alla vega:
hvę ek at and-spilli · kom=umk hins unga mans

[R 11r/2, A 2v/4]

4 fyr greyjum Gymis.“

“Tell this, O herdsman who sittest on the mound
and watchest all the ways,
how to discourse I might come with the young girl
past Gymer’s greyhounds.”

1 á haugi sitr ‘who sittest on the mound’ | For this motif cf. *Vsp* 41/1 n.

[Hirðir] kvað: 12 „Hvart est feigr, · eða est framm ginginn
2 [...];
 and-spillis vanr · þú skalt é vesa
4 góðrar meýjar Gymis.“

[R 11v/4, A 2v/5]

Quoth [the herdsman]: “Regardless of whether thou art fey or passed-on,
[...]
discourseless shalt thou for ever be
with Gymer’s good maiden!”

2 [...] | No gap is indicated in the mss. but it is certain that a c-line is missing here, probably containing a vocative ‘O stranger’, or similar.

4 góðrar meýjar ‘good maiden’ | Formulaic, carrying with it a sense of chastity. See note to *Háv* 102/1 for further occurrences.

[Skírnir] kvað: 13 „Kostir ’ro bętri · an klökkva séi
2 hveim es fúss es fara,
 ęinu dógri · mér vas aldr of skapaðr
4 ok alt líf of lagit.“

[R 11v/6, A 2v/7]

Quoth [Shirner]: “Choices are better than sobbing might
for whomever is eager to journey.
In one half-day my age was shaped,
and all my life laid down.”

1 an ‘than’ | so A; hęldr an at ‘rather than to [be]’ R

ALL | An excellent formulation of the Old Germanic fatalistic world-view. After uttering these words Shirner rides through the fire surrounding the fortress.

1 Kostir ‘Choices’ | I.e., ‘alternatives, other ways’.

3 ęinu dógri · mér vas aldr of skapaðr ‘In one half-day my age was shaped’ | Formulaic. The single half-day is both the time of one’s birth when the norms or dises arrive (cf. 1 *HHund* 1–4 and *Hákm* 19/1–2: *Góðu dógri · verðr sá gramr of borinn, / es sér getr s-likan sefa* ‘On a good half-day will that lord be born who gets for himself such heart’) and the fixed time of one’s inevitable death (*Gríp* 25/4). For the norms shaping one’s age (ON (*of*) *skapa aldr*) cf. 1 *HHund* 2/2 and *Gylf* 15:30: *Enn eru fleiri nornir, þęr er koma til bvers barns, er borit er, at skapa aldr* ‘There are yet more norms, those which come to every child which is born to shape its age’; for the use of the verb shape in this context cf. also *Reg* 2/3, 6/3, *Sigs* 7/3.

4 alt líf of lagit ‘all my life laid down’ | The causative *leggja* ‘to lay (down, in place)’ is closely connected to fate; the expression is formulaic. Cf. *Lok* 48: *í ár-daga vas þér bit ljóta líf of lagit* ‘in days of yore was thy ugly life laid down’ and *Vsp* 19: *þér lög lögðu* ‘they [= the Norns] laid down laws’.

[Gerd]r kvað: 14 „Hvat ’s þat hlym hlymja · es hlymja heyrir’k nú til
2 osum rönnum i?
jörð bifa=sk, · en allir fyr
4 skjalfa garðar Gymis.“

[R 11v/7, A 2v/8]

Quoth [Gird]: “What is this din of dins which I now hear dinning
in our houses?
The earth trembles, but before us all
Gymer’s yards do quake.”

Ambótt kvað: 15 „Maðr ’s hér úti, · stigin af mars baki,
2 jó léttr til jarðar taka.“

[R 11v/9, A 2v/10]

Quoth the maid-servant: “A man is here without, stepped down off horse-back;
he lets his steed graze the earth.”

2 jó léttr til jarðar taka ‘he lets his steed graze the earth’ | Lit. ‘he lets his steed take to the earth’.
According to Finnur Jónsson (1932) this expression is still used in modern Icelandic.

[Gerd]r kvað: 16 „Inn bið hann ganga · i okkarn sal
2 ok drekka inn méra mjöð,
þó ek hitt ó=umk, · at hér úti séi
4 minn bróður-bani.“

[R 11v/10, A 2v/11]

Quoth [Gird]: “Bid him go into our hall
and drink the renowned mead;
though I fear that here outside might be
my brother’s bane.”

[Gerd]r kvað: 17 „Hvat ’s þat alfa · né ása sona,
2 né víssa vana;
hví einn of komt · eikinn fúr yfir
4 ór sal-kynni at séa?“

[R 11v/12, A 2v/13]

[Quoth Gird]: “Which one of the Elves is this; not of sons of the Eese,
nor of the wise Wanese?
Why camest thou alone o’er the raging fire,
to see the state of our hall?”

ALL | Gird addresses Shirner and asks him about his origin. She can tell that he is not a god, and so asks him what he is, apparently thinking him an elf.

[Skírnir kvað:] 18 „Eṃ'k=at alfa · né ǻsa sona
2 né vísǻa vana,
þó ǻinn of kom'k · ǻikinn fúr yfir
4 yður sal-kynni at séa.

[R 11v/14]

[Quoth Shirner:] “I am not of Elves, nor of sons of the Eese,
nor of wise Wanes—
though I came alone o'er the raging fire,
to see the state of your hall.

19 Eṗli ǻllifu · hér hef'k al-gollin,
2 þau mun'k þér Gērðr gefa,
frið at kaupa, · at þú þér Fręy kveðir
4 ò·lēiðastan at lifa.“

[R 11v/15, A 2v/14]

Eleven apples have I here, all-golden;
them will I to thee, Gird, give
to buy thy love, that thou mightst call Free
the most unloathsome [beloved] in thy life.”

ALL | Shirner begins his coercion of Gird, which takes up sts. 19–36. Shirner first offers Gird gold (sts. 19–22), then threatens her with violence (23–25) and finally curses her with a long spell (26–36), which breaks her.

It has been noted by Brate (1913) that the structure of this passage bears some resemblance to Weden's seduction of Wrind in Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 3.4.1–8. In Weden's seduction of Wrind he disguises himself first as a warrior, then as a gold-smith, then again as a warrior but is spurned each time. Finally he makes himself out to be a witch, and having tied Wrind down, proceeds to rape her (cf. *Vsp* 31 n.) If the first disguise is omitted, we see in both texts a three-fold progression consisting of giving gold, using force of arms, and at last employing magic.

1 Eṗli ǻllifu ‘Eleven apples’ | Probably the apples of Idin, which grant perpetual youth to the Gods. So *Gylf* 26:7: *Hon varð-veitir i eski sinu epli þau, er goð'in skulu á bita, þá er þau elda-sk, ok verða þá allir ungir, ok svá mun vera allt til ragna-rökr.* ‘She keeps in her casket the apples which the Gods should bite into when they age, and then they all grow young, and so it will be all until the Twilight of the Reins’. Idin's apples and the theft thereof are dealt with in *Skm* 2–3 and *Haustr* 1–13. It is not clear whether Shirner actually has the apples in his possession or whether he is merely making a big promise.

4 at lifa ‘in thy life’ | at lifa here seems to mean ‘in life/living’ rather than the typical infinitive sense ‘to live’; cf. st. 22 at *deila* ‘in sharing’ below. This may be an archaism.

[Gērðr] kvað: 20 „Eṗli ǻllifu · ek þigg aldri=gi
2 at manns-kis munum,
né vit Fręyr, · meðan okkart fјor lifir,
4 byggjum bēði saman.“

[R 11v/17, A 2v/15]

[Quoth Gird:] “Eleven apples will I never take
to any man’s liking,
nor will I and Free—while our life remains—
dwell both together.”

[Skírnir kvað:] **21** „Baug þér þá gef’k, · þann’s brænndr vas
2 með **ungum** Óðins syni;
átta ’ro **jafn**-hofgir, · es **af** drjúpa
4 hina **níundu** hverja **nött**.“

[R 11v/19, A 2v/17]

[Quoth Shirner:] “The bigh I then give thee, which was burned
with Weden’s young son [= Balder].
Eight even-heavy ones do drip thereof
every ninth night.”

3–4 átta ... nött ‘Eight ... night.’ | *om. (by parablepsis) A*

1 Baug ‘The bigh’ | Bigh, meaning ‘armlet’ or ‘ring’. While not named, the bigh is clearly Dleepner. It is known from *Gylf* 49:54, which describes Balder’s funeral and probably draws on the present stanza: *Óðinn lagði á bál’t gull-bring þann, er Draupnir heitir. Hónum fylgði sú náttúra, at ina níundu hverja nött drupu af bónum átta gull-bringar jafn-hofgir*. ‘Weden laid on the pyre that gold ring which is called Dleepner. Its nature was such that every ninth night eight even-heavy golden rings dripped from it.’ The Eese later regained the bigh, which is presumably why Shirner can promise to give it. *Gylf* 49:73–74 tells us that when the god Harmod rode to Hell to try to bring Balder back, Balder instead gave him the bigh, and told him to bring it back to Weden as a token by which he would be remembered.

[Gerdör] kvað: **22** „Baug þikk=a’k, · þó’tt brænndr séi,
2 með **ungum** Óðins syni;
es=a mér **golls** vant · i gøðum **Gymis**
4 at deila **fé** fðður.“

[R 11v/21, A 2v/18]

[Quoth Gird:] “The bigh I will not take although it may have been burned
with Weden’s young son [= Balder].
I have no want of gold in Gymer’s yards,
sharing the wealth of my father.”

1–2 Baug ... syni ‘The bigh ... son’ | *om. (by parablepsis) A*

[Skírnir kvað:] **23** „Sér þú **méki**, **mér**, · **mjóvan**, **mál**-faan,
2 es **hef’k** i **hendi hér**?
hofuð **hoggva** · mun’k þér **halsi** af,
4 nema mér **sétt** **segir**.“

[R 11v/23, A 2v/19]

[Quoth Shirner:] “Seest thou the sword, maiden—slender, picture-painted—
which I have here in my hand?

I will cut the head from off thy neck
unless thou agree with me!”

1 mēki ... mál-faan ‘sword ... picture-painted’ | The sword is inlaid with metal (perhaps gold or silver) forming a pattern; this may also be a reference to a damascened blade. The expression *mēki mál-faan* (acc. sg.) ‘picture-painted sword’ also occurs in *Sígr 4/2*.

[Gērðr kvað:] 24 „Á·nauð þola · vil’k aldri=gi
2 at manns-kis munum,
þó hins get’k, · ef it Gyimir finnið=sk
4 vígs ò-trauðir · at ykkir vega tíði.“

[R 11v/25, A 2v/20]

[Quoth Gird:] “Sexual coercion will I never stand
to any man’s liking,
though I still know that if thou and Gymer meet—
men unreluctant of conflict—ye will desire to fight.”

2 manns-kis ‘any man’s (lit. ‘no man’s)’ | manns çnskis A

3 þó ‘although’ | The interpretation of this word changes the tone of the stanza. If it means ‘although, even though’ then Gird is expressing her fear of violence between Shirner and her father, i.e., “I will not give in, even if it should lead to violence, as I fear”. If, on the other hand, it means ‘still, yet’, she may be expressing pride, i.e., “I will not give in, and what is more, my father will be eager to fight thee”. I find the former understanding more natural.

[Skírnir kvað:] 25 „Sér þú mēki, mēr, · mjóvan, mál-faan,
2 es hef’k i hendi hér?
fyr þessum eggjum · hnígr sá inn aldni jötunn,
4 verðr þinn feigr faðir.

[R 11v/27, A 2v/22]

[Quoth Shirner:] “Seest thou the sword, maiden—slender, picture-painted—
which I have here in my hand?
By these edges will that olden ettin sink down;
fey becomes thy father!

26 Tams-vendi þik drep’k, · çn ek þik tēmja mun,
2 mēr, at mínum munum,
þar skalt ganga · es þik gumna synir
4 síðan éva séi.

[R 11v/28, A 2v/24]

With the taming-wand I strike thee, but I will tame thee,
maiden, to my liking!
Thou shalt go whither the sons of men
never since will see thee!

ALL. | With this stanza Shirner's turns away from his direct threats of violence and begins his long curse (sts. 26–36). He curses Gird to be loveless, joyless, captive, and the subject of sexual abuse at the hands of loathsome ettins if she does not give in to his demands.

1 Tams-vendi 'taming-wand' | Probably a cane or whip, perhaps of a magical nature. The imagery is uncomfortably sexual, and Shirner threatens to 'tame' Gird like an animal.

- 27 **Ara þúfu á · skalt ár sitja,**
 horfa hęimi ór;
 snugga hęljar til;
 4 **matr sęi þęr męir lęiðr · an manna hvęim**
 inn fráni ormr með firum.

[R 11v/30, A 2v/26]

On an eagle's perch shalt thou sit for long,
 turn away from the world,
 hanker after Hell!

Be the food more loathsome to thee than to any man
 the gleaming Wyrms among folk.

1 Ara þúfu á · skalt ár sitja 'On an eagle's perch shalt thou sit for long' | ár skalt sitja · ara þúfu á 'for long shalt thou sit on an eagle's perch' A 2–3 horfa hęimi ór; / snugga hęljar til 'turn away from the world, / hanker after Hell' | horfa ok snugga hęljar til 'turn and hanker after Hell' A 2 ór | *add. in marg.* R 5 firum | *The last word on A 2v, after which the text cuts off; apart from the very last stanza, the rest of the poem is preserved only in R.*

ALL. | Shirner threatens Gird with captivity on a high mountain. The structure of sts. 27 and 28 is identical; both feature a direct threat in ll. 1–3 followed by a mythological hyperbole in ll. 5–6.

2–3 horfa hęimi ór; / snugga hęljar til 'turn away from the world, / hanker after Hell' | On the mountain-perch Gird will be able to see both Earth and the Underworld, but her situation will be so miserable that she will turn her face away from the former and long for her own death.

4–5 matr ... firum 'Be ... folk.' | Gird's disgust over her food will be greater than the hatred of the Middenyardswyrms among mankind, which is understood to be extreme. For this hatred cf. *Hym* 22.

- 28 **At undr-sjónum verðir · es þú út kœmr,**
 á þik Hrímnir hari
 á þik hot-vetna stari,
 4 **víð-kunnari verðir · an vörðr með goðum,**
 gapi þú grindum frá.

[R 11v/32]

A wondrous sight mayst thou be when thou comest out;
 at thee may Rimner ogle;
 at thee may anyone stare!

Mayst thou be more widely known than the watchman with the Gods;
 mayst thou gape from the gates.

2 Hrímnir ‘Rimner’ | An unknown ettin whose name derives from *brím* ‘rime ice’; he is one the many who will jeer at Gird.

4 vörðr með goðum ‘the watchman with the Gods’ | Homedall, who guards Bivrest from the ettins; cf. *Gylf* 27:8 (edited under *Eddbr* III). The poetic epithet is also found in *Grm* 13/3 and *Lok* 48/4.

- 29 **T**ópi ok ópi, · tjosull ok ò·þoli, [R 12r/2]
 2 vaxi þér **t**ór með **t**rega;
 sæt=sk þú niðr · en mun’k **s**egja þér
 4 **s**váran **s**ús-breka,
 ok **t**vinnan **t**rega.
 Toop and woop, tarsle and restlessness—
 may thy tears grow with grief!
 Sit thee down, but I will tell thee
 a hard roaring-breaker
 and a twined grief.

1 Tópi ok ópi, · tjosull ‘Toop and woop, tarsle’ | Otherwise unknown magic curse words without clear meaning; I have left them untranslated. *ópi* resembles *óp* ‘scream’, and *tjosull* ‘tarsle’ may perhaps be related to OE *teors* ‘penis’ and mean ‘little phallus’.

4 sváran sús-breka ‘hard roaring-breaker’ | Unclear. A curse that will hit Gird like a breaking wave (*breki*)?

- 30 Tramar gñeypa · þik skulu gęstan dag [R 12r/3]
 2 jętna gęðum i,
 til hrim-þursa hallar · þú skalt hęrjan dag
 4 kranga kosta-laus;
 kranga kosta-vęn;
 6 grát at gamni · skalt i gęgn hafa
 ok leiða með tęrum trega.
 Fiends shall pine thee on a dismal day
 in the yards of the Ettins.
 To the hall of Rime-Thurses shalt thou every day
 crawl choice-less;
 crawl choice-lacking.
 Weeping shalt thou have in exchange for joy,
 and nurse thy grief with tears.

1 Tramar ‘Fiends’ | TODO: reference ordsifjabók.

- 31 Með þursi þrí-hęfðuðum · þú skalt ę nara [R 12r/7]
 2 eða ver-laus vesa;

þitt gēð grípi,
 4 þik morn morni;
 ves þú sem þistill, · sá's þrunginn vas
 6 i ofan-verða qnn.

With a three-headed thurse shalt thou always dwell
 or be husband-less.
 May thy senses seize;
 may murrain mourn thee!
 Be thou like the thistle which was pressed
 during highest harvest!

1 þursi þri-hqðuðum 'three-headed thurse' | Ettins often have an abnormal number of body parts. For their many-headed-ness see note to *Hym* 8/2.

5-6 ves ... qnn 'Be ... harvest' | The thistle was considered a weed; cf. the Old English galder against a cattle-thief ("For Theft of Cattle" under Galders) cursing him to be *swá bræðel ... swá þystel* 'as useless as the thistle'. The 'pressing' of the thistle has been connected with an Estonian folk-ritual wherein a thistle would be crushed by stones at the beginning of harvest to prevent further weeds (TODO: reference).

32 Til holts ek gekk · ok til hrás viðar
 2 gamban-tēin at geta
 gamban-tēin ek gat.

[R 12r/9]

To the grove I went and to the raw/sappy tree,
 the gombentoe for to get;
 the gombentoe I got.

1 til hrás viðar 'to the raw/sappy tree' | The wood of a sapling was apparently thought to be the most effective for magic; cf. *Háv* 152, which speaks about a runic curse carved on *rótum rás viðar* 'the roots of a raw/sappy tree'.

2 gamban-tēin 'gomben-toe' | Perhaps 'mighty twig', also found in *Hárþ* 20/4. The word is a cpd. of the very rare prefix *gamban-* 'magic/curse?' (cf. *Lok* 8/4 n.) and *tēinn* 'twig, branch' (cf. *mistil-tēinn* 'mistle-toe'). This may be the stick on which the runic curse in st. 36 below should be carved, or it is to be identified with the *tams-vpnðr* 'taming-wand' of st. 26 above. *Hárþ* 21 suggests that it is an object of some value.

33 Rēiðr 's þér Óðinn, · rēiðr 's þér Ása-bragr,
 2 þik skal Fręyr fía=sk,
 hin firin-illa mér, · ęn fingit hęfr
 4 gamban-rēiði goða.

[R 12r/10]

Wroth with thee is Weden; wroth with thee is Eesebray (= Thunder);
 thee shall Free come to hate,
 O wickedly evil maiden, if thou hast earned
 the gomben-wrath of the gods.

1 Ása-bragr ‘Eesebray’ | ‘The pinnacle of the Eese’, Thunder.

- 34 Hęyri jǫtnar, · hęyri hrīm-þursar, [R 12r/12]
 2 synir Suttunga, · sjalfir ǫs-liðar,
 hvé ek fyrir·býð, · hvé ek fyrir-banna
 4 manna glaum mani,
 manna nyt mani.

Hear may Ettins, hear may Rime-thurses,
 sons of Sutting [ETTINS], even the Eese-folk,
 how I forbid, how I forban
 men’s fellowship from the maid,
 men’s joy from the maid!

- 35 Hrīm-grímnir hętir þurs, · es þik hafa skal [R 12r/14]
 2 fyr Ná-grindr neðan,
 þar þér víl-męgir · à viðar rótum
 4 gęita-hland gefi;
 ǫðri drykkju · fà þú aldri=gi,
 6 męr, af þinum munum,
 męr, at minum munum.

Rimegrimner is the name of the thurse who shall have thee
 down beneath Neegrind,
 where lads of toil [THRALLS] on the roots of a tree
 goat-piss will give thee.
 Never fetch a finer drink,
 O maiden, against thy liking,
 O maiden, to *my* liking!

- 36 Þurs ríst’k þér · ok þría stafi, [R 12r/16]
 2 ęrgi ok ǫði ok ǫ·þola,
 svá ek þat af ríst · sem ek þat à reist,
 4 ef gǫra=sk þarfar þęss.“

Thurse I carve for thee, and three staves:
 queerness and madness and restlessness.
 So will I carve it *off* like I carved it *on*,
 if there arise need for that.”

ALL | With the carving of the rune-stick Shirner threatens to fulfill the curse predicted in sts. 26–35. He hints to Gird that he will scrape the runes off and nullify if she will accept his demands.

1 Þurs ‘thurse’ | Thurse is the name of the þ-rune (þ); it is carved as part of the curse.

1 þria stafi ‘three staves’ | Three runic letters (or phrases) representing the three following words (*ergi* ‘queerness, degeneracy’ etc.). The magic notion of carving “three staves” is also found on the C7th Gummarp stone: **h**a**þ**u**w**o**l**a**f**a **s**a**t**e **s**t**a**b**a** **þ**r**i**a **f**f**f** ‘Hathwolf placed three staves: fff’, where the **f**-rune (𐌺) stands for its name **fēb* (> ON *fē* ‘wealth, cattle’) and is thus meant to bring wealth.

2 *ergi* ok óði ok óþola ‘queerness and madness and restlessness’ | Both *ergi* ‘queerness, degeneracy’ and *óþoli* ‘restlessness’ (here probably from strong lust) are found in the love magic charm on the rune stick B257 from Bryggen (edited below under Galders). *ergi* is also found in the curse-formula on the C7th Proto-Norse runestones from Stentoften and Björketorp. See further introduction to B257.

- [Geṛðr kvað:] 37 „Hęill ves þú hęldr, sveinn, · ok tak við hrīm-kalki [R 12r/19]
 2 fullum forns mjaðar,
 þó haðá’k ętlat, · at mynda’k aldri=gi
 4 unna vaningja vęl.“
- [Quoth Gird:] “Hale be thou rather, swain, and receive the rime-chalice,
 full of ancient mead,
 although I had intended that I never would
 love the Waning [= Free] well.”

1–2 Hęill ... mjaðar ‘Hale ... mead’ | Formulaic; repeated identically in *Lok* 53/1–2.

1 hrīm-kalki ‘rime-chalice’ | Some kind of expensive glazed drinking vessel; the second element *kalkr* ‘chalice’ is a borrowing from Latin *calix* and suggests a Roman origin. Cf. the *kalkr* in *Hym* 28/4b.

4 vaningja ‘the Waning [= Free]’ | The ‘descendant of the Wanæs’. A rare word. Its only other occurrence in the Norse corpus is in a thule of boar-names. Boars were sacred to Free, TODO.

- [Skírnir kvað:] 38 „Ørendi mīn · vil’k ęl vita, [R 12r/21]
 2 áðr riða’k hęim hęðan,
 nęr à þingi · munt inum þroska
 4 nęnna Njarðar syni?“
- [Quoth Shirner:] “My errands all I wish to know
 before I ride home hence:
 when on the Thing wilt thou to the virile
 son of Nearth [= Free] submit?”

- [Geṛðr kvað:] 39 „Barri hęitir, · es vit bęði vitum, [R 12r/23]
 2 lundr logn-fara,
 ęn ępt nętr níu, · þar mun Njarðar syni
 4 Geṛðr unna gamans.“
- [Quoth Gird:] “Barrey is the name—as we both do know—
 of a grove of calm breezes,
 and after nine nights there will to the son of Nearth
 Gird her pleasure grant.”

1 Barri ‘Barrey’ | Derived from *barr* ‘leaf, foliage’, perhaps a reference to a cornfield (of wheat or barley, not maize!) which would fit in an interpretation of the poem as an analogy for agricultural fertility.

2 logn-fara ‘calm breezes’ | A *bapax* compound, here read as a gen. pl. of *logn* n. ‘calm (wind)’ + *far* ‘trail, passage’, i.e., ‘where one travels calmly’. Another interpretation is a gen. sg. of an unattested proper noun *Logn-fari* ‘Calm-farer’, ‘the one who causes calm winds’ (cf. *Mundil-fari* in *Vafþ 23*), probably a name for Free in his role as a fertility god.

P4 Þá reið Skírnir heim. Freyr stóð úti ok kvaddi hann ok spurði [R 12r/24]
2 tíðenda:

Then Shirner rode home. Free stood outside and greeted him and asked for the tidings:

40 „Sæg mér, Skírnir, · áðr verpir sǫðli af mar [R 12r/25]
2 ok stígir feti framarr,
hvat þú árnaðir · i Jǫtun-heima
4 þíns eða míns munar?“

“Tell me, Shirner, before thou mightst throw the saddle off the steed
and take a step further,
what thou accomplished in the Ettinhomes
to thy or my liking?”

2 ok stígir feti framarr ‘and take a step further’ | Formulaic; a variant of *feti ganga/gangir framarr* (*Háv 38/2*, *Lok 1/2*).

[Skírnir kvað:] 41 „Barri heitir, · es vit báðir vitum, [R 12r/27]
2 lundr logn-fara,
en ept nētr níu, · þar mun Njarðar syni
4 Geðr unna gamans.“

[Quoth Shirner:] “Barrey is the name—as we both do know—
of a grove of calm breezes,
and after nine nights there will to the son of Nearth
Gird her pleasure grant.”

ALL | *Abbrev.* ‘Barri. h. l. er. vi. l. l. c. e. n. n. þ. m. n. s. g. u. gamans’ R.

[Freyr kvað:] 42 „Lǫng es nótt, · langar ’ro tvér, [R 12r/28,
2 hvé of þreyja’k þríar?
opt mér mánaðr · minni þótti
4 an sjá hǫlf hý-nótt.“ S 9r/32, T 9v/35
W TODO, U TODO]

[Quoth Free:] “Long is a night, long are two—
how can I yearn for three?
Oft a month to me seemed less
than this half wedding-night!”

1 langar 'ro tvér 'long are two' | löng es önnur 'long is another' G 2 hvé of þreyja'k þríar? | hvé
meða'k þreyja þríar G

ALL | This stanza is cited following *Gylf* 37:15 in that text; see below.

4 hólfr hý-nótt 'half wedding-night' | *hý-nótt* is a hapax cpd. of *hý-* + *nótt* 'night'. *hý-* has been variously explained, e.g. as a form of the demonstrative pronoun stem PGmc. **biz*, but is most likely the same prefix found in *hý-býli* 'farmstead', equivalent to Gothic *beiuwa-* 'marriage, household', OHG *bi-* 'marriage'; for the root cf. Kroonen (2013, p. 227).

On the basis of the first element the most likely sense of the cpd. is the wedding-night and more specifically the consummation of the marriage. The word *hólfr* 'half' should then probably not be taken as a measurement of time (like 'half a month') but rather as meaning 'incomplete' or 'divided' (cf. e.g. *Háv* 53/4). The wedding-night may be called divided since although the two are now betrothed, they are still separated; each is 'half'.

Appendix

Gylf 37:1–15

NOTE: The following excerpt has not yet been critically edited.

Gylf 37:1–15 deals with the relevant myth. The remainder of the chapter (37:16–19) deals with Free's lack of his sword and is cited in *Vsp* 51/3 (n.). Cf. also st. 8 above and *Lok* 42.

Gylf 37:1–7 corresponds to *Ski* P1–2 and 37:8–13 paraphrases sts. 3–9. The rest of the poem is summed up very succinctly by 37:14.

1Gymir hét maðr, en kona hans Aur-boða. Hón var berg-risa
2éttar. 2Dóttir þeira er Gerðr, er allra kvinna var fegrst. 3Þat var
4einn dag, at Freyr hafði gengit í Hlið-skjálfr ok sá of heima alla.
5En er hann leit í norðr-étt, þá sá hann á einum bó mikit hús ok
6fagrt, ok til þess húss gekk kona, 5ok er hón tók upp høndum
7ok lauk hurð fyrir sér, þá lýsti af høndum hennar bæði í lopt ok á
8lög, ok allir heimar birtusk af henni. 6Ok svá hefnði hónum þat
9mikla mikil-léti, er hann hafði setsk í þat it helga sæti, at hann
10gekk í braut fullr af harmi. 7Ok er hann kom heim, mēlti hann
ekki. Ekki svaf hann, ekki drakk hann. Engi þorði ok at krefja
hann orða.

1Gymer was the name of a man, and his woman was Earbode; she was of the lineage of barrow-risers. 2Their daughter is Gird who was fairest of all women. 3It was one day when Free had gone to the Lithshelf and looked out over all the Homes. 4But when he looked north he saw on a farm a large

and fair house, and to that house walked a woman, ⁵and when she raised her hands and closed the doors behind her then it shone from her hands into both the air and the waters, and all the homes were brightened by her. ⁶And so greatly did the greatness which he had beheld in the holy seat harm him that he walked away filled with grief, ⁷and when he came home he said nothing. He slept nothing; he drank nothing. No one dared to get words out of him.

2 ⁸Þá lét Njorðr kalla til sín Skírni, skó-svein Freys, ok bað hann
ganga til Freys ok beiða hann orða ok spyrja, hverjum hann væri
4 svá reiðr, at hann mélti ekki við menn. ⁹En Skírnir létsk ganga
mundu ok eigi fúss ok kvað illra svara vera ván af honum. ¹⁰En
6 er hann kom til Freys, þá spurði hann, hví Freyr var svá hnipinn
ok mélti ekki við menn. ¹¹Þá svarar Freyr ok sagði, at hann hefði
8 sét konu fagra ok fyrir hennar sakir var hann svá harm-fullr, at
eigi myndi hann lengi lifa, ef hann skyldi eigi ná henni, ¹²ok
10 nú skaltu fara ok biðja hennar mér til handa ok hafa hana heim
hingat, hvárt er faðir hennar vill eða eigi, ok skal ek þat vel launa
þér.“ ¹³Þá svarar Skírnir, sagði svá, at hann skal fara sendi-ferð,
12 en Freyr skal fá honum sverð sitt. Þat var svá gott sverð, at sjálft
vást. En Freyr lét eigi þat til skorta ok gaf honum sverðit.

⁸Then Nearth had Shirner, Free's shoe-swain, summoned before him and asked him to go to Free and bid him to speak and ask at whom he was so wroth that he would not speak with men. ⁹And Shirner said that he would go, although not eagerly, and said that he expected ill answers from him. ¹⁰And when he came to Free he asked why Free was so downcast and spoke nothing with men. ¹¹Then Free answers, and said that he had seen a fair woman and for her sakes was he so full of grief that he would not live long if he should not reach her, ¹²“and now shalt thou journey to ask for her hand on my behalf, and bring her home hither whether her father wants to or not, and I shall reward thee well for that.” ¹³Then Shirner answers; said so, that he will go on the errand-journey, but Free shall give him his sword; it was such a good sword that it struck by itself. And Free did not deny him that and gave him the sword.

2 ¹⁴Þá fór Skírnir ok bað honum konu'nna ok fekk heit hennar,
ok níu nóttum síðar skyldi hon þar koma, er Barrey heitir, ok
4 ganga þá at brul-laupinu með Frey. ¹⁵En er Skírnir sagði Frey
sitt erindi, þá kvað hann þetta: [...]

¹⁴Then Shirner journeyed and asked for the woman's hand for him [Free] and

got her promise that nine nights later she would come to that place which is called Barrey and have a wedding with Free.¹⁵ And when Shirner told Free his errand then he quoth this: [...]

4 [...] | Here the text cites its own variant of st. 42; see there for critical notes.

Leeds of Hoarbeard

(*Hár·barðs ljóð*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): early C11th (0.578)–late C11th (0.377)

Meter: Varied

Introduction

Textual preservation and transmission

The **Leeds of Hoarbeard** (*Hárþ*) is preserved in full (sts. 1–60) in **R** on foll. 12r/30–13v/26, where it follows *Skí* and precedes *Hym*.

The poem is partially preserved (sts. 19/4b–60) in **A** on foll. 1r/1–1v/17, where it is followed by *Bdr*.

Contents

Hárþ is a dialogue between the two figures Thunder (*Þórr*) and Hoarbeard (*Hár·barðr*, i.e., ‘grey-beard’), who meet at a sound. Thunder, the traveller, asks Hoarbeard, the ferryman, for passage; an argument ensues, and Thunder is forced to depart without passage.

The Gods

Thunder is of course the well-known god, but Hoarbeard merits discussion. Considering his name, which appears in *Grm* 51 as a name for Weden, and his generally Odinic character (cf. esp. st. 24), he is near-universally considered to be the god Weden in disguise.

The difference in personality between the two gods is striking, so that *Hárþ* is far from a flying between, say, two warriors of equal stature. Thunder is portrayed as moral and altruistic, but also as rather naïve and the foil for Hoarbeard’s insults. Hoarbeard on the other hand is egoistic and sly. He is the first to insult Thunder, and gets the last laugh by denying him passage.

The poem might be seen as an allegory on class relations, namely between the self-owning yeomen farmers and the warlike earls, represented by their patron gods. TODO.

Humour and satire

Hárþ stands out from the six preceding poems (*Vǫp-Ski*, and particularly the first five) in its humorosity and less than irreverent tone regarding the gods. This lighter tone is particularly shared with *Lok* and, to a somewhat lesser degree, *Þrk* and *Hym*; since this is the first such “irreverent” poem it is reasonable to deal with the phenomenon here.

It has to be strongly emphasized that this irreverence is in no way a sign of Christian influence or a weakening of the pagan religion as such. To begin with, it never crosses into direct blasphemy; all insults between gods are uttered by the Gods themselves, not directly by the poet. Nor does the poet denounce the gods or call them false or dæmonic; on the contrary in all four mentioned poems there are respectful and even reverent statements about or attributed to the gods (e.g. *Hárþ* 23, 47, *Hym* 21–24, 36, *Lok* 55, 57, 59, 61, 63, *Þrk* 21, 31–32).

Furthermore this treatment of the Gods in mythology is by no means unique to the late Norse religion of the Wiking Age. Parallels are found already in Homer (*Il* 21.385–440, 458–513), where several gods and goddesses are humorously described as fighting with their fists over the fate of the Trojans. The most likely explanation for this is that the texts we are dealing with are mythological; they are not hymns or documents of cultic Law, genres almost totally absent from Old Norse literature (but cf. Lindow 1988).

In Paganism (unlike Judaism, which does away almost completely with divine mythology!) it thus seems clear that these supposedly irreverent descriptions were not felt to damage the credibility of the gods or their ritual significance. That the poems themselves are not Christian is certain; several of them have archaic linguistic features (cf. e.g. *Hym* 23/1, 28/2, *Lok* 15/3, 18/4, 27/4, *Þrk* 1/1), and they assume a deep familiarity with the nature and character of the different gods.

Meter

Of all Eddic poems *Hárþ* is probably the strangest in terms of form. It consists of 149 lines across 60 “stanzas”, some of which consist merely of single unmetrical prose lines. No narrative prose is embedded apart from P1 at the very beginning, which sets the stage for the rest of the poem.

Stanza length varies greatly. 4 lines is by no means the standard; in fact, only a single fully regular Leeds-meter-stanza of type *abcabc* occurs, viz. st. 47.

The meter itself is an irregular mix of Leeds-meter and a peripheral form of Speeches-meter. Many lines are unusually long (e.g. 4/3b, 56/5a, 59/1–2) and others have no metrical qualities at all (17/1, 31/1, 41/1, 44–46, 57/1, 60/1).

Language

The language of *Hárþ* comes across as unusually young and informal.

The clitic definite *-inn* is employed with unique frequency throughout *Hárþ* in both the prose and poetic lines. This is probably the clearest identifiable young feature of the poem. The clitic, although attested in Wiking Age runic inscriptions from the 11th c. onwards, only rarely appears in poetry older than the 14th c., suggesting that it was not considered appropriate for use in poetic composition. (TODO: cite this.)

The particle *of*, an old trait, is found 3 times (18/5, 19/5, 33/1) with a total frequency of 0.120 per 10 unique lines; a relatively low rate compared to most Eddic poems (Sapp 2022, p. 70).

The normal or prosaic forms *þingat* and *þangat* are used in the respective sense ‘hither’ and ‘thither’ for the older *þiníg* and *þiníg*. On the other hand there is the presence of the rare and prob. old words *ogurr* ‘burden(?)’ (st. 13) and *gamban-þeinn* (st. 20).

Possibilities of performance

The loose meter and non-formal language demand discussion. To begin with, we should disregard the notion that *Hárþ* is heavily corrupt and requires restoration. It must be stated clearly that no amount of emendation could “restore” *Hárþ* to a pure Leeds-meter resembling what we find in *Háv*, *Vaff*, or *Lok*. Furthermore, most lines of *Hárþ*, including those of unusual length or without clear metrical qualities, are readily understandable and fit well both within their immediate context and the poem as a whole. If there is such great corruption, it has still produced a remarkably consistent and intelligible text. Yet, even so, the poem is unconventional.

As all Norse poetry, at least prior to the antiquarian period of the 12th c., was originally oral, it must have been performed in some way. Assuming *Hárþ* is older than the 12th c., it should not be an exception. With this in mind the traits described above may be explained quite nicely if we assume that *Hárþ* was originally acted out, perhaps in a carnivalesque theatre with two actors standing on a stage, separated by a staged body of water and shouting at each other; alternatively with one actor playing both roles by the use of props, gestures, and voices.

The whole poem in fact seems remarkably fit for such a performance, and with this assumption many pieces fall into place. Take Thunder’s talk of his breakfast and the pack on his back (st. 3), which invites the actor to point to his back and then rub his belly; Hoarbeard’s insult of Thunder’s dress (st. 6), which would work much better if there was in fact an actor with his pants pulled up to his knees; or Hoarbeard’s declaration that he will not cross the water but instead remain *bér* ‘here’ (st. 14), which invites stomping on the ground.

A theatric performance would also explain the metrical variations and the use of informal features like the clitic definite as vulgar elements, deliberately contrasting with the more formal language expected for a mythological poem.

The prose lines may even have been shouted out, which would explain their lack of meter as a discordant stylistic feature meant to catch the audience by surprise; the regular metrical sts., like 47, become all the more powerful when standing immediately surrounded by prose.

(TODO: mention the concept of the "double scene" by Lars Lönnroth?)

Circumstantial support is found in the structure of the dialogue, which has a remarkable affinity to a fixture in modern comedic duos: the straight man (Thunder) and the funny man (Hoarbeard). The by Wiking Age standards ever-moral Thunder serves as the perfect foil to the egoistic Hoarbeard and falls effortlessly for the ferryman's "trolling". It is hard not to imagine the audience laughing more and more as Thunder gets angrier and angrier.

The god really is the butt of the joke for much of the poem. As noted above, his threat in st. 47 is quite impressive, but it is soon neutralized by Hoarbeard's accusation that his wife Sib is currently engaged in adultery behind his back. Even so, Thunder's great feats are never made fun of directly (beyond st. 37–39, where Thunder has the last word); in the pagan religion such stories served not just as entertainment, but also as ritual etiology (Lindow 1988).

Dating

Its formal and linguistic criteria can be taken to point towards a later date for *Hárþ* than for most other mythological poems, but as discussed above the loose meter and use of the clitic definite may also be stylistic features belonging to the relaxed and vulgar comedic register of the poem.

There are also features that speak against a late date. Among content-based criteria, there is a thorough and deep understanding of the personalities of the two gods which would seem unlikely to have survived long after the conversion of Iceland and which does not come off as antiquarian, but on the other hand seems to reflect felt tensions between the cults of the two gods (see above). The use of a variant ettin-name for the attested story in st. 26 is notable since it points away from antiquarian composition, which would more likely have inserted the familiar name *Skrymir* 'Shrimer' as known from *Lok* and *Gylf*.

A content-based argument for a late dating is that *Hárþ* takes its subject-matter (the two gods, Weden and Thunder) too lightly and therefore can hardly have been composed by a pagan poet (TODO: refs). Yet it is shown by *Lok* (certainly an old poem, as proven by the metrically required *vr-* in *Lok* 15/3 (n.), 18/4, 27/4) and *Þrk* (generally held to be a particularly old poem) that pre-Christian Norse poetry could in fact depict the Gods in a light-hearted and comedic manner, and *Hárþ* certainly falls neatly into that pattern.

The model devised by Sapp (2022) gives the poem a 57.8% likelihood of being from the early 11th c., and a 37.7% likelihood of being from the late 11th. These percentages are most similar to those obtained by *Gríp* (a poem recognised as very young—at earliest from the latter half of the 12th

c.) but *Hárþ* shares so little in common with it that the similar results must be considered meaningless.

Text

The Leeds of Hoarbeard

- P1 Þórr fór ór austr-vegi ok kom at sundi einu. Qðrum megum [R 12r/30]
 2 sunds'ins var ferju-karl'inn með skip'it. Þórr kallaði:

THUNDER JOURNEYED out of the Eastern Way and came to a sound. At the other side of the sound was the ferryman with the ship. Thunder called out:

- 1 „Hvęrr 's sá sveinn sveina · es stęndr fyr sund'it handan?“ [R 12r/32]
 “Who is this swain of swains, standing yonder across the sound?”

1 sveinn sveina ‘swain of swains’ | The word *sveinn* ‘swain, lad’ generally refers to a prepubescent boy, later on a page (the servant of a knight, who was aged approx. 7–14), but can also mean ‘servant’ (cf. English boy as a term of address), as is most likely the case here. It is presumably offended by this address that the decidedly non-servile Hoarbeard decides to insult Thunder. — The construction “X of Xs” may ultimately stem from Biblical language, although it appears fairly early on in Norse poetry; cf. 2 *Gũðr* 1/1.

- Hann svaraði: 2 „Hvęrr 's sá karl karla · es kallar of vág'inn?“ [R 12v/1]
 He answered: “Who is this churl of churls, calling out o'er the wave?”

1 karl karla ‘churl of churls’ | Hoarbeard directs an insult to Thunder by denigrating his social status as a lowly peasant. The construction should not be read as a compliment like modern Swedish *karlakarl* ‘a real man, manly man’. Although *karl* ‘churl’ is an unmarked word for ‘adult human being’ in later NGmc., including modern Icelandic, in the oldest Norse poetry it specifically refers to a ‘churl, peasant, old man’ (so *Hym* 10/4, 31/3, 32/3, 2 *HHund* 2/2, *Reg* 18/3, *Rþ* 23/4; in *SkP*: *Vitg* Lv 1, *KormQ* Lv 16, *EVald Þórr* 1, *GunnL* Lv 5) unless occurring in the collocation *konur ok karlar* ‘women and menfolk’ (*Háv* 91/2, *Helr* 14/2, *Am* 70/1). The only exception to this in the Poetic Edda is *Am* 63/3, but *Am* is a fairly late poem and so the general rule holds.

- [Þórr kvaði:] 3 „Fęr þú mik of sund'it, · fðði'k þik á morgun;
 2 męis hęfi'k á baki, · verðr=a matr inn bętri.
 Át'k i hvild · áðr ek hęiman fór,
 4 síldr ok hafra; · saðr em'k ęnn þęss.“ [R 12v/2]
- [Quoth Thunder:] “Ferry me o'er the sound; I'll feed thee in the morning.
 A basket I have on my back; better food will not be found.
 I ate, while at rest, before I journeyed from home,
 herring and oatmeal/he-goats—I am still full thereof.”

4 hafra ‘oatmeal/he-goats’ | The easiest reading (preferred by Finnur Jónsson (1932), Pettit (2023) and others) is an acc. pl. of *hafr* ‘he-goat’. Thunder also eats his goats in *Gylf* 44:11–16, where he butchers and cooks them in the evening and brings them back to life at dawn by blessing them with his hammer (cf. *Hym* 37–38), and this seems to be a common motif of the god. For his goats cf. *Hym* 20, 31, *Þrk* 21.

Other scholars instead read an acc. pl. of *hafri* ‘oat’, i.e., ‘porridge, oatmeal’. Stiles (2023) connects this with the porridge-eating of the Vedic god *Pūṣān* (*RV* 6.56.1, 57.2), who is “partner and yoke-mate” (*RV* 6.56.2) of *Indra*, Thunder’s Vedic equivalent. Another similarity Stiles notes between Thunder and *Pūṣān* is that both have chariots driven by goats (*RV* 6.57.3: “Goats are the draft-animals for the one”, 6.58.2: “Having goats as his horses”). Whether the Vedic tradition has split the Thunder-god in two or whether the Germanic Thunder has absorbed elements of an earlier yokemate is hard to say. Like *Indra*, Thunder is frequently joined by companions, as is in fact one of his most identifying characteristics (Lindow 1988, p. 123).

[Hár-barðr kvað:] 4 „Ár=ligum verkum · hrósar þú, vęðoi’num; [R 12v/5]

2 vęitst=at-tu fyr gęr=la,
dępr ’ro þín hęim-kynni, · dauð hygğ’k at þín móðir sé.“

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “Of early morning works thou boastest—of thy *eating*!
Thou seest not clearly ahead;
dire is the state of thy home; I think that thy mother is dead!”

1 Ár=ligum verkum · hrósar þú, vęðoi’num ‘Of early works thou boastest, of thy eating’ | A difficult line, not unlikely corrupt. The present interpretation sees it as an insult directed against Thunder for bragging about the quality of his food; that is not the type of *ár=ligt verk* ‘early morning work’ a real man should boast about (cf. *Háv* 33, 58–59).

2 vęitst=at-tu fyr gęr=la | A third verse appended to the previous two; for this form cf. 6/2, 13/3 below, *Háv* 80/2.

[Þórr kvað:] 5 „Þat sęgir þú nú · es hęvęjum þikkir [R 12v/6]

2 męst at víta: · at mín móðir dauð sé.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Now sayest thou that which to every man seems
of most weight to know—that my mother is dead!”

[Hár-barðr kvað:] 6 „Þęy=gi ’s sęm þú · þrjú bú góð ęgir; [R 12v/8]

2 bęr-bęinn þú stęndr · ok hęfir brautinga gęrvi,
þat-ki at þú hafir brókr þinar.“

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “Yet it’s not as if *thou* mightst own three good farms—
bare-legged thou standest and hast the gear of a tramp;
thou hast not even thy breeches on!”

[Þórr kvað:] 7 „Stýr þú hingat ęikju’nni, · ek mun þér stęð’na kęnna [R 12v/9]

2 ęða hęrr á skip’it · es þú hęldr við land’it?“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Steer hither the boat! I will show thee to the harbour—
or who owns the ship which thou holdest by the shore?”

[Hár-barðr kvað:] 8 „Hild-ólfr sá hęitir · es mik halda bað, [R 12v/11]

2 rekkir inn ráð-svinni · es býr i Ráðs-ęyar-sundi;

4 bað=at hann hleñni-menn flytja · eða hrossa-þjófa,
 góða ęina · ok þa's ek gęrva kunna;
 sęę-đu til nafns þíns · ef þú vill of sund'it fara.“

[Quoth Hoarheard:] “Hildolf is he called who bade me hold it,
 the counsel-wise man who lives in Redeseysound.
 He bade me not ferry highwaymen nor horse-thieves—
 good ones alone and those I know well—
 speak to thy name if thou wilt come o'er the sound!”

1 Hild-ólfr ‘Hildolf’ | Perhaps the son of Weden mentioned in the thule *Þul Ása* I 1/3a in SkP 3, although that god is otherwise unattested and quite likely fabricated. The name can probably not be identified with any concrete figure.

2 Ráðs-ęjar-sundi ‘Redeseysound’ | An island named Redey (New Norse *Radøy*) is in fact attested in Harthland, Western Norway, so that this may be a real place. For another place-name from Western Norway found in the mythology cf. *Grm* 29/1.

[Þórr kvað:] 9 „Sęja mun'k til nafns míns · þó'tt ek sękr sjá'k [R 12v/15]
 2 ok til alls øðlis: · Ek em Óðins sonr,
 Męila bróðir · ęn Magna faðir,
 4 þrúð-valdr goða · við Þór knátt-u hér dóma!
 Hins vil'k nú spyrja, · hvat þú heitir.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “I will speak to my name—though I may be charged—
 and to all my origin: I am Weden's son,
 Male's brother and Main's father,
 the strength-wielder of the Gods—with Thunder dost thou here speak!
 One thing will I now ask, what thou art called.”

1 sękr ‘charged’ | I.e., involved in an unresolved blood feud.

[Hár·barðr kvað:] 10 „Hár·barðr ek heiti, · hyl'k umb nafn sjaldan.“ [R 12v/18]

[Quoth Hoarheard:] “Hoarheard I am called; I seldom conceal my name.”

1 hyl'k umb nafn sjaldan ‘I seldom conceal my name’ | Clearly sarcastic; the audience (who is expected to know the pilot's true identity) would likely have found this quite amusing.

Þórr kvað: 11 „Hvat skalt-u umb nafn hylja · nema þú sakar ęigir?“ [R 12v/18]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Why shalt thou conceal thy name unless thou have charges?”

[Hár·barðr kvað:] 12 „En þó'tt ek sakar ęiga, · fyr s'líkum sem þú est [R 12v/19]
 2 þa mun'k forða fęrvi mínu · nema ek fęigr sé.“

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “Yet even though I had charges, from such a one as thou art
I would then preserve my life—unless I were fey.”

ALL | The sense is that even if Woden had outstanding charges he would still give his true name, since such a wretched man as the *brautingi* ‘tramp’ Thunder can hardly pose a threat. This insult to Thunder’s strength is what provokes him to finally retort.

2 feigr ‘fey’ | Doomed (by fate) to die shortly.

[Þórr kvað:] 13 „Harm ljótan mér þíkkir í því
2 at vaða of vág’inn til þín
ok véta qgur minn;
4 skylda’k launa kōgur-svęini · þinum kagin-yrði
ef ek kom=umk yfir sund’it.“

[R 12v/21]

[Quoth Thunder:] “An ugly harm it seems to me
to wade o’er the wave to thee,
and wet this burden of mine.
I would repay thee, swaddle-swain, for thy mocking words
if I might get myself over the sound.”

1 Harm ljótan mér þíkkir í því ‘An ugly harm it seems to me’ | The meter is clearly faulty. Rhythmically the whole line comes off as an a- and b-verse of Leeds-meter (*Harm ljótan* · ...), but the verses are not linked by alliteration, which instead falls on *þ* in the b-verse.

3 qgur ‘burden’ | The sense of this word is not clear, though it is probably the same as the first element of the compound *qgur-stund* ‘burdensome hour’ found in *Vkv* 42. I find the most convincing interpretation to be that it refers to the food Thunder carries on his back, as previously mentioned in st. 3. Thunder then uses his desire not to get his food wet as an excuse not to wade. Some authors have read it as a euphemism for ‘bollocks’, but this is discordant with the angered but quite serious tone of the rest of the stanza and with Thunder’s general role in the poem as the “straight man” next to the scurrilous Hoarbeard. It is also a very poor excuse for Thunder’s unwillingness to wade, since wading is a frequent attribute of this god (e.g. *Grm* 29, *Eddbr* VI), who on those occasions shows no fear of “getting his bollocks wet”.

4 skylda’k launa kōgur-svęini · þinum kagin-yrði | Both words are rare. *kōgur-svęinn* ‘swaddle-swain’, i.e., a babe swaddled in cloth rather than clothed like an adult, is clearly an insult and only attested at one other place; cf. the more common *kōgur-barn* ‘swaddle-child’. *kagin-yrði* ‘mocking words’ is a hapax due to the otherwise unattested first element, which is however most likely cognate with Swedish *kāngas* ‘to banter inappropriately’ (Ásgeir Blöndal Magnússon 1989, s.v. *kanginyrði*). The whole line has a close parallel in the latter half of *Gylf* 45:35: *Nú mun ek ráða yör heil-ręði: látið þér eigi stór-liga yfir yör. Ekki munu birð-menn Útgarða-Loka vel þola því-likum kōgur-sveinum kōpur-yrði.* ‘Now I will give you a piece of wholesome counsel: do not speak too haughtily about yourselves. Nowise will the hirdmen of Outyards-Lock suffer insulting words from such swaddle-swains.’

[Hár-barðr kvað:] 14 „Hér mun’k standa · ok þín heðan biða;
2 fannt=a-tu mann inn harðara · at Hrungni dauðan.“

[R 12v/23]

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “Here will I stand and from here await thee.
Thou foundest no harder man since Rungne died!”

2 Hrungni ‘Rungner’ | Rungner was a famous ettin slain by Thunder in a fierce battle (*Skm* 24–25, *Haustl* 14–20).

[Þórr kvað:] 15 „Hins vilt-u nú geta · es vit Hrungnir deildum, [R 12v/25]
 2 sá inn stór-úðgi jötunn, · es ór stęini vas hofuð’it á,
 þó lét’k hann falla · ok fyrir hníga;
 4 hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Hár-barðr?“

[Quoth Thunder:] “This wilt thou now bring up, how I and Rungner dealt with each other,
 that great-minded ettin on whom the head was of stone.
 Yet I made him fall and kneel down before me—
 what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Hoarbeard?”

2 es ór stęini vas hofuð’it á ‘on whom the head was of stone’ | Cf. *Hym* 29–30, where the ettin Hymer’s head is harder than stone. This characteristic part of ettin-physiology can probably be explained by reference to pre-Christian cosmology.

In numerous Indo-European cosmologies the Firmament is believed to be made of stone, as is seen in the PIE root **h₂ék_{mō}* whose descendants can mean both ‘heaven, sky’, ‘meteorite’ and ‘stone’, sometimes varying even within branches (West 2007, p. 342; Calin 1996, p. 3); cf. e.g. OI *áşman* ‘stone, rock’ against Old Persian *asman* ‘sky, heaven’ and ON *biminn* ‘sky, heaven’ against *bamarr* ‘cliff, rock’ (Kroonen 2013, pp. 206–207, 220). In the Germanic cosmology the Stoney Heaven was made out of the skull of Yimer, the primordial ettin sacrificed by the Gods (*Vsp* 3–4, *Vafþ* 21, *Grm* 41), and as the ancestor of the Ettins he thus passed his stone-skull on to his descendants.

4 hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Hár-barðr? ‘what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Hoarbeard?’ | This question begins the argument over their respective accomplishments or *mann-jafnaðr* which takes up the bulk of the poem (sts. 16–40). — The metricality of this line and the corresponding *hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Þórr?* is questionable. Both lines are most likely non-metrical prose, but since they do have words that can be taken to alliterate with the names those words have been marked.

[Hár-barðr kvað:] 16 „Vas’k með Fjöl-vari · fimm vetr alla [R 12v/27]
 2 ĩ ey þęiri · es Al-grøn hętir;
 vega vér þar knótum · ok val fęlla,
 4 margs at fręista, · mans at kosta.“

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “I was with Felwar for five winters all
 in that island which is called Allgreen.
 There we did fight and fell the slain;
 many a girl did we tempt and win.”

1 Fjöl-vari ‘Felwar’ | The name is clearly equivalent to the adj. *fjöl-varr* ‘reluctant, very wary’ but is not attested elsewhere.

4 margs at fręista, · mans at kosta ‘many a girl did we tempt and win’ | I read *margs* ‘many a’ as modifying *mans* ‘girl’.

[Þórr kvað:] 17 „Hversu snúnuðu yðr konur yðrar?“ [R 12v/30]

[Quoth Thunder:] “How did your women turn out for you?”

1 snúnuðu ‘turn out’ | A rare verb only found in poetry.

[Hár-barðr kvað:] **18** „Sparkar óttum vér konur · ef oss at spökum yrði;
 2 horskar óttum vér konur · ef oss hollar véri,
 þér ór sandi · síma undu
 4 ok ór dali djúpum
 grund of grófu;
 6 varð’k þeim einn öllum · øfri at róðum;
 hvílda’k hjá þeim systurum sjau
 8 ok hafða’k gæð þeira allt ok gaman;
 hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Þórr?“

[R 12v/30]

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “We had smart women if they were to our enjoyment;
 we had wise women if they were hold toward us.
 Out of sand they wound a string
 and out of a deep dale
 dug up the ground.
 I alone became superior to them all in counsel;
 I rested by those sisters seven
 and had their senses all, and pleasure—
 what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Thunder?”

ALL | The sense of the whole stanza, but especially ll. 3–5, is quite unclear. If it is referring to a specific myth it is wholly lost. If we take it to be a astrological analogy (cf. st. 19/2–5) then the seven sisters may tentatively be identified

3 þér ór sandi · síma undu ‘Out of sand they wound a string’ | Unclear. If it is to be understood that they spun string out of sand that is clearly a reference to some sort of magic.

8 gæð þeira allt ok gaman ‘their senses all, and pleasure’ | Formulaic word-pair, occurring in *Háv* 99/4 and 162/2.

Þórr kvað: **19** „Ek drap Þjatsa, · hinn þrúð-móðga jotun,
 2 upp ek varp augum · All-valda sonar
 á þann inn heïða himin;
 4 þau ’ro merki mest · minna verka,
 þau’s allir menn síðan of séa;
 6 hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Hár-barðr?“

[R 13r/2, A 1r/1]

Quoth Thunder: “I slew Thedse, the strength-minded ettin;
 I threw up the eyes of Allwald’s son [= Thedse]
 onto the clear heaven.
 Those are the greatest marks of my works,
 those which all men since do see—
 what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Hoarbeard?”

4 minna | *From this word forwards the poem is also attested in A.* 5 síðan | *om. A*

ALL | For the slaying of Thedse, cf. *Lok* 50 n. In this stanza we seem to have a rare example of native Germanic star-lore. TODO: is the exact constellation identifiable?

Hár-barðr kvað: 20 „Miklar man-vélar · hafða'k við myrk-riður
2 þá's ek vélta þér frá verum.
Harðan jötun · hugða'k Hlé·barð vesa;
4 gaf hann mér gamban-tēin
en ek vélta hann ór viti.“

[R 13r/5, A 1r/1]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “Great girl-tricks I had against mirk-rideresses
when I lured them away from men.
A hard ettin I judged Leebeard to be;
he gave me a gombentoe
but I tricked him out of his wits.”

1 myrk-riður ‘mirk-rideresses’ | The *riður* ‘rideresses, fevers’ were witches thought to torment people and cause disease and delirium. See *Háv* 156 for discussion.

2 frá verum ‘from men’ | Alternatively ‘from their husbands’, but that makes less sense in the context of rideresses who are out tormenting mankind, not consorting with their husbands. For *verar* ‘men, husbands’ in the general sense ‘mankind’ cf. st. 53/3 below, *Lok* 24/3.

3 Hlé·barð ‘Leebeard’ | *blé* ‘lee, calm, shelter (from bad weather)’ + *barðr* ‘beard’, an otherwise unattested ettin. For alternative explanations of the first element see note to *Pul Óðins* 4/1: *Hléfjörð* in *SkP* 3.

4 gamban-tēin ‘gombentoe’ | An unknown magical object also occurring in *Ski* 32/2. Etymologically it is clearly some type of stick (*tēinn* ‘stick, branch’), perhaps for carving runes into.

pórr kvað: 21 „Illum huga launaðir þú þá góðar gjafar.“

[R 13r/7, A 1r/3]

Quoth Thunder: “With an evil heart didst thou then repay the good gifts.”

1 þá | *om. A*

Hár-barðr kvað: 22 „Þat hefir eik · es af annarri skęfr;
2 umb sik es hvęrr i s·líku—
hvat vannt-u þá meðan, þórr?“

[R 13r/8, A 1r/4]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “An oak has that which it chafes from another;
it is every man for himself in such matters—
what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Thunder?”

1 Þat hefir eik · es af annarri skęfr ‘An oak has that which it chafes from another’ | Proverbial, also appearing in *Mbkv* 26/3a.

pórr kvað: 23 „Ek vas austr · ok jętna barða'k

[R 13r/9, A 1r/4]

2 brúðir bǫl-vísar · es til bjargs gingu;
 mikil myndi étt jǫtna · ef allir lifði,
 4 vétr myndi manna · undir Mið-garði—
 hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Hár-barðr?

Quoth Thunder: “I was in the east and bashed Ettins,
 bale-wise brides who were walking to a mountain.
 Great would the lineage of Ettins be if they all lived;
 naught would remain of men within Middenyard—
 what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Hoarbeard?”

ALL | Thunder here makes a moral response to Hoarbeard's egoism as expressed in the previous stanza. In the religion, Thunder is the defender of the Gods and Middenyard (the home of Men) against the Ettins, for which cf. *Vsp* 25, 53, *Þrk* 18. For Thunder's killing of ettin-women in particular cf. sts. 37–39 below, *Eddbr* VI, and Lindow (1988).

Hár-barðr kvað: 24 „Vas'k á Val-landi · ok vígum fylgðá'k,
 2 atta ek jǫfrum · en aldri sétta'k;
 Óðinn á jarla · þá's i val falla
 4 en Þórr á þrēla kyn.“

[R 13r/11, A 1r/6]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “I was in Walland and followed wars;
 I incited princes and never reconciled them.
 Weden owns the earls which fall among the slain—
 but Thunder owns the race of thralls.”

ALL | Weden brushes off Thunder's moralism and instead expresses a characteristic aristocratic disregard for lower life and life as mere life. Where the altruistic Thunder boasts of protecting mankind, the ambivalent Weden sarcastically responds that he incited war and conflict in order to take the best of them for himself.

1 Val-landi ‘Walland’ | The normal term for France in ON, originally referring to Roman Gaul. The idea of continental Europe as particularly war-torn certainly goes back to the Migration Period; cf. the similar view about the Gots in *Vsp* 30/2, *Vkv* 1.

3 Óðinn á ‘Weden owns’ | For Weden's ‘owning’ of men see *Vsp* 23 n.

4 Þórr á þrēla kyn ‘Thunder owns the race of thralls’ | This has been connected (TODO: cite) with the sacrifice of prisoners and criminals to Thunder, which, if true, would support a pre-Christian origin for the poem, as such an allusion would soon fade out of relevance following the Conversion.

Þórr kvað: 25 „Ó-jafnt skipta · es þú myndir með ǫsum liði
 2 ef þú éttir vil=gi mikils vald.“

[R 13r/13, A 1r/8]

Quoth Thunder: “Unfairly wouldst thou deal out troops amidst the Eese
 if thou hadst unrestrained power.”

1 ǫsum | ása A

Hár-barðr kvað: 26 „Þórr á afl órit · en ekki hjarta;

[R 13r/14, A 1r/9]

- 2 af hrēðslu ok hug-bleyði · vas þér í handska troðit
ok þótti=sk=a þú þá Þórr vesa;
4 hvár=ki þú þá þorðir · fyr hrēðslu þinni
hnjósa né fisa · svát Fjalarr heyrði.“

Quoth Hoarbeard: “Thunder has ample strength but little heart.
Out of fear and heart-softness wast thou driven into a glove
and didst not then seem to be Thunder.
Thou daredst neither for thy fear
sneeze nor fart lest Feller should hear.”

2 vas þér | þér vas R 5 hnjósa né fisa ‘sneeze or fart’ | fisa né hnjósa ‘fart or sneeze’ A

ALL | The story to which this stanza alludes is also hinted at in *Lok* 60 and told in full in *Gylf* 45:5–16: Lock, Thunder, and his servants Thelvé and Wrash had journeyed east for a long time and the day was drawing late when they found before them a great hall, with an opening on one end as wide as the building itself. They took lodgings inside, but in the middle of the night they were awakened by a great earthquake. Thunder rose and led the party into a side-room to the right in the middle of the hall. He stood closest to the opening with his hammer ready while the terrified others cowered further inside; so they stood for the whole night and heard great noise outside. At daybreak they left the building and found the huge ettin Shrimir asleep outside. His snoring had caused the earthquakes and noise, and the house was his mitten; the side-room was its thumb.

5 Fjalarr ‘Feller’ | To be identified with Shrimir in *Lok* 60 and *Gylf* 45. The use of an alternative name for the same figure suggests a variant tradition and strengthens the idea that *Hárþ* is not an antiquarian product.

- þórr kvað: 27 „Hár·barðr inn ragi, · ek munda þik í hæl drepa
2 ef ek mætta seila=sk of sund.“

[R 13r/17, A 1r/11]

Quoth Thunder: “Hoarbeard the queer, I would strike thee into Hell
if I could sail o’er the sound!”

2 sund | sundit A

- Hár·barðr kvað: 28 „Hvat skyldir of sund seila=sk · es sakir ’ro alls øngar?
2 Hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Þórr?“

[R 13r/18, A 1r/12]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “Why shouldst thou sail o’er the sound when there are no charges at all?
What didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Thunder?”

1 skyldir | skalt-u A 1 sakir | sakar A

- þórr kvað: 29 „Ek vas austr · ok ó’na varða’k
2 þá’s mik sóttu þeir Svárangs synir;
grjóti mik þorðu, · gagni urðu þó lítt fegnir,
4 þó urðu mik fyrri · friðar at biðja—
hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Hár·barðr?“

[R 13r/19, A 1r/13]

Quoth Thunder: “I was in the east and guarded the river
when I was set upon by Sweering’s sons.
With rocks they bashed me, yet in victory rejoiced little;
yet they sooner had to beg for peace—
what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Hoarbeard?”

2 mik sóttu þeir | þeir sóttu mik A 3 þó | om. A

Hár-barðr kvað: 30 „Ek vas austr · ok við ein-hverja dómða’k,
2 lék’k við ina lín-hvítu · ok laun-þing háða’k,
gladda’k ina goll-björtu, · gamni mér unði.“

[R 13r/22, A 1r/15]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “I was in the east and flirted with a certain someone;
I played with the linen-white one and held secret trysts:
I gladdened the gold-bright one—the maiden enjoyed pleasure.”

1 ein-hverja | ein-hverju A 2 lín-hvítu | so A; lind-hvítu ‘linden-white’ R 2 laun-þing ‘secret trysts’ | so A; laung þing ‘long trysts’ R 3 goll-björtu ‘gold-bright’ | goll-hvítu ‘gold-white’ A

ALL | Weden’s answer is sarcastic and subverts a common Norse literary trope where men who stay at home with women are presented as cowardly and soft against those who “go out” to wage war (e.g. Þhorn *Harkv* 6 in SkP 1).

1 ein-hverja ‘a certain someone’ | The A reading *ein-hverju* looks like the acc. sg. of an otherwise unattested **ein-berja*, f. of *ein-beri* ‘Oneharrier’ and perhaps a synonym for a walkirie.

Þórr kvað: 31 „Góð óttuð ér man-kynni þar þá.“

[R 13r/24, A 1r/17]

Quoth Thunder: “Then ye had good experiences with the girls there.”

1 óttuð ér | so (‘óttu þér’) A; óttu þeir ‘ye bad’ R 1 man-kynni | mann-kynni (‘man’, with erroneous macron above the n) A

1 Góð óttuð ér man-kynni þar þá. | Thunder is once again distracted by Weden’s mention of women; cf. st. 17 above. — The line is clearly prose.

Hár-barðr kvað: 32 „Liðs þíns véra’k þá þurfi, Þórr, · at ek hefda þeiri inni lín-hvítu
mey.“

[R 13r/24, A 1r/17]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “I might have needed thy aid then, Thunder, that I might have held that linen-white maiden.”

1 véra’k | vas’k A

Þórr kvað: 33 „Ek mynda þér þá þat vęita · ef ek viðr of kóm=umk.“

[R 13r/25, A 1r/18]

Quoth Thunder: “I would then have offered it to thee, if I were able.”

1 þá þat | þat þá A 1 kóm=umk | so (‘kæmvmz’) A; kómist R

Hár·barðr kvað: **34** „Ek mynda þér þá trúa, · nema mik ì tryggð véltir.“ [R 13r/26, A 1r/18]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “I would then have trusted thee, if thou wouldst not have betrayed my trust.”

Þórr kvað: **35** „Em’k=at ek sá hël-bitr · sem húð-skór forn á vár.“ [R 13r/27, A 1r/19]

Quoth Thunder: “I am not such a heel-biter as an old hide-shoe in spring.”

1 Em’k=at ek sá hël-bitr · sem húð-skór forn á vár ‘I am not such a heel-biter as an old hide-shoe in spring’ | Likely proverbial; a heel-biter is someone who betrays his companions, and the old shoe-leather becomes stiff over the winter.

Hár·barðr kvað: **36** „Hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Þórr?“ [R 13r/28, A 1r/20]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “What didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Thunder?”

Þórr kvað: **37** „Brúðir ber-sęrkja · barða’k ì Hlés-ęyju;
2 þér hofðu vęrst unnit, · vélta þjóð alla.“ [R 13r/28, A 1r/20]

Quoth Thunder: “The brides of bearsęrks I bashed in Leeseý; they had done the worst thing; tricked the whole people.”

1 Hlés-ęyju | Hlés-ęy A

1 Hlés-ęyju ‘Leeseý’ | Læsø in Denmark. This island figures in mythology. TODO.

Hár·barðr kvað: **38** „Klęki vannt-u þá, Þórr, · es þú á konum barðir.“ [R 13r/29, A 1r/21]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “A disgrace didst thou accomplish, Thunder, when thou bashedst women!”

1 á | ‘ę’ with small corr. above A

Þórr kvað: **39** „Vargynjur vöru þér · ęn var=la konur,
2 skęlldu skip mitt · es skorðat hafða’k,
ógðu mér járn-lurki · ęn ęltu þjálfa—
4 hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Hár·barðr?“ [R 13r/30, A 1r/22]

Quoth Thunder: “She-wolves were they, but hardly women.
They overturned my ship which I had propped up,
terrorised me with iron cudgels and chased Thelvé around—
what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Hoarbeard?”

1 vöru þér | þat vöru A 3 mér | add. þęim A

Hár·barðr kvað: **40** „Ek vas’k ì hęr’num · es hingat gørði=sk [R 13r/32, A 1r/23]

2 gnéfa gunn-fana, · geir at rjóða.“

Quoth Hoarbeard: “I was in the host which readied itself hither to raise the war-standard, to redden the spear.”

Þórr kvað: 41 „Þess vilt-u nú geta, es þú fórt oss ò-ljúfan at bjóða!“

[R 13v/1, A 1r/24]

Quoth Thunder: “That wilt thou now bring up—that thou didst set out to bring hatred against us!”

1 ò-ljúfan | ‘óliyfán’ A; †olubann† R

ALL | The exchange shifts away from the comparison of deeds.

1 ò-ljúfan ‘hatred’ | Lit. ‘un-lovely’, a rare m. dat. sg. adverbial.

Hár-barðr kvað: 42 „Bóta skal þér þat þá · munda baugi
2 sem jafnendr unnu · þeir’s okkr vilja sétta.“

[R 13v/2, A 1r/25]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “Then I shall repay thee for that with a hand-bigh bestowed by the mediators who wish to reconcile us two.”

1 þat þá | om. A 2 þeir’s okkr vilja sétta | þeir’s okkr vilja sétta hafa A

Þórr kvað: 43 „Hvar namt þessi · in hnófi=ligu orð
2 es heyrðað aldri=gi · in hnófi=ligri?“

[R 13v/3, A 1r/26]

Quoth Thunder: “Where didst thou learn these scornful words when I never heard more scornful ones?”

2 in | so A; om. R

Hár-barðr kvað: 44 „Nam’k at mǫnnum þeim inum aldr-ónum es búa í
heimis-skógum.“

[R 13v/5, A 1r/27]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “I learned them from the elderly men who dwell in the homely forests.”

1 mǫnnum | om. A

Þórr kvað: 45 „Þó gefr þú gótt nafn dysjum, es þú kallar þat heimis-skóga.“

[R 13v/5, A 1v/1]

Quoth Thunder: “Though thou givest a good name to poor cairns when thou callest them ‘homely forests’.”

1 dysjum ‘poor cairns’ | A reference to Weden’s consultation of the dead for knowledge as attested e.g. in *Vsp* and *Bdr*.

Hár-barðor kvað: 46 „Svá dǫmi’k umb s-líkt far.“

[R 13v/6, A 1v/2]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “So do I speak about such matters.”

1 umb | om. A

þórr kvað: 47 „Orð-kringi þin · mun þér illa koma
2 ef ek réð á vág at vaða;
ulfi herra · hygð’k at ópa mynir
4 ef hlýtr af hamri hogg.“

[R 13v/7, A 1v/2]

Quoth Thunder: “Thy glibness of word will bring thee ill
if I decide to wade on the wave.
Louder than a wolf I think thou wilt scream
if thou gettest a strike from the hammer!”

3 at ópa mynir | þik ópa munu A

ALL | This perfectly regular Leeds-meter-stanza marks a sudden shift in the exchange from the previous laconic one-line prose lines. Thunder’s threat of hammer-based violence is paralleled by *Lok* 57–63.

Hár-barðor kvað: 48 „Sif á hó hęima, · hans munt fund vilja,
2 þann munt þrek drýgja, · þat ’s þér skyldara.“

[R 13v/9, A 1v/4]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “Sib has a lover at home; *him* wilt thou wish to seek out;
on *him* wilt thou use thy strength—that is more urgent for thee!”

2 skyldara | skyldra A

1 hó ‘lover’ | Most editors take this acc. sg. word as an alternative form of *bórr* m. ‘adulterer’ (gen. *bórs*), containing the same root as *bóra* f. ‘whore, prostitute’, *bór* n. ‘adultery, fornication’, ModEngl. whore. The *-r* has presumably been reinterpreted as the m. nom. sg. ending, yielding nom. sg. **bór*, gen. sg. **bós*, although neither form is attested. The same accusation is found in *Lok* 54, where Lock says that he has been Sib’s lover (*bórr*).

On formal grounds CV (s.v. *bór*) interpret this word as the unrelated *bór* m. ‘pot-hook’, ‘insinuating that Thor busied himself with cooking and dairy-work.’ If that reading is correct *hans*, *þann* ‘him’ should be translated ‘it’ instead, but the whole thing seems rather unlikely when we consider Thunder’s strong response: ‘I think thou liest’, which fits well against an accusation of his wife’s adultery, not so much about her owning a pot-hook.

þórr kvað: 49 „Méðir þú at munns ráði · svá’t mér skyldi vęrst þikkja,
2 hafr inn hug-blauði, · hygð’k at þú ljúgir.“

[R 13v/10, A 1v/5]

Quoth Thunder: “Thou speakest after thy mouth’s counsel what should seem worst to me—
O heart-soft man, I think thou liest!”

Hár-barðor kvað: 50 „Satt hygð’k mik sęgja, · sęinn est at fęr þinni,

[R 13v/12, A 1v/6]

2 langt myndir nú kominn, Þórr, · ef þú litum fyrir.“

Quoth Hoarheard: “I think I speak truly. Thou art late on thy journey;
far wouldst thou have come by now, Thunder, if thou hadst changed colour.”

1 mik | þik A

2 litum fyrir ‘changed colour’ | An unclear expression, probably metaphorically ‘if thou hadst not been so stubborn’.

Þórr kvað: 51 „Hár-barðr inn ragi, · heldr hefir nú mik dvalðan!“

[R 13v/14, A 1v/8]

Quoth Thunder: “Hoarheard the queer, greatly hast thou now delayed me!”

1 dvalðan | dvalit A

Hár-barðr kvað: 52 „Ása-Þórs · hugða’k aldri=gi myndu
2 glæpja fē-hirði farar.“

[R 13v/14, A 1v/8]

Quoth Hoarheard: “The journeys of Thunder of the Eese I never thought
a shepherd would divert.”

1 Ása-Þórs | Ása-Þór A

1 Ása-Þórs ‘Thunder of the Eese’ | A reverent, majestic epithet, here used sarcastically, i.e., ‘the high and mighty Thunder’.

Þórr kvað: 53 „Ráð mun’k þér nú ráða: · ró hingat báti’num,
2 hëttum hótingi, · hitt fōður Magna!“

[R 13v/15, A 1v/9]

Quoth Thunder: “I will now counsel thee a counsel: row the boat hither;
let us cease the taunting; meet the father of Main [= Thunder = me]!”

Hár-barðr kvað: 54 „Far þú firr sundi, · þér skal fars synja!“

[R 13v/17, A 1v/10]

Quoth Hoarheard: “Go far away from the sound; passage shall be denied thee!”

1 firr | frá A

Þórr kvað: 55 „Visa þú mér nú leið’ina, · alls þú vill mik eigi of vág’inn ferja.“

[R 13v/17, A 1v/11]

Quoth Thunder: “Show me now the way, since thou wilt not ferry me o’er the wave.”

1 nú | om. A

Hár-barðr kvað: 56 „Lítit ’s at synja, · langt ’s at fara;

[R 13v/18, A 1v/11]

- 2 stund 's til stokks'ins, · qnnur til stęins'ins,
halt svá til vinstra vegs'ins · und's þú hittir Ver-land;
4 þar mun Fjörgyn · hitta Þór, son sinn,
ok mun hōn ķenna hōnum ǫttunga brautir · til Óðins landa."

Quoth Hoarbeard: "It is little to deny. It is long to journey:
an hour to the log, another to the stone.
Hold so to the left road until thou findest Wereland;
there will Firgyn find Thunder, her son,
and she will show him the ancestral roads to Weden's lands [= Osyard]."

1 at | om. R 2 stokks'ins | stokks A 2 stęins'ins | stęins A 3 vegs'ins | vegs A 3 Ver-land
'Wereland' | Valland A

3 Ver-land 'Wereland' | The 'Land of Men'.

4 Fjörgyn 'Firgyn' | Another name for Earth, Thunder's mother.

Þórr kvað: 57 „Mun'k taka þangat ĩ dag?“

[R 13v/22, A 1v/14]

Quoth Thunder: "Will I get thither today?"

1 ĩ dag | á dęgi A

Hár-barðr kvað: 58 „Taka við vıl ok ęrfiði · at upp-vesandi sólu
2 es ek get þána.“

[R 13v/22, A 1v/14]

Quoth Hoarbeard: "[Thou wilt] get thither with toil and hardship by the rising of the sun,
as I believe it is thawing."

1 ok | við A 1 upp-vesandi | upp-rennandi A

Þórr kvað: 59 „Skammt mun nú mál okkat vesa, · alls þú mér skótingu ęinni
svarar;
2 launa mun'k þér far-synjun · ef vit fínum=sk ĩ sinn annat.“

[R 13v/23, A 1v/15]

Quoth Thunder: "Short will now our speech be since thou answerest me with scoffing alone.
I will reward thee for this ferry-denial if we meet another time!"

Hár-barðr kvað: 60 „Far þú nú þar's þik hafi allan gramir!“

[R 13v/25, A 1v/17]

Quoth Hoarbeard: "Go now whither the fiends may have thee whole!"

ALL | The speaker is uncertain. This line is introduced with the speech marker 'H. q.' (= Hár-barðr kvað 'Quoth Hoarbeard') in A; in R it belongs to 59 and is thus spoken by Thunder. Since it seems more likely for a speech marker to be dropped than erroneously added the A reading is preferred.

1 þik hafi allan gramir ‘the fiends may have thee whole’ | The *gramir* ‘fiends’, lit. ‘wroth, cross ones’ are (male) demons. The adjective *gramr* is commonly used specifically with a connotation of divine wrath and they may thus be supernatural avengers for severe crimes. The same curse is found in *Grm* P1 with *smyl* for *gramir* and in related form in *Brot* 10.

Lay of Hymer

(*Hymis kviða*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.694)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Lay of Hymer** (*Hym*) comedically narrates how the gods Thunder and Tew go on an adventure into Ettinland in order to fetch a great cauldron, and how Thunder pulls up the Middenyardswyrm with his fishing pole.

Textual preservation and transmission

Hym attested in both **R** and **A**. The two mss. agree very well with each other; they share the same stanzas in the same order. The most substantial difference is the title; **A** has *Hymis kviða* ‘the lay of Hymer’ while **R** instead has *Þórr dró Mið-garðs-orm* ‘Thunder pulled the Middenyardswyrm’.

The story

Hym belongs to a genre of comedic stories about Thunder’s adventures in Ettinland. These stories all see Thunder set out from Osyard followed by one or more companions. Together the party undergoes various fantastical tests and hardships on their way through the Ettinhomes, and return home after Thunder has slaughtered yet another Ettin clan. The popularity of this genre is seen by the large number of stories belonging to it. In the Poetic Edda is also represented by *Þrk* and to some extent *Hárþ*. Other examples are Thunder’s journey to Outyards-Lock in *Gylf* 44–47, his fight with Thedse in *Skm* 2–3 and *Haustrl* 2–13, his fight with Rungner in *Skm* 24 and *Haustrl* 14–20, and his journey to Garfrith in *Skm* 26 (in which two sts. are cited; see *Eddbr* VI).

The otherness of the Ettins

In these stories the Ettins are very much an *other* to the Gods, and this is something which *Hym* strongly emphasizes:

- The Ettins live in the far east (st. 5) in an inhospitable, frozen climate (st. 10) of mountains (sts. 2, 17) and lavafields (sts. 36, 38);
- they are physically deviant: misshapen (st. 10), grey-haired (st. 16), many-headed (sts. 8, 35), having heads harder than stone (sts. 30–31);
- they are likened to apes (st. 20), whales (st. 36) and Danes (st. 17, see note!);
- they are stingy and inhospitable (sts. 9, 16);
- they are snide and cowardly (sts. 19–20, 25–26, 28–32).

These traits of the Ettins stand in direct opposition to the Old Germanic social norms as represented and upheld by the Gods, who live in a lush green land and are young, beautiful, generous, and brave. The one exception in the poem is Tew's mother in st. 8, who is blonde, beautiful and hospitable. The mother of a god should also be godlike, and this likely reflects the broader motif of a beautiful ettin-woman who is taken by a god, for which cf. the st. 8 n. and *Skí* above.

As natural inferiors and a threat to the social order the Ettins must be subjugated by the Gods, and the agent of this is Thunder. Throughout the poem he recurrently humiliates the ettins Eagre and Hymer through completing their various challenges and performing tests of strength. These tests follow a similar outline: Thunder is given a dangerous or near-impossible challenge but accomplishes it anyway with surprising ease through a combination of brawn and brain to the humiliation of the challenger. The challenges consist of finding an enormously large kettle (st. 3, explicitly called Eagre's "revenge"), wrestling one of Hymer's oxen for bait (sts. 17–18), carrying home Hymer's whales and boat (st. 26), breaking Hymer's finest chalice (st. 28), and perhaps also taking away the cauldron (st. 33)—though that may just be Hymer wishing to finally be rid of the pestering gods.

In the end Thunder delivers justice by slaughtering Hymer and his whole clan of many-headed Ettins.

The fishing expedition

At the center of the poem stands Thunder's famous fishing trip, where the god gets the Middenyardswyrm on his hook but ultimately fails to catch it. In this section of *Hym*, especially in sts. 22–24, we find a noticeably more reverent tone than elsewhere in the poem.

Thunder's abortive encounter with the Wyrm was clearly very popular in the Wiking Age and is, apart from *Hym*, also dealt with in five fragmentary

Scaldic poems from the 9th or 10th centuries and extensively in *Gylf* 48:3–31. The story is also represented pictorially on numerous objects from the Wiking Age.

The Scaldic fragments are all found in citations scattered throughout *Skm*, all edited in SkP 3. They are, by descending number of long-lines: Bragi Þórr, *Húsdr* 3–6, EVald Þórr, and Ggnæv Þórr, *Qlv Þórr*.

In their present state none of these fragments are complete narratives, but mainly focus on the scene of Thunder in the boat facing off against the hooked Wyrms pressed against the gunwale. From what little we can glean from them they also disagree on the course of events. In Bragi Þórr 6 the encounter ends when the cowardly Hymer cuts the fishing line and the Wyrms sink back unscathed into the sea in *Húsdr* 6 and probably also Ggnæv Þórr 1 Thunder strikes the head off the Wyrms with his hammer Millner.

Other than *Hym* the only complete retelling of the myth is found in *Gylf* 48:3–31, which may be summarized as follows:

Thunder goes out alone into Middenyard in the shape of a young man (*ungr drengr*) without his goats and chariot. In the evening he comes to the ettin Hymer and asks to stay the night. At dawn Hymer plans to go fishing and Thunder asks to join him. Hymer says that Thunder will not be of much help since he is “small and but a young man” (*lítill ok ung-menni eitt*), and warns him that he usually takes long and arduous trips. Thunder, angered, says that he will row very far, and then asks Hymer what bait they will use. Hymer tells him to find it himself, and so he turns to his flock of oxen; he tears off the head from the greatest ox, one called Heavenrid (*Himin-brjóðr*). The two go out to sea, and Thunder rows far past Hymer’s usual fishing waters. Hymer, unhappy, warns him that if they row any further out they will be in danger of the Middenyardswyrm, but Thunder keeps on. After some time he puts down the oars, readies his fishing line, hooks the ox-head and lowers it. The Wyrms soon bites, and struggles so hard that Thunder is pressed against the gunwale. In rage he brings himself into his Os-might (*ós-megin*) and pulls back with such force that his feet go through the bottom of the ship and press into the seabed. The Wyrms’s head goes up against the gunwale. The two enemies ferociously stare at each other, Thunder “sharpening his eyes” and the Wyrms spitting venom. Hymer is frightened, reaches for his bait-cutting knife, and cuts the line—the Wyrms then sinks back into the sea. Thunder throws his hammer after it, “and men say that he struck off the monster’s head, but I think it true to tell thee that the Middenyardswyrm still lives and is lying in the outer sea.” Thunder gives Hymer a punch to the ear so that he flies headfirst overboard; the god then wades back to land.

Snorre’s account is clearly based on multiple sources, certainly including the Scaldic fragments he himself cites in *Skm*. It is hard to say whether Snorre had access to *Hym*; the closest verbal agreement is when it is said in *Gylf* 48:22 that *Mið-garðs-ormr gein yfir uxa-höfuð’it, en öngull’inn vá í göm’inn orm’inum* ‘The Middenyardswyrm snapped at the ox-head and the

hook went into the roof of the wyrm's mouth', which has some resemblance to st. 22.

Some details in *Gylf* 48 not found in *Hym* must derive from now-lost texts available to Snorre; most famously the detail of Thunder's feet going through the boat is also found on the Swedish Altuna stone and the Danish Hørdum stone (but see note to st. 34/2 below). The name of the ox Heavenrid is attested in thules listing names of oxen.

In addition to the literary sources there are also numerous pictorial depictions of the myth from the Wiking Age. These are the Swedish runestones from Altuna (U 1611, figure 4, p. 271) and Linga (Sö 352), several Jutlandic picture stones from Hørdum, a Cumbrian picture stone from Gosforth, and the Gotlandic picture stone GP 21 from Ardre church. The images depict the same scene as the Scaldic fragments: Thunder stands in the boat above the hooked Wyrm, often depicted as a fish; next to him is one companion. Some of them have additional details like the use of the ox-head for bait (U 1611, Sö 352), Thunder's foot going through the boat (U 1611, Hørdum), or Thunder raising his hammer (U 1611).

More broadly, Thunder's fishing reflects the archetypal fight (the *Chaoskampf*) between the Storm-God and the Dragon, as found in a great many mythologies. Important examples of this include Vedic *Índra* and *Vṛtrá* (*RV* 1.32 et c.), Babylonian *Marduk* and *Tiamat* (*Enūma Eliš* TODO), Greek *Zeús* (*Zeús*) and *Tūphôn* (*Tūphôn*), Hebrew YHWH and Leviathan (TODO: references). With these analogies in mind it seems that the versions where Thunder slays the Wyrm reflect an older layer of Germanic mythology, before the lethal fight between Thunder and the Wyrm had been transposed to the End Times (see *Vsp* 53).

Hym as a composite

The narrative of *Hym* can be subdivided into the following episodes:

1. Sts. 1–6: The Gods wish to drink ale and Thunder goes to Eagre to force him to brew it; Eagre in turn asks for a cauldron big enough to brew enough ale for all the Gods.
2. 7–16: Thunder and Tew go to visit Tew's father, the stingy ettin Hymer, who owns such a cauldron; horrified at Thunder's great appetite during the evening he tells them that they must go fishing for food.
3. 17–19: Thunder says that he will do it, if he is given bait; Hymer challenges him to kill one of his oxen; Thunder tears off the head from one of them.
4. 20–25: The three go fishing; Hymer pulls up some whales; with the ox-head as bait Thunder manages to hook the Middenyardswyrm itself; he loses it.

5. 26–27: Hymer challenges Thunder to carry the boat and whales back to his farm; he does.
6. 28–32: Hymer challenges Thunder to break a supposedly indestructible chalice; he succeeds by smashing it against the ettin's forehead.
7. 33–36: Thunder and Tew depart with the cauldron; they find themselves followed by Hymer and his ettins; Thunder kills them all.
8. 37–38: One of Thunder's goats goes halt.
9. 39: Thunder returns to the Gods with Hymer's cauldron; they host a banquet.

The fishing expedition found in the Scaldic fragments and *Gylf* 48 is represented by episodes 3–4. *Hym* is the only source to place the fishing expedition within the broader context of Thunder and Tew obtaining a cauldron from Hymer for the sake of brewing ale (episodes 1–2, 9).

It seems inescapable, both on the basis of the other Norse sources and broader comparative mythology, that both the frame narrative and the additional episodes (e.g. number 8) originally had nothing to do with Thunder's encounter with the Wyrn. They have in any case been woven together into a single narrative, probably by the poet himself, for the sake of a more entertaining story for an audience which was likely expecting certain common "Thunder's journey" tropes.

Although the poem is skilfully written this weaving-together has not been entirely successful and has resulted in a few loose threads. The halt goat of sts. 37–38 (episode 8) finds a parallel in *Gylf* 44:17–21 where it serves as the origin story of Thunder's two child servants Thelvé and Wrash who accompany him on the way to Outyards-Lock. These two children play an important part in the narrative of *Gylf* 44–47, but in *Hym* are an entirely superfluous detail—something the poet himself anticipates in his address to the audience. It is also strange that Lock should appear so late in the poem when he is not mentioned before or after; he too plays an important role in the Outyards-Lock story of *Gylf* 44–47.

A major superfluous element is the god Tew, who plays no role at all in the fishing expedition. He is last alluded to in st. 16 where Hymer speaks of "[us] three", only to reappear in st. 33 where he fails to lift the cauldron. It is also rather strange that Tew shows no reaction to the murder of Hymer, his father, taking place right before his eyes (sts. 35–36), but for the paternity cf. *Hym* 5/3 n.

The simplest explanation for this is however that Tew originally had nothing to do with the encounter between Thunder and the Wyrn, and within the confines of *Hym* mainly serves to segue from the narrative of the cauldron-fetching to the fishing expedition. Strong support for this is found in the fact that Thunder in the other variants of the fishing-story only has one companion—Hymer. These variants include the pictorial depictions, which only show two figures seated in the boat.

Style

When speaking of a composite poem, one must distinguish between a text where several originally separate works have been put together mostly unchanged, and a text composed by a single author drawing from multiple narrative sources. A likely example of the former is *Háv*, but *Hym* undoubtedly belongs to the latter category.

Hym has a distinct style and rhythm throughout which stands alone in the Poetic Edda. Indeed, the sharpest stylistic contrast is with the poem most similar content-wise, *Þrk*. Where *Þrk* is written in a rustic style with fairly loose Ancient-words-law meter, repeats lines and even whole stanzas, *Hym* instead uses an unusually strict meter, avoids repetition, and revels in kennings, difficult grammatical constructions, and highly unnatural word order (see especially sts. 16/3–4, 20, and 39/3–4). These are all traits one associates more closely with Scaldic poetry in complex measures like Court-spoken meter than with Eddic poetry in Ancient-words-law, and it seems certain that the anonymous poet of *Hym* must have had some training in the Scaldic art and familiarity with compositions in that genre. Two kennings (17/4a *brjótr berg-Dana*, 22/4 *umb-gjörð allra landa*) are even shared identically with Scaldic poems in Court-spoken meter.

Meter and stanza

Hym consists of 152 long-lines divided into 39 stanzas. The typical length of a stanza is 4 lines (32/39 sts.: 1–5, 7–10, 12–23, 28–35, 37–39). Deviant stanzas with 2 lines (1 st.: 6), 3 lines (4 sts.: 24–26, 36), and 5 lines (2 sts.: 11, 27) are also represented. The 4-line stanzas generally have a semantic division between ll. 2 and 3 and thus consist of two helmings.

Of the deviant stanzas, st. 6 appears to represent an isolated helming and is thus likely missing two lines. 2/4 3-line sts. (24 and 25) are clearly corrupt owing to syntactical issues; on the other hand the 2 others (26 and 36) show no obvious corruption. The 2 5-line stanzas do not seem to be missing any lines; in both of them one may identify an additional fifth line (11/1, 27/5) which could be removed without hindering the form of the other 4, although that is not to say that these lines are necessarily later inserts. To conclude, the original *Hym* most likely only tolerated 4-line sts., with occasional exceptions for 5-line stanzas with a marked fifth line.

The meter of *Hym* is Ancient-words-law, but of a stricter variant than that of any other poem in the Poetic Edda; this is especially true when it comes to the count and weight of syllables. Three-syllable lines are rare, and the ones that do exist can all be corrected by restoring older hiatus forms (see note to 23/1b below). The poet also has a notable tendency to avoid lines of type C1 (xP#Px) where both stresses are heavy, something shared with Scaldic poems in Lay-meter and with Eyel's Headransom. This probably explains his unique tendency to place the two-syllable preposition *fyrir* 'before, in front, (up) ahead' at the end of the b-verse (never the a-verse), which he does 6 times—more frequently than in any other Ancient-words-law poem of the Poetic Edda.



Figure 4: Detail of Thunder on the Altuna stone. Viking Age, ca. 1000 CE. © Bengt A. Lundberg, RAÄ. CC BY 4.0. <https://pub.raa.se/dokumentation/a4396e83-dac1-4f69-9cab-ff877da64e8d>

Text

The Lay of Hymer

- 1 Ár val-tívar · vęiðar nómu
 2 ok sumbl-samir · áðr saðir yrði,
 hristu tęina · ok á hlaut sǫu,
 4 fundu at Ēgis · ør-kost hvera.

[R 13v/26, A 5v/25]

OF YORE THE SLAIN-TEWS (Gods) had caught game,
 and, assembled at the simble before they might eat,
 they shook the twigs and looked upon the leat;
 they found at Eagre's a great choice of cauldrons.

1 val-tívar 'slain-Tews' | The Gods, a rare epithet only otherwise found in *Vsp* 50/2, 59/4 (n).

1 vęiðar 'game' | The root *vęið-* may refer both to hunting/catching food more broadly and to fishing specifically, although the latter sense predominates and is certainly the way it is used in 10/2 and 16/4 below.

2 sumbl-samir 'assembled at the simble' | A simble being a drinking-feast or banquet. For the simble of the Gods see *Grm* 37/6, 46/4-5, *Lok* (*passim*).

2 áðr saðir yrði 'before they might eat' | Lit. 'might become sated'.

3 hristu tęina · ok á hlaut sǫu 'they shook the twigs and looked upon the leat' | The Gods performed an augury, the details of which are not clear from this line alone. The term *hlaut* 'leat' is explained in *HákGóð* and *Eb* as the sacrificial blood of the slaughtered beasts, which was sprinkled by means of *hlaut-tęinar* 'leat-twigs'. These two words are also found together in an OE glossary, where *tân-blyta* 'twig-allotter' glosses Latin *sortilegus*. Etymologically ON *hlaut* is identical to OS *blôt* 'lot' (*Heli* 5547b), Gothic *blauts* 'lot, inheritance' (Streitberg 1910, p. 58). If we trust these sources the simplest explanation is that the Gods sprinkled the animal blood and interpreted the patterns. In any case they found it most auspicious to feast at Eagre's.

4 Ēgis 'Eagre's' | *Ēgir* 'Eagre' is the spirit of the Sea, an ettin.

- 2 Sat berg-búi · barn-tęitr fyrir,
 2 mjǫk g-líkr męgi · Miskur-blinda,
 lęit i augu · Yggs barn i þrá:
 4 „þú skalt ǫsum · opt sumbl gǫra!“

[R 13v/28, A 5v/27]

The crag-dweller [ETTIN = Eagre] sat merry like a child ahead,
 much like the son of Misherblind.
 Into his eyes looked Ug's (Weden's) child [= Thunder] defiantly:
 "Thou shalt for the Eese oft make simbles!"

4 gora 'make' | gefa 'give' A

ALL. | Having seen that Eagre has a great store of cauldrons, Thunder visits him and orders him to brew ale for the thirsty Eese.

2 mjök g-líkr megi · Miskur-blinda ‘much like the son of Misherblind’ | An unexplained reference. *Miskur-blindi* ‘Misherblind’ might be another name for Firneet (*Fornjótr*), the father of Eagre (Sea), Lay (*Logi* ‘Fire’), and Wind (*vindr*; *Skm* 35, 36, *Yf*). The line would then be a tautology: “he looked just like the son his father”.

- 3 Qnn fekk jǫtni · orð-béginns halr,
2 hugði at hefndum · hann nést við goð,
bað Sifjar ver · sér fóra hver,
4 „þann’s ek ǫllum ǫl · yör of heita.“

[R 13v/31, A 5v/29]

Great toil for the ettin the word-peevisish man [= Thunder] caused;
he thought of revenge, soon, against the god.
He bade Sib’s husband [= Thunder] bring him a cauldron,
“that one with which I for you all might warm ale.”

2 hefndum | *composite*; hefnd A; †hefndom† R

ALL | Eagre is upset at the demand but too cowardly to openly challenge Thunder. He instead gets back at him by demanding a single cauldron big enough to supply ale for all the Eesc.

- 4 Né þat mǫttu · mǣrir tívar
2 ok ginn-ręgin · of geta hver=gi,
und’s af tryggðum · Týr Hlór-riða
4 ǫst-ráð mikit · ęinum sagði:

[R 14r/1, A 5v/30]

Yet of one could not the famous Tews
and the Yin-Reins anywhere get hold—
until, out of loyalty, Tew to Lorde
a great loving counsel in private told:

3 Hlór-riða ‘Lorde’ | ‘The Loud/Bellowing Rider’, a name for Thunder.

- 5 „Býr fyr austan · Éli-vága
2 hund-víss Hymir · at himins ęnda;
á minn faðir · móðugr ketil,
4 rúm-brugðinn hver · rastar djúpan.“

[R 14r/3, A 6r/2]

“To the east of the Ilewaves dwells
the hundred-wise Hymer, at heaven’s end.
My father [= Hymer] owns, fierce, a kettle:
a roomy cauldron one rest deep.”

4 rúm-brugðinn | †rumbrygðan† A

1 fyr austan Ēli-vága ‘To the east of the Illeaves’ | According to *Vafþ* 31 the Illeaves were the poisonous wild rivers from which the ettins emerged, and so it makes sense that they would be found in the east, where the ettins dwell. That Hymer should dwell even to the east of the Illeaves then illustrates his unusually ettin-like nature.

For the notion we may compare the Greek Ὠκεανός ‘Ocean’, the world-encircling river, beyond which the world is supernatural and uncanny (*Od* 11.13–22, 155–160). In *Theog* 790–1, Ὠκεανός consists of nine rivers which flow out into the world-sea that surrounds the Earth (cf. West (1966, p. 201)), which has a Norse parallel in the Outer Sea (*Út-haf*), the sea surrounding the Earth in which the Middenyardswyrm dwells (cf. l. 2 n., 22/4 n. below). Like the Middenyardswyrm which bites its tail, so is Ὠκεανός given the epithet ἀπορροός ‘back-flowing, flowing into itself’ (*Il* 18.399, *Od* 20.65, *Theog* 776).

2 hund-viss ‘hundred-wise’ | Alternatively “hound-wise”; the prefix simply means “very”, but the word is used exclusively for ettins, typically in the collocation *bund-viss jotunn* (so *HHj* 25, *Skm* 24, 26, *Gautr* 3, et c.).

2 himins ęnda ‘at heaven’s end’ | The heaven is thought of as a solid dome of stone, the earth as a flat disc (*Vsp* 3 n., *Hárþ* 15 n.) Hymer thus lives at the very edge of the disc, next to the Outer Sea which encircles all lands and in which the Wyrm lies. For another ettin living at the edge of heaven cf. *Vafþ* 37.

3 mǫnn faðir ‘my father’ | A notable detail since Tew is elsewhere called the son of Weden (*Skm* 16) and it would be rather strange for the son of a male ettin to be afforded a place among the Eese due to the Norse patriarchal concern for male lineage. A possible explanation for this discrepancy is if Weden slept with Tew’s mother, the beautiful woman of st. 8, which would be an instance of the motif of a god mating with a beautiful ettin-woman as seen e.g. in *Ski*.

[Þórr kvað:] 6 „Veitst, ef þiggjum · þann lög-velli?“

[R 14r/4, A 6r/4]

[Týr kvað:] 2 „Ef, vinr, vélar · vit gørum till!“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Knowest thou if we’ll get that liquid-boiler [CAULDRON]?” —

[Quoth Tew:] “If, friend, we two make use of wiles!”

ALL | Like elsewhere in this poem the speakers are not indicated, but it is most sensible that Thunder asks and Tew answers.

7 Föru drjúgum · dag frá-liga
2 Ös-garði frá · und’s til Egils kvömu;
hirði hafra · horn-gofgasta;
4 hurfu at hóllo · es Hymir átti.

[R 14r/5, A 6r/4]

They journeyed far, swiftly at day,
away from Osyard until they came to Eyel;
he took care the he-goats noblest of horns—
they turned to the hall which Hymer owned.

1 dag frá-liga ‘swiftly at day’ | so A; dag þann framm ‘on that day forth’ (unmetrical) R. 2 Egils ‘Eyel’ | so R; Egils ‘Eagre’ A.

1 dag frá-liga ‘swiftly at day’ | Finnur Jónsson (1932) proposes the emendation *dag þann framan* ‘from the beginning of the day’, but since A has a metrically sufficient reading its form is adopted here.

2 Egils ‘Eyel’ | The reading of A is probably from confusion with the ettin Eagre, who is mentioned earlier in the poem. Eyel, who takes Thunder’s goats in possession, is not otherwise known. He may perhaps be identified with the farmer in *Gylf* 44:10–21, for which see Note to st. 37 below.

- 8 Mǫgr fann ǫmmu, · mjök leiða sér, [R 14r/7, A 6r/6]
 2 hafði hǫfða · hundruð níu,
 ęn ǫnnur gekk · al-gollin framm
 4 brún-hvít bera · bjór-vęig syni:

The lad [= Tew] found his grandmother very loathsome;
 of heads she had nine hundred.
 But another woman, all-golden, stepped forth,
 white-browed, bringing a beer-draught for her son [= Tew]:

2 hafði hǫfða · hundruð níu ‘of heads she had nine hundred’ | Malformed bodies, especially with a deviant number of body parts, are typical of ettins. Other examples include a three-headed thurse in *Ski* 31, the nine-headed ettin Thriwold (Bragi Frag 3 in SkP 3), and the eight-armed Starked Eldreng. Cf. Introduction and st. 35 below.

3 ǫnnur ‘another woman’ | The use of the word “son” in the following line reveals this as Tew’s mother. The poet stresses her beauty of dress and countenance, in contrast to the grandmother.

- [Týs móðir:] 9 „Átt-niðr jǫtna · ek vilja’k ykkur [R 14r/9, A 6r/8]
 2 hug-fulla tvá · und hvera sętja;
 es minn fríi · mǫrgu sinni
 4 glǫggr við gęsti · gǫrr ills hugar.“

[Tew’s mother:] “O clansman of ettins [= Tew]! I would wish to place
 you two, full of heart, beneath the cauldrons.
 Many a time has my lover [= Hymer] been
 stingy with guests, quick to ill mood.”

2 hug-fulla | hug-fulla hug-fulla R 3 fríi ‘lover’ | so R; faðir ‘father’ A

2 tvá ‘two’ | Here an instance of contraction < *tváa also found in st. 15/4 below, but cf. 21/2b which has the disyllabic form. It appears the poet was willing to use either form to accommodate the meter.

4 glǫggr ... hugar ‘stingy ... mood’ | Ettins are characteristically inhospitable, in stark opposition to the Old Germanic social norms; see Introduction to the poem above. This statement foreshadows the later fishing expedition starting at st. 16 below.

- 10 Ęn vá-skapaðr · varð síð-búinn, [R 14r/11, A 6r/9]
 2 harð-ráðr Hymir, · heim af vęiðum;
 gekk inn ĩ sal, · glumðu jǫklar,
 4 vas karls, es kom, · kinn-skógr frórin.

But the misshapen one was come late,
 hard-minded Hymer, home from fishing.

He entered the hall; icicles clattered;
on the churl who came was the cheek-shaw [BEARD] frozen.

1 *sið-búinn* 'delayed' | *om.* A

3 *jökla* 'icicles' | In Hymer's frozen beard. In modern Icelandic the word *jökull* has come to mean 'glacier', but its original sense (as found here) is that of its English cognate "icicle".

4 *karls* 'churl' | The first of three instances in the poem of Hymer being called a *karl* 'churl, old man, peasant'; a reference to his boorish nature. For the sense of this word in ON poetry (in contrast to both ON prose and later Scandinavian languages) see *Hárþ* 2 n.

[Týs móðir:] 11 „Ves *heill*, *Hymir*, · *ï hugum góðum*!

[R 14r/13, A 6r/11]

2 Nú 's *sonr* *kominn* · til *sala þinna*,
sá's *vit vætum* · af *vegi lönnum*;
4 fylgir *hönnum* · *Hróðrs* and-skoti,
vinr ver-liða; · *Vé-urr* *heitir* *sá*.

[Tew's mother:] "Be thou hale, Hymer, in good spirits!
Now the son has come to thy halls,
he whom we've awaited, from a long way off.
He is followed by Rooder's enemy [= Thunder],
the friend of manly retinues—Wighward is he called.

1 *Ves heill*, ... *ï hugum góðum*! 'Be thou hale ... in good spirits!' | A formulaic greeting; cf. the almost identical greeting in N B380 (edited below under Galders). Further afield cf. the type exemplified by *Beow* 407a: *Wæs þú, Hróð-gár, hál* 'Be thou, Rothgar, hale!'

5 *Vé-urr* 'Wighward' | The guardian of wighs (sanctuaries), a name of Thunder.

12 Sé hvar *sitja* · und *salar* *gafli*,
2 *svá* *forða sér*, · *stendr súl* *fyrir*.“
Sundr *stökk súla* · *fyr sjón jötuns*,
4 *en áðr* *ï tvau* · *áss* *brotnaði*.

[R 14r/15, A 6r/13]

See where they sit beneath the hall's gable:
so they save themselves—a column stands before them!"
The column burst apart before the ettin's gaze,
but earlier the roof-beam broke in two.

2 *forða sér* | *forða-sk* A 2 *súl* 'column' | *sól* A

2 *súl* 'column' | A hapax in ON, though attested in modern Icelandic. *súl* is the strong form of the weak *súla* 'id.' as found in the very next line.

13 Stukku *átta*, · *en einn* af þeim
2 *hverr harð-slæginn* · *heill* af þolli;
framm *gingu þeir*, · *en forn* *jötunn*

[R 14r/17, A 6r/15]

4 sjónum leiddi · sinn and-skota.

Eight [cauldrons] crashed down, but one of them,
a hard-forged cauldron, [came] whole off its peg.
Forth they went, but the ancient ettin
with his gaze tracked his enemy.

1–2 Stukku ... þolli ‘Eight ... peg.’ | Nine cauldrons were hanging from the roof-beam supported by the column behind which the gods were hiding. Eight of them broke from the fall, but one remained whole; we may presume that this one was the famed cauldron which the gods had come to get.

14 Sagði=t hönnum · hugr vel þá’s sá
2 gýgjar gróti · á golf kominn,
þar vóru þjórar · þrír of tæknir,
4 bað senn jötunn · sjóða ganga.

[R 14r/19, A 6r/16]

His heart did not please him when he saw
the gow’s distresser [= Thunder] come upon the floor.
There were three bulls a-taken;
the ettin bade them at once go cook.

2 gróti ‘distresser’ | gétu ‘keeper, warder’ A 4 senn ‘at once’ | sun ‘[bi]s son [= Tew]?’ A

1 Sagði=t hönnum · hugr vel ‘His heart did not please him’ | Lit. “his heart did not speak well to him”.

15 Hvern létu þeir · hofði skemmra
2 auk á seýði · síðan bõru,
át Sifjar verr · áðr sofa gingi,
4 einn með ǫllu · øxn tvá Hymis.

[R 14r/21, A 6r/18]

Each one they made shorter by a head
and onto the cooking-pit then did carry.
Sib’s husband [= Thunder] ate, before he went to sleep,
alone by himself two of Hymer’s oxen.

3–4 át ... Hymis. ‘Sib’s ... oxen.’ | Cf. *Þrk* 24 for another instance of Thunder’s great eating, which curiously also uses the kenning *Sifjar verr* ‘Sib’s husband [= Thunder]’.

16 Þótti hórur · Hrunnis spjalla
2 verðr Hlór-riða · vël full-mikill,
[Hymir:] „munum at aptni · ǫðrum verða
4 við vęiði-mat · vér þrír lifa.“

[R 14r/23, A 6r/19]

To Rungner’s hoary friend [= Hymer] did seem
Loride’s eating far too great—

“Next evening will we three
on fished food have to live.”

ALL | Hymer's stinginess—he refuses to share more of his own food but instead forces his guests to go fish—breaks all Indo-European rules of hospitality and illustrates the otherness of the Ettins; see Introduction above.

3–4 munum ... lifa. ‘Next ... live.’ | The poet is pushing at the limits of Old Norse syntax. In prose word order it should be construed as: *at öðrum aptni munum vér þrír verða lifa við vęði-mat*, where *verða* ‘have to, must’ is used like its modern German cognate *werden*.

- 17 **V**é·urr kvað=sk **v**ilja · à **v**ág róa,
2 ef **b**allr ȝotunn · **b**ęitur gęfi.
[Hymer:] „**H**verf til **h**jarðar, · ef **h**ug trúir,
4 **b**rjótr **b**erg-Dana, · **b**ęitur sókja.

[R 14r/24, A 6r/21]

Wighward called himself willing to row on the wave
if the stubborn ettin might give pieces of bait.

[Hymer:] “Turn to the herd if thou trustest thy heart—
O breaker of boulder-Danes [ETTINS > = Thunder]—to seek pieces of bait.

3 Hverf | so (‘hverf þu’) A; †hverfo† (fōr *‘hverf þu’) R. 3 hjarðar | hallar corr. A

4 brjótr berg-Dana ‘breaker of boulder-Danes [ETTINS > = Thunder]’ | The same kenning for Thunder also occurs in *Haustr* 18. The kenning-type, which is not uncommon, emphasises the otherness of the Ettins (see Introduction to the poem) by equating them with ethnic foreigners or enemies (Marold 1990). The most prolific use of it is seen in *Þdr*, where ettins are called Scots, Brythons, Swedes, Danes, Ruges and Harths, all peoples hostile to the Norwegian Earl Hathkin, at whose court that poem may have been composed.

- 18 **Þ**ęss vęntir mik, · at **þ**ér myni=t
2 ȝgn at **o**xa · **a**uð-fęng vesa.“
Sveinn sýsliga · **s**veif til skógar,
4 þar’s **o**xi stóð · **a**l-svartr fyrir.

[R 14r/26, A 6r/23]

I expect that the bait from the ox
will not be an easy catch for thee!”
The swain [= Thunder] swiftly turned to the wood
where an ox stood, all-black, ahead.

1 vęntir mik | so A; vęnti ek (*norm.*) R 1 myni=t ‘will not’ | so A; myni ‘will’ R. The A reading is preferable since it makes this the first of Hymer’s several challenges of strength to Thunder, which the god, to the ettin’s humiliation, easily accomplishes.

3 Sveinn ‘The swain’ | Thunder was in the shape of a young boy, a detail which is also found in *Gylf* 48:4; see Introduction to the poem.

4 oxí ... al-svartr ‘ox ... all-black’ | Formulaic, also occurring in *Þrk* 23; see note there for further parallels to the custom of sacrificing animals of certain colours. It seems that all-black oxen were thought the noblest, and so Thunder’s slaying one instead of an inferior beast is probably intended to humiliate the stingy Hymer. — We learn more about this ox in *Gylf* 48:13: *Hann tók inn mesta uxá’n, er Himin-brjóðr hét, ok sleit af höfuð’it ok fór með til sjávar*. ‘He took the greatest ox, which was called Heavenrid, and tore off its head and went with it to the sea’.

- 19 Braut af þjóri · þurs ráð-bani [R 14r/28, A 6r/24]
 2 hó-tún ofan · horna tveggja.
 [Hymir:] „Verk þikkja þín · verri myklu
 4 kjóla valdi · an kyrr sitir.“

Off from the bull the thurse's death-planner [= Thunder]
 broke the high meadow of two horns [HEAD] from above.—
 [Hymer:] “Worse by far thy works appear
 to the wielder of keels [= Hymer = me] than if thou wouldst sit calm!”

4 kjóla valdi ‘wielder of keels’ | I.e., ‘master of ships’, foreshadowing the later fishing expedition. — *valdi* is here taken as dat. sg. of *valdr* ‘wielder, master’ and as the indirect object of *þykkja* ‘seem, appear’. The word can however also be read as the semantically identical nom. sg. *valdi*, in which case the phrase would be a vocative addressing Thunder. In context the former reading makes more sense: the kenning ‘ruler of keels’ fits better for Hymer than Thunder and *þykkja* gets an indirect object.

- 20 Bað hlunn-gota · hafra dróttinn [R 14r/30, A 6r/26]
 2 átt-runn apa · útar fóra,
 en sá jötunn · sína talði,
 4 lítla fýsi · at róa lengra.

The Lord of He-goats bade the kinsman of the ape [ETTIN = Hymer]
 push the launcher-steed [BOAT] further out,
 but that ettin told of his
 little wish to row any longer.

2 átt-runn | †atrænn† A 3 talði | milldi *corr.* A

ALL | The scene shifts and the party is out at sea. It is possible that a stanza has been lost here, or that the transition would have been indicated in some other way during oral performance.

1 hafra dróttinn ‘Lord of He-goats’ | Thunder. Reoccurs in 31/1 below; cf. *Þrk* 21/1.

2 apa ‘ape’ | The specific sense of *api* ‘ape’ is uncertain. It seems to generally refer to a fool, but see Index.

3–4 en ... róa. ‘but ... longer.’ | Thunder’s humorous humiliation of Hymer continues with the snide ettin now forced to row against his will.

4 at róa lengra | The alliteration falls on the second stressed word which is not expected; emendation to **lengra at róa* is metrically convenient but not supported by either ms.

- 21 Dró mærr Hymir · móðugr hvali [R 14r/31, A 6r/27]
 2 einn á ongli · upp sænn tváa;
 en aptr í skut · Óðni sífaðr
 4 Vé-urr við vélar · vað gerði sér.

Famous Hymer, fierce, pulled whales:
 one on the hook, soon up two—

but back in the stern the Weden-affinitive
Wighward (= Thunder) craftily fixed his line.

1 męrr ‘famous’ | so R; męirr ‘more, further’ A

1 hvali | A rare acc. pl. form also occurring in 26/2b.

3 Óðni sifaðr ‘Weden-affinitive’ | I.e., the one related to Weden, an adjective describing Wighward (Thunder).

- 22 Egnði à ȝngul · sá’s ȝldum bergr,
2 orms ęin-bani · oxa hȝfði;
ęein við agni · sú’s goð fía
4 umb-gjorð neðan · allra landa.

[R 14v/1, A 6r/29]

On the hook baited he who rescues men—
the Wyrms lone slayer—the ox’s head.
At the bait snapped the one whom the Gods hate—
the engirdler of all lands—from below.

3 agni ‘bait’ | so A; ȝngli ‘hook’ R

ALL | This stanza skilfully juxtaposes Thunder and the Wyrms by employing strong parallelism across the two helmings (ll. 1–2 and 3–4). The poetic juxtaposition between the two primordial enemies, Storm-God and Serpent, is also found in the Scaldic fragments (e.g. *Qlv Þórr*; see note to l. 4) and, further afield, in the Vedic tradition (e.g. *RV* 1.32.13c: *Índraṣ ca yád · yuyudhātē Ábiṣ ca* ‘When Indra and the Wyrms (*ábi*) fought each other.’)

2 orms ęin-bani ‘Wyrms lone slayer’ | Watkins (1995, pp. 419–424) sees in this kenning for Thundr a reflex of the ancient IE formula HERO SLAY (PIE **g^{wh}en-*) SERPENT, where the root **g^{wh}en-* ‘slay, kill’ is reflected in ON by the agent noun *bani* ‘bane, slayer’ < **g^{wh}on-ō* (so e.g. Seebold 1967, pp. 113–114, although the sound change **g^{wh}-* > **b-* is not universally accepted; see Kroonen 2013, pp. xxxviii, 51). The IE formula, reconstructed as **h₁é-g^{wh}ent h₂óg^{wh}im* ‘he slew the Serpent’, occurs directly only as OI *ábann Ábim* (11 times in *RV*; see Watkins 1995, pp. 304 ff.), but has parallels throughout the IE family, including Greek and Hittite (Watkins 1995, *passim*).

On the basis of the rare sound combination **-g^{wh}-* : *-g^{wh}-*, Wikander (2021) argues brilliantly that the IE formula was likely phono-semantically calqued from IE into Northwest Semitic as the formulaic rhyming phrase **maḥaša naḥaša(m)* ‘he struck the serpent’ (which features another rare and highly marked phoneme, the ejective **š* [ʔ¹]), perhaps along with the Chaokampf myth as a whole.

4 umb-gjorð ... allra landa ‘engirdler of all lands’ | The same kenning is found in a fragment by Alewigh Snub (*Qlv Þórr* in SkP 3) quoted in *Skm* 11: *Óstri-sk allra landa · umb-gjorð ok sonr Jarðar* ‘The engirdler of all lands and the son of Earth surged.’ Closely related is the kenning in a 9th c. fragment by Bray the Old quoted in the same chapter (*Bragi Þórr* 3 in SkP 3): *ęndi-ęęiðr allra landa* ‘boundary-saith of all lands’. Both kennings relate to the cosmological idea of the Outer Sea (ON *Út-bafr*) which surrounds the solid Earth; in this sea lies the Wyrms, biting its tail and enwrapping the lands. Cf. st. 5/1 n. above.

- 23 Dró djarf=liga · dáð-rakkr Þóarr
2 orm ęitr-faan · upp at borði;
hamri kníði · hȝ-fjall skarar

[R 14v/3, A 6v/1]

4 of-ljótt ofan · ulfs hnit-bróður.

Bravely, deed-ready Thunder pulled
the venom-gleaming Wyrms up on the gunwale.
With the hammer he struck the high mountain of hair [HEAD]—
very hideous, from above—on the Wolf's clash-brother [= the Wyrms].

1 djarf=liga | so A; †diafliga† R

1 Þóarr 'Thunder' | Out of 8 three-syllable lines in *Hym*, this is the only one which is deficient in both R and A and cannot easily be emended by restoring an hiatus form. In the quite strict meter (see Introduction above) observed by the *Hym* poet we should expect a disyllabic form in this spot, and this may be had if we restore an archaic *Þóarr or *Þóurr. Such a form is less secure than other hiatus forms, but is also metrically required in *Hym* 28/2b below and further in the Scaldic *Þdr* 2/2b. This issue is treated in depth by Haukur Þorgeirsson (2023), who argues for the form *Þóurr.

3 hö-fjall skarar 'high mountain of hair [HEAD]' | A rather unfitting kenning, since serpents do not have hair.

24 Hraun-golkn hrutu, · en hólkn þutu,
2 fór hin forna · fold öll saman;
[...]
sökkði=sk síðan · sá fiskr i mar.

[R 14v/5, A 6v/2]

The waste-monsters [ETTINS] bounded and bedrock resounded;
the ancient earth moved all at once.
[...]
Thereafter sank that Fish into the sea.

1 Hraun-golkn 'The waste-monsters' | emend.; hrēin-golkn AR 1 hrutu | so A; hlumðu 'dashed' R.

1 Hraun-golkn 'The waste-monsters' | Both mss. have *hrēin*-, which may mean either 'clean' or 'reindeer', neither of which make sense Semantically. On the other hand *hraun* ONP: 'stone/barren area, wasteland; lavafield' is well attested in Scaldic kennings for ettins, including in the present poem (36/4, 38/3). The precise meaning of *galkn* 'monster' (plural *golkn*) is unclear, but it is attested in 3 Scaldic verses, in all cases as the base-word in kennings of the type "troll-woman of the shield [AXE]", which may suggest that it (like another neuter word, *flagð*) refers specifically to female malevolent beings.

While the mss. spelling '*galkn*' (norm. *gálkn*) could reflect either singular or plural, the form of the verb is plural. This means that the word cannot be referring to the Middenyardswyrm as Larrington (2014) understands it in her translation: "the sea-wolf shrieked".

1 hrutu | The A reading is preferred since it has the metrically required short root syllable. End rhyme is paralleled elsewhere in the poem (st. 3/3); here it heightens the dramatic impact of the verse.

2 [...] | It is very likely that a line is missing here, since the stanzas in the poem fairly consistently have 4 lines and since the *siðan* 'thereafter' in l. 3 is left without a referent. In other tellings of the myth it is at this point that Hymer cuts Thunder's fishing line, so that is probably what has been lost. Cf. *Gylf* 48:26–27: *Þá er sagt, at jötunn'inn Hymir gerði-sk lit-verpr, fjlnaði ok bréddi-sk, er hann sá orm'inn ok þat er sér'inn féll út ok inn of nokkvann. Ok í því bili, er Þórr greip bamar'inn ok fœrði á loft, þá fálmaði jötunn'inn til agn-saxi'nu ok hjó vað Þórs á borði, en ormr'inn sökkti-sk í sæ'inn.* 'Then it is said that the ettin Hymer lost his colour, turned pale and was frightened when he saw the Wýrm and how the sea fell in and out of the boat. And in that moment when Thunder gripped the hammer and brought it aloft then the ettin reached for the bait-cutting knife and cut Thunder's fishing-line against the gunwale. But the Wýrm sunk into the sea.' Based on this account we may reconstruct a hypothetical line **und's fjör Hymir · fekk á saxi* 'until pale Hymer grasped the knife'.

3 fiskr 'fish' | A good example showing that pre-modern speciation, especially in poetry, was not exact. The appellation is not a mere fancy of the poet, for the Wýrm appears in the shape of a fish in various pre-Christian pictorial sources (e.g. GP 21). It may also be called a fish in *Grm* 21 (see note there), and in Scaldic sources it is often called a *saithe* (*sēiðr*).

25 Ò·tęitr jętunn, · es aptr ręru,
[...]

[R 14v/6, A 6v/3]

2 svá't ár Hymir · ękki męlti,
veįfði róði · veðrs annars til.

The unmerry ettin [= Hymer], as they rowed back,
[...]

so that for a long time Hymer said not a thing;
he pulled the oar against the wind:

1 [...] | Another likely missing line. As noted in the previous stanza the meter usually requires four lines; more importantly the first half of the sentence is incomplete without a verb.

2 svá't ár 'so that for a long time' | Finnur Jónsson (1932) suggests *svá't at ór* 'so that by the oar', but this burdens the strict meter. For this sense of *ár* cf. *Ski* 27.

[Hymir:] 26 „Munt of vinna · verk halft við mik,
2 at heįm hvali · haf til bójar
eða flot-brúsa · feęstir okkarn.“

[R 14v/8, A 6v/4]

[Quoth Hymer:] “Thou wilt accomplish a half work compared to me,
if thou bringest home the whales to the farm,
or our float-buck [BOAT] thou dost fasten.”

ALL | Hymer tells Thunder, who having let go of the Wýrm has nothing to show for the trip, that he can accomplish something half as great as the catching of the whales if he carries them home and ties the boat by the shore.

27 Gekk Hlór-riði · greįp á stafni
2 vatt með austri · upp lęg-faki;
ęinn með órum · ok með aust-skotu

[R 14v/9, A 6v/6]

4 **bar** til **bójar** · **brim**-svin jötuns
 ok **holt**-riða · **hver** i gegnum.

Loride went, grasped the stern,
 hurled up the lake-nag [BOAT] with the bilge-water.
 Alone with the oars and the bilge-bucket
 he bore to the farm the ettin's brim-swines [WHALES],
 even through the spring of woodland ridges.

1 á | til á R 5 **holt**-riða | †holtriba† R

2 með austri 'with the bilge-water' | That is, the bilge-water was still inside the boat; another impressive work of strength.

5 **holt**-riða hver 'spring of woodland ridges' | An uncertain geographical description apparently meant to impress the audience as a particularly impressive feat. In Iceland *hverr* 'cauldron' also carries the sense '(hot) spring', in which case this could be an attestation of Thunder's prowess in wading (for which see *Grm* 29). TODO: What do other editors and translators say?

28 **Ok** **enn** jötunn · **umb** **afr**-endi,
 2 þrá-girni vanr, · við þóar sēti,
 kvað=at mann **ram**man, · þó'tt **róa** kynni,
 4 **kröptur**-ligan, · nema **kalk** bryti.

[R 14v/12, A 6v/7]

And yet the ettin, used to stubbornness,
 over strength of hand with Thunder flyted.
 He would call no man strong, even though he could row
 mightily, unless he broke the chalice.

1 Ok | Enn A

ALL | Even after witnessing several great feats of strength Hymer still refuses to admit Thunder's superiority. He now insists on challenging him to break his indestructible chalice.

29 **En** **Hlór**-riði, · es at **høndum** kom,
 2 **brátt** lét **bresta** · **bratt**-stein glēri,
 sló sitjandi · **súlur** i gognum;
 4 bögu þó **heilan** · fyr **Hymi** síðan,

[R 14v/14, A 6v/9]

But Loride, when it came to his hands,
 impatiently crushed steep stone with the glass.
 He struck right through the standing columns,
 yet they brought it, whole, before Hymer thereafter,

2 bratt-stein glēri 'steep stone with the glass' | Thunder broke the stone columns in Hymer's house with the glass chalice.

3 sitjandi 'standing' | This word is ambiguous and can modify either Thunder (in which case it would mean "sitting") or the columns (*súlur*). I have chosen the latter and read it as signifying their stability.

30 und's þat hin fríða · fríðla ķendi

[R 14v/16, A 6v/10]

- 2 ðst-ráð mikít, · ęitt es vissi,
 „drep við haus Hymis, · hann 's harðari,
 4 kost-móðs ęotuns, · kalki hveřjum!“

until the handsome mistress [= Tew's mother] gave
 a great loving counsel, the one she knew:
 “Strike against Hymer's skull! It is harder—
 the choice-weary ettin's—than any chalice.”

1 hin | so A; 'ið' (n. nom. sg.) R 4 hveřjum | so A; hveřju (n. dat. sg.) R.

1–2 und's ... vissi, 'until ... knew.' | Harkening back to st. 4.

3 haus Hymis, · hann 's harðari 'Hymer's skull! It is harder' | Ettins characteristically have hard skulls; cf. *Hárð* 15 and note for the significance of this minor detail.

4 kost-móðs 'choice-weary' | Hymer can justly be called “choice-weary” since at this point the gods have destroyed eight of his nine cauldrons and slain three of his bulls.

31 Harðr reįs á kné · hafra dróttinn,

[R 14v/18, A 6v/12]

- 2 fórðisk allra · i ős-męgin;
 heįill vas karli · hjalm-stofn ofan,
 4 ęn vīn-ferill · valr rifnaði.

On his knee rose the hard Lord of He-goats;
 he brought himself to his highest Os-might.
 Whole on the churl [= Hymer] was the helm-stump [HEAD] above,
 but the round wine-track [CHALICE] rent apart.

1 reįs | om. A

2 fórðisk allra · i ős-męgin 'brought himself into his fullest Os-might' | The exact meaning of this is not clear, but a likely reading is that Thunder brings himself into his true form as the mighty, red-bearded man; recall that he was previously (st. 18/3) in the shape of a young boy. Cf. *Gylf* 48:24 in its description of Thunder attempting to pull up the Wyrms: *Þá varð Þórr reiðr ok fýrði-sk i ős-męgin* [...] 'Then Thunder turned wroth and brought himself into his Os-might' and Eddic fragment 6, st. 1.

[Hymir kvað:] 32 „Męrg vęit'k męti · męr gingin frá,

[R 14v/20, A 6v/13]

- 2 es kalki sę'k · fyr knéum hrundit,
 karl orð of kvað: · „kná'k=at sęgia
 4 aptr ęva=gi: · þú 'st ęlðr of heitt.“

[Quoth Hymer:] “I know many treasures parted from me
 when I see the chalice thrown before [my] knees!”—
 The churl [= Hymer] spoke words: “I cannot say
 ever again: ‘Thou art, ale, well warmed!’”

2 es | *om.* R 2 fyr | ýr R; firi A 2 knéum | *metr. emend.*; knjám (*norm.*) RA 4 heitt | *so*
A; †heitt† R.

3–4 kná'k-at ... of heitt. 'I cannot ... warmed!' | Hymer laments that with the loss of his finest vessel he will never be able to enjoy his drink again, ironically since it was he who challenged Thunder to break it in the first place. For 'warmed' (*heiti*) *ale* cf. st. 3/4 above.

- 33 Þat 's til **k**ostar · ef koma méttið [R 14v/22, A 6v/15]
2 út ór **ó**ru · **q**l-kjól hófi.“
Týr leitaði · **t**ysvar hróra;
4 stóð at **h**vóru · **h**verr kyrr fyrir.

It would be choicest if ye might bring
that ale-vessel [CAULDRON] out from our hall.”
Tew attempted twice to move it—
each time stood the cauldron unmoved ahead.

2 *q*l-kjól 'ale-vessel [CAULDRON]' | *q*l-kjól is the accusative of *q*l-kjóll, but in this construction (CV: *koma*, B) we would expect the dative *q*l-kjóli. Since the meter does not allow for this the poet has probably taken a grammatical liberty.

2 hófi 'hall' | This is the only Old Norse occurrence of the word *hof* in the sense “hall, house”—it otherwise only means “temple” (hove). The West Germanic cognates consistently mean “hall”, but that is probably the original sense, so it is unclear if this is an instance of foreign (if so, most likely Anglo-Saxon) influence or just a poetic archaism.

- 34 Faðir Móða · fekk á þræmi [R 14v/24, A 6v/16]
2 ok i gegnum stęig · **g**olf niðr i sal;
hóf=sk á **h**aufuð upp · **h**ver Sifjar verr,
4 en á **h**ęlum · **h**ringar skullu.

The father of Moody [= Thunder] grasped the brim
and stepped through the floor in the hall.
Up onto his head heaved Sib's husband [= Thunder] the cauldron,
but by his heels the rings clattered.

2 stęig 'stepped' | *so* R; stóð 'stood' A 2 i | á (*norm.*) A

2 ok i gegnum stęig · *g*olf niðr i sal 'and stepped through the floor in the hall' | In *Gylf* 48:24 Thunder is said to have stepped through the boat when trying to pull up the Míddensvǫlm, a detail famously depicted on the Altuna runestone (U 1611) from Uppland, Sweden and the Hørdum stone from Denmark. It is very likely that the original detail of Thunder exerting himself to the point of his feet going through the bottom of the boat has later been transposed to this place in the narrative, although it is unclear whether this is the work of the poet himself or of an earlier tradition.

3 *haufuð* 'head' | The archaic long form *haufuð* rather than the short *hfuð* is metrically superior in a type B verse (TODO: cite MalesTODO note). Cf. the similar line 36/1 below.

4 hringar skullu ‘the rings clattered’ | I.e. the chain-links. This detail is mentioned in an example sentence contrasting long and short phonemes in *FGT* 1950: *beyrði til þoddu, þá er Þórr bar þverinn* ‘the sound of the pot-links (*hadda*) was heard when Thunder bore the cauldron’. According to Finnur Jónsson (1932) the chain (or *hadda*) on a Wiking-age cauldron would reach across it, being bound on two opposing points along the rim, in which case this would be a reference to the cauldron’s enormous size, with its diameter—mentioned in st. 5 as one rest—being roughly the same as Thunder’s height.

- 35 Fóru=t lęgi, · áðr líta nam
2 aþr Óðins sonr · ęinu sinni;
sá ór hreysum · með Hymi austan
4 folk-drótt fara · fjol-hofðaða.

[R 14v/26, A 6v/18]

They did not journey for long before Weden’s son
took to look back a single time.
He saw out of stone-heaps with Hymer from the east
a war-troop coming, many-headed.

4 folk-drótt ... fjol-hofðaða ‘war-troop ... many-headed’ | The adjective *fjol-hofðaðr* means ‘many-headed, polyccephalic’ and is not referring to the size of the host. For many-headed ettins see st. 8 and for their malformed bodies in general see Introduction to the poem.

- 36 Hóf sér af hęðum · hver standandi,
2 veifði Mjöllni · morð-gjörnum framm,
ok hraun-hvala · hann alla drap.

[R 14v/28, A 6v/19]

He heaved off his shoulders the cauldron, standing,
swung the murder-eager Millner forth,
and all the whales of the waste [ETTINS] he slew.

ALL | For another light-hearted instance of Thunder’s ettin-bashing cf. *Þrk* 31–32.

2 morð-gjörnum ‘murder-eager’ | By this adjective the poet gives the Hammer something of a will of its own; cf. *Skm* 43, where the Hammer is said to always return to Thunder when thrown, perhaps by its own will. With this may be connected the curious fact that several pagan hammer-amulets of the Wiking Age depict the Hammer with a mouth, nose, and eyes. Three such finds are the silver hammer from Bredsättra, Öland, Sweden (item number 106666 HST), the gilt silver hammer from Ödeshög, East Geatland, Sweden (108249 HST), and the silver hammer from Baron Claes Kurck’s collection found somewhere in Scania, (106659 HST), the last of which is depicted in Fig. 5, p. 289.

- 37 Fóru=t lęgi, · áðr liggja nam
2 hafr Hlór-riða · half-dauðr fyrir,
vas skęr skøkuls · skakkr á þęini,
4 ęn því hinn lę-vísi · Loki of olli.

[R 14v/30, A 6v/21]

They did not journey for long before Lorida’s he-goat
took to lie half-dead ahead.

The colt of the cart-pole [GOAT] was halt in the leg,
but that the guile-wise Lock had caused.

3 skér | emend. from meaningless †skirr† RA

ALL | Sts. 37–38 deal with one of Thunder's goats going halt and an ettin farmer giving up two of his children in return. A related story is also found in *Gylf* 44:9–21 and may be summarized as follows:

Thunder and Lock were on the way to visit Outyards-Lock and stayed the night with a certain farmer. For supper Thunder cut his two goats and invited the farmer and his family to dine with him. After they had eaten he spread the goatskins before the fire and bade the housefolk throw the bones of the goats on top of them. The farmer's son stealthily pried open the thigh of one of the goats and ate the marrow. At dawn Thunder blessed the goatskins with his hammer and the goats came back to life, but the one Thelwe had cut had a halt leg. Thunder was enraged, but the farmer begged for his life and offered to give up his two children, namely his son Thelwe and his daughter Wrash. Thunder spared him, and the two became his servants.

The present stanza may reference a version of the same myth wherein Lock has a part to play in the halting of the goat, perhaps by encouraging Thelwe to pry the bone open; this is strongly supported by *Skm* 23 where Lock is called *þjóf* [...] *þáfrs* 'thief of the he-goat', almost certainly Thunder's. The farmer may be identified with Eyel, with whom the goats were left in st. 7 above, so it is probably also Eyel who gives away his two children (Thelwe and Wrash) in st. 38.

38 Ën ér hęyrtr hafıð, · hvęrr kann umb þat
2 goð-mólugra · gorr at skilja,
 hvęr af hraun-búa · hann laun of fekk,
4 es bęði galt · bęrn sın fyrir.

[R 14v/32, A 6v/22]

But ye have heard—about that can each
god-speaking man more clearly discern—
what recompense *be* [= Thunder] got from the waste-dweller [ETTIN]
when he [= the farmer] paid up both his children for it.

1 ér 'ye' | The listeners. A direct address to the audience of this type is otherwise unparalleled in Eddic mythological poetry. Such are, however, typical for the Scaldic poems with which *Hym* shares several traits; see Introduction above. Cf. st. 39/3–4 n.

1–2 hvęrr ... goð-mólugra 'each god-speaking man' | Literally "each of the god-speaking ones". *goð-mólugr* 'god-speaking' is an hapax, but easily understood as "learned in the lore of the gods".

39 Þrótt-ęflugr kom · á þing goða
2 ok hafði hver, · þann's Hymir átti;
 ęn véar hvęrjan · vęl skulu drikka
4 ęlðr at ęgis · ęitt hęr-męitið.

[R 15r/1, A 6v/24]

The one strong of vigour came to the Thing of the Gods
and had the cauldron which Hymer had owned—
but the Wighers <Gods> shall drink well
one ale-feast at Eagre's every flax-cutter [SUMMER?].

1 Þrótt-ęflugr 'The one strong of vigour' | Thunder.

3–4 *en véar hverjan · vel skulu drikka / ql̥ðr at Egis · ęitt hqr-męitið* ‘but the Wighers (Gods) well shall drink / one ale-feast at Eagre’s every flax-cutter [SUMMER]:’ | Regardless of whether (*ęitt*) *hqr-męitið* means [SUMMER] or [WINTER] (see note), these concluding lines seems to describe the Gods celebrating a yearly seasonal festival (*ql̥ðr*). The fact that this is mentioned at the very end of the poem seems to give an etiological purpose to the whole narrative; with the claiming of the cauldron the Gods are henceforth able to enjoy an abundance of drink at a specified point each year. The festival alluded to is probably equivalent to an annual agricultural festival celebrated by humans, since the cult of the Gods serves as the model for the human religion (*Vsp* 7/2 n.), and with that in mind we can deduce that *Hym* was likely composed for recitation either at a festival taking place in late July or at Yule—a unique insight into the performance of Eddic poetry. This is further supported by the address of the audience in st. 38 above. — The word order is unusually complex for an Eddic poem but is not unprecedented in *Hym* (e.g. st. 16/3–4). In prose word order: *ęn véar skulu drikka vel ęitt ql̥ðr at Egis hverjan hqr-męitið*; or with emendation from La Farge and Tucker: *ęn véar skulu drikka vel ęitt ql̥ðr at Egis hverjan ęitr-hqr-męitið*.

4 *ęitt hqr-męitið* ‘one ... flax-cutter’ | The latter word is an *hapax* and very obscure. It clearly belongs with *hverjan* ‘every, each’ (m. acc. sg.); its nom. sg. form should be **hqr-męitiðr*. I take this as a compound formed from *hqr* ‘flax, cord’ + *męita* ‘to cut’ with an agent noun suffix *-ðr*. Since the determiner *hverjan* implies seasonality the word is easily read as a kenning for SUMMER, or specifically the time when flax is cut around late July. This is however unprecedented amongst kennings for SUMMER, which otherwise always belong to the type “mercy of the SERPENT” (Meissner 1921, p. 109). — Following the ms. evidence the pres. ed. reads *ęitt* ‘one’ n. acc. sg. as modifying *ql̥ðr* ‘ale-feast’, but based on typical WINTER-kennings of the type “harm of the SERPENT” La Farge and Tucker (1992, p. 46) suggest the emendations *ęitr-hqr-męitið* ‘venom-rope-cutter [SNAKE > WINTER]’ and *ęitr-*orm-męitiðir* ‘venom-worm-schather [WINTER]’.



Figure 5: Hammer-amulet with face from unknown findspot, Scania. Wiking Age, ca. 900 CE. © Ola Myrin, Historiska museet/SHM. CC BY 4.0. <https://samlingar.shm.se/media/1B654576-D251-475F-B366-6EF893A1D537>

Flyting of Lock

(*Loka senna*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.965)

Meter: Leeds-meter

Introduction

The **Flyting of Lock** (abbrev. *Lok*) is a narrative poem dealing with Lock's insults of the gods at their simle and the consequences that follow.

Textual preservation and transmission

The poem is preserved only in **R** on foll. 15r/3–17r/12. It follows *Hym* and precedes *Þrk*.

In **R**, *Lok* is tied together into a continuous narrative with *Hym* by the prose passage “From Eagre and the Gods” (edited as P1–P2 of the present poem), but the two poems are so drastically different in style that they are certainly distinct compositions.

In the related Eddic manuscript **A**, *Hym* stands alone with no trace of a frame narrative while no trace of *Lok* survives, which strongly suggests that the frame narrative is a later addition on the part of the **R** tradition.

A stanza that appears to belong to *Lok* is found in *Gylf*; it is edited below following the end of the poem. The poem—and especially its introductory prose (*Lok* P1, P2)—is also alluded to in *Skm* 41.

Meter and stanza

Lok is composed entirely in Leeds-meter. The poem has 266 lines across 65 stanzas. Most stanzas (60/65) follow the typical four-line structure *ab-cabc*, but the variants *abcabcc* (13, 54, 62, 65) and even *abcabccc* (23) are also represented.

The stanzas exclusively represent dialogue, and all narrative elements are told in prose. Apart from the short speaker notes before stanzas longer prose

interjections are also found between sts. 5 and 6 (P3), 10 and 11 (P4), 52 and 53 (P5), 53 and 54 (P6), and 56 and 57 (P7).

Two unambiguous instances show that alliteration can fall between *v* and a vowel: 2/4 (*orði : vinr*) and 10/1 (*Víð-arr : ulfs*). Cf. 36/4 (n.). Still, the numerous other instances of normal *v*- or vowel-alliteration show that this was not preferred, and it is notable that both *orð* 'word' and *ulfr* 'wolf' contained a *v*- in an earlier stage of the language; see note to 2/4.

One line lacks suitable alliteration: 39/3. The alliteration in 14/2 is highly questionable.

Origin and motifs

It is easy to interpret *Lok* as a blasphemous composition belonging to the period after the conversion to Christianity. Surely no pious pagan would have written a poem insulting his own gods. Yet, as discussed in the introduction to *Hárb*, this argument is not very strong since examples of humorous or irreverent descriptions of Gods can be found in many other pagan poetic traditions in the context of mythology, which is what *Lok* is. What is more, many of *Lok*'s insults are likely taken out of their original contexts or baseless, and the taunting god is ultimately forced to flee before the might of Thunder, which the poet by no means denigrates.

If anything, the fact that *Lok* assumes a deep familiarity with the pagan mythology and the characters and incidents of the gods probably speaks for a pre-Christian origin. The gods are after all insulted on their own merits, not as idols powerless before Almighty God and His holy men, which was the Christian view. If the goal was to make fun of the gods there would surely have been easier and more effective ways to do so.

Dating

Notably for the question of dating *Lok* has three occurrences of alliteration between old *vr*- (> *r*-) and *v*-: 15/3 (*vega : vręiðr*), 18/4 (*vręiðir : vegi-sk*), and 27/4 (*vręiðum : vegit*). Since all Scaldic attestations of *vr*- alliterating with *v*- rather than with *r*- date to before 1000 CE (cf. *Háv* 26/2) this is a solid dating criterion for pre-Christian composition (Haukur Þorgeirsson 2016).

A feature in the alliteration which tentatively suggests a very earlier dating is the fact that secure alliteration between *v*- and a vowel is isolated to two instances (2/4 and 10/1), both of which have vowel-words which in Proto-Norse began with *w*-; see note to 2/4.

When it comes to the occurrence of the preverbal particle *of*, a trait strongly correlated with *vr*-, *Lok* shows the high rate of 0.326 per 10 unique lines (Haukur Þorgeirsson 2016, p. 54; Sapp 2022, p. 70).

In addition *Lok* preserves two archaic Germanic hapax legomena in their etymological senses: the noun *ffęrg* 'Farrows, Gods' (19/4) and the adj. *tilr* 'conciliatory' (38/2).

Linguistic and metrical factors thus strongly suggest that *Lok* is a pre-Christian poem from the 9th or 10th c.

Summary

Overview of speakers by stanza, first occurrence in bold:

1 **Lock**, 2 **Elder**, 3 Lock, 4 Elder, 5 Lock — 6–7 Lock, 8 **Bray** — 9 Lock, 10 **Weden** — 11 Lock, 12 Bray, 13 Lock, 14 Bray, 15 Lock — 16 **Idin**, 17 Lock, 18 Idin — 19 **Yiven**, 20 Lock — 21 Weden, 22 Lock, 23 Weden, 24 Lock — 25 **Frie**, 26 Lock, 27 Frie, 28 Lock — 29 **Frow**, 30 Lock, 31 Frow, 32 Lock — 33 **Nearth**, 34 Lock, 35 Nearth, 36 Lock — 37 **Tew**, 38 Lock, 39 Tew, 40 Lock — 41 **Free**, 42 Lock — 43 **Bewer**, 44 Lock, 45 Bewer, 46 Lock — 47 **Homedall**, 48 Lock — 49 [**Shede**], 50 Lock, 51 [Shede], 52 Lock — 53 **Sib**, 54 Lock — 55 **Beal**, 56 Lock — 57 **Thunder**, 58 Lock, 59 Thunder, 60 Lock, 61 Thunder, 62 Lock, 63 Thunder, 64–65 Lock

The poem begins with two prose passages (P1–P2), the first one connecting to the previous poem, *Hym* and introducing the gods and their banquet, the second one describing the immediate events leading up to the poem, Lock's wanton killing of one of the servants.

Lock meets the servant Elder outside and asks him of what the Eese are speaking at the banquet (1). Elder answers that they speak of their prowess and splendid arms, and in no way favourably about Lock (2). Lock declares that he will go inside to insult the Eese (3). Elder warns him that he will regret it, (4) but Lock insults his intellect (5) and goes inside (P3).

Lock greets the Gods sarcastically and asks for a drink (6). When they ignore him he tells them to make a choice: either to invite him to sit or to drive him away (7). Bray answers and tells him that they will never let him drink (8), but Lock ignores him and turns to Weden, calling to mind a blood-oath between them (9). Weden, acknowledging the oath, asks his son Wider to give Lock a drink and let him sit (10). He does (P4).

Lock now begins his insults, first turning to Bray (11). From Lock's insult of Bray in st. 11 until Thunder's arrival in P7 the poem has a very regular structure. Lock and a god take turns insulting each other for one or two pairs of stanzas before another god comes to the defense of the previous one and becomes the new target for Lock's insults. There is no point in summarising the insults beyond the overview of speakers above, although it may be noted that Lock's insults towards the Gods are considerably more creative than those towards the Goddesses, which almost exclusively consist of accusations of adultery.

Immediately after Lock mentions Thunder (54) his arrival is heralded (55), and he arrives (P7). Thunder and Lock take turns (sts. 57–63), before Lock is at last forced to yield as he knows that Thunder alone will break the law of non-violence even inside the hall (64). Lock curses the Eese and Eagre one last time and departs (65). After this the prose tells us that Lock hid himself in a river in the shape of a salmon, but was eventually caught and bound upon three sharp stones with a venomous serpent set above his face to torment him. When he writhed from the pain the whole earth shook in what is now known as earth-quakes (P8).

Text

Frá Égi ok goðum ('From Eage and the Gods')

- P1 Égir, er qðru nafni hét Gymer, hann hafði búit ósum ql þá er
 2 hann hafði fengit ketil inn mikla sem nú er sagt. Til þeirar veit-
 slu kom Óðinn ok Frigg kona hans. Þórr kom eigi því at hann var
 4 í austr-vegi. Sif var þar, kona Þórs; Bragi, ok Iðunn kona hans.
 Týr var þar, hann var ein-hendr; Fenrisulfr sleit hönd af hánum,
 6 þá er hann var bundinn. Þar var Njorðr ok kona hans Skaði;
 Freyr ok Freyja; Víð-arr son Óðins. Loki var þar, ok þjónustu-
 8 menn Freys, Byggvir ok Beyla. Mart var þar ása ok alfa.

EAGE, who by another name was called Gymer—he had prepared an ale-feast for the Eese when he had got the great kettle as was just told. To that gathering came Weden and Frie his wife. Thunder came not, for he was on the Eastern Way. Sib was there, Thunder's wife; Bray and Idin his wife. Tew was there, he was one-handed; the Fenrerswolf tore his hand off when it was bound. Nearth was there and his wife Shede, Free and Frow, Wíder the son of Weden. Lock was there, and the servants of Free Bew and Beal. There was a great deal of Eese and Elves.

2 sem nú er sagt 'as was just told' | In immediately preceding *Hym*.

5–6 Fenrisulfr sleit hönd af hánum, þá er hann var bundinn 'the Fenrerswolf tore his hand off when it was bound' | This detail is presumably brought up on the basis of sts. 38–39; for the myth see there.

- P2 Égir átti tvá þjónustu-menn, Fima-fengr ok Eldir. Þar var lýsi-
 2 gull haft fyr elds-ljós; sjalft bar=sk þar ql. Þar var griða-stadr
 mikill. Menn lofuðu mjök hversu góðir þjónustu-menn Égis
 4 vóru. Loki mátti eigi heyra þat, ok drap hann Fimafeng. Þá
 skóku ésir skjöldu sína ok óptu at Loka, ok eltu hann braut til
 6 skógar, en þeir fóru at drekka. Loki hvarf aptr ok hitti úti Eldi;
 Loki kvaddi hann:

Eage had two servants, Femfinger and Elder. There glowing gold was used instead of fire; the ale there carried itself. That was a great place of griths. The folk greatly praised how good the servants of Eage were. Lock could not stand to hear that, and he slew Femfinger. Then the Eese shook their shields and screamed at Lock and chased him away to the woods, but they left to drink. Lock turned back and hit upon Elder outside. Lock greeted him:

2 gríða-stadr ‘place of griths’ | A *gríðr* ‘grith’ being a form of temporary truce of non-violence (LMNL, s.v. *gríð*). The *gríða-stadr* was thus a place wherein all violence was forbidden, as was typical in shrines (wighs) and at legal assemblies (Things). This detail is important for the narrative, since it explains why Lock can insult the Gods without repercussions for most of the poem.

4–5 Þá skóku ęsir skjöldu sína ok óptu ‘Then the Eese shook their shields and screamed’ | Apparently in some sort of ancient war dance. Cf. the Old Swedish Heathen Law: *ępr hann þrý ní-ęp* ‘He screams three nithing-screams TODO’.

The Flying of Lock

1 „Seg þú þat, Ełdir, · svá’t ęinu=gi
2 feti gangir framarr,
hvat hér inni · hafa at ęl-mólum
4 sig-tíva synir.“

[R 15r/17]

“TELL THIS, ELDER, so that thou not
takest one step further:
What here within they say over their ale,
the sons of the victory-Tews.”

1–2 svá’t ... framarr ‘so that ... further’ | Shared with *Háv* 38.

3 hafa at ęl-mólum ‘they say over the ale’ | Lit. “they have for their ale-speeches”.

4 sig-tíva synir ‘sons of the victory-Tews’ | The gods, the ‘sons of the Gods’ [= the Gods] being a common kenning-type.

Ełdir: 2 „Of vępn sĳn dǫma · ok of vĳg-risni sĳna
2 sig-tíva synir;
asa ok alfa, · es hér inni eru,
4 mann=gi ’s þér ĳ orđi vinr.“

[R 15r/18]

Quoth Elder: “Of their weapons they speak and of their battle-prowess,
the sons of the victory-Tews.
Of the Eese and Elves which are here within
none is thee a friend in words.”

4 mann=gi ’s þér ĳ orđi vinr. ‘none is thee a friend in words.’ | I.e., ‘nobody says anything good about you’.

Something may be said about the alliteration in this line and also in 10/1 below (*Við-arr : ulfs*). It is unambiguous in both instances that the semi-vowel *v* (/w/) is participating in vowel-alliteration with *a*, something occasionally allowed in Norse Eddic poems but never in Norse Scaldic or West Germanic poetry. These are however the only occurrences of this type of alliteration in *Lok* (cf. st. 36/4 below). An intriguing explanation is if the alliteration originally fell exclusively on *v*-. This is possible due to the fact that in both the present st. and 10/1 the vowel-words *orð* ‘word’ and *ulfr* ‘wolf’ originally began with *v*- (PN **worda*, **wulfar*), which in the case of *ulfr* is attested in archaic runic inscriptions. For metrical reasons *Lok* must postdate the syncope of unstressed short vowels in some positions, but on the basis of the three closely related 7th c. runestones from Blekinge (DR 357 Stentofte, DR 358 Gummarp, DR 359 Istaby) this syncope is known to predate the loss of *w* before rounded vowels (e.g. DR 359 *hǫpwwulafir* *Hǫpu-wul^afir*).

If we look away from the possibility of pure coincidence, which is not impossible, there are two explanations. The first is that *Lok* was in fact composed in the 7th or perhaps 8th c. when the semi-vowel was still retained; certainly the poem has archaic features (see Dating above), but this is extremely daring. A more likely explanation is that the alliteration reflects archaic poetic formulae or perhaps a vague intuition that only certain vowel-words should alliterate with *v*-. The fact that West Germanic does not allow alliteration between vowels and *w*- suggests that this license most likely arose in North Germanic following the loss of *w*- before rounded vowels, and an intuition for which pairs felt ‘right’ would likely have existed in the earliest period of composition following this change. In any case this seems to be yet another argument for an early date of *Lok*, for which cf. also 15/3 n. below.

In the C7th the Proto-Norse form of this line would have been **mann-gí ʒ þér in worðé winir*.

Loki kvað: 3 „Inn skal ganga · Égis hallir i
2 á þat sumbl at séa,
jöll ok ófu · fóri’k ása sonum
4 ok blænd’k þeim svá meini mjöð.“

[R 15r/20]

Quoth Lock: “I shall go into Eagre’s halls,
on that simble for to see.
Scorn and hatred I bring the sons of the Eese,
and so I mix their mead with evil.”

2 sumbl ‘simble’ | The Germanic word for “feast, banquet”.

3 jöll ok ófu ‘scorn and hatred’ | Two rare words to which the present translation hardly does justice. The former occurs nowhere else, while the latter only otherwise occurs in *Sigsk* 33. They have been interpreted in a variety of ways: CV sees the first word as *jöll* ‘wild angelica’, whereas the second is taken to be an error for *áfr* (“a beverage [...] translated by Magnaeus by *sorbitio avenacea*, a sort of common ale brewed of oats”). TODO: What do other editors say? Esp. Kommentar.

4 blænd’k ... meini mjöð ‘I mix ... mead with evil’ | Formulaic, cf. *Sigrðr* 8 (and others TODO).

Elðir kvað: 4 „Veitst, ef inn gengr · Égis hallir i
2 á þat sumbl at séa,
hrópi ok rógi · ef eyss á holl rēgin,
4 á þér munu þau þerra þat.“

[R 15r/22]

Quoth Elder: “Thou knowest, if thou goest into Eagre’s halls,
on that simble for to see—
if slander and strife thou pourest on the hold Reins,
on *thee* will they dry it off!”

Loki kvað: 5 „Veitst þat **E**ldir, · ef **ç**inir skulum [R 15r/24]
 2 sár-yrðum saka=sk,
 auðigr verða · mun'k i and-svorum,
 4 ef þú mēlir til mart!“

Quoth Lock: “Thou knowest, Elder, if one-on-one we shall
 bandy wounding words,
 wealthy will I in my answers grow
 if thou speak too much!”

2 sár-yrðum saka=sk ‘bandy wounding words’ | Reoccurring at st. 19/2.

4 ef þú mēlir til mart! ‘if thou speak too much!’ | Formulaic; cf. *Háv* 27.

P3 Síðan gekk Loki inn í holl'ina; en er þeir sá, er fyrir váru, hverr [R 15r/25]
 2 inn var kominn, þögnuðu þeir allir.

Thereafter Lock went into the hall, but when those who were further within
 saw who had come inside they all turned silent.

Loki kvað: 6 „Þyrstr ek kom · þessar hallar til [R 15r/27]
 2 Loptr of langan veg,
 ֆsu at biðja, · at mér çinn gefi
 4 mēran drykk mjaðar.

Quoth Lock: “Thirsty I came to these halls,
 Loft (= Lock), over a long way,
 to bid the Eese that they give me but one
 famed drink of mead.

4 mēran drykk mjaðar ‘famed drink of mead’ | Formulaic language for describing mead; cf. *Háv* 105, 140, *Ski* 16. TODO: more parallels.

7 Hví þegið ér svá · þrungen goð, [R 15r/28]
 2 at mēla né mēguð;
 sessa ok staði · velið mér sumbli at,
 4 eða heitið mik heðan!“

Why shut ye up so, ye pressed Gods,
 that ye cannot speak?
 Choose seats and places for me at the simble,
 or call me away hence!”

3–4 sessa ... heðan! ‘Choose ... hence!’ | That is, “Cease your dallying; give me a seat or tell me to leave!”

Bragi: 8 „Sessa ok staði · vęlja þér sumbli at

[R 15r/30]

2 ęsir aldri=gi;

því't ęsir vitu · hveim alda skulu

4 gamban-sumbl of geta.“

Bray: “Choose seats and places for thee at the simble
the Eese will never do,
for the Eese know for which man they shall
prepare the gomben-simble.”

3 hveim alda ‘which man’ | Here “person, being”. See note to *Vafþ* 55/6.

4 gamban-sumbl ‘gomben-simble’ | *gamban-* ‘gomben-’ being an obscure prefix which apart from the present instance also occurs in *Ski* 32, 33 and *Hárb* 20. CV suggest it means something like ‘costly’, but most editors connect it with magic.

[Loki:] 9 „Mant þat Óðinn, · es vit i ár-daga

[R 15r/32]

2 blendum blóði saman?

ęlvi þęrgja · lét=sk ęgi mundu,

4 nema okkr vęri bōðum borit.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Recallest thou, Weden, when we in days of yore
blended our blood together?
Thou didst declare thou wouldst ne’er taste ale,
unless it were for us both borne forth!”

ALL | Lock turns to Weden, chief of the Eese, and reminds him of an oath of blood-brotherhood the two undertook in the early days of the world. The circumstances of this oath are otherwise entirely unknown.

[Óðinn:] 10 „Rís þá Við·arr · ok lát ulfs fōður

[R 15r/34]

2 sitja sumbli at,

síðr oss Loki · kvęði lasta-stōfum

4 Ęgis hōllu i.“

[Quoth Weden:] “Then rise, Wider, and let the Wolf’s father [= Lock]
sit at the simble,
lest Lock greet us with words of blame
in Eagre’s hall.”

1 Rís þá Við·arr · ok lát ulfs fōður ‘Then rise, Wider, and let the Wolf’s father’ | For the alliteration see note to st. 2/4. In the C7th the Proto-Norse form of this line would have been **Rís þan Wiðarr · auk lát wulfs fōður*.

P4 Þá stóð Við·arr upp ok skenkti Loka, en áðr hann drykki, kvaddi
2 hann ósu’na:

[R 15v/1]

Then Wider stood up and poured a drink to Lock, but before he [= Lock] drank, he greeted the Eese:

- 11 „Heilir **ę**sir, · heilar **ę**synjur [R 15v/3]
 2 ok ęll ginn-heiļęę **ę**ęđ,
 nema sá **ę**inn **ę**ss · es innar sitr
 4 **B**ragi **b**ękkjum á.“
 “Hail the Eese! Hail the Ossens,
 and all yin-holy Gods!
 But for that one os who sits further within:
 Bray, upon the benches.”

ALL | The first line is identical to the prayer in *Sigrđr* 4. An intriguing possibility suggests itself, viz. that this formula for hailing the Gods may actually have been used in Heathen drinking-toasts, where the second helming (ll. 3–4) would follow the hailing by asking for gifts. If this is the case it would greatly increase the dramatic effect of Lock’s insult in ll. 3–4, since he, instead of asking for a boon, subverts the prayer by insulting one of the gods present, something that would have been come off as shocking to the Heathen audience expecting a typical prayer.

- [Bragi] kvađ: 12 „Mar ok **m**ęki · gef’k þér **m**įns fęar [R 15v/4]
 2 ok **b**ótir þér svá **b**augi Bragi,
 síđr þú **ę**sum · **ę**fund of gįaldir;
 4 **ę**ęm þú **ę**igi **ę**ęđ at þér!“
 Quoth [Bray]: “Steed and sword I give thee of my own wealth
 and so Bray restores thee with a bigh,
 lest thou with envy repay the Eese;
 anger not the Gods against thee!”

1 Mar ok męki ‘Steed and sword’ | Formulaic pair; cf. *Háv* 83/2.

2 bótir þér svá baugi ‘restores thee with a bigh’ | Cf. the comment in *Hárđ* 42.

- [Loki] kvađ: 13 „Jós ok arm-bauga · munt **ę** vesa [R 15v/6]
 2 **b**ęggja vanr Bragi,
 asa ok **a**ľa, · es hér inni eru,
 4 þú est við **v**íg **v**arastr,
 ok **s**kįarrastr við **s**kot.“
 Quoth [Lock]: “Of horse and arm-bighs wilt thou always be
 both lacking, Bray!
 Of the Eese and Elves which are here within
 thou art wariest of war
 and shiest of shot.”

- [Bragi] kvað: 14 „Vei't'k, ef fyr útan véra'k, · svá sem fyr innan em'k, [R 15v/8]
 2 Égis höll of kominn,
 höfuð þitt · béra'k i hendi mér;
 4 lít*'k þér þat fyr lygi.“

Quoth [Bray]: “I know if I were without, as I am within
 come into Eagre's hall,
 that head of thine would I hold in my hands;
 this I see for thy lie.”

1 fyr | 'pyr' R 4 lít*'k þér þat fyr lygi | 'litt ec þer þat fyr lygi' R

1 Vei't'k, ef fyr útan véra'k, · svá sem fyr innan em'k 'I know if I were without, as I am within' | As said in P1, the law of grith (a legally binding pact or pledge of non-violence, even between enemies) applies inside the hall, and Bray and the other gods are bound by it not to injure Lock.

2 Égis höll of kominn | The alliteration in this line is highly questionable since the particle *of* is otherwise always unstressed, let alone subject to alliteration. Any metrical investigation should exclude it as likely corrupt.

4 lít*'k þér þat fyr lygi | In the ms. 'tt' (in 'litt') is written with a single *t* with a small dot above which marks it out as doubled. I see this abbreviation as an erroneous insertion. A variety of other emendations have been proposed for this line, e.g. *litt es þér þat fyr lygi* 'that is little [punishment] for thee for lying'. Based on the similarity of *ē* (= *tt*) and *c* Finnur Jónsson (1932) gives *lyka'k þér þat fyr lygi* 'that I would bring thee for thy lie'.

- [Loki] kvað: 15 „Snjallr est i sessi, · skal=at-tu svá gera, [R 15v/10]
 2 Bragi þekk-skrautuðr;
 vega þú gakk · ef vręiðr séir;
 4 hygg=sk vętr hvatr fyrir.“

Quoth [Lock]: “Valiant art thou in the seat. Thou shalt not do so,
 Bray the bench-adorned!
 Go to strike if thou art wroth;
 the bold thinks not ahead.”

ALL | Lock calls out Bray's excuse. A truly brave (*hvatr*) man would break even the grith to avenge such a severe personal insult, as Thunder indeed is willing to do (st. 64 below).

3 vega ... vręiðr 'strike ... wroth' | Formulaic, the alliterative word-pair *vega* : *vręiðr* otherwise also occurs in *Fáfn* 7/2, 17/2, 30/2, *Sigrdr* 25/2. — The restoration of *v-* before *r* is required by the meter, likewise at 18/4, 27/4. This is an archaic feature; cf. *Háv* 26/2 n.

- [Íðunn] kvað: 16 „Bið ek, Bragi, · barna-sifjar duga [R 15v/11]
 2 ok allra ósk-maga,
 at þú Loka · kveðir=a lasta-stofum
 4 Égis höllu i.“

Quoth [Ídin]: “I bid thee, Bray, to suit the ties of children
 and all adopted sons,

that thou not greet Lock with words of blame
in Eagre's hall."

[Loki] kvað: 17 „Þegi þú, Iðunn, · þik kveð'k allra kvinna
2 ver-gjarnasta vesa
síðst þú arma þína · lagðir ítr-þvegna
4 umb þinn bróður-bana.“

[R 15v/13]

Quoth [Lock]: “Shut up, Idin! I call thee of all women
the most man-eager,
since thou didst lay thy brightly washed arms
around thy brother's bane.”

[Iðunn] kvað: 18 „Loka ek kveð'k=a · lasta-stöfum
2 Égis hollu i;
Braga ek kyrrí · bjór-rēifan,
4 vil'k=at at it vreiðir vegi=sk.“

[R 15v/15]

Quoth [Idin]: “I do not greet Lock with words of blame
in Eagre's hall;
I do calm Bray, made rowdy from beer—
I wish not that ye two, wroth, should fight.”

[Geḟjun] kvað: 19 „Hví it ęsir tveir · skuluð inni hér
2 sár-yrðum saka=sk?
Lopt*-ki þat vęit · at hann lęikinn es
4 ok hann fјorg ęll f*ía.

[R 15v/16]

Quoth [Yiven]: “Why shall ye two Eese here within
bandy wounding words?
Loft (= Lock) knows not that he is crazed,
and all the Farrows (= Gods) hate him.”

3 Lopt*-ki | ‘lopci’ R 4 fјorg ęll ‘all the Farrows’ | ‘fiorgvall’ R. 4 f*ía ‘hate’ | fria R

ALL | By reading l. 3a *lopci þat vęit* as an impersonal construct, adopting the sense ‘playful’ of l. 3b *lęikinn* and not emending l. 4 *fria* the rhetorical function of the stanza has been understood by some editors (e.g. Sijmons and Gering, Pettit) as Yiven's attempt to play down Lock's insults: “Is it not well known that Lock is playful and that all the Gods love him?” Yet in the context of the narrative this can hardly be accurate, since Lock has already killed a servant and insulted both Bray and Idin.

3 Lopt*-ki þat vęit ‘Loft knows not’ | For the rare poetic construction where a verb is negated by suffixing -gi ‘not, no’ to the stem of the subject cf. sts. 29/4 and 39/3 below. — Sijmons and Gering, Pettit and others here read an impersonal construction ‘is it not known about Lock’, etc.

3 lęikinn ‘crazed’ | This word typically occurs in the sense ‘playful’ but the sense ‘bewitched’, here understood as ‘crazed’, is attested in ON; cf. *Vsp* 21/3 and *Prestssaga Guðmundar góða* 19 in *Sturlunga (leikinn af flagði einu* ‘bewitched by a certain trollwoman’).

4 *fjorg* ǥll ‘all the Farrows’ | *‘fjorgvall’* is taken as an error for **‘fjorg avll’*, norm. *fjorg ǥll*. Mezger (1944)’s suggestion of a masc. acc. pl. *fjergu alla* is metrically impossible and leaves the verb without a subject. —

fjorg ‘Farrows’ (sg. *fjarg*) is a rare and archaic (pantheistic) neuter term for the Gods most likely derived from PGmc. **ferga* ‘vital forces(?)’, related to the root of **ferbuq* ‘body, life-force’ (> ON *fjor* ‘id.’). The term has no direct equivalents in other Gmc. languages but the related word **ferbuq* is found in the name of the Roman-era Germanic goddesses the *Alaferbviae* (< PGmc. **ala-firbuwizōz* ‘all-life giving ones(?)’) as attested on Latin-inscribed altars from the Rhineland (TODO: cite).

ON *fjarg* is never otherwise used as a simplex but does appear in the cpds. *fjarg-bús* ‘god-house(?)’ (*Akv* 43/4, 46/3) and *fjarg-vefr* ‘god-weave, silk’ (a poetic variant of *gōð-vefr* ‘id.’; ÞKolb Lv 12 in SkP 5) which confirm its sense of ‘Gods’. It is found in a few additional cpds. in modern Icelandic (Ásgeir Blöndal Magnússon 1989, s.v. *fjarg*-).

4 *f*ia* ‘hate’ | *fria* means ‘love’ but is emended to its antonym *fia* ‘hate’ since the statement that all the Gods love Lock can hardly be defended when he has already killed one of their servants and it is only very reluctantly that they let him back in. Cf. *Hym* 22 for the Gods’ hatred of one of Lock’s children, the Middenyardswyrm.

[Loki] kvað: 20 „Þegi þú, Gefjun, · þess mun’k nú geta
2 es þik glapði at gęði:
svęinn inn hvíti · es þér sigli gaf
4 ok þú lagðir lęr yfir.“

[R 15v/18]

Quoth [Lock]: “Shut up, Yiven! *Him* will I now mention,
who seduced thy senses:
the white-hued swain who gave thee a necklace,
and thou laidest o’er him thy leg!”

ALL | The truth of the insult is questionable since Yiven is said to be a virgin. So *Gylf* 35:5: *Fjóðā er Gefjun. Hón er męr, ok benni þjónā þęr, er meýjar anda=sk.* ‘The fourth [goddess] is Yiven. She is a maiden and those women serve her who die as maidens.’

3 sigli ‘necklace’ | A very rare poetic word ultimately derived from Latin *sigillum*. It only occurs in two other places in the Old Norse corpus: *Sigsk* 49/3 and KormQ Lv 56 (SkP 5).

4 lagðir lęr yfir ‘laidest o’er him thy leg’ | A cynical variant of *Háv* 108/4 (*lęgð=umk arm yfir*).

[Óðinn kvað] þat: 21 „Örr est, Loki, · ok ør·viti,
2 es þú fęr þér Gefjun at gręmi
því’t aldar ør-løg · hygg at ǥll of viti
4 jafn-gor=la sem ek.“

[R 15v/20]

This [quoth Weden]: “Mad art thou, Lock, and out of thy wits
when thou rousest Yiven’s wrath against thee,
for all the orlays of men I think she knows
quite as clearly as I.”

1 Örr ... ok ør·viti ‘Mad ... and out of thy wits’ | Formulaic line, also occurring in 2 *HHund* 34 and *Oddr* 15. Cf. also st. 47 and G1 below.

[Loki] kvað: 22 „Þegi þú, Óðinn, · þú kunnir aldri=gi

[R 15v/22]

2 deila víg með verum;
 opt þú gaft · þeim's gefa skyldir=a,
 4 inum slévvurum, sigr.“

Quoth [Lock]: “Shut up, Weden! Thou couldst never
 deal out war amidst men—
 oft thou gavest to those thou shouldst not have given,
 to the duller men victory.”

[Óðinn] kvað: 23 „Veitst ef ek gaf · þeim's gefa né skylda,
 2 inum slévvurum, sigr,
 áttu vetr · vast fyr jörð neðan
 4 kýr mólkandi ok kona
 ok hefir þar börn of borit
 6 ok hugða'k þat args aðal.“

[R 15v/24]

Quoth [Weden]: “Thou knowest, if I gave to to those I should not have given,
 to the duller men victory,
 for eight winters wast thou beneath the earth
 a milch cow and a woman,
 and there hast thou borne children,
 and I've judged that a queer's nature!”

5 *börn of* | *sens. and metr. emend.* (cf. st. 33/4 below); *om.* R

4 kýr mólkandi 'a milch cow' | This phrase may also be read as “milking cows”, the form *kýr* being grammatically ambiguous between nom. sg. and acc. pl., and *mólka* meaning both 'to milk' and 'to give milk'. “Milch cow” (cows, of course, only giving milk after calving) is preferable for several reasons. Firstly, the phrase is followed by *ok kona* 'and a woman' rather than *sem kona* 'as a woman' or similar; secondly, it conforms to a known pattern of insults between men where the insultee is equated with a woman and said to have been impregnated (cf. 1 *HHund*); thirdly, it agrees well with another instance where Lock shapeshifts into a female animal and gives birth, namely the episode of the building of the wall around Osyard as told in *Gylf* 42 and alluded to in *Vsp* 24–25 (n.).

[Loki] kvað: 24 „En þik síga kóðu · Sams-eyju i
 2 ok drapt á vett sem vödur,
 vitka líki · fórt ver-þjóð yfir,
 4 ok hugða'k þat args aðal.“

[R 15v/26]

Quoth [Lock]: “But thou, they said, didst sink down into Samsey,
 and didst beat on the drum like wallows.
 In a warlock's likeness didst thou journey o'er the folk of men
 and I've judged that a queer's nature!”

ALL | For Weden taking the shape of a witch or warlock cf. the story of Wrind (*Vsp* 31 n.) TODO: elaborate on the feminine nature of this type of magic.

1 Sams-eyju ‘Samsey’ | *Samsø* in Denmark, which features prominently in later legendary literature. TODO: cite.

2 drapt á vett sem vǫlur ‘didst beat on the drum like wallows’ | A reference to “shaman”-like drums as attested in the later Lappish religion. TODO: elaborate.

[Frigg kvað:] 25 „Ør-łogum ykkrum · skylið aldri=gi [R 15v/28]
 2 sęgja sęggjum frá,
 hvat it ęsir tveir · drýgðuð i ár-daga;
 4 firri=sk ę forn røk firar.“

[Quoth Frig:] “Of your orlays should ye two never
 speak to the youth.
 Whatsoever ye two Eese did in days of yore,
 let ancient tales be ever shunned by folk.”

[Loki kvað:] 26 „Þęgi þú, Frigg, · þú est Fjörgyns męr [R 15v/30]
 2 ok hęfir ę ver-gjörn vesit,
 es þa Vęa ok Vilja · létst þér, Viðris kvęn,
 4 baða i baðm of tękit.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Shut up, Frie! Thou art Firgyn’s maiden
 and hast always been eager for men,
 [like] when thou Wigh and Will—O Withrer’s wife—
 both in thy bosom didst take.”

3 Vęa ok Vilja ‘Will and Wigh’ | Weden’s brothers. The event alluded to here is a myth where Weden is exiled from the Eese and his wife, Frie, instead marries his two brothers. So *Yng 3: Óðinn átti tvá bróðr, hét annarr Vę, en annarr Vili; þeir bróðr hans stjórðu ríki’nu, þá er hann var í brottu. Þat var eitt sinn, þá er Óðinn var fjarinn langt í brott ok hafði lengi dvaltsk, at ósum þótti ør-vęnt hans heim; þá tóku bróðr hans at skipta arfi hans, en konu hans Frigg gęngu þeir báðir at eiga. En litlu síðar kom Óðinn heim, tók hann þá við konu sinni.* ‘Weden had two brothers; one was called Wigh, the other Will. Those brothers of his ruled the realm when he was departed. It was one time when Weden had journeyed far away and had tarried for long that the Eese thought his homecoming unlikely. Then his brothers took to divide his inheritance, but his wife Frie they both went to own. But a short while later Weden came home; then he took back his wife.’

[Frigg kvað:] 27 „Vęitst ef inni ętta’k · ęgis hollum i [R 15v/32]
 2 Baldri líkan bur
 út né kvęmir · frá asa sonum
 4 ok vęri þa at þér vřęiðum vęgit.“

[Quoth Frig:] “Thou knowest, if I had within Eagre’s halls
 a boy like Balder,
 thou camest out from the sons of the Eese,
 and wouldst, wroth man, be fought!”

- [Loki kvað:] **28** „Einn vill þú, Frigg, · at ek fleiri telja [R 16r/1]
 2 mīna meīn-stafi:
 ek því réð · es þú ríða sér=at
 4 síðan Baldr at solum.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Still wilt thou, Frie, that I recount more
 of my evil deeds:
 It was my doing that thou dost not henceforth see
 Balder ride to the halls.”

ALL | Lock caused the death of Balder, as alluded to in *Vsp* 31–33 (see note there) and *Bdr* 8–11 and described in depth in *Gylf* 49. It is probably this admission of guilt that seals Lock's fate.

- [Fręyja kvað:] **29** „Örr est, Loki, · es þú yðra telr [R 16r/3]
 2 ljóta leið-stafi;
 or·lög Frigg · hygg at ǫll viti
 4 þó'tt hön sjölf=gi sęgi.“

[Quoth Frow:] “Mad art thou, Lock, when thou dost recount
 your ugly, loathsome deeds!
 All orlays I think Frie knows,
 though she says them not herself.”

- [Loki kvað:] **30** „Þęgi þú, Fręyja, · þik kann'k full-görva; [R 16r/4]
 2 es=a þér vamma vant:
 ása ok alfa, · es hér inni eru,
 4 hveřr hęfir þinn hór vesit.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Shut up, Frow! I know thee full well—
 thou art not free of blemishes.
 Of the Eese and Elves which are here within
 each has been thy lover!”

ALL | For Frow's promiscuity cf. *Drk* 13/4 n.

2 vamma vant ‘free of blemishes’ | Formulaic, cf. *Háv* 22/4: *bann es=a vamma vanr* ‘he is not free of blemishes’.

- [Fręyja kvað:] **31** „Fló 's þér tunga, · hygg at þér fręmr myni [R 16r/6]
 2 ð·gótt of gala;
 vreiðir 'ro þér ęsir · ok ęsynjur,
 4 hryggr munt hęim fara.“

[Quoth Frow:] “False is thy tongue, I think it further will
 sing evil [into being] for thee.

Wroth with thee are the Eese and the Ossens:
grieved wilt thou journey home.”

1 *myni* | ‘mý’ R

ALL | Frow foresees the future and makes a prophecy. Lock will come to regret his insults.

1 Fló’s þér tunga ‘False is thy tongue’ | Cf. *Háv* 118/3: *flá-rðð tunga* ‘false-counseling tongue’.

2 ó-gótt of gala; ‘sing evil [into being] for thee’ | The same expression is found in *Háv* 29/4, which also advises keeping one’s tongue in check.

- Loki: 32 „Þegi þú, Freyja, · þú est for-déða [R 16r/8]
2 ok meini blandin mjök,
síðst-u at bróðr þinum · síðu blíð regin
4 ok myndir þá, Freyja, frata.“
Lock: “Shut up, Frow! Thou art an evil-working woman,
and mixed with much evil,
since towards thy brother the blithe Reins bewitched thee
and then wouldst thou, O Frow, fart.”

ALL | Lock accuses Frow of committing incest with her brother (Free) while bewitched by the Gods. Incest between siblings is particularly associated with the family of Nearth; cf. how Nearth is said to have begotten Free by his sister in st. 36 below.

3 blíð regin ‘the blithe Reins’ | A reverent formulaic epithet for the Gods, here used blasphemously. It otherwise occurs in *Grm* 6/1, 38/3 and 42/1. For another instance of Lock sarcastically using reverent language cf. st. 11/1–2 above.

4 þá ‘then’ | In the act of (incestual) coitus, an especially graphic insult.

- Njörðr: 33 „Þat ’s vó-lítit · þó’tt sér varðir vers fái, [R 16r/10]
2 hós eða hvárs;
hitt ’s undr, es oss ragr · es hér inn of kominn
4 ok hefir sá börn of borit.“
Nearth: “It is little woe that women get themselves a man,
a lover or whomever else,
on the other hand it is a wonder when a queer Os has come here within,
and that man has borne children!”

- Loki: 34 „Þegi þú, Njörðr, · þú vast austr heðan [R 16r/12]
2 gísl of sendr at goðum;
Hymis meýjar · hófðu þik at hland-trogi
4 ok þér i munn migu.“
Lock: “Shut up, Nearth! Thou wast to the east hence
sent as hostage for the Gods.

Hymer's daughters had thee for a lant-trough
and pissed thee in the mouth!"

ALL | For Nearth as a hostage cf. *Vafþ* 39.

Njörðr: 35 „Sú es=umk líkn · es vas'k langt heðan
2 gísl of sēndr at goðum:
þà ek mōg gat · þann's mann=gi fiar,
4 ok þikkir sá ása jaðarr.“

[R 16r/14]

Nearth: “This is my relief since I was far-away hence
sent as hostage for the Gods,
when I begot the lad whom no man hates
and he seems the peak of the Eese.”

3 mōg ... þann's mann=gi fiar ‘the lad whom no man hates’ | Free.

Loki: 36 „Hētt-u nú, Njörðr, · haf á hófi þik;
2 mun'k=a því lēyna lēngr:
við systur þinni · gatst s·líkan mōg,
4 ok es=a þó vōnu verr.“

[R 16r/16]

Lock: “Cease now, Nearth; restrain thyself!
I will no longer hide it:
by thy own sister didst thou beget such a lad
and naught can be expected worse.”

4 vōnu | ónu R.

4 ok es=a þó vōnu verr | R's ónu is dat. sg. of *vōn* ‘expectation’ with fronting of nasal *ō* > *ó* and loss of *v* before *o*. This fronting, which is an irregular sound change often flattened by analogy, can be tracked in Scaldic poetry using the name *Q-leiðr* ~ *Q-láfr* ‘Anlaf’ (< Proto-Norse **Anu-laibar*) with a nasal root vowel. In Scaldic poetry the earliest instance of the name forming an ethelhending with *ó* rather than an *á* or *ō* is from c. 1070 CE, Steinn *Óldr* 5/4b: *Q-láfr borinn sólu* (SkP 2). Since *Lok* is undoubtedly older than 1070 (see Dating above) it is justified to restore *vōnu*.

Týr: 37 „Fręyr 's bętstr · allra ball-riða
2 ása gōrðum i;
męy né grótir · né manns konu,
4 ok lęysir ór hoptum hvern.“

[R 16r/17]

Tew: “Free is the best of all bold riders
in the Yards of the Eese;
he makes no maiden weep nor any man's woman,
and loosens each from his bonds!”

2 ása gǫrðum ‘the Yards of the Eese’ | I.e., Oyard.

- Loki: 38 „Þegi þú, Týr, · þú kunnir aldri=gi
2 bera tilt með tveim;
handar ennar hógri · mun’k hinnar geta
4 es þér sleit Fēnrir frá.“

[R 16r/19]

Lock: “Shut up, Tew! Thou couldst never
settle strife between two;
the right hand will I mention next,
which from thee Fenrer tore.”

2 bera tilt með tveim ‘settle strife between two’ | Lit. ‘carry conciliatory [words] between two.’ This statement appears to be what Snorre alludes to in *Gylf* 25:12: *ok er hann ein-bendr ok ekki kallaðr sēttir manna* ‘and he is one-handed, and not called a reconciler of men’. The sense seems to be that Tew’s one-handedness is also the reason why he, as a war god, cannot grant equal victory to both sides. — *tilt* ‘conciliatory [words]’ is a hapax, n. acc. sg. of **tilr*, cognate with OE *til* ‘good, upstanding’, Gothic *ga-tils* ‘fitting, convenient’. The use of this old Germanic word in the poem is undoubtedly an archaism.

3–4 handar ... frá. ‘the right ... tore.’ | A reference to a myth told in *Gylf* 25:9–12 and at greater length in *Gylf* 34:10–42. Lock begat three children with the ettin-woman Angerbode, one of which was the Fenrerswolf. It grew quickly and Tew alone was brave enough to feed it. When the spæes of the Eese foretold that the Wolf would be of great harm to them they resolved to bind it. They twice tried to make fetters and convinced the Wolf to prove its strength by breaking them, yet both times it did so. At last they made the great fetter Glapner (for which cf. *Eddbr* VIII), but the Wolf was clever and understood that it would not be able to break it. The Gods promised to release him even if he could not break it, but the Wolf did not trust them and as a pledge of their honesty he asked one of them to place his hand in his mouth. Only Tew dared to do so. When the Wolf could not break the fetter he knew that he had been tricked, and so he bit off his hand. After this the Eese dragged the Wolf deep into a cave and bound him there to a great stone; in his mouth they stuck a sword so that he could not bite. The wolf drooled, and thereof flowed the great river named Ween, and in the cave he shall lie until the Twilight of the Reins. For the difference between Garm and the Fenrerswolf, if such a one originally existed, see *Vsp* 43/1–2.

- Týr: 39 „Handar em’k vanr · ęn þú hróðrs vitnis;
2 bǫl es þeggja þráa;
ulf=gi hęfir ok vel · es ĩ bǫndum skal
4 biða ragna rǫkr.“

[R 16r/21]

Tew: “A hand am I missing, but thou the Famous Wolf;
both yearnings are a bale!
Nor does the Wolf have it well which in its bonds
shall await the Twilight of the Reins.”

3 ulf=gi hęfir ok vel · es ĩ bǫndum skal | Alliteration is absent from this otherwise metrically acceptable line and no obvious emendation suggests itself.

- Loki: 40 „Þegi þú, Týr, · þat varð þinni konu

[R 16r/23]

2 at hōn átti mōg við mér!
 Qln né þenning · hafðir þess aldri=gi
 4 van-réttis, vę-sall.“

Lock: “Shut up, Tew! It happened to thy woman
 that she had a son by me!
 No ell [of wool] nor penny gotst thou ever for that
 injustice, O wretch!”

ALL | This event is entirely unsubstantiated, and Tew’s nameless wife is not known from any other source.

3 Qln ‘ell [of wool]’ | Wool, measured in ells, was often used for barter in Iceland and Norway.

3 þenning ‘penny’ | A hapax in the Poetic Edda, *þenningr* only appears thrice in Scaldic poetry. Its use by Bray the Old (*Rdr* 12) does however suggest its early presence in the language.

Fręyr: 41 „Ulf sé’k liggja · áar-ósi fyrir
 und’s rjúfa=sk ręgin;
 því munt nęst, · nema nú þęgir,
 4 bundinn, bqlva smiðr!“

[R 16r/25]

Free: “The Wolf I see lying before the river-mouth
 until the Reins are ripped;
 there wilt thou next—unless thou now shut up—
 be bound, O smith of bales!”

1 áar-ósi fyrir ‘before the river-mouth’ | The river Ween, which flows from the Wolf’s mouth. For Snorre’s explanation of this see st. 38/3–4 n.

2 und’s rjúfa=sk ręgin ‘until the Reins are ripped’ | During the Rakes of the Reins. Formulaic; see note to *Bdr* 14/4.

Loki: 42 „Golli kępta · létst Gymis dóttur
 ok sęldir þitt svá sverð,
 en es Mú-spells synir · riða Myrk-við yfir
 4 vęitst=a þà, vę-sall, hvé vęgr!“

[R 16r/26]

Lock: “With gold thou hadst Gymer’s daughter [= Gird] bought,
 and didst so sell thy sword,
 but when Muspell’s sons ride over Mirkwood
 then thou knowest not, O wretch, how to fight!”

ALL | Lock alludes to the events of *Skí*: Free gave his sword to his servant Shirner and sent him on a mission to convince Gird, Gymer’s daughter, to wed him. The mission was successful and Free and Gird were united, yet he did not get back his sword, for which he will suffer at his fight with Surt. See *Vęp* 51/3 n.

3 Mú-spells synir ‘Muspell’s sons’ | See *Vęp* 49/1 n.

Byggvir: 43 „Veitst ef **øðli** **étta**’k · sem **Ingunar**-Fręyr,
 2 ok **svá** **sél**=ligt setr:
męrgi smęra · **møð**ða’k þá **męin**-króku
 4 ok **lęm**ða alla **ĩ** **li**ðu.“

[R 16r/29]

Bewer: “Thou knowest, if I had pedigree like Ingwin-Free
 and such blessed pasture—
 finer than bone-meal would I mill this harm-crow,
 and beat all his limbs lame!”

ALL | Free’s servant Bewer (*Byggvir*, < *bygg* ‘barley’) comes to his defence.

1 øðli ‘pedigree’ | Free is the son of Nearth and the legendary ancestor of the Ingling dynasty originally based at Upsale.

1 Ingunar-Fręyr ‘Ingwin-Free’ | A rare (probably cultic) name for the god Free, whose usual name *Fręyr* originally simply means ‘Lord’.

Ingunar- appears to be the gen. of a name **Ingunn* and is probably related to OE *Ing-winas* ‘friends of Ing [DANES]’ (*Beow* 1044, 1319) and Latin *Ingæuonēs* ‘a Germanic tribe around the North Sea’ (Tacitus, *Germania* 2). It clearly contains the same root as *Yngvi* ‘Ing’, an earlier name for Free found in the 11st male given name *Inguiomerus* (Tacitus, *Annals* 1.60, 1.68, 2.17 et c.), the ON compound *Yngvi-Fręyr* ‘Ing-Free’ (i.e., “Lord Ing”), and the OE Rune Poem (rune 8, st. 22, where it is again associated with the Danes).

Loki: 44 „Hvat ’s þat it **litla** · es þat **lęggra** **sé**’k
 2 ok **snap**-víst **snapir**?
 At **ęyrum** Fręys · munt **ę** vesa
 4 ok und **kęrnum** **klaka**.“

[R 16r/31]

Lock: “What’s this little thing I see wagging its tail
 and snap-wisely snapping?
 At Free’s ears wilt thou always be
 and chirping under mills!”

1 lęggra ‘wagging its tail’ | A hapax; cognate with Danish and Norwegian *logre* ‘wag (one’s tail)’.

[Byggvir kvað:] 45 „Byggvir ek **heiti**, · en mik **bráðan** **kveða**
 2 **goð** ęll ok **gumar**;
 því em’k **hęr** **hródugr** · at **drekka** **Hropts** **męgir**
 4 **allir** ęl saman.“

[R 16r/32]

[Quoth Bewer:] “Bewer I am called, and hurried do call me
 all Gods and men.
 Therefore I am honoured here when Roft’s lads [the EEESE] drink
 ale all together.”

1 Byggvir | ‘Beyggvir’ R

2 goð ... ok gumar ‘Gods and men’ | This pairing also occurs in *Lok* 55/4 and *Reg* 19.

[Loki kvað:] 46 „Þegi þú, Byggvir, · þú kunnir aldri=gi [R 16v/1]
 2 deila með mǫnnum mat;
 ok þik i flets strái · finna né mǫttu
 4 þá's vǫgu verar.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Shut up, Bewer! Thou couldst never
 deal out food amidst men,
 and in the bench-straw they could not find thee
 when the warriors fought.”

[Hęim·dallr kvað:] 47 „Qlr est, Loki · svá't es ǫr·viti, [R 16v/3]
 2 hví né lęt=sk=a þú, Loki?
 því't of-drykkja · vęldr alda hęim
 4 es sına męlgi né man=at.“

[Quoth Homedall:] “Drunk art thou, Lock, so that thou art out of thy wits;
 why holdest thou not back, O Lock?
 For over-drinking makes every man
 no more mind his speech.”

[Loki kvað:] 48 „Þegi þú, Hęim·dallr, · þér vas i ár·daga [R 16v/5]
 2 it ljóta líf of lagit;
 ǫrgu baki · munt ę vesa
 4 ok vaka vǫrðr goða.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Shut up, Homedall! For *thee* in days of yore
 was thy ugly life laid down.
 With a stiff back wilt thou always be
 and waking, O Watchman of the Gods.”

2 líf of lagit ‘life laid down’ | His course of life was decreed by the Norns. Formulaic language; cf. *Ski* 13/4.

3 ǫrgu ‘stiff’ | ‘*argr*’ R is ambiguous since *ar* can represent both *ǫ* and *au*. It is here read as a form of *ǫrðgu*, n. dat. sg. of *ǫrðigr* ‘upright, arduous, harsh’, but it can also be read as *aurgu* ‘muddy’. The former is thought to give better sense since it specifies Homedall’s *ljóta líf* ‘ugly life’; “all that standing must hurt your back, Watchman of the Gods!”

4 vǫrðr goða ‘Watchman of the Gods’ | Formulaic epithet of Homedall, who had to guard the rainbow bridge of the Gods against their enemies. See *Grm* 13 n.

[Skaði kvað:] 49 „Lét't s þér, Loki; · mun=at-tu lęngi svá [R 16v/7]
 2 lęika lausum hala,
 því't þik á hjǫrvi skulu · ins hrím-kalda magar
 4 gǫrnum binda goð.“

[Quoth Shede:] “Thou takest it lightly, Lock—thou wilt not so for long
play with a loose tail,
for on a sword with thy rime-cold lad’s
guts the Gods shall bind thee.”

ALL | The speaker of sts. 49 and 51 is not indicated in **R** and is not directly named in Lock’s answers, but is certainly Shede. She would otherwise be the only deity mentioned in P1 without a speaking role, and Lock’s mention of the killing of Thedse (st. 50) is only effective if it relates personally to whomever he is attacking, which is only the case for Shede.

3–4 því at þik á hjörvi skulu · ins hrím-kalda magar / gornum binda goð. ‘for on a sword with thy rime-cold lad’s / guts the Gods shall bind thee’ | See P8 below.

[Loki kvað:] **50** „Veitst ef mik á hjörvi skulu · ins hrím-kalda magar
2 gornum binda goð,
fyrstr ok øfstr · vas’k at fjör-lagi
4 þar’s vér á Þjatsa þrifum.“

[R 16v/9]

[Quoth Lock:] “Thou knowest, if on a sword with my rime-cold lad’s
guts the Gods shall bind me,
first and highest was I in life-taking
where we laid hands on Thedse.”

4 þar’s vér á Þjatsa þrifum ‘where we laid hands on Thedse’ | A reference to a longwinded myth told most fully in *Skm* 2–4 and *Haustr* 2–13. After Idin was abducted by the ettin Thedse, the Eese forced Lock to recover her, which he set out to do by flying to his home in the shape of a hawk. When he found Idin he turned her into a nut, took her in his claws, and turned back to Osyard. Thedse quickly spotted him, set chase in the shape of an eagle, and was soon closing the distance. Standing in Osyard, the Eese saw the chase from afar and hurriedly threw wood shavings on the ground; just as Lock had flown over them they set fire to the shavings; the fire rose and scorched the wings of Thedse, who fell down to the ground and was killed. Not long thereafter, Shede, Thedse’s daughter, came to Osyard to avenge her father, but the gods convinced her to settle with them, after which she married Nearth. It is most sensible that Lock brings this myth up in order to insult Shede; cf. note to the previous st.

[Skaði kvað:] **51** „Veitst ef fyrstr ok øfstr · vast at fjör-lagi
2 þá’s ér á Þjatsa þrifuð,
frá mínum véum · ok vöngum skulu
4 þér é köld röð koma.“

[R 16v/11]

[Quoth Shede:] “Thou knowest that if thou wert first and highest in life-taking
when ye laid hands on Thedse:
from my wighs and wongs shall for thee
ever cold counsels come.”

3 frá mínum véum · ok vöngum ‘from my wighs and wongs’ | From her cultic sites; viz. her sanctuaries and sacred meadows.

[Loki kvað:] **52** „Léttari i mölum · vast við Lauf-eyjar son

[R 16v/12]

2 þá's lét=sk mér á bæð þinn boðit;
 getit verðor oss s'liks · ef vér gǫrva skulum
 4 telja vǫmm'in vǫt.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Lighter in thy words wast thou with Leafie's son [= Lock, me]
 when thou didst summon me to thy bed.
 Such will be said of us if we clearly shall
 recount our blemishes.

P5 Þá gekk Sif fram ok byrlaði Loka í hrím-kalki mjǫð ok mēlti: [R 16v/15]
 Then Sib stepped forth and poured for Lock mead in a rime-chalice, and
 spoke:

1 Sif | ; (prob. pointing to a corr. in the no longer extant margin) R

1 Sif | That Sib is the speaker is supported by the mention of her in P1 and by the fact that st. 54 mentions Thunder, her husband.

53 „Heill ves þú nú, Loki, · ok tak við hrím-kalki [R 16v/12]
 2 fullum forns mjaðar,
 hēldr þú hana ęina · látir með ása sonum
 4 vamma-lausa vesa.“

“Hale be thou now, Lock, and receive this rime-chalice,
 full of ancient mead,
 but thou oughtst to let me alone among the sons of the Eese
 remain blemish-less.”

4 vamma-lausa | gramm. emend.; vamma-lausum (dat. pl.) R.

1–2 Heill ... mjaðar ‘Hale ... mead’ | Formulaic; repeated identically in *Ski* 37/1–2.

3 hana ‘her’ | Sib speaks in the third person.

P6 Hann tók við horni ok drakk af: [R 16v/17]
 He received the horn and drank thereof:

54 „Ęin þú vérrir · ef þú svá vérrir, [R 16v/18]
 2 vǫr ok grǫm at veri;
 ęinn ek vęit, · svá't ek vita þikkj=umk,
 4 hór ok af Hlór-riða,
 ok vas þat sá inn lę-vísi Loki.“

“Alone wouldst thou remain, if thou hadst remained
 wary and wroth against menfolk.

I know one—whom I think me to know—
adulterer behind even Lorida's back—
and that was the guile-wise Lock!"

4 Hlór-riða 'Lorida' | "The Loud Rider", a common name for Thunder. It seems that Lock's mere mention of Thunder invites his presence, probably a suggestion of the efficacy of invoking this god when threatened by evil supernatural forces (see Lindow 1988).

The same thing occurs in several other myths, e.g. the Gods' dealing with the Master Builder (see *Vsp* 24–25) and when ettin Rungner is at the banquet of the Eese in *Skm* 24: *En er ósum leiddu-sk ofr-yrði bans, þá nefna þeir Þór. Því næst kom Þórr í þoll'ina ok hafði á lopti bamar'inn ok var all-reiðr ok spýrr, þverr því rēðr, er jotnar bund-vísir skulu þar drekka, eða þverr seldi Hrungni gríð at vera í Val-þoll eða því Freyja skal skenkja bonum sem at gildi ása.* 'But when the Eese grew tired of his boasting words, then they mention Thunder's name. Just thereafter Thunder came into the hall and had his hammer in the air and was all-wroth, asking whose doing it is that hundred-wise ettins shall drink there, or who gave Rungner grith to be in Walhall, or why Frow shall pour forth drinks for him like at the banquets of the Eese.'

5 lé-*visi* Loki 'guile-wise Lock' | Formulaic, also occurring in *Hym* 37. Cf. also *Vsp* 35 where Lock is called *lé-gjarn* 'guile-eager' and *Vsp* 17 where Lother (possibly to be identified with Lock) gives men *lé*, which may be an accusative form of *lé*.

[Beyla kvað:] 55 „Fjöll öll skjalfa, · hygg á fōr vesa
2 heiman Hlór-riða;
hann rēðr ró · þeim's rógir hér
4 gōð öll ok guma!“

[R 16v/20]

[Quoth Beal:] "The fells all quake—I think on his journey
from home Lorida must be.
He will bring to rest the one who here maligns
all the Gods and men!"

ALL | The mention of Thunder has invited his presence and Beal announces his coming.

1 Fjöll öll skjalfa 'The fells all quake' | The movement of gods, especially Thunder, is often signalled by cosmic disturbance. Cf. *Þrk* 21 n.

[Loki kvað:] 56 „Þegi þú, Beyla, · þú est Byggvis kvæn
2 ok mēini blandin mjök;
ð·kynja'n mēira · kom=a með ása sonum;
4 öll est, dēigja, dritin.“

[R 16v/21]

[Quoth Lock:] "Shut up, Beal! Thou art Bewer's wife,
and mixed with much evil.
A greater disgrace came not amidst the sons of the Eese;
thou art all, dough-girl, dungy!"

4 öll est, dēigja, dritin 'thou art all, dough-girl, dungy' | *dēigja* 'dough-girl' is a derivative of *dēigr* 'dough' and refers to a young maid at a farm who carries out tasks like kneading dough, milking the cows, and carrying water. Lock insults her; she's still covered with cow dung.

P7 Þá kom Þórr at ok kvað:

[R 16v/23]

Then Thunder arrived and quoth:

57 „Þegi þú, röð véttr, · þér skal minn þrúð-hamarr,
2 Mjöllnir, mál fyr-nema!
Hērða klett · drep’k þér halsi af,
4 ok verðr þá þínu fjörvi of farit.“

[R 16v/24]

“Shut up, thou queer wight! Thee shall my thrith-hammer
Millner, deprive of speech!
The rock of thy shoulders [HEAD] I will cut from thy neck,
and then is thy life destroyed!”

ALL | The threatening st. bears some resemblance to *Hárb* 47.

1 þrúð-hamarr ‘thrith-hammer’ | “Strength-hammer”, *þrúðr* ‘thrith’ being an obsolete word for strength generally used only in connection with Thunder or ettins. *Þrúðr* ‘Thrith’ is also the name of Thunder’s daughter.

[Loki kvað:] 58 „Jarðar burr · es hér nú inn kominn;

[R 16v/25]

2 hví þrasir þú svá, Þórr?
En þá þorir ekki · es skalt við ulf’inn vega
4 ok svelgr hann allan Sig-föður.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Earth’s Son is here now come inside,
why thrashest thou so, Thunder?
Yet thou wilt nowise dare when thou shalt fight the Wolf
and he swallows Syefather (= Weden) whole.”

1 burr | *metr. and sens. emend.; om. R*

3–4 es skalt við ulf’inn vega / ok svelgr hann allan Sig-föður ‘when thou shalt fight the Wolf / and he swallows Syefather (= Weden) whole.’ | A reference to the Rakes of the Reins, where Weden is slain by the Wolf. Thunder, meanwhile, dies while slaying the Wyrms; see *Vsp* 51–53, *Vafþ* 53.

[Þórr kvað:] 59 „Þegi þú, röð véttr, · þér skal minn þrúð-hamarr,
2 Mjöllnir, mál fyr-nema!
Upp ek þér verp · ok á austr-vega,
4 síðan þik mann=gi sér.“

[R 16v/28]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Shut up, thou queer wight! Thee shall my thrith-hammer
Millner, deprive of speech!
I will throw thee up and onto the eastern ways,
whereafter no man will see thee!”

3 austr-vega 'eastern ways' | The desolate eastern wastelands where Thunder hunts ettins, troll-women and other unnatural creatures.

- [Loki kvað:] **60** „Austr-förum þínum · skalt aldri=gi [R 16v/29]
 2 segja seggjum frá
 síðst í hanska þumlungi · hnúkðir þú, Eín-hęri,
 4 ok þótti=sk=a þá Þörr vesa!“

[Quoth Lock:] “From thy eastern journeys shalt thou never
 speak to the youth,
 since into a glove’s thumb thou crawledest, Oneharrier,
 and didst not seem to be Thunder then!”

2 segja seggjum frá ‘speak to the youth’ | Lock here borrows from Frie’s use of this expression in st. 25 above.

3 í hanska þumlungi · hnúkðir þú ‘since into a glove’s thumb thou crawledest’ | Sts. 60 and 62 allude to Thunder’s journey to Outyards-Lock as told in *Gylf* 44–47, during which he encounters the ettin Shrimmer (*Gylf* 45:5–38). Lock (not to be confused with Outyards-Lock) is also present on that journey. For the part of the narrative alluded to in st. 60 see the summary of *Gylf* 45:5–16 in the note to *Hárþ* 26, although the ettin is there called Feller.

- [Þörr kvað:] **61** „Þęgi þú, rög vęttr, · þér skal męnn þrúð-hamarr, [R 16v/31]
 2 Mjöllnir, mál fyr-nema!
 hęndi inni høgri · drep’k þik Hrungnis bana,
 4 svát þér brotnar þęina hvat.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Shut up, thou queer wight! Thee shall my thrith-hammer
 Millner, deprive of speech!
 With my right hand I will beat thee with Rungner’s bane [= Millner]
 so that every bone in thee breaks!”

3 Hrungnis bana ‘Rungner’s bane [= Millner]’ | For Rungner, a famous ettin slain by Thunder, cf. *Hárþ* 14.

- [Loki kvað:] **62** „Lifa ętla’k mér · langan aldr [R 16v/32]
 2 þótt hótir hamri mér;
 skarpar álar · þóttu þér Skrymis vesa
 4 ok máttir=a þá nęsti náa
 ok svalt=sk þá hungri hęill.“

[Quoth Lock:] “I intend for myself to live a long life
 although thou mightst threaten me with the hammer.
 Strong seemed Shrimmer’s knots to thee,
 and then couldst thou not get to thy provisions,
 and then wast thou dying, healthy, of hunger!”

3 skarpar álar · þóttu þér Skrymis vesa ‘Strong seemed Shrimmer’s knots to thee’ | Another allusion to Thunder’s encounter with Shrimmer, this part found narrated in *Gylf* 45:18–22: After the gods took on Shrimmer as a companion he offered to carry their provisions in his knapsack. They agreed to this, and by evening they rested beneath a big oak. Shrimmer went to sleep but told the companions to get a meal from the sack. Thunder took it and tried untying the straps, but the knots were so firmly tied by the ettin that he could nowise untie or even move them. In *Gylf* 47:9 the incident is revealed to have been an illusion; Shrimmer was Outyards-Lock in disguise and the cords tying up the sack were made of unbreakable iron (*grés-járn*).

[Þórr kvað:] 63 „Þegi þú, röð vétttr, · þér skal minn þrúð-hamarr, [R 17r/1]
 2 Mjöllnir, mál fyr-nema!
 Hrunnis bani · mun þér i hæl koma
 4 fyr Ná-grindr neðan.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Shut up, thou queer wight! Thee shall my thrith-hammer
 Millner, deprive of speech!
 Rungner’s bane will take thee to hell,
 down beneath Neegrind!”

[Loki kvað:] 64 „Kvað’k fyr ǫsum, · kvað’k fyr ása sonum, [R 17r/2]
 2 þat’s mik hvatti hugr,
 en fyr þér ǫinum · mun’k út ganga
 4 því’t ek veit at þú vegr.

[Quoth Lock:] “I spoke before the Eese; I spoke before the sons of the Eese
 whatever my heart did goad me,
 but for thee alone will I walk out
 for I know that thou dost strike.

65 Ql gørðir þú, Égir, · en þú aldri munt [R 17r/4]
 2 síðan sumbl of gøra;
 ǫiga þin ǫll, · es hér inni es,
 4 leiði yfir logi
 ok brenni þér à baki.“

Ale hast thou made, Eagre, but thou wilt never
 henceforth make a simble!
 All thy estate which is here within—
 let flame play over it
 and burn thee in the back!”

Frá Loka (‘From Lock’)

- P8** En eptir þetta fal=sk Loki í Frán·angrs·forsí í lax líki. Þar tóku [R 17r/6]
 2 Ésir hann. Hann var bundinn með þǫrmum sonar Nara; en
 Narfi, sonr hans, varð at vargi. Skaði tók eittr-orm ok festi upp
 4 yfir and-lit Loka; draup þar ór eittr. Sigyn, kona Loka, sat þar
 ok helt munn-laug undir eittr'it, en er munn-laug'in var full bar
 6 hón út eittr'it, en meðan draup eittr'it á Loka. Þá kippti=sk hann
 svá hart við, at þaðan af skalf jörð ǫll; þat eru nú kallaðir land-
 8 skjálftar.

BUT AFTER THIS Lock hid himself in Freenangersforce in the likeness of a salmon. There the Eese took him. He was bound with the intestines of his son Nare, but his son Narve was made a wolf/outlaw. Shede took a venomous serpent and fastened it up over Lock's face; out of it ran venom. Syein, Lock's wife, sat there and held a basin under the venom and when the basin was full she carried out the venom, but meanwhile the venom ran onto Lock. Then he struggled so hard that thereof all the earth quaked; such are now called earth-quakes.

ALL | The myth of the binding of Lock is alluded to in *Vsp* 34 and H31 and told at length in *Gylf* 50:3–25, which does not entirely agree with the present passage, although numerous details are shared between them (e.g. the name of the force and the comment about earth-quakes at the end).

According to *Gylf* 50:20–22 (cited in *Vsp* H31 n.; cf. there) the Eese captured two of Lock's sons, Wonnell and "Nare or Narve". They turned Wonnell into a wolf (*vargr*, which also means 'outlaw') and forced him to tear his brother Narve apart. Then they took Narve's intestines used them to bind Lock on top of three sharp stones. The intestines hardened into iron and Lock was bound fast.

Since the author of *Gylf* knew *Vsp* it is possible that he combined a prose text similar to the present *Lok* P8 with the stanza *Vsp* H31, interpreting the form *Vála víg-bænd* as 'Wonnell's war-bonds' (whereas the present ed. adopts the emendation to nom. sg. *Váli*).

Wonnell is the son of Weden who avenges Balder by killing HATH (*Vsp* 31 n., *Bdr* 11/1, *Gylf* 30:1–2, *Skm* 19), and there is no reason as to why he could not have bound Lock.

Appendix

Stanza from *Gylf*

- G1** „Örr est, Loki, · ok ør·viti, [S 5v/36, T TODO,
 2 hví né lēt=sk=a þú, Loki? W TODO, U TODO]
 ør·løg Frigg · hygg at ǫll viti
 4 þó'tt hōn sjǫlf=gi sǫgi.“
- “Mad art thou, Lock, and out of thy wits,
 why holdest thou not back, O Lock?
 All orlays I think Frie knows,
 though she says them not herself.”

ALL | In *Gylf* 20:7 this stanza is cited as proof of Frie's foresight regarding the orlays of men. It is introduced by the words *svá sem hér er sagt, at Óðinn mælti sjálfir við þann ós, er Loki heitir* 'just as it is said here, that Weden himself spoke to that Os who is called Lock'. — The stanza looks like an amalgamation of several *Lok* stanzas, which is why it has been placed here, rather than under *Eddbr*; l. 1 corresponds to st. 21/1 (spoken by Weden), l. 2 to st. 47/2 (spoken by Homedall), and ll. 3–4 to st. 29/3–4 (spoken by Frow). It is possible that the st. derives from an alternate version of *Lok*, but it could also be the result of faulty memory on Snorre's part, since the first line corresponds to the one spoken by Weden in st. 21.

Lay of Thrim

(*Þryms kviða*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C9th (0.741)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Lay of Thrim** (abbrev. *Þrk*) is a narrative poem dealing with the god Thunder's adventure to retrieve his hammer from the ettin Thrim.

Textual preservation and transmission

Þrk is only found in **R**, on foll. 17r/12–18r/4. It follows *Lok* and precedes *Vkv*.

No sts. are found in other sources, although there is a possible allusion to (a variant of) stanza 29 in *Gylf* (see *Þrk* 29/5 n.).

Structure and form

The poem consists of 32 stanzas and 129 long-lines. 4 lines is the typical length of a stanza (sts. 1–3, 7, 8, 10–12, 14–16, 18, 21–23, 25–28, 30–31), but lengths of 2 (4), 3 (5, 6, 17, 20), 5 (9, 13, 24, 29, 32), and 6 (19) lines are also represented.

The meter is Ancient-words-law of a somewhat looser variety. No prose is embedded in the poem itself, which consists of both narrative and dialogue.

Style and Language

Þrk consists of both narrative and dialogue and much of the poetry is notably formulaic. Numerous passages are repeated throughout the poem (1/1 ~ 13/1, 3/1–2 ~ 12/1–2, 5/1–3 ~ 9/1–3, 8/3–4 ~ 11/3–4, 12/3 ~ 15/3, 12/4 = 20/3, 15/3–16/4 = 19/1–6, 26/1–4 ~ 28/1–4) and several long-lines are shared or closely related with other poems (1/3, 2/1, 7/1, 14/1–3, 15/1, 18/2, 23/1b–2a, 31/1).

Some of the long-lines of the latter group (viz. 1/3, 2/1, 14/1–3, 15/1) are of the oral-formulaic type, in that they do not fill a function unique to the particular narrative of a given poem. Instead they carry the narrative forward by describing generic actions, e.g. by introducing someone's entering a hall or commencing speech. This type of line is only found in a few select narrative poems in Ancient-words-law and should probably be considered a sign of an early date. To that effect speak two reasons: first, such lines hardly figure at all in younger antiquarian Eddic poetry, indicating that they had fallen out of favour by the antiquarian revival of the 12th c.; second, they very frequently contain the particle *of* before verbs, an archaic feature not used to a great extent in 12th c.

A unique trait of *Þrk* is that the archaic particle *of* here appears at a higher rate than in any other Eddic poem (0.688 occurrences / 10 unique half-lines), and more than 40% as often as the poem with the second-highest incidence, *Oddr* (Sapp 2022, p. 70), which notably also shares numerous formulaic long-lines (cf. in particular *Oddr* 3).

Alliteration between **vr-* and *v-* is uncertain for *Þrk*, although it is likely the case in *Þrk* 1/1 (n.).

Story

Þrk tells the story of the theft of Thunder's hammer Millner by the ettin Thrim, and his regaining of it through (cross-)dressing as the goddess Frow, after which he slays the whole ettin clan.

Origin and motifs

At the core of the narrative lies the ancient motif where the Ettins, the enemies of the Gods, desire to rob them of their weapon and to possess a goddess, viz. the light-bringing Dawn, and hide Her under ground. The concealment of the strength and light of the heavens threatens not merely the Gods but also Mankind, who rely on their protection.

Þrk is not the only Norse source for this motif. The closest parallel is the story of the ettin Master Builder in *Gylf* 42:3–29 (cf. *Vsp* 24–25 nn.), where an ettin craftsman in exchange for building the wall of Osyard asks for the hand of Frow and the Sun and the Moon as a dowry—a price which would effectively steal away all the light in the world. For the inevitable catastrophic consequences of the theft of the light we may compare the eschatological Fimblewinter (*Vsp* 40/3–4, *Vafþ* 44/3–4 (n.), *Hdl* 41/3, *Gylf* 51:1–4), which occurs when the enemies of the Gods at last succeed in robbing the world of the sun.

The motif of the enemies of the Gods wishing to steal and hide the heavenly light(s), usually symbolized by the Goddesses, has ancient roots. It is also found in Finnic mythology. In *Kalevala* 47–49, the evil witch *Louhi* of the Northland successfully steals the sun, moon, and fire (note the fire-symbolism of the *Brisinga-mén*, st. 13/3 n.!) and thereby deprives the world of its light. This motif is authentic and not the invention of Lönnroth, for

in Finnish folk-songs both the Sun (or its goddess Päivätär, the mother of the Panu, the fire-god) and the Moon are varyingly said to have been locked up in a stone (*SKVR* XIII 99) or an iron stronghold (*SKVR* XV 220.1–7). A much older form of the same motif is found in the Vedic *Valá*-myth (part of which is told in *RV* 10.108), where the enemies of the Gods, the *Paṇi*-s, lock up the Dawns in the form of kine in the *Valá*-cave and thereby prevent the natural cycle between Night and Day. With his great song the Storm-god *Indra* breaks open the cave, killing *Valá* and releasing the light-bringing Dawns (Brereton and Jamison 2020, pp. 70–71).

In this way *Prk* also comes to symbolise cyclical cosmic renewal. The weapon of the Gods is stolen from them and they find themselves at a low point, powerless against the forces of evil (st. 18), but they are at last redeemed, and the enemy defeated and humiliated in comical fashion (sts. 31–32). Although we know nothing about the performance context of *Prk*, it is perhaps not unlikely that it would have been performed as part of a festival, perhaps at the winter solstice, when the year is at its darkest point and the light seems furthest away. In this way the poem gives its listeners hope: Thunder has vanquished the ettins and shown them to be of no threat, even laughable in their weakness. The light will return.

More generally, comedic stories involving Thunder and his ettin-bashing seem to have been very popular in Wiking age Norway and Iceland, and in these the god himself is not infrequently the butt of the joke. Apart from *Prk* there are also the Eddic poems *Hym* and *Hárb*, and the Scaldic poems *Haustr* and *Þdr*. Fragment from a lost Eddic poem about Thunder's fight with the ettin Garfrith and his daughters also survive in *Gylf*; see *Eddbr* VI below.

Later parallels

The story of Thunder getting back his stolen hammer by impersonating the goddess Frow was clearly extremely popular, for numerous later reflexes in the form of folk-ballads are found in all four major North Germanic-speaking countries (Sweden, Norway, Denmark, and Iceland); for a useful overview and discussion of their features see Vijūnas (2019).

The oldest such ballad is the 15th c. Icelandic *ríma Þrymlur*. Judging by numerous direct textual parallels (e.g. *Prk* 27/3 = *Þrymlur* 2.22; see Vijūnas 2019, pp. 46–47, 54), *Þrymlur* is clearly closely related to *Prk*, if not directly drawing on it, although it also adds numerous details not found in *Prk* and on the whole greatly embellishes the story. In addition, however, *Þrymlur* shares some details with the later Scandinavian ballads that are absent from *Prk*, most notably the bringing of the hammer for the bride (Vijūnas 2019, pp. 57–58); these parallels suggest that it is not a mere rewrite of the older *Prk* by a learned antiquarian, but rather based on the same common proto-myth as both *Prk* and the later ballads.

The later continental ballads are numerous and documented from 1591 to the 20th c.; Vijūnas (2019, pp. 43–44) lists 1 from Sweden, 6 from Norway, and 9 from Denmark. These ballads, though the names of the gods in them

are more or less corrupt and though their nature as gods is forgot, still feature a plot remarkably identical to *Þrk*.

This is all the more notable since the oldest example was printed in Denmark in 1591, decades before the first edition of the Poetic Edda, for which reason direct influence from *Þrk* must be discounted. Nor is direct influence from the Icelandic *Þrymlur* possible, for the numerous embellishments found in it but not in *Þrk* do not appear in the ballads (Vijūnas 2019, pp. 41–42).

Dating

Þrk has often been considered the oldest poem in the **R** collection, and Sapp (2022)'s model agrees with that judgment by placing it solidly (0.741) in the 9th c., earlier than any other Eddic poem. An early date is supported by the unusually high incidence of the particle *of* before verbs, the use of narrative formulaic lines (see Style and Language above), and the likely alliteration between **vr-* and *v-* (st. 1/1).

Text

Lay of Thrim

- 1 Vreǵiðr vas þá Ving-Þörr · es hann vaknaði [R 17r/13]
 2 ok sǫns hamars · of saknaði,
 skegg nam at hrista, · skǫr nam at dýja,
 4 réð Jarðar burr · umb at þreifa-sk.

W ROTH WAS THEN WING-THUNDER when he woke,
 and of his hammer was bereft.
 His beard he took to rustle, his locks he took to rip;
 the son of Earth resolved to grope about.

1 Vreǵiðr | Reiðr R

1 Vreǵiðr | Initial *vr- is restored for the sake of alliteration since the first nominal in a line must typically carry alliteration; in *Þrk* 13/1 it definitely does not, but that may well be due to that line mirroring the present line and thereby breaking convention for the sake of parallelism. For the age of this feature cf. *Háv* 32/2 n.

1 Ving-Þörr ‘Wing-Thunder’ | A rare poetic name for Thunder; it only elsewhere occurs in *Alv* 6. The first element is not *vǵngr* ‘wing (of a bird)’ but perhaps means ‘swinging’ (cf. Swedish *vingla*), referring to his swinging of his hammer, or ‘victorious’, representing a n-infixed extension of the verb *vega* ‘to strike, smite, fight’ (cf. Latin *vincere* ‘to win, vanquish’). Cf. the related name Wingner (ON *Vingnir*) in *Vafþ* 51/4.

3 skegg nam at hrista, · skǫr nam at dýja ‘His beard he took to rustle, his locks he took to rip’ | *N1* nam at *VI*; *N2* nam at *V2* appears to be a formulaic long-line; cf. *Brøt* 13/1.

- 2 Ok hann þat orða · alls fyrst of kvað: [R 17r/15]
 2 „Hęyr-ðu nú, Loki, · hvat ek nú męli
 es ęigi veit · jarðar hver=gi
 4 né upp-himins: · ęss es stolinn hamri!“

And he this word first of all did say:
 “Hear thou now, Lock, what I now will speak,
 which no man knows anywhere on Earth
 nor in Up-heaven: the os [I] is robbed of His hammer!”

1 Ok hann þat orða · alls fyrst of kvað ‘And he this word first of all did say’ | The whole line is formulaic, occurring in five other places: *Þrk* 3/2, 9/5, and 12/2 below, *Oddr* 3/5, *Brøt* 5/2.

3–4 jarðar ... upp-himins ‘Earth ... Up-heaven’ | A formulaic meristic expression for the whole cosmos; see Index: Earth and Up-heaven.

- 3 Gingu þęir fagra · Freyju tůna [R 17r/17]
 2 ok hann þat orða · alls fyrst of kvað:
 „Munt-u męr, Freyja, · fjaðr-hams lęa

4 ef ek mǫnn hamar · mǫtta'k hitta?“

They went to the fair courts of Frow
and he this word first of all did say:
“Wilt thou to Me, O Frow, the feather-hame lend,
if I My hammer might find?”

2 hann ‘he’ | The speaker is Thunder, since he speaks about “my hammer”.

3 fjaðr-hams ‘feather-hame’ | A “feather-cloak” by which the wearer can transform or fly like a bird. TODO.

Frēyja kvað: 4 „Þó mynda'k gefa þér · þó'tt ór gollí vǫri
2 ok þó sǫlja · at vǫri ór silfri.“

[R 17r/19]

[Quoth Frow:] “Yet would I give it to Thee though it were golden,
and yet hand it to Thee if it were silvern.”

2 sǫlja ‘hand’ | *sǫlja*, cognate of English *sell*, here has its older sense of ‘hand over’, cf. Gotish *saljan* ‘offer; θάειν’ (Streitberg 1910, p. 116).

5 Fló þá Loki, · fjaðr-hamr dunði,
2 und's fyr útan kom · ása garða
ok fyr innan kom · jǫtna heima.

[R 17r/20]

Then flew Lock—the feather-hame rustled—
until he came outside the Yards of the Eese,
and he came inside the Homes of the Ettins.

1 Loki ‘Lock’ | Though Thunder is the one asking for the feather-hame (3/4 “if I my hammer might find”), it is Lock who takes off flying.

2 ása garða ‘the Yards of the Eese’ | Semantically identical to Osyrd (st. 18/3 below).

6 Þrymr sat á haugi, · þursa dróttinn,
2 grǫyjum sínum · goll-bönd snøri
ok mǫrum sínum · mǫn jafnaði.

[R 17r/22]

Thrim sat on the mound, the lord of Thurses:
on his greyhounds the golden leashes he twirled,
and on his steeds the manes he cut even.

1 sat á haugi ‘sat on the mound’ | Probably a sign of his power, the mound representing his wealth and ancient estate. Cf. *Vsp* 41 n. for other attestations.

1 þursa dróttinn ‘lord of Thurses’ | This formulaic half-line also occurs in Runic charms against such thursen lords (*Cant* and U Fv1933;134 under Galders). *Cant* in particular is a prayer to Thunder himself, and thus goes to show that even light-hearted poems like *Þrk* held religious significance by serving as examples of Thunder’s prowess as daemon-slayer, for which he could be invoked also in the present. Cf. .

2–3 gręyjum sínum ... męrum sínum ‘his greyhounds ... his steeds’ | Thrim sits surrounded by dogs and horses. The scene is reminiscent of the ancient “master of animals” motif, especially as attested on panel A of the Gundestrup cauldron.

- [Drymr kvað:] 7 „Hvat ’s með ęsum? · Hvat ’s með ęlfum? [R 17r/23]
 2 Hví est ęinn kominn · i jętun-ęęima?“
 [Loki kvað:] „Illt ’s með ęsum, · illt ’s með ęlfum!
 4 Hęfir þú Hlór-riða · hamar of folginn?“
 [Quoth Thrim:] “What’s with the Eese? What’s with the Elves?
 Why art thou alone come into the Ettin-Homes?”—
 [Quoth Lock:] “’Tis ill with the Eese! ’Tis ill with the Elves!
 Hast thou Loride’s hammer hid?”

3 illt ’s með ęlfum | required by sense and meter; *om.* R

1 Hvat ’s með ęsum? · Hvat ’s með ęlfum? ‘What is with the Eese? What is with the Elves?’ | Formulaic, the same line occurs in *Vęp* 46/1.

2 jętun-ęęima ‘Ettin-Homes’ | Semantically identical to the *jętna ęęimar* ‘Homes of the Ettins’ in 5/3 above. The distinction is purely metrical, since *i *jętna ęęima* would be an illegal type C verse of Ancient-words-law.

4 Hlór-riða ‘Loride’ | “The Loud Rider”, Thunder.

- [Drymr kvað:] 8 „Ek hęfi Hlór-riða · hamar of folginn [R 17r/25]
 2 átta ręstum · fyr jęrę neðan;
 hann ęngi maðr · apr of ęęimtir
 4 nema fęri mér · Frejju at kvęn.“
 [Quoth Thrim:] “I have Loride’s hammer hid
 eight rests beneath the earth.
 It will no man fetch back again,
 unless he bring me Frow to wife.”

2 átta ręstum ‘eight rests’ | Eight leagues; a “rest” being an old distance measurement. See Index.

4 Frejju ‘Frow’ | Frow, who is probably originally the Indo-European dawn-goddess. The Ettins apparently have a great desire to obtain her; in *Gylf* 42:5 the ettin who builds the wall of Osyard asks specifically for Frow in return, along with the Sun and the Moon (cf. *Vęp* 24).

- 9 Fló þa Loki, · fjaðr-hamr dunði, [R 17r/27]
 2 und’s fyr útan kom · jętna ęęima
 ok fyr innan kom · asa garða;
 4 mótti hann þęr · miðra garða
 ok hann þat orða · alls fyrst of kvað:

Then flew Lock—the feather-hame rustled—
 until he came outside the Homes of the Ettins

and he came inside the Yards of the Eese.
 He met Thunder in the middle yards,
 and he [= Thunder] this word first of all did say:

5 *hann þat* | *emend.* (cf. st. 2 n.); þat hann with elsewhere unprecedented word order **R**

4 *mótti hann Þór* ‘He met Thunder’ | This line is compatible with the reconstructed disyllabic form **Þoar* acc. sg. if the pronoun *hann* is excised; for that form see note to *Hym* 23/1.

- 10 „Hefir þú *ørendi* · sem *erfiði*? [R 17r/29]
 2 Seg-ðu á *lopti* · *long* tíðendi!
 Opt *sitjanda* · *sogur* of falla=sk,
 4 ok *liggjandi* · *lygi* of *þellir*.“

“Hast thou an errand for thy hardship?
 Tell thou the long tidings aloft!
 Oft the sitting man’s stories fail each other
 and the lying down blows up his lie.”

1 Hefir þú *ørendi* · sem *erfiði*? ‘Hast thou an errand for thy hardship?’ | Thunder asks Lock whether he has found out anything from his long journey. The rhyming pair *ørendi* ‘errand’ ... *erfiði* ‘trouble, hardship’ also occurs in *HHj* 5/1.

3–4 Opt *sitjanda* · *sogur* of falla=sk, // ok *liggjandi* · *lygi* of *þellir*. ‘Oft the sitting man’s stories fail each other // and the lying down blows up his lie.’ | Proverbial. If one waits and mulls over bad news after receiving them, details will be left out and excuses thought up. It is therefore best that Lock immediately tell Thunder what he has learned. ON *liggja* ‘lie (recline)’ and *ljúga* ‘lie (speak untruth)’ are entirely different verbs; it is unfortunate that they sound the same in English.

- [Loki kvað:] 11 „Hefi’k *ørendi*, · *erfiði* ok: [R 17r/31]
 2 Þrymr hēfir þinn hamar, · þursa dróttinn;
 hann *engi* maðr · *aptr* of hēimtir
 4 nema hōnum *fōri* · *Freyju* at kvēn.“

[Quoth Lock:] “I have an errand, hardship also:
 Thrim has thy hammer, the lord of Thurses.
 It will no man fetch back again,
 unless he bring him Frow to wife.”

- 12 Ganga þeir *fagra* · *Freyju* at hitta [R 17r/33]
 2 ok hann þat *orða* · *alls* fyrst of kvað:
 „Bitt-u þik, *Freyja*, · *brúðar* lín;
 4 vit skulum *aka* tvau · í *jōtun*-hēima.“

They go the fair Frow to find,
 and he this word first of all did say:

“Bind thyself, Frow, with bridal linen.
We two shall drive into the Ettin-Homes!”

2 hann ‘he’ | The speaker is either Thunder or Lock.

3 brúðar líni; ‘bridal linen’ | The dress of the bride.

- 13 Vreǵið varð þá Freyja · ok fnasaði,
2 allr ása salr · undir bifði=sk,
stokk þat it mikla · men brisinga:
4 „Mik vǵitst verða · ver-gjarnasta
ef ek ǵk með þér · i ǵotun-heima.“

[R 17v/1]

Wroth became Frow then, and snorted;
all the hall of the Eese beneath her shook;
down crashed the great Necklace of Blazes—
“Thou knowest I’ll become most eager for men
if I drive with thee into the Ettin-Homes!”

1 fnasaði ‘snorted’ | A rare word. TODO.

3 men brisinga ‘Necklace of Blazes’ | The *Brisinga-men* (second element *men* ‘neckring, necklace, jewel’) is a jewel worn by Frow. It is probably a symbol of fire and light, as shown by the first element *brisingr*, which is listed as a poetic synonym for fire in *Pul Elds* 4 (SkP 3) and appears in the sense ‘blaze’ in Norwegian dialects. This strengthens Frow’s identification with the Dawn, for which cf. *Vsp* 24. The association of the Necklace with fire is further supported by the obscure myth wherein the two probable fire-figures Lock and Homedall fight over it, as mentioned in *Skm* 15, 23 and *Húsdr* 2. Lock is identified in later folklore with the Ash-lad, a wight living in or under the fire-place (Heide 2011), while Homedall’s fire-related epithets include *Heim-dallr* ‘World-Brilliant’, *vörðr goða* ‘Watchman of the Gods’ (*Grm* 13/3 n., *Lok* 48/4, *Gylf* 27:8), *vári ragna* ‘Guardian of the Gods’ (*Húsdr* 2) *bvitastr Ása* ‘whitest of the Eese’ (*Þrk* 15/1), *bviti óss* ‘the White Os’ (*Gylf* 27:2), *Gollin-tanni* ‘Goldentooth’, and *Hallin-skíði* ‘One with leaning sticks’ (*Gylf* 27:5).

For the opposition between these two Gods cf. *Gylf* 51:48, about the Rakes of the Reins: *Loki á orrostu við Heim-dall ok verðr hvárr annars bani*. ‘Lock battles against Homedall, and each one slays the other.’ For further discussion about Homedall and his epithets see *Eddbr* III. Lock’s role in the theft is also alluded to in *Haustr* 9, where he is called *gírði-þjófr brisings* ‘girdle-thief of the blaze’, i.e., ‘thief of the girdle of the blaze [= the Necklace of Blazes]’.

Archeologically the Necklace of Blazes seems to appear in various finds depicting a lady or goddess wearing an oversized brooch (Arrhenius 1962, pp. 79–84). Such oversized brooches of the disc-on-bow type are in fact known from Wiking Age Scandinavia, including Western Norway (Arrhenius 1962, p. 86), where *Þrk* is likely to have been written, and are some of the finest pieces of jewelry surviving from the period (Arrhenius 1962, p. 87). These brooches, which with their original *cloisonné*-fitted red garnets give off a beautiful fire-like lustre, are doubtless cultic objects. They are far too large and heavy to have been worn as part of dress (e.g., the fragmentary brooch from Kårsta, Uppland, Sweden, item number 267203 HST, would have been as long as 28.5 cm, Arrhenius 1962, p. 93); nor are they found in graves as part of women’s dress, which further suggests that they were not worn as status objects (Arrhenius 1962, pp. 84–85, 97). On the basis of the lack of association between their find circumstances and cultic sites, Arrhenius (1962, p. 97) suggests that they were probably venerated as independent objects rather than adorning wooden statues. As a representative symbol of Frow the brooches would thus have served to connect the worshipper to the goddess in the same way as amulets depicting Thunder’s hammer Millner (cf. *Hym* 36/2 n.) or Woden’s spear Gungner. A particularly beautiful example from the village Othemars in Othem parish, Gotland (item number 453312 HST) is depicted in Figure 6, p. 330.

4 verða · ver-gjarnasta ‘become most eager for men’ | Presumably Frow is speaking out of self-awareness of her lustful inclinations, i.e., she will be siezed by uncontrollable desire if surrounded by strange men. It is also possible that she worries about being accused of promiscuity by the other gods, but that is not the literal sense of the words. For Frow’s alleged looseness cf. *Lok* 30; in *Lok* 26 another goddess, Frie, is likewise called *ver-gjörn* ‘eager for men’.

- 14 Şenn vöru řsir · allir á þingi
 2 ok řsynjur · allar á máli,
 ok umb þat réðu · ríkir tívar:
 4 hvé þeir Hlór-riða · hamar of sótti?

[R 17v/3]

Soon were the Eese all at the Thing,
 and the Ossens all at speech,
 and of this counseled the mighty Tews:
 how they Lorida’s hammer might find.

1–3 Şenn ... tívar ‘Soon ... Tews’ | The very same three lines also occur in *Bdr* 1/1–3; see Note there.

- 15 Þa kvað þat Hęim-dallr, · hvítastr Ása,
 2 vissi vęl framm · sęm vanir aðrir:
 „Bindu vér Þor þa · brúðar līni;
 4 hafi hann it mikla · męn brisinga!

[R 17v/5]



Figure 6: The gilt bronze disc-on-bow brooch from Othemars, Gotland. Viking Age, ca. 900 CE. © Ola Myrin, Historiska museet/SHM. CC BY 4.0. <https://samlingar.shm.se/object/AECAAAD2-4C29-4164-BB36-E6F589FDE1A5>

Then this quoth Homedall, whitest of the Eese;
he knew well ahead like the other Wanes:
“We shall bind Thunder, then, with bridal linen;
let Him have the great Necklace of Blazes!”

1 Þá kvað þat ... ‘Then this quoth ...’ | Formulaic way of introducing speech in a certain type of Ancient-words-law-poetry. The template is *þá kvað þat X · Y*, where the name X can be either mono- or disyllabic and Y (taking up the b-verse) is an epithet or descriptor and always alliterates with X. This formula has been exceptionally productive and is found in 21 other instances in the Poetic Edda; it never occurs in poetry in SkP. The other occurrences are: *Þrk* 17/1, 18/1, 20/1, 22/1, 25/1, 30/1; *Rþ* 44/3; *1 HHund* 54/3; *Brot* 7/1, 10/1; *1 Guðr* 6/1, 12/1, 17/1, 23/1, 24/1, 25/1; *Akv* 13/3, 25/1; *Gbv* 4/1, 8/1; *Hamð* 12/1 (n.).

1 Guðr 4/1 has *þá kvað Gjaf-laug, · Gjúka systir*, but judging by the use of *þá kvað þat X ...* at 6 other places in that poem that is probably a scribal error from earlier **þá kvað þat Gjaf-laug ...*, in which case the total rises to 22.

A variant formula is *bitt kvað þá X · Y* as found in *Sigsk* 31/1, and *Hamð* 6/1, 9/1, 22/1, 24/1, 26/1. A rare variant is *Akv* 27/1: *mérr kvað þat Gunn-arr, · geir-Niflungr*.

1 hvitastr Ása ‘whitest of the Eese’ | A likely fire-epithet; cf. st. 13/3 n. above

2 vissi vęl framm ‘he knew well ahead’ | I.e. saw the future. Compare the derived adjective *fram-viss* ‘forth-wise, prescient.’

2 sęm vanir aðrir ‘like the other Wanes’ | Homedall is not otherwise considered one of the Wanes, which are generally held to encompass only the gods Nearth, Free, and Frow, in *Yng* 4 also the being Quasher (cf. *Vsp* 17/3, but contrast the introduction to *Háv* 103–110). This verse has been thought to undermine the existence of the Wanes as a group distinct from the Eese, since the word *vanir* here can be plausibly taken to mean nothing other than ‘Gods’; for this distinction cf. *Vsp* 22 n.

- 16 Lótum und hōnum · hrynja lukla
2 ok kven-váðir · umb kné falla
en á brjósti · breiða stęina
4 ok hag=liga · umb hōfuð typpum!“

[R 17v/6]

We shall hang by His side keys to jingle,
and women’s garments to fall about His knees,
but on His breast broad stones,
and skilfully shall We tip His head!”

ALL | A unique description of Wiking Age bridal dress. Cf. the description’s of dress in *Rþ*, which is, however, a much younger poem than *Þrk*. Being the mistress of the household, keys were the mark of a respectable married woman. The “broad stones” on the breast may be tortoise brooches (also mentioned in *Vkv* 25, 36.) or beads in a large necklace. The “tipping” of the head refers to some sort of bridal hat which would have included a veil (cf. st. 27 below).

- 17 Þá kvað þat Þörr, · þrúðugr ۆss:
2 „Mik munu ęsir · argan kalla
ef ek binda=sk lét · brúðar lęni!“

[R 17v/8]

Then this quoth Thunder, the mighty Os:
“Me will the Eese call queer
if I let Myself be bound with bridal linen!”

2 argan kalla ‘call queer’ | Although reminiscent of schoolyard taunting, such an insult in fact carried legal consequences, for a man deemed *argr* (or *ragr* the metathesised form) ‘queer, effeminate, unmanly’ suffered the loss of personal rights and could no longer marry or swear oaths. Laws explicitly concerning this word are found among both the Icelanders and the Longbeards. In Iceland the word was explicitly banned as one of the three great words of insult, and punished by *skóg-gangr* ‘forest-walk’, i.e., full outlawry. So the Grey-Goose of the *Staðarbólsbók*, 376 (Vilhjálmur Finsen 1879, p. 392): *Þau eru orð þrjú [...] er skóg-gang varða þll, ef maðr kallar mann ragan eða ströðinn eða sorðinn*. ‘These are the three words which all incur full outlawry: if a man queer or sodomised or catamited.’

In older times an insult of masculinity had to be either retracted or settled by duel. So the Longbeardish Edict of Rothari, codified in 643 AD (TODO): *Si quis alium arga per furorem clamaverit et negare non poterit et dixerit, quod per furorem dixisset, tunc iuratus dicat, quod eum arga non cognovisset; postea conponat pro ipso iniurioso verbo solidos duodecim. Et si perseveraverit, convinct per pugnam, si potuerit, aut certe conponat, ut supra*. ‘If anyone calls another man *arga* ‘queer’ in anger, and cannot deny it, and says that it was said in anger, then in his oath he says that he does not know him as queer; let him thereafter settle for the insulting word with twelve solidi. But if he persists, let him prove it by fighting if he can, or otherwise settle it as above.’ The same is found in the Old Swedish Heathen law, which however does not explicitly mention the word *argr* (Läffler 1879; Friesen 1902; **RosenbergForthcoming**).

18 Þà kvað þat Loki · Lauf-eyjar sonr:

[R 17v/9]

- 2 „Þegi þú, Þórr, · þeira orða!
 Þegar munu jǫtnar · Ǫs-garð búa
 4 nema þinn hamar · þér of hēimtir.“

Then this quoth Lock, Leafie’s son:
 “Shut up Thou, Thunder, with those words!
 Shortly will the Ettins settle Osyard,
 unless Thou Thy hammer for Thyself dost fetch!”

2 Þegi þú, Þórr, · þeira orða! ‘Shut up thou, Thunder, with those words!’ | Formulaic line; cf. *I Guðr* 24/2: *Þegi þú, þjóð-leið, · þeira orða*.

3–4 Þegar ... hēimtir. ‘Shortly ... dost fetch!’ | Guarding the lands of the Gods and men from transgressive and destructive forces is Thunder’s task, and the Hammer his most important tool. Cf. *Vsp* 24–25, *Hárþ* 23–24, *Hym* 22, and a couplet by the obscure poet Thurbern Dise-scold, cited in *Skm* 11 (Þdis Þórr in SkP 3): *Þórr hefr Yggs með ǫrum · Ǫs-garð af þrek varðan*. ‘Thunder has with the messengers of Ug [gods] mightily guarded Osyard.’

19 Bundu þeir Þór þà · brúðar líní

[R 17v/11]

- 2 ok inu mikla · mēni brisinga,
 létu und hǫnum · hrynja lukla
 4 ok kven-váðir · umb kné falla
 en à brjósti · bręiða stęina
 6 ok hag=liga · umb hǫfuð typpðu.

They bound Thunder then with bridal linen
 and with the great Necklace of Blazes.
 They hung by his side keys to jingle,
 and women’s garments to fall about the knees,

but on the breast broad stones,
and skilfully they tipped his head.

- 20 Þá kvað þat **L**oki · **L**auf-eyjar sonr: [R 17v/13]
2 „Mun’k **a**uk með þér · **a**mbótt vesa,
vit skulum **a**ka tvau · ï **j**otun-heima.“

Then this quoth Lock, Leafie’s son:
“I too will with Thee be a handmaid;
We two shall drive into the Ettin-Homes.”

3 vit ... tvau ‘we two’ | It is a fundamental characteristic of Thunder in the Norse mythology that he is very seldom alone on his adventures, but almost always has a travel companion or sidekick (Lindow 1988, p. 123). — *tvau* ‘two’ is here in the neuter, which is used for mixed-sex groups. This is either an error due to mindless copying of st. 11, or a backhanded insult against Thunder by Lock.

- 21 Senn vöru **h**afrar · **h**eim of **v**reknir, [R 17v/14]
2 **s**kyndir at **s**köklum, · **s**kyldu vël rinna;
björg brotnuðu, · **b**rann jörð loga;
4 **ó**k Óðins sonr · ï **j**otun-heima.

Soon were the he-goats driven home,
hastened onto the cart-poles; they were to run well.
Crag burst, the earth burned with flame;
Weden’s son [= Thunder] drove to the Ettin-Homes.

1 *hafrar* ‘he-goats’ | Thunder’s chariot is driven by his two goats; cf. the kenning *hafra dróttinn* ‘Lord of He-goats’ (*Hym* 20, 31).

3 *björg brotnuðu*, · *brann jörð loga* ‘Crag burst, the earth burned with flame’ | Thunder’s driving is often heralded by cosmic disturbance and fire. So his arrival in *Lok* 55 is signalled by the mountains quaking. It is for this reason he must wade to the Thing of the Gods rather than ride across the Rainbow Bridge (Bivrest), *Grm* 29. The description most similar to the present stanza is found in Thedwolf’s *Hausti* 14–16, where crags (*björg*) burst asunder and fires rage before him as he drives to fight Rungner. A possibly Indo-European parallel is the Vedic myth of Indra breaking the mountains and releasing the rivers (as described most famously in *RV* 1.32). Cf. also *Bdr* 3 where the ground rumbles beneath the riding Weden.

- 22 Þá kvað þat Þrymr, · þursa dróttinn: [R 17v/16]
2 „Standið upp, jotnar, · ok stráið bækki!
Nú **f**örð mér · **F**reyju at kvön,
4 **N**jarðar dóttur · ór **N**óa-tünnum.

Then this quoth Thrim, the lord of Thurses:
“Stand up, ye ettins, and strew the benches!
Now bring me Frow to wife,
Nearth’s daughter from the Nowetons!

- 23 Ganga hér at garði · goll-hyrnðar kýr,
 2 oxn al-svartir, · jǫtni at gamni,
 fjǫlð á’k meïðma, · fjǫlð á’k meñja;
 4 ɛinnar mér Freyju · á-vant þykkir.“

[R 17v/18]

Here march to my farmstead golden-horned kine,
 all-black oxen to the ettin’s [my] pleasure.
 A multitude I own of treasures, a multitude I own of torcs;
 only Frow I think me missing.”

1–2 goll-hyrnðar kýr, oxn al-svartir ‘golden-horned kine, all-black oxen’ | Two related formulae. Together they emphasize the great value and sacrificial purpose of the oxen; both have Indo-European parallels and also appear together in Latvian *Daina* 33863 (*Melni vērsi, zelta ragi, / nāk par jūru baurodami* ‘Black oxen, golden horns, come bellowing over the sea’, Calin 1996, pp. 37–40). — goll-hyrnðar kýr is also found in *HHj* 4/2a, and the term *gollin-borni* ‘golden-horned one’ appears as a poetic synonym for “ox” in the *Þul* *Øxna* 3. — The singular *oxi al-svartr* ‘all-black ox’ appears in *Hym* 18, likewise of an animal to be sacrificed. For sacrificial black beasts cf. Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 1.8.12, where the hero Hadding has to atone for his slaying of a heavenly being by a sacrifice of dark-coloured victims (*furvae hostiae*): *Siquidem propiciandorum numinum gratia Frø deo rem divinam furvis hostiis fecit. Quem litationis morem annuo feriarum circuitu repetitum posteris imitandum reliquit. Frøblot Sveones vocant.* ‘In order to mollify the divinities he [= Hadding] did indeed make a holy sacrifice of dark-coloured victims to the god Frø. He repeated this mode of propitiation at an annual festival and left it to be imitated by his descendants. The Swedes call it Frøblot.’ This ancient ritual taboo even finds a parallel in the Tanakh, where animals dedicated to YHWH were to be unblemished (Hebrew מִקְדָּשׁ, Leviticus 1:3), which prob. includes being of a single colour.

TODO: write about the IE parallels

- 24 Vas þar at kveldi · of komit snimma
 2 ok fyr jǫtna · ǫl framm borit;
 ɛinn át oxa, · átta laxa,
 4 krásir allar, · þér’s konur skyldu,
 drakk Sifjar verr · sǫld þrjú mjaðar.

[R 17v/20]

There was the evening come early,
 and for the ettins ale brought forth.
 He [= Thunder] alone ate an ox, eight salmons,
 all the dainties meant for the women;
 Sib’s husband [= Thunder] drank three sieves of mead.

3–5 ɛinn ... mjaðar. ‘He alone ... of mead.’ | Thunder is renowned for his great appetite; cf. *Hym* 15 where he eats two of Hymer’s oxen and *Gylf* 46–47 where he drinks a large part of the sea.

5 Sifjar verr ‘Sib’s husband’ | It is curious that the same kenning is used in *Hym* 15 which also describes Thunder’s eating; it is perhaps a borrowing from the present stanza.

- 25 Þá kvað þat Prymr, · þursa dróttinn:
 2 „Hvar sát-t-u brúðir · bíta hvassara?
 Sá’k=a brúðir · bíta ɛnn bręiðara

[R 17v/23]

4 né ęnn meira mjoð · meę of drekka!“

Then this quoth Thrim, the lord of Thurses:
“Where sawest thou brides bite sharper?
I never saw brides bite yet broader;
nor yet more mead a maiden drink!”

26 Sat in al-snotra · ambótt fyrir
2 es orð of fann · við ęotuns máli:
„Át vętr Freęja · áttá nóttum,
4 svá vas hęn óð-fús · i ęotun-ęęima.“

[R 17v/25]

Sat the all-clever handmaid [= Lock] in front,
who found a word against the ettin's speech:
“Frow ate naught for eight nights;
so madly She longed for the Ettin-Homes.”

27 Laut und līnu, · lysti at kyssa,
2 en hann útan stókk · ęnd-langan sal:
„Hví eru ęndótt · augu Freęju?
4 Þykkja mér ór augum · ęldar brinna!“

[R 17v/27]

He [= Thrim] looked 'neath the linen, lusted to kiss—
but flung back out across the length of the hall—
“Why are the eyes of Frow so hostile?
Methinks there are fires burning from her eyes!”

4 ęldar ‘fires’ | *emend.; om. R*

1 līnu ‘linen’ | Like in many other Eurasian cultures, the face of the bride was thickly veiled.

2 ęnd-langan sal ‘across the length of the hall’ | Lit. ‘[across] the endlong hall’. — A formulaic b-verse. In Ancient-words-law it otherwise occurs as part of a formulaic long-line expressing people entering halls; cf. *Vkv* 8 n. In Leeds-meter the acc. pl. ęnd-langa salí is found in *Ski* 3 and in Speeches-meter a variant dat. sg. ęnd(i)-lęngu búi is attested in *Am* 18/1b, 24/1b; .

3 ęndótt ‘so hostile’ | A rare word. TODO.

4 Þykkja mér ór augum · ęldar brinna! ‘Methinks there are fires burning from her eyes!’ | The line is clearly corrupt in R (‘þicci mer ór augom brenna’); if we place the cæsura between *ór* and *augum* the a-verse is only three syllables long and alliteration must quite unnaturally fall on the weakly stressed preposition *ór* ‘from’. Since vowel alliteration is required by *augum*, *ęldar ‘fires’ has been inserted between ‘eyes’ and *brenna* ‘burns’. This requires the form of 3sg. pres. ind. *þykki* ‘it seems, -thinks’ R to be changed to 3pl. *þykkja*, for which reason Finnur Jónsson (1932) has the b-verse as *ęldr of brinna instead, but the pre-verbal particle *of* is not otherwise used before the verb *brinna* ‘burn’ in *Þrk*, and inserting it seems too hypothetical. An alternative emendation of the line that does not require the changing of the verb is *þykki mér ęldr · ór augum brinna, but the b-verse with anacrusis is unmetrical and does not appear anywhere else in *Þrk*. — The same expression is attested in *Gylf* 51:19: *eldar brenna ór augum hans ok nęsum* ‘fires burn from his eyes and nostrils’ (cf. *Vsp* H48 n.).

- 28 Sat in al-snotra · ambótt fyrir
 2 es orð of fann · við jötuns máli:
 „Svaf vętr Fręyja · áttanótum,
 4 svá vas hōn óð-fūs · i jötun-heima.“

[R 17v/29]

Sat the all-clever handmaid in front,
 who found a word against the ettin's speech:
 "Frow slept naught for eight nights;
 so madly She longed for the Ettin-Homes."

1 fyrir | add. †f.† R.

- 29 Inn kom in arma · jōtna systir,
 2 hin's brúð-fear · biðja þorði:
 „Lát þér af hōndum · hringa rauða
 4 ef þú ǫðla=sk vill · ástir mīnar,
 ástir mīnar, · alla hylli!“

[R 17v/30]

In came the wretched sister of the ettins,
 she who for the bride-fee had dared ask:
 "Slide off from thy hands the red rings,
 if thou wilt win my affections,
 my affections, [and] all [my] holdness."

ALL | The sister, who was apparently the one who asked for the Hammer, now has the audacity to ask Thunder (disguised as Frow) to give her the very rings on his hands.

2 brúð-fear 'the bride-fee' | Thunder's hammer.

5 ástir mīnar, · alla hylli 'my affections, [and] all [my] holdness' | Possibly formulaic. There are no preserved parallels in poetry but there may be one in *Gylf* 49:31–32, following the death of Balder: *En er goð'in vitkuðu=sk, þá mēlti Frigg ok spurði, hvęrr sá vęri með Ósum, er eigna=sk vildi* „allar ástir mīnar (so **TW**; ástir hennar 'her affections' **SU**) ok hylli, ok vili hann riða á hel-veg ok freista, ef hann fái fundit Baldr, ok bjóða Helju út-laun, ef bōn vill láta fara Baldr heim í Ós-garð.“

'But when the gods came back to their wits, then Frigg spoke and asked which one among the Eese would win "all my affections and boldness and would ride upon the Hellway and try whether he may find Balder and offer Hell a ransom if she will let Balder come home to Osyard."'

We can tell from the citation of a Leeds-meter stanza at the end of *Gylf* 49 (*Eddbr* V 1 below) that Snorre had access to now-lost Eddic poetry concerning Balder's death, and it may thus be the case that one of these poems contained the same two long-lines as the present ll. 4–5. For such a sharing of several lines cf. st. 14/1–3 above, which is identical to *Bdr* 1/1–3, a Ancient-words-law poem dealing with the earliest part in the Balder-cycle.

- 30 Þá kvað þat Þrymr, · þursa dróttinn:
 2 „Berid inn hamar · brúði at vígja,
 leggið Mjöllni · i meýjar kné,
 4 vígið okkr saman · Várar hęndi!“

[R 17v/32]

Then this goth Thrim, the lord of Thurses:
 "Bear ye in the hammer the bride for to bless;

lay ye Millner in the maiden's lap;
bless us two together by the hand of Ware!"

4 Várar 'Ware' | According to *Gylf* 35:16 *Vör* 'vow, covenant' is the goddess who governs vows between men and women. Here she is apparently invoked as a witness in the wedding ceremony, perhaps a reflex of authentic pagan wedding customs of the Wiking Age. This word may however also be read as the formally identical noun *vör*, which would give us a phrase *várar bönd* 'hand of the vow', perhaps a reference to a certain hand gesture, and leave out the goddess.

- 31 Hló Hlór-riða · hugr i brjósti [R 17v/34]
2 es harð-hugaðr · hamar of þekkði;
 Þrym drap hann fyrstan, · þursa dróttin,
4 ok étt jötuns · alla lamði.

Loride's heart laughed in his chest,
when, hard-hearted, he recognised the hammer.
Thrim he smote first, the lord of Thurses,
and all the ettin's lineage he beat lame.

1 Hló Hlór-riða · hugr i brjósti 'Loride's heart laughed in his chest' | Cf. 3 *Guðr* 9/1: *Hló þá Atla* · *hugr i brjósti* 'Then laughed Atle's heart in his chest'.

- 32 Drap hann ina ǫldnu · jǫtna systur, [R 18r/1]
2 hin's brúð-féar · of beðit hafði;
 hǫn skell of hlaut · fyr skillinga,
4 en hogg hamars · fyr hringa fjöld.
 Svá kom Óðins sonr · ęndr at hamri.

He smote the olden sister of the ettins,
she who for the bride-fee had asked.
She got a smiting for shillings,
and a blow of the hammer for a multitude of rings.
So came Weden's son back to his hammer.

3 skillinga 'shillings' | *skillingr* 'shilling' is commonly used in ON prose and has cognates in other Germanic languages: OE *scilling*, OS, OHG *skilling*, Gothic *skillingg*. This is however its only attestation in Norse poetry of any kind, whether Eddic or Scaldic.

Lay of Wayland

(*Vǫlundar kviða*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.428)–early C11th (0.475)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Lay of Wayland** (abbrev. *Vkv*) is a psychologically complex narrative poem dealing with the capture and revenge of the famous smith Wayland.

Textual preservation and transmission

Vkv only survives in full in **R** (foll. 18r/4–19v/6), where it follows *Þrk* and is followed by *Alv*. The beginning of the prose introduction is found on the very last foll. of **A** (6v/26–28), where it follows *Hym*.

Although technically a heroic poem, *Vkv* is part of the mythological section of **R**, to which it conforms orthographically (Lindblad 1980, pp. 160–166), and it is found in the otherwise exclusively mythological **A**. The poem also does not belong to the story of the Walsings, nor to the Hallow-poems, which are the main subjects of the heroic part of **R**. For these reasons, *Vkv* is placed under Norse Mythic Poetry in the pres. ed.

Origin and motifs

Vkv is a narrative poem telling the story of Wayland the Smith (ON *Vǫlundr*, OE *Weland* or *Weland*, MHG **Welent*). Wayland was one of the most popular figures in early mediæval Germanic legend and independent versions of his tale are found in Germany, England, and Iceland.

In his archetypal form, Wayland is an uncannily talented smith who is taken captive and hamstrung by the greedy tyrant King Nithad (ON *Nið-uðr*, OE *Niþbad*, MHG **Nidung*). Nithad forces Wayland to make jewels for him and his household but Wayland carries out a cruel revenge against the king: he murders his two sons and rapes his daughter, Beadchild (ON *Bǫðv-ildir*, OE *Beadubild*, MHG **Botil*), making her pregnant. At last, he makes a flight-suit

out of feathers, typically (though not in *Vkv*) with the help of his brother Eysel (ON *Egill*, OE *Ægili*). Having regained his mobility through ingenuity he makes his escape and leaves the ruined king's household behind.

There is a strong parallelism throughout the narrative in that Wayland gets his revenge on the whole royal household by doing unto them what was done to him. This theme is developed very effectively in the present poem (but cf. the treatment in the OE *Déor* 1–2). Like Wayland was taken while waiting for his wife, so he murders Nithad's two young sons and ends his family line. Like he was made powerless, he defangs Nithad's *kunnig kvæn* 'cunning wife' by reducing her once powerful counsels to cold words. Like he lost his wife's golden ring, so he rapes Beadchild, depriving her of her maidenhood.

In this way the royal household is reduced to the very same state of abject powerlessness that Wayland himself experienced, something signalled by the repetition of the adjective *vilja-lauss* 'powerless'. In st. 12 this word describes Wayland after he awakes in shackles, but in st. 31 it is King Nithad who uses it to refer to his own mental state after the deaths of his sons. This sense of hopelessness also concludes the poem with Beadchild's haunting words: "In no way did I know how to withstand him; in no way could I withstand him."

Parallels

As mentioned above, *Vkv* is not the only retelling of Wayland's story. The other relevant retellings are the 9th century OE *Déor* and the 13th century Norse *Þiðr*; the former represents the older, Anglo-Norse version, while the latter represents the younger Low German version.

Wayland is alluded to in numerous other sources, from which we learn a little about the fate of Beadchild. After Wayland abandoned her she gave birth to a son, Woody (OE *Wudga*, *Þiðr Viðga*, in Danish ballads *Vidrik Verlandson*). He went on to become a great hero, and in the later heroic ballads far eclipses his father in fame. His birth seems heavily foreshadowed by Wayland forcing Nithad to swear an oath on the unborn child in st. 33, but he is nowhere directly mentioned in the poem, probably for artistic reasons: dwelling on the tragic image of Beadchild is certainly a powerful ending.

Déor shortly relates the lives of five figures from Germanic legend. Stanzas 1–2 deal with Wayland and Beadchild, and the underlying story is identical to that of *Vkv*: Wayland is imprisoned by Nithad, then kills his sons and rapes Beadchild. Like *Vkv*, *Déor* particularly emphasises the powerlessness felt by Wayland and how his revenge in turn inflicted the same on Beadchild.

An Anglo-Saxon pictorial depiction of the story is found on the early C8th Franks casket, which shows Wayland drugging Beadchild, Nithad's decapitated sons, and his brother Eysel collecting swan-feathers for the flight-suit (fig. 7). The fact that the Wayland-Story is as prominent as the depiction of the Adoration of the Magi is a testament to the weight with which it was regarded in early mediæval England.

The other full retelling of Wayland's life is found in the much younger *Þiðr*. While written in Old Norse, it is clear from the linguistic forms of



Figure 7: The front panel of the Franks casket. Anglo-Saxon, ca. 725 CE.
 © John W. Schulze. CC BY 2.0. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Franks_Casket_front.jpg

the proper names and content in it that it is based on Low German sources, probably heroic ballads. Thus the native Norse forms *Völundr* and *Nið-uðr* are replaced with the Low German *Velent* [sic] and *Niðungr*. The 13th century author makes an interesting note which reveals that native Norse stories about Wayland were not yet entirely extinct in his time: he mentions “*Velent*, the excellent smith, whom Warrings (*væringjar* ‘Varangians’) call *Völundr*. [...] *Velent* is so famous in the whole northern hemisphere that all men seem to praise his workmanship in such a way that the craftsman of any piece which is crafted better than others is called a *Völundr* with regards to craftsmanship.”

It is not merely in dialect that *Þiðr* departs from the older retellings; far more important is the difference in tone. The psychological complexity and tragedy of *Vkv* and *Déor* are entirely gone, and Wayland is no longer a mysterious supernatural wild man, but a chivalrous knight who can escape from any peril through his ingenuity and skill. He is not kidnapped out of Nithad’s greed nor hamstrung on the suspicions of his cruel wife, but is instead a loyal servant of Nithad’s, banished from the kingdom after defending himself against the king’s corrupt steward and hamstrung after being caught attempting to poison the king’s food.

Yet the biggest change in the narrative is without doubt that the personality of Beadchild is entirely expunged. Far from the Anglo-Norse version she has here become the anonymous “king’s daughter”, a nameless *jungfrú* ‘maiden’ (a borrowing from Low German) whom Wayland seduces by means of a vulgar sex joke (“Now the king’s daughter comes into the smithy and asks Wayland to mend the ring, but he says that he firsts wants to ‘forge’ something else.”) and who quickly falls in love with him.

Likewise gone is the person of Nithad’s cunning wife, and the murder of

his sons no longer ends his lineage, since he has another son who survives him and takes over the kingdom. Wayland still flies away laughing after telling Nithad what he has done, but only four years later reconciliates with Nithad's living son, retrieves Beadhild and their three-year old son and lives a long and happy life as a famous smith.

By the time of the *Þiðr* the old story of Wayland had been heavily bowdlerized, a tragic victim of chivalric sensibilities. This younger version does not have any high literary value, but is of course still of interest since it shows the wide reception and variation of the narrative.

Origin and motifs

If we are to search for the origins of the Wayland-myth we can hardly look in Scandinavia. As we have seen above the story was particularly popular in Anglo-Saxon England, and it is probably hence that it made its way to Scandinavia.

Vkv does indeed show signs of Old English influence in its vocabulary (1/2: *al-vitr*, 11/2: *ljóði*, 36/3: *aukin*), nor do the proper names of its characters (particularly Beadhild and Thankred, the thrall) seem North Germanic. Of course, the poem cannot be a direct translation from OE. The impossibility of that is shown by the use of formulaic Norse lines (e.g. 16/1–2, 30/1–2) and by lines requiring North Germanic sound changes to alliterate (e.g. 14/3: *óra aura · i Ulf-dǫlum* 'our ounces in the Woldfdales' vs. reconstructed OE: **ūre éaras · in Wulf-dalum*, and note that OE **éaras* 'ounces' is not even a real word).

Even older versions of the story must needs remain forever lost. It is clear from their names that Wayland and Nithad are fairy-tale characters, not historical figures, for Wayland's name means 'Crafty Hand' (< PGmc. **wēla-handuz*, Brate 1908) and Nithad's 'Shameful Fighter' (< PGmc. **niþa-haduz*).

Comparatively there are striking similarities between Wayland and the Greek smith Δαίδαλος. Both are legendary inventors trapped on an island by an evil tyrant for whom they have been forced to work, and both make their escape alongside a near relation (Wayland's brother Eyel, Δαίδαλος' son Ἴκαρος) by means of a flight-suit. The difficulty with these parallels is that the Wayland-story, anchored as it is in Germanic legend, is attested long before knowledge of Greek mythology can have existed in Northern Europe. We may therefore be dealing with much older folklore, perhaps even going back to the Bronze Age (as the image of the Labyrinth definitely does) or the Neolithic European Farmers, although such connections cannot but remain speculation.

A unique narrative feature of the Norse *Vkv* is its incorporation of the motif of the swan-wife at the beginning of the poem. This motif, widespread throughout world mythology (TODO: cite), is not otherwise found in connection with story of Wayland. Whether this is due to the incompleteness of our early parallel sources or a genuine innovation of the Norse Wayland-tradition remains unclear.

Text

Frá Völundi ('From Wayland')

P1 Níð-uðr hét konungr í Sví-þjóð. Hann átti tvá sonu ok eina dóttur; hón hét Bøðv-ildr. Bróðr vöru þrír, synir Finna konungs. Hét einn Slag-fiðr, annarr Egill, þriði Völundr. Þeir skriðu ok veiddu dýr. Þeir kvómu í Ulf-dali ok gerðu sér þar hús. Þar er vatn, er heitir Úlf-sjár. Snemma of morgin fundu þeir á vats-ströndu konur þrjár, ok spunnu lín. Þar vöru hjá þeim álftarhamir þeira; þat vöru val-kyrjur. Þar vöru tvær dótr Hlōð-vés konungs: Hlað-guðr svan-hvít ok Her-vor al-vitr. In þriðja var Ql-rún Kjárs dóttir af Val-landi. Þeir hófðu þér heim til skála með sér. Fekk Egill Ql-rúnar, en Slag-fiðr svan-hvítar, en Völundr al-vitrar. Þau bjuggu sjau vetr. Þá flugu þér at vitja víga ok kvómu eigi apr. Þá skreið Egill at leita Ql-rúnar, en Slag-fiðr leitaði svan-hvítar, en Völundr sat í Ulf-dölum. Hann var ha-gastr maðr, svá at menn viti í fornum sǫgum. Níð-uðr konungr lét hann hǫndum taka, svá sem hér er um kveðit:

[R 18r/4, A 6v/26]

Nithad was the name of a king in Sweden. He had two sons and one daughter; she was called Beadchild. There were three brothers, the sons of a king of the Finns. One was called Slayfinn, the other Eyel, the third Wayland. They fared on skis and hunted wild beasts. They came into the Wolfdales and made for themselves houses there. There is a lake there which is called the Wolfsea. Early in the morning they found by the lake-shore three women and they were spinning linen. There beside them were their swan-hames; those were Walkirries. There were two daughters of king Ludwigh: Ladguth Swanwhite and Harware Elwight. The third was Alerune, daughter of Coser of Walland. The men took the women to their halls with them. Eyel got Alerune and Slayfinn Swanwhite and Wayland the Elwight. The couples lived there for seven winters; then the women left to attend battles, and did not come back. Then Eyel fared on skis to search for Alerune and Slayfinn searched for Swanwhite, but Wayland stayed in the Wolfdales. He was the most skilled craftsman whom men know of in the ancient saws. King Nithad had him taken captive, about which it is here sung:

2 hón hét 'she was called' | ok hét hón 'and she was called' A 2 vöru 'were' | om. R 4 gerðu 'made' | after this word the rest of the ms. ends for loss of following foll. A

9 Kjárs ... af Val-landi 'Coser of Walland' | I.e. 'Caesar of Rome/France'. Of course no specific historical emperor can be identified by this name, but rather it is an anachronistic reflex of the position, a title which has been misunderstood as a proper name. Cf. *Wid* 4/3, where Coser (OE *Cāsere*) is said to rule the Greeks. For the form see st. 15/4 n., for other occurrences see Index.

Frá Völundi ok Níð-aði ('From Wayland and Nithad')

- 1 **M**eyjar flugu sunnan · **M**yrk-við i gognum [R 18r/19]
 2 **a**l-vitr **u**ngar, · **ø**r-lög drýgja;
 þér á sēvar strönd · sēttu=sk at hvíla=sk,
 4 **d**rósir suð-rónar · **d**ýrt lín spunnu.

Maidens flew from the south through Mirkwood
 —young elwights—to fulfill orlay.

By a lake-shore they set down to rest;
 the southern ladies span costly linen.

2 **u**ngar | *gramm. emend.*; unga **R**

1 Myrk-við 'Mirkwood' | A great border forest, surely referenced for its association with the war-ravaged lands of the Gots and Huns; a natural environment for Walkirries.

2 al-vitr 'elwights' | "Strange beings, foreign wights", from Proto-Norse **alja-wihtiz* or borrowed from OE *æl-wiht* pl. 'strange creatures, monsters'.

2 ør-lög drýgja 'to fulfill orlay' | That is, to fulfill their preordained destinies, viz. to attend battles as Walkirries and choose which men to take away (cf. P1 and st. 3). Clunies Ross (2005, p. 103), La Farge and Tucker (1992, p. 319) and others see these words as a sign of English influence and translate *drýgja ør-lög* as 'engage in war', considering *ør-lög* a semantic borrowing from OE *or-lege* 'war, strife' (cf. Dutch *oorlog* 'war'). This is unnecessary. ON *ør-lög* otherwise only means 'fate, destiny', as may OE *or-leg* as seen by an equivalent phrase found in l. 29 of a poem on the Christian Doomsday (TODO?), where a man going to Hell for his sins þenne á tó ealdre · *or-legg dreógeð* 'then for ever and ever suffers his orlay'.

- 2 **E**in nam þeira · **E**gil at verja [R 18r/21]
 2 **f**ogr mēr fira · **f**aðmi ljósum;
 qnnur vas **S**van·hvít, · **s**van-fjaðrar dró,
 4 [...]
 en in þriðja · þeira systir
 6 varði **h**vítan · **h**als Völundar.

One of them took to embrace Eyel
 —the fair maiden among men—in her shining bosom.
 Second was Swanwhite; her swan-feathers she rustled,
 [...] but the third sister among them
 embraced the white throat of Wayland.

6 Völundar | *sens. emend.*; Qnnundar **R**

ALL | The three swan-maidens meet the three brothers, and each one takes a husband.

4 [...] | A line mentioning Slayfinn has probably been lost here.

6 hvítan 'white' | Pale skin being a sign of noble ancestry; cf. 17/3.

- 3 Sötu síðan · sjau vetr at þat, [R 18r/24]
 2 en hinn áttu · allan þröðu,
 en hinn níunda · nauðr of skilði,
 4 meyjar fýstu=sk · á myrkvan við,
 al-vitr ungar · ör-loð drýgja.

They stayed then seven winters after that,
 but during all the eighth they yearned,
 and during the ninth need parted them.
 The maidens longed for the Mirky Wood,
 the young elwights to fulfill orlay.

5 ungar | *gramm. emend.*; unga R

- 4 Kom þar af veði · veðr-eygr skyti [R 18r/26]
 2 Völundr liðandi · of langan veg,
 Slag-fiðr ok Eggill, · sali fundu auða,
 4 gingu út ok inn · ok umb söu=sk.

There from the hunt came the stormy-eyed shooter:
 Wayland passing over a long way.
 Slayfinn and Eysel found the halls deserted;
 they walked out and in and looked about.

1 veðr-eygr | *emend.*, cf. st. 9/3; †vegr†-eygr R 2 Völundr ... veg 'Wayland ... way' | *emend.*
 based on st. 9/3-4; om. R

- 5 Austr skreið Eggill · at Ql-runu, [R 18r/27]
 2 en suðr Slag-fiðr · at Svan·hvítu,
 en einn Völundr · sat i Ulf-dölum.

To the east skied Eysel after Alerune,
 but to the south Slayfinn after Swanwhite,
 and alone Wayland stayed in the Wolfdales.

- 6 Hann sló goll rautt · við gim fastan, [R 18r/29]
 2 lukði alla · linn-bauga vel;
 svá beidd hann · sinnar ljóssar
 4 kvánar, ef hönnum · koma gerði.

He struck red gold against fastened gemstone;
 he enclosed all the serpent-bighs well;
 so he awaited his shining wife,
 if to him she might come.

2 linn-bauga ‘serpent-bighs’ | *emend.*; ‘lind bauga’ R 3 ljóssar | *emend.*; ljósar R

1 sló goll rautt · við gim fastan ‘struck red gold against fastened gemstone’ | A description of the *cloisonné* technique wherein red garnet is encased in thin gold plates. Finds featuring this technique are very common in the period between ca. 300–700 CE, but almost non-existent afterwards (Nerman 1931, pp. 33–37). As *Vkv* was most likely composed one or two centuries after 700 this reflects a memory of the material culture of an earlier period. For a similar instance cf. *HHj* 9.

2 linn-bauga ‘serpent-bighs’ | It is unclear whether this word refers to rings actually fitted with snake-heads or is merely a poetic description of twisted rings or spirals. Archeological examples of the former include the so-called “snake-head rings” (German *Schlangenkopfringe*, Swedish *ormbuvudringar*) from the early Migration Period (Nerman 1931, p. 38), and the snake- or dragon-shaped armlet from the Viking Age found in a hoard in Undrom, Ångermanland, northern Sweden (item number 108822 HST; <https://samlingar.shm.se/object/5C5658C4-0813-4DFF-947F-E5E4C4BAB965>).

- 7 Þat spyrri Níð-uðr, · Níara dróttinn,
2 at ęinn Völundr · sat i Ulf-dölum;
nóttum fóru seggir, · neglðar vóru brynjur,
4 skildir bliku þeira · við inn skarða mána.

[R 18r/31]

This learns Nithad, lord of the Nears:
that alone Wayland did stay in the Wolfdales.
At night journeyed warriors—nailed were their byrnies—
their shields gleamed by the sickle moon.

3 fóru | *emend.*; vóru R 3 seggir | *emend.*; segir R

1 Níara ‘the Nears’ | An obscure tribe. The fact that they are located in Sweden (P1 above) may allow us to connect them with the inhabitants of the Swedish province of Närke, who in OSwe. are known as *Nerikjar*, most likely from the tribal/geographical root *ner-* + *-ikjar* ‘inhabitants’. The stem *ner-* (with unclear vowel length) is also found in the adjective OSwe. *ner-isker* ‘belonging to Närke, Närkeian’ and could then be the equivalent of OWN *níar-* ~ *njár-*. For further discussion on the origin of OSwe. *ner-* see Sahlgren (1925).

3 neglðar vóru brynjur ‘nailed were their byrnies’ | The byrnies here are some kind of plate armour.

- 8 Stigu ór sðölum · at salar gaffi,
2ingu inn þaðan · ęnd-langan sal,
sðu á bast · bauga dregna,
4 sjau hundruð allra, · es sá seggr átti.

[R 18r/33]

They stepped off their saddles by the hall’s gables,
went thence inside the endlong hall.
They saw on a bast-rope bighs drawn up:
seven hundred in all, which that man owned.

2ingu ... sal ‘went ... hall’ | The line appears to be a variant of the formulaic *bann/hęn inn of gekk* · *ęnd-langan sal* ‘he/she went inside the endlong hall’ which also occurs in below *Vkv* 16/2 and 30/2 and in *Oddr* 3/3. For *ęnd-langan sal* ‘endlong hall’ in general cf. *Þrk* 27/2 n.

- 9 Ok þeir af tóku · ok þeir á létu
 2 fyr einn útan, · es af létu.
 Kom þar af vęði · veðr-eygr skyti
 4 Völundr liðandi · of langan veg.

[R 18v/2]

And they took them off and they slid them [back] on,
 save for one which they slid off.—

There from the hunt came the stormy-eyed shooter:
 Wayland passing over a long way.

2 fyr einn útan, · es af létu ‘save for one, which off they slid’ | This bigh is probably the one mentioned in sts. 17 and 26, since Beadchild has it already when Wayland is brought back after being captured. It may have been kept for its particular beauty. Finnur Jónsson (1932) writes, in my translation from the Danish: “The ring which Nithad kept must have had special properties and distinguished itself before others. There is no doubt that the ring is a flight ring; whether this was clear to the poet is however questionable. This much is certain: that Wayland seems to be able to fly away only after he has got back the ring; that is, the one which Beadchild brings him.” This is by no means certain. Wayland was a craftsman of legendary skill and could certainly have built wings for himself without a magical flight-ring. That is what he does in the Low German version; it is also what happens in the related Daidalos myth. For both of these see the introduction to the present poem.

- 10 Gekk hann brúnni · beru hold stęikja;
 2 ár brann hrísi · all-þurr fura,
 viðr inn vind-þurri, · fyr Völundi.

[R 18v/4]

Went he the brown she-bear’s flesh to roast;
 in early morn burned the twigs of all-dry pine—
 the wood wind-dry—before Wayland.

2 ár | *metr. and sens. emend.*; hár R

- 11 Sat á ber-fjalli, · bauga talði,
 2 alfa ljóði · eins saknaði;
 hugði at hefði · Hlōð-vés dóttir,
 4 al-vitr unga · vęri aþr komin.

[R 18v/5]

Sat he on the bear-pelt, bighs he counted—
 the prince of elves was missing one!
 Thought he that Ludwigh’s daughter [= Harware] might have it,
 that the young elwight might be come back.

1 bauga talði ‘bighs he counted’ | Wayland’s grief and loneliness is skilfully illustrated by his counting all seven hundred rings, something which has apparently become habitual for him.

2 alfa ljóði ‘prince of elves’ | Probably referring to Wayland’s nature as a wild man; this is further seen by his bear-hunting, skiing, and fierce gaze, all associated with the Finns or Saami. Cf. 14/2b and 32/1b, where Nithad calls him *vísi alfa* ‘chief of elves’.

12 Sat svá lengi, · at sofnaði,

[R 18v/7]

2 ok vaknaði · vilja-lauss;
vissi sér á hǫndum · hǫfgar nauðir,
4 ęn á fótum · fǫtur of spęnntan.

Sat he so long that asleep he fell,
and he awoke, powerless.
He knew on his hands heavy restraints,
and on his feet a fetter tightened.

[Vǫlundr kvað:] 13 „Hverir ’ro jǫfrar · þęir’s á logðu

[R 18v/9]

2 bęsti*-sima · ok bundu mik?“

[Quoth Wayland:] “Which are the princes that have laid on
the bast-cordage, and bound me?”

2 bęsti*-sima | *emend.*; ‘besti-byr-sima’ R

14 Kallaði nú Níð-uðr, · Níara dróttinn:

[R 18v/10]

2 „Hvar gatst, Vǫlundr, · vísi alfa,
óra aura, · i Ulf-dǫlum?
4 Goll vas þar ęgi · á Grana leiðu,
fjarri hugða’k vart land · fjǫllum Rínar.“

Now called Nithad, lord of the Nears:
“Where didst thou, Wayland, chief of elves,
get *our* ounces in the Wolfdales?
Gold was there not on Grane’s path;
far I thought our land from the fells of the Rhine.”

ALL | Grane was the horse of the legendary hero Siward, who slew the dragon Fathomer and took his gold (see *Füfi*); these events are here, as in the later German *Nibelung* tradition, supposed to have taken place around the Rhine. Nithad’s speech is sarcastic: “How did you get so rich, Wayland? Was there a dragon’s hoard in the Wolfdales? Clearly not, so you must have stolen from me.”

[Vǫlundr kvað:] 15 „Man’k at meiri · mėti ǫttum,

[R 18v/13]

2 es vér heil hía · heima vǫrum:
Hlað-guðr ok Hęr-vǫr · borin vas Hlǫð-véi,
4 kunn vas Ǫl-rún · Kíars dóttir.“

[Quoth Wayland:] “I recall that we owned a greater treasure
when we a whole household were at home.
Ladguth and Harware were born to Ludwigh;
known was Alerune, Coser’s daughter.”

ok seṭið hann síðan · i Sétvar-stoð.“

“His teeth are bared when he is shown the sword,
and Beadhild’s high he recognizes;
reminiscent are his eyes to the gleaming serpent’s.
Snithe ye from him the might of his sinews,
and set him thereafter on Seastead!”

- P3** Svá var gort, at skornar vöru sínar í knés-fótum ok settir í holm [R 18v/21]
2 einn, er þar var fyrir landi, er hét Sétvar-staðr. Þar smíðaði hann
konungi alls-kyns gort-simar; engi maðr þorði at fara til hans,
4 nema konungur einn. Völundr kvað:

So it was done that the sinews in his houghs were cut and he was placed on
the lonely islet which lay there before the land and which was called Seastead.
There he forged for the king every kind of jewel. No man dared go to him,
save the king alone. Quoth Wayland:

- 18** „Skínn Níð-aði · sverð á linda, [R 18v/24]
2 þat’s ek hvēsta · sem hagast kunna’k
ok ek hēðā’k · sem hógst þótti;
4 sá’s mér fránn mékir · é fjarri borinn;
sé’k=a þann Völundi · til smiðju borinn.

“The sword shines on Nithad’s belt,
which I sharpened as most handily I could,
and I hardened as most pleasingly seemed.
That gleaming blade is ever further from me carried;
I see it not for Wayland to the smithy carried!

1 Skínn ‘shines’ | Metrically deficient, since *sk-* and *s-* cannot alliterate. A possible emendation is *se’k* ‘I see’.

- 19** Nú berr Bøðv-ildr · brúðar minnar [R 18v/27]
2 —bíð’k=a þess bót— · bauga rauða.“

Now does Beadhild bear my bride’s
—I await no recompense for that—red bigs.”

- 20** Sat—né svaf á-valt— · ok sló hamri; [R 18v/28]
2 vél gerði hēldr · hvatt Níð-aði;
drifu ungir tveir · á dýr sea
4 synir Níð-aðar · i Sétvar-stoð.

He sat—never slept—and struck the hammer;
 wiles he most boldly planned for Nithad.
 Two young ones were drifting to see costly things:
 Nithad's sons, to Seastead.

1 Sat—né svaf á-valt— ‘He sat—never slept—’ | Compare *Gbv* 13/3: *böfu mik—né drękkðu—* ‘[they] lifted me—drowned [me] not—’.

- 21 Kvømu til kistu, · krøfðu lukla, [R 18v/30]
 2 opin vas ill-úð, · es þeir i sðu,
 fjöld vas þar meina, · es mōgum sýndi=sk
 4 at véri goll rautt · ok gōr-simar.

Came they to the chest, demanded the keys;
 open was the evil when inside they looked.
 A host was there of harms, which to the lads seemed
 like were they red gold and jewelry.

- [Völundr kvað:] 22 „Komið einir tveir, · komið annars dags; [R 18v/33]
 2 ykkir lét'k þat goll · of gefit verða;
 segið-a meyjum · né sal-þjóðum,
 4 manni øngum, · at mik fyndið.“

[Quoth Wayland:] “Come alone ye two, come another day;
 to you, I say, this gold will be given.
 Tell no maidens nor hall-folk
 —not a man!—that *me* ye met.”

- 23 Snimma kallaði · segrgr á annan, [R 19r/1]
 2 bróðir á bróður: · „gōngum baug séa!“
 Kvømu til kistu, · krøfðu lukla,
 4 opin vas ill-úð · es þeir i litu.

Early called one youth to another,
 brother to brother: “Let us go see the highs!”
 Came they to the chest, demanded the keys;
 open was the evil when inside they gazed.

1 kallaði | *emend.*; kallað R

- 24 Sneið af hōfuð · hūna þeira [R 19r/3]
 2 ok und fēn fjoturs · fōtr of lagði,
 en þēr skálar, · es und skōrum vōru,
 4 sveip útan silfri, · sēldi Níð-aði.

He sliced off the heads of those bear-cubs,
and under the fetter's fen their feet he laid.
And the bowls which were under their curls
he coated with silver, gave to Nithad.

2 lagði | *emend.*; †logði† R

1 húnna 'bear-cubs' | This word is common in prose, but only in the sense 'bear-cub', never used as here about humans. The affectionate sense for young boys perhaps relates to warrior-initiations done in bear-skins. Its only occurrence in the sense 'young boys' outside of *Vkv* is in *Ghv* 12/1, but it is repeated by Nithad in st. 32 and mirrored by Wayland in st. 34 below.

2 fēn fjoturs 'the fetter's fen' | Unclear. The smithy or islet may be Wayland's "fetter", in which case he buried them in a fen on the island.

3 þęr skálar, · es und skörum vöru 'those bowls which were under their curls' | Their skulls.

- 25 **E**n ór **a**ugum · **j**arkna-stęina [R 19r/5]
 2 sęndi **k**unnigri · **k**vęn Níð-aðar;
 ęn ór tønnum · tveggja þęira
 4 sló brjóst-kringlur, · sęndi Bęðv-ildi.

And from the eyes arkenstones
he sent to the cunning wife of Nithad.
And from the teeth of the two
he struck breast-brooches, sent to Beadhild.

2 *kven* | *emend.*; konu R

1 jarkna-stęina 'arkenstones' | Generally held to be a borrowing from OE. Probably round crystals.

- 26 Þa nam Bęðv-ildr · baugi at hrósa [R 19r/7]
 2 [...] · es brotit hafði,
 „þori'g=a'k sęja, · nema þér ęinum.“

Then Beadhild began the high to praise,
[...] which she had broken,
“I dare not tell, save to thee alone.”

ALL. | Something appears to be missing before this stanza, but the narrative can be gleaned. Beadhild breaks the high given to her by Nithad (mentioned above in sts. 10—see note there—and 17), and fears her father's anger. She goes to Wayland in secret and begs him to fix it. The sight of the ring reminds Wayland of his wife and he is furious; he decides to begin with his revenge, and rapes Beadhild.

2 [...] | The meter requires a half-line here, perhaps containing a repetition of 1a: *baugi at hrósa* 'the high to praise'.

- Völundr kvað: 27 „Ek bóti svá · brest á golli,

[R 19r/8]

- 2 at fēðr þinum · fegri þykkir,
ok móðr þinni · miklu bētri,
4 ok sjalfri þér · at sama hófi.“

Quoth Wayland: “I will so mend the crack on the gold,
that to thy father it fairer seems,
and to thy mother even better,
and to thyself of the same rank.”

- 28 Bar hana bjóri, · því't bētr kunni,
2 svá't hön i sessi · of sofnaði.
[Völundr kvað:] „Nú hef'k hefnt · harma minna
4 allra nema einna · i-við-gjarna.“

[R 19r/10]

He overcame her with beer—for he knew better—
so that she in the seat did fall asleep.
“Now have I avenged my harms,
all, save one, on the insidious ones.”

4 i-við-gjarna | *sens. emend.*; i-við-†gjarira†

1 því't bētr kunni ‘for he knew better’ | He was more cunning than she.

4 nema einna ‘save one’ | Presumably the deprivation of his mobility due to the hamstringing,
which he resolves by crafting his flight suit.

4 i-við-gjarna ‘insidious ones’ | King Nithad and his house.

- 29 „Vēl ek,“ kvað Völundr, · „verða'k á fitjum,
2 þeim's mik Níð-aðar · nómu rekkar.“
Hléjandi Völundr · hóf=sk at lopti,
4 grátandi Bøðv-ildr · gekk ór eyju,
tregði fōr friðils · ok fōður reði.

[R 19r/12]

“Well I”, quoth Wayland, “fall on my paddles;
those of which Nithad's men bereaved me!”
Laughing, Wayland threw himself in the air;
weeping, Beadhild went from the island,
grieved the lover's flight and the father's wrath.

1 fitjum ‘paddles’ | CV: *fit* ‘the webbed foot of water-birds’, here a reference to the flight-suit which
allows Wayland to regain his freedom.

- 30 Úti stóð kunnig · kvön Níð-aðar,
2 ok hön inn of gekk · çnd=langan sal,
çn hann á sal-garð · sætti=sk at hvíla=sk,

[R 19r/14]

4 „Vakir þú Níð-uðr, · Níara dróttinn?“

Outside stood the cunning wife of Nithad
and she went inside the endlong hall,
but he on the courtyard set down to rest—
“Art thou awake, O Nithad, lord of the Nears?”

1 stóð ‘stood’ | *emend.*; stendr ‘stands’ R

[Níð-uðr kvað:]

31 „Vaki’k á·valt · vilja-lauss,
2 sofná’k minst, · síðst sonu dauða,
kæll mik i hofuð, · kold eru=mk röð þín,
4 vilnumk þess nú, · at við Völund dóma’k.“

[R 19r/17]

[Quoth Nithad:]

“I am always awake, powerless;
I sleep the least since my sons died.
My head turns cold; cold seem thy counsels—
I would now but that I with Wayland may speak.”

1 Vaki’k á·valt · vilja-lauss ‘I am always awake, powerless’ | This line references sts. 12 and 20, but there Wayland was the powerless man who never slept. By his revenge the suffering has been transferred onto Nithad.

3 kold eru=mk röð þín ‘cold seem thy counsels’ | A severe insult to a woman of power, for such counsels to her husband was how she would influence worldly affairs. In this way Wayland’s revenge reaches also Nithad’s wife.

[Níð-uðr kvað:]

32 „Sæg mér þat Völundr, · vísi alfa,
2 af heilum hvat · varð húnum mínum?“

[R 19r/19]

[Quoth Nithad:]

“Tell me this, Wayland, chief of elves:
what became of my healthy bear-cubs?”

2 húnum | *metr. emend.*; sonum R

[Völundr kvað:]

33 „Eiða skalt mér áðr · alla vinna,
2 at skips borði · ok at skjaldar rønd,
at mars bógi · ok at mækis egg
4 at þú kvelj=at · kvøn Völundar,
né brúði mínni · at bana verðir,
6 þó’tt kvøn ęigim, · þá’s *er kunnið,
eða jóð ęigim · innan hallar.

[R 19r/20]

[Quoth Wayland:]

“Oaths shalt thou first swear to me all—
by side of ship and rim of shield,
by bough of steed and edge of sword—
that thou shalt not torment the wife of Wayland,

nor of my bride become the bane,
though we might own a wife which ye might know,
or might own a babe within the hall.

6 *çigim* | *emend.*; †*égim*† R 6 **ér* | *metr. emend.*; þér R 7 *cða* | *emend.*; †*çþ*† R

2–3 at skips ... *çgg* ‘by side ... of sword’ | Nithad must swear oaths by the tools of trade of the warrior i.e., on his martial honour. Cf. 2 *HHund*, where broken oaths are to come back “biting” the oath-breaker by cursing his ship, horse, and sword, in that order.

4 *kvēlj-at* ‘shalt not torment’ | A negative imperative. The 2nd. sg. imper. of *kvēlja* ‘torment’ is *kvēl*, but the negative clitic *-at* causes the *-j-* of the stem to reappear in a rare *liaison* effect. This indicates that forms like *kvēl* were still understood to contain *-j-*, just no longer pronounced, but which could reappear in the correct circumstance.

4–5 *kvön Völundar* ‘wife of Wayland’, *brúði minni* ‘my bride’ | *Beadhild*, who is now pregnant.

- 34 **G**akk til smiðju, · þeirar’s gørðir,
2 þar fiðr **b**ęlgi · blóði stokna,
 snęið’k af hęfuð · huna þinna
4 ok und fęn fjoturs · fotr of lagða’k.

[R 19r/24]

Go to the smithy which thou madest;
there wilt thou find bellows blood-besprinkled.
I sliced off the heads of thy bear-cubs,
and under the fetter’s fen their feet I laid.

- 35 **E**n þér skálar, · es und skorum vöru,
2 sveip’k útan silfri, · sęlda’k Níð·aði,
 en ór augum · jarkna-stęina,
4 sęnda’k kunnigri · kvön Níð·aðar.

[R 19r/26]

And the bowls which were under their curls,
I coated with silver, gave to Nithad.
And from the eyes arkenstones
I sent to the cunning wife of Nithad.

- 36 **E**n ór tønnum · tveggja þeira
2 slók brjóst-kringlur, · sęnda’k Bęðv-ildi;
 nú gengr Bęðv-ildir · barni aukin,
4 ęinga dóttir · ykkur þeggja.“

[R 19r/28]

And from the teeth of the two
I struck breast-brooches, sent to Beadhild.
Now Beadhild goes swollen with child;
the only daughter of you both.”

3 barni aukin 'swollen with child' | A likely sign of OE influence, as this is the only occurrence of ON *aukin* 'increased, augmented' in the sense 'pregnant', whereas this is attested in OE. Indeed, in *Déor* 11, Beadhild is also described as *éacen*, the direct cognate.

4 ęinga dóttir · ykkur beggja. 'the only daughter of you both' | Formulaic, near-identical to *Heiðr* st. 25/1–2: (*Vaki, Angantýr*, · *vekr þik Hęrvęr*, // *ęinga dóttir* · *ykkur Svęfu*. 'Wake, Ongentew: Harware awakes thee, the only daughter of thee and Sweve.' Cf. also *Beow* 375a, 2997b: *ąngan dohtor* 'only daughter (accusative)').

- [Níð-uðr kvað:] 37 „Mél̥tir=a þat mál, · es mik meirr tregi, [R 19r/30]
2 né þik vilja'k Vǫlundr · verr of níta;
es=at svá maðr hǫr, · at þik af hești taki,
4 né svá ǫflugr, · at þik neðan skjóti,
þar's þú skollir · við ský uppi.“

[Quoth Nithad:] “Thou couldst not have spoken a speech which would grieve me more;
nor could I worse wish, Wayland, to deny thee.
There is no man so high that he might take thee from a horse,
nor so strong that he might shoot thee from below,
where thou dost jeer by the clouds above!”

- 38 Hléjandi Vǫlundr · hóf=sk at lopti, [R 19v/1]
2 ęn ǫ·kátr Níð-uðr · sat þa ętir.
Laughing, Wayland threw himself in the air;
but, gloomy, Nithad stayed behind.

- [Níð-uðr kvað:] 39 „Upp rís Þakk-ráðr, · þrél̥l minn batsti, [R 19v/2]
2 bið Bǫðv-ildi, · mey ina brá-hvitu,
gangi fagr-varið · við fǫður róða.“

[Quoth Nithad:] “Rise up, Thankred, my best thrall;
bid Beadhild, the brow-white maiden,
to go, fair-clothed, with her father to counsel.”

1 Þakk-ráðr ‘Thankred’ | A German name never found elsewhere in ON, but equivalent to MHG *Dancrāt*.

2–3 mey hina brá-hvitu ... fagr-varið ‘the brow-white maiden ... fair-clothed’ | Nithad still has some doubt in his heart and by these words tries to convince himself of the innocence of his daughter (*męr* ‘maiden, virgin’).

- [Níð-uðr kvað:] 40 „Es þat satt Bǫðv-ildr, · es sǫgðu mér, [R 19v/3]
2 sǫtuð it Vǫlundr · saman í holmi?“

[Quoth Nithad:] “Is it true, Beadhild, as they told me—
stayed thou and Wayland together on the islet?”

[Bǫðv·ildr kvað:] 41 „Satt ’s þat Nið·uðr · es sagði þér:
 2 sǫtum vit Völundr · saman í holmi
 3 ęina ǫgur-stund, · ęva skyldi;
 4 ek vętr hǫnum · vinna kunna’k,
 ek vętr hǫnum · vinna mätta’k.“

[R 19v/4]

[Quoth Beadchild:] “True is that, Nithad, which *he* told thee—
 I and Wayland stayed together on the islet
 for one heavy hour—it should never have been.
 I nowise knew withstand him;
 I nowise could withstand him.”

4 *vinna* | *metr. and sens. emend.; om. R*

1 sagði ‘*he* told’ | Beadchild knows that Wayland is the only one aware of the rape and thus deduces that *he* told her father. She makes a subtle change in the conjugation from her father’s general third person plural (“what they told”), to the specific singular form (“what *he* told”).

4–5 kunna’k ‘knew’, mätta’k ‘could’ | Beadchild did not know (*kunna* ‘to know, understand’) how to ward him off, yet even if she had been wise enough, she would still have been overpowered, for she had not the strength (*meęa* ‘to have strength to, avail’). A touching final stanza.

Speeches of Allwise

(*Al·víss mól*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.851)

Meter: Leeds-meter

Introduction

The **Speeches of Allwise** (*Alvissmal*) is a list of poetic synonyms set in a frame narrative of Thunder being visited by a dwarf insisting that he has been promised his daughter's hand.

Textual preservation and transmission

Alv is found in whole in **R** on foll. 19v/7–20r/19, where it follows *Vkv* and is followed by *1 HHund*. It concludes the mythological group of poems (to which also *Vkv* belongs) in the manuscript; the immediately following *1 HHund* introduces the heroic group.

The poem was known to Snorre. Sts. 20 and 30 are cited in *Skm*, where they are attributed to *Al·víss mól* in TODO (A, C) and to *Al·svinns mól* 'the Speeches of Allswith' in all other mss. (TODO).

Origin and motifs

There is not much of a story in *Alv*, but two elements of the frame narrative (sts. 1–8, 35) are of interest.

The first is the motif of an enemy of the Gods wishing to steal away one of their women. This is also attested in the myth of the ettin Master Builder (*Vsp* 24 nn., *Gylf* 42) and in *Þrk* (see Introduction to that poem), where the ettin Thrim demands the hand of the goddess Frow as a ransom for Thunder's hammer Millner.

The second motif is that of a dwarf perishing (usually by turning to stone, e.g. *HHj* 29–30, although that is not stated explicitly in *Alv*) when exposed to sunlight at daybreak, a motif famously employed by J.R.R Tolkien in *The Hobbit*.

The language of the Gods

The bulk of the poem (sts. 9–34) is however taken up by the listing of poetic synonyms for various phenomena. *Alv* contrasts the normal terms used by men with those used by the Elves, Dwarfs, Gods, and those in Hell or the Underworld. Some of these synonyms, especially those said to be used by the Gods, are quite archaic and represent older common Indo-European and Germanic words that have been displaced by younger words in the common register (10/1 *fold*, 26/1 *funi*, 32/1 *barr*) or alternate forms of the same IE root (16/1 *sunna*). Others are transparent kennings not found elsewhere.

The fascinating idea of a language of the Gods is not unique to the Norse but is also attested in other cultures.

Notably, Homer often mentions that things have different names among Gods and mortals. So a certain hill at Troy “do men truly call ‘Thorny Hill’ (Βατίειαν), but the Undying ‘the Barrow of much-springing Myrina’ (σῆμα πολυ-σκάρθμοιο Μυρίνης)” (*Il* 2.813–814); a certain bird “do Gods call Bronzen (χαλκίδα), but men κύμινδιν” (*Il* 14.291); and the river Scamander “do Gods call Xanthus (Ξάνθον), but men Scamander (Σκάμανδρον)” (*Il* 20.74).

Meter and stanza

The meter of *Alv* is Leeds-meter. The poem consists of 140 lines (71 full-lines, 70 long-lines) divided into 35 sts., all of which follow the typical structure *abcabc* except for the final st. 35 which has the 5-line structure *abcabcc*.

Summary

As mentioned above the frame narrative of the poem consists of sts. 1–8 at the beginning and 35 at the very end.

The section dealing with names (sts. 9–34) is tightly structured and the phenomena are frequently paired according to their nature, e.g. earth and heaven (9–12), sun and moon (15–18), water and fire (23–26). The following phenomena are dealt with:

Sts. 9–10: earth, 11–12: heaven, 13–14: moon, 15–16: sun, 17–18: clouds, 19–20: wind, 21–22: calm weather, 23–24: water, 25–26: fire, 27–28: wood, 29–30: night, 31–32: grain, 33–34: ale.

Text

The Speeches of Allwise

- [All-víss kvað:] 1 „Bekki breiða · nú skal brúðr með mér
2 heim i sinni snúask;
hratat of mégi · mun hverjum þikkja;
4 heima skal=at hvíld nema.“ [R 19v/7–8]
- [Quoth Allwise:] “SPREAD OUT ON THE BENCHES shall now the bride with me,
[and] turn home by my side.
A hurried engagement it will seem to each;
at home shall she not take rest!”
- [Þórr kvað:] 2 „Hvat ’s þat fira; · hví est svá fǫlr umb nasar;
2 vast-u i nǫtt með ná?
Þursa líki · þikki mér á þér vesa;
4 est=at-tu til brúðar borinn.“ [R 19v/9–10]
- [Quoth Thunder:] “What sort of man is this; why art thou so pale about the nose;
wast thou tonight with a corpse?
The likeness of a thurse methinks thou hast;
thou wast not born for this bride!”
- [All-víss kvað:] 3 „Al-víss ek heiti · bý’k fyr jorð neðan
2 á’k undir stęini stað.
vagna vers · ek em á vit kominn
4 bregði engi fǫstu heiti fira.“ [R 19v/10–12]
- [Quoth Allwise:] “Allwise I am called; I live beneath the earth;
I own under a stone my home.
The man of wagons [= Thunder] I am come to visit;
let no man break a firm vow!”
-
- 3 vagna vers ‘man of wagons’ | The “wagons” may here be constellations in the heavens, namely the *Charles’ Wain* (Great Bear, Big Dipper) and *Women’s Wain* (Little Bear, Little Dipper). Cf. *Skm* 31, where heaven/the sky is kenned *land sólar ok tungls ok himin-tungla, vagna ok vęðra* ‘the land of sun and moon, and the heavenly bodies, wagons and winds.’
- [Þórr kvað:] 4 „Ek mun bregða · því’t ek brúðar á
2 flest umb rǫð sem fǫðir.
vas’k=a ek heima · þá’s þér heitit vas
4 at sá ęinn es gjǫf es með goðum.“ [R 19v/12–14]

[Quoth Thunder:] “I will break it, for about the bride
I have the greatest say, as her father.
I was not at home when it was vowed to thee,
but he [I] alone is the giver among the gods.”

[All-viss kvað:] 5 „Hvat ’s þat rekka · es i rǫðum tǣlsk [R 19v/14–16]
2 fljóðs ins fagr-glóa;
fjarra-fléina · þik munu fair kunna;
4 hverr hefir þik baugum borit?“

[Quoth Allwise:] “What sort of champion is this who claims to have a say
about the fair-glowing girl?
O foreign tramp, few men will know thee;
who has borne bigs to thee?”

[Þórr kvað:] 6 „Ving-Þórr ek heiti · ek hefi víða ratat [R 19v/16–18]
2 sonr em’k Síð-grana;
at ó-sátt minni · skalt þat it unga man hafa
4 ok þat gjaf-orð geta.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Wing-Thunder I am called; I have widely roamed;
I am the son of Sidegrane.
Against my assent shalt thou have this young girl,
and get that gift-word!”

[All-viss kvað:] 7 „Sáttir þinar · es ek vil snemma hafa [R 19v/18–20]
2 ok þat gjaf-orð geta.
eiga vilja · heldr an án vera
4 þat it mjall-hvíta man.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Thy assents I wish to have soon,
and get that gift-word,
I would rather have than be without
this snow-white girl.”

⁴ þat it mjall-hvíta man ‘this snow-white girl’ | For whiteness as a symbol of nobility cf. Introduction to *Rþ*.

[Þórr kvað:] 8 „Meyjar óstum · mun=a þér verða [R 19v/20–21]
2 vísi gestr of varit,
ef þú ór heimi kant · hverjum at segja
4 allt þat’s ek vil vita.

[Quoth Thunder:] “The maiden’s love will not be,
O wise guest, denied thee,
if thou from every home canst tell
all I wish to know:

9 Sęg-đu mér þat Al·viss · ǫll of rǫk fira
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir,
hvé sú jǫrð heitir · es liggr fyr alda sonum
4 heimi hverjum ĩ.“

[R 19v/21–23]

Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the earth is called which lies before the sons of men
in every home.”

1 ǫll of rǫk fira ‘all rakes of men’ | To be understood as ‘all lore’.

[All·viss kvað:] 10 „Jǫrð heitir með mǫnnum · ęn með ǫlfum fold,
2 kalla vega vanir.
ĩ-grón jǫtnar · alfar gróandi
4 kalla aur upp-ręin.“

[R 19v/23–25]

[Quoth Allwise:] “Earth it is called among men but among Elves ‘fold’;
call it ‘ways’ the Waners,
‘evergreen’ Ettins, Elves ‘growing’;
call it ‘mud’ the Up-reins.”

[Þórr kvað:] 11 „Sęg-đu mér þat Al·viss · ǫll of rǫk fira
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;
hvé sá himinn heitir · erakendi
4 heimi hverjum ĩ.“

[R 19v/25]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the heaven is called ...
in every home.”

3 erakendi ‘..’ | A string too corrupt to restore without excessive conjecture; it at least appears to contain the relative pronoun *er* ‘which’, younger form of *es* and the adjective *ķęnndr* ‘known’. Based on the first line, the alliteration must have fallen on *b-*, and the root that first suggests itself is *hęð* ‘height’. A possible restoration is then *es á hęð es ķęnndr* ‘which is known on high’.

[All·viss kvað:] 12 „Himinn heitir með mǫnnum · ęn Hlýrnir með goðum
2 kalla Vind-ófni vanir;

[R 19v/26–27]

upp-heim jǫtnar · alfar fagra-réfr
dvergar drjúpan sal.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Heaven it is called among men but ‘Lerner’ among the Gods;
‘Wind-ovner’ call it the Wanes;
‘upham’ Ettins, Elves ‘fair roof’,
Dwarfs ‘dripping hall.’”

[Þórr kvað:] 13 „Sæg-ðu mér þat Al-víss · ǫll of rök fira
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;
hversu mæni heitir · sá's mænn sjá
4 heimi hverjum i.“

[R 19v/27–28]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
how the moon is called which men do see
in every home.”

[All-víss kvað:] 14 „Mæni heitir með mǫnnum · en Mylinn með goðum,
2 kalla hverfanda hvél hejju i;
skyndi jǫtnar · en skin dvergar
4 kalla alfar ár-tala.“

[R 19v/28–30]

[Quoth Allwise:] “Moon it is called among men, but ‘Milen’ among the Gods,
they call it ‘turning wheel’ in Hell,
‘haster’ Ettins and ‘shine’ Dwarfs;
Elves call it ‘year-tallier.’”

4 ár-tala ‘year-tallier’ | The moon was important in the Germanic calendar (witness *month*, a “moon-th”). Cf. *Vsp* 6 and *Vǫsp* 23, 25.

[Þórr kvað:] 15 „Sæg-ðu mér þat Al-víss · ǫll of rök fira
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;
hvé sú sól heitir · es sjá alda synir.
4 heimi hverjum i.“

[R 19v/30]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the sun is called, which the sons of men see,
in every home.”

[All-víss kvað:] 16 „Sól heitir með mǫnnum · en sunna með goðum
2 kalla dvergar Dvalins leika;
Ey-glói jǫtnar · alfar fagra-hvél

[R 19v/31–32]

4 al-skír asa synir.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Sun it is called among men, but ‘Swail’ among the Gods,
Dwarfs call it ‘Dwollen’s playmate’;
‘ever-glower’ Ettins, Elves ‘fair wheel’,
‘all-bright’ the sons of the Eese.”

1 Sól ... sunna ‘Sun ... Swail’ | A problem arises for the translation since *sól* is the normal word for ‘sun’ in ON, whereas the direct cognate to English “sun” *sunna* is a poetic synonym. *sól* and *sunna* are in fact doublets, ultimately deriving from different declensions of the IE heteroclitlic noun nom. *sh₂u-el, gen. *sh₂-en- ~ *sh₂u-n-ós (Kroonen 2013, pp. 463–464). To retain this symmetry in the translation ON *sunna* has been rendered as ‘swail’ (< OE *swēgel*), a cognate of *sól* that preserves the old nominative-accusative *-l of the PIE noun.

[Þórr kvað:] 17 „Sęg-đu mér þat Al-víss · ǫll of rǫk fira
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;
hvé þau ský ęęita · es skúrum blanda=sk
4 ęęimi hveřjum ĩ.“

[R 19v/32–33]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the clouds are called which are mixed with showers
in every home.”

[All-víss kvað:] 18 „Ský ęęita með mǫnnum, · ęn skúr-vǫn með goðum;
2 kalla vind-flot vanir;
úr-vǫn jǫtnar, · alfar veðr-męgin;
4 kalla ĩ ęęļu hjalm huliðs.“

[R 19v/33–20r/1]

[Quoth Allwise:] “Clouds they are called among men, but ‘shower-hope’ among the Gods;
‘wind-fat’ the Wanes call them;
‘drizzle-hope’ the Ettins, Elves ‘weather-strength’;
in Hell they call them ‘helmet of the hidden’.”

[Þórr kvað:] 19 „Sęg-đu mér þat Al-víss · ǫll of rǫk fira
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;
hvé sá vindr ęęitir · es víðast fęř
4 ęęimi hveřjum ĩ.“

[R 20r/1]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the wind is called where travels widest
in every home.”

[All-víss kvað:] 20 „Vindr ęęitir með mǫnnum, · ęn vǫfuðr með goðum;

[R 20r/2–3
TODO]

- 2 kalla gneggjuð ginn-ręgin.
 ópi jōtnar · alfar dyn-fara
 4 kalla i hęlju hviđuð.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Wind it is called among men but ‘waver’ among the Gods,
 ‘neigher’ call it the Yin-Reins;
 ‘weeper’ Ettins, Elves ‘din-farer’;
 in Hell they call it ‘stormer’.”

ALL | This st. is cited in *Skm* 74.

- [Þórr kvað:] 21 „Sęg-đu męr þat Al-viss · ęll of rōk fira
 2 vęr=umk dvergr at vitir;
 hvę þat logn hętir · es liggja skal
 4 hęimi hęęjum i.“

[R 20r/3–4]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
 I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
 what the calm is called, which shall lie
 in every home.”

- [All-viss kvað:] 22 „Logn hętir með mōnnum, · ęn lęgi með goðum,
 2 kalla vinds flot vanir;
 of-hlý jōtnar · alfar dag-sefa,
 4 kalla dvergar dags veru.“

[R 20r/4–5]

[Quoth Allwise:] “Calm it is called among men and ‘lowering’ among the Gods,
 ‘wind’s fat’ the Wanes call it;
 ‘great lee’ Ettins, Elves ‘day-sleep’,
 call it Dwarfs ‘day’s rest’.”

2 kalla vinds flot vanir “‘wind’s fat’ the Wanes call it’ | Most likely corruption from st. 18/2 above.

- [Þórr kvað:] 23 „Sęg-đu męr þat Al-viss · ęll of rōk fira
 2 vęr=umk dvergr at vitir;
 hvę sá marr hętir · es męnn róa
 4 hęimi hęęjum i.“

[R 20r/5]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
 I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
 what the ocean is called where men do row
 in every home.”

- [All-viss kvað:] 24 „Sęr hętir með mōnnum, · ęn s-i-lęgja með goðum,

[R 20r/6–7]

2 kalla vág vanir;
 ál-heim jǫtnar, · alfar laga-staf,
 4 kalla dvergar djúpan mar.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Sea it is called among men but ‘ever-low’ among the Gods;
 ‘wave’ the Wanes call it;
 ‘eelhome’ Ettins, Elves ‘staff of waters’;
 Dwarfs call it ‘deep ocean.’”

[Þórr kvað:] 25 „Segðu mér þat Al·víss · ǫll of rök fira
 2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;
 hvé sá ǣldr heitir · es brenn fyr alda sonum
 4 heimi hverjum i.“

[R 20r/7–8]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
 I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
 what the fire is called, which burns for the sons of men,
 in every home.”

[All·víss kvað:] 26 „Eldr heitir með mǫnnum · ǣn með ǫsum funi
 2 kalla vág vanir;
 frekan jǫtnar · ǣn for-brēnni d*vergar
 4 kalla i helju hrǫðuð.“

[R 20r/8–9]

[Quoth Allwise:] “Fire it is called among men but among the Eese ‘flame’,
 ‘wave’ the Wanes call it;
 ‘the greedy’ Ettins, but ‘burner’ Dwarfs;
 in Hell they call it ‘hurrier’.”

2 kalla vág vanir “wave’ the Wanes call it’ | Certainly an error based on st. 24/2 above; fire is not otherwise known as ‘wave’.

[Þórr kvað:] 27 „Segðu mér þat Al·víss · ǫll of rök fira
 2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;
 hvé viðr heitir · es vǣx fyr alda sonum
 4 heimi hverjum i.“

[R 20r/9–10]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
 I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
 what the wood is called, which grows for the sons of men,
 in every home.”

[All·víss kvað:] 28 „Viðr heitir með mǫnnum. · ǣn vallar fax með goðum
 2 kalla hlíð-þang halir;

[R 20r/10–11]

ǫldi jǫtnar · alfar fagr-lima
4 kalla vǫnd vanir.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Wood it is called among men but ‘mane of the plain’ among the Gods;
‘slope-kelp’ heroes call it;
‘firewood’ Ettins, Elves ‘fair-limb’;
‘wand’ the Wanes call it.”

1 vallar fax | *emend.*; vallar far R.

[Þórr kvað:] 29 „Seg-ðu mér þat Al-víss · ǫll of rök fira
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;
hvé sú Nǫtt heitir · in Nǫrvi kenda
4 heimi hverjum i.“

[R 20r/11–12]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the Night is called, born to Narrow,
in every home.”

3 in Nǫrvi kenda ‘born to Narrow’ | See *Vafþ* 25/2 n.

[All-viss kvað:] 30 „Nǫtt heitir með mǫnnum · ęn njól með goðum,
2 kalla grímu ginn-ęgin;
ǫljós jǫtnar · alfar svefn-gaman
4 kalla dvergar draum-Njǫrun.“

[R 20r/12–13
TODO]

[Quoth Allwise:] “Night it is called among men but ‘nivel’ among the Gods;
‘mask’ the Yin-Reins call it,
‘un-light’ Ettins, Elves ‘sleep-joy’;
Dwarfs call it ‘dream-Narn’.”

ALL | This st. is cited in *Skm* 78.

[Þórr kvað:] 31 „Seg-ðu mér þat Al-víss · ǫll of rök fira
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;
hvé þat sǫð heitir · es sáa alda synir
4 heimi hverjum i.“

[R 20r/13–14]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the seed is called, which the sons of men sow
in every home.”

[All-viss kvað:] 32 „Bygg heitir með mǫnnum · ęn barr með goðum

[R 20r/14–15]

2 kalla vǫxt vanir.
 3 **é**ti jǫtnar · alfar laga-staf
 4 kalla **ī** hēlju hnipinn.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Barley it is called among men but ‘leaf’ among the Gods;
 ‘growth’ the Wanes call it;
 ‘eating’ Ettins, Elves ‘staff of waters’;
 in Hell they call it ‘wilting’.”

[Þórr kvað:] **33** „Seg-ðu mér þat Al·víss · **ǫ**ll of rǫk fira
 2 **v**qr=umk dvergr at **v**itir;
 hvé þat **ǫ**l hēitir · es drekka **a**lda synir
 4 **h**ēimi **h**vęrjum **ī**.“

[R 20r/15–16]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
 I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
 what the ale is called, which the sons of men drink,
 in every home.”

[All·víss kvað:] **34** „**Ǫ**l hēitir með mǫnnum · **ę**n með **ǫ**sum bjórr;
 2 kalla **v**ęig vanir;
hręina-lǫg jǫtnar · **ę**n **ī** hēlju mjǫð;
 4 kalla **s**umbl **S**uttungs **s**ynir.“

[R 20r/16–17]

[Quoth Allwise:] “Ale it is called among men but among the Eese ‘beer’;
 ‘draughts’ the Wanes call it;
 ‘pure water’ the Ettins but in Hell ‘mead’;
 ‘simble’ Sutting’s sons call it.”

[Þórr kvað:] **35** „**ī** **ę**inu brjósti · ek sá’k **a**ldri=gi
 2 **f**lēiri forna stafi;
 miklum **t**ǫlum · ek kveð **t**éldan þik:
 4 uppi est **d**vergr of **d**agaðr;
 nú skinn **s**ól **ī** **s**ali.“

[R 20r/18–19]

[Quoth Thunder:] “In a single breast I never saw
 more ancient staves—
 with mighty tricks I call thee tricked:
 thou art, dwarf, dayed up;
 now shines the sun into the halls!”

Thule of Rígh

(*Rígs þula*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C13th (0.280)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Thule of Rígh** (abbrev. *Rþ*) is an incomplete narrative poem describing the origin of the social classes and the monarchy.

Textual preservation and transmission

Rþ is preserved only on a single folio (78rv) in the 14th century ms. **W**, where it follows the Prose Edda and four grammatical treatises all written in the same hand as the poem.

Numerous leaves are unfortunately missing from the original **W**, and among them the conclusion to *Rþ*. Still, part of what would have been found in the lost part of the poem can be gleaned from parallel sources, as will be dealt with below.

Origin and motifs

Rþ is a powerful and, due to its incompleteness, enigmatic poem. It has something of the folk-tale about it and serves as an etiology for the origin of the Wiking Age Norwegian class system and a celebration of the superiority of the warrior-nobility.

In the poem the mysterious Rígh (ON *Rígr*) fathers in succession three human sons with three women, *Edda* 'Great-grandma', *Amma* 'Grandma', and *Móðir* 'Mother'. Their respective sons become *Þræll* 'Thrall', *Karl* 'Churl', and *Jarl* 'Earl', each in turn serving as the ancestor for each of the three classes: the slaves, the freeholders or farmers, and the nobility. In turn, the youngest of Earl's twelve sons, Kin the young (*Konr ungr*), becomes the first to hold the title of 'king' (*konungr*).

The identity of Rígh

The main mystery of the poem is the obscure figure Rígh (*Rígr*), identified in the prose introduction as Homedall. His name has traditionally been seen as a sign of Irish influence on the basis of Old Irish *rí* (oblique sg. stem *rig-*) 'king'.

Rígh does not appear in any other poetic source, but his name is found in two related genealogies: in *Yng* 17 and in the epitome of the lost *Skjoldunga saga*, both of which are included in the Appendix to the poem below.

These genealogies, although conflicting, are clearly related to an episode we only get a hint about at the very end of this poem (st. 46), namely Kin the young's visit to Dene and Danp.

In the parallel sources these two figures are ancestral to the later Danish and Norwegian monarchies through their relation to Rígh, and this was almost certainly the case also in *Rþ*, as shown by the pun on the name of Kin the young (ON *Konr ungr*) and the title king (*konungr*). According to *Yng* 17, Rígh was the first ruler to be called 'king' in the Scandinavian cultural sphere.

Having already laid out the origins of the thralls, churls, and earls, it seems inevitable, then, that the remaining sts. would have dealt with the establishment of monarchy.

Although Rígh is identified as Homedall in the prose introduction, his role in the poem is really more reminiscent of what we know about the god Woden. Like Woden, Rígh is an aristocrat, an inciter of war, and a teacher of runes; like Woden he bestows favour on his protégé, who tends to be the youngest son (cf. *Grm* P1–P2).

Since the introductory prose is likely the work of a learned writer, viz. the compiler of the **W** manuscript, it is not at all unlikely that it could be drawing on *Vsp* 1/2, where the unparalleled expression *megir Hęim-dalar* 'sons of Homedall' seems to be a kenning referring to men. It is of course not impossible that Homedall also had the aforementioned Odinic traits, but we learn of no such thing from other sources where the runes are always the exclusive domain of Woden alone (so e.g. *Háv* 138–139). For these reasons, Rígh is probably more likely to be identified with Woden than Homedall, the prose introduction notwithstanding.

Class, race, and essentialism

One of the most striking aspects of *Rþ* is its long and detailed physical descriptions of the founders of the human social classes, which includes both dress and phenotype. Thus Thrall is swarthy and crooked (sts. 7–8), Churl is red-haired, ruddy, and well-turned out, with wandering eyes (18–19), and Earl is blonde and pale, with a piercing gaze (33). That piercing gaze is important as it symbolizes the acquisitive nature of earldom, unlike the wandering eyes of the freeholder. The aristocratic earl, the type of man celebrated by *Rþ*, is content with nothing but the best and will pursue it unrelentingly until victory or death.

It should not be controversial to say that *Rþ* is by all accounts an essentialist poem which posits that distinctions in class are fundamentally racial. According to this worldview one's birth is not drawn by lot, nor are souls randomly assigned to their station; everything is due to blood, and the superior man breeds superior children who prove their natural superiority in warlike conquest.

If we are to search for a historical circumstance to explain the phenotypical differences described in the poem, the taking of "swarthy" (in comparison to the Nordic Scandinavians) slaves from the British Isles, especially Ireland, quite likely played a role. As shown by Rodríguez-Varela et al. (2023), this slave traffic left a lasting and substantial effect on the genetics of all of Scandinavia, although Celtic ancestry gradually decreased after the Wiking Age. A likely explanation for this is that the Celtic ancestry was negatively correlated with total fertility due to its concentration in the lower social strata.

It is common knowledge that to this day the Western Norwegians have both the highest rate of Celtic ancestry (e.g. as measured by the haplogroup R1b-L21) and the greatest incidence of red and black hair amongst non-Uralicised Norwegians (Bryn and Schreiner 1929), something also shared with the heavily Celtic-influenced Icelanders (Coon 1939, p. 326). As the Celtic slave populations were gradually assimilated (largely but not exclusively through concubinage) into the freeholding farmers the prevalence of red hair also in the mixed children would have been noticed and made them stand out against the blonde Nordic aristocracy among whom redness was likely nearly nonexistent, as still in our time amongst the Swedes.

Apart from the explanation of Celtic influence (which certainly was a reality), we should also remember that in a stratified society with an emphasis on breeding, attractive traits tend to accumulate in the upper strata. Most Neolithic Eurasian societies have historically strongly favoured light skin, especially in women, as a sign of wealth and beauty, and Northern Europe, where the genes for light hair and blue eyes could also be selected for, was no exception to this rule, as shown by evidence both genetic (Wilde et al. 2014) and literary (most notably *Rþ* itself). As the Nordic upper classes were bred for beauty, strength, and intelligence these traits would co-mingle and gradually become strongly correlated, leading to a racialised in-group sense.

A curious anecdote known in somewhat varying form from two sagas, *Ldn* 2.19 and *Hálf* 17, reveals some complexities of the Norse essentialist worldview: A Norse king took to wife a daughter of a king of Barmland (*Bjarma-land*, i.e., Permian) and she begot two sons with him, Garmund and Highmund, who came out swarthy and very ugly (*Hálf* 17: *svartir ok fúrðu ljótir*, implying Mongoloid features). Upset, the queen switched out the two sons with a blonde and beautiful slave-boy, Loaf, of the same age. One day when the boys were three years old all men had gone away save for the poet Bray the Old. Loaf was sitting in the king's high seat and playing with some gold, while Garmund and Highmund were down in the straw; jealous, the brothers pulled him down from the seat and took all the gold. Loaf wept. At that moment Bray knew that Loaf could not be the son of two noble parents, and announced it in a stanza, after which Garmund and Highmund regained

their status as the king's sons.

Even in this supposedly non-racist anecdote the moral of the story is none other than biological essentialism. The boy Loaf's slavish nature can instantly be ascertained by his behaviour, regardless of the way in which he is raised. Like Churl, he does not have the eyes of acquisition which signify true nobility. Being put on the king's throne in no way entitles him to it, and when given the chance the king's true sons quickly retake it.

TODO: Dumézil three-part society.

Meter and stanza

Rþ consists of 183 total long-lines divided into 46 stanzas. The length of the stanza is extremely irregular. Stanzas of 3 (14/46: 1, 3, 5–6, 9–10, 15, 19, 24–25, 28, 32, 44–45) and 4 lines (15/46: 11, 14, 17, 20, 22–23, 26–27, 29, 33, 37–39, 43, 46) are most common, followed by 5 lines (10/46: 2, 8, 13, 16, 21, 30(?), 35, 40–42). Other represented lengths are 2 (7, 18, 31), 6 (4, 34, 36), and 7 lines (12).

Metrically *Rþ* is in an unusual form of Ancient-words-law. The meter is notable for its unusually high incidence of 3-syllable verses, which are not allowed in all types of Ancient-words-law, and for the extremely high incidence of type A verses at 77.7 %, higher than any other Eddic poem (Sapp 2022, p. 152).

Language and style

Rþ has a very low occurrence of the particle *of* at 0.082 per 10 unique lines (Sapp 2022, p. 70).

The language is exceptionally formulaic and repetitive, with many expressions, lines and even whole stanzas repeated identically throughout as *Rígh* visits each of the three households. This repetition gives the poem something of an incantatory feeling.

Dating

On the basis of the loose and unusual meter, the likely Celtic influence in the name *Rígr*, its connection to later legendary material in the form of the textual parallels, and the extremely low prevalence of the particle *of* *Rþ* is most likely to be a late antiquarian poem composed after the conversion to Christianity, likely in the 12th or even 13th century. To signs of a late composition may be added the poem's central premise (but cf. above for a comparative discussion), since it is questionable to what degree the social structure evinced in the poem actually existed in the Wiking Age, when even the wealthiest noble families were closely allied with freeholding farmers, compared to the more stratified High Middle Ages.

A late dating agrees with Sapp's model, which yields a most likely dating to the 13th c., although at 0.280 the confidence is rather low.

Another dimension for dating is the detailed descriptions of dress and lifestyle which may be considered archeologically, particularly in sts. 15–16, 26–27, 29–30, 33. On the basis of these Nerman (1969) estimates the composition of the poem to the Wiking Age, but this assumes that knowledge of earlier material culture cannot have survived after a certain period had passed, an assumption we know based on other sources (e.g. *HHj* 9/1, *Sigs* 68/1) to be incorrect.

Text

- P1 Svá segja menn í fornum sǫgum, at einn-hverr af ǫsum, sá er [W 78r/1–3]
 2 Heim·dallr hét, fór ferðar sinnar ok framm með sjóvar-ströndu
 4 nǫkkurri, kom at einum húsa-bó ok nefndi=sk Rígr; eptir þeiri
 sǫgu er kvæði þetta.

SO DO MEN SAY in the ancient saws that one of the Eese, he who was called Homedall, went upon his journey, and, going forth along a certain lake shore, he came upon a lone homestead and called himself Righ. After that saw is this poem.

- 1 Ár kvóðu ganga · grónar brautir [W 78r/4–5]
 2 ǫflgan ok aldinn · ǫs kunnigan,
 ramman ok rǫskvan · Ríg stíganda.

OF YORE, THEY SAID, did walk on green roads
 a mighty and ancient os, cunning:
 the strong and brisk Righ, striding.

1 Ár 'Of yore' | *emend.*; 'at' W

1 Ár 'Of yore' | Formulaic; it is very common for poems to begin with *ár* 'of yore, in the beginning'. Cf. *Vsp* 3/1, *Hym* 1/1, *I HHund* 1/1, *I Guðr* 1/1, *Sigsk* 1/1.

- 2 Gekk męirr at þat · miðrar brautar, [W 78r/5–6]
 2 kom hann at húsi, · hurð vas á gętti;
 inn nam at ganga, · ęldr vas á golfi,
 4 hjón sǫtu þar · hǫr at arni,
 Ái ok Edda · aldin-falda.

He walked further thereafter on the middle of the road,
 came to a house; the door was wide open.
 He took to go inside; fire was on the floor;
 a couple sat there, hoary by the hearth:
 Great-Grandpa and Great-Grandma in an old-time shawl.

4 at | *sens. emend.*; af W

2 á gętti 'wide open' | Lit. 'on the threshold', in contrast to 14/2 and 24/3.

- 3 Rígr kunni þeim · rǫð at segja; [W 78r/7–8]
 2 męirr sętti=sk hann · miðra fletja

en á hlið hvára · hjón sal-kynna.

Rígh knew to tell them counsels,
further he set himself down on the middle of the bench,
and on either side: the couple of the hall.

- 4 Þá tók Edda · økkvinn hleif, [W 78r/8–10]
2 þungan ok þykkvan, · þrunginn sóðum,
bar hön meirr at þat · miðra skutla,
4 soð vas í bolla · setti á bjóð;
vas kalfr soðinn · krása bætstr;
6 reis hann upp þaðan, · réð=sk at sofna;

Then Great-Grandma took a lumpy loaf—
heavy and thick, stuffed with chaff—
carried it further thereafter in the middle of a trencher;
broth was in a bowl—she set it on a platter.
A cooked calf was the best dainty;
he [= Rígh] rose up thence, resolved to sleep.

- 5 Rígr kunni þeim · róð at sęja; [W 78r/10–11]
2 meirr lagði=sk hann · miðrar rekkju,
en á hlið hvára · hjón sal-kynna.

Rígh knew to tell them counsels;
further he laid himself down on the middle of the bed,
and on either side: the couple of the hall.

- 6 Þar vas hann at þat · þrjár nætr saman; [W 78r/11–12]
2 gekk hann meirr at þat · miðrar brautar;
liðu meirr at þat · mönuðr níu.

There he was thereafter for three nights in their midst;
he walked further thereafter in the middle of the road;
further thereafter passed nine months.

- 7 Jóðól Edda, · jósu vatni [W 78r/12]
2 hqrund-svartan, · hétu þrél.

Great-Grandma begot a child—they sprinkled it with water:
swarthy of skin, they called it Thrall.

2 hqrund-svartan 'swarthy of skin' | emend.; hqrfi svartan 'swarthy with flax(?)' W

1 jósu vatni ‘they sprinkled it with water’ | A reference to the Heathen naming ceremony wherein water would be poured on a newborn, somewhat resembling the Christian baptism. See *Háv* 156.

- 8 Hann nam at vaxa · ok vǫl dafna; [W 78r/12–14]
 2 vas þar á hǫndum · hrokkit skinn,
 kropnir knúar, · [...]
 4 fingr digrir, · fúl=ligt and-lit,
 lotr hryggr, · langir hēlar.

He took to grow and have it well;
 there on his hands was wrinkled skin,
 crooked knuckles, [...],
 stubby fingers, loathsome face,
 stooping back, long heels.

- 9 Nam meirr at þat · magns of kosta, [W 78r/14–15]
 2 bast at binda, · byrðar gørva;
 bar hēim at þat · hrís gęstan dag.

He took further thereafter to try his strength:
 bast to bind, burdens to make;
 he carried home thereafter brushwood on a gloomy day.

- 10 Þar kom at garði · gęgil-bęina, [W 78r/15–16]
 2 aurr vas á iljum, · armr sól-brunninn,
 niðr-bjúgt es nęf, · nęfndi=sk þír.

There to the farm came a gangle-boned girl:
 mud was on her footsoles, her arm sunburnt,
 downturned her nose; she called herself Thew.

1 gęgil-bęina ‘gangle-boned girl’ | Derogatory, somebody who (due to poverty) only travels by foot.

3 þír ‘Thew’ | A variant of *þýr* ‘maid-servant, female slave’. Unlike Thrall, this word is not attested in any prose texts, but it is found in poetry (chiefly in the plural) and in legal compounds like *þý-borinn* ‘born of a female slave or concubine’. It is related to OS *thiwi* ‘maid(-servant)’, being the female form of the Proto-Norse *þewar* ‘servant’, OE *þéow* ‘slave, servant’, ultimately from the root of the verb *þéa* - *þjá* ‘to enthrall’.

- 11 Meirr sętti=sk hōn · miðra fletja, [W 78r/16–17]
 2 sat hjá hęnni · sonr hús,
 róddu ok rýndu, · rękkju gørðu
 4 þręll ok þír · þrungin dógr.

Further she set herself down on the middle of the bench;
by her sat the son of the house [= Thrall].
They spoke and whispered, made a bed—
Thrall and Thew—in hard-pressed nights.

1 Męirr sętti=sk hęn · miðra fletja | *emend. based on other sts.*; miðra fletja · męirr sętti=sk hęn
W

- 12 Bęrn ólu þau, · bjuggu ok unðu;
2 hygg'k at héti · Hřęimr ok Fjósniř,
Klúrr ok Klęggi, · Kęfsir, Fúlnir,
4 Drumbr, Digraldi, · Dřottr ok Hęsvir,
Lútr ok Lęggjaldi; · lęđu garða,
6 akra tųddu, · unnu at svinum,
gęita gęttu, · grófu torf.

[W 78r/17–19]

Children they begot, settled and were content.
I think that they were called Rame and Feesner,
Clour and Cledge, Chafser, Foulner,
Drumber, Digrald, Drant and Hazer,
Lout and Leggald. They laid yard-fences,
dunged fields, looked after swine,
herded goats, dug turf.

- 13 Dótr vęru þęr · Drumba ok Kumba,
2 Økkvin-kalfa · ok Arin-nęfja,
Ysja ok Ambóttr, · Eikin-tjasna,
4 Třtrug-hypja · ok Tręnu-bęina;
þaðan eru komnar · þręla ęttir.

[W 78r/20–21]

The daughters were these: Drumb and Cumb,
Inkencalf and Arnneb,
Eaze and Ambight, Oakentarsen,
Tattryhip and Tranebone—
thereof are come the lines of thralls.

- 14 Gekk Rigr at þat · réttar brautir
2 kom hann at hęllu, · hurð vas à skíði,
inn nam at ganga, · ęldr vas à golfi,
4 hjęn sętu þar · heldu à syslu.

[W 78r/21–22]

Righ walked thereafter on straight roads,
came to a hall; the door was hinged.

He took to go inside; fire was on the floor;
a couple sat there, kept to their chores.

2 *þollu* ‘hall’ | *sens. and metr. emend. (cf. st. 38); om. W*

- 15 **Maðr** tēlgði þar · **mēið** til riðar,
2 vas **skēgg** skapat, · **skor** vas fyr enni
skyrtu þrōngva · **skokkr** vas á golfi.

The man there carved a stick into a loom-beam.
His beard was shapely; locks hung down his forehead,
his shirt tight; a toolbox was on the floor.

- 16 **Sat** þar kona, · **svēigði** rokk,
2 **brēiddi** faðm, · **bjó** til váðar;
svēigr vas á hqðoi, · **smokkr** vas á bringu,
4 **dúkr** vas á halsi, · **dvergar** á oxlum;
Afi ok **Amma** · **óttu** hús.

There sat the woman, twirled a distaff,
stretched out her arms, readied the cloth.
A scarf was on her head, a smock on her breast,
a kerchief on her throat, dwarfs on her shoulders—
Grandpa and Grandma owned a house.

ALL. | This st. contains an extremely interesting description of female dress. Nerman (1969) deals with this. TODO.

4 *dvergar* ‘dwarfs’ | Nerman (1969) explains this word as referring to an archeological find. TODO.

- 17 **Rígr** kunni þeim · **róð** at segja,
2 **rēis** frá borði · **réð** at sofna.
Mēirr lagði=sk hann · **miðrar** rēkkju
4 en á **hlið** hvára · **hjon** sal-kynna.

Rígh knew to tell them counsels,
rose from the table, resolved to sleep.
Further he laid himself down on the middle of the bed,
and on either side: the couple of the hall.

- 18 **Þar** vas hann at þat · **þrjár** nētr saman;
2 liðu **mēirr** at þat · **mōnuðr** níu.

There he was thereafter for three nights in their midst;
further thereafter passed nine months.

- 19 Jóðól Amma, · jósu vatni, [W 78r/27–28]
 2 kǫlluðu Karl · kona svęip ripti
 rauðan ok rjóðan · riðuðu augu.

Grandma begot a child, they sprinkled it with water,
 called it Churl; the woman wrapped him in cloth,
 red-haired and ruddy; his eyes wandered.

- 20 Hann nam at vaxa · ok vęl dafna, [W 78r/28–30]
 2 oxn nam at tēmja · arðr at gørva
 hús at timbra · ok hløður smíða
 4 karta at gørva · ok keyra plóg.

He took to grow and turn out well;
 oxen he took to tame, the ard to make,
 houses to timber and storehouses to forge,
 carts to make and drive the plough.

- 21 Hęim óku þa · Hangin-luklu [W 78r/30–31]
 2 gęita-kyrthlu · giptu Karli.
 Snør hęitir sú, · sętti=sk und ripti.
 4 Bjuggu hjón, · bauga dęildu,
 bręiddu blęjur, · ok bú gørðu.

Home they then drove with Hangenkey,
 in a goatskin-skirt, married her to Churl.
 Daughter-in-law she is called; she sat down beneath a felt.
 The couple settled, shared their wealth,
 hung tapestries and made a home.

- 22 Bqrn ólu þau, · bjuggu ok önðu; [W 78r/31–78v/1]
 2 hét Halr ok Dreng, · Hqlðr, Þegn ok Smiðr,
 Bręiðr, Bóndi, · Bundin-skęggi,
 4 Búi ok Boddi · Bratt-skęggr ok Sęggr.

Children they begot, settled and were content.
 They were called Hale and Drang, Health, Thane and Smith,
 Broad, Bond, Boundenshag,
 Bower and Bod, Brantshag and Seg.

- 23 Eņn hétu svá · qðrum nqfnum [W 78v/1–2]
 2 Snot, Brúðr, Svanni, · Svarri, Sprakki,
 Fljóð, Sprund, ok Víf, · Fęima, Ristill;

4 þaðan eru komnar · karla éttir.

Further they were called thus by other names:
Snoot, Bride, Swannie, Swarrie, Sprackie,
Fleed, Sprund and Wife, Fome, Ristle—
therof are come the lines of churls.

ALL | Most of these names are mentioned in *Skm* 84. TODO.

24 Gekk Rígr þaðan · réttar brautir [W 78v/2–3]
2 kom hann at sal, · suðr horfðu dyrr,
vas hurð hnigin, · hringr vas í gëtti.

Right walked thence on straight roads;
he came to a hall, south faced the doors;
the door was opened, a ring was on the gate.

25 Gekk hann inn at þat · golf vas stráat [W 78v/3–4]
2 sǫtu hjón · sǫu=sk í augu
faðir ok móðir · fingrum at lëika.

He walked in thereafter; the floor was strawed;
the couple sat, looked eachother in the eyes,
Father and Mother, playing with their fingers.

26 Sat hús-gumi · ok snøri stręng [W 78v/4–5]
2 alm of bęndi · qrvar skępti;
en hús-kona · hugði at qrmum,
4 strauk of ripti · sterti ęrmar.

The man of the house sat and twisted the bow-string,
bent the elmwood, shafted arrows—
but the wife of the house minded her arms,
smoothened the fabric, tightened the sleeves.

27 Kęisti fald, · kinga vas á bringu, [W 78v/6–7]
2 síðar slóður, · sęrk blá-fáan;
brún bjartari, · brjóst ljósara,
4 hals hvítari · hręinni mjöllu.

The linen hood jutted out, a brooch was on her chest,
a trailing gown, a serk dyed blue;
her brow was brighter, her chest lighter,
her throat whiter than purest snow.

- 28 Rígr kunni þeim · rjóð at sęja;
 2 meirr setti=sk hann · miðra fletja
 en á hlið hvára · hjón sal-kynna.

[W 78v/7–8]

Rígh knew to tell them counsels,
 further he set himself down on the middle of the bench,
 and on either side: the couple of the hall.

- 29 Þá tók Móðir · merktan dúk,
 2 hvítan af hęrvi, · hulði bjóð;
 hón tók at þat · hleifa þunna,
 4 hvíta af hveiti, · ok hulði dúk.

[W 78v/8–9]

Then Mother took an embroidered cloth,
 white of flax—she covered the platter.
 She took thereafter thin loaves,
 white of wheat—and covered the cloth.

ALL | Note the strong parallelism between the helmings. The rich household can afford such an excess of expensive fabric and bread that they can cover a plate with an embroidered (*merkrtr*) flaxen cloth, and then cover that cloth with loaves of wheat-bread.

- 30 Framm setti hōn · skutla fulla
 2 silfri varða á bjóð
 fáin* flęski · ok fugla stęikta;
 4 vīn vas ī kōnnu, · varðir kálkar
 drukku ok dómðu, · dagr vas á sinnum.

[W 78v/9–11]

She set forth full trenchers,
 silver-covered on platters
 shining with pork, and roasted fowls.
 Wine was in a flagon; the women from goblets
 drank and discussed; the day was waning.

3 fáin* ‘shining’ | *emend.*; ‘faan ok’ W

ALL | The description of the opulence of Father and Mother’s household continues.

1–2 Framm ... bjóð ‘She ... platters’ | These lines are clearly corrupt: l. 1, although rhythmically regular, has no alliteration and l. 2 is entirely malformed. Alliteration may be restored in l. 1 by reversing *skutla* and *fulla* (so Finnur Jónsson 1932).

3 fáin* ‘shining’ | The present emendation follows Finnur Jónsson (1932). Olsen (1923, pp. 307–312) (followed by Hesselman 1948, p. 59) explains *fán* as a variant of *fǫarn* ‘gizzard’, but this is problematic. Formally it requires some level of scribal corruption Olsen (1923, pp. 311–312) and grammatically it is in the acc. sg. unlike the paired *flęski* (dat. sg. of *flęsk* ‘pork’). The grammatical inconsistency may be solved if *flęski* is acc. sg. of the rare form *flęski* ‘id.’ (Fr, s.v. *fleski*), but the formal concerns remain.

- 31 **R**ígr kunni þeim · **r**óð at segja, [W 78v/11]
 2 **r**eis **R**ígr at þat, · **r**ekkjju gørði.

Rígh knew to tell them counsels;
 Rígh rose thereafter; he made the bed.

- 32 **Þ**ar vas hann at þat · **þ**riár nætr saman; [W 78v/12–13]
 2 gekk hann **m**ęirr at þat · **m**iðrar brautar;
 liðu **m**ęirr at þat · **m**önuðr níu.

There he was thereafter for three nights in their midst;
 he walked further thereafter on the middle of the road;
 further thereafter passed nine months.

- 33 **S**vein ól móðir, · **s**ilki vaðði, [W 78v/13–14]
 2 **j**ósu vatni— · **J**arl létu hęita;
 blęikt vas hár, · **b**jartir vangar,
 4 **ę**tul vöru **a**ugu · **s**em **y**rmlingi.

Mother begot a swain, swaddled him in silk;
 they sprinkled him with water, let him be called Earl.
 Pale was his hair, bright his cheeks;
 fierce were his eyes like the young serpent's.

4 *ętul vöru augu · sem yrmilingi* 'fierce were his eyes like the young serpent's' | Unlike those of Churl (st. 19/3), which wandered. It is a common motif in Norse literature that those of noble stock distinguish themselves by their appearance and chiefly by a unique piercing gaze even at birth. This is said of Hallow Syemund's son in 1 *HHund* 6/3–4 and of the king's son Wayland in *Vkv* 17/3 whose gaze is likewise compared to the serpent's. In 2 *HHund* 2–4 the same Hallow is almost caught while in disguise as a bond-woman due to his unslavelike eyes, which, like in the present stanza, are said to be *ętul* 'fierce, terrible'.

- 34 **U**pp óx þar · **J**arl á fletjum; [W 78v/14–16]
 2 **l**ind nam at skęlfá, · **l**ęggja stręngi,
alm at bęygja, · **ę**rvar skępta,
 4 **f**łęin at fłęyja, · **f**rękkur dýja,
hęstum ríða, · **h**undum verpa,
 6 **s**verðum bregða, · **s**und at fręmja.

There Earl grew up on the floor-benches;
 he took to shake the linden shield, fasten bow-strings,
 bend elmwood, shaft arrows,
 throw javelins, hoist Frankish spears,
 ride horses, sic hounds,
 brandish swords, practice swimming.

- 35 Kom þar ór runni · Rígr gangandi,
 2 Rígr gangandi, · rúnar kenndi;
 sitt gaf hęiti, · son kvęð=sk ęiga;
 4 þann bað hann ęigna=sk · Óðal-vøllu,
 Óðal-vøllu, · aldnar bygðir.

[W 78v/16–18]

There from a thicket came Righ, walking:
 Righ, walking, taught him the runes,
 gave him his own title, said that he had a son.
 He bade him possess the ethel-plains:
 the ethel-plains, the ancient farmsteads.

ALL | Righ approaches his son, Earl. He reveals himself as his father and initiates him into the warrior aristocracy by teaching him the runes and giving him the noble title Righ (cf. st. 43/4 below); henceforth he will be known as Righ-Earl. Finally Righ instructs him to set out and win lands for himself.

- 36 Reįð hann męirr þaðan · myrkan við
 2 hélug fjøll · und's at høllu kom;
 skapt nam at dýja, · skelfði lind,
 4 hęsti hleypti, · ok hjørvi brá;
 víg nam at vękja, · vøll nam at rjóða,
 6 val nam at fęlla, · vá til landa.

[W 78v/18–20]

He [= Righ-Earl] rode further thence through the mirky wood,
 o'er the frosty fells till to a hall he came.
 The shaft he took to hoist, shook the linden shield,
 leapt with his horse and brandished his blade.
 War he took to rouse; the plain he took to redden;
 men he took to fell—he won the lands.

- 37 Réð hann ęinn at þat · át-ján búum;
 2 auð nam skipta · øllum vęita
 meįðmar ok męsma, · mara svang-rifja;
 4 hringum hreytti, · hjó sundr baug.

[W 78v/20–21]

He alone ruled thereafter eighteen homesteads.
 Wealth he took to hand out; to grant all men
 gifts and treasures, slender-ribbed steeds;
 rings he scattered; he struck apart the bigh.

4 hringum hreytti 'rings he scattered' | Cf. StarkSt Frag 1/2a *bring-breytanda* 'ring-scattererer [GENEROUS MAN]' which contains the same words.

- 38 Óku* ęrir · úrgar brautir

[W 78v/21–22]

- 2 kvómu at hollu · þar's Hersir bjó:
 móttu meyju · mjó-fingraðri
 4 hvítri ok horskri, · hétu Erna.

Messengers drove on drizzling roads,
 came to the hall where Herser lived;
 they met a maiden slender-fingered,
 white and wise; her name was Erne.

1 Óku* | 'okú' W 3 móttu | mótti W 3 meyju | om. W 3 mjó-fingraðri | mjó-fingraði W

3 móttu 'they met' | Past singular mótti is impossible, since the maiden is the one being met. móta 'meet' takes the dative.

3 meyju 'maiden' | A feminine dat. sg. noun meaning 'maiden, virgin, girl' is required here by the meter and the following adjectives; meyju dat. sg. of mēr fits perfectly with the alliteration and is to be considered fairly likely.

- 39 Bóðu hennar · ok heim óku,
 2 giptu Jarli, · gekk hón und líní;
 saman bjuggu þau · ok sér unðu,
 4 éttr jóku · ok aldrs nutu.

[W 78v/22–24]

They asked for her hand and drove home,
 married her to Earl; she went 'neath the linen.
 Together they settled and were content,
 increased their lineage and enjoyed life.

2 gekk hón und líní 'she went 'neath the linen' | She donned the bridal veil; cf. Þrk 27.

- 40 Burr vas hinn eldsti, · en Barn annat;
 2 Jóð ok Aðall, · Arfi, Møgr,
 Niðr ok Niðjungr, · (nómu lēika)
 4 Sonr ok Sveinn, · (sund ok tafl)
 Kundra hét einn; · Konr vas hinn yngsti.

[W 78v/24–25]

Byre was the eldest and Bairn the other;
 Ede and Athel, Arver and Maw,
 Nith and Nothing (they learned to partake)
 Son and Swain (in swimming and tables);
 Cund was one called; Kin was the youngest.

3–4 nómu lēika ... sund ok tafl 'they learned to partake in swimming and tables' | This sentence is embedded in the list of names. Swimming (*sund*) and board games (*tafl*) were typical past-times for aristocrats; cf. the two Scaldic stanzas attributed to Earl Rainwald (SkP: Rv Lv 1) and King Harold Hardreide (Hharð Gamv 4) where each man recounts his *íþróttir* 'skills, pursuits', among which are both *sund* and *tafl*.

- 41 Upp óxu þar · Jarli bornir: [W 78v/25–27]
 2 hęsta tǫmðu, · hlífar þęndu,
 skęyti skófu, · skęlfðu aska.
 4 Ẽn Konr ungr · kunni rúnar:
 ęvin-rúnar · ok aldr-rúnar.

There grew up the sons of Earl,
 horses they tamed, shield-rims they bent,
 shafts they planed, shook ashen spears—
 but Kin the young knew the runes:
 eternal runes and life-runes.

4 Konr ungr ‘Kin the young’ | A folk etymological pun on *konungr* ‘king’. It is notable that it is the youngest son who attains the highest rank (for the king is above even the earls); for the motif of a god favouring the youngest son cf. *Grm* Pl.

5 ęvin-rúnar ‘eternal runes’ | A native, pre-Christian word; the first element is an otherwise lost adjective corresponding to Gothic *aiweins* ‘eternal, everlasting’, OHG *ęwin* ‘id’. This is one of two occurrences in the ON corpus, the other one being *aiuinrunar* *ęvin-rúnar* on the 9th c. Malt stone (DR NOR1988;5/DK Sjö38), alongside *taitirunar* *tęiti-rúnar* ‘joy-runes’.

- 42 Męirr kunni hann · mǫnnum bjarga, [W 78v/27–28]
 2 ęggjar dęyfa, · ęgi lęgja;
 klǫk nam fugla, · kyrra ęlda,
 4 sǫfa ok svefja, · sorgir lęgja,
 afl ok ęljun · átta manna.

Further he could rescue men,
 dull blades, lower the sea.
 He learned the chirping of birds, to calm fires,
 to lull and put to sleep, to lower sorrows,
 the strength and zeal of eight men.

- 43 Hann við Ríg Jarl · rúnar deildi; [W 78v/28–29]
 2 brǫgðum þęitti · ok þętr kunni;
 þa ǫłladi=sk · ok þa ęiga gat,
 4 Rígr at hęita, · rúnar kunna.

With Righ-Earl he shared the runes,
 employed tricks and knew better.
 Then he earned and won the right
 to be called Righ, to know the runes.

4 Rígr at hęita ‘to be called Righ’ | The title Righ passes through the generations, first in st. 35/3 from Righ (the grandfather) to Righ-Earl (the father), now from Righ-Earl to his son Kin the young.

- 44 Reǿ Konr ungr · kjorr ok skóga; [W 78v/30–31]
 2 kolfi fleygði · kyrði fugla;
 þa kvað þat kráka · —sat kvisti ein—

Kin the young rode through brushes and woods,
 hurled his bolts, stunned the birds.
 Then quoth a crow—it sat on a branch alone:

2 kolfi fleygði · kyrði fugla ‘hurled his bolts, stunned the birds’ | Perhaps by means of a slingshot, an ancient and widespread birding practice.

- 45 „Hvat skalt, Konr ungr, · kyrra fugla? [W 78v/30–31]
 2 Hēldr mēttið ér · hęstum riða
 þęstum riða · ok hęr fęlla.

“Why shalt thou, Kin the young, stun the birds?
 Rather might ye ride horses,
 ride horses, fell hosts.

3 þęstum riða ‘horses to ride’ | *emend.; om. (presumably by haplography)* W

ALL | In the final 2 sts. the talking crow begins its exhortation, encouraging Kin the young, to go out and conquer like his father. The exhortation is most likely cut short by the loss of the rest of the poem.

- 46 Á Danr ok Danpr · dýrar hallir; [W 78v/31–32]
 2 óðra óðal · an ér hafið;
 þęir kunnu vel · kjól at riða,
 4 ęgg at kęnna, · undir rjúfa.“

Dene and Danp own costly halls,
 nobler ethel than ye have.
 They can well ride the ship,
 teach the blade, tear open wounds.”

2 ér ‘ye’ | *metr. emend.; þér ‘id.’* W

1 Danr ok Danpr ‘Dene and Danp’ | For these figures see the Appendix to the poem.

2 óðal ‘ethel’ | Ancestral farmland, in this case the eighteen homesteads owned by Earl.

2 ér ‘ye’ | The older form *ér* is required by the alliteration, so the use of the younger *þér* in the ms. shows that the poem has been linguistically modernised.

3 kjól at riða ‘ride the ship’ | I.e. to sail.

4 ęgg at kęnna ‘teach the blade’ | To wage war. A euphemism; to “teach someone the blade” is to fight (and kill) him.

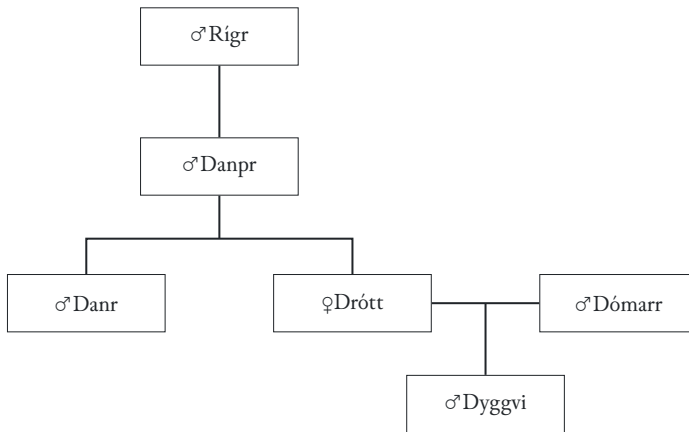
(At this point fol. 78 of W ends, and the rest of the poem is lost. For parallels see the Appendix below.)

Appendix

Exactly how *Rþ* would have progressed is of course unclear, but the following parallels may offer something of a hint.

Yng 17

In *Yng*, Due is the seventh in the line of Inglings, the legendary Swedish and later Norwegian royal dynasty. The relevant family tree is as follows:



2 Móðir Dyggva var Drótt, dóttir Danps konungs, sonar Rígs,
 er fyrstr var konungr kallaðr á danska tungu. Hans átt-menn
 4 höfðu á-valt síðan konungs-nafn fyrir it ózta tignar-nafn. Dyg-
 gvi var fyrst konungr kallaðr sinna étt-manna. [...] Drótt drót-
 tning var systir Dans konungs ins mikil-láta, er Dan-mörk er
 6 við kend.

Due's mother was Dright, the daughter of king Danp, the son of Righ, who was the first to be called king in [the geographical extent of] the Danish tongue. His kinsmen always thereafter held the title of king to be the utmost title of rank. Due was the first of his kinsmen to be called king. [...] Queen Dright was the sister of king Dene the proud, after whom Denmark is named.

2 á danska tungu 'in [the geographical extent of] the Danish tongue' | Namely the area of the Old Norse or Scandinavian language, not merely its Danish dialect. This area originally includes Sweden, Norway, and Denmark.

The epitome of the lost *Skjöldunga saga*

In the epitome of the *Skjöldunga saga* we read (Bjarni Guðnason 1982, pp. 1–45):

TODO: text

TODO: translation

Leeds of Hindle

(Hyndlu ljóð)

Dating (Sapp 2022): late C11th (0.996)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Leeds of Hindle** (*Hdl*) is a poorly preserved poem found only in F. St. 32 is cited in *Gylf* and attributed to the *Vǫluspó in skamma* ‘Short Spae of the Wallow’. The relation of that poem to the *Hdl* in its present form is unclear.

NOTE: Both translation and edition are currently incomplete.

Text

- [Freyja kvað:] 1 „Vaki **mér** **meyja**, · vaki **mín** vina,
 2 **Hyndla** systir, · es **í** **helli** býr;
 nú 's **røkr** **røkra**, · **ríða** vit skulum
 4 til **Val**-hallar · ok til **vés** **heilags**.

[Quoth Freyja:] “**W**AKE, MAIDEN OF MAIDENS! Wake, my friend!
 O Hindle, sister, who livest in the cave!
 Now is the twilight of twilights; we two shall ride
 to Walhall and to the holy wigh!

- 2 Biðjum **Hērja***·**fǫðr** · **í** **hugum** sitja,
 2 hann **geldr** ok **gefr** · **goll** **verðugum**,
 gaf hann **Hēr**·**móði** · **hjaln** ok brynju,
 4 **en** **Sig**·**mundi** · **sverð** at þiggja.

Let us bid the Father of Hosts (= Weden) to remain in good thoughts;
 he pays and gives gold to the worthy.
 He gave to Harmod helmet and byrnie,
 but to Syemund a sword to take.

1 **Hērja***·**fǫðr** | *emend.*; ‘herians faudur’ F

2 hann **geldr** ok **gefr** · **goll** **verðugum** ‘he pays and gives gold to the worthy’ | Closely related to *I HHund* 9/3, which is why Finnur Jónsson (1932) and Guðni Jónsson (1954) *emend verðugum* ‘the worthy’ to *verðungu* ‘the retinue’.

- 3 Gefr hann **sigr** **sonum**, · **en** **svinnum** **aura**,
 2 **męlsku** **mǫrgum** · ok **man**-vit **firum**,
byri **gefr** **brǫgnum**, · **en** **brag** **skǫldum**,
 4 **gefr** hann **mann**-**sęmi** · **mǫrgum** **rekki**.

He gives victory to sons and ounces [of silver] to the wise,
 speech to many and manwit to men.
 Fair wind he gives to nobles and praise-song to scalds;
 he gives manly valour to many a champion.

- 4 Þór mun **hǫn** **blóta**, · þess mun **hǫn** **biðja**,
 2 at hann **ę** **við** þik · **ęin**-art **lát**i;
 þó 's **hǫnum** **ó**-títt · við **jǫtuns** **brúðir**.

To Thunder she [I] will bloot, of this she [I] will pray:
 that he always be upright with thee,
 although he bears hatred for the ettin’s brides.

- 5 Nú tak-tu ulf þinn · **ę**inn af stalli,
 2 lát hann rinna · með runa mínum.“—
 [Hyndla kvað:] „Seinn es góltr þinn · goð-veg troða,
 4 vil’k=*at* mar minn · mętan hlóða.

Now take thy one wolf from the stable;
 let him run alongside my boar.”—

[Quoth Hindle:] “[Too] slow is thy boar to tread the Godways;
 I wish not to load my noble steed.

- 6 Fló est Freyja, · es freistar mín,
 2 vísar þú augum · á oss þannig,
 es hafir ver þinn · i val-sinni
 4 Ótt-ar unga · Inn-stęins bur.“

False art thou, Frow, who temptest me;
 thou showest thy eyes on us this way
 since thou hast thy lover on the slain-path:
 the young Oughter, Instone’s offspring.”

2–3 vísar ... val-sinni ‘thou showest ... slain-ways’ | I.e., “You only show favour to me because you want me to help your lover”. For the expression cf. *Sigrdr* 3/3 n.

- [Freyja kvað:] 7 „Dulið est Hyndla, · draums ętla’k þér,
 2 es kveðr ver minn · i val-sinni,
 þar’s góltr glóar · Gollin-bursti,
 4 Hildi-svíni, · es mér hagir gęrðu,
 dvergar tvęir · Dáinn ok Nabbi.

[Quoth Frow:] Deluded art thou, Hindle; I think thee dreamy,
 who sayest that my man is on the slain-path
 where the boar Goldenbristle glows,
 Hildswine, which for me made
 the two skilful dwarfs Downen and Nab.

4 Hildi-svíni ‘Hildswine’ | The ‘battle-swine’, another name for Goldenbristle.

- 8 Sęnn* i sęðlum · sitja vit skulum
 2 ok of jęfra · ęttir dóma,
 gumna þęira, · es frá goðum kómu.

Soon in the saddles we two shall sit,
 and of the lines of chieftains speak,
 of those men who came from the gods.

1 *Senn** | *emend.*; 'sennum' F 1 *i* | *emend.*; vit ór F

- 9 Þeir hafa vęðjat · vala malmi
 2 Ótt·arr ungi · ok Angantýr;
 skylt 's at vęita, · svá't skati inn ungi
 4 fęður-leiřđ hafi · ępt fręndr sína.

They have wagered the Welsh ore [GOLD],
 young Oughter and Ongenthew.
 It must be granted so that the young prince
 may have the patrimony after his kinsmen.

- 10 Hęrg hann mér gęrđi · hlađinn stęinum;
 2 nú 's grjót þat · at glęri orđit;
 rauđ hann i nýju · nauta blóđi;
 4 ę trúđi Ótt·arr · a ęsynjur.

A harrow he made for me, loaded with stones;
 now that stone-pile has turned into glass.
 He reddened it in the fresh blood of oxen;
 always did Oughter trust in the Ossens.

- 11 Nú lát forna · niđja talđa
 2 ok upp·bornar · ęttir manna
 hvat 's skjöldunga, · hvat 's skilfinga,
 4 hvat 's ęđlinga · hvat 's ylfinga
 hvat 's hęld-borit, · hvat 's hęrs-borit
 6 męst manna val · und Miđ-garđi?“

Now let ancient ancestors be counted,
 and the high-born lines of men.
 What is of Shieldings? What is of Shilvings?
 What is of Athlings? What is of Wolvings?
 What is born of hero? What is born of chief,
 the greatest choice of men in Middenyard?”

- 12 „Þú est Ótt·arr · borinn Inn·stęini,
 2 ęn Inn·stęinn vas · Ólfi inum gamla,
 Ólfr vas Ulfi, · Ulfr Sę·fara,
 4 ęn Sę·fari · Svan inum rauđa.

[Quoth Hindle:] “Thou art, Oughter, born to Instone,
 and Instone was born to Elf the old,

Elf was to Wolf, Wolf to Seafarer,
and Seafarer to Swan the red.

ALL | Hindle begins the genealogy; she speaks directly to Oughter.

- 13 Móður átti faðir þinn · męnjum gøfga,
2 hygg at hėti · Hlédís gyðja,
 Fróði vas faðir þeirar, · ęn Friund móðir;
4 ęll þótti ęt sù · með yfir-męnnum.

Thy father got thy mother, beautiful with torcs;
I think that she was called Leedise the gidden.
Frood was her father, but Friend her mother;
all that lineage seemed to be among overmen.

3 Friund | emend. from meaningless †friauf† F

- 14 Auði vas áðr · ęflgastr manna,
2 Half-danr fyrri · hęstr skjöldunga,
 fręg vøru folk-víg, · þau's framir gęrðu,
4 hvarfla þóttu hans verk · með himins skautum.

Ed was once the strongest of men,
Halfdane yet earlier the highest of Shieldings.
Famous were the troop-wars which the brave ones made;
his (= Halfdane's) works seemed to whirl along the corners of heaven.

- 15 Eflði=sk við Eý-mund · øðstan manna
2 ęn vá Sig-trygg · með svølum ęggjum,
 ęiga gekk Alm-veig, · øðsta kvinna,
4 ólu þau ok ętту · átján sonu.

He became the in-law of Eanmund, the noblest of men,
but he slew Syetru with cool edges.
He went to have Elmwey, the noblest of women;
they begot and had eighteen sons.

1 Eflði=sk 'became the in-law' | Lit. 'was strengthened by'. Elmwey was Eanmund's daughter or sister.

- 16 Þaðan eru skjöldungar, · þaðan eru skilfingar,
2 þaðan eru ęðlingar, · þaðan eru ynglingar,
 þaðan es hõld-borit, · þaðan es hęrs-borit,
4 mest manna val · und Mið-garði;

allt 's þat ętt þin, · Ótt·arr heĩmski.

Thereof come the Shieldings! Thereof come the Shilvings!
 Thereof come the Athlings! Thereof come the Inglings!
 Thereof is born of hero! Thereof is born of chief
 the greatest choice of men within Middenyard!
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!”

2 ynglingar ‘Ingling’ | Note the variation from st. 12, which has *yǫfingar* ‘Wolvings’. Since the Inglingas have already been mentioned (under the name of Shilvings), it seems likely that st. 12’s Wolvings is the original reading.

- 17 Vas Hildi·gunnr · hęnnar móðir,
 2 Svófu barn · ok Sé·konungs;
 allt 's þat ętt þin, · Ótt·arr heĩmski.
 4 varði at viti svá, · vilt ęnn lęgra?

Hildguth was her (= Elmwey’s) mother,
 the child of Sweve and Sea-king.
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!
 It is meaningful that one might know thus; wilt thou yet further?

- 18 Dagr átti Þóru · dręngja móður,
 2 ólu=sk i ętt þar · óðstir kappar,
 Frað·marr ok Gyrðr · ok Frekar báðir,
 4 Ámr ok Jǫsur·marr, · Ólfr inn gamli.
 varðar at viti svá, · vilt ęnn lęgra?

Day got Thure, the mother of valiant men;
 in that lineage were begotten the noblest champions:
 Fradmer and Yird and both Frecks,
 Ame and Essermer, Atholf the old.—
 It is meaningful that one might know thus; wilt thou yet further?

- 19 Kętill hét vinr þęira · Klypps arf-þęgi,
 2 vas hann móður·faðir · móður þinnar;
 þar vas Fróði · fyrr ęnn Kári,
 4 hinn ęldri vas · Ólfr of getinn.

Kettle was the name of their friend, the heir of Clip;
 he was the father of thy mother’s mother.
 There was Frood, yet earlier Keer,
 the elder Atholf was mentioned.

- 20 *N*anna vas *n*ést þar · *N*okkva dóttir
 2 vas *m*ogr hennar · *m*ágr þíns fǫður.
 *f*yrnd 's sú méggð · *f*ramm tēl'k lengra
 4 kunna'k *b*áða · *B*rodd ok Hǫrvi
 allt 's þat *ét*t þín, · *Ó*tt·arr hēimski.

Nan was next there, the daughter of Nake;
 her son was the in-law of thy father.
 Ancient is that family; I foresee further.
 I know both Brord and Harrow.
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

1 *N*anna | *emend.*; Manna F

4 kunna'k báða · Brodd ok Hǫrvi 'I know both Brord and Harrow' | This l. is probably in error here; it reoccurs identically as 24/1 below.

- 21 *Í*s-ólfr ok *Ö*s-ólfr · *Q*l·móðs synir
 2 ok *S*kur·hildar · *S*kękkils dóttur,
 *s*kalt til tēlja · *s*katna margra
 4 allt 's þat *ét*t þín, · *Ó*tt·arr hēimski.

Icewolf and Osulf, the sons of Alemod
 and Showerhild Shackle's daughter—
 them shalt thou recount before the many princes.
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

- 22 *G*unn·arr balkr, · *G*rimr arð·skafi,
 2 *J*árn·skjöldr, Þörir, · *U*lfr gīnandi,
 *B*úi ok *B*rami, · *B*arri ok Rēifnir,
 4 *T*indr ok *T*yrfingr · ok *t*vęir Haddingjar.
 allt 's þat *ét*t þín, · *Ó*tt·arr hēimski.

Guthr the balk, Grim the ard-shaver,
 Ironshield, Thurwigh, Wolf the grinning,
 Bowe and Brame, Barr and Rafner,
 Tind and Tirving and the two Hardings.
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

- 23 *Á*ni, *Ö*mi · *v*ǫru bornir
 2 *A*rn·gríms synir · ok *E*y·furu;
 *b*rokun *ber*-serkja · *b*ols margs-konar
 4 of *l*ond ok of *l*ög · sem *l*ogi fǫri.
 allt 's þat *ét*t þín, · *Ó*tt·arr hēimski.

Ane, Ome were born
 the sons of Arngrim and Eanfore.
 The battles of the bear-serks of the manifold evils
 over land and over sea went forth like a flame.
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

- 24 Kunna'k báða · Brodd ok Hǫrvi
 2 vǫru þeir i hirð · Hrólfs ins gamla,
 allir bornir · frá Jǫrmun·reki
 4 Sig·urðar mági · (hlýð sǫgu minni!)
 folkum gríms · þess 's Fáfni vá.

I know both Brord and Harrow;
 they were in the troop of Rotholf the old,
 all born from Ermenric,
 from the inlaw of Siward—heed my tale!—
 the terror of hosts who slew Fathomer.

4 Sig·urðar | The meter of the line requires that the first syllable of this name be short (*Sig·urð-* < **Sig·vǫrð-*), a young feature (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141).

- 25 Sá vas vísir · frá Vǫlsungi
 2 ok Hǫr·dís · frá Hraudungi
 en Ey·limi · frá Öðlingum.
 4 allt 's þat ét þín, · Ött·arr heimski.

That ruler came from Walsing,
 and Hardise from Reading,
 but Eanlime from the Athlings.
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

- 26 Gunnarr ok Hogni · Gjúka arfar
 2 ok it sama Guð·rún · systir þeira.
 Eigi vas Guð·þormr · Gjúka étta
 4 þó vas hann bróðir · þeggja þeira
 allt 's þat ét þín, · Ött·arr heimski.

Guther and Hawn, Yivick's heirs,
 and likewise Guthrun, their sister.
 Godthorm was not of Yivick's lineage,
 though he was the brother of them both.
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

- 27 Haraldr hildi-tǫnn · borinn Hró·reki

- 2 slongvan-bauga · son*^r vas hann Auðar.
 Auðr djúp-audga · Í·vars dóttir
 4 en Ráð·barðr · vas Rand·vé*s faðir
 þeir vóru gumnar · goðum signaðir.
 6 allt 's þat étt þín, · Ött·arr heimski.

Harold Hild-tooth was born to Rethric
 the slinger of bigs; he was the son of Ead.
 Ead the deep-minded was Inwar's daughter,
 but Redebeard was Randwigh's father.
 They were men dedicated to the gods.
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

- 28 Vóru ellifu · ęsir taldir
 2 Baldr es hné · við bana-þúfu
 þess létsk Váli · verðr at hefna
 4 sęns bróður · sló hand-bana;
 allt 's þat étt þín, · Ött·arr heimski.

Eleven were the Eese tallied
 when Balder sank down against the tuft of his bane.
 That Wonnell declared himself worthy to avenge;
 he slew the hand-bane of his brother.
 That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

- 29 Vas Baldrs faðir · Burs arf-þegi,
 2 Fręyr átti Gęrdi, · hön vas G*ymis dóttir
 jętna ęttar · ok Aur·boðu;
 4 þó vas Þjatsi · þęira fręndi
 skaut-gjarn jętunn; · hans vas Skaði dóttir.

Balder's father was the heir of Byre.
 Free had Gird; she was the daughter of Gymer
 from the lineage of the ettins and Earbode.
 Further Thedse was their kinsman,
 the shot-eager ettin; Shede was his daughter.

- 30 Mart sęgjum þer · ok munum flęira
 2 vęrumsk at viti svá, · vilt ęnn flęira.

Much we tell thee and recall yet more;
 I warn against one knowing such; wilt thou yet more?

- 31 Haki vas Hveðnu · Hóti bætstr sona
2 en Hveðnu vas · Hjor·varðr faðir
Heiðr ok Hross·þjófr · Hrímnis kindar.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 32 Eru vqlur allar · frá Víð-ólfi,
2 vítkar allir · frá Vil-meði,
seð-berendr · frá Svart-höfða,
4 jötnar allir · frá Ymi komnir.

All wallows are from Widolf,
all warlocks from Wilmad,
soth-bearers from Swarthead,
all ettins are come from Yimer.

3 seið-berendr · frá Svart-hofða, | om. U 3 seið-berendr | skil-berendr F

ALL | This st. is quoted following *Gylf* 5:6–9, which describes Yimer (cf. *Vsp* 3/1 n.) and *Gylf* 5:10–11 which introduces it with the words *ok eru þaðan komnar ętir brim-þursa, svę sem segir í Vǫlu-spę binni skǫmmu* ‘and thereof are come the lineages of Rime-Thurses, as it says in the short Spę of the Wallow’.

- 33 Mart sęgjum þér · ok munum fleira
2 vorumsk at viti svá, · vilt enn lengra?

Much we tell thee and recall yet more;
I warn against one knowing such; wilt thou yet further?

- 34 Varð **ei**nn borinn · í **ár**-daga
2 ramm-aukinn mjök · **ro**gna kindar;
níu bóru þann · **nadd**-göfgan mann
4 **jot**na meýjar · við **jar**ðar þrom.

One was born in days of yore,
much increased in strength by the race of the Reins.
Nine gave birth to that arrow-famed man:
the maidens of ettins at the rim of the earth.

- 35 Mart segjum þér · ok munum fleira
2 vorumsk at viti svá, · vilt enn lengra?

Much we tell thee and recall yet more;
I warn against one knowing such; wilt thou yet further?

- 36 Hann Gjölp of bar · hann Greip of bar,
 2 bar hann Físla · ok Eyr-gjafa;
 hann bar Ulf-rún · ok Ang-eyja,
 4 Ímdr ok Atla · ok Jarn-saxa.

Him Yelp did bear; him Grope did bear;
 Astle bore him and Earyive;
 Wolfrun bore him and Angie,
 Imd and Attle and Ironsaxe.

- 37 Sá vas aukinn · jarðar magni
 2 sval-köldum sé · ok sónar dręyra.

He was increased with the might of the earth,
 the freezing cold sea and the guts of a boar.

- 38 Mart segjum þér · ok munum fleira
 2 vörumsk at viti svá, · vilt ęnn lengra?

Much we tell thee and recall yet more;
 I warn against one knowing such; wilt thou yet further?

- 39 Ól Ulf Loki · við Angr-boðu
 2 ęn Sleipni gat · við Svaðil-fara;
 ęitt þótti skars · allra fęiknast
 4 þat vas bróður frá · Bý-leįsts komit.

Lock begot the Wolf with Angerbode,
 but Slopner he begat with Swaddlefare.
 One troll-woman seemed wickedest of all;
 she was come from the brother of Bilast.

3 ęitt ... skars 'One troll-woman' | Viz. Hell, Lock's daughter.

- 40 Loki át hjarta · lindi bręnndu
 2 fann hann half-sviðinn · hug-stęin konu;
 varð Loptr kviðugr · af konu illri
 4 þaðan es á foldu · flagð hvęrt komit.

Lock ate a heart burned with linden-wood;
 he found the half-scorched thought-stone [HEART] of a woman.
 Loft became pregnant from that evil woman;
 thereof is come every troll upon the earth.

- 41 **H**aƿ ǵeŋgr **h**ríðum · við **h**imin sjalfan
 2 **líðr** lǫnd yfir · ǵn lǫpt bilar;
 þaðan koma **s**njóvar · ok **s**narir vindar
 4 þà 's i **r**áði · at **r**egin of þrjóti.

The sea rises in storms against the very heaven,
 goes over the lands, but the air gives way.
 Thence come snows and swift winds;
 then it is in the motions that the Reins expire.

ALL | A prediction of the Rakes of the Reins (as told at length in *Vsp* 43–54), likely the reason why this passage is called the Short Spae of the Wallow.

- 42 **V**arð **ǵ**inn borinn · ǵllum meiri
 2 sá vas **a**ukinn · **j**arðar mǵni.
 þann kveða **s**tilli · **s**tór-auðgastan
 4 **S**if sifjaðan · **s**jotum ǵorv-ǵllum.

One was born greater than all;
 he was increased with the might of the earth.
 That ruler they say is the very wealthiest,
 related to Sib, to each and every dwelling.

- 43 Þà kǫmr **a**nnarr · ǵnn mátkari
 2 þó þori'k ǵigi · þann at nǵfna;
 fáir sjá nú · fram of lǵngra
 4 an **Óð**inn man · **U**lfí móta.“

Then comes another one, far mightier,
 though I dare not say his name.
 Few folk now see further ahead
 than when Weden will meet the Wolf.”

ALL | This stanza is most likely pulling from *Vsp* H58 which indicates that the version of *Vsp* available to the poet likely contained that stanza.

- 44 „Ber **m**innis-ǵl · **m**inum ǵęsti
 2 svá hann ǵll muni · **o**rð at tīna
 þessa rǫðu · à þridja morni
 4 þà's þeir **A**ngan·týr · **ǵ**ttir rǵkna.“

“Bear an ale of remembrance unto my guest,
 that he may remember to recite all the words
 of this speech on the third morning,
 when he and Ongentew reckon lineages.”

- 45 „Snú þú burt heðan · sofa lystir mik
 2 fêr þú fátt af mér · fríðra kosta.
 hleypr þú edlvina · úti á nöttum
 4 sem með hofrum · Heið·rún fari.

Turn away hence! I desire to sleep;
 from me wilt thou get few pretty things.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 46 Rant at Óði · ey þreyjandi
 2 skutusk þér fleiri · und fyrir skyrtu.
 hleypr þu edlvina · úti á nöttum
 4 sem með hofrum · Heið·rún fari.“

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 47 „Ek slé eldi · af i·viðju
 2 svá't eigi kœmsk · á burt heðan.“
 „hleypr þu edlvina · úti á nöttum
 4 sem með hofrum · Heið·rún fari.

“I strike a fire around the Inwithy,
 that thou wilt not come away hence!”
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 48 Hyr sé'k brenna · en hauðr loga
 2 verða flestir · fjör-lausn þola;
 ber Ótt·ari · bjór at hendi
 4 eitri blandinn mjök · illu heilli.“

A fire I see burning, but the earth does blaze;
 most must suffer the saving of life.
 Bring beer to Oughter's hands,
 mixed with much poison, of ill omen!”

- 49 „Orð-heill þin · skal engu ráða
 2 þótt brúðr jötuns · bølvi heitir;
 hann skal drekka · dýrar veigar

4 bið'k Ótt·ari · ǫll goð duga.“

“Thy word-omens shall have no power,
though the ettin's bride does summon a bale.
He shall drink costly draughts;
Oughter I bid all gods avail!”

Fragments from Snorre's Edda

Introduction

A number of Eddic lines, stanzas and groups of stanzas are quoted in Snorre's Edda. The majority of them are taken from longer Eddic poems preserved in full in other manuscripts (primarily **R** and **A**), but a few are found nowhere else. These fragments will be edited in the present section.

The fragments have some things in common: they are generally pieces of spoken dialogue quoted in the context of longer narrative prose sections, and are, with one exception (Homedall's galder, see below), not introduced by reference to their source but rather with phrases like *þá kvað hann* 'then quoth he'.

I. A lost riddle-poem (*Gylf* 2:15–20)

Introduction

This half-stanza is quoted in *Gylf* 2. It is the second Eddic stanza in *Gylf*, following *Háv* 1 which is uttered by Yilfer himself when he enters the hall of the Eese in the same chapter. The whole passage is clearly drawing on other Eddic mythic wisdom contests and is particularly reminiscent of *Vǫlþ*. Whether the stanza itself is authentic or made up by Snorre himself is hard to tell.

Text

¹⁵Hann sá þrjú há-sæti ok hvert upp frá ǫðru, ok sátu þrír menn
 2 sinn í hverju. ¹⁶Þá spurði hann, hvert nafn høfðingja þeira véri.
 Sá svarar, er hann leiddi inn, at ¹⁷sá, er í inu neðsta há-sæti sat,
 4 var konungr, ok heitir Hárr, en þar næst sá, er heitir Jafn-hárr,
 en sá ofast, er Þriði heitir. ¹⁸Þá spyrr Hárr komanda'nn, hvárt
 6 fleira er erendi hans, en heimill er matr ok drykkir honum sem
 ǫllum þar í Háva holl. ¹⁹Hann segir, at fyrst vill hann spyrja, ef
 8 nokkurr er fróðr maðr inni. ²⁰Hárr segir, at hann komi eigi heill
 út, nema hann sé fróðari,

¹⁵HE [= Yilfer] SAW THREE HIGH-SEATS, and each one higher than the last; and three men sat there, each in his own seat. ¹⁶Then he asked what the names of those chieftains were. He who led him in answers that ¹⁷the one who sat in the lowest high-seat was a king called High, and next to him he who is called Evenhigh, and uppermost he who is called Third. ¹⁸Then High asks the guest whether he has any other errands—but he is as welcome to food and drink as every man is there in the High One's hall. ¹⁹He [= Yilfer] asks whether anyone within is a learned man. ²⁰High says that he will not come out whole unless he be the more learned one,

1 „ok statt-u framm · meðan þú fregn;
 2 sitja skal sá es segir.“

[S TODO, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

“and stand forth while thou askest;
 sit shall he who speaks!”

II. Nearth and Shede (*Gylf* 23:1–14)

Introduction

The following passage is almost the whole of *Gylf* 23, excepting at the very end *svá er sagt* ‘so it is said’, after which the text cites *Grm* 11.

It is notable that the two stanzas cited here are also found translated in Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 1.8.18–19, where they are said to have been spoken by the legendary hero Harding (corresponding to Nearth) and Rainhild (corresponding to Shede); in this way the old myth has been reinterpreted to fit Saxo's heroic context. For discussion see Hopkins (2021).

Text

¹Inn þriði ǫss er sá, er kallaðr er Njorðr. ²Hann býr á himni, þar sem heitir Nóa-tún. ³Hann ræðr fyrir gongu vinds ok stillir sjá ok eld. ⁴Á hann skal heita til sé-fara ok til veiða. ⁵Hann er svá auðigr ok fé-séll, at hann má gefa þeim auð, landa eða lausafjár er hann vill. Á hann skal til þess heita. ⁶Eigi er Njorðr ása ęttar. Hann var upp fōddr í Vana-heimi, en Vanir gisluðu hann goðu'num ok tóku í mót at gíslingu þann, er Hónir heitir. Hann varð at sętt með goðum ok Vønum. ⁷Njorðr á þá konu, er Skaði heitir, dóttir Þjatsa jötuns. ⁸Skaði vill hafa bú-stað þann, er átt hafði faðir hennar, þat er á fjöllum nokkurum, þar sem heitir Þrym-heimr, en Njorðr vill vera nēr sé. ⁹Þau sęttusk á þat, at þau skyldu vera níu nętr í Þrym-heimi, en þá aðrar níu at Nóa-túnum. ¹⁰En er Njorðr kom aprt til Nóa-túna af fjalli'nu, þá kvað hann þetta:

¹THE THIRD OS IS HE WHO IS CALLED NEARTH. ²He lives in the heaven in the place called Nowetons. ³He rules the course of the wind, and stills sea and fire. ⁴On him shall one call for sea-faring and for hunting. ⁵He is so wealthy and blessed with money that he may give a wealth of lands or loose property to whomever he wants; on him shall one call for that sake. ⁶Nearth is not of the lineage of the Eese. He was brought up in Wanehome, but the Wanegave him as a hostage to the gods, and in return got as hostage that one who is called Heener. He was used to reconcile the gods and the Waneg. ⁷Nearth has to wife the woman who is called Shede, the daughter of the ettin Thedse. ⁸Shede wishes to have the dwelling which her father had owned, which lies on some fells in the place called Thrimham—but Nearth wishes to live by the sea. ⁹They agreed with each other that they would live for nine nights in Thrimham, but the other nine at Nowetons. ¹⁰But when Nearth came back to the Nowetons from the fell, then this quoth he:

5–8 Eigi er Njörðr ása ęttr. ... Hann varð at sētt með goðum ok Vǫnum. ‘Nearth is not of the lineage of the Æse. ... He was used to reconcile the gods and the Wanæs.’ | For this episode see Vǫp 22 n., *Vafþ* 38–39.

1 „Leĩð eru=mk fjöll, · vas’k=a lęgi á,
2 nętr ęinar níu;
ulfa þytr · mér þótti illr vesa
4 hjá sǫngvi svana.“

[S 6v/15, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

“Loathsome I find the fells, I was not long thereon—
only nine nights.
The howling of wolves seemed evil to me
against the song of swans.”

¹¹Þá kvað Skaði þetta:

¹¹Then this quoth Shede:

2 „Sofa né māt’k=a’k · sęvar beðjum á
2 fugls jarmi fyrir;
sá mik vękr · es af víði kǫmr
4 morgun hverjan mār.“

[S 6v/16, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

“I could not sleep on the bed of the sea
for the bleating of the bird.
That one awakens me who comes from the main
every morning: the mew.”

2 ¹²Þá fór Skaði upp á fjall ok byggði í Þrym-heimi, ¹³ok ferr hón
mjök á skíðum ok með boga ok skýtr dýr. ¹⁴Hón heitir ǫndur-
goð eða ǫndur-dís.

¹²Then Shede went up to the fells and dwelled in Thrimham, ¹³and she often
goes on skis with her bow and shoots beasts. ¹⁴She is called ski-god or ski-
dise.

III. Homedall's Galder (*Heim-dallar-galdr*, *Gylf* 27)

Introduction

This mysterious fragment is quoted in *Gylf* 27, the chapter describing Homedall. The following section is the complete chapter.

The fragment consists of two c-lines and appears to be the end of a stanza in the fitting meter Galders-law.

The same poem is mentioned again in *Skm* 15: *Heim-dallar hofuð heitir sverð. Svá er sagt, at hann var lostinn manns hofði í gegnum. Um þat er kveðit í Heim-dallar-galdri, ok er síðan kallat hofuð mjötuðr Heim-dallar* 'A sword is called Homedall's head. So it is said that he was pierced through with a man's head; about that it is sung in Homedall's galder, and thenceforth the head is called Homedall's bane.'

Text

¹Heim-dallr heitir einn. ²Hann er kallaðr hvíti óss; ³hann er
² mikill ok heilagr. ⁴Hann bõru at syni meyjar niu ok allar systr;
⁵hann heitir ok Hallin-skíði ok Gullin-tanni; tennr hans vöru
⁴ af gulli. ⁶Hestr hans heitir Gull-toppr. ⁷Hann býr þar er heitir
⁶ Himin·björg við Bifrøst; ⁸hann er vörðr goða ok sitr þar við
⁸ himins enda at gæta brúar'innar fyrir berg-risum. ⁹Hann þarf
¹⁰ minna svefn en fugl. ¹⁰Hann sér jafnt nótt sem dag hundrað
¹⁰ rasta frá sér; ¹¹hann heyrir ok þat, er gras vex á jörðu eða ull á
¹² sauðum, ok allt þat er héra léttr. ¹²Hann hefir lúðr þann er Gjallar-
¹² horn heitir, ok heyrir blástr hans í alla heima. ¹³Heim-dallar
 sverð er kallat hofuð manns.
 [...]
 ¹⁵ Ok enn segir hann sjalfr í Heimdallar-galdri:

¹HOMEDAL IS THE NAME OF ONE. ²He is called the White Os; ³he is great and
 holy. ⁴He was born as the son of nine maidens, sisters all. ⁵He is also named
 Haldenshid and Goldentooth; his teeth were of gold. ⁶His horse is named
 Goldtop. ⁷He lives at the place called the Heavenbarrows near Bivrest. ⁸He is
 the Watchman of the Gods and sits there at Heaven's end to guard the bridge
 against barrow-risers. ⁹He needs less sleep than a bird. ¹⁰Both during night
 and day he sees as far as a hundred rests away from him; ¹¹he also hears when
 grass grows on the ground or wool on sheep, and everything which makes
 louder sound. ¹²He has the lur called the Horn of Yell, and his blowing can
 be heard in all realms. ¹³A man's head is called 'Homedall's sword'.

[...]

¹⁵ And further he himself says in Homedall's Galder:

1 Heim-dallr ‘Homedal’ | ‘World-Brilliant’. For the word **dallr*, possibly ‘brilliant, splendid’, see *Vafþ* 25 n. Homedal appears to be an original fire-god, as seen by his epithets which closely resemble those of the Vedic *Agni*; cf. *Þrk* 13/3 n. Importantly Homedal also appears to fill the same ritual role as *Agni*, namely as the conveyor of mankind’s prayers and sacrifices to the Gods, for he hears and sees all the speeches and works of men (27:10–11).

1 hvíti óss ‘the White Os’ | Cf. *Þrk* 15/1b: *hvítastr Ása* ‘whitest of the Eese’.

2 Hann bóru at syni meýjar níu ok allar systir ‘He was born as the son of nine maidens, sisters all’ | Also mentioned in the galder below, though the significance of this is unclear since the nine sisters are not identified. They may perhaps be the nine daughters of the rulers of the sea, Eagre and Ran (*Skm* 33, 41, 76), which would further strengthen the identification of Homedal with fire; cf. the Indo-Iranian fire-epithet, OI *apám nápāt* ‘grandson of the Waters’ (*RV* 2.35; Brereton and Jamison 2020, p. 75).

3 Hallin-skiði ‘Haldenshid’ | ‘The one with slanting planks’, perhaps a name for a kind of (ritual?) fire. This word only appears in two poetic sources. First in the kenning *tennr Hallin-skiða* ‘the teeth of Haldenshid [GOLD]’ in *Glúmr Gráf* 14 (SkP 1) from ca. 970 CE, secondly alongside *Heim-dali* ‘Homedale’ (apparently a variant of *Heim-dallr* ‘Homedal’) as a poetic synonym for the ‘ram’ in the list of synonyms *Þul Hríus* 1 (SkP 3). The latter may suggest an interpretation ‘the one with curved horns’, but the sense ‘horn’ for *skið* is never otherwise attested. The main sense of *skið* is ‘long thin piece of wood, firewood, billet’ (so *Háv* 60/1 and *Vsp* 19/4), whence also its common meaning ‘ski’ and the rare poetic ‘sheath’ (only in *Hamð* 15/1). It is therefore considerably more likely that this epithet originally referring specifically to the god Homedal has been applied to the ram, rather than the reverse: the fact that it is never found in active use in the sense ‘ram’ (but only in a list of synonyms) suggests that the sense ‘ram’ may in fact be a fully antiquarian invention.

3–4 Gullin-tanni; tennr hans vöru af gulli ‘Goldentooth; his teeth were of gold.’ | Attested in a kenning, as noted above. — A direct cognate occurs in *RV* 5.2.3 as an adjective describing *Agni*, the god of fire: *híranya-dantan śúci-varṇam ... a-paśyam* ‘I saw Him with golden teeth and flaming color’, where OI *híranya-danta* ‘with golden teeth’ < PIE **ǵʰh₂-enyó-h₂dontos* ~ **ǵʰh₂t-iHno-h₂donto* > PGmc **gulþina-tanþó* > ON *Gollin-tanni*.

12 [...] | Here the text cites *Grm* 13 with the words *Hér er svá sagt* ‘Here it is said so’; see there.

- 1 „Níu em’k meýja mǫgr,
2 níu em’k systra sonr.“

[S 7r/23, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

“Of nine maidens am I the lad,
of nine sisters am I the son.”

1 meýja ‘maidens’ | so U; móðra ‘mothers’ STW 2 sonr ‘son’ | om. T

1 meýja ‘maidens’ | I.e., nine virgins. The minority reading of U is supported by Snorre’s prose in *Gylf* 27:4 which is clearly drawing from the present stanza.

IV. Gna and the Wanæs (Gylf 35:21–26).

Introduction

The following passage is found in *Gylf* 35, the chapter describing the Ossens, i.e., the goddesses.

Text

21 Fjórátánda Gná, hana sendir Frigg í ymsa heima at ørindum
 2 sínum. 22 Hón á þann hest, er renn lopt ok lög, er heitir Hóf-varpnir.
 23 Þat var eitt sinn, er hón reið, at vanir nokkvörir sá reið hennar
 4 í lopti'nu. 24 Þá mælti einn:

21 THE FOURTEENTH IS GNA; Frie sends her into various homes to run her
 errands. 22 She owns the horse which runs through air and sea and is called
 Hoofwarpner. 23 It was one time when she rode that some Wanæs saw her
 riding in the air. 24 Then one spoke:

1 „Hvat þar flýgr, · hvat þar fær,
 2 eða at lopti liðr?“

[S TODO, T TODO,
 W TODO, U TODO]

“What flies there, what fares there,
 or passes through the air?”

25 Hón svarar:
 25 She answers:

2 „Né ek flýg, · þó ek fær
 2 ok at lopti liðr'
 á Hóf-varpni, · þeim's Ham·skerpir
 4 gat við Garð·rofu.“

[S TODO, T TODO,
 W TODO, U TODO]

“I fly not, though I fare
 and pass through the air,
 on Hoofwarpner, whom Hamsherper
 begot with Yardrove.”

26 Af Gnár nafni er svá kallat, at þat gnéfar, er hóttr ferr.

26 From Gna's name it is so called that something which fares high up *reaches high*.

V. Balder's death (*Gylf* 49:77–82)

Introduction

Gylf 49 contains the narrative of Balder's death, beginning with his ominous dreams, and ending with the Eese failing to "weep him out of Hell" (for a summary and discussion of the Balder-cycle and its attestations, see the introduction to *Vsp* 31–33).

The following passage is the very end of the chapter, in which a single Leeds-meter speech-stanza is quoted.

Text

⁷⁷Því nést sendu ésir um allan heim ørind-reka at biðja, at Baldr
²véri grátinn ór Helju, ⁷⁸en allir gerðu þat, menn'inir ok kykvendi'n
 ok jörð'in ok steinar'nir ok tré ok allr málmr, ⁷⁹svá sem þú munt
⁴sét hafa, at þessir hlutir gráta, þá er þeir koma ór frosti ok í hita.
⁸⁰Þá er sendi-menn fóru heim ok hófðu vel rekit sín ørindi, finna
⁶þeir í helli nökkvorum, hvar gýgr sat; hón nefndist Þökk. ⁸¹Þeir
 biðja hana gráta Baldr ór helju, hón segir:

⁷⁷THEHEREAFTER THE EESE SENT AN ERRAND-RUNNER through all the Home
 to ask that Balder be wept out of hell. ⁷⁸And all did that, the men and the
 beasts and the earth and the stones and trees and all metals, ⁷⁹even as thou
 must have seen that these things weep when they come out of cold and into
 heat. ⁸⁰When the messengers journeyed home and had run their errand well,
 they find in a certain cave where a gow was sitting; she called herself Thanks.
⁸¹They ask her to weep Balder out of hell. She says:

1 „Þökk mun gráta · þurrum torum
²Baldrs bál-farar;
 kyks né dauðs · naut'k=a Karls sonar
⁴hafi Hel því's hefir.“

[S TODO, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

“Thanks will weep dry tears
 for Balder's pyre-journey [DEATH].
 Neither living nor dead I profitted from Churl's son [= Balder];
 let Hell have what she has!”

⁸²En þess geta menn, at þar hafi verit Loki Lauf-eyjar son, er
²flest hefir illt gørt með Ósum.

⁸²But men guess that this must have been Lock, Leafy's son, who has done the most evil among the Eese.

VI. Thunder's journey to Garfrith (*Skm* 26)

Introduction

Skm 26, here edited in part, tells of Thunder's journey to the ettin Garfrith and his following killing of the ettin and his two daughters, Yelp and Grope.

Thunder's fight with Garfrith and his daughters was clearly a very popular story in the late Wiking Age. Its retelling takes up most of the Scaldic *Þdr*, of which 19 full stanzas and 4 half-stanzas survive. The killing of Yelp is also invoked in a pagan prayer to Thunder quoted in *Skm* 11: *stétt of Gjölþ dauða* 'Thou didst stand over the dead Yelp' (Vetr l 1/1b in SkP 3). The story apparently remained popular after Christianization as seen by a humorous anecdote from the Kings' Saws. As King Harold 'Hardrede' Siwardson (born ca. 1015, dead 1066) was walking with his retinue, they witnessed an argument between a blacksmith and a tanner. Harold asked one of his court poets to compose a stanza (viz. ÞjóðA l 5 in SkP 2) about the incident while at the same time casting the blacksmith as Thunder and the tanner as Garfrith. The king was impressed and asked the poet to make another stanza, this time about Siward and Fathomer. The story of Garfrith is further alluded to in a curious way in Saxo Grammaticus (2015, pp. 598–613) 8.14.1–20, where a party guided by a man named Thurkettle (Latin *Thorkillus*) visit Garfrith's (Latin *Gerruthus*) cave and find his mutilated corpse along with those of three young women with their backs broken. Thurkettle tells them that this was once done by the god Thunder (Latin *Thor*).

Although the story of *Skm* 26 is clearly based partly on *Þdr* (from which it cites at length), it may also rely on a now-lost poem in Leeds-meter since it quotes two stanzas in that meter. Of these sts. the first is found in all four main manuscripts while the second only in U. Both are spoken by Thunder and closely resemble each other stylistically, which is why they are likely to come from the same poem.

Text

- 2 Þá fór Þórr til ár þeirar, er Vimur heitir, allra á mest. Þá spennti
hann sik megin-gjörðum ok studdi for-streymis Gríðar-völ, en
4 Þá hélt undir megin-gjarðar. Ok þá er Þórr kom á miðja ó'na,
þá óx svá mjök ó'in, at uppi braut á oxl honum. Þá kvað Þórr
þetta:

THEN JOURNEYED THUNDER to that river which is called Wimbre, greatest of all rivers. Then he strapped his might-girdle around him and leaned upon Grith's stave against the stream, and Lock clung to the might-girdle. And when Thunder came to the middle of the river, then it waxed so great that it broke over his shoulders. Then this quoth Thunder:

1 „Vax=at-tu nú, Vimur, · alls mik þik vaða tíðir
 2 jötna garða i;
 vætist, ef þú vęx · at þa vęx mér ős-męgin
 4 jafn-hött upp sem himinn.“

[S TODO, T TODO,
 W TODO, U TODO]

“Wax not now, Wimbre, as I wish to wade through thee
 into the yards of the ettins!
 Thou knowest, if thou waxest, then my Os-might waxes
 up even as high as the heaven.”

ALL | The contents of the st. are also found in *Þdr* 8/3–4.

1 Vimur ‘Wimbre’ | The name of the river is also found in a kenning in *Húsdr* 6/3: *Við-gymnir* *Vimrar vaðs* ‘the Widegimmer (ettin) of Wimbre’s ford [= Thunder]’.

3 ős-męgin ‘Os-might’ | TODO.

Þá sér Þórr uppi í gljúfrum nokkurum, at Gjølþ, dóttir Geir-røðar
 2 stóð þar tveim męgin ár’innar, ok gerði hón ár-vøxt’inn. Þá tók
 Þórr upp ór ǵ’nni stein mikinn ok kastaði at henni ok męlti svá:
 4 „At ósi skal ǵ stemma.“ Eigi missti hann, þar er hann kastaði til,
 ok í því bili bar hann at landi ok fekk tekit reyni-runn nokkurn
 6 ok steig svá ór ǵ’nni. Því er þat orð-tak haft, at reynir er björg
 þórs.

Then Thunder sees that up in some certain gorges Yelp, the daughter of
 Garfrith, stood on both sides of the river, and she caused the river’s growth.
 Then Thunder took up from the river a great stone and threw it at her and
 spoke so: “At its source shall the river be dammed.” He did not miss his
 target, and in that very moment he threw himself towards land and caught
 hold of a certain rowan shrub, and so he came out of the river. From this
 comes the saying that the rowan is Thunder’s deliverance.

2 stóð þar tveim męgin ár’innar, ok gerði hón ár-vøxt’inn ‘stood on both sides of the river, and she
 caused the river’s growth’ | She stood with her legs spread and befouled the river with urine or
 menstrual blood.

En er Þórr kom til Geir-røðar, þá var þeim fé-lögum vísat fyrst í
 2 geita-hús til her-bergis, ok var þar einn stóll til sétis, ok sat Þórr
 þar. Þá varð hann þess varr, at stóll’inn fór undir honum upp at
 4 réfri. Hann stakk Gríðar-veli upp í rapt’ana ok lét sígast fast á
 stól’inn. Varð þá brestr mikill, ok fylgði skrékr. Þar höfðu verit
 6 undir stóli’num dótr Geir-røðar, Gjølþ ok Greip, ok hafði hann
 brotit hrygg’inn í báðum. Þá kvað Þórr:

But when Thunder came to Garfrith’s, then the companions were first shown
 into a goathouse for lodgings, and therein was but one chair for sitting and

Thunder sat down there. Then he became aware that the chair under him was moving upwards into the rafters. He thrust Grith's stave up against the rafters and pushed himself firmly down into the chair. Then there was a great crack, followed by a shriek. There beneath the chair had been the daughters of Garfrith, Yelp and Grope, and he had broken the backs of them both. Then quoth Thunder:

7 Þá kvað Þórr: | *only in U; om. all others.*

2 „**E**inu *sinni* · neytta'k alls meġins

[U TODO]

2 jǫtna gǫrðum i

þá's **G**jǫlp ok **G**reip, · dótr **G**eir-raðar,

4 vildu **h**efja mik til **h**imins.“

“A single time I used all my might
in the yards of the ettins,
when Yelp and Grope, the daughters of Garfrith,
would lift me to the heaven.”

ALL | *only in U; om. all others.*

1 *sinni* ‘time’ | metr. and sens. emend.; om. U.

VII. The tree Glazer (*Skm* 42)

Introduction

The original context of this half-stanza in Leeds-meter is obscure. The present excerpt represents the whole ch. 42 of *Skm*.

Text

¹Hví er gull kallat barr eða lauf Glasis? ²Í Ós-garði fyrir durum
 2 Val-hallar stendr lundr, sá er Glasir er kallaðr, en lauf hans allt
 er gull-rautt, ³svá sem hér er kveðit, at

¹WHY IS GOLD called the needle or leaf of Glazer? ²In Otyard, before the
 doors of Walhall stands a tree which is called Glazer, and its leafing is all
 golden red, ³as it is sung here, that

1 Glasir stendr · með gollnu laufi
 2 fyrir Sig-týs solum.

[S TODO, T TODO,
 W TODO, U TODO]

Glazer stands with golden leaf
 before Sye-Tew's (Weden's) halls.

⁴Sá er víðr fegrstr með goðum ok mǫnnum.

⁴It is the fairest tree among gods and men.

VIII. On the making of Glapner (*Litla skálda*)

Introduction

The following fragmentary stanza about the making of Glapner—the fetter used to bind the Fenrerswolf—is found in the short work on kennings today called the Little Scalda (*Litla skálda*), a text which probably served as a source for Snorre’s Edda (see further Males (2020, pp. 129–47)).

For the binding of the Wolf see *Gylf* 34:10–42 and the summary in *Lok* 38/3–4 n.

A variant of this stanza is transparently paraphrased in *Gylf* 34:21, which tells us that: *Hann var gørr af sex blutum: af dyn kattar’ins ok af skeggi konu’nnar ok af rótum bjargs’ins ok af sinum bjarnar’ins ok af anda fisks’ins ok af fogls bráka*. ‘It [Glapner] was made from six things: from the cat’s din and from the woman’s beard and from the mountain’s root and from the bear’s sinews and from the fish’s breath and from the fowl’s spittle.’ The small variants—*bráka* ‘spittle’ for *mjolk* ‘milk’, and the reversal of lines 2 and 3—suggest that Snorre had access to a somewhat different variant of the present stanza.

Text

- 1 Ór kattar dyn · ok ór konu skeggi,
2 ór fisks anda · ok ór fugla mjolk,
ór bergs rótum · ok bjarnar sinum,
4 ór því vas hann Gleipnir gørr.

[A, 9v/30, B TODO]

“FROM CAT’S DIN and from woman’s beard,
from fish’s breath and from fowls’ milk,
from mountain’s roots and bear’s sinews—
from this was Glapner made.”

Norse Heroic Poetry from the Walsing-Cycle

First Lay of Hallow Hundingsbane

(I Hēlga kviða Hundings-bana)

Dating (Sapp 2022): late C12th (0.805)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

This rather late poem is very well written. Particularly beautiful are the introductory stanzas, which tell of Norns arriving in the night to predetermine Hallow's life.

Text

- P1 Hér hefr upp kvæði frá Helga Hundings bana, þeira ok Hǫð·brodds.
 2 Vǫlsunga kviða.

HERE BEGINS A LAY about Hallow, the bane of Hunding and his men, and of Hathbrod. A lay of the Walsings.

ALL | *The title of the poem, introduced by an unusually large initial otherwise only paralleled by Vsp*
 I R.

- 1 ÁR was alda · þat's arar gullu [R 20r/21]
 2 hnigu heilög vǫtn · af Himin-fjǫllum;
 þá hafði Hēlga · inn hugum stóra
 4 Borg·hildr borit · i Brá-lundi.

It was early of ages when eagles shrieked;
 holy waters poured down from the Heavenfells;
 then to Hallow the great of heart
 had Burhild in Browlund given birth.

1 ÁR was alda 'It was early of ages' | This formulaic introduction immediately situates the events of the poem in the distant mytho-heroic past, indeed, if one compares *Vsp* 3/1 where the same line occurs, at the beginning of history.

1 arar gullu 'eagles shrieked' | In celebration of the birth of a great warrior to feed them. Cf. TODO (beasts of battle motif).

- 2 Nǫtt varð i bǫ, · nornir kvǫmu, [R 20r/23]
 2 þér's ǫðlingi · aldr of skópu;
 þann bǫðu fylki · frégstan verða
 4 ok buðlunga · bætstan þykkja.

It turned night in the settlement; norns oncame,
 they who shaped the athling's age.
 They bade that battle-arrayer become the noblest
 and among princes seem the best.

- 3 Snøru þér af afli · ør·løg-þóttu [R 20r/25]
 2 þá's borgir braut · i Brá-lundi;
 þér of grēiddu · gollin-símu
 4 ok und mǫna sal · miðjan fēstu.

They turned with strength the orlay-strands
 when castles were broken in Browlund.

They arranged a golden cord
and beneath the middle of the moon's hall [SKY/HEAVEN] fastened it.

1 *ör-log-þóttu* 'orlay-strands' | The strands of men's destinies. The likeness with strings of fabric is notable since it has a close parallel to the role of the Greek Μοῖραι, the three weavers of fate. Cf. the semantically identical cpd. *ör-log-síma* in *Reg* 14/4.

- 4 Þęr austr ok vestr · ęnda fōlu, [R 20r/27]
2 þar átti lofðungr · land á milli,
brá nipt Nera · á norðr-vega
4 ęinni fęsti, · ęy bað hōn halda.

In the east and west they hid its ends;
there the praised man owned land in between.
The kinswoman of Nare [NORN] pulled onto the northern ways
a single strand—she bade it hold for ever.

- 5 Ęitt vas at angri · Ylfinga nið [R TODO]
2 ok þęiri męyju · es mun-úð fōddi;
hrafn kvað at hrafni, · sat á hōm meiði
4 and-vanr ọtu: · „Ek vęit nọkkut!

TODO.

TODO.

A raven quoth to raven; it sat on a high branch,
lacking food: “I know something!”

- 6 Stęndr i brynju · burr Sig-mundar, [R TODO]
2 dōgrs ęins gamall, · nú 's dagr kominn!
Hvęssir augu · sem hildingar,
4 sá's varga vīnr, · vit skulum tętir!“

In his byrnie stands Syemund's son,
one half-day old; now the day is come!
He sharpens his eyes like do men of war;
that one is a friend of wolves; we shall be merry!”

- 7 Drótt þótti sá · dọglingr vera, [R TODO]
2 kvọðu með gumnum · ár of kominn;
sjalfr gekk vísi · ór víg-þrimu
4 ungum fōra · ítr-lauk grami.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.
TODO.

- 8 Gaf hann Hēlga nafn · ok Hring-staði, [R TODO]
2 Sól-fjöll, Sné-fjöll · ok Sig·ars-völlu,
 Hring-stöð, Hó-tún · ok Himin-vanga,
4 blóð-orm búinn · bróðr Sin·fjötla.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

- 9 Þá nam at vaxa · fyr vina brjósti [R TODO]
2 almr ítr-borinn · ynðis ljóma.
 Hann galt ok gaf · goll verðungu,
4 sparði eigi hilmir · hodd blóð-rekin.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

- 10 Skammt lét vísi · vígs at biða [R TODO]
2 þá's fylkir vas · fimm-tán vetra
 ok hann harðan lét · Hunding veginn,
4 þann's lengi réð · lönnum ok þegnum.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

- 11 Kvæddu síðan · Sig·mundar bur [R TODO]
2 auðs ok hringa · Hundings synir
 því't þeir óttu · jofri at gjalda
4 fjár-nám mikit · ok fœður dauða.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

- 12 Lét=at buðlungr · bótir uppi [R TODO]
 2 né niðja in hēldr · nef-gjöld fáa;
 vón kvað hann myndu · veðrs ins mikla
 4 grára gæira · ok grēmi Óðins.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
- 13 Fara hildingar · hjör-stefnu til, [R TODO]
 2 þeirar's lögðu · at Loga-fjöllum;
 sléit Fróða-frið · fjánda á milli,
 4 fara Viðris grēy · val-gjörn umb ey.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
- 14 Sætti=sk vísi, · þá's vegit hafði [R TODO]
 2 Ólf ok Eyj-ólf, · und Ara-stēini,
 Hjör-varð ok Hó-varð, · Hundings sonu;
 4 farit hafði hann allri · étt geir-Mimis.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
- 15 Þá brá ljóma · af Loga-fjöllum [R TODO]
 2 en af þeim ljómum · leiptrir kvómu;
 þá vas und hjölmum · á Himin-vanga;
 4 brynjur vöru þeira · blóði stokknar,
 en af gæirum · gæislar stóðu.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
- 16 Frá ár=liga · ór ulf-iði [R TODO]

- 2 dǫglingr at því · dísir suð-rónar
 ef þér vildi heim · með hildingum
 4 þá nött fara; · þrymr vas alma.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 17 En af hęsti · Hǫgna dóttir,
 2 —líddi randa rym— · rési sagði:
 „Hygg at vér ęigim · aðrar sýslur
 4 an með baug-brota · bjór at drekka.

[R TODO]

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 18 Hęfir minn faðir · meýju sinni
 2 grimmum hętit · Gran·mars syni;
 en ek hęfi, Hęlgi, · Hǫð-brodd kveðinn
 4 konung ó-neisan · sem kattar son.

[R TODO]

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 19 Þa kǫmr fylkir · fara náttu
 2 nema hǫnum vísir · val-stefnu til
 eða meý nemir · frá mildingi.“

[R TODO]

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 20 „Uggi ęigi þú · Ísungs bana!
 2 Fyrr mun dolga dynr · nema dauðr séa’k!“

[R TODO]

TODO.

TODO.

- 21 Sēndi **ó**ru · all-valdr þaðan [R TODO]
 2 of lopt ok of lög · lēiðar at biðja,
 ið-gnógan · ógnar ljóma
 4 brögnum **b**jóða · ok **b**urum þeira.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
- 22 „Biðið **sk**jót=liga · til **s**kípa ganga [R TODO]
 2 ok ór **B**rand-eyju · **b**úna verða!“
 Þaðan bæið þengill · und's þing kvómu
 4 halir **h**und-margir · ór **H**ęðins-eyju.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
- 23 Ok þar af **str**öndum · ór **S**tafns-nęsi [R TODO]
 2 **b**ęit hans út skriðu · ok **b**úin golli;
 spurði **H**ęlgi · **H**jör·lēif at því:
 4 Hęfir þú **k**annaða · **k**oni ó-nęisa?
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
- 24 En **un**gr konungr · **q**ðrum sagði: [R TODO]
 2 Sęint kvað at **t**ęlja · af **T**rönu-eyri
 lang-hęfðuð skip · und **l**íðöndum,
 4 þau's i **Q**rva-sund · **ú**tan fóru:
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
- 25 „**T**olf hundruð · **t**ryggra manna;
 2 þó 's i **H**ó-túnum · **h**ölfu flęira,
 víg-lið konungs; · **v**öu erum rómu!“ [R TODO]

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 26 Svá brá stýrir · stafn-tjöldum af [R TODO]
 2 at mildinga · męngi vakði,
 ok döglingar · dags-brún séa,
 4 ok siklingar · snøru upp við tré
 vef-nistingum · à Varins-firði.

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 27 Varð ára ymr · ok járna glymr, [R TODO]
 2 brast rōnd við rōnd, · røru víkingar;
 ęisandi gekk · und ǫðlingum
 4 loðungs floti · lōndum fjarri.

There was splashing of oars and clashing of swords;
 shield struck against shield—the Vikings rowed.

TODO.
 TODO.

1 járna ‘swords’ | The contracted form is metrically preferred. TODO.

- 28 Svá vas at heyra · es saman kvómu [R TODO]
 2 Kólgu systir · ok kilir langir
 sem björg eða brim · brotna myndi.

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 29 Draga bað Helgi · hō segl ofarr, [R TODO]
 2 varð=at hrōnnum · hōfn þing-loga,
 þa’s ógur=lig · Égis dóttir
 4 stag-stjórn-morum · stęypa vildi.

TODO.
 TODO.

TODO.
TODO.

- 30 En þeim sjölfum · Sig-rún ofan [R TODO]
2 folk-djörf of barg · ok fari þeira,
snørisk ramm=liga · Rón ór hendi
4 gjalfr-dýr konungs · at Gnipa-lundi.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

- 31 Svát þar umb aptan · i Una-vógum, [R TODO]
2 flaust fagr-búin · fljóta knöttu,
en þeir sjalfir · frá Svarins-haugi
4 með hǫrmðar hug · hǫr konnuðu.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

- 32 Frá goð-borinn · Guð-mundr at því: [R TODO]
2 „Hverr 's land-reki · sá's liði stýrir
ok hann fǫikna-lið · fǫrir at landi?“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

- 33 Sin-fjötli kvað, · slong upp við ró [R TODO]
2 rauðum skildi, · rōnd vas ór golli;
þar vas sund-vörðr · sá's svara kunni
4 ok við ǫðlinga · orðum skipta:

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
and with athlings bandy words.

- 34 „Sǫg þat i aptan, · es svinum gefr [R TODO]

- 2 ok tíkr yðrar · tēygir at solli,
at sé Ylfingar · austan komnir
4 gunnar gjarnir · frá Gnipa-lundi.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

- 35 Þar mun Hǫð-broddr · Hēlga finna,
2 flug-trauðan gram · i flota miðjum,
sá's opt hēfir · ǫrnu sadda,
4 meðan þú á kvernum · kysstir þýjar.“

[R TODO]

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

- 36 „Fátt mant, fylkir, · fornra spjalla
2 es þú ǫðlingum · ó-sönnu bregðr!
þú hēfir etnar · ulfa krásir
4 ok bróðr þínum · at bana orðit,
opt sǫr sogin · með svǫlum munni,
6 hēfir i hreysi · hvar-leiðr skriðit!“

[R TODO]

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

- 37 „Þú vast vǫlva · i Varins-eyju,
2 skoll-vís kona, · bart skrǫk saman;
kvaðst engi mann · eiga vilja,
4 sēgg brynjaðan, · nema Sin-fjǫtla!

[R TODO]

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

- 38 „Þú vart in skóða,“ (kvað) „skass, val-kyrja, [R TODO]
 2 ǫtul, á máttlig, · at Al-föður;
 mundu ein-herjar · allir þerja=sk,
 4 své-vís kona, · of sakar þínar!

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 39 Níu óttu vit · á nesi Sögu [R TODO]
 2 ulfa alna, · ek vas einn faðir þeira!“

TODO.
 TODO.

- 40 „Faðir vas=at-tu · fœnris-ulfa, [R TODO]
 2 ǫllum elli, · svát ek muna,
 síðst þik gældu · fyr Gnipa-lundi
 4 þursa meýjar · á Þörs-nesi!

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 41 Stjúpr vast Sig-geirs, · látt und stöðum hēima, [R TODO]
 2 varg-ljóðum vanr · á viðum úti;
 kvömu þér ó-gögn · ǫll at hendi
 4 þá's bróðr þinum · brjóst raufaðir;
 gøðir þik frégjan · af firin-verkum!

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 42 Þú vart brúðr Grana · á Brá-velli, [R TODO]
 2 goll-bitluð vart · gør til rásar,
 hafða'k þér móðri · margt skēið riðit
 4 svangri und sǫðli, · simul, for-bergis!“

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 43 „Sveinn þóttir þú · sið-lauss vesa [R TODO]
 2 þá's þú Gollnis · geitr molkaðir
 en i annat sinn · Imðar dóttir
 4 töttrug-hypja; · vill þú tölú lengri?“

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 44 „Fyrr vilda ek · at Freka-stęini [R TODO]
 2 hrafna sęðja · á hręum þinum
 en tıkr yðrar · tęygja at solli
 4 eða gefa goltum; · deili gręm við þik!“

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 45 „Vęri ykk, Sin-fjötli,“ (kvað) „sómra myklu [R TODO]
 2 gunni at hejja · ok glaða ęrnu
 an sé ó-nýtum · orðum at bręğðask
 4 þó'tt hring-brotar · heiptir deili.

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 46 Þikkja-t mér góðir · Gran-mars synir, [R TODO]
 2 þó dugir siklingum · satt at męla;
 þęir hafa markat · á Móins-heimum,
 4 at hug hafa · hjęrum at bręğða.“

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

TODO.

- 47 Þeir af ríki · rinna létu [R TODO]
 2 Svipuð ok Svegjuð · Sól-heima til,
 dala dōgg-ótta, · dōkkvar hlíðir,
 4 skalf Mistar marr · hvar's megir fóru.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 48 Móttu þeir tiggja · i tūn-hliði, [R TODO]
 2 sōgðu stríð=liga · stilli kvómu.
 Úti stóð Hōð-broddr · hjalmi faldinn,
 4 hugði hann jó-reið · étta sinnar:
 „Hvi 's hērmðar litr · à Hniflungum?“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

3 Hōð-broddr | creatively corr. in same hand from Bōð-víldr 'Beadbild' (due to influence from the nearby Vkv; see Males 2024a, p. 159) R.

5 Hniflungum | This is the only attestation of *hniflungr* rather than *niflungr* in R ('*bniflungom*'), but the initial *b* is also metrically necessary in *Gbv* 12/3.

- 49 „Snúa=sk hér at sandi · snéfgir kjólar, [R TODO]
 2 rakka hirtir · ok ráar langar,
 skildir margir, · skafnar árar,
 4 gōfugt lið gylfa, · glaðir Ylfingar.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 50 Ganga fimm-tán · folk upp á land, [R TODO]
 2 þó's i Sogn út · sjau þúsundir,
 liggja hér i grindum · fyr Gnipa-lundi
 4 brim-dýr blá-svört · ok búin golli.

- þar 's miklu męst · męgi þęira;
 6 mun=a nú Hęlgi · hjęr-þing dvala.“

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 51 „Rinni raukn bitluð · til ręgin-þinga
 2 ęn Spor-vitnir · at Sparins-þęiði.
 Męlnir ok Mýlnir · til myrk-viðar;
 4 látið ęngi mann · ęptir sitja
 þęira 's bęn-logum · bręðða kunni!

[R TODO]

“TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

Let no man remain behind
 of those who can brandish wound-flames [SWORDS]!

- 52 Bjóðið ér Hęgna · ok Hrings sonum,
 2 Atla ok Yngva, · Ólf inum gamla;
 þęir 'ro gjarnir · gunni at þęyja;
 4 lötum Vęlsunga · viðr-nám fää!“

[R TODO]

Summon Hawn and the sons of Ring;
 Attle and Ing and Atholf the Old.
 They are eager to wage war;
 let us make the Walsings face resistance!”

- 53 Svipr ęinn vas þat · es saman kvęmu
 2 fęlvir oddar · at Freka-stęini;
 ęy var Hęlgi · Hundings bani
 4 fyrstr i folki · þar's firar bęrðu=sk,
 óstr à imu, · all-trauðr flugar;
 6 sá hafði hilmir · hart móð-akarn.

[R TODO]

TODO.
 TODO.

always was Hallow Hunding's bane
 the first in the troop where the folk did fight;
 TODO.

that helmet-bearer had a hard courage-acorn [HEART].

- 54 Kvómu þar ór himni · hjalm-vitr ofan, [R TODO]
 2 —óx geira gnýr— · þér's grami hlífðu;
 þá kvað þat Sig-rún, · —sár-vitr flugar—
 4 át hǫlða skér · af Hugins barri:

There, out of heaven, helmet-wights came down,
 they who shielded the lord—the din of spears grew.
 Then this quoth Syerun, the wound-wight of flight—
 TODO.

- 55 „Hæill skalt, vísi, · virða njóta, [R TODO]
 2 átt-stafr Yngva, · ok una lífi
 es þú fellað hefir · inn flugar-trauða
 4 jǫfur, þann's olli · Égis dauða.

“TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.”

- 56 Ok þér, buðlungr, · samir bæði vel [R TODO]
 2 rauðir baugar · ok in ríkja mēr;
 hæill skalt, buðlungr, · bæði njóta
 4 Hǫgna dóttur · ok Hring-staða
 sigrs ok landa; · þá's sókn lokit!“

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.”

Lay of Hallow Harwardson

(Hēlga kviða Hjør·varðs-sonar)

Dating (Sapp 2022): early C11th (0.385)–late C11th (0.550)
Meter: Ancient-words-law (1/1–12/2, 31–43), Leeds-meter (12/3–30/4)

Introduction

The **Lay of Hallow Harwardson** (*HHj*) is a heroic prosimetrum and the second of the Hallow-poems. According to Lindblad it forms an orthographic group with 2 *HHund*.

TODO: the speaker notes are emended. Note this!!!

Text

Frá Hjor·varði ok Sigr·linn ('From Harward and Syelind')

- P1 Hjor·varðr hét konungr; hann átti fjórar konur. Ein hét Alf·hildr;
 2 sonr þeira hét Heðinn. Önnur hét Sér·eiðr; þeira sonr hét Hum-
 lungr. In þriðja hét Sin·rjóð; þeira sonr hét Hymlingr. Hjor·varðr
 4 konungr hafði þess heit strengt at eiga þá konu er hann vissi vên-
 sta. Hann spurði at Sváfni konungr átti dóttur *allra fegrsta;
 6 sú hét Sigr·linn. Ið·mundr hét jarl hans; Atli var hans sonr,
 er fór at biðja Sigr·linnar til handa konungi. Hann dvalði=sk
 8 vetr-langt með Sváfni konungi. Frán·marr hét þar jarl, fóstri
 Sigr·linnar; dóttir hans hét Álof. Jarl'inn réð, at meyjar var syn-
 10 jat, ok fór jarl'inn heim. Atli jarls sonr stóð einn dag við lund
 nokkurn, en fugl sat í limu'num uppi yfir hánun, ok hafði heyrt
 12 til, at hans menn kǫlluðu vênstar konur þær, er Hjor·varðr ko-
 nungr átti. Fugl'inn kvakaði, en Atli hlýddi hvat hann sagði.
 14 Hann kvað:

Hearward was the name of a king; he had four wives. One was called Elfhild; their son was called Headen. The other was called Searad; their son was called Humbling. The third was called Sindread; their son was called Himbling. King Hearward had undertaken a vow to have the women whom he knew to be the most handsome. He learned that king Swebnar had a daughter fairest of all; she was called Syelind. Idmund was the name of his earl; Attle was his son, who journeyed to ask for Syelind's hand on behalf of the king. He stayed over the winter with king Swebnar. Frenmar was the name of an earl there, the foster-father of Syelind; his daughter was called Anlave. The earl decided that the maiden was denied him and the earl journeyed home. Attle the earl's son one day stood by a certain tree, but a bird sat in the branches above him and had overheard that his men said that the women which king Hearward had were the most handsome. The bird twittered, and Attle listened to what he said. Quoth he:

5 *allra | 'vænallra' R

- Fugl kvað: 1 „Sátt-u Sigr·linn, · Sváfnis dóttur,
 2 mēyna fęgrstu · ĩ munar-þęmi?
 þó hag=ligar · Hjor·varðs konur
 4 gumnum þykkja · at Glasis-lundi.“

Quoth the bird: “Hast thou seen Syelind Swebnar's daughter,
 the fairest of maidens in the realm of love [WORLD]?”

Although Hearward's wives seem handsome
to the men in Glazerslund."

Atli kvađ: 2 „Munt við Atla · Ið·mundar son
2 fugl fróð-hugađr · fleira męla?“
Fugl kvađ: „Mun'k ef mik buđlungr · blóta vildi
4 ok kýs'k þat's ek vil · ór konungs garði.“

Quoth Atle: "Wilt thou with Atle Idmund's son,
O wise-minded bird, speak yet more?"
Quoth the bird: "I will, if the chieftain will make a bloot for me
and I may choose what I wish from the house of the king."

Atli kvađ: 3 „Kjós=at-tu Hęor-varđ · né hans sonu
2 né inar fęgru · fylkis brúđir,
ęigi brúđir · þęr's buđlungr á;
4 kaupum vel saman, · þat's vina kynni.“

Quoth Atle: "Choose not Harward nor his sons,
nor the fair brides of the marshaller—
not the brides which the chieftain has.
Let us deal well together; that is the manner of friends."

Fugl kvađ: 4 „Hof mun'k kjósa, · hęrga marga,
2 goll-hyrnđar kýr · frá grams búi,
ef hęnum Sigr·linn · søfr á armi
4 ok ó·nauđig · jęfri fylgir.“

Quoth the bird: "Hoves will I choose, many harrows,
golden-horned kine from the ruler's estate
if Syelind will sleep on his arm
and without coercion follow the lord."

2 goll-hyrnđar kýr 'golden-horned kine' | Formulaic, also found in *Þrk* 23/1b.

P2 Þetta var áđr Atli fóri. En er hann kom heim ok konungr spurði
2 hann tíđinda, hann kvađ:

This was before Atle journeyed. But when he came home and the king asked
him for the tidings, quoth he:

5 „Hęfum ęrfiđi · ok ękki ęrendi;
2 mara þraut óra · á męgin-fjalli,

- urðum síðan · Sǣ·morn vaða;
 4 þá vas oss synjat · Sváfnis dóttur,
 hringum góðdrar, · es vér hafa vildum.“

“We have a hardship and no errand.
 Our steeds expired on the mighty fell;
 thereafter we had to wade through Seamorn.
 Then we were refused Swebner's daughter,
 endowed with rings, whom we wished to have.”

1 Hǫfum ǣrfiði · ok ǣkki ǫrendi | I.e., ‘we have had great struggle and got no results.’ A formulaic word-pair; cf. *Þrk* 10/1, 11/1.

- P3 Konungr bað at þeir skyldu fara annat sinn; fór hann sjálf. En
 2 er þeir kómu upp á fjall ok sá á Sváfa-land lands-bruna ok jó-
 reyki stóra, reið konungr af fjalli’nu fram í land’it ok tók nátt-
 4 ból við á eina. Atli helt vǫrð ok fór yfir á’na. Hann fann eitt
 hús. Fugl mikill sat á húsi’nu ok gétti ok var sofnaðr. Atli
 6 skaut spjóti fugl’inn til bana en í húsi’nu fann hann Sigr’linn
 konungs dóttur ok Á·lǫfu jarls dóttur ok hafði þér báðar braut
 8 með sér. Frán·marr jarl hafði hamatst í arnar líki ok varit þér
 fyr her’num með fjǫl·kynngi. Hróð·marr hét konungr, biðill
 10 Sigr’linnar. Hann drap Sváfa-konung ok hafði rént ok brennt
 land’it. Hjǫr·varðr konungr fekk Sigr’linnar en Atli Á·lǫfar.

The king bade that they should journey another time; he himself journeyed. But when they came up onto the fell and saw out over Swebeland, the singed land and the great dust-clouds from horses, the king rode down from the fell into the land and took his nightly lodgings by a river. Atle kept watch and journeyed over the river; he found a lone house. A graet bird sat upon the house and guarded it and had fallen asleep. Atle shot the bird to its death with a spear, but in the house he found Syelind, the king's daughter, and Onlave, the earl's daughter, and took them both away with him. Earl Frenmar had shifted hames into the likeness of an eagle and had guarded them against the host with manicunningness. Rothmar was the name of a king, the suitor of Syelind. He slew the king of the Swebes and had robbed and burned the land. King Harward got Syelind, but Atle got Onlave.

- P4 Hjǫr·varðr ok Sigr’linn áttu son mikinn ok vęnan. Hann var
 2 þǫgull; ekki nafn festi=sk við hann. Hann sat á haugi. Hann sá
 riða val·kyrjur níu ok var ein gǫfug=ligust. Hón kvað:

Harward and Syelind got a son, great and beautiful. He was silent; no name stuck to him. He sat on a mound. He saw nine walkirries riding, and one was the most worshipful. Quoth she:

- 6 „Síð munt, **H**elgi, · **h**ringum ráða,
2 **r**íkr **r**óg-apaldr, · né **R**oðuls-vøllum,
—**o**rn gól **á**r=la— · ef þú **ę** þęgir,
4 þó'tt **h**arðan **h**ug, · **h**ilmir, gjaldir.“

“Late wilt thou, Hallow, rule the rings,
O strong strife-apple-tree [WARRIOR], nor the Raddlewolds,
—the eagle crowed in early morn—if thou art for ever silent,
even if thou hast a hard heart, O prince!”

1 Helgi ‘Hallow’ | The walkirie here gives the silent boy his name, *Hęłgi* ‘the Holy One’.

- [Hęłgi] kvað: 7 „Hvat lętr fylgja · **H**ęłga nafni,
2 **b**rúðr **b**jart-lituð, · alls **b**jóða ręðr?
Hygg fyr **o**llum · **a**t·kvęðum vel;
4 **þ**igg **ę**igi **þ**at · nema **þ**ik hafa!“

Quoth [Hallow]: “What lettest thou follow Hallow’s name,
O bright-faced bride, as thou dost offer it?
Think well before all decisions;
I will take nothing other than that to have *thee*!”

- [Val-kyrja] kvað: 8 „**S**verð vęit’k liggja · **i** **S**ig=ars-holmi,
2 **f**jórum **f**ęra · an **f**imm tōgu;
ęitt es þęira · **o**llum bętra
4 **v**ig-nesta **b**ōl · ok **v**arit golli.

Quoth [the walkirie]: “Swords I know lying in Sigarsholm:
four less than fifty.
One of them is better than all—
a bale of war-covers(?) [SHIELDS]—and covered with gold.

- 9 **H**ringr ’s **i** **h**jalti, · **h**ugr ’s **i** miðju,
2 **o**gn ’s **i** oddi, · þeim’s **ę**iga getr;
liggr með **ę**ggju · **o**rmr dreyr-fáaðr
4 en **a** **v**al-bōstu · **v**erpr naðr hala.“

A ring is on its hilt; heart is in the middle;
terror is in the point for him who gets to own it.
Along the edge lies a serpent painted in blood
and on the walbast an adder eats its tail.”

1 Hringr 's i hjalti 'A ring is on its hilt' | The sword is a so-called *ring-sword*. It was popular among Germanic warriors of the Migration Period to have oath-ring on their sword-hilts as a symbol of fidelity to their lords, but this custom was entirely extinct by ca. 700 (Nerman 1931, pp. 40–44) and the detail thus serves to emphasize the exceptional age of the sword. It also helps us date at least this part of the poem, for it is highly unlikely that an Icelandic antiquarian of the C12th would have been aware of this circumstance, whereas a Norwegian of the C10th conceivably might. Cf. *Sígsk* 68 which probably also refers to a ring-sword. A well preserved Norwegian ring-sword survives from Snartemo in Vest-Agder, dating to around 500 CE (object ID C26001); see Fig. 8.

4 val-böstu 'walbast' | An unclear part of the sword-hilt, this word also occurs in *Sigrdr* 6. TODO.

- P5 Ey·limi hét konungr; dóttir hans var Sváfa. Hón var val-kyrja ok
 2 reið lopt ok lög. Hón gaf Helga nafn þetta ok hlífði hönunum opt
 síðan í orrustum. Helgi kvað:

Eanlime was the name of a king; his daughter was Sweve. She was a walkirrie and rode over air and sea. She gave Hallow this name and thereafter often shielded him in battles. Quoth Hallow:

- 10 „Est=at, Hjör-varðr, · heil-ráðr konungr,
 2 folks odd-viti, · þó'tt frégr séir;
 létst-u ǣld eta · jǫfra byggðir



Figure 8: Hilt of the Snartemo sword, front and reverse. Migration period, ca. 500 CE. © Eirik Irgens Johnsen. CC BY-SA 4.0. <https://www.unimus.no/portal/#/photos/d8932af5-1082-4938-9b4b-ca6b86f2bdfb>

4 en þeir angr við þik · ekki gørðu.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO 10

11 En Hróð·marr skal · hringum ráða,
2 þeim es óttu · örir niðjar;
 sá sé=sk fylkir · fěst at lífi,
4 hygg=sk al-dauðra · arfi at ráða.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO 11

P6 Hjör·varðr svaraði at hann myndi fá lið Helga ef hann vill hefna
2 móður-fjður síns. Þá sótti Helgi sverð'it er Sváfa vísaði hánun
 til. Þá fór hón ok Atli ok felldu Hróð·mar ok unnu mǫrg þrek-
4 virki. Hann drap Hata jǫtun er hann sat á bergi nokkuru. Helgi
 ok Atli lǫgu skipum í Hata-firði. Atli helt vǫrð inn fyrra hlut
6 nétr'innar. Hrímr·gerðr Hata dóttir kvað:

Harward answered that he would get Hallow a troop if he wished to avenge his mother's father. Then Hallow sought out the sword to which Sweve had shown him. Then she and Attle journeyed and felled Rothmar and accomplished many great deeds of strength. He slew the ettin Hate when he sat on a certain mountain. Hallow and Attle lay in their ships in Hate's firth. Attle kept watch during the first part of the night. Quoth Rimegird, Hate's daughter:

12 „Hverir 'ro hǫlðar · i Hata-firði?
2 Skjöldum es tjaldat · á skipum yðrum,
 frókn=liga látið, · fátt hygg yðr séask;
4 kennið mér nafn konungs!“

“Which are these heroes in Hate's firth?

With shields it is canopied upon your ships,

bravely adorned; I ween ye fear little.

Teach me the name of the king!”

Atli kvað: 13 „Helgi hann heitir · en þú hver=gi mátt

- 2 vinna **grand** **grami**,
 éarn-borgir · 'ro umb **ǫ**ðlings flota
 4 knegu-t oss **f**ǫlur **f**ara.“

Quoth Attle: “Hallow is he called, but thou mayst in no wise
 accomplish injury against the chief.
 Iron strongholds are around the athling's fleet;
 no shrews can destroy us.”

- 14 „Hvé þik **h**eitir,“ (kvað Hrí^m·gerðr) „**h**alr inn ám-átt=ki?
 2 Hvé þik **k**alla **k**onir?
 Fylkir þér trúir · es þik i **f**ogrum léttr
 4 **b**eits stafni **b**úa.“

“What art thou called,” quoth Rimegird, “O uncanny man—
 what does mankind call thee?
 The marshallers trusts thee when he lets thee stay
 in the prow of the tacked ship.”

- Atli kvað: 15 „Atli ek **h**eyti, · **a**tall skal'k þér vera,
 2 mjök em'k **g**ífrum **g**ramastr;
 úrgan stafn · ek **h**eyi **o**pt búit
 4 ok **k**vaðar **k**veld-ríður.

Quoth Attle: “Attle am I called; I shall be terrible toward thee
 I am by far the cruelest to troll-hags.
 In a drizzling prow have I often stayed
 and tormented evening-rideresses.

1 atall 'terrible' | A pun, the name *Atli* 'Attle' is identical to *atli* 'the terrible one', weak masculine of the adj. *atall*.

- 16 **H**vé þú **h**eytir, · **h**ála ná-gróðug?
 2 Nefn þinn, **f**ála, **f**öður;
 níu røstum · es þú skyldir **n**eðar vesa,
 4 ok vaxi þér á **b**aðmi **b**arr!“

What art thou called, O corpse-greedy witch?
 Name thy father, shrew!
 It is nine rests below where thou oughtst to be,
 and let grass grow on thy bosom!”

- Hrí^m·gerðr kvað: 17 „Hrí^m·gerðr ek **h**eyti, · **H**ati hét minn fáðir,
 2 þann vissa'k **a**·máttkastan **j**ötun;

margar brúđoir · hann lét frá búi tęknar
und's hann Hęłgi hęó.“

Quoth Rimegird: “Rimegird I am called—Hate was my father called,
I knew him to be the uncanniest ettin;
many brides he had taken from their homes
before Hallow cut him down.”

Atli kvađ: 18 „Þú vast, hála, · fyr hildings skipum
2 ok látt i fjarðar-mynni fyrir;
ręsis rekka · es vildir Ręn gefa
4 ef þér kómi't i þverst þvari.“

Quoth Attle: “Thou wast, witch, before the hilding's ships
and didst lie in the firth's mouth ahead!
The ruler's champions wouldst thou have given to Ran
if the sword had not stood in thy path!”

Hrim-gerđor kvađ: 19 „Duliđor est nú, Atli, · draums kveđ'k þér vesa,
2 síga lętr þú brýnn fyrir bráar;
móđir mín · lá fyr mildings skipum,
4 ek drekkđa Hlęđ-varđs sonum i hafi.

Quoth Rimegird: “Deluded art thou now, Attle; I say thou art dreamy;
thou lettest thy lashes sink before thy brow!
My mother lay before the generous man's ships;
I drowned Ludward's sons in the sea!

1 Duliđor est nú, Atli, · draums kveđ'k þér vesa | Found near-identically (but with different addressee) in *Hdl* 7/1.

20 Gnęggja myndir þú, Atli, · ef gęldr né vęrir:
2 bręttir sinn Hrim-gerđor hala!
Aptar=la hjarta · hygg at þitt, Atli, sé
4 þó'tt þú hafir *ręina rędd.“

Thou wouldst neigh, Attle, if thou wert not a gelding;
Rimegird lifts her tail!
A cowering heart I think be thine, Attle,
although thou hast a stallion's voice.”

4 *ręina | hręina R.

ALL | The sexual tension in this exchange is strong, all the more so since human sexual relations are frequently likened to those of horses in Norse literature (so e.g. Anon (*ÓTHkr*) 1 in SkP 1, *Bösa saga* 11).

Atli kvað: **21** „*Ręini* mun þér ek þikkja · ef þú *řeyna* knátt
 2 ok stíga'k á *land* af *lęgi*;
*q*ll munt *lęmja*=sk · ef mér 's *al*-hugat
 4 ok sveigja þinn *hala*, *Hrím*-gerðr!“

Quoth Attle: “A stallion will I seem to thee if thou wouldst try me
 and I should step aland off the lake;
 thou wilt be all beaten lame if I am full of heart,
 and wag thy tail, Rimegird!”

1 *Ręini* | ‘remi’ R.

Hrím·gerðr kvað: **22** „*Atli*, gakk á *land* · ef *a*flí *tręysti*=sk
 2 ok hittumk i *vík* *Varins*,
*ři*řja *řét*ti · es þú munt, *re*kk, fá
 4 ef þú mér i *krymmur* *k*ömr.“

Quoth Rimegird: “Attle, go aland if thou trustest in thy strength,
 and let us meet in Warren’s bay.
 TODO.
 TODO 22”

Atli kvað: **23** „*Mun*'k=a ek *g*anga · áðr *g*umnar vakna
 2 ok halda of *vísa* *v*qrð;
 es=a mér *ør*-vęnt · nęr *ö*ru *k*ömr
 4 *sk*ass upp undir *sk*ipi.“

Quoth Attle: “I will not go before the men awaken,
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO 23”

Hrím·gerðr kvað: **24** „*Vaki* þú, *Hęlgi*, · ok bót við *Hrím*-gerðr
 2 es þú létst *h*oggvinn *H*ata;
*ę*ina nót · kná hön hjá *j*öfri sofa,
 4 þá hęfir hön *b*ölv *b*ötr.“

Quoth Rimegird: “Wake thou, Hallow, and restitute Rimegird
 since thou didst let Hate be cut down.
 A single night may she sleep by the ruler;
 then she has restitution for her bales.”

Hęlgi kvað: **25** „*Loðinn* hętir es þik skal *ę*iga, · —*l*ęð est mann-kyni—,
 2 sá býr i *p*oll-ęju *p*urs,

4 **h**und-víss jötunn, · **h**raun-búa verstr,
 sá 's þér **m**akligr **m**aðr.“

Quoth Hallow: “Loden is the name of him who shall own thee—thou art loathsome to mankind—
 he lives in Thalley, a thurse,
a hundred-wise ettin, the worst of desert-dwellers;
 he is for thee a fitting man!”

Hrím-gerðr kvað: **26** „**H**ina vilt **h**elldr, **H**elgi, · es réð **h**afnir skoða
2 **f**yrri nótt með **f**irum;
 mar-gollin **m**ér · **m**ér þótti afli bera;
4 hér sté hön land af **l**egi
 ok **f**esti svá yðarn **f**lota;
6 hön **e**in því veldr · es ek **e**igi má'k
 buðlungs mǫnnum **b**ana.“

Quoth Rimegird: TODO.
 TODO.
TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
TODO.
 TODO 26

Helgi kvað: **27** „**H**eyr þú nú, **H**rím-gerðr, · ef ek bóti **h**arma þér,
2 seg þú **g**orr **g**rami:
 Vas sú **e**in vetttr · es barg **o**ðlings skipum
4 eða **f**öru þér **f**leiri saman?“

Quoth Hallow: TODO.
 TODO.
TODO.
 TODO 27

Hrím-gerðr kvað: **28** „**P**rennar níundir meýja, · **þ**ó reið ein fyrir,
2 **h**vít und **h**jalmi mér;
 marir hristu=sk, · stóð af mǫnum þeira
4 **d**ogg i **d**júpa **d**ali,
 hagl i **h**óva viðu,
6 þaðan kǫmr með **o**ldum **ár**;
 allt vas mér þat **l**eitt es **l**eit'k.“

Quoth Rimegird: TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO 28

Helgi kvað: 29 „Austr **lit**-tu nú, Hrí^m-gērðr, · ef þik **lost**na hefr
 2 **Helgi** hē^l-stofum;
 á landi ok á **vat**ni · borgit 's **ǫð**lings flota
 4 ok **sik**lings mōnnum it **sama**!“

Quoth Hallow: “Look eastwards now, Rimegird, if Hallow has stricken
 thee with hell-staves!
 On land and on water is the athling's fleet saved
 and the ruler's men likewise!”

ALL | For the motif of an ettin or dwarf turning into stone at daybreak cf. Introduction tio *Alv*.

Atli kvað: 30 „Dagr 's nú, Hrí^m-gērðr, · en þik **dvalð**a hefir
 2 **Atli** til **aldr**-laga;
hafnar mark · þykkir **hlóg**=ligt vesa,
 4 þar's þú ǿ **stę**ins líki **stę**ndr!“

Quoth Attle: “'Tis day now, Rimegird, but thou hast been delayed
 by Attle to thy loss of life!
 A laughable harbour-mark seemest thou to be
 where thou standest in the like of a stone!”

P7 Helgi konungr var all-mikill her-maðr. Hann kom til Ey·lima
 2 konungs ok bað Svǫfu, dóttur hans. Þau Helgi ok Sváfa veittu=sk
 várar ok unnu=sk furðu mikit.
 4 Sváfa var heima með feðr sínum en Helgi í hernaði; var Sváfa
 val-kyrja enn sem fyrr.
 6 Heðinn var heima með fǫður sínum, Hjør-varði konungi, í Noregi.
 Heðinn fór einn saman heim ór skógi jóla-aptan ok fann troll-
 8 konu; sú reið vargi ok hafði orma at taumum ok bauð fylgð sína
 Heðni. „Nei,“ sagði hann. Hón sagði: „Þess skaltu gjalda at
 10 bragar-fulli!“
 Um kveld'it óru heit-strengingar; var framm leiddr sonar-goltr;
 12 lögðu menn þar á hendr sínar ok strengdu menn þá heit at bragar-
 fulli. Heðinn strengði heit til Svǫfu Ey·lima dóttur, unnustu

- 14 Helga, bróður síns, ok iðraði=sk svá mjök at hann gekk á braut villi-stigu suðr á lǫnd ok fann Helga bróður sinn. Helgi kvað:

King Hallow was a fully great raider. He came to king Eanlime and asked for the hand of Sweve, his daughter. Hallow and Sweve exchanged vows and loved each other very much. Sweve was at home with her father but Hallow was raiding; Sweve was still a walkirrie as before. Headen was at home with his father, King Harward, in Norway. Headen journeyed alone home out of the woods on Yule evening and found a troll-woman; she rode a wolf and had snakes for reins and asked Headen to follow her. “No”, said he. She said: “This wilt thou pay for at the bray-cup!” In the evening there were the stringing of vows; the boar of atonement was led forth; thereon men laid their hands and then men strung their vows at the bray-cup. Headen strung a vow to possess Sweve, Eanlime’s daughter, the lover of Hallow, his brother; and he regretted it so much that he went away on trailing roads south through the lands, and found Hallow, his brother. Quoth Hallow:

- 31 „Kom heill, Hęðinn, · hvat kannt segja
2 nýra spjalla · ór Nor·egi?
Hví ’s þér, stillir, · stökkt ór landi
4 ok est ęinn kominn · oss at finna?“

“Come hale, Headen! What canst thou say
of new tidings from Norway?
Why art thou, controller, hurried from the land,
and come alone to find us?”

- [Hęðinn kvað:] 32 „Mik hęfir myklu glópr · męiri sóttan:
2 Ek hęfi korna · ina konung-bornu
brúði þína · at bragar-fulli.“

[Quoth Headen:] “A false word has greatly afflicted me:
I have chosen the kingly born
bride of thine at the bray-cup.”

- 33 „Saka=sk ęigi þú! · Sǫnn munu verða
2 ęl-mól, Hęðinn, · okkur beggja;
mér hęfir stillir · stökkt til ęyrar,
4 þriggja náttu, · skyla’k þar koma;
if’s mér á því · at aptr koma;
6 þá má at góðu · gøra=sk s·líkt ef skal.“

“Blame not thyself! True will they be,
the ale-speeches, Headen, for both of us.

Me has the controller TODO.
 for three nights; I must come thither.
 I have doubt whether I should come back;
 TODO 33"

- 34 „Sagðir þú, Hēlgi, · at Hēðinn væri
 2 góðs verðr frá þér · ok gjafa stórra;
 þér es sómra · sverð at rjóða
 4 an frið gefa · fjöndum þínum.“

“Thou hast said, O Hallow, that Headen is
 worthy of good things from thee and of great gifts.
 It is more fitting for thee to redder the sword
 than to give peace to thy enemies.”

- P8 Þat kvað Helgi því at hann grunaði um feigð sína ok þat at fylgjur
 2 hans hǫfðu vitjat Heðins þá er hann sá konu'na ríða vargi'num.
 Álfir hét konungr, sonr Hróð·mars, er Helga hafði vǫll haslaðan
 4 á Sigars-velli á þriggja náttu fresti. Þá kvað Helgi:

Hallow said that for he suspected his own feyness, and for his followeresses
 had visited Headen when he saw the woman riding the wolf. Atholf was the
 name of a king, Rothmar's son, against whom Hallow had hazeled the plain
 at Sigarswold with a three nights' summons. Then quoth Hallow:

- 35 „Rēið á vargi · es rǫkvit vas,
 2 fljóð eitt es hann · fylgju bēiddi;
 hǫn vissi þat · at veginn myndi
 4 Sigr·linnar sonr · á Sig·ars-vǫllum.“

“On the wolf rode when it was twilight
 TODO.
 she knew that slain would be
 Syelind's son [= I, Hallow] upon the Sigarswolds.”

- P9 Þar var orrusta mikil ok fekk þar Helgi bana-sár.

At that place there was a great battle and there Hallow got his bane-wound.

- 36 Sēndi Hēlgi · Sig·ar at ríða
 2 ęptir Eý·lima · ęinga dóttur;
 biðr brál·liga · búna verða

4 ef hön vill **f**inna · **f**ylki kvikvan.

Hallow sent Sigar to ride
for Eanlime's only daughter.
He asks her hurriedly to make herself ready,
if she wishes to meet the marshaller alive.

[Sig-arr kvað:] **37** „Mik **h**ęfir **H**ęłgi · **h**ingat sęndan
2 við þik, **S**váfa, · **s**jalfa at męla,
þik kvað=sk **h**ilmir · **h**itta vilja
4 **á**ðr **í**tr-borinn · **ę**ndu týndi.“

[Quoth Sigar:] “Me has Hallow sent hither,
with thy very self, O Sweve, to speak.
Thee the helmet-bearer said he wished to see
before the noble-born one must give up his life.”

[Sváfa kvað:] **38** „**H**vat varð **H**ęłga · **H**ęor-varðs syni?
2 Męr 's **h**arð=liga · **h**arma ļęitat;
ef hann **s**ęr of lęk · eða **s**verð of bęit,
4 þęim skal ek **g**umna · **g**rand of vinna!“

[Quoth Sweve:] “What happened to Hallow, Harward's son?
A cruel injury has found its way to me.
If the sea betrayed him or a sword bit him,
against that man I shall avenge the harm!”

1 *Hvat* varð | ‘H varð’ R

[Sig-ar kvað:] **39** „**F**ell hęr ĩ morgun · at **F**reka-stęini
2 **b**uðlungr sá's vas · **b**atstr und sólu;
Ółfr mun sigri · **ę**llum ráða
4 þó'tt þętta sinn · þęrf=gi vēri.“

[Quoth Sigar:] “Here this morning by Freckstone fell
the chieftain who was the best under the sun.
Atholf will have all the victory,
although this time it was not a boon.”

[Hęłgi kvað:] **40** „**H**ęil ves, Sváfa! · **H**ug skalt dęila,
2 sjá mun ĩ **h**ęimi · **h**indstr fundr vera;
tjá **b**uðlungi · **bl**óða undir;
4 męr **h**ęfir **h**ęorr **k**omit · **h**jarta it nęsta.

[Quoth Hallow:] “Be hale, Sweve! Thou shalt share in my heart;
in the Home this will be our very last meeting.
On the chieftain the wounds do bleed;
the sword has come nearest to my heart.

41 **Bið’k þik, Sváfa, · brúðr, grátt=at-tu,**
2 ef þú vill **mínu · máli hlýða**
 at þú **Hęðni · hvílu gørvir**
4 ok **jøfur ungan · østum leiðir.**“

I bid thee, Sweve—O bride, do not weep
if thou wilt harken to my speech—
that thou for Headen makest a bed
and showest the young warrior thy affections.”

ALL | Hallow asks Sweve to marry his brother, Headen, after he is dead.

[Sváfa kvað:] 42 „**Mélt hafða’k þat · i munar-heimi**
2 þá’s mér **Hęlgi · hringa valði;**
 myndi’g=a ek **lostig · at liðinn fylki**
4 **jøfur ø-kunnan · armi vęrja.**“

[Quoth Sweve:] “I had declared in the home of joy [THE LIVING WORLD]
when Hallow chose rings for me,
that I would not willingly after the marshaller’s passing,
embrace the arm of an unknown warrior.”

43 „**Kyss mik, Sváfa, · køm’k ęigi áptr**
2 **Rog-heimis á vit · né Røðuls-fjalla**
 áðr **hęfnt hęfi’k · Hjør-varðs sonar,**
4 þęss es **buðlungr vas · bętstr und sólu!**“

“Kiss me, Sweve! I will not come back
to visit Rugham nor the Raddlefells,
before I have avenged Harward’s son,
who was the best chieftain under the sun.”

ALL | The speaker is unclear. Is it Hallow declaring that he will not come back (i.e., be reborn) until he has been avenged, or is it instead Headen, who says that he will not return until he has avenged Hallow, his brother?

P10 Helgi ok Sváfa er sagt at véri endr-borin.

Hallow and Sweve, it is said, were reborn.

Second Lay of Hallow Hundingsbane (*II Hēlga kviða Hundings-bana*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): late C11th (0.587)

Meter: Ancient-words-law (TODO)

Introduction

The **Second Lay of Hallow Hundingsbane** (abbrev. *2 HHund*) is another epic poem based on the life of Hallow Syemund's son. It is the last of the three *Helga-kviður* 'Hallow-poems' in R.

Textual preservation and transmission

2 HHund is only attested in R, where it follows *HHj* and is followed by *Grip*.

Origin and motifs

The latter part of the poem contains a touching description of Syerun's visit to Hallow's grave mound, where the two lovers embrace for one last time. The same folkloric motif is found in many traditional British ballads (e.g. Roud 50 "Sweet William's Ghost", Roud 179 "The Lover's Ghost" or "The Grey Cock", Roud 22568 "The Night Visiting Song"), where two lovers separated by death reunite one last time in the grave before being forced to part at cock-crow, although in some variants of 179 and 22568 the supernatural element is not explicit. As an example, the following text is the version of Roud 22568 recorded by *The Dubliners* in 1972:

*I must away now; I can no longer tarry
This morning's tempest I have to cross
I must be guided without a stumble
Into the arms I love the most.*

*And when he came to his true love's dwelling
He knelt down gently upon a stone*

*And through her window he's whispered lowly:
"Is my true lover within at home?"*

*"Wake up, wake up, love, it is thine own true lover
Wake up, wake up, love, and let me in
For I am tired, love, and oh so weary
And more than near drenched to the skin."*

*She's raised her off her down soft pillow
She's raised her up and she's let him in
And they were locked in each other's arms
Until that long night was past and gone.*

*And when that long night was past and over
And when the small clouds began to grow
He's taken her hand and they've kissed and parted
Then he saddled and mounted and away did go.*

I must away now et c.

In the depiction of this motif in the present poem one might see a conflict between two varying conceptions of the afterlife, viz. the popular idea of the dead man as dwelling *within* his burial mound or grave, and the elite idea of the dead warrior departing to Walhall. The story of the "lover's ghost" is only properly compatible with the former idea, but as a legendary warrior Hallow is thought to go to Walhall immediately after death, and so to resolve the two the poet has Hallow ride down from Walhall to the mound where he reunites with Syerun.

Text

Frá Volsungum ('From the Walsings')

- P1 Sig-mundr konungr Volsungs sonr átti Borg-hildi af Brá-lundi.
 2 Þau hétu son sinn Helga ok eptir Helga Hjør-varðs syni. Helga
 fósttraði Hagall. Hundingr hét ríkr konungr; við hann er Hund-
 4 land kennt. Hann var her-maðr mikill ok átti marga sonu þá er
 í hernaði vóru. Ó-friðr ok dylgjur vóru á milli þeira Hundings
 6 konungs ok Sig-mundar konungs; drópu hvárir annarra frændr.
 Sig-mundr konungr ok hans étt-menn hétu Volsungar ok Ylfín-
 8 gar. Helgi fór ok njósnaði til hirðar Hundings konungs á laun.
 Hemingr, sonr Hundings konungs, var heima. En er Helgi fór
 10 í brott þá hitti hann hjarðar-svein ok kvað:

King Syemund, Walsing's son, had for wife Burhild of Browlund. They called their son Hallow after Hallow Harward's son. Hallow was fostered by Hail. Hunding was the name of a mighty king; from him comes the name Hundland. He was a great harrier and had many sons who were in the harrying host. Enmity and evil strikes at that time stood between the [sons] of King Hunding and King Syemund; men on either side slew the kinsmen of the other. King Syemund and the men of his lineage were called Walsings and Wolvings. Hallow journeyed and spied at the hird of King Hunding in secret. Heming, King Hunding's son, was at home. But when Hallow journeyed away then he struck upon a herding-swain, and quoth:

- 1 „Sęg Hęmingi · at Hęłgi man
 2 hvern ĩ brynju · bragnar fęlldu,
 ęr ulf gráan · inni hęřđuð
 4 þar's Hamal hugði · Hundingr konungr.“

“Tell Heming that Hallow remembers
 which man in a byrnie the warriors felled.
 Ye have a grey wolf within [your halls]
 where King Hunding thought Hamble was.”

- P2 Hamall hét sonr Hagals. Hundingr konungr sendi menn til Ha-
 2 gals at leita Helga, en Helgi mátti eigi forða=sk annan veg en tók
 klęði ambáttar ok gekk at mala. Þeir leituðu ok fundu eigi Helga.
 4 Þá kvað Blindr inn bøl-vísi:

Hamble was the name of Hail's son. King Hunding sent men to Hail to look for Hallow, but Hallow could not save his life in any other way than that he

took the clothes of a bondwoman and went to grind. They looked and did not find Hallow. Then quoth Blind the bale-wise:

- 2 „Hvøss eru augu · ï Hagals þýju,
2 es=a þat karls étt · es à kvænum stændr,
stęinar rifna, · stökrk lúðr fyrir.

“Sharp are the eyes on Hail’s slave-woman;
it is not the lineage of a churl that stands by the querns;
the stones crack apart, the flour-box breaks before her!

1 Hvøss eru augu ‘Sharp are the eyes’ | For sharp eyes as a sign of class see *Vkv* 17/3, *Rþ* 19/3, 33/4, 1 *HHund* 6/3–4.

2 kvænum ‘the querns’ | The quern alluded to is a Wiking Age hand quern consisting of two stones, one fast at the base (the mill-stone) and one above it which is spun by means of a handle. Cf. *Vafþ* 23.

- 3 Nú hefir hōrð dömi · hildingr þegit
2 es vísi skal · val-bygg mala;
hēldr es sōmri · hęndi þęiri
4 meðal-kafli · an mōndul-tré.“

Now hath the prince received hard judgments,
when the chieftain shall grind Welsh barley.
It is more fitting for that hand [to hold]
the sword-pommel than the handle-stick.

P3 Hagall svaraði ok kvað:

Hail answered and quoth:

- 4 „Þat ’s litil vō · þó’tt lúðr þrumi
2 es mēr konungs · mōndul hrōrir;
hōn skęvaði · skýjum øfri
4 ok vega þorði · sęm víkingar
áðr hana Helgi · hōptu gōrði;
6 systir ’s hōn þęira · Sig-ars ok Hōgna,
því hefir øtul augu · Ylfinga man.“

“It is little woe yet that the flour-box thunders
when the king’s daughter moves the handle.
She strode forth higher than the clouds
and dared to fight like Wikings
before Hallow made her a prisoner.

She is the sister of Sigar and Hawn;
therefore the slave-girl of the Wolvings has terrible eyes.”

- P4 Undan kom=sk Helgi ok fór á her-skip. Hann felldi Hunding
2 konung ok var síðan kallaðr Helgi Hundings bani. Hann lá með
her sinn í Bruna-vágum ok hafði þar strand-hogg ok ótu þar
4 hrátt. Hogni hét konungr; hans dóttir var Sig-rún. Hón var val-
kyrja ok reið lopt ok lög; hón var Sváva endr-borin. Sig-rún reið
6 at skipum Helga ok kvað:

Hallow got away and went onto a harrying-ship. He felled King Hunding and was thereafter called Hallow Hunding's bane. He lay with his host in the Brunwaves and there raided the shores and there ate raw flesh. Hawn was the name of a king; his daughter was Syerun. She was a walkirrie and rode over air and water; she was Sweve reborn. Syerun rode alongside Hallow's ships and quoth:

- 5 „Hverir láta fljóta · flęy við bakka?
2 Hvar, hęr-męgir, · hęima ęiguð?
Hvers bíðið ęr · i Bruna-vógum?
4 Hvęrt lystir yðr · lęið at kanna?“

“TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.”

- 6 „Hamall lętr fljóta · flęy við bakka;
2 ęigum hęima · i Hlės-ęyju;
bíðum byrjar · i Bruna-vógum;
4 austr lystir oss · lęið at kanna!“

“TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.”

- 7 „Hvar hęfir, hilmir, · hildi vakða
2 ęða gęgl alin · Gunnar systra?
Hví 's brynja þín · blóði stokkin?
4 Hví skal und hjęlmum · hrátt kjöt eta?“

“TODO.

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.”

- 8 „Þat vann n^est n^ys · niðr Ylfinga
 2 fyr v^estan v^er, · ef þik vⁱta lystir,
 es ek b^jörn^u tók · i Braga-lundi
 4 ok ^ett ara · oddum sadda’k.

“TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.”

2 ef þik vita lystir ‘if thou hast lust to know’ | Formulaic b-verse, also occurring in *Helr* 2/3b, 5/2b, 6/3b.

- 9 Nú ’s sagt, mér, · hvaðan sakar g^orðu=sk,
 2 því vas á l^egi mér · lítt st^eikt etit.“

TODO.
 TODO.”

- 10 „Vig lýsir þú; · varð fyr H^elga
 2 Hundingr konungr · hníga at v^elli;
 bar sókn saman · es sefa h^efnduð
 4 ok busti blóð · á brimis eggjar.“

“TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.”

- 11 „Hvat vissir þú · at þ^eir séi,
 2 snót svinn-huguð, · es sefa h^efnduð?
 Margir ’ro hvassir · hildings synir
 4 ok á·munir · ossum niðjum.“

“TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.”

- 12 „Vas’k=a ek fjarri, · folks odd-viti,

- 2 gęř à morgun · grams aldr-lokum;
 þó tęł'k slógjan · Sig-mundar bur
 4 es ĩ val-rúnum · víg-spjǫll segir.

“TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.”

- 13 Lęit'k þik umb sinn fyrr · à lang-skipum
 2 þá's þú byggðir · blóðga stafna
 ok úr-svalar · unnir léku;
 4 nú vill dylja=sk · dǫglingr fyr mér
 en Hǫgna mér · Hęłga kęnnir.“

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.”

- P5 Gran·marr hét ríkr konungr er bjó at Svarins-haugi. Hann átti
 2 marga sonu: Hǫð·broddr, annarr Guð·mundr, þriði Starkaðr.
 Hǫð·broddr var í konunga-stefnu. Hann fastnaði sér Sig-rúnu
 4 Hǫgna dóttur en er hón spýrr þat þá reið hón með valkyrjur um
 lopt ok um lög at leita Helga.
 6 Helgi var þá at Loga-fjǫllum ok hafði barit=sk við Hundings
 sonu. Þar felldi hann þá Álf ok Eyj·ólfr, Hjør-varð ok Her·varð ok
 8 var hann all-víg-móðr ok sat undir Ara-steini. Þar hitti Sig-rún
 hann ok rann á hals hǫnum ok kyssti hann ok sagði hǫnum
 10 erendi sitt, svá sem segir í Vǫlsunga kviðu inni fornu:

TODO.

- 14 Sótti Sig-rún · sikling glaðan,
 2 hęim nam hǫn Hęłga · hǫnd at sǫkja,
 kyssti ok kvaddi · konung und hjalmi,
 4 þa varð hilmi · hugr à vífi;
 fyrr lét=sk hǫn unna · af ǫllum hug
 6 syni Sig-mundar · an hǫn sét hafði.

TODO.
 TODO.

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 15 „Vas’k Høð·broddi · ĩ hēr fōstnuð
 2 en jøfur annan · ęiga vilda’k;
 þó séumk, fylkir, · fręnda reĳði;
 4 hefi’k mĳns fōður · mun-ráð brotit.“

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 16 Nam=a Høgna mēr · umb hug męla;
 2 hafa kvað=sk hōn Hęlga · hylli skyldu.

TODO.
 TODO.

- 17 „Hirð ęigi þú · Høgna reĳði
 2 né illan hug · ęttar þĳnnar;
 þú skalt, mēr ung, · at mēr lifa;
 4 ętt átt, in gōða, · es ek séumk.“

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- P6 Helgi samnaði þá miklum skipa-her ok fór til Freka-steins ok
 2 fengu í hafi of-viðri mann-hétt. Þá kvømu leiptr yfir þá ok stóðu
 geislar í skipin. Þeir sá í lopti’nu at val-kyrjur níu riðu ok kenndu
 4 þeir Sig-rúnu. Þá légði storm’inn ok kvømu þeir heilir til lands.
 Gran-mars synir sōtu á bjargi nōkkuru er skipin sigldu at landi.
 6 Guð-mundr hljóp á hest ok reið á njósn á berg’it við hōfn’ina; þá
 hlóðu Vølsungar seglum; þá kvað Guð-mundr, svá sem fyrr er
 8 ritat í Hęlga-kviðu:

TODO.

- 18 „Hverr es fylkir · sá's flota stýrir
2 ok fçikna-lið · fçórir at landi:“

TODO.

TODO.

- P7 Sin·fjotli Sig·mundar sonr svaraði ok *er* þat enn ritat. Guð·mundr
2 reið heim með her-sögu. Þá sömnundu Gran·mars synir her;
kómu þar margir konungar. Þar var Högni, faðir Sig·rúnar, ok
4 synir hans, Bragi ok Dagr. Þar var orrusta mikil ok fellu al-
lir Gran·mars synir ok allir þeira höfðingjar nema Dagr Högna
6 sonr fekk grið ok vann eiða Volsungum. Sig·rún gekk í val'inn
ok hitti Höð-brodd at kominn dauða. Hón kvað:

TODO.

- 19 Mun=a þér, Sig·rún, · frá Sefa-fjollum,
2 Höð-broddr konungr, · hníga at armi;
liðin es évi, · opt náir hrévi
4 grán-stóð gríðar, · Gran·mars sona.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- P8 Þá hitti hón Helga ok varð all-fegin. Hann kvað:

TODO.

- 20 Es=at þér at ǫllu, · al-vitr, gefit,
2 þó kveð'k nǫkkvi · nornir valda;
fellu i morgun · at Freka-steini
4 Bragi ok Högni · —varð'k bani þeira—

TODO.

TODO.

this morning by the Freckstone fell
Bray and Hawn—I was their bane—

- 21 en at Styr·kleifum · Starkaðr konungr
2 en at Hlé·björgum · Hrol·laugs synir;

- þann sá'k gylfa · grim-úðgastan
 4 es barði=sk bolr, · vas á brot hofuð.

but at TODO King Starked,
 but at TODO, TODO's sons.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 22 Liggja at jorðu · allra flestir
 2 niðjar þínir · at nóm orðnir;
 vannt=at-tu vígi, · vas þér þat skapat
 4 at þú at rógi · rík-menni vart.

Upon the earth lie nearly all
 of thy kinsmen, become corpses.
 TODO.
 TODO.

1 jorðu | Jór 'Jordan'

- P9 Þá grét Sig-rún. Hann kvað:

Then Syerun wept. Quoth he:

- 23 „Hugga=sk-tu, Sig-rún! · Hildr hefir þú oss verit;
 2 vinna=t skjöldungar sköpum.“
 „Lifna mynda'k nú kjósa · es liðnir eru
 4 ok knétta'k þér þó i fæðmi fela=sk.“

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- P10 Þetta kvað Guð-mundr, Gran-mars sonr:

This quoth Godmund, Granmer's son:

- 24 „Hverr es skjöldungr · sá's skipum stýrir,
 2 léttr gunn-fana · gollinn fyr stafni?
 Þikkja mér friðr · i farar broddi;
 4 verpr víg-roða · umb víkinga.“

TODO.
 TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- Sin-fjötli kvað: **25** „Hér má Hǫð-broddr · Hęłga ķenna
 2 flótta trauðan · i flota miðjum;
 hann hęfir ęðli · ęttar þinnar,
 4 arf fjorsunga, · und sik þrungit.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 26** Því fyrr skulu · at Freka-steini
 2 sáttir saman · umb sakar dǫma;
 mál es, Hǫð-broddr, · hęfnd at vinna
 4 ef vér lęgra hlut · lęngi bǫrum.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 27** Fyrr munt, Guð-mundr, · gęitr of halda
 2 ok berg-skorar · brattar klifa,
 hafa þér i hęndi · hęsli-kylfu;
 4 þat 's þér blíðara · an brimis dǫmar.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 28** „Þér es, Sin-fjötli, · sǫmra myklu
 2 gunni at hęjja · ok glaða ǫrnu
 an ǫ-nýtum · orðum at dęila
 4 þó'tt hildingar · hęiptir dęili.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 29 Þikki=t mér góðir · Gran·mars synir,
 2 þó dugir siklingum · satt at mēla,
 þeir merkt hafa · à Móins-heimum
 4 at hug hafa · hjörum at brægða;
 eru hildingar · hældsti snjallir.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- P11 Helgi fekk Sig-rúnar ok öttu þau sonu; var Helgi eigi gamall.
 2 Dagr Høgna sonr blótaði Óðin til fǫður-hefnda. Óðinn léði
 Dag geirs síns. Dagr fann Helga, mág sinn, þar sem heitir at
 4 Fjöturlundi. Hann lagði í gognum Helga með geir'num. Þar
 fell Helgi, en Dagr reið til fjalla ok sagði Sig-rúnu tíðindi:

Hallow got Syerun for a wife and they had sons; Hallow was not old. Day, Hawn's son, made a bloot to Weden for the sake of avenging his father. Weden lent Day his spear. Day found Hallow, his brother-in-law, at the place called Fetterlund; he ran Hallow through with the spear. There fell Hallow, but Day rode to the fells and told Syerun the news:

- 30 „Trauðr em'k, systir, · trega þér at segja
 2 því't ek hefí nauðigr · nipti gróttu:
 Fell i morgun · und Fjöturlundi
 4 buðlungr sá's vas · bætstr i heimi
 ok hildingum · à halsi stóð.“

“Regretful am I, sister, to grieve thee by saying it—
 for, forced, must I make my kinswoman weep:
 this morning fell in Fetterlund
 that noble who was the best in the world
 and on the throats of princes stood.”

- [Sig-rún kvað:] 31 „Þik skyli allir · eiðar bíta,
 2 þeir es Hēlga · hafðir unna,
 at inu ljósa · Lēiptrar vatni
 4 ok at úr-svǫlum · Unnar steini!

“Thee should all oaths bite,
 which thou to Hallow hast sworn,
 by the shining water of Lafter,

and by the spray-cold stone of Ithe.

- 32 Skríði=at þat skip, · es und þér skríði,
2 þó'tt óska-byrr · eptir leggi=sk!
 Renni=a sá marr, · es und þér renni,
4 þó'tt fiendr þína · forða=sk eigr!

May the ship not glide which glides beneath thee,
although it has a wished-for gust behind it!
May the horse not run which runs beneath thee,
although from thy foes thou must escape!

- 33 Bíti=a þér þat sverð, · es þú bręðir,
2 nema sjölfum þér · syngvi of hofði!
 Þá véri þér hefnt · Hēlga dauða,
4 ef þú vérrir vargr · á viðum úti,
 auðs and-vani · ok alls gamans,
6 hefðir eigi mat, · nema á hréum spryngir!“

May the sword not bite for thee which thou brandishest,
unless it sing around thy very own head!
Then were on thee Hallow's death avenged,
if thou wert a wolf in the woods outside,
bereft of wealth and all pleasure;
hadst no food, save thou plundered carrion!“

- Dagr kvað: 34 „Ór est, systir, · ok ør-vita,
2 es bróðr þínum · biðr for-skapa!
 Einn veldr Óðinn · öllu þölví,
4 því't með sífjungum · sak-rúnar bar!

Quoth Day: “Mad art thou, sister, and out of thy wits,
when onto thy brother thou dost bid a cruel shape!
Alone is Weden at fault for all evil
for he carried strife-runes amidst kin!

1 Ór ... ok ør-viti ‘Mad ... and out of thy wits’ | Formulaic, also occurring in *Lok* 21/1 and *Oddr* 15/1.

3 Einn veldr Óðinn · öllu þölví ‘Alone is Weden at fault for all evil’ | Formulaic, also occurring (with other names than *Óðinn* ‘Weden’) at *I Guðr* 25/2 and *Sigsk* 27/4.

- 35 Þér býðr bróðir · bauga rauða,
2 öll Vandils-vé · ok Víg-dali;

- haf halfan hëim · harms at gjöldum
 4 brúðr baug-varið · ok burir þinir.

Thy brother offers thee red bighs,
 all Wendelswigh and the Wighdales.
 Have half the realm as restitution for the harm—
 O bigh-adorned bride, and thy sons also.

- 36 „Sir'k=a svá sél · at Sefa-fjollum,
 2 ár né of nętr, · at ek una lífi,
 nema at liði loðungs · ljóma bręgði,
 4 renni und vísa · Vig-blęr þinig,
 goll-bitli vanr, · knega'k grami fagna!

“I will not sit so happy in the Sevefells,
 by morning nor night, that I should be content with my life
 unless the troop of the praised man splendidly shone,
 [and] beneath the ruler Wighblaw ran hither,
 wont to the golden bit—[and] I might greet the prince!

- 37 Svá hafði Hęlgi · hrędda gęrva
 2 fjándr sína alla · ok fręndr þęira,
 sem fyr ulfi · óðar rynni
 4 gęitr af fjalli, · gęiska fullar!

So would Hallow have terrified
 his enemies all and their kinsmen,
 like from a wolf did madly rush
 goats down a fell, full of fright.

- 38 Svá bar Hęlgi · af hildingum
 2 sem ítr-skapaðr · askr af þyrni
 eða sá dýr-kalfr · dęggu slunginn
 4 es øfri fęrr · ęllum dýrum,
 ok horn glóa · við himin sjalfan.“

So did Hallow surpass the princes
 like the nobly shaped ash the thorn,
 or the deer-calf, dew-besprinkled,
 which fares higher than all beasts,
 and its horns gleam against heaven itself.”

P12 Haugr var gorr eptir Helga. En er hann kom til Val-hallar, þá
 2 bauð Óðinn hönnum öllu at ráða með sér. Helgi kvað:

A barrow was made for Hallow. But when he came to Walhall Weden offered him to rule everything together with him. Quoth Hallow:

39 „Þú skalt, Hundingr, · hverjum manni
 2 fót-laug geta · ok funa kynda;
 hunda binda, · hesta gæta,
 4 gefa svinum soð, · áðr sofa gangir!“

“Thou shalt, Hunding, for every man
 make a foot-bath and kindle the fire,
 bind the hounds, feed the horses,
 give wastewater to the swine—before thou mightst go to sleep!”

P13 Ambótt Sig-rúnar gekk um aptan hjá haugi Helga ok sá at Helgi
 2 reið til haugs’ins með marga menn. Ambótt kvað:

Syerun’s maid-servant walked in the evening by Hallow’s barrow and saw that Hallow rode to the barrow with many men. Quoth the maid-servant:

40 „Hvart ’ro þat svik ein · es séa þikkjumk
 2 eða ragna rök · ríða menn dauðir,
 es jóa yðra · oddum keyrið,
 4 eða es hildingum · hēim-för gefin?“

“Either these are only tricks, as I seem to see
 —or the Rakes of the Reins?—dead men riding;
 as ye drive your steeds by spear-points on—
 or are the princes granted leave to go home?”

[Einn þeira kvað:] **41** „Es=a þat svik ein · es séa þikki=sk
 2 né aldar rof · þótt-u oss lítir,
 þótt vér jóa óra · oddum keyrim,
 4 né es hildingum · hēim-för gefin.“

[Quoth one of them:] “It is not only tricks, as thou seemest to see—
 nor the Ripping of the Age, although thou behold us;
 although we drive our steeds by spear-points on
 the princes are not granted leave to go home.”

2 aldar rof ‘Ripping of the Age’ | Formulaic. Cf. TODO *rjúfa=sk regin*. This is the same root, only zero-grade.

P14 Heim gekk ambótt ok sagði Sig-rúnu:

The maid-servant went home and said to Syerun:

- 42 „Út gakk Sig-rún, · frá Sęfa-fjöllum
 2 ef þik folks jaðarr · finna lystir;
 upp 's haugr lokinn, · kominn es Hęlgi!
 4 Dólg-spor dreýra · döglingr bað þik
 at þú sár-dropa · svęfja skyldir.“

“Go outside, Syerun from the Sevefells,
 if thou hast lust to find the leader of the troop—
 the barrow is unlocked; Hallow is come!
 The ruler of bloody wounds bade thee
 that thou his wound-drops [BLOOD] shouldst calm.”

P15 Sig-rún gekk í haug'inn til Helga ok kvað:

Syerun walked into Hallow's barrow, and quoth:

- 43 „Nú em'k svá fęgin · fundi okkrum
 2 sem át-frękir · Óðins haukar
 es val vitu, · varmar bráðir,
 4 eða dōgg-litir · dags-brún séa.“

“Now do I so rejoice at our meeting
 like the ravenous hawks of Weden [RAVENS]
 when they know corpses, warm carrion,
 or, gleaming with dew, they see the day's brow [DAWN]!”

- 44 Fyrr vil'k kyssa · konung ó·lifðan
 2 an þú blóðugri · brynju kastir;
 hár 's þitt, Hęlgi, · hėlu þrungit,
 4 allr es vísi · val-dōgg slęinn,
 hęndr úr-svalar · Hōgna mági;
 6 hvé skal'k þér, buðlungr, · þess bót of vinna?“

Sooner would I kiss the unliving king,
 than thou the bloody byrnie mightst cast away!
 Thy hair is, Hallow, with hoarfrost thick;
 the prince is all with corpse-dew [BLOOD] whipped;
 the hands spray-cold on Hawn's in-law [= Hallow]—
 how shall I for thee, noble, remedy that?”

4 allr es vísí · val-dögg slęinn ‘the prince is all with corpse-dew whipped’ | Cf. *Bdr* 5, where the dead wallow says something similar.

- [Hęłgi kvað:] 45 „Eín vęldr þú, Sig-rún · frá Sefafjollum,
 2 es Hęłgi es · harm-dögg slęinn:
 Grętr þú, goll-varið, · grimmum tórum,
 4 sól-björt suð-rón, · áðr þú sofa gangir,
 hvert fellr blóðugt · à brjósti grami,
 6 úr-svalt, inn-fjalgt · ękka þrungit.
- “Thou alone causest, Syerun from the Sevefells,
 that Hallow be with harm-dew whipped.
 Thou weepest—gold-covered—bitter tears—
 sun-bright southern lady—before thou goest to sleep.
 Each one falls bloody on the prince’s chest,
 spray-cold, stifled, pressed forth by grief.

- 46 Vęl skulum drekka · dýrar vęigar
 2 þó’tt misst hafim · munar ok landa!
 Skal ęngi maðr · angr-ljóð kveða
 4 þó’tt mér à brjósti · bęnjar líti.
 Nú eru brúðir · byrgðar í haugi,
 6 lofða dísir, · hjá oss liðnum!“

Well shall we drink costly draughts
 although we may have lost both love and land!
 No one shall sing songs of sorrow,
 although he behold the wounds on my chest.
 Now are the brides shut within the barrow,
 the praised one’s dises, next to us, passed-on.”

5–6 brúðir, dísir, oss ‘brides, dises, us’ | Hallow speaks in the plural. “Now has my bride, my goddess, come into the barrow, next to me, who am dead.”

P16 Sig-rún bjó sęing í haug’inum.

Syerun made a bed in the barrow:

- 47 „Hér hęfi’k þér, Hęłgi, · hvílu gørva,
 2 angr-lausa mjök, · Ylfinga niðr;
 vil’k þér í faðmi, · fylkir, sofna
 4 sem’k lofðungi · lifnum mynda’k!“

“Here I’ve for thee, Hallow, made a place of rest
almost sorrowless, kinsman of the Wolvings!
I will in thy arms, marshal, fall asleep,
like I would with the living man of praise.”

4 sem’k loðungi · lifnum mynda’k! ‘like I would with the living man of praise’ | I.e. “just as I would if you were still alive.”

[Hēlgi kvað:] 48 „Nú kveð’k ęns-kis · ęr-vęnt vesa,
2 sįđ né snimma, · at Sefa-fjollum
es þú á armi · ę-lifðum sęfr,
4 hvit, i haugi, · Hęgna dóttir,
ok est-u kvik, · in konung-bornal“

[Quoth Hallow:] “Now, I say, there is naught more missing
neither late nor soon from the Sevefells,
when thou sleepest on the unliving arm
(O white daughter of Hawn) in the barrow—
and thou art alive! (borne of the king).”

[Hēlgi kvað:] 49 „Mál ’s mér at rįða · roðnar brautir,
2 láta fęlvan jó · flug-stig troða;
skal’k fyr vestan · vind-hjals brúar
4 áðr Sal-gofnir · sigr-þjóð vęki.“

“It is time for me to ride the reddening roads,
to let my pale steed tread the path of flight [SKY/HEAVEN].
I must be west of the wind-helm’s bridges [SKY/HEAVEN > CLOUDS?]
before Salgovner awakens the victorious folk.”

ALL | The night has passed; dawn is breaking, and Hallow speaks. The manuscript does not indicate the change of scene.

1 roðnar ‘reddening’ | From the rising dawn.

P17 Þęir Hęlgi riðu leið sína, en þęr fóru hęim til bójar. Annan aptan
2 lét Sig-rún ambótt halda vęrð á haugi’num. En at dag-setri, es
Sig-rún kom til haugs’ins, hón kvað:

Hallow and his men rode on their way, but the women journeyed home to the farm. The next evening Syerun made her maid-servant keep watch on the barrow. And at sunset as Syerun came to the barrow, quoth she [= the maid-servant]:

50 „Kominn vęri nú, · ef koma hygðoi,

- 2 Sig-mundar burr · frá solum Óðins;
 kveð'k grams þinig · gręna=sk vånir
 4 es á ask-limum · ęrnir sitja
 ok drífr drótt ęll · draum-þinga til.“

“He would be come by now if he had thought to come,
 Syemund's son [= Hallow] from Weden's halls.
 I say, hopes are fading of the prince's coming
 when on ashen branches eagles sit,
 and all mankind drifts off to dream-Things.

4 es á ask-limum · ęrnir sitja ‘when on ashen branches eagles sit’ | I.e., “when the eagles roost on yonder trees”. This is a sign of Hallow and his men not coming; if they were, the eagles would be following them and picking at their bodies.

5 drífr ... draum-þinga til ‘drifts off to dream-Things’ | Drifts off to the courts of dreams, i.e., falls asleep. A fine metaphor.

- 51 Ves ęigi svá ór · at ęin farir,
 2 dís skjöldunga, · draug-húsa til!
 Verða ęflgari · allir á nótturn
 4 đauðir dólgar, mér, · an of daga ljósa.“

Be not so mad that thou journey alone,
 O dise of the Shieldings, to the ghost-houses!
 Mightier at night do all become
 dead fiends, maiden, than during the bright days!”

- P18 Sig-rún varð skamm-líf af harmi ok trega. Þat var trúa í for-
 2 neskju, at menn vęri endr-bornir, en þat er nú kęlluð kerlinga-
 villa. Helgi ok Sig-rún er kallat at vęri endr-borin. Hét hann þá
 4 Helgi Haddingja-skati en hón Kára Hálfdanar dóttir, svá sem
 kveðit er í Kęru ljóðum, ok var hón val-kyrja.

Syerun became short-lived for pain and grief. It was the belief in olden times that men were reborn, but that is now called an old wives' tale. Of Hallow and Syerun it is claimed that they were reborn. He was then called Hallow Hardingskate and she Cheer Halfdanesdaughter, as is told in the Leeds of Cheer, and she was a walkirrie.

1–2 Þat var trúa í forneskju ‘It was the belief in olden times’ | For another instance of beliefs in *forneskju* ‘olden times, antiquity’, see *Fáfn* Pl.

5 Kęru ljóðum ‘Leeds of Cheer’ | A now-lost heroic poem.

Spae of Griper

(*Grípis spó*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): early C11th (0.616)–late C11th (0.313).

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Spae of Griper** (abbrev. *Gríp*) is a fairly long poem dealing with the life of Siward. It essentially serves as a summary of the entire Walsing-cycle from Siward's life onwards.

Textual preservation and transmission

Gríp is only preserved in **R**, where it is found on foll. 26v/19–28v/29.

Meter

The meter is strict Ancient-words-law. Anacrusis is occasionally allowed (3/2b, 45/3a). No half-lines of type A3 appear in the b-verse.

The length of the stanza is unusually regular; indeed, every single one of the 53 Ancient-words-law stanzas is exactly four lines long, something otherwise attained only by the much shorter 3 *Guðr*.

Style

The poem is very formal and comes off as a product of late learning.

Dating

Although Sapp (2022)'s model arrives at a most probable early C11th date for the poem, its results cannot take precedence over reliable linguistic diagnostic criteria.

A convincing explanation for the metrical regularity of *Gríp* is that the poem has not been transmitted for very long before ending up in the archetype to the heroic half of **R**.

Numerous traits speak to a late date for *Gríp*. The poem displays hiatus contraction, which is not found in Scaldic poetry older than ca. 1150. It also has four metrically required occurrences of the short form *Sig-urðr* (16/3, 24/2, 40/2, 53/4), a form which is not found in any other Eddic poem apart from *Hdl*, another likely late composition (Sievers 1889, pp. 138–139).

Together these two traits point convincingly towards composition in the late 12th c.

Text

Frá dauða Sin-fjötla ('From the Death of Sinfittle')

P1 Sig-mundr Volsungs sonr var konungr á Frakk-landi. Sin-fjötli
 2 var eldstr hans sona, annarr Helgi, þriðji Há-mund*r. Borg-hildir,
 kona Sig-mundar, átti bróður er hét ... En Sin-fjötli, stjúp-sonr
 4 hennar, ok ... báðu einnar konu báðir ok fyr þá sók drap Sin-fjötli
 hann. En er hann kom heim þá bað Borg-hildir hann fara á
 6 brot en Sig-mundr bauð henni fé-bótr ok þat varð hón at þig-
 gja. En at erfi'nu bar Borg-hildir ǫl. Hón tók eittr mikitt, horn
 8 fullt, ok bar Sin-fjötla. En er hann sá í horn'it skilði hann at
 eittr var í ok mēlti til Sig-mundar: „Gjör-ótttr er drykk'rinn, ái!“
 10 Sig-mundr tók horn'it ok drakk af. Svá er sagt at Sig-mundr var
 harð-gǫrr at hvár-ki mátti hánnum eittr granda útan né innan. En
 12 allir synir hans stóðu=sk eittr á hǫrund útan. Borg-hildir bar an-
 nat horn Sin-fjötla ok bað drekka ok fór allt sem fyrr. Ok enn
 14 it þriðja sinn bar hón hánnum horn'it ok þó á-mēlis-orð með ef
 hann drykki eigi af. Hann mēlti enn sem fyrr við Sig-mund;
 16 hann sagði: „Lát-tu grǫn sía þá, sonr!“ Sin-fjötli drakk ok varð
 þegar dauðr. Sig-mundr bar hann langar leiðir í fangi sér ok
 18 kom at firði einum mjóvum ok lǫngum ok var þar skip eitt lítit
 ok maðr einn á. Hann bauð Sig-mundi far of fjörð'inn. En er
 20 Sig-mundr bar lík'it út á skip'it þá var bát'rinn hlaðinn. Karl
 mēlti at Sig-mundr skyldi fara fyr inn á fjörð'inn. Karl hratt
 22 út skip'inu ok hvarf þegar. Sig-mundr konungr dvalði=sk lengi
 í Danmǫrk í ríki Borg-hildar síðan er hann fekk hennar. Fór
 24 Sig-mundr þá suðr í Frakk-land til þess ríkis er hann átti þar.
 Þá fekk hann Hjör-dísar, dóttur Ey-lima konungs. Þeira sonr
 26 var Sig-urðr. Sig-mundr konungr fell í orrustu fyr Hundings
 sonum. En Hjör-dís gipti=sk þá Álf, syni Hjalp-reks konungs.
 28 Óx Sig-urðr þar upp í barn-ósku. Sig-mundr ok allir synir hans
 vóru langt um fram alla menn aðra um afl ok vǫxt ok hug ok alla
 30 at-görvi. Sig-urðr var þá allra framarstr ok hann kalla allir menn
 í forn-fróðum um alla menn fram ok gǫfgastan her-konunga.

Syemund, Walsing's son, was a king in Frankland. Sinfittle was the eldest of his sons, the other Hallow, the third Highmund. Burhild, Syemund's wife, had a brother whose name was ... But Sinfittle, her stepson, and ... both asked for the hand of a single woman, and for that reason Sinfittle slew him. But when he came home Burhild bade him go away, but Syemund offered her

restitutory money and she had to accept it. But at the wake Burhild brought forth the ale. She took much venom, a full horn, and brought it to Sinfittle. But when he looked into the horn he understood that there was venom in it, and said to Syemund: "Treacherous is this drink, father!" Syemund took the horn and drank it up. So it is said that Syemund was sturdy enough that venom could not injure him from without nor within. But all his sons [only] withstood venom on the skin without. Burhild brought another horn to Sinfittle and bade him drink, and everything passed as before. And once more a third time she brought him the horn, and yet with accusatory words if he would not drink it up. He spoke as before with Syemund; he said: "Let thy whisker-hairs sieve it, son!" Sinfittle drank and was shortly dead. Syemund bore him through long journeys in his arms and came to a single firth, narrow and long, and thereat there was one little ship and one man on it. He offered Syemund passage around the firth. But when Syemund bore the body out into the ship then the boat was fully loaded. The churl said that Syemund should journey further inland along the firth. The churl pushed out the ship and shortly disappeared. King Syemund stayed for a long time in Denmark in Burhild's realm after he got her hand. Then Syemund journeyed south into Frankland to the realm he owned there. Then he got the hand of Hardise, the daughter of King Eanlime. Their son was Siward. King Syemund fell in battle at the hands of the sons of Hunding. But Hardise was then given to Atholf, the son of King Helpric. There Siward grew up in his childhood. Syemund and all his sons were far ahead of all other men in strength and size and thought and all accomplishments. Siward was furthest of them all, and in ancient sources men call him ahead of all men and the most worshipful of raiding kings.

2 Há·mund**r* | Hámundir R 3 ... | *An unfilled gap for a lost name is clearly indicated in R* 4
... | *A gap is indicated in R*

- P2 Grípir hét sonr Ey·lima, bróðir Hjor·dísar. Hann réð lǫndum ok
2 vas allra manna vitrastr ok fram-víss. Sig·urðr reið einn saman
ok kom til hallar Grípis. Sig·urðr vas auð-keन्द्र. Hann hitti
4 mann at máli úti fyr hǫll'inni; sá nefndi=sk Geitir. Þá kvaddi
Sig·urðr hann máls, ok spyrr:

Griper was the name of Eanlime's son, Hardise's brother. He ruled lands and was of all men the smartest, and forthwise. Siward rode alone and came to Griper's hall; Siward was easily recognized. He went up to speak to a man outside of the hall; that one called himself Goater. Then Siward greeted him with speech, and asks:

Grípis spó ('The Spae of Griper')

- 1 „Hverr byggir hér · borgir þessar?

- 2 Hvat þann þjóð-konung · þegnar nefna?“
 „Grípir heitir · gumna stjóri,
 4 sá's fastri rēðr · foldu ok þegnum.“

“WHO DWELLS HERE in these strongholds?
 What is this great king called by thanes?”
 “Griper is the name of the steerer of men
 who rules the steadfast land and thanes.”

2 þjóð-konung ‘great king’ | An old poetic word, cognate with OE *þeod-cyning* ‘id.’, OS *þiud-kuning* ‘id.’ The first element is most likely to be equated with Gothic *þiupi-* ‘good’ (in *þiupi-qiss* ‘blessing’, calquing Greek εὐλογία, Streitberg 1910, s.v. *þiupi-qiss*) rather than Gothic *þiuda* ‘people, tribe’, ON *þjóð* ‘id.’, OE *þeod* ‘id.’

Its distribution in ON poetry is not altogether neutral. In the Poetic Edda it appears, outside of the present poem, in *Sigsk* 35/3, 36/4, *Akv* 47/3, *Gbv* 14/2, and *Hamð* 4/1, all likely old poems. In Scaldic poetry it appears in the early *Yt* 22 (ca. 850 CE) and *Gldr* 7 (ca. 900 CE), but appears to have been proscribed in the formal praise poetry of the 10th and earliest 11th century until it was revived by Sighvat Thurfrithson in the 1010s, from which point it is found in praise poetry until the extinction of the tradition in the 13th c. In apocryphal Eddic poetry the word only appears in *HljQ* 19 and Gunnleif *Merl* I 58 (both in SkP 8).

- 2 „Es horskr konungr · hēima i landi?
 Mun sá gramr við mik · ganga at mēla?
 Máls es þarfi · maðr ó-kunnigr,
 4 vil’k fljót=liga · finna Grípi.“

“Is the wise king at home in the land?
 Will that chief go to speak with me?
 This foreign man is in need of speech;
 I wish shortly to find Griper.”

- 3 „Þess mun glaðr konungr · Gēiti spyrja
 2 hvęrr sá maðr sé · es máls kveðr Grípi.“
 „Sig-urðr ek heiti, · borinn Sig-mundi
 4 en Hjor-dís es · hilmis móðir.“

“TODO.
 TODO.”
 “TODO.
 TODO”

- 4 Þá gekk Gētir · Grípi at segja:
 2 „Hér’s maðr úti · ó-kuðr kominn;
 hann ’s ítar=ligr · at á·liti;
 4 sá vill, fylkir, · fund þinn hafa.“

TODO.
 “TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO”

- 5 Gęngr ór **skála** · **skatna** dróttinn
 2 ok **hęilsar** vel · **hilmi** komnum:
 „Þigg þú hér, **Sig-urðr**, · **vęri sęmra** fyrr!
 4 En þú, **Gętir**, tak · við **Grana** sjölfum.“

TODO.
 TODO.
 “TODO.
 TODO”

- 6 **Męla** nęmu · ok **margt** hjala
 2 þá's **rǣð**-spakir · **rekkar** fundu=sk.
 „Sęg-ðu **męr** ef þú vęizt, · **móður**-bróðir,
 4 hvę mun **Sig-urði** · **snúna** ęvi?“

They took to speak and chatter much,
 when the council-wise champions found each other.
 “Tell me, if thou knowest, O mother's brother:
 how will Siward's age turn out?”

- 7 „Þú munt **maðr** vesa · **mętstr** und sólu
 2 ok **hęstr** borinn · **hverjum** jęfri;
 gjęfull af **golli** · ęn **glęggr** flugar,
 4 **ítr** **ǣ**-liti · ok **ĩ** orðum spakr.“

„Thou wilt be a man noblest beneath the sun,
 and born higher than every ruler,
 giving with gold but stingy of flight,
 radiant of hue and wise in words.“

- 8 „Sęg **gęgn** konungr · **gęrr** an ek spyrja
 2 **snotr** **Sig-urði** · ef þú **sja** þikki=sk,
 hvát mun **fyrst** gęra=sk · til **farnaðar**
 4 þá's ór **garði** em'k · **gęginn** þinum?“

“TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.”

TODO”

- 9 „Fyrst munt fylkir · fǫður of hefna
 2 ok Ey·lima · alls harms reka;
 þú munt harða · Hundings sonu
 4 snjalla fella— · munt sigr hafa.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 10 „Sæg itr konungr · éttingi mér
 2 hēldr horsk=liga · es vit hugat mēlum;
 sér þú Sig·urðar · snor brögð fyrir
 4 þau's hēst fara · und himin-skautum?“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 11 „Munt einn vega · orm inn frána
 2 þann's grǫðugr liggr · à Gnita-hēiði;
 þú munt bǫðum · at bana verða
 4 Regin ok Fáfni; · rétt segir Grípir.“

“Thou alone wilt slay the gleaming Wyrms
 which lies greedy on the Gnit-heath.
 Thou wilt be the bane of them both:
 Rein and Fathomer—rightly speaks Griper.”

- 12 „Auðr mun órinn · ef efli'k svá
 2 víg með virðum · sem þú visst segir;
 leið at huga · ok lengi seg
 4 hvat mun einn vesa · évi minnar?“

“The wealth will be ample if I accomplish such
 a triumph amongst men as thou sayest for certain.

TODO.

TODO”

- 13 „Þú munt finna · Fáfnis bóli
 2 ok upp taka · auð inn fagra,
 golli hlóða · á Grana bógu;
 4 ríðr til Gjúka · gramr víg-risinn.“

“Thou wilt find Fathomer’s dwelling
 and take up the fair wealth,
 load the gold on Grane’s shoulders;
 thou wilt ride to Yivick a triumph-sure man.”

- 14 „Ænn skalt hilmi · i hugaðs-róðu
 2 fram-lyndr jöfurr · flëira sęgja;
 gęstr em’k Gjúka · ok ek gęng þaðan,
 4 hvat mun ęnn vesa · ęvi minnar?“

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO

- 15 „Søfr á fjalli · fylkis dóttir
 2 björt i brynju · ęptir bana Hęlga;
 þú munt hoggva · hvøssu sverði,
 4 brynju rista · með bana Fáfnis.“

“On the fell sleeps the marshaller’s daughter,
 bright in a byrnie, after Hallow’s killing.
 Thou wilt cut it with a sharp sword,
 carve up the byrnie with Fathomer’s bane.”

4 bana Fáfnis ‘Fathomer’s bane’ | Viz. the sword Riddle; cf. *Fifin* P3.

- 16 „Brotin es brynja · brúðr męla tękr
 2 es vaknaði · víf ór svefni;
 hvat mun snót at hęldr · við Sig-urð męla
 4 þat ’s at farnaði · fylki verði?“

“Broken is the byrnie; the bride takes to speak,
 the woman who awakened from her sleep.
 TODO.
 TODO”

- 17 „Höf mun ríkjum þér · rúnar kęnna

- 2 allar þér's aldir · ęigna=sk skyldu
ok á manns tungu · męla hverja;
4 lif með lękning · lif heill konungr!“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO

- 18 „Þá's því lokit · numin eru fróði
2 ok em braut þaðan · búinn at ríða;
lęið at huga · ok lęngra sęg
4 hvat mun męirr vesa · minnar ęvi?“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO

1 Þá's því lokit · numin eru fróði | Alliteration is missing from this line and no obvious emendation can be found.

- 19 „Þú munt hitta · Hęimis bygðir
2 ok glaðr vera · gęstr þjóð-konungs;
farit es Sig-urðr · þat's ek fyr·vissa'k,
4 skal=a fręmr an svá · fregna Grípi.“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO

- 20 „Nú fór mér ękka · orð þat's męltir
2 því't langt fram of sér · fylkir lęngra;
veitst of·mikit · angr Sig-urði,
4 því þú Grípír þat · gørra sęgja!“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO

- 21 „Lá mer umb ęsku · ęvi þinnar
2 ljósast fyrir · lita ęptir;

- rétt em'k=a ek · ráð-spakr taliðr
 4 ne in heldr fram-víss · farit þat's ek víska'k."

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 22 „Mann væt'k engi · fyr mold ofan
 2 þann's flæira sé · fram an þú Grípir;
 skal=at lęyna · þó'tt ljótt sér
 4 eða meın gori=sk · à mīnum hag."

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 23 „Es=a með lǫstum · lǫð ęvi þér;
 2 lát-tu, inn ítri, · þat, ǫðlingr, nema=sk,
 því at uppi mun · meðan ǫld lifir,
 4 nadd-ęls boði, · nafn þitt vera."

"With vices is thy age not laid out;
 let thyself, radiant athling, take that to heart,
 for remembered will while mankind lives,
 O beseecher of the sword-storm [BATTLE > WARRIOR], thy name be!"

- 24 „Verst hyggjum því · verðr at skilja=sk
 2 Sig-urðr við fylki · at só-gǫru.
 lęið vísa þú · lagt 's allt fyrir,
 4 mér, mér ef þú vilt · móður bróðir."

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 25 „Nú skal Sig-urði · sęgja gǫrva
 2 alls þęngill mik · til þęss neyðir.
 munt víst vita · at vęt-ki lýgr.
 4 dógr ęitt es þér · dauði ętlaðr."

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 26 „Vil'k=at ek **r**ęiði · **r**íks þjóð-konungs
 2 **g**óð-ráðs at * hęldr · **G**rípis þiggja;
 nú vill **v**íst **v**ita · þó'tt **v**ilkit sé
 4 hvat á **s**ynt **S**ig-urðr · **s**ér fyr hęndum.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 27 „Fljóð 's at Hęimis · **f**agrt à·litum.
 2 hana **B**ryn·hildi · **b**ragnar nęfna.
dóttir Buðla · en **d**yrr konungr
 4 **h**arð-úgðigt man · **H**ęimir fóðir.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 28 „Hvat 's **m**ik at því · þó'tt **m**ęr sé
 2 **f**ęgr à·liti · **f**ódd at Hęimis?
 Þat skalt **G**rípir · **g**ęrva sęja
 4 því't þú **ę**ll of sér · **ę**r·log fyrir.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 29 „Hęn **f**irrir þik · **f**leştu gamni
 2 **f**ęgr à·liti · **f**óstra Hęimis;
svefn þú né **s**ęfr · né umb **s**akar dęmir
 4 gær=a þú **m**anna · nema þú **m**ęy sér.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 30 „Hvat mun til líkna · lagt Sig-urði
 2 sęg Grípir þat · ef sjá þikki=sk.
 mun'k męy ná · mundi kaupa
 4 þa ina fęgru · fylkis dóttur.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 31 „It munuð alla · ęiða vinna
 2 full fast=liga— · fā munuð halda;
 vesit hęfir þú Gjúka · gęstr ęina nót
 4 mant=at horska · Hęimis fóstru.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 32 „Hvart 's þa Grípir · gętt þess fyr mér
 2 sér þú gęð=leysi · ĩ grams skapi
 es skal við męy þa · mólum slíta
 4 es alls hugar · unna þóttumk.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 33 „Þú verður siklingr · fyr svikum annars
 2 munt Grím·hildar · gjalda ráða;
 mun bjóða þér · bjart-haddat man
 4 dóttur sína · dregr hön vel at gram.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 34 „Mun'k við þa Gunn·ar · gęrva hleyti
 2 ok Guð·rúnu · ganga at ęiga
 full-kvēni þa · fylkir vēri

4 ef męin-tregar · męr angraði-t.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

35 „Þik mun Grím·hildr · gǫrva véla
2 mun hǫn Bryn·hildar · biðja fýsa
Gunn·ari til handa · Gotna dróttni
4 heitr þú fljót=liga fǫr · fylkis móður.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

36 „Męin eru fyr hǫndum · má'k líta þat
2 ratar gǫr=liga · ráð Sig·urðar,
ef ek skal męrrar · męyjar biðja
4 ǫðrum til handa · þęirar ek unna vel.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

37 „Ér munuð allir · ęiða vinna
2 Gunn·arr ok Hǫgni · en þú gramr þriði,
því't litum víxla · es á leið eruð
4 Gunn·arr ok þú— · Grípir lýgr ęigi.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

38 „Hví gegnir þat · hví skulum skipta
2 litum ok lǫtum · es á leið erum.
þar mun flá-róði · fylgja annat
4 atalt með ǫllu— · ęnn sęg Grípir!“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

39 „Lit hefir þú Gunn·ars · ok létu hans.

2 mǣlsku þína · ok megin-hyggjur;

munt fastna þér · fram-lundaða

4 fóstru Heimis · sér vǣtr fyr því.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

40 „Verst hyggjum því · vándr mun’k heitinn

2 Sig·urðr með seggjum · at só·göru.

vilda’k eigi · vélum bæta

4 jöfra brúðr · es óðsta vǣt’k.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

41 „Þú munt hvíla, · hǣrs odd-viti,

2 mǣrr hjá meyju · sem þin móðir sé;

því mun uppi · meðan ǫld lifir,

4 þjóðar þengill, · þitt nafn vera.

“Thou wilt lie, O point-knower of the host [WARRIOR],
famous, beside the maiden like she were thy mother.

For that will remembered while mankind lives,

O prince of the nation, thy name be.

42 Saman munu bru·llaup · bæði drukkin

2 Sig·urðar ok Gunn·ars · i sǫlum Gjúka;

þá hǫmum víxlið · es it heim komið,

4 hefir hvǣrr fyr því · hyggju sína.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 43 „Mun góða kvón · Gunn·arr ęiga
 2 męrr með mōnnum, · —mér sęg Grípír!—
 þótt hafi þrjár nętr · þęgns brúðr hjá mér
 4 snar-lynd sofit? · S·líks eru-t dōmi!

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 44 Hvé mun at ynði · ęptir verða
 2 męğð með mōnnum? · Mér sęg Grípír!
 Mun Gunn·ari · til gamans ráðit
 4 síðan verða · eða sjölfum mér?“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 45 „Minnir þik ęiða · mátt þęgja þó
 2 ann Guð·rūnu · góðra ráða
 en Bryn·hildr þikki=sk · brúðr vas gefin
 4 snót fíðr vélar · sér at hęfndum.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 46 „Hvat mun at bótum · brúðr sú taka
 2 es vélar vér · vífi gerðum;
 hęfir snót af mér · svarna ęiða
 4 ønga ęfnda · en unat lítit?“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

- 47 „Mun hōn Gunn·ari · gōrva sęgja
 2 at þú ęigi vel · ęiðum þyrmir
 þá's ítr konungr · af ǫllum hug

4 Gjúka arfi · á gram trúði.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

48 „Hvat 's þá, Grípir? · Get þess fyr mér;

2 mun'k saðr vesa · at sǫgu þeiri,

 eða lýgr á mik · lof-sæl kona

4 ok á sjalfa sik? · Sæg Grípir þat!“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

49 „Mun fyr ræiði · rík brúðr við þik

2 né af of-trega · all-vel skipa.

 viðr þú góðri · grand aldri=gi

4 þó 's víf konungs · vélum þeittuð.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

50 „Mun horskr Gunn·arr · at hvotun þennar

2 Guð·þormr ok Hǫgni · ganga síðan?

 Munu synir Gjúka · af sífjungum mér

4 eggjar rjóða? · Einn seg Grípir!“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO

51 „Þá 's Guð·rúnu · grimmt umb hjarta

2 bróðr þennar þér · til bana ráða,

 ok at öngu verðr · yndi síðan

4 vitru vífi, · veldr því Grím·hildr.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.
TODO

- 52 Því skal hugga þik, · hęrs odd-viti,
2 sú mun gipt lagit · á grams évi;
mun=at mętri maðr · á mold koma
4 und sólar sjöt · an, Sig-urðr, þikkir.“

For that shall she soothe(?) thee, O point-knower of the host;
she will have laid venom in the ruler's age.
No nobler man will come upon the earth
beneath the seat of the sun [SKY/HEAVEN], than thou, Siward, dost seem!

- 53 „Skiljum=k hęilir; · mun=at sköpum vinna!
2 Nú hęfir þú, Grípir, vęl · gört sem þeidda'k;
fljótt myndir þú · fríðri sęja
4 mına évi · ef þú męttir þat!“

“Let us part in health; one will not withstand the shapes!
Now hast thou, Griper, done well as I asked.
Sooner wouldst thou have told finer things
of my age, if thou couldst do so!”

Speeches of Rein

(*Ręins mól*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.666)–early C11th (0.259)

Meter: Leeds-meter, Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Speeches of Rein** (*Reg*) is a heroic poem, really a prosimetrum, dealing with the youth of Siward the Walsing.

Textual transmission and preservation

Reg is preserved in full in **R**, where it follows *Grip* and precedes *Fáfn*. The prosimetrum is introduced with a large initial and an illegible title originally in red ink.

The text of the prosimetrum is also found in *Norn* 4–6, which reproduce the entire sequence *Reg* P6–26, with all relevant stanzas. The main ms. for this text is **F**. Although *Norn* 4–6 is clearly textually related to *Reg* in its written form, as seen by the shared prose passages, it is probably not directly derived from **R**, but rather from a sister manuscript. Note that *Norn* also preserves *Helr*.

Reg in its written form clearly serves as the basis for two additional sources: *Vols* 14–15 and 17–18 (for ch. 16 see *Grip*) cites sts. 1, 2, 6, and 18 verbatim and paraphrases many others. *Skm* 46–48 retells the whole story of Siward's youth, also pulling on *Fáfn* and *Sigrdr*.

The Siward sequence

In **R**, *Reg* is the first of a group of three very similar poems in an unbroken narrative sequence (*Reg*, *Fáfn*, *Sigrdr*), for which reason the whole group will be discussed here.

To begin with, it should be said that modern philology has disproven the existence of these three poems—indeed their very names—as independent

units. Although *Fáfn* is introduced by a title and large initial and thus separated from *Reg*, the division between *Fáfn* and *Sigrdr* is entirely arbitrary, since the two are continuous in **R**. More importantly, none of the three poems is a unitary poetic composition. Instead, they form a single continuous narrative, told in the same characteristic style: an amalgamation of narrative prose and poetic dialogue-stanzas, alternating between Ancient-words-law and Leeds-meter. The style of the stanzas in each meter is in fact very similar throughout, so that we may be dealing with two long separate cycles treating the same overarching story, which have been edited into a single text. A particularly likely example of overlap between these potential sources is the speech of the tits in *Fáfn* 32–39, where there is a good narrative progression of thought in the stanzas of each meter, but which is confused if one reads both.

That is not to say that the existence of such sources is certain. In fact, it is not implausible that the whole sequence was written as a prosimetrum, most likely by a 12th century antiquarian, drawing on older narratives and perhaps incorporating older poetry. Antiquarian influence is inevitable in the rune-spell section of *Sigrdr*, where a post-conversion Latin loanword is found in st. 8/1.

In any case, the old division into three poems has been retained in the present edition for reasons of accessibility and compatibility with earlier editions, but the reader is encouraged to read the entire sequence in order.

Text

The Speeches of Rein

- P1 Sig-urðr gekk til stóðs Hjálp-reks ok kaus sér af hest einn er
2 Grani var kallaðr síðan. Þá var kominn Reginn til Hjálp-reks,
sonr Hreið-mars. Hann var hverjum manni hagari ok dvergr
4 of vøxt. Hann var vitr, grimmr ok fjöl-kunnigr. Reginn veitti
Sig-urði fóstr ok kennslu ok elskaði hann mjök. Hann sagði
6 Sig-urði frá for-ellri sínu ok þeim at-burðum at Óðinn ok Hónir
ok Loki höfðu komit til And-vara-fors; í þeim forsi var fjölði
8 fiska. Einn dvergr hét And-vari; hann var lǫngum í forsi'num í
geddu líki ok fekk sér þar matar.
10 „Otr hét bróðir várr,“ kvað Reginn, „er opt fór í fors'inn í otrs líki.
Hann hafði tekit einn lax ok sat á ár-bakka'num ok át blundandi.
12 Loki laust hann með steini til bana. Þóttu-sk ేశir mjök heppnir
verit hafa ok flógu belg af otrinum. Þat sama kveld sóttu þeir
14 gisting til Hreið-mars ok sýndu veiði sína. Þá tóku vér þá hǫn-
dum ok lǫgðum þeim fjor-lausn at fylla otr-belginn með gulli
16 ok hylja útan ok með rauðu gulli. Þá sendu þeir Loka at afla
gulls'ins. Hann kom til Ránar ok fekk net hennar ok fór þá
18 til And-vara-fors ok kastaði neti'nu fyr geddu'na en hón hljóp
í net'it. Þá mēlti Loki:

SIWARD WALKED to Helpric's stable and chose himself thereof a horse which was thenceforth called Grane. Then Rein, son of Rethmar, had come to Helpric's. He was craftier than every man and a dwarf in stature; he was clever, cruel and man cunning. Rein granted Siward fosterage and teaching, and loved him much. He told Siward about his parentage, and about the events that Weden, Heener and Lock had come to Andwaresforce; in that force was a multitude of fish. One dwarf was called Andware; he was for a long time in the force in the likeness of a pike and got his food there. "Otter was our brother called," said Rein, "who often went forth in the force in the likeness of an otter. He had taken a salmon and sat on the riverbank and ate it with his eyes closed. Lock beat him with a stone to his death. The Eese thought themselves to have been very lucky and flayed the skin from the otter. That same evening they sought lodgings at Rethmar's house, and showed their catch. Then we bound them and gave them as a life-ransom to fill the otter-skin with gold and cover even the outside with red gold. Then they sent Lock to procure the gold. He came to Ran and got her net, and then journeyed to Andwaresforce and threw the net in front of the pike, and it jumped into the net. Then spoke Lock:

- 1 „Hvat ’s þat fiska · es rinn flóði i;
 2 kann=at sér við víti varask?
 Höfuð þitt · leys-tu helju ór;
 4 finn mér lindar loga!“
- “WHAT SORT OF FISH is it which runs in the flood?
 It cannot help itself from harm.
 Redeem thy head out of Hell;
 find me the fountain-flame [GOLD]!”

4 finn | ok finn N 4 lindar | emend.; linar R; liondar N

- 2 „And·vari ek heiti, · Óinn hét minn faðir,
 2 margan hef’k fors of farit.
 Aumlig norn · skóp oss i ár-daga
 4 at ek skylda i vatni vaða.“
- “Andware I am called; Owen was my father called;
 through many a force I have fared.
 A wretched norn shaped for us in days of yore
 that I should in the water wade.”

1 Óinn | Óðinn *wo. doubt corrupt* N

- 3 „Segðu þat, And·vari,“ (kvað Loki,) „ef þú eiga vill
 2 líf i lýða solum:
 Hver gjöld · fáa gumna synir
 4 ef höggvask orðum á?“
- “Tell this, Andware”—quoth Lock—“if thou wilt own
 life in the halls of men:
 Which recompense do the sons of men get,
 if they hew at each other with words?”

- 4 „Ofr-gjöld · fáa gumna synir
 2 þeir’s Vað-gelmi vaða;
 ó-saðra orða · hverr’s á annan lýgr,
 4 of lengi leiða limar.“
- “Terrible recompense do the sons of men get,
 they who in Wadyelmer wade.
 By the results of untrue words is each
 who lies to another long followed.”

ALL | Watery torment for criminals (both in this life and the next) is well attested in Germanic sources. See *Vsp* 39 and note for discussion.

- P2 Loki sá allt gull þat er And-vari átti. En er hann hafði fram
2 reitt gull'it, þá hafði hann eptir einn hring ok tók Loki þann af
 hánum. Dvergr'inn gekk inn í stein'inn ok mēlti:

Lock saw all the gold which Andware owned. But when he had prepared the gold, then he still had one ring and Lock took it from him. The dwarf went into the stone and spoke:

- 5 „Þat skal goll · es Gustr átti
2 bróðrum tvēim · at bana verða
 ok ǫðlingum · átta at rógi;
4 mun míns féar · mann=gi njóta.“

“That gold which Gust owned shall
for two brothers become the bane,
and for eight nobles the cause of strife;
of my wealth will no man profit.”

- P3 Ésir reiddu Hreið-mari féit ok tráðu upp otr-belginn ok reistu á
2 fóttr; þá skyldu ésirnir hlaða upp gulli'nu ok hylja. En er þat var
 gørt gekk Hreið-marr framm ok sá eitt grana-hár ok bað hylja.
4 Þá dró Óðinn framm hringinn And-vara-naut ok hulði hárit.

The Eese prepared the fee for Rethmar and stuffed the otter-skin and raised it on its feet; then the Eese should load up the gold and cover it. But when it was done Rethmar walked up to it and saw a single whisker strand and bade it be covered. Then Weden drew forth the ring Andwaresgift and covered the strand.

- 6 „Goll's þér nú reitt“, (kvað Loki,) „en þú gjöld hefir
2 mikil mīns hǫfuðs;
 syni þinum · verðr=a sǣla skǫpuð;
4 þat verðr ykkarr bēggja bani!“

“The gold is now prepared for thee”—quoth Lock—“and thou hast the great payment for my head.

For thy son will no welfare arise;
it will be the bane of you both!”

3 verðr=a | verðr=at N 4 verðr | es N

Hreiðmarr sagði: 7 „Gjafar þú **g**aft— · **g**aft=at òst-gjafar,
 2 gjaf=at af **h**eilum **h**ug!
Fjörvi yðru · skylduð ér **f**irrðir vesa
 4 ef vissa’k þat **f**ar **f**yrr.“

“Thou gavest a gift—gavest not a gift of love;
 gavest not out of true heart!
 From your lives would ye be far removed,
 if I had known that danger before!”

8 „Ènn es **v**erra, · þat **v**ita þikkjumk,
 2 **n**iðja stríð um **n**ept;
jöfra ó-borna · hygg þá **è**nn vesa
 4 es þat ’s til **h**atrs **h**ugat.“

“Still worse is what I seem to know ahead:
 the forced hatred of kinsmen.
 In unborn princes I think it still
 intends to stir up strife.”

9 „**R**auðu golli“, (kvað Hreiðmarr,) „hykk mik **r**áða munu
 2 svá **l**engi sem ek **l**ífi;
hót þín · **h**rêðumk ekki lyf
 4 ok **h**aldið **h**eim **h**eðan!“

“The red gold”—quoth Rethmar—“I think I will wield
 so long as I do live.
 Thy threats I fear not at all—
 and turn ye home hence!”

P4 Fáfñir ok Reginn kröfðu Hreið·mar nið-gjalda eptir Otr, bróður
 2 sinn. Hann kvað nei við. En Fáfñir lagði sverði Hreið·mar,
 fýður sinn, sofanda. Hreið·marr kallaði á dótr sínar:

Fathomer and Rein demanded from Rethmar the kin-payment for Otter,
 their brother. He said no to it, but Fathomer ran his sword through Rethmar,
 his father, sleeping. Rethmar called out to his daughters:

10 „**L**ýng·hēiðr ok **L**ofn·hēiðr, · vitið mínu **l**ífi farit!
 2 Mart ’s þat’s þorf þéar!“
 „**F**ó mun systir, · þó’tt fýður missi,
 4 **h**ēfna hlýra **h**arms.“

“Lingheath and Lovenheath! Witness my life destroyed;

Lingheath answered: “much does the need compel!”
 “Few a sister, though she might miss her father,
 will avenge her brother’s harm.”

2 Mart ’s þat’s þorþ þéar! ‘much does the need compel!’ | The circumstances require yet more terrible actions; as his only children, Rethmar’s daughters have a duty to avenge their father, even if by killing their brother.

11 „Al þú þó dóttur“, (kvað Hreiðmarr,) „dís ulf-huguð,
 2 ef þú getr=at son · við siklingi;
 fá þú mey manni · i megin-þarfar,
 4 þá mun þeirar sonr · þíns harms reka.“
 “Beget yet a daughter”—quoth Rethmar—“a wolf-minded lady,
 if thou gettest no son by the prince.
 Out of great need wed that maiden to a man;
 then *her* son will avenge thy harm!”

3 manni · i megin-þarfar | mann imeginþarfar R

3 fá þú mey manni · i megin-þarfar ‘Out of great need wed that maiden to a man’ | Out of the great need to avenge her father; *þarfar* being pl. of *þorþ* as used in the previous stanza.

ALL | Rethmar’s last words foretell the life of Siward who will come to avenge him by slaying Fathomer. Lingheath must thus marry Eanline and give birth to Hardise (the “wolf-minded lady”), Siward’s mother.

P5 Þá dó Hreið·marr, en Fáfñir tók gull’it allt. Þá beiddisk Reginn
 2 at hafa fōður-arf sinn, en Fáfñir galt þar nei við. Þá leitaði
 Reginn ráða við Lyng·heiði, systur sína, hvernig hann skyldi
 4 heimta fōður-arf sinn. Hón kvað:

Then Rethmar died, but Fathomer took all the gold. Then Rein begged to have his father’s inheritance, but Fathomer gave back a no. Then Rein sought counsel from Lingheath, his sister, over how he should take his father’s inheritance. Quoth she:

12 „Brúðar kvęðja · skalt blíð=liga
 2 arfs ok óðra hugar;
 es=a þat hóft · at þú hjörvi skylir
 4 kvęðja Fáfni fęar!“

“From the bride shalt thou kindly ask
 for heritance and nobler thoughts;
 it is not fitting that thou by the sword
 shouldst ask for Fathomer’s wealth!”

1 Brúðar 'From the bride' | "From me." It seems that Lingheath here offers Rein her part of the inheritance.

- P6 Þessa hluti sagði Reginn Sig-urði. Einn dag, er hann kom til
2 húsa Regins, var hánunum vel fagnat. Reginn kvað:

These things Rein told Siward. One day when he came to Rein's house he was greeted heartily. Quoth Rein:

ALL | The passage P6–26 is copied almost word-for-word in *Norn* 5–6, narrated by the eponymous Norn-Guest who claims to have accompanied Siward in this part of his adventure. Due to the striking similarity in both verse and prose indicating a close textual relationship the mss. of *Norn* are here treated as attesting the same base text as R.

- 13 „Kominn 's hingat · konr Sig-mundar,
2 seggr inn snar-ráði, · til sala várra;
móð hefir meira · an maðr gamall,
4 ok es mér fangs vön · at frekum ulfi.

“Hither is come the son of Syemund [= Siward],
the youth of quick counsel to our halls!
He has greater heart than the old man,
and I expect a catch from the hungry wolf.

3 maðr gamall 'the old man' | Rein himself, who now plans to use Siward to do what he dares not: take Fathomer's wealth.

- 14 Ek mun fœða · folk-djarfan gram;
2 nú 's yngva konr · með oss kominn;
sjá mun rêsir · ríkstr und sólu,
4 þrymr um ǫll lönd · ǫr-ǫg-símu.“

I will raise the troop-bold prince;
now the son of a king is come in our midst!
This one will become a ruler mightiest under the sun;
he fastens through all lands his orlay-strands!”

4 þrymr ... ǫr-ǫg-símu 'he fastens ... orlay-strands' | His fate is being fixed through all lands. Cf. the first four sts. of *1 HHund*.

- P7 Sig-urðr var þá jafnan með Regin ok sagði hann Sig-urði at Fáfñir
2 lá á Gnita-heiði ok var í orms líki. Hann átti ógis-hjalm er ǫll
kvikvendi hréddu=sk við. Reginn gerði Sig-urði sverð er Gramr
4 hét. Þat var svá hvasst at hann brá því ofan í Rín ok lét reka ullar-

- 6 lagð fyrir straumi ok tók í sundr lagð'inn sem vatnit. Því sverði
 klauf Sig-urðr í sundr steðja Régins. Eptir þat eggjaði Reginn
 Sig-urð at vega Fáfni. Hann sagði:

Thereafter Siward was always with Rein, and he told Siward that Fathomer lay on the Gnit-heath and was in a Wyrn's likeness; he owned the helm of awe by which all living things were frightened. Rein made Siward the sword called Gram; it was so sharp that he held it upside down in the Rhine and let a lock of wool float down the stream; and it cut the lock even as it did the water. With that sword Siward struck asunder Rein's anvil; after that Rein urged Siward to slay Fathomer. He said:

- 15 „Hótt munu hléja · Hundings synir
 2 þeir's Ey·lima · aldrs synjuðu,
 ef mēirr tiggja · munar at sókja
 4 hringa rauða · an hefnd fōður.“

“Loudly laugh will Hunding's sons
 —they who denied Eanlme old age—
 if the chief is more eager to seek
 red rings than revenge for his father.”

- P8 Hjálp-rekr konungr fekk Sig-urði skipa-lið til fōður-hefnda. Þeir
 2 fengu storm mikinn ok beittu fyr bergs-nōs nakkvara. Maðr
 einn stóð á berg'inu ok kvað:

King Helpric got Siward a ship-retinue to revenge his father. They caught a great storm, and tacked their ships below a set of crags. A lone man stood on the crag and quoth:

- 16 „Hverir ríða þar · Réfils hęstum
 2 hóvar unnir, · haf glymjanda?
 Segl-vigg eru · svęita stokkin,
 4 mun=at vág-marar · vind of standask.“

“Which men there ride Revil's horses [SHIPS]
 on the high waves, on the roaring sea?
 The sail-steeds [SHIPS] are spattered with sweat;
 the wave-chargers [SHIPS] will not bear the wind!”

- 17 „Hér eru vér Sig-vorðr · á sé-tréum;
 2 es oss byrr gefinn · við bana sjalfan;
 fellr brattr breki · brōndum héri,

- 4 hlunn-vigg hrapa— · hværr spyrr at því?“
 “Here are we, Siward [and his men], upon sea-trees [SHIPS];
 we are given a gust towards our very deaths!
 The steep breaker falls higher than flames;
 the launcher-steeds [SHIPS] rush forth—who asks of this?”

1 Sig-vörðr | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R 1 sć-tréum | *metr. emend.*;
 sć-trjám R

- 18 „Hnikar hétu mik · þá's Hugin gladdi [R 29v/32–30r/1, N]
 2 Völsungr ungi · ok vegit hafði;
 nú mátt-u kalla · karl af bergi,
 4 Feng eða Fjølmi; · far vil'k þiggja.“
 “Nicker they called me when young Walsing
 gladdened Highen and had triumphed.
 Now mayst thou call me churl-from-the-crag,
 Feng or Fillner—I wish to beg passage.”

1 þá's | *add.* ek T' N 3 bergi | bjargi N

1 Hugin gladdi 'gladdened Highen' | That is, when he had “fed the raven”, i.e., by the corpses of slain foes on the battlefield.

2 Völsungr ungi 'young Walsing' | Siward's grandfather, the founder of the Walsing dynasty.

P9 Þeir viku at landi, ok gekk karl á skip, ok léggði þá veðrit.

They turned to land and the man went on the ship, and then the weather calmed down.

- 19 „Seg mér þat, Hnikarr, · alls hvár-tveggja vëitst,
 2 goða heill ok guma:
 hvæ bōzt eru · ef bërja=sk skal,
 4 heill at sverða svipun?“

“Tell me this, Nicker, as thou knowest both
 the omens of gods and men:
 Which are the best—if one shall fight—
 omens for the swinging of swords?”

- Hnikarr kvað: 20 „Morg eru góð · ef gumar vissi,
 2 heill at sverða svipun;
 dyggja fylgju · hygg ins dökkva vesa
 4 at hrotta-meði hrafns.

“There are many good—if men would know them—
omens for the swinging of swords.
A good followeress I think the dark one is
for the sword-tree of the raven [WARRIOR].”

21 Þat es annat · ef est út of kominn
2 ok est á braut búinn:
tvá þú lítr · á tái standa
4 hróðr-fúsa hali.

This is another one: if thou art come outside
and art ready on the road:
thou wilt behold two standing on their toes
glory-eager heroes.

22 Þat 's it þriðja · ef þjóta heyrir
2 ulf und ask-limum,
heilla auðit · verðr þér af hjalm-stofum
4 ef sér þá fyrri fara.

This is the third: if thou hearest howling
a wolf beneath ashen branches
TODO.
TODO.

23 Øngr skal gumna · i gogn vega
2 síð skinandi · systur Mána;
þeir sigr hafa · es séa kunnu,
4 hjör-letiks hvatir, · eða hamalt fylkja.

No man shall fight in evening
facing the shining sister of the Moon [SUN].
Those men brisk in sword-play [BATTLE] have the triumph
who can see—or draw up the flying wedge.

4 hamalt fylkja ‘draw up the flying wedge’ | This formation, known in ON as the *svín-fylking* ‘swine-array’, was favoured by the Germanic peoples. It is mentioned already in Tacitus, *Germania* ch. 6: *acies per cuneos componitur* ‘their troops are drawn up in a wedge-like formation’. In the legendary saws the swine-array has a particular association with Weden. According to *Fornk* he taught it to the Danish king Harold Hildtooth, who went on to win great victories with the formation until Weden betrayed him and taught it to the Swedish king Siward Ring, who defeated and slew Harold at the battle of the Browolds (*Brávöllir*). So *Fornk* 8: *Brúni segir*: „*Svá lít-sk mér sem Hringr muni búinn at berja-sk ok hans lið. Hann befir undar-liga fylkt. Hann befir svín-fylkt her sinum, ok mun eigi gott at berja-sk við hann.*“ *Pá segir Haraldr konungr*: „*Hverr mun Hringi bafa kennt hamalt at fylkja? Ek hugða engan kunna nema mik ok Óðin, eða mun Óðinn vilja skippla-sk í sigr-gjöf inni við mik?* [...]“ ‘Brown says: “It seems to me that Ring is ready to fight, and his troop too. He has drawn them up in a strange way; he has drawn up his host in the swine-array, and it will not be good to fight against him. Then says king Harold: “Who can have taught Ring to draw up the flying wedge? I thought no one knew it save for me and Weden, or does Weden wish to take back his gift of victory from me? [...]”’

- 24 Þat 's fār mikit · ef fōti drepr
 2 þar's þú at vígi vęðr;
 talar dísir · standa þér á tvęr hliðar
 4 ok vilja þik sáran séa.

It is a great peril if thou stumblest thy foot
 where thou wadest forth in war.
 Treacherous dises stand on thy either side
 and wish to see thee harmed.

- 25 Kęmbðr ok þvęinn · skal kónna hvęrr
 2 ok at morni męttr,
 því't ó-sýnt es · hvar at aptni kęmr;
 4 illt 's fyr hęill at hrapa.

Combed and washed shall each keen man be,
 and by morning fed,
 for it is unseen where by evening he comes—
 it is ill to rush ahead of the omens!

ALL | The wording of the first half of this stanza is very close to *Háv* 61 and *Vsp* 33; for personal hygiene and bathing in the culture see note to the former.

Capitulum ('New Chapter')

- P10 Sig-urðr átti orrustu mikla við Lyngva Hundings son ok bróðr
 2 hans. Þar fell Lyngvi ok þeir þrír bróðr. Eptir orrustu kvað
 Reginn:

SIWARD HAD a great battle with Ling, Hunding's son, and his brothers. There fell Ling and the three brothers. After the battle quoth Rein:

ALL | *This passage is introduced by a bolded initial in R.*

- 26 Nú 's blóðugr ǫrn · bitrum hjǫrvi
2 bana Sig-mundar · á baki ristinn;
ǫngr es frēmri, · sá's fold ryði,
4 hilmis arfi · ok Hugin gladdi!

Now the bloody eagle with a bitter sword
is carved on the back of Syemund's bane.
No chieftain's heir is more successful
who has reddened the earth and gladdened Highen!

4 Hugin gladdi 'has gladdened Highten' | See above.

- P11 Heim fór Sig-urðr til Hjálp-reks. Þá eggjaði Reginn Sig-urð
2 til at vega Fáfnir. Sig-urðr ok Reginn fóru upp á Gnita-heiði
ok hittu þar slóð Fáfnis þá er hann skreið til vats. Þar gørði
4 Sig-urðr grøf mikla á vegi'num ok gekk Sig-urðr þar í. En er
Fáfnir skreið af gulli'nu blés hann eitri ok hraut þat fyr ofan
6 hǫfuð Sig-urði. En er Fáfnir skreið yfir grøf'ina þá lagði Sig-urðr
hann með sverði til hjarta. Fáfnir hristi sik ok barði hǫfði ok
8 sporði. Sig-urðr hljóp ór grøf'inni ok sá þá hvárr annan. Fáfnir
kvað:

Siward journeyed home to Helpric. Then Rein incited Siward to fight Fathomer. Siward and Rein journeyed up on the Gnit-heath and found there Siward's trail as he was crawling to a body of water. There Siward made a great trench in the way and Siward went down into it. But when Fathomer crawled off from the gold he blew venom, and it flew over Siward's head. But when Fathomer crawled over the trench, then Siward ran him through with his sword unto the heart. Fathomer recoiled and struck his head and spurned. Siward leapt out of the trench, and then each of them saw the other. Quoth Fathomer:

Speeches of Fathomer

(*Fáfnis mól*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.442)–early C11th (0.402)

Meter: Leeds-meter, Ancient-words-law (TODO)

Introduction

The **Speeches of Fathomer** (abbrev. *Fáfn*) is only preserved in **R**, where it has the title *Frá dauða Fáfnis* ‘From the death of Fathomer’. It forms a continuous text with the preceding *Reg* and the following *Sigrdr* and should not be analyzed in isolation.

The poetry of *Fáfn* is closely paraphrased by *Vǫls* 18–19, and it is clear that the now-lost source underlying that text was near-identical to **R**.

Siward’s slaying of the wyrm Fathomer was an exceptionally famous story in the Wiking Age and Scandinavian Middle Ages. Outside of *Reg–Fáfn* and *Vǫls* the narrative is referenced in Scaldic poetry (TODO) and depicted pictorially on numerous objects. The most important of these is the Swedish runic inscription Sö 101 (ca. 1030 CE) from Ramsund, Södermanland. The carving consists of a long serpent or wyrm inscribed with a generic memorial inscription. At the bottom right a figure thrusts a sword through the wyrm’s body and in the space enclosed by it several important events following Siward’s slaying of Fathomer are depicted with remarkably close correspondence to the version preserved in the Norse-Icelandic sources; see Fig. 9.



Figure 9: The Ramsund carving, Viking Age, ca. 1030 CE. Details depicted: 1. Siward slays Fathomer. 2. Siward roasts Fathomer's heart by a fire; he burns his finger and puts it in his mouth to cool it, inadvertently tasting the blood. 3. Two birds sit in the tree, presumably talking to Siward. 4. Rein lies decapitated surrounded by his bellows, tongs, and anvil. 5. Grane stands loaded with a chest on his back. 6. A wolf or dog; the only detail not found in Reg-Faþn. © Bengt A. Lundgren/RAA. CC BY 4.0. <https://pub.raa.se/visa/dokumentation/7dd6614e-950b-42bf-b31f-4f910c74e936>

Text

Frá dauða Fáfnis ('From Fathomer's death')

- 1 „Sveinn ok sveinn! · Hverjum est sveini of borinn?
 2 Hverra est manna mǫgr?
 es þú á Fáfni rautt · þinn inn frána męki;
 4 stöndumk til hjarta hjǫrr!“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “O SWAIN and swain! To which swain art thou born;
 of which men art thou the son?
 When thou on Fathomer hast reddened this thy gleaming blade;
 the sword stands unto my heart!”

- P1 Sig-urðr dulði nafns síns fyr því at þat var trúa þeira í forneskju
 2 at orð feigs manns mętti mikit ef hann bǫlvaði ó-vin sínum með
 nafni. Hann kvað:

Siward belied his name, for it was their belief in olden times that a fey man's
 word could do much if he cursed his foe by name. Quoth he:

1 þat var trúa þeira í forneskju 'it was their belief in olden times' | For another instance of beliefs
 in *forneskju* 'olden times, antiquity', see 2 *HHund* P18.

- 2 „Gǫfugt dýr ek heiti · en ek gengit hef'k
 inn móður-lausi mǫgr,
 fǫður ek á'kk=a · sem fira synir,
 4 geng ek ęinn saman.“

“Noble Beast am I called, but I have gone
 as the motherless lad.
 A father I have not like the sons of men;
 I go alone.”

- 3 „Vęitst, ef fǫður né átt=at · sem fira synir,
 2 af hverju vastu undri alinn?
 [...]“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “Knowest thou, if thou hast no father like the sons of men,
 by which wonder thou wast begotten?”

3 [...] | Two lines appear to be missing here, but may have survived in the ms. underlying *Vǫls*. *Vǫls* 18 paraphrases: *Ef þú átt engan föður né móður, af hverju undri ertu þá alinn? Ok þótt þú segir mér eigi þitt nafn á bana-dögri mínu, þá veistu, at þú lýgr nú.* ‘If thou hast no father or mother, by which wonder art thou begotten? And although thou wilt not tell me thy name in my hour of death, thou knowest that thou art lying.’ It is apparently this now-missing appeal to Siward’s conscience—it would be shameful to lie to a dying man—that makes him reveal his true name.

- 4 „**É**tterni mitt · kveð’k þér **ó**-kunnigt vesa
 2 ok mik **s**jalfan hit **s**ama:
Sig-urðr ek heiti · **S**ig-mundr hét minn faðir
 4 es hef’k þik **v**ópnum **v**egit.“

[Quoth Siward:] “My lineage, I say, is unknown to thee,
 and my self the same.¹

Siward I am called—Syemund was called my father—
 who with weapons have smitten thee.”

¹The sense is that Fathomer would not recognize Siward’s lineage (i.e., his father) or name, since he is an orphan who up until this point has not accomplished much. He is not saying that he is lineage is unknown even to himself, since *sjalfan mik* ‘my self’ is accusative, not dative.

- 5 „**H**verr þik **h**vatti, · **h**ví **h**vetja=sk lést,
 2 mínu **f**jörvi at **f**ara?
 Inn **f**rán-eygi sveinn, · þú áttir **f**öður bitran,
 4 á-bornu **s**kjór á **s**keið.“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “Who goaded thee; why didst thou let thee be goaded
 my life for to destroy?
 O gleaming-eyed swain, thou hadst a sharp father;
 inborn traits show quickly.”

4 á-bornu skjór á skeið. ‘inborn traits show quickly’ | The original is cryptic. *á skeið* means roughly ‘rapidly, quickly’, whence the expression *riða á skeið* ‘CV: to ride at full speed’, but the other words are uncertain. La Farge and Tucker (1992) read ‘your innate qualities show quickly’, suggesting two unattested words: an adjective **áborinn* ‘innate, inborn’ and a verb **skjóa* ‘to show’. Yet the lack of i-umlaut in the supposed 3rd sg. pres. ind. *skjór* is difficult, since we would expect ***skjyr*, as in *skjóta* ‘to shoot,’ with 2nd/3rd sg. pres. ind. *skýtr*. A solution would be emending to a 2nd sg. pres. subj. *skjóir*, but this has not been undertaken.

- 6 „**H**ugr mik **h**vatti, · **h**endr mér full-týðu
 2 ok minn inn **h**vassi **h**jör;
 fár es **h**vatr · es **h**røða=sk tekr
 4 ef i barn-ösku es **bl**auðr.“

[Quoth Siward:] “My heart goaded me; my hands availed me
 and this my sharp sword.

Few a man is bold when he takes to grow,
if in childhood he be soft.”

- 7 „Vei't'k, ef þú vaxa næðir · fyr þinna vina brjósti,
2 séi maðr þik vręðan vega;
nú est haptr · ok hęr-numinn,
4 ę kveða bandingja bifask.“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “I know that if thou hadst grown up upon thy kinsmen’s breast
man would see thee wrathfully fight;
now art thou a captive and war-taken;
they say the boundling always trembles.”

2 vręðan vega ‘wrathfully fight’ | Formulaic word-pair.

- 8 „Því bregðr þú nú mér, Fáfñir, · at til fjarri sjá’k
2 mñnum fęðr-munum,
ęgi em’k haptr · þó’tt vęra hęr-numi;
4 þú fannt, at ek lauss lifi!“

[Quoth Siward:] “For that dost thou now upbraid me, Fathomer, that I be too far
from the love of my fathers.
I am nowise a captive, although I be war-taken;
thou hast found that I live loose!”

- 9 „Hępt-yrði ęin · tęlr þú þér í hví-vętna
2 en ek þér satt ęitt sęgi’k:
It gjalla goll · ok it glóð-rauða fé,
4 þér verða þęir baugar at bana!“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “With hateful words alone dost thou answer anything,
but I tell thee truth alone:
The clanging gold and the glowing red wealth—
those bigs will be thy bane!”

- 10 „Féi ráða · skal fyrða hvęrr
2 ę til ins ęina dags
því’t ęinu sinni · skal alda hvęrr
4 fara til hęljar heðan.“

[Quoth Siward:] “Rule his wealth shall every man,
always, until the one day;
for at one time shall every man
journey hence to Hell.”

ALL | Siward dismisses the curse. He is a man, and therefore mortal; he must die regardless of whether he takes the gold or not, and it is better to die wealthy and renowned than wretched and unknown.

2 ins çina dags ‘the one day’ | His predetermined day of death.

- 11 „Norna dóm · munt fyr nešjum hafa
2 ok ó-svinns apa;
i vatni þú drukknar · ef i vindi rér;
4 allt es feigs forað.“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “The judgment of the Norns shalt thou have before the headlands,
and that of an unwise ape.
Thou wilt drown in water if thou rowest in wind;
everything is the pit of the fey.”

ALL | Fathomer points out the danger of the curse: insidious death will find Siward in an unforeseen circumstance, and his fated death will be imminent. — The redactor of *Vþls* clearly misunderstood the import of the stanza when he took it to be a warning specifically against sailing on the windy sea, which is of course only one example of the many potential ways in which Siward might die. *Vþls* 18 paraphrases: *Fátt vill þú at mínum dómum gera, en drukknar muntu, ef þú ferr um sjá ó-varliga, ok bið heldr á landi, und’s lofn er.* ‘Thou hast little wish to act according to my examples, but thou wilt drown if thou goest to journey carelessly at sea, so do rather abide on land until it is calm.’

1 Norna dóm ‘The judgment of the Norns’ | The time when the Norns decree that one should die, one’s predestined hour of death (cf. *Ski* 13/3, *Grip* 25/4). The expression is synonymous with *kviðr norna* ‘verdict of the Norns’, *Hamð* 30/4; cf. also *Vþ* 19/5–6.

1 fyr nešjum ‘before the headlands’ | I.e. ‘close at hand, imminent’. An established metaphor for imminent death, cf. *Sont* 25, where Eyel concludes his poem by declaring that Hell (the goddess of Death) *á nešjum stendr* ‘stands upon the headlands’.

- 12 „Seg mér, Fáfñir, · alls þik fróðan kveða
2 ok vęl mart vita:
Hverjar ’ro þér nornir · es nauð-gonglar ’ro
4 ok kjósa móðr frá mógum?“

[Quoth Siward:] “Tell me, Fathomer, as they call thee wise
and knowing well enough:
Who are the Norns which attend in need
and choose mothers from their lads?”

ALL | Sts. 12–15 consist of two general mythological questions in a style most closely resembling *Vafþ.* These questions do not at all contribute to the narrative and it is not impossible that yet more of them have been removed for that reason; cf. note to st. 16.

3 es nauð-gonglar ‘ro ‘attend in need’ | Lit. ‘are attendant in need’; they help ailing mothers during childbirth. Cf. *Sigrdr* 9.

- 13 „Sundr-bornar mjök · hygg at nornir sé,

[S 5r/11, T TODO,
W TODO, U TODO]

- 2 ęigu-t þęr ętt saman;
 sumar 'ro ęs-kunngar, · sumar alf-kunngar,
 4 sumar dętr Dvalins.“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “Of most sundry birth I judge the norns to be;
 they have not a lineage in common.
 Some are Os-born, some Elf-born,
 some the daughters of Dwoollen [DWARFESSES].”

ALL | This stanza is cited in *Gylf* 15:32. TODO.

- 14 „Sęg męr þat, Fáfñir, · alls þik fróðan kveða
 2 ok vęl margt vita,
 hvę sá holmr hętir · es blanda hjęr-lęgi
 4 Surtr ok ęsir saman.“

[Quoth Siward:] “Tell me this, Fathomer, as they call thee wise
 and knowing well enough:
 What is the islet called, where Surt and the Eese
 blend sword-water [BLOOD] together?”

3–4 hvę ... saman. ‘What ... together?’ | Namely at the Rakes of the Reins. For the fight between Surt and the Gods see *Vsp* 48–53, *Vafþ* 17–18.

- 15 „Ö-skópnir hętir · ęn þar ęll skulu
 2 ęęirum lęika goð;
 Bil-ręst brotnar · es á brott fara
 4 ok svima ĩ móðu marir.

[Quoth Fathomer:] “Unshopner it is called, and there shall all
 the Gods play with spears [MAKE WAR];
 Bilrest shatters when they ride on their way
 and the steeds swim in the sea.

1 Ö-skópnir ‘Unshopner’ | An otherwise unattested name.

3–4 Bil-ręst ... marir. ‘Bilrest ... the sea.’ | Bilrest is an alternative name for Bivrest, the Rainbow Bridge. — These lines are explained by a passage of Snorre, *Gylf* 13:6: *Ok svá sem bön er sterk, þá mun bön brotna þá er Muspells megir fara ok riða bana, ok svima bestar þeira yfir stórar ár. Svá koma þeir fram.* ‘And strong as it [Bivrest] is, yet it will shatter when the lads of Muspell fare and ride over it, and then their horses swim through great rivers. So they make it forwards.’

- 16 „Ögis hjalm · bar'k of alda sonum
 2 meðan of menjum lá'k;
 ęinn rammari · hugðumk ęllum vesa,
 4 fann'k=a'k marga męgu.

The helmet of awe I carried over the sons of men
 while on the neckrings I lay;
 stronger than all I thought me alone to be;
 I did not find many lads.”

ALL | Fathomer continues speaking, but there is probably something missing here since the transition away from the mythological questions is abrupt. It seems not unlikely that there were originally other mythological questions here but that they have been cut away for their perceived lack of relevance to the narrative. Between its paraphrases of st. 15 and of st. 16, *Vþls* has *Ok enn mēlti Fäfnir: „Reginn bróðir minn veldr mínum dauða, ok þat bléggir mik, er hann veldr ok þínum dauða, ok ferr þá, sem hann vildi.“* ‘And further Fathomer spoke: “My brother Rein is the cause of my death and it gladdens me that he will also cause thy death, and then it will go as he has willed.”’, which may perhaps be a paraphrase of a lost st.

- 17 „**Ö**gis hjalmr · bergr **ę**inu=gi
 2 hvar’s skulu **vrę**iðir **ve**ga;
 þa þat **f**innr · es með **f**leįrum kęmr
 4 at **ę**ngi es **ę**inna hvatastr.“

[Quoth Siward:] “The helmet of awe rescues no man
 wherever wroth men shall fight;
 this he then finds when among the many he comes—
 that none is the boldest of all.”

3–4 þa þat finnr · es með fleįrum kęmr / at ęngi es ęinna hvatastr ‘this he then finds when among the many he comes— / that none is the boldest of all’ | Near-identical to *Háv* 64/3–4; see there.

- 18 „**E**itri ek fnęsta · es á **a**rfi lá’k
 2 **m**iklum **m**íns fęður.“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “Venom I snorted while I lay on the great
 inheritance of my father.”

- 19 „Inn rammi ormr, · þú gęrðir fręs mikla
 2 ok gatst **h**arðan **h**ug;
hępt at męiri · verðr **h**ęlða sonum
 4 at þann **h**jalm **h**afi.“

[Quoth Siward:] “O mighty wyrm, thou madest a great snort,
 and didst get a hard heart.
 Greater hatred arises for the sons of men
 who might have that helm.”

- 20 „**R**ęð’k þér nú, Sig-urðr, · en þú **r**áð nemir
 2 ok ríð **h**ęim **h**eðan;

4 it gjalla goll · ok it glóð-rauða fé,
þér verða þeir baugar at bana!“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “I counsel thee now, Siward—and thou oughtst to take the counsel,
and ride home hence:

The clanging gold and the glowing red wealth—
those bighs will be thy bane!”

21 „Ráð 's þér ráðit · en ek ríða mun
2 til þess golls es i lyngvi liggr,
en þú, Fáfni, · ligg i fjör-brotum
4 þar's þik Hæl hafi!“

[Quoth Siward:] “Thy counsel has been counseled, but I will ride
to the gold which in the heather lies,
but thou, Fathomer, lie in the lifeblood tracks,
where Hell may have thee!”

4 þar's þik Hæl hafi 'where Hell may have thee' | Formulaic. TODO.

22 „Reginn mik réð, · hann þik ráða mun,
2 hann mun okkr verða bōðum at bana;
fjör sitt láta · hygg at Fáfni myni;
4 þitt varð nú meira megin.“

[Quoth Fathomer:] “Rein betrayed me; he will betray thee;
he will become the bane of us both!
Give up his life I think that Fathomer will—
thy strength was now the greater.”

P2 Rein var á brott horfinn meðan Sig-urðr vā Fáfni ok kom þá
2 aptr er Sig-urðr strauk blóð af sverði'nu. Reginn kvað:

Rein had disappeared while Siward fought Fathomer, and then came back as
Siward wiped the blood off the sword. Quoth Rein:

23 „Heill þú nú, Sig-urðr, · nú hefir sigr vegit
2 ok Fáfni of farit;
manna þeira · es mold troða
4 þik kveð'k ð·blauðastan alinn.“

“Hail thee now, Siward—now hast thou won victory
and Fathomer destroyed!
Of those men who tread on the earth
I declare thee unsoftest begotten.”

- 24 „Þat 's ð·víst at vita · þá's komum allir saman,
 2 sig-tíva synir,
 hværr ð·blauðastr es alinn;
 4 margr es sá hvatr · es hjör né rýðr
 annars brjóstum ĩ.“

[Quoth Siward:] “It is unsure to know, when we all come together,
 sons of the victory-Tews [MEN],
 who is unsoftest begotten.
 Many a man is bold who reddens no sword
 in another's chest.”

- 25 „Glaðr est nú, Sig·urðr, · ok gagni feginn
 2 es þú þærrir Gram á grasi;
 bróður minn · hefir þú þenjaðan
 4 ok veld ek þó sjalfr sumu.“

[Quoth Rein:] “Glad art thou now, Siward, and rejoicing in gain
 when thou driest Gram on the grass.
 My own brother hast thou deathly wounded,
 and yet I myself bear some fault.”

- 26 „Þú því rétt · es ek ríða skyldak
 2 heilög fjöll hinig;
 féi ok fjörvi · réði sá inn fráni ormr
 4 nema þú frýðir mér hvats hugar.“

[Quoth Siward:] “Thou didst counsel that I should ride
 o'er the holy fells hither.
 Wealth and life would the gleaming Wyrn rule
 if thou hadst not braved my bold heart.”

- P3 Þá gekk Reginn at Fáfni ok skar hjarta ór hánum með sverði er
 2 Riðill heitir ok þá drakk hann blóð ór undinni eptir.

Then Siward walked up to Fathomer and cut the heart out of him with the
 sword called Riddle, and then he drank blood from the wound afterwards.

- 27 „Sit-tu nú, Sig·urðr, · en ek mun sofa ganga
 2 ok halt Fáfnis hjarta við funa!
 Eisköld ek vil · etin láta
 4 eptir þenna dreyra drykk.“

[Quoth Rein:] “Sit thou now, Siward—but I will go sleep—

and hold Fathomer's heart by the fire!
The heart-strings I wish to eat
after this drink of blood."

3 Eisköld 'heart-strings' | An obscure poetic synonym for heart in the neuter plural. The translation "heart-strings" is guesswork.

- 28 „Fjarri þú gekkt · meðan ek á Fáfni rauð'k
2 mīnn inn hvassa hjör;
afli mínu · áttá'k við orms megin
4 meðan þú ǿ lyngvi látt.“

[Quoth Siward:] “Far didst thou go while I on Fathomer reddened
this my sharp sword.
My strength I held against the might of the Wyrn,
while thou in the heather layst.”

- 29 „Lengi liggja · létir þú þann lyngvi ǿ,
2 inn aldna jötun,
ef þú sverðs né nytir, · þess es ek sjalfr gørða,
4 ok þíns ins hvassa hjörs.“

[Quoth Rein:] “Long in the heather wouldst thou have let lie
this ancient ettin [me],
if thou hadst not used the blade which I myself made
and this thy sharp sword.”

- 30 „Hugr es bētri · en sé hjörs megin
2 hvar's vrēiðir skulu vega,
því at hvatan mann · ek sé harð=liga vega
4 með slévu sverði sigr.

[Quoth Siward:] “Heart is better than might of sword may be
wherever wroth men should fight,
for a bold man I see furiously fighting
with a sluggish sword to victory.

- 31 Hvötum 's bētra · an séi ǿ·hvötum
2 ǿ hildi-leik hafask
glöðum 's bētra · an séi glúpanda
4 hvat sem at hendi kœmr.“

For the bold it is better than it may be for the unbold
to hold themselves in battle-play [WAR];

for the glad it is better than it may be for the gloomy
no matter what comes to their hands.”

1 Hvøtum 's bættra · an séi ó-hvøtum 'For the bold it is better than it may be for the unbold' | The line type “it is better for the X than it may be for the un-X” is apparently formulaic, also appearing in *Háv* 71/1 (with emendation).

- P4 Sig-urðr tók Fáfnis hjarta ok steikði á teini. Er hann hugði at
2 full-steikt véri ok freyddi sveit'inn ór hjarta'nu þá tók hann á
fingri sínum ok skynjaði hvárt full-steikt véri. Hann brann ok
4 brá fingri'num í munn sér. En er hjart-blóð Fáfnis kom á tungu
hánnum ok skildi hann fugls rødd. Hann heyrði at igður kløkuðu
6 á hrísi'num. Igða'n kvað:

SIWARD TOOK Fathomer's heart and roasted it on a stick. When he thought that it was fully roasted and the blood frothed out of the heart then he touched it with his finger to see whether it was fully roasted. He burned himself and jerked his finger in his mouth. But when the heart's blood of Fathomer came upon his tongue and he understood the speech of birds—he heard that tits were chirping in the brushes. Quoth the tit:

1 Sig-urðr 'Siward' | *The S is a bold capital in R.*

- 32 „Þar sitr Sig-vørðr · svēita stokkinn,
2 Fáfnis hjarta · við funa stēikir;
spakr þótti mér · spillir bauga
4 ef hann fȝor-sega · fránan étí.“

“There sits Siward spattered with blood;
Fathomer's heart by the fire he roasts.
Wise would I think the spiller of rings
if he the gleaming life-muscle ate.”

1 Sig-vørðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R*

ALL, | Sts. 32–33 are cited in *Skm* 47.

- Qnnur: 33 „Þar liggr Rēginn, · rēðr umb við sik,
2 vill tēla mōg · þann's trúir hōnum;
berr af rēiði · rōng orð saman,
4 vill bōlva smiðr · bróður hefna.“

The other one:

“There lies Rein, takes counsel with himself,
wants to betray the lad who trusts in him.

Out of wrath he carries twisted words together;
the smith of bales wants to avenge his brother.”

1 · | add. kvað qnnur ‘*quoth the other one*’ Skm

Priðja: 34 „Hǫfði skemmra · láti hann inn hára þul
2 fara til heilar heðan!
Qllu golli · þá kná hann einn ráða,
4 fjöld, því’s und Fáfni lá.“

The third one:

“A head shorter ought he to let the hoary thyle
journey hence to Hell!
All the gold he can then rule alone:
the trove which ’neath Fathomer lay.”

Fjórða: 35 „Horskr þótti mér · ef hafa kynni
2 öst-ráð mikit · yðvar systra;
hygði umb sik · ok Hugin glæddi;
4 þar’s mér ulfs vön · es eyru sé’k.“

The fourth one: “Sharp would he seem to me if he could take
the great loving counsel from you, my sisters;
he would think for himself and gladden Highen—
I expect a wolf where I see an ear!”

36 „Es=at svá horskr · hildi-meiðr
2 sem ek hers jaðar · hyggja mynda’k
ef hann bróður léttr · á brott komask
4 en hann öðrum hefr · aldrs of synjat.“

[Quoth Siward:] “The battle-tree [WARRIOR] is not as sharp
as I would have thought the peak of the host [RULER]
if he lets one brother get away
and he has denied the other old age.”

37 „Mjök es ösviðr · ef hann enn sparir
2 fjánda inn folk-skáa,
þar’s Reginn liggr · es hann ráðinn hefr;
4 kann=at hann við s-líku at séa.“

[Quoth Siward:] “Very foolish is he if still he spares
that fight-shy fiend,

where Rein lies who has planned against him,
he cannot look out against such.”

- 38 „Hǫfði skemmra · láti hann þann inn hrīm-kalda jǫtun
2 ok af baugum búa;
þá mund-u fēar · þess es Fáfñir réð
4 ein-valdi vesa.“

[Quoth Siward:] “A head shorter ought he to make that rime-cold ettin,
and take from him the bighs,
then of the wealth which Fathomer ruled
wilt thou be the lone ruler.”

- [Sig-urðr:] 39 „Verða-t svá rík sköp · at Reginn skyli
2 mitt ban-orð bera
því at þeir báðir bróðr · skulu brá=liga
4 fara til Hǫljar heðan.“

[Quoth Siward:] “The Shapes will not be so powerful that Rein should
bear my bane-word,
for those brothers both shall hurriedly
journey hence to Hell!”

- P5 Sig-urðr hjó hǫfuð af Regin ok þá át hann Fáfñis hjarta ok drakk
2 blóð þeira beggja, Regins ok Fáfñis. Þá heyrði Sig-urðr hvað
igður mǫltu:

Siward struck the head off of Rein and then he ate Fathomer’s heart and
drank the blood of them both, Rein’s and Fathomer’s. Then Siward heard
what the tits spoke:

- 40 „Bitt þú, Sig-vǫrðr, · bauga rauða;
2 es=a konung=ligt · kvíða mǫrgu.
Mey veit’k ęina, · myklu fęgrsta,
4 golli góddi, · ef þú geta mǫttir.

“Bind, O Siward, the red bighs;
it is not kinglike to tarry much.
I know one maiden fairest of all,
endowed with gold—if thou mightst get her!”

1 Sig-vǫrðr | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R

- 41 „Liggja til Gjúka · grønar brautir,
 2 framm vísa skop · folk-líðöndum;
 þar hefir dýrr konungr · dóttur alna,
 4 þá munt, Sig·vörðr, · mundi kaupa.“
 “Towards Yivick’s home lie green highways:
 the Shapes show the way forth for wandering exiles.
 There the wealthy king has reared a daughter;
 her wilt thou, Siward, for a bride-fee buy.”

4 Sig·vörðr | metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urðr R

- 42 „Salr ’s á hǫu · Hindar-fjalli,
 2 allr ’s hann útan · elli sveipinn;
 þann hafa horskir · halir of gǫrvan
 4 ór òðökkum · ógnar ljóma.“
 “A hall stands on the high Hinderfell;
 it is all outside by fire enwrapped,
 that one have wise men made
 from an un-dark radiance of terror.”

- 43 „Væt’k á fjalli · folk-vitr sofa
 2 ok lǣkr yfir · lindar váði;
 Yggr stakk þorni— · aðra féldi
 4 hǫr-Gefn hali · es hafa vildi.“
 “I know on the fell a war-wight sleeps
 and over her licks the linden’s harm [FIRE].
 Ug stung her with a thorn; the flax-Yevn [LADY] slew
 the other heroes who wished to have her.”

- 44 „Knátt, mögr, séa · mey und hjalmi
 2 þá’s frá vígi · Ving-skorni reið;
 má=at Sigr·drífar · svefni bregða,
 4 skjöldunga niðr, · fyr skǫpum norna.“
 “Thou wilt, lad, see the maiden beneath a helmet,
 her who from the fray on Wingshorner rode.
 No man may break Syedrive’s sleep,
 O heir of the Shieldings, against the Shapes of the Norns.”

- P6 Sig·urðr reið eptir slóð Fáfnis til bólis hans ok fann þat opit
 2 ok hurðir af járne ok gétti; af járne vóru ok allir timbr-stokkar í

4 húsi'nu en grafit í jorð niðr. Þar fann Sig·urðr stór-mikit gull
 ok fylldi þar tvær kistur. Þar tók hann ógis-hjálrn ok gull-brynju
6 ok sverð'it Hrotta ok marga dýr-gripi ok klyfjaði þar með Grana.
 En hestr'inn vildi eigi fram ganga fyrr en Sig·urðr steig á bak
 hónum.

Siward rode along Fathomer's trail to his dwelling and found it open and doors and rabbits of iron. Of iron were also all the timber trunks in the house, and dug down into the earth. There Siward found very much gold and he filled there two chests. Then he took the helmet of awe and a golden byrnie and the sword Rotte and many precious things and loaded Grane with them. But the horse did not want to go forth until Siward mounted his back.

Speeches of Syedrive (*Sigr·drífu mól*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.961)

Meter: Ancient-words-law(1, 5), Leeds-meter(2–4, 6–13/4, 18–22, 23/6–27), Galders-law (13/5–14, 16–17, 23/1–23/5), Speeches-meter (15)

Introduction

The **Speeches of Syedrive** (*Sigrdr*) are found in **R**, where they directly continue the narrative told in *Reg* and *Fáfn*. In the manuscript there is no marker of any kind, not even an initial, separating the poem from *Fáfn*; the title is editorial.

Stanzas in *Vǫls*

A number of stanzas are quoted in **N**, the main ms. of *Vǫls*. *Vǫls* ch. 21 begins with the following passage, which is clearly based chiefly on *Sigrdr* P3, but in the mention of the gods perhaps also sts. 3–4:

Bryn·bldr segir, at tveir konungar þorðust. Hét annarr Hjalm·Gunn·arr; bann var gamall ok hinn mesti bermaðr, ok hafði Óðinn bonum sigr heitit. En annarr Agnarr eða Auða bróðir. „Ek féllða Hjalm·Gunn·arr í orrostu, en Óðinn stakk mik svefn·þorni í befn þess ok kvað mik aldri síðan skyldu sigr hafa ok kvað mik giptast skulu. En ek strengða þess beit þar í mót at giptast engum þeim, er bręðast kynni.“ Sig·urðr męlti: „Kenn oss ráð til stórra hluta.“ Hun svarar: „Þér munuð betr kunna, en með þökkum vil ek kenna yðr, ef þat er nokkut, er vér kunnum, þat er yðr mętti líka, í rúnum eða qðrum blutum, er liggja til hvers hlutar, ok drekkum bæði saman, ok gefi goðin okkr góðan dag, at þér verði nýt ok fregð at mínum vitrleik, ok þú munir eptir þat, er vit réðum.“ Bryn·bldr fyllði eitt ker ok fęrði Sig·urði ok męlti:

‘Byrnhild tells that two kings fought each other. The one was called Helm-Guther; he was old and the greatest warrior, and Weden had promised him victory. But the other was called Eyner or Ead’s brother.

“I made Helm-Guther fall in battle, but Weden stung me with a sleeping-thorn as revenge for that, and said that I should never thenceforth have victory and said that I must marry. But I made the vow in response to marry no such one as could be frightened.” Siward spoke: “Teach us counsel about great things.” She answers: “Ye will know better, but with thanks will I teach you if there be anything which we know that may please you, of runes or other things of importance; and let us both drink together, and may the gods give us two a good day, that thou mayst have use and pleasure from my wisdom and that thou mayst afterwards recall that of which we two speak.” Byrnhild filled a vessel and brought it to Siward and spoke:’

After this the saw cites sts. 5–13 and 15–19 in uninterrupted sequence, and paraphrases sts. 20 ff. (TODO: edit these!) The order of stanzas in N is rather different from that of R. Both mss. have sts. 5–6 and 13–19 in the same order, but the order of sts. 7–12 in between is divergent. The following table illustrates the relationship:

	<i>pres. ed.</i>	R	N
5	Bjór fóri’k þér	5	6
6	Sig-rúnar skalt rísta	6	7
7	Ql-rúnar skalt kunna	7	10
8	Full skal signa	7*	11
9	Bjarg-rúnar skalt kunna	8	12
10	Brim-rúnar skalt rísta	9	8
11	Lim-rúnar skalt kunna	10	13
12	Mál-rúnar skalt kunna	11	9
13	Hug-rúnar skalt kunna	12a	14
14	Á bjargi stóð	12b–13	–
15	Á skildi kvað ristnar	14–15/4	15–17
16	Allar vöru af skafnar	15/5–16	18
17	Þat eru bókrúnar	17	19
18	Nú skalt kjósa	18	20
19	Mun’k=a ek flója	19	21

Contents

TODO.

Text

P1 Sig-urðor reið upp á Hindar-fjall ok stefndi suðr til Frakklands.
 2 Á fjalli'nu sá hann ljós mikit svá sem eldr brynni, ok ljómaði af
 til himins. En er hann kom at þá stóð þar skjald-borg ok upp
 4 ór merki. Sig-urðor gekk í skjald-borg'ina ok sá at þar lá maðr ok
 svaf með öllum her-vápnum. Hann tók fyrst hjálm'inn af höfði
 6 hánun; þá sá hann at þat var kona. Brynjan var fóst sem hón væri
 hold-gróin. Þá reist hann með Gram frá höfuð-smátt brynju'na
 8 í gognum niðr ok svá út í gognum báðar ermar. Þá tók hann
 brynju af henni en hón vaknaði ok settisk hón upp ok sá Sig-urð
 10 ok mēlti:

Siward rode up on the Hinderfell and stood looking south toward Frankland.
 On the fell he saw a light as great as if a fire burned; and the rays from it
 went up to heaven. But when he came to it there was a shield-wall rising up
 out of the ground. Siward went into the shield-wall and saw that a man lay
 there, sleeping in full armour. He first took the helmet off the man's head;
 then he saw that it was a woman. The byrnie was as tight as if it were grown
 out of her flesh. Then he took Gram and cut the byrnie from the head-hole
 down through and then out through both sleeves. Then he took the byrnie
 off her, and she awakened and sat herself up and saw Siward and spoke:

1 „Hvat bēit brynju? · Hví brá'k svefni?

[R 31v/33]

2 Hverr fēldi af mér · fólvar nauðir?“

Hann svaraði:

„Sig-mundar burr, · slēit fyr skömmu

4 hrafns hrē-lundir · hjorr Sig-varðar.“

“What bit the byrnie? How did I break my sleep?
 Who loosened from me these death-pale chains?”

He answered: “Syemund's son [= Siward] has just torn off
 the raven's corpse-trees [BYRNIE?] with Siward's sword.”

4 Sig-varðar | metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðar R

4 hrafns hrē-lundir ‘the raven's corpse-trees [BYRNIE?]' | An unclear kenning. TODO.

[Sigrdrífa kvað:] 2 „Lengi ek svaf, · lengi ek sofnuð vas,

[R 32r/2]

2 löng eru lýða lē;

Óðinn því veldr · es ęigi máttat'k

4 bregða blund-stöfum.“

[Quoth Syedrive:] “Long I slept, long was I asleep,
 long are the guiles of men.

It is Weden's fault that I could not
break the staves of sleep."

- P2 Sig·urðr settisk niðr ok spyr hana nafns. Hón tók þá horn fullt
2 mjaðar ok gaf hönum minnis-veig.

Siward set himself down, asking for her name. She then took a horn full of
mead and gave him a draught of remembrance:

2 minnis-veig 'draught of remembrance' | To drink someone's *minni* 'memory, remembrance'
seems originally to have referred specifically to the funerary toast, but here has clearly come to
carry a broader sense, viz. to drink a toast to someone's favour, whether man or god.

- 3 Heill Dagr, · heilir Dags synir,
2 heil Nött ok nipt!
Ö·vręðum augum · lítið okkr þinig
4 ok gefið sitjendum sigr!

[R 32r/6]

"Hail Day! Hail the sons of Day!
Hail Night and her kinswoman!
With unwrathful eyes look Ye towards us twain
and give the settlers [= us] victory.

ALL | *Sigrdr* 3–4 represents the only surviving poetic prayer to the collective Gods in the whole
Norse literature (for prayers to individual gods, esp. Thunder and Weden, cf. Lindow (1988), and
in the pres. ed. *Cant* and N B380 under Galders). Both stanzas follow the same balanced outline:
the first helming (ll. 1–2) invokes the relevant gods and the second (ll. 3–4) makes the request.
The speaker is Sýchdrive, who is the one offering the horn.

1 Dags synir 'the sons of Day' | Their identity is uncertain, for Day does not have any known
sons in the Norse mythology. Based on comparative mythology the most likely candidates are the
heavenly Horse Twins, who are securely attested in the Vedic, Greek, and Baltic traditions. In the
Vedic religion the two *āsvínau* are the children of Father Heaven and follow the Dawn (Brereton and
Jamison, 2020, pp. 81–84). In the Greek the two Διός-κούροι (lit. 'Sons of Zeus') are prominent
horsemen, but their celestial role is less apparent. In the Latvian folksongs the *Dieva dēli* 'Sons
of Dievs' are still closely associated with the Heaven, although they are not always twins (Calin
1996, pp. 53–65), while the Lithuanian horse-twins (the *Asvieniai*) pull the Sun-chariot. Within
the Germanic sphere, the Twins have often been associated with the Anglo-Saxon founding figures
Hengist and *Horsa*, which however have no solar associations apart from their coming from the east;
there are also the two stallions Yorewaker and Allswith which pull the Sun (*Grm* 38, *Sigrdr* 15a/2),
but they do not have any anthropomorphic riders. An archeological connection may be made
with a pair of cultic figures from Grevensvænge, Denmark, dated to periods 4–5 (1100–700 BC) of
the Nordic Bronze Age (Thrane 2010). The two bronze figures, both wearing horned helmets, are
depicted as sitting on their knees beside each other with their backs straight, facing forwards. They
mirror each other, so that their inner elbows touch, placing the inner hand on the belly, while the
outer arm raises a large axe. The two were originally connected at their knees by a bronze support,
and belonged to a larger ensemble which was probably originally placed upon a cultic solar boat
(Glob 1961), in which case a solar association (like the other IE Twins) is certain.

2 nipt ‘her kinswoman’ | The identity of this kinswoman (*nipt* typically refers to a younger female relative) is not clear. According to *Gylf* 10:4 (cited in *Vafþ* 11 n.) the daughter of Night is Earth, but Earth is also mentioned in st. 4/4 and so might be out of place here. If we look beyond Norse mythology in its Scaldic form as codified by Snorre, the kinswoman of Night may tentatively be identified with the obscure Germanic Dawn-goddess, whose Vedic equivalent (OI *uśás*) is conceived of as the sister or daughter of the Night (*nákti*; Brereton and Jamison 2020, p. 93; *RV* 1.113, 1.124.8, 3.55.12, 7.71.1, etc.) and who is often ritually paired with her (1.13.7, 2.3.6, 3.4.6, etc.). This would be a ritual archaism predating the Scaldic system, but it has the advantage of giving the stanza greater internal consistency. All gods described in it would then be heavenly phenomena, who can gaze with their “eyes” onto the couple, something the Earth cannot. A similar “pre-Scaldic” linguistic archaism is likely found in *fold* in st. 4 below.

3 Ó-vręðum augum · litið okkr þinig ‘With unwrathful eyes look Ye towards us two’ | I.e., ‘gaze upon us with gracious eyes’, the grace (or wrath) of the Gods being conveyed by their eyes turning towards the worshipper. Cf. *Hdl* 6/2–3.

This anthropomorphic conception of the divine gaze is very old and within Indo-European has secure parallels in Greek, OI, Avestan, and Hittite (West 2007, p. 318). Further parallels are found among both the Hebrews and Egyptians, which however speak about the face rather than the eyes. Biblical examples include the famous Priestly Blessing of Numbers 6:25–26 (“May YHWH light up His face to thee and grant grace to thee; / May YHWH lift up His face to thee and give thee peace.”), Psalms 4:6 (“Lift up the light of Thy face to us, YHWH”), and the chorus of Psalms 80 (“YHWH God of Armies, bring us back. / Light up Thy face, that we may be rescued.”) while Egyptian examples involve the phrase *nfr hr* ‘good, fair of face,’ which refers specifically to the grace of a god or god-like ruler (Spiegelberg 1917, p. 115) and which is known from inscriptions as early as the 4th dynasty of the Old Kingdom (ca. 2600 BCE) (Abdelhamid 2018, p. 146) until as late as the very last known Hieroglyphic inscription (GPH 436, from 394 CE) (Griffith 1937, pp. 126–127; Parkinson 1999, pp. 178–179). Spiegelberg (1917, p. 115) cites the following Middle Kingdom prayer to Osiris from the 18th dynasty (ca. 1400 BCE), which I find particularly similar to the present stanza (my translation from his German): “Mayst Thou be gracious to me (*hṯp=k n=f*); may Thy face be fair towards me (*nfr hr=k ’m=f*) on the day when I behold Thy fairness.”

4 Hęilir ęsir, · hęilar ęsynjur,
2 hęil sjá in fјol-nýta fold!
Mál ok man-vit · gefið okkr męrum tvęim
4 ok lęknis-hęndr meðan lifum!

[R 32r/7]

Hail the Eese! Hail the Ossens!

Hail this much-bountiful Fold!

Speech and manwit give Ye us famed twain,
and a leecher’s hands, while we live.”

1 Hęilir ęsir, · hęilar ęsynjur ‘Hail the Eese! Hail the Ossens!’ | The same line occurs in *Lok* 11, but is there subverted; just like here, the first half of that stanza hails the Gods, but the second half, instead of asking for a boon, instead insults one of the gods present by beginning with the word *nema* ‘except, save for’. The direction of influence is almost certainly from a prayer like the present stanza to *Lok*, for it is surely much less likely for a blasphemous parody of a prayer to inspire a real one than the reverse.

2 sjá in fjöl-nýta fold ‘this much-bountiful Fold’ | The bountiful Earth, an expression with Indo-European roots. Throughout the rest of the Norse poetic corpus *fold* refers exclusively to the unpersonified inanimate “land, earth” without religious associations, but the present instance seems to be a ritual archaism. Cf. the Old English *Æcer* 5/1: *Hāl wes þú Folde · firba módor!* ‘Hale be thou, Fold, mother of men!’ and the Old Indian cognate *Pṛthivī* (Brereton and Jamison, 2020, p. 96), found frequently in *ṚV* (e.g. 1.89.4b: *mātā Pṛthivī* ‘mother Earth’). The common IE root is **pṛth₂-* ‘flat, broad’ which has been nominalized as a feminine noun (PGmc. **fuldō* < **pṛth₂-eb₂*; OI *pṛthivī* < **pṛth₂-u-ib₂*, Kroonen 2013, p. 159). For this development cf. Hfr *Hákr* 8 (in SkP 3), where Earth is the *breið-leita brúðr Bál-eygs* ‘broad-faced bride of Bale-eye (= Weden)’. — For the epithet ‘much-giving’ cf. *II* 3.89: ἐπὶ χθονὶ πολυ-βοτείρῃ ‘upon the much-nourishing earth’, where the Greek πολυ- is cognate with ON *fjöl-*, both deriving from PIE **pólb₁u-* ~ **pólb₁u-* ‘much, many’ (Kroonen 2013, p. 136).

3 Mál ‘Speech’ | Good speech, by which is also understood silence rather than frivolous chatter. For the importance of proper speech see *Háv* 7/2 n.

3 man-vit ‘manwit’ | Wisdom to conduct ourselves uprightly; for this word see *Háv* 6/6 n.

4 lēknis-hendr ‘a leecher’s hands’ | The hands of a physician, i.e., hands with (magical) powers of healing. The singular *lēknis-hönd* occurs on the Ribe galder-stick (SJy 41), edited below under Galders.

- P3** Hón nefndi=sk Sigrdrífa ok var val-kyrja. Hón sagði, at tveir
 2 konungar þorðu=sk. Hét annarr Hjalm-Gunn·arr; hann var þá
 gamall ok inn mesti her-maðr, ok hafði Óðinn hönum sigri heitit.
 4 En annarr hét Agnarr, · *Auðu bróðir
 es vétr engi · vildi þiggja.
 6 Sigr·drífa felldi Hjalm-Gunn·ar í orrostu’nni, en Óðinn stakk
 hana svefn-þorni í hefnð þess ok kvað hana aldri skyldu síðan
 8 sigr vega í orrostu, ok kvað hana gipta=sk skyldu, „en sagða’k
 hönum at strengða’k heit þar í mót, at gipta=sk öngom þeim
 10 manni er hréða=sk kynni.“ Hann segir ok biðr hana kenna sér
 speki ef hón vissi tíðendi ór qllum heimum. Sigr·drífa kvað:

She said her name was Syedrive and was a walkirie. She said that two kings had fought; one was called Helm-Guther—he was old by then and the great-warrior, and Weden had promised him victory,

but the other was called Eyner, Ead’s brother,
 who in no way wished to sue for peace.

Syedrive made Helm-Guther fall in the battle, but Weden stung her with the sleeping-thorn as revenge for that and declared that she would never thenceforth win victory in battle and said that she must marry, “but I told him that I had made a vow in response not to marry any man who could be frightened.” He [= Siward] speaks and asks her to teach him wisdom if she knew tidings out of all the Homes. Quoth Syedrive:

4 *Auðu | *emend.*; Hauðu R

4 *Auðu | It is proven beyond a doubt by *Helr* 8 that the correct form of the name is in fact *Auða* (as found in *Vpls* 21; see introduction above). The form with *b-* is thus due to corruption.

- 5 „Bjór föri’k þér, · bryn-þings apaldr,
2 magni blandinn · ok megin-tíri,
fullr es ljóða · ok líkn-stafa,
4 góðra galdra · ok gaman-rúna.

[R 32r/18–20, N 24v/1]

Beer I bring thee—O apple-tree of the byrnie-Thing [BATTLE > WARRIOR]!—
mixed with might and mighty splendour.
It is full of leeds and grace-staves,
of good galders and pleasure-runes.

1 bryn-þings apaldr ‘apple-tree of the byrnie-Thing [BATTLE > WARRIOR]’ | bryn-þinga valdr ‘wielder of byrnie-Things [BATTLES > WARRIOR]’ N 4 gaman-rúna ‘pleasure-runes’ | gaman-þrædna† N

- 6 Sig-rúnar skalt rísta, · ef vilt sigr hafa,
2 ok rísta á hjalti hjors,
sumar á vétt-rimum, · sumar á val-bøstum,
4 ok nefna tysvar Tý.

[R 32r/20–22, N 24v/1]

Victory-runes shalt thou know, if thou wilt have victory,
and carve them on the hilt of the sword;
some on the weight-rims, some on the wal-basts,
and twice name Tew.

1 sigr hafa ‘have victory’ | snotr vera ‘be clever’ N 2 rísta | †rist† N 3 sumar ‘some’ | *om.* N 3 vétt-rimum ‘weight-rims’ | vétt-†rvnum† N 3 sumar ‘some’ | ok ‘and’ N 3 val-bøstum ‘wal-basts’ | val-†bystum† N

3 vétt-rimum ‘weight-rims’ | Unclear. TODO.

3 val-bøstum ‘wal-basts’ | Possibly the sword-pommel; this word also occurs in *HHj* 9. TODO.

- 7 Ql-rúnar skalt kunna · ef vilt at annars kvæn
2 véli=t þik í tryggð ef trúir;
á horni skal þér rísta · ok á handar baki
4 ok mækja á nagli Nauð.

[R 32r/22–24, N 25r/1]

Ale-runes shalt thou know, if thou wilt that another man’s wife
not betray thee in troth if thou trust her.
On the horn shall one carve them, and on the back of the hand,
and mark Need on the nail.

1 at ‘that’ | *emend. from* †a† N; *om.* R 2 véli=t þik í tryggð | véli þik eigi tryggð N 3 þér ‘them’ | þat ‘it’ N

4 Nauð ‘Need’ | i.e., the n-rune, †.

- 8 Full skal signa · ok við fari séa

[R 32r/24–25, N 25r/3]

- 2 ok verpa lauki í lög;
 þá þat veit'k, · at þér verðr aldri=gi
 4 męini blandinn mjðr.

The cup shall one sign, and gaze against the danger,
 and throw in the liquid a leek.
 Then I know that it will never be
 mixed with harm, thy mead.

1 Full 'The cup' | ǫl 'The ale' N breaks alliteration. 4 męini blandinn | emend.; męin-blandinn N

1 signa 'sign' | Dedicating the cup by means of making a certain sign or speech over it. TODO.

3-4 þá ... mjðr | only in N; om. R

- 9 Bjarg-rúnar skalt kunna · ef bjarga vilt
 2 ok leysa kind frá konum;
 á lófa þér skal rísta · ok of liðu spęnna
 4 ok biðja þá dísir duga.

[R 32r/25-26, N 25r/5-7]

Rescue-runes shalt thou know, if thou wilt rescue
 and loosen children from women;
 on the palm shall one carve them, and wrap them round the joints,
 and then bid the dises to avail.

1 kunna 'know' | nema 'learn' N 1 ef bjarga vilt 'if thou wilt rescue' | ef þú vilt borgit fá 'if thou wilt have rescued' N 4 þá 'then' | om. N

4 dísir 'dises' | Minor goddesses and fates; one of their roles was helping ailing women during childbirth. Cf. *Fáfn* 12 where *nornir* 'Norns' is used for the childbirth goddesses.

- 10 Brim-rúnar skalt rísta · ef vilt borgit hafa
 2 á sundi segl-mörum;
 á stafni skal rísta · ok á stjórnar blaði
 4 ok leggja ęld í ár;
 es=a svá brattr breki · né svá bláar unnir,
 6 þó kǫmsk-tu hęill af hafi.

[R 32r/27-29, N 24v/16-19]

Surf-runes shalt thou carve, if thou wilt rescue
 sail-steeds [SHIPS] on the sound;
 on the stem shall one carve them, and on the rudder's blade,
 and lay fire into the oar.
 There is not so steep a breaker nor so dark blue waves
 that thou not come whole off the sea.

1 rísta 'carve' | gjöra 'make' N 3 skal rísta 'shall [one] carve' | skal þér rísta 'shall [one] carve them' N 5 es=a 'There is not' | falla=t 'There fall not' N

4 leggja eld í ár 'lay fire into the oar' | i.e., mark it with fire in some way.

6 þó kómsk-tu heill af hafi 'that thou not come whole off the sea.' | Lit. "yet comest thou whole off the sea."

- 11 **L**im-rúnar skalt kunna · ef wilt **l**éknir vesa
 2 ok kunna **s**ór at **s**éa;
 3 à **b**erki skal þér rísta · ok à **ba**ðmi viðar,
 4 þeim's **l**úta austr **l**imar.

[R 32r/29–31, N 25r/7]

Limb-runes shalt thou know, if thou wilt be a leecher,
 and know how to look at wounds;
 on the bark shall one carve them, and on the trunk of the tree:
 on the one whose limbs bow to the east.

3 baðmi 'beam' | barri 'leaf' 4 þeim's | þess es N

1 léknir 'leecher' | Physician; see *Háv* 148 n.

- 12 **M**ál-rúnar skalt kunna · ef wilt at **mann**=gi þér
 2 **h**éptum gjaldi **h**arm;
 3 þér of **v**indr, · þér of **v**efr,
 4 þér of **s**etr allar **s**aman,
 5 à **þ**ví þingi · es þjóðir skulu
 6 i fulla dóma **f**ara.

[R 32r/31–34, N 24v/]

Speech-runes shalt thou know, if thou wilt that no man
 should repay thy insults with harm;
 them wilt thou wind, them wilt thou weave,
 them wilt thou sew all together,
 on that Thing where peoples shall
 go to full judgments.

1 vilt | om. N 2 gjaldi | †giallda† N 5 þjóðir 'peoples' | menn N *breaks alliteration*.

- 13 **H**ug-rúnar skalt kunna · ef wilt **h**verjum vesa
 2 **g**æð-svinnari **g**uma;
 3 þér of **r**éð, · þér of **r**eist,
 4 þér of **h**ugði **H**roptr,
 5 af þeim **l**egi · es lekit hafði
 6 ór **h**ausi **H**eið·draupnis
 ok ór **h**orni **H**odd·rofnis.

[R 32r/34–32v/3, N 25r/]

Mind-runes shalt thou know, if thou wilt be
 swifter in sense than every man;

them did counsel, them did carve,
 them did Roft think out,
 from that liquid which had leaked
 out of Heathdreepner's skull
 and out of Hoardrovner's horn.

1 kunna 'know' | nema 'learn' N 2 geð-svinnari 'swifter in sense' | geð-horskari 'sharper in sense'
 N 5-7 af ... Hodd-rofnis 'from ... horn. | om. N

14 Á bjargi stóð · með Brimis eggjar,

[R 32v/3-4]

2 hafði sér á hofði hjalm;
 þá mælti Míms hofuð
 4 fróðligt it fyrsta orð,
 ok sagði sanna stafi.

On the barrow he stood along Brimer's edges;
 he had on his head a helmet.
 Then Mime's head spoke,
 learnedly, the first word,
 and said true staves:

15 Á skildi kvað ristnar · þeim's stendr fyr skínanda goði,

[R 32v/5-7, N 25r/11-13]

2 á eyra Árvaks, · ok á Al·svinn's hófi,
 á því hvéli · es snýsk und reið Hrungnis,
 4 á Sleipnis tönnum · ok á sleða fjötrum,

On the shield, he said, [runes] were carved—on the one that stands before
 the Shining God [SUN];
 on Yorewaker's ear and on Allswith's hoof,
 on the wheel which turns beneath Rungner's chariot,
 on Slopner's teeth and on the fetters of sleds,

2 á eyra Árvaks, · ok á 'on Yorewaker's ear and on' | om. N 3 á | ok á N 3 snýsk 'turns' |
 stendr 'stands' N 3 Hrungnis 'Rungner's' | emend. based on sense and meter; Raygnis R; Raugnis
 N 4 tönnum 'teeth' | taunnum 'reins' N

1 skildi ... þeim's stendr fyr skínanda goði 'the shield ... that stands before the Shining God' | For
 this notion cf. *Grm* 39, according to which the Sun is covered by a disc shielding the earth from
 its heat. Without it, the whole world would burn up.

2 Árvaks ... Al·svinn's 'Yorewaker ... Allswith' | The two horses that pull the Sun across the
 heavens; cf. st. 3/1 n. above, *Grm* 38.

6 á bjarnar hrammi · ok á Braga tungu,
 á ulfs klóum · ok á arnar nefi,
 á blóðgum vængjum · ok á brúar sporði,

[R 32v/7-9, N 25r/13-15]

8 à lausnar lófa · ok à líknar spori,

on the bear's paw and on Bray's tongue,
on the wolf's claws and on the eagle's beak,
on bloody wings and on the bridge's head,
on the palm of release and the trail of grace,

6 nęfi | †nefiu† N 8 ok à | ok N

 à gļeri ok à golli · ok à gumna heillum,

[R 32v/9–11, N 25r/15–

10 í víni ok virtri · ok vili-sessi,

 à Gunnis oddi · ok à Grana brjósti,

12 à nornar nagli · ok à nęfi uglu;

on glass and on gold and on men's luck-charms,
in wine and beerwort and the comfortable seat,
on Gungner's point and on Grane's chest,
on a norn's nail and on an owl's beak.

9 gumna heillum 'men's luck-charms' | góðu silfri 'good silver' N 10 vili-sessi 'the comfortable seat' | völu sessi 'a willow's seat' N 10 vili-sessi 'the comfortable seat' | í guma holdi 'in a man's flesh' add. N. 11 Gunnis oddi 'Gungner's point' | Gaupnis oddi 'Yéapner's point' (an elsewhere unknown spear) N 11 Grana brjósti 'Grane's chest' | gýgjar brjósti 'a gow's chest' N

16 Allar vöru af skafnar, · þér's vöru à ristnar,

[R 32v/11–14, N 25r/18

2 ok hvefðar við inn hęlga mjōð

ok sęndar à víða vega:

4 þér 'ro með ósum, · þér 'ro með olfum,

sumar með vísu vqnum,

6 sumar hafa męnskir męnn.

All were shaven off—those that were carved on—
and mixed into the holy mead,
and sent on wide ways:

They are among the Eese, they are among the Elves,
some among the wise Waners,
some have manly men.

2 hvefðar 'mixed' | †hrędar† (for hrórðar 'stirred?') N 4 ósum ... olfum 'Eese ... Elves' | olfum ... ósum 'Elves ... Eese' N 4 þér 'ro 'they are' | sumar 'some' N 5 sumar 'some' | ok 'and' N

2 hęlga mjōð 'the holy mead' | Apparently the Mead of Poetry. This is the only place in the Eddic corpus where it is called *hęilag* 'holy, inviolable', but in Scaldic poetry it is called holy in the late pagan composition Refr *Giz* 2 (in SkP 3): *hęilagt full brafni-ásar* 'the holy cup of the Raven-Os [= Weden > POETRY]'.

17 Þat eru bók-rúnar, · þat eru bjarg-rúnar

[R 32v/14–16, N 25r/2

- 2 ok allar ǫl-rúnar
 ok mętar męgin-rúnar
 4 hveim's þęr kná ó-villtar · ok ó-spilltar
 sér at heillum hafa;
 6 njót-tu ef namt
 und's rjúfa-sk ręgin!“

They are book-runes, they are rescue-runes,
 and all ale-runes,
 and noble might-runes—
 for whomever knows them unfalsified and uninjured
 to have for himself as charms.
 Use them if thou learn them
 until the Reins are ripped!“

1 þat eru 'the are' | ok 'and' N 3 ok mętar 'and noble' | ok męrar ok 'and renowned and' N 4
 ó-spilltar | þof villtar† N 7 rjúfa-sk | rjúfa N

1 bók-rúnar 'book-runes' | The word ought likely to be emended to **bót-rúnar* 'remedy-runes', since the letters *c* and *t* are often conflated due to their similarity. This emendation is supported by two arguments. Firstly the semantic pair *bót* 'remedy' : *bjarg* 'rescue' is surely stronger than *bók* 'book, beech' : *bjarg* 'rescue' and the stanza is specifically referring to the practical (magico-medical) use of the runes. Secondly the pair *bót-rúnar* : *bjarg-rúnar* is in fact attested on a runic charm, N B257 (edited under Galders from Bryggen).

- 18 „Nú skalt kjósa · alls þęr 's konstr of boðinn,
 2 hvassa vǫpna hlynr,
 sęgn eða þęgn · haf þęr sjalfr ĩ hug;
 4 ęll eru męin of metin.“

[R 32v/16–18, N 25v/3–5]

[Quoth Syedrive:] “NOW SHALT THOU CHOOSE, as the choice is offered thee,
 O maple-tree of sharp weapons [WARRIOR]!
 Speech or silence have for thyself in thy heart;
 all the harms are measured!”

1 Nú 'Now' | Ornamented with 4 cross-bars in R.

ALL | Another section begins, though the speaker is the same. Byrnhild offers the young Siward the choice between taking her prophetic advice or letting it remain unsaid. Much of the advice likely relates to Siward's future dealings with the Nivlings Guthar and Hawn, and the implication of Byrnhild's offering him the choice seems to be that he will not entirely enjoy having the knowledge of things to come (for that theme cf. *Grip* and *Háv* 56).

4 of metin 'measured' | I.e., in advance, by the *Mjotuðr* 'Measurer'; cf. *Vsp* 45/1 n.

- 19 „Mun'k=a ek flója · þó'tt mik fęigan vitir,
 2 em'k=a ek með bleyði borinn;
 ęst-ręð þín · ek vil ęll hafa

[R 32v/18–20, N 25v/5–8]

4 svá lęngi sem ek lifi.“

[Quoth Siward:] “I shall not flee, although thou mightst know me to be fey;
I was not born with softness.
Thy loving counsels, all, will I have
for as long as I may live.”

2 með | om. N

2 með bleyði borinn ‘born with softness’ | A common heroic expression or formula. Being “born with softness” means that one was born soft and cowardly (*blauðr*), and such traits were thought to last from childhood unchanged into adulthood unchanged; cf. *Fáfn* 6/4.

20 „Þat réð’k þér it fyrsta · at við fręndr þína
2 vamma-laust verir;
síðr þú hefñir · þótt þęir sakar gøri;
4 þat kveða dauðum duga.“

[R 32v/20–22]

[Quoth Syedrive:] “This I counsel thee first: that thou against thy kinsmen
defend thyself faultlessly.
Late oughtst thou to take revenge, although they incur charges;
that, they say, befits the dead.

21 Þat réð’k þér annat, · at eið né svęrir,
2 nema þann ’s saðr séi,
grimmar simar · ganga at tryggð-rofi;
4 armr es vára vargr.

[R 32v/22–24]

This I counsel thee second: that thou not swear an oath,
save for the one which is true.
Grim strands follow the troth-breach;
wretched is the outlaw of vows.

ALL | The punishment for perjury is one of painful torment in the afterlife; see note to *Vsp* 39.
— The whole stanza is paraphrased in *Vþls* ch. 21: *Ok sver eigi rangan eið, því at grimn hefnd fylgir griðrofi*. ‘And swear no wrong oath, for grim revenge follows the grith-breach.’

3 simar ‘strands’ | i.e., ‘strands of fate’; cf. *1 HHund* 3, where the norms are said to twist such strands. Often emended to *limar* ‘ramifications’ in accordance with *Reg* 4, where that word is used in basically the same context. Such a scribal confusion is easily understood, since *s* in this position was always spelled with long *f* in the old mss. The paraphrase (see other note) is not conclusive, since it replaces this word with *befnd* ‘revenge’.

22 Þat réð’k þér þriðja · at þú þingi á
2 deili=t við heimska hali
því’t ó-sviðr maðr · léttr oft kveðin
4 verri orð an viti.

[R 32v/24–25]

This I counsel thee third: that thou on the Thing
not bandy with foolish men;
for an unwise man often lets be spoken
worse words than he ought to know.

- 23 Allt es vant · ef við þegir;
2 þá þikkir þú með bleyði borinn
eða sönnu sagðr;
4 hētr es heimis-kviðr
nema sér góðan geti.
6 Annars dags · lát hans ondu farit
ok launa svá lýðum lygi.

[R 32v/25–28]

Everything is wrong if thou shut up in reply;
then thou seemest born with softness,
or truthfully accused.
Risky is the hometown-verdict,
unless one get himself a good one.
On another day destroy his life,
and thus repay the people for the lie.

6 ondu 'life' | lit. 'breath, spirit'. Cf. *Vsp* 17 where *ond* is Wēden's gift to the first men.

- 24 Þat réð'k þér it fjórða · ef býr for-déða
2 vamma-full á vegi:
ganga 's betra · an gista séi
4 þó'tt þik nótt of nemi.

[R 32v/28–30]

This I counsel thee fourth: if there lives an evil-working woman,
full of faults, by the road,
to walk is better than to take lodgings [with her]
although night overtake thee.

- 25 For-njósna augu · þurfu fira synir
2 hvar's skulu vreiðir vega;
opt bøl-vísar konur · sitja brautu nér;
4 þér's deyfa sverð ok sefa.

[R 32v/30–32]

Eyes of looking-out do the sons of folk need,
wherever wroth men shall fight;
oft bale-wise women sit near the highway,
they who dull sword and sense.

1 For-njósna 'looking-out' | Verbal noun to *nýsask fyrir* 'look out, look ahead', as found in *Háv* 7.

- 26 Þat réð'k þér it fimmta, · þó'tt fagrar séir [R 32v/32–34]
 2 brúðir bekkjum á,
 sífa silfr · lát=a þínum svefni ráða,
 4 teygj=at þér at kossi konur.

This I counsel thee fifth: although thou seest
 fair brides on the benches,
 let not kinsmen's silver rule thy sleep;
 lure not women to thee for kisses.

- 27 Þat réð'k þér it sétta, · þó'tt með seggjum fari [R 32v/34]
 2 ǫlðr-mól til ǫfug:
 drukinn deila · skal=at við dolg-viðu
 4 margan stelr vín viti.

This I counsel thee sixth: although among warriors may grow
 the ale-speech too awry,
 drunkenly deal shalt thou not with war-trees [WARRIORS];
 wine steals wit from many.

1 Þat réð'k þér it sétta, · þó'tt með seggjum fari 'This I counsel thee sixth: although among warriors may grow' | The last line of fol. 32v of R, after which we have the Great Lacuna. The rest of *Sigrdr*, including ll. 2–4 of this stanza, are supplied from younger paper mss.

TODO: Add the remaining stanzas from paper manuscripts.

Fragments from the Saw of the Walsings

Introduction

In **R**, *Sigrdr* ends abruptly at stanza 27 due to the loss of a number of pages; the so-called **Great Lacuna**. The poetry contained on these pages undoubtedly belonged to the Walsing cycle and would have dealt at length with the life of Siward.

The author of *Vǫls* drew heavily from a collection of Walsing-cycle poetry closely related to **R**. He quotes many stanzas known from **R**, but also some which do not survive anywhere else—it is these which are edited here. They largely correspond to the story which would have been found in the Great Lacuna and it is probable that most of them derive from the now-lost poems.

TODO: The stanzas [are to] follow the numbering of stanzas in *Vǫls*.

Text

- 1 Ristu af **m**agni · **m**ikla hellu,
2 **S**ig·mundr hjǫrvi · ok **S**in·fjǫtli.

They carved with strength the great stone,
Syemund with sword, and Sinfittle.

- 2 **E**ldr nam at **ó**sask · en **j**örð at skjalfa
2 ok **h**ár logi · við **h**imni gnéfa;
 fár treystisk þar · fylkis rekka
4 **e**ld at ríða · né **y**fir stíga.

The fire took to rage and the earth to shake
and high flame to rise to heaven.
Few there dared of the marshall's champions
the fire to ride or to step over it.

- 3 **Sig-vǫrðr** Grana · sverði keyrði;
 2 **ǣldr** sloknaði · fyr **ǫðlingi**;
 logi allr **légðisk** · fyr **lof-gjörnum**;
 4 **bliku** **reiði**, · es **Reginn** átti.

Siward drove Grane on by his sword;
 the fire went out before the athling;
 the flame all lowered before the praise-eager man;
 the harness flashed which Rein had owned.

1 **Sig-vǫrðr** | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); **Sig-urðr** R

- 4 **Sig-urðr** vá at ormi, · en þat **síðan** mun
 2 **øngum** fyrnask, · meðan **ǫld** lifir.
 En **hlýri** þinn · **hvárki** þorði
 4 **ǣld** at riða · né **yfir** stíga.

Siward smote the Wyrn and that will afterwards
 by none be forgotten while mankind lives—
 but *thy brother* dared neither
 the fire to ride nor to step over it.

- 5 **Út** gekk **Sig-vǫrðr** · **ann**-spjalli frá,
 2 **holl**-vinr lofða, · ok **hnípaði**,
 svá at **ganga** nam · **gunnar**-fúsum
 4 **sundr** of **síður** · **serkr** járn-ofinn.

TODO: translation.

1 **Sig-vǫrðr** | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); **Sig-urðr** R

- 6 Sumir **við**-fiska tóku, · sumir **vitnis**-hré skífðu,
 2 sumir **Gutt**-ormi **göfu** · **gëra** hold
 við **mun**-gáti · ok **marga** hluti
 4 aðra i tyfrum.

Some took wood-fishes [SERPENTS], some sliced wolf-carrion,
 some gave Godthorm hound-flesh
 with strong drink and many other
 things in magic potions.

ALL | This st. is apparently related to *Brot* 4, with which it shares (in divergent form) its first two lines. It is cited in *Vǫls* 30, where it is introduced by the words *sem skáld'it kvað*: ‘as the scald quoth:’

Fragment of a Lay of Siward

(Brot af Sig·urðar kviða)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.974)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

Following the Great Lacuna, the text of **R** picks up in the middle of a lay about Siward and Byrnhild, namely the present **Fragment** (*Brot*). According to the prose at the end of the poem *Brot* originally began with Siward's death. It has been speculated that *Brot* was the original “long” Lay of Siward, contrasting with the “Short Lay of Siward” (*Sigska*).

Although most of *Brot* is lost, parts of *Vǫls* up to ch. 32 are clearly based on it, and a version of st. 4 is cited in *Vǫls* 30.

TODO: Translation is in progress.

Text

- 1 „*hvat* *hefir* *Sig-vǫrðr* · *saka* unnit
2 *es þú fróknan* vill · *fjorvi* néma?“

“[What has Siward] done for a crime,
that thou wilt deprive the brave of life?”

1 *hvat hefir Sig-vǫrðr* ‘[What has Siward]’ | *om.* R

1 *hvat hefir Sig-vǫrðr* ‘[What has Siward]’ | A full reconstruction, which however can be held as reasonably secure owing to the parallelism in the following stanza.

- 2 „*Mér* *hefir* *Sig-vǫrðr* · *selda* *eiða*
2 *eiða* *selda* · *alla* logna;
þá *vélta* hann mik · *es* hann *vesa* skyldi
4 *allra eiða* · *ein* full-trúi.“

“To me has Siward given oaths:
oaths given, all broken;
he tricked me when he should have been
of all the oaths the one true keeper.”

1 *Sig-vǫrðr* | *metr. emend.* (*Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141*); *Sig-urðr* R

- 3 „Þik *hefir* *Bryn-hildr* · *ból* at gørva
2 *heiptar* *hvattan* · *harm* at vinna;
fyr man hön *Guð-runu* · *góðra* ráða
4 en *síðan* þér · *sín* at njóta.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

- 4 Sumir *ulf* sviðu, · sumir *orm* sniðu,
2 sumir *Goðþormi* · af *gæra* deildu,
áðr þeir *métti* · *mæins* of lystir
4 á *horskum* *hal* · *hendr* of leggja.

Some roasted a wolf; some cut up a serpent;
some shared hound-flesh with Godthorm,

TODO.

TODO..

ALL | A related st. is cited in N (*Vþls* 30). It is sufficiently different to be edited on its own; see *Vþlsbr* 6 above.

- 5 Úti stóð Guð·rún · Gjúka dóttir
 2 ok hön þat orða · alls fyrst of kvað:
 „Hvar ’s nú Sig·vörðr · seggja dróttinn
 4 es frændr mínir · fyrri ríða?“

Outside stood Guthrun, Yivick’s daughter,
 and she this word first of all did say:
 “Where is now Siward, the lord of men,
 when my kinsmen ride ahead?”

3 Sig·vörðr | *metr. emend.* (*Sievers* 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R

- 6 Einn því Hogni · and·svör vęitti:
 2 „Sundr hofum Sig·vörðr · sverði hoggvinn;
 gnafir ę grár jór · yfir gram dauðum.“

Alone then Hawn this answer granted:
 “We have cut Siward asunder by sword;
 his grey steed ever neighs over the dead prince.”

2 Sig·vörðr | *metr. emend.* (*Sievers* 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urð R

1 Einn því Hogni · and·svör vęitti ‘Alone then Hawn this answer granted’ | Shared with *Sigsk* 17/1, 45/1, which however have *ęinu* (neut. dat. sg.) for *ęinn* (m. nom. sg.) The difference is probably a mere spelling error, but it is unclear which form of the line is original.

- 7 Þa kvað þat Bryn·hildr · Buðla dóttir:
 2 „Vęl skuluð njóta · vápna ok níu landa;
 ęinn myndi Sig·vörðr · ęllu ráða
 4 ef hann lęngr lítlu · lifi hęldi.“

Then this quoth Byrnhild, Budle’s daughter:
 “Well shall ye enjoy the weapons and nine lands!
 Alone would Siward have ruled them all
 if a little longer he had held his life.”

3 myndi | myndiv R 3 Sig·vörðr | *metr. emend.* (*Sievers* 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R

- [Hogni kvað:] 8 „Vęri=a þat sómt · at hann svá réði
 2 Gjúka arfi · ok gota męngi,
 es hann fimm sonu · at folk-róði

4 gunnar fūsa · getna hafði.“

[Quoth Hawn:] “It would not have been right that he should so have ruled
Yivick’s inheritance and the menfolk of the Gots,
when to rule the folk he had begot
five sons eager for war.”

ALL | The speaker is not indicated, but it is most likely Hawn who responds.

9 Hló þa Bryn·hildr · —bór allr dunði—
2 ēinu sinni · af ǫllum hug:
 „Vēl skuluð njóta · landa ok þegna
4 es þér fróknan gram · falla létuð.“

Then Byrnhild laughed—the town all resounded—
a single time out of all her heart:
“Well shall ye enjoy the lands and thanes,
since ye made the brave prince to fall.”

1–2 Hló ... hug ‘Then ... heart’ | Found near-identically in *Sigsk* 30/1–2.

3 Vēl skuluð njóta · landa ok þegna | Alliteration is missing in this line and no obvious emendation can be found.

10 Þa kvað þat Guð·rún · Gjúka dóttir:
2 „Mjök mēlir þú · miklar firnar;
 gramir hafi Gunn·ar · gǫtvað Sig·varðar,
4 hēipt-gjarns hugar · hēfnt skal verða.“

Then this quoth Guthrun, Yivick’s daughter:
“Many great evils hast thou spoken.
Let the fiends have Guthar, Siward’s burier;
his evil heart will be revenged.”

3 Sig·varðar | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urðar R

3 gramir hafi ‘let the fiends have’ | Apparently a common curse; cf. *Hárþ* 60.

11 Soltinn varð Sig·vǫrðr · sunnan Rinar,
2 hrafn at mēiði · hǫtt kallaði:
 „Ykk mun Atli · eggjar rjóða,
4 munu víg-skáa · of víða eðar.“

Siward expired to the south of the Rhine;
a raven on a branch loudly called out:
“On you two will Atle redden his blades;
the oaths will destroy the war-harried men!”

1 Sig-vörðr | metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R

1 Soltinn varð ‘expired’ | Lit. ‘became, turned dead’; *soltinn* ‘dead; starved, dejected’ is the past participle of *svelta* ‘die; starve’. Apart from the present st. *soltinn* is used in three other places in Norse poetry: *Síðsk* 47/2 (‘dejected’), 50/3 (‘dead’) and 2 *Guðr* 10 (‘dejected’). The penchant for this participle together with the shared subject matter may indicate a close relationship between these three poems.

- 12 Framm vas kvelda · fjölð vas drukkit
 2 þá vas hví-vetna · vil-mál talit;
 sofnuðu allir · es i sęing kvömu,
 4 ęinn vakði Gunn·arr · ęllum lęngr.

The evening was late, much was drunk;
 then were all kinds of pleasant speeches told.
 All fell asleep when they came into bed;
 alone did Guthur wake longer than all.

- 13 Fót nam at hróra · fjölð nam at spjalla
 2 hitt hęr-glötuðr · hyggja téði,
 hvat þęir i bęðvi · báðir sęğðu
 4 hrafn ęy ok ęrn · es þęir hęim riðu.

His foot he took to move, much he took to consider.
 Of this the troop-destroyer thought,
 what in the fray those two had said,
 the raven always and the eagle, when they rode home.

1 Fót ... spjalla ‘His foot ... consider.’ | Probably a formulaic line-template; cf. *Þrk* 1/3.

- 14 Vaknaði Bryn·hildr · Buðla dóttir
 2 dís skjöldunga · fyr dag lítlu:
 „Hvętið mik eða lętið mik · —harmr es unninn—
 4 sorg at sęgja · eða svá láta.“

Byrnhild awoke, Budle’s daughter,
 the dise of shieldings, a little before day:
 “TODO.”

- 15 Þęğðu allir · við því orði
 2 fār kunni þeim · fljóða lötum
 es hön grátandi · gørðisk at sęgja
 4 þat’s hlęjandi · hęlða þęiddi:

All were silent upon that word;

TODO.

when she, weeping, made ready to tell

that which, laughing, she had asked from the heroes:

ALL | Sts. 15–20 are transparently paraphrased in *Vǫls* 31: *Nú þóttist engi kunna at svara, at Brynhildr beiddi þess hljandi, er hón barmaði með gráti. Þá mælti hón: „Þat dreymdi mik, Gunn-arr, at ek átta kalda séng, en þú riðr í bendr ó-vinum þínum, ok öll ert þú mun illa fara, er þér eruð eið-rofa, ok mundir þú þat ó-glǫgt, er þit blönduð blóði saman, Sigurðr ok þú, er þú rétt hann, ok hefir þú bonum allt illu launat þat, er hann gerði vel til þín ok lét þik fremstan vera, ok þá reyndi þat, er hann kom til vár, hvé hann belt sína eiða, at hann lagði okkar í milli it snarp-eggjaða sverð, þat er eitri var bert. [...] (15) Now nobody thought himself able to answer how Byrnhild had laughed when she asked for what she now grieved by weeping. (16) Then she spoke: “I dreamt, Guthur, that I had a cold bed, but thou didst ride into the hands of thy enemies, (17) and all your lineage will fare ill, for ye are oath-breakers, (18) and thou didst not kindly recall how ye two blended your blood together, thou and Siward, when thou betrayed him; and thou hast all cruelly repaid him for how he was good towards thee and let thee be the foremost; (19) and it was proven when he came to us how well he kept his oaths (20) by that he laid between us the sharp-edged sword which was hardened with venom. [...]’*

- 16 „Hugða’k mér, Gunn:arr, · grimmt i svefni,
2 svalt allt i sal · étta’k séing kalda,
en þú gramr riðir · glaums and-vani
4 fjotri fatlaðr · i fjánda lið.

“I had a cruel thought, Guthur, in my sleep:
everything died in the hall, I had a cold bed,
and thou, prince, didst ride without cheerful fellows,
bound by fetters, into a troop of foes.

- 17 Svá mun ǫll yður · étt Niflunga
2 afli gengin— · eruð eið-rofa!

So will all your line of Nivlings
part from power—ye are oath-breakers!

- 18 Mant-at-tu Gunn:arr · til gǫrva þat
2 es þit blóði i spor · báðir rennduð,
nú hefir þú hönum þat allt · illu launat
4 es hann fremstan þik · finna vildi.

Thou didst not recall, Guthur, clearly enough
that your blood in your tracks ye both did drive.
Now hast thou for all that cruelly repaid him,
when he would have *thee* as the foremost man.

4 þik ‘thee’ | so in paraphrase N; sik ‘himself’ R

2 þit blóði í spor · báðir rennduð ‘your blood in your tracks ye both did drive’ | Referring to a ritual of blood-brotherhood, wherein the brothers-to-be would spill and mix their blood into their footprints on the ground. Blood-brotherhood is also mentioned in *Lok* 9, and the footprint-ritual is described in Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 1.6.7: *Siquidem icturi foedus veteres vestigia sua mutui sanguinis aspersione perfundere consueverant, amicitiarum pignus alterni cruoris commercio firmaturi* ‘Now our ancestors, when they meant to strike a pact, would sprinkle their combined blood in their footprints and mingle it, so as to strengthen the pledge of their fellowship.’ For discussion see PCRN History and Structures III:845 ff.

- 19 Þá reyndi þat · es riðit hafði
2 móðigr á vit · mīn at biðja,
hvé her-glötuðr · hafði fyrri
4 eiðum haldit · við inn unga gram.

Then it was proven when he had ridden,
brave, to visit and ask for my hand,
how the troop-destroyer [WARRIOR] had upheld
his side of the oaths against the young lord:

- 20 Ben-vond of lét · brugðinn gólli
2 marg-dýrr konungr · á meðal okkar;
eldi vöru eggjar · útan görvar
4 en eittr-dropum · innan fáðar.“

He placed a wound-wand [SWORD] wrapped in gold,
the much-adorned king, between us two.
With fire was its blade on the outside made,
but with poison-droplets on the inside stained.”

1 gólli | gylli R

Frá dauða Sig-urðar (‘From the Death of Siward’)

- P1 Hér er sagt í þessi kviðu frá dauða Sig-urðar ok víkr hér svá til
2 sem þeir drépi hann úti. En sumir segja svá at þeir drépi hann
inni í rekkju sinni sofanda. En þýðverskir menn segja svá at þeir
4 drépi hann úti í skógi, ok svá segir í Guð-rúnar kviðu inni fornu
at Sig-urðr ok Gjúka synir hefði til þings riðit þá er hann var
6 drepinn. En þat segja allir einnig at þeir sviku hann í tryggð ok
vógu at hán um liggjanda ok ó-búnum.

HERE IT HAS BEEN TOLD in this lay from the death of Siward, and here it begins at the point when they slew him outside. But some say that they slew

him inside in his chamber, sleeping. But the Germans say that they slew him outside in the forest, and so it says in the Ancient Lay of Guthrun that Siward and the sons of Yivick had ridden to the Thing when he was slain. But this they all say in unison, that they betrayed him while he trusted them and struck at him lying down and unarmed.

1 Hér | *Introduced by an ornamented 3-line initial in R.*

4 Guð-rúnar kviðu inni fornu 'Ancient Lay of Guthrun' | Probably a reference to 2 *Guðr* 4–5.

First Lay of Guthrun

(1 Guð·rúnar kviða)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.988)
Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **First Lay of Guthrun** (abbrev. *1 Guðr*) directly follows the narrative of *Brot*, as is seen by the fact that the concluding prose of *Brot* directly leads into the introduction to *1 Guðr* in **R**. As such the two are clearly intended to form a continuous narrative.

The poem shares several lines with *Sigs* in sts. 1, 16, 22, 23 (n.) and 25, and with *2 Guðr* in sts. 1 and 18.

After Siward's death Guthrun is so upset that she cannot make herself weep until she sees his body.

Text

- P1 Guð-rún sat yfir Sig-urði dauðum. Hón grét eigi sem aðrar
 2 konur en hón var búin til at springa af harmi. Til gengu bæði
 konur ok karlar at hugga hana en þat var eigi auð-velt. Þat er
 4 sögn manna at Guð-rún hefði etit af Fáfnis hjarta ok hón skilði
 því fugls rödd. Þetta er enn kveðit um Guð-rúnu:

Guthrun sat over Siward, dead. She did not weep like other women, but she was ready to burst apart from grief. Both women and men arrived to console her, but that was not easily done. It is the saying of men that Guthrun had eaten of Fathomer's heart and therefore she understood the speech of birds. This is further sung about Guthrun:

ALL | No break between this passage and the concluding prose of Brot is made in R.

Guð-rúnar kviða ('A Lay of Guthrun')

- 1 Ár vas þat's Guð-rún · gørði=sk at deyja,
 2 es hön sat sorg-full · yfir Sig-vørði,
 gørði=t hön hjúfra · né hön dum sláa
 4 né kveina of · sem konur aðrar.

IT WAS OF YORE that Guthrun made ready to die
 as she sat sorrowful over Siward.
 She did not pant nor beat her hands
 nor wail over him like other women.

1 Ár | *The A is an ornamented initial 3 lines in height in R.* 2 Sig-vørði | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urði R*

1 Ár vas þat's 'It was of yore that' | Shared with *Sigs* 1/1. ár 'of yore' is a common initial word, also found in *Vsp* 3/1, *Hym* 1/1 and *HHund* 1/1.

2–4 es hön ... aðrar 'as she ... women.' | Closely related to 2 *Guðr* 10/3–5.

- 2 Gingu jarlar · al-snotrir fram,
 2 þeir's harðs hugar · hana lottu;
 þey=gi Guð-rún · gráta mátti,
 4 svá vas hön móðug; · mundi hön springa.

There went forth all-clever earls,
 they who would loosen her hard heart,
 yet nowise could Guthrun weep;
 so moody was she—she would burst apart.

- 3 Sötu ítrar · jarla brúðir
 2 gollu búnar · fyr Guð-rúnu;
 hver sagði þeira · sinn of-trega
 4 þann's bitrastan · of beðit hafði.

There sat the splendid brides of the earls
 adorned with gold before Guthrun.
 Each one of them told her own great sorrow,
 the bitterest one she had endured.

- 4 Þá kvað Gjaf-laug, · Gjúka systir:
 2 „Mik veyt'k á moldu · munar-lausasta;
 hef'k fimm vera · for-spell beðit,
 4 tveggja dótra, · þriggja systra,
 átta bróðra, · þó ek ein lifi.“

Then quoth Yeflie, Yivick's sister:
 “I know myself on the earth to be most joyless.
 Of five husbands have I suffered the loss,
 of two daughters, three sisters,
 eight brothers—yet I alone live.”

4 tveggja dótra, · þriggja systra | No alliteration is found in this line and no obvious emendation can be found; it seems that the strong parallelism and assonance between *tveggja* and *þriggja* compensate for it.

- 5 Þeygi Guð-rún · gráta mátti;
 2 svá vas hön móðug · at mōg dauðan
 ok harð-huguð · of hrør fylkis.

Yet nowise could Guthrun weep;
 so moody was she after the lad's death,
 and hard-hearted over the marshal's corpse.

- 6 Þá kvað þat Her-borg, · Húna-lands dróttning:
 2 „Hef'k harðara · harm at segja:
 mínir sjau synir · sunnan lands,
 4 verr inn átti, · i val fellu.

Then this quoth Harburg, Hunland's queen:
 “I have a harder harm to tell.
 My seven sons to the south of their land,
 —my husband eighth—in battle fell.”

- 7 Faðir ok móðir, · fjórir bróðr,
 2 þau á vági · vindr of lék,
 barði bára · við borð-þili.

My father and mother, four brothers—
 them on the wave the wind outplayed;
 the breaker beat against the ship-side.

- 8 Sjölf skylda'k gøfga, · sjölf skylda'k gøtva,
 2 sjölf skylda'k hōndla, · hēl-fōr þeira;
 þat ek allt of þeið · ēin misseri
 4 svá't mér maðr engi · munar leitaði.

I alone had to honour them; I alone had to bury them;
 I alone had to handle their hell-journey [DEATH].
 This all I suffered in one half-year,
 while noone found me any joy.

2 hēl-fōr | *emend.*; hēf-fōr R

- 9 Þá varð'k hapta · ok hēf-numa
 2 sams misseris · síðan-verða;
 skylda'k skreyta · ok skúa binda
 4 hērsis kván · hvērjan morgin.

Then I became a captive and taken in war,
 in the latter part of that same half-year.
 I had to dress and bind the shoes
 of the ruler's wife every morning.

- 10 Hōn ógði mér · af af-brýði
 2 ok hōrðum mik · hōggum keyrði;
 fann'k hús-guma · hvēr=gi inn bētra
 4 en hús-frēyju · hvēr=gi verri.“

She tortured me out of jealousy
 and with hard blows drove me on.
 A husband nowhere I've met better,
 but a housewife nowhere worse.”

- 11 Þey=gi Guð-rún · gráta mátti;
 2 svá vas hōn móðug · at mōg dauðan
 ok harð-huguð · of hrør fylkis.

Yet nowise could Guthrun weep;
so moody was she after the lad's death,
and hard-hearted over the marshal's corpse.

- 12 Þá kvað þat Goll-rönd, · Gjúka dóttir:
2 „Fó kannt, föstra, · þó'tt fróð séir,
ungu vífi · and-spjöll bera.“
4 Varaði hön at hylja · of hrør fylkis.
- Then this quoth Goldrand, Yivick's daughter:
“Little canst thou, foster-mother—though thou be wise—
to a young wife give answers.”—
She bade them uncover the marshal's corpse.

- 13 Svípti hön bléju · af Sig-væðði
2 ok vatt vængi · fyr vífs knéum:
„Lít-tu á ljúfan, · legg þú munn við grön
4 sem þú halsaðir · hēilan stilli.“
- She drew the shroud off of Siward
and turned his cheeks before the wife's knees:
“Look on thy beloved! Lay thy mouth to his lips
like thou didst embrace the hale prince.”

1 Sig-væðði | metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urði R 2 knéum | metr. emend. by restoration of old hiatus form; knjám R

- 14 Á leit Guð-rún · einu sinni;
2 sá hön döglinga skör · dreyra runna,
fránar sjónir · fylkis liðnar,
4 hug-borg jöfurs · hjörvi skorna.
- On him looked Guthrun a single time;
she saw the noble's locks run with blood,
the gleaming gaze of the marshal gone,
the heart-fort [CHEST] of the ruler cut by sword.

- 15 Þá hné Guð-rún · höll við bólstri;
2 haddr losnaði, · hlýr roðnaði
en regns dropi · rann niðr umb kné.

Then Guthrun sank down, slooped against the bolster;
her hair fell loose, her cheek turned red,
and a drop of rain ran down her lap.

- 16 Þá grét Guð-rún, · Gjúka dóttir,
 2 svá't tór flugu · tresk i gögnum
 ok gullu við · gæss i túni,
 4 mérir fuglar · es mér átti.

Then wept Guthrun, Yivick's daughter,
 so that the tears flew through the ...
 and in response shrieked the geese in the yard,
 the famed fowls which the maiden owned.

2 tresk '...' | This word is an unexplained *bapax*.

3 ok gullu við · gæss i túni 'and in response shrieked the geese in the yard' | Shared identically with *Sigs* 29/4.

- 17 Þá kvað þat Goll-rönd, · Gjúka dóttir:
 2 „Ykkar vissa'k · ástir meistar
 manna allra · fyr mold ofan;
 4 unðir þú hvár-ki · úti né inni,
 systir mín, · nema hjá Sig-væðoi.“

Then this quoth Goldrand, Yivick's daughter:
 "I knew the love between you two was the greatest
 of all men above the earth.
 Thou wast never content outside or inside,
 O sister of mine, save by Siward's side."

5 Sig-væðoi | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R

- [Guð-rún kvað:] 18 „Svá vas minn Sig-væðör · hjá sonum Gjúka
 2 sëm væri gëir-laukr · ór grasi vaxinn,
 eða væri þjartr steinn · á band drëginn:
 4 jarkna-steinn · yfir øðlingum.

[Quoth Guthrun:] "So was my Siward beside the sons of Yivick
 like were a garlic out of grass grown,
 or were a bright stone on a string drawn:
 an arkenstone over the athlings.

1 Sig-væðör | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R

ALL | Guthrun begins her monologue, lasting from sts. 18–22.

1–2 Svá vas ... vaxinn 'So was ... grown' | These two lines are almost identical to 2 *Guðr* 2/1–2. Since the present poem is probably older (Sapp 2022), it is likely the source.

2 gëir-laukr 'garlic' | Or 'spear-leek'. I have opted for this translation based on etymology (cf. OE *gær-léac* 'spear-leek'), but the botanical identity is unclear. 2 *Guðr* 2 has *grönn laukr* 'green leek' instead. For the cultural importance of leeks and onions see note to *Vsp* 4.

3–4 eða véri ... qðlingum. ‘or were ... athlings.’ | Beaded necklaces were commonly worn by Scandinavian women of the time, and the beads were mostly of opaque coloured glass. Siward is likened to a bright crystal, the sons of Yivick to dull glass.

- 19 Ek þótta auk · þjóðans rekkum
 2 hveŕri héri · Heŕjans dísi;
 nú em’k svá lítil · sem lauf séa
 4 øfst i jølstrum · at jøfur dauðan.

I also seemed to the ruler’s champions
 higher than any of the Lord of Hosts’ dises [WALKIRRIES].
 Now am I so small as if I were a leaf,
 the highest in the willows, after the ruler’s death.

4 øfst | ‘opt’ R

4 øfst | Though the ms. spelling ‘opt’ in R may suggest the word *opt* ‘often’ (as it has been read by many eds.), this hardly makes sense in the context of the single leaf. On the other hand, the superlative *øfstr*, *øfstr* ‘highest, uppermost’ is occasionally spelled with a ‘-ptr’ in mss. (ONP, s.v. *øfri*, *øfri*), and it is therefore most likely that word which with we are dealing.

- 20 Sakna’k i sessi · ok i séingu
 2 mĩns mál-vinar— · valda meŕir Gjúka;
 valda meŕir Gjúka · mĩnu þolvi
 4 ok systr sinnar · sòrum gráti.

I miss in the seat and in the bed
 my confidant—at fault are the lads of Yivick;
 the lads of Yivick are at fault for my bale
 and for their sister’s [my] bitter weeping.

- 21 Svá ér umb lýða · landi eyðið
 2 sem ér of unnuð · eiða svarða;
 man=a þú, Gunn-arr, · golls of njóta;
 4 þeir munu þér baugar · at bana verða
 es þú Sig-veŕði · svarðir eiða.

Even so may ye ruin the land for folk,
 as ye fulfilled the sworn oaths!
 Thou wilt not, Guthur, enjoy the gold;
 those bigs will for thee become the bane
 on which thou to Siward didst swear the oaths.

5 Sig-veŕði | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urði R

4 þeir munu þér baugar · at bana verða ‘those bigs will for thee become the bane’ | I.e. ‘the money will be the end of you’, a prediction of the curse of the Nivling-hoard. Very similar to *Fáfnir* 9, 20.

- 22 Opt vas í túni · tēiti meiri
2 þá's minn Sig·vǫrðr · sǫðladi Grana,
ok þeir Bryn·hildar · biðja fóru,
4 armrar vǫttar · illu heilli.“

Often in the courtyard there was greater cheer,
[like] when my Siward saddled Grane
and they journeyed to ask for Byrnhild's hand,
that wretched wight of ill omen.”

2 Sig·vǫrðr | *metr. emend.* (*Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141*); Sig·urðr R

3 ok þeir Bryn·hildar · biðja fóru ‘and they journeyed to ask for Byrnhild's hand’ | The same line is found in *Sigsk* 3/1.

- 23 Þá kvað þat Bryn·hildr · Buðla dóttir:
2 „Vǫn sé sú vǫttr · vers ok barna
es þik Guð·rún · gráts of þeiddi
4 ok þér í morgun · mál·rúnar gaf.“

Then this quoth Byrnhild, Budle's daughter:
“Let this wight [me] be without husband and children,
who brought forth, O Guthrun, thy weeping
and this morning gave thee things to speak of.”

ALL | Byrnhild responds, stressing that she will not live long after Siward.

2 Vǫn ... vers ok barna ‘without husband and children’ | Cf. *Sigsk* 9/1 with emendation based on this line.

4 þér ... mál·rúnar gaf ‘gave thee things to speak of’ | Lit. ‘gave thee speech-runes’.

- 24 Þá kvað þat Goll·rǫnd · Gjúka dóttir:
2 „Þegi þú, þjóð-leið, · þeira orða!
Urðr ǫðlinga · hefir þú ǣ vesit
4 —rekr þik alda hver · illrar skǣpnu—
sorg sára · sjau konunga
6 ok vin-spell · vífa mest.“

Then this quoth Goldrand, Yivick's daughter:
“Shut up, thou most loathsome woman, with those words!
The Weird of athlings hast thou always been,

—thou art driven by every wave of evil fate—
the sore sorrow of seven kings,
and the greatest spoiler of women's friendship.”

2 Þegi þú, þjóð-leið, · þeira orða ‘Shut up, thou most loathsome woman, with those words’ |
The same line is found in *Þrk* 18/2, with *Þörr* ‘Thunder’ for *þjóð-leið* ‘most loathsome woman’.

- 25 Þá kvað þat Bryn·hildr · Buðla dóttir:
2 „Veldr ęinn Atli · ęllu þövi
of borinn Buðla · bróðir minn
4 þá's vit i hęll · húnskrar þjóðar
ęld á jęfri · orm-bęðs litum;
6 þęss hęfi'k gangs · goldit síðan,
þęirar sýnar; · sęumk ęy.“

Then this quoth Byrnhild, Budle's daughter:
“Alone is Attle at fault for all evil,
the man born of Budle, my own brother,
since we two in the hall of the Hunnish folk
beheld the fire of the wyrm-bed [GOLD] on the prince.
For that journey I have paid ever since,
for that sight—I always worried over it.”

ALL | Byrnhild blames the tragic events on the greed of her brother Attle, who according to *Sigsk* 37 forced her to be married.

2 Veldr ęinn Atli · ęllu þövi ‘Alone is Attle at fault for all evil’ | Related to 2 *HHund* 34/3 and *Sigsk* 27/4.

3 of borinn Buðla · bróðir minn ‘born of Budle, my own brother’ | Identically shared with *Sigsk* 56/5.

5 ęld orm-bęðs ‘fire of the wyrm-bed [GOLD]’ | An unparalleled kenning. GOLD can be ‘fire of the river’ (since it shines underwater) and ‘wyrm-bed’ (since the Wyrms or dragon dwells upon it), but not ‘fire of the wyrm-bed’. TODO: reference Meissner.

- 26 Stóð hęn und stoð · stręngðei hęn ęlfi,
2 brann Bryn·hildi · Buðla dóttur
ęldr ór augum; · ęitri fnósti
4 es hęn sęr of leit · á Sig·vęrði.

She stood beneath a pillar, fueled her anger;
in Byrnhild Budle's daughter burned
fire from her eyes; she spit venom
when she beheld the wounds on Siward.

4 Sig·vęrði | *metr. emend.* (*Sievers* 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urði R

- P2** Guð·rún gekk þaðan á braut til skógar á eyði·merkr ok fór allt til
 2 Danmarkar ok var þar með Þóru, Hákonar dóttur, sjau misseri.
 Bryn·hildr vildi eigi lifa eptir Sig·urð. Hón lét drepa þręla sína
 4 átta ok fimm ambóttir, þá lagði hón sik sverði til bana svá sem
 segir í Sig·urðar kviðu inni skömmu.

Guthrun went away thence through the woods of the wastelands and journeyed all the way to Denmark and stayed there with Thure, Hathkin's daughter, for seven half-years. Byrnhild did not want to live after Siward. She had her eight thralls and five handmaids slain; then she ran herself through with a sword unto her death, as it says in the Short Lay of Siward.

Short Lay of Siward

(*Sig·urðar kviða in skamma*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): early C11th (0.876)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Short Lay of Siward** (*Sigsk*) continues the story of Siward, focusing on his death and Byrnhild's subsequent grieving. Despite its title, *Sigsk* has ca. 280 long-lines and is thus one of the longest poems in **R**, something which suggests that it was once preceded by an even longer poem about Siward (cf. *Vǫlsbr* above).

Dating

The language of *Sigsk* has some archaic and unusual features.

The most notable archaic feature is its use of the particle *of* before nominals. This particle originally corresponds to an older Germanic **ga-* (thus Anon *Bjark* 1/4b (SkP 3): *of sinnar* 'companions' < PGmc **ga-sinþaniz* > OE *ge-siþas* 'id.')

but becomes obsolete early in ON poetry except for when preceding verbs; in the Scaldic corpus attestations of *of* before nominals occur almost exclusively(?—TODO) before ca. 1000 CE (SkP 5, p. xcic).

In *Sigsk*, *of* occurs twice before nouns: 23/1a *of dolgr* (no non-Norse parallels but see note there) and 58/5a: *of skǫp* (= OE *ge-sceap*). It also occurs twice before the adj. *líkr*, viz. in 36/2b and 61/4b: *of líkr* (= OE *ge-líc*). This usage is unique in ON poetry since the *of* replaces the usual fossilized *g-* in *g-líkr*, which proves that the poet of *Sigsk* had a strong intuitive sense of the semantics of this particle. A later archaizer would far more likely have created the hypercorrected form **of g-líkr*

Another archaic feature is the long form *haufuð* (23/2). Like the other Walsing-poems (save *Gríp*), *Sigsk* requires the long first syllable in the name *Sig-vǫrðr* 'Siward' (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141).

Metrically *Sigsk* has a notable tolerance for three-syllable verses.

Contrary to Sapp's statistical model the aforementioned archaic traits allow us to date the poem to the 10th century. It should therefore be of interest to the reader that the poem's depictions of widow-suicide (suttee) and the afterlife are likely authentic and pagan.

Text

Sig-urðar kviða ('A Lay of Siward')

- 1 Ár vas þat's Sig-*v*ørðr · sótti Gjúka
2 *v*ølsungr ungi · es *v*egit hafði;
3 tók við tryggðum · tveggja bróðra
4 seǵdu=sk *ę*ða · *ę*ljun-fróknir.

IT WAS OF YORE that Siward, the young Walsing
who had triumphed, sought out Yivick.
He got the truces of two brothers;
they exchanged oaths, the men brave of zeal.

1 Ár | The A is an ornamented initial 3 lines in height in R. 1 Sig-*v*ørðr | metr. emend. (Stievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R

1 Ár vas þat's 'It was of yore that' | Shared with 1 Guðr 1/1; see there for further parallels.

- 2 Męy buðu hönnum · ok *m*ęiðma fjøłð,
3 Guð-runu ungu · Gjúka dóttur;
4 drukku ok *d*ómðu · *d*ógr mart saman
Sig-*v*ørðr ungi · ok *s*ynir Gjúka,

They offered him a maiden and a multitude of treasures
with young Guthrun, Yivick's daughter.
They drank and discussed for many days and nights together,
young Siward and the sons of Yivick,

- 3 und's þęir Bryn-hildar · *b*iðja fóru
2 svát þęim Sig-*v*ørðr · *r*ęið i *s*inni
3 *v*ølsungr ungi · ok *v*ega kunni;
4 hann of *ę*tti · ef hann *ę*iga knętti.

till they journeyed to ask for Byrnhild's hand,
whenas Siward rode alongside them,
the young Walsing, and he could fight;
he would have her if he could have her.

- 4 Sęggr inn suðr-øni · lagði sverð nøkkvit
2 *m*ęki *m*ál-faan · á *m*eðal þęira
3 né hann konu · kyssa gęrði
4 né *h*únskr konungr · *h*ęfja sér af armi

mey frum-unga; · fal hann megi Gjúka.

The southern youth laid a naked sword,
a picture-painted blade between them;
nor did he kiss the woman,
nor did the Hunnish king hold in his arms
the most young maiden; he left that to the lad of Yivick.

ALL | Siward disguised himself as Guthur and married Byrnild while still in disguise, but out of loyalty for his oath-sworn friend Siward did not sleep with nor even touch her in the bed; instead he placed a sword between them.

2 mēki mál-faan ‘a picture-painted blade’ | Also occurring in *Ski* 23/1, 25/1; see there.

- 5 Hön sér at lífi · lōst né vissi
2 ok at aldr-lagi · ekki grand
vamm þat’s vëri · eða vesa hyðö;
4 gengu þess á milli · grimmar urðir.

She knew no blemish to her life
and in her allotted age no wrong,
no fault which had been nor which thought to arise;
in that the cruel weirds intervened.

- 6 Eīn sat hön úti · aptan dags,
2 nam hön svá þert · umb at mēla=sk:
„Hafa skal’k Sig-vörð, · —eða þó sveltí!—
4 mōg frum-ungan, · mér á armi.

Alone she sat outside at the close of day;
she took to speak plainly thus:
“I shall have Siward—else let him die!—
that most young lad in my arms!

2 nam hön svá þert · umb at mēla=sk: | This line is missing alliteration and no obvious emendation can be found.

- 7 Orð mēlta’k nú, · iðr=umk ęptir þess,
2 kvön ’s hans Guð-rün · ęn ek Gunn-ars,
ljótar nornir · skópu oss langa þró.“

The word I just spoke I afterwards regret.
Guthrun is his wife, but I am Guthur’s;
ugly norns shaped for us a long yearning.“

- 8 Opt ęngr hön innan, · ills of fylld,

- 2 ísa ok jøkla, · aptan hvern,
 es þau Guð-rún · ganga á beð
 4 ok hana Sig-vörðr · sveipr i ripti,
 konungr inn húnski, · kvon frjá sína.

She often goes outside filled with hate,
 ice-sheets, and icicles every evening
 when he and Guthrun go to their bed
 and Siward wraps her in the blanket,
 the Hunnish king his beloved wife.

2 ísa ok jøkla ‘with ice-sheets and icicles’ | A description of Byrnild’s inner state; her jealousy makes her so cold that it is as if her insides froze to ice.

- 9 „Von geng’k vilja, · vers ok barna,
 2 verð’k mik góla · af grimmum hug.“
 “I go without strength of will, husband, or children;
 I shall have to soothe myself from my cruel thoughts.”

1 barna | *sens. emend.*, cf. 1 Guðr 23/2; beggja ‘both’ R

- 10 Nam af þeim heiptum · hvetja=sk at vígi:
 2 „Þú skalt, Gunn-arr, · gørst of láta
 minu landi · ok mér sjalfri;
 4 mun’k una aldri · með qðlingi.

Out of that hatred she took to incite [men] to war:
 “Thou shalt, Guthur, very soon lose
 my land and my very self;
 I will never be content with an athling.

- 11 Mun’k aptr fara · þar’s áðan vas’k
 2 með ná-bornum · niðjum mínum,
 þar mun’k sitja · ok sofa lífi
 4 nema þú Sig-vörðr · svelta látir
 ok jøfurr qðrum · óðri verðir.

I will go back whither I was before
 amidst my close-born kinsmen;
 there will I sit and sleep my life away
 unless thou lettest Siward die,
 and become a chieftain nobler than he.

- 12 Lötum son fara · fœðr ï sinni;
 2 skal=at ulf ala · ungan lengi.
 Hveim verðr hǫlða · hefnd létari
 4 —síðr til sáttar— · at sonr lifi.“

We shall let the son follow in his father's tracks;
 one shall not rear a young wolf for long.
 For every man revenge becomes easier
 —peace less likely—if his son lives.”

- 13 Reðir varð Gunn-arr · ok hnipnaði,
 2 sveip sínum hug, · sat umb allan dag;
 hann vissi þat · vil=gi gǫr=la
 4 hvat hönum væri · vinna sómst
 eða hönum væri · vinna þęzt,
 6 alls sik Vǫlsung · vissi firrðan
 ok at Sig-vǫrð · sǫknuð mikinn.

Then Guthur turned wroth and drooped;
 he twisted his mind, sat for the whole day.
 He knew not clearly in any way
 what was most fitting for him to do,
 or what was best for him to do,
 as he knew he would be bereaved of the Walsing
 and [feel] great loss after Siward.

1 Reðir varð Gunn-arr · ok hnipnaði | This line is missing alliteration and no obvious emendation can be found.

- 14 Ýmist hann hugði · jafn-langa stund,
 2 þat vas eigi · árar títt
 at frá konung-dóm · kvánir gengi;
 4 nam hann sér Hǫgna · heita at rúnum,
 þar átti hann · alls full-trúa.

His thoughts went back and forth for an even-long time.
 It was not at all desirable in times of yore
 that wives should depart from a kingdom.
 He summoned Hawn for private counsel;
 there he had a friend fully trusted in all.

- [Gunn-arr kvað:] 15 „Eiñ 's mér Bryn-hildir · ǫllum þętri,
 2 of borin Buðla, · hǫn 's bragr kvenna;
 fyrr skal'k mīnu · fjǫrvi láta

4 an þeirar meýjar · meðmum týna.

[Quoth Guthur:] “Byrnhild alone is better to me than all—
that woman born of Budle; she is the peak of women.
I shall sooner lose my own life
than abandon that maiden’s treasures.

16 Vill þú okkr fylki · til féar véla?

2 Gótt ’s at ráða · Rínar malmi,
ok unandi · auði stýra

4 ok sitjandi · seltu njóta.“

Wilt thou with me betray the marshaller for money?
It is good to rule the ore of the Rhine [GOLD],
and, prospering, to wield the wealth,
and, sitting, to enjoy good fortune.”

17 Eínu því Hogni · ann·svor veitti:

2 „Samir eigi okkr · slíkt at vinna,
sverði rofna · svarna eiða,

4 eiða svarna, · unnar tryggðir.

This one answer Hawn then granted:
“It does not befit us two to work such things,
to break by the sword the sworn oaths—
the sworn oaths, the taken truces.

1 Eínu því Hogni · ann·svor veitti ‘This one answer Hawn then granted’ | Shared with st. 45/1 below and *Brot* 6/1.

18 Vitum=a vit à moldu · menn in selli

2 meðan fjórir vér · folki røðum
ok sá inn húnski · her-Baldr lifir,

4 né in mætri · mægð à moldu
ef vér fimm sonu · fœðum lengi

6 óttum góða · óxla knéttim.

We shall not know upon the earth a more blessed man
while we four do rule the folk
and the Hunnish host-Balder [WARRIOR = Siward] lives;
nor a nobler in-law upon the earth
if we rear five sons for long
good of lineages, [and] should let them grow.

2 fjórir vér ‘we four’ | Guthur, Hawn, Godthorm, and Siward.

- 19 Ek v̥eit g̥or=la · hvaðan vegir standa:
2 Eru Bryn·hildar · brek of·mikil.

I know clearly whence these troubles arise:
Byrnhild's demands are far too great.

- 20 Vit skulum Guð·þorm · g̥orva at vígi,
2 yngra bróður, · ð·fróðara;
hann vas fyr útan · ǣiða svarna,
4 ǣiða svarna, · unnar tryggðir.“

We shall make Godthorm ready for war,
our younger brother, the less learned.
He was outside of the sworn oaths,
the sworn oaths, the taken truces.”

- 21 Dēlt vas at eggja · ð·bil-gjarnan,
2 stóð til hjarta · hjorr Sig·v̥erði.

It was easy to incite the unyielding man [= Godthorm];
the sword was stood unto the heart of Siward.

1 eggja · ð·bil-gjarnan ‘incite the unyielding man’ | Also found in a proverb in *Gr*.

2 stóð til hjarta · hjorr ‘the sword was stood unto the heart’ | Formulaic. Cf. *Vsp* 52/3–4, *Fáfn* 1/4.

- 22 Réð til h̥efnda · h̥er-gjarn i sal
2 ok ǣptir varp · ð·bil-gjornum;
fló til Guð·þorms · Grams ramm=liga
4 kyn-birt éarn · ór konungs h̥endi.

The war-eager one turned to revenge in the hall
and threw after the unyielding man;
towards Godthorm flew violently Gram's
flashing-white blade from the hand of the king.

ALL | Sts. 22–23: Siward throws his sword, Gram, at Godthorm with such strength that it cuts him clean in two parts.

- 23 Hné hans of dolgr · til hluta tveggja;
2 h̥endr ok haufuð · hné á annan veg
ǣn fóta hlutr · fell aptr i stað.

His enemy sunk down in two parts:
his arms and head sunk to the side,
but the part of his legs fell backwards to the ground.

2 **haufuð** | *metr. emend.*; **höfuð R**

1 of *dolgr* ‘enemy’ | Identical in sense to *dolgr*. The prefixing of a noun by the particle *of* is an archaic feature; cf. Introduction to the poem above. The authenticity of *of dolgr* is confirmed by another attestation in Egill *Arkv* 22 (SkP 5) from ca. 962 CE.

2 **haufuð** | The long form *haufuð* is metrically required since the second lift cannot fall on a short syllable (Males 2025b, p. 15).

- 24 **Sofnuð** vas Guð·rún · ÿ **séingu**
 2 **sorga**-laus · hjá **Sig**-værdi;
 en hön **vaknaði** · **vilja** firrð
 4 es hön **Fręys** vinar · **flaut** ÿ dreýra.

Guthrun lay sleeping in the bed,
 sorrowless by Siward’s side,
 but she awoke deprived of strength of will
 when in the blood of Free’s friend [= Siward] she swam.

4 Fręys vinar ‘Free’s friend’ | It is not clear why Siward is called the friend of this god in particular. TODO: any other kennings of this type? Cf. *Ing-wine*.

- 25 **Svá** sló hön **svárar** · **sínar** hendr
 2 at **ramm**-hugaðr · **reis** upp við bæð:
 „Grát=a þú, Guð·rún, · svá **grimm**=liga,
 4 **brúðr** frum-unga— · þér **bróðr** lifa.

So harshly did she beat her hands
 that the strong-minded man [= Siward] rose up against the bed:
 “Weep thou not, Guthrun, so horribly,
 O most young bride—thy brothers still live!

- 26 **Á’k** til **ungan** · **erfi**-nytja,
 2 kann=at hann **firra**=sk · ór **fjánd**-garði;
 þeir **sér** hafa · **svárt** ok dát
 4 en **nér** **numit** · **ný**=lig röð.

I have an heritage-enjoyer [SON] far too young;
 he cannot remove himself from the court of foes.
 They make themselves fierce and violent,
 and have nearly fulfilled their new plans.

ALL | Sts. 26–27: Siward predicts the death of his young son, Syemund.

- 27 Ríðr=a þeim **síðan** · þó’tt **s**jau alir,

- 2 systur sonr · s·líkr at þingi;
 ek veit gǫr=la · hví gegnir nú:
 4 ęin veldr Bryn·hildr · ǫllu bǫlvi.

With them will not ride—though thou begettest seven—
 such a sister's son to the Thing.
 I know clearly why this now happens:
 alone is Byrnhild at fault for all evil.

- 28 Mér unni męr · fyr mann hvęrn
 2 ęn við Gunn·ar · grand ękki vann'k;
 þyrmda'k sifjum, · svǫrnum ęiðum,
 4 síðr vęra'k hęitinn · hans kvánar vinr.“

That maiden loved me more than any man,
 but against Guthur I did no wrong;
 I respected the kinship, the sworn oaths;
 late will I be called a 'friend' of his wife.”

ALL.L | Siward comforts Guthrun by blaming Byrnhild for his death while defending the innocence of her brother Guthur who has no apparent motive to kill Siward when he has not done anything ill against him.

- 29 Kona varp ǫndu · ęn konungr fјorvi,
 2 svá sló hǫn sváran · sįnni hęndi
 at kvǫðu við · kálkar ĩ vǫ
 4 ok gullu við · gęss ĩ tųni.

The woman lost her breath but the king his life.
 So harshly did she beat her hand
 that in response clanged the chalices in the cupboard
 and in response shrieked the geese in the yard.

4 ok gullu við · gęss ĩ tųni 'and in response shrieked the geese in the yard' | Identically shared with *I Guðr* 16/3.

- 30 Hló þa Bryn·hildr, · Buðla dóttir,
 2 ęinu sinni · af ǫllum hug
 es hǫn til hvílu · hęyra knátti
 4 gjallan grát · Gjúka dóttur.

Then laughed Byrnhild, Budle's daughter,
 a single time out of all her heart,
 when from their resting-place she heard
 the shrill weeping of Yivick's daughter.

1–2 Hló ...hug ‘Then ... heart’ | Also found in *Brot* 9/1–2 with variation in the first b-verse.

- 31 Hitt kvað þá Gunn·arr, · gramr hauk-stalda:
 2 „Hlér=a þú af því, · heipt-gjörn kona,
 glöð á golfi, · at þér góðs viti;
 4 hví hafnar þú · inum hvíta lit?
 Fekna fódur, · hygg at feig séir.

This then quoth Guthur, the lord of young warriors
 “Thou dost not laugh, O feud-eager woman,
 glad on the floor, since thou knowest any good.
 Why dost thou abandon thy white colour?
 Rearer of wickedness, I think thou art fey!

- 32 Þú vécir þess · verðust kvinna
 2 at fyr augum þér · Atla hjöggim,
 séir bróðr þinum · blóðugt sár,
 4 undir dreýrgar, · knéttir yfir binda.“

For this wouldst thou be the worthiest of women
 that we before thy eyes should cut down Attle,
 that thou would see on thy brother a bloody gash,
 gory wounds; then wouldst thou bind over them.”

- 33 „Frýr=a maðr þér engi, Gunn·arr, · hefir full-vegít!
 2 Lítt sé=sk Atli · ófu þína;
 hann mun ykkar · ond síðarri
 4 ok é vesa · afl it meira.

“No one taunts thee, Guthur; thou hast fully triumphed!
 Little does Attle fear thy wrath;
 he will breathe longer than you two,
 and for ever be the greater power.

- 34 Ségja mun’k þér, Gunn·arr, · —sjalfr veitst gort=la—
 2 hvé ér yðr snimma · til saka réðuð;
 varð’k=at ek til ung · né ofþrungin
 4 full-gódd fēi · á flēti bróður.

I will tell thee Guthur—thou knowest it clearly thyself—
 how ye were too soon in your decisions.
 I was not too young nor oppressed,

fully endowed with wealth upon my brother's floor.

- 35 Né ek vilda þat · at mik verr étta
 2 áðr ér Gjúkungar · riðuð at garði
 þrír á hestum, · þjóð-konungar,
 4 en þeira fōr · þorf=gi véri.

Nor did I wish that a husband should have me
 before ye Yivickings rode to the court,
 three great kings upon your horses—
 but their coming was not a boon.

3 þjóð-konungar 'great kings' | An old poetic word; for etymology + distribution see *Grip* 1/2 n.

- 36 Þeim hét=umk þa
 2 es með golli sat · á Grana bógum;
 vas=at hann i augu · yðr of líkr,
 4 né á engi hlut · at álitum;
 þó þikki=sk ér · þjóð-konungar.

Then I vowed myself to *him*
 who sat with the gold on the back of Grane.
 In his eyes he was not like *you*
 nor in any part of his appearance,
 though ye think yourselves great kings!

1 Þeim hét=umk þa | There is certainly some corruption here seen by the unusual meter of this orphaned “line”, but the syntax and sense otherwise appears in order and no obvious emendation suggests itself.

- 37 Ok mér Atli þat · einni sagði
 2 at hvár=ki lét=sk · hōfn of deila,
 goll né jarðir, · nema gefa=sk léta'k;
 4 ok engi hlut · auðins féar,
 þa's mér jóð-ungri · eigu seldi
 6 ok mér jóð-ungri · aura talði.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

- 38 Þá vas á hvorfun · hugr minn umb þat
 2 hvárt ek skylda vega · eða val fella,
 þoll í brynju, · umb bróður sök.
 4 Þat myndi þá · þjóð-kunnt vesa,
 mǫrgum manni · at munar stríði.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

- 39 Létum síga · sátt-mól okkur;
 2 lék mér meirr í mun · meðmar þiggja,
 bauga rauða, · burar Sig-mundar,
 4 né ek annars manns · aura vilda'k.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

No other mans ounces of silver would I have.

- 40 Unna einum · né ýmissum,
 2 bjó=at umb hverfan · hug men-Skǫgul;
 allt mun þat Atli · eptir finna
 4 es hann mīna spyr · morð-fǫr gǫrva,

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

- 41 at þey=gi skal · þunn-gæð kona
 2 annarrar ver · aldri leiða;
 þá mun á hefndum · harma mīnna.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

- 42 Upp reis Gunn·arr, · gramr verðungar,
 2 ok umb hals konu · hendr of lagði;
 gingu allir, · ok þó ýmsir,

4 af **h**eilum **h**ug, · **h**ana at lētja.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

43 **H**ratt af **h**alsi · **h**veim þar sér;

2 lét=a mann sik lētja · langrar gongu.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

44 Nam hann sér **H**ogna · hvetja at rúnun:

2 „Seggi vil’k alla · i sal ganga,

þína með minum · —nú ’s þorf mikil—

4 vita ef **m**ęini · **m**orð-för konu

und’s af **m**éli · ęnn **m**ęin komi,

6 þà lötum því · þarfar ráða.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

45 **E**inu því Hogni · and·svor veitti:

2 „Lētj=a maðr hana · langrar gongu

þar’s hōn **a**ptr·borin · **a**ldri verði!

4 Hōn **k**rong of **k**om=sk · fyr **k**né móður,

hōn **ę** borin · **ó**-vilja til,

6 **m**orgum **m**anni · at **m**óð-trega.“

This one answer Hawn then granted:

“Let no man restrain her from the long journey

where she might never be born again!

Frail she arrived before her mother’s lap;

she was always born to ill deeds,

to [cause] heart-grief for many a man.”

3 þar’s hōn aptr·borin aldi verði ‘the long journey where she might never be born again’ | The underlying implication is a bit unclear. Is the suicide thought to prevent her from being reborn, or is the sense that she will be so happy with Siward in the afterlife that she her soul will not desire to return among the living?

- 46 Hvarf sér ð·hróðugr · and·spilli frá
 2 þar's mǫrk męnja · meĩðmum deĩldi.

The dishonoured man turned away from their conversation,
 where the wood of neckrings [WOMAN] was dealing out treasures.

- 47 Leit hęn of alla · ęigu sına,
 2 soltnar þýjar · ok sal-konur;
 goll-brynju smó · —vas=a gótt ĩ hug—
 4 áðr sik miðlaði · mękis ęggjum.

She beheld throughout all her estate
 the dead hand-maids and hall-women.
 She donned a golden byrnie—there was no good in her heart—
 before she pierced her stomach with the short-sword's edges.

ALL | Byrnild dons a golden byrnie and fatally wounds herself by disembowlement (see note to l. 3 *miðlaði*). There is a notable contradiction here, s Byrnild cuts through the byrnie she has just donned.

4 *miðlaði* 'pierced her stomach' | *miðla* usually means 'to deal out, share' but here has the unparalleled sense 'cut something at the middle'. The image is thus that Byrnild plunges her sword into her belly (cf. the Japanese *hara-kiri* or 'bowel-cutting') and disembowels herself.

- 48 Hné við bólstri · hęn á annan veg
 2 ok hýr-unduð · hugði at rǫðum:

She knelt down against the bolster on her side
 and, sword-wounded, thought of counsel:

- 49 „Nú skulu ganga · þęr's goll vili
 2 ok minni því · at mér þiggja;
 ek gef hęrri · of hroðit sigli,
 4 bók ok blęju, · bjartar váðir.“

“Now shall those who will have gold
 and less things than it come and receive it from me.
 I give every woman a gold-enclosed necklace,
 a coverlet and bed-cover, [and] bright garments.”

3 of *hroðit sigli* 'a gold-enclosed necklace' | of *broðit* '(metal-)enclosed' corresponding to OE *ge-broden*. For *sigli* 'necklace', only found thrice in the whole Norse corpus, see *Lok* 20.

- 50 Þęðu allir, · hugðu at rǫðum,
 2 ok allir sęnn · ann·svǫr vęittu:
 „Örnar soltnar · munum ęnn lifa,

4 verða **sal**-konur · **sómð** at vinna.“

All were silent; thought of counsel,
and all at once an answer granted:
“Enough women have died! We will live on;
the women of the hall will do what is fitting.”

51 Und's af **hyggjandi** · **hǫr**-skrydd kona,
2 **ung** at **aldri**, · **orð** við of kvað:
„Vil'k=at ek mann **trauðan** · né **tor**-bónan
4 **umb** **óra** sǫk · **aldri** týna,

Until wisely the linen-clad woman
young of age quoth a word in reply:
“I wish not that ont reluctant or hardly asked
for our sake should lose his life,

ALL | Byrnild relents. She will not force those who are reluctant to die with her, but they will receive greater honour in the afterlife if they follow her now than if they go on living.

52 þó mun á **bęinum** · **brinna** yðrum
2 **fęri** eyrir · þá's ér **framm** komið,
neitt **Męnju** góð, · **mın** at vitja.

yet will on your limbs burn fewer
ounces of silver when ye arrive
—nor any boons of Mene [GOLDEN JEWELS]—to visit me.

53 **Sęt**=sk-tu niðr, Gunn·arr, · mun'k **sęja** þér
2 **lifs** ęr·vęna · **ljósa** brúði;
mun=a **yðvart** far · **allt** i sundi
4 þó'tt **ek** hafa · **ęndu** látit.

Sit thee down Guthér—I will tell thee
of a light bride whose hopes of life are o'er.
Your ship will not be all [sunk] in the sound,
though I have given up my breath of life.

ALL | Byrnild speaks to Guthér and makes a spae.

54 **Sótt** munuð it Guð·rún, · **snemmr** an hyggir;
2 hęfir **kunn** **kona** · við **konungi**
daprar minjar · at **dauðan** ver.

Thou and Guthrun will be reconciled sooner than thou thinkest;
the famous woman has a sorrowful remembrance
from the king after her husband's death.

3 daprar minjar 'sorrowful remembrance' | Swanhild, by whom Guthrun will remember Siward.

- 55 Þar 's mēr borin, · móðir fóðir;
2 sú mun hvítari · an inn heiði dagr,
Svan·hildr, vesa, · sólar geisla.

There a maiden is born; her mother rears her.
She will be whiter than the clear day,
Swanhild, than a ray of the sun.

3 sólar geisla 'sun-ray' | Swanhild is also likened to a *sólar geisli* in *Ghv* 15.

- 56 Gefa munt Guð·rúnu · góðra nokkurum,
2 skęyti skóða · skatna męngi;
mun=at at vilja · ver-sęl gefin,
4 hana mun Atli · ęiga ganga,
of borinn Buða · bróðir minn.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

Attle will go to take her to wife,
the man born of Budle, my own brother.

5 of borinn Buða · bróðir minn 'the man born of Budle, my own brother' | Identically shared with *I Guðr* 25/3.

- 57 Margs á'k minna=sk · hvé við mik fóru
2 þá's mik sára · svikna hofðuð;
vaðin at vilja · vas'k meðan lifða'k.

I have much to remember from how they treated me,
when they had sorely betrayed me.
I was deprived of willpower while I lived.

- 58 Munt Odd·rúnu · ęiga vilja
2 ęn þik Atli mun · ęigi láta;
it munuð lúta · á laun saman,
4 hön mun þér unna · sęm ek skylda'k,

ef okkr góð of sköp · gørði verða.

Thou wilt want to take Guthrun to wife
but Attle will nowise let thee.
Ye two will embrace in secret.
She will love thee like I should have
if good shapes had let it be so for us.

- 59 Þik mun Atli · illu þeita,
2 munt i öngan · orm-garð lagiðr.

Thee will Attle afflict with evil;
thou wilt be laid in the narrow snake-pit.

- 60 Þat mun ok verða · því=gi=t lengra
2 at Atli mun · qndu týna,
sælu sinni, · ok sofa lífi.
4 Því't hönum Guð·rún · grýmir á þeð
snorpum eggjum · af sörum hug.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO: Translation.

- 61 Sömri véri Guð·rún, · systir okkur
2 frum-ver sinum · [...]
ef henni gæfi · góðra ráð
4 eða etti hön hug · oss of líkan.

It would be more fitting for Guthrun, our sister,
[to follow] her first husband [in death],
if she had the counsel of good men,
or she had a heart like ours.

- 62 Ö·ort mæli'k nú · en hön eigi mun
2 umb óra sök · aldri týna;
hana munu hefja · hovar börur
4 til Jón·akrs · óðal-torfu.

Now I speak unhastily, but she will not
lose her life for our sake.
She will be lifted by billows high

to Enacker's ethel-turf.

3 hana munu hefja · hóvar bōrur 'She will be lifted by billows high' | Clearly related to *Ghv* 13/3, with which the b-verse is identical.

- 63 [...] eru i vōr-úðum · Jōn-akrs sonum;
 2 mun hōn Svan·hildi · sēnda af landi,
 sīna mēy · ok Sig·varðar.

TODO.

she will send Swanhild away from the land,
 her daughter and Siward's.

- 64 Hana munu bíta · Bikka rōð
 2 því't Jōrmun·rekkr · ð·þarft lifir;
 þá's ǫll farin · ét Sig·varðar,
 4 eru Guð·rúnar · gróti at fleiri.

Her will Beck's counsels bite,
 for Ermenric lives wickedly.
 Then is all the lineage of Siward destroyed;
 for Guthrun there are yet more causes for weeping.

ALL | Byrnhild predicts Swanhild's death. Cf. *Ghv* P1.

- 65 Biðja mun'k þik · bōnar einnar,
 2 sú mun i hēimi · hinst bōn vesa:
 Lát-tu svá brēiða · borg á velli
 4 at undir oss ǫllum · jafn-rúmt séi,
 þeim es sultu · með Sig·vērði.

I will ask thee a single ask;
 in the Home it will be my very last ask.
 Let the stronghold upon the plain be so broad
 that under us all there be even room—
 us who perished with Siward.

- 66 Tjaldi þar umb þá borg · tjöldum ok skjöldum,
 2 vala-ript vel fōð · ok vala mēngi;
 brēnni mér inn hūnska · á hlið aðra.

Let it be canopied there around the stronghold with canopies and shields,
 Welsh canvas well painted and a multitude of horses.
 Let me be burned by the Hunnish man's side.

2 vala 'horses' | A rare word. TODO.

- 67 Brœnni inum húnka · á hlið aðra
 2 mīna þjóna, · mēnjum gofga,
 tvá at hofðum · ok tvęir haukar;
 4 þá's ǫllu skipt · til jafnaðar.

Let be burned by the Hunnish man's other side
 my servants noble of neckrings,
 two by his head, and two hawks;
 then all is arranged evenly.

- 68 Liggi okkar enn i milli · malmr hring-variðr,
 2 egg-hvasst éarn, · svá ęndr lagit
 þá's vit bæði · bæð ęinn stigum
 4 ok hétum þá · hjóna nafni.

Let once more lie between us the ring-adorned metal [SWORD],
 the edge-sharp iron, once again laid
 like when we both mounted a single bed
 and then were called by a wedded couple's name.

ALL | Cf. *Brot* 20.

1 malmr hring-variðr 'ring-adorned metal [SWORD]' | A ring-sword, long obsolete by the time of *Sigsk*. See *HHj* 9/1 n.

- 69 Hrynja hönnum þá · á hæl þęy=gi
 2 hlunn-blik hallar, · hringa litkuð
 ef hönnum fylgir · ferð mín heðan;
 4 þęy=gi mun vör fȳr · aum=lig vesa,

Then will nowise the roller-gleams [DOORS?] of the hall
 crash down on the heels of the colourer of ring-swords [WARRIOR],
 if he is followed by my departure hence.
 Nowise will our journey be wretched,

2 hlunn-blik hallar 'roller-gleams of the hall' | TODO, proverbial?

- 70 Því't hönnum fylgja · fimm ambóttir,
 2 áttu þjónar, · ǫðlum góðir,
 fostr-man mitt · ok faðerni
 4 þat's Buðli gaf · barni sínu.

for he is followed by five handmaids,
 eight servants of good pedigree,
 my foster-daughter, and the paternity
 which Budle gave unto his child [me].

- 71 Margt sagða ek, · mynda'k fleira
 2 es mér męir mjötuðr · mál-rúm gęfi;
 ómun þverr, · undir svella,
 4 satt ęitt sagða'k— · svá mun'k láta!“

Many things I said, I would [say] yet more
 if the Measurer gave me greater room to speak.
 My voice wanes, my wounds swell,
 truth alone I have spoken—so will I die!”

Hell-ride of Byrnhild

(*Hęł-ręið Bryn·hildar*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): late C11th (0.650)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The Hell-ride of Byrnhild (*Helr*) describes how Byrnhild after her death is burned on her pyre in a beautiful chariot or wagon. In the afterlife she rides on the Hellway to reach her resting place in Hell when her road is blocked by a certain gow or troll-woman. The poem consists of their conversation.

Textual preservation and transmission

Helr is attested in full in **R**, where it follows *Sigs* and is followed by 2 *Guðr*.

The poem is also attested, with the exception of st. 6, in *Norn* 9, in a sequence of tales about the Walsings which also includes *Reg*. *Norn* is attested in several mss., including **F**. TODO: Halldórsson (2000), Introduction.

The textual variants in *Norn*'s version of *Helr* are divergent to the point that *Norn*'s *Helr* cannot be directly copied from **R**, but it is unclear whether it ultimately derives from **R** through a chain of copies, or whether both derive from a lost archetype predating **R**. At the very least, we can tell from the similarities between the prose of *Norn* and **R** that the two are unlikely to be related through oral tradition alone.

Text

- P1 Eptir dauða Bryn·hildar vóru gør ból tvau: annat Sig·urði, ok
 2 brann þat fyrr, en Bryn·hildr var á qðru brennd ok var hón í reið
 þeiri er guð·vefum var tjölduð. Svá er sagt at Bryn·hildr ok með
 4 reið·inni á hel·veg ok fór um tún þar er gýgr nokkur bjó. Gýgr·in
 kvað:

After Byrnhild's death two pyres were made: one for Siward, and it burned earlier; but Byrnhild was burned on the other, and she was in that chariot which was canopied with god-weave. So it is said that Byrnhild drove with the chariot onto the Hellway and passed through a yard where a certain gow lived. Quoth the gow:

1 Eptir | The E is a bold capital in R.

ALL | The equivalent passage in *Norn*: *En birð-maðr einn spyrr: „hversu fór Bryn·hildr þá með?“ Gestr svarar: „þá drap Bryn·hildr sjau þræla sína ok fimm ambáttir en lagði sik sverði í gegnum ok bað sik aka með þessa menn til báls ok brenna sik dauða. Ok svá var gert, at henni var gert annat bál en Sigurði annat ok var hann fyrri brenndr en Bryn·hildr. Henni var ekit í reið einni ok var tjaldat um guð·vef ok purpúra ok glóaði allt við gull. Ok svá var hón brennd.“ Þá spurðu menn Gest hvárt Bryn·hildr hefði nokkut kveðit dauð. Hann kvað þat satt vera. Þeir báðu bann kveða ef bann kynni. Þá mælti Gestr: „þá er Bryn·hildr var ekit til brennu·nnar á hel·veg ok var farit með bana nýgr þomrum nokkurum, þar bjó ein gýgr. Hón [var] úti firir bellis·dyrum ok var í skinn·kyrtli ok svört yfir·lits. Hón hefir í bendi sér skogar·vond langan ok mælti. „Þessu vil ek beina til brennu þinnar, Bryn·hildr; ok véri betr at þú vérir lifandi brennd firir ó·dæðir þínar þér at þu lést drepa Sigurð Fífnis·bana, svá á·gétan mann; ok opt var ek bómum fínunt†. Ok firir þat skal ek hljóða á þik með hefndar·orðum þeim at þllum sér þú at leiðari er s·líkt beyra frá þér sagt.“ Eptir þat hljóðast þér á Bryn·hildr ok gýgr. Gýgr kvað: ‘But a hirdman asked: “How did Byrnhild come with him [= Siward]?” Guest answers: “Then Byrnhild slew her seven thralls and five handmaids and ran herself through with a sword and bade herself be driven to a pyre with these people and be burned after her death. And so it was done that one pyre was made for her and one for Siward, and he was burned earlier than Byrnhild. She was driven in a chariot and it was canopied with god-weave and purple, and it all glowed from gold, and so was she burned.” Then the men asked Guest whether Byrnhild had sung anything after death. He said it was true. They bade him sing, if he knew it. Then spoke Guest: “When Byrnhild had been driven to her burning on the Hellway and had passed near some cliffs, a gow lived there. She was outside before the doors of the cliffside and was in a skin skirt and swarthy of countenance. She has in her hand a long tree-branch, and spoke: ‘With this [wood] I wish to assist thy burning, Byrnhild, and it were better hadst thou been burned alive for thy misdeeds that thou didst cause Siward, Fathomers’ bane, to be slain—such an excellent man, and I was often ... with him. And therefore I shall bespeak thee with words of revenge such that all men will hate thee all the more as they hear such things told about thee.’ After that they scream at each other, Byrnhild and the gow. Quoth the gow:”*

2–3 í reið þeiri er guð·vefum var tjölduð ‘in that chariot which was canopied with god-weave’ | The canopy on the chariot was woven from silk (known as *god-weave*, the fabric of the gods). For the burial of women in wagons and chariots cf. TODO (Oseberg ship?).

3–4 Bryn·hildr ok með reið·inni á hel·veg ‘Byrnhild drove with the chariot on the Hellway’ | This gives us some interesting insight into old afterlife beliefs. After Byrnhild is burned she ends up between the worlds of the dead and the living, the so-called “Hell-way” or road to Hell, which she must travel to arrive at her final resting place in the Underworld; she is burned inside a chariot so that she will be able to travel comfortably. We may presume that the animals driving the chariot were slaughtered and burnt with her on the pyre.

Bryn·hildr ręið hæl-veg ('Byrnhild rode the Hellway')

- 1 „Skalt i gęgnum · ganga ęigi
2 grjęti studda · garða mına;
bętr sęmði þęr · borða at rękja
4 hęldr an vitja · vers annarar.

[R TODO, F TODO]

“Thou shalt nowise pass through these
rock-supported yards of mine!
It befit thee better to weave tapestries
rather than visit another’s husband.

1 Skalt | *The S is an ornamented initial 3 lines in height in R.* 4 an | *add. at F* 4 vers annarar
'another's husband' | *várra ranna (norm.) 'our halls' F*

ALL | The gow begins by insulting Byrnhild and blames her early death on her immoral and unwomanly actions; if she had lived like a chaste woman and tended to simple domestic duties she would still have been alive. She also points out that Siward is not even her husband, but Guthrun's.

- 2 Hvat skalt vitja · af Val-landi,
2 hvar-füst hęfuð, · húsa mınna?
þú hęfir, Vęr golls, · ef þik vita lystir,
4 mild, af hęndum · manns blóð þvegit.“

[R TODO, F TODO]

Why shalt thou visit, come from Walland,
O straying head, these houses of mine?
Thou hast, mild Ware of gold [LADY], if thou hast lust to know,
washed man-blood from thy hands.”

1 af Val-landi | *vá á landi F* 2 hvar-füst 'straying' | *hverf-lynt 'fickle-minded' F* 3–4 Þú ...
þvegit. 'Thou ... hands.' | Þú hęfir vęrgum · ef þin vitja / męrgum til matar · manns blóð gefit
'Thou hast to many—if thou art visited(?)—wolves given man-blood for food.' F

[Bryn·hildr svaraði:]

- 3 „Bregð ęigi mér, · brúðr ór stęini,
2 þó'tt ek vęra'k · i vikingu;
ek mun okkur · őri þikkja
4 hvar's męnn őli · okkart kunna.“

[R TODO, F TODO]

“Upbraid me not, O bride from the stone [Gow],
although I may have been in the wiking host;
of us two will I seem the nobler
wherever men know our pedigrees.”

1 ęigi mér | *mér ęigi F* 2 vęra'k 'I may have been' | *add. fyrr 'formerly' F* 4 hvar's męnn őli ·
okkart kunna 'wherever men know our pedigrees' | *þeim's őli mitt um kunna 'to those who know
my pedigree' (unmetrical) F*

- [Gýgr kvað:] 4 „Þú vast, Bryn-hildr, · Buðla dóttir,
2 heilli verstu · i heim borin;
þú hefir Gjúka · of glatat þorðum
4 ok búi þeira · brugðit góðu.“

[R TODO, F TODO]

“Thou wast, O Byrnchild, Budle’s daughter,
under the worst omen born into the Home.
Thou hast destroyed Yivick’s children
and deprived their house of good.”

1 vast ‘wast’ | ert ‘art’ F

- [Bryn-hildr kvað:] 5 „Ek mun segja þér · svinn ór reiðu,
2 vit-laussi mjök, · ef þik vita lystir:
hvé gørðu mik · Gjúka arfar
4 ásta-lausa · ok eið-rofa.

[R TODO, F TODO]

“I will tell thee, wise from my chariot,
O very witless one, if thou hast lust to know,
how the heirs of Yivick made me
loveless and an oath-breaker.

- 6 Lét hami vára · hug-fullr konungr,
2 áttu systra, · undir eik borit;
vas’k vetra tólf, · ef þik vita lystir,
4 es ungum gram · eiða selda’k.

[R TODO, F TODO]

The king full of heart [= Budle] let the forms of us
eight sisters be born beneath an oak.
I was twelve winters old, if thou hast lust to know,
when to the young lord oaths I gave.

2 undir eik borit ‘under an oak’ | King Budle let Byrnchild and her seven sisters be born under a (holy) oak due to the protection believed to be afforded by that species.

- 7 Hétu mik allir · i Hlym-dolum
2 Hildi und hjalmi, · hvęrr es kunni.

[R TODO]

In the Limdales all did call me
a Hild ’neath the helmet, whoever knew me.

- 8 Þá lét’k gamlan · á Got-þjóðu
2 Hjalm-Gunn-ar nęst · hełjar ganga;
gaf’k ungum sigr · Auðu bróður;

[R TODO, F TODO]

4 þar varð mér Óðinn · of-rēiðr um þat.

Then I next in the land of the Gots
let old Helm-Guther go the way of Hell.
I gave victory to Ead's young brother;
then was Weden furious with me over that.

1 Gor-þjóðu | Goð-þjóðu R

ALL | As told in *Sigrdr* P3.

1 Gor-þjóðu 'land of the Gots' | Also found in *Ghv* 8, 16. The spelling -t- attested in mss. of *Heiðr* st. 94/8b (SKP 8). It is notable that ON *Gor-þjóð* is a direct reflex of the attested Gotish self-name, *Gut-piuda*, as found in the Gotish liturgical calendar (Schäferdieck 1988, p. 118).

9 Lauk hann mik skjöldum · ï Skata-lundi,
2 rauðum ok hvítum, · randir snurtu;
þann bað hann slíta · svefni mínum
4 es hversgi lands · hrēða=sk kynni.

[R TODO, F TODO]

He locked me inside shields in Shatelund,
red ones and white; their rims clasped.
He bade that one upend my sleeping
who in no land could be frightened.

10 Lét umb sal minn · sunnan-verðan
2 hóvan brinna · hēr alls viðar;
þar bað hann einn þegn · yfir at ríða,
4 þann's mér fōrði goll · þat's und Fáfni lá.

[R TODO, F TODO]

He made around my hall a south-facing
high host of all wood [FIRE] burn.
He bade only one thane there ride over it:
him who brought me the gold which neath Fathomer lay.

11 Rēið góðr Grana · goll-miðlandi
2 þar's fōstri minn · flētjum stýrði;
einn þótti hann þar · qllum bētri,
4 víkingr Dana, · ï verðungu.

[R TODO, F TODO]

On Grane rode the good gold-dealer [RULER = Siward]
where my foster-son ruled the benches.
Alone he seemed there better than all,
the wiking of Danes, in the warband.

12 Svófum vit ok unðum · ï séing einni

[R TODO, F TODO]

- 2 sem hann minn bróðir · of borinn véri;
 hvárt-ki knátti · hǫnd yfir annat
 4 átta nóttum · okkart leggja.

We slept and were content in a single bed
 as if he had been born my brother;
 neither laid a hand o'er the other
 for eight nights, of us two.

- 13 Því brá mér Guð-rún, · Gjúka dóttir,
 2 at ek Sig-vǫrði · svéfa'k á armi;
 þar varð'k þess vís · es vildi'g=a'k
 4 at þau véltu mik · i ver-fangi.

[R TODO, F TODO]

Thus upbraided me Guthrun Yivick's daughter,
 because I slept on Siward's arm.
 There I became wise of what I did not want to be:
 that those two had tricked me in the catch of man.

2 Sig-vǫrði | metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-vrði R

- 14 Munu við of-stríð · alls til lengi
 2 konur ok karlar · kvikkvir fǫðask;
 vit skulum okkrum · aldri slíta,
 4 Sig-vǫrðr, saman. · Søkks-tu, gýgjar-kyn!“

[R TODO, F TODO]

In great strife for far too long
 will men and women alive be born.
 We two shall end our age,
 I and Siward, together.—Sink, thou gow-kind!”

4 Sig-vǫrðr | metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-vrðr R

ALL | Following this stanza, *Norn* adds the following short prose passage: *Þá ópti gýgr ogurligri rǫddu ok hljóp inn í bjarg'it.* ‘Then the gow shrieked with a terrible voice and jumped into the hill.’

3 aldri slíta ‘end our age’ | In the afterlife. An interesting expression considering how both their *aldrar* ‘ages, lifetimes’ have already concluded, but Byrnild is presumably saying that they will now spend an eternity together.

Second Lay of Guthrun

(II Guð·rúnar kviða)

Dating (Sapp 2022): early C11th (0.759)–late C11th (0.199)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Second Lay of Guthrun** (abbrev. *2 Guðr*) takes the form of a monologue told by Guthrun, who laments her fate. The ancient lay of Guthrun?

Text

Dráp Niflunga ('The Slaying of the Nivlings')

- P1 Gunn·arr ok Hogni tóku þá gull'it allt, Fáfnis arf. Ó·friðr var
 2 þá milli gjúkunga ok Atla; kenndi hann gjúkungum völd um
 and·lát Bryn·hildar. Þat var til sétta, at þeir skyldu gipta hánnum
 4 Guð·rúnu, ok gófu henni ó·minnis·veig at drekka áðr hón játti
 at giptask Atla. Synir Atla voru þeir Erpr ok Eitill, en Svan·hildr
 6 var Sig·urðar dóttir ok Guð·rúnar. Atli konungr bauð heim
 Gunn·ari ok Hogni, ok sendi Vinga eða Kné·frøð*. Guð·rún
 8 vissi vélar ok sendi með rúnum orð at þeir skyldu eigi koma ok
 til jar·tegna sendi hón Hogni hring'inn And·vara·naut ok knýtti
 10 í vargs·hár. Gunn·arr hafði beðit Odd·rúnar, systur Atla, ok gat
 eigi; þá fekk hann Glaum·varar, en Hogni átti Kost·beru. Þeira
 12 synir voru þeir Sól·arr ok Snév·arr ok Gjúki. En er gjúkungar
 kómu til Atla, þá bað Guð·rún sonu sína at þeir bæði gjúkungum
 14 lífs en þeir vildu eigi. Hjarta var skorit ór Hogni en Gunn·arr
 settir í orm·garð. Hann sló hǫrpu ok svéðði orma'na, en naðra
 16 stakk hann til lifrar.

Guthur and Hawn then took all the gold, Fathomer's inheritance. Then there was enmity between the Yivickings and Attle; he blamed the Yivickings for Byrnild's passing. Such were their terms, that they would marry Guthrun off to him; and they gave her a forgetfulness-draught to drink before she agreed to be married off to Attle. The sons of Attle were Earp and Oatle, but Swanhild was the daughter of Siward and Guthrun. Attle invited Guthur and Hawn to his home and sent Winge or Kneefrith. Guthrun knew his wiles and sent a word in runes that they should not come, and for a sign she sent Hawn the ring Andwaresneat and tied through it a wolf's hair. Guthur had asked for the hand of Ordrun, Attle's sister, and did not get her; then he got Gleamware, and Hawn had Costbeare. Their sons were Solwer and Snower and Yivick. But when the Yivickings came to Attle Guthrun asked her sons that they should plead for the life of the Yivickings, but they would not do so. The heart was cut out of Hawn but Guthur was placed in the snake-pit. He struck his harp and soothed the serpents, but an adder stung him unto the liver.

1 Gunn·arr | *The G is an ornamented initial 3 lines in height in R.* 7 Kné·frøð* | *gramm. emend.; Kné·frøðr (with erroneous abbreviation mark for nom. sg. -r) R*

ALL | This orienting prose passage serves to shortly summarise the narrative context behind the following 5 poems (2 *Guðr-Am*), all of which deal with Attle.

7 Vinga eða Kné·frøð* 'Winge or Kneefrith' | The messenger is known as *Vingi* in *Am*, *Kné·frøðr* in *Akv*.

P2 Þjóð-rekr konungr var með Atla ok hafði þar látit flesta alla menn
2 sína. Þjóð-rekr ok Guð-rún kærðu harma sín á milli. Hón sagði
hánun ok kvað:

King Thedric was with Attle, and had there lost almost all of his men. Thedric
and Guthrun brooded over their injuries between themselves. She spoke to
him and quoth:

Guð-rúnar kviða ('A Lay of Guthrun')

- 1 „Mér vas'k meýja; · móðir mik fódði,
2 björt í búi; · unna'k vel bróðrum—
und's mik Gjúki · golli reifði,
4 golli reifði, · gaf Sig-vørði.

“I WAS A MAIDEN OF MAIDENS; my mother raised me
bright in her bower; I loved well my brothers—
until Yivick with gold endowed me,
with gold endowed me and gave [me] to Siward.

1 MÉR | *The M is an ornamented initial 3 lines in height in R.* 4 Sig-vørði | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urði R*

- 2 Svá vas Sig-vørðr · of sonum Gjúka
sem véri grønn laukr · ór grasi vaxinn,
eða hjortr hǫ-beinn · of hvössum dýrum,
4 eða goll glóð-rautt · af gróu silfri.“

So was Siward over the sons of Yivick,
like were a green leek out of grass grown,
or a hart, high-legged, amidst coarse beasts,
or gold, glowing-red, beside grey silver—

1 Sig-vørðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R*

ALL | Cf. 1 *Guðr* 18, which shares the first two lines with only small differences, and the similar descriptions of Hallow (2 *HHund* 38) and Swanhild (*Gbv* 15).

2 grønn laukr ‘green leek’ | The leek was a highly valued plant. Compare *Vsp* 4 where the *grønn laukr* ‘green leek’ is said to have grown the first Golden Age. See also note there about its mythological significance.

- 3 und's mér fyr·munðu · mínir bróðr
2 at ek étta ver · ǫllum fremra;
sofa þeir né mǫttu-t · né of sakar dóma
4 áðr þeir Sig-vørð · svelta létu.

until my brothers begrudged me
that I had a husband better than all.
They could not sleep nor speak of anything
before they made Siward die.

4 Sig-vørð | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urð R*

- 4 Grani rann at þingi, · gnýr vas at heýra,
 2 en þá Sig·vǫrðr · sjalfr eigi kom;
 öll vǫru sǫðul-dýr · svęita stokkin
 4 ok of vanið vási · umb vegǫndum.

Grane ran to the Thing—a din was to be heard—
 but then Siward himself never came.

All the saddle-beasts [HORSES] with sweat were dripping
 although used to toil beneath riding men.

2 Sig·vǫrðr | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urðr R

3 sǫðul-dýr ‘saddle-beasts [HORSES]’ | This kenning also occurs in a loose stanza by Norse King Anlaf “the Holy” Haraldson.

- 5 Gekk ek grátandi · við Grana róða,
 2 úrug-hlýra, · jó frá’k spjalla;
 hnipnaði Grani þá, · drap ĩ gras hǫfði;
 4 jór þat vissi: · eígendr né lifðu-t.

I went, weeping, with Grane to speak;
 with teary cheeks I asked the horse for news.
 Then Grane drooped, bent his head in the grass;
 the horse knew that its owners lived not.

4 þat | ‘þ’ (*with abbreviation mark omitted*) R

- 6 Lengi hvarf=at, · lengi hugir deildu=sk
 2 áðr of frégja’k · folk-vǫrð at gram;
 hnipnaði Gunn·arr, · sagði mér Hǫgni
 4 frá Sig·varðar · sǫrum dauða:

Not long went by—long my thoughts were torn—
 before I asked the folk-ward about the prince.
 Guthur drooped; Hawn told me
 about Siward’s sore death:

4 Sig·varðar | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urðar R

- 7 ,Liggr of hǫggvinn · fyr handan ver
 2 Guð·þorms bani, · of gefinn ulfum;
 lít-tu þar Sig·vǫrð · á suðr-vega,
 4 þá heýrir þú · hrafna gjalla,
 ǫrnu gjalla, · éttsli fegna,
 6 varga þjóta · of veri þinum.’

‘Cut down lies across yonder sea,
 Godthorm’s bane [= Siward] given to the wolves.
 Look for Siward there on the southern ways!
 Then wilt thou hear the ravens shriek,
 the eagles shriek, rejoicing in flesh,
 the wolves howling o’er thy husband.’

3 Sig-vǫrð | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urð R

- 8 ,Hví þú mér, Hǫgni, · harma s·líka
 2 vilja-laussi · vill of segga?
 Þitt skyli hjarta · hrafnar slíta
 4 víð lǫnd yfir · en þú vitir manna.
 ‘TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.’

- 9 Svaraði Hogni · sinni einu,
 2 trauðr góðs hugar, · af trega stórum:
 ,Þess átt, Guð-rún, · gróti at fleiri
 4 at hjarta mitt · hrafnar slíti.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 ‘TODO.
 TODO.’

- 10 Hvarf’k einn þaðan · ann·spilli frá
 2 á víð, lesa* · varga leifar;
 gørði’g=a’k hjúfra · né hǫndum sláa
 4 né kveina of · sem konur aðrar
 þá’s sat soltin · of Sig-vǫrði.

Alone I turned away from the conversation,
 into the woods, to behold the leftovers of the wolves.
 I did not pant nor beat my hands
 nor wail over him like other women
 when I sat dejected over Siward.

4 of | ‘v’ (*corrupt form of* ‘v̅’) R 5 Sig-vǫrði | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urði R

3–5 gørði’g=a’k ... Sig-vǫrði ‘I did not ... Siward.’ | Closely related to 1 Guðr 1/2–4.

- 11 Nött þótti mér · nið-myrr vesa
 2 es sár=la sat'k · yfir Sig·vęrði;
 ulfar þóttu=sk · ęllu bętri
 4 ef þęir lęti mik · lifi týna
 ęða bręnni mik · sem birkinn við.

The night seemed to me as dark as if moonless
 when grieving I sat over Siward.
 The wolves would have seemed to me all the better
 if they had let me lose my life,
 or if they had burned me like birch-dry wood.

2 Sig·vęrði | metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urði R

- 12 Fór'k af fjalli · fimm dógur talit
 2 und's hęll Hę·alfr · hęva þękkęa'k.

I journeyed down from the fell for five nights and days,
 until the high hall of Highelf I knew.

- 13 Sat'k með þöru · sjau misseri,
 2 dętr Hę·konar, · i Dan-męrkur;
 hęn mér at gamni · goll bókaði
 4 sali suör-ęna · ok svani danska.

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 southern halls and Danish swans.

4 svani danska 'Danish swans' | In which Guthrun apparently took some delight. These fowls are also mentioned in I Guðr 16, Sigsk 29.

- 14 Hęđu vit á skriptum · þat's skatar léku
 2 ok á hann-yrðum · hilmis þęgna,
 randir rauðar, · rekka Huna,
 4 hjęr-drótt, hjalm-drótt, · hilmis fylgju.

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 15 Skip Sig·mundar · skriðu frá landi,

- 2 gylltar grímur, · grafnir stafnar;
 byrðu vit á borða · þat's þeir bōrðu=sk,
 4 Sig·arr ok Sig·gæirr, · suðr á Fífi.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 16 Þa frá Grím·hildr, · gotnesk kona,
 2 hvat ek véra hyggjuð;
 hōn brá borða · ok buri hēimti,
 4 þrō-gjarn=liga, · þess at spyrja:
 Hverr vildi son · systur bōta
 6 eða ver veginn · vildi gjalda.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

2 hvat ek véra hyggjuð | This half-line is clearly incomplete and missing another half. The alliteration on *h* is probable.

- 17 Gørr létsk Gunn·arr · goll at bjóða,
 2 sakar at bōta, · ok it sama Hōgni;
 hōn frétti at því · hverr fara vildi
 4 vigg at sōðla, · vagn at þeita,
 hēsti ríða, · hauki fleygja,
 6 qrum at skjóta · af ý-boga.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 18 Valdarr Dōnum · með Jarits·leifi,
 2 Eymóðr þriði · með Jarits·kári;
 inn gengu þá, · jōfrum líkir,
 4 Lang·barðs liðar, · hōfðu loða rauða,

- 6 stuttar brynjur, · steypta hjalma,
 skölmum gyrðir, · höfðu skarar jarpar.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

5 stuttar | *sø* N; *unmetrical* skreyttar R 5 steypta | *stepta* N 6 gyrðir | *add.* ok N

ALL | This st. is paraphrased in *Vǫls* 32, and ll. 5–6 are quoted.

- 19 Hverr vildi mér · hnossir velfja,
2 hnossir velfja, · ok hugat mēla
 ef þeir mētti mér · margra suta
4 tryggðir vinna; · né trúa gørða'k.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

- 20 Fórði mér Grím·hildr · full at drekka,
2 svalt ok sár=ligt, · né sakar munða'k;
 þat vas of aukit · urðar magni,
4 svá koldum sé · ok sonar dreýra.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

- 21 Vöru i horni · hverr kyns stafir
2 ristnir ok roðnir · —ráða né máttá'k—
 lyng-fiskr langr, · lands Haddingja
4 ax óskorit, · inn·leið dýra.

Into the horn were all kinds of staves
carved and reddened—I could not read them—
a long heather-fish [SNAKE] from the land of the Hardings,
an unshorn ear of corn, the entrails of beasts.

3 langr | *lagar* N

ALL. | This st. and the next are quoted in *Vǫls* 32.

- 22 Vǫru þeim bjóri · bǫl mǫrg saman,
 2 urt alls víðar · ok akarn *brunnin*,
 um-dogg arins, · iðrar blótnar,
 4 svíns lifr soðin; · því't hǫn sakar deyfði.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

2 *brunnin* | so N; *meaningless* inn R 3 iðrar blótnar | 'itrar blotna' N 4 hǫn | om. N

- 23 Eṇ þá glǽymðu, · es getit hǫfðu,
 2 ǫll jǫfurs · jór-bjúg i sal;
 kvǫmu konungar · fyr kné þrennir
 4 áðr hǫn sjalfa mik · sótti at máli.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 24 ,Gef'k þér, Guð-rún, · goll at þiggja,
 2 fǫlð alls féar, · at þinn fǫður dauðan,
 hringa rauða, · Hlǫð-vés sali,
 4 ár-sal allan, · at jǫfur fallinn.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 25 Húnskar meýjar, · þér's hlaða spjöldum
 2 ok gøra goll fagrt, · svá't þér gaman þikki;
 ein skalt ráða · auði Buðla,
 4 golli gǫfguð · ok gefin Atla.'

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 26 ,Vil'k ęigi ek · með veri ganga
 2 né Bryn·hildar · bróður ęiga;
 samir ęigi mér · við son Buðla
 4 ęt at auka · né una lífi.'

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 27 ,Hirð-a þú hǫldum · heiptir gjalda
 2 því't vér hǫfum · valdit fyrri;
 svá skalt láta · sem þeir lífi báðir,
 4 Sig·vǫrðr ok Sig·mundr, · ef þú sonu fǫðir.'

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

4 Sig·vǫrðr | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urðr R

- 28 ,Má'k=a'k, Grím·hildr, · glaumi bella
 2 né víg-risins · vǫnir tēja
 síðst Sig·varðar · sár=la drukku
 4 hrę-gífr, Huginn · hjart-blóð saman.'

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

3 Sig·varðar | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urðar R

- 29 ,Þann hefi'k allra · ęt-gofgastan
 2 fylki fundit · ok framarst nøkkvi;
 hann skalt ęiga · und's þik aldr viðar,
 4 ver-laus vesa, · nema vilir þenna.'

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 30 ,Hirð-a þú bjóða · bǫlva-fullar

- 2 þró-gjarn=liga · þér kindir mér!
 Hann mun *Gunn·ar · grandi þeita
 4 ok ór Högna · hjarta slíta.
 Mun'k=at létja · áðr lífs-hvatan
 6 egg-léiks hvötuð · aldri némi'k.

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 31 Grátandi Grím·hildr · greip við orði
 2 es burum sīnum · bǫlva vetti
 ok mǫgum sīnum · meina stórra:

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 32 ,Lond gef'k ęnn þér, · lýða sinni,
 2 Vin-björg, Val-björg, · ef þú vill þiggja;
 ęig of aldr þat · ok uni, dóttir!'

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 33 ,Þann mun'k kjósa · af konungum
 2 ok þó af niðjum · nauðig hafa;
 verðr ęigi mér · verr at ynði
 4 né bǫl bróðra · at bura skjóli.'

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 34 Sęnn vas á hęsti · hvęrr dręngr litinn
 2 en víf valnesk · hafð i vagna;
 vér sjau daga · svalt land riðum,
 4 en aðra sjau · unnir kníðum,

en ina þriðju sjau · þurrt land stigum.

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 35 Þar hlið-verðir · hárar borgar
 2 grind upp luku · áðr í garð riðum;
 vakði mik Atli · en ek vesa þóttumsk
 4 full ills hugar · at frændr dauða:

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 36 ,Svá mik ný=liga · nornir vøkja,
 2 víl-sinnis spó · vildi at ek réða;
 hugða'k þik, Guð·rún, · Gjúka dóttir,
 4 lē-blöndnum hjör · lēggja mik í gognum.

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 37 Þat 's fyr ęldi · es járn dreyma,
 2 fyr dul ok vil · drósar reiði;
 mun'k þik við bølvi · brenna ganga,
 4 líkna ok lękna · þó'tt mér leiðr sér.

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 38 Hugða'k hér í túni · tęina fallna
 2 þá's ek vildi'g=a'k · vaxna láta,
 rifnir með rótum, · roðnir í blóði,
 4 bornir á bękki, · beðið mik at tyggva.

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 39 **H**ugða'k mér af **h**endi · **h**auka fljúga
 2 **br**áða-lausa · **b**ól-ranna til;
 hjortu **h**ugða'k þeira · við **h**unang tuggin,
 4 **s**org-móðs **s**efa, · **s**ollin blóði.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 40 **H**ugða'k mér af **h**endi · **h**velpa losna,
 2 **g**laums and·vana, · **g**ylli báðir;
 hold **h**ugða'k þeira · at **h**rém orðit,
 4 **n**auðigr* **n**ái · **n**ýta'k skylda'k.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 41 Þar munu **s**eggir · of **s**óing dóma
 2 ok **h**vítinga · **h**ofði nēma;
 þeir munu **f**egir · **f**ara náttu
 4 fyr **d**ag litlu · **d**róttum þergja.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 42 **L**égja'k **s**íðan · —né **s**ofa vilda'k—
 2 **þ**ró-gjarn i kǫr; · **þ**at man'k gǫrva.“
 TODO.
 TODO.

Third Lay of Guthrun

(*III Guð·rúnar kviða*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.731)–early C11th (0.178)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Third Lay of Guthrun** (*3 Guðr*) is a short narrative poem, depicting just a single scene. At 10 stanzas it is the shortest poem in **R**, and arguably one of the most forgettable. Its only notable moments are its depiction of an ordeal by hot water and its allusion to the drowning of a slave-woman in a bog.

Dating

The most important factor towards dating *3 Guðr* is its conception of the ordeal by hot water. This type of ordeal first appears in the early C6th Frankish *Salic Law*, and is always closely associated with the Catholic clergy. TODO: We ought to investigate when it went out of fashion. <https://www.degruyterbrill.com/document/details/003/html>

Summary

Herch, one of Attle's slave-women and concubines tells him that she has seen his wife Guthrun sleep with Thedric. Attle becomes distressed upon hearing this (P1). Guthrun asks him what is wrong (1), and he responds that Herch has accused her of sleeping with Thedric (2). Guthrun promises to prove her innocence through a trial by ordeal involving taking up a white stone out of boiling water (3); while she and Thedric did sit down together, they did so only in mutual grief over the deaths of her brothers (4–5). Guthrun tells Attle to summon the German lord Saxe to carry out the trial, and seven hundred men arrive as witnesses (6). Before picking up the stone, Guthrun laments over her brothers' deaths, saying that they would have disputed the accusation through violence, but that she must prove her innocence alone

(7). She then puts her hand in the boiling water, and takes out the stone unscathed. She holds it up and shows it to the witnesses (8). Atle laughs, knowing that his wife has been faithful, and orders Herch to pick up the stone (9). She does so—and her hands are horribly scorched. She is dragged to a “foul bog”, presumably to be drowned. The poet ends by laconically stating that this was how Guthrun in such a way was “restored for her affronts” (10).

Text

Capitulum ('New Chapter')

- P1 Herkja hét ambótt Atla; hón hafði verit frilla hans. Hón sagði
 2 Atla at hón hefði sét Þjóð-rek ok Guð-rúnu bæði saman. Atli var
 þá all-ó-kátr. Þá kvað Guð-rún:

Herch was the name of a maidservant of Attle; she had been his concubine.
 She told Attle that she had seen Thedric and Guthrun both together. Then
 Attle was very unhappy. Then quoth Guthrun:

Guð-rúnar kviða ('A Lay of Guthrun')

- 1 „Hvat 's þér, Atli? · **É**, Buðla sonr,
 2 es þér hryggst í **h**ug; · hví **h**lér þú **é**va?
 Hitt myndi **ó**ðra · **j**orlum þykkja
 4 at við **m**enn **m**éltir · ok **m**ik s^éir.“

“**W**HAT IS WITH THEE, Attle? Always, son of Bodle,
 art thou sad at heart—why laughest thou never?
 It would seem more proper to earls
 that thou spoke with men and looked at me.”

1 Hvat | The H ('b') is an ornamented initial 2 lines in height with the left line rising in the margin 5 lines high in R.

- 2 „Tregi mik þat, Guð-rún, · **G**júka dóttir,
 2 mér í **h**ollu · **H**erkja sagði
 at **þ**it **þ**jóðrekr · undir **þ**aki svéfið
 4 ok léttliga · **l**ini verðið.“

“It troubles me, O Guthrun, Yivick's daughter,
 that in the hall Herch told me
 that thou and Thedric slept beneath one roof,
 and lightly did ye mind your linen.”

4 léttliga · líni verðið 'lightly did ye mind your linen' | Euphemistic; they threw off their clothes and slept with each other.

- 3 „Þér mun'k **a**lls þess · **é**iða vinna
 2 at inum **h**víta · **h**elga st^eini,
 at ek við **þ**jóðmar · **þ**at-ki átta'k,

4 es vǫrðr né verr · vinna knátti,—

“For thee I will swear the oaths to all of it
—by the white, holy stone,
that I did no such thing with Thedmar—
those which no married woman nor man has sworn,

2 at inum hvíta · hęlga steini ‘by the white, holy stone’ | The stone lifted out of a pot of boiling water in the trial by ordeal, as described further in st. 8.

3 Þjóðmar ‘Thedmar’ | Historically, Thedmar (*Theodemir*) was the father of Thedric (*Theoderic*) the Great, who took over the kingdom after his father’s death (see Index). The use of the name here may either be a scribal error (whether for “Thedric” or for “Thedmar’s son”), or a nickname caused by the conflation of the two persons in the late Norse tradition.

4 es vǫrðr né verr · vinna knátti ‘those which no married woman nor man has sworn’ | I.e., “those oaths which et c.” — Guthrun’s use of *vǫrðr* ‘wife, married woman’ and *verr* ‘husband, married man’ serve to question the reliability of Herch’s testimony by pointing out that she, as an unmarried slave-woman, is not in a position to make legally binding accusations.

4 nema ek halsaða · hęrja stilli,
2 jǫfur óneisinn, · ęinu sinni;
aðrar vǫru · okkrar spēkjur
4 es vit hǫrmug tvau · hnigum at rúnum.

unless I embraced the stiller of hosts [RULER = Thedmar],
the unshamed prince, a single time.
Different were the dealings of us two,
when we, distressed, reclined in whispers.

5 Hér kom Þjóðrekr · með þrjá tǫgu,
2 lifa þęir né ęinir, · þriggja tega manna;
hrink-tu mik at bróðrum · ok at brynjuðum,
4 hrink-tu mik at ęllum · à hǫfuð-niðjum.

Hither Thedric came with thirty men;
of those thirty none still lives.—
Surround me with brothers and with byrned men;
surround me with all close kinsmen!

3 hrink-tu ‘surround’ | Consisting of *bring*, 2nd sg. imper. of *bringja* ‘surround, encircle’ + *þú* ‘thou’. The clitic form *-tu* has caused devoicing.

6 Sęnd at Saxa, · sunn-manna gram;
2 hann kann hęlga · hver vellaða;
sjau hundruð manna · ĩ sal gingu
4 áðr kvęn konungs · ĩ kętil tóki.

Send for Saxe, the lord of Southmen;
 he can hallow the boiling cauldron.”
 Seven hundred men went into the hall,
 before the king’s wife should reach into the kettle.

1 Saxa, · sunn-manna gram ‘Saxe, the lord of Southmen’ | The Southmen being the Germans. —
 This line shows that the trial by cauldron was considered a foreign, specifically German custom by
 the poet, who naturally imagined Atle and Guthrun to have belonged to his own, Norse culture.
 For its bearing on dating the poem see Introduction.

- 7 „Kømr=a nú Gunn·arr, · kalli’k=a Høgna,
 2 sé’k=a síðan · svása bróðr;
 sverði myndi Høgni · s·líks harms reka,
 4 nú verð’k sjölf fyr mik · synja lýta.“
 “Now Guther will not come; I will not call on Hawn;
 I will not henceforth see my beloved brothers.
 By his sword would Hawn avenge such an affront;
 now I for myself must disprove the slanders!”

- 8 Brá hōn til botns · björtum lófa
 2 ok hōn upp of tók · jarkna-stēina:
 „Sé nú sēggir · —sykn em’k orðin
 4 hēilag=liga— · hvé sjá hvern velli.“

She thrust to the bottom her bright palms,
 and she up did take the arkenstones:
 “Let men now see—I am proven innocent
 through holy means!—how this cauldron boils!”

2 jarkna-stēina ‘arkenstones’ | Gems, crystals; probably a borrowing from the Old English *eorcnan-stānas* ‘id.’ The modern English form *arkenstone* was coined by Tolkien.

- 9 Hló þá Atla · hugr ĩ brjósti
 2 es hann hēilar sá · hēndr Guð·rúnar:
 „Nú skal Hērka · til hvers ganga,
 4 sú’s Guð·rúnu · grandí vęnti.“

Then laughed Atle’s heart in his chest,
 when he saw unscathed the hands of Guthrun:
 “Now shall Herch to the cauldron go,
 she who hoped for Guthrun’s harm!”

1 Hló þá Atla · hugr ĩ brjósti ‘Then laughed Atle’s heart in his chest’ | Echoing *Þrk* 31/1.

- 10 Sá=at maðr armligt, · hvęrr es þat sá=at,
 2 hvé þar á Hęrkju · hęndr sviðnuðu;
 leiddu þá męy · ĩ mýri fúla,
 4 svá þá Guð·rún · sĭnna harma.

Man saw nothing pitiful if he did not see that,
 how there on Herch the hands were scorched.
 Then they led the maiden into the foul bog;
 so was Guthrun restored for her affronts.

3 leiddu þá męy · ĩ mýri fúla ‘Then they led the maiden into the foul bog’ | To be drowned, as was the customary Germanic punishment for perjurers; see *Vsp* 38 n.

Weeping of Ordrun

(Odd·rúnar grátr)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.954)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Weeping of Ordrun** (*Oddr*) is another heroic poem. The following edition and translation is by no means complete.

Text

Frá Borgnýju ok Odd-rúnu ('From Burgny and Ordrun')

- P1 Heið·rekr hét konungr; dóttir hans hét Borg·ný. Vil·mundr hét
 2 sá er var friðill hennar. Hón mátti eigi fóða börn áðr til kom
 Odd·rún, Atla systir; hón hafði verit unnusta Gunn·ars, Gjúka
 4 sonar. Um þessa sögu er hér kveðit:

HEATHRIC WAS THE NAME OF A KING. His daughter's name was Burgny. Wilmund was the name of her lover. She could not bear children before Ordrun, Attle's sister, arrived. She had been the lover of Guthar, Yivick's son. About this saw it is here sung:

1 Heið·rekr | *The H ('D') is an ornamented initial 2 lines in height with the left line rising 4 lines high in R.*

- 1 Hęyrðað'k sęgja · i sęgum fornum
 2 hvę męř of kom · til Morna-lands;
 ęngi mátti · fyr jęřð ofan
 4 Hęiðreks dóttur · hįlpir vinna.

I HEARD IT SAID in ancient saws
 how a maiden came to Mornland;
 noone could—above the earth—
 find help for Heathric's daughter [= Burgny].

1 Hęyrðað'k | *The H is an ornamented initial 3 lines in height in R.*

1 Hęyrðað'k sęgja · i sęgum fornum 'I heard it said in ancient saws' | Formulaic opening; cf. *Hild* 1: *ik gi·bǫrta dat sęggen* 'I heard it said' which likewise uses the 1sg past of 'hear' and the infinitive of 'say'. The ancestral Proto-Germanic phrase may be reconstructed as **ek ga-hauzidō (þat) sęgianq*. — For a similar opening formula involving the verb **frehnanq* '(come to) learn, find out through hearsay' cf. *Gbv* 1/1 n.

- 2 Þat frá Odd·rún, · Atla systir,
 2 at sú męř hafði · miklar sóttir;
 brá hęn af stalli · stjórն-bitluðum
 4 ok à svartan · sęðul of lagði.

This learned Ordrun, Attle's sister,
 that the maiden [= Burgny] had great ailments;
 she grabbed from the stable a rudder-bitted steed,
 and a black saddle on [it] did lay.

- 3 Lét hōn **mar** fara · **mold**-veg sléttan
 2 und's at **hári** kom · **hōll** standandi;
 ok hōn **inn** of gekk · **ęnd**-langan sal;
 4 **svipti** hōn **sōðli** · af **svōngum** jó
 ok hōn þat **orða** · **alls** fyrst of kvað:

She let the steed travel the smooth soil-way [EARTH]
 until she came to the high standing house
 and she went inside the endlong hall.
 She cast the saddle off the slender horse
 and she this word first of all did say:

3 ok hōn inn of gekk · ęnd-langan sal 'and she went inside the endlong hall.' | The whole line is formulaic; cf. *Vkr* 8 n.

5 ok ... of kvað 'and ... did say' | A formulaic long-lines; cf. *Þrk* 2/1 n.

- 4 „Hvat es **frégst** · á **foldu**
 2 eða **hvat** er **hléðst** · **Hūna**-lands?“
 „Hér liggr **Borg**-ný · of **borin** vęrkjum,
 4 **vina** þin, Odd-rún, · **vit** ef hjalpir!“

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 5 „Hvęrr hęfir **vísir** · **vamms** of lęitat?
 2 Hví eru **Borg**-nýjar · **bráðar** sóttir?“

TODO.
 TODO.

- 6 „**Vil**-mundr hét · **vinr** hauk-stalda,
 2 hann **varði** męy · **varmri** blęju,
fimm vetr alla, · svá hōn sīnn **fōður** lęyndi.“

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 7 **Þęr** hykk męltu · **þvígir** flęira,
 2 gekk **mild** fyr kné · **męyju** at sitja;
ríkt gól Odd-rún, · **rammt** gól Odd-rún,

4 bitra galdra · at Borg-nýju.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

8 Knátti mēr ok mögr · mold-veg sporna,

2 börn þau in blíðu · við bana Högna;

þat nam at mēla · mēr fȝor-sjúka

4 svá't hōn ękki kvað · orð it fyrra:

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

9 „Svá hjalpi þér · hollar vęttir,

2 Frigg ok Freyja · ok fleiri goð

sem þú fęlldir mér · fār af hōndum.“

“So help thee hold wights,

Frie and Frow, and yet more gods,

as thou removedest this danger from my hands.”

1 Svá hjalpi þér ‘So help thee’ | A close semantic parallel, likewise invoking several gods to “help” somebody, is found on the 12th c. Saltfleetby spindle-whorl (E 18, normalised): *Óðinn ok Heim-dalr ok Þjálfi, þęir hjalpa þér Ulf-ljótr(?)* ... “Weden and Homedall and Thelwe, may they help thee, Wolfight ...”.

10 „Hné’k=at ek af því · til hjalpar þér

2 at þú vęrir þess · verð aldri=gi;

hét’k ok ęfnda’k · es ek hinig mēla

4 at ek hví-vetna · hjalpa skylda’k

þá’s qōlingar · arfi skiptu.“

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

11 Þa nam at setjask · sorg-móð kona

2 at tēlja bōl · af trega stórum:

TODO.

TODO.

- 12 „Vas’k upp alin · ì jofra sal,
 2 flęstr fagnaði, · at fira ráði;
 unða ek aldri · ok ęign fęður
 4 fimm vetr ęina · svá’t minn faðir lifði.

I was reared up in the princely hall,

TODO.

I was content with life and my father’s estate
 for but five winters while my father lived.

- 13 Þat nam at męla, · mál it øfsta
 2 sjá móðr konungr · áðr hann sylti.

TODO.

TODO.

- 14 Mik bað hann góða · golli rauðu
 2 ok suðr gefa · syni Grím·hildar;
 kvað-a hann ina óðri ·alna myndu
 4 męy ì hęimi · nema mjötuðr spillti.“

He bade me be endowed with red gold
 and given in the south to the son of Grimhild.

TODO.

TODO.

- 15 „Ør est, Odd-rún, · ok ør·vita
 2 es þú mér af fari · flęst orð of kvað;
 ęn ek fylgða’k þer · à fjörgynju
 4 sęm vit bróðrum tveim · of bornar vęrim.

“TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

4 bornar | borin R

- 16 Man’k hvat męltir · ęnn umb aptan
 2 þá’s ek Gunn·ari · gørða’g drekku;

- s·líks dómi kvað=at-tu · síðan mundu
 4 meyju verða · nema mér einni.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

1 Man'k hvat mēltir · enn umb aptan | This line is clearly corrupt as seen by the lack of alliteration connecting the two halves. The simplest solution is to switch the places of *mēltir* and *enn*, but this produces a three-syllabic a-verse and a five-syllabic b-verse. Another possibility would be *Man'k hvat *enn · umb aptan mēltir*, but the metrics are still questionable.

- 17 Bryn·hildr i búi · borða rakði,
 2 hafði hōn lýði · ok lōnd umb sik;
 jorð dusaði · ok upp-himinn
 4 þa's bani Fáfnis · borg of þatti.

Byrnhild in her bower wove tapestries;
 she had warriors and lands around her.
 The Earth stood still and Up-heaven
 when Fathomer's bane [= Siward] beheld that stronghold.

- 18 Þa vas víg vegit · vōlsku sverði
 2 ok borg brotin, · sú's Bryn·hildr átti;
 vas=a langt af því · heðr vō-lítit
 4 und's þer vélar · vissi allar.

Then the battle was fought with a Welsh sword
 and broken was the stronghold which Byrnhild owned.
 It was not long thereafter—rather woefully short—
 until she knew all the guiles.

4 þer vélar 'the guiles' | Namely that Siward had switched shapes with Guthel.

- 19 Þess lét hōn harðar · hefndir verða
 2 svá't vér ǫll hōfum · órnar raunir;
 þat mun á hōlða · hvert land fara
 4 es hōn lét svelta=sk · at Sig·verði.

For that she declared there would be harsh revenge,
 just what of which we all have seen enough.
 It will spread to every land of men
 how she let herself die after Siward.

4 Sig·verði | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig·urði R

- 20 Ën ek Gunn·ari · gat'k at unna,
 2 **bauga** ðeili, · sēm Bryn·hildr skyldi;
 en hann Bryn·hildi · **bað** hjalm geta,
 4 hana kvað hann ósk·meý · verða skyldu.

But I got to love Guthr,
 the dealer of bigs whom Byrnhild should have,
 but he bade a helmet be given to Byrnhild;
 he said she would be his adopted daughter.

- 21 Buðu þeir Atla · **bauga** rauða
 2 ok bróðr minum · bótr ó·smáar;
 bauð hann enn við mér · bú fimm·tían,
 4 hlið·farm Grana · ef hann hafa vildi.

They offered Attle red bigs,
 and my brother unsmall restitutions.
 TODO.
 TODO.

1 Atla | árla **R.** 3 fimm·tían | .xv. **R.**

3 fimm·tían ‘fifteen’ | For metrical reasons the abbreviation *xv* is resolved to the archaic hiatus form *fimm-tían* rather than the standard *fimm-tán*. The meter of *Oddr* does rarely permit 3-syllable verses (*Oddr* 4/1a–b, 4/2b, 6/1a), but restoring hiatus is the better option since it agrees with the typical metrical patterns of the poem; *-tían* is also metrically secured from the early C11th by Þorm Þorgdr (SkP 5), 1/4b: *fimm-tían* ‘fifteen’, 15/2b: *þré-tían* ‘thirteen’.

The suffix *-t(j)án* ‘teen’ in the numerals 13–19 behaves curiously in classical ON and modern Icelandic. In 13–16 (*þré-tán*, *fjór-tan*, *fimm-tán*, *sex-tán*) the suffix is *-tán*, but in 17–19 (*sjau-tján*, *át-tján*, *ní-tján*) it is *-tján* (< *-tían*). The latter is undoubtedly the older form, deriving from PN **-tiban* corresponding to OHG *-zeban*, Gothic *-taibun*; see further Konráð Gíslason (1879), Kock (1893, pp. 137–142).

- 22 Ën Atli kvað=sk · **ęgi** vilja
 2 **mund** aldri=gi · at męgi Gjúka;
 þęy=gi vit mōttum · við munum vinna
 4 nema ek hélt hōfði · við hring·brota.

TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.
 TODO.

- 23 Méltu margir · münir niðjar,
 2 kvóðu=sk okkr hafa · orðit bæði
 en mik Atli kvað · **ęgi** myndu

4 **l**ýti ráða · né **l**øst gøra.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

24 **E**n s·líks skyli · synja aldri
2 **m**aðr fyr annan · þar's **m**un-úð dēilir.

TODO.

TODO.

25 Sęndi **A**tli · **ó**ru sína
2 of **m**yrkvan við · **m**ín at fręista;
 ok þęir **k**vómu · þar's **k**oma né skyldu=t
4 þa's **b**ręiddu vit · **bl**ęju ęina.

Attle sent his messengers
o'er the mirky wood to ask for me,
and they came where they should not have come,
when we two had spread out a single bed-cover.

1 Sęndi Atli · óru sína 'Attle sent his messengers' | Cf. *Akv* 1/1.

26 **B**uðu vit þegnum · **b**auga rauða
2 at þęir **ę**igi til · **A**tla sęðði;
 ęn þęir **ó**=liga · **A**tla sęğðu
4 ok **h**vat=liga · **h**ęim skunduðu.

We offered the thanes red bighs
that they should not tell it to Attle,
but harmfully they told Attle,
and rushingly hurried home.

27 **E**n þęir **G**uð·rúnu · **g**or=la lęyndu
2 því at hōn **h**ęldr vita · **h**ōlfu skyldi.

TODO.

TODO.

28 **H**lymr vas at **h**ęyra · **h**óf-gollinna
2 þa's i **g**arð riðu · **G**júka arfar;
 þęir ór **H**ęgna · **h**jarta skøru

4 ɛn i ɔrm-garð · annan lɔgðu.

There was a din to be heard from the golden-hooved ones
when into the court rode Yivick's heirs;
out of Hawn they cut the heart,
but in the snake-pit they laid the other.

3–4 þeir ... lögðu. 'out of ... the other.' | The deaths of Guthur and Hawn are told in *Akv* 23–35, *Am* 56–64.

29 Vas'k ɛnn farin · ɛinu sinni
2 til Gɛir-mundar · gørva drykkju;
 nam horskr konungr · hɔrpu sveigja
4 því't hann hugði mik · til hjalpar sér,
 kyn-ríkr konungr, · of koma myndu.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

30 Nam'k at heyra · ór Hlés-eyju
2 hvé þar af stríðum · strængir meltu,
 bað'k ambáttir · búnar verða,
4 vilda'k fylkis · fjorvi bjarga;
 létum fljóta · far lund yfir
6 und's alla sá'k · Atla garða.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

31 Þá kom in arma · út skévandi,
2 móðir Atla, · hön skyli morna!

TODO.
TODO.

32 Ok Gunn·ari · gróf til hjarta
2 svá't mátti'g=a'k · mærum bjarga.

TODO.

TODO.

- 33 Opt undr=umk þat · hví ęptir má'k,
 2 linn-vęngis Bil, · lífi halda
 es ek ógn-hvötum · unna þött=umk,
 4 sverða deili, · sęm sjalfri mér.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

- 34 Satst ok hlýddir · meðan sagða'k þér
 2 mǫrg ill of skǫp · mǫn ok þeira;
 mǫðr hvęrr lifir · at munum sínum;
 4 nú 's of ęęginn · grátr Odd·rúnar.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

TODO.

2 of skǫp | An instance of the archaic particle *of* in a prenominal position, corresponding to a lost Germanic prefix **ga-*; see *Sigsk* 23/1 n. *of skǫp* (< PGmc. **ga-skapō* > OS *gi-skapu*, OE *ge-sceap*) also occurs in *Sigsk* 58/5 and the present occurrence may be due to borrowing.

Lay of Attle

(*Atla kviða*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.719)–early C11th (0.212)

Meter: loose Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Lay of Attle** (*Akv*) is a narrative heroic poem dealing with King Attle of the Huns and his destruction of the Burgends Guthur and Hawn.

Textual preservation and transmission

Akv is preserved only in **R**, on foll. 39v/11–41r/9, where it follows *Oddr* and is followed by *Am*. The poem was clearly available to the redactor of *Vǫls*, which suggests its presence in the poetic source used for that text.

Meter and stanza

Akv consists of 176 long-lines across 47 stanzas. The poem itself has no narrative prose, but it is introduced by a short orienting prose passage (P1) and concludes with a short note introducing the following poem, *Am* (P2).

Together with *Vkv* and *Hamð*, *Akv* is composed in an unusually loose form of Ancient-words-law. Though still characterised by 4 positions (unlike the 5-position Speeches-meter, as found in *Am*), the meter of *Akv* has a greater tolerance for verses with a greater number of unstressed syllables. This is seen especially in its strong preference for verses of the otherwise rare type D* (e.g. 4/2a: *hjalma goll-roðna*) over type D (e.g. 28/4a: *hodd Niflunga*) and its common use of anacrusis. Both traits are shared with Speeches-meter to the exclusion of regular Ancient-words-law (Suzuki 2014, pp. 504–6, 518–19; Goering 2023, pp. 82–83).

A unique, innovative verse-type found in *Akv* (and, less commonly, in *Hamð*), but not in regular Norse Ancient-words-law (nor in *Beow*), is what Goering (2023, pp. 83–85) terms E*. This type is marked by the basic patterns

/ x / x (Ea*, e.g. 29/3b: *róg-malmi skatna*) and / x / x (Eb*, e.g. 13/3b: *erfi-vörðr Hogni*), and here occurs in 11 lines (Goering 2023, 83, n. 64).

Despite its tolerance for extended verses, the poem also permits catalectic (3-position) verses, including verses with only 3 syllables. One verse, 32/3, has no corresponding verse; another, 28/2, is clearly defective owing to corruption.

The typical length of the stanza is 4 lines (29/47: 1–7, 9–10, 12–18, 21–22, 28–29, 32–33, 36–37, 40, 43–45, 47). The other commonly represented lengths are 2 (5/47: 8, 11, 24, 30, 34), 3 (6/47: 19, 20, 23, 26, 38–39), and 5 (5/47: 25, 27, 41–42, 46). Stanzas of 1 line (31) and 6 lines (35) each appear once. Clauses occasionally span across multiple stanzas in the case of long lists, so 7–8, 15–16, and 18–19.

Origin and motifs

Akv narrates the treacherous murder of the Burgends or Nivlings, Guthar and Hawn, at the hands of the Hunnish King Attle. Of all Eddic poems dealing with these figures, *Akv* shows the closest adherence to the known historical circumstances. This is seen in its clear distinction between the tribes of the Gots and the Huns, its geographical awareness, and its labelling of Guthar as a Burgend (21/2).

Compare with the younger *Am*.

In R, the poem has the title *Atla kviða in grón-lenska* ‘the Greenlandish Lay of Attle’, but the adjectival phrase is almost certainly due to influence from the following *Am*, which, unlike *Akv*, does in fact show signs of a Greenlandish origin. Greenland was not settled by Icelanders until ca. 1000 CE (TODO: cite), by which point *Akv*—judging by the metrically required *vr-* (see below)—must already have been composed.

Together with *Am*, *Akv* clearly serves as a source for *Vþls* 36–38. Although *Am* is the main source for most of the section, *Akv* 22–35 clearly underly parts of *Vþls* 37.

Style

TODO: The old Germanic epic style of telling the whole story in poetry rather than delegating the verse exclusively to dialogue and otherwise relying on prose to progress the narrative.

Dating

Akv has long been held to be a particularly archaic poem, and this is confirmed by its linguistic traits. The poem displays uncontracted hiatus forms—a sign of composition before ca. 1150—and alliteration between old *vr-* and *v-* (st. 2/2, 14/4)—a sign of composition before ca. 1000 (Haukur Þorgeirsson 2023, pp. 36–38). On the other hand, the poem does not have a particularly high rate of the archaic particle *of*, which appears at a frequency of 0.1709

occurrences per 10 unique lines (Sapp 2022, p. 70), although it should be stressed that this is not an exceptionally low frequency, either.

Text

Dauði Atla ('The Death of Attle')

- P1 Guð·rún Gjúka dóttir hefndi bróðra sinna, svá sem frégt er orðit.
 2 Hón drap fyrst sonu Atla, en eptir drap hón Atla ok brendi
 holl'ina ok hirð'ina alla; um þetta er sjá kviða ort.

GUTHRUN YIVICK'S DAUGHTER AVENGED her brothers as has become renowned.
 She first slew the sons of Attle, but afterwards she slew Attle and burned the
 hall and the whole hird. About that this lay is wrought.

1 Guð·rún | *The G is an ornamented initial 3 lines high in R.*

Atla kviða in grón-lenska ('The Greenlandish Lay of Attle')

- 1 Atli sændi · ór til Gunn·ars
 2 kunnan segg at ríða, · Kné·frøðr vas sá heitinn;
 at gørdum kom Gjúka · ok at Gunn·ars hollu,
 4 bækkjum arin-græypum · ok at bjóri svôsum.

ATTLE SENT a messenger to Guthur
 a well-known man to ride; Kneefrith he was called.
 He came to the yards of Yivick and the hall of Guthur,
 to the hearth-surrounding benches and the pleasant beer.

1 Atli | *The A is an ornamented initial 3 lines high, more elaborate than the one immediately above (in P1), in R.*

1 Atli sændi · ór til Gunn·ars 'Attle sent a messenger to Guthur' | Echoed in *Oddr* 25/1.

2 Kné·frøðr 'Kneefrith' | In *Am* the messenger is called Winge and plays a greater role in the narrative.

- 2 Drukku þar drótt-megir · —en dyljendr þogðu—
 2 vīn i val-hollu, · vrēiði sôu=sk þeir Húna;
 kallaði þá Kné·frøðr · kaldri røddu,
 4 seggr inn suð-røni · sat á bækk hójum:

There the dright-lads [WARRIORS] drank—but the concealed ones shut up—
 wine in the walhall; they feared the wrath of the Huns.
 Then Kneefrith called out with a cold voice—
 the southern man sat on a high bench:

1 dyljendr ‘concealed ones’ | Finnur Jónsson (1932) reasonably interprets this as referring to Attle’s spies at Guthur’s court.

2 val-höllu ‘the walhall’ | The interpretation of this cpd. is difficult in the current context. The first element *val-* may be (1) *valr* ‘falcon’, referring to aristocratic hunting practices; (2) *valr* ‘Wale’, cognate with ‘Welsh’ but in ON referring to the French or Romans, stressing the southern-ness of the hall (cf. st. 15/3 below); or (3) *valr* ‘(collective) the battle-slain’, foreshadowing the inevitable death (feyness) of the Yivickings. If (3) is correct the word is linguistically identical to Walhall, Weden’s hall, whither the battle-slain go.

2 vrēði ‘wrath’ | An example of highly archaic alliteration between *v-* and old *vr-*, securing the presence of the latter in *Akv*; cf. sts. 9/3, 14/4.

- 3 „Atli mik hingat sēndi · ríða ørēndi,
2 mar inum mēl-grēypa, · Myrk-við inn ó-kunna
at biðja yðr, Gunn·arr, · at it á bēkk kómið
4 með hjǫlmum arin-grēypum · at sókja hēim Atla.

“Attle sent me hither to ride an errand
on the bit-champing steed through Mirkwood uncharted—
to ask you, O Guthur, that ye two [= Guthur and Hawn] on the bench come
with hearth-surrounding helmets to seek the home of Attle.

- 4 Skjöldu kneguð þar vǽlja · ok skafna aska,
2 hjalma goll-roðna · ok Húna mēngi,
silfr-gyllt sǫðul-klēði, · sērki val-rauða,
4 dafar, darraða, · drǫsla mēl-grēypa.

There ye might choose shields and shaven ash-spears,
helmets gold-reddened and a multitude of Huns,
silver-gilt saddle-cloth, blood-red serks,
javelins, pennants, bit-champing steeds.

- 5 Vǫll lét=sk ykkir ok myndu gefa · víðrar Gnita-hēiðar
2 af gēiri gjallanda · ok af gylltum stǫfnum,
stórar mēiðmar · ok staði Danpar,
4 hrís þat it mēra · es mēðr Myrk-við kalla.“

He declared he would also give you the plain of the wide Gnit-heath,
from yelling spears and from gilded prowes,
great treasures and the banks of the Danper,
the renowned brush which men call Mirkwood.”

2 gēiri gjallanda ‘yelling spears’ | Formulaic. Also found in Egill Lv TODO; in OE as *giellende gār* in *Wid* TODO, *Fērst* TODO.

3–4 stórar ... kalla ‘great ... Mirkwood.’ | Both lines bear strong resemblance to ll. of 7, 9 of *Heiðr* st. 94.

3 Danpar ‘the Danper’ | The Dnieper, which runs through eastern Ukraine to the Black Sea. The Norse form *Danþar* (gen. sg.) is only attested here and in *Heiðr* st. 94 (for which see ll. 3–4 n.). The nominative form is uncertain; if it be a feminine it should be **Dənp*, a masculine **Danpr* or **Dənp̃r*. In any case it appears to be a reflex of the Gothic form *Danaper* as found in Jordanes, *Getica* 30, 35, 44 et c. As Males (2025, TODO) points out, *Heiðr* has the more historically accurate conception of the river, since it is there part of the Gothic kingdom, as it was historically, rather than of the Hunnish kingdom, as it is here.

- 6 Hǫfði vatt þá Gunn·arr · ok Hǫgna til sagði:
2 „Hvat réðr okkr, sęggr hinn ǫri, · alls vit s·líkt heyrum?
 Goll vissa’k ękki · á Gnita-heiði,
4 þat’s vit ęttim=a · annat s·líkt.

His head turned then Guthur and said to Hawn:
“What dost thou counsel for us two, O younger man, as such things we hear?
I knew of no gold on the Gnit-heath
of which we two had not owned even as much.

- 7 Sjau ęigu vit sal·hús · sverða full,
2 hveŗju ’ro þęira · hjǫlt ór goll;
 minn veit’k mar bętstan · ęn męki hvassastan,
4 boga bękk-sóma · ęn brynjur ór goll,

We own seven hall-houses filled with swords—
on each of them is a golden hilt.
I know my horse is best and [my] sword the sharpest,
[my] bow is bench-fit and [my] byrnies golden,

- 8 hjalm ok skjǫld hvítastan, · kominn ór hǫll Kíars;
2 ęinn ’s minn bętri · an séi allra Húna.“

[my] helmet and my whitest shield, come from Coser’s hall;
mine alone is better than those of all of the Huns might be!”

- 9 „Hvat hyggr brúði bęndu · þá’s hǫn okkr baug sęndi,
2 varinn vǫðum heiðingja? · Hykk at hǫn vǫrnuð byði!
 Hár fann’k heiðingja · vriðit i hring rauðum;
4 ylfskr es vegr okkarr · at riða ǫręndi.“

[Quoth Hawn:] “What dost thou think the bride meant when she sent us a big
wrapped in a heath-dweller’s [WOLF’s] cloth? I think she offered a warning!
A heath-dweller’s hair I found tied round the red ring:
wolvern is our road if we ride that errand!”

ALL | That it is the more cautious Hawn who speaks here is clear from Guthur's response in the following stanzas. Whereas Hawn judges the wolf-hair to be a warning of Hunnish treachery, Guthur thinks that it is a warning that wolves will steal his treasure if he does not show up.

- 10 Niðjar=gi hvøttu Gunn·ar · né nǫungr annarr,
 2 rýnendr né ráðendr, · né þeir's ríkir vǫru;
 kvaddi þá Gunn·arr · sem konungr skyldi,
 4 mér ǫ mjǫð-ranni · af móði stórum:

No kinsmen goaded Guthur nor any other relation,
 not counselors nor advisors nor those who were powerful.
 Then Guthur announced—as a king should—
 renowned in the mead-hall out of great spirit:

- 11 „Rís-tu nú, Fjǫrnir, · lát-tu á flēt vaða
 2 greppa goll-skálir · með gumna höndum!

“Rise now, Ferner! Let on the benches wade forth
 the golden bowls of soldiers along the hands of men!

1 Fjǫrnir ‘Ferner’ | An otherwise unknown servant.

- 12 Ulfr mun ráða · arfi Niflunga,
 2 gamlir grán-varðir, · ef Gunn·ars missir;
 birnir blakk-fjallir · bíta þref-tǫnnum,
 4 gamna grey-stóði, · ef Gunn·arr né kǫmr=at.“

The wolves will rule the patrimony of the Nivlings—
 old, grey-pelted—if Guthur is absent!
 Black-furred bears will bite with wrangling teeth—
 amusing the bitch-pack—if Guthur comes not!”

4 né kǫmr=at ‘comes not’ | Note the archaic double negation *né ... -at*; cf. *Háv* 135/4 n.

- 13 Leiddu land-rǫgni · lýðar ǫ-neisir,
 2 grátendr, gunn-hvatan, · ór garði Húna;
 þá kvað þat inn ǫri · erfir-vǫrðr Hǫgna:
 4 „Heilir farið nú ok horskir · hvar's ykkir hugr tægir!“

Unshamed [FAMOUS] troops led the lord of the land—
 weepers—the battle-bold man out of the yards of the Huns.
 Then this quoth the younger heritage-guardian [SON] of Hawn:
 “Fare ye two now whole and wise, wherever your heart may draw you!”

1 lýðar ò-neisir ‘unshamed [FAMOUS] troops’ | Compare the long-line on the Thorsberg chape (~160–240 AD): *uþuþewar · ni waje-márir* ‘Wolthewe, the not ill-famed [FAMOUS]’.

- 14 **F**etum létu fróknir · of fjöll at þyrja
 2 **m**ar ina mël-græpy, · **M**yrk-við inn ò-kunna;
 hristisk öll Hún-mörk · þar’s **h**arð-móðgir fóru,
 4 **v**röku þeir **v**and-stygga · **v**öllu al-gröna.

With strides the braves made the bit-champing steed
 rush o’er the fells through Mirkwood uncharted.
 All Hunmark shook where the hard-minded went forth;
 they drove the whip-shy horse across all-green fields.

- 15 **L**and sôu þeir Atla · ok lið-skjalfar djúpar;
 2 **B**ikka greppar standa · á **b**org inni hœu,
 sal umb suðr-þjóðum, · **s**leginn sess-meiðum,
 4 **b**undnum røndum, · **b**leiikum skjöldum,

They saw the land of Attle and its ravines deep,
 Beck’s soldiers standing upon the high stronghold,
 the hall of the south-folk built with seat-beams,
 with bound rims and pale shields;

2 Bikka ‘Beck’ | An obscure legendary figure; cf. *Sigsk* 64/1 and *Ghv* P1, where he is Ermenric’s counsellor. He appears alongside Attle, Ermenric, and Yivick in *Wid* 19 and again in *Wid* 115.

2 á borg inni hœu ‘upon the high stronghold’ | Formulaic, also found in *Hamð* 22/5b. A likely West Germanic parallel is found in OE *in/on/tó sēli þām hēan* ‘in/on/to the high hall’ (*Beow* 713b, 919b, 1016b, 1984b) with identical syntax.

3 sess-meiðum ‘seat-beams’ | Probably large load-bearing pillars or columns.

- 16 **d**afar, **d**arraða; · ęn þar **d**rakk Atli
 2 **v**in i **v**al-höllu; · **v**erðir sôtu úti
 at **v**arða þeim Gunn·ari · ef þeir hér **v**itja kómi
 4 með **g**ęiri **g**jallanda · at **v**ękja **g**ram hildi.

[they saw] javelins and pennants. But there Attle drank
 wine in the wal-hall; the watchmen stayed outside
 to watch for Guthur’s men, if they came hither to visit
 with a yelling spear to wake the ruler with war.

- 17 **S**ystir fann þeira **s**nemmst · at þeir i **s**al kvómu,
 2 **b**rœðr hennar **b**áðir, · **b**jóri vas hœn litt drukkin:
 „**R**áðinn est nú, Gunn·arr, · **h**vat munt, **r**íkr, vinna

- 4 við Húna harm-brögðum? · Hóll gakk ór snimma!
 Their sister found soonest that they had come into the hall,
 her brothers both—on beer was she lightly drunk:
 “Tricked art thou now, Guthur! How wilt thou, rich man, withstand
 the Hunnish harm-tricks? Go out of the hall, quick!

- 18 Bætr hefðir, bróðir, · at i brynju fòrir,
 2 sëm hjölmum arin-græypum · at séa hëim Atla;
 sëtir i sððlum · sól-hëiða daga,
 4 nái nauð-fólva · létir nornir gráta,

Better hadst thou done, brother, if thou hadst gone in thy byrnie
 with hearth-surrounding helmets to see the realm of Attle;
 if thou hadst loaded in the saddles during sun-bright days
 need-pale corpses; if thou hadst let the norns cry,

ALL | In sts. 18–19, Guthrun tells Guthur that he should not have shown up unarmed; rather he should have brought his whole army to defeat Attle in open battle.

4 létir nornir gráta ‘if thou hadst let the norns cry’ | The tragic killings and carnage are thought to be the cause of the rejoicing of evil spirits, but the weeping of good spirits; a dualistic notion. On the good side of this equation stand the elves (*Hamð* 1/2), on the evil side the Norns, Dises (ON *disir*, *Reg* 2, *Hamð* 28/3), and Ogresses (ON *flgð*, *Hamð* 15/2).

- 19 Húna skjald-meyjar · hërfi kanna,
 2 en Atla sjalfan · létir i orm-garð koma;
 nú ’s sá orm-garðr · ykkir of folginn.“

[and] the Hunnish shield-maidens know the harrow—
 but Attle himself shouldst thou have put in the snake-pit;
 now that snake-pit has enveloped you two!”

1 Húna skjald-meyjar · hërfi kanna ‘the Hunnish shield-maidens know the harrow’ | I.e. if he had enslaved the Hunnish shield-maidens and turned them into farmhands.

2 orm-garð ‘snake-pit’ | A piece of foreshadowing; Guthur should have put Attle in the snake-pit, but his naivité will instead result in it happening to himself (st. 35).

- [Gunn-arr svarar:] 20 „Sëinat ’s nú, systir, · at samna Niflungum,
 2 langt ’s at lëita · lýða sinnis til,
 of rosmu-fjöll Rëinar, · rekka ó-neissa.“

[Guthur answers:] “It is too late now, sister, to gather the Nivlings.
 It is long to look for the support of men
 o’er the red fells of the Rhine, for unshamed [FAMOUS] warriors.”

- 21 Fengu þeir Gunn·ar · ok ï fǫtur sættu
 2 vin Borgunda · ok bundu fast=la;
 sjau hjó Hogni · sverði hvössu
 4 en inum átta hratt hann · ï ǣld heitan.

They captured Guthur and in fetters placed
 the friend of the Burgends [= Guthur] and bound him firmly.
 Hawn smote seven with his sharp sword,
 but the eighth one he threw in the hot fire.

2 vin | vinir (‘vǫn’) R

2 vin Borgunda ‘the friend of the Burgends’ | The historic Guthur (Latin *Gundabarius* < **Gunþi-bari*) was a king of Burgundy; cf. *Wald* B 14, where Walder addresses Guthur, whom he is just about to fight, with the identical *wine Burgenda*. Addressing a king as a **winiz* ‘friend’ of his people or dynasty is common in early Germanic heroic poetry; cf. *Beow* 30, 170, 1183 et c.: *wine Scyldinga* ‘friend of the Shieldings [DANISH KING]’, 350 *wine Deniga* ‘friend of the Danes [DANISH KING]’. The present instance is the only mention of the Burgends in all of Norse literature and as such is an impressive archaism that further adds support to an early dating for *Akv*. — R has a small stroke above the *n* that abbreviates the syllable *ir*, indicating the nom. pl. *vinir* ‘friends’, who would then be the people binding Guthur. This is probably due to scribal corruption, since the ones who bind Guthur are Huns, not Burgends.

- 22 Svá skal frókn · fjöndum verja=sk;
 2 Hogni varði · hęndr Gunn·ars.
 frögu fróknan · ef fjör vildi
 4 Gotna þjóðan · gollu kaupa.

So shall a brave guard himself against foes;
 Hawn guarded the hands of Guthur.
 They asked the brave sovereign of the Gots [= Guthur]
 if he would buy his [Hawn’s] life with gold.

1 Svá ... verjask | Line moved from the last st. to this one since it seems to connect semantically with the immediately following line, and results in two typical four-line stanzas.

4 Gotna þjóðan ‘sovereign of the Gots’ | Guthur; cf. sts. 1, 3, 10. — Although Gothic *þiudans* is the unmarked word for ‘ruler’ and reflexes of PWGmc. **þeudan* are exceptionally common in West Germanic heroic poetry (*þeoden* 40 times in *Beow*, *þeodan* 22 in *Heli*), ON *þjóðann* is a rare word and its presence here very likely a semantic archaism. Outside of *Akv* (st. 22/4, 23/3) the word is found only once in the heroic poetry of the Poetic Edda (*I Guðr* 19/1), thrice in the mythological poetry (*Háv* 15/1, 114/2, and 147/1) and only once in a dateable Scaldic composition (the Lay-meter poem Egill *Arkv* 11/3a (SkP 5) from ca. 980). It otherwise occurs in the list of poetic synonyms for ‘king’ (*Þul Konunga* 2 (SkP 3)), three C12th or 13th antiquarian heroic poems (*Heiðr* 91, GunnLeif *Merl* I 81, *Gautr* 38 (all in SkP 8), probably imitating earlier heroic poetry like *Akv*), and the thoroughly Christian C13th advice-poem *Hsv* 143 (almost certainly drawing on *Háv*). Thus it appears this archaic word belonging to the Migration Period was thought unfitting for poetry in Court-spoken meter, which already from the time of Bray the Old preferred words like *stillir* (found ca. 104 in the SkP corpus; cf. Ög 136 Rök) or *þengill* (found 120 times in the SkP corpus).

- 23 „Hjarta skal mér Hogni · ï hęndi liggja

- 2 blóðugt, ór brjósti · skorit bald-riða,
saxi slíðr-þeitu, · syni þjóðans.“

“The heart of Hawn shall lie in my hands:
bloody, cut from the breast of the bold rider,
with a slide-biting sax from the son of the sovereign.”

ALL | The Huns offer Guthur to pay a ransom for Hawn's life. Guthur instead responds with this st.

3 saxi slíðr-þeitu 'slide-biting sax' | A short-sword with a blade so sharp that it draws blood when one slides the finger across it. — Possibly formulaic; cf. *Hamð* 8/4.

- 24 Skóru þeir hjarta · Hjalla ór brjósti,
2 blóðugt, ok á bjóð lögðu · ok bóru þat fyr Gunnar.

They cut the heart of Helle from the breast,
bloody, and on a plate laid it, and brought it before Guthur.

- 25 Þá kvað þat Gunnarr, · gumna dróttinn:
2 „Hér hefí'k hjarta · Hjalla ins blauða,
ó-líkt hjarta · Hogna ins frókna,
4 es mjök bifa=sk · es á bjóði liggr;
bifði=sk hǫlfu meirr · es í brjósti lá!“

Then this quoth Guthur, the lord of men:
“Here have I the heart of Helle the soft
—unlike the heart of Hawn the brave!—
which quivers greatly when on the plate it lies;
it quivered twice as much when in the breast it lay.”

- 26 Hló þá Hogni · es til hjarta skóru
2 kvikvan kumbla-smið · —klökkva síðst hugði.
Blóðugt þat á bjóð lögðu · ok bóru fyr Gunnar.

Hawn then laughed as to the heart they cut
the living wound-smith [WARRIOR = Hawn]; he thought least of sobbing.
Bloody on a plate they laid it, and brought it before Guthur.

- 27 Mérr kvað þat Gunnarr, · geir-Niflungr:
2 „Hér hefí'k hjarta · Hogna ins frókna,
ó-líkt hjarta · Hjalla ins blauða,
4 es lítt bifa=sk · es á bjóði liggr;
bifði=sk svá=gi mjök · þá's í brjósti lá!

Renowned, this quoth Guthur, the Spear-Nivling:
 “Here have I the heart of Hawn the brave
 —unlike the heart of Helle the soft!—
 which quivers little when on the plate it lies;
 it quivered not so much when in the breast it lay.

- 28 Svá skalt, Atli, · augum fjarri
 2 sęm munt [...] · męnjum verða;
 es und ęinum mér · ęll of folgin
 4 hodd Niflunga: · lifir=a nú Hęgni!

So shalt thou, Attle, be as far from eyes
 as thou wilt from the [...] neck-rings.
 Under me alone is hidden all
 the hoard of the Nivlings—now Hawn lives not!

2 [...] | *No gap is indicated in R.*

ALL | Sts. 28–30: Guthur declares his unwillingness to reveal the location of the treasure. He alone knows it and he will take it with him to the grave.

1 augum fjarri ‘be as far from eyes’ | Perhaps as far from men’s eyes, namely after he is dead. The sense seems to be that Attle will soon die.

2 [...] | This word would most likely have been an adjective beginning with *m-*, probably *męrum* ‘renowned’ or *mętum* ‘splendid’. It has likely been skipped owing to the similar dative ending. The paraphrase of *Vęls* does not offer any help.

- 29 Eę vas mér týja · međan vit tvęir lifđum,
 2 nú ’s mér ęngi · es ęinn lifi’k;
 Rın skal ráđa · róg-malmi skatna,
 4 svinn, ęs-kunnum · arfi Niflunga.

I always had doubt while we two lived;
 now I have none as I alone live.
 The swift Rhine shall rule the strife-ore of princes [GOLD],
 the Os-born inheritance of the Nivlings!

4 ęs-kunnum | *gramm. emend.*; ęs-kunna R

4 svinn, ęs-kunnum · arfi ‘swift ... Os-born inheritance’ | Difficult. (1) The ms. form *ęs-kunna* ‘Os-born’ does not concord with the m. dat. sg. *arfi* ‘inheritance’ (an interpretation of it as the weak form is unlikely), and so the ending has been emended. The hoard can be called ‘Os-born’, i.e., ‘born of the Eese’, for it was the Gods who gave it to Rethmar as weregild for his son (*Reg* Pl–st. 9). *svinn* ‘swift’ is taken to be an adj. modifying *Rın* ‘Rhine’ in l. 3. Still, it is highly unusual for a type D verse to have alliteration fall on the second lift but not the first. (2) An alternative solution is to keep *ęs-kunna* and instead read *svinn* as an error for *sú* in nom. sg. f. ‘this’. This would give the sense *Rın sú in ęs-kunna skal ráđa* ‘This Os-born Rhine shall rule etc.’ The construction *sá (b)inn* ‘this’ does occur elsewhere in the poem (5/4 above).

- 30 Í veltanda vatni · lýsask val-baugar
2 hęldr an á hęndum goll · skíni Húna bęrnum.“

In tumbling water shall the Welsh bighs gleam,
rather than gold shine on the hands of the children of Huns!”

2 Húna bęrnum ‘the children of the Huns’ | Here just meaning ‘the Huns’, a common Germanic kenning-type (Meissner 1921, pp. 23–25, 245). Cf. expressions like *alda bęrn* ‘the children of men [MEN]’.

- [Atli kvað:] 31 “Ýkvið ér hvél-vęgnum, · hapr ’s nú í bęndum!”
[Quoth Atle:] “Turn ye the wheel-wagons; the captive is now in bonds!”

- 32 Atli inn ríki · reįđ Glaum męnum,
2 sleginn róg-þornum, · sífjungr þęira;
Guð-rún sig-tíva
4 varnaði við tęrum, · vađin í þys-hęllu:

Atle the powerful, their in-law, rode
on Gleam by his mane surrounded by strife-thorns [SWORDS].
Guthrun of the victory-Tews [...];
she held back her tears, pacing in the tumultous hall:

ALL | Atle rides back to the hall surrounded by his warriors with their swords raised.

1 Glaum ‘Gleam’ | Atle’s horse.

3 Guð-rún sig-tíva ‘Guthrun of the victory-Tews’ | This verse is entirely opaque as its corresponding verse has been lost. Whether it is an a- or b-verse is also uncertain. The *sig-tívar* ‘victory-Tews’ are the gods, but what they are doing here is unclear. Is Guthrun being presented as a descendant of the gods?

- 33 „Svá gangi þér, Atli, · sęm við Gunn-ar áttir
2 ęiđa opt of svarða · ok ár of nęfnda
at sól inni suđr-hęllu · ok at Sig-týs bergi,
4 hulkvi hvíl-bęđjar · ok at hringi Ullar.“

“So may it go with thee, Atle, like thou with Guthur hadst
oaths often sworn and always mentioned
by the south-facing sun and by Victory-Tew’s mountain,
by any pleasant bed and by the ring of Wolder.”

- 34 Ok męirr þađan · męn-vęrđ bituls,
2 dolg-Ręgni, dró · til dauðs, skókr.

And further thence the shaker of the bridle [WARRIOR = Atle] brought
the torc-defender, the battle-Reiner [WARRIOR = Guthur] to his death.

ALL | The word-order is difficult and the st. may be corrupt. In prose word order: *Ok meirr þaðan dró skókr bituls men-vörð, dolg-Rogni, til dauðs.*

1 men-vörð ‘the torc-defender’ | A rare kenning, really an anti-kenning, since it is typical to describe a man as a giver or destroyer of rings (i.e., a generous man), not their defender. Yet in the present context Guthur is called this since he refuses to divulge the location of the gold which he has buried in the Rhine.

- 35 Lifanda gram · lagði i garð,
 2 þann's skriðinn vas, · skatna mengi,
 innan ormum. · En einn Gunn·arr
 4 heipt-móðr hǫrpu · hendi kníði;
 glumðu strengir. · Svá skal golli
 6 frókn hring-drifi · við fira halda!

The living lord [= Guthur] was laid in the pit
 (which was crawling) by a troop of warriors
 (with snakes inside), but Guthur alone
 spitefully struck the harp with his hand;
 its strings rang out. So shall a brave
 ring-strewer [GENEROUS MAN] withhold his gold from men!

ALL | Guthur was laid alive in a snake-pit, but was given a harp to pacify the snakes and played it with his feet. This worked until a single serpent pierced his heart, and he died. The same is told in 2 *Guðr* P1, *Am* 63, and *Ghv* 17/3–4. The scene of Guthur playing with his feet was very famous and is depicted pictorially in several archeological finds and stave church carvings, most notably on the surviving carvings from the now-demolished Hylestad stave church (ca. 1170 CE) in Setesdal, Norway (TODO: figure).

- 36 Atli lét · lands síns á vit
 2 jó ǫr-skáan · aptr frá morði;
 dynr vas i garði, · dröslum of þrungit,
 4 vápn-sǫngr virða— · vǫru af heði komnir.

Atle turned towards his land
 on his watchful steed back from the murder.
 There was a din in the yard from the trampling of horses,
 the weapon-song of warriors—they had come from the heath.

1 Atli lét | This verse is highly unusual, since the alliteration falls on the finite verb *lét* rather than the leftmost nominal *Atli* (Goering 2023, p. 81). Corruption seems likely.

2 ǫr-skáan ‘watchful’ | A hapax, best explained as a cognate with Gothic *us-skaws* ‘vigilant, watchful’.

- 37 Út gekk þá Guðrún, · Atla i gögn,
 2 með gylltum kalki · at reifa gjöld ragnis:

4 „Þiggja knátt, þengill, · ì þinni hollu
glæðr at Guð-rúnu · gnadda nifl-farna.“

Then out went Guthrun, Attle to face,
with a gilt chalice to give repayments to her lord.
“Do accept, ruler, in thy own hall,
glad, from Guthrun, young beasts gone to the shades!”

4 gnadda nifl-farna ‘young beasts gone to the shades’ | These ‘young beasts’ are of course her children, Earp and Oatle. The killing is described more directly in *Am* 74–76.

38 Umðu ǫl-skálar · Atla vīn-hofgar
2 þá's ì holl saman · Húnar tǫlðu=sk,
gumar gran-síðir · gengu inn hvárir.

The ale-bowls of Attle clanged heavy with wine
when gathered in the hall the Huns were counted;
the long-bearded men walked in two by two.

39 Skévaði þá hin skír-leita, · veigar þeim at bera,
2 af-kór dís, ǫfrum, · ok ǫl-krásir valði,
nauðug, nef-fólum, · en níð sagði Atla:

Forth strode the pure-faced woman bearing them draughts,
the violent dise for the princes, and chose the ale-dainties,
forced, for the pale-faced men—but spoke a nithe to Attle.

1 veigar ‘draughts’ | The alliteration requires a word starting with *sk-*. For this reason *veigar* probably ought to be replaced with the synonym *skálar* ‘bowls’.

3 níð ‘nithe’ | An evil, cursing word.

40 „Sona hefir þinna, · sverða deilir,
2 hjörtu hré-dreyrug · við hunang of tuggin,
melta knátt, móðugr, · manna val-bráðir
4 eta at ǫl-krósum · ok ì ǫnd-ugi at sænda.

“Thy own sons’ hast thou, dealer of swords,
corpse-bloody hearts with honey chewed.
Thou art stomaching, fierce man, the death-flesh of men,
eating it by ale-dainties, passing it on from the high seat!

3 val-bráðir | *sens. emend.*; val-brúðir R.

41 Kallar=a þú síðan · til knéa þinna
2 Erp né Eitil, · ǫl-reifa tvá;

- sér=a þú síðan · ï seti miðju
 4 golls miðlendr · gęira skępta,
 manar meęta · né mara keęra.“

Thou wilt not henceforth call up to thy lap
 Earp or Oatle, the ale-rowdy two.

Thou wilt not henceforth see in the middle of the seat
 the dealers of gold shafting spears,
 brushing horse-manes or driving steeds.”

2 ęl-ęęfa tvą ‘the ale-rowdy two’ | At this time there was nothing unusual about young boys drinking.

- 42 Ymr varð á bekkjum, · af-kárr sęngr virða,
 2 gnýr und guð-veęjum, · grétu bęrn Huna,
 nema ęin Guðrún · es hęn ęva grét
 4 bróðr sína ber-harða · ok buri svása,
 unga, ó-fróða, · þa’s hęn við Atla gat.

There was clangour on the benches, the violent song of warriors,
 whimpering beneath the god-weave; the children of the Huns wept,
 save for Guthrun alone, for she never wept
 for her bear-hard brothers and beloved sons,
 the young, unlearned, which she begot by Attle.

2 und guð-veęjum ‘beneath the god-weave’ | Beneath the silken fabric, presumably of the tents in which the nomadic Huns dwelled.

4 ber-harða ‘bear-hard’ | Before the lion was adopted for this sake on the basis of Classical and Biblical models, the bear was the animal associated with strength and bravery in the North. — *ber-* is a compounding form of **beri* ‘bear’, an otherwise unattested *m. n-stem* noun inherited from PGmc. **berō*, whence also OHG *bero*, OE *bera* ‘id.’; along with the ON *f. bera* ‘she-bear’ and diminutive *bersi* ‘(playful) bear’. The normal ON word for “bear” is *björn*, an *u-stem* derived from the oblique cases of **berō*. *ber-* appears to be an archaism, since it is only otherwise attested in *Vkv* 11.

5 unga, ó-fróða ‘the young, unlearned’ | Cf. *Hild* 16: *alte anti fróte* ‘the old and learned’.

- 43 Golli sęri · hin gagl-bjarta,
 2 hringum rauðum · reįfði hęn hús-karla;
 skęp lét hęn vaxa · ęn skíran malm vaða,
 4 ęva fljóð ękki · gąði fįarg-húsa.

With gold the goose-bright lady sowed [the floor];
 with red rings she cheered the housecarls.
 She let the large vats grow and the pure ore [GOLD] wade;
 never did that woman heed the god-houses.

ALL | The image is that of a crazed Guthrun throwing her golden rings and bracelets around her to the cheer of the drunken warriors.

- 44 Ó·varr Atli · *óðan hafði sik drukkit;
 2 vápñ hafði hann ekki, · varnaði-t við Guð·rúnu;
 opt vas sá leíkr bētri · þá's þau lint skyldu
 4 optarr of faðma=sk · fyr ǫðlingum.

Unwary, Attle had drunk himself mad;
 he had no weapon, did not beware Guthrun.
 Oft their play was better when they gently would
 oftener embrace each other before the athlings.

1 *óðan 'mad' | *emend.*; móðan 'tired' R

1 *óðan 'mad' | A word alliterating with a vowel is required by the meter and *óðan 'mad' lies closest at hand, differing only by a letter from móðan 'tired'.

- 45 Hön bæð broddi · gaf blóð at drekka,
 2 hendi hēl-fússi, · ok hvelpa lęysti;
 hratt fyr hallar dyrr · ok hús-karla vakði
 4 brandi, brúðr, hęitum; · þau lét hön gjöld bróðra.

With a blade she gave the bed blood to drink
 by a hell-eager hand—and set loose the whelps,
 blocked the doors of the hall and awoke the housecarls
 with hot flame, the bride; such were her repayments for her brothers.

- 46 Ełdi gaf hön alla · es inni vǫru
 2 ok frá morði þeira Gunn·ars · komnir vǫru ór Myrk-hęimi;
 forn timbr fellu, · fjarg-hús ruku,
 4 bǫr Buðlunga, · brunnu ok skjald-męyjar,
 inni; aldr-stamar · hnigu ĩ ęld hęitan.

To the fire she gave all who were within
 and from the murder of Guther and his [brother] had come out of Mirkham.
 Ancient timbers fell; the god-houses smoked,
 the settlement of the Budlungs. The shield-maidens too burned
 inside; short-lived, they sank into the hot fire.

- 47 Full-rótt's umb þetta; · fęrr ęngi svá síðan
 2 brúðr ĩ brynju · bróðra at hęfna;
 hön hęfir þriggja · þjóð-konunga

4 **ban-orð borit**, · **björt**, áðr sylti.

It is told fully about this. Henceforth no bride will
so don a byrnie to avenge her brothers.
She has, bright, borne the bane-word
of three great kings before she must die.

3 þjóð-konunga ‘great kings’ | An old poetic word; for etymology + distribution see *Grip* 1/2 n.

4 ban-orð borit ‘borne the bane-word’ | I.e., she has brought death to three great kings. For the idea of death as a “word” cf. *Yf* 1: *Varð fram-gengt* [...] *feigðar-orð es at Fjölni kom* ‘The word of feyness (i.e., imminent death or destruction) which came upon Fillner was fulfilled,’ that is to say, “Fillner died at his fatefully appointed time.” This expression is discussed along with its Germanic and Indo-European parallels in detail in Watkins (1995, pp. 417–422).

P2 Enn segir glöggra í Atla-mólum inum grón-lendskum.

This is told yet more clearly in the Greenlandish Speeches of Attle.

Greenlandish Speeches of Attle

(*Atla mól in grón-lęndsku*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): late C11th (0.472)

Meter: Speeches-meter

Introduction

NOTE: The following translation is currently incomplete and the edition has not been thoroughly checked.

The **Greenlandish Speeches of Attle** (abbrev. *Am*) is a long Eddic heroic poem dealing with the deaths of Guthur and Hawn at the hands of Attle.

Textual preservation and transmission

Am is only preserved in **R** where it is found on foll 41r/9–44r/13. It follows *Akv* and precedes *Ghv*. The title *Atla mól in grón-lęndsku* ‘The Greenlandish Speeches of Attle’ is preserved in *Akv* P2.

Story and parallels

The basic narrative of *Am* is largely the same as the preceding *Akv*, and together with that poem it clearly serves as a source for *Vǫls* 36–38. For much of that section *Am* is the chief source, probably due to its greater length.

Although both poems build on the same basic narrative frame, *Am* is far longer and contains a number of otherwise unparallelled details. One of the most interesting differences is the *Am*-poet’s clear lack of familiarity with continental European circumstances. Whereas the poet of *Akv* has Guthur and Hawn ride through the dark Mirkwood and over high mountains to get to Attle in the south (*Akv* 14), *Am* instead lets Guthur and Hawn sail out of their home firth (*fięręđr*) to the land of Budle (*Am* 28–35) in what is clearly an insular Norse adaptation of the original setting.

Meter and formal concerns

Am consists of 382 long-lines distributed across 102 stanzas. The typical length of a stanza is 4 lines, but other lengths are also represented.

The poem is composed in Speeches-meter throughout.

Localisation

In *R* the adjective *grón-lēndskr* ‘Greenlandish’ is applied to both *Akv* and *Am*, but only the latter appears actually to have been composed in one of the Norse settlements on Greenland. This is shown most clearly by st. 18, where the poet makes reference to a “white-bear” (*hvíta-björn*) arriving in a storm from the east. The polar bear (*Ursus maritimus*) is indeed found on Greenland, where members of the species not infrequently drift onto the shores on ice sheets carried by the winds, whereas they never appear on Iceland or the Scandinavian peninsula.

Dating

A Greenlandish origin for the poem lets us to determine a *terminus post quem* for its composition. *Am* cannot have been composed before ca. 985 CE, the time of Greenland’s settlement by Icelanders agreed upon both by the mediaeval saws and modern archeology.

We may push this date some decades forward based on the treatment of the dead in the poem. Being burned on a pyre is a punishment associated with stoning (st. 84), while a proper burial is in a painted coffin, though apparently still in a boat (st. 100). The equation of stoning and cremation clearly points towards composition after conversion, whereas pre-Christian poems like *Háv* show no such association (cf. *Háv* 71/3, 81/1). Iceland officially became Christian in 1000 CE and Greenland probably did not follow long thereafter, but the old custom of cremation can hardly have become thoroughly taboo immediately in the way it clearly is here.

On the linguistic side of things *Am* shows noticeably younger characteristics than its predecessor *Akv*.

Most notably the sound change *vr-* > *r-* is consistently applied in roots originally containing the glide, namely *vreiðr*, *vreiði* > *reiðr*, *reiði* ‘wroth, wrath’ (*Am* 51/1: *rōskr*, *rōða* : *reiðr*, 75/4: *ró*, *reiði* : *reynir* vs. *Akv* 2/2: *vīn*, *val-bollu* : *vreiði*), *vrangr*, *vrengja* > *rangr*, *rengja* ‘twisted, twist’ (*Am* 4/1: *rūnar*, *rista* : *rengði* vs. *Bragi Þórr* 6 (in *SkP* 3): *vildi-t*, *vrongum* : *vágs*), and **vrōskr* > *rōskr* ‘vigorous’ (*Am* 51/1, 57/2: *rōskr*, *reyna-sk* : *reynt*, 87/1: *rōskr*, *rōða* : *rakði-sk* vs. *Þdr* 22/1: *vreiðr*, *Vrōsku* : *vá*). For the root *vreka* > *reka* ‘drive, chase’, which is not found in *Am*, cf. *Akv* 14/4.

Another young feature is the comparative rarity of the pre-verbal particle *of*, which appears three times. Of all 37 Eddic poems or sections of poems treated separately by Sapp (2022, p. 70), *Am* has the lowest frequency of this particle at 0.039 occurrences per 10 unique lines. This contrasts with the 6 occurrences in the much shorter *Akv*, which has a middling frequency of 0.1709 occurrences per 10 unique lines.

Text

Atla mól in grón-lendsku ('The Greenlandish Speeches of Attle')

- 1 Frétt hefir **q**ld **ó**fu · þá's **ç**ndr of gøðu
 2 seggir **s**am-kundu, · **s**ú vas nýt fěstum;
óxtu **ç**in-méli, · **y**ggt vas þeim síðan
 4 ok it **s**ama **s**onum Gjúka · es vöru **s**ann-ráðnir.

FOLK HAVE LEARNED of the enmity long ago
 when men held an assembly; that was a boon to the fewest.
 Their private speeches intensified; it was terrible for them afterwards,
 and the same for the sons of Yivick who were truly deceived.

1 Frétt | The F is an ornamented initial 3 lines high, with the left vertical stroke tail-shaped and descending an additional 6 lines in the margin in R.

ALL | Sts. 1–2 describe how Attle and his advisors decide to trick Guthur and Hawn and betray them.

- 2 Skop **ó**xtu skjöldunga · —skyldu=at fçigir—
 2 illa réð=sk **A**tla, · **á**tti hann þó hyggju;
 fçllði **st**oð **st**óra, · **st**ridði sér harð=la,
 4 af **b**ragði **bo**ð seydi · at kvæmi **b**rátt mágur.

They intensified the Shapes of the noblemen—they should not have been
 fey—
 evil was coming for Attle although he had wit.
 He toppled a great pillar, injured himself grievously,
 hurriedly sent a summons that his inlaws should come soon.

1 Skop **ó**xtu skjöldunga 'They intensified the Shapes of the noblemen' | Attle and his men caused cruel fates (*skop* 'Shapes') to afflict Guthur and Hawn.

3 fçllði stoð stóra 'He toppled a great pillar' | Symbolic. His own greed was to be his undoing, just like a man who topples a pillar only for it to fall upon himself.

- 3 Horsk vas **h**ús-frøyja, · **h**ugði at man-viti,
 2 lag heyrði hön orða, · hvat þeir á **l**aun meltu;
 þa vas **v**ant **v**itri, · **v**ildi hön þeim hjalpa,
 4 skyldu of **s**ç sigla · çn sjölf né kom=sk=at.

[R TODO]

Wise was the lady of the house; she thought cleverly;
 she heard the gist of the words which the men spoke in secret.
 Then the clever woman was pressed; she wished to help them;
 the men were to sail o'er the sea but she herself would not come.

ALL. | Guthrun overhears the plans of her husband but since she herself cannot come to warn her brothers she comes up with a plan.

- 4 Rúnar nam at rísta, · reŋgði þer Vingi— [R TODO]
 2 fárs vas hann flýtandi— · áðr hann framm seldi,
 fóru þá síðan · sændi-menn Atla
 4 umb fjörð Lima · þar's fróknir bjoggu.

She took to carve runes; Winge distorted them—
 he was a hastener of dangers—before he handed them over.
 Then thereafter journeyed Attle's messengers
 around the Limfirth whither the brave men dwelled.

4 fjörð Lima 'Limefirth' | Limfjorden in the north of Jutland; the localisation of the poem's events in Denmark rather than in Burgundy (as the more archaic *Akv* 21/2) is a secondary development of the story likely based on the confusion between the continental and originally Asiatic Huns and the similarly named tribe of Denmark (TODO).

- 5 Ql-vérir urðu · ok elda kyndu, [R TODO]
 2 hugðu vétr véla · es þeir vöru komnir;
 tóku þeir fórnir · es þeim fríðr sændi,
 4 hængðu á súlu, · hugðu=t þat varða.

They were generous with ale and kindled the fires,
 nowise suspected wives from those who had come.
 They took the gifts which the beautiful woman [= Guthrun] had sent them,
 hung them on a pillar, did not think it had meaning.

3 fórnir 'gifts' | Apparently whereon the runes were inscribed as suggested by the implication in the last line of the stanza. The fact that they can be hung on a pillar seems to suggest that Guthrun embroidered the runes into a tapestry.

- 6 Kom þá Kost-bera, · kvæn vas hön Högna, [R TODO]
 2 kona kapps-gælig, · ok kvaddi þá báða;
 glöð vas ok Glaum-vör · es Gunn·arr átti,
 4 fell=sk=at saðr sviðri, · sýsti of þorf gæsta.

Then came Costbearer—she was Hawn's wife,
 a very discerning woman—and greeted them both.
 Also glad was Gleamware, she whom Guther had for wife;
 virtue did not fail that wise woman; she looked after the needs of the guests.

4 saðr 'virtue' | Literally 'truth'.

- 7 Buðu þeir heim Högna · ef hann þá hældr fóri; [R TODO]

- 2 sýn vas svip-vísi · ef þeir sîn gęði;
 hét þá Gunn·arr · ef Hogni vildi,
 4 Hogni því nítiti · es hinn of réði.

They invited Hawn to their home if he would be more willing to go;
 the deceit was apparent if they would have watched out for themselves.
 Guthur asked if Hawn wished to go;
 Hawn turned down what the other one counselled.

2 sýn vas svip-vísi · ef þeir sîn gęði | Repeated in 71/2 below.

- 8 Bóru mjōð męrar, · margs vas alls þęini, [R TODO]
 2 fór þar fjōłð horna · und's þōtti full-drukkít.

The famous women bore mead; the servings were all plentiful;
 there went forth a multitude of horns before it seemed fully drunk.

- 9 Hjú gęrðu hvílu · sęm þęim hógst þōtti; [R TODO]
 2 kęnnđ vas Kost·bera, · kunni hōn skil rúna,
 innti orð-stafi · at ęldi ljósum;
 4 gęta varð hōn tungu · ĩ góma báða:
 vōru svá villtar · at vas vant at ráða.

The couple made their place of rest as they thought most pleasing;
 Costbearer was renowned; she knew the distinctions of runes;
 she interpreted the word-staves by the bright fire.
 She had to hold her tongue between her gums;
 they were so confused that there was little to read.

ALL | Sts. 9–19 are paraphrased in *Vǫls* 34.

4 ĩ góma báða ‘between her gums’ | Lit. ‘in her gums’, that is, due to the difficulty of reading the runes.

- 10 Sęing fóru síðan · sına þau Hogni; [R TODO]
 2 dreymði drótt-láta, · dulði þęss vęttki,
 sagði horsk hilmi · þęgar's hōn réđ vakna:

Then they went to their bed, she and Hawn;
 the courtly-faced woman dreamt, hid no part of it;
 the wise woman told the prince when she awoke:

- 11 „Heıman gęri=sk þú, Hogni, · hygg þú at rōðum! [R TODO]
 2 Fár 's full-rýninn, · far þú ĩ sinn annat!
 Réð'k þęr rúnar · es reıst þın systir:

- 4 **bj**ort hęfir þér ęigi · **b**ođit i sinn þetta.

“Thou makest ready to leave home, Hawn; think about this counsel.
Few know runes fully; journey another time!
I read the runes which thy sister carved;
the bright woman has not summoned thee this time.

- 12 **E**itt ek męst **undr**=umk · —má’k=at **ę**nn hyggja—

[R TODO]

- 2 hvat þa **varð** **v**itri · es skyldi **v**illt rísta;
því’t svá vas **a** **v**ísat · ęm **und**ir véri
4 **b**ani ykkarr **b**ęggja · ef it **brál**=la kvęmið.
Vant ’s stafs **v**ífi · eđa **v**alda aðrir.“

I wonder most about a single thing; I cannot get to the bottom of it:
what happened to the clever woman that she should carve so confused,
for it was so indicated as if it were underneath
that it would the bane of you both if ye came hurriedly.
The wife left out a stave—or others are at fault.”

- 13 „**A**llar ’ro ill-úðgar,“ (kvað Hęgni,) „**a**’kk=a’k þęss kynni,

[R TODO]

- 2 vil’k=a’k þęss lęita · nema **la**una ęigim;
okkr mun **g**ramr **g**olli · řęifa **g**lóð=rauðu,
4 **ó**=umk ek **aldri**=gi · þó’tt vér **ó**gn fregnim.“

“All women are suspicious,” quoth Hawn, “I have not such a mind.
I will not look out for such unless we have to repay it.
The chief will gladden us two with glowing-red gold;
I shall never fear, although we should learn of something fearful.”

- [Kost=bera kvað:] 14 „**S**topalt munuð ganga · ef it **stundið** þangat,

[R TODO]

- 2 **y**kk mun **ř**st=kynni · ęigi i sinn þetta.
Dřęymði mik, Hęgni, · **d**ylj=umk þat ęigi:
4 Ganga mun **y**kk **and**=óris · eđa **ę**lla hręð=umk.

[Quoth Costbearer:] “Stumbling will ye two go if ye proceed thither;
there will not be any loving welcome shown you this time.
I had a dream, Hawn; I will not hide it:
It will go ill for you two—or else I am just afraid.

ALL | Sts. 14–19 deal with Costbearer’s prophetic dreams as told to her husband Hawn.

- 15 **B**léju hugða’k þína · **b**renna i ęldi,

[R TODO]

- 2 **h**ryti **h**ęr logi · **h**ús mīn i gęgnum.“
[Hęgni kvað:] „**L**iggja hér **l**īn=klęði · þau’**s** ér **l**ítt rōkið,

4 þau munu brátt brenna · þar's þú bléju sátt.“

I thought thy cover were burning in fire;
the high flame roared throughout my halls.”

[Quoth Hawn:] “Here lie linen clothes which ye little do mind;
they will soon burn where thou didst see the cover.”

3 þau's ér | 'þau er' R

[Kost·bera kvað:] 16 „Björn hugða'k hér inn kominn, · bryti upp stokka,

[R TODO]

2 hristi svá hramma · at vér hrédd yrðim;

munn oss mǫrg hefði · svá't vér mǣttim ekki;

4 þar vas ok þrømmun · þey=gi svá lítil.“

[Quoth Costbearer:] “I thought a bear came in hither, broke up the rafters,
struck so fiercely that we were frightened,
held many of us in its mouth so that we could nowise resist;
there was also crashing not at all small.”

[Høgni kvað:] 17 „Veðr mun þar vaxa, · verða ótt snemma;

[R TODO]

2 hvíta-björn hugðir: · þar mun hregg austan.“

[Quoth Hawn:] “The storm will grow yonder, turn violent shortly;
thou thoughtest of a white-bear—there comes a tempest from the east.”

2 hvíta-björn hugðir: · þar mun hregg austan ‘thou thoughtest of a white-bear—there comes a tempest from the east’ | The image is undoubtedly Greenlandish; polar bears float from the east to the island on large sheets of ice. There is a real power to these lines which gives a sense of the harshness of the Greenland climate, even by Icelandic standards.

[Kost·bera kvað:] 18 „Qrn hugða'k hér inn fljúga · at end-löngu húsi,

[R TODO]

2 þat mun oss drjúgt deila=sk, · dreifði hann oss öll blóði;

hugða'k af heitum · at véri hamr Atla.“

[Quoth Costbearer:] “I thought an eagle flew in hither through the end-long hall;
that must be of weight for us; he spattered us all in blood;
I thought from the names that it were Attle's hame!”

1 at end-löngu húsi | Also occurring at 24/1b below. The verse appears to be a Speeches-meter variant of the formulaic Ancient-words-law b-verse *end-langan sal* (cf. *Þrk* 27/2 n.)

3 hamr Atla ‘Attle's hame’ | I.e., Attle in the shape of an eagle.

[Høgni kvað:] 19 „Slótrum sýs=liga, · séum þá roðru;

[R TODO]

2 opt 's þat fyr qxnum · es qrnú dreymir;

heill 's hugr Atla · hvat-ki's þik dreymir.“

4 Lokit því létu, · líðr hver róða.

[Quoth Hawn:] “We will go to slaughter shortly—*then* we will see blood;
it is oft a sign of oxen when one dreams of eagles.
Attle’s heart is wholesome no matter what thou dreamest.”
They closed the matter; each speech comes to its end.

20 Vǫknuðu vel-borin, · vas þar sams dōmi,

[R TODO]

2 gḡtti=sk þess Glaum-vǫr · at véri grand svefna
[...] við Gunn·arr · at fá tvér leiðir.

The well-born couple awoke; the same thing happened there;
Gleamware asked for counsel about the blemishes of her sleep [NIGHTMARES];
[...] with Guthur that it may have two outcomes:

ALL | Gleamware, Guthur’s wife, also has prophetic dreams; she tells them to Guthur in sts. 20–26.
Sts. 20–38 are paraphrased in *Vǫls* 35.

21 „Gǫrvan hugða’k þér galga, · gengir þú at hanga

[R TODO]

2 ḡti þik ormar, · yrða’k þik kvikvan,
gørði=sk rǫk ragna; · ráð hvat þat véri!

“I thought a gallows were readied for thee; thou wentest to hang;
snakes did eat thee; I lost thee in life;
it was [like] the Rakes of the Reins. Interpret what that was!

22 Blóðgan hugða’k mēki · borinn ór serk þinum,

[R TODO]

2 illt ’s svefn s·líkan · at segja nauð-manni;
gḡir hugða’k standa · i gǫgnum þik miðjan,
4 ḡmjuðu ulfar · à ḡndum bōðum.“

I thought a bloodied sword were pulled out from thy shirt;
it is ill to tell of such a sleep to one’s husband.
I thought a spear were piercing through thy stomach;
wolves bellowed on both of its sides.”

2 nauð-manni ‘husband’ | Hapax. TODO.

[Gunn·arr kvað:] 23 „Rakkar þar renna, · ráða=sk mjök gḡyja,

[R TODO]

2 opt verðr glaumr hunda · fyr gḡira flaugin.“

[Quoth Guthur:] “Yonder hounds will run; they are loudly barking;
oft the revel of dogs comes before the hurling of spears.”

[Glaum-vor kvað:] **24** „**Q** hugða'k hér inn renna · at **ę**ndi-löngu húi,
 2 þyti af þjósti · þęysti=sk of þękki;
 bryti fótr ykkra · bróðra hér tveggja,
 4 gørði=t vatn vęgja; · vesa mun þat fyr nøkkvi.

[R TODO]

[Quoth Gleamware:] “I thought a river ran in hither through the end-long hall;
 it roared furiously, gushed over the benches,
 here broke the feet of you brothers twain;
 the water did not cede. That must mean something!”

25 Konur hugða'k dauðar · koma i nött hingat,
 2 vęri=t vart búnar, · vildi þik kjósa,
 byði þér bráð=liga · til þękkja sinna;
 4 ek kveð af-lima · orðnar þér dísir.“

[R TODO]

I thought dead women came hither tonight;
 they were not poorly dressed; they would choose thee,
 invited thee hurriedly onto their benches.
 For thee, I say, the díses have become feeble!”

4 ek kveð af-lima · orðnar þér dísir ‘For thee, I say, the díses have become feeble’ | The goddesses of fate have become powerless to protect him due to his imminent death; for the expression cf. *Grm* 55.

[Gunn-arr kvað:] **26** „Sęinat 's at sęgja, · svá 's nú ráðit;
 2 forð=umk=a fōr þó · alls þó 's fara ętlat;
 margt 's mjok glík=ligt · at munim skamm-ęir.“

[R TODO]

[Quoth Guthur:] “It is too late to tell; it has now been thusly interpreted,
 yet I cannot refrain from the journey when it is intended I should journey.
 Much makes it likely that we shall be short-lived.”

ALL | Guthur at last admits that Gleamware likely has seen something. He will not try to explain away the dreams further, but even if what they imply is true, fate has already decided that he and Hawn must journey to Attle.

27 Litu es lýsti · létu=sk þeir fúsir
 2 allir upp rísa, · qnnur þau lottu;
 fóru fimm saman, · flęiri til vōru
 4 hōlfu hús-karlar, · hugat vas því illa.
 Snęv-arr ok Sól-arr, · synir vōru þeir Hōgna,
 6 Orkning þann hétu · es þeim ęnn fylgdi;
 blíðr vas bōrr skjaldar, · bróðir hans kvánar.

[R TODO]

They beheld that it grew light; they said they were all
 eager to arise; others would have restrained them.

They journeyed five men together; there were more men at hand,
twice as many housecarls; it was ill thought out.
Snower and Soler; they were the sons of Hawn.
Orkning they called yet one who followed them;
blithe was that shield-tree [WARRIOR], the brother of his wife.

7 bróðir hans kvávar ‘brother of his wife’ | The brother of Hawn’s wife, as Orkning was apparently Costbearer’s brother.

- 28 **Fóru** **fagr**-búnar · und’s þau **fj**örðr skilði, [R TODO]
2 **l**öttu ávallt **lj**ósar, · **l**étu=at hēldr segja=sk.

The women went fair-clothed until the firth parted them;
the light ones would restrain them; the men would not be convinced.

ALL | The scene of sts. 28–32 is that the men, Guthur, Hawn, Snower, Soler, and Orkning are in the parting ship alongside Attle’s messenger Winge, while the women, ashore, run alongside it.

- 29 **Glaum**-vǫr kvað at orði, · es **Gunn**-arr átti, [R TODO]
2 mēlti hōn við **V**inga · sēm hēnni **v**ert þótti:
„**V**eit’k=at hvárt **v**erð launið · at **v**ilja ossum,
4 **gl**ópr’s **g**ęsts kvāma · ef **ĩ** **g**ori=sk nõkkvat.“

Gleamware took to speak, she whom Guthur had for wife;
she spoke with Winge as she thought worthiest:
“I know not whether ye will repay us according to our will;
a guest’s coming is a disgrace if something [ill] comes out of it!”

- 30 **Sór** þá **V**ingi, · **sér** réð hann lítt ęira: [R TODO]
2 „**E**gi hann **j**otnar · ef hann at **y**ðr lygi,
galgi **g**orv-allan · ef hann á **g**rið hygði.“

Then Winge swore; he chose not to protect himself little:
“Let the ettins have him if he lies to you,
on a full gallows, if he thought to break the grith!”

2 hann ‘him’ | Winge himself.

- 31 **Bera** kvað at orði, · **blíð** **ĩ** hug sīnum: [R TODO]
2 „**S**iglið ér **s**ęlir · ok **s**igr árnið,
fari sēm fyr-mēli’k! · **F**ęst ęigi því níta.“

Bearer took to speak, blithe in her heart:
“May ye sail blessed and win victory;
may it go as I proclaim! May the fewest deny that.”

- 32 **H**ogni svaraði · —**h**ugði gótt nōnum: [R TODO]
 2 „**H**uggið=sk it, **h**orskar, · **h**vé=gi's þat gørvi=sk!
 Méla þat **m**argir, · **m**issir þó stórum,
 4 mōgum réðr **l**itlu · **h**vé verð **l**ēiddr heīman.“

Hawn answered; he thought well of his kin:
 “Comfort yourselves, wise women, however it may turn out!
 Many men say—yet it is utterly wrong,
 that for many a man it matters little how he leaves his home.”

ALL | Hawn thanks the women for accompanying them to the point of their departure.

- 33 **S**ou=sk til síðan · áðr ĩ **s**undr hyrfi; [R TODO]
 2 þá hygg **s**kōp **s**kīptu, · **s**kilðu=sk vegir þeira.

They looked at each other then before they were driven apart;
 then I think the Shapes split them up; their roads did part.

- 34 **R**óa nōmu ríki, · **r**ifu kjōl halfan, [R TODO]
 2 þeystu **b**ak-fōllum, · **b**rugðu=sk hēldr reiðir;
 hōmlur slitnuðu, · **h**áir brotnuðu,
 4 gørðu=t **f**ar **f**esta · áðr þeir **f**rā hyrfi.

They took to row with strength, tore up half the keel,
 struck the water leaning backwards, became rather wrathful;
 the oar-straps snapped; the tholes broke;
 they did not fasten their boat before they turned from it.

ALL | The men row furiously and leave the boat untied; they know that they will not return.

- 35 **L**itlu ok lēngra · —**l**ok mun'k þess sēgja— [R TODO]
 2 **b**ó sōu þeir standa · es **B**uðli átti;
 hótt **h**rikðu grindr · es **H**ogni kníði.

And a little later—I will tell it to its end—
 they saw standing the town which Budle owned;
 loudly creaked the gates when Hawn moved them.

- 36 **O**rð kvað þá Vingi · þat's **ā**n véri: [R TODO]
 2 „**F**arið **f**irr húsi! · **F**látt 's til sōkja,
 brátt hēf'k ykk **b**rennda, · **b**ragðs skuluð hōgggnir;
 4 **f**agrt bað'k ykk kvámu, · **f**látt vas þó undir,
 ēlla heðan bíðið · meðan **e**k hōgg yðr galga!“

Then quoth Winge a word which he were better without:
 “Fare ye far from the house! It is false to visit;
 I will soon have you burned; ye shall shortly be cut down;
 fairly I asked for your coming though there was falsehood underneath—
 or else stay here while I cut you a gallows!”

- 37 Orð kvað hitt Hogni · —hugði lítt végja—
 2 varr at véttu=gi · es varð at reyna:
 „Hirð=a þú oss hréða, · haf þú þat framm sjaldan!
 4 Ef þú eykr orði · illt munt þér lengja.“

[R TODO]

A different word quoth Hawn—he thought little of withdrawing—
 wary of nothing which he might come to find out:
 “Do not try to frighten us; thou wilt seldom be successful!
 If thou addest to thy word thy suffering will be prolonged!”

- 38 Hrundu þeir Vinga · ok i hæl drópu,
 2 oxar at lögðu · meðan i qnd hiksti.

[R TODO]

They threw Wing and beat him into Hell,
 laid their axes to him while he gasped for his breath.

- 39 Flykkðu=sk þeir Atli · ok fóru i brynjur,
 2 gengu svá gǫrvir · at vas garðr milli;
 urpu=sk á orðum · allir senn reiðir:
 4 „Fyrr vǫrum full-ráða · at firra yör lífi.“

[R TODO]

Atle and his men arrayed themselves and got in their byrnies,
 then went forth ready so that a courtyard stood between them.
 They threw words at each other, all wrathful at once:
 “We have long since fully decided to deprive you of life!”

2 milli ‘between them’ | I.e., between the two groups, Guthur and Hawn on the one side and Atle’s men on the other.

- 40 „Á sér þat illa · ef höfuð áðr ráðit;
 2 enn eruð ò-búnir · ok höfum einn fældan,
 lamðan til hējar— · liðs vas sá yðars!“

[R TODO]

“One thinks it looks bad if ye had decided beforehand;
 ye are still unprepared and we have felled one man,
 beat him lame to Hell—he was one of yours!”

- 41 Óðir þá urðu · es þat orð heyrðu, [R TODO]
 2 forðuðu fingrum · ok fengu i snóri,
 skutu skarp=liga · ok skjöldum hlífðu=sk.

Then they became mad when they heard that word,
 twitched their fingers and seized their spears,
 hurled them furiously and hid behind their shields.

- 42 Inn kom þá ann·spilli · hvat úti drýgðu [R TODO]
 2 hött fyr hollu; · heyrðu þrél segja.

The news came inside of what they were waging outside,
 loudly through the hall; they heard a thrall speak.

- 43 Qtul vas þá Guð·rún · es hön ękka heyrði, [R TODO]
 2 hlaðin hals-męnjum · hreytti hön þeim gęrv-qlum,
 slęngði svá silfri · at i sundr hrutu baugar.

Then Guthrun became terrible when she heard his crying;
 laden with neckrings she shook them off one and all;
 she threw the silver so that the bigs crashed asunder.

- 44 Út gekk hön síðan, · ypði=t lítt hurðum, [R TODO]
 2 fór=a fęlt þęy=gi · ok fagnaði komnum;
 hvarf til Niflunga, · sú vas hindst kvęðja,
 4 fylgði saðr s·líku, · sagði hön mun fleira:

Then she went outside, did not open the doors slowly,
 went forth, nowise timid, and heartily greeted the comers.
 She turned to the Nivlings; that was their last meeting;
 virtue followed that doing; she spoke more from her mind:

- 45 „Lęitaða'k i líkna · at lętja ykkur hęiman, [R TODO]
 2 skępum viðr mann=gi · ok skuluð þó hęr komnir.“
 Męlti af man-viti · ef mundu sętta=sk,
 4 ękki at ręðu=sk, · allir ní kvęðu.

“I tried to care for you by keeping you from leaving your home;
 no man withstands the Shapes—and yet ye shall come here.”
 She asked with little man-wit if they might be reconciled;
 they did not plan to do that; they all said no.

2 skępum viðr mann=gi ‘no man withstands the Shapes’ | I.e., ‘no man can beat fate.’ The same construction is found in *Gríp* 53/1b.

3 af man-viti ‘with little man-wit’ | Lit. ‘against man-wit’, i.e., ‘with a girl’s naive sense’. The men can hardly reconcile with Atle when they have already slain one of his men.

- 46 Sá þá sél-borin · at þeir sárt léku, [R TODO]
 2 hugði á harð-ræði · ok hrauð=sk ór skikkju,
 nøkkðan tók hön mæki · ok niðja fjor varði,
 4 hóg vas at hjaldri · hvar’s hön hēndr fēsti.

Then the woman of blessed birth saw that they sorely fought;
 she thought of a harsh counsel and cast off her robe.
 She took a naked sword and defended her kinsmen’s lives;
 she was skilled in the fight where’er she turned her hands.

ALL | Am has Guthrun throwing off her clothes, taking a sword and fighting alongside her brothers. Nothing of the sort is found in the older *Akv* and it is clearly a later addition to the story, although it does show the high regard in which the Greenlanders held their women. A similar anecdote is found in the *Saw of the Greenlanders* (the famous episode of Freydis, who bares her breasts in the fight against the natives. TODO: reference).

- 47 Dóttir lét Gjúka · drengi tvá hníga, [R TODO]
 2 bróður hjó hön Atla, · bera varð þann síðan,
 skapði hön svá skæru, · skældi fót undan.

The daughter of Yivick let two young warriors sink down.
 She struck Atle’s brother; he had to be borne away thereafter;
 thus did she handle that engagement: she severed his foot from under him.

2 bróður ... Atla ‘Atle’s brother’ | An unknown figure.

- 48 Annan réð hön hoggva · svá’t sá upp reís=at, [R TODO]
 2 i hēlju hön þann hafði; · þey=gi hēnni hēndr skulfu.

She struck the other man so that he did not rise up;
 she let that man go to Hell; yet nowise her hands trembled.

- 49 Þjorku þar gjörðu, · þeiri vas við brugðit; [R TODO]
 2 þat brá umb allt annat · es unnu börn Gjúka;
 svá kvóðu Niflunga · meðan sjalfir lifðu
 4 skapa sókn sverðum, · slíta=sk af brynjur,
 hoggva svá hjalma · sēm þeim hugr dygði.

They made war there; it was up and off;
 it beat every other thing which the children of Yivick had accomplished.
 So they said that the Nivlings while they themselves were alive
 waged war with swords, tore off their byrnies,
 struck so the helmets as did their hearts availed them.

- 50 **M**orgin **m**ęst vógu · und's **m**iðjan dag líddi, [R TODO]
 2 óttu alla · ok ǫnd-urðan dag;
 fyrr vas full-vegit, · flóði vǫllr blóði;
 4 át-tján áðr fellu, · øfri þeir urðu,
 Beru tveim sveinum · ok bróður hennar.

For most of the morning they fought, until mid-day had passed,
 the whole dawn and early part of the day.
 Before it was fully fought the plain flowed with blood;
 eighteen had then fallen; they got the upper hand
 over Bearer's two boys and her brother.

5 tveim sveinum | *gramm. and sens. emend.*; 'ii. sveinar' (*nom. pl.*) R

5 Beru tveim sveinum · ok bróður hennar 'over Bearer's two boys and her brother' | The sense of the poem requires Bearer's "two boys" (i.e., Guthur and Hawn) to lose which justifies replacing the *nom.* forms with *dat.*

- 51 **R**ǫskr tók at **r**óða · þótt hann **r**eiðr véri: [R TODO]
 2 „Illt 's umb líta=sk, · yðr 's þat kenna;
 vǫrum þrír tigur, · þegnar víg=ligir,
 4 ęptir lifum ęllifu; · ór 's þar brunnit.

The bold man [= Attle] took to speak although he was wroth:
 “It is evil to look around; this is your doing!
 We were thirty thanes made ready for battle;
 afterwards but eleven live; the rest have burned away.”

2 umb líta=sk 'to look around' | And see the bloodied corpses lying on the ground.

4 ór 's þar brunnit 'the rest have burned away' | Lit. 'it has burned away there', symbolic; their numbers have waned greatly.

- 52 **B**róðr vǫrum fimm · es **B**uðla misstum, [R TODO]
 2 hęfir nú **H**ęl halfa · ęn hǫgnir tveir liggja.

We were five brothers when we lost Budle;
 now Hell has half of them when two lie cut down.

- 53 **M**ęğð gat'k **m**ikla · —**m**á'k=a'k þvi lęyna— [R TODO]
 2 konu vá=liga, · **k**ná'k=a'k þęss njóta;
 hljótt ęttum sjaldan, · síðst komt i hęndr ossar,
 4 firðan mik fręndum, · fę opt svikinn;
 sęnduð systr Hęlju, · s'líks ek męst kęnn=umk.“

I received strong in-laws—I can not deny that—
 [but] a woeful wife; I do not enjoy that.

We seldom had peace since thou camest to our hands;
thou didst distance me from my kinsmen, oft betrayed me for wealth;
ye sent my sister to Hell—I suffer the most from that.”

ALL | Attle addresses Guthrun.

1 gat'k 'I received' | From his marriage with Guthrun.

5 senduð systir Hǫlju 'ye sent my sister to Hell' | Byrnhild, who committed suicide after the Yivickings Guthur and Hawn slew Siward as told in *Sigsk.*

[Guð-rún kvað:] 54 „Getr þú þess, Atli, · gørðir svá fyrri: [R TODO]
2 Móður tókt mīna · ok myrðir til hnossa,
svinna systrungu · svēltir þú ī hēlli;
4 hlóg=ligt mér þat þikkir · es þú þinn harm tīnir,
goðum ek þat þakka · es þér gęng=sk illa.“

[Quoth Guthrun:] “Thou tellest, Attle, of what thou thyself didst yet earlier!
Thou didst take my mother and murder her for gold;
my wise cousins didst thou starve to death.
I find it laughable that thou speakest of thy griefs;
I thank the Gods when it goes ill for thee!”

2–3 Móður ... hēlli ‘Thou didst take ... to death.’ | The content is otherwise unknown.

[Atli kvað:] 55 „Eggja'k yör, jarlar, · auka harm stóran [R TODO]
2 vífs ins veg=liga, · vilja'k þat lita;
kostið svá keppa · at klökkvi Guð-rún,
4 sjá ek þat mętta'k · at hōn sér né ynði=t.

[Quoth Attle:] “I incite you, earls! Increase the great harm
for the glorious wife; I want to behold that.
Strive to achieve that Guthrun sobs,
so that I might see that she is unhappy.

1 jarlar ‘earls’ | Attle’s surviving companions.

56 Takið ér Hōgna · ok hyldið með knífi, [R TODO]
2 skerið ór hjarta, · skuluð þess gōrvir;
Gunn·ar grimm-úðgan · ā galga fęstið,
4 bēllið því bragði, · bjóðið til ornum!“

Take ye Hawn and pry him open with a knife;
cut out his heart—ye shall be quick about it!
Guthur the grim-hearted fasten on the gallows—
hasten to that deed!—offer him to the snakes!”

ALL | Sts. 56–64 deal with the deaths of Guthur and Hawn, especially focusing on the death of Hawn. The same episode is found in *Akv* 22–35.

1 *hyldið* ‘pry him open’ | Otherwise only used of cutting up animals, esp. whales. Finnur Jónsson (1932) is most likely right in seeing its use here as a Greenlandicism.

3–4 Gunn-ar ... ornum! ‘Guthur ... snakes!’ | Fulfilling the prophecy of st. 21. In *Akv* Guthur is thrown in a snake-pit, not hung on the gallows.

- Högni kvað: 57 „Gør sem til lystir! · Glǽðr mun’k þess biða, [R TODO]
 2 rǫskr mun þér reyna=sk, · reynt hefi’k fyrr brattara;
 hofðuð hnækking · meðan hēilir vǫrum,
 4 nú erum svá sárir · at þú mátt sjalfr valda.“

Quoth Hawn: “Do as thou desirest! I will suffer it gladly;
 I’ll be proven brave to thee; I have tempted harder things before.
 Ye suffered a setback while we were still healthy;
 now we are so wounded that thou thyself mayst decide.”

3 hnækking ‘a setback’ | Namely the loss of the eighteen retainers (st. 50).

- 58 Bēiti þat mélti · —bryti vas hann Atla: [R TODO]
 2 „Tókum vér Hjalla · en Hǫgna forðum!
 Hǫgum vér halft-yrkjum, · hann es skap-dauði,
 4 lífir=a svá lengi, · lǫskr mun é hēitinn.“

Bote spoke this—he was Attle’s overseer:
 “Let us take Helle, but Hawn let us spare!
 Let us handle the half-worker; he is shaped for death;
 he will not live for so long; he will always be known as lazy.”

- 59 Hrēddr vas hver-gétir, · helt=a in lengr rúmi, [R TODO]
 2 kunni klökkur verða, · klēif ī rǫ hverja;
 ve-sall lét=sk vigs þeira · es skyldi vass gjalda
 4 ok sinn dag dapran · at dēyja frá svinum,
 allri ør-kostu · es hann áðr hafði.

The kettle-keeper was afraid, could not run further into the room,
 knew how to start sobbing, hid in every nook;
 said he was wretched o’er the feud of those who should repay him for his toil,
 and that his day was dismal if he should die away from his swine,
 from all the great pleasure which he had previously had.

- 60 Tóku þeir brás Buðla · ok brugðu til knífi, [R TODO]
 2 øpði ill-préli · áðr odds kēndi;

- tóm lét=sk=at ęiga, · tęđja vel garđa,
 4 vinna it vergasta · ef hann við rétti;
 ęeginn lét=sk þó Hjalli · at hann fęor þęgi.

They took Budle's cookboy and brandished the knife,
 the bad thrall screamed before he saw the point.
 He said he would take no leisure, dung the fields well,
 do the meanest work if he might but be let go;
 Helle said he would rejoice if he might but keep his life.

1 brás 'cookboy' | A hapax, but apparently in ablaut with Swedish *brasa* 'fire', i.e., one who tends to the fire.

- 61 Gętti=sk þess Hęgni · —gęrva svá fęri— [R TODO]
 2 at ęrna ę·nauđgum · at undan gengi:
 „Fyrir kveđ'k mér minna · at fęmja lęik þęnna;
 4 hví mynim hęr vilja · hęyra ę þa skręktun?“

Hawn gave counsel—few men do so!—
 to grant the enthralled man that he might get away.
 “It would be easier, I say, for me to endure this game;
 why should we here wish to listen to this screeching?”

- 62 Þrifu þęir þjóđ-góđan, · þa vas kostr ęngi [R TODO]
 2 rekkum rakk-látum · ráđ ęnn lęngr dvelja;
 hló þa Hęgni, · hęyrđu dag-męgir,
 4 kęppa hann svá kunni, · kvęl hann vel þolði.

They seized the very good man; then there was no choice
 for the stern-faced retainers to tarry with their orders.
 Then Hawn laughed; the sons of daylight [WORKMEN] heard it;
 so did he know how to struggle; he suffered well the torment.

- 63 Hęrpu tók Gunn·arr, · hrórđi il-kvistum; [R TODO]
 2 slá hann svá kunni · at snótir grętu;
 klukku þęir karlar · es kunnu gęrst hęyra;
 4 ríkri rőđ sagði, · raptar sundr brustu.

Guthur took the harp, plucked it with his footsole-twigs [TOES],
 struck as he knew so that the ladies wept;
 the menfolk cried who heard it clearest;
 he gave the powerful woman counsel; the rafters burst asunder.

ALL | The poet turns to Guthur, who is on the gallows and at the same time being tortured by the wyrms. For the scene of Guthur playing the harp with his toes see *Akv* 35.

4 ríkri ‘powerful woman’ | Presumably Guthrun; cf. 65/2 below.

- 64 **D**óu þá dýrir, · **d**ags vas hēldr snemma, [R TODO]
2 létu þeir á lēsti · **l**ifa iþrótta.

Then the precious men died; the day was rather early;
to the very last they let their skills linger on.

- 65 **S**tórr þótti=sk Atli, · **s**té hann of þá báða, [R TODO]
2 horskri **h**arm sagði · ok réð hēldr at bręða:
„Morginn ’s nú, Guð-rún, · **m**isst hęfir þér hollra,
4 sums est **s**jalf-skapa · at hafi **s**vá gęngit.“

Attle thought himself great; he stood over them both,
he told the wise woman a thing of harm and did harshly upbraid her:
“It is morning now, Guthrun; thou hast lost those true to thee;
it is partly thy own doing that things have gone so.”

- [Guð-rún kvað:] 66 „Fęginn est, Atli, · **f**err þú víg lýsa, [R TODO]
2 á munu þér iðrar · ef allt reynir;
sú mun **e**rfð **e**ptir · —**e**k kann þér segja:
4 ills gęng=sk þér aldri · nema **e**k ok dęja.“

[Quoth Guthrun:] “Thou art rejoicing, Attle; thou goest to announce the slayings;
thou wilt come to regret them if thou dost come to prove it all.
There will be an inheritance afterwards—I can tell thee:
evil will never part from thee unless I too die.”

- [Atli kvað:] 67 „Kann’k=a’k **s**-líks **s**ynja, · **s**é’k til ráð annat, [R TODO]
2 hǫlfu hóg=ligra · —hǫfnum opt góðu:
Man*i **m**un’k þik hugga, · **m**étum á-gétum,
4 silfri **s**nę-hvítu · sem sjǫlf vilir.“

[Quoth Attle:] “I cannot deny such a thing; I see another counsel,
twice as fitting; we often abandon what is good.
I will comfort thee with a handmaid and with excellent treasures,
with snow-white silver, whate’er thou thyself desirest!”

3 Man*i | *metr. and sens. emend.*; manni R.

- [Guð-rún kvað:] 68 „Ön es þęss **e**ngi, · **e**k vil því níta, [R TODO]
2 sleit’k þá sáttir · es vǫru **s**akar minni;
af-kǫr ek áðr þótta’k, · á mun nú góða,

4 hréðǫa'k umb hot-vetna · meðan Hogni lifði.

[Quoth Guthrun:] “That will hardly be expected; I will refuse it.
I tore up reconciliations when the crimes were lesser;
I seemed violent before—I will now exceed it;
I put up with anything while Hawn still lived.

69 Alin vit upp vǫrum · ï ċinu húsi,

[R TODO]

2 lékum lēik margan · ok ï lundi óxum,
góddi okkr Grím·hildr · golli ok hals-męnjum.

4 Bana munt mér bróðra · bóta aldri=gi
né vinna þess ċkki · at mér vel þikki.

We two were reared up in one house;
we played many a game and waxed in the glade;
Grimhild endowed us with gold and neckrings.
For the slaying of my brothers wilt thou never restore me,
nor accomplish anything that might seem good to me.

1 vit ‘we two’ | Guthrun and Hawn.

70 Kostum drepr kvenna · karla of-ríki,

[R TODO]

2 ï kné gęngr hnefi · ef kvistir þverra,
tré tękr at hnīga · ef hogggr tág undan;
4 nú mátt ċinn, Atli, · ǫllu hér ráða.“

The choices of women are beat down by the tyranny of men.
The fist gets on its knees if the branches thin out;
the tree begins to lean if one cuts away its roots from underneath it;
now mayst thou alone, Attle, rule everything here.”

2 ï kné gęngr hnefi · ef kvistir þverra ‘The fist gets on its knees if the branches thin out’ | Pettit (2023) sees this as a reference to the game Neve-Table (*Hnefa-tafl*), where the *hnefi* ‘fist’ is the name of the King, surrounded by his soldiers (Pawns or Rooks) on all sides, which seem to resemble branches. For board games see *Vǫp* 8/1 n.

71 Gnótt vas grunn-ýðgi · es gramr því trúði,

[R TODO]

2 sýn vas sveip-vísi · ef hann sîn gęði.
Krǫpp vas þá Guð-rún, · kunni umb hug męla,
4 lét hōn sér gørði, · lēk hōn tvęim skjöldum.

There was gullibility enough when the chief believed that;
the deceit was apparent if he would have watched out for himself.
Then Guthrun was hard; she could speak with care;
she made herself out to be light; she played with two shields.

- 72 Øxti hōn ǫl-drykkjur · at ęřfa bróðr sína, [R TODO]
 2 samr lét=sk ok Atli · at sīna gōrva.

She made the ale-vessels grow to drink the wake of her brothers;
 Attle, too, did the same for his own.

- 73 Lokit því létu, · lagat vas drykkju; [R TODO]
 2 sú vas sam-kunda · við svōrfun of-mikla;
 strōng vas stór-huguð, · striddi hōn ęt Buðla,
 4 vildi hōn ver sīnum · ofr-ęęfndir.

They closed the matter; the drink was brewed;
 that was an assembly with too great destruction.
 Cruel was the great-minded woman; she injured the lineage of Budle;
 against her husband she wished to wreak great revenge.

4 vildi hōn ver sīnum · ofr-ęęfndir | Alliteration between *v*- and vowels is by no means unheard of in Norse poetry but varies greatly between styles. In the Scaldic genre, for instance, it was always entirely forbidden.

- 74 Lokkaði hōn litla · ok lagði við stokki; [R TODO]
 2 glúpnuðu grimmir · ok grétu þęy=gi,
 fóru ĩ faðm móður, · frétu hvat þa skyldi.

She called on her little ones and laid them against a stump;
 the grim ones were downcast and yet nowise cried;
 they jumped to their mother's bosom, asked what would happen.

ALL | Guthrun kills her own children, Earp and Oatle. The killing is not described directly in *Akv* but is alluded to in *Akv* 37 and mentioned in 40–41.

- [Guð-rún kvað:] 75 „Spyrið lítt ęptir! · Spilla ętla'k bōðum, [R TODO]
 2 lyst vōr=umk þęss lęgi · at lyfja ykkř ęlli.“
 [Bōrn'in:] „Blótt sęm vilt bōrnum, · bannar þat mann=gi,
 4 skōmm mun ró ręði · ef þú ręynir gōrva.“

[Quoth Guthrun:] “Ask no more what is coming! I intend to slay you both,
 I have long had lust to deprive you of old age.”
 [The children:] “Bloot thy children if thou wilt; no man forbids thee;
 the respite of thy wrath will be short if thou dost truly try it.”

3 Blótt ‘Bloot’ | I.e., ‘sacrifice’.

- 76 Brá þa barn-ōsku · bróðra in kapp-svinna, [R TODO]
 2 skipti=sk skap=liga, · skar hōn á hals báða.

- Enn frétti Atli · hvert farnir véri
 4 sveinar hans leika · es hann sá þá hvergi.

Then childhood was cut short for the battle-wise brothers,
 it was overturned according to Shapes—she slit the throats of them both.
 Soon Atle asked whither they had gone,
 his swains in their play, when he nowhere saw them.

- 77 „Yfir róð=umk ganga, · Atla til sægja, [R TODO]
 2 dylja mun'k þik eigi, · dóttir Grím·hildar;
 glaða mun þik minnst, Atli, · ef þú görva reynir;
 4 vakðir vó mikla · es þú vatt bróðr mína.

“I decide to come over to tell thee, Atle;
 I, the daughter of Grimhild, will not hide it from thee.
 It will gladden thee the least if thou dost truly find it out;
 thou didst awaken great woe when thou slewest my brothers.

- 78 Svaf'k mjök sjaldan, · síðan's þeir fellu, [R TODO]
 2 hét'k þér hǫðu, · hefi'k þik nú minntan;
 morgin mér sagðir, · man'k enn þann görva,
 4 nú 's ok aptann, · átt s·líkt at fréttu.

I slept very seldom since they fell;
 I vowed harsh things towards thee; I have now reminded thee.
 This morning thou spokest to me; I still remember it clearly.
 Now it is the evening; thou hast to learn such things:

3 morgin ‘This morning’ | Cf. st. 65.

- 79 Maga hefir þinna · misst sem síðst skyldir; [R TODO]
 2 hausa veitst þeira · hafða at öl-skólum,
 drýgða'k þér svá drykkju— · dreyra blett'k þeira.

Thou hast lost thy lads as thou least shouldst have.
 I know their skulls have been made into ale-bowls;
 thus I enriched thy drink: I mixed it with their blood.

ALL | In sts. 79–81 Guthrun recounts how she fed Atle the corpses of their children. Cf. the description of the same events in *Akv* 40–41; the strong correspondences suggest a direct line of influence.

- 80 Tók'k þeira hjörtu · ok á tēini stēikta'k,
 2 seldað'k þér síðan, · sagða'k at kalfs véri; [R TODO]

4 ęinn þú því ollir · ękki rétt leifa,
toggť tío=liga, · trúðir vel joxlum.

I took their hearts and roasted them on a stick,
then I handed them to thee; I said they were a calf's.
Thou alone didst do that; thou decidedst to leave nothing,
didst chew greedily; thou trustedst thy molars well!

81 Barna vęitst þinna · —biðr sér fár verra—
2 hlut veld'k minum, · hęl=umk þó ękki.“

[R TODO]

Thou knowest of thy children; few will ask for worse;
I bear fault for my part although I do not boast of it.”

82 „Grimm vast, Guð·rún, · es þú gøra svá máttir,
2 barna þinna blóði · at blanda mér drykkju;
snýtt hęfir sifjungum · sęm síðst skyldir,
4 mér lętr þú ok sjölfum · millum ills lítit.“

[R TODO]

“Thou wast cruel, Guthrun, when thou couldst do so,
to blend thy own children's blood into my drink.
Thou hast destroyed thy own relations as thou least shouldst have;
for me leavest thou little [time] between evil.”

4 millum ills lítit 'little [time] between evil' | Referring to Guthrun's recent killing of Atle's brother (sts. 47–48).

[Guð·rún kvað:] 83 „Vili mér ęnn vęri · at vęga þik sjalfan,
2 fátt 's full-illa · farit við gram s·líkan.“
[Atli kvað:] „Drýgt þú fyrr hafðir · þat's męnn dōmi vissu=t,
4 til hęmsku, harð-ręðis, · ĩ hęimi þessum;
nú hęfir þú ęnn aukit · þat's nú áðan frógum,
6 greipt glóp stóran, · gørt hęfir þú þitt ęrfi.

[R TODO]

[Quoth Guthrun:] “If but I still had willpower to slay thy very self;
little is evil enough when done against such a prince!”
[Quoth Atle:] “Thou hast already done that of which men knew no equivalent
in foolishness and harsh counsel in this Home.
Now hast thou yet added to what we earlier had learned;
thou didst accomplish a great disgrace; thou hast had thy wake!

4 ĩ hęimi þessum 'in this Home' | I.e., in the world of mankind.

84 Bręnnð munt á báli · ok barið grjóti áðr,

[R TODO]

- 2 þá hefir þú árnat · þat's ę beįđi=sk.
 [Guđ-rún kvađ:] „Sęg þér s·líkar · sorgir ár morgin,
 4 frįđra vil'k dauđa, · fara i ljós annat.“

Thou wilt be burned on a pyre and struck with stones beforehand;
 then hast thou earned what thou always begged for!”

[Quoth Guthrun:] “Tell thyself such sorrows early in the morning;
 by a fairer death I wish to go into the other light.”

1 Bręnn munt á báli · ok bariđ grjóti áđr ‘Thou wilt be burned on a pyre and struck with stones beforehand’ | A Christian, mediæval punishment. That being burned on a pyre is seen as a punishment and associated with stoning reveals a mediæval Catholic sensibility horrified at the thought of burning a body rather than burying it. In pagan times, however, burning was a neutral way of disposing of a body and had no negative associations (so e.g. *Háv* 71/3, 81/1); cf. Males (2024b, pp. 93–96).

4 ljós annat ‘the other light’ | The next world; the world as ‘light’ is more commonly found in West Germanic heroic poetry.

- 85 Sötu sam-týnis, · sęndu=sk fár-hugi, [R TODO]
 2 hęndu=sk heįpt-yrđi, · hvárt=ki sér unđi.
 Heįpt óx Hniflungi, · hugđi á stór-ręđi,
 4 gat fyr Guđ-runu · at hann vęri grimmr Atla.

They sat in the same court, gave each other evil thoughts,
 handed each other hateful words; neither was content.
 Hatred grew in Nivling; he thought of great counsel;
 mentioned to Guthrun that he was furious towards Atle.

3 Hniflungi ‘Nivling’ | *Hniflungr*, the son of Hawn.

- 86 Kvęmu i hug hęnni · Hęgna við·farar, [R TODO]
 2 talđi happ hęnum · ef hęfnt ynni;
 veginn vas þa Atli, · vas þęss skammt bíđa,
 4 sonr vá Hęgna · ok sjölf Guđ-run.

Into her mind came Hawn’s demise;
 she counted it lucky for him if he might accomplish the revenge.
 Then Atle was slain; it was short to abide;
 Hawn’s son struck him and Guthrun herself.

- 87 Ręskr tók at rōđa, · rakđi=sk ór svefni, [R TODO]
 2 kęnni brátt bęnja, · bands kvađ þorf ęnga:
 „Sęğđ it sannasta: · Hvērr vá son Buđla?
 4 Em’k=a’k líttr lęikinn, · lífs tęt’k vęn ęga.“

The bold man took to speak, roused from his sleep,
 shortly felt his wounds; said dressings were of no use.
 “Tell the whole truth! Who struck Budle’s son?
 I am not a little injured; I count no hopes for my life.”

[Guð·rún kvað:] **88** „Dylja mun þik ęigi · **dóttir** Grím·hildar: [R TODO]
 2 **L**ot=umk því valda · es **liðr** þína ęvi
 ęn **s**umu **s**onr Hęgna · es þik **s**ör móða.“

[Quoth Guthrun:] “The daughter of Grimhild will not hide it from thee:
 I made myself the cause for why thy age comes to its end,
 but some part the son of Hawn [plays] when the wounds do pain thee.”

[Atli kvað:] **89** „Vaðit hęfir þú at **v**ígi · þó’tt **v**ęri=t skap=ligt; [R TODO]
 2 illt ’s **v**in **v**éla, · þann’s þér **vel** trúir;
bęiddr fór’k hęiman · at **b**iðja þin, Guð·rún.

[Quoth Attle:] “Thou hast waded forth in killings although it was not shapely;
 it is ill to betray a friend who does trust thee well;
 urged-on, I journeyed from home to ask for thee, Guthrun.

3 bęiddr ‘urged-on’ | Attle reminds Guthrun that it was not his choice to marry her.

90 **L**eyfð vast-u, ękkja, · **l**étu stór-ráða, [R TODO]
 2 **v**arð=a **v**ön lygi · es **v**ér of reyndum;
 fórt-u hęim **h**ingat, · fylgði oss **h**ęrr manna,
 4 **a**llt vas **í**tar=ligt · umb **ó**rar fęrðir.

Thou wast praised, woman; they said thou hadst great plans;
 that expectation was no lie, as we found out.
 Thou journeyedst hither from home; we were followed by a host of men;
 everything was splendid about our journey.

91 **M**args vas alls sðmi, · **m**anna tíginna, [R TODO]
 2 **n**aut vöru órin, · **n**utum af stórum;
 þar vas **f**jölð **f**ęar, · **f**engu til margir.

There was much honour in everything for the distinguished men;
 the kine were ample, we enjoyed them greatly;
 there was a multitude of wealth; many received it.

92 **M**und galt ek **m**ęrri, · **m**ęiðma fjölð þiggja, [R TODO]
 2 **þ**ręla **þ**rjá-tøgu, · **þ**ýjar sjau góðar;

sómð vas at s·líku, · silfr vas þó meira.

I paid the bride-price for the famed woman who got a multitude of treasures:
thirty thralls, seven good handmaids.
There was honour in all such things; there was even more silver.

- 93 Létst þér allt þikkja · sëm ekki véri
2 meðan lǫnd þau lǫgu · es mér leiðði Buðli;
gróft svá undir, · gørði=t hlut þiggja.
4 Svêru létst þína · sitja opt grátna,
fann'k=a'k i hug hēilum · hjóna vétr síðan.“

[R TODO]

Thou saidst it all seemed to thee as if it were nothing
while the lands which Budle left me lay [unused];
thou didst undermine [them]; one did not receive a part.
Thou didst let thy mother-in-law sit often weeping;
I never found the household in good heart thereafter.”

2–3 meðan ... þiggja 'while ... a part.' | Difficult. L. 2 seems to say that Guthrun was a nagging wife and chastised Atle for not working harder (namely for not cultivating all his fields—the very suggestion reveals the poverty of the Greenlandish poet, for whom Atle can be little more than a wealthy farmer). L. 3 is more difficult.

- [Guðrún kvað:] 94 „Lýgr þú nú, Atli, · þótt ek þat lítt rækja;
2 hēldr vas'k hǫg sjaldan · hóft=sk þó stórum;
bǫrðuð=sk ér bróðr ungir, · bǫruð=sk róg milli.
4 Halft gekk til hēljár · ór húsi þínu;
hroldi hot-vetna · þat's til hags skyldi.

[R TODO]

[Quoth Guthrun:] “Thou liest now, Atle, though I care little about it;
rather, I was seldom docile, yet thou didst elevate thyself haughtily.
Ye young brothers fought each other, carried strife between yourselves.
Half of thy household went to Hell;
everything faltered which should have been a boon.

- 95 Þrjú vǫrum systkin, · þöttum ó-végin,
2 fórum af landi, · fylgðum Sig·verði;
skéva vér létum, · skipi hvørt vart stýrði,
4 orkuðum at auðnu · und's vér austr kvǫmum.

[R TODO]

We were three siblings; we seemed undefeatable;
we went away from the land; we followed Siward.
We let ourselves speed forth; we each steered a ship;
we went forth according to luck until we came to the east.

2 Sig-vgrði | *metr. emend.*; Sigurði R

4 ǫrkuðum at auðnu ‘we went forth according to luck’ | Proverbial; the verb *arka* is only found in this expression which appears twice in prose (see ONP) and nowhere else in poetry.

- 96 Konung drǫpum fyrstan, · kurum land þaðra, [R TODO]
2 hęrsar oss á hǫnd gengu, · hręðslu þat vissi;
 vǫgum ór skógi · þann’s vildum syknar,
4 sęttum þann sęlan · es sér né átti=t.

We first slew a king, chose the lands there;
the chieftains yielded to us; that showed fear.
We fought the way out of the forest for him who we would see redeemed;
we set down blessedly him who owned naught for himself.

3–4 vǫgum ... átti=t. ‘We fought ... for himself.’ | Siward, who was an orphaned outlaw before he met the Yivickings.

- 97 Dauðr varð inn húnski, · drap þa brátt kosti, [R TODO]
2 strangt vas angr ungri · ękkju nafn hljóta;
 kvǫl þótti kvikri · at koma ĩ hús Atla;
4 átti áðr kappi, · illr vas sá missir.

The Hunnish man [= Siward] died; then I was soon without choice;
it was a cruel sorrow for a young woman to get a widow’s name.
It seemed a torture for her in life to come to the house of Atle;
she had once had a champion—ill was that loss.

1 inn húnski ‘The Hunnish man [= Siward]’ | Cf. *Sigs* 4/4 for this appellation.

- 98 Komt=a þú því þingi · es vér þat frégim [R TODO]
2 at sǫk sóttir · né slękkðir aðra;
 vildir á-vallt vęgja · ęn vętt=ki halda,
4 kyrrt of því láta.“ · ...

Thou didst not come from that Thing, as we have learned it,
after thou hadst pursued one charge or quashed another.
Thou wantedst always to withdraw—but nowise to hold fast—
[and] to stay quiet about it.” ...

4 ... | A blank space is left for this half-line in R.

- [Atli kvað:] 99 „Lýgr þú nú, Guð-rún, · lítt mun við bóta=sk [R TODO]
2 hluti hvar-igra, · hǫfum ǫll skarðan;

4 gør þú nú, Guð·rún, · af gótsku þinni
 okkr til á·gétis · es mik út hefja.“

[Quoth Attle:] “Thou liest now, Guthrun; little remedy will be found
for the lot of either of us; we have all been bereaved!
Act now, Guthrun, out of thy goodness,
to the honour of us both when they carry me out.”

[Guð·rún kvað:] 100 „Knorr mun’k kaupa · ok kistu stęinda,
2 vęxa vel blęju · at vęrja þitt líki,
 hyggja à þorǫf hverja · sęm vit holl vęrim.“

[R TODO]

[Quoth Guthrun:] “I will buy a cargo-ship and a painted coffin,
weave the cover great to protect thy corpse,
think of every necessity, like if we had been true to each other.”

101 Nár varð þá Atli, · niðjum stríð óxti,
2 ęfndi ítr-borin · allt þat’s réð hęita;
 fróð vildi Guð·rún · fara sér at spilla,
4 urðu dvöl dógra, · dó hęn ĩ sinn annat.

[R TODO]

Then Attle became a corpse; grief swelled for his kinsmen;
the noble-born woman carried out all what she had vowed.
Wise, Guthrun wished to go to destroy her life;
there was a delay in her days; she died another time.

4 urðu dvöl dógra ‘there was a delay in her days’ | Namely when she was carried over the waves to King Enacker as told in *Ghv* Pl.

102 Sęll ’s hverr síðan · es s·líkt getr fódða
2 jóð at afr·eki · sęm’s ól Gjúki;
 lifa mun þat ęptir · à landi hverju,
4 þęira þrý·męli · hvar=gi’s þjóð hęyrir.

[R TODO]

Blessed is whoever thenceforth gets to raise
such children to heroism like those Yivick begot.
It will afterwards live upon every land:
their troubled tale, wherever men hear it.

Instigation of Guthrun

(*Guð·rúnar hvöt*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): early C11th (0.781)–late C11th (0.177)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

Textual preservation and transmission

The **Instigation of Guthrun** (*Ghv*) is the penultimate poem of **R**, where it is found on fol. 44r/13–44v/27. The poem is complete.

Story

As its name spells out, *Ghv* deals with Guthrun's instigation of her two sons Sarle and Hamthew to avenge their sister Swanhild, killed by the cruel tyrant Ermenric. After the sons depart on their inevitably fatal course, Guthrun laments her cruel fate before addressing her long-dead first husband and true love, Siward. She constructs a great funeral pyre in order to join him, it is implied, by self-immolation.

A variant of Guthrun's instigation and the eager response of her sons (*Ghv* 2–8), but not her following monologue, is also found in *Hamð* 3–10. These sections share so much in common, including numerous identical or near-identical lines (*Ghv* 2/3a, 4b–6 = *Hamð* 3/2–4, *Ghv* 4/1–3 = *Hamð* 6/1–3, *Ghv* 4/4 = *Hamð* 7/1, *Ghv* 4/5a ~ = *Hamð* 7/2b), that they must be related. It is however clear from the variant forms that this relation is through the oral tradition (cf. e.g. *Ghv* 4/3 and *Hamð* 6/3, which are near-identical, but where the former appears to be an unmetrical corruption of a line originally resembling the latter; in a scribal context such corruption could never happen). Since both poems are related through oral tradition, this of course means that neither poem can be a scribal composition.

Historical basis

Because both *Ghv* and the immediately following *Hamð* deal with the same events it is best to discuss their historical basis in a single section.

It is a remarkable thing that the narrative described in these two poems is surprisingly close to historical fact, or at least what we know as such. In Jordanes' *Getica* 129 we read the following:

Nam Hermanaricus, rex Gothorum, licet, ut superius retulimus, multarum gentium extiterat triumphator, de Hunnorum tamen adventu dum cogitat, Rosomonorum gens infida, quae tunc inter alias illi famulatum exhibebat, tali eum nanciscitur occasione decipere. Dum enim quandam mulierem Sunilda nomine ex gente memorata pro mariti fraudulento discessu rex furore commotus equis ferocibus inligatam incitatisque cursibus per diversa divelli praecipisset, fratres eius Sarus et Ammius, germanae obitum vindicantes, Hermanarici latus ferro petierunt; quo vulnere saucius egram vitam corporis inbecillitate contraxit.

'Now although Hermanaric, king of the Goths, was the conqueror of many tribes, as we have said above, yet while he was deliberating on this invasion of the Huns, the treacherous tribe of the Rosomoni, who at that time were among those who owed him their homage, took this chance to catch him unawares. For when the king had given orders that a certain woman of the tribe I have mentioned, Sunilda by name, should be bound to wild horses and torn apart by driving them at full speed in opposite directions (for he was roused to fury by her husband's treachery to him), her brothers Sarus and Ammius came to avenge their sister's death and plunged a sword into Hermanaric's side. Enfeebled by this blow, he dragged out a miserable existence in bodily weakness.' (Jordanes 1915, p. 87)

It is known that Ermenric died in 375 CE and that Jordanes was working ca. 550 CE. So it is that in two poems composed at least 450 years (probably closer to 550) after Ermenric's death, preserved in a manuscript written 900 years after his death, we find the very same events retold—the torture-murder of Swanhild with horses, the execution of her lover, the revenge of her two brothers Sarle and Hamthew, their maiming of the king—events retold not on the basis of historical learning, but rather through an independent oral tradition.

Prose parallels

Ghv is paraphrased in *Vǫls* 41, which as usual with that text appears (cf. st. 5/3a) to have relied on a ms. related to, but not identical with or descended from R.

For other Norse attestations of the journey of Hamthew and Sarle and their revenge on Ermenric see the Introduction to *Hamð*.

Style and word-choices

The poem is rather sparse with kennings and the few that do occur (6/2b, 8/2a, 14/3b; 20/1b should not be taken as an actual kenning) are conventional.

Many sts. are very touching, particularly 13, 15–16, and 19.

A few rare or marked words occur: *tá* in 9/2b, *húnn* in 12/1a, *þjóð-konungr* in 14/2b.

Meter

The meter is Ancient-words-law.

The length of the stanza is variable and not limited to 4 lines.

The number of non-alliterating ll. in **R** is high, and includes 5/1, 5/3, 13/2, 14/4, 18/1 and 20/4. Of these 5/3 can be restored on the basis of *Vǫls*, but the rest are irrestorably defective. All remaining non-alliterating ll. except for 13/2 have some accompanying signs of corruption along with the lack of alliteration. 5/1 and 20/4 are too short and appear to have lost an alliterating word in transmission, as certainly happened in 5/3. 14/4 and 18/1 are isolated half-lines. Thus, only 13/2 is a rhythmically perfect line without alliteration.

Text

Frá Guð·rúnu ('From Guthrun')

- P1 Guð·rún gekk þá til sévar er hón hafði drepit Atla, gekk út á [R 44r/13–20]
 2 sé'inn ok vildi fara sér. Hón mátti eigi sökka. Rak hana yfir
 4 fjörð'inn á land Jón·akrs konungs; hann fekk hennar. Þeira synir
 6 voru þeir Sörli ok Erpr ok Ham·ðir. Þar fódði=sk upp Svan·hildr
 8 Sig·urðar dóttir. Hón var gípt Jormun·rekk inum ríkja. Með
 hánun var Bikki. Hann réð þat at Rand·vér konungs son skyldi
 taka hana; þat sagði Bikki konungi. Konungr lét hengja Rand·vé
 en troða Svan·hildi undir hrossa fótum. En er þat spurði Guð·rún
 þá kvaddi hón sonu sína.

GUTHRUN THEN WENT TO THE SEA after she had slain Atle, went out into the sea and would end herself. She could not sink. She was driven across the firth to the land of king Enacker; he got her for wife. Their sons were Sarle and Earp and Hamthew. There Swanhild, Siward's daughter, was reared. She was married off to Ermenric the powerful. With him was Beck. He counseled that Randwigh, the king's son, should sleep with her; this Beck told the king. The king let Randwigh be hanged, but Swanhild he had trampled beneath the hooves of horses. But when Guthrun learned of that she called out to her sons.

1 Guð·rún | *The G is an ornamented capital 2 lines high in R.*

4 Erpr 'Earp' | Actually, the prose is mistaken here. Earp was Enacker's son from a previous marriage and not the son of Guthrun (*Hamð* 12–14).

Guð·rúnar hvot ('The Instigation of Guthrun')

- 1 Þá frá'k sennu · slíðr-feng=ligasta,
 2 trauð mól talið · af trega stórum,
 es harð-huguð · hvatti at vígi
 4 grimmum orðum · Guð·rún sonu:

I HAVE LEARNT THAT EXCHANGE brought the direst results—
 the hard-pressed speeches told from great grief—
 when hard-hearted she goaded to war,
 with fierce words, Guthrun, her sons:

1 Þá | *The Þ is an ornamented initial 3 lines high, with the left vertical stroke ascending 3 lines and descending 2 lines in the margin in R.*

1 frá'k 'I have learnt' | A formulaic opening. The narrator expresses that he is not a direct witness to the events of the poem by means of the formulaic verb *fregna* (< PGmc. **frehnaną* '(come to) learn, find out through hearsay'). This formula has identical parallels elsewhere in ON and WGmc. poetry; cf. *Yt* 8/1, 15/5, 16/1, *Beow* 74, 575, 1026 etc., *Heli* 288, 367, 510, etc., and esp. *Wessobrunn* 1/1, where the syntax (note the bracketing of the finite verb between the article and the noun it modifies) is identical to the present line: *Dat ga-fregin ih mit firahim · firi-wizzó mēsta* 'I have learnt among men that greatest of wonders'. The ancestral expression may be reconstructed in PGmc. as follows: **þa*-ACC-SG *ga-frah* ek ... NOUN-ACC-SG 'I have learnt (of) that NOUN'. — For related formulaic openings involving the verb **hauzijaną* 'hear' cf. *Oddr* 1/1, *Hild* 1.

- 2 „Hví sitið it? · Hví sofið lífi?
2 Hví **regr**=at ykkir · **tęti** at męla,
es **Jormun**=rekr · **yðra** systur,
4 **unga** at aldri, · **jóm** of traddi,
hvítum ok svörtum · á **hęr**-vegi
6 **gróum**, **gang**-tómum · **Gotna** hrossum?

“Why do ye two sit? Why sleep ye your lives away?
Why does it not trouble you to speak merrily
when Ermenric has had your sister
young of age trampled by steeds,
by the white and black on the path of war,
by the grey, pacing, Gotnish horses?”

1 it | *metr. emend.; om. by haplography* (*‘fitit it’ > ‘fitit’) R

3–6 es ... hrossum. ‘when ... horses?’ | Repeated almost identically in *Hamð* 3.

4 of traddi ‘has had ... trampled’ | Lit. ‘made to be trampled’, 3sg past ind. of (*of*) *tręðja* ‘make to be trampled’, causative of *tróða* ‘trample, tread (upon)’.

- 3 Urðu=a it **g**-líkir · þeim **Gunn**-ari
2 né in **hęldr** **hugðir** · sęm vas **Hęgni**;
hęnnar myндуð it · **hęfna** lęita
4 ef it **móð** ęttið · **münna** bróðra
ęða **harðan** **hug** · **hün**-konunga.“

Ye have not turned out alike to Guthur
nor instead thoughtful like Hawn was.
Her would ye have sought to avenge
if ye had the courage of my brothers
or the hard heart of the Hunnish kings!”

- 4 Þá kvað þat **Ham**-ðir · inn **hugum** stóri:
2 „**Litt** myndir þú · **lęyfa** dōð **Hęgna**
þá's **Sig**-vörð vękðu · **svefni** ór;

- 4 **bó**kr vǫru þínar, · inar **blá**-hvítu,
 roðnar i **vers** dreýra, · folgnar i **val**-blóði.

Then this quoth Hamthew the great of heart:
 “Thou hadst little cause to praise Hawn’s deeds
 when they woke Siward from his sleep.
 Thy blue-white bed-clothes were
 reddened in thy husband’s gore, buried in death-blood.”

3 **Sig-vǫrð** | *metr. emend.* (*Sievers 1889*, pp. 135–141); **Sig-vrð R**

ALL | L. 1–5a in this st. closely correspond to *Hamð* 6/1–3, 7/1–2.

3 þá’s **Sig-vǫrð** vǫkðu · **svetni** ór | This l. is metrically defective in the present poem but survives better as *Hamð* 6/3.

- 5 Urðu þér [...] · bróðra hefndir
 2 **slíð**rar ok **sá**rar · es þú sonu myrðir;
 knéttim **allir** · **J**ormun·rekki,
 4 **sam**-hyggjendr, · systur hefna.

For thee thy [...] deeds of revenge for thy brothers became
 biting and sore when thou murderedst thy sons.
 We shall all with a single mind
 avenge our sister on Ermenric.

3 **allir** | *om.* **R**

3 allir ‘all’ | The restoration of this word is secured by its occurrence in the paraphrase of this st. in *Vǫls* 41: *ok betr mætum vér allir saman drepa Jormun-rek konung* ‘and it would be better if we all together might kill king Ermenric.’ This implies that the version of the poem before the redactor of *Vǫls* was in some ways better preserved than that surviving in **R**.

- 6 Berið **hnossir** framm · **hún**-konunga,
 2 **hef**r þú okkr **hvatta** · at **h**jör-þingi.“

Bring forth the treasures of the Hunnish kings!
 Thou hast incited us to the thing of swords [BATTLE].”

- 7 **Hl**éjandi Guð·rún · **hvarf** til skemmu,
 2 **kumbl** konunga · ór **k**erum valði,
 síðar brynjur · ok sonum fórði;
 4 hlóðu=sk **móðgír** · á **mara** bógu.

Laughing, Guthrun turned to her chamber.
 The heirlooms of kings from the chests she picked,
 the trailing byrnies, and brought them to her sons.
 Fierce, they loaded themselves onto the backs of steeds.

- 8 Þá kvað þat Hamðir · inn hugum stóri:
 2 „Svá kom=a'k meirr aptr · móður at vitja
 geir-Njörðr hniginn · á Goð-þjóðu
 4 at þú erfir · at ǫll oss drykkir,
 at Svan-hildi · ok sonu þína.“

Then this quoth Hamthrew the great of heart:
 “So will I no more come back to visit my mother,
 [when I am] a spear-Nearth [WARRIOR] fallen in the land of the Gots,
 after thou hast drunk a wake for us all,
 for Swanhild and for thy sons.”

2 kom=a'k | 'comaz' R

- 9 Guð-rún grátandi, · Gjúka dóttir,
 2 gekk treg=liga · á tæi sitja
 ok at telfja, · tórug-hlýra,
 4 móðug spjöll · á margan veg:

Guthrun, weeping, Yivick's daughter,
 went in grief to sit on the ground,
 and to tell with teary cheeks
 her moving tale in many ways:

ALL | The two boys depart (cf. *Hamð*), and Guthrun's long monologue begins, lasting from sts. 10 to 20.

- 10 „Þrjá vissa'k elda, · þrjá vissa'k arna,
 2 vas'k þrimr verum · vegin at húsi;
 einn vas mér Sig-vörðr · ǫllum bętri
 4 es bróðr mínir · at bana urðu.

“I have known three fires; I have known three hearths;
 for three husbands I have been brought to the house.
 To me Siward alone was better than all—
 he whose bane my brothers became.

3 Sig-vörðr | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sig-urðr R

- 11 Svárra sára · sá'k=at, né kunna
 2 [...]
 meirr þöttu=sk · mér of stríða
 4 es mik ǫðlingar · Atla gófu.

Heavy griefs I neither saw nor knew,
[...];
moreover I thought it injurious to me
when the athlings gave me to Attle.

1 Svárra sára · sá'k=at, né kunna 'Heavy griefs I neither saw nor knew' | Before the killing of Siward. Guthrun thus presents her life as idyllic before her brothers killed her lover.

2 [...] | No gap is indicated in R, but it seems inevitable that a line has fallen out here containing something to the effect of "before my brothers murdered Siward".

3 mçirr 'moreover' | Namely after the killing of Siward, when she was married off to Attle against her will.

- 12 Húna hvassa · hét'k mér at rúnum;
2 mátti'g=a'k bǫlva · bǫtr of vinna
 áðr ek hnóf hǫfuð · af Hniflungum.

The smart bear-cubs I called to me for counsel;
I could not find remedies for the bales
before I severed the heads from the Nivlings.

3 Hniflungum | *metr. emend.* (cf. 1 HHund 48/5); Niflungum R

ALL. | Guthrun alludes to her murder of her children with Attle, as dealt with in *Akv* 37–42 and *Am* 73–81. Cf. *Hamð* 8.

1 Húna hvassa 'The smart bear-cubs' | Her sons with Attle; for the appellation cf. *Vkv* 24/1.

- 13 Gekkk ek til strandar, · grǫm vas'k nornum,
2 vilda'k hrinda · stríð gríð þeira;
 hófu mik, né drękkðu, · hǫvar bǫrur,
4 því land of sté'k · at lifa skylda'k.

I went to the shore; I was wroth with the norms;
I wished to break their stubborn peace.
I was lifted—not drowned—by the billows high,
so I stepped aland since I was meant to live.

ALL. | Guthrun attempted to take her own life, but was instead driven to the realm of king Enacker, who married her. See P1 above.

3 hófu mik, né drękkðu, · hǫvar bǫrur 'I was lifted—not drowned—by the billows high' | Clearly related to the prophecy of this event in *Sigsk* 62/3, with which the b-verse is identical.

- 14 Gekkk ek á bæð · —hugða'k mér fyr bætra—
2 þriðja sinni · þjóð-konungi;
 ól ek mér jóð, · ęrfi-vǫrðu
4 [...] · Jón·akrs sonu.

I mounted the bed—I thought it better for me—
of a great king for a third time.
I begot babes, heritage-defenders [sons],
[...], Enacker's sons.

2 þjóð-konungi 'great king' | An old poetic word; for etymology + distribution see *Grip* 1/2 n.

4 sonu | emend.; *sonum* R

- 15 Æn umb Svan·hildi · sǫtu þýjar,
2 es mænna barna · batst full-hugða'k;
 svá vas Svan·hildr · i sal minum,
4 sœm véri sœm-lettr · sólar geisli.
- But around Swanhild handmaids sat,
she whom I thought best of among my children.
So was Swanhild in my hall
like were she a fair-faced ray of the sun.

- 16 Gódda'k golli · ok guð-vefjum,
2 áðr ek géfa'k · Goð-þjóðar til;
 þat 's mér harðast · harma mænna
4 of þann inn hvíta · hadd Svan·hildar:
 auri tröddu · und jóa fótum;
- I endowed her with gold and with cloth of god-weave
before I gave her to the folk of the Gots.
That is for me the hardest of my harms,
over the white hair of Swanhild—
they had it trampled in mud beneath the hooves of steeds!—

- 17 en sá sárastr, · es þeir Sig·vörð minn,
2 sigri rēntan, · i sēing vǫgu;
 en sá grimmastr, · es þeir Gunn·ari,
4 fránir ormar, · til fjors skriðu;
 en sá hvassastr, · es til hjarta
6 konung ð·blauðan · kvikvan skǫru.

but the sorest when my Siward,
robbed of victory, they slew in bed,
but the cruelest when for Guthur
the gleaming serpents slithered to his bane,
but the sharpest when unto the heart
they cut the unsoft king [= Hawn], alive.

1 *Sig-vǫrð* | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); *Sig-urð R*

3–6 ęn ... skǫru ‘but ... alive.’ | For the deaths of Guthur and Hawn cf. *Akv* 23–35, *Am* 56–64.

- 18 Fjǫlð man’k bǫlva, · [...]
 2 bęit-tu, *Sig-vǫrðr*, · inn blakka mar,
 hęst inn hrað-fóra · lát-tu hinig renna!
 4 Sitr ęgi hér · snǫr né dóttir
 sú’s Guð-rúnu · gęfi hnossir.

I recall a multitude of bales; [...]
 Saddle, Siward, thy fallow steed,
 thy quick-pacing horse—let it run hither!
 Here sits no son’s wife nor daughter
 who to Guthrun might give presents.

2 *Sig-vǫrðr* | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); *Sig-urð R*

ALL | After recounting her cruel fates, Guthrun addresses Siward, who is long dead. The tone is at last one of release. With the departure of her doomed sons Guthrun has nothing to live for upon the earth; her family line is ended, as Byrnild predicted (*Sigs* 63–64) and she now knows that at last her hard life must soon be over. She will at last find happiness again, but only in death, reunited with her true love and first husband, Siward.— An interesting question not dealt with in the poetry is the fact that Byrnild has already joined Siward by suttee immediately after his death (*Sigs* 65–71, *Hehr*). Do the two rival women encounter each other in the afterlife as co-wives, or does one oust the other?

1 [...] | A half-line is undoubtedly missing here. It would presumably have mirrored the first half-line, containing *fjǫlð man’k b-* ‘I recall a multitude of ...’ with alliteration on a noun beginning with *b*; cf. the similar structure of *Þrk* 23/3.

- 19 Minns-tu, *Sig-vǫrðr*, · hvat vit męltum
 2 þá’s vit á bęð · bęði sǫtum?
 at þú myndir mın · móðugr vitja,
 4 halr, ór hęlju, · en ek þın ór hęimi.

Dost thou remember, Siward, what we said
 when on the bed we both did sit,
 that thou, fierce man, wouldst visit me
 out of Hell—and I thee out of the world?

1 *Sig-vǫrðr* | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); *Sig-urð R*

- 20 Hlaðið ér, jarlar, · ęki-kǫst’inn,
 2 látið þann und himni · hęstan verða!
 Megi bręnna brjóst · bǫlva-fullt ęldr
 4 [...] umb hjarta · þiðni sorgir!“

Load, ye earls, the oaken pile [PYRE]!
 Let it become the highest under heaven!
 May fire burn my bale-filled breast,
 unto the heart ... may the sorrows melt away!"

2 himni 'heaven' | *emend.*; hilmi 'prince' R

ALL | Guthrun orders the construction of her own pyre. It is not necessary to think that she is to be burned alive, although that is by no means impossible; she may plan to commit suicide (prob. by a sword) beforehand.

1 *ęiki-kęst'inn* 'the oaken pile' | Acc. sg. of *ęiki-kęstr* 'pile, heap of oakwood', suffixed with the definite *inn*. The clitic definite, a decidedly late, or at the very least non-poetic, feature, is metrically required.

2 *himni* 'heaven' | Although *und hilmi* could be read as 'around the prince', the pyre is certainly Guthrun's. At this point in the narrative Siward is long dead, and the point of the pyre is for Guthrun to join him in the afterlife. Since no prince is being burned this requires emendation, and *bimni* 'heaven' (dat. sg.) easily presents itself. It is a common poetic motif for something to be 'the best under heaven'; cf. *Grip* 10/4, *Yi* 27, *Sö* 136 (under Misc. Runic Poetry), etc.

3 *brjóst þolva-fullt* 'my bale-filled breast' | The possessive pronoun is implicit. With these words Guthrun reflects on the many evils she has been responsible for (cf. *Akv* 47).

21 *Jǫrlum ęllum · óđal batni,*
 snótum ęllum · sorg at minni
 at þetta treg-róf · of talit věri.

For all earls may patrimony improve;
 for all ladies may sorrow decrease
 after this grief-chain has been retold!

ALL | The last st. steps out of the world of the poem and should be read in the voice of the narrating ballad-poet, who indirectly addresses the members of the audience and wishes them better fortunes than the character in the poem. The aristocratic titles afforded to the audience are notable.

Speeches of Hamthew

(*Ham·ðis mōl*)

Dating (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.885)

Meter: Speeches-meter, Ancient-words-law, Leeds-meter (29)

Introduction

The **Speeches of Hamthew** (abbrev. *Hamð*) is the final poem in **R**, and chronologically the last poem in the Walsing-cycle alongside *Ghv*.

Textual preservation and transmission

Hamð is only attested in **R**, where it is the final poem, found on foll. 44v/27–45v/23. The prose at the end is followed by the text *explicit liber iste* in cipher form, indicating that no later part of the manuscript is missing.

Story and parallels

Like *Ghv*, *Hamð* begins with Guthrun's exhortation. She exhorts her sons to avenge their sister Swanhild, killed by the tyrannical King Ermenric. These parts of the respective poems are closely related, and numerous lines are shared between them (see Introduction to *Ghv* for an overview). Although both poems deal with the same events, they differ in their perspective. Whereas *Ghv* stays behind with Guthrun after the departure of her sons and sees her build her own funeral pyre in preparation for her long-delayed suttee, *Hamð* instead follows the boys as they set out to take revenge. The historical background of these events is dealt with in the Introduction to *Ghv* above.

In other Norse sources the slaying of Ermenric is also told in *Rdr*, *Vǫls* 42 (which is clearly based on *Hamð* as seen by its citation of a variant of st. 28), and *Skm* 50. It may be noted that on the point of Ermenric's death the already highly archaic *Rdr* is still further removed from historical fact than *Hamð*, since *Rdr* 4/3–4 seems to describe Ermenric as drowning in a well, whereas *Hamð* 24–31, in accordance with Jordanes (see Introduction to *Ghv*), sees the brothers killed after maiming, not killing, the king.

Meter and stanza

Together with *Vkv* and *Akv*, *Hamð* is composed in an unusually loose form of Ancient-words-law. Suzuki (2014, pp. 525–539) considers the meter of this poem as intermediary between *Akv* and regular Ancient-words-law.

Text

Hamðis mól ('The Speeches of Hamthew')

- 1 Spruttu á **tái** · **t**regnar iðir
 2 **gróti** alfa · in **glý**-stomu;
 ár of **morgin** · **manna** þolva
 4 **sútir** hverjar · **sorg** of kveykva.

In the courtyard sprung up tragic deeds,
 the gleeless causes for the weeping of elves.
 In early morning each kind of pain
 of the bales of men awakens sorrow.

1 Spruttu | *The S is an ornamented initial 2 lines high in R.*

2 gróti alfa 'causes for the weeping of elves' | The killings are thought to be the cause of the weeping of good spirits (in this case elves, most likely understood as familiar protective spirits), but the rejoicing of ill spirits. For this notion see *Akv* 18/4 n.; cf. sts. 15/2, 28/3 below.

- 2 Vas=a þat **nú** · **né** i gér,
 2 þat hefir **langt** · **liðit** síðan;
 es **fátt** fornara · **fræmr** vas þat hǫlfu
 4 es hvatti **Guð-rún** · **Gjúka** borin
sonu **sína** unga · at hefna **Svan**-hildar.

That was not now nor yesterday;
 it has passed a long time since.
 Little is older, [yet] it was twice as long ago
 when Guthrun, born of Yivick, goaded
 her young sons to avenge Swanhild.

4 es hvatti Guð-rún 'when Guthrun ... goaded' | As also told in *Ghv*.

- 3 „Systir vas ykkur · **Svan**-hildr of hęitin
 2 sú's **Jormun**-rekr · **jóm** of traddi,
hvítum ok svörtum · á her-vegi
 4 **gróum**, **gang**-tómum · **Gotna** hrossum.

“The sister of you two was named Swanhild,
 she whom Ermenric had trampled by steeds,
 by the white and black on the path of war,
 by the grey, pacing, Gotnish horses!

2–4 sú's ... hrossum, 'she whom ... horses!' | Repeated almost identically in *Ghv* 2/3–6.

- 4 Eptir 's ykkir þrungit · þjóð-konunga,
2 lifið einir ér þátta · étta minnar.

Ye two have been pushed back by great kings;
of the strands of my lineage ye alone live.

1 þjóð-konunga 'great kings' | An old poetic word; for etymology + distribution see *Grip* 1/2 n.

- 5 Einn-stóð em'k orðin · sem osp i holti,
2 fallin at frændum · sem fura at kvisti,
vaðin at vilja · sem viðr at laufi,
4 þá's in kvist-skóða · komr umb dag varman."

I am become as supportless as the asp in the grove,
as bereaved of kinsmen as the pine of its branch,
as deprived of willpower as the tree of its leaf
when the branch-scather comes on a warm day."

- 6 Hitt kvað þá Hamðir · inn hugum stóri:
2 „Litt myndir þú þá, Guðrún, · leyfa dōð Hognar
es þeir Sigvǫrð · svefni ór vǫkðu;
4 satst þú á bæð · en banar hlógu.

This then quoth Hamthrew the great of heart:
"Thou hadst little cause, Guthrun, to praise Hawn's deeds
when they woke Siward from his sleep;
thou layst in the bed, but his killers laughed.

3 Sigvǫrð | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sigvǫrð R

1–3 | These lines correspond directly to *Gbv* 4/1–3, with minor variants.

- 7 Bókr vǫru þinar · inar blá-hvítu
2 ofnar vǫlundum, · flutu i vers dreyra;
svalt þá Sigvǫrð, · satst yfir dauðum,
4 glýja né gáðir; · Gunnarr þér svá vildi.

Thy blue-white bed-clothes were
woven by artisans; they swam in thy husband's gore.
Then died Siward; thou satst o'er him, dead;
hadst no sake for glee. Guthur willed thee so.

3 Sigvǫrð | *metr. emend.* (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141); Sigvǫrð R

1–2 | L. 1 corresponds directly to *Gbv* 4/4, l. 2b roughly to *Gbv* 4/5a.

- 8 Atla þótti=sk þú stríða · at Erps morði
 2 ok at Eitils aldr-lagi, · þat vas þér enn verra!
 Svá skyldi hverr qðrum · verja til aldr-laga
 4 sverði sár-beitu · at sér né stríddi=t.“

Thou wouldst injure Attle through the murder of Earp
 and the laying down of Oatle's life; that was yet worse for thee!
 In such wise should each man cause the laying down of another's life
 with a sorely biting sword, that it does not injure himself!”

ALL | Hamthew alludes to Guthrun's murder of her children with Attle, as dealt with in *Akv* 37–42 and *Am* 73–81. Cf. *Ghv* 12.

1 Erps 'Earp' | Not to be confused with Enacker's son of the same name.

4 sverði sár-beitu 'a sorely biting sword' | Cf. *Akv* 23/3.

4 at sér né stríddi=t 'that it does not injure himself' | One should not injure another in such a way that it also hurts oneself, which Guthrun's killing of her own sons undoubtedly did.

- 9 Hitt kvað þá Sqrli, · svinna hafði hann hyggu:
 2 „Vil'k=at við móður · mólum skipta;
 orðs þikkir enn vant · ykkru hvöru;
 4 hverr biðr nú, Guð-rún, · es at gráti né fór=at?

This then quoth Sarle; he had a wise mind:
 “With my mother I do not wish to bandy words;
 [no] more word seems wanting from either of you.
 What dost thou now ask for, Guthrun, when thou takest not to weeping?

ALL | Sarle upbraids his brother Hamthew for insulting his mother. Both Guthrun and Hamthew have said what there is to be said; now it is time for the brothers to depart and fulfill their orlay, and for his mother to weep at last.

3 ykkru hvöru 'from either of you' | Neuter dat. sg. of *ykkarr hvaðarr* 'of either of you', presumably in the neuter since the addressed (Guthrun and Hamthew) are of mixed gender. It must be understood to be in the negative since the sense is certainly that “you two have spoken enough”, though an expected nominal negative *-gi* 'not, no' or verbal negative *-at* is missing.

- 10 Bróðr grát þú þína · ok buri svása,
 2 niðja ná-borna · leidda nér rógi;
 okkr skalt ok, Guð-rún, · gráta báða
 4 es hér sitjum feigir á mörum, · fjarri munum dýja.“

Weep for thy brothers and beloved sons,
 for thy close-born kinsmen led into strife.
 For us both shalt thou also, Guthrun, weep,
 who here sit fey upon our steeds; far away will we die!”

- 11 Gengu ór garði · gǫrvir at eiskra;
 2 liðu þá yfir ungir · úrig fjöll
 mǫrum hún-lęndskum, · morðs at hefna.

They went out of the settlement ready to wage fury.
 Then the young ones passed over drizzling mountains
 on Hunlandish horses to avenge the murder.

- 12 Þá kvað þat Erpr · einu sinni,
 2 męrr of lék · á mars baki:
 „Illt 's blauðum hal · brautir kęnna;“
 4 kóðu harðan mjök · hornung vesa.

Then that quoth Earp a single time;
 renowned, he balanced on the back of a steed:
 “It is bad to teach a soft man the roads.”—
 They said the corner-boy was a very hard man.

ALL. | In sts. 12–15 Hamthw and Sarle encounter their half-brother Earp on the road. The order of the dialogue-sts. 12–14 is difficult and likely corrupt. The paraphrase in *Vþls* 42 gives little help: *Ok er þeir vǫru komnir á leið, finna þeir Erp, bróður sinn, ok spyrja, hvat bann mundi veita þeim. Hann svarar: „S-líkt sem bǫnd bendi eða fótr fęti.“ Þeim þótti þat ekki vera ok drápu hann.* ‘And when they had come upon their way they find Earp, their brother, and ask how he will be of aid to them. He answers: “Like a hand to a hand or a foot to a foot.” They thought that was not so, and slew him.’

4 hornung ‘corner-boy’ | I.e., one who must sit in the corner out of shame or neglect. A word used for a boy born to a mother of lower status than the father as the result of an extra-marital relationship (Fr, s.v. *hornungr*), in this case used disparagingly by Sarle and Hamthw, who consider their mother, Guthrun, superior to Earp’s.

- 13 Fundu á stręti · stór-brǫgð-óttan:
 2 „Hvé mun jarp-skammr · okkr full-tingja?“

They found on the street the very cunning man:
 “How should this brown shorty assist us?”

1 stręti ‘street’ | A Roman loanword used specifically for a paved road or street in a town. It probably emphasises the southern geography in which the events transpire.

- 14 Svaraði inn sundr-móðri, · svá kvaðsk veita myndu
 2 full-ting fręndum · sem fótr ǫðrum.
 „Hvat megi fótr · fōti veita
 4 né hold-gróin · hǫnd annarri?“

He of sundry mother answered, said that he would offer
 his kinsmen assistance like a foot to another.—

“What can a foot offer a foot,
or a trunk-grown hand another?”

- 15 Drógu ór **skíði** · **skíði**-éarn,
2 **mékis** eggjar · at **mun** flagði;
Þverðu þrótt sinn · at **þriðjungi**,
4 létu **mög** ungan · til **moldar** hniga.

They drew from their sheaths their sheath-irons [SWORDS],
the edges of the blade at the behest of the ogress.
They used their strength on the third one;
they let the young lad sink down to the earth.

2 at mun flagði ‘at the behest of the ogress’ | They were acting according to the will of a cruel norn (*flagð*); cf. st. 1/2 n. above, 28/3 below.

- 16 **Skóku** loða, · **skalmir** fęstu,
2 ok **goð**-bornir · smugu i **goð**-vęfi.

They shook their wool-coats, fastened their knives,
and the god-born ones got into their clothes of god-weave.

2 goð-vęfi ‘clothes of god-weave’ | Their silk; they were beautifully dressed.

- 17 **Framm** lögu brautir, · **fundu** vó-stigu
2 ok systur **son** · **sáran** á meíði,
varg-tré vind-köld · **vestan** bójar;
4 **trýtti** é **trönu** hvöt, · **títt** vas=at **bíð***a.

Forwards lay their roads; they found paths of woe
and their sister’s son [= Randwigh] maimed on a branch
on a wind-cold hanging tree to the west of the town;
the crane’s incitement [CORPSE] kept dangling; it was not good to tarry.

- 18 **Glaumr** vas i **høllu**, · **halir** ǫl-ręfir,
2 ok til **gota** ękki · **gørðu**-t hęyra
áðr halr hug-fullr · i **horn** of þaut.

There was a revel in the hall, the men ale-rowdy,
and of the sound of the horses they heard naught,
before a man full of heart blew in his horn.

- 19 **Sęja** fóru **ęrir** · **Jǫrmun**-rekki

- 2 at sénir vǫru · seggir und hjǫlmum:
 „Róðið ér umb rǫð! · Ríkir eru komnir,
 4 fyr mǫttkum hafið ér mǫnnum · meý of tradda.“

Messengers went to tell Ermenric
 that the youths had been seen beneath their helmets:
 “Make your decision! Strong ones have come.
 To the wrath of mighty men have ye trampled that maiden!”

1 *érir* | *om.* R

- 20 Hló þá Jǫrmun·rekkr, · hendi drap á kampa,
 2 beiddi=sk at brǫngu, · bǫðvaði=sk at vini;
 skók hann skǫr jarpa, · sá á skjöld hvítan,
 4 lét hann sér i hendi · hvarfa kęr gollit.

Then Ermenric laughed, put his hand to his beard,
 made ready for battle, became ferocious in his wine.
 He shook his brown locks, looked on his white shield;
 he let spin in his hand a golden cup.

2 beiddi=sk at brǫngu ‘made ready for battle’ | Uncertain translation; *branga* ‘battle(?)’ is a hapax.

- 21 „Séll ek þá þótt=umk · ef séa knétta
 2 Ham·ði ok Sǫrla · i hǫllu minni;
 buri mynda’k þá binda · með boga stręngjum,
 4 góð börn Gjúka · fęsta á galga.“

“I would have thought me blessed if I got to see
 Hamthrew and Sarle in my own hall;
 those boys I would then bind with bow-strings,
 the good children of Yivick, and fasten them on the gallows!”

4 góð börn Gjúka ‘the good children of Yivick’ | Yivick was Guthrun’s father and the boys’ grand-father. The poet is not presenting an alternative genealogy; cf. 2/4 above, 25/4 below.

- 22 Hitt kvað þá Hróðr·glǫð, · stóð of hleðum,
 2 mę-fingr męlti · við mǫg þenna:
 „Því’t þat hęita · at hlýði=gi myni;
 4 mega tvęir menn ęinir · tíu hundruð Gotna
 binda eða berja · i borg inni hǫu?”

This then quoth Rothglad, she stood by the doors,
 slender-fingered she spoke to this lad:
 “Since they swear that no army will;

can two men alone bind or beat
ten hundred Gots in the high stronghold?”

1 Hróðr-glōð ‘Rothglad’ | An unknown woman, perhaps implied to be Attle’s mother by the word *mōgr* ‘lad’, which can also mean ‘son’.

5 borg inni høu ‘the high stronghold’ | Formulaic, also found in *Akv* 15/2b; see there for further parallels.

- 23 **S**tyrr varð i ranni, · **s**tukku ǫl-skálir,
2 i blóði **b**ragnar lǫgu, · komit ór **br**jósti Gotna.

There was uproar in the hall; the ale-bowls shattered;
champions lay in blood flown from the breasts of the Gots.

1 Styrr varð i ranni ‘There was uproar in the house’ | Strongly reminiscent of *Rdr* 3/5: *Rósta varð i ranni* ‘There was tumult in the hall’, *Beow* 1302a: *Hréam wearð ǥn Heorote* ‘There was an outcry in the Hart’, both in the context of hall-fights, the former describing the same events as *Hamð*.

- 24 **H**itt kvað þa **H**am-ðir · inn **h**ugum stóri:
2 „**Ö**stir **J**ǫrmun-rekkr · **o**kkarrar kvǫmu
 bróðra sam-móðra · innan **b**orgar þinnar;
4 fótr **sér** þú þína · høndum **sér** þú þínum
 Jǫrmun-rekkr **or**pit · i **ē**ld hęitan!“

This then quoth Hamthrew the great of heart:
“Thou, Ermenric, didst incite our coming,
we brothers of the same mother, into thy stronghold!
Thou seest thy feet; thou seest them with thy hands,
O Ermenric, thrown in the hot fire!”

4–5 fótr ... hęitan! ‘Thou seest ... fire!’ | The detail of Ermenric’s severed hands and feet is also found in *Rdr* 4.

- 25 Þa **r**aut við · inn **r**ęgin-kunngi
2 **B**aldr i brynju · sem **b**jǫrn hryti:
 „**G**rýtið ér a **g**umna · alls **g**ęirar né bíta,
4 **ę**ggjar né **ę**orn, · **J**ón-akrs sonu!“

Then roared back the Rein-descended
Balder in his byrnie [WARRIOR > = Ermenric] like a roaring bear:
“Stone ye the men! For spears do not bite
—nor edges nor irons—on Enacker’s sons!”

1 **r**aut | *metr. emend.*; hraut **R**

1 regin-kunngi 'Rein-descended' | Descended from the Reins, i.e., the Gods. The godly ancestry of the Gotnish Amals, the house to which Ermenric belonged, is described in Jordanes *Getica* 78, 79 (excerpt): *Magnaque potiti per loca victoria iam proceres suos, quorum quasi fortuna vincebant, non puros homines, sed semideos id est Ansis vocaverunt. Quorum genealogia ut paucis percurram vel quis quo parente genitus est aut unde origo coepta, ubi finem effecit, [...] 79 Horum ergo heroum, ut ipsi suis in fabulis referunt, primus fuit Gapt, qui genuit Hulmul. Hulmul vero genuit Augis, et Augis genuit etc. etc.* 'They thereafter called their leaders, by whose good fortune they seemed to have conquered, not mere men, but demigods, that is Ansis. Their genealogy I shall run through briefly, telling the lineage of each and the beginning and the end of this line. [...] Now the first of these heroes, as they themselves relate in their legends, was Gapt, who begat Hulmul. And Hulmul begat Augis; and Augis begat' et c. et c. Jordanes' *Ansis* is a cognate to ON *ēsir* 'the Eese', i.e., the Gods, which are called demigods in a clear instance of Christian euhemerism. The first of the *Ansis* is *Gapt*, i.e., Geat, whose name directly corresponds to OE *Géat*, the progenitor of several Anglo-Saxon royal lineages, and ON *Gautr*, a poetic synonym for the god Weden (*Grm* 56/4, *Bdr* 2/1).

26 **Hitt** kvað þá **Ham**-ðir · inn hugum stóri:

2 „Bḡl vannt, bróðir, · es þann bēlg lēystir;
opt ór þeim bēlg · bḡll rōð koma.“

This then quoth Hamthew the great of heart:

“Thou accomplishedst a bale, brother, when thou loosened that bag;
oft from that bag come bold counsels!”

2 es þann bēlg lēystir 'when thou loosened that bag' | Unclear, but perhaps referring to their slaying of Earp.

27 „Hug hēfðir, **Ham**-ðir, · ef hēfðir hyggjandi,

2 mikils es á mann hvern vant · es man-vits es.“

“Thou wouldst have had heart, Hamthew, if thou hadst had understanding;
much is any man wanting when he lacks manwit!”

28 „Af véri nú hōfuð · ef **Erpr** lifði,

2 bróðir okkarr inn bōð-frókni, · es vit á braut vōgum,

verr hinn víð-frókni, · hvōtt=umk at dísir,

4 gumi hinn gunn-hēlgi, · gōrðum=sk at vígi.“

“Off were now the head if Earp had lived,
our battle-brave brother whom we slew on the road,
the widely brave warrior—the Dises incited me—
the war-holy man—we made ready for the slaying.”

1–2 Af ... vōgum | Also in N. 1 hōfuð | hōfuð'it N

1–2 Af ... vōgum | These lines are quoted in *Vǫls* 42, preceded by the text: *Þá mēlti Ham-ðir: „Af mundi nú hōfuð'it, ef Erpr lifði, bróðir okkarr, er vit vōgum á leið'inni, ok sām vit þat of síð,” sem kveðit er.* 'Then Hamthew spoke: "The head would now have been off if Earp had lived, our brother whom we slew on the road, and we worried about that for some time", as it is sung.'

3 hvøtt-umk at ðísir ‘the Dises incited me’ | The evil fates, cf. sts. 1/2, 15/2 above, *Akv* 18/4 n. —
The alliteration is highly unusual and requires the cluster *hv* to behave like *v*.

- 29 „**E**kki hygg okkr vesa · ulfa dómi,
2 at vit mynim sjalfir of saka=sk
sem grey norna · þau’s gróðug eru
4 i auðn of alin.“

“I do not think wolves an example for us,
that we should fight amidst ourselves
like the greedy bitches of the Norns
who are begotten in the wilderness.”

- 30 „Vel höfum vit vegit, · stöndum á val Gotna
2 ofan egg-móðum · sem ernir á kvisti;
góðs höfum tírar fengit · þó’tt skylim nú eða i gér deýja,
4 kvæld lifir maðr ekki · eptir kvið norna.“

“Well have we two fought; we stand on the slain of the Gots—
over edge-wearied men like eagles on a branch.
Great glory have we won though we should die now or tomorrow—
man lives not one evening after the verdict of the Norns!”

4 kvið norna ‘verdict of the Norns’ | The fated hour of one’s death, equivalent to the *dómr norna* ‘judgment of the Norns’ in *Fáfn* 11/1.

- 31 Þar fell Sörli · at salar gaffi,
2 en Ham-ðir hné · at hús-baki.

There fell Sarle by the hall’s gables,
but Hamthrew sank down by the back of the house.

P1 Þetta eru kǫlluð Ham-ðis mól in fornu.

These are called the Ancient Speeches of Hamthrew.

1 fornu | *add.* ðexpløcøt lðbðr ðlðð (*cipher for *explicit liber iste*) ‘Here this book ends’ R

West Germanic Heroic Poetry

Bewolf

(*Beo·wulf*)

Dating: early C8th (TODO)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

NOTE: The Old English edition is largely the work of Yuanlong Zhao, as available at <https://github.com/FolgeriLeninaes/beowulf>. The OE edition and associated commentary is released under CC BY 4.0, a looser license than the CC BY-NC 4.0 license under which the rest of the project is released.

The present file is for now heavily incomplete. Only non-commented lines (i.e., those which actually appear in the .pdf) have been edited. The commented lines are placeholders based on James A. Harrison and Robert Sharp, eds. (1883) with minor corrections.

The orthography is normalized to an archaic Anglian dialect. Its goal is to present the poem as closely as possible to how it would most likely have sounded at the time of composition; this includes removing svarabhakti vowels where metrically required, marking long unstressed vowels (as evinced by Kaluza's law), and restoring hiatus forms.

The long diphthongs descending from PWGmc. **au*, **eu*, **iu* are written *ea*, *eo* and *io* respectively; diphthongs arising from colouring or breaking of a vowel *V* are written *V^o*.

Textual preservation and transmission

Beow is only found in the Nowell codex (Cotton MS Vitellius A XV, foll. 94r–209v; henceforth N), a miscellaneous collection of fantastical texts written in two hands (A: 94r–175v/3 and B: 175v/4–209v). The text of *Beow* is found on foll. 132r–201v. In the poem itself, A writes as far as the word *scýran* in 1939b, and the rest of the poem is written by B.

Text

- Pr Hwæt, wé Gār-Denā · in jær-dagum
 2 þeod-cyningá · þrymm gi·frugnun,
 hú þā æðilingas · ęllæn fręmidun.
 4 Oft Sceld Scébing · scaðaná þreatum,
 mōngum mægðum · medu-setlá æb·teah.
 6 Eǵisodá Iʀlí, · sið-ðan ærist wærð
 fea-scaeft fundæn: · hé þæs fróbrá gi·bād,
 8 wóx undær wolcnum, · weʀð-myndum þāh,
 oð þæt him óg-hwēlc þér · ymb-sittędrá
 10 obær hrōn-râdæ · hēran scoldæ,
 gōmban gēldan: · þæt wæs gód cyning!
 12 Þæm aburá wæs · æftær cęnnid
 jung in gardum, · þoná God sęndæ
 14 folcá tó fróbrá; · firin-þarbá ǵn·gæt,
 þæt hiá ær drugun · aldur-léasæ
 16 langá hwilæ. · Him þæs lib-fréjá,
 wuldræs waldænd, · weræld-áræ fær·gæb;
 18 Biowi* wæs brómi · (blæd widæ sprang),
 Sceldæs aburá · Scędi-landum in.
 20 Swá scæl jung gumá, · gódá gi·wyrčan,
 frōmum feo·giftum · ǵn fadur bærmá,
 22 þæt hiná ǵn ældæ · ęft gi·wyngæn
 will-gi-siðas, · þōnná wīg cumæ,
 24 liodí gi·læstæn: · lob-dædum scæl
 in mægðá gi·hwæm · mann gi·þīhan.

How, we have learnt of the glory of the great kings
 of the spear-Danes in days of yore,
 how those athlings accomplished zeal.
 Oft Shield Sheaving from the hosts of foemen,
 from many tribes stole away the mead-benches,
 frightened the Erls after he first had been
 found destitute; he knew refuge from that,
 grew under the clouds, throve in honours
 till to him every surrounding folk
 o'er the dolphin's ride [SEA] had to submit,
 yield tribute—that was a good king.
 TODO: Translation.

2 gi·frugnun | 'gefrunon' N 5 mōngum | mōnægum with restored syncopation N 6 Eǵisodá |
 Eǵsodá with restored medial vowel N 6 Iʀlí 'the Erls' | metr. and sens. emend.; cʀl N 8 wóx |

weox with transfer to strong class 7 reversed N 9 *ôg*-hwēlc | Anglian form of *æg*-hwēlc, cf. early Anglian 'oeghuucl' N 9 *þær* | metr. emend.; *þara* N 16 *lib*-fréja | metr. emend.; lib-fréa N 18 Biowi* 'Bewer' | Biowulf N 22 *gi*-wynġæn | *gi*-wunigæn with inherited class III paradigm, cf. northern Mercian 'wynigaþ' N 25 *gi*-hwām | 'gehwære' N 25 *gi*-þīban | metr. emend.; *gi*-þeon with restoration of medial -h- N

6 *Iorlí* 'the Erls' | The ms. form *eorl* 'the earl, nobleman' is metrically deficient and near-universally emended (Robert D. Fulk 1992, p. 205). According to Jordanes (*Getica* 23) the *Heruli* were driven out by the Danes from southern Scandinavia, a legend likely reflected here when the legendary Danish ancestor-king Shield is said to have 'frightened' (i.e., 'expulsed') the **Iorlí*. As old tribal names were forgot, scribes replaced it with the more transparent "earl". For the confusion of proper names in *Beow* cf. ll. 18, 53, 2921 below.

18 Biowi* 'Bewer' | Emendation to (forms of) *Beo* 'Bewer' is adopted by most modern eds. (including R. D. Fulk, Bjork, and Niles) and is supported by the Anglo-Saxon royal genealogies, where Shield is the father of Bewer (R. D. Fulk, Bjork, and Niles 2008, pp. 291–292); cf. l. 53 below. The insertion of Bewulf's name is most likely due to scribal confusion with the name of the poem's protagonist.

- 26 Him þá Sceld gi·wāt · tó gi·scæp-hwílæ
felo-hrór fōran · qn frean wæræ;
28 hiæ hinæ þá æt·bærun · tó brimæs faroðæ.
swæsæ gi·siðas, · swæ hé selbá bæd,
30 þendin wordum wé^old · wini Scildingá.
Leob land-frumá · langæ áhtæ—
32 þær æt hýðæ stód · hringid-steþná,
isæg end út·fús, · æðilingæs fær;
34 á·lægdun þá · leobnæ þeodæn,
beagá bryttan · qn bærm scipæs,
36 mærnæ bi mæstæ. · þær wæs mǣðmá felá,
æb fe^orr-wegum · frætwá gi·lædid:
38 ni hérdæ ic cým·licor · ceol gi·ġerwan
hildi-wǣpnum · end haðu-wædum,
40 billum end brynnum; · him qn bærmæ læg
mǣðma mængu, · þá him mid scoldun
42 qn flódæs æht · fe^orr gi·witan.
Nallæs hiæ hinæ læssan · lácum tiodun,
44 þeod-gi-streonum, · þonnæ þá dydun,
þi hinæ æt frum·scæftæ · forð qn·sendun
46 ænnæ obær ýðæ · umbr-wesendí:
þá gét hiæ him á·sættun · seġn gylðinnæ
48 heah obær heabud, · létun holm beran,
ġæbun qn ġær-seġġ: · him wæs jómær sebá,
50 murnendí mód. · Menn ni cunnun
seġġan tó sōðæ · sēli-rædendí,

52 hēlið undær heþnum, · hwa þæm hlæstæ qn·féng.

TODO: Translation.

34 á·lægdun | á·lēgdun without levelling of umlaut, cf. northern Mercian 'lægdun' N 41 mænġu | mænæġu with restored syncopation N 47 á·sættun | á·sēttun without levelling of umlaut, cf. Northumbrian 'gesætte' N 52 hēlið | hælið with expected umlaut, cf. early Northumbrian 'heliðum' N

1 Þá wæs on burgum · Biowí* Scildingá,
 54 leob liod-cýning, · lōngæ þrāgæ
 folcum ġi·fræġi · (fædær ellær hwærþ,
 56 aldr æþ ærdæ), · ðð þæt him eft qn·wóc
 heah Halb-ðeni; · h^{eo}ld þendin libdæ,
 58 gamæl end ġuð-hreoh, · glædæ Scildingas.
 Þæm feowær bærn · forð-ġi·rimid
 60 in wer-æld wócun, · werudá ræswan,
 Heru-gâr end Hrôð-gâr · end Hālgá til;
 62 hêrdæ ic, þæt Irsé · wæs Qnulan cwón
 Haðu-Scilfingæs · hals-ġi·bēddæ.
 64 Þá wæs Hrôð-gâræ · hēri-spôd ġibæn,
 wīgæs we^orð-mynd, · þæt him his wini-mágas
 66 ġe^ornæ hêrdun, · ðð þæt siu ġuguð ġi·wóx,
 magu-dryht micil. · Him on mód bi·rann,
 68 þæt hall-rcēid · hātan woldæ,
 medu-ærn micil · mēnn ġi·wyrčan,
 70 þonæ ældá bærn · æfiri ġi·frugnun,
 end þær qn innan · all ġi·dælan
 72 jungum end aldum, · swēlc him God saldæ,
 bútan folc-scæræ · end ferhum gumaná.
 74 Þá ic wíðæ ġi·fræġn · we^orc ġi·bannan
 manægræ máġðæ · jond þisnæ middun-gard,
 76 folc-stēdi frætwan. · Him on fristæ ġi·lōmp
 ædræ mid ældum, · þæt hit wærð all garu,
 78 hall-ærná mæst; · scóp him Herut naman,
 sé þi his wordæs ġi·wald · wíðæ hæbdæ.
 80 Hé bi-hât ni á·leag, · beagas dældæ,
 sinc æt simlæ. · Seli hliþodæ
 82 heah end horn-geap: · haðu-wælmá bād,
 lāðan līgæs; · ni wæs hit lēngæ þá jén
 84 þæt sé *ēġġ-ġeti · āðum-sweoran
 æftær wæl-níðæ · wæcnan scoldæ.

86 Þá sé **ell**æn-gâst · **ar**bað-lícæ
 þrâgæ gi·þolodæ, · sé þi in þiostrum bâd,
 88 þæt hé **dó**grá gi·hwæm · **d**ream gi·hêrdæ
 hlúdnæ in hallæ; · þær wæs hærpæn swóg,
 90 switul sang scopæs. · **S**ægdæ sé þi cūðæ
 frum-scæft firhá · **fe**°rran rēccan,
 92 cwæð þæt sé æl-mēhtigá · **e**°rðan worhtæ,
 wliht-berhtnæ wang, · swæ wætær bi·býgið,
 94 gi·sættæ sigi-hrōðig · sunnun end mōnan
 leoman tō leohtæ · land-búendum,
 96 end gi·frætwadæ · foldan sceatas
 limum end leabum; · lib eac gi·scóp
 98 cynná gi·hwelcūm, · þará þi cwicæ hwērbað.
 Swæ þa dryht-guman · dreamum libdun
 100 eadæg-lícæ, · oð þæt án on·gán
 firinæ frēmman, · fiond on hēllæ:
 102 wæs sé grimmá gâst · Grēndil hātæn,
 mæri marc-stapá, · sé þi morhas hē°ld,
 104 fēnn end fæstin; · fifl-cynnæs ærd
 wōn-sælæg wer · wærdodæ hwilæ,
 106 síððan him sceppend · fær·scribæn hæbdæ.
 In Cāinæs cynnæ · þonæ cwalm gi·wræc,
 108 éci dryhtin, · þæs þi hé Åbæl slóg;
 ni gi·fæh hé þæræ fæhðæ, · æc hé hinæ **fe**°rr fær·wræc,
 110 metad fær þi mǣnæ · mann-cynnæ fram.
 Þanan un-týdras · allæ on-wócun,
 112 etunas end ælbí · end orc-nēas,
 swelcæ gígantas, · þa wið godæ wunnun
 114 langæ þrâgæ; · hé him þæs lean fær·gald.

TODO: Translation.

62 *I°rsæ* 'Erse' | *restoration*.; om. N 84 *ēgg̃-ĥeti | *sens. emend.* seǵǵĥeti N 84 *āðum*-sweoran | *sens. emend.* 'aþum swerian' N 94 gi·sættæ | gi·settæ cf. l. 47 N

62 *I°rsæ* 'Erse' | TODO.

2 Gi·wāt þá **ne**osian, · síð-ðan **n**æht bi·cwóm,
 2 heaban hūsæs, · hú hit Hring-Deñi
 æftær beor-þegæ · gi·býin hæbdun.
 4 Fand þá þær innæ · æðilingá gi·dryht

- swefan æftær **s**ymb^lá; · **s**orgá ni cūðun,
 6 w^on-scæft **w**erá. · **W**iht un-hælu
 grim end **g**rædæg · **g**aru sóna wæs,
 8 reoc end **r**óðí, · end on **r**æstá gi·nam
 þritig þegná: · þanan eft gi·wát
 10 hūðá **h**rómig · tó **h**ām faran,
 mið þærá **w**æl-fyllu · **w**ícá neosan.
 12 Þá wæs on **u**htan · mið **á**r-dægá
Greñdlæs **g**ūð-cræft · **g**umum un-derní:
 14 þá wæs æfter **w**istá · **w**óp up á-hæbæn,
mičil **m**orgæn-swóg. · **M**ári þeodæn,
 16 æðiling **á**r-gód, · **u**n-bliðí sæt,
þolodá **þ**rýð-swíð, · **þ**egn-sorgá dreag,
 18 síð-ðan hiæ þæs láðan · **l**ást sceawodun,
weḡgan gāstæs; · wæs þæt gi·**w**inn tó strang,
 20 láð end **l**ongsum. · Næs hit **l**engrá frist,
 æc ymb **á**ná næht · **e**ft gi·frēmidá
 22 **m**orð-balá **m**ârá · end nā **m**ærn forá
fæhðá end **f**iriná; · wæs tó **f**æst on þæm.
 24 Þá wæs **e**að-fyndí, · þi him **e**llæs hwær
 gi·**r**úm-licor · **r**æstá sóhtá,
 26 **b**ædd æftær **b**úrum, · þá him gi·**b**eadnad wæs,
 gi·**s**ægd sōð-licá · **s**witulan tācná
 28 **h**all-þegnæs **h**eti; · **h**é^old hiná síð-ðan
fi^orr end **f**æstor, · sé þæm **f**iend æt·wand.
 30 Swá **r**icsodá · end wið **r**ihtá wann
áná wið **a**llum, · ðð þæt **i**dæl stóð
 32 **h**úsá sōlist. · Wæs sio **h**wíl mičil:
twelf-wintrá **t**íd · **t**orn gi·þolodá
 34 **w**ini Scildingá, · **w**áwaná gi·hwelcnaé,
sídrá **s**orgá; · fær þan gi·**s**ioní wærð
 36 **æ**ldá bænum · **u**n-derní cūð,
gēddum jómrá, · þætti **G**reñdil wann,
 38 **h**wilá wið **H**róð-gâr; · **h**eti-níðas wæg,
firiná end **f**æhðá · **f**elá missærá,
 40 **s**in-gálá **s**æcá, · **s**ibbá ni waldá
 wið **m**anná hwoná · **m**ægnæs Dēniḡa
 42 **f**erh-balu **f**e^orran, · **f**e þingian,
 ní þær nænig **w**itaná · **w**ōnan þorftá

- 44 berhtræ bótá · tó banan folmum;
 æc sé æġ-lâcá · óhtendi wæs,
 46 deorc deað-scúa · duguðá end juguðá
 semodá end sēridá. · Sin-nehti hē'ld
 48 mistġá mórás; · meñn ni cunnun,
 hwædr heġl-rúnan · hwērfum scriðað.
 50 Swá fela firiná · fiond mann-cynnæs,
 atul ân-ġengá, · oft ġi-frēmidá
 52 hædrá hēnðá; · Herut ærdodá,
 sinc-fāġá sæl · swærtum næhtum
 54 (nâ hé þoná ġeb-stól · grótan móstá,
 mād̃m fær metodá, · ní his myni wissá);
 56 þæt wæs wrác micil · wini Scildingá,
 módæs brecðá. · Mōnæg-oft ġi-sæt
 58 rícá tó rúná; · ræd æhtodun,
 hwæt swið-ferhðum · sōlist wæri
 60 wið fær-gryrum · tó ġi-frēmmaná.
 Hwílum hiá ġi-hétun · æt h*ærg-trabum
 62 wīg-we^orðungá, · wordum bædun,
 þæt him ġâst-þoná · jeocá ġi-frēmidá
 64 wið þeod-þrawum. · Swēlc wæs þea hirá,
 hæðinrá hyht; · heġlā ġi-mundun
 66 in mód-seban, · metad hiá ni cūðun,
 dædá dōmēnd, · ni wissun hiá Dryhtin God,
 68 ní hiá hwaru hebná helm · heġjan ni cūðun,
 wuldræs waldēnd. · Wâ bið þæm þi scæl
 70 þurh slíðná nið · sâwlá bi-scūban
 in fýræs fæðm, · fróbrá ni wōnan,
 72 wihtá ġi-wēndan; · wel bið þæm þi mót
 æftær deað-dæġá · dryhtin sócan
 74 end tó fadur fæðmum · friðu wilnian.

TODO: Translation.

2 heaban | hean with intervocalic -h- restored N 34 Scildingá | sens. emend.; 'scylðenda' N 34
 wāwaná | weaná with reversal of compression N 35 ġi-sioní | restoration.; om. N 44 banan | 'banū'
 N 45 æc sé | restoration.; om. N 61 h*ærg-trabum | 'brærg trafum' N 64 þeod-þrawum |
 þreaum (without assimilation of awu > ea, cf. early Anglian 'thrauuu') N 68 hwaru | huru (without
 assimilation of -wa- > -u-) N

Fight at Finnsbury

Dating: TODO

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

Along with *Wald* and *Beow*, the **Fight at Finnsbury** (*Finn*) is one of three Anglo-Saxon narrative epics dealing with heroic legend.

Textual preservation and transmission

Finn only survives in the printed edition of Hickes (1703–1705, vol. 1, pp. 192–3), based on the original manuscript which was most likely destroyed in the Cottonian fire of 1731.

Hickes introduces the poem with the following words (original emphasis kept):

Eodem metro conditum forte reperi fragmenti poetici singulare folium, in codice MS. homiliarum Semi-Saxonicarum qui extat in Bibliotheca Lambethana. Fragmentum autem subsequitur.

‘By chance, I found a single leaf of a poetic fragment composed in the same meter, in a manuscript codex of Semi-Saxon homilies that is housed in the Lambeth Library. The fragment itself follows.’

Hickes’ edition seems generally reliable, and the singular folio appears to have been in good shape. The majority of his errors are transparent spacing errors, e.g. writing two words as one (3 ‘*berdraca*’ for **ber draca*) or splitting one word in two (9 ‘*þis ne*’ for **þisne*, 11 ‘*Hie geap*’ for **Hicgeap*). Others are plain copying errors, e.g. reading **a* as *u* in l. 3 ‘*eastun*’ (for **eastan*) or **þ* as the very similar *ƿ* in l. 2 ‘*bearo*’ (for **beapo*).

Contents

TODO. A similar episode appears in *Beow*.

Prior to the fragment's commencing the poem would have seen Naf and his warriors encamped and asleep in the Finnsbury hall late at night. One of the men, perhaps a lookout, sees the blinking of swords and chainmail from the east and loudly asks what it may be; is it the dawn, or a dragon, or (and here the fragment picks up) are the gables of the hall burning (l. 1)? King Naf responds in parallel: it is not the dawn, nor a dragon, nor do the gables burn—rather it is a hostile army (ll. 2–9). Naf makes a speech to rouse his warriors (ll. 10–12).

TODO

Text

„[...] *hornas byrnað náfre*.“

“[...] gables never burn.”

1 *hornas* | reconstructed based on l. 4; “nas’ *Hickes*

- 2 *Hleoðrode þá · heaðo-geong cyning:*
 „Né þis ne *dagað éastan*, · né hér *draca* ne *fléogeð*,
 4 né hér þisse *healle* · *hornas* ne *byrnað*,
 ac hér *forð berað* · *fugelas singað*,
 6 *gylleð græg-hama*, · *güð-wudu hlynneð*,
scyld scēfte on-cwyð. · Nú *scīneð* þes mōna
 8 *waðol under wolcnum*; · nú á-rísað *wéa-dæda*,
 þe þisne *fōlces nīð* · *frēmman willað*.
 10 Ac on-*wacnigeað* nú, · *wīgend mīne*,
hēbbað éowre banda, · *hicgeað* on *ellen*,
 12 *winnað* on *orde*, · *wesað* on *móde*!“

Then bellowed out the battle-young king:

“This is no dawning from the east, nor does a dragon fly hither,
 nor here on this hall do the gables burn—

but here they bear forth arms, the birds sing,
 the grey-pelt [WOLF] howls, the war-wood [SHIELD] dins,
 the shield clashes against the spear. Now shines the moon,
 wandering behind the clouds; now arise the woeful deeds
 which wish to fulfill the evil of this host.

Yet awaken now, ye my warriors!

Raise your hands, put your minds to zeal,
 win by the spear-point, be in brave spirits!”

2 *heaðo-geong* | ‘hearo geong’ (for “*heaþo geong*”) *Hickes* 3 *éastan* | ‘Eastun’ *Hickes* 3 *hér*
draca | ‘herdraca’ *Hickes* 5 *forð berað* | ‘forþberað’ *Hickes* 7 *scīneð* | *scýneð* *Hickes* 9 *þisne* |
 ‘ðis ne’ *Hickes* 11 *banda* | *landa* *Hickes* 11 *hicgeað* | ‘Hie geaþ’ *Hickes* 12 *winnað* | ‘Windað’
Hickes

10–12 Ac ... móde! ‘Yet ... spirits!’ | It has often been noted that Naf’s rousing of the sleeping warriors bears a strong resemblance to Beader’s speech in *Bjarkamál in fornu* l. 11. 3–4 (Anon *Bjark* in SkP 3): *Vaki é ok vaki, · vīna bauðuð, // allir inir óðstu · Aðils of sinnar*. ‘Wake now and wake, ye chief of friends; all the noblest companions of Edyls!’

- 14 Þá á-râs mōnig *gold-hladen þegn*, · *gyrde hine his swurde*;
 þá tó *dura éodon* · *driht-lice cēmpān*,
Sige-ferð and *Ēaha*, · *hyra sweord ge-tugon*,

- 16 and æt ððrum durum · Ord-láf and Gûð-láf,
and Hengest sylf; · hwearf him on lâste.

Then arose many a gold-ladenthane, girded on his sword.
Then to the door went the lordly champions
Syeferth and Eah—they drew their swords—
and at the other door Ordlaaf and Guthlaaf
and Hengest himself; he followed in their tracks.

13 gyrde hine his swurde ‘girded on his sword’ | Cf. *Hild* 5b.

- 18 Þá gít Gâr·ulf · Gûð·ere styrode,
þæt hie swá fréo=lic feorh · forman siðe
20 tó þære healle durum · hysta ne báron,
nú hyt niða heard · á·nyman wolde:
22 ac hé frægn ofer eal · un·dearninga,
deor-mód hæleð, · hwa þá duru héolde.

TODO: Translation

19 forman | ‘for man’ *Hickes*

- 24 „Sige-ferð is min nama“, (cwæð hé) „ic eom Secgena léod,
wrecca wide cûð. · Fela ic wéana ge·bâd,
26 heardra hilda; · þe is gýt hér witod,
swæðer þú sylf tó mé · sócean wylle.“

TODO: Translation

- 28 Þá wæs on wealle · wæl-slihta ge·hlyn,
sceolde celæs bord · cónum on handa
30 bân-helm berstan. · Buruh-þelu dynede,
oð þæt æt þære gûðe · Gâr·ulf ge·crang,
32 ealra ærest · eorð-búendra,
Gûð-láfes sunu; · ymbe hine góðra fela
34 hwearf-latra hræw. · Hræfen wandrode
sweart and sealo-brún; · swurd-léoma stód
36 swylce eal Finnes-buruh · fyrenu wære.

TODO: Translation

Until in that battle Garulf perished
earliest of all earth-dwellers [MEN],
the son of Guthlaaf. Around him a great many of good men,
the corpses of those late to flight. A raven wandered,

black and dusky brown. The sword-flash stood
as if all Finnsbury were a burning beacon.

Ne ge·frægn ic nǣfre wurð=licor · æt wera hilde
38 sixtig sige-beorna · söl ge·báran,
ne nǣfre swānas swōtne · medo söl for·gyldan,
40 þonne Hnæfe guldor · his hæg-stealdas.
Hig fuhton fif dagas, · swá hyra nān ne fēol
42 driht-ge-siða, · ac hig þā duru héoldon.

I have not learned that in a worthier manner in the fight of men
ever sixty triumph-warriors better carried themselves
nor ever lads better repaid sweet mead
than Naf was repaid by his young warriors.
They fought for five days while not one fell
among that troop-fellowship, yet they held the doors.

Þá ge·wāt him wund hæleð · on wæg gangan,
44 sǣde þæt his byrne · á·brocen wære,
here-sceorp un·hrór, · and éac wæs his helm þyrl.
46 Þá hine sōna frægn · folces hyrde,
hú þā wígend · hyra wunda ge·náson
48 oððe hwæðer þāra hyssa

Then went a wounded hero, walking away;
he said that his byrnie was broken up,
his war-gear powerless, and his helmet, too, was pierced.
Then he was soon asked by the herdsman of the troop [LEADER]
how the warriors were treating their wounds,
or ... of the boys ...

Walder

(*Wald·here*)

Dating: TODO

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

Walder (abbrev. *Wald*) is an Old English epic fragment.

Textual preservation and transmission

Wald is preserved on two folios clearly belonging to the same manuscript. They are housed in the royal library of Copenhagen and together given the signum NKS MS 167 b 4^o (henceforth abbrev. as 167). The text on the two folios is not continuous, and the present edition therefore does not number them continuously, instead splitting the text into two parts. *Wald A* corresponds to the text on 167 1r–v and *Wald B* to 167 2r–v.

For the manuscript I have inspected the digital facsimile at <https://digipal.eu/digipal/page/1072/>.

Story

The majority of the surviving poem consists of dialogue.

The taunts between the heroes Walder and Guthur in fragment B is very reminiscent of the dialogue in *Hild*.

Text

Part A

A [...] hyrde hyne georne:

TODO: Translation.

- 2 „Húru Welandes · worc ne ge·swiceð
 mōnna ænigum · þāra þe Mimming can
 4 heardne ge·healdan. · Oft æt hilde ge·dreas
 swât-fâg and sweord-wund · secg æfter oðrum.

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation.

- 6 Ætlan ord-wyga, · ne lât þín ellen nú gyt
 ge·dréosan to dæge, dryht-scipe.
 8 Nú is se dæg cumen
 þæt þú scealt âninga · oðer twēga,
 10 lif for·leosan · oððe langne dóm
 âgan mid ealdum, · Ælf·heres sunu!

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation.

- 12 Nalles ic þe, wine mín, · wordum cide,
 þý ic þe ge·sawe · æt ðām sweord-plegan
 14 þurh ed-wit-scype · æniges mōnnes
 wīg for·bugan · oððe on weal fléon,
 16 lice beorgan, · þeah þe lâðra fela
 þínne byrn-hōmon · billum heowun.

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation
 TODO: Translation.

- 18 Ac þú symle furðor · feohtan sóhtest,
 mæl ofer mearce; · þý ic þe metod ʒn·dréd,
 20 þæt þú to fyren·lice · feohtan sóhtest
 æt þām æt·stealle · ððres mōnnes,
 22 wīg·rædenne. · Weorða þe selfne
 gódum dædum, · þenden þin God ʒecce.

TODO: Translation
 TODO: Translation
 TODO: Translation
 TODO: Translation
 TODO: Translation
 TODO: Translation.

- 24 Ne murn þú for þí méce; · þe wearð mādma cyst
 gifeðe to geoce, · mid þý þú Gūð·here scealt
 26 beot for·bigan, · þæs þe hé þás beaduwe ʒn·gan
 mid un·ryhte · ārest sócan.

TODO: Translation
 TODO: Translation
 TODO: Translation
 TODO: Translation.

- 28 For·sóc hé þām swurde · and þām sync·fatum,
 béaga mænigo; · nú sceal béaga·léas
 30 hworfan fr̥m þisse hilde, · hlāfurd sócan
 ealdne ððel · ðððe hér ár swefan,
 32 gif hé þa [...]“

TODO: Translation
 TODO: Translation
 TODO: Translation
 TODO: Translation
 TODO: Translation.

Part B

B „...ce bæteran

- 2 b·útōn þām ānum · þe ic éac hafa
 on stān·fate · stille ge·híded.

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation.

- 4 Ic wāt þæt hit þōhte · Þeod·ric Wíðian
 selfum on·sendon, · and éac sinc micel
 6 mǣðma mid þí mēce, · mōnig oðres mid him
 golde ge·gírwān · (iu·léan ge·nam),
 8 þæs þe hine of nearwum · Níð·hades mæg,
 Welandes bearn, · Wíðia út for·lét;
 10 þurh fífla ge·weald · fōrð on·ette.“

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation.

- Wald·ere mǣðelode, · wíga ellen·rof,
 12 hæfde him on handa · hilde·frófre,
 gūð·billa gripe, · gyddode wordum:

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

- 14 „Hwæt þú húru wōndest, · wine Burgenda,
 þæt mé Hagenan hand · hilde ge·frēmede
 16 and ge·twæmde fēðe·wigges. · Feta, gyf þú dyrre,
 æt þus heaðu·wórgan · hære byrnan.

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

- 18 Standeð mé hér on caxelum · Ælf·heres láf,
 gód and géap·neþ, · golde ge·weorðod,

- 20 **e**alles **un**-scende · æðelinges réaf
to **h**abbanne, · þonne **h**and wæreð
22 **f**eorh-hord **f**eondum. · Ne bið **f**āh wið mé,
þonne ... **un**-mægas · eft ʒn·gynnað,
24 mécum ge·**m**ōtað, · swá gé **m**é dydon.

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

23 ... | 2–3 illegible characters, possibly erased already by the scribe ms.

- Peah mæg **s**ige **s**yllan · sé þe **s**ymle byð
26 **r**econ and **r**æd-fest · **r**yhtra ge·hwilces.
Sé þe him tó þām **h**ālgan · **h**elpe ge·lifeð,
28 to **G**ode **g**ioce, · hé þær **g**earo findeð
gif þā **e**arnunga · ær ge·þenceð.

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation.

- 30 Þonne móten **w**lance · **w**elan britnian,
æhtum wealdan, · þæt is [...]“

TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation

Widsith

(*Wīd·siþ*)

Dating: C7th–8th (Neidorf 2013)

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

Widsith (abbrev. *Wīd*) is an archaic heroic poem.

Textual preservation and transmission

Wīd is found in E on foll. 84v/11–87r/8. It comes after the Christian “Vain-glory” (*Hwæt, mé fród wita* ...) and is followed by the Christian “Fortunes of Mortals” (*Ful oft þæt ge·gongēð* ...).

Meter and stanza

Like *Déor*, *Wīd* is clearly stanzaic. This stands in stark contrast with almost all other West Germanic legendary poetry which is stichic. On the other hand it agrees well with Norse poetry, especially those Norse poems (e.g. *Vkv*) which are less strict with the 4-line stanza and frequently admit ones also of 3 or 5 lines.

For ease of reference with earlier editions, the line numbers are numbered continuously rather than per-stanza.

Text

- 1 Wíd·sið maðolade, · word-hord qn·leac,
 2 sé þe mǣst · mǣrpa ofer eorþan,
 folca geond·fōrde; · oft hé flette ge·þāh
 4 myne-licne mǣppum. · Hine frōm Myrgingum
 æpele qn·wócon. · He mid Ealh·hilde,
 6 fǣlre freoþu-wębban, · forman siþe
 Hreð·cyninges · hām ge·sóhte
 8 éastan of Qngle, · Eorman·ríces,
 wrāþes wær-logan. · Qn·gōnn þā worn sprecan:

WIDSITH SPOKE, unlocked his word-hoard,
 he who furthest through tribes on the earth
 and nations had journeyed. Oft on the bench had he received
 delightful treasures. Amongst the Mirgings
 he had his ancestry. Along with Elhild,
 the good peace-weaveress, for the very first time
 he had sought out the Reth-King's realm
 to the east of the Angles: [the realm] of Ermenric
 the fierce oath-breaker. He then began a long speech:

ALL | The narrator begins with a 9-line introduction.

6 freoþu-wębban 'peace-weaveress' | A woman used in a political marriage to bring peace between two tribes or families, in this case between a king Edwin (st. 20) and Ermenric of the Gots.

7 Hreð-cyninges 'Reth-King' | Ermenric, the king of the Reth-Gots, which is apparently just a poetic name for the Eastern Gots; cf. ll. 18, 57, 88–89, also *Vaff* 12/3 n. and Ög 136 Rök (under Runic poetry).

- 10 2 „Fela ic mōnna ge·frægn · mægþum wealdan.
 Sceal þeoda ge·hwylc · þeawum lifgan,
 12 eorl æfter oþrum · oðle rǣdan,
 sé þe his þeoden-stól · ge·þéon wile.

“A great deal of men I've learned ruling tribes.
 Every person shall live in virtue,
 each earl after the other lead his homeland
 who on his sovereign seat will prosper.

- 14 3 Þāra wæs Hwala · hwile sólast,
 qnd Alexandreas · ealra rícost
 16 mōnna cynnes, · qnd he mǣst ge·þāh
 þāra þe ic ofer foldan · ge·frægen hæbbe.

Of them was Wale for a while the best,
and Alexander of all the strongest
of mankind, and he prospered most
of those men over the earth of whom I've learned.

14 Hwala | Wala E

- 18 4 **Æ**tla weold Húnum, · **E**orman·ric Gotum,
 Becca **B**aningum, · **B**urgendum Gifica.
20 **C**ásere weold **Cr**éacum · ƿnd **C**ælic Finnum,
 Hagena **H**olm-rycum · ƿnd **H**enden Glommum.

Attle ruled the Huns, Ermenric the Gots,
Beck the Banings, Yivick the Burgends.
Coser ruled the Greeks and Calic the Finns,
Hawn the Holmrighs and Henden the Glams.”

- 22 5 **W**itta weold Swáƿum, · **W**ada Hælsingum,
 Meaca **M**yrgingum, · **M**earch·ealf Hundingum.
24 **Þ**éod·ric weold Frƿncum, · **Þ**yle Rƿndingum,
 Breoca **B**rƿndingum, · **B**illing Wernum.
26 **Ö**s·wine weold Eowum · ƿnd **Y**tum Gef·wulf,
 Finn **F**olc·walding · **F**resna cynne.

Wit ruled the Swebes, Wade the Helsings,
Mack the Mirgings, Marchalf the Hundings.
Thedric ruled the Franks, Thyle the Randings,
Brack the Brandings, Billing the Werns.
Oswin ruled the Eawes and Gefwolf the Ytes,
Finn Folkwalding the race of Frisians.

- 28 6 **S**ige·here lęngest · **s**ǣ·Dęnum weold,
 Hnǣf **H**ocingum, · **H**elm Wulfingum,
30 **W**ald **W**óingum, · **W**ód Þyringum,
 Sǣ·ferð **S**ycgum, · **S**wéom Ongend·þeow,
32 **S**caft·here Ymbrum, · **S**cafa Lęng·beardum,
 Hún **H**æt·werum · ƿnd **H**olen Wrosnum;
34 **H**ring·wald wæs hāten · **H**ęre-farena cyning.

Sigar for the longest ruled the sea-Danes,
Naf the Hockings, Helm the Wolvings,
Wald the Wooings, Wood the Thirings,
Seaferth the Sidges, Angenthew the Swedes,
Shafta the Imbres, Sheaf the Longbeards,

Hown the Hatweres, and Holen the Wrasens;
Ringwald was the name of the king of Herefarers.

- 7 Offa weold Qngle, · Ale-wih Denum;
36 sé wæs þāra manna · mōdgast ealra,
 no hwæpre he ofer Offan · eorl-scype frēmede,
38 ac Offa ge·slóg · ārest mōnna,
 cniht-wesende, · cyne-ríca mǣst.

Offe ruled the Angles, Alewigh the Danes;
of these men he was bravest of all,
but he did not further greater earlship than Offe,
for Offe conquered—youngest of men,
still a boy—the greatest of kingdoms.

ALL. | The great praise here accorded to Offe, the legendary ruler of the continental Angles from whom the Anglo-Saxons claimed descent, is paralleled by *Beow* 1954–1960a.

- 40 8 Nænig efen-eald him · eorl-scipe mǣran
 on or·ette: · āne sweorde
42 mērc ge·mǣrde · wið Myrgingum
 bi Fīfel-dore; · heoldon forð siþþan
44 Engle qnd Swǣfe, · swá hit Offa ge·slóg.

No man of his age accomplished
greater earlship: with a single sword
he marked the border against the Mirgings
by Fiveldoor. It was thenceforth held
by the Angles and Swebes as Offe had won it.

- 9 Hróþ·wulf qnd Hróð·gâr · heoldon lēngest
46 sibbe æt·sōmne · suhtor-fædran,
 siþþan hý for·wræcon · Wicinga cynn
48 qnd Ingeldes · ord for·bigdon,
 for·heowon æt Heorote · Heaðo-beardna þrym.

Rotholf and Rothgar held for the longest
the peace together, uncle and nephew,
since they drove away the race of Wikings,
and bent down Ingeld's spear-point;
at Hart they cut down the host of the Hathbeards.

49 Heorote 'Hart' | The legendary hall of the Danish kings, the Shieldings. It is described at length in *Beow*.

- 50 **10** Swá ic geond·fórde fela · frēmdra lōnda
 geond ginne grund. · Gódes ōnd yfles
 52 þær ic cunnade; · cnósle bi-dæled,
 fréo-mægum feor · folgade wide.

So I journeyed through a great deal of strange lands
 through the wide world. Of good and evil
 I there became acquainted. Of kin deprived,
 far from dear kinsmen, I strayed widely.

- 54 **11** For·þon ic mæg singan · ōnd sēcgan spell,
 mænnan fore mēngo · in meodu-healle
 56 hú mé cyne-góde · cystum dohten.

Therefore I can sing and tell tales,
 recall before the many in the mead-hall,
 how men of good kin treated me with grace.

- 12** Ic wæs mid Húnum · ōnd mid Hreð-Gotum,
 58 mid Swéom ōnd mid Géatum · ōnd mid sūþ-Denum.
 Mid Wēnlum ic wæs ōnd mid Wærnum · ōnd mid
 Wicingum;
 60 mid Gefþum ic wæs ōnd mid Winedum · ōnd mid Gefleggum;
 mid Englum ic wæs ōnd mid Swæfum · ōnd mid Ænenum;
 62 mid Seaxum ic wæs ōnd Sycgum · ōnd mid Sweord-werum;
 mid Hronum ic wæs ōnd mid Déanum · ōnd mid
 Heaþo-Réamum.

I was among Huns and among Reth-Gots,
 among Swedes and among Geats, and among south-Danes.
 Among Wendles I was and among Warns, and among Wikings;
 among Yefths I was and among Wends, and among Yefflegs;
 among Angles I was and among Swebes, and among Anens;
 among Saxes I was and among Sidges, and among Sword-weres;
 among Ranes I was and among Deans, and among Hath-Reams.

- 64 **13** Mid Þyringum ic wæs · ōnd mid Þrowendum,
 ōnd mid Burgendum, · þær ic béag ge·þâh;
 66 mé þær Gūð-here for·geaf · glæd-licne maþþum
 sōnges to léane. · Næs þæt sære cyning!

Among Thirings I was and among Throwends
 and among the Burgends where I received a high;

there Guthur gladdened me with treasures
as reward for my song. That was not a bad king!

- 68 14 Mid **F**rōncum ic wæs ƿnd mid **F**rysum · ƿnd mid
Frumtingum;
mid **R**ugum ic wæs ƿnd mid Glōmmum · ƿnd mid
Rúm-walum.

Among Franks I was and among Frises, and among Frumtings;
among Ruges I was and among Glams, and among Rome-Wales.

- 70 15 Swylce ic wæs ƿn **E**atule · mid **Æ**lf-wine,
sé hæfde mƿn-cynnes, · mīne ge-fræge,
72 leohteste hƿnd · lofes tó wyrceenne,
heortan un-hneaweste · hringa ge-dāles,
74 beorhtra béaga, · bearn Éad-wines.

Likewise was I in Italy with Elfwin.
Of mankind he had—as I have learned—
the lightest hand in working generosity,
the unstingiest heart in the dealing of rings
and bright bighs, the child of Edwin.

70 Ælf-wine ‘Elfwin’ | Latin *Alboinus* (530s – 28 June 572), king of the Longbeards. As king he succeeded his father Edwin (Latin *Audoinus*) and led the Longbeards to settle in Northern Italy, where they established their kingdom and gave the region its present name, Lombardy.

- 16 Mid **S**ęrcingum ic wæs · ƿnd mid **S**eringum;
76 mid **C**reacum ic wæs ƿnd mid Finnum · ƿnd mid **C**āsere,
sé þe win-burga · ge-weald áhte,
78 wiolena ƿnd wilna, · ƿnd **W**ala ríces.

Among Serkings I was and among Searings;
among Greeks I was and among Finns, and with Coser,
he who held dominion over wine-towns,
over wealth and concubines and the realm of the Wales.

75 Sęrcingum ‘Serkings’ | Probably related to ‘Saracen’. Cf. ON *Sęrk-land* ‘Serkland’, a name for Arabia or North Africa, which appears to be from the same Germanic source.

76 Cāsere ‘Coser’ | Caesar, the Roman Emperor, but no particular historical emperor is intended. Cf. *Vkv* Pl, 15, *Hild* 33.

77 win-burga ‘wine-towns’ | Roman vineyards.

78 Wala ríces ‘the realm of the Wales’ | The Roman Empire, or more specifically Gaul (which in ON was known as *Val-land* from the same root). For the use of *Walas* ‘Wales’ in the sense ‘Romans’ see st. 14/2 above

as repayment for his giving me land,
—that lord of Mirgins—my father's ethel.

- 20 Qnd mé þá Ealh·hild · ǫþerne for·geaf,
98 dryht·cwén duguþe, · dohtor Éad·wines;
hyre lof lēngde · geond lōnda fela.
100 Þonne ic be sǫnge · sæcgan sceolde
hwær ic under swegl · sǫlast wisse
102 gold·hrodene cwén · giefre bryttian.

And then Elhild gave me another one,
the noble queen of the old troop, daughter of Edwin;
her praise stretched far through many lands.
Then in my song I had to say,
where beneath the sun I knew the best
gold-adorned queen dispensing gifts.

- 21 Þonne wit Scilling · scíran reorde
104 for uncrum sige·dryhtne · sǫng a·hófon,
hlúde bí hearpan, · hleoþor swinsade,
106 þonne mǫnige mēnn, · móðum wlōnce,
wordum sprēcon, · þá þe wel cūþon,
108 þæt hí nǣfre sǫng · sǫllan ne hýrdon.

Then I and Shilling with clear voices
for our victorious lord raised up a song,
loud by the harp—the tune rang out.
Then many men proud of heart
told with words—those who knew well—
that they never had heard a better song.

- 22 Ðonan ic ealne geond·hwearf · ǫþel Gotena,
110 sóhte ic á sīþa · þá sǫlestan;
þæt wæs inn·weorud · Earman·rices.

Thence I passed through all the ethel of the Gots;
I always sought out the best companions;
that was the inner retinue of Ermenric.

111 Earman·rices | eormanrices E

- 112 23 Heðcan sóhte ic qnd Beadecan · qnd Here·lingas,
Emercan sóhte ic qnd Fridlan · qnd East·Gotan,

114 fróðne ƿnd góðne · fæder Un·wōnes.

TODO

24 Seccan sóhte ic ƿnd Beccan, · Seafolan ƿnd Þeod·ric,
 116 Heaþo·ric ƿnd Sifecan, · Hliþe ƿnd Incgen·þeow.
 Eað·wine sóhte ic ƿnd Elsan, · Ægel·mund ƿnd Hún·gâr,
 118 ƿnd þá wlōcan ge·dryht · Wiþ·myrginga.

TODO

25 Wulf·here sóhte ic ƿnd Wyrm·here; · ful oft þær wig ne á·læg,
 120 þonne Hræda here · heardum sweordum
 ymb Wistla·wudu · wergan sceoldon
 122 ealdne éþel·stól · Ætlan léodum.

I sought out Wolfer and Wyrmer—most seldom there the warring ceased
 when the Reth-host with hard swords
 in the Wistlewood had to defend
 the old ethel-seat against Attle's folk.

26 Ræd·here sóhte ic ƿnd Rōnd·here, · Rúm·stân ƿnd Gisl·here,
 124 Wiþer·gield ƿnd Freoþe·ric, · Wudgan ƿnd Hâman;
 ne wæron þæt ge·siþa · þá sǣmestan,
 126 þeah þe ic hý a·nīht · nēmnan sceolde.

I sought out Reeder and Rander, Roomstan and Yisler,
 Witheryeld and Frithric, Woody and Homer;
 nor were those the worst of companions,
 although I last should mention them.

27 Ful oft of þâm héape · hwínende fléag
 128 giellende gâr · ƿn grōme þéode;
 wræccan þær weoldon · wundnan golde
 130 werum ƿnd wífum, · Wudga ƿnd Hâma.

Most often from that troop did fly a whizzing,
 yelling spear into the fiendish folk.
 There ruled the exiles Woody and Homer
 over twisted gold, men and women.

128 giellende gâr 'yelling spear' | Formulaic. Cf. in ON *Akv* 5/2a: *af geiri gjallanda*, Egill Lv 9/2a (SkP 5): *ok gjallanda giri*.

- 28 Swá ic þæt symle on·fōnd · on þære feringe,
 132 þæt sé biþ léofast · lond-búendum
 sé þe him God syleð · gumena ríce
 134 to ge·healdenne, · þenden hé hér leofað.“

So I always found while on that journey,
 that he is dearest to land-dwellers [MEN],
 whom God grants sovereignty of men
 for to hold while here he lives.”

- 29 Swá scrīþende · ge·sceapum hweorfað
 136 gléo-menn gumena · geond grunda fela,
 þearfe sæcgað, · þonc-word sprecað,
 138 simle sūð oþþe norð · sumne ge·mótað
 gydda gleawne, · geofum un·hneawne,
 140 sé þe fore duguþe wile · dóm a·râran,
 eorl-scipe æfnan, · oþ·þæt eal scæcð,
 142 leoht ond lif sōmod; · lof sé ge·wyrceð,
 hafað under heofonum · héah-fæstne dóm.

So passing through fates they wander,
 the song-men of mankind, through many lands.
 They tell their needs, speak thoughtful words;
 whether in the south or north they meet some one,
 gay in songs, unstingy with gifts,
 who for the old troop will rear up fame,
 accomplish earlship until all goes away,
 light and life together. He who works generosity
 has under the heavens high, lasting fame.

ALL | Widsith's speech ends, and the narrator (who last spoke in ll. 1–9) reflects on the importance of generosity and providing hospitality for wayfaring strangers in another 9-line st.

Deer

(*Deor*)

Dating: TODO

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

Deer (*Déor*) is short personal poem told by the eponymous poet, who likens his own tragic fate to stories from Germanic heroic legend.

Textual preservation and transmission

Déor is found in E on fol. 100r/8–100v/13. It comes after the Christian poem “Soul and Body II” (*Húru, þæs be·bófap ...*) and is followed by the heroic *Wulf*.

Contents

The poem briefly summarizes the tragic lives of five figures from Germanic heroic legend, each ending with the refrain *Þæs ofer-eode · þisses swá mæg* ‘That passed over; this may likewise.’ After this the poet reflects on fate, and finally tells his own story as an outcast.

The five legends mentioned are:

1. Wayland the Smith, who was captured by the tyrant Nithad and forced to make jewelry for him and his family. He took revenge by raping
2. Nithad’s daughter, Beadhild. The child born from this act was Woody (OE *Wudga*), an obscure hero.
3. Mathild, the protagonist of a poorly attested love tragedy.
4. Thedric the Great, who ruled over the Gots.
5. Ermenric, who succeeded Thedric, and was eventually slain.

The name *Déor*, first revealed in line 37, is the ancestor of modern English “deer”, and it can mean this in Old English as well, but it can also betoken ‘beast, animal’ more generally. It is not otherwise known as a personal name and is clearly fictional; we may perhaps compare *Fáfn* 2, where the young hero Siward calls himself *göfugt dýr* ‘noble beast/deer’.

Text

- 1 Wélund him be wurman · wræces cunnade,
 2 ân-hýdig eorl · earfoða dréag,
 hæfde him tó ge·sibbe · sorge ƿnd lƿngah,
 4 winter-cealde wræce; · wéan oft ƿn·fōnd,
 sibban hine Nið·had ƿn · néde lēgde,
 6 swƿncre seono-bende · ƿn syllan mƿnn.
 ƿæs ofer·eode, · þisses swá mæg!

W AYLAND ALONGSIDE WORMS experienced his exile;
 the one-minded earl suffered hardship,
 had for him as companions sorrow and longing,
 winter-cold exile. Woes he often found,
 after Nithad upon him fetters did lay,
 heavy sinew-bonds upon the better man.
That passed over; *this* may likewise.

1 be wurman 'alongside worms' | I take this to be a description of Wayland's desolate state after his hamstringing; he is forced to crawl on the ground in the company of worms (by which is also understood serpents). — The possibility of this word being an English form of German Worms, the capital of the Burgends, is unlikely since the OHG name for the city was *Wormazia*.

- 8 2 Beado·hilde ne wæs · hyre bróþra déaþ
 on sefan swá sâr · swá hyre sylfre þing,
 10 þæt heo gearo·lice · on·gieten hæfde
 þæt heo éacen wæs; · æfre ne meahte
 12 þriste ge·þencan, · hú ymb þæt sceolde.
 ƿæs ofer·eode, · þisses swá mæg!

For Beadhild was not her brothers' deaths
 in her heart so sore as her own thing,
 that she clearly had understood
 that she was pregnant. Never could she
 boldly think out how she would manage it.
That passed over; *this* may likewise.

- 14 3 Wé þæt Mæð·hilde · mƿnge ge·frugnon
 wurdon grund·léase · Geates frige,
 16 þæt hí seo sorg·lufu · slæp ealle bi·nƿm.
 ƿæs ofer·eode, · þisses swá mæg!

Ww have learned that for Mathild many
 bottomless [troubles] arose, for Geat's beloved;

that the sorrowful love deprived her of all sleep.
That passed over; *this* may likewise.

- 18 4 Þeod·ric âhte · þritig wintra
 Máringa burg; · þæt wæs mōnegum cūþ.
 20 Þæs ofer·éode, · þisses swá mæg!

Thedric owned for thirty winters
 the stronghold of the Meerings; that was known to many.
That passed over; *this* may likewise.

- 5 Wé ge·ascodan · Eorman·ríces
 22 wylfenne ge·þóht; · âhte wíde folc
 Gotena ríces. · Þæt wæs grim cyning!
 24 Sæt sæcg mōnig · sorgum ge·bunden,
 wéan on wénan, · wýscte ge·neahhe
 26 þæt þæs cyne·ríces · ofer·cumen wære.
 Þæs ofer·eode, · þisses swá mæg!

We have learned of Ermenric's
 wolveren nature. He wielded widely the host
 of the realm of the Gots; that was a grim king.
 There sat many a man bound by sorrows,
 with woes in his thoughts, wishing aplenty
 that that kingdom might be overcome.
That passed over; *this* may likewise.

23 þæt wæs grim cyning! 'that was a grim king!' | Formulaic; cf. *Wid* TODO: *Næs þæt séne cyning!*
 "That was not a bad king!"; *Beow* 11b: *þæt wæs gód cyning!* "That was a good king!"

- 28 6 Siteð sorg·céarig, · sǣlum bi·dǣled,
 on sefan sweorceð, · sylfum þinceð
 30 þæt sý ende·léas · earfoda dǣl.
 Mæg þonne ge·þencan, · þæt geond þás woruld
 32 witig dryhten · wendeþ ge·neahhe,
 eorle mōnegum · âre ge·sceawað,
 34 wís·licne blǣd, · sumum wéana dǣl.

One sits troubled by sorrow, of blessings bereft;
 his heart darkens; to himself he thinks
 that endless must be his share of hardships.
 Then he may come to think that throughout this world
 the Wise Lord turns His coat aplenty;

to many an earl honour He shows,
sure success—to another a share of woes.

- 7 þæt ic bi mé sylfum · sæcgan wille,
36 þæt ic hwile wæs · Heodeninga scóp,
 dryhtne dýre— · mé wæs Deor noma.
38 Âhte ic fela wintra · folgað tilne,
 holdne hláford, · oþ þæt Heorrenda nú,
40 léoð-cræftig mōnn · lōnd-ryht ge·þāh,
 þæt mé eorla hléo · ær ge·sealde.
42 Þæs ofer·eode, · þisses swá mæg!

This of myself I wish to say,
that for a while I was the Heedenings's shop,
dear to their lord; Deer was my name.
I had for a great many winters a good retinue,
a hold bread-giver—until Harrend now,
the lay-crafty man, has won the land-right
which the shelter of earls [KING] to *me* once granted.
That passed over; *this* may likewise.

Wolf and Edwaker

(Wulf and Éad·wacer)

Dating: TODO

Meter: Ancient-words-law, Leeds-meter

Introduction

Wolf and Edwaker (abbrev. *Wulf*) is a mysterious stanzaic poem.

Textual preservation and transmission

Wulf is found in E on foll. 100v/14–101r/4. It comes after the heroic elegy *Déor* and is followed by Riddles 1–59 (*Hwylc is hæleþa þæs horsc ...*). rom the Exeter Book.

Text

- 1 Léodum is mīnum · swylce him mon lāc gife;
 2 willað hý hine á·þeċgan, · gif hé ʒn þréat cymeð.
 Un-ge·lic is ūs.

For my people it is as if one gave them an offering;
 they wish to devour him if he comes upon that host.
 It is not so for us.

- 2 Wulf is ʒn iege, · ic ʒn ðerre;
 2 fæst is þæt eg-lond, · fenne bi-worpen.
 Sindon wæl-reowe · weras þær ʒn ige;
 4 willað hý hine á·þeċgan, · gif hé ʒn þréat cymeð.
 Un-ge·lice is ūs.

Wolf is on an island, I on another;
 fast is that island, surrounded by water.
 There are slaughter-fierce warriors there on the island;
 they wish to devour him if he comes upon that host.
 It is not so for us.

- 3 Wulfes ic mīnes wīd-lāstum · wēnum dogode,
 2 þonne hit wæs rēnig weder · ʒnd ic réotugu sæt;
 þonne mec sé beadu-cāfa · bógum bi-lēgde,
 4 wæs mé wyn tó þon, · wæs mé hwæþre éac lāð.

The far journeys of my Wolf I've thought of in my yearnings,
 when it was rainy weather and I sat grieving,
 when the battle-bold man laid his arms around me,
 I found joy in that, yet also found it loathsome.

- 4 Wulf, mīn Wulf, · wēna mé þīne
 2 séoce ge-dydon, · þīne seld-cymas,
 murnende mōd, · nales mēte-liste.

Wolf, my Wolf! My yearnings for thee
 have made me sick, and thy rare comings,
 a mourning mind—nowise want of food!

- 5 Ge·hýrest þú, Éad·wacer? · Uncerne earne hwelp
 2 bireð Wulf to wuda;

4 þæt mōn éaþe tó·sliteð · þætte náfre ge·sōmnad wæs,
 uncer giedd geador.

Hearest thou Edwaker? Our wretched whelp
is carried by Wolf to the woods.

One easily tears apart that which was never put together:
our song together.

Lay of Hildbrand

(*Hildebrandslied*)

Dating: C8th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Lay of Hildbrand** (abbrev. *Hild*) is the only surviving High German alliterative poem dealing with native legendary material and is such of immense value.

Textual preservation and transmission

Hild is preserved in the 2^o Ms. theol. 54 of the Kassel university library (ca. 820 CE, henceforth labelled **K**) where it is written in a different hand (ca. 830 CE) on the outer covers, foll. 1r and 76v. 76v ends in the middle of a line and the poem is thus fragmentary.

Language

The language of *Hild* is one of the great mysteries of German philology since it reflects a strange and clearly unnatural mix of Old High German and Old Saxon.

Let us begin with an overview of features. For transparency, the quoted forms will be in their manuscript orthography and not normalized.

TODO: list is incomplete!

The following features are clearly Old Saxon:

1. The Ingvaconic nasal spirant law /Vnθ/ > /Ṽ:θ/ (*guð*- 5, *ódre* 12, *chud* 13, 28, *usere* 15, *gudea* 59).
2. m. nom. pl. *-os* (*helidos* 6).
3. Loss of *-*r* after a vowel in monosyllabic words (*mi* 12a, 12b, 15, 41; but cf. TODO below).

4. Unshifted *-k* in *ik* 'I' (cf. below).

On the other hand, the following features are clearly High German:

1. **wr-* > *r-*, as required by the alliteration between *reccheo* and *riche* (l. 47 n.)
2. Preserved **-R* (> *-r*) after a vowel in monosyllabic words.
3. Neuter adj. nom./acc. sg. *-at* (*suasat* 52).
4. **p* > *d* (see below).
5. The High German consonant shift (see below).

The last two changes affect such a great number of words that their examples ought to be listed separately.

**p* > *d*

This change eventually came to affect most of continental Germanic (including non-High German varieties like Dutch and Low German), but in the 9th c. had not yet spread to OS and is therefore an OHG diagnostic feature.

1. *p* (ð: *ðat* 1, 2, *haðubrant* 3, *guð-* 5; *th*: *theotribhe* 19) > *d* (*bēlidos* 6, *do* 6, 32, 62, 64, *dero* 6, 60, *eddo* 11, 53, *du* 11, 12, 31, 38, 40, 47, 47, 54, 56, *de* 12, 59, *ódre* 12, *chind* (< **kinþ-*) 13, 52, *chud* 13, 28, *irmindeot* 13, *hadubrant* 14, 17, 35, *dat* 15, 17, 24, 31, 34, 41, 42, 46, 47, 63, *dea* 16, *nid* 18, *degano* 19, 26, *des* 23, *sid* 23, *detribhe* 23, *darba* 23, 26*, *dechisto* 26, *deotrichhe* 26, *quad* 30, 48, 57, *dana* 31, *dinc* 31, *der* 33, 57, 58, *dir* 34, 38, 54, 58, *huldi* 34, *pidar* 37, *dinem* 39, 45, *dinu* 39, *seolidante* 41, *desemo* 47, *dar* 50, 56, *perdan* 53, *doh* 54, 57, *aodlihho* 54, *din* 54, *dih* 58, *gudea* 59, *perdar* 60, *erdo* 61, *desero* 61, *bedero* 61, *dem* 63).

The High German consonant shift

The High German consonant shift consists of two related changes in the consonant system from Proto-West Germanic to OHG. Their distribution varies somewhat across OHG dialects but they work very similarly.

1. The spirantisation of voiceless stops *p*, *t*, *k* > *f*, *z*, *h* or *pf*, *tz*, *kh*, depending on their position in the word. Note that the fricatives *z* and *h* geminate after long vowels.
2. The devoicing of voiced stops *b*, *d*, *g* > *p*, *t*, *k*.

The following examples are attested in *Hild*:

1. Spirantisation:

- a) *k* (*ik* 1, 12, *cnuosles* 11) > *b* (initially and medially *ch*: *folche* 10, *chind* 13, 52, *chunincriche* 13, *chud* 13, 28, *otachres* 18, *otachre* 25, *dechisto* 26, *folches* 27, *chonnem* 28, *cheisuringu* 33, *chuning* 33, *chludun* 64; word-finally *h*: *sib* 2, 5, 60, *ib* 17, 29, 34, 45, 49, 53, *mih* 39, 50, 52, *dih* 58); *k* after a long vowel > *hh* (*hb*: *pelibbes* 11, *theotribbe* 19, *detribbe* 23, *aodlibbo* 54; *chb*: *deotrichbe* 26; *cc*: *harmlicco* 65; *ch*: *chunincriche* 13, *riche* 47);
- b) *kk* > *kkb* (*reccheo* 47).

2. Devoicing:

- a) *b* (*biltibrant* 3, 7, 17, 30, 43, 44, 48, 57, *hadubrant* 3, 14, 17, 35, *ubar* 6, 42, *heribrantes* 7, 43, 44, *ibu* 12, 54, 56, *biltibrantes* 14, 35, *bure* 21, *barn* 21, *arbo-* 22, *darba* 23, 26, *lib* 29, *habbe* 29, *obana* 30, *ab* 30, *bauga* 32, *bi* 34, 47, *gibu* 34, *geba* 36, *bist* 38, *habes* 46, 56, *burc* 51, *banun* 51, *breton* 53, *billiu* 53, *banin* 53, *rauba* 56, *bibrabanen* 56, *brunnono* 61, *bedero* 61, -*bort* 64, *pabnum* 67) > *p* (*prut* 21, *leop* 27, *gap* 33, *pist* 40);
- b) *bb* > *pp* (*pp*: *sippan* 31).
- c) **d* > *t* (*gihorta* 1, *muotin* 2, *biltibrant* 3, 7, 17, 30, 43, 44, 48, 57, *enti* 3, 19, 49, *hadubrant* 3, 14, 17, 35, *untar* 3, *sunufatarungo* 4, *garutun* 5, *gurtun* 5, *suert* 5, *hiltiu* 6, *ritun* 6, *gimabalta* 7, 14, 35, 44, *heribrantes* 7, 43, 44, *froto* 8, *gistuont* 8, *uortum* 9, *fater* 9, 17, *irmindeot* 13, *biltibrantes* 14, 35, *sagetun* 15, 41, *liuti* 15, *alte* 16, *anti* 16, *frote* 16, *otachre* 18, 25, *miti* 19, 53, 67, *theotribbe* 19, *lante* 20, 49, *prut* 21, *raet* 22, *detribbe* 23, *gistuontum* 23, *fatereres* 24, *friuntlaos* 24, *unti* 26, *deotrichbe* 26, *gistontun* 26, *ente* 27, *irmingot* 30, *halt* 31, *mit* 31, 36, 39, *gileitos* 31, *pant* 32, *puntane* 32, *gitan* 33, *truhtin* 34, *ort* 37, *orte* 37, *alter* 38, *puortun* 39, *gialtet* 40, *inpit* 40, *fortos* 40, *seolidante* 41, *pentilseo* 42, *tot* 43, *goten* 46, *purti* 47, *paltant* 48, *got* 48, *pepurt* 48, *skibit* 48, *pallota* 49, *scerita* 50, *sceotantero* 50, *suertu* 52, *breton* 53 (n.), *taoc* 54, *liuto* 57, *lustit* 58, *hiutu* 60, *uualtan* 61, *scritan* 62, *sciltim* 63, *stont* 63, *bort* 64, *scilti* 65, *lintun* 66, *purtun* 66).
- d) *g* (*gihorta* 1, *sunufatarungo* 4, *garutun* 5, *gudhamun* 5, *gurtun* 5, *ringa* 6, *gimabalta* 7, 14, 35, 44, *fragen* 8, *gistuont* 8, *sages* 12, *sagetun* 15, 41, *gibueit* 18, *degano* 19, 26, *gistuontum* 23, *gistontun* 26, *irmingot* 30, *gileitos* 31, *bauga* 32, *cheisuringu* 33, *gitan* 33, *chuning* 33, *gap* 33, *gibu* 34, *geru* 36, *geba* 36, *gialtet* 40, *gisihu* 45, *goten* 46, *pelaga* 48, *got* 48, *enigeru* 51, *gifasta* 51, *gipinnan* 55, *argosto* 57, *piges* 58, *gudea* 59, *gimeinun* 59, *bregilo* 60, *gipigan* 67) > *k* (only word-finally: *chunicriche* 13, *dinc* 31, *pic* 42, *sebestic* 49, *burc* 51, *taoc* 54, *enic* 56);
- e) *gg* (*seggen* 1).

The absence of $t > z$

With the extremely consistent application of the High German consonant chain shift in the dentals $*b > d$, $*d > t$ it is very strange that the last natural step, the spirantisation $t > z$, does not occur in *Hild*. Instead we have a situation where any given t in *Hild* may stand for two separate values: old $*d$ (= standard OHG t) and old $*t$ (= standard OHG z).

Above we have already listed all examples of $t < *d$. From old t *Hild* has both t and tt , the latter of which may reflect either an old short t when following a long vowel or an old long tt . The following occurrences are relevant:

1. old t (*dat* 1, 2, 15, 17, 24, 31, 34, 41, 42, 46, 47, 63, *tuem* 3, *to* 6, 64, *uuet* 12, *gibueit* 18, *fur laet* 20, *ummet* 25, 38, *at* 27, 51, *ti* 27, 53, *it* 34, *sebstic* 49, *suasat* 52); old t after a long vowel (*sceotantero* 50) $> tt$ (*hætte* 17, *beittu* 17, *luttila* 20, *pettu* 30, *motti* 59, *muotti* 60, *lettun* 62, *huitte* 65, *luttilo* 66);
2. old tt (*urhettun* 2, *sitten* 20).

Note that the High German spirantisation $t > z$ never (i.e., in no varieties of OHG) occurs in the following clusters, which are thus identical to their equivalents in OS and PWGmc. and irrelevant for the discussion:

1. *ht* (*rihtun* 6, *pebeta* 27 (for **fehta*), *truhtin* 34, *maht* 54, *reht* 56),
2. *st* (*gistuont* 8, *ist* 13, 43, *ostar* 18, 22, *gistuontum* 23, *dechisto* 26, *gistontun* 26, *bist* 38, *pestar* 42, *brustim* 45, *gifasta* 51, *brusti* 55, *argosto* 57, *ostar* 57, *lustit* 58, *ærist* 62, *stont* 63, *stoptun* 64, *staim-* 64),
3. *nt* (*pintro* 49).

The merger between old t and d is not found in other OHG varieties nor in modern High German and can not have been an authentic part of the language at any stage. With a large enough body of text we would be able to statistically prove the separation of these sounds in the dialect of *Hild* through alliteration, but unfortunately we have not a single instance of alliteration falling on either old t ($< t$) nor new t ($< d$).

It is however notable that old t when following a long vowel in 9/10 cases (the one exception being l. 50: *sceotantero*) turns into the geminate tt . This feature has no parallel in Old Saxon, but on the other hand is equivalent to what we see for the fricative $h < k$. What it seems to suggest is that t was likely in fact spirantised to z in the dialect of *Hild* but has been “masked” orthographically by the substitution of all cases of z for t ; thus an archetypal doubled zz in a word like l. 20 **luzzila* has been replaced with *luttila*, rather than the correct form ***lutila*.

Together with the metrically proven change $*wr- > r-$ (l. 47 n.) the High German consonant shift thus appears structural to the text of *Hild*, whose language therefore must be classified as OHG with OS influences rather than as a true hybrid or Germanised OS.

Orthography

For the orthography of the edition I have found it impossible to produce a normalized text without too heavily distorting the received text, being as it is, a blend of several dialects. One need only observe the treatment of the name Thedric, which appears thrice, and each time in a markedly different form. Apart from the typical practices as described in the General Introduction, and using acute accents to signify long vowels, circumflex accents to signify now-monophthongised original diphthongs, and overdots to mark nasal vowels, I have carried out the following changes in order to clarify etymological relationships and make the text somewhat less unwieldy. Of these changes, 7–9 have also been noted in the apparatus where they occur:

1. Replaced both *p* (wynn) and *uu* with *w*.
2. Replaced *c* with *k*.
3. Replaced *qu* with *kw*.
4. Replaced *t* with *ȝ* where corresponding to OHG *z*.
5. Replaced *th* with *þ*.
6. Replaced *e* with *ē* when reflecting an original a-vowel affected by *i*-mutation.
7. Replaced unetymological double *nn* with *n*.
8. Restored initial *b*- where etymological and/or metrically required.
9. Removed initial *b*- where unetymological and/or metrically deficient.

The punctuation of the original, entirely consisting of interpuncts, at times representing metrical breaks, at others sporadically placed, has not been retained.

Where it appears in the *cæsura*, the extrametrical interjection *kwad Hilti-brant* ‘quoth Hildbrand’ (found in ll. 30, 49, and 58) replaces the usual interpunct to indicate that the pause of the *cæsura* has been filled with an indication of the speaker. Outside of *Hild*, similar interjections are found throughout early Germanic poetry: in Old Norse (e.g. *Reg* 3/1, Anon *Eirm* 1/1 (in SkP 1)), Old Saxon (e.g. *Heli* 226, *SaxGen* 1), and Old English (e.g. *Finn* 24). The chronological distribution of these interjections is such that they cannot be mere scribal additions (Old Norse poetry was first written down in the C12th, several centuries after the alliterative meter had gone extinct in Germany); instead, they appear to be genuine remnants of oral performance going back to the common Germanic tradition.

Summary

The poet begins with a short formulaic introduction; he is relating older stories (1–2). The two duellists, Hildbrand and Hathbrand, father and son, arm themselves and ride into battle at the head of two opposing armies (3–6). They speak, and Hildbrand asks Hathbrand for his name and lineage (7–13). Hathbrand gives his name and ancestry; his father was the warrior Hildbrand, who abandoned him as a newborn. This was long ago, and Hathbrand does not think him still alive (14–29). Hearing this, Hildbrand calls on God as witness, and offers his son a golden torc as a token of loyalty (30–34). Hathbrand takes this as an insulting trick. He proclaims that wealth should be won by struggle alone and accuses Hildbrand of having grown old through treachery (35–40); he has heard from sailors on the Mediterranean that his father is dead (41–43).

After this straight-forward narrative sequence three short speeches follow, in the ms. all spoken by Hildbrand. The second is certainly spoken by Hildbrand, but the other two may be misplaced or misattributed.

1. Hildbrand reflects on his son's prosperity: from his clothes he can tell that he has a good lord, and that he, unlike himself, has not suffered the fate of exile (44–47).

2. Hildbrand calls on God, and laments that, after thirty years at war, he is now forced to fight against his own son. Still, Hathbrand should easily be able to kill such an old man as Hildbrand, if he has strength and fate on his side (48–56).

3. Hildbrand (or Hathbrand, and there is a case for emending here) says that only the most cowardly easterner could refuse the fight so greatly desired. Let both men fight their hardest, and when the duel is over the winner will strip the armour of the other (57–61).

The two men then throw their javelins into each other's shields and rush at each other, hacking away at their shields until they become worthless (62–67). Here the poem ends abruptly in the middle of the battle.

Text

- Ik gi·hôrta ðaṭ seḡgen [K 1r/1–5]
 2 ðaṭ sih **ur**-hêtṭun · **aenon** muotín:
Hilti-brant ęnti **Hadu**-brant · untar **her**jun ṭwêm;
 4 **sunu**-fatar-ungo · iro **saro** rihtun
garutun sé iro **güd**-hamun · **gurtun** sih iro swert ana
 6 **hę**lidos ubar **bringa** · dó sie ṭó dero **hiltu** ritun.

I HAVE HEARD IT SAID
 that two champions struggled alone against each other:
 Hildbrand and Hathbrand under two hosts.
 The son and father set their armour,
 readied their warcloth, girded on their swords,
 the heroes, over the chain-links, when to that fray they rode.

6 **bringa** | ringa K

- 2 aenon ‘alone’ | A dative plural adverbial, i.e., ‘in single combat’.
 3 untar herjun ṭwêm ‘under two hosts’ | Either man was a champion of his army.
 5 güd-hamun ‘warcloth’ | Their chainmail. Cf. l. 6l.
 5 gurtun sih iro swert ana ‘girded on their swords’ | Cf. *Finn* 13b.

- Hilti**-brant gi-mahalta · —her was **hêrôro** man [K 1r/5–11]
 8 **ferāhes** frótôro— · her frágén gi-stuont
fôhém wortum · **bwer** sín **fater** wári
 10 **firi**bo in **fôlkhe** · [...]
 [...] · „eddo hwe-líhhes **knuosles** dú síš
 12 **ibu** dú mí **ênan** sagés · ik mí de **ôdre** wêt
khind in **khun***ink-ríkhe · **khûd** ist mí* al irmin-deot.“

Hildbrand spoke—he was the hoarier man,
 more learned of life. He began to ask
 in few words who his father might be
 of men in the troop, [...]
 [...] “or of which lineage thou be.
 If thou tell me one I will recall the others,
 my child, in the kingdom I know all great men.”

7 gi-mahalta | heribrantes sunu ‘*Harbrand’s son*’ add. K 9 bwer | wer K 10 **firi**bo | fireo K
 11 hwe-líhhes | welihhes K 13 **khun***ink-ríkhe | chunnincriche K 13 mí* | mín K

8 ferāhes frótôro ‘more learned of life’ | Possibly formulaic; cf. *Maldon* 317a: *Ic eom fród feores*. ‘I am learned of life’.

10 *firibo* ‘men’ | Gen. of *fir(a)ba*, a *plurale tantum* poetic synonym for ‘men, people’ found throughout the Old Germanic languages. In OHG it is only otherwise found in *Wessobrunn* 1 and *Musp* 55, never in prose (EWA, s.v. *fir(a)ba*), although it is also found in the cpd. *smala-firibi* m. pl. ‘the common people’ (EWA, s.v. *fērah*).

The word stems from PGmc. *firbwiǰōz*, a *ja*-stem derivative of PGmc. **ferbuq* ‘life, lifeblood’. It is cognate to OS *firibos*, OE *fir(b)as* ‘men’ (cf. Goering 2025, p. 11), and ON *fīrar*, *fyrvar*, *fjērvār*, *fyrðar*. The fact that the aforementioned cognates are also exclusively poetic suggests that this was likely the case already in PGmc., or at the very least in PNWGmc.

13 *khind* ‘my child’ | Here Hildbrand is addressing Hathbrand as his junior (cf. modern English son), but the word also subtly foreshadows his paternity even though at this point in the narrative he is not yet aware of it.

- 14 **Hadu·brant** gi·mahalta · **Hilti·brantes** sunu: [K 1r/11–16]
 „Daṭ sagetun mí · ùsere liuti
 16 **alte** anti fróte · **dea êr** hina wárun
 daṭ **Hilti·brant** hæṭṭi mín fater · ih heṭṭu **Hadu·brant**.
 18 Forn her **ôstar** gi·*weṭ; · flôh her **Ôt·akhres** níd
 hina miti **Deot·ríhhe** · ḡnti sínero degano filu.

Hathbrand spoke, Hildbrand's son:

“This our liegemen said to me—
 the old and learned who lived long ago—
 that Hildbrand was the name of my father; my name is Hathbrand.
 Long ago he turned east; he fled Edwaker's hate
 thither with Thedric and his multitude of thanes.

18 gi·*weṭ | gihueit K 19 *Deot·ríhhe* | *theotrihhe with pre-shift consonant K*

15 Daṭ sagetun mí · ùsere liuti ‘This our liegemen said to me’ | The scansion of this line is inscrutable (cf. l. 42), but the required alliteration is missing.

- 20 Her fur·læt in **lante** · **lúṭṭila** siṭṭen [K 1r/16–20]
 brút in **búre**, · **barn** un·wahsan
 22 **arbjo**-laosa; · **her** raet **ôstar** hina,
 des síd **Deot·ríhhe** · **darba** gi·stuontun
 24 **fater***es mines: · daṭ was só **friunt**-laos man.

He left behind in this land a little wife to stay:
 a bride in the bower, a child ungrown,
 inheritance-less. He rode thither to the east,
 since at that time Thedric was in great need
 of my father—that was so friendless a man!

21 *brút* | *prut* K 22 *her raet* | *heraet* K 23 gi·stuontun | gistuontum K 24 *fater**es | *fatereres* K

20 *lúṭṭila* ‘a little wife’ | The word is the f. acc. sg. of *luzzil* ‘little, small’, but ‘wife’ is supplied in the translation to resolve the ambiguity between the bride and the child.

- Her was Ôt·akhre · um·meṭ *irri,
 26 degano dekhisto · unti Deot·ríkhhe*;
 her was eo folkhes aṭ ente, · imo was eo fēheta ṭi leop;
 28 khūd was her [...] · khón*ém mannum:
 ni wāniu ih iu līb habbe.“

[K 1r/20–24]

He was at Edwaker utterly enraged;
 the dearest of thanes under Thedric.
 He was ever at the head of the troop; he ever loved the fight too much;
 known was he among keen men.
 I do not expect he could still be alive.”

25 um·meṭ *irri | *written together as ummettirri* K 26 Deot·ríkhhe* | ‘darba gistontun’ *add.* K
 27 fēheta | ‘pēheta’ K 28 khón*ém | ‘chonnem’ K

25 um·meṭ *irri ‘utterly enraged’ | The second word is sometimes read as *tirri*, a hapax, but it is more reasonable to take it as a spelling error where the final consonant of the previous word has been erroneously doubled. This gives us the well-attested adj. *irri* which survives in modern German as *irre* ‘mad, crazy, insane’. This sense is probably very old (cf. Gothic *airzeis* ‘erroneous, deceived’), but the sense ‘angry, enraged, wrathful’ is attested in MHG, OS, and OE and must also be used here (EWA, s.v. *irri*).

- 30 „Wēṭṭu Irmin got“ (kwad Hilti·brant) „obana ab hevane
 daṭ dú neo dana halt mit sus sippan man · dink ni gi·lēitós.“
 32 Want her dó ar arme · wuntane bauga
 khēisur·ingu gi·tān · só imo sie der khuning gap,
 34 Húnjo truhtin, · „daṭ ih dír iṭ nú bí huldí gibu.“

[K 1r/24–76v/4]

“I call as my witness Ermen-God,” quoth Hildbrand, “in heaven above,
 that thou never hence with such close kin shouldst lead dispute,”
 —then he unwound from his arm twisted bighs
 made of Coser’s coin, which the king had given him,
 the lord of the Huns—“that I now give thee this out of goodwill.”

30 hevane | ‘hevane’ K

30 Irmin got ‘Ermen-God’ | These words may be interpreted in two ways, either as a cpd. *irmin-got* ‘great God’ referring to the Christian God, or as an invocation of the pre-Christian god Ermen (OHG *Irmin*, ON *Jǫrmunr* ‘Weden’), the ancestor of the *Herminones* of Tacitus (*Germania* 2). The problem with the former interpretation is that such a cpd is unparalleled in all of Germanic, including in related Christian epic poetry like *Heli* and *SaxGen*, whereas something like *waltant got* ‘wielding God’ (l. 48) is very widely paralleled, so that *irmin-* does not seem to have been an unmarked element. For this reason we are most likely looking at a pagan expression, although this does not necessarily imply that the poet himself was a pagan; he may have borrowed it from earlier poetry without understanding its original significance.

For the invocation of Ermen in oaths we have Widukind of Corvey's *History of the Saxons* 1:12 (ca. 968 CE): *quia Hirmin vel Hermis Graece Mars dicitur; quo vocabulo ad laudem vel ad vituperationem usque hodie etiam ignorantes utimur* 'For Hirmin or Hermes is what they call Mars in Greek, a term which we use even to this day, without knowing its meaning, for praise or for blame.' This passage seems to imply that the name of this god persisted into the 10th c. in vulgar expletives or mild oaths, gradually losing its power as knowledge of the pagan religion declined. Yet in the present circumstance it is certainly not used in such a way, but rather with full conviction by the warrior Hildbrand.

30 hevane 'heaven' | A likely Old Saxon form which merits some discussion on the relation between the synonymous words **himil* 'heaven' and **beban* 'id.' in West Germanic. OE only has *heofon*, OS has both, and OHG only has *bimil*. The distribution of the two forms in OS is not random; *bimil* is the unmarked word whereas *beban* is never used in prose, and is heavily stereotyped in poetry (*Heli* and *SaxGen*), where it is restricted to 3 formulaic expressions, always in the gen. sg., and 5 cpds. Even still, it must have existed in the broader language seeing as it has left descendants in modern Low German dialects.

In any case this word adds further difficulty to the question of providence; if *Hild* were an originally OHG text (cf. l. 47 n.) haphazardly "translated" into OS in a scribal context it seems strange that the translator should have replaced the neutral *bimil* with the rare, stereotyped *beban*, but on the other hand the presence of *bevan* in the OHG archetype would be a major anomaly since that word is not attested in any known variety of High German ancient or modern.

32 wuntane bauga 'twisted bighs' | A spiral cord of precious metal, in this case probably gold. The association between bighs (metal armlets) and a warrior's honour is well attested; see Index. This encounter is particularly reminiscent of *Hárþ* 42.

33 khëisur-ingu gi-tân 'made of Coser's coin' | Coser (< OE *Cāser*), i.e., Caesar. A cultural memory of the melting down of Roman *solidi* by Germanic mercenaries.

34 Húnjo truhtin 'lord of the Huns' | Almost certainly Atle, although he is not mentioned by name in the poem.

34 ðaŕ ih ðír iŕ nú 'that I now ...' | Grammatically this clause connects to the previous one and is thus part of Hildbrand's oath to Ermen-God; he swears that he is giving the bigh out of goodwill (*bí buldi*), i.e., without any secret motive.

Hadu·brant gi·mahalta · Hilti·brantes sunu:

[K 76v/4–10]

36 „Mit gêru skal man · geba in·fahan
ort widar orte!

38 Dú bist dir altér Hún · um·meŕ spáhér;
spënis mih mit díném wortun: · wili mih dínu speru werpan!

40 Pist al·só gi·altét man · só dú êwín in·wit fórtós.

Daŕ sagetun mí · sêo·lídante

42 westar ubar Wëntil·sêo · ðaŕ inan wík fur·nam:
tôt ist Hilti·brant · Hëri·brantes suno!“

Hathbrand spoke, Hildbrand's son:

“By the spear shall man win gifts,
point against point!

Thou art, old Hun, utterly clever;

thou temptest me with thy words—at me wilt thou hurl thy spear!

Indeed, thou hast become an old man by always employing treachery.

This sea-farers said to me,

in the west o'er the Wendle-sea: that war took him away;

dead is Hildbrand, Harbrand's son!"

42 inan | emend.; man K

36 Mit gêru skal man · geba in-fāhan 'By the spear shall man win gifts' | The line comes off as proverbial, although it probably isn't. It is however notable that the same warrior-ethic was codified by the Indians as part of the *ksatra-dharma*, the honour-code of the Warrior-caste (*ksatriya*), which explicitly forbade them from taking gifts. So in *MBh* 12.192.73, a *ksatriya* king refuses a gift from a priest (*brāhmaṇa*) since "it is the duty prescribed for a *ksatriya* that he must fight and protect (people). *Ksatriya* are said to be the givers, then, how can I take (this) from you?" (transl. Hara 1974, see further there).

40 Pist al-sô gi·altêr man · só dû êwin in-wit fôrtôs. 'Indeed, thou hast become an old man by always employing treachery' | Lit. 'thou art indeed an old man since thou always didst employ treachery.' Hathbrand accuses Hildbrand of being an imposter and views his old age as suspect; no brave warrior (it is implied) should be so old, so he must have relied on cunning and cowardly blows instead.

40 in-wit 'treachery' | A hapax in OHG, although the related form *in-witte* is attested in a gloss (EWA, s.v. *inwitti*). The word is cognate with OS *in-wid*, OE *in-wid*, and ON *ī-við-* (in *Vkv* 28/4). It has been argued that *in-witti* is in fact the only High German form and that *Hild's in-wit* is a product of Saxon scribal influence (EWA), but it seems unlikely for metrical reasons that the present line should ever have had a trisyllabic form of this word.

41 sêo-lidante 'sea-farers' | An inherited formulaic poetic cpd.; cf. the poetic OE *sê-lîðendê* 'id.' (formulaic b-verse, *Beow* 377b) and its *nd*-stem form *sê-lîðend* (*Beow* 411a, 1818a, 2806a) along with the poetic OS *sêo-lîðandjan* 'id.' (*Heli* 2909). Semantically identical cpds. with the same second element but other first elements are found in OE and OS, e.g. with *lagu-* 'water' (*Heli* 2918, 2964) and *mêri-* 'ocean' (*Beow* 255). — The pairing with *sagetun* 'said' is formulaic (*Beow* 377b, 411a, 1818a). For the motif of sea-farers as rumour-spreaders cf. particularly *Beow* 377b: *ƿomnê sægdun ƿet · sê-lîðendê* 'then sea-farers said this'.

42 Węntil-sêo 'Wendle-sea' | The Mediterranean Sea, the name referring to the *Vandali*, who for a time ruled North Africa.

44 Hilti·brant gi·mahalta · Hęri·brantes suno:
„Wela gi·sihu ih in dínem hrustim
46 ðađ dú habés hême · hêrron góten,
ðađ dú noh bí desemo ríkhe · rękkhjo ni wurti.

[K 76v/11–13]

Hildbrand spoke, Harbrand's son:
“Well do I see upon thy armour,
that thou hast at home a good lord;
that thou yet in this realm hast not become an exile.

47 rękkhjo 'exile' | An important word for identifying the poem's original dialect. *rękkhjo* (< PWGmc. **urakkjō*) originally began with a *w-* (cf. OE *wręcca*, OS *wrękkjo*), but its alliteration with *rikhe* (< PWGmc. **rikija*, cf. OE *rice*, OS *riki*) proves that this sound had been lost by the time of the poem's composition. Since the *w-* is retained in OS (cf. *Heli* 631, 671) and to this day in Low German, *Hild* must have been composed in the High German dialect area.

48 Welaga nú waltant got,“ (kwad Hilti·brant) „wê-wurt skihit.
Ih wallóta sumaro ęnti wintro · sehs-tik ur lante
50 ðár man mih eo skęrita · in folk skeoťantero,

[K 76v/13–22]

- só man mir aṭ **burk** ênigeru · **banun** ni gi·fasta.
 52 Nú skal mih **swásat** khind · **swertu** hauwan
bretón mit sínu **billju** · eddo ih imo ṭi **banin** werdan.
 54 Doh maht dú nú **aod-líhho** · ibu dir dín **ellen** taok
 in sús **hêremo** man · **hrusti** gi·winnan
 56 **rauba** bi·***rahanen** · ibu dú dár **ênig** reht habés!“

Well now, Wielding God!“ quoth Hildbrand, “The woeful Weird comes to pass.

I roamed for sixty summers and winters away from this land
 when I always was placed in the troop of shooters,
 while at no stronghold my bane was fastened.
 Now shall my beloved child strike me with his sword,
 beat me with his blade—or I become his bane.
 Yet thou mayst now easily—if thy zeal avails thee—
 from such a hoary man win the armour,
 bear away the booty—if thou hast any right thereto!“

56 bi·***rahanen** | ‘bírahanen’ K

48 waltant got ‘Wielding God!’ | Cf. OE *wealdend god*, OS *waldand god*. Apparently a common West Germanic poetic expression.

48 wê-wurt ‘woeful Weird’ | The sense of *wurt* ‘weird’ bears explaining. Rather than the Norse norn Weird (*Vsp* 19), its meaning here ought to be understood as ‘inexorable course of events decreed by fate’, although this sense is still tied to the pagan norn and ultimately of pre-Christian origin. The same sense underlies OS *wurd(i)* at various points in *Heli* (e.g. l. 4619), OE *wyrd* (e.g. *Beow* 572b, quoted in the note to l. 54 below), and ON *grimmar urðir* ‘grim weirds’ in *Sigsk* 5/4.

49 sumaro çnti wintro · sehs-tik ‘sixty summers and winters’ | Thirty years. Cf. *Beow* 1498, 1769: *bund misséra* ‘a hundred half-years’, i.e., ‘fifty years’. Hathbrand is then thirty years old while Hildbrand is probably in his late forties or fifties.

50 skeoçantero ‘shooters’ | Probably used in a specifically poetic sense. Cf. *Beow* 702, where the OE cognate *sceotend* stands for ‘warriors’ in general rather than archers in particular.

53 bretón ‘beat’ | A hapax. TODO: cite (EWA, s.v. *bretón*)

53 billju ‘blade’ | Instr. sg. of *billi*, a hapax in OHG whose exact sense is unclear (EWA, s.v. *billi*). It is cognate with OE *bil* ‘a type of weapon’ which is exclusively used in poetry. The rarity of this word in the old languages suggests that it is probably simply being used as a poetic synonym for ‘sword’ or ‘sharp weapon’, whence the present translation ‘blade’.

54 ibu dir dín ellen taok ‘if thy zeal avails thee’ | Formulaic. Cf. *Beow* 572b–573: *Wyrd oft nerið // un-fégnæ eorl* · þønnæ his ellin déah. ‘Weird often saves the un-fey earl when his zeal avails.’

56 ibu dú dár ênig reht habés! ‘if thou hast any right thereto!’ | The last three lines of Hildbrand’s speech bear a remarkable similarity to *Wald* B/14 ff. From comparison to such passages it is clear these lines must be understood in the cultural context of the flying and taunting speeches of Germanic warriors as a direct provocation, as is most clearly seen in this final half-line. This in turn is what motivates Hathbrand’s hostile answer in ll. 57–61.

„Der sí doh nú **argósto**“ (kwad *Hadu*-brant) „ôstar-liuto
 der dir nú **wíges warne** · nú dih es só **wel** lustit

[K 76v/22–26]

60 gūđja gi·mēinun; · niuse de mótŕi
 bwę*dar sih *hiutu dēro* hręgilo · hruomen muotŕi
 eddo desero brunnōno · bēdero waltan!“

“Yet he would now,” quoth Hathbrand, “be the cowardliest of easterners whoever should deny thee the fight now that thou hast such desire for a battle between us. Let him try who might, whichever one today of these garments will boast, or both these byrnie’s wield!”

57 kwad *Hadu-brant* | *emend.*; ‘quad hiltibrant’ K 60 bwę*dar | ‘werdar’ K 60 *hiutu dēro* | *metr. emend.*; *rev.* K 60 hruomen | ‘hrumen’ K 61 eddo | ‘erdo’ K

ALL | That the speaker of ll. 57–61 is in fact Hathbrand, the son, rather than Hildbrand, the father, is suggested by the speaker’s hostile tone (unlike the more resigned, albeit taunting tone of ll. 48–56) and his prejudice against *ōstar-liuto* ‘easterners’, i.e., the Huns, against whom Hathbrand is clearly negatively disposed and to whom he thinks the imposter Hildbrand belongs (cf. l. 38). A switch of speaker is further implied by the finality of Hildbrand’s speech in l. 56b. On its own, the speech-marker in the caesura of l. 57 (*kwad X* ‘quoth X’) is not proof that we are dealing with a new speaker (cf. l. 48), but it does yield additional support to it considering the high likelihood of corruption due to the formulaic nature of the marker and the numerous proofs of clear inattention on the part of the scribe(s) of the poem as a whole, e.g. the parablepsis in l. 26, the highly inconsistent handling of the name Thedric in ll. 19, 23, 26, and the various unmetrical lines likely resulting from skipped words.

60–61 hręgilo hruomen muotŕi ... desero brunnōno bēdero waltan ‘of these garments will boast ... both these byrnie’s wield’ | Like in the *ll*, the winner is expected to strip the slain of his armour.

62 Dó lęttun sé ærist · askim skρίtan
 skarpén skúrim · daŕ in dem skiltim stónt
 64 dó stóptun tó·samane · staim-bort chlubun
 hewun harm-likko · hwítŕe skilti
 66 unti imo iro lintún · lúŕŕilo wurtun
 gi·wigan miti wábum · [...]

[K 76v/26–29]

Then they first let their ashen spears glide
 in sharp showers so that in the shields they stuck.
 Then they charged at each other, split the painted boards [SHIELDS];
 they hewed harmfully at the white shields,
 till before them their linden-planks [SHIELDS] became small,
 worn down by the weapons, [...]

62 askim | ‘asckim’ K 64 chlubun | chludun K

63 skarpén skúrim ‘in sharp showers’ | Formulaic half-line describing a hail of projectiles, also occurring in *Heli* 5136a.

64 staim-bort ‘painted boards’ | A cpd., transparently segmented as *staim-* + *bort* ‘board, plank’. In OE poetry *bord* can also mean ‘shield’ (e.g. *Beow* 2259, 2524, 2673, in cpds. 1243, 2203, 2559, 2895, 2980), as can OS *bord* (only once: *Heli* 5767) and ON *borð* (e.g. *Þmáhl Máv* 8/2 (in SkP 5)), so that this is probably an inherited poetic sense and certainly the sense here.

The first element is more difficult, but is generally understood to be an assimilated form of *stein* 'stone' (though note that in the ms. the digraph *ai* is only found here, and that the etymological reflex of PGmc. **ai* is otherwise spelled '*ei*' or '*ae*'). This has often been interpreted as 'jewel' (an attested sense), so that the sense would be 'bejewelled shield', yet the existence of such shields in the late 8th c. must be considered highly doubtful. On the basis of the ON cognate *steinn*, which in addition to 'stone' can also mean 'mineral colour, paint' (cf. ModEngl. stain, e.g. in "stained glass", an ON loan), I propose that the word mean 'paint' in the sense 'painted shield'. Such painted shields are in fact attested in near-contemporary Norse poetry (*Rdr* 1, ca. 850 CE), which, although not identical to High German poetry, still belongs to the same Germanic epic tradition.

67 [...] | At this point **K** 76v ends in the middle of the line. The rest of the poem would have been found on the now-lost following page(s); see Introduction above.

Poetry on Christian Subjects

Introduction to Old Saxon Christian Poetry

The forced conversion of the Saxons to Christianity under Charlemagne was a notably violent process, involving 32 years of war from 772 to 804 CE. TODO: historical discussion.

It was only a generation after the Saxon Wars that the two poems edited here—the **Healend** (abbrev. *Heli*) and the **Saxon Genesis** (abbrev. *SaxGen*) were composed under the guidance of the Frankish king. Their political purpose is clear enough: to depict Biblical stories and figures in the language of Germanic epic, and thereby to allow the aristocratic Saxon audience to identify with the but recently imposed religion.

Together *Heli* and *SaxGen* form the totality of the Old Saxon poetic corpus. Both are thoroughly Christian, and although written in the language of traditional epic, surely for a noble audience, they launch a pointed Christian attack on the fatalistic and warlike worldview of Germanic Paganism.

Before the two poems I present the **Old Saxon Baptismal Vow** as an important piece of historical context.

Old Saxon Baptismal Vow

Dating: ?
Meter: None

Introduction

While not an alliterative poem in the slightest, the **Old Saxon Baptismal Vow** is an extremely important historical document. It was under just this vow many an Old Saxon would have gone during his forced baptism in the late 8th century, in many cases directly before his execution. For this reason I have here placed it before the two Old Saxon Biblical epics, in order to give some relevant cultural context.

The format of the short text is straight-forward and resembles the Catholic questions posed to participants during the Sacrament of Confirmation (TODO: reference). The person to be baptised is to respond positively to three denying and three affirming questions. He is to forsake the Devil, all “devil-yields” (pagan rituals), all the Devil’s works and words and his followers, among which the three Old Saxon gods Thunder, Woden, and Saxneet are mentioned by name. He is then to profess belief in each member of the Trinity: God the Father, Jesus Christ, and the Holy Ghost.

Text

P1 „For·sachistu diobole?“

2 et respondeat: „ec for·sacho diabole“

“Forsakest thou the Devil?”

and he should respond: “I forsake the Devil.”

P2 „end allum diobol-gelde?“

2 respondeat: „end ec for·sacho allum diobol-gelde.“

“And all devil-yields?”

he should respond: “I forsake all devil-yields.”

1 diobol-gelde ‘devil-yields’ | An obvious calque of OE *dēofol-gield* ‘idolatrous acts of worship’.

P3 „End allum dioboles wercum?“

2 respondeat „end ec for·sacho allum dioboles wercum and wor-
dum, Thuner ende Wōden ende Sax-nôte ende allem them un·holdum
4 the hira ge·nôtas sint.“

“And all the Devil’s works?”

he should respond: “and I forsake all the Devil’s works and words, Thunder and Weden and Saxneat and all the unhold ones which are their fellows.”

P4 „Ge·lôbistu in Got ala-męhtigun fader?“

2 „Ec ge·lôbo in Got ala-męhtigun fader.“

“Believest thou in God, the Almighty Father?”

“I believe in God, the Almighty Father.”

P5 „Ge·lôbistu in Crist Godes suno?“

2 „Ec ge·lôbo in Crist Gotes suno.“

“Believest thou in Christ, God’s son?”

“I believe in Christ, God’s son.”

P6 „Ge·lôbistu in hâlogan gâst?“

2 „Ec ge·lôbo in hâlogan gâst.“

“Believest thou in the Holy Ghost?”

“I believe in the Holy Ghost.”

Healend

(*Hêljand*)

Dating: 830s

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Healend** (abbrev. *Heli*; OS *Hêljand* ‘Healend, Saviour’, cf. OE *Hêlend*, OHG *Heiland*) is an Old Saxon epic poem that narrates the life of Jesus. Although based on the 9th c. OHG translation of Tatian’s 2nd c. gospel harmony, the *Diatessaron*, *Heli* is still an original work in the Saxon branch of the Germanic epic tradition, and betrays a creative spirit not afraid to go into dialogue not just with Christian commentaries but also with earlier, now-lost, pagan poetry. *Heli* is by far the most important source of Old Saxon literature.

Textual preservation and transmission

Heli was very popular and is preserved in several mss. The following is a list of all source mss. in chronological order.

Siglum	Date	Lines	Full name
L	840–850	5823b–5870a	Thomas 4073
P	840–850	958–1006a	Berlin DHM R 56/2537
V	800–850	1279–1358a	Palatini Latini 1447
S	850	351b–360a, 368b–384, 393–400a, 492–582a, 675–683a, 693–706, 716b–722a	BSB Cgm 8840
M	850–875	85–2198a, 2256–2514a, 2576–3414a, 3491–3950, 4017b–4674, 4740b–5275a, 5969–5980	BSB Cgm 25
C	950–1000	1–5969	Cotton Caligula A VII

The two main mss. are **M** and **C**; of these the older **M** is to be preferred, as the orthography of **C** is often influenced by OE and probably the product of an English scribe.

Fragments **L** and **P** are identical in terms of handwriting and page layout and appear to have originally belonged to the same codex.

V also attests *SaxGen*, which suggests a close relation between that text and *Heli*.

Historical context

We have a Latin preface preserved independently of *Heli* itself which can offer some external historical information about the poem. The original manuscript of this short work is now lost, but it was fortunately printed by the Croatian reformer Flacius Illyricus in 1562. It consists of two titled parts.

The first is in prose and entitled *Praefatio ad librum antiquum in lingua Saxonica conscriptum* 'Preface to an ancient book written in the Saxon language'. This short text in turn appears to consist of two separate paragraphs. According to the first, *Heli* was composed at the behest of emperor Ludwig (*Ludowicus Augustus*, probably Ludwig "the Pious" 778–840, son of Charlemagne), who commanded a Saxon man, *qui apud suos non ignobilis vates habebatur* 'who was regarded among his own as a not undistinguished poet' to render the entirety of the Old and New Testaments into Saxon verse. Thus, the poet, *a mundi creatione initium capiens, iuxta historiae veritatem quaeque excellentiora summatim decerpens, interdum quaedam ubi commodum duxit, mystico sensu depingens, ad finem totius Veteris ac Novi Testamenti interpretando more poetico satis faceta eloquentia perduxit*, 'beginning with the creation of the world, and summarizing according to the truth of history the most significant events, at times depicting certain events with a mystical sense where he saw fit, led the interpretation, according to poetic custom and with rather witty eloquence, through to the end of the entire Old and New Testaments;' further, *iuxta morem vero illius poematis omne opus per vitteas distinxit, quas nos lectiones vel sententias possumus appellare* 'according to the manner of that poem, he distinguished every work by *fitts*, which we can call lessons or sentences.'

There is no reason to doubt the general truth of this account, although it is hard to believe that our unnamed poet should have rendered the entirety of the Old and New Testaments, even the prophets and epistles, into alliterative verse. The antiquity of this paragraph of the preface is in any case certified by the use of the Germanic technical word *vitteas* 'fitts', which, as pointed out already by Sievers (1878, p. xxv), could not possibly have been known by a 16th century scholar. The rendering of the Old Testament is probably to be identified with *SaxGen*, while the New Testament is what we have before us in *Heli*.

This first paragraph of the *Praefatio* is then followed by a second, where we hear (in part) that, "they say that this same poet, while he was still entirely ignorant of this art, was warned in a dream to adapt the precepts of

the Sacred Law into song, with a fitting melody in his own language.” (*ferunt eundem Vatem dum adhuc artis huius penitus esset ignarus, in somnis esse admonitum, ut Sacrae Legis praecepta ad cantilenam propriae linguae congrua modulatione coaptaret.*) This narrative is clearly closely related to that which Bede (TODO) tells us about the illiterate Anglo-Saxon poet Cadman (see *Cadman* below); in fact its Latin wording is so close to that of Bede that it must have been plagiarised thence. Finally, the same narrative is then told in Latin verse under the title *Versus de poeta et interprete huius codicis* ‘Verses about the poet and interpreter of this codex’.

Whatever the truth of Cadman’s story, it can scarcely be the case that the poet or poets behind *Heli* and *SaxGen* were ignorant of the poetic art. Both poems are wrought in an intricate style, and their composer must doubtless have been trained in the traditional craft, having first mastered the art of secular (or, very likely, pagan) heroic poetry before he was commissioned to versify the Biblical texts; the first paragraph of the *praefatio* itself tells us as much when it says that he “was regarded among his own as a not undistinguished poet”, and the idea that Emperor Ludwig would have commissioned a man entirely without poetic experience is obviously absurd. This strongly suggests that the second paragraph of the *praefatio* and the *versus* are later interpolations based on the story of Cadman, irrelevant for the context of *Heli* and *SaxGen*.

Style and content

It was for good reason that the *Heli*-poet was esteemed among his own, for he displays considerable mastery in such “Beowulfian” type scenes as the feast in the great mead-hall (ll. 2005–12, 2736–42), the stormy sea-voyage (2233–68, 2906–65), the host asking for the identity of noble strangers come to his land (551–61)—a mastery which reveals his training in traditional Saxon heroic poetry. In fact, it is precisely in these passages that his poetry is most fluent, for it is here he can make the most use of his inherited stock of oral-formulaic expressions, synonyms, and kennings. When our poet, by contrast, has to deal with exclusively Christian matters he is treading new ground, and it is apparent that his work suffers as a result. This is in part due to the lack of traditional poetic formulae for the concepts of the new religion, and although he invents some (e.g. *allaro barno bēst* ‘best of all babes’ and *frīðu-barn godes* ‘peace-child of God’ for Christ), they quickly end up stale from overuse. A further hindrance is, as will be discussed shortly, his frequent moralising sermons.

Another notable traditional element found throughout the poem is the relationship between Christ and his Disciples, which is consistently described using the vocabulary of the Germanic warband (as found in earlier heroic poetry like *Beow* and *Hild*). In the language of *Heli* the Disciples are brave “thanes” who express their undying loyalty towards their “drihten” Jesus Christ in long heroic speeches, exclaiming their wish to win ever-lasting fame and glory by dying alongside him in the “dance of weapons” (e.g., Thomas at 3994–4002, Simon Peter at 4673–88). In conjunction with this there is an

emphasis on the noble ancestry and high social status of the Disciples (e.g., 4003a) and especially Jesus and his family (e.g., 361b–67a), something which gives us an idea of the intended audience—these were likely members of the Saxon social elite, no mere commoners, and it was important for them that the heroes of the Gospel-story were of similarly high birth.

Still, we should not interpret such traditional elements as evidence for *Heli* reflecting a syncretist Germanic “warrior Christianity”, as more romantic scholars have done. It would not have been possible for the poet to utterly excise the traditional heroic language—after all, he was commissioned to write an alliterative poem, and such elements were built into the very essence of the alliterative genre, being necessary for the poetry to function, not just in the social setting of courtly performance, but metrically, i.e., as poetry, for the alliteration itself was upheld by the existence of a large number of poetic synonyms and formulaic expressions. It was thus within these social and formal constraints that the poet was to relate the New Testament message, and yet that message is ever one of Christian pacifism and humility. The New Testament is not a warlike text, and neither is *Heli*; regardless of the poem’s *aesthetics*, its *ethics* are thoroughly Christian.

As said, although *Heli* generally adheres closely to Germanic poetic tradition in its language, we find important divergences in its contents. The heroic poetic tradition is turned against itself, and the Germanic warrior ideology comes under direct attack by means of its own specialised vocabulary, which is condemned, not just in the speeches of Jesus Christ, but in the poet’s own, sermonising voice. This is perhaps best seen in the episode of the Denial of Peter. At the Last Supper Peter first makes a solemn speech (ll. 4673–88), declaring in formal heroic language that he will not betray Jesus Christ, his lord, but stay with him until the end and give his life in battle; he swears upon his heart (*hugi*) and strength of hand (*hand-kraft*). Jesus first praises Peter’s courage, and says that he indeed has a “thane’s heart” (*þegnes hugi*), but then predicts that he will betray him thrice before cockcrow anyway. Peter does just that, and upon hearing the cock repents by a lamenting speech (ll. 5011–20). The poet himself then delivers a short sermon on the events (5021–49)—if not even Peter, “the best of men” and “most valiant of thanes” could keep his promise without God’s help, what is its worth? Man’s solemn vow (*bi-þēt*, = OE *béot* which is used positively in *Beow*), pride (*bróm*; cf. *Hild* 60), bravery (*mód*), and strength of hand (*hand-kraft*, by which Peter vowed) are all to no avail if God’s grace should fail him due to his lack of faith. Naturally, moral exegesis of this kind is totally foreign to the pagan epic tradition.

In this context it is of value to talk about the language of war; although the New Testament is not a warlike text, the poet takes the opportunity to break out some traditional formulae when he can, e.g. at the arrest of Jesus (ll. 4865–84). Still, he is generally very restrained, and tries hard to avoid the active *celebration* of war, probably because of its association with the warlike pre-Christian cult of Woden and his Walkirries and Oneharriers. Where warlike sentiments are expressed by the Disciples (e.g. at the arrest, or in Peter’s vow at the Last Supper; see above) they are swiftly reproached by Jesus and

ultimately proven flawed and misguided. Traditional motifs like the greedy beasts of battle are entirely expunged, and the old feminine poetic synonyms **gūðja* and *hildi*, found in *Hild* and commonplace in Norse and English poetry, have not fared much better. **gūðja*, found in early OS female names and the non-*Heli* compound *gūþ-fano* ‘field standard’, is entirely absent, and *hildi* is only used twice (ll. 68, 5043)—in both cases disparagingly. In their stead we find neuter-gender synonyms like *strid*, *ur-lagi*, *wig*, and *gi-winn*. It is probably significant that *Gunnr* and *Hildr* are known as walkirries in the Norse tradition, and in the 9th century were still actively worshipped in pagan Denmark, just to the north of Saxony.

I mentioned above how the depiction of the Disciples in their relationship as servants of Christ makes use of the language of the Germanic war-band, and that is the case when it comes to singular words, but although the Disciples are described as loyal thanes (*þegnos*), heroes (*þeliðos*, cf. *Hild* 6), and earls (*erlos*)—words perfectly fit for a Germanic war-band in a poem like *Beow*—they are not a war-band and are never described by explicitly war-like terms like *hildi-skalkos* ‘war-servants’, *wēpan-berandos* ‘weapon-bearers’, or *helm-berandos* ‘helmet-bearers’. Those terms—which in *Beow* or Norse poetry could describe any group of warriors, including the protagonists—are instead given a derogatory sense, and for the most part refer only to the wicked Jews under their kings (68b, 765b, 2779b, 4810a).

There are, of course, other ways in which *Heli* departs from Germanic heroic tradition. One that deserves mention is the treatment of hostile fate, which often plays a key role in driving the narrative in the old pagan legends (e.g. in *Hild* or the Walsing Cycle). Although *Heli* refers to fated events by what are almost certainly originally pagan expressions like *regano gi-skapu* ‘Shapes of the Reins’ and *wurdi-gi-skapu* ‘Shapes of Weird’, fated events can also be called *godes gi-skapu* ‘God’s Shapes’, for in the Christian worldview it is God that wields the destinies of Men—not the ambivalent Norns.

Orthography

Notes on the normalization:

- Long vowels are marked by the acute rather than by the circumflex accent or macron. This is both faithful to the original manuscripts and concordant with my practice in normalising other Germanic languages.
- The long vowels *ê* and *ô* (resulting from monophthongisation of the diphthongs *ei* and *au*) are, however, written with the circumflex accent. That these were in fact articulated separately is seen by the following circumstance: in the mss. the old monophthongs *é* and *ó* are frequently written as *ie* and *uo*, but this is never done for *ê* and *ô*.
- If attested in all mss., epenthetic (*svara-b^bakti*) vowels are marked with an underdot. Otherwise they are deleted.
- Unstressed *a*-vowels reduced to *e* in C are reverted back to *a*.

- Long vowels resulting from nasal assimilation are marked with an over-dot. *i* is written as *ī*.
- ms. *e* and *i*, when occurring between vowels are written as *j*.
- ms. *i*, when word-initial or following *g* and corresponding to etymological *j* is written as *j*.
- ms. *e* as resulting from *i*-mutation is written as *ē*.
- ms. *b*, or *ḃ*, when representing the voiced bilabial fricative, is written as *ḃ*.
- ms. *th* is written as *þ*.
- ms. *uu* is written as *w*.

NOTE!

The following edition is very much a work in progress. The radically normalized orthography has been implemented, as has the marking of alliteration, but the original text has not been thoroughly critically edited, nor is there any English translation.

Text

- 1 Manega wáron, · þe sia iro mód ge·spón,
 2 þat sia bi·gunnun word godes,
 3 rëkkjan þat gi·rúni, · þat þie ríkjo Krist
 4 undar man·kunnja · máriða gi·frumida
 5 mid wordun ęndi mid werkun. · Þat wolda þó wísara filo
 6 liudo barno lobon, · lêra Kristes,
 7 hêlag word godas, · ęndi mid iro handon skríban
 8 beręht·líko an buok, · hwó sia is gi·bod·skip skoldin
 9 frummjan, firiho barn. · Þan wárun þoh sia fiori te þiu
 10 under þera męnigo, · þia habdon maht godes,
 11 helpa fan himila, · hêlagna gęst,
 12 kraft fan Kriste; · sia wurðun gi·korana te þio,
 13 þat sie þan Éwangelium · ęnan skoldun
 14 an buok skríban · endo só manag gi·bod godes,
 15 hêlag himilisk word: · sia ne muosta hęliðo þan mēr,
 16 firiho barno frummjan, · newan þat sia fiori te þio
 17 þuru kraft godas · ge·korana wurðun,
 18 Matheus ęndi Markus, · —só wárun þia man hêtana—
 19 Lukas ęndi Johannes; · sia wárun gode lieba,
 20 wirðiga ti þem gi·wirkje. · Habda im waldand god,
 21 þem hęliðon an iro hertan · hêlagna gęst
 22 fasto bi·folhan · ęndi ferąhtan hugi,
 23 só manag wís·lík word · ęndi gi·wit mikil,
 24 þat sea skoldin a·hębbjan · hêlagaro stemnun
 25 god·spell þat guoda, · þat ni habit ęnigan gi·gadon hwęgin,
 26 þiu word an þesaro wer·oldi, · þat io waldand mēr,
 27 drohtin diurje · efþo derbi þing,
 28 firin·werk fęllje · efþo fiundo níð,
 29 stríd wiðer·stande—, · hwand hie habda starkan hugi,
 30 mildjan ęndi guodan, · þie þe mēster was,
 31 aðal·ord·frumo · alo·mahtig.
 32 Þat skoldun sea fiori · þuo fingron skríban,
 33 settjan ęndi singan · ęndi seggjan forð,
 34 þat sea fan Kristes · krafte þem mikilon
 35 gi·sáhun ęndi gi·hórdun, · þes hie selbo gi·sprak,
 36 gi·wísda ęndi gi·warąhta, · wundar·líkas filo,
 só manag mid mannon · mahtig drohtin,

38 all so hie it fan þem an-ginne · þuru is ênes kraht,
 waldand gi-sprak, · þuo hie êrist þesa wer-old gi-skuop
 40  ndi þuo all bi-fieng · mid  nu wordo,
 himil  ndi er a ·  ndi al þat sea bi-hlidan  gun
 42 gi-warahtes  ndi gi-wahsanes: · þat war  þuo all mid wordon
 godas
 fasto bi-fangan, ·  ndi gi-frumid after þiu,
 44 hwi-l k þan liud-skepi · landes skoldi
 w dost gi-waldan, · ef o hw r þiu wer-old-aldar
 46  ndon skoldin. ·  n was iro þuo noh þan
 firiho barnun bi-foran, ·  ndi þiu fi bi w run a-gangan:
 48 skolda þuo þat sehsta · s lig-l ko
 kuman þuru kraft godes ·  ndi Kristas gi-burd,
 50 h landero b stan, · h lagas g stes,
 an þesan middil-gard · managon te helpun,
 52 firjo barnon ti frumon · wi  fiundo ni ,
 wi  d rnero dwalm. · Ðan habda þuo drohtin god
 54 R mano-liudjon far-liwan · rikjo m sta,
 habda þem h ri-skipje · herta gi-st rkid,
 56 þat sia habdon bi- wungana ·  iedo gi-hwi-l ka,
 habdun fan R mu-burg · rik  gi-wunnan
 58 helm-gi-tr stjon, · s ton iro h ri-togon
 an lando gi-hwem, · habdun liudjo gi-wald,
 60 allon  li- eodon. · Erodes was
 an Jerusalem · ober þat Judeono folk
 62 gi-koran te kuninge, · s  ina þie k ser þarod,
 fon R mu-burg · rik   iodan
 64 satta undar þat gi-si i. · Hie ni was þoh mid sibbjon bi-lang
 a aron Israheles, ·   ili-gi-burdi,
 66 kuman fon iro knuosle, · newan þat hie þuru þes k sures þank
 fan R mu-burg · rik  habda,
 68 þat im w run s  gi-h riga · hildi-skalkos,
 a aron Israheles ·  lljan-ruoba:
 70 swi o un-wanda wini, · þan lang hie gi-wald  hta,
 Er des þes rikjas ·  ndi r d-burdjon held
 72 Judeo liudi. · Ðan was þ r  n gi-gamalod mann,
 þat was fruod gomo, · habda fer tan hugi,
 74 was fan þem liudjon · Lewias kunnes,
 Jakobas sunjas, · guodero  iedo:

76 Zakharias was hie hêtan. · Þat was só sálig man,
 hwand hie simblon gerno · gode þeonoda,
 78 warahta after is willjon; · deda is wif só self
 —was iru gi·aldrod idis: · ni muosta im ƿrbi·ward
 80 an iro juguð·hêdi · gíbiðig werðan—
 libdun im far·úter laster, · waruhtun lof goda,
 82 wárun só gi·hōriga · heban-kuninge,
 diuridon úsan drohtin: · ni weldun dērbjas wiht
 84 under man-kunnje, · mēnes gi·frummjan,
 ne saka ne sundja; · was im þoh an sorgun hugi,
 86 þat sie ƿrbi·ward · êgan ni móstun,
 ak wárun im barno-lôs. · Þan skolda hé gi·bod godes
 88 þár an Jerusalem, · só oft só is gi·gengi gi·stód,
 þat ina torht·liko · tídi gi·manodun,
 90 só skolda hé at þem wíha · waldandes geld
 hêlag bi·hwerban, · heban-kuninges,
 92 godes jungar-skēpi: · gern was hé swíðo,
 þat hé it þurh ferhtan hugi · frummjan mósti.

TODO.

85 saka | With this word *M* begins. Above it seven lines have been erased.

3 rēkkjan | The use of this verb is reminiscent to its use in *Beow* 89b–91, introducing a *shop*'s (bard, poet) song about the creation of the Earth from a Christian perspective: *þér was he⁴rpan swóg, / switl sang scopas. · Seǵd sé þi cūðé / frum-scaft firbá · fe⁴rran rēccan* ‘There there was the air of the harp, the clear song of the shop. He who knew told of the early days of men, narrated from afar.’

41 himil ęndi erða · ęndi al þat sea bi·hlidan êgun | A cosmological expression, reappearing almost identically in 1425 below.

45 wer-old-aldar | The six ages of the world was a common concept in mediæval Christianity, being popularized by Augustine of Hippo around 400 CE. It is not found in Tatian, and so Augustine or a text derived from his writing must have been a source for *Heli*.

47–48 fiþi ... sehsta ‘five ... sixth’ | The five ages lasted (1) from Creation to the Flood, (2) from then to Abraham, (3) from him to David, (4) from him to the Babylonian Exile, (5) from then until the birth of Christ, which inaugurated the sixth age.

71 Eródes | The name *Erodes* can alliterate either with a vowel (following the Germanic root stress pattern: / x x) or with the consonant *r* (following the Latin penultimate stress: x / x). Out of 17 total appearances of the name in *Heli*, 12 alliterate with a vowel; 4 with *r*; and 1 has no alliteration.

94 2 Þó warð þiu tíð kuman, · —þat þár gi·tald habdun
 wisa man mid wordun,— · þat skolda þana wíh godes
 96 Zakharias bi·sehan. · Þó warð þár gi·samnod filu
 þár te Jerusalem · Judeo liudi,
 98 werodes te þem wíha, · þár sie waldand god

- swíðo þeo-líko · þiggjan skoldun,
 100 hêrron is huldi, · þat sie heban-kuning
 lêðes a-léti. · Þea liudi stóðun
 102 umbi þat hêlaga hús, · ėndi géng im þe gi·hêrodo man
 an þana wih innan. · Þat werod oðar béd
 104 umbi þana alaḥ útan, · Ebreo liudi,
 hwan êr þe fródo man · gi·frumid habdi
 106 waldandes willjon. · Só hé þó þana wi·rôk dróg,
 ald aftar þem alaḥa, · ėndi umbi þana altari géng
 108 mid is rôk-fatun · ríkjun þionon,
 —frēmida ferht-líko · frâon sines,
 110 godes jungar-skēpi · gerno swíðo
 mid hluttru hugi, · *só man hêrren skal
 112 gerno ful-gangan—, · grurjos kwámun im,
 ėgison an þem alaḥe: · hie gi·sah þár aftar þiu ėnna ėngil
 godes
 114 an þem wihe innan, · hie sprak im mid is wordun tuo,
 hiet þat fruod gumo · forḥt ni wári,
 116 hiet þat hie im ni an·driede: · „þína dádi sind“, kwaḥ-hie*,
 „waldanda werðe · ėndi þín word só self,
 118 þín þionost is im an þanke, · þat þú su-líka gi·þáht habes
 an is ėnes kraft. · Ik is ėngil bium,
 120 Gabriel bium ik hêtan, · þe gio for goda standu,
 and·ward for þem alo·waldon, · ne sí þat hé mé an is ârundi
 hwárod
 122 sęndjan willja. · Nú hiet hé mé an þesan sið faran,
 hiet þat ik þi þoh gi·küðdi, · þat þi kind gi·boran,
 124 fon þínera alderu idis · ôðan skoldi
 werðan an þesero wer-oldi, · wordun spáhi.
 126 Þat ni skal an is líba gio · líðes an·bitan,
 wínes an is wer-oldi: · só hæbed im wurd-gi·skapu,
 128 metod gi·markod · ėndi maht godes.
 Hét þat ik þi þoh sagdi, · þat it skoldi gi·sið wesan
 130 heban-kuninges, · hét þat git it heldin wel,
 tuhin þurh treuwa, · kwað þat hé im tíras só filu
 132 an godes ríkja · for·geban weldi.
 Hé kwað þat þe gódo gumo · Johannes te namon
 134 hebbjan skoldi, · gi·bôð þat git it hétin só,
 þat kind, þan it kwámi, · kwað þat it Krístes gi·sið

136 an þesaro wíðun wer-old · werðan skoldi,
 is selbes sunjes, · ɛndi kwað þat sie sliumo herod
 138 an is bod-skępi · bēðe kwámin.“
 Zakharias þó gi-mahalda · ɛndi wið selban sprak
 140 drohtines ɛngil, · ɛndi im þero dádjo bi-gan,
 wundron þero wordo: · „hwó mag þat gi-werðan só“, kwað hé,
 142 „aftar an aldre? · it is unk al te lat
 só te gi-winnanne, · só þú mid þínun wordun gi-spríkis.
 144 Hwanda wit habdun aldres · êr efno twên-tig
 wintro an unkro wer-oldi, · êr þan kwámi þit wíf te mí;
 146 þan wárun wit nú at-samna · ant-sibunta wintro
 gi-bɛnkjon ɛndi gi-bɛddjon, · siðor ik sie mí te brúdi ge-kôs.
 148 Só wit þes an unkro juguði · gi-girnan ni mohtun,
 þat wit ɛrbi-ward · égan móstin,
 150 fódjan an unkun flettja, · nú wit sus gi-fródod sint
 —habad unk ɛldi bi-noman · ɛlljan-dádi,
 152 þat wit sint an unkro siuni gi-slekit · ɛndi an unkun sídun lat;
 flêsk is unk ant-fallan, · fel un-skôni,
 154 is unka lud gi-liðen, · lík gi-drusnod,
 sind unka and-bári · ôðar-líkaron,
 156 mód ɛndi męgin-kraft—, · só wit giu só managan dag
 wárun an þesero wer-oldi, · só mí þes wundar þunkit,
 158 hwó it só gi-werðan mug, · só þú mid þínun wordun
 gi-spríkis.

TODO.

116 an·driede | The original segmenting of *an-dráðan* is *and-* + *ráðan*, but already by the time of *Heli* it had clearly been reanalyzed as *an(t)-dráðan*, as seen by the alliteration in the present line and by the variant spelling *antdráðan* seen throughout the poem. Cf. English *dread*, from OE *dréðan*, earlier *on-dréðan*.

3 Þó warð þat heban-kuninges bodon · harm an is móde,
 160 þat hé is gi-werkes · só wundron skolda
 ɛndi þat ni welda gi-huggjan, · þat ina mahta hêlag god
 162 só ala-jungan, · só hé fon êrist was,
 selbo gi-wirkjan, · of hé só weldi.
 164 Skęrida im þó te wítja, · þat hé ni mahte ênig word sprekan,
 gi-mahljen mid is müðu, · „êr þan þi magu wirðid,
 166 fon þínero aldero idis · erl a-fódit,
 kind-jung gi-boran · kunnjes gódes,
 168 wánum te þesero wer-oldi. · Þan skalt þú eft word sprekan,

hebbjan þínaro stemna gi-wald; · ni þarft þú stum wesan
 170 leŋgron hwíla.“ · Þó warð it sán gi-lêstid só,
 gi-worðan te wáron, · só þár an þem wíha gi-sprak
 172 ęgil þes alo-waldon: · warð ald gumo
 spráka bi-lôsit, · þoh hé spáhan hugi
 174 bári an is breostun. · Bidun allan dag
 þat werod for þem wíha · ęndi wundrodun alla,
 176 bi-hwí hé þár só lango, · lof-sálig man,
 swíðo fród gumo · frâon sínun
 178 þionon þorfti, · só þár êr ênig þegno ni deda,
 þan sie þár at þem wíha · waldandes geld
 180 folmon frumidun. · Þó kwam fród gumo
 út fon þem alaha. · Erlos þrungun
 182 náhor mikilu: · was im niud mikil,
 hwat hé im sôð-likes · sęggjan weldi,
 184 wísjan te wáron. · Hé ni mohta þó ênig word sprekan,
 gi-sęggjan þem gi-siðja, · b-útan þat hé mid is swíðron hand
 186 wísda þem weroda, · þat sie üses waldandes
 lêra lêstin. · Þea liudi for-stóðun,
 188 þat hé þár habda gegnungo · god-kundes hwat
 for-sehen selbo, · þoh hé is ni mahti gi-sęggjan wiht,
 190 gi-wísjan te wáron. · Þó habda hé üses waldandes
 geld gi-lêstid, · al só is gi-gęngi was
 192 gi-markod mid mannun. · Þó warð sán aftar þiu maht godes,
 gi-küðid is kraft mikil: · warð þiu kwán ôkan,
 194 idis an ira ęldju: · skolda im ęrbi-ward,
 swíðo god-kund gumo · gibiðig werðan,
 196 barn an burgun. · Bêd aftar þiu
 þat wíf wurdi-gi-skapu. · Skrêd þe wintar forð,
 198 géng þes gęres gi-tal. · Johannes kwam
 an liudjo lioht: · lík was im skôni,
 200 was im fel fagar, · fahs ęndi naglos,
 wangun wárun im wlitige. · Þó fórun þár wíse man,
 202 snelle te-samne, · þea swásostun mêst,
 wundrodun þes werkes, · bi-hwí it gio mahti gi-werðan só,
 204 þat undar só aldun twêm · ôðan wurði
 barn an gi-burdjon, · ni wári þat it gi-bod godes
 206 selbes wári: · af-suobun sie garo,
 þat it ęlkor só wán-lík · werðan ni mahti.

208 Þó sprak þár ên gi·fródot man, · þe só filo konsta
 wísaro wordo, · habde gi·wit mikil,
 210 frágode niud·liko, · hwat is namo skoldi
 wesan an þesaro wer·oldi: · „mí þunkid an is wísu gi·lík
 212 iak an is gi·bárja, · þat hé sí bætara þan wi,
 só ik wániu, þat ina us gegnungo · god fon himila
 214 selbo sęndi“. · Þó sprak sán aftar
 þiu módar þes kindes, · þiu þana magu habda,
 216 þat barn an ire barme: · „hér kwam gi·bod godes“, kwað siu,
 „fernun gęre, · furmon wordu
 218 gi·bôd, þat hé Johannes · bi godes lêrun
 hêtan skoldi. · Þat ik an mínumu hugi ni gi·dar
 220 węndjan mid wihti, · of ik is gi·waldan mót“.
 Þó sprak ên gël·hert man, · þe ira gaduling was:
 222 „ne hét êr io·wiht só“, (kwað hé,) „aðal·boranes
 üses kunnjes efþo knósles; · wita kiasan im öðrana
 224 niud·samna namon: · hé niate of hé móti“.
 Þó sprak eft þe fródo man, · þe þár konsta filo mahljan:
 226 „ni gibu ik þat te ráde“, (kwað hé,) „rinko neg·ênun,
 þat hé word godes · węndjan bi·ginna;
 228 ak wita is þana fader frágon, · þe þár só gi·fródod sitit,
 wís an is wín·sęli: · þoh hé ni mugi ênig word sprekan,
 230 þoh mag hé bi bók·stabon · bréf ge·wirkjan,
 namon gi·skríban“. · Þó hé náhor gęng,
 232 lęgda im êna bók an barm · ęndi bad gerno
 wrítan wís·líko · word·gi·merkjun,
 234 hwat sie þat hêlaga barn · hêtan skoldin.
 Þó nam hé þia bók an hand · ęndi an is hugi þahte
 236 swiðo gerno te gode: · Johannes namon
 wís·líko gi·wrêt · ęndi ôk aftar mid is wordu gi·sprak
 238 swiðo spáh·líko: · habda im eft is spráka gi·wald,
 gi·wittjas ęndi wísun. · Þat wíti was þó a·gangan,
 240 hard harm·skare, · þe im hêlag god
 mahtig makode, · þat hé an is mód·seþon
 242 godes ni for·gáti, · þan hé im eft sęndi is jungron tó.

TODO.

4 Þó ni was lang aftar þiu, · ne it al só gi·lêstid warð,
 244 só hé man·kunnja · managa hwíla,

god alo-mahtig · for·geben habda,
 246 þat hé is himilisk barn · herod te wer-oldi,
 sí selbes sunu · sændjan weldi,
 248 te þiu þat hé hér a·lōsdi · al liud-stamna,
 werod fon wítja. · Þó warð is wis-bodo
 250 an Galilea-land, · Gabriel kuman,
 ɛngil þes alo-waldon, · þár hé êne idis wisse,
 252 muni-líka magað: · María was siu hêten,
 was iru þiorna gi·þigan. · Sea ên þegan habda,
 254 Joseph gi·mahlit, · gódes kunnjes man,
 þea Dawides dohter: · þat was só diur-lík wíf,
 256 idis ant-hêti. · Þár sie þe ɛngil godes
 an Nazareth-burg · bi namon selbo
 258 grótte gegin-warde · ɛndi sie fon gode kwēdda:
 „Hêl wis þú, Maria“, (kwað hé,) „þú bist þínun hêrron liof,
 260 waldande wirðig, · hwand þú gi·wit habes,
 idis ɛnstjo fol. · Þú skalt for allun wesan
 262 wíðun gi·wíhit. · Ne habe þú wêkan hugi,
 ne forhti þú þínun ferhe: · ne kwam ik þi te ênigun frêson
 herod,
 264 ne dragu ik ênig drugi-þing. · Þú skalt üses drohtines wesan
 móðar mid mannun · ɛndi skalt þana magu fódjan,
 266 þes hôhon heban-kuninges suno. · Þe skal Hêljand te namon
 êgan mid ɛldjun. · Neo ɛndi ni kumid,
 268 þes wídon ríkjas gi·wand, · þe hé gi·waldan skal,
 mári þeodan.“ · Þó sprak im eft þiu magað an·gegin,
 270 wið þana ɛngil godes · idiso skônjost,
 allaro wíbo wlitigost: · „hwó mag þat gi·werðen só“, kwað siu,
 272 „þat ik magu fódje? · Ne ik gio mannes ni warð
 wís an mínara wer-oldi.“ · Þó habde eft is word garu
 274 ɛngil þes alo-waldon · þero idisiu te·gegnēs:
 „an þi skal hêlag gêst · fon heban-wange
 276 kuman þurh kraft godes. · Þanan skal þi kind ôðan
 werðan an þesaro wer-oldi; · waldandes kraft
 278 skal þi fon þem hôhoston · heban-kuninge
 skadowan mid skimon. · Ni warð skônjera gi·burd,
 280 ne só mári mid mannun, · hwand siu kumid þurh maht godes
 an þese wídon wer-old.“ · Þó warð eft þes wíbes hugi
 282 aftar þem ârundje · al gi·hworþen

an godes willjon. · „Þan ik hér garu standu“, kwað siu,
 284 „te su-líkun ambaht-skêpi, · só hé mí êgan wili.
 Þiu bium ik þeot-godes. · Nú ik þeses þinges gi-trúon;
 286 werðe mí aftar þínun wordun, · al só is willjo sí,
 hêrron mines; · nis mí hugi twíffi,
 288 ne word ne wísa.“ · Só gi-fragn ik, þat þat wíf ant-féng
 þat godes ârundi · gerno swíðo
 290 mid leohtu hugi · êndi mid gi-lôbon góðun
 êndi mid hluttrun treuwun; · warð þe hêlago gêt,
 292 þat barn an ira bósmá; · êndi siu ira breostun for-stód
 iak an ire sebon selbo, · sagða þem siu welda,
 294 þat sie habde gi-ôkana · þes alo-waldon kraft
 hêlag fon himile. · Þó warð hugi Josepes,
 296 is mód gi-worrid, · þe im êr þea magað habða,
 þea idis ant-hêttja, · aðal-knósles wíf
 298 gi-boht im te brúðju. · Hé af-sóf þat siu habða barn undar iru:
 ni wánda þes mid wihti, · þat iru þat wíf habði
 300 gi-wardod só waro-líko: · ni wisse waldandes þó noh
 blíði gi-bod-skêpi. · Ni welda sia imo te brúði þó,
 302 halon imo te híwon, · ak bi-gan im þó an hugi þenkjan,
 hwó hé sie só for-léti, · só iru þár nú wurði lêdes wiht,
 304 ôðan arbides. · Ni welda sie aftar þiu
 meldon for mēnigi: · ant-dréd þat sie manno barn
 306 líbu bi-námin. · Só was þan þero liudjo þau
 þurh þen aldon êw, · Ebreo folkes,
 308 só hwi-lik só þár an un-reht · idis gi-híwida,
 þat siu simbla þana bed-skêpi · buggjan skolda,
 310 frí mid ira ferhu: · ni was gio þiu fēmja só gód,
 þat siu mid þem liudun lēng · libbjen mósti,
 312 wesán undar þem weroda. · Bi-gan im þe wíso mann,
 swíðo gód gumo, · Joseph an is móða
 314 þenkjan þero þingo, · hwó hé þea þiornun þó
 listjun for-léti. · Þó ni was lang te þiu,
 316 þat im þár an drôma · kwam drohtines engil,
 hēban-kuninges bodo, · êndi hét sie ina haldan wel,
 318 minnjon sie an is móde: · „Ni wis þú“, kwað hé, „Mariun
 wrêð,
 þiornun þínaro; · siu is gi-þungan wíf;
 320 ne for-hugi þú sie te hardo; · þú skalt sie haldan wel,

wardon ira an þesaro wer-oldi. · Lêsti þú inka wini-treuwa
 322 forð só þú dádi, · ɛndi hald inkan friund-skepi wel!
 Ne lát þú sie þi þiu lêðaron, · þoh siu undar ira liðon êgi,
 324 barn an ira bósma. · It kumid þurh gi·bod godes,
 hêlages gêstes · fon heban-wanga:
 326 þat is Jêsu Krist, · godes êgan barn,
 waldandes sunu. · Þú skalt sie wel haldan,
 328 hêlag-liko. · Ne lát þú þi þinan hugi twiðfen,
 merrjan þina mód-gi·þáht.“ · Þó warð eft þes mannes hugi
 330 gi·wëndid aftar þem wordun, · þat hé im te þem wíba ge·nam,
 te þera magað minnja: · ant·kenda maht godes,
 332 waldandes gi·bod; · was im willjo mikil,
 þat hé sia só hêlag-liko · haldan mósti:
 334 bi·sorgoda sie an is gi·sīðja, · ɛndi siu só súbro dróg
 al te huldi godes · hêlagna gêst,
 336 gód·likan gumon, · ant·þat sie godes gi·skapu
 mahtig gi·manodun, · þat siu ina an manno lioht,
 338 allaro barno bêtst, · bręngjan skolda.

TODO.

266 heban-kuniges | so M; himilcuniges C

266 Hêljand te namon | The first appearance of the word which has given the whole poem its scholarly name; this is one of two places (cf. l. 443) where it is treated as a true proper noun, for which reason it is capitalized. Its presence is an undeniable sign of influence from an earlier work, the OHG Tatian, which in the corresponding passage (3:4, TODO: cite translated the Latin *concipies in utero et paries filium et vocabis nomen eius Ihesum* 'thou wilt conceive in your womb and bear a son, and thou wilt call his name Jesus' as OHG *nu in·fabis in reue inti gi·biris sun inti gi·nemnis sinan namon Heilant*. '... and thou wilt call his name Healend.' This is an important point for determining the sources of *Heli* since it shows that the poet did not rely directly on the Latin version, but rather on the OHG translation.

336 godes gi·skapu 'God's shapes' | TODO: some note about this.

338 allaro barno bêtst | A formula used throughout the poem. It may have inspired the later Otfrid, who in *Evangelienbuch* 1.13.10 calls Christ *barno bezista*.

5 Þó warð fon Rúmu-burg · rikes mannes
 340 obar alla þesa irmin-þiod · Oktawiánas
 ban ɛndi bod-skepi · obar þea is brêdon gi·wald
 342 kuman fon þem kêsure · kuningo gi·hwi·likun,
 hêm-sittjandjun, · só wído só is hêri-togon
 344 obar al þat land-skepi · liudjo gi·weldun.
 Hiet man þat alla þea ɛli-lęndjun man · iro óðil sóhtin,
 346 hêliðos iro hand-mah̄al · an·gegin iro hêrron bodon,

348 kwámi te þem knósla gi·hwe, · þanan hé kunnjas was,
 gi·boran fon þem burgjun. · Þat gi·bod warð gi·lêstid
 350 oðar þesa wídon wer-old; · werod samnoda
 te allaro burgjo gi·hwem. · Fórun þea bodon oðar all,
 352 þea fon þem kêsura · kumana wárun,
 bók-spáha weros, · ɛndi an bréf skribun
 354 swíðo niud-liko · namono gi·hwi-likan,
 ia land ia liudi, · þat im ni mahti a·lêttjan mann
 gumono su-liká gamba, · só im skolda geldan gi·hwe
 356 hêliðo fon is hôbda. · Þó gi·wêt im ôk mid is híwiska
 Joseph þe gódo, · só it god mahtig,
 358 waldand welda: · sóhta im þiu wánamon hêm,
 þea burg an Bethlehem, · þár iro bæiðero was,
 360 þes hêliðes hand-mahā* · ɛndi ôk þera hêlagun þiornun,
 Mariun þera gódun. · Þár was þes márjon stól
 362 an êr-dagun, · aðal-kuninges,
 Dawides þes gódon, · þan langa þe hé þana druht-skêpi þár,
 364 erl undar Ebreon · êgan mósta,
 haldan hôh-gi-setu. · Sie wárun is híwiskas,
 366 kuman fon is knósla, · kunnjas gódes,
 bêðju bi gi·burdjun. · Þár gi·fragn ik, þat sie þiu berhtun
 gi·skapu,
 368 Mariun gi·manodun · *ɛndi maht godes,
 þat iru an þem siða · sunu ôðan warð,
 370 gi·boran an Bethlehem · barno strangost,
 allaro kuningo krafftigost: · kuman warð þe márjo,
 372 mahtig an manno liht, · só is êr managan dag
 biliði wárun · ɛndi bôkno filu
 374 gi·worðen an þesero wer-oldi. · Þó was it all gi·wárod só,
 só it êr spáha man · gi·sprokan habdun,
 376 þurh hwi-lik ôð-módi · hé þit erð-ríki herod
 þurh is selbes kraft · sókjan welda,
 378 managaro mund-boro. · Þó ina þiu móðar nam,
 bi·wand ina mid wáðju · wíbo skônjost,
 380 fagaron fratahun, · ɛndi ina mid iro folmon twê
 lēgda liob-liko · lutilna man,
 382 þat kind an êna kribbjun, · þoh hé habdi kraft godes,
 manno drohtin. · Þár sat þiu móðar bi·foran,
 384 wíf wakojadi, · war*doda selbo,

held þat hêlaga barn: · ni was ira hugi twíflī,
 386 þera magað ira mód-sebo. · Þó warð þat managun küð
 obar þesa wídon wer-old, · wardos ant-fundun,
 388 þea þár ehu-skalkos · úta wárun,
 weros an wahtu, · wiggjo gômjan,
 390 fehas aftar fel*da: · gi-sáhun finistri an twê
 te-látan an lufte, · ęndi kwam lioht godes
 392 wánum þurh þiu wolkan · ęndi þea wardos þár
 bi-fęng an þem felda. · Sie wurðun an forhtun þó,
 394 þea man an ira móda: · gi-sáhun þár mahtigna
 godes ęngil kuman, · þe im te-geğnes sprak,
 396 hét þat im þea wardos · wiht ne ant-drédin
 lêðes fon þem liohta: · „ik skal eu“, kwað hé, „liobara þing,
 398 swíðo wár-liko · willjon seggjan,
 küðjan kraft mikil: · nú is Krist ge-boran
 400 an þeser*o selbun naht, · sálig barn godes,
 an þera Dawides burg, · drohtin þe gódo.
 402 Þat is męndislo · manno kunnjas,
 allaro firiho fruma. · Þár gí ina fiðan mugun,
 404 an Bethlema-burg · barno ríkjost:
 hebbjad þat te tēkna, · þat ik eu gi-telljan mag
 406 wárun wordun, · þat hé þár bi-wundan ligid,
 þat kind an ênera kribbjun, · þoh hé sí kuning obar al
 408 erðun ęndi himiles · ęndi obar ęldjo barn,
 wer-oldes waldand“. · Reht só hé þó þat word gi-sprak,
 410 só warð þár ęngilo te þem ênun · un-rím kuman,
 hêlag hęri-skępi · fon heban-wanga,
 412 fagar folk godes, · ęndi filu sprákun,
 lof-word manag · liudjo hêrron.
 414 Af-hóbun þó hêlagna sang, · þó sie eft te heban-wanga
 wundun þurh þiu wolkan. · Þea wardos hôrdun,
 416 hwó þiu ęngilo kraft · alo-mahtigna god
 swíðo werð-liko · wordun lobodun:
 418 „diuriða sí nú“, (kwáðun sie,) „drohtine selbun
 an þem hôhoston · himilo ríkja
 420 ęndi friðu an erðu · firiho barnun,
 gód-willigun gumun, · þem þe god ant-ķennjad
 422 þurh hluttran hugi.“ · Þea hirdjo for-stóðun,
 þat sie mahtig þing · gi-manod habda,

424 blíð·lík bod·skêpi: · gi·witun im te Bethleem þanan
 426 nahtes siðon; · was im niud mikil,
 þat sie selbon Krist · gi·sehan móstin.

TODO.

359 beidero | so *M* ('beidero') *S* ('beidera'); 'bethero' *C*

359 beidero | This very rare occurrence of the original diphthong, which almost everywhere else has been contracted to *ē*, is found in 2/3 witness mss. It also occurs at l. 2265; cf. l. 3674 n.

427 6 Habda im þe ęngil godes · al gi·wisid
 torhtun tēknun, · þat sie im tó selbun,
 429 te þem godes barne · gangan mahtun,
 ęndi fundun sán · folko drohtin,
 431 liudjo hērron. · Sagdun þó lof goda,
 waldande mid iro wordun · ęndi wído kúðdun
 433 oþar þea berhtun burg, · hwi·lík im þár biliði warð
 fon heban·wanga · hēlag gi·tôgit,
 435 fagaŕ an felde. · Þat frí al bi·held
 an ira hugi·skęftjun, · hēlag þiorna,
 437 þiu magað an ira móde, · só hwat só siu gi·hórda þea mann
 sprekan.
 Fódða ina þó fagaŕo · frího skânjosta,
 439 þiu módar þurh minnja · managaro drohtin,
 hēlag himilisk barn. · Hēliðos gi·sprákon
 441 an þem ahtodon daga · erlos managa,
 swíðo glauwa gumon · mid þera godes þiornun,
 443 þat hé Hêljand te namon · hębbjan skoldi,
 só it þe godes ęngil · Gabriel gi·sprak
 445 wáron wordun · ęndi þem wíbe gi·bôd,
 bodo drohtines, · þó siu ęrist þat barn ant·féng
 447 wánum te þesero wer·oldi; · was iru willjo mikil,
 þat siu ina só hēlag·liko · haldan mósti,
 449 ful·gęng im þó só gerno. · Þat gęŕ furðor skrêd
 unt·þat þat friðu·barn godes · fiar·tig habda
 451 dago ęndi nahto. · Þó skoldun sie þár ęna dád frummjan,
 þat sie ina te Jerusalem · for·geþan skoldun
 453 waldanda te þem wíha. · Só was iro wísa þan,
 þero liudjo land·sidu, · þat þat ni mósta for·látan ne·gên
 455 idis undar Ebreon, · ef iru at ęrist warð

457 sunu a·fódit, · ne siu ina simbla þarod
 te þem godes wíha · for·geban skolda.
 459 Gi·witun im þó þiu gódun twê, · Joseph ęndi Maria
 bēðju fon Bethleem: · habdun þat barn mid im,
 461 hêlagna Krist, · sóhtun im hús godes
 an Jerusalem; · þár skoldun sie is geld frummjan
 463 waldanda at þem wíha · wísa lēstjan
 Judeo folkes. · Þár fundun sea ênna góðan man
 465 aldan at þem alāha, · aðal-boranan,
 þe habda at þem wíha só filu · wintro ęndi sumaro
 467 gi·libd an þem liohta: · oft warhta hé þár lof goda
 mid hluttru hugi; · habda im hêlagna gēst,
 469 sálig-líkan sebon; · Simeon was hé hêtan.
 Im habda gi·wísid · waldandas kraft
 471 langa hwíla, · þat hé ni mósta êr þit lioht a·geban,
 węndjan af þesero wer-oldi, · êr þan im þe willjo gi·stódi,
 þat hé selban Krist · gi·sehan mósti,
 473 hêlagna heban-kuning. · Þó warð im is hugi swiðo
 blíði an is briostun, · þó hé gi·sah þat barn kuman
 475 an þena wíh innan. · Þuo sagda hie waldande þank,
 al-mahtigon gode, · þes hé ina mid is ôgun gi·sah.
 477 Géng im þó te·gęgnes · ęndi ina gerno ant·féng
 ald mid is armun: · al ant·kęnde
 479 bôkan ęndi biliði · ęndi ôk þat barn godes,
 hêlagna heban-kuning. · „Nú ik þi, hêrro, skal“, kwað hé,
 481 „gerno biddjan, · nú ik sus gi·gamalod bium,
 þat þú þínan holdan skalk · nú hinan hwerþan látas,
 483 an þína friðu-wára faran, · þár êr mína forðrun dedun,
 weros fon þesero wer-oldi, · nú mí þe willjo gi·stód,
 485 dago liobosto, · þat ik mínan drohtin gi·sah,
 holdan hêrron, · só mí gi·hêtan was
 487 langa hwíla. · Þú bist lioht mikil
 allun ęli-þiodun, · þea êr þes alo-waldon
 489 kraft ne ant·kęndun. · Þína kumi sindun
 te dóma ęndi te diurðon, · drohtin frô mín,
 491 aþarun Israhelas, · êganumu folke,
 þínun liobun *liudjun.“ · Listjun talde þó
 493 þe aldo man an þem alāha · idis þero góðun,
 sagda sôð-liko, · hwó iro sunu skolda

495 õbar þesan middil-gard · managun werðan
 sumun te falle, sumun te fróbru · firiho barnun,
 497 þem liudjun te leoba, · þe is lêrun gi·hórdin,
 ɛndi þem te harma, · þe hórjen ni weldin
 499 Kristas lêron. · „Þu skalt noh“, kwað hé, „kara þiggjan,
 harm an þinumu herton, · þan ina hêliðo barn
 501 wápnun wítnod. · Þat wirðid þi werk mikil,
 þrim te gi·þolonna.“ · Þiu þiorna al for·stód
 503 wísas mannas word. · Þó kwam þár ôk ên wíf gangan
 ald innan þem alaha: · Anna was siu hêtan,
 505 dohtar Fanueles; · siu habde ira drohtine wel
 gi·þionod te þanka, · was iru gi·þungan wíf.
 507 Siu mósta aftar ira magað-hêdi, · siðor siu mannes warð,
 erles an êhti · ɛðili þiorne,
 509 só mósta siu mid ira brúdi-gumon · bodlo gi·waldan
 sibun wintar saman. · Þó gi·fragn ik þat iru þár sorga gi·stód
 511 þat sie þiu mikila maht · metodes te·dêlda,
 wrêð wurdi-gi·skapu. · Þó was siu widowa aftar þiu
 513 at þem friðu-wíha · fior ɛndi ant·ahtoda
 wintro an iro wer-oldi, · só siu nia þana wíh ni for·lét,
 515 ak siu þár ira drohtine wel · dages ɛndi nahtes,
 gode þionode. · Siu kwam þár ôk gangan tó
 517 an þea selbun tíð: · sán ant·kênde
 þat hêlage barn godes · ɛndi þem hêliðon kûðde,
 519 þem weroda aftar þem wíha · wil·spel mikil,
 kwað þat im nêrjandas gi·nist · gi·náhid wári,
 521 helpa heban-kuninges: · „nú is þe hêlago Krist,
 waldand selbo · an þesan wíh kuman
 523 te a·lôsjenne þea liudi, · þe hér nú lango bidun
 an þesara middil-gard, · managa hwíla,
 525 þurftig þioda, · só nú þes þinges mugun
 męndjan man-kunni.“ · Manag fagonoda
 527 werod aftar þem wíha: · gi·hórdun wil·spel mikil
 fon gode sęggjan. · Þat geld habde þó gi·lêstid
 529 þiu idis an þem alaha, · al só it im an ira êwa gi·bôð
 ɛndi an þera berhtun burg · bók gi·wísdun,
 531 hêlagaro hand-gi·werk. · Gi·witun im þó te hús þanan
 fon Jerusalem · Joseph ɛndi Maria,
 533 hêlag híwiski: · habdun im heban-kuning

simbla te gi·siða, · sunu drohtines,
 535 managaro mund-boron, · só it gio mári ni warð
 þan wíðor an þesaro wer-oldi, · b-útan só is willjo gégng,
 537^a heban-kuninges hugi.

TODO.

537^b 7 Þoh þár þan gi·hwi-lík hêlag man
 Krist ant·kendi, · þoh ni warð it gio te þes kuninges hobe
 539 þem mannun gi·márid, · þea im an iro mód-sebon
 holde ni wárun, · ak was im só bi·halden forð
 541 mid wordun endi mid werkun, · ant-þat þár weros ôstan,
 swíðo glauwa gumon · gangan kwámun
 543 þrea te þero þiodu, · þegnos snelle,
 an langan weg · oþar þat land þarod:
 545 folgodun ênun berhtun bôkne · endi sóhtun þat barn godes
 mid hluttru hugi: · weldun im hnígan tó,
 547 gehan im te jungrun: · driþun im godes gi·skapu.
 Þó sie Eródesan þár · ríkJan fundun
 549 an is sæli sittjen, · slið-wurdjan kuning,
 móðagna mid is mannun: · —simbla was hé morðes gern—
 551 þó kwaddun sie ina kúsko · an kuning-wisun,
 fagaþo an is flêttje, · endi hé frágoda sán,
 553 hwi-lík sie ârundi · úta gi·bráhti,
 weros an þana wrak-sið: · „Hweðer lêðjad gí wundan gold
 555 te gebu hwi-likun gumuno? · te hwi gí þus an ganga kumad,
 gi·faran an fóðju? · Hwat gí n-êt-hwanan ferran sind
 557 erlos fon ôðrun þiodun. · Ik gi·sihu þat gí sind
 ẽðili-gi·burdjun
 kunnjes fon knósle góðun: · nio hér êr su-líka kumana ni
 wurðun
 559 êri fon ôðrun þiodun, · siðor ik mósta þesas erlo folkes,
 gi·waldan þesas wídon ríkJas. · Gí skulun mí te wárun seggjan
 561 for þesun liudjo folke, · bi·hwí gí sín te þesun lande kumana“.
 Þó sprákon im eft te gegnes · gumon ôstr-onja,
 563 word-spáhe weros: · „wí þí te wárun mugun“, kwáðun sie,
 „úse ârundi · ôðo gi·têlljen,
 565 gi·seggjan sôð-líko, · bi·hwí wí kwámun an þesan sið herod
 fon ôstan te þesaro erðu. · Giu wárun þár aðaljes man,
 567 góð-sprákja gumon, · þea ús gódes só filu,

569 helpa gi·hétun · fon heban-kuninge
 wárum wordun. · Þan was þár ên gi·wittig man,
 fród êndi fil-wís · —forn was þat giu—,
 571 úse aldiro ôstar hinan, · —þár ni warð siðor ênig man
 sprákono só spáhi—; · hé mahte rekkjen spel godes,
 573 hwand im habde for·liwan · liudjo hêrro,
 þat hé mahte fon erðu · up gi·hôrjan
 575 waldandes word: · bi·þiu was is gi·wit mikil,
 þes þegnes gi·þáhti. · Þó hé þanan skolda,
 577 a·geben gardos, · gadulingo gi·mang,
 for·lâten liudjo drôm, · sókjen lioht ôðar,
 579 þó hé is jungron hét · gangan nâhor,
 erbi·wardos, · êndi is erlun þó
 581 sagde sôð-liko: · —þat al siðor kwam,
 gi·warð* an þesaro wer-oldi—: · þó sagda hé þat hér skoldi
 kuman ên wís-kuning
 583 mári êndi mahtig · an þesan middil-gard
 þes bêtston gi·burdjes; · kwað þat it skoldi wesán barn godes,
 585 kwað þat hé þesero wer-oldes · waldan skoldi
 gio te êwan-daga, · erðun êndi himiles.
 587 Hé kwað þat an þem selbon daga, · þe ina sáligna
 an þesan middil-gard · móðar gi·drógi,
 589 só kwað hé þat ôstana · ên skoldi skínan
 himil-tungál hwít, · su-lík só wí hér ne habdin êr
 591 undar·twisk erða êndi himil · ôðar hwërgin,
 ne su-lík barn ne su-lík bôkan. · Hét þat þár te bedu fôrin
 593 þrea man fon þero þiodu, · hét sie þenkjan wel,
 hwan êr sie gi·sáwin ôstana · up siðojan,
 595 þat godes bôkan gangan, · hét sie garwjan sán,
 hét þat wí im folgodin, · só it furi wurði,
 597 westar oðar þesa wer-oldi. · Nú is it al gi·wárod só,
 kuman þurh kraft godes: · þe kuning is gi·fôdit,
 599 gi·boran bald êndi strang: · wí gi·sáhun is bôkan skínan
 hêdro fon himiles tunglun, · só ik wêt, þat it hêlag drohtin,
 601 markoda mahtig selbo; · wí gi·sáhun morgno gi·hwi-likes
 blíkan þana berhton sterron, · êndi wí gëngun aftar þem
 bôkna herod
 603 wegas êndi waldas hwílon. · Þat wári ús allaro willjono mêsta,

- þat wí ina **sel**bon gi·**se**han móstin, · wissin, hwár wí ina **sók**jan
skoldin,
605 þana **k**uning an þesumu **k**êsur-dóma. · Saga ùs, undar
hwi·líkumu hé sí þesaro **k**unngo a·fódit.“
- Þó warð **E**rodesa · **i**nnan briostun
607 **h**arm wið **h**erta, · bi·gan im is **h**ugi wallan,
sebo mid **s**orgun: · gi·hörde **s**eggjan þó,
609 þat hé þár **o**bar-hôbðon · **ê**gan skoldi,
kraftagoron **k**uning · **k**unnjes gódes,
611 **s**áligoron undar þem gi·**s**íðja. · Þó hé **s**amnon hét,
só hwat só an **J**erusalem · **g**ódaro manno
613 allaro **s**páhoston · **s**prákono wárun
endi an iro **b**rioston · **b**ók-kraftes mêst
615 **w**issun te wárun, · endi hé sie mid **w**ordun fragn,
swíðo **n**iud-líko · **n**íð-hugdig man,
617 **k**uning þero liudjo, · hwár **K**rist gi·boran
an **w**er-old-ríkja · **w**erðan skoldi,
619 **f**riðu-gumono bêtst. · Þó sprak im eft þat **f**olk an·gegin,
þat **w**erod wár-líko, · kwáðun þat sie **w**issin garo,
621 þat hé skoldi an **B**ethleem gi·boran werðan: · „só is an ùsun
bókun gi·skriban,
wís-líko gi·**w**ritan, · só it wár-sagon,
623 swíðo **g**lauwa **g**umon · bi **g**odes krafta
fil-wíse man · **f**urn gi·sprákon,
625 þat skoldi fon **B**ethleem · **b**urgo hirdi,
liof landes ward · an þit **l**ioht kuman,
627 **r**íki **r**ád-gebo, · þe rihtjen skal
Judeono **g**um-skêpi · endi is **g**eba wesan
629 **m**ildi oðar **m**iddil-gard · **m**anagun þiodun.“

TODO.

557–561 erlos ... kumana | *Ll. 557a–560b and 561b are hypermetrical (Suzuki 2004, p. 380).*

554 **w**undan gold | Formulaic, belonging to the culture of the Germanic Migration Period.

599–605 wí ... a·fódit | *Ll. 599b–602a, 603a–605b are hypermetrical (Suzuki 2004, pp. 380–381).*
The contrast between the length of 605b, the last verse of speech, and 606, spoken in the voice of
the narrative poet, is notable.

- 8 Þó gi·fragn ik þat **s**án aftar þiu · **s**líð-mód kuning
631 þero wár-sagono **w**ord · þem **w**rëkkjun sagða,
þea þár an **ê**li-lendi · **e**rlos wárun

633 ferran gi·farana, · ɛndi hé frágoda aftar þiu,
 hwan sie an ôstar-wegun · êrist gi·sáhin
 635 þana kuning-sterron kuman, · kumbal liuhtjen
 hêdro fon himile. · Sie ni weldun is im þó helen eo·wiht,
 637 ak sagdun it im sóð-líko. · Þó hét hé sie an þana sið faran,
 hét þat sie ira ârundi al · undar fundin
 639 umbi þes kindes kumi, · ɛndi þe kuning selbo gi·bôd
 swiðo hard-liko, · hêrro Judeono,
 641 þem wísun mannun, · êr þan sie fórin westan forð,
 þat sie im eft gi·küðin, · hwár hé þana kuning skoldi
 643 sókjan at is seðon; · kwað þat hé þár weldi mid is gi·siðun tó,
 bedan te þem barne. · Þan hogda hé im te banon werðan
 645 wápnes eggjun. · Þan eft waldand god
 þáhte wið þem þinga: · hé mahta a·þengjan mêt,
 647 gi·lêstjan an þesum liohte: · þat is noh lango skín,
 gi·küðid kraft godes. · Þó géngun eft þiu kumbl forð
 649 wánum undar wolknun. · Þó wárun þea wíson man
 fûsa te faranne: · gi·witun im forð þanan
 651 balda an bod-skêpi: · weldun þat barn godes
 selbon sókjan. · Sie ni habdun þanan gi·siðjas mêt,
 653 b·útan þat sie þríe wárun: · wissun im þingo gi·skêð,
 wárun im glauwe gumon, · þe þea geba lêddun.
 655 Þan sáhun sie só wís-liko · undar þana wolknas skion,
 up te þem hôhon himile, · hwó fórun þea hwíton sterron
 657 —ant·kêndun sie þat kumbal godes—, · þiu wárun þurh

Krista herod

gi·warht te þesero wer-oldi. · Þea weros aftar géngun,
 659 folgodun feráht-liko · —sie frumide þe mahte—
 ant-þat sie gi·sáhun, · sið-wórige man,
 661 berht bôkan godes, · blêk an himile
 stillo gi·standen. · Þe sterro liohto skên
 663 hwít obar þem húse, · þár þat hêlage barn
 wonode an willjon · ɛndi ina þat wíf bi·held,
 665 þiu þiorne gi·þiudo. · Þó warð þero þegno hugi
 blíði an iro briostun: · bi þem bôkna for-stóðun,
 667 þat sie þat friðu-barn godes · funden habdun,
 hêlagna heban-kuning. · Þó sie an þat hús innan
 669 mid iro geþun géngun, · gumon ôstr-onja,
 sið-wórige man: · sán ant·kêndun

- 671 þea weros waldand Krist. · Þea wrækkjon fellun
te þem kinde an kneo-beda · ʒndi ina an kuning-wisa
673 góðan gróttun · ʒndi im þea geba drógun,
gold ʒndi wih-rôk · bi godes tēknun
675 *ʒndi myrra þár mid. · Þea man stóðun garowa,
holde for iro hērron, · þea it mid iro handun sán
677 fagaro ant-fēngun. · Þó gi-witun im þea ferāhton man,
seggi te seþðon · sið-wórige,
679 gumon an gast-seþi. · Þár im godes ʒngil
slápandjun an naht · sweban gi-tôgde,
681 gi-drog im an drôme, · al so it drohtin self,
waldand welde, · þat im þuhte þat man im mid wordun
gi-budi,
683 þat sie im* þanan ôðran weg, · erlos fórin,
liðodin sie te lande · ʒndi þana lêðan man,
685 Erodesan · eft ni sóhtin,
móðagna kuning. · Þó warð morgan kuman
687 wánum te þesero wer-oldi. · Þó bi-gunnun þea wíson man
seggjan iro swebanos; · selbon ant-kēndun
689 waldandes word, · hwand sie gi-wit mikil
bárun an iro briostun: · bádun alo-waldon,
691 hēron heban-kuning, · þat sie móstin is huldi forð,
gi-wirkjan is willjon, · kwáðun þat sea ti im habdin gi-wēndit
hugi,
693 *iro mód morgan gi-hwem. · Þó fórun eft þie man þanan,
erlos ôstr-onje, · al só im þe ʒngil godes
695 wordun gi-wisde: · námun im weg ôðran,
ful-géngun godes lêrun: · ni weldun þemu Judeo kuninge
697 umbi þes barnes gi-burd · bodon ôstr-onje,
sið-wórige man · seggjan gio-wiht,
699^a ak wēndun im eft an iro willjon.

TODO.

- 699^b 9 Þó warð sán aftar þiu waldandes,
godes ʒngil kumen · Josepe te sprákun,
701 sagde im an swefne · slápandjun an naht,
bodo drohtines, · þat þat barn godes
703 slíð-mód kuning · sókjan welda,
áhtjan is aldres; · „nú skaltu ine an Aegypteo

705 land ant·lêdjan · ɛndi undar þem liudjun wesn
 mid þiu godes barnu · ɛndi mid þeru góðan þior*nan,
 707 wunon undar þemu werode, · unt·þat þi word kume
 hêrron þínes, · þat þú þat hêlage barn
 709 eft te þesum land-skepi · lêdjan mótis,
 drohtin þínen.“ · Þó fon þem drôma an·sprang
 711 Joseph an is gëst-seli, · ɛndi þat godes gi·bod
 sán ant·kenda: · gi·wêt im an þana sið þanen
 713 þe þegan mid þeru þiornon, · sóhta im þiod ôðra
 obar brêdan berg: · welda þat barn godes
 715 fiundun ant·fórjan. · *Þó gi·frang aftar þiu
 Eródes þe kuning, · þár hé an is rikja sat,
 717 þat wárun þea wíson man · westan gi·hworban
 ôstar an iro óðil · ɛndi fórun im ôðran weg:
 719 wisse þat sie im þat ârundi · eft ni weldun
 seggjan an is seððon. · Þó warð im þes an sorgun hugi,
 721 mód mornondi, · kwað þat it im þie man dedin,
 hêliðos* te hônðun. · Þó hé só hriuwig sat,
 723 balg ina an is briostun, · kwað þat hé is mahti bêtaron rád,
 ôðran gi·þenkjen: · „nú ik is alðar kan,
 725 wêt is winter-gi·talú: · nú ik gi·winnan mag,
 þat hé io obar þesaro erðu · ald ni wirðit,
 727 hêr undar þesum hêri-skepi.“ · Þó hé só hardo gi·bôð,
 Eródes obar is ríki, · hét þó is rinkos faran
 729 kuning þero liudjo, · hét þat sie kinda só filo
 þurh iro hand-magen · hôbdu bi·námin,
 731 só manag barn umbi Bethlehem, · só filo só þár gi·boran wurði,
 an twêm gérun a·togan. · Tionon frumidon
 733 þes kuninges gi·siðos. · Þó skolda þár só manag kindisk man
 sweltan sundjono lôs. · Ni warð sið noh êr
 735 jámar-líkara for·gang · jungaro manno,
 arm-líkara dôð. · Idisi wiopun,
 737 módar managa, · gi·sáhun iro megi spildjan:
 ni mahte siu im nio gi·formon, · þoh siu mid iro faðmon twêm
 739 iro êgan barn · armun bi·féngi,
 liof ɛndi luttill, · þoh skolda is simbla þat líf geþan,
 741 þe magu for þeru módar. · Mênes ni sáhun,
 wítjes þie wam-skaðon: · wápnes eggjun
 743 frëmidun firin-werk mikil. · Fellun managa

745 magu-junge man. · Þia módar wiopun
 kind-jungaro kwalm; · kara was an Bethleem,
 747 hofno hlúdost: · þoh man im iro herton an twê
 sniði mid swerdu, · þoh ni mohta im gio sêrara dád
 749 werðan an þesaro wer-oldi, · wiþun managun,
 brúðjun an Bethleem: · gi·sáhun iro barn bi·foran,
 kind-junge man, · kwalmu sweltan
 751 blódag an iro barmun. · Þie banon wítnodun
 un·skuldige skole: · ni bi·skribun gio·wiht
 753 þea man umbi mên-werk: · weldun mahtigna,
 Krist selbon a·kwêlljan. · Þan habde ina kraftag god
 755 gi·nêridan wið iro níðe, · þat inan nahtes þanan
 an Aegypteo land · erlos ant·lêddun,
 757 gumon mid Josepe · an þana grónjon wang,
 an erðono bêtstun, · þár ên aha flutid,
 759 Nil·strôm mikil · norð te sêwa,
 flódo fagorosta. · Þár þat friðu-barn godes
 761 wonoda an willjon, · ant·þat wurd for·nam
 Erodes þana kuning, · þat hé for·lét êldjo barn,
 763 módag manno drôm. · Þó skolda þero marka gi·wald
 êgan is êrbi·ward: · þe was Arkheláus
 765 hêtan, hêri·togo · helm·berandero:
 þe skolda umbi Jerusalem · Judeono folkes,
 767 werodes gi·waldan. · Þó warð word kuman
 þár an Egypti · êðiljun manne,
 769 þat hé þár te Josepe, · godes êngil sprak,
 bodo drohtines, · hét ina eft þat barn þanan
 771 lêdjen te lande. · „nú habað þit lioht af·geben“, kwað hé,
 „Erodes þe kuning; · hé welde is áhtjen giu,
 773 frêson is ferahas. · Nú maht þú an friðu lêdjen
 þat kind undar euwa kunni, · nú þe kuning ni libod,
 775 erl oðar·módig.“ · Al ant·kênde
 Josep godes têkan: · gêriwide ina sniumo
 777 þe þegan mit þera þiornun, · þó sie þanan weldun
 bêðju mid þiu barnu: · lêstun þiu berhton gi·skapu,
 779 waldandes willjon, · al só hé im êr mid is wordun gi·bôd.

TODO.

10 Gi·witun im þó eft an Galilea·land · Joseph êndi Maria,

781 hêlag hîwiski · heban-kuninges,
 wárun im an Nazareth-burg. · Þár þe nêrjondjo Krist
 783 wóhs undar þem werode, · warð gi·wittjes ful,
 an was imu anst godes, · hé was allun liof
 785 módar·mágun: · hé ni was ôðrun mannun gi·lík,
 þe gumo an sínera gódi. · Þó hé gêr·talo
 787 twe·líbi habde, · þó warð þiu tíð kuman,
 þat sie þár te Jerusalem, · Juðeo liudi
 789 iro þiod·gode · þionon skoldun,
 wirkjan is willjon. · Þó warð þár an þana wih innan
 791 þár te Jerusalem · Judeono gi·samnod
 man·kraft mikil. · Þár Maria was
 793 self an gi·síðja · êndi iru sunu habda,
 godes êgan barn. · Þó sie þat geld habdun,
 795 erlos an þem alaha, · só it an iro êwa gi·bôd,
 gi·lêstid te iro land·wísun, · þó fórun im eft þie liudi þanan,
 797 weros an iro willjon · êndi þár an þem wiha af·stód
 mahtig barn godes, · só ina þiu módar þár
 799 ni wissa te wáron; · ak siu wánda þat hé mid þem weroda forð,
 fóri mit iro friundun. · Gi·frang aftar þiu
 801 eft an ôðrun daga · aðal·kunnjes wíf,
 sálig þiorna, · þat hé undar þem gi·síðja ni was.
 803 warð Mariun þó · mód an sorgun,
 hriuwig umbi iro herta, · þó siu þat hêlaga barn
 805 ni fand undar þem folka: · filu gornoda
 þiu godes þiorna. · Gi·witun im þó eft te Jerusalem
 807 iro sunu sókjan, · fundun ina sittjan þár
 an þem wiha innan, · þár þe wísa man,
 809 swíðo glauwa gumon · an godes êwa
 lásun ênde línodun, · hwó sie lof skoldin
 811 wirkjan mid iro wordun þem, · þe þesa wer·old gi·skóp.
 Þár sat undar middjun · mahtig barn godes,
 813 Krist alo·waldo, · só is þea ni mahtun ant·kênnjan wiht,
 þe þes wíhes þár · wardon skoldun,
 815 êndi frá·goda sie · firi·wit·líko
 wísera wordo. · Sie wundradun alle,
 817 bi·hwí gio só kindisk man · su·líka kwidi mahti
 mid is müðu gi·mênjan. · Þár ina þiu módar fand
 819 sittjan under þem gi·síðja · êndi iro sunu grótta,

- wísan undar þem weroda, · sprak im mid ira wordun tó:
 821 „hwí weldes þú þínera módar, · manno liobosto,
 gi·sidon su-líka sorga, · þat ik þí só sêrag-mód,
 823 idis arm-hugdig · êskon skolda
 undar þesun burg-liudjun?“ · Þó sprak iru eft þat barn
 an·gëgin
 825 wísun wordun: · „Hwat þú wêst garo“, kwað hé,
 „þat ik þár gi·rísu, · þár ik bi rehton skal
 827 wonon an willjon, · þár gi·wald habad
 mín mahtig fader.“ · Þie man ni for·stódun,
 829 þie weros an þem wiha, · bi·hwí hé só þat word gi·sprak,
 gi·mênda mid is müðu: · Maria al bi·held,
 831 gi·barg an ira breostun, · só hwat só siu gi·hôrda ira barn
 sprekan
 wísaro wordo. · Gi·witun im þó eft þanan
 833 fon Jerusalem · Joseph êndi Maria,
 habdun im te gi·sîðja · sunu drohtines,
 835 allaro barno bêtsta, · þero þe io gi·boran wurði
 magu fon módar: · habdun im þár minnja tó
 837 þurh hluttran hugi, · êndi hé só gi·hôrig was,
 godes êgan barn · gaduling-mágun
 839 þurh is ôd-módi, · aldron sínun:
 ni welda an is kindiski þó noh · is kraft mikil
 841 mannun márjan, · þat hé su-lík mëgin êhta,
 gi·wald an þesaro wer-oldi, · ak hé im an is willjon bêd
 843 gi·þiudo undar þero þiodu · þrí-tig gëro,
 êr þan hé þár tēkan ênig · tōgjan weldi,
 845 seggjan þem gi·sîðja, · þat hé selbo was
 an þesaro middil-gard · manno drohtin.
 847 Habda im só bi·halden · hêlag barn godes
 word êndi wís-dóm · ênde allaro gi·wittjo mêt,
 849 tulgo spáhan hugi: · ni mahta man is an is sprákon werðan,
 an is wordun gi·war, · þat hé su-lík gi·wit êhta,
 851 þegan su-líka gi·þahti, · ak hé im só gi·þiudo bêd
 torhtaro tēkno. · Ni was noh þan þiu tid kuman,
 853 þat hé ina oðar þesan middil-gard · márjan skolda,
 lērjan þie liudi, · hwó sie skoldin iro gi·lōbon haldan,
 855 wirkjan willjon godes; · wissun þat þoh managa
 liudi aftar þem landa, · þat hé was an þit lioht kuman,

- sundjono sikoron, · só hwene só só sálíg mót
 893 werðen an þesaro wer-oldi, · þat þes willjon habad,
 þat hé só gi·lêstja, · só hé þesun liudjun wili,
 895 gi·bioden barn godes. · Ik bium an is bod-skêpi herod
 an þesa wer-old kumen · êndi skal im þana weg rúmjen,
 897 lêrjan þesa liudi, · hwó sea skulin iro gi·lôbon haldan
 þurh hluttran hugi, · êndi þat sie an hêlja ni þurbin,
 899 faran an fern þat hêta. · Þes wirðid só fagan an is móde
 man te só managaro stundu, · só hwe só þat mên for·látid,
 901 gerno þes gramon an·busni, · —só mag im þes gódon
 gi·wirkjan,
 huldi heban-kuninges,— · só hwe só habad hluttra treuwa
 903 up te þem alo-mahtigon gode.“ · Erlos managa
 bi þem lêrun þó, · liudi wándun,
 905 weros wár-liko, · þat þat waldand Krist
 selbo wári, · hwanda hé só filu sôðes gi·sprak,
 907 wároro wordo. · Þó warð þat só wido küð
 oðar þat for·gebana land · gumono gi·hwi·líkum,
 909 seggjun at iro sełðun: · þó kwámun ina sókjan þarod
 fon Jerusalem · Judeo liudjo
 911 bodon fon þeru burgi · êndi frágodun, ef hé wári þat barn
 godes,
 „þat hér lango giu“, (kwáðun sie,) „liudi sagdun,
 913 weros wár-liko, · þat hé skoldi an þesa wer-old kuman“.
 Johannes þó gi·mahalde · êndi te·gegnes sprak
 915 þem bodun bald-liko: · „ni bium ik“, kwað hé, „þat barn
 godes,
 wár waldand Krist, · ak ik skal im þana weg rúmjen,
 917 hêrron mínum.“ · Þea hêliðos frugnun,
 þea þár an þem ârundje · erlos wárun,
 919 bodon fon þero burgi: · „ef þú nú ni bist þat barn godes,
 bist þú þan þoh Elias, · þe hér an êr-dagun
 921 was undar þesumu werode? · hé is wis-kumo
 eft an þesan middil-gard. · Saga ús, hwat þú manno sís!
 923 Bist þú ênig þero, · þe hér êr wári
 wísaro wár-saguno? · Hwat skulun wí þem werode fon þi
 925 seggjan te sôðon? · Neo hér êr su-lík ni warð
 an þesun middil-gard · man oðar kuman
 927 dádjun só mári. · Bi·hwí þú hér dôpislí

frēm̃is undar þesumu folke, · ef þú þaro fora·sagono
 929 ên·hwi·lík ni bist?“ · Þó habde eft garo
 Johannes þe gódo · glau and·wordi:
 931 „Ik bium fora·bodo · frâon mínes,
 liobes hêrron; · ik skal þit land rekon,
 933 þit werod aftar is willjon. · Ik hêbbju fon is worde mid mí
 stranga stemna, · þoh sie hér ni willje for·standan filo
 935 werodes an þesaro wóstunni. · Ni bium ik mid wihti gi·lík
 drohtine mínum: · hé is mid is dádjun só strang,
 937 só mári êndi só mahtig · —þat wirðid managun kûð,
 werun aftar þesaro wer·oldi— · þat ik þes wirðig ni bium,
 939 þat ik móti an is gi·skuoha, · þoh ik sí is skalk êgan,
 an só ríkjumu drohtine, · þea reomon ant·bindan:
 941 só mikilu is hé bêtara þan ik. · Nis þes bodon gi·mako
 ênig obar erðu, · ne nú aftar ni skal
 943 werðan an þesaro wer·oldi. · Hêbbjad euwan willjon þarod,
 liudi euwan gi·lôbon: · þan eu lango skal
 945 wesan euwa hugi hrómag; · þan gí hêlli·gi·þwing,
 for·látad lêðaro drôm · êndi sókjad eu lioht godes,
 947 up·ôdes hêm, · êwig ríki,
 hôhan heban·wang. · Ne látad euwan hugi twífljan!“

TODO.

881 lédas ... hôrjad | Hypermetrical (Suzuki 2004, p. 385).

897–903 hwó ... gode. | LL 897b, 898b–901b, 902b–903a are hypermetrical (Suzuki 2004, p. 386).
 Note the contrast between hypermetrical 903a and normal 903b; cf. ll. 605–6 above.

925 seggjan te sóðon | Formulaic, also found in *Heli* 2077a, 4018a, 4988a, along with *Beow* 51a:
seggan tó sôðe.

949 **12** Só sprak þó jung gumo · bi godes lêrun
 mannun te márðu. · Manag samnoda
 951 þár te Bethania · barn Israheles;
 kwámun þár te Johannese · kuningo gi·siðos,
 953 liudi te lêrun · êndi iro gi·lôbon ant·féngun.
 Hé dôpte sie dago gi·hwi·likes · êndi im iro dádi lóg,
 955 wrêðaro willjon, · êndi lobode im word godes,
 hêrron sínes: · „heban·ríki wirðid“, kwað hé,
 957 „garu gumono só hwem, · só ti gode þenkid
 êndi an þana hêljand *wili · hluttro gi·lôbjan,
 959 léstjan is lêra“. · Þó ni was lang te þiu,

þat im fon Galilea gi-wêt · godes êgan barn,
 961 *diur-lik drohtines sunu, · dôpi suokjan.
 was im þuo an is wastme · waldandes barn*,
 963 al só hé mid þero þiodu · þrí-tig habdi
 wintro an is wer-oldi. · þó hé an is willjon kwam,
 965 þár Johannes · an Jordana strôme
 allan langan dag · liudi manage
 967 dôpte diur-liko. · Reht só hé þó is drohtin gi-sah,
 holdan hêrron, · só warð im is hugi blíði,
 969 þes im þe willjo gi-stód, · ęndi sprak im þó mid is wordun tó,
 swíðo gód gumo, · Johannes te Kriste:
 971 „nú kumis þú te mínero dôpi, · drohtin frô mín,
 þiod-gumono bętsto: · só skolde ik te þínero duan,
 973 hwand þú bist allaro kuningo kraftigost.“ · Krist selbo gi-bôd,
 waldand wár-liko, · þat hé ni spráki þero wordo þan mēr:
 975 „wêst þú, þat ős só gi-rísid“, (kwað hé,) „allaro rehto gi-hwi-lik
 te gi-fulljanne · forð-wardes nú
 977 an godes willjon“. · Johannes stód,
 dôpte allan dag · druht-folk mikil,
 979 werod an watere · ęndi ôk waldand Krist,
 hêran heban-kuning · handun sínun
 981 an allaro baðo þem bętston · ęndi im þár te bedu gi-hnêg
 an kneo kraftag. · Krist up gi-wêt
 983 faġar fon þem flóde, · friðu-barn godes,
 liof liudjo ward. · Só hé þó þat land af-stóp,
 985 só ant-hlidun þó himiles doru, · ęndi kwam þe hêlago gęst
 fon þem alo-waldon · obane te Kriste:
 987 —was im an gi-lik-nissje · lungras fugles,
 diur-likara dúbun— · ęndi sat im uppan őses drohtines ahslu,
 989 wonoda im oðar þem waldandes barne. · Aftar kwam þár
 word fon himile,
 hlúd fon þem hōhon radura · ęndi gróttu þane hêljand selbon,
 991 Krista, allaro kuningo bętston, · kwað þat hé ina gi-korana
 habdi
 selbo fon sínun ríkja, · kwað þat im þe sunu likodi
 993 bętst allaro gi-boranaro manno, · kwað þat hé im wári allaro
 barno liobost.
 Þat móste Johannes þó, · al só it god welde,
 995 gi-sehan ęndi gi-hōrjan. · Hé gi-deda it sán aftar þiu

mannun **mári**, · þat sie þár **mahtigna**
 997 hêrron **habdun**: · „Þit is“, kwað **hé**, „**heban**-kuninges sunu,
 ên **alo**-waldand: · þesas willjo ik **ur**-kundjo
 999 **wesan** an þesaro **wer**-oldi, · hwand it sagda mí **word** godes,
drohtines stemne, · þó **hé** mí **dôpjan** hét
 1001 **weros** an **watare**, · só **hwár** só ik gi·sáwi **wár**-líko
 þana **hêlagon** gêst · *fan **heban**-wange
 1003 an þesan **middil**-gard · ênigan **man** waron,
kuman mid **kraftu**; · þat kwað, þat skoldi **Krist** **wesan**,
 1005 **diur**-lík **drohtines** suno. · Hie **dôpjan** skal
 an þana **hêlagan** gêst · êndi **hêljan** managa
 1007 **manno** **mên**-dádi. · Hé habad **maht** fon gode,
 þat **hé** a·látan mag · **liudjo** gi·hwi·líkun
 1009 **saka** êndi **sundja**. · Þit is **selbo** **Krist**,
godes êgan barn, · **gumono** bêtsto,
 1011 **friðu** wið **fiundun**. · Wala þat eu þes mag **frâh**-mód hugi
wesan an þesaro **wer**-oldi, · þes eu þe **willjo** gi·stód,
 1013 þat **gí** só **libbjanda** · þana **landes** ward
selbon gi·sáhun. · Ní **mót** sliumo **sundjono** lôs
 1015 manag **gêst** faran · an **godes** willjon
tionon a·tómíð, · þe mid **treuwon** wili
 1017 wið is **wini** **wirkjan** · êndi an **waldand** **Krist**
fasto gi·lôbjan. · Þat skal te **frumun** werðen
 1019 **gumono** só hwi·líkun, · só þat **gerno** dót“.

TODO.

988–993 êndi ... liobost. | 988b–992a, 993ab are hypermetrical (Suzuki 2004, p. 387).

13 Só ge·fragn ik þat **Johannes** þó · **gumono** gi·hwi·líkun,
 1021 **loboda** þem **liudjun** · **lêra** **Kristes**,
hêrron sînes, · êndi **heban**-ríki
 1023 te gi·winnanne, · **welono** þane mêston,
sálig **sin**-líf. · Þó **hé** im **selbo** gi·wêt
 1025 aftar þem **dôpislja**, · **drohtin** þe gódo,
 an êna **wóstunnja**, · **waldandes** sunu;
 1027 was im þár an þero **ên**-ôdi · **erlo** drohtin
lange hwíla; · ne habda **liudjo** þan mêr,
 1029 **sëggjo** te gi·sîðun, · al só **hé** im **selbo** gi·kôs:
welda is þár látan **koston** · **kraftiga** wihti,
 1031 **selbon** **Satanasan**, · þe gio an **sundja** spênit,

man an mên-werk: · hé konsta is mód-sebon,
 1033 wrêðan willjon, · hwó hé þesa wer-old êrist,
 an þem an-ginnja · irmin-þiða
 1035 bi·swêk mit sundjun, · þó hé þiu sin-híun twê,
 Adaman êndi Êwan, · þurh un-treuwa
 1037 for·lêdda mid luginun, · þat liudo barn
 aftar iro hin-fêrði · hêlþja sóhtun,
 1039 gumono gêstos. · Þó welda þat god mahtig,
 waldand wêndjan · êndi welda þesum werode for·geben
 1041 hôh himil-riki: · be·þiu hé herod hêlagna bodon,
 is sunu sênda. · Þat was Satanase
 1043 tulgo harm an is hugi: · afonsta heban-riðjes
 manno kunnje: · welda þó mahtigna
 1045 mid þem selbon sakun · sunu drohtines,
 þem hé Adaman · an êr-dagun
 1047 darnungo bi·dróg, · þat hé warð is drohtine lêð,
 bi·swêk ina mid sundjun · —só welda hé þó selban dón
 1049 hêlandjan Krist. · Þan habða hé is hugi fasto
 wið þana wam-skaðon, · waldandes barn,
 1051 herte só gi·hêrðid: · welda heban-riki
 liudjun gi·lêstjan. · Was im þes landes ward
 1053 an fastunnja · fior-tig nahto,
 manno drohtin, · só hé þár mates ni ant·bêt;
 1055 þan langa ni gi·dorstun im · dêrnja wihti,
 níð-hugdig fiund, · náhor gangan,
 1057 grótjan ina gëgin-warðan: · wánde þat hé god ên-fald,
 for·ûtar man-kunnjes wiht · mahtig wári,
 1059 hêleg himiles ward. · Só hé ina þó ge·hungrijan lét,
 þat ina bi·gan bi þero mênnskio · móses lustjan
 1061 aftar þem fiuwar-tig dagun, · þe fiund náhor géng,
 mirki mên-skaðo: · wánda þat hé man ên-fald
 1063 wári wissungo, · sprak im þó mid is wordun tó,
 grótta ina þe gêr-fiund: · „ef þú síis godes sunu“, kwað hé,
 1065 „be·hwí ni hêtis þú þan werðan, · ef þú gi·wald habes,
 allaro barno bêtst, · brôð af þesun stênun?
 1067 Ge·hêli þinna hungar!“ · Þó sprak eft þe hêlago Krist:
 „ni mugun êldi-barn“, (kwað hé,) „ên-faldes brôdes,
 1069 liudi libbjen, · ak sie skulun þurh lêra godes
 wesan an þesero wer-oldi · êndi skulun þiu werk frummjen,

1071 þea þár werðað a·hlúdid · fon þero hêlogun tungun,
 fon þem galme godes: · þat is gumono líf
 1073 liudjo só hwi·líkon, · só þat lêtjan wili,
 þat fon waldandes · worde ge·biudid.“
 1075 Þó bi·gan eft niuson · ęndi náhor géng
 un·hiuri fiund · ôðru siðu,
 1077 fandoda is frôhan. · Þat friðu·barn þolode
 wrêðes willjon · ęndi im gi·wald for·gaf,
 1079 þat hé umbi is kraft mikil · koston mósti,
 lét ina þó lédjan · þana liud·skaðon,
 1081 þat hé ina an Jerusalem · te þem godes wiha,
 alles oðan·wardan, · up gi·setta
 1083 an allaro húso hôhost, · ęndi hosk·wordun sprak,
 þe gramo þurh gelp mikil: · „ef þú síis godes sunu“, kwað hé,
 1085 „skríð þi te erðu hinan. · Ge·skriban was it giu lango,
 an bókun ge·writen, · hwó gi·boden hábad
 1087 is ęngilun · alo·mahtig fader,
 þat sie þi at wege ge·hwem · wardos sinðun,
 1089 haldad þi undar iro handun. · Hwat þú hwargin ni þarft
 mid þínun fótun · an felis be·spurnan,
 1091 an hardan stên.“ · Þó sprak eft þe hêlago Krist,
 allaro barno bętst: · „só is ôk an bókun ge·skriban“, kwað hé,
 1093 „þat þú te hardo ni skalt · hêrran þínes,
 fandon þínes frôhan: · þat nis þi allaro frumono neg·ên.“
 1095 Lét ina þó an þana þriddjan sið · þana þiod·skaðon
 gi·bręngen uppán ênan berg þen hôhon: · þár ina þe balo·wiso
 1097 lét al oðar·sehan · irmin·þiode,
 wonod·saman welon · ęndi wer·old·ríki
 1099 ęndi all su·lík ôdes, · só þius erða bi·hábad
 fagororo frumono, · ęndi sprak im þó þe fiund an·gegin,
 1101 kwað þat hé im þat al só gód·lík · for·geþen weldi,
 hôha hęri·dómos, · „ef þú wilt hnígan te mí,
 1103 fallan te mínun fótun · ęndi mí for frôhan hábas,
 bedos te mínun barma. · Þan látu ik þi brúkan wel
 1105 alles þes ôd·welon, · þes ik þi hębbju gi·ôgit hír.“
 Þó ni welda þes lédan word · lęngeron hwíle
 1107 hôrjan þe hêlago Krist, · ak hé ina fon is huldi for·drêf,
 Satanasan for·swêp, · ęndi sán aftar sprak
 1109 allaro barno bętst, · kwað þat man bedon skoldi

up te þem alo-mahtigon gode · ęndi im ęnum þionon
 1111 swiðo þio-liko · þegnos managa,
 hęliðos aftar is huldi: · „þár ist þiu helpa ge·lang
 1113 manno ge·hwi-líkun.“ · Þó gi-wêt im þe męn-skaðo,
 swiðo sęrag-mód · Satanas þanan,
 1115 fiund undar fern-dalu. · Warð þár folk mikil
 fon þem alo-waldan · obana te Kriste
 1117 godes ęngilo kumen, · þie im siðor jungar-dóm,
 skoldun ambaht-skępi · aftar lęstjen,
 1119 þionon þio-liko: · só skal man þiod-gode,
 hęrron aftar huldi, · heban-kuninge.

TODO.

1035–1037 þó ... luginun | As told in *SaxGen*, the sister poem of *Heli*.

1053 fior-tig ‘forty’ | Note the unstable form of this numeral; *fior-tig* is the younger form, but the older *fiuwar-tig* occurs at l. 1061 below.

1061–1115 þe fiund náhor gęng, ... fiund undar fern-dalu. | The temptation of Christ in the desert (Matthew 4:1–11, Luke 4:1–13). — The way Satan is described in the narrative parts of this passage is extremely similar to the descriptions of the three monsters fought by Bewolf: Grendle (*Beow* 99–836), Grendle’s mother (1251–1590), and the nameless Wýrm (2200–2711). Semantic parallels are found not just in descriptive nouns (*Heli* 1062a: *męn-skaðo* = *Beow* 712a, 737b, 1339a: *mæn-scaða*, *Heli* 1061b et c.: *fiund* = *Beow* 101b, 143b, 164b et c.: *fjond*, *Heli* 1095b: *þiod-skaðo* = *Beow* 2278a, 2688a *þeod-scaða*) and adjectives (*Heli* 1056a: *nið-bugdig*, 1096a: *balu-wis* ~ *Beow* 723a: *bealu-bygdig*, *Heli* 1076a: *un-biuri* = *Beow* 2120b, 2413b: *un-biort*), but also in verbs that describe the antagonists as ‘seeking out’ (*Heli* 1075a: *niuson* = *Beow* 115a, 2074b: *néosian*) and ‘drawing nearer’ (*Heli* 1061b, 1075b: *nábor gęng* ~ *Beow* 745b: *forð néar at-stóp* ‘he stepped nearer forth’) their intended victim. A particularly notable parallel is found between *Heli* 1095 and *Beow* 2688, both of which pair **þeudō-skapō* ‘people-scather’ with **þriddjō sinþa* ‘third time’ in reference to the third attack from the dragon/temptation from Satan. Although the idea of three temptations is present in *Heli*’s Biblical source material, the rule of threes is common throughout world mythology and as shown by *Beow* also found in earlier Germanic monster-fights, so that this verbal parallel is likely also inherited. With such a great number of direct parallels it is apparent that the *Heli*-poet is drawing on older traditional Germanic stories of night-stalking monsters in his description of Satan and perhaps also on descriptions of battles involving three attacks by the monster. In this way the poet subtextually makes Christ take on the archetypal role of the Germanic heroic monster-slayer, something which would have been obvious (and likely emotionally effective) to the contemporary Saxon audience.

1121 14 Was im an þem sin-węldi · sálig barn godes
 lange hwíle, · unt·þat im þó liobora warð,
 1123 þat hé is kraft mikil · kũðjen wolda
 weroda te willjon. · Þó for·lét hé waldes hleo,
 1125 ęn-ødjes ard · ęndi sóhte im eft erlo ge·mang,
 mári megin-þiode · ęndi manno dróm,
 1127 gęng im þó bi Jordanes staðe: · þár ina Johannes ant·fand,
 þat friðu-barn godes, · fróhan sínan,
 1129 hęlagana heban-kuning, · ęndi þem hęliðun sagda,

Johannes is junguron, · þó hé ina gangan ge·sah:
„þit is þat lamb godes, · þat þár lōsjan skal
af þesaro wídon wer-old · wrēða sundja,
man-kunnjas mēn, · mári drohtin,
kuningo kraftigost.“ · Krist im forð gi·wēt
an Galileo land, · godes êgan barn,
fór im te þem friundun, · þár hé a·fódit was,
tír-líko a·togan, · ęndi talda mid wordun
Krist undar is kunnje, · kuningo ríkjost,
hwó sie skoldin iro selboro · sundja bótjan,
hét þat sie im iro harm-werk manag · hreuwān létin,
feldin iro firin-dádi: · „nú is it all ge·fullot só,
só hír alde man · êr hwanna sprákun,
ge·hétun eu te helpu · heþan-ríki:
nú is it giu gi·náhid þurh þes nęrjandan kraft: · þes mótun gi
neotan forð,
só hwe só gerno wili · gode þeonojan,
wirkjan aftar is willjon.“ · Þó warð þes werodes filu,
þero liudjo an lustun: · wurðun im þea lēra Kristes,
só swótja þem gi·siðja. · Hé bi·gan im samnon þó
gumono te jungoron, · góđoro manno,
word-spáha weros. · Géng im þó bi ênes watares staðe,
þat þár habda Jordan · a·neþan Galileo land
ēnna sē ge·warhtan. · Þár hé sittjan fand
Andreas ęndi Petrus · bi þem aha-strôme,
bēðja þea ge·bróðar, · þár sie an brēd watar
swído niud-líko · nętti þenidun,
fiskodun im an þem flóde. · Þár sie þat friðu-barn godes
bi þes sēes staðe · selbo gróttā,
hét þat sie im folgodin, · kwað þat hé im só filu woldi
godes ríkjas for·geben; · „al só git hír an Jordanes strôme
fiskos fāhat, · só skulun git noh firiho barn
halon te inkun handun, · þat sie an heþan-ríki
þurh inka lēra · líðan mótin,
faran folk manag.“ · Þó warð frô-mód hugi
bēðjun þem gi·bróðrun: · ant·kęndun þat barn godes,
lioban hęrron: · for·létun al saman
Andreas ęndi Petrus, · só hwat só sie bi þeru ahu habdun,
ge·wunstes bi þem watare: · was im willjo mikil,

þat sie mid þem godes barne · gangan móstin,
 1169 samad an is gi·siðja, · skoldun sálig-líko
 lôn ant·fáhan: · só dót liudjo so hwi-lík,
 1171 só þes hêrran wili · huldi gi·þionon,
 ge·wirkjan is willjon. · Þó sie bi þes watares staðe
 1173 furðor kwámun, · þó fundun sie þár ênna fróðan man
 sittjan bi þem sêwa · êndi is suni twêne,
 1175 Jakobus êndi Johannes: · wárun im junga man.
 Sátun im þá ge·sun-fader · an ênumu sande uppen,
 1177 brugdun êndi bóttun · bêðjum handun
 þiu nêtti niud-líko, · þea sie habdun nahtes êr
 1179 for·sliten an þem sêwa. · Þár sprak im selbo tó
 sálig barn godes, · hét þat sie an þana sið mid im,
 1181 Jakobus êndi Johannes, · géngin bêðje,
 kind-junge man. · Þó wárun im Kristes word
 1183 só wirðig an þesaro wer-oldi, · þat sie bi þes watares staðe
 iro aldan fader · ênna for·létun,
 1185 fróðan bi þem flóde, · êndi al þat sie þár fehas êhtun,
 nêttju êndi neglid-skipu, · ge·kurun im þana nerjandan Krist,
 1187 hêlagna te hêrron, · was im is helpono þarf
 te gi·þiononne: · só is allaro þegno ge·hwem,
 1189 wero an þesero wer-oldi. · Þó gi·wêt im þe waldandes sunu
 mid þem fiuwarjun forð, · êndi im þó þana fifton gi·kôs
 1191 Krist an ênero kôp-stêdi, · kuninges jungoron,
 mód-spáhana man: · Mattheus was hé hêtan,
 1193 was im ambahtjo · êðilero manno,
 skolda þár te is hêrron · handun ant·fáhan
 1195 tins êndi tolna; · treuwa habda hé góða,
 aðal-and·bári: · for·lét al saman
 1197 gold êndi siluþar · êndi geþa managa,
 diurje mêðmos, · êndi warð im üses drohtines man;
 1199 kôs im þe kuninges þegn · Krist te hêrran,
 milderan mêðom-gebon, · þan êr is man-drohtin
 1201 wári an þesero wer-oldi: · féng im wóðera þing,
 lang-samoron rád. · Þó warð it allun þem liudjun küð,
 1203 fon allaro burgo gi·hwem, · hwó þat barn godes
 samnode ge·siðos · êndi selbo ge·sprak
 1205 só manag wís-lík word · êndi wáres só filu,
 torhtes gi·tôgde · êndi têkan manag

- 1207 ge·warhte an þesero wer·oldi. · Was þat an is wordun skín
 iak an is dádjun só same, · þat hé drohtin was,
 1209 himilisk hêrro · ęndi te helpu kwam
 an þesan middil-gard · manno barnun,
 1211 liudjun te þesun liohta. · Oft ge·deda hé þat an þem lande
 skín,
 þan hé þár torht·liko · só manag tēkan gi·warhte,
 1213 þár hé hêlde mid is handun · halte ęndi blinde,
 lōsde af þeru lēf·hēdi · liudi manage,
 1215 af su·likun suhtjun, · só þan allaro swároston
 an firihō barn · fiund bi·wurpun,
 1217^a tulgo lang·sam legar.

TODO.

1176 ge·sun·fader | An archaic compound form. TODO.

1186 neġlid·skipu | A clinker-built ship, certainly a native Saxon term. Cf. *bōb·burnid skip* at 2266a, 2907a.

1198 diurje mēðmos | Formulaic, shared with *Beow* 2236a.

- 1217^b 15 Þó forun þár þie liudi tó
 allaro dago ge·hwi·likes, · þár ūsa drohtin was
 1219 selbo undar þem gi·sǿġe, · unt·þat þár ge·samnod warð
 meġin·folk mikil · managero þido,
 1221 þoh sie þár alle be ge·likumu · ge·lōbon ni kwámin.
 weros þurh ęnan willjon: · sume sóhtun sie þat waldandes
 barn,
 1223 armoro manno filu · —was im átes þarf—,
 þat sie im þár at þeru męnigi · mates ęndi drankes,
 1225 þigidin at þeru þiodu; · hwand þár was manag þegan só gód,
 þie ira alamosnje · armun mannun
 1227 gerno gābun. · Sume wárun sie im eft Judeono kunnjes,
 fęgni folk·skępi: · wárun þár ge·farana te þiu,
 1229 þat sie ūses drohtines · dádjo ęndi wordo
 fāron woldun, · habdun im fęknjan hugi,
 1231 wrēðen willjon: · woldun waldand Krist
 a·lédjen þem liudjun, · þat sie is lēron ni hōrdin,
 1233 ne węndin aftar is willjon. · Suma wárun sie im eft só wíse
 man,
 wárun im glauwe gumon · ęndi gode werðe,

1273 rinkos te þeru rúnu, · þár þe ráðand sat,
 managoro mund-boro, · þe allumu man-kunnje
 1275 wið hêllje ge-þwing · helpa welde,
 formon wið þem ferne, · só hwem só frummjen wili
 1277 só liob-lika lêra, · só hé þem liudjun þár
 þurh is gi-wit mikil · wísjan hogda.

TODO.

1279 **16** Þó umbi þana nêrjandon Krist · náhor géngun
 su-líka ge-sīðos, · só hé im selbo ge-kôs,
 1281 waldand undar þem werode. · Stóðun wísa man,
 gumon umbi þana godes sunu · gerno swíðo,
 1283 weros an willjon: · was im þero wordo niud,
 þáhtun êndi þagodun, · hwat im þero þiодо drohtin,
 1285 weldi waldand self · wordun kűðjan
 þesum liudjun te liobe. · Þan sat im þe landes hirdi
 1287 gëgin-ward for þem gumun, · godes égan barn:
 welda mid is sprákun · spáh-word manag
 1289 lêrjan þea liudi, · hwó sie lof gode
 an þesum wer-old-ríkja · wirkjan skoldin.
 1291 Sat im þó êndi swígoda · êndi sah sie an lango,
 was im hold an is hugi · hêlag drohtin,
 1293 mildi an is móde, · êndi þó is mund ant-lók,
 wíste mid wordun · waldandes sunu
 1295 manag mār-lík þing · êndi þem mannum sagde
 spáhun wordun, · þem þe hé te þeru spráku þarod,
 1297 Krist alo-waldo, · ge-koran habda,
 hwi-líke wárin allaro · irmin-manno
 1299 gode werðoston · gumono kunnjes;
 sagde im þó te sōðan, · kwað þat þie sálige wárin,
 1301 man an þesoro middil-gardun, · þie hér an iro móde wárin
 arme þurh ôð-módi: · „þem is þat êwana ríki,
 1303 swíðo hêlag-lík · an heban-wange
 sin-líf far-geben.“ · Kwað þat ôk sálige wárin
 1305 mǣð-mundja man: · „þie mótun þie mārjon erðe,
 of-sittjen þat selbe ríki.“ · Kwað þat ôk sálige wárin,
 1307 þie hír wiopin iro wammun dádi; · „þie mótun eft willjon
 ge-bídan,

- frófre an iro frâhon ríkja. · Sálige sind ôk, þe sie hír frumono
gi·lustid,
1309 rinkos, þat sie rehto a·dómjen. · Þes mótun sie werðan an
þem ríkja drohtines
gi·fullit þurh iro ferhton dádi: · su·líkoro mótun sie frumono
bi·knégan
1311 þie rinkos, þie hír rehto a·dómjad, · ne willjad an rúnun
be·swíkan
man, þár sie at mahle sittjad. · Sálige sind ôk þem hír mildi
wirðit
1313 hugi an hēliðo briostun: · þem wirðit þe hēlego drohtin,
mildi mahtig selbo. · Sálige sind ôk undar þesaro managon
þiodu,
1315 þie hēbbjad iro herta gi·hrēnod: · þie mótun þane hebanes
waldand
sehan an sínun ríkja.“ · Kwað þat ôk sálige wárin,
1317 „þie þe friðu-samo undar þesumu folke libbjod · ėndi ni
willjad ėniga fehta ge·wirken,
saka mid iro selboro dádjun: · þie mótun wesun suni
drohtines ge·nēmñide,
1319 hwanðe hé im wil ge·nádig werðen; · þes mótun sie niotan
lango
selbon þes sines ríkjes.“ · Kwað þat ôk sálige wárin
1321 þie rinkos, þe rehto weldin, · „ėndi þurh þat þolod ríkjoro
manno
hęti ėndi harm-kwidi: · þem is ôk an himile eft
1323 godes wang for·geben · ėndi gēst·lík líf
aftar te êwan-dage, · só is io ėndi ni kumit,
1325 welan wun-sames.“ · Só habde þó waldand Krist
for þem erlom þár · ahto ge·talda
1327 sálða ge·sagða; · mid þem skal simbla gi·hwe
himil-ríki ge·halon, · ef hé it hēbbjan wili,
1329 eþþo hé skal te êwan-daga · aftar þarþon
welun ėndi willjon, · siðor hé þese wer-old a·gibid,
1331 erð·líbi-gi·skapu, · ėndi sókit im ôðar lioht
só liof só lêð, · só hé mid þesun liudjun hér
1333 gi·werkod an þesoro wer-oldi, · al só it þár þó mid is wordun
sagde
Krist alo-waldo, · kuningo ríkjost

1335 godes êgan barn · jungorun sînun:
 „Gé werðat ôk só sálige“, (kwað hé,) „þes iu saka biodat
 1337 liudi aftar þeson lande · ęndi lêð sprekat,
 hębbjad iu te hoska · ęndi harmes filu
 1339 ge·wirkjad an þesoro wer-oldi · ęndi wíti ge·frummjad,
 fęlgjad iu firin-spráka · ęndi fiund-skepi,
 1341 lágnejad iuwa lęra, · dót iu lêðes filu,
 harmes þurh iuwan hęrron. · Þes látad gí iuwan hugi simbla,
 1343 líf an lustun, · hwand iu þat lôn stęndit
 an godes ríkja garu, · gódo ge·hwi-líkes,
 1345 mikil ęndi manag-fald: · þat is iu te médu far-geban,
 hwand gí hér êr bi-foran · arbid þolodun,
 1347 wíti an þesoro wer-oldi. · Wirs is þem ôðrum,
 gíbiðig grimmora þing, · þem þe hér gód êgun,
 1349 wídan worold-welon: · þie for-slítat iro wunnja hér;
 ge·niudot sie ge·nóges, · skulun eft narowaro þing
 1351 aftar iro hin-fęrði · hęliðos þolojan.
 Þan wópjan þár wan-skefti, · þie hér êr an wunnjon sîn,
 1353 libbjad an allon lustun, · ne willjad þes far-látan wiht,
 męni-gi-þahtjo, · þes sie an iro mód spęnit,
 1355 lêðoro gi-lęstjo. · Þan im þat lôn kumid,
 ubil arbêd-sam, · þan sie is þane ęndi skulun
 1357 sorgondi ge·sehan. · Þan wirðid im sêr hugi,
 þes sie þesero wer-oldes só filu · willjan ful-gęngun,
 1359 man an iro mód-sebon. · Nú skulun gí im þat mên lahan,
 węrjan mid wordun, · al só ik giu nú ge·wísjan mag,
 1361 sęggjan sóð-líko, · ge·sīðos míne,
 wárun wordun, · þat gí þesoro wer-oldes nú forð
 1363 skulun salt wesana, · sundigero manno,
 bótjan iro balu-dádi, · þat sie an bętara þing,
 1365 folk far-fáhan · ęndi for-látan fiundes gi-werk,
 diubales ge·dádi, · ęndi sókjan iro drohtines ríki.
 1367 Só skulun gí mid iuwon lęrun · liud-folk manag
 węndjan aftar mínon willjon. · Ef iuwar þan a-wirðid hwi-lík,
 1369 far-látid þea lęra, · þea hé lęstjan skal,
 þan is im só þem salte, · þe man bi sêes staðe
 1371 wído te-wirpit: · þan it te wihti ni dóg,
 ak it firiho barn · fótun spurnat,
 1373 gumon an greote. · Só wirðid þem, þe þat godes word skal

- mannum márjan: · ef hé im þan látid is mód twehon,
 1375 þat hí ne willja mid hluttro hugi · te heban-ríkja
 spanen mid is spráku · ęndi seggjan spel godes,
 1377 ak węnkid þero wordo, · þan wirðid im waldand gram,
 mahtig módag, · ęndi só samo manno barn;
 1379 wirðid allun þan · irmin-þiodun,
 liudjun a·lêðid, · ef is lera ni dugun.“

TODO.

1323 lif | end V/27r; text continues on 32v. 1358 sie | cuts off V

1284 þáhtun ęndi þagodun | Found identically in three other places; TODO.

1300 kwað þat þie sálga wárin | Beginning the list of beatitudes; cf. 1326b and note.

1305 mād-mundja | A hapax, generally assumed to be the same word as English “smooth”, but without the s-mobile.

1326–1327 ahto ge-talda / sálða ge-sagða | Sievers (1878) connects the eight-numbering of the beatitudes to a passage from Hrabanus. TODO.

- 17 Só sprak hé þó spáh-liko · ęndi sagða spel godes,
 1382 lérde þe landes ward · liudi síne
 mid hluttru hugju. · Hęliðos stóðun,
 1384 gumon umbi þana godes sunu · gerno swíðo,
 weros an willjon: · was im þero wordo niud,
 1386 þáhtun ęndi þagodun, · gi·hórdun þero þiodo drohtin
 seggjan ew godes · ęldi-barnun;
 1388 gi·hét im heban-ríki · ęndi te þem hęliðun sprak:
 „Ók mag ik iu seggjan, · ge·siðos mína,
 1390 wárun wordun, · þat gí þesoro wer-olde nú forð
 skulun lioht wesun · liudjo barnun,
 1392 faḡar mid firihun · oþar folk manag,
 wlitig ęndi wun-sam: · ni mugun iuwa werk mikil
 1394 bi·holan werðan, · mid hwi-liko gí sea hugi kűđjat:
 þan mēr þe þiu burg ni mag, · þiu an berge stáð,
 1396 hōh holm-kliþu, · bi·holen werðen,
 wrisi-lík gi·werk, · ni mugun iuwa word þan mēr
 1398 an þesoro middil-gard · mannum werðen,
 iuwa dádi bi·dęrnit. · Dót, só ik iu lęrju:
 1400 látad iuwa lioht mikil · liudjun skínan,
 manno barnun, · þat sie far-standan iuwan mód-sebon,
 1402 iuwa werk ęndi iuwan willjon, · ęndi þes waldand god
 mid hluttro hugju, · himiliskan fader,

1404 lo·bon an þesumu liohte, · þes hé iu su·líka lêra far·gaf.
 Ni skal neoman lioht, þe it habad, · liudjun dęrnjan,
 1406 te hardo be·hwęlbjan, · ak hé it hôho skal
 an sęli settjan, · þat þea ge·sehan mugin
 1408 alla ge·líko, · þea þár inna sind,
 hęliðos an hallu. · Þan hald ni skulun gí iuwa hêlag word
 1410 an þesumu land·skępa · liudjun dęrnjen,
 hęlið·kunnje far·helan, · ak gé it hôho skulun
 1412 brêdjan, þat gi·bod godes, · þat it allaro barno ge·hwi·lík,
 o·bar al þit land·skępi · liudi far·standan
 1414 ęndi só ge·frummjen, · só it an forn·dagun
 tulgo wise man · wordun ge·sprákun,
 1416 þan sie þana aldan êw · erlos heldun,
 ęndi ôk su·líku swiðor, · só ik iu nú sęggjan mag,
 1418 alloro gumono ge·hwi·lík · gode þionojan,
 þan it þár an þem aldom · êwa ge·beode.
 1420 Ni wánjat gí þes mit wihtju, · þat ik bi þiu an þesa wer·old
 kwámi,
 þat ik þana aldan êw · irrjen willje,
 1422 fęlljan undar þesumu folke · efþo þero fora·sagono
 word wiðar·werpen, · þea hér só gi·wárja man
 1424 bar·líko ge·budun. · Êr skal bêðju te·faran,
 himil ęndi erðe, · þiu nú bi·hlidan standat,
 1426 êr þan þero wordo · wiht bi·líða
 un·lêstid an þesumu liohte, · þea sie þesum liudjun hér
 1428 wár·líko ge·budun. · Ni kwam ik an þesa wer·old te þiu,
 þat ik feldi þero fora·sagono word, · ak ik siu fulljen skal,
 1430 ôkjon ęndi nígjan · ęldi·barnum,
 þesumu folke te frumu. · Þat was forn ge·skriban
 1432 an þem aldon êo · —ge hôrdun it oft sprekan
 word·wise man—: · só hwe só þat an þesoro wer·oldi gi·dót,
 1434 þat hé ăðrana · aldru bi·neote,
 líðu bi·lôsje, · þem skulun liudjo barn
 1436 dôd a·dêljan. · Þan willjo ik it iu diopor nú,
 furðor bi·fahan: · só hwe só ina þurh fund·skępi,
 1438 man wiðar ôðrana · an is mód·seþon
 bilgit an is breostun · —hwand sie alle ge·bróðar sint,
 1440 sálig folk godes, · sibbjon bi·tęngja,

man mid mág-skepi—, · þan wirðit þoh hwe ôðrumu an is
 móde só gram,
 1442 líbes weldi ina bi·lôsjen, · of hé mahti gi·lêstjen só:
 þan is hé sán a·fêhit · çndi is þes ferahas skolo,
 1444 al su·líkes ur·dêljes · só þe ôðar was,
 þe þurh is hand·megin · hôbdo bi·lôsde
 1446 erl ôðarna. · Ôk is an þem êo ge·skriban
 wárun wordun, · só gí wíton alle,
 1448 þan man is náhiston · niud·líko skal
 minnjan an is móde, · wesen is mágun hold,
 1450 gadulingun gód, · wesen is geba mildi,
 frâhon is friunda ge·hwane, · çndi skal is fiund hatan,
 1452 wiðer·standen þem mid strídu · çndi mid starks hugi,
 wërjan wiðar wrêðun. · Þan seggjo ik iu te wáron nú,
 1454 ful·líkur for þesumu folke, · þat gí iuwa fiund skulun
 minnjon an iuwomu móde, · só samo só gí iuwa mágos dót,
 1456 an godes namon. · Dót im gódes filu,
 tôgjat im hluttran hugi, · holda treuwa,
 1458 liof wiðar ira lêðe. · Þat is lang·sam rád
 manno só hwi·líkumu, · só is mód te þiu
 1460 ge·flíhit wiðar is fiunde. · Þan mótun gí þea fruma êgan,
 þat gí mótun hêten · heban·kuninges suni,
 1462 is blíði barn. · Ne mugun gí iu bêtaran rád
 ge·winnan an þesoro wer·oldi. · Þan seggjo ik iu te wáron ôk,
 1464 barno ge·hwi·líkum, · þat gí ne mugun mid gi·bolgono hugi
 iuwas gódes wiht · te godes húsun
 1466 waldande far·geban, · þat it imu wirðig sí
 te ant·fáhanne, · só lango só þú fiund·skepjes wiht,
 1468 wiðer ôðran man · in·wid hugis.
 Êr skalt þú þi simbla ge·sónjen · wið þana sak·waldand,
 1470 ge·módi gi·mahljan: · siðor maht þú mêðmos þína
 te þem godes altere a·geban: · þan sind sie þemu góðan werðe
 1472 heban·kunge. · Mêr skulun gí aftar is huldi þionon,
 godes willjon ful·gán, · þan ôðra Judeon duon,
 1474 ef gí willjat êgan · êwan ríki,
 sin·líf sehan. · Ôk skal ik iu seggjan noh,
 1476 hwó it þár an þem aldon · êo ge·biudid,
 þat ênig erl ôðres · idis ni bi·swíka,
 1478 wíf mid wammu. · Þan seggjo ik iu te wáron ôk,

1480 þat þár man is siuni mugun · swíðo far·lêdjan
 an mirki mên, · ef hí ina látid is mód spanen,
 1482 þat hé be·ginna þero girnjan, · þiu imu ge·gangan ni skal.
 Þan habed hé an imu selbon sán · sundja ge·warhta,
 ge·hêftid an is hertan · hêlli-wíti.
 1484 Ef þan þana man is siun wili · eþþa is swíðare hand
 far·lêdjen is liðo hwi·lík · an lêðan weg,
 1486 þan is erlo ge·hwem · ôðar bêtara,
 firihó barno, · þat hé ina fram werpa
 1488 êndi þana lið lósje · af is lík-hamon
 êndi ina áno kuma · up te himile,
 1490 þan hé só mid allun · te þem Inferne,
 hwerþe mid só hêlun · an hêlli-grund.
 1492 Þan mênid þiu léf-hêd, · þat ênig liudjo ni skal
 far·folgan is friunde, · ef hé ina an firina spanit,
 1494 swás man an saka: · þan ne sí hé imu eo só swíðo an sibbjun
 bi·lang,
 ne iro mág-skêpi só mikil, · ef hé ina an morð spênit,
 1496 bêdid balu-werko; · bêtara is imu þan ôðar,
 þat hé þana friund fan imu · fer far·werpa,
 1498 míðe þes máges · êndi ni hêbbja þár êniga minnja tó,
 þat hé móti êno · up ge·stígan
 1500 hoh himil-ríki, · þan sie hêlli-ge·þwing,
 brêd balu-wíti · bêðja gi·sókjan,
 1502^a ubil arbidi.

TODO.

1500 hoh | TODO: Critical note (ms. apparently has hó)

1396 holm-klibu | Also found in Beow.

1502^b 18 Ôk is an þem êo ge·skriban
 wárun wordun, · só gí witun alle,
 1504 þat míðe mên-êðos · man-kunnjes ge·hwi·lík,
 ni for·swêrje ina selbon, · hwand þat is sundje te mikil,
 1506 far·lêdid liudi · an lêðan weg.
 Þan willjo ik iu eft sêggjan, · þan sán ni swêrja neo-man
 1508 ênigan êð-staf · êldi-barno,
 ne bi himile þemu hohon, · hwand þat is þes hêrron stól,
 1510 ne bi erðu þár undar, · hwand þat is þes alo-waldon

- 1512 fagar fôt-skamel, · nek ênig firiho barno
 ne swerja bi is selbes hôbde, · hwand hé ni mag þár ne swart
 ne hwít
 ênig hár ge-wirkjan, · b-útan só it þe hêlago god,
 1514 ge-markode mahtig; · be-þiu skulun mîðan filu
 erlos êð-wordo. · Só hwe só it ofto dôt,
 1516 só wirðid is simbla wîrsa, · hwand hé imu gi-wardon ni mag.
 Bi-þiu skal ik iu nú te wárun · wordun gi-beodan,
 1518 þat gí neo ne swerjen · swíðoron êðos,
 méron met mannun, · b-útan só ik iu mid mínun hér
 1520 swíðo wár-liko · wordun ge-biudu:
 ef man hwemu saka sókja, · bi-seggja þat wáre,
 1522 kweðe já, gef it sí, · geha þes þár wár is,
 kweðe nên, af it nis, · láta im ge-nóg an þiu;
 1524 só hwat só is mêr oðar þat · man ge-frummjad,
 só kumid it al fan ubile · Ƿldi-barnun,
 1526 þat erl þurh un-treuwa · ôðres ni wili
 wordo ge-lôbjan. · Ðan seggjo ik iu te wáron ôk,
 1528 hwó it þár an þem aldon · êo ge-biudit:
 só hwe só ôgon ge-nimid · ôðres mannes,
 1530 lôsid af is lík-haman, · eþþa is liðo hwi-líkan,
 þat hé it eft mid is selbes skal · sán ant-gelden
 1532 mid ge-likun liðjon. · Ðan willjo ik iu lêrjan nú,
 þat gí só ni wrekan · wrêða dádi,
 1534 ak þat gí þurh ôð-módi · al ge-þolojan
 wítjes Ƿndi wammes, · só hwat só man iu an þesoro wer-oldi
 ge-dóe.
 1536 Dóe alloro erlo ge-hwi-lik · ôðrom manne
 frume Ƿndi ge-fóri, · só hé willje, þat im firiho barn
 1538 gódes an-gëgin dóen. · Ðan wirðit im god mildi,
 liudjo só hwi-likum, · só þat lêstjen wili.
 1540 Êrod gí arme man, · dêljad iuwan ôð-welon
 undar þero þurfstigon þiodu; · ne rókjad, hweðar gí is ênigan
 þank ant-fáhan
 1542 efþo lôn an þesoro lêhnjon wer-oldi, · ak huggjat te iuwomu
 leobon hêrran
 þero geþono te gelde, · þat sie iu god lônno,
 1544 mahtig mund-boro, · só hwat só gí is þurh is minnes gi-dót.
 Ef þú þan geþojan wili · gódun mannun

1546 fagare feho-skattos, · þár þú eft frumono hugis
 mēr ant-fāhan, · te hwi hábas þú þes ēniga méda fon gode
 1548 eþþa lōn an þemu is liohte, · hwand þat is lēhni feho?
 Sô is þes alles ge-hwat, · þe þú ôðrun ge-duos
 1550 liudjon te leobe, · þár þú hugis eft ge-lik neman
 þero wordo ėndi þero werko: · te hwi wēt þi þes ūsa waldand
 þank,
 1552 þes þú þín só bi-filhis · ėndi ant-fāhis eft þan þú wili?
 iuwan ôð-welon · geban gí þem armun mannun,
 1554 þe ina iu an þesoro wer-oldi ne lōnon · ėndi rōmot te iuwes
 waldandes ríkja.
 Te hlúd ni dó þú it, · þan þú mid þínun handun bi-felhas
 1556 þína alamosna þemu armon manne, · ak dó im þurh
 ôð-móðjen
 gerno þurh godes þank: · þan móst þú eft geld niman,
 1558 swiðo liof-lik lōn, · þár þú is lango bi-þarft,
 fagaroro frumono. · Sô hwat só þú is só þurh ferhtan hugi
 1560 darno ge-dēljas, · —so is ūsumu drohtine werð—
 ne galpo þú fār þínun gebun te swiðo, · noh ēnig gumono ne
 skal,
 1562 þat siu im þurh ídale hróm · eft ni werðe
 lêð-líko far-loren. · Þanna þú skalt lōn nemen
 1564 fora godes ôgun · gódero werko.
 Ôk skal ik iu ge-beodan, · þan gí willjad te bedu hnígan
 1566 ėndi willjad te iuwomu hêrron · helpono biddjan,
 þat hé iu a-láte · lêðes þinges,
 1568 þero sakono ėndi þero sundjono, · þea gí iu selbon hír
 wrêða ge-wirkjad, · þat gí it þan for ôðrumu werode ni duad:
 1570 ni mārjad it far mēnigi, · þat iu þes man ni lōbon,
 ni diurjan þero dādjo, · þat gí iuwes drohtines gi-bed
 1572 þurh þat ídala hróm · al ne far-leosan.
 Ak þan gí willjan te iuwomo hêrron · helpono biddjan,
 1574 þiggjan þeo-líko, · —þes iu is þarf mikil—
 þat iu sigi-drohtin · sundjono tómja,
 1576 þan dót gí þat só darno: · þoh wēt it iuwe drohtin self
 hēlag an himile, · hwand imu nis bi-holan n-eo-wiht
 1578 ne wordo ne werko. · Hé látid it þan al ge-werðan só,
 só gí ina þan biddjad, · þan gí te þero bedo hnígað
 1580 mid hluttru hugi.“ · Hēliðos stóðun,

gumon umbi þana godes sunu · gerno swíðo,
 1582 weros an willjon: · was im þero wordo niud,
 þáhtun ɛndi þagodun, · was im þarf mikil,
 1584 þat sie þat eft ge·hogdin, · þat im þat hêlaga barn
 an þana forman sið · filu mid wordun
 1586 torhtes ge·talde. · Þó sprak im eft ên þero twe-libjo an·gegin,
 glauworo gumono, · te þem godes barne:

TODO.

1575 sigi-drohtin | Cf. OE *sige-dryhten*. TODO?

1588 19 „Hêrro þe gódo“, (kwað hé,) „ús is þínoro huldi þarf,
 te gi·wirkenne þinna willjon, · ɛndi ôk þínoro wordo só self,
 1590 allaro barno bɛtst, · þat þú ús bedon lêres,
 jungoron þíne, · só Johannes duot,
 1592 diur·lík dôperi, · dago ge·hwi·líkas
 is werod mid wordun, · hwí sie waldand skulun,
 1594 gódan grótjan. · Dó þína jungorun só self:
 ge·rihti ús þat ge·rúni.“ · Þó habda eft þe rikjo garu
 1596 sán aftar þíu, · sunu drohtines,
 gód word an·gegin: · „Þan gí god willjan“, kwað hé,
 1598 „weros mid iuwon wordun · waldand grótjan,
 allaro kuningo kraftigostan, · þan kweðað gi, só ik iu lêrju:
 1600 ,Fadar úsa · firiho barno,
 þú bist an þem hôhon · himila ríkja,
 1602 ge·wíhid sí þín namo · wordo ge·hwi·líko.
 Kuma þín · kraftag ríki.
 1604 Werða þín willjo · obar þesa wer-old alla,
 só sama an erðo, · só þár uppa ist
 1606 an þem hôhon · himilo ríkja.
 Gef ús dago ge·hwi·líkes rád, · drohtin þe gódo,
 1608 þína hêlaga helpa, · ɛndi a·lát ús, hebanes ward,
 managoro mên·skuldjo, · al só we ôðrum mannum dóan.
 1610 Ne lát ús far·lédjan · lêða wihti
 só forð an iro willjon, · só wí wirðige sind,
 1612 ak help ús wiðar allun · ubilon dádjun.
 Só skulun gí biddjan, · þan gí te bede hnígað
 1614 weros mid iuwom wordun, · þat iu waldand god
 lêðes a·láte · an leut·kunnja.
 1616 Ef gí þan willjad a·látan · liudjo ge·hwi·líkun

1618 þero sakono çndi þero sundjono, · þe sie wið iu selbon hîr
 wrêða ge·wirkjat, · þan a·lâtîd iu waldand god,
 1620 fadar ala-mahtig · firin-werk mikil,
 managoro mên-skuldjo. · Ef iu þan wirðid iuwa mód te stark,
 1622 þat gí ne wiljat ôðrun · erlun a·látan,
 weron wam-dádi, · þan ne wil iu ôk waldand god
 grim-werk far·geban, · ak gí skulun is geld niman,
 1624 swíðo lêð-lik lôn · te languru hwílu,
 alles þes un-rehtes, · þes gí ôðrum hîr
 1626 gi·lêstjad an þesumu liohte · çndi þan wið liudjo barn
 þea saka ni gi·sónjad, · êr gí an þana sið faran,
 1628 weros fon þesoro wer-oldi. · Ôk skal ik iu te wárun seggjan,
 hwó gí lêstjan skulun · lêra mína:
 1630 þan gí iuwa fastonnja · frummjan willjan,
 minson iuwa mên-dádi, · þan ni duad gí þat te managom küð,
 1632 ak miðad is far ôðrum mannun: · þoh wêt mahtig god,
 waldand iuwan willjan, · þoh iu werod ôðar,
 1634 liudjo barn ne lobon. · Hé gildid is iu lôn aftar þiu,
 iuwa hêlag fadar · an himil-ríkja,
 1636 þes ge im mid su·líkum ôð-módja, · erlos þeonod,
 só ferht-líko undar þesumu folke. · Ne willjat feho winnan
 1638 erlos an un-reht, · ak wirkjad up te gode
 man aftar médu: · þat is mêra þing,
 1640 þan man hîr an erðu · ôdag libbja,
 wer-old-skattes ge·wono. · Ef gí willjad mínun wordun
 hôrjan,
 1642 þan ne samnod gí hîr sink mikil · silôbres ne goldes
 an þesoro middil-gard, · mêðom-hordes,
 1644 hwand it rotat hîr an roste, · çndi rëgin-þeobos far·stelad,
 wurmi a·wardjad, · wirðid þat gi·wádi far·slitan,
 1646 ti·gangid þe gold-welo. · Lêstjad iuwa gódon werk,
 samnod iu an himile · hord þat méra,
 1648 fagara feho-skattos: · þat ni mag iu éniç fund be·niman,
 ne·wiht an·wëndjan, · hwand þe welo standid
 1650 garu iu te·gegnes, · só hwat só gí gódes þarod,
 an þat himil-ríki · hordes ge·samnod,
 1652 hêliðos þurh iuwa hand-geþa, · çndi hëbbjad þarod iuwan
 hugi fasto;
 hwand þár ist alloro manno gi·hwes · mód-ge·þahti,

- 1654 hugi ęndi herta, · þár is hord ligid,
 sink ge·samnod. · Nis eo só sálig man,
 1656 þat mugi an þesoro brêdon wer-old · bêðju ant·þęngjan,
 ge þat hí an þesoro erðo · ôdag libbja,
 1658 an allun wer-old-lustun wesa, · ge þoh waldand gode
 te þanke ge·þeono: · ak hé skal alloro þingo gi·hwes
 1660 simbla ôðar-hweðar · ên far·látan
 eþþo lusta þes lík-hamon · eþþo líf êwig.
 1662 Be·þiu ni gornot gí umbi iuwa ge·garuwi, · ak huggjad te gode
 fasto,
 ne mornont an iuwomu móde, · hwat gí eft an morgan skulin
 1664 etan eþþo drinkan · eþþo an hębbjan
 weros te ge·wêdja: · it wêt al waldand god,
 1666 hwes þea bi·þurbun, · þea im hír þionod wel,
 folgod iro frôhan willjon. · Hwat gí þat bi þesun fuglun
 mugun
 1668 wár·líko undar·witan, · þea hír an þesoro wer-oldi sint,
 farad an feðar-hamun: · sie ni kunnun ênig feho winnan,
 1670 þoh gibid im drohtin god · dago ge·hwi·líkes
 helpa wiðar hungre. · Ôk mugun gí an iuwom hugi markon,
 1672 weros umbi iuwa ge·wádi, · hwó þie wurti sint
 faġoro ge·fratohot, · þea hír an felde stád,
 1674 berht·líko ge·blóid: · ne mahta þe burges ward,
 Salomon þe kuning, · þe habda sink mikil,
 1676 mêðom-hordas mêt, · þero þe ênig man êhti,
 welono ge·wunnan · ęndi allaro ge·wádjo kust,—
 1678 þoh ni mohte hé an is líbe, · þoh hé habdi alles þeses landes
 ge·wald,
 a·winnan su·lík ge·wádi, · só þiu wurt haðad,
 1680 þiu hír an felde stád · faġoro ge·gariwit,
 lilli mid só liof·líku blómon: · ina wádit þe landes waldand
 1682 hêr fan hebanes wange. · Mêr is im þoh umbi þit hęliðo
 kunni;
 liudi sint im lioboron mikilu, · þea hé im an þesumu lande
 ge·warhte,
 1684 waldand an willjon sínan. · Be·þiu ne þurbon gí umbi iuwa
 ge·wádi sorgon,
 ne gornot gí umbi iuwa ge·gariwi te swíðo: · god wili is alles
 rádan,

- 1686 helpan fan hebanes wange, · ef gí willjad aftar is huldi þeonon.
Gerot gí simbla êrist þes godes ríkjas, · ęndi þan duat aftar
þem is góðun werkun,
1688 rómod gí rehtoro þingo: · þan wili iu þe ríkjo drohtin
gebon mid alloro góðu ge·hwi-liku, · ef gí im þus ful·gangan
willjad,
1690 só ik iu te wárun hír · wordun seggjo.

TODO.

1656 ant·þengjan | so *M*; a·þengjan (*norm.*) *C*

1603 *K*uma þín | A three-syllable line, which is otherwise unmetrical in Old Saxon. Its presence suggests that the poet is following the text of his source particularly closely and therefore is willing to sacrifice meter for the sake of sense.

1645 wurmi a·wardjad | Sounds very similar to ‘dragons guard it’, but the sense of *a-węrdjan* is ‘destroy’.

- 20 Ne skulun gí ênigumu manne · un-rehtes wiht,
1692 dęrbjes a·dēljan, · hwand þe dóm eft kumid
obar þana selbon man, · þár it im te sorgon skal,
1694 werðan þem te wítja, · þe hír mid is wordun ge·sprikid
un-reht ôðrum. · Neo þat iuwar ênig ne dua
1696 gumono an þesom gardon · geldes eþþo kôpes,
þat hí un-reht gi·met · ôðrumu manne
1698 mên-ful mako, · hwand it simbla mótjan skal
erlo ge·hwi-likomu, · su-lik só hé it ôðrumu ge·dód,
1700 só kumid it im eft te·gegnēs, · þár hé gerno ne wili
ge·sehan is sundjon. · Ôk skal ik iu seggjan noh,
1702 hwár gí iu wardon skulun · wítjo mēsta,
mên-werk manag: · te hwí skalt þú ênigan man be·sprekan,
1704 bróðar þínan, · þat þú undar is bráhon ge·sehas
halm an is ôgon, · ęndi ge·huggjan ni wili
1706 þana swáran balkon, · þe þú an þínoro siuni haþas,
hard trio ęndi hębig. · Lát þi þat an þínan hugi fallan,
1708 hwó þú þana êrist a·lôsjas: · þan skínid þi lioht be·foran,
ôgun werðad þi ge·oponot; · þan maht þú aftar þiu
1710 swáses mannes ge·siun · sīðor ge·bótjan,
ge·hēljan an is hōbde. · Só mag þat an is hugi mēra
1712 an þesoro middil-gard · manno ge·hwi-likumu,
wesān an þesoro wer-oldi, · þat hí hír wammas ge·duot,
1714 þan hí ahtoja · ôðres mannes

- saka ɛndi sundja, · ɛndi habad im selbo mēr
 1716 firin-werko ge·frumid. · Ef hé wili is fruma lēstjan,
 þan skal hí ina selbon êr · sundjono a·tómjan,
 1718 lêð-werko lōson: · siðor mag hí mid is lērun werðan
 hēliðun te helpu, · siðor hí ina hluttran wêt,
 1720 sundjono sikoran. · Ne skulun gí swinum te·foran
 iuwa mēre-gríton makon · eþþo mēðmo ge·striuni,
 1722 hēlag hals-mēni, · hwand siu it an horu spurnat,
 sulwjad an sande: · ne witun súbrjas ge·skêð,
 1724 fagaroro fratoho. · Su-lik sint hír folk manag,
 þe iuwa hēlag word · hōrjan ne willjad,
 1726 ful-gangan godes lērun: · ne witun gódes ge·skêð,
 ak sind im lári word · leoboron mikilu,
 1728 umbi·þarbi þing, · þanna þeot-godes
 werk ɛndi willjo. · Ne sind sie wirðige þan,
 1730 þat sie ge·hōrjan iuwa hēlag word, · ef sie is ne willjad an iro
 hugi þenkjan,
 ne línon ne lēstjan. · Þem ni seggjan gí iuworo lēron wiht,
 1732 þat gí þea spráka godes · ɛndi spel managu
 ne far·leosan an þem liudjun, · þea þár ne willjan gi·lōþjan tó,
 1734 wároro wordo. · Ôk skulun gí iu wardon filu
 listjun undar þesun liudjun, · þár gí aftar þesumu lande farad,
 1736 þat iu þea luggjon ne mugin · lēron be·swíkan
 ni mid wordun ni mid werkun. · Sie kumad an su-likom
 ge·wáðjon te iu,
 1738 fagoron fratohon: · þoh hēbbjad sie fēknan hugi:
 þea mugun gí sán ant·kennjan, · só gí sie kuman ge·sehad:
 1740 sie sprekað wís-lik word, · þoh iro werk ne dugin,
 þero þegno ge·þáhti. · Hwand gí witun, þat eo an þornjun ne
 skulun
 1742 wín-beri wesana · eþþa welon eo·wiht,
 fagororo fruhtjo, · nek ôk figun ne lesad
 1744 hēliðos an hiopon. · Þat mugun gí undar·huggjan wel,
 þat eo þe ubilo bôm, · þár hé an erðu stád,
 1746 góden wastum ne gibid, · nek it ôk god ni ge·skóp,
 þat þe gódo bôm · gumono barnun
 1748 bári bittres wiht, · ak kumid fan alloro bāmo ge·hwi-likumu
 su-lik wastom te þesero wer-oldi, · só im fan is wurtjon
 ge·drægid,

1750 eþþa berht eþþa bittar. · Þat mênid þoh breost-hugi,
 managoro mód-sebon · manno kunnjes,
 1752 hwó alloro erlo ge·hwi-lik · ôgit selbo,
 meldod mid is müðu, · hwi-likan hé mód habad,
 1754 hugi umbi is herte: · þes ni mag hé far·helan eo-wiht,
 ak kumad fan þem ubilan man · in-wid-rádos,
 1756 bittara balu-spráka, · su-lik só hí an is breostun habad
 ge·heftid umbi is herte: · simbla is hugi küðid,
 1758 is willjon mid is wordun, · endi farad is werk aftar þiu.
 Só kumad fan þemu góðan manne · glau and-wordi,
 1760 wís-lik fan is ge·wittja, · þat hí simbla mid is wordu ge·sprikid,
 man mid is miðu su-lik, · só hé an is móde habad
 1762 hord umbi is herte. · Þanan kumad þea hêlagan lêra,
 swiðo wun-sam word, · endi skulun is werk aftar þiu
 1764 þeodu ge·þihan, · þegnun managun
 werðan te willjon, · al só it waldand self
 1766 góðun mannun far·gibid, · god alo-mahtig,
 himilisk hêrro, · hwand sie áno is helpa ni mugun
 1768 ne mid wordun ne mid werkun · wiht a·þengjan
 gódes an þesun gardun. · Be·þiu skulun gumono barn
 1770 an is ênes kraft · alle gi·lôbjan.

TODO.

1714 ahtoja | ‘hatogea’ *M*

1722 hêlag hals-mēni | In an interesting example of cultural adaptation, OHG Tatian 39:7 *beilagaz* ‘that which is holy’ is concretized as a “holy neck-ring”, an important type of object in pre-Christian Germanic society commonly found in archeological excavations. We must assume that such rings were still not entirely uncommon in Old Saxony in the 830s, when *Heli* was written.

1771 21 Ôk skal ik iu wísjan, · hwó hír wegos twêna
 liggjad an þesumu liohte, · þea farad liudjo barn,
 1773 al irmin-þiod. · Þero is ôðar sán
 wid stráta endi brêd, · —farid sie werodes filu,
 1775 man-kunnjes manag, · hwand sie þarod iro mód sþenit,
 wer-old-lusta weros— · þiu an þea wirson hand
 1777 liudi lêdid, · þár sie te far·lora werðad,
 hêliðos an hêllju, · þár is hêt endi swart,
 1779 egis-lik an innan: · ôði ist þarod te faranne
 eldi-barnun, · þoh it im at þemu endje ni dugi.
 1781 Þan ligid eft ôðar · engira mikilu

- weg an þesoro wer-oldi, · fērid ina werodes lút,
 1783 fāho folk-skepi: · ni willjad ina firiho barn
 gerno gangan, · þoh hé te godes ríkja,
 1785 an þat ēwiga líf, · erlos lēdja.
 Þan nimad gí iu þana ęngjan: · þoh hé só ôði ne sí
 1787 firihon te faranne, · þoh skal hí te frumu werðan
 só hwemu só ina þurh-gęngid, · só skal is geld niman,
 1789 swíðo lang-sam lôn · ęndi líf ēwig,
 diur-líkan drôm. · Eo gí þes drohtin skulun,
 1791 waldand biddjen, · þat gí þana weg mótin
 fan foran ant-fāhan · ęndi forð þurh gi-gangan
 1793 an þat godes ríki. · Hé ist garu simbla
 wiðar þiu te gebanne, · þe man ina gerno bidid,
 1795 fergot firiho barn. · Sókjad fadar iuwan
 up te þemu ēwinom ríkja: · þan mótun gí ina aftar þiu
 1797 te iuworu frumu fiðan. · Kūðjad iuwa fard þarod
 at iuwas drohtines durun: · þan werðad iu an-dón aftar þiu,
 1799 himil-portun ant-hlidan, · þat gí an þat hēlage lioht,
 an þat godes ríki · gangan mótun,
 1801 sin-líf sehan. · Ōk skal ik iu seggjan noh
 far þesumu werode allun · wár-lík biliði,
 1803 þat alloro liudjo só hwi-lík, · só þesa mína lēra wili
 ge-haldan an is herton · ęndi wil iro an is hugi a-þenkjan,
 1805 lēstjan sea an þesumu lande, · þe gi-líko duot
 wísumu manne, · þe gi-wit habad,
 1807 horska hugi-skefti, · ęndi hús-stędi kiusid
 an fastoro foldun · ęndi an felisa uppan
 1809 wēgos wirkid, · þár im wind ni mag,
 ne wág ne watares strôm · wihtju ge-tiunjan,
 1811 ak mag im þár wið un-gi-widerjon · allun standan
 an þemu felise uppan, · hwand it só fasto warð
 1813 gi-stęllit an þemu stēne: · ant-habad it þiu stędi niðana,
 wręðid wiðar winde, · þat it wíkan ni mag.
 1815 Só duot eft manno só hwi-lík, · só þesun mínun ni wili
 lērun hōrjen · ne þero lēstjen wiht;
 1817 só duot þe un-wíson · erla ge-líko,
 un-ge-wittigon were, · þe im be watares staðe
 1819 an sande wili · sęli-hús wirkjan,
 þár it westrani wind · ęndi wágo strôm,

1821 sêes üðjon te·sláad; · ne mag im sand ðndi greot
 ge·wrēðjan wið þemu winde, · ak wirðid te·worpan þan,
 1823 te·fallen an þemu flóde, · hwand it an fastoro nis
 erðu ge·timbrod. · Só skal allaro erlo ge·hwes
 1825 werk ge·þiðan wiðar þiu, · þe hí þius mín word frumid,
 haldid hêlag ge·bod.“ · Þó bi·gunnun an iro hugi wundron
 1827 megin-folk mikil: · ge·hòrdun mahtiges godes
 liof-líka lêra; · ne wárun an þemu lande ge·wuno,
 1829 þat sie eo fan su-líkun êr · seggjan ge·hòrdin
 wordun eþþo werkun. · Far·stóðun wíse man,
 1831 þat hé só lérde, · liudjo drohtin,
 wárun wordun, · só hé ge·wald habde,
 1833 allun þem un-ge·líko, · þe þár an êr-dagun
 undar þem liud-skêpja · lérjon wárun
 1835 a·koran undar þemu kunnje: · ne habdun þiu Kristes word
 ge·makon mid mannun, · þe hé far þero mēnigi sprak,
 1837^a ge·bôð uppan þemu berge.

TODO.

1837^b **22** Hé im þó bēðju be·falh
 te ge·seggennja · sínom wordun,
 1839 hwó man himil-ríki · ge·halon skoldi,
 wið-brêðan welan, · gia hé im ge·wald far·gaf,
 1841 þat sie móstin hêljan · halte ðndi blinde,
 liudjo léf-hêdi, · legar-bêð manag,
 1843 swára suhti, · giak hé im selbo ge·bôð,
 þat sie at ênigumu manne · méde ne námin,
 1845 diurje mēðmos: · „ge·huggjad gi“, kwað hé, „hwand iu is þiu
 dád kuman,
 þat ge·wit ðndi þe wís-dóm, · ðndi iu þea ge·wald far·gibid
 1847 alloro firio fadar, · só gí sie ni þurbun mid ênigo feho kôpon,
 mēðjan mid ênigun mēðmun,— · só wesat gí iro mannun forð
 1849 an iuwon hugi-skêftjun · helpono mildja,
 lérjad gí liudjo barn · lang-samna rád,
 1851 fruma forð-wardes; · firin-werk lahad,
 swára sundjon. · Ne látad iu silôbar nek gold
 1853 wihti þes wirðig, · þat it eo an iuwa ge·wald kuma,
 fagara feho-skattos: · it ni mag iu te ênigoro frumu hwêrgin,
 1855 werðan te ênigumu willjon. · Ne skulun gí ge·wáðjas þan mēr

- erlos êgan, · b·útan só gí þan an hëbbjan,
 1857 gumon te garewja, · þan gí gangan skulun
 an þat gi·mang innan. · Neo gí umbi iuwan męti ni sorgot,
 1859 lęng umbi iuwa lif-nare, · hwand þene lęrjand skulun
 fódjan þat folk-skępi: · þes sint þea fruma werða,
 1861 leob-likes lōnes, · þe hí þem liudjun sagad.
 wirðig is þe wurhtjo, · þat man ina wel fódja,
 1863 þana man mid mósu, · þe só managoro skal
 seola bi·sorgan · ęndi an þana sið spanen,
 1865 gęstos an godes wang. · Þat is grôtara þing,
 þat man bi·sorgon skal · seolun managa,
 1867 hwó man þea ge·halde · te heban-ríkja,
 þan man þene lík-hamon · liudi-barno
 1869 mósu bi·morna. · Be·þiu man skulun
 haldan þene hold-líko, · þe im te heban-ríkja
 1871 þene weg wísit · ęndi sie wam-skaðun,
 feondun wit·fāhit · ęndi firin-werk lahid,
 1873 swára sundjon. · Nú ik iu sęndjan skal
 aftar þesumu land-skępje · só lamb undar wulbos:
 1875 só skulun gí undar iuwa fiund faren, · undar filu þeodo,
 undar mis-like man. · Hëbbjad iuwan mód wiðar þem
 1877 só glauwan te·gęgnes, · só samo só þe gelwo wurm,
 nádra þiu fēha, · þár siu iro níð-skępjes,
 1879 witodes wánit, · þat man iu undar þemu werode ne mugi
 be·swikan an þemu siðe. · Far þiu gí sorgon skulun,
 1881 þat iu þea man ni mugin · mód-ge·þāhti,
 willjan a·wardjen. · Wesat iu so wara wiðar þiu,
 1883 wið iro fęknjon dádjun, · só man wiðar fiundun skal.
 Þan wesat gí eft an iuwon dádjun · dúbon ge·líka,
 1885 hëbbjad wið erlo ge·hwene · ên-faldan hugi,
 mildjan mód-sebon, · þat þár man neg-ên
 1887 þurh iuwa dádi · be·drogan ne werðe,
 be·swikan þurh iuwa sundja. · Nú skulun gí an þana sið faran,
 1889 an þat ârundi: · þár skulun gí arbidjes só filu
 ge·þolon undar þeru þiod · ęndi ge·þwing só samo
 1891 manag ęndi mis-lík, · hwand gí an mínumu namon
 þea liudi lęrjat. · Be·þiu skulun gí þár lêðes filu
 1893 fora wer-old-kuningun, · wítjas ant·fāhan.
 Oft skulun gí þár for ríkja · þurh þius mín rehtun word

1895 ge·bundane standen · ɛndi bēðju ge·þolojan,
 ge hosk ge harm-kwidi: · umbi þat ne látad gí iuwan hugi
 twíflon,
 1897 sebon swíkandjan: · gí ni þurbun an ênigun sorgun wesan
 an iuwomu hugi hwergin, · þan man iu for þea hêri forð
 1899 an þene gast-seli · gangan hêtid,
 hwat gí im þan te·gēgnes skulin · góðoro wordo,
 1901 spáh-likoro ge·sprekan, · hwand iu þiu spód kumid,
 helpe fon himile, · ɛndi sprikid þe hêlogo gêst,
 1903 mahtig fon iuwomu munde. · Be·þiu ne an·drádad gí iu þero
 manno nið
 ne forhtjat iro fiund-skēpi: · þoh sie hēbbjan iuwas ferāhes
 ge·wald,
 1905 þat sie mugin þene lik-hamon · líbu be·neotan,
 a·slahan mid swerde, · þoh sie þeru seolon ne mugun
 1907 wiht a·wardjan. · Ant·drádad iu waldand god,
 forhtjad fader iuwan, · frummjad gerno
 1909 is ge·bod-skēpi, · hwand hí habad bēðjes gi·wald,
 liudjo líbes · ɛndi ôk iro lik-hamon
 1911 gek þero seolon só self: · ef gí iuwa an þem sīðe þarod
 far·liosat þurh þesa lêra, · þan mótun gí sie eft an þemu liohte
 godes
 1913 be·foran fīðan, · hwand sie fader iuwa,
 haldid hêlag god · an himil-ríkja.

TODO.

1877 gelwo wurm | TODO: Note on this wyrm. Biblical or Saxon?

1915 **23** Ne kumat þea alle te himile, · þea þe hér hrópat te mí
 manno te mund-burd. · Managa sind þero,
 1917 þea willjad alloro dago ge·hwi-likes · te drohtine hnígan,
 hrópad þar te helpu · ɛndi huggjad an ôðar,
 1919 wirkjad wam-dádi: · ne sind im þan þiu word fruma,
 ak þea mótun hwerban · an þat himiles liocht,
 1921 gangan an þat godes riki, · þea þes gerne sint,
 þat sie hír ge·frummjen · fader ala-waldan
 1923 werk ɛndi willjon. · Þea ni þurbun mid wordun só filu
 hrópan te helpu, · hwanda þe hêlogo god
 1925 wêt alloro manno ge·hwes · mód-ge·þáhti,
 word ɛndi willjon, · ɛndi gildid im is werko lôn.

- 1927 Be·þiu skulun gí sorgon, · þan gí an þene sið farad,
hwó gí þat ârundi · ti êndja be·brengen.
- 1929 Þan gí liðan skulun · aftar þesumu land-skepja,
wído aftar þesoro wer-oldi, · al só iu wegos lédjad,
- 1931 brêð stráta te burg, · simbla sókjad gí iu þene betston sán
man undar þeru menegi · êndi kúðjad imu iuwan móð-sebon
- 1933 wárun wordun. · Ef sie þan þes wirðige sint,
þat sie iuwa gódun werk · gerno ge·lêstjen
- 1935 mid hluttru hugi, · þan gí an þemu húse mid im
wonod an willjon · êndi im wel lônod,
- 1937 geldad im mid góðu · êndi sie te gode selbon
wordun ge·wíhad · êndi seggjad im wissan friðu,
- 1939 hêlaga helpa · heban-kuninges.
- Ef sie þan só sálíga · þurh iro selboro dád
- 1941 werðan ni mótun, · þat sie iuwa werk frummjen,
lêstjen iuwa lêra, · þan gí fan þem liudjun sán,
- 1943 farad fan þemu folke, · —þe iuwa friðu hwirbid
eft an iuworo selboro sið,— · êndi látad sie mid sundjun forð,
- 1945 mid balu-werkun búan · êndi sókjad iu burg ôðra,
mikil man-werod, · êndi ne látad þes melmes wiht
- 1947 folgan an iuwom fótun, · þanan þe man iu ant-fáhan ne wili,
ak skuddjat it fan iuwon skóhun, · þat it im eft te skamu
werðe,
- 1949 þemu werode te ge·wit-skepje, · þat iro willjo ne dôg.
Þan seggjo ik iu te wárun, · só hwan só þius wer-old êndjad
- 1951 êndi þe márjo dag · obar man farid,
þat þan Sodomoburg, · þiu hír þurh sundjon warð
- 1953 an af-grundi · êldes kraftu,
fiuru bi·fallen, · þat þiu þan habad friðu mêran,
- 1955 mildiran mund-burd, · þan þea man êgin,
þe iu hír wiðar·werpat · êndi ne willjad iuwa word frummjen.
- 1957 Só hwe só iu þan ant-fáhit · þurh ferhtan hugi,
þurh mildjan móð, · só habad mínan forð
- 1959 willjon ge·warhten · êndi ôk waldand god,
ant-fangan fader iuwan, · firiho drohtin,
- 1961 ríkjan rád-gebon, · þene þe al reht bi·kan.
wêt waldand self, · êndi willjan lônót
- 1963 gumono ge·hwi-líkumu, · só hwat só hí hír gódes ge·duot,
þoh hí þurh minnja godes · manno hwi-líkumu

- 1965 willjandi far·gebe · watares drinkan,
 þat hí þurftigumu manne · þurst ge·hêlje,
 1967 kaldes brunnan. · Þesa kwidi werðað wára,
 þat eo ne bi·líbid, · ne hí þes lôn skuli,
 1969 fora godes ôgun · geld ant·fahan,
 méda manag-falde, · só hwat só hí is þurh mína minnja
 ge·duot.
 1971 Só hwe só mín þan far·lôgnid · liudi-barno,
 hêlido for þesoro hêrju, · só dóm ik is an himile só self
 1973 þár uppe far þem alo-waldan fader · êndi for allumu is êngilo
 krafte,
 far þeru mikilon mênigi. · Só hwi-lík só þan eft manno barno
 1975 an þesoro wer-oldi ne wili · wordun miðan,
 ak gihit far gum-skêpi, · þat hé mín jungoro sí,
 1977 þene willju ek eft ôgjan · far ôgun godes,
 fora alloro firiho fader, · þár folk manag
 1979 for þene alo-waldon · alla gangad
 rêðinon wið þene ríkjón. · Þár willju ik imu an reht wesan
 1981 mildi mund-boro, · só hwemu só mínun hír
 wordun hôrid · êndi þiu werk frumid,
 1983 þea ik hír an þesumu berge uppan · ge·boden hêbbju.“
 Habda þó te wárun · waldandes sunu
 1985 ge·lêrid þea liudi, · hwó sie lof gode
 wirkjan skoldin. · Þó lét hí þat werod þanan
 1987 an alloro halba ge·hwi-líka, · hêri-skêpi manno
 siðon te sełðon. · Habdun selbes word,
 1989 ge·hôrid heban-kuninges · hêlaga lêra,
 só eo te wer-oldi sint · wordo êndi dádjo,
 1991 man-kunnjes manag · oðar þesan middil-gard
 sprákono þiu spáhiron, · só hwe só þiu spel ge·frang,
 1993 þea þár an þemu berge ge·sprak · barno ríkjast.

TODO.

- 24 Ge·wêt imu þó umbi þrea naht aftar þiu · þesoro þiодо drohtin
 1995 an Galileo land, · þár hé te ênum gômum warð,
 ge·bedan þat barn godes: · þár skolda man êna brúd geban,
 1997 muna-líka magað. · Þár Maria was,
 mid iro suni selbo, · sálig þiorna,
 1999 mahtiges móder. · Managoro drohtin

- géng imu þó mid is jungoron, · godes égan barn,
 2001 an þat hōha hús, · þár þiu hēri drank,
 þea Judeon an þemu gast-seli: · hé im ôk at þem gōmun was,
 2003 giak hí þár ge·küðde, · þat hí habda kraft godes,
 helpa fan himil-fader, · hêlagna gêst,
 2005 waldandes wís-dóm. · Werod bliðode,
 wárun þár an luston · liudi at·samne,
 2007 gumon glad-módje. · Géngun ambaht-man,
 skēnkjon mid skálun, · drógun skírjane wín
 2009 mid orkun ėndi mid alo-fatun; · was þár erlo drôm
 fagar an flet̃tja, · þó þár folk undar im
 2011 an þem bēnkjon só bēstst · blíðsja af·hóbun,
 wárun þár an wunnjun. · Þó im þes wínes brast,
 2013 þem liudjun þes líðes: · is ni was far·lêbid wiht
 hwergin an þemu húse, · þat for þene hēri forð
 2015 skēnkjon drógin, · ak þiu skapu wárun
 líðes a·láríd. · Þó ni was lang te þiu,
 2017 þat it sán ant·funda · frío skōnjosta,
 Kristes móder: · géng wið iro kind sprekan,
 2019 wið iro sunu selbon, · sagda im mid wordun,
 þat þea werdos þó mēr · wínes ne habdun
 2021 þem gēstjun te gōmun. · Siu þó gerno bad,
 þat is þe hêlogo Krist · helpa ge·riedi
 2023 þemu werode te willjon. · Þó habda eft is word garu
 mahtig barn godes · ėndi wið is móder sprak:
 2025 „Hwat ist mí ėndi þí“, (kwað hé,) „umbi þesoro manno lið,
 umbi þeses werodes wín? · Te hwí sprikis þú þes, wíf, só filu,
 2027 manos mí far þesoro mēnigi? · Ne sint mína noh
 tídi kumana.“ · Ðan þoh gi·trúoda siu wel
 2029 an iro hugi-skēftjun, · hêlag þiorne,
 þat is aftar þem wordun · waldandes barn,
 2031 hêljandoro bēstst · helpan weldi.
 Hét þó þea ambaht-man · idiso skōnjost,
 2033 skēnkjon ėndi skap-wardos, · þea þár skoldun þero skolu
 þionon,
 þat sie þes ne word ne werk · wiht ne far·létin,
 2035 þes sie þe hêlogo Krist · hêtan weldi
 lēstjan far þem liudjun. · Lárja stóðun þár
 2037 stēn-fatu sehsi. · Þó só stillo ge·bôð

mahtig barn godes, · só it þár manno filu
 2039 ne wissa te wárun, · hwó hé it mid is wordu ge·sprak;
 hé hét þea skenkjon · þó skirjas watares
 2041 þiu fatu fulljen, · ɛndi hí þár mid is fingrun þó,
 segnade selbo · sínun handun,
 2043 warhte it te wíne · ɛndi hét is an ên wêgi hlaðen,
 skëppjen mid ênoro skálon, · ɛndi þó te þem skenkjon sprak,
 2045 hét is þero gëstjo, · þe at þem gômun was
 þemu hêroston · an hand geban,
 2047 ful mid folmun, · þemu þe þes folkes þár
 ge·wêld aftar þemu werde. · Reht só hí þes wínes ge·drank,
 2049 só ni mahte hé be·míðan, · ne hí far þeru mënigi sprak
 te þemu brúdi-gumon, · kwað þat simbla þat bëtste líð
 2051 alloro erlo ge·hwi-lík · êrist skoldi
 geban at is gômun: · „undar þiu wirðid þero gumono hugi
 2053 a·wëkid mid wínu, · þat sie wel bliðod,
 drunken drômjad. · Þan mag man þár dragan aftar þiu
 2055 líht-líkora líð: · só ist þesoro liudjo þau.
 Þan habas þú nú wundër-liko · werd-skëpi þínan
 2057 ge·markod far þesoro mënigi: · hétis far þit manno folk
 alles þínes wínes · þat wirsiste
 2059 þíne ambaht-man · êrist brëngjan,
 geban at þínun gômun. · Nú sint þína gësti sade,
 2061 sint þíne druhtingos · drunkane swíðo,
 is þit folk frô-mód: · nú hétis þú hírf forð dragan
 2063 alloro líðo lof-samost, · þero þe ik eo an þesumu liohte ge·sah
 hwërgin hëbbjan. · Mid þius skoldis þú üs hin-dag êr
 2065 gebon ɛndi gômjan: · þan it alloro gumono ge·hwi-lík
 ge·þigedi te þanke.“ · Þó warð þár þegan manag
 2067 ge·war aftar þem wordun, · siðor sie þes wínes ge·drunkun,
 þat þár þe hêlogo Krist · an þemu húse innan
 2069 tēkan warhte: · trúodun sie siðor
 þiu mēr an is mund-burd, · þat hí habdi maht godes,
 2071 ge·wald an þesoro wer-oldi. · Þó warð þat só wído kúð
 oðar Galileo land · Judeo liudjun,
 2073 hwó þár selbo ge·deda · sunu drohtines
 water te wíne: · þat warð þár wundro êrist,
 2075 þero þe hí þár an Galilea · Judeo liudjon,
 tēkno ge·tôgdi. · Ne mag þat ge·tëlljan man,

2077 ge·seggjan te sôðan, · hwat þár siðor warð
 wundres undar þemu werode, · þár waldand Krist
 2079 an godes namon · Judeo liudjon
 allan langan dag · lêra sagde,
 2081 gi·hét im heban-ríki · ęndi hełljo ge·þwing
 węride mid wordun, · hét sie wara godes,
 2083 sin-líf sókjan: · þár is seolono lioht,
 drôm drohtines · ęndi dag-skímon,
 2085 gód-lik-nissja godes; · þár gęst manag
 wunod an willjan, · þe hír wel þenkid,
 2087 þat hé hír bi·halde · heban-kuninges ge·bod.

TODO.

2001 þiu hēri | so C (norm. 'thiu heri'); þe hęri (norm. 'the heri') M.

25 Ge·wēt imu þó mid is jungoron · fan þem gômun forð
 2089 Kristus te Kapharnaum, · kuningo ríkjost,
 te þeru márjon burg. · Męgin samnode,
 2091 gumon imu te·gęgnes, · góđoro manno
 sálig ge·siði: · weldun þiu is swótjan word
 2093 hêlag hôrjen. · Þár im ên hunno kwam,
 ên gód man an·gęgin · ęndi ina gerno bad
 2095 helpa hêlagne, · kwað þat hí undar is hiwiskja
 ênna léfna lamon · lango habdi,
 2097 seokan an is sełðon: · „só ina ênig seggjo ne mag
 handun ge·hêljen. · Nú is im þínoro helpono þarf,
 2099 frô mín þe gódo.“ · Þó sprak im eft þat friðu-barn godes
 sán aftar þiu · selbo te·gęgnes,
 2101 kwað þat hé þár kwámi · ęndi þat kind weldi
 neřjan af þeru nôdi. · Þó im náhor géng
 2103 þe man far þeru męnigi · wið só mahtigna
 wordun wehsan: · „ik þes wirðig ne bium,“ kwað hé,
 2105 „hêro þe gódo, · þat þú an mín hús kumes,
 sókjas mína sełiða, · hwand ik bium só sundig man
 2107 mid wordun ęndi mid werkun. · Ik ge·lôbju þat þú ge·wald
 habas,
 þat þú ina hinana maht · hêlan ge·wirkjan,
 2109 waldand frô mín: · ef þú it mid þínun wordun ge·sprikis,
 þan is sán þiu léf-hêð lósot · ęndi wirðid is lík-hamo
 2111 hêl ęndi hrêni, · ef þú im þína helpa far·gibis.

2113 Ik bium mí **ambaht**-man, · hêbbju mí **ôdes** ge·nóg,
 welono ge·**wunnen**: · þoh ik undar ge·**wêl**di sí
 2115 **aðal**-kuninges, · þoh hêbbju ik **er**lo ge·trôst,
 holde **hêri**-rinkos, · þea mí só ge·**hô**riga sint,
 2117 þat sie þes ne **word** ne **werk** · **wiht** ne far·látad,
 þes ik sie an þesumu **land**-skêpje · lêtjan hête,
 2119 ak sie **farad** êndi **frumm**jad · êndi eft te iro **frô**han kumad,
 holde te iro **hêrron**. · Þoh ik at mínumu **hús** êgi
wid-brêdene **welon** · êndi **werodes** ge·nóg,
 2121 **hêliðos** **hugi**-dêrbje, · þoh ni gi·dar ik þi só **hêl**agna
biddjen, **barn** godes, · þat þú an mín **bú** gangas,
 2123 **sókjas** mína **sêliða**, · hwand ik só **sundig** bium,
wêt mína far·**wurhti**.“ · Þó sprak eft **waldand** Krist,
 2125 þe **gumo** wið is **jungoron**, · kwað þat hí an **Judeon** hwêrgin
undar **Israheles** · **aboron** ne fundi
 2127 ge·**makon** þes **mannes**, · þe io **mêr** te gode
 an þemu **land**-skêpi · ge·**lô**bon habdi,
 2129 þan **hluttron** te **himile**: · „nú látú ik iu þár **hôr**jen tó,
 þár ik it iu te **wárun** **hír** · **wordun** seggjo,
 2131 þat noh skulun **êli**-þeoda · **ôstane** êndi westane,
man-kunnjes kuman · **manag** te·samne,
 2133 **hêlag** folk godes · an **hê**þan·ríki:
 þea motun þár an **Abrahames** · êndi an **Isaakes** só self
 2135 êndi ôk an **Jakobes**, · **gó**ðoro manno,
barmun rêstjen · êndi **bêðju** ge·þolojan,
 2137 **welon** êndi **willjon** · êndi **wonod**-sam líf,
gód liobt mid **gode**. · Þan skal **Judeono** filu,
 2139 þeses **ríkjas** suni · be·**rô**bode werðen,
 be·**dêlide** su·líkoro **diurðo**, · êndi skulun an **dalun** þiustron
 2141 an þemu alloro **ferristan** · **ferne** ligen.
 Þár mag man ge·**hôr**jen · **hêliðos** kwíðjan,
 2143 þár sie iro **torn** manag · **tandon** bítað;
 þár ist **grist**-grimmo · êndi **grádag** fiur,
 2145 **hard** **hêlljo** ge·þwing, · **hêt** êndi þiustri,
swart **sin**-nahti · **sundja** te lône,
 2147 **wrêðoro** ge·**wurhtjo**, · só hwemu só þes **willjon** ne haðad,
 þat hé ina a·lôse, · êr hí þit **liobt** a·geþe,
 2149 **wêndje** fan þesoro **wer**-oldi. · Nú maht þú þi an þínan **willjon**
 forð

- sīðon te seļðun; · þan findis þú ge·sundan at hús
 2151 mago-jungan man: · mód is imu an luston,
 þat barn is ge·hêlid, · só þú bédi te mí:
 2153 it wirðid al só ge·lêstid, · só þú ge·lôþon habas
 an þinum hugi hardo.“ · Þó sagde heban-kuninge,
 2155 þe ambaht-man · alo-waldon gode
 þank for þero þido, · þes hé imu at su-líkun þarbun halp.
 2157 Habda þo gi·ârundid, · al só hé welde,
 sálig-líko: · gi·wêt imu an þana sīð þanan,
 2159 wēnde an is willjan, · þár hé welon êhte,
 bú ėndi bodlos: · fand þat barn ge·sund,
 2161 kind-jungan man. · Kristes wárun þó
 word ge·fullot: · hí ge·wald habda
 2163 te tōgjanna tēkan, · só þat ni mag gi·tēlljen man,
 ge·ahton oþar þesoro erðu, · hwat hé þurh is ênes kraft
 2165 an þesaro middil-gard · máriða ge·frumide,
 wundres ge·warhte, · hwand al an is ge·wēldi stád,
 2167^a himil ėndi erðe.

TODO.

2093 hunno ‘centurion’ | A native Germanic term perhaps going back to the days when the Saxons served in the Roman armies.

- 2167^b 26 Þó ge·wêt imu þe hêlogo Krist
 forð-wardes faren, · frēmide alo-mahtig
 2169 alloro dago ge·hwi-líkes, · drohtin þe gódo,
 liudjo barnum leof, · lérde mid wordun
 2171 godes willjon gumun, · habda imu jungorono filu
 simbla te gi·sīðun, · sálig folk godes,
 2173 manno megin-kraft, · managoro þeodo,
 hêlag hēri-skēpi, · was is helpono gód,
 2175 mannun mildi. · Þó hí mid þeru mēnigi kwam,
 mid þiu brahtmu þat barn godes · te burg þeru hôhon,
 2177 þe neġjendo te Naim: · þár skolde is namo werðen
 mannun ge·márid. · Þó géng mahtig tó
 2179 neġjendo Krist, · ant-tat hé gi·náhid was,
 hêljandero bēst: · þó sáhun sie þár ên hrêo dragan,
 2181 ênan líf-lôsan lík-hamon · þea liudi fôrjen,
 beran an ênaru báru · út at þera burges dore,
 2183 magu-jungan man. · Þiu móder aftar géng

- an iro hugi hriuwig · ɛndi handun slóg,
 2185 karode ɛndi kúmde · iro kindes dôð,
 idis arm-skapan; · it was ira ênag barn:
 2187 siu was iru widowa, · ne habda wunnja þan mêt,
 bi-úten te þemu ênagun sunje · al ge-láten
 2189 wunnja ɛndi willjan, · ant-tat ina iru wurd be·nam,
 mári metodo-ge·skapu. · Megin folgode,
 2191 burg-liudjo ge·brak, · þár man ina an báru dróg,
 jungan man te grabe. · Þár warð imu þe godes sunu,
 2193 mahtig mildi · ɛndi te þeru móder sprak,
 hét þat þiu widowa · wóp far·léti,
 2195 kara aftar þemu kinde: · „þú skalt hír kraft sehan,
 waldandes gi·werk: · þi skal hír willjo ge·standen,
 2197 frófra far þesumu folke: · ne þarft þú ferah karon
 barnes þínes.“ · *Þuo hie ti þero báron géng
 2199 iak hie ina selbo ant·hrên, · suno drohtines,
 hêlagon handon, · ɛndi ti þem hêliðe sprak,
 2201 hiet ina só ala-jungan · up a·standan,
 a·rísan fan þeru rēstun. · Þie rink up a·sat,
 2203 þat barn an þero bárun: · warð im eft an is briost kuman
 þie gēst þuru godes kraft, · ɛndi hie te·gēgnes sprak,
 2205 þe man wið is mágos. · Þuo ina eft þero muoder bi·falāh
 hêlandi Krist an hand: · hugi warð iro te fróbra,
 2207 þes wíbes an wunnjon, · hwand iro þár su·lík willjo gi·stuod.
 Fêll siu þó te fuotun Kristes · ɛndi þena folko drohtin
 2209 loboda for þero liudjo mēnigi, · hwand hie iro at só liobes
 ferāhe
 mundoda wiðer metodi-gi·skēftje: · far·stuod siu þat hie was
 þie mahtigo drohtin,
 2211 þie hêlago, þie himiles gi·waldid, · ɛndi þat hie mahti
 gi·helpan managon,
 allon irmin·þiedon. · Þuo bi·gunnun þat ahton managa,
 2213 þat wunder, þat under þem weroda gi·burida, · kwāðun þat
 waldand selbo,
 mahtig kwámi þarod is mēnigi wíson, · ɛndi þat hie im só
 márjan sandi
 2215 wár-sagon an þero wer-oldes ríki, · þie im þár su·líkan willjon
 frumidi.
 Warð þár þuo erl manag · ɛgison bi·fangan,

- 2217 þat folk warð an forðhton: · gi·sáhun þena is ferah égan,
 dages liobt sehan, · þena þe êr dôð for·nam,
 2219 an suht·beðddjon swalt: · þuo was im eft gi·sund after þiu,
 kind·jung a·kwikot. · Þuo warð þat küð obar all
 2221 abaron Israheles. · Reht só þuo áband kwam,
 só warð þár all gi·samnod · seokora manno,
 2223 haltaro endi hábaro, · só hwat só þár hwergin was,
 þia lébun under þem liudjon, · endi wurðun þár gi·lêdit tuo,
 2225 kumana te Kriste, · þár hie im þuru is kraft mikil
 halp endi sie hêlda, · endi liet sia eft gi·haldana þanan
 2227 wendan an iro willjon. · Be·þiu skal man is werk lobon,
 diuran is dádi, · hwand hie is drohtin self,
 2229 mahtig mund·boro · manno kunnje,
 liudjo só hwi·líkon, · só þár gi·lôbit tuo
 2231^a an is word endi an is werk.

TODO.

- 2231^b 27 Þuo was þár werodes só filo
 allaro eli·þiodo kuman · te þem êron Kristes,
 2233 te só mahtiges mund·burd. · Þuo welda hie þár êna mēri
 líðan,
 þie godes suno mid is jungron · a·neban Galilea·land,
 2235 waldand ênna wāgo strôm. · Þuo hiet hie þat werod ôðar
 forð·werdes faran, · endi hie gi·wêt im fahora sum
 2237 an ênna nakon innan, · nējendi Krist,
 slápan sīð·wórig. · Segel up dádun
 2239 wede·wisa weros, · lietun wind after
 manon obar þena mēri·strôm, · unþ·þat hie te middjan kwam,
 2241 waldand mid is werodu. · Þuo bi·gan þes wedares kraft,
 út up stígan, · ūðjun wahsan;
 2243 swang gi·swerk an gi·mang: · þie sēw warð an hruoru,
 wan wind endi water; · weros sorogodun,
 2245 þiu mēri warð só muodag, · ni wánda þero manno nig·ên
 lengron líbes. · Þuo sia landes ward
 2247 wēkidun mid iro wordon · endi sagdun im þes wedares kraft,
 bádun þat im gi·náðig · nējendi Krist
 2249 wurði wið þem watere: · „effa wí skulun hier te
 wunder·kwálu
 sweltan an þeson sēwe.“ · Self up a·rês

2251 þie guodo godes suno · ɛndi te is jungron sprak,
 hiet þat sia im wedares gi·win · wiht ni an·drédin:
 2253 „te hwi sind gi só forhta?“ (kwaþ-hic.) „Nis iu noh fast hugi,
 gi·lôbo is iu te luttill. · Nis nú lang te þiu,
 2255 þat þia strômos skulun · stilrun werðan
 gi þit *wedar wun-sam.“ · Þo hí te þem winde sprak
 2257 ge te þemu sêwa só self · ɛndi sie smultro hét
 bêðja ge·bárjan. · Sie gi·bod lêstun,
 2259 waldandes word: · wedeþ stillodun,
 fagar warð an flóde. · Þó bi·gan þat folk undar im,
 2261 werod wundrajan, · ɛndi suma mid iro wordun sprákun,
 hwi·lík þat só mahtigoro · manno wári,
 2263 þat imu só þe wind ɛndi þe wág · wordu hôrdin,
 bêðja is gi·bod-skeþjes. · Þó habda sie þat barn godes
 2265 gi·nɛrid fan þeru nôdi: · þe nako furðor skreïd,
 hoh·hurnid skip; · hɛliðos kwámun,
 2267 liudi te lande, · sagdun lof gode,
 máridun is megin-kraft. · Kwam þár manno filu
 2269 an·gegin þemu godes sunje; · hé sie gerno ant·féng,
 só hwene só þár mid hluttru hugi · helpa sóhte;
 2271 lérde sie iro gi·lôbon · ɛndi iro lík-hamon
 handun hêlde: · nio þe man só hardo ni was
 2273 gi·sêrit mid suhtjun: · þoh ina Satanases
 fêknja jungoron · fiundes kraftu
 2275 habdin undar handun · ɛndi is hugi-skefti,
 gi·wit a·wardid, · þat hé wódjendi
 2277 fôri undar þemu folke, · þoh im simbla ferh far·gaf
 hêlandjo Krist, · ef hé te is handun kwam,
 2279 drêf þea diublas þanan · drohtines kraftu,
 wárun wordun, · ɛndi im is ge·wit far·gaf,
 2281 lét ina þan hêlan · wiðer hettjandun,
 gaf im wið þie fiund friðu, · ɛndi im forð gi·wêt
 2283 an só hwi·lík þero lando, · só im þan leobost was.

TODO.

2265 skreïd | so ('skreid') *M*; skréð ('scred') *C*

2265 skreïd | A rare occurrence of the original diphthong in 1 of 2 witness mss.; see note to line 359 above.

2313 hóbun ina mid iro handun · ɛndi uppan þat hús stigon,
 slitun þene sæli obana · ɛndi ina mid sêlun létun
 2315 an þene rakud innan, · þár þe ríkjo was,
 kuningo kraftigost. · Reht só hé ina þó kuman gi·sah
 þurh þes huses hróst, · só hé þó an iro hugi far·stód,
 2317 an þero manno mód-sebon, · þat sie mikilana te imu
 ge·lôbon habdun, · þó hé for þen liudjun sprak,
 2319 kwað þat hé þene siakon man · sundjono tómjān
 lātan weldi. · Þó sprākun im eft þea liudi an·gegin,
 2321 gram-harde Judeon, · þea þes godes barnes
 word aftar warodun, · kwáðun þat þat ni mahti gi·werðen só,
 2323 grim-werk far·geben, · bi·útan god êno,
 waldand þesaro wer-oldes. · Þó habda eft is word garu
 2325 mahtig barn godes: · „ik gi·dón þat“, kwað hé, „an þesumu
 manne skín,
 þe hír só siak ligid · an þesumu sæli innan,
 2327 te wundron gi·wêgid, · þat ik ge·wald hêbbju
 sundja te far·gebanne · ɛndi ôk seokan man
 2329 te ge·hêljanne, · só ik ina hrīnan ni þarf.“
 Manoda ina þó · þe mārjo drohtin,
 2331 liggjandjan lamon, · hét ina far þem liudjun a·standan
 up alo·hêlan · ɛndi hét ina an is ahsulun niman,
 2333 is bēd-gi·wádi te baka; · hé þat gi·bod lêste
 sniumo for þemu gi·siðja · ɛndi géng imu eft ge·sund þanan,
 2335 hêl fan þemu húse. · Þó þes só manag hêðin man,
 weros wundraðun, · kwáðun þat imu waldand self,
 2337 god alo-mahtig · far·geban habdi
 mēron mahti · þan ɛlkor ênigumu mannes sunje,
 2339 kraft ɛndi kústi; · sie ni weldun ant·kennjan þoh,
 Judeo liudi, · þat hé god wári,
 2341 ne ge·lôbdun is lêran, · ak habdun im lêðan stríd,
 wunnun wiðar is wordun: · þes sie werk hlutun,
 2343 lêð·lík lôn-geld, · ɛndi só noh lango skulun,
 þes sie ni weldun hōrjen · heban-kuninges,
 2345 Kristes lêrun, · þea hé kúðde oðar al,
 wido aftar þesaro wer-oldi, · ɛndi lét sie is werk sehan
 2347 allaro dago ge·hwi·líkes, · is dādi skawon,
 hōrjen is hêlag word, · þe hé te helpu ge·sprak
 2349 manno barnun, · ɛndi só manag mahtig·lík

tēkan ge·tōgda, · þat sie gi·trúodin þiu bēt,
 2351 gi·lōbdin an is lēra. · Hé só managan lik·hamon
 balu·suhtjo ant·band · ģndi bōta ge·skēride,
 2353 far·gaf fēgjun ferah, · þem þe fūsid was
 hēlið an hēl-sið: · þan gi·deda ina þe hēland self,
 2355 Krist þurh is kraft mikil · kwikan aftar dōða,
 lét ina an þesaro wer·oldi forð · wunnjono neotan.

TODO.

2339 kústi | so M; *kunsti* norm. C

2357 **29** Só hēlde hé þea haltun man · ģndi þea hābon só self,
 bōtta þem þar blinde wārun, · lét sie þat berhte lioht,
 2359 sin-skōni sehan, · sundja lōsda,
 gumono grim·werk. · Ni was gio Judeono be·þiu,
 2361 lēðes liud·skeþjes · gi·lōbo þiu bētara
 an þene hēlagon Krist, · ak habdun im hardene mód,
 2363 swiðo starkan stríd, · far·standan ni weldun,
 þat sie habdun for·fangan · fiundun an willjan,
 2365 liudi mid iro ge·lōbun. · Ni was gio þiu latoro be·þiu
 sunu drohtines, · ak hé sagde mid wordun,
 2367 hwó sie skoldin ge·halon · himiles ríki,
 lērde aftar þemu lande, · habde imu þero liudjo só filu
 2369 gi·wēnid mid is wordun, · þat im werod mikil,
 folk folgoda, · ģndi hé im filu sagda,
 2371 be biliðjun þat barn godes, · þes sie ni mahtun an iro breostun
 far·standan,
 undar·huggjan an iro herton, · êr it im þe hēlago Krist
 2373 oþar þat erlo folk · oþonun wordun
 þurh is selbes kraft · seggjan welda,
 2375 mārjan hwat hé mēnde. · Þar ina megin umbi,
 þioda þrungun: · was im þarf mikil
 2377 te gi·hōrjenne · heban·kuninges
 wār·fastun word. · Hé stód imu þó bi ênes watares staðe,
 2379 ni welde þó bi þemu ge·þringe · oþar þat þegno folk
 an þemu lande uppan · þea lēra kūðjan,
 2381 ak gēng imu þó þe gódo · ģndi is jungaron mid imu,
 friðu·barn godes, · þemu flóde náhor
 2383 an ên skip innan, · ģndi it skalden hét
 lande rúmur, · þat ina þea liudi só filu,

- 2385 þioda ni þrungi. · Stód þegan manag,
 werod bi þemu watere, · þár waldand Krist
 2387 obar þat liudjo folk · lêra sagde:
 „Hwat ik iu seggjan mag“, (kwað hé,) „ge·sīðos míne,
 2389 hwó imu ên erl bi·gan · an erðu sájan
 hrên-korni mid is handun. · Sum it an hardan stên
 2391 oþan-wardan fel, · erðon ni habda,
 þat it þár mahti wahsan · efþa wurtjo gi·fahan,
 2393 kīnan efþa bi·klīben, · ak warð þat korn far·loren,
 þat þár an þeru léjan gi·lag. · Sum it eft an land bi·fel,
 2395 an erðun aðal-kunnjes: · bi·gan imu aftar þiu
 wahsen wán·liko · ęndi wurtjo fahan,
 2397 lōd an lustun: · was þat land só gód,
 frānisko gi·fēhod. · Sum it eft bi·fallen warð
 2399 an êna starka strátun, · þár stópon géngun,
 hrosso hóf·slaga · ęndi hēliðo tráda;
 2401 warð imu þár an erðu · ęndi eft up gi·gég,
 bi·gan imu an þemu wege wahsen; · þó it eft þes werodes
 far·nam,
 2403 þes folkes fard mikil · ęndi fuglos a·lásun,
 þat is þemu êksan wiht · aftar ni móste
 2405 werðan te willjan, · þes þár an þene weg bi·fel.
 Sum warð it þan bi·fallen, · þár só filu stóðun
 2407 þikkero þorno · an þemu dage;
 warð imu þár an erðu · ęndi eft up gi·gég,
 2409 kēn imu þár ęndi klibode. · Þó slógun þár eft krúd an
 gi·mang,
 wēridun imu þene wastom: · habda it þes waldes hlea
 2411 forana obar·fangan, · þat it ni mahte te ęnigaro frumu werðen,
 ef it þea þornos · só þringan móstun.“
 2413 Þó sātun ęndi swīgodun · ge·sīðos Kristes,
 word·spáha weros: · was im wundar mikil,
 2415 be hwi·líkun biliðjun · þat barn godes
 su·lík sōð·lík spel · seggjan bi·gunni.
 2417 Þó bi·gan is þero erlo · ên frágojan
 holdan hērron, · hnêg imu te·gēgnes
 2419 tulgo werð·liko: · „Hwat þú ge·wald habas“, kwað hé,
 „ia an himile ia an erðu, · hēlag drohtin,
 2421 uppa ęndi niðara, · bist þú alo·waldo

gumono gêsto, · ɛndi wí þíne jungaron sind,
 2423 an úsumu hugi holde. · Hêrro þe gôdo,
 ef it þín willjo sí, · lát ús þínaro wordo þár
 2425 ɛndi gi·hôrjen, · þat wí it aftar þi
 oðar al Kristin-folk · kûðjan mótin.
 2427 wí witun þat þínun wordun · wár·lík biliði
 forð folgojad, · ɛndi ús is firinun þarf,
 2429 þat wí þín word ɛndi þín werk, · —hwand it fan su·líkumu
 ge·wittja kumid—
 þat wí it an þesumu lande · at þi línon mótin.“

TODO.

2431 30 Þó im eft te·gægnes · gumono bêtsta
 and·wordi ge·sprak: · „ni mēnde ik ɛlkor wiht“, kwað hé,
 2433 „te bi·dɛrnjenne · dádjo mínaro,
 wordo efþa werko; · þit skulun gí witan alle,
 2435 jungaron mine, · hwand iu far·geþen habað
 waldand þesaro wer·oldes, · þat gí witan mótun
 2437 an iuwom hugi·skɛftjun · himilisk ge·rúni;
 þem öðrun skal man be biliðjun · þat gi·bod godes
 2439 wordun wisjen. · Nú willju ik iu te wárun hier
 márjen, hwat ik mēnde, · þat gí mína þiu bêt
 2441 oðar al þit land·skɛpi · lēra far·standan.
 Þat sád, þat ik iu sagda, · þat is selbes word,
 2443 þiu hêlaga lēra · heban·kuninges,
 hwó man þea márjen skal · oðar þene middil·gard,
 2445 wído aftar þesaro wer·oldi. · Weros sind im gi·hugide,
 man mis·líko: · sum su·líkan mód dregid,
 2447 harda hugi·skɛfti · ɛndi hréan sebon,
 þat ina ni ge·werðod, · þat hé it be iuwon wordun due,
 2449 þat hé þesa mína lēra forð · lēstjen willje,
 ak werðað þár só far·lorana · lēra mína,
 2451 godes am·busni · ɛndi iuwaro gumono word
 an þemu ubilon manne, · só ik iu êr sagda,
 2453 þat þat korn far·warð, · þat þár mid kiðun ni mahte
 an þemu stēne uppan · stɛði·haft werðan.
 2455 Só wirðid al far·loran · ɛðilero spráka,
 ârundi godes, · só hwat só man þemu ubilon manne
 2457 wordun ge·wísid, · ɛndi hé an þea wirson hand,

undar **f**iundo **f**olk · **f**ard ge·kiusid,
 2459 an **g**odes un-wiljan · **e**ndi an **g**ramono hróm
endi an **f**iures **f**arm. · **F**orð skal hé hêtjan
 2461 mid is **b**reost-hugi · **b**rêda logna.
 Nio gí an þesumu **l**ande þiu **l**és · **l**êra mína
 2463 **w**ordun ni **w**isjad: · is þeses **w**erodes só filu,
erlo aftar þesaro **e**rðun: · bi·stéd þár **ô**ðar man,
 2465 þe is imu **j**ung **e**ndi **g**lau, · —**e**ndi habad imu **g**óðan mód—,
sprákono **s**páhi · **e**ndi wêt iuwaro **s**pello gi·skêð,
 2467 **h**ugid is þan an is **h**erton · **e**ndi **h**ôrid þár mid is ôrun tó
 swíðo **n**iud·líko · **e**ndi **n**áhor stéd,
 2469 an is **b**reost hlêdid · þat gi·**b**od godes,
línod **e**ndi **l**éstid: · is is gi·**l**ôbo só gód,
 2471 talod imu, hwó hé **ô**ðrana · **e**ft gi·hwêrþje
mên·dádigan **m**an, · þat is **m**ód draga
 2473 **h**luttra treuwa · te **h**eban·kuninge.
 Þan **b**rêdid an þes **b**reostun · þat gi·**b**od godes,
 2475 þie **l**ubigo gi·**l**ôbo, · só an þemu **l**ande duod
 þat **k**orn mid **k**íðun, · þár it gi·**k**und habad
 2477 **e**ndi imu þiu **w**urð bi·hagod · **e**ndi **w**edêres gang,
rêgin **e**ndi sunne, · þat it is **r**eht habad.
 2479 Só duod þiu **g**odes lêra · an þemu **g**óðun manne
dages **e**ndi nahtes, · **e**ndi gangid imu **d**iubal fer,
 2481 **w**rêða **w**ihti · **e**ndi þe **w**ard godes
náhor mikilu · **n**ahtes **e**ndi dages,
 2483 ant·tat sie ina **b**rêngjad, · þat þár **b**êðju wirðid
 ia þiu **l**êra te frumu · **l**iudjo barnun,
 2485 þe fan is **m**üðe kumid, · iak wirðid þe **m**an gode;
 habad só gi·**w**ehsloð · te þesaro **w**er·old·stundu
 2487 mid is **h**ugi·skêftjun · **h**imil·ríkjas gi·dêl,
welono þene **m**êstan: · farid imu an gi·**w**ald godes,
 2489 **t**ionuno **t**ómig. · **T**reuwa sind só góða
gumono ge·hwi·líkumu, · só nis **g**oldes hord
 2491 ge·lík su·líkumu gi·**l**ôbon. · **W**esad iuwaro **l**êrono forð
man·kunnje **m**ildje; · sie sind só **m**is·líka,
 2493 **h**êliðos ge·**h**ugða: · sum habad iro **h**ardan stríd,
wrêðan **w**illjan, · **w**ankolna hugi,
 2495 is imu **f**êknes **f**ul · **e**ndi **f**irin·werko.
 Þan bi·ginnid imu **þ**unkjan, · þan hé undar þeru **þ**iodu stád

- 2497 endi þár gi·hōrid · obar hlust mikil
 þea godes lēra, · þan þunkid imu, þat hé sie gerno forð
 2499 lêstjen willje; · þan bi·ginnid imu þiu lēra godes
 an is hugi hafton, · ant-tat imu þan eft an hand kumid
 2501 feho te gi·fōrja · endi frēmiði skat.
 þan far·lêdjad ina · lêða wihti,
 2503 þan hé imu far·fāhid · an feho-giri,
 a·lēskid þene gi·lōbon: · þan was imu þat luttill fruma,
 2505 þat hé it gio an is hertan ge·hugda, · ef hé it halden ne wili.
 þat is só þe wastom, · þe an þemu wege be·gan,
 2507 liodan an þemu lande: · þó far·nam ina eft þero liudjo fard.
 Só duot þea mēgin-sundjon · an þes mannes hugi
 2509 þea godes lēra, · ef hé is ni gōmid wel;
 ēlkor bi·fēlljad sia ina · ferne te boðme,
 2511 an þene hētan hēl, · þár hé heban-kuninge
 ni wirðid furður te frumu, · ak ina fiund skulun
 2513 wítju gi·warājan. · Simla gí mid wordun forð
 lêrjad an þesumu lande: · *ik kan þesaro liudjo hugi,
 2515 só mis-líkan muod-sebon · manno kunnjes,
 só wanda wísa · [...].
 2517 Sum habit all te þiu is muod gi·látan · endi mēr sorogot,
 hwó hie þat hord bi·halde, · þan hwó hie heban-kuninges
 2519 willjon gi·wirkje. · Be·þiu þár wahsan ni mag
 þat hêlaga gi·bod godes, · þoh it þár a·hafton mugi,
 2521 wurtjon bi·werpan, · hwand it þie welo þringit.
 Só samo só þat krúd endi þie þorn · þat korn ant·fāhat,
 2523 wērjat im þena wastom, · só duot þie welo manne:
 gi·heftid is herta, · þat hie it gi·huggjan ni muot,
 2525 þie man an is muode, · þes hie mēst bi·þarf,
 hwó hie þat gi·wirkje, · þan lang þie hie an þesaro wer-oldi sí,
 2527 þat hie ti êwon-dage · after muoti
 hēbbjan þuru is hērren þank · himiles ríki,
 2529 só endi-lōsan welon, · só þat ni mag ênig man
 witan an þesaro wer-oldi. · Nio hie só wído ni kan
 2531 te gi·þenkjanne, · þegan an is muode,
 þat it bi·haldan mugi · herta þes mannes,
 2533 þat hie þat ti wáron witi, · hwat waldand god habit
 guodes gi·gērēwid, · þat all gēgin-werd stéð
 2535 manno só hwi-líkon, · só ina hier minnjot wel

2537 ɛndi **se**lbo te þiu · is **se**ola gi·haldit,
 þat hie an **li**oht godes · líðan muoti.“

TODO.

31 Sô wísda hie þuo mid wordon, · stuod werod werod mikil
 2539 umbi þat barn godes, · ge-hôrdun ina bi biliðon filo
 2541 umbi þesaro wer-oldest gi-wand · wordon tēlljan;
 kwað þat im ôk ên aðales man · an is akker sáidi
 hluttar hrên-korni · handon sínon:
 2543 wolda im þár só wun-sames · wastmes tiljan,
 fagares fruhtes. · Þuo géng þár is fiond aftar
 2545 þuru dērnjan hugi, · êndi it all mid durðu obar-séu,
 mid weodo wirsiston. · Þuo wóhsun sia bêðju,
 2547 ge þat korn ge þat krúd. · Só kwámun gangan
 is haga-stoldos te hús, · iro hêrren sagdun,
 2549 þegnos iro þiodne · þristjon wordon:
 „Hwat þú sáidos hluttar korn, · hêrro þie guodo,
 2551 ên-fald an þínon akkar: · nú ni gi-sihit ênig erlo þan mēr
 weodes wahsan. · Hwí mohta þat gi-werðan só?“
 2553 Þuo sprak eft þie aðales man · þem erlon te-gegnes,
 þiodan wið is þegnos, · kwað þat hie it mahti undar-þenkjan
 wel,
 2555 þat im þár un-hold man · aftar sáida,
 fiond fêkni krúd: · „ne gionsta mí þero fruchtjo wel,
 2557 a-werda mí þena wastom.“ · Þuo þár eft wini sprákon,
 is jungron te-gegnes, · kwáðun þat sia þár weldin gangan tuo,
 2559 kuman mid kraftu · êndi lôsjan þat krúd þanan,
 halon it mid iro handon. · Þuo sprak im eft iro hêrro
 an-gegin:
 2561 „ne welljo ik, þat gí it wíodon“, (kwaþ-hie,) „hwand gí bi-wardon
 ni mugun,
 gi-gômjan an iuwon gange, · þoh gí it gerno ni duan,
 2563 ni gí þes kornes te filo, · kíðo a-werðjat,
 fēlljat under iuwa fuoti. · Láte man sia forð hinan
 2565 bêðju wahsan, · und êr beuwod kume
 êndi an þem felde sind · fruhti ríþja,
 2567 arwa an þem akkare: · þan faran wí þár alla tuo,
 halon it mid ússan handon · êndi þat hrên-kurni lesan
 2569 súbro te-samne · êndi it an mínon sēli duojan,

- 2571 hebbjan it þár gi·haldan, · þat it hwęgin ni mugi
 wiht a·werđjan, · ęndi þat wiod niman,
 2573 bindan it te burðinnjon · ęndi werpan it an bittar fiur,
 láton it þár halojan · hêta logna,
 ald un·fuodi.“ · Þuo stuod erl manag,
 2575 þegnos þagjandi, · hwat þiod-gomo,
 *mári mahtig Krist · mênjan weldi,
 2577 bôknjen mid þiu biliðju · barno ríkjost.
 Bádun þó só gerno · góðan drohtin
 2579 ant·lúkan þea lêra, · þat sia móstin þea liudi forð,
 hêlaga hôrjan. · Þó sprak im eft iro hêrro an·gegin,
 2581 mári mahtig Krist: · „þat is“, kwað hé, „mannes sunu:
 ik selbo bium, þat þár sáiu, · ęndi sind þesa sálga man
 2583 þat hluttra hrên-korni, · þea mí hér hôrjad wel,
 wirkjad mínan willjan; · þius wer-old is þe akkar,
 2585 þit brêða bú-land · barno man-kunnjes;
 Satanas selbo is, · þat þár sáid aftar
 2587 só lêð-líka lêra: · habad þesaro liudjo só filu,
 werodes a·wardid, · þat sie wam frummjad,
 2589 wirkjad aftar is willjon; · þoh skulun sie hér wahsen forð,
 þea for·griponon gumon, · só samo só þea góðun man,
 2591 ant-tat Múd·spelles megin · oðar man fęrid,
 ęndi þesaro wer-oldest. · Þan is allaro akkaro ge·hwi-lík
 2593 ge·rípod an þesumu ríkja: · skulun iro regan-gi·skapu
 frummjen firiho barn. · Þan te·farid erða:
 2595 þat is allaro beuwo brêdost; · þan kumid þe berhto drohtin
 oðana mid is ęngilo kraftu, · ęndi kumad alle te·samne
 2597 liudi, þe io þit lioht gi·sáun, · ęndi skulun þan lôn ant·fáhan
 ubiles ęndi gódes. · Þan gangad ęngilos godes,
 2599 hêlage heban·wardos, · ęndi lesat þea hluttron man
 sundor te·samne, · ęndi duat sie an sin-skôni,
 2601 hôh himiles lioht, · ęndi þea ôðra an hêllja grund,
 werpad þea far·warhton · an wallandi fiur;
 2603 þár skulun sie gi·bundene · bittra logna,
 þrá-werk þolon, · ęndi þea ôðra þiod-welon
 2605 an heban-ríkja, · hwítaro sunnon
 liohtjan ge·líko. · Su-lík lôn nimad
 2607 weros wal·dádjo. · Só hwe só gi·wit êgi,
 ge·hugdi an is hertan, · eþþa gi·hôrjen mugi,

2609 erl mid is ôrun, · só láta imu þit an innan sorga,
 an is mód-sebon, · hwó hé skal an þemu márjon dage
 2611 wið þene ríkjon god · an rēðju standen
 wordo ėndi werko allaro, · þe hé an þesaro wer-oldi gi-duod.
 2613 Þat is egis-likost · allaro þingo,
 forht-likost firiho barnun, · þat sie skulun wið iro frâhon
 mahljen,
 2615 gumon wið þene góðan drohtin: · þan weldi gerno ge-hwe
 wesan,
 allaro manno ge-hwi-lik · mēnes tómig,
 2617 sliðero sakono. · Aftar þiu skal sorgon êr
 allaro liudjo ge-hwi-lik, · êr hé þit lioht af-gebe,
 2619 þe þan êgan wili · alungan tír,
 hōh heban-ríki · ėndi huldi godes.“

TODO.

2591 *Múd·spelles* *mēgin* | Apparently an incorporation of an earlier Germanic expression; the variant *Mút·spelli* occurs at line 4358 below. For the etymology and sense of this word see note to *Musp* l. 56 (attesting its OHG cognate *Mú·spilli*) and *Vsp* 49/1 (attesting ON *Mú·spell*).

32 Sô gi·fragn ik þat þó selbo · sunu drohtines,
 2622 allaro barno bēst · biliðjo sagda,
 hwi-lik þero wári · an wer-old-ríkja
 2624 undar hēlið-kunnje · himil-ríkje ge-lik;
 kwað þat oft luttiles hwat · liohtora wurði,
 2626 só hōho af-huobi, · „so duot himil-ríki:
 þat is simla mēra, · þan is man ênig
 2628 wánje an þesaro wer-oldi. · Ôk is imu þat werk ge-lík,
 þat man an sēo innan · sēgina wirpit,
 2630 fisk-ŋet an flód · ėndi fāhit bēðju,
 ubile ėndi góde, · tiuhid up te staðe,
 2632 liðod sie te lande, · lisit aftar þiu
 þea góðun an greote · ėndi látid þea ôðra eft an grund faran,
 2634 an wíðan wág. · Só duod waldand god
 an þemu márjon dage · mēnskono barn:
 2636 brēngid irmin-þiod, · alle te·samne,
 lisit imu þan þea hluttron · an heban-ríki,
 2638 látid þea far·griponon · an grund faren
 hēllje fiures. · Ni wēt hēliðo man
 2640 þes wítjes wiðar-lága, · þes þár weros þiggjat,

- an þemu **Inferne** · **irmin**-þioda.
 2642 Þan hald ni mag þera **médan** **man** · gi·**makon** fiðen,
 ni þes **welon** ni þes **willjon**, · þes þár **waldand** skerid,
 2644 **gildid** **god** selbo · **gumono** só hwi·líkumu,
 só ina **hér** gi·**haldid**, · þat hé an **heban**-ríki,
 2646 an þat **lang**-same **lioht** · **líðan** móti.“
 Só **lêrda** hé þó mid **listjun**. · Þan fórun þár þea **liudi** tó
 2648 oðar al **Galilaeo** land · þat **godes** barn sehan:
 dádun it bi þemu **wundre**, · hwanen imu mahti su·lík **word**
 kumen,
 2650 só **spáh**-líko gi·**sprokan**, · þat hé **spel** godes
 gio só **sôð**-líko · **sëggjan** konsti,
 2652 só **kraftig**-líko gi·**kweðen**: · „Hé is þeses **kunnjes** hinen“,
 kwáðun sie,
 „þe man þurh **mág**-skëpi: · hér is is **móder** mid ùs,
 2654 **wíf** undar þesumu **werode**. · Hwat wí þe hér **witun** alle,
 só **küð** is ùs is **kuni**-burd · çndi is **knósles** ge·hwat;
 2656 a·**wóhs** al undar þesumu **werode**: · hwanen skoldi imu su·lík
 ge·**wit** kuman,
méron mahti, · þan hér ôðra **man** êgin?“
 2658 Só far·**munste** ina þat **manno** folk · çndi sprákuim im
 gi·**mêd**-lík word,
 far·**hogdun** ina só **hêlagna**, · **hôrjen** ni weldun
 2660 is gi·**bod**-skëpjës. · Ni hé þár ôk **biliðjo** filu
 þurh iro **un**-gi·lôþon · **ôgjan** ni welde,
 2662 **torhtero** **têkno**, · hwand hé wisse iro **twífljan** hugi,
 iro **wrêðan** **willjan**, · þat ni wárun **weros** ôðra
 2664 só **grimme** under **Judeon**, · só wárun umbi **Galilaeo** land,
 só **hardo** ge·**hugide**: · só þár was þe **hêlago** Krist,
 2666 gi·**boren** þat **barn** godes, · si ni weldun is gi·**bod**-skëpi þoh
 ant·fáhan **ferht**-líko, · ak bi·gan þat **folk** undar im,
 2668 **rinkos** **rádan**, · hwo sie þene **ríkjon** Krist
wêgðin te **wundron**. · Hétun þó iro **werod** kumen,
 2670 ge·**síði** te·**samne**: · **sundja** weldun
 an þene **godes** sunu · **gerno** gi·tëlljen
 2672 **wrêðes** **willjon**; · ni was im is **wordo** niud,
spáharo **spello**, · ak sie bi·gunnun **sprekan** undar im,
 2674 hwo sie ina só **kraftagne** · fan ênumu **klibe** wurpin,
 oðar ênna **berges** wal: · weldun þat **barn** godes

2676 libu bi·lôsjen. · Þó hé imu mid þem liudjun samad
 frô·líko fôr: · ni was imu for̥ht hugi,
 2678 —wisse þat imu ni mahtun · mēnniskono barn,
 bi þeru god·kundi · Judeo liudi
 2680 êr is tîdjun wiht · teonon gi·frummjen,
 lêðaro gi·lêsto—, · ak hé imu mid þem liudjun samad
 2682 stêg uppen þene stēn·holm, · ant·þat sie te þeru stēdi
 kwámun,
 þár sie ine fan þemu walle niðer · werpen hugdun,
 2684 fēlljen te foldu, · þat hé wurði is ferhes lôs,
 is aldres at ēndje. · Þó warð þero erlo hugi,
 2686 an þemu berge uppen · bittra gi·þáhti
 Judeono te·gangen, · þat iro ênig ni habde só grimmon sebon
 2688 ni só wrêðen willjon, · þat sie mahtin þene waldandes sunu,
 Krist ant·kēnnjen; · hé ni was iro kûð ênigumu,
 2690 þat sie ina þó undar·wissin. · Só mahte hé undar ira werode
 standen
 ēndi an iro gi·mange · middjumu gangen,
 2692 faren undar iro folke. · Hé dede imu þene friðu selbo,
 mund·burd wið þeru mēnegi · ēndi gi·wêt imu þurh middi
 þanan
 2694 þes fiundo folkes, · fôr imu þó, þár hé welde,
 an êne wóstunnje · waldandes sunu,
 2696 kuningo kraftigost: · habde þero kustes gi·wald,
 hwár imu an þemu lande · leobost wári
 2698^a te wesanne an þesaru wer·oldi.

TODO.

2698^b 33 Ðan fôr imu an weg ôðran
 Johannes mid is jungarun, · godes ambaht·man,
 2700 lêrde þea liudi · lang·samane rād,
 hêt þat sie frume frēmīdin, · firina far·létin,
 2702 mēn ēndi morð·werk. · Hé was þár managumu liof
 góðaro gumono. · Hé sóhte imu þó þene Judeono kuning,
 2704 þene hēri·togon at hūs, · þe hēten was
 Erodes aftar is ēldiron, · oðar·módig man:
 2706 búide imu be þeru brúdi, · þiu êr sīnes bróðer was,
 idis an ēhti, · ant·tat hé ēlljor skók,
 2708 wer·old weslode. · Þó imu þat wíf gi·nam

2748 wínu gi·wlenkid, · ɛndi þó te þemu wíbe sprak;
 grótte sie fora þemu gum-sképje · ɛndi gerno bad,
 þat siu þár fora þem gastjun · gaman af·hóbi
 2750 fagar an flettje: · „lát þit folk sehan,
 hwó þú ge·línod habas · liudjo mēnegi
 2752 te bliōsjanne an bēnkjun; · ef þú mí þera bede tugiðos,
 mín word for þesumu werode, · þan willju ik it hēr te wárun
 ge·kweðen,
 2754 liahto fora þesun liudjun · ɛndi ók gi·lêstjen só,
 þat ik þí þan aftar þiu · êron willju,
 2756 só hwes só þú mí bidis · for þesun mínun bâg-winjun:
 þoh þú mí þesaro hēri-dómo · halbaro fergos,
 2758 ríkjas mínes, · þoh gi·dón ik, þat it ênig rínko ni mag
 wordun gi·wēndjen, · ɛndi it skal gi·werðen só.“
 2760 Þó warð þera magað aftar þiu · mód gi·hworben,
 hugi aftar iro hêrron, · þat siu an þemu húse innen,
 2762 an þemu gast-seli · gamen up a·huof,
 al só þero liudjo · land-wise gi·dróg,
 2764 þero þiодо þau. · Þiu þiorne spilode
 hrór aftar þemu húse: · hugi was an lustun,
 2766 managaro mód-sebo. · Þó þiu magað habda
 gi·þionod te þanke · þiод-kuninge
 2768 ɛndi allumu þemu erl-sképje, · þe þár inne was
 góðaro gumono, · siu welde þó ira geþa êgan,
 2770 þiu magað for þeru mēnegi: · géng þó wið iro móðar sprekan
 ɛndi frágode sie · firi-wit-líko,
 2772 hwes siu þene burges ward · biddjen skoldi.
 Þó wísde siu aftar iro willjon, · hét þat siu wihtes þan êr
 2774 ni gērodi for þemu gum-sképje, · bi·útan þat man iru Johannes
 an þeru hallu innan · hôbid gábi
 2776 a·lôsid af is lik-hamon. · Þat was allun þem liudjun harm,
 þem mannun an iro móde, · þó sie þat gi·hōrdun þea magað
 sprekan;
 2778 só was it ók þemu kunge: · hé ni mahte is kwidi liagan,
 is word wēndjen: · hét þó is wēpan-berand
 2780 gangen fan þemu gast-seli · ɛndi hét þene godes man
 lífu bi·lōsjen. · Þó ni was lang te þiu,
 2782 þat man an þea halla · hôbid bráhte
 þes þiод-gumon, · ɛndi it þár þeru þiornun far·gaf,

2784 magað for þeru mēnegi: · siu dróg it þeru móder forð.
 Þó was ên-dago · allaro manno
 2786 þes wísoston, · þero þe gio an þesa wer-old kwámi,
 þero þe kwene ênig · kind gi·bári,
 2788 idis fan erle, · lét man simla þen ênon bi·foran,
 þe þiu þiorne gi·dróg, · þe gio þegnes ni warð
 2790 wís an iro wer-oldi, · bi·útan só ine waldand god
 fan heban-wange · hêlages gēstes
 2792 gi·markode mahtig: · þe ni habde ênigan gi·makon hwęgin
 êr nek aftar. · Erlos hwurbun,
 2794 gumon umbi Johannen, · is jungaron managa,
 sálig ge·sīði, · ęndi ine an sande bi·gróbun,
 2796 leobes lík-hamon: · wissun þat hé lioht godes,
 diur·líkan drôm · mid is drohtine samad,
 2798 up·ôdas hēm · êgan móste,
 2799^a sálig sókjan.

TODO.

2799^b 34 Þó ge·witun im þea ge·sīðos þanen,
 Johannes jungaron · jámer-móde,
 2801 hêlag-ferāha: · was im iro hêrron dōð
 swīðo an sorgun. · Ge·witun im sókjan þó
 2803 an þeru wóstunni · waldandes sunu,
 kraftigana Krist · ęndi imu kũð gi·dedun
 2805 gódes mannes for·gang, · hwó habde þe Judeono kuning
 manno þene mārjostan · mākjas eggjun
 2807 hōbdu bi·hauwan: · hé ni welde is ênigen harm spreken,
 sunu drohtines; · hé wisse þat þiu seole was
 2809 hêlag gi·halden · wiðer hęttjandjon,
 an friðe wiðer fiundun. · Þó só gi·frági warð
 2811 aftar þem land-skepjun · lērjandero bęts
 an þeru wóstunni: · werod samnode,
 2813 fōr folkun tó: · was im firi-wit mikil
 wísaro wordo; · imu was ôk willjo só samo,
 2815 sunje drohtines, · þat hé su·lík ge·sīðo folk
 an þat lioht godes · laðoan mósti,
 2817 węnnjen mid willjon. · Waldand lērde
 allan langan dag · liudi managa,
 2819 ęli-þeodige man, · ant-tat an áband sêg

sunne te sedle. · Þó gégung is ge-siðos tve-liþi,
 gumon te þemu godes barne · ęndi sagdun iro gódumu
 hêrron,
 mid hwi-líku arbêdju þár þea erlos libdin, · kwáðun þat sie is
 êra bi-þorfтин,
 weros an þemu wóstjon lande: · „sie ni mugun sie hér mid
 wihti ant-hêbbjen,
 hêliðos bi hungres ge-þwinge. · Nú lát þú sie, hêrro þe gódo,
 siðon, þár sie sêliða fiðen. · Náþ sind hér ge-setana burgi
 managa mid megin-þiodun: · þár fiðað sie meþi te kôpe,
 weros aftar þem wíkjon.“ · Þó sprak eft waldand Krist,
 þioda drohtin, · kwað þat þes êniga þurufsti ni wárin,
 „þat sie þurh meþi-lôsi · mína far-látan
 leob-líka lêra. · Geþað gi þesun liudjun gi-nóg,
 wënnjad sie hér mid willjon.“ · Þó habde eft is word garu
 Philippus fród gumo, · kwað þat þár só filu wári
 manno mēnigi: · „þoh wí hér te meþi habdin
 garu im te geþanne, · só wí mahtin far-gelden mēst,
 ef wí hér gi-saldin · siluþer-skatto
 twê hund samad, · tweho wári is noh þan,
 þat iro ênig þár · ênes gi-námi:
 só luttik wári þat þesun liudjun.“ · Þó sprak eft þe landes ward
 ęndi frágode sie · firi-wit-líko,
 manno drohtin, · hwat sie þár te meþi habdin
 wistes ge-wunnin. · Þó sprak imu eft mid is wordun an-gëgin
 Andreas fora þem erlun · ęndi þemu alo-waldon
 selbumu sagde, · þat sie an iro gi-siðje þan mēr
 garowes ni habdin, · „bi-útan girstin brôð
 fiþi an úsaru fērði · ęndi fiskos twêne.
 Hwat mag þat þoh þesaru mēnigi?“ · Þó sprak imu eft mahtig
 Krist,
 þe gódo godes sunu, · ęndi hét þat gumono folk
 skęrjen ęndi skêðen · ęndi hét þea skola sęttjen,
 erlos aftar þeru erðu, · irmin-þioda
 an grase grunimu, · ęndi þó te is jungarun sprak,
 allaro barno bętst, · hét imu þiu brôð halon
 ęndi þea fiskos forð. · Þat folk stillo bêð,
 sat ge-siði mikil; · undar þiu hé þurh is selbes kraft,
 manno drohtin, · þene meþi wíhide,

- 2855 hêlag heban-kuning, · ɛndi mid is handun brak,
gaf it is jungarun forð, · ɛndi it sie undar þemu gum-skępie
hét
- 2857 dragan ɛndi dêljen. · Sie lêstun iro drohtines word,
is geþa gerno · drógun gumono gi·hwemu,
- 2859 hêlaga helpa. · It undar iro handun wóhs,
męti manno gi·hwemu: · þeru męgin-þiodu warð
- 2861 líf an lustun, · þea liudi wurðun alle,
sade sálig folk, · só hwat só þár gi·samnod was
- 2863 fan allun wíðun wegun. · Þó hét waldand Krist
gangen is jungaron · ɛndi hét sie gômjen wel,
- 2865 þat þiu léþa þár · far·loren ni wurði;
hét sie þó samnon, · þó þár sade wárun
- 2867 man-kunnjes manag. · Þár móses warð,
brôdes te léþu, · þat man birilos gi·las
- 2869 twe·libi fulle: · þat was tēkan mikil,
grôt kraft godes, · hwand þár was gumono gi·tald
- 2871 áno wíf ɛndi kind, · werodes at·samme
fif þúsundig. · Þat folk al far·stód,
- 2873 þea man an iro móde, · þat sie þár mahtigna
hêrron habdun. · Þó sie heban-kuning,
- 2875 þea liudi lobodun, · kwáðun þat gio ni wurði an þit lioht
kuman
- wísaro wár-sago, · efþa þat hé gi·wald mid gode
- 2877 an þesaru middil-gard · méron habdi,
êñ-faldaran hugi. · Alle gi·sprá kun,
- 2879 þat hé wári wirðig · welono ge·hwi·líkes,
þat hé erð-ríki · êgan mósti,
- 2881 wídene wer-old-stól, · „nú hé su·lík ge·wit habad,
só grôte kraft mid gode.“ · Þea gumon alle gi·warð,
- 2883 þat sie ine gi·hóbin · te hêrosten,
gi·kurin ine te kuninge: · þat Kriste ni was
- 2885 wihtes wirðig, · hwand hé þit wer-old-ríki,
erðe ɛndi up·himil · þurh is ênes kraft
- 2887 selbo gi·warhte · ɛndi sïðor gi·held,
land ɛndi liud-skępi, · —þoh þes ênigan gi·lôbon ni dedin
- 2889 wrêðe wiðer-sakon— · þat al an is gi·walde stád,
kuning-ríkjo kraft · ɛndi kêsur-dómes,

2891 megin-þiðo mahal. · Be-þiu ni welde hé þurh þero manno
spráka
hëbbjan ênigan hêr-dóm, · hêlag drohtin,
2893 wer-old-kuninges namon; · ni hé þó mid wordun strid
ni af-hóf wið þat folk furður, · ak fôr imu þó, þár hé welde,
2895 an ên ge·birgi uppan: · flôh þat barn godes
gêlaro gelp-kwidi · êndi is jungaron hét
2897 ôbar ênne sêo siðon · êndi im selbo gi·bôð,
hwár sie im eft te·gêgnes · gangen skoldin.

TODO.

2899 35 Þó te·lét þat liud-werod · aftar þemu lande allumu,
te·fôr folk mikil, · siðor iro frâho gi·wêt
2901 an þat ge·birgi uppan, · barno ríkjust,
waldand an is willjon. · Þó te þes watares staðe
2903 samnodun þea ge·siðos Kristes, · þe hé imu habde selbo
gi·korane,
sie twe·libi þurh iro treuwa gôða: · ni was im tweho nigijan,
2905 neþu sie an þat godes þionost · gerno weldin
ôbar þene sêo siðon. · Þó létun sie swiðjan strôm,
2907 hôh-hurnid skip · hluttron ûðjon,
skêðan skír water. · Skrêd liot dages,
2909 sunne warð an sedle; · þe sêo-liðandjan
naht nebulu bi·warp; · náðidun erlos
2911 forð-wardes an flód; · warð þiu fiorðe tíð
þera nahtes kuman · —nêrjendo Krist
2913 warode þea wág-liðand—: · þó warð wind mikil,
hôh wedeþ af·haben: · hlamodun ûðjon,
2915 strôm an stamne; · stridjun fêridun
þea weros wiðeþ winde, · was im wrêð hugi,
2917 sebo sorgono ful: · selbon ni wándun
lagu-liðandja · an land kumen
2919 þurh þes wederes ge·win. · Þó gi·sáhun sie waldand Krist
an þemu sêe uppan · selbun gangan,
2921 faran an fâðjon: · ni mahte an þene flód innan,
an þene sêo sinkan, · hwand ine is selbes kraft
2923 hêlag ant·habde. · Hugi warð an forhtun,
þero manno mód-sebo: · an·drédun þat it im mahtig fiund
2925 te gi·droge dáði. · Þó sprak im iro drohtin tó,

- hêlag heban-kuning, · ɛndi sagde im þat hé iro hêrro was
 2927 mári ɛndi mahtig: · „nú gí módes skulun
 fastes fâhen; · ne sí iu forht hugi,
 2929 gi·bárjad gí bald-liko: · ik bium þat barn godes,
 is selbes sunu, · þe iu wið þesumu sêe skal,
 2931 mundon wið þesan mēri-strôm.“ · Þó sprak imu ên þero
 manno an·gëgin
 oþar bord skipes, · bar-wirðig gumo,
 2933 Petrus þe gódo · —ni welde píne þolon,
 watares witi—: · „ef þú it waldand sís“, kwað hé,
 2935 „hêrro þe gódo, · só mí an mínumu hugi þunkit,
 hêt mí þan þarod gangan te þí · oþar þesen geþenes strôm,
 2937 drokno oþar diap water, · ef þú mín drohtin sís,
 managoro mund-boro.“ · Þó hét ine mahtig Krist
 2939 gangan imu te·gëgnes. · Hé warð garu sáno,
 stôþ af þemu stamne · ɛndi stríðjun gëng
 2941 forð te is frôþan. · Þiu flód ant·habde
 þene man þurh maht godes, · ant-tat hé imu an is móde bi·gan
 2943 an·dráden diap water, · þó hé dríþen gi·sah
 þene wég mid windu: · wundun ina üðjon,
 2945 hôh strôm umbi·hring. · Reht só hé þó an is hugi twehode,
 só wêk imu þat water under, · ɛndi hé an þene wág innan,
 2947 sank an þene sêo-strôm, · ɛndi hé hriop sán aftar þiu
 gáhon te þemu godes sunje · ɛndi gerno bad,
 2949 þat hé ine þó ge·nēridi, · þó hé an nōðjun was,
 þegan an ge·þwinge. · Þiodo drohtin
 2951 ant·fēng ine mid is faðmun · ɛndi frágoðe sána,
 te hwí hé þó ge·twehodi: · „Hwat þú mahtes ge·trúoþan wel,
 2953 witen þat te wárun, · þat þi watares kraft
 an þemu sêe innen · þínes siðes ni mahte,
 2955 lagu-strôm gi·lëttjen, · só lango só þú habdes ge·lôþon te mí
 an þínumu hugi hardo. · Nú willju ik þi an helpun wesen,
 2957 nēþjen þi an þesaru nōði“. · Þó nam ine alo-mahtig,
 hêlag bi handun: · þó warð imu eft hlutter water
 2959 fast under fótun, · ɛndi sie an fāði samad
 bêðja gëngun, · ant-tat sie oþar bord skipes
 2961 stóþun fan þemu strôme, · ɛndi an þemu stamne ge·sat
 allaro barno bēst. · Þó warð brêd water,
 2963 strômos ge·stillid, · ɛndi sie te staðe kwámun,

lagu-liðandja · an land samen
 2965 þurh þes wates ge·win, · sagdun þo waldande þank,
 diurden iro drohtin · dádjun ęndi wordun,
 2967 fellun imu te fótun · ęndi filu sprákun
 wísaro wordo, · kwáðun þat sie wissin garo,
 2969 þat hé wári selbo · sunu drohtines
 wár an þesaru wer-oldi · ęndi ge·wald habdi
 2971 oþar middil-gard, · ęndi þat hé mahti allaro manno gi·hwes
 feráhe gi·formon, · al só hé im an þemu flóde dede
 2973^a wið þes watares ge·win.

TODO.

2973^b 36 Þó gi·wēt imu waldand Krist
 siðon fan þemu sêe, · sunu drohtines,
 2975 ęnag barn godes. · Ełi-þioda kwam imu,
 gumon te·gęgnes: · wárun is gódun werk
 2977 ferran ge·frági, · þat hé só filu sagde
 wároro wordo: · imu was willjo mikil,
 2979 þat hé su-lík folk-skepi · frummjen mósti,
 þat sie simla gerno · gode þionodin,
 2981 wárin ge·hórige · heban-kuninge
 man-kunnjes manag. · Þó gi·wēt hé imu ober þea marka
 Judeono,
 2983 sóhte imu Sidono burg, · habde ge·siðos mid imu,
 góde jungaron. · Þár imu te·gęgnes kwam
 2985 ęn idis fan áðrom þiodun; · siu was iru aðali-ge·burdjo,
 kunnjes fan Kananeo lande; · siu bad þene kraftagan drohtin,
 2987 hêlagna, þat hé iru helpe ge·rédi, · kwað þat iru wári harm
 gi·standen,
 soroga at iru selbaru dohter, · kwað þat siu wári mid suhtjun
 bi·fangen:
 2989 „be·drogan habbjad sie dęnja wihti. · Nú is iro dôd at hęndi,
 þea wrêðon habbjad sie ge·wittju be·numane. · Nú biddju ik
 þi, waldand frô min,
 2991 selbo sunu Dawides, · þat sie af su-líkum suhtjun a·tómjes,
 þat þú sie só arma · ę-gróht-fullo
 2993 wam-skaðon bi·weri.“ · Ni gaf iru þó noh waldand Krist
 ęnig and·wordi; · siu imu aftar gęng,
 2995 folgode fruokno, · ant-tat siu te is fótun kwam,

- grótte ina greatandi. · Jungaron Kristes
 2997 bádun iro hêrron, · þat hé an is hugja mildi
 wurði þemu wíbe. · Þó habde eft is word garu
 2999 sunu drohtines · ęndi te is ge·siđun sprak:
 „êrist skal ik Israheles · aboron werðen,
 3001 folk-skępi te frumu, · þat sie ferhtan hugi
 hębbjan te iro hêrron: · im is helpoþo þarf,
 3003 þea liudi sind far·lorane, · far·lāten habbjad
 waldandes word, · þat werod is ge·twiřlid,
 3005 driþad im ęernjan hugi, · ne willjad iro drohtine hōrjen
 Israhelo erl-skępi, · un-gi·lōbiga sind
 3007 hęliđos iro hêrron: · þoh skal þanen helpe kumen
 allun ęli-þiodun.“ · Agalēto bad
 3009 þat wif mid iro wordun, · þat iru waldand Krist
 an is mōd-sebon · mildi wurði,
 3011 þat siu iro barnes forð · brúkan mōsti,
 hębbjan sie hēle. · Þó sprak iru hērro an·ęegin,
 3013 mări ęndi mahtig: · „nis þat“, kwađ hé, „mannes reht,
 gumono nig·ênum · gód te gi·frummjenne
 3015 þat hé is barnun · brōdes af·tíhe,
 wernje im oþar willjon, · lāte sie wíti þoljan,
 3017 hungar hęti-grimmen, · ęndi fōdje is hundos mid þiu.“
 „Wár is þat, waldand“, (kwađ siu,) „þat þú mid þínun wordun
 sprikis,
 3019 sōđ·líko sagis: · Hwat þoh oft an sęli innen
 undar iro hêrron diske · hwelpoþ hwerbad
 3021 brosmoþo fulle · þero fan þemu biode niđer
 ant·fallat iro frōjan.“ · Þó gi·hōrde þat friđu-barn godes
 3023 willjan þes wíbes · ęndi sprak iru mid is wordun tó:
 „wela þat þú wif haþes · willjan góden!
 3025 Mikil is þín gi·lōþo · an þea maht godes,
 an þene liudjo drohtin. · Al wiřđid gi·lêstid só
 3027 umbi þínes barnes líf, · só þú bádi te mi.“
 Þó warð siu sán gi·hêlid, · só it þe hêlago ge·sprak
 3029 wordun wár-fastun: · þat wif fagonode,
 þes siu iro barnes forð · brúkan mōste;
 3031 habde iru gi·holpen · hêljando Krist,
 habde sie far·fangane · fiundo krafft,
 3033 wam-skađun bi·węrid. · Þó gi·wêt imu waldand forð,

barno þat bêtste, · sóhte imu burg öðre,
 3035 þiu só þikko was · mid þeru þiodu Judeono,
 mid süðar-liudjun gi·seten. · Þár gi·fragn ik þat hé is ge·siðos
 grôtte,
 3037 þe jungaron þe hé imu habde be is góde gi·korane, · þat sie
 mid imu gerno ge·wunodun,
 weros þurh is wíson spráka: · „alle skal ik iu“, kwað hé, „mid
 wordun frágon,
 3039 jungaron míne: · hwat kweðat þese Judeo liudi,
 mári megin-þioda, · hwat ik manno sí?“
 3041 Imu and·wordidun frô·líko · is friund an·gegin,
 jungaron síne: · „nis þit Judeono folk,
 3043 erlos ên·wordje: · sum sagad þat þú Elias sí,
 wís wár·sago, · þe hér giu was lango,
 3045 gód undar þesumu gum·skêpje, · sum sagad þat þú Johannes
 sí,
 diur·lík drohtines bodo, · þe hér dôpte iu
 3047 werod an watere; · alle sie mid wordun sprekað,
 þat þú ên·hwi·lík sí · ẽðilero manno,
 3049 þero wár·sagono, · þe hér mid wordun giu
 lêrdun þese liudi, · ẽndi þat þú sí eft an þit lioht kumen
 3051 te wísjanne þesumu werode.“ · Þó sprak eft waldand Krist:
 „Hwe kweðad gí, þat ik sí“, (kwað hé,) „jungaron míne,
 3053 liobon liud·weros?“ · Þó te lat ni warð
 Símon Petrus: · sprak sán an·gegin
 3055 êno for im allun · —habde imu ẽlljen gód,
 þristja gi·þáhti, · was is þeodone hold—:

TODO.

3057 **37** „Þú bist þe wáro · waldandes sunu,
 libbjendes godes, · þe þit lioht gi·skóp,
 3059 Krist kuning êwig: · só willjad wí kweðen alle,
 jungaron þíne, · þat þú sí god selbo,
 3061 hêljandero bêtst.“ · Þó sprak imu eft is hêrro an·gegin:
 „sálig bist þú Símon“, kwað hé, „sunu Jonases; · ni mahtes þú
 þat selbo ge·huggjan,
 3063 gi·markon an þínun mód·gi·þáhtjun, · ne it ni mahte þi
 mannes tunge
 wordun ge·wísjen, · ak dede it þi waldand selbo,

- 3065 fader allaro firiho barno, · þat þú só forð gi·spráki,
só diapo bi drohtin þinen. · Diur-líko skalt þú þes lôn
ant·fáhen,
- 3067 hluttro habas þú an þinan hêrron gi·lôbon, · hugi-skêfti sind
þíne stêne ge·líka,
só fast bist þú só felis þe hardo; · hêten skulun þi firiho barn
- 3069 sankte Péter: · obar þemu stêne skal man mínen sêli wirkjan,
hêlag hús godes; · þár skal is hîwiski tó
- 3071 sálig samnon: · ni mugun wið þem þínun swiðjun krafte
an·þebbjen hêllje portun. · Ik far·gibu þi himil·ríkjas slutilas,
- 3073 þat þú móst aftar mí · allun gi·waldan
kristinum folke; · kumad alle te þi
- 3075 gumono gêstos; · þú haþe grôte gi·wald,
hwene þú hér an erðu · êldi-barno
- 3077 ge·binden willjes: · þemu is bêðju gi·duan,
himil·ríki bi·loken, · êndi hêllje sind imu opana,
- 3079 brinnandi fiur; · só hwene só þú eft ant·binden wili,
an·þeftjen is hêndi, · þemu is himil·ríki,
- 3081 ant·loken liohto mêst · êndi líf êwig,
gróni godes wang. · Mid su·líkaru ik þi geþu willju
- 3083 lônon þinen gi·lôbon. · Ni willju ik, þat gí þesun liudjun noh,
márjen þesaru mênigi, · þat ik bium mahtig Krist,
- 3085 godes êgan barn. · Mí skulun Judeon noh,
un-skuldigna · erlos binden,
- 3087 wêgjan mí te wundrun · —dót mí wítjes filo—
innan Jerusalem · gêres ordun,
- 3089 áhtjen mínes aldres · eggjun skarpun,
bi·lôsjen mí líbu. · Ik an þesumu liohte skal
- 3091 þurh úses drohtines kraft · fan dôde a·standen
an þriddjumu dage“. · Þó warð þegno bêtst
- 3093 swiðo an sorgun, · Símon Petrus,
warð imu hugi hriuwig, · êndi te is hêrron sprak
- 3095 rink an rúnun: · „ni skal þat ríki god“, kwað hé,
„waldand willjen, · þat þú eo su·lík wíti mikil
- 3097 gi·þolos undar þesaru þiod: · nis þes þarf nigijan,
hêlag drohtin.“ · Þó sprak imu eft is hêrro an·gëgin,
- 3099 mári mahtig Krist · —was imu an is móde hold—:
„Hwat þú nú wiðer·ward bist“, (kwað hé,) „willjon mínes,
- 3101 þegno bêtsto! · Hwat þú þesaro þiodo kanst

3103 mēnniskan sidu: · þú ni wêst þe maht godes,
 þe ik gi·frummjen skal. · Ik mag þi filu sēggjan
 3105 wárun wordun, · þár hér undar þesumu werode standad
 ge·sīðos míne, · þea ni mótun swelten êr,
 3107 hwerþen an hinen-fard · êr sie himiles lioht,
 godes ríki seht.“ · Kôs imu jungarono þó
 sán aftar þiu · Símón Petrus,
 3109 Jakob ęndi Johannes, · ea gumon twēne,
 bêðja þea gi·bróðer, · ęndi imu þó uppen þene berg gi·wêt
 3111 sunder mid þem ge·sīðun, · sálig barn godes,
 mid þem þegnun þrim, · þido drohtin,
 3113 waldand þesaro wer-oldest: · welde im þár wundres filu,
 tēkno tōgjan, · þat sie gi·trúodin þiu bêt,
 3115 þat hé selbo was · sunu drohtines,
 hēlag heban-kuning. · Þó sie an hôhan wall
 3117 stigun stēn ęndi berg, · ant-tat sie te þeru stędi kwámun,
 weros wiðer wolkan, · þár waldand Krist,
 3119 kuningo kraftigost · gi·koren habde,
 þat hé is god-kundi · jungarun sínun
 3121 þurh is ęnes kraft · ógjan welde,
 3122^a berht-lík biliði.

TODO.

3122^b **38** Þó imu þár te bedu gi·hnēg,
 þó warð imu þár uppe · óðar-líkora
 3124 wliiti ęndi gi·wádi: · wurðun imu is wangun liohte,
 blíkandi só þiu berhte sunne: · só skēn þat barn godes,
 3126 liuhte is lik-hamo: · liomon stóðun
 wánamo fan þemu waldandes barne; · warð is ge·wádi só hwít
 3128 só snēw te sehanne. · Þó warð þár seld-lík þing
 gi·ógid aftar þiu: · Elias ęndi Moyses
 3130 kwámun þár te Kriste · wið só kraftagne
 wordun wehsljan. · Þár warð só wun-sam spráka,
 3132 só gód word undar gumun, · þár þe godes sunu
 wið þea mārjan man · mahljen welde,
 3134 só bliði warð uppan þemu berge: · skēn þat berhte lioht,
 was þár gard gód-lík · ęndi gróni wang,
 3136 Paradise ge·lík. · Petrus þó gi·mahalde,
 hēlið hard-módig · ęndi te is hērron sprak,

3138 grótte þene godes sunu: · „gód is it hér te wesanne,
 ef þú it gi·kiosan wili, · Krist alo-waldo,
 3140 þat man þi hér an þesaru hôhe · ên hús ge·wirkja,
 mâr·líko ge·mako · êndi Moysesê ôðer
 3142 êndi Eliase þriddja: · þit is ôðas hêm,
 welono wun-samost.“ · Reht só hé þó þat word ge·sprak,
 3144 só ti·lét þiu luft an twê: · lioht wolkan skên,
 glitandi glímo, · êndi þea góðun man
 3146 wli·t-skôni be·warp. · Þó fan þemu wolkne kwam
 hêlag stemne godes, · êndi þem hêliðun þár
 3148 selbo sagde, · þat þat is sunu wári,
 libbjendero liobost: · „an þemu mí líkod wel
 3150 an mínun hugi·skeftjun. · Þemu gí hôrjen skulun,
 ful·gangad imu gerno.“ · Þó ni mahtun þea jungaron Kristes
 3152 þes wolknes wli·t · êndi word godes,
 þea is mikilon maht · þea man ant·standen,
 3154 ak sie bi·fellun þó forð·wardes: · ferhes ni wándun,
 lêngiron líbes. · Þó géng im tó þe landes ward,
 3156 be·hrên sie mid is handun · hêljandero bêtst,
 hét þat sie im ni an·drédin: · „ni skal iu hér derjen eo·wiht,
 3158 þes gí hér seld·líkes · gi·sehen habbjad,
 mérjaro þingo.“ · Þó eft þem mannun warð
 3160 hugi at iro herton · êndi gi·hêlid mód,
 gi·bade an iro breostun: · gi·sáhun þat barn godes
 3162 ênna standen, · was þat ôðer þó,
 be·hliden himiles lioht. · Þó gi·wêt imu þe hêlago Krist
 3164 fan þemu berge niðer; · gi·bôd aftar þiu
 jungarun sínun, · þat sie obar Judeono folk
 3166 ni sagdin þea gi·sioni: · „er þan ik selbo hér
 swíðo diur·líko · fan dôðe a·stande,
 3168 a·ríse fan þeru rēstu: · siðor mugun gí it rēkkjen forð,
 mârjen obar middil·gard · managun þiodun
 3170^a wído aftar þesaru wer·oldi.“

TODO.

3170^b 39

Þó gi·wêt imu waldand Krist

eft an Galileo land, · sóhte is gadulingos,
 3172 mahtig is mágo hêm, · sagde þár manages hwat
 berhtero biliðjo, · êndi þat barn godes

- 3174 þem is sáligun ge·siðun · sorg·spell ni for·hal,
 ak hé im open·liko · allun sagde,
 3176 þem is góðun jungarun, · hwó ine skolde þat Judeono folk
 wêggjan te wundrun. · Þes wurðun þár wise man
 3178 swiðo an sorgun, · warð im sêr hugi,
 hriuwig umbi iro herte: · gi·hórdun iro hêrron þó,
 3180 waldandes sunu · wordun tēlljen,
 hwat hé undar þeru þiodu · þolojan skolde,
 3182 willjendi undar þemu werode. · Þó gi·wêt imu waldand Krist,
 gumo fan Galilea, · sóhte imu Judeono burg,
 3184 kwámum im te Kafarnaum. · Þár fundun sie ênan kuninges
 þegan
 wlankan undar þemu werode: · kwað þat hé wári gi·wēldig
 bodo
 3186 aðal·kêsure; · hé grótte aftar þiu
 Símon Petrusen, · kwað þat hé wári gi·sēndid þarod,
 3188 þat hé þár gi·manodi · manno ge·hwi·líken
 þero hōbid·skatto, · þe sie te þemu hobe skoldin
 3190 tinsi gelden: · „nis þes tweho ênig
 gumono ni·gj·ênumu, · ne sie ina far·gelden sán
 3192 mēðmo kustjon, · bi·úten iuwe mēster êno
 habad it far·láten. · Ni skal þat líkon wel
 3194 mínumu hêrron, · só man it imu at is hobe küðid,
 aðal·kêsure.“ · Þó géng aftar þiu
 3196 Símon Petrus, · welde it seggjjan þó
 hêrron sínumu: · hé was is an is hugi iu þan,
 3198 gi·waro waldand Krist: · —imu ni mahte word ênig
 bi·holen werðen, · hé wisse hugi·skēfti
 3200 manno ge·hwi·likes—: · hét þó þene is márjan þegan,
 Símon Petrus · an þene sêo innen
 3202 angul werpen: · „su·líken só þú þár êrist mugis
 fisk gi·fáhen“, (kwað hé,) „só teoh þú þene fan þemu flóde te þi,
 3204 ant·klēmmi imu þea kinni: · þár maht þú undar þem kaflon
 nimen
 guldine skattos, · þat þú far·gelden maht
 3206 þemu manne te gi·módja · mínen êndi þinen
 tinsjo só hwi·líkan, · só hé ùs tó sókid.“
 3208 Hé ni þorfte imu þó aftar þiu · ððaru wordu
 furður gi·bioden: · géng fiskari gód,

- 3210 Símón Petrus, · warp an þene sêo innen
angul an ûðjon · ęndi up gi-tôh
3212 fisk an flóde · mid is folmun twêm,
te·klóf imu þea kinni · ęndi undar þem kaflun nam
3214 guldine skattos: · dede al, só imu þe godes sunu
wordun ge·wisde. · Þár was þó waldandes
3216 megin-kraft gi·márid, · hwó skal allaro manno ge·hwi-lík
swíðo willjendi · is wer-old-hêrron
3218 skuldi ęndi skattos, · þea imu gi·skęride sind,
gerno gelden: · ni skal ine far·gúmon eo-wiht,
3220 ni far·muni ine an is móde, · ak wese imu mildi an is hugi,
þiono imu þio-líko: · an þiu mag hé þiod-godes
3222 willjan ge·wirkjan · ęndi ôk is wer-old-hêrron
3223^a huldi habbjen.

TODO.

- 3223^b 40 Sô lêrde þe hêlago Krist
þea is gódon jungaron: · „ef ênig gumono wið iu“, kwað hé,
3225 „sundja ge·wirkja, · þan nim þú ina sundar te þi,
þene rink an rúna · ęndi imu is rād saga,
3227 wísi imu mid wordun. · Ef imu þan þes werð ne sí,
þat hé þi gi·hôrje, · hala þi þár ôðara tó
3229 góðaro gumono, · ęndi lah imu is grimmun werk,
sak ina sôð-wordun. · Ef imu þan is sundja aftar þiu,
3231 lôs-werk ni lêðon, · gi·duo it ôðrun liudjun kûð,
mári it þan for męnegi · ęndi lát manno filu
3233 witen is far·wurhti: · ôðo be·ginnad imu þan is werk tregan,
an is hugi hreuwen, · þan hé it gi·hórid hęliðo filu,
3235 ahton ęldi-barn · ęndi imu is ubilon dád
werjad mid wordun. · Ef hé þan ôk węndjen ne wili,
3237 ak far·módat su-líka męnegi, · þan lát þú þene man faren,
haba ina þan far hêðinen · ęndi lát ina þi an þinumu hugi
lêðen,
3239 míð is an þinumu móde, · ne sí þat imu eft mildi god,
hêr heban-kuning · helpe far-líhe,
3241 fader allaro firiho barno.“ · Þó frágode Petrus,
allaro þegno bętst · þeodan sínan:
3243 „hwó oft skal ik þem mannun, · þe wið mí habbjad
lêð-werk gi·duan, · leobo drohtin,

3245 skal ik im sibun siðun · iro sundja a·lâten,
 wrêðaro werko, · êr þan ik is êniga wrêka frummje,
 3247 lêðes te lône?“ · Þó sprak eft þe landes ward,
 an·gegin þe godes sunu · gódumu þegne:
 3249 „ni seggju ik þi fan sibunjun, · só þú selbo sprikis,
 mahlis mid þínu müðu, · ik duom þi mêra þár tó:
 3251 sibun siðun sibun-tig · só skalt þú sundja ge·hwemu,
 lêðes a·lâten: · só willju ik þi te lêrun geben
 3253 wordun wár-fastun. · Nú ik þi su-líka gi·wald far·gaf,
 þat þú mínes híwiskes · hêrost wáris,
 3255 manages mann-kunnjes, · nú skalt þú im mildi wesen,
 liudjun líði.“ · Þó þár te þemu lêrjande kwam
 3257 ên jung man an·gegin · êndi frágode Jesu Krist:
 „mêster þe gódo“, (kwað hé,) „hwat skal ik manages duan,
 3259 an þiu þe ik heban-riki · ge·halan móti?“
 Habde imu ôd-welon · allen ge·wunnen,
 3261 mêðom-hord manag, · þoh hé mildjan hugi
 bári an is breostun. · Þó sprak imu þat barn godes:
 3263 „hwat kwiðis þú umbi gódon? · nis þat gumono ênig
 bi·útan þe êno, · þe þár al ge·skóp,
 3265 wer-old êndi wunnja. · Ef þú is willjan hábas,
 þat þú an lioht godes · líðan mótis,
 3267 þan skalt þú bi·halden · þea hêlagon lêra,
 þe þár an þemu aldon · êwa ge·biudid,
 3269 þat þú man ni slah, · ni þú mènes ni sweri,
 far·legar-nessi far·lát · êndi luggi ge·wit-skêpi,
 3271 stríd êndi stulina; · ne wis þú te stark an hugi,
 ne níðin ne hatul, · ni nôd-róf ni frêmi;
 3273 aþ-unst alla far·lát; · wis þínun êldirun gód,
 fader êndi móder, · êndi þínun friundun hold,
 3275 þem náhistun gi·náðig. · Þan þú þi gi·niodon móst
 himilo rikjas, · ef þú it bi·halden wili,
 3277 ful·gangan godes lêrun.“ · Þó sprak eft þe jungo man
 „al hebbju ik só gi·lêstid“, (kwað hé,) „só þú mí lêris nú,
 3279 wordun wísis, · só ik is eo wiht ni far·lét
 fan mínero kindiski.“ · Þó bi·gan ina Krist sehan
 3281 an mid is ôgun: · „ên is þár noh nú“, kwað hé,
 „wan þero werko: · ef þú is willjon hábas,
 3283 þat þú þurh-frêmid · þionon mótis

3285 hêrron þínumu, · þan skalt þú þat þín hord nimen,
 skalt þínan ôd-welon · allan far-kôþjen,
 3287 diurje mêðmos, · êndi dêljen hét
 armun mannun: · þan habas þú aftar þiu
 hord an himile; · kum þi þan gi·halden te mí,
 3289 folgo þi mínaro fêrði: · þan habas þú friðu siður.“
 Þó wurðun Kristes word · kind-jungumu manne
 3291 swíðo an sorgun, · was imu sêr hugi,
 mód umbi herte: · habde mêðmo filu,
 3293 welono ge·wunnen; · wênde imu eft þanen,
 was imu un-ôðo · innan breostun,
 3295 an is sebon swáro. · Sah imu aftar þó
 Krist alo-waldo, · kwað it þó, þár hé welde,
 3297 te þem is jungarun gegin-wardun, · þat wári an godes ríki
 un-ôði ôdagumu manne · up te kumanne:
 3299 „ôður mag man olbundjon, · þoh hé sí un-met grôt,
 þurh náðlan gat, · þoh it sí naru swíðo,
 3301 sáftur þurh·slóþjen, · þan mugi kuman þiu siole te himile
 þes ôdagan mannes, · þe hér al hábad
 3303 gi·wêndid an þene wer-old-skat · willjon sínén,
 mód-gi·þáhti, · êndi ni hugid umbi þie maht godes.“

TODO.

3305 41 Imu and-wordjade · êr-þungan gumo,
 Símon Petrus, · êndi seggjan bad
 3307 leoban hêrron: · „Hwat skulun wí þes te lône nimen“, kwað
 hé,
 „gódes te gelde, · þes wí þurh þín jungar-dóm
 3309 êgan êndi êrbi · al far-létun
 hobos êndi hiwiski · êndi þi te hêrron gi-kurun,
 3311 folgodun þínaru fêrði: · hwat skal ús þes te frumu werðen,
 langes te lône?“ · Liudjo drohtin
 3313 sagde im þó selbo: · „Þan ik sittjen kumu“, kwað hé,
 „an þie mikilan maht · an þemu márjan dage,
 3315 þár ik allun skal · irmin-þiodun
 dómos a·dêljen, · þan mótun gí mid iuwomu drohtine þár
 3317 selbon sittjen · êndi mótun þera saka waldan:
 mótun gí Israhelo · êðili-folkun
 3319 a·dêljen aftar iro dádjun: · só mótun gí þár gi·diuride wesen.

Ðan seggju ik iu te wáran: · só hwe só þat an þesaru wer-oldi
 gi-duot,
 3321 þat hé þurh mína minnja · mágo ge·sidli
 liof far·létid, · þes skal hí hér lôn niman
 3323 tehan siðun tehin-fald, · ef hé it mid treuwon duot,
 mid hluttru hugi. · Obar þat habad hé ôk himiles lioht,
 3325 open êwig líf.“ · Bi-gan imu þó aftar þiu
 allaro barno bêtst · ên biliði seggjan,
 3327 kwað þat þár ên ôdag man · an êr-dagun
 wári undar þemu werode: · þe habde welono ge·nóg,
 3329 sinkas gi·samnod · êndi imu simlun was
 garu mid goldu · êndi mid godo-wëbbju,
 3331 fagarun fratahun · êndi imu so filu habde
 gódes an is gardun · êndi imu at gômun sat
 3333 allaro dago ge·hwi-likes: · habde imu diur-lík líf,
 blíðsja an is bēnkjun. · Ðan was þár eft ên biddjendi man,
 3335 gi·lébod an is lík-hamon, · Lazarus was hé hēten,
 lag imu dago ge·hwi-likes · at þem durun foren,
 3337 þár hé þene ôdagan man · inne wisse
 an is gēst-seli · gôme þiggjan,
 3339 sittjen at sumble, · êndi hé simlun bēd
 gi·armod þár úte: · ni mōste þár in kuman,
 3341 ne hé ni mahte ge·biddjen, · þat man imu þes brôdes þarod
 gi·dragan weldi, · þes þár fan þemu diske niðer
 3343 ant·fel undar iro fôti: · ni mahte imu þár ênig fruma werðen
 fan þemu hēroston, þe þes húses gi·wéld, · bi·útan þat þár
 géngun is hundos tó,
 3345 likkodun is lík-wundon, · þár hé liggjandi
 hungar þolode; · ni kwam imu þár te helpu wiht
 3347 fan þemu ríkjon manne. · Ðó gi·fragn ik þat ina is regano
 gi·skapu,
 þene armon man · is ên-dago
 3349 gi·manoda mahtjun swið, · þat hé manno drôm
 a·geben skolde. · Godes engilos
 3351 ant·féngun is ferh · êndi lêddun ine forð þanen,
 þat sie an Abrahames barm · þes armon mannes
 3353 siole gi·sëttun: · þár mōste hé simlun forð
 wesen an wunnjun. · Ðó kwámun ôk wurde-gi·skapu,
 3355 þemu ôdagan man · or-lag-hwíle,

3395 þat sie im þár far·wirkjen, · þat sie skulin ôk an þit wíti te mí,
 an só grádag fiur.“ · Þó imu eft te·gegnes sprak
 3397 Abraham ald-fader, · kwað þat sie þár êo godes
 an þemu land-skepí, · liudi habdin,
 Moyseses gi·bôd · êndi þár managaro tó
 3399 wár-saguno word: · „ef sie is willige sind,
 þat sie þat bi·halden, · þan ni þurbun sie an þea hêll innen,
 3401 an þat fern faren, · ef sie ge·frummjad só,
 só þea ge·biodad, · þe þea bók lesat
 3403 þem liudjun te lêrun. · Ef sie þes þan ni willjad lêstjen wiht,
 þanne ni hôrjad sie ôk · þemu þe hinan a·stád,
 3405 man fan dôðe. · Láte man sie an iro mód-sebon
 selbon keosen, · hweðer im swótjera þunkje
 3407 te gi·winnanne, · só lango só sie an þesaru wer-oldi sind,
 þat sie eft ubil eþþa gód · aftar habbjæn.“

TODO.

3409 **42** Só lérde hé þó þea liudi · liohton wordon,
 allaro barno bêtst, · êndi biliði sagde
 3411 manag man-kunnje · mahtig drohtin,
 kwað þat imu ên sálig gumo · samnon bi·gunni
 3413 man an morgen, · „êndi im méda gi·hét,
 þe hêrosto þes híwiskjas, · swiðo *hold-lík lôn“,
 3415 kwað þat hie iro allaro gi·hwem · ênna gábi
 silōbrinna skat. · „Þuo samnodun managa
 3417 weros an is wín-gardon, · —êndi hie im werk bi·falāh—
 ádro an úhtan. · Sum kwam þár ôk an undorn tuo,
 3419 sum kwam þár an middjan dag, · man te þem werke,
 sum kwam þár te nónu, · þuo was þiu niguða tíð
 3421 sumar-langes dages; · sum þár ôk siðor kwam
 an þia elliſtun tíð. · Þuo géng þár áband tuo,
 3423 sunna ti sedle. · Þuo hie selbo gi·bôd
 is ambahtjon, · erlo drohtin,
 3425 þat man þero manno gi·hwem · is meoda for·guldi,
 þem erlon arbid-lôn; · hiet þiem at êrist geban.
 3427 þia þár at létst wárun, · liudi kumana,
 weros te þem werke, · êndi mid is wordon gi·bôd,
 3429 þat man þem mannon iro · mieda for·guldi
 alles at aftan, · þem þár kwámun at êrist tuo

- 3431 willendi te þem werke. · Wándun sia swíðo,
 þat man im mēra lôn · gi·makod habdi
 3433 wið iro arābedje: · þan man im allon gaf,
 þem liudjon gi·liko. · Lēð was þat swíðo,
 3435 allon þem ando, · þem þár kwámun at êrist tuo:
 „wí kwámun hier an morāgan“, (kwáðun sia,) „endi þolodun hier
 manag te dage
 3437 arābid-werko, · hwílon un-met hét,
 skínandja sunna: · nú ni gibis þú ús skattes þan mēr,
 3439 þie þú þem ôðron duos, · þia hier êna hwíla
 wáron an þínon werke.“ · Þuo habda eft is word garo
 3441 þie hêrosto þes híwiskes, · kwað þat hie im ni habdi gi·hêtan
 þan mēr
 werðes wið iro werke: · „Hwat ik gi·wald hēbbju“, kwaþ-hie,
 3443 „þat ik iu allon gi·liko · muot lôn for-geldan,
 iuwes werkes werð.“ · Þan waldandi Krist
 3445 mēnda im þoh mēra þing, · þoh hie oþar þat manno folk
 fan þem wín-gardon só · wordon spráki,
 3447 hwó þár un-efno · erlos kwámun,
 weros te þem werke. · Só skulun fan þero wer-oldi duon
 3449 mann-kunnjes barn · an þat mārjo lioht,
 gumon an godes wang: · sum bi·ginnit ina giriwan sán
 3451 an is kindiski, · habit im gi·koreanan muod,
 willjon guodan, · wer-old-saka mīðit,
 3453 far·látit is lusta; · ni mag ina is lik-hamo
 an un·spuod for·spanan: · spáhiða línót,
 3455 godes êw, · gramono for·látit,
 wrêðaro willjon, · duot im só te is wer-oldi forð,
 3457 lêstit só an þeson liohte, · ant-þat im is líbes kumit,
 aldres áband; · gi·wítit im þan up-wegos:
 3459 þár wirðit im is arābedi · all gi·lônót,
 far·goldan mid guodu · an godes ríkje.
 3461 Þat mēndun þia wuruhtjon, · þia an þem wín-gardon
 ádro an úhta · arbid·liko
 3463 werk bi·gunnun · endi þuru·wonodun forð,
 erlos unt áband. · Sum þár ôk an undern kwam,
 3465 habda þuo far·mērrid, · þia morāgan-stunda
 þes dag-werkes for·duolon; · só duot doloro filo,
 3467 gi·mēðaro manno: · driþit im mis·lik þing

3469 gerno an is **juguði**, · —habit im **gelp-kwidi**
lêða gi·línot · **endi lôs-word** manag—,
3471 ant-þat is **kindiski** · far-**kuman** wirðit,
þat ina after is **juguði** · **godes** anst manot
3473 **blíði** an is **brioston**; · fahit im te **bęteron** þan
wordon **endi werkon**, · **lêdit** im is **wer-old** mid þiu,
3475 is **aldar** ant þena **endi**: · **kumit** im **alles lôn**
an **godes ríkje**, · **góðaro** werko.
3477 Sum **mann** þan **mid-firi** · **mên** far-**látid**,
swára **sundjun**, · fahit im an **sálig** þing,
3479 bi·ginnit im þuru **godes** kraft · **guodaro** werko,
buotit **baló-spráka**, · **látit** im is **bittrun** **dád**
3481 an is **hugje hreuwan**; · **kumit** im þiu **helpa** fon gode,
þat im gi·**lêstid** þie gi·**lôbo**, · **só lango** **só** im is **lif** warod;
3483 **farit** im **forð** mid þiu, · ant-**fahit** is **mieda**,
guod **lôn** at **gode**; · **ni sindun** **êniga** **geþa** **bęteran**.
3485 Sum bi·ginnit þan **ók** **furðor**, · þan hie ist **fruodot** **mêr**,
is **aldares** af-**hêldit**, · —þan bi·ginnat im is **ubilon** **werk**
3487 **lêðon** an þeson **liohte**, · þan ina **lêra** **godes**
gi·**manod** an is **muode**: · **wirðit** im **mildera** **hugi**,
3489 þuru·**gęngit** im mid **guodu** · **endi** **geld** **nimit**,
hôh **himil-ríki**, · þan hie **hinan** **węndit**,
3491 **wirðit** im is **mieda** **só sama**, · **só þem** **man** ***nun** **warð**,
þea þár te **nónu** **dages**, · an þea **nigunda** **tíd**,
3493 an þene **wín-gardon** · **wirkjan** **kwámun**.
Sum **wirðid** þan **só swíðo** **ge·fródot**, · **só hé** **ni wili** is **sundja**
bótjen,
ak **hé ôkid** **sie** mid **ubilu** **ge·hwi-líku**, · ant-tat **imu** is **áband**
náhid,
3495 is **wer-old** **endi** is **wunnja** **far-slítid**; · þan be·ginnid **hé** **imu**
wíti an-**dréden**,
is **sundjon** **werðad** **imu** **sorga** an **móde**: · **ge·hugid** **hwat** **hé**
selbo **ge·frumide**
3497 **grimmes** þan **lango**, þe **hé móste** is **juguðjo** **neoten**; · **ni mag**
þan mid **ôðru** **góðu** gi·**bótjen**
þea **dádi**, þea **hé** **só dęrþja** **ge·frumide**, · **ak** **hé slęhit** **allaro**
dago **ge·hwi-líkes**
3499 an is **breost** mid **bęðjun** **handun** · **endi wópit** **sie** mid **bittrun**
trahnun,

3533 an þriddjon dage. · Ni kwam ik undar þesa þeoda herod
 te þiu, þat mín ęldi-barn · arbêd habdin,
 3535 þat mí þionodi þius þiod: · ni willju ik is sie þiggjen nú,
 fergon þit folk-skępi, · ak ik skal imu te frumu werðen,
 3537 þeonon imu þeo-liko · ęndi for alla þesa þeoda geben
 seole míne. · Ik willju sie selbo nú
 3539 lôsjen mid mínu líbu, · þea hér lango bidun,
 man-kunnjes manag, · mínara helpa.“
 3541 Fór imu þó forð-wardes · —habde imu fasten hugi,
 blíðjan an is breostun · barn drohtines—
 3543 welda im te Jerusalem · Judeo folkes
 willjon wisan: · hé konste þes werodes só garo
 3545 hęti-grimmen hugi · ęndi hardan strid,
 wrêðan willjon. · Werod siðode
 3547 furi Jerikho-burg; · was þe godes sunu,
 mahtig undar þero męnigi. · Þár sátun twênje man bi wege,
 3549 blinde wárun sie bêðje: · was im bótono þarf,
 þat sie ge-hêldi · hebanes waldand,
 3551 hwand sie só lango · liohtes þolodun,
 managa hwíla. · Sie gi-hôrdun þó þat męgin faren
 3553 ęndi frágodun sán · firi-wit-liko
 ręgini-blindun, · hwi-lík þár ríki man
 3555 undar þemu folk-skępi · furista wári,
 hêrost an hôbid. · Þó sprak im ên hęlið an-ęegin,
 3557 kwað þat þár Jesu Krist · fan Galilea-lande,
 hêljandero bętst · hêrost wári,
 3559 fóri mid is folku. · Þó warð fráh-mód hugi
 bêðjun þem blindun mannun, · þó sie þat barn godes
 3561 wissun under þemu werode: · hreopun im þó mid iro wordun
 tó,
 hlúdo te þemu hêlagon Kriste, · bádun þat hé im helpe
 ge-rédi:
 3563 „drohtin Dawides sunu: · wis ęs mid þínun dádjun mildi,
 nęri ęs af þesaru nôdi, · só þú gi-nóge dós
 3565 manno kunnjes: · þú bist managun gód,
 hilpis ęndi hêlis.“ · Þo bi-gan im þat hęliðo folk
 3567 węrjen mid wordun, · þat sie an waldand Krist
 só hlúdo ni hriopin. · Si ni weldun im hôrjen te þiu,
 3569 ak sie simla mêr ęndi mêr · oðar þat manno folk

hlúdo hreopun. · Hêljand ge·stód,
 3571 allaro barno bêtst, · hét sie þó brenġen te imu,
 lêdjen þurh þea liudi, · sprak im listjun tó
 3573 mild·líko for þeru mēnegi: · „hwat willjad git mínaro hér“,
 kwað hé,
 „helpono habben?“ · Sie bádun ina hêlagna,
 3575 þat hé im ira ôgon · opana gi·dádi,
 far·liwi þeses liohtes, · þat sie liudjo drôm,
 3577 swigle sunnun skín · gi·sehen móstin,
 wliiti-skônje wer·old. · Waldand frumide,
 3579 hrên sie þó mid is handun, · dede is helpe þár tó,
 þat þem blindun þó · bêðjum wurðun
 3581 ôgon gi·oponod, · þat sie erðe ġndi himil
 þurh kraft godes · ant·kiennjen mahtun,
 3583 lioht ġndi liudi. · Þó sagdun sie lof gode,
 diurdun úsan drohtin, · þes sie dages liohtes
 3585 brúkan móstun: · ge·witun im bêðje mid imu,
 folgodun is fērdi: · was im þiu fruma ġibiðig,
 3587 ġndi ôk waldandes werk · wído ge·kūðid,
 3588^a managun gi·márid.

TODO.

3588^b 44 Þár was só mahtig·lík
 biliði gi·bóknid, · þár þe blindon man
 3590 bi þemu wege sátun, · wíti þolodun,
 liohtes lôse: · þat mēnid þoh liudjo barn,
 3592 al man·kunni, · hwó sie mahtig god
 an þemu ana·ginne · þurh is ġnes kraft
 3594 sin·hiun twê · selbo gi·warhte,
 Ádam ġndi Éwan: · far·gaf im up·wegos,
 3596 himilo ríki; · ak þó warð im þe hatola te náh,
 fiund mid fēknu · ġndi mid firin·werkun,
 3598 bi·swēk sie mid sundjun, · þat sie sin·skôni,
 lioht far·létun: · wurðun an lêðaron stēdi,
 3600 an þesen middil·gard · man far·worpen,
 þolodun hér an þiustrju · þiod·arbēdi,
 3602 wunnun wrak·sīðos, · welon þarbodun:
 far·gátun godes ríkjes, · gramon þeonodun,
 3604 fiundo barnun; · sie guldun is im mid fiuru lôn

an þeru hêton hêljju. · Be·þiu wárun siu an iro hugi blinda
 3606 an þesaru middil-gard, · mēnniskono barn,
 hwand siu ine ni ant·kiendun, · kraftagne god,
 3608 himilisen hêrron, · þene þe sie mid is handun gi·skóp,
 gi·warhte an is willjon. · Þius wer-old was þó só far·hwērbid,
 3610 bi·þwungen an þiustrje, · an þiod·arbidi,
 an dōðes dalu: · sátun im þó bi þeru drohtines strátun
 3612 jámar-móde, · godes helpe bidun:
 siu ni mahte im þó êr werðen, · êr þan waldand god
 3614 an þesan middil-gard, · mahtig drohtin,
 is selbes sunu · sēndjen weldi
 3616 þat hé lioht ant·luki · liudjo barnun,
 oponodi im êwig líf, · þat sie þene alo-waldon
 3618 mahtin ant·kēnnjen wel, · kraftagna god.
 Ôk mag ik giu gi·tēlljen, · of gí þár tó willjad
 3620 huggjen ċndi hōrjen, · þat gí þes hêljandes mugun
 kraft ant·kēnnjen, · hwó is kumi wurðun
 3622 an þesaru middil-gard · managun te helpu,
 ia hwat hé mid þem dādjun · drohtin selbo
 3624 manages mēnde, · ia be·hwiu þiu mārje burg
 Jerikho hêtid, · þiu þár an Judeon stád
 3626 gi·makod mid mûrun: · þiu is aftar þemu mánen gi·nēmnið,
 aftar þemu torhten tungle: · hé ni mag is tīdi be·míðen,
 3628 ak hé dago ge·hwi·líkes · duod ôðer·hweðer,
 wanod ohþo wahsid. · Só dód an þesaro wer-oldi hér,
 3630 an þesaru middil-gard · mēnniskono barn:
 farad ċndi folgod, · fróde sterbad,
 3632 werðad eft junga · aftar kumane,
 weros a·wahsane, · unt-tat sie eft wurd far·nimid.
 3634 Þat mēnde þat barn godes, · þó hé fon þeru burgi fôr,
 þe gódo fan Jerikho, · þat ni mahte êr werðen gumono barnun
 3636 þiu blindja gi·bótíd, · þat sie þat berhte lioht,
 gi·sáhin sin-skôni, · êr þan hé selbo hér
 3638 an þesaru middil-gard · mēnniski ant·féng,
 flêsk ċndi lík-hamon. · Þó wurðun þes firihō barn
 3640 gi·war an þesaru wer-oldi, · þe hér an wítje êr,
 sátun an sundjun · gi·siunjes lôse,
 3642 þolodun an þiustrje, · —sie af·sóðun þat was þesaru þiod
 kuman

hêljand te helpu · fan heban-ríkje,
 3644 Krist allaro kuningo beſt; · sie mahtun is ant·kennjen sán,
 gi·fôljen is fardjo. · Þó sie só filu hriopun,
 3646 þe man te þemu mahtigon gode, · þat im mildi aftar þiu
 waldand wurði. · Þan wëridun im swiðo
 3648 þia swárun sundjon, · þe sie im êr selbon gi·dádun,
 lettun sie þes gi·lôbon. · Sie ni mahtun þem liudjun þoh
 3650 bi·wërlen iro willjon, · ak sie an waldand god
 hlúdo hriopun, · ant-tat hé im iro hêli far·gaf,
 3652 þat sie sin·lif · gi·sehen móstin,
 open êwig liocht · êndi an faren
 3654 an þiu berhtun bú. · Þat mëndun þea blindun man,
 þe þár bi Jerikho-burg · te þemu godes barne
 3656 hlúdo hriopun, · þat hé im iro hêli far·lihi,
 liottes an þesumu libe: · þan im þea liudi só filu
 3658 wëridun mid wordun, · þea þár an þemu wege fórun
 bi·foren êndi bi·hinden: · só dót þea firin-sundjon
 3660 an þesaru middil-gard · man-kunnje.
 hôrjad nú hwó þie blindun, · siður im gi·bótíd warð,
 3662 þat sie sunnun liocht · ge·sehen móstun,
 hwó si þó dádun: · ge·witun im mid iro drohtine samad,
 3664 folgodun is fërdi, · sprákun filu wordo
 þemu landes hirdje te lobe: · só dód im noh liudjo barn
 3666 wído aftar þesaru wer-oldi, · siður im waldand Krist
 ge·liuhte mid is lêrun · êndi im lif êwig,
 3668 godes ríki far·gaf · gódun mannun,
 hôh himiles liocht · êndi is helpe þár tó,
 3670 só hwemu só þat gi·werkod, · þat hé móti þemu is wege
 folgon.

TODO.

45 Þó náhide · nërljendo Krist,
 3672 þe gódo te Jerusalem. · Kwam imu þár te·gegnes filu
 werodes an willjon · wel huggendjes,
 3674 ant·fëngun ina fağaro · êndi imu bi·foren streidun
 þene weg mid iro gi·wádjun · êndi mid wurtjun só same,
 3676 mid berhtun blómun · êndi mid bômo tógun,
 þat feld mid fağaron palmun, · al só is fard ge·buride,
 3678 þat þe godes sunu · gangan welde

te þeru márjan burg. · Hwarf ina megin umbi
 3680 liudjo an lustun, · endi lof-sang a-hóf
 þat werod an willjon: · sagdun waldande þank,
 3682 þes þár selbo kwam · sunu Dawides
 wíson þes werodes. · Þó ge-sah waldand Krist
 3684 þe gódo te Jerusalem, · gumono bêtsta,
 blíkan þene burges wal · endi bú Judeono,
 3686 hōha horn-seli · endi ôk þat hús godes,
 allaro wího wun-samost. · Þó wel imu an innen
 3688 hugi wið is herte: · þó ni mahte þat hêlage barn
 wópu a-wísjen, · sprak þó wordo filu
 3690 hriuwig-liko · —was imu is hugi sêreg—:
 „wê warð þí, Jerusalem“, (kwað hé,) „þes þú te wárun ni wêst
 3692 þea wurde-gi-skæfti, · þe þí noh gi-werðen skulun,
 hwo þú noh wirðis be-habd · hêrjes kraftu
 3694 endi þí bi-sittjad · slíð-móde man,
 fiund mid folkun. · Þan ni hábas þú friðu hwêrgin,
 3696 mund-burd mid mannun: · lêðjad þi hér manage tó
 ordos endi eggja, · or-legas word,
 3698 far·fiop þín folk-skæpi · fiures liomon,
 þese wíki a-wóstjad, · wallos hōha
 3700 fêlljad te foldun: · ni af-stád is felis nígijan,
 stên obar ôðrumu, · ak werðad þesa stêdi wóstja
 3702 umbi Jerusalem · Judeo liudjo,
 hwand sie ni ant-kennjad, · þat im kumana sind
 3704 iro tídi tó-wardes, · ak sie habbjad im twífljen hugi,
 ni witun þat iro wísad · waldandes kraft.“
 3706 Gi-wêt imu þó mid þeru mēnegi · manno drohtin
 an þea berhton burg. · Só þó þat barn godes
 3708 innan Jerusalem · mid þiu gumono folku,
 sêg mid þiu ge-siðu, · þó warð þár allaro sango mêt,
 3710 hlúd stemnje af-haben · hêlagun wordun,
 lobodun þene landes ward · liudjo mēnegi,
 3712 barno þat bêtste; · þiu burg warð an hróru,
 þat folk warð an forhtun · endi frágodun sán,
 3714 hwe þat wári, · þat þár mid þiu werodu kwam,
 mid þeru mikilon mēnegi. · Þó sprak im ên man an-gegin,
 3716 kwað þat þár Jesu Krist · fan Galileo lande,
 fan Nazareth-burg · nêrjand kwámi,

- 3718 witig wár-sago · þemu werode te helpu.
 Þó was þem Judiun, · þe imu êr grame wárun,
 3720 un·holde an hugi, · harm an móde,
 þat imu þea liudi só filu · lof-sang warhtun,
 3722 diurdun iro drohtin. · Þó géngun dol-móde,
 þat sie wið waldand Krist · wordun sprákun,
 3724 bádun þat hé þat ge·sǿði · swígon hétí,
 letti þea liudi, · þat sie imu lof só filu
 3726 wordun ni warhtin: · „it is þesumu werode lēð“, kwáðun sie,
 „þesun burg-liudjun.“ · Þó sprak eft þat barn godes:
 3728 „ef gí sie a·merrjad“, (kwað hé,) „þat hér ni mótin manno barn
 waldandes kraft · wordun diurjen,
 3730 þan skulun it hrópen þoh · harde sténos
 for þesumu folk-skępi, · felisos starka,
 3732 êr þan it eo be·líbe, · nebo man is lof spreke
 wído aftar þesaru wer-oldi.“ · Þó hé an þene wíh innen,
 3734 géng an þat godes hús: · fand þár Judeono filu,
 mis-like man, · manage at·samne,
 3736 þea im þár kôp-stędi · gi·kora habdun,
 mangodun im þár mid manages hwí: · munitęrjas sátun
 3738 an þemu wíhe innan, · habdun iro wesl gi·dago
 garu te geþanne. · Þat was þemu godes barne
 3740 al an andun: · drêf sie út þanen
 rúmo fan þemu rakude, · kwað þat wári rehtara dád,
 3742 þat þár te bedu fórin · barn Israheles
 „ęndi an þesumu mínumu húse · helpono biddjan,
 3744 þat sia sigi-drohtin · sundjono tuomje,
 þan hér þeobas · an þing-stędi halden,
 3746 þea far·warhton weros · wehsal driþan,
 un-reht ên-fald. · Ne gí êniga êra ni witun
 3748 þeses godes húses, · Judeo liudi.“
 Só rúmde hé þó ęndi rekode, · ríki drohtin,
 3750 þat hêlaga hús · ęndi an helpun was
 managumu man-kunne, · þem þe is mikilon kraft
 3752 ferrene ge·frugnun · ęndi þár gi·faran kwámun
 oþar langan weg. · Wærð þár léf so manag,
 3754 halt gi·hêlid · ęndi háf só same,
 blindun gi·bótíd. · Só dede þat barn godes
 3756 willjendi þemu werode, · hwand al an is gi·wêldi stéd

umbi þesaro liudjo líf · ęndi ôk umbi þit land só same.

TODO.

3674 streidun | so ('streidun') M; 'stroidun' C

3674 streidun | 3pl. past ind. of *streuwjan* 'to strew' ~ *strôjan* 'id.' M reflects the former and C the latter variant. The *ęi* is not to be confused with rare *ęi* < PGmc. *ai* as found in ll. 359 and 2265.

3753 obar langan weg | Also found in ON as *of langan veg* (Vkv 4/2b, 9/4b).

- 3758 **46** Stód imu þó fora þemu wíhe · waldandjo Krist,
 3760 liof landes ward, · ęndi imu þero liudjo hugi,
 iro willjon aftar warode: · gi-sah werod mikil
 an þat márje hús · mēðmos fôrjen,
 3762 geþon mid goldu · ęndi mid godu-wębbju,
 diurjun fratahun. · Þat al drohtin Krist
 3764 warode wís-liko. · Þó kwam þár ôk ên widowa tó,
 idis arm-skapen, · ęndi te þemu alāha gęng
 3766 ęndi siu an þat tresur-hús · twēne lęgde
 ęrine skattos: · was iru ên-fald hugi,
 3768 willjan gódes. · Þó sprak waldand Krist,
 þe gumo wið is jungaron, · kwað þat siu þár geþa brāhti
 3770 mēron mikilu þan ęlkor · ęnig mannes sunu:
 „ef hér ôdaga man“, (kwað hé,) „êra brāhtun,
 3772 mēðom-hord manag, · sie létun im mēr at hús
 welona ge-wunnen. · Ni dede þius widowa só,
 3774 ak siu te þesumu alāhe gaf · al þat siu habde
 welono ge-wunnen, · só siu iru wiht ni far-lét
 3776 gódes an iro gardun. · Be-þiu sind ira geþa mēron,
 waldande werða, · hwand siu it mid su-líkumu willjon dede
 3778 te þesumu godes huse. · Þes skal siu geld niman,
 swiðo lang-sam lôn, · þes siu su-líkan gi-lôbon habad.“
 3780 Só gi-fragn ik þat þár an þemu wíhe · waldandjo Krist
 allaro dago ge-hwi-likes, · drohtin manno,
 3782 wísde mid wordun. · Stód ine werod umbi,
 grôt folk Judeono, · gi-hôrdun is góðan word,
 3784 swótja seggjan. · Sum só sálig warð
 manno undar þeru męnegi, · þat it bi-gan an is mód hladen;
 3786 línodun im þea lēra, · þe þe landes ward
 al be biliðjun sprak, · barn drohtines.
 3788 Sumun wárun eft so lēða · lēra Kristes,

- waldandes word: · was im wiðer-mód hugi
 3790 allun þem, þe an þemu hēri-skēpi · hērost wárun,
 furiston an þemu folke: · fāres hugdun
 3792 wrêða mid iro wordun · —habdun im wiðer-sakon
 gi·haloden te helpu, · þes hēroston man,
 3794 Erodeses þegan, · þe þár and·ward stód
 wrêðes willjan, · þat hé iro word obar·hōrði—
 3796 ef sie ina for·fēngin, · þat sie ina þan feteros an,
 þea liudi liðo·bēndi · lēggjen móstin,
 3798 sundja lōsan. · Þó géngun im þea ge·siðos tó
 bittra gi·hugde, · þat sie wið þat barn godes,
 3800 wrêða wiðer-sakon · wordun sprákun:
 „Hwat þú bist êo·sago“, (kwáðun sie,) „allun þiodun,
 3802 wísis wáres só filu: · nis þi werð eo·wiht
 te bi·míðanne · manno ni·ênumu
 3804 umbi is ríki·dóm, · nebo þú simlun þat reht sprikis
 ėndi an þene godes weg · gumono ge·siði
 3806 lēdis mid þinun lērun: · ni mag þi laster man
 fīðan undar þesumu folke. · Nú wí þi frágon skulun.
 3808 ríki þiodan, · hwi·lík reht hábad
 þe kēsúr fan Rúmu, · þe imu te þesumu kunnje herod
 3810 tinsi sókid · ėndi gi·tald hábad,
 hwat wí imu gelden skulin · gēro ge·hwi·líkes
 3812 hōbid-skatto. · Saga hwat þi þes an þinumu hugi þunkja:
 is it reht þe nis? · Rád for þinun
 3814 land·mégun wel: · ūs is þínaro lérono þarf.“
 Sie weldun þat hé it ant·kwáði: · þan mahte hé þoh
 ant·kēnnjen wel
 3816 iro wrêðon willjon: · „te hwi gi wár·logon“, kwað hé,
 „fandot mín só frókno? · Ni skal iu þat te frumu werðen,
 3818 þat gi dreogerjas · darnungo nú
 willjad mí far·fāhen.“ · Hét hé þó forð dragan
 3820 te skawonne þe skattos, · „þe gi skuldige sind
 an þat geld ge·ben.“ · Judeon drógun
 3822 ênna silubrinna forð: · sáhun manage tó,
 hwó hé was ge·munitod: · was an middjen skín
 3824 þes kēsures biliði · —þat mahtun sie ant·kēnnjen wel—,
 iro hērron hōbid·mál. · Þó frágode sie þe hēlago Krist,
 3826 aftar hwemu þiu ge·lík·nessi · gi·legid wári.

Sie kwáðun þat it wári · wer-old-kêsuren
 3828 fan Rúmu-burg, · „þes þe alles þeses ríkes habad
 ge·wald an þesaru wer-oldi.“ · „Þan willju ik iu te wárun hér“,
 kwað hé,
 3830 „selbo seggjian, · þat gí imu sín gebad,
 wer-old-hêrron is ge·wunst, · ęndi waldand gode
 3832 selljad, þat þár sín ist: · þat skulun iuwa seolon wesen,
 gumono gêstos.“ · Þó warð þero Judeono hugi
 3834 ge·minsod an þemu mahle: · ni mahtun þe mên-skaðon
 wordun ge·winnen, · só iro willjo géng,
 3836 þat sie ina far·fęngin, · hwand imu þat friðu-barn godes
 wardode wið þe wrêðon · ęndi im wár an·gegin,
 3838 sôð-spel sagde, · þoh sie ni wárin só sálige te þiu,
 þat sie it só far·fęngin, · só it iro fruma wári.

TODO.

3840 47 Sie ni weldun it þoh far·lâten, · ak hétun þár lêdjen forð
 ęn wif for þemu werode, · þiu habde wam ge·frumid,
 3842 un-reht ęn-fald: · þiu idis was bi·fangen
 an far·legar-nessi, · was iro líbes skolo,
 3844 þat sie firiho barn · ferahu bi·námin,
 ęhtin iro aldres: · só was an iro êw ge·skriben.
 3846 Sie bi·gunnun ina þó frágon, · fruokne liudi,
 wrêða mid iro wordun, · hwat sie skoldin þemu wíbe duan,
 3848 hweðer sie sie kwêlidin, · þe sie sie kwika létin,
 þe hwat hé umbi su·líka dádi · a·dêljen weldi:
 3850 „þú wêst, hwó þesaru męnegi“, (kwáðun sie,) „Moyses gi·bôð
 wárun wordun, · þat allaro wíbo ge·hwi·lík
 3852 an far·legar-nessi · líbes far-warhti
 ęndi þat sie þan a·wurpin · weros mid handun,
 3854 starkun stênun: · nú maht þú sie sehan standen hér
 an sundjun bi·fangan: · saga hwat þú is willjes.“
 3856 weldun ine þea wiðer-sakon · wordun far·fâhen,
 ef hé þat gi·kwáði, · þat sie sie kwika létin,
 3858 friðodi ira feræhe, · þan weldi þat folk Judeono
 kweðen, þat hé iro aldiron · êo wiðer-sagdi,
 3860 þero liudjo land-reht; · ef hé sie þan hėti líbu bi·nimen,
 þea magað fur þeru męnegi, · þan weldin sie kweðen, þat hé só
 mildjene hugi

- 3862 ni **bári** an is **breostun**, · só skoldi habbjen **barn** godes:
 weldun sie só **hweðeres** · **hêlagne** Krist
 3864 þero **wordo** ge·wítton, · só hé þár for þemu **werode** ge·spráki,
 a·**dêl**di te **dóme**. · Þan wisse **drohtin** Krist
 3866 þero **manno** só garo · **mód-gi**·þáhti,
 iro **wrêðon** **willjon**; · þó hé te þemu **werode** sprak,
 3868 te **allun** þem **erlun**: · „só hwi·lík só iuwar **áno** sí“, kwað hé,
 „**slíðja** **sundjon**, · só ganga iru **selbo** tó
 3870 **endi** sie at **êrist** · **erl** mid is handun
stên ana werpe.“ · Só **stódun** Judeon,
 3872 **þáhtun** **endi** **þagodun**: · ni mahte **þe**gan nigijan
 wið þem **word**·kwidi · **wiðer**·saka finden:
 3874 ge·hugde **manno** ge·hwi·lík · **mên-gi**·þáhti,
 is **selbes** **sundja**: · ni was iro só **sikur** ênig,
 3876 þat hé bi þemu **worde** · þemu **wíbe** ge·dorsti
stên an werpen, · ak létun sie **standen** þár
 3878 **ênan** þár inne · **endi** im **út** þanen
gêgun **gram**·harde · **Judeo** liudi,
 3880 **ên** aftar **ôðrumu**, · ant·tat iro þár **ênig** ni was
 þes **fiundo** **folkes**, · þe iro **ferhes** þó,
 3882 þeru **idis** **aldar**·lago · **áhtjen** weldi.
 Þó gi·fragn ik þat sie **frágode** · **friðu**·barn godes,
 3884 **allaro** **gumono** bêtst: · „Hwár kwámun þit **Judeono** folk“,
 kwað hé,
 „þíne **wiðer**·sakon, · þea þi hér **wrógdun** te mí?
 3886 Ne sie þí **hiudu** wiht · **harmes** ne gi·dádun,
 þea liudi **lêðes**, · þe þí weldun **líbu** be·niman,
 3888 **wêgjan** te **wundrun**?“ · Þó sprak imu eft þat **wíf** an·gêgin,
 kwað þat iru þár **nio**·man · þurh þes **nêrjandan**
 3890 **hêlaga** **helpa** · **harm** ne gi·frumidi
wammes te lône. · Þó sprak eft **waldand** Krist,
 3892 **drohtin** **manno**: · „ne ik þi geþ ni **derju** n·eo·wiht“, kwað hé,
 „ak gang þi **hêl** **hinen**, · lát þi an þínumu **hugi** sorga,
 3894 þat þú nio **síð** aftar þius · **sundig** ni werðes.“
Habde iru þó gi·holpen · **hêlag** barn godes,
 3896 ge·**friðot** iro **feráhe**. · Þan stód þat **folk** Judeono
uðiles an·mód · só fan **êristan**,
 3898 **wrêðes** **willjan**, · hwó sie **word**·hêti
 wið þat **friðu**·barn godes · **frummjen** móstin.

3900 Habdun þea liudi an twê · mid iro gi·lôbon gi·fangan:
 was þiu smale þioda · sínes willjan
 3902 gernora mikilu, · þes godes barnes word
 te ge·frummjenne, · só im iro frâho gi·bôd:
 3904 rómodun te rehta · bet þan þie ríkjon man,
 habdun ina far iro hêrron · ia far heban-kuning,
 3906 ful·gêgun imu gerno. · Þó gi·wêt imu þe godes sunu
 an þene wih innan: · hwarf ina werod umbi,
 3908 megin-þiodo gi·mang. · Hé an middjen stód,
 lêrde þea liudi · liochtun wordun,
 3910 hlúdero stemnun: · was hlust mikil,
 þagode þegan manag, · êndi hé þeru þiod gi·bôd,
 3912 só hwe só þár mid þurstu · bi·þwungan wári,
 „só ganga imu herod drinkan te mí“, (kwað hé,) „dago
 ge·hwi·líkes
 3914 swótjes brunnan. · Ik mag seggjan iu,
 só hwe só hér gi·lôbid te mí · liudjo barno
 3916 fasto undar þesumu folke, · þat imu þan flioten skulun
 fan is lík-hamon · libbjendi flód,
 3918 irnandi water, · aho-spring mikil,
 kumad þanen kwika brunnon. · Þesa kwidi werðad wára,
 3920 liudjun gi·lêstid, · só hwemu só hér gi·lôbid te mí.“
 Þan mênde mid þiu wataru · waldandjo Krist,
 3922 hêr heban-kuning · hêlagna gêst,
 hwó þene firiho barn · ant·fâhen skoldin,
 3924 liocht êndi listi · êndi lif êwig,
 hôh heban-ríki · êndi huldi godes.

TODO.

3926 **48** Wurðun þó þea liudi · umbi þea lêra Kristes,
 umbi þiu word an ge·winne: · stóðun wlanka man,
 3928 gêl-móde Judeon, · sprákun gelp mikil,
 habdun it im te hoska, · kwáðun þat sie mahtin gi·hôrjen wel,
 3930 þat imu mahlidin fram · módaga wihti,
 un·holde út: · „nú hé an abu lêrid“, kwáðun sie,
 3932 „wordu ge·hwi·líku.“ · Þó sprak eft þat werod ôðar:
 „ni þurbun gí þene lêrjand lahan“, (kwáðun sie:) „kumad líbes
 word
 3934 mahtig fan is müde; · hé wirkid manages hwat,

wundres an þesaru wer-oldi: · nis þat wrêðaro dád,
 3936 fiundo kraftes: · nio it þan te su-líkaru frumu ni wurði,
 ak it gegnungo · fan gode alo-waldon,
 3938 kumid fan is krafte. · Þat mugun gí ant·kennjen wel
 an þem is wárun wordun, · þat hé gi·wald habad
 3940 alles obar erðu.“ · Þó weldun ina þe and-sakon þár
 an stędi fāhen · efþa stēn ana werpen,
 3942 ef sie im þero manno · męnigi ni an·drėdin,
 ni forhtodin þat folk-skępi. · Þó sprak þat friðu-barn godes:
 3944 „ik tōgju iu gódes só filu“, (kwað hé,) „fan gode selbumu,
 wordo ęndi werko: · nú willjad gí mí wítton hér
 3946 þurh iuwan starkan hugi, · stēn ana werpen,
 bi·lōsjen mí líbu.“ · Þó sprákon imu eft þea liudi an·gegin,
 3948 wrēða wiðer-sakon: · „ne wí it be þínun werkun ni duat“,
 kwáðun sia,
 „þat wí þí aldres · tó áhtjen willjad,
 3950 ak wí duat it be þínun wordun, · hwand þú su-lík wáh sprikis,
 *hwand þú þik só mátis · ęndi su-lík mēn sagis,
 3952 gihiš for þeson Judeon, · þat þú sís god selbo,
 mahtig drohtin, · ęndi bist þi þoh man só wi,
 3954 kuman fan þeson kunnje.“ · Krist alo-waldo
 ne wolda þero Judeono þuo lęng · gelpes hōrjan,
 3956 wrēðaro willjon, · ak hie im af þem wihe fuor
 obar Jordanes strōm; · habda jungron mid im,
 3958 þia is sáligun gi·siðos, · þia im simlon mid im
 willjon wonodun: · suohta werod oðer,
 3960 deda þár só hie gi·wonoda, · drohtin selbo,
 lērda þia liudi: · gi·lōbda þie wolda
 3962 an is hēlagun word. · Þat skolda sinnon wel
 manno só hwi-líkon, · só þat an is muod gi·nam.
 3964 Þuo gi·frang ik þat þár te Kriste · kumana wurðun
 bodon fan Bethaniu · ęndi sagdun þem barne godes,
 3966 þat sia an þat ârundi þarod · idisi sęndin,
 Maria ęndi Martha, · magað fri-líka,
 3968 swiðo wun-sama wíf; · þia wissa hie bēðja,
 wárun im gi·swester twá, · þia hie selbo êr
 3970 minnjoda an is muode · þuru iro mildjan hugi,
 þiu wíf þuru iro willjon guodan. · Sia im te wáron þuo
 3972 an·budun fon Bethaniu, · þat iro bruoðer was

Lazarus legar-fast · ɛndi þat sia is lifes ni wáundun;
 3974 bádun þat þarod kwámi · Krist alo-waldo
 hêlag te helpu. · Reht só hie sia gi·hôrda þuo
 3976 seggjan fan só siekon, · só sprak hie sán an·gegin,
 kwað þat Lazaruses · legar ni wári
 3978 gi·duan im te dôðe, · „ak þár skal drohtines lof“, kwaþ-hie,
 „gi·frumid werðan: · nis it im te ôðron frêson gi·duan.“
 3980 was im þár þuo selbo · suno drohtines
 twá naht ɛndi dagas. · Þiu tíð was þuo ge·náhit,
 3982 þat hie eft te Jerusalem · Judeo liudjo
 wíson welda, · só hie gi·wald habda.
 3984 Sagda þuo is gi·siðon · suno drohtines,
 þat hie eft oþar Jordan · Judeo liudi
 3986 suokjan welda. · Þuo sprákun im sán an·gegin
 jungron sína: · „te hwi bist þú só gern þarod“, kwaðun sia,
 3988 „frô mín, te faranne? · Ni þat nú furn ni was,
 þat sia þik þínero wordo · wítnon hogdun,
 3990 weldun þi mid stênon starkan a-werpan? · nú þú eft undar þia
 stridigun þioda
 fundos te faranne, · þár ist fiondo gi·nuog,
 3992 erlos oþar-muoda?“ · Þuo ên þero twe-libjo,
 Þuomas gi·málða · —was im gi·þungan mann,
 3994 diur-lík drohtines þegan—: · „ne skulun wí im þia dád lahan“,
 kwaþ-hie,
 „ni wernjan wí im þes willjen, · ak wita im wonjan mid,
 3996 þuolajan mid ússon þiodne: · þat ist þegnes kust,
 þat hie mid is frâhon samad · fasto gi·stande,
 3998 dôje mid im þár an duome. · Duan ús alla só,
 folgon im te þero fêrði: · ni látan úse ferah wið þiu
 4000 wihtes wirðig, · neþa wí an þem werode mid im,
 dôjan mid úson drohtine. · Þan lêbot ús þoh duom after,
 4002 guod word for gumon.“ · Só wurðun þuo jungron Kristes,
 erlos aðal-borana · an ên-falden hugje,
 4004 hêrren te willjen. · Þuo sagda hêlag Krist
 selbo is gi·siðon · þat a·slápan was
 4006 Lazarus fan þem legare, · „hábit þit lioht a·geþan,
 an·swebit ist an selmon. · Nú wí an þena sið faran
 4008 ɛndi ina a·wêkkjan, · þat hie muoti eft þesa wer-old sehan,
 libbjandi lioht: · þan wirðit iuwa gi·lôbo after þiu

4010 forð-werd gi·fēstid.“ · Duo gi-wēt hie im obar þia fluod þanan,
 þie guodo godes suno, · an-þat hie mid is jungron kwam
 4012 þár te Bithaniu, · barn drohtines
 selbo mid is gi·sīðon, · þár þia gi·swester twá,
 4014 Maria ĕndi Martha · an muod-karon
 sêraga sátun. · Was þár gi·samnot filo
 4016 fan Jerusalem · Judeo liudo,
 þia þiu *wif weldun · wordun fruobrian,
 4018 þat sie só ni karodin · kind-jungas dôð,
 Lazaruses far·lust. · Só þó þe landes ward
 4020 géng an þiu gardos, · só wurðun þes godes barnes
 kumi þár gi·kūðid, · þat hé só kraftig was
 4022 bi þeru burg úten. · Þó im bêðjun was,
 þem wíðun su·lík willjo, · þat sie im waldand tó,
 4024 þat friðu-barn godes, · farandjen wissun.

TODO.

49 Þó þem wíðun was · willjono mēsta
 4026 kumi drohtines · ĕndi Kristes word
 te gi·hōrjenne. · Heobandi géng
 4028 Martha mód-karag · wið só mahtigne
 wordun wehslan · ĕndi wið waldand sprak
 4030 an iro hugi hriuwig: · „Þár þú mí, hērro mín“, kwað siu,
 „neřjendero bēst, · náhor wáris,
 4032 hēljand þe gódo, · þan ni þorfte ik nú su·lík harm þolon,
 bittra breost-kara, · þan ni wári nú mín bróðer dôð,
 4034 Lazarus fan þesumu liohte, · ak hé imu mahti libbjen forð
 ferāhes ge·fullid. · Ik þoh, frô mín, te þi
 4036 liohto gi·lōbju, · lērjendero bēst,
 só hwes só þú biddjen wili · berhton drohtin,
 4038 þat hé it þi sán far·gibid, · god alo-mahtig,
 gi·werðot þinan willjan.“ · Þó sprak eft waldand Krist
 4040 þeru idis and-wordi: · „Ni lát þú þi an innan þes“, kwað hé,
 „þinan sebon swerkan: · ik þi seggjan mag
 4042 wárun wordun, · þat þes nis gi·wand ĕnig,
 nebu þín bróðer skal · þurh gi·bod godes,
 4044 þurh drohtines kraft · fan dôðe a·standen
 an is lík-hamon.“ · „All hēbbju ik gi·lōbon só“, kwað siu,
 4046 „þat it só gi·werðen skal, · só hwan só þius wer-old ĕndjod

4048 ɛndi þe márjo dag · oþar man fɛrid,
 þat hé þan fan erðu skal · up a·standen
 an þemu dômes daga, · þan werðað fan dōðe kwika
 4050 þurh maht godes · man-kunnjes ge·hwi-lík,
 a·risad fan rɛstu.“ · Þó sagde ríkjo Krist
 4052 þeru idis alo-mahtig · oponun wordun,
 þat hé selbo was · sunu drohtines,
 4054 bêðju ia líf ia lioht · liudjo barnon
 te a·standanne: · „nio þe sterben ni skal,
 4056 líf far·liosen, · þe hér gi·lôbid te mí:
 þoh ina ɛldi-barn · erðu bi·þekkjen,
 4058 diapo bi·delben, · nis hé dōd þiu mēr:
 þat flêsk is bi·folhen, · þat ferah is gi·halden,
 4060 is þiu siola gi·sund.“ · Þó sprak imu eft sán an·gegin
 þat wíf mid iro wordun: · „ik gi·lôbju þat þú þe wáro bist“,
 kwað siu,
 4062 „Krist godes sunu: · þat mag man ant·kennjen wel,
 witen an þínun wordun, · þat þú gi·wald habes
 4064 þurh þiu hêlagon gi·skapu · himiles ɛndi erðun.“
 Þó ge·fragn ik þat þár þero idisjo kwam · ôðar gangan
 4066 Maria mód-karag: · géngun iro managa aftar
 Judeo liudi. · Þó siu þemu godes barne
 4068 sagde sêrag-mód, · hwat iru te sorgun gi·stód
 an iro hugi harmes: · hofnu kúmde
 4070 Lazaruses far·lust, · liabes mannes,
 griat gornundi, · ant-tat þemu godes barne
 4072 hugi warð gi·hrórid: · hête trahni
 wópu a·wellun, · ɛndi þó te þem wíbun sprak,
 4074 hét ina þó lêdjen, · þár Lazarus was
 foldu bi·folhen. · Lag þár ên felis bi·oþan,
 4076 hard stên be·hliden. · Þó hét þe hêlago Krist
 ant·lúkan þea léja, · þat hé mósti þat lík sehan,
 4078 hrêo skawojen. · Þó ni mahte an iro hugi míðan
 Marþa for þeru mɛnegi, · wið mahtigne sprak:
 4080 „frô mín þe gódo“, (kwað siu,) „ef man þene felis nimid,
 þene stên ant·lúkid, · þan wániu ik þat þanen stank kume,
 4082 un·swóti swek, · hwand ik þi seggjan mag
 wárun wordun, · þat þes nis gi·wand ênig,
 4084 þat hé þár nú bi·folhen was · fiuwar naht ɛndi dagos

an þemu erð-grabe.“ · And-wordi gaf
 4086 waldand þemu wíbe: · „Hwat ni sagde ik þí te wárun êr“,
 kwað hé,
 „ef þú gi·lôbjen wili, · þan nis nú lang te þiu,
 4088 þat þú hér ant·kennjen skalt · kraft drohtines,
 þe mikilon maht godes?“ · Þó géngun manage tó,
 4090 af·hóbun harden stên. · Þó sah þe hêlago Krist
 up mid is ôgun, · á-lát sagde
 4092 þemu þe þese wer-old gi·skóp, · „þes þú mín word gi·hôris“,
 kwað hé,
 „sigi-drohtin selbo; · ik wêt þat þú só simlun duos,
 4094 ak ik duom it be þesumu grôton · Judeono folke,
 þat sie þat te wárun witin, · þat þú mí an þese wer-old sêndes
 4096 þesun liudjun te lêrun.“ · Þó hé te Lazaruse hriop
 starkaru stemnju · êndi hét ina standen up
 4098 ia fan þemu grabe gangan. · Þó warð þe gêst kumen
 an þene lík-hamon: · hé bi·gan is liði hrôrjen,
 4100 ant·warp undar þemu gi·wêdje: · was imo só be·wunden þó
 noh,
 an hrêo-bêddjon bi·helid. · Hét imu helpen þó
 4102 waldandjo Krist. · Weros géngun tó,
 ant·wundun þat ge·wádi. · Wánum up a·rês
 4104 Lazarus te þesumu liohte: · was imu is lif far·geben,
 þat hé is alðar-lagu · êgan mósti,
 4106 friðu forð-wardes. · Þó fagonadun bêðja,
 Maria êndi Martha: · ni mag þat man ôðrumu
 4108 gi·seggjan te sôðe, · hwó þea ge·swester twó
 mēndjodun an iro móde. · Maneg wundrode
 4110 Judeo liudjo, · þó sie ina fan þemu grabe sáhun
 sīðon ge·sunden, · þene þe êr suht far·nam
 4112 êndi sie bi·dulbun · diapo undar erðu
 líbes lôsen: · þó móste imu libbjen forð
 4114 hêl an hêmun. · Só mag heþan-kuninges,
 þiu mikile maht godes · manno ge·hwi·likes
 4116 feræhe gi·formon · êndi wið fiundo níð
 hêlag helpen, · só hwemu só hé is huldi far·gibid.

TODO.

4118 50 Þó warð þár só managumu manne · mód aftar Kriste,

gi·hworben hugi-skêfti, · siðor sie is hêlagon werk
 4120 selbon gi·sahun, · hwand eo êr su·lik ni warð
 wundêr an wer·oldi. · Ðan was eft þes werodes só filu,
 4122 só mód·starke man: · ni weldon þe maht godes
 ant·kennjen küð·líko, · ak sie wið is kraft mikil
 4124 wunnun mid iro wordun: · wárun im waldandes
 lêra so lêða: · sóhtun im liudi ôðra
 4126 an Jerusalem, · þár Judeono was
 hêri hand·maḡal · çndi hôbid·stêdi,
 4128 grôt gum·skêpi · grimmaro þioda.
 Sie küðdun im þó Kristes werk, · kwáðun þat sie kwikan sáhin
 4130 þene erl mid iro ôgun, · þe an erðu was,
 foldu bi·folhen · fiuwar naht çndi dagos,
 4132 dód bi·dolben, · ant·tat hé ina mid is dádjun selbo,
 mid is wordun a·wêkide, · þat hé mósti þese wer·old sehan.
 4134 Þó was þat só wiðêr·ward · wlankun mannun,
 Judeo liudjun: · hétun iro gum·skêpi þó,
 4136 werod samnojan · çndi warbos fâhen,
 megin·þioda gi·mang, · an mahtigna Krist
 4138 riedun an rúnun: · „nis þat rád ênig“, kwáðun sie,
 „þat wí þat gi·þolojan: · wili þesaro þioda te filu
 4140 gi·lôbjen aftar is lêrun. · Ðan ús liudi farad,
 an eo·rid·folk, · werðat úsa oðar·hóðdun
 4142 rinkos fan Rúmu. · Ðan wí þeses ríkjes skulun
 lôse libbjen · efþa wí skulun úses líbes þolon,
 4144 hêliðos úsaro hôðdo.“ · Þó sprak þár ên gi·hêrod man
 oðar warf wero, · þe was þes werodes þó
 4146 an þeru burg innan · biskop þero liudjo
 —Kaiphás was hé hêten; · habdun ina gi·koranen te þiu
 4148 an þeru gér·talú · Judeo liudi,
 þat hé þes godes húses · gômjen skoldi,
 4150 wardon þes wíhes—: · „Mí þunkid wundêr mikil“, kwað hé,
 „mári þioda, · —gí kunnun manages gi·skêð—
 4152 hwí gí þat te wárun ni witin, · werod Judeono,
 þat hér is beþera rád · barno ge·hwi·líkumu,
 4154 þat man hér ênne man · aldrú bi·lôsje
 çndi þat hé þurh iuwa dádi · drôreg sterþe,
 4156 for þesumu folk·skêpi · ferah far·láte,
 þan al þit liud·werod · far·loren werðe.“

- 4158 Ni was it þoh is willjan, · þat hé só wár ge·sprak,
 só forð for þemu folke, · frume man-kunnjes
 4160 gi·mênde for þeru mēnegi, · ak it kwam imu fan þeru maht
 godes
 þurh is hêlagan hêd, · hwand hé þat hús godes
 4162 þár an Jerusalem · bi·gangan skolde,
 wardon þes wíhes: · be·þiu hé só wár gi·sprak,
 4164 biskop þero liudjo, · hwó skoldi þat barn godes
 alla irmin-þiod · mid is ênes ferhe,
 4166 mid is líbu a·lôsen: · þat was allaro þesaro liudjo rád,
 hwand hé gi·halode · mid þiu hêðina liudi,
 4168 weros an is willjon · waldandjo Krist.
 Þó wurðun ên-wordje · oþar-módje man,
 4170 werod Judeono, · ėndi an iro warþe gi·sprákon,
 mári þioda, · þat sie im ni létin iro mód twehon:
 4172 só hwe só ina undar þemu folke · finden mahti,
 þat ina sán gi·féngi · ėndi forð bráhti
 4174 an þero þiodo þing; · kwáðun þat sie ni mahtin gi·þolojan lęng,
 þat sie þe êno man · só alla weldi,
 4176 werod far·winnen. · Þan wisse waldand Krist
 þero manno só garo · mód-gi·þáhti,
 4178 hęti-grimmon hugi, · hwand imu ni was bi·holen eo-wiht
 an þesaru middil-gard: · hé ni welde þó an þie mēnigi innen
 4180 siðour open·líko, · under þat erlo folk,
 gangan under þea Judeon: · bêd þe godes sunu
 4182 þero toręhtjon tíð, · þe imu tó-ward was,
 þat hé far þesa þioda · þolojan welde,
 4184 far þit werod wíti: · wisse imu selbo
 þat dag-þingi garo. · Þó gi·wêt imu ęse drohtin forð
 4186 ėndi imu þó an Effrem · alo-waldo Krist
 an þeru hôhon burg · hêlag drohtin
 4188 wunode mid is werodu, · ant-tat hé an is willjan hwarf
 eft te Bethania · brahtmu þiu mikilun,
 4190 mid þiu is gódum gum-skępi. · Judeon bi·sprákon þat
 wordu ge·hwi-líku, · þó sie imu su-lík werod mikil
 4192 folgon gi·sáhun: · „nis frume ênig“, kwáðun sie,
 „ęses ríkjes gi·rádi, · þoh wí reht sprekan,
 4194 ni þihit ęses þinges wiht: · þius þiod wili
 węndjen after is willjan; · imu all þius wer-old folgot,

4196 liudi bi þem is lêrun, · þat wí imu lêðes wiht
for þesumu folk-skepi · gi·frummjen ni mótun.“

TODO.

4198 **51** Gi·wêt imu þó þat barn godes · innan Bethania
sehs nahtun êr, · þan þiu samnunga
4200 þár an Jerusalem · Judeo liudjo
an þem wih-dagun · werðen skolde,
4202 þat sie skoldun haldan · þea hêlagon tídi,
Judeono paskha. · Béd þe godes sunu,
4204 mahtig under þeru mēnegi: · was þár manno kraft,
werodes bi þem is wordun. · Þár géngun ina twê wif umbi,
4206 Maria ęndi Martha, · mid mildju hugi,
þionodun imu þeo-líko. · Þiodo drohtin
4208 gaf im lang-sam lôn: · lét sea lêðes gi·hwes,
sundjono sikora, · ęndi selbo gi·bôd,
4210 þat sea an friðe fôrin · wiðer fiundo nið,
þea idisa mid is orlobu gódu: · habdun iro ambaht-skepi
4212 bi·węndid an is willjon. · Þó gi·wêt imu waldand Krist
forð mid þiu folku, · firiho drohtin,
4214 innan Jerusalem, · þár Judeono was
hęte-lík hard-buri, · þár sie þea hêlagon tíd
4216 warodun at þemu wihe; · was þár werodes só filu,
kraftigaro kunnjo, · þie ni weldun Kristes word
4218 gerno hórjen · ni te þemu godes barne
an iro mód-sebon · minnje ni habdun,
4220 ak wárun im só wrêða · wlanka þioda,
módeg man-kunni, · habdun im morð-hugi,
4222 in·wid an innan: · an abuh far·fęngun
Kristes lere, · weldun ina kraftigna
4224 witnon þero wordo; · ak was þár werodes só filu,
umbi erl-skepi · ant-langana dag,
4226 habde ine þiu smale þiod · þurh is swótjun word
werodu bi·worpen, · þat ine þie wiðer-sakon
4228 under þemu folk-skepi · fāhen ne gi·dorstun,
ak miðun is bi þeru mēnegi. · Þan stód mahtig Krist
4230 an þemu wihe innan, · sagde word manag
firiho barnun te frumu. · Was þár folk umbi
4232 allan langan dag, · ant-tat þiu liohte gi·wêt

sunne te **sedle**. · Þó te **sēliðun** fór
 4234 **man**-kunnjes **manag**. · Þan was þár ên **mári** berg
 bi þeru **burg** úten, · þe was **brêd** êndi hôh,
 4236 **gróni** êndi **skôni**: · hétun ina **Judeo** liudi
Oliueti bi namon. · Þár imu **up** gi-wêt
 4238 **nērjendjo** Krist, · só ina þiu **naht** bi-féng,
 was imu þár mid is **jungarun**, · só ine þár **Judeono** ênig
 4240 ni **wisse** ti **wárun**, · hwand hé an þemu **wíhe** stód,
liudjo drohtin, · só **lioht** ôstene kwam,
 4242 ant-féng þat **folk**-skēpi · êndi im **filu** sagde
wároro **wordo**, · só nis an þesaru **wer**-oldi ênig,
 4244 an þesaru **middil**-gard · **manno** só spáhi,
liudjo barno nig-ên, · þat þero **lêrono** mugi
 4246 êndi gi-tēlljen, · þe hé þár an þemu **aláhe** gi-sprak,
waldand an þemu **wíhe**, · êndi simlun mid is **wordun** gi-bôd,
 4248 þat sie sie **gērewidin** · te **godes** ríkje,
 allaro **manno** ge-hwi-lík, · þat sie móstin an þemu **márjon** daga
 4250 iro **drohtines** · **diuriða** ant-fáhen.
 Sagde im hwat sie it **sundjun** frumidun · êndi **simlun** gi-bôd,
 4252 þat sie þea a-lēskidin; · hét sie **lioht** godes
minnjon an iro **móde**, · **mên** fār-láten,
 4254 **aþoha** **obar**-hugdi, · **ôd**-módi niman,
hlaðen þat an iro **hertan**; · kwað þat im þan wári **heban**-ríki,
 4256 **garu** **gódo** mēst. · Þó warð þár **gumono** só filu
 gi-wēndid aftar is **willjon**, · sīður sie þat **word** godes
 4258 **hêlag** gi-hôrdun, · **heban**-kuninges,
 ant-kēndun **kraft** mikil, · **kumi** drohtines,
 4260 **hêrron** **helpe**, · ia þat **heban**-ríki was,
nērjendi gi-náhid · êndi **náða** godes
 4262 **manno** barnun. · Sum só **módeg** was
Judeo folkes, · habdun **grimman** hugi,
 4264 **slíð**-móden **sebon** · [...],
 ni weldun is **worde** gi-lôbjēn, · ak habdun im ge-win mikil
 4266 wið þea **Kristes** kraft: · **kumen** ni móstun
 þea liudi þurh **lêðen** stríd, · þat sie gi-lôbon te imu
 4268 **fasto** gi-féngin; · ni was im þiu **frume** gibiðig,
 þat sie **heban**-ríki · **habbjēn** móstin.
 4270 **Géng** imu þó þe **godes** sunu · êndi is **jungaron** mid imu,
waldand fan þemu **wíhe**, · all só is **willjo** géng,

iak imu uppen þene berg gi-stêg · barn drohtines:
 sat imu þar mid is ge-siðun · ɛndi im sagde filu
 wároro wordo. · Sí bi-gunnun im þó umbi þene wíh sprekan,
 þie gumon umbi þat godes hús, · kwáðun þat ni wári
 gód-líkora
 alah obar erðu · þurh erlo hand,
 þurh mannes gi-werk · mid megin-kraftu
 rakud a-rihtid. · Þó þe ríko sprak,
 hêr heban-kuning · —hôrdun þe ôðra—:
 „ik mag iu gi-telljen“, (kwað hé,) „þat noh wirðid þiu tíð kumen,
 þat is af-standen ni skal · stên obar ôðrumu,
 ak it fallid ti foldu · ɛndi fiur nimid,
 grádag logna, · þoh it nú só gód-lík sí,
 só wís-líko gi-warht, · ɛndi só dód all þesaro wer-oldest
 gi-skapu,
 te·glídid gróni wang.“ · Þó géngun imu is jungaron tó,
 frágodun ina só stillo: · „hwó lango skal standen noh“,
 kwáðun sie,
 „þius wer-old an wunnjun, · êr þan þat gi-wand kume,
 þat þe lasto dag · liohtes skíne
 þurh wolkan-skion, · efþo hwan is þín eft wán kumen
 an þene middil-gard, · manno kunnje
 te a-dêljenne, · dôðun ɛndi kwikun?
 frô mín þe gódo, · ús is þes firi-wit mikil,
 waldandjo Krist, · hwan þat gi-werðen skuli.“

TODO.

4294 52 Þó im and-wordsi · alo-waldo Krist
gód-lík far·gaf · þem gumun selbo:
4296 „þat hábad só bi·d̥ernid“, (kwað hé), „drohtin þe gódo,
iak só hardo far·holen · himil-ríkjes fader,
4298 waldand þesaro wer-oldest, · só þat witen ni mag
ênig mannisk barn, · hwan þiu márje tíð
4300 gi·wirðid an þesaru wer-oldi, · ne it ôk te wáran ni kunnun
godes engilos, · þie for imu gegin-warde
4302 simlun sindun: · sie it ôk gi·seggjan ni mugun
te wáran mid iro wordun, · hwan þat gi·werðen skuli,
4304 þat hé willje an þesan middil-gard, · mahtig drohtin,
firiho fandon. · Fader wêt it êno

- 4306 hêlag fan himile: · ɛlkur is it bi·holen allun,
 kwikun ɛndi dôdun, · hwan is kumi werðad.
 4308 Ik mag iu þoh gi·têlljen, · hwi·lík hér têkan bi·foran
 gi·werðad wunder·lík, · êr þan hé an þese wer·old kume
 4310 an þemu márjon daga: · þat wirðid hér êr an þemu mánon
 skín
 iak an þeru sunnon só same; · gi·swerkad siu bêðju,
 4312 mid finistre werðad bi·fangan; · fallad sterron,
 hwít heban·tungal, · ɛndi hrisid erðe,
 4314 bibod þius brêde wer·old · —wirðid su·líkaro bôkno filu—:
 grimmid þe grôto sêo, · wirkid þie gebenes strôm
 4316 ɛgison mid is ûðjun · erð·búandjun.
 Þan þorrot þiu þiod · þurh þat ge·þwing mikil,
 4318 folk þurh þea forhta: · þan nis friðu hwęgin,
 ak wirðid wíg só maneg · obar þese wer·old alla
 4320 hęte·lík af·haben, · ɛndi hęri lêdid
 kunni obar ôðar: · wirðid kuningo gi·win,
 4322 megin·fard mikil: · wirðid managoro kwalm,
 open ur·lagi · —þat is ɛgis·lík þing,
 4324 þat io su·lík morð · skulun man af·hębbjen—,
 wirðid wól só mikil · obar þese wer·old alle,
 4326 man·sterbono mêt, · þero þe gio an þesaru middil·gard
 swulti þurh suhti: · liggjad seoka man,
 4328 drisosat ɛndi dôjat · ɛndi iro dag ɛndjad,
 fulljad mid iro ferahu; · fęrid un·met grôt
 4330 hungar hęti·grim · obar hęliðo barn,
 meþi·gêðjono mêt: · nis þat minniste
 4332 þero wítjo an þesaru wer·oldi, · þe hér gi·werðen skulun
 êr dómes dage. · Só hwan só gí þea dádi gi·sehan
 4334 gi·werðen an þesaru wer·oldi, · só mugun gí þan te wáran
 far·standen,
 þat þan þe latsto dag · liudjun náhid
 4336 mári te mannun · ɛndi maht godes,
 himil·krafte hróri · ɛndi þes hêlagon kumi,
 4338 drohtines mid is diuriðun. · Hwat gí þesaro dádjo mugun
 bi þesun bômun · biliði ant·kennjen:
 4340 þan sie brustjad ɛndi blójat · ɛndi bladu tógjat,
 lôf ant·lúkad, · þan witun liudjo barn,
 4342 þat þan is sán after þiu · sumer gi·náhid

warm ɛndi wun-sam · ɛndi wedeʃ skôni.
 4344 Sô witin gí ôk bi þesun tēknun, · þe ik iu talde hér,
 hwan þe latsto dag · liudjun náhid.
 4346 Ðan seggjo ik iu te wáran, · þat êr þit werod ni mót,
 te·faran þit folk-skēpi, · êr þan werðe ge·fullid só,
 4348 mínu word gi·wárod. · Noh gi·wand kumid
 himiles ɛndi erðun, · ɛndi stéid mín hêlag word
 4350 fast forð-wardes · ɛndi wirðid al ge·fullod só,
 gi·lêstid an þesumu liohte, · só ik for þesun liudjun ge·spriku.
 4352 wakot gí war-liko: · iu is wis-kumo
 duom-dag þe mārjo · ɛndi iuwes drohtines kraft,
 4354 þiu mikilo mēgin-strengi · ɛndi þiu mārje tíð,
 gi·wand þesaro wer-oldest. · Fora þiu gí wardon skulun,
 4356 þat hé iu slápanðje · an swef-rēstu
 fārungo ni bi·fāhe · an firin-werkun,
 4358 mēnes fulle. · Mút·spelli kumit
 an þiustrja naht, · al só þiof fērid
 4360 darno mid is dádjun, · só kumid þe dag mannun,
 þe latsto þeses liohtes, · só it êr þese liudi ni witun,
 4362 só samo só þiu flód deda · an furn-dagun,
 þe þár mid lagu-strômun · liudi far·tēride
 4364 bi Nôeas tíðjun, · bi·útan þat ina nēride god
 mid is híwiskja, · hêlag drohtin,
 4366 wið þes flódes farm: · só warð ôk þat fiur kuman
 hêt fan himile, · þat þea hôhon burgi
 4368 umbi Sodomu land · swart logna bi·féng
 grim ɛndi grádag, · þat þár n·ênig gumono ni gi·nas
 4370 bi·útan Loth êno: · ina ant·lêddun þanen
 drohtines ɛngilos · ɛndi is dohter twá
 4372 an ênan berg uppen: · þat ôðar al brinnandi fiur,
 ia land ia liudi · logna far·tēride:
 4374 só fārungo warð þat fiur kumen, · só warð êr þe flód só samo:
 só wirðid þe latsto dag. · For þiu skal allaro liudjo ge·hwi-lik
 4376 þenkjan fora þemu þinge; · þes is þarf mikil
 manno ge·hwi-likumu: · be·þiu látad iu an iuwan mód sorga.

TODO.

4358 Mút·spelli 'the Muspell' | See note to l. 2591a above.

4369 grim ɛndi grádag | Formulaic; OE *grim ɛnd gráðig* is used of Grendel in *Beow* 121a and his mother in l. 1499a.

- 4378 **53** Hwand só hwan só þat ge·wirðid, · þat waldand Krist,
 mári mannes sunu · mid þeru maht godes,
 4380 kumit mid þiu kraflu · kuningo ríkjost
 sittjan an is selbes maht · ĕndi samod mid imu
 4382 alle þea ĕngilos, · þe þár uppa sind
 hēlaga an himile, · þan skulun þarod hēliðo barn,
 4384 ĕli-þeoda kuman · alla te·samne
 libbjandero liudjo, · só hwat só io an þesumu liohte warð
 4386 firiho a·fódid. · Þár hé þemu folke skal,
 allumu man-kunnje · mári drohtin
 4388 a·dēljen aftar iro dādjun. · Þan skēðid hé þea far·duanan man,
 þea far·warhton weros · an þea winistron hand:
 4390 só duot hé ôk þea sáligon · an þea swiðeron half;
 grótid hé þan þea góðun · ĕndi im te·gegnes sprikid:
 4392 „Kumad gí“, kwiðid hé, „þea þár gi·korene sindun, · ĕndi
 ant·fahad þit kraftiga ríki,
 þat góde, þat þár gi·gērēwid stēndid, · þat þár warð gumono
 barnun
 4394 gi·warht fan þesaro wer·oldes ĕndje: · iu habad ge·wíhid selbo
 fader allaro firiho barno: · gí mótun þesaro frumono neotan,
 4396 ge·waldon þeses wídon ríkjās, · hwand gí oft mínan willjon
 frumidun,
 ful·gēngun mí gerno · ĕndi wárun mí iuwaro gebo mildje,
 4398 þan ik bi·þwungan was · þurstu ĕndi hungro,
 frostu bi·fangan · efþo an feteron lag,
 4400 bi·klēmmd an karkare: · oft wurðun mí kumana þarod
 helpa fan iuwun handun: · gí wárun mí an iuwomu hugi
 mildje,
 4402 wísodun mín werð·liko.“ · Þan sprikid imu eft þat werod
 an·gēgin:
 „Frô mín þe gódo“, (kweðat sie,) „hwan wári þú bi·fangan só,
 4404 be·þwungan an su·líkun þaraþun, · só þú fora þesaru þiod tēlis,
 mahtig mēnis? · Hwan gi·sah þi man ēnig
 4406 be·þwungan an su·líkun þaraþun? · Hwat þú haþes allaro
 þiodo gi·wald
 iak só samo þero mēðmo, · þero þe io manno barn
 4408 ge·wunnun an þesaro wer·oldi.“ · Þan sprikid im eft waldand
 god:
 „só hwat só gí dādun“, (kwiðit hé,) „an iuwes drohtines namon,

- 4410 gódes far·gábun · an godes êra
 þem mannun, þe hér minniston sindun, · þero nú undar
 þesaru mēnegi standad
 4412 endi þurh ôd-módi · arme wárun
 weros, hwand sie mínan willjon frēmidun · —só hwat só gí
 im iuwaro welono far·gábun,
 4414 gi·dádun þurh diuriða, · þat ant·fēng iuwa drohtin selbo,
 þiu helpe kwam te heban-kuninge. · Be·þiu wili iu þe hêlago
 drohtin
 4416 lônon iuwan gi·lôbon: · gibid iu lif êwig.“
 Wēndid ina þan waldand · an þea winistron hand,
 4418 drohtin te þem far·duanun mannun, · sagad im þat sie skulin
 þea dád ant·gelden,
 þea man iro mēn-gi-werk: · „nú gí fan mí skulun“, kwiðit hé,
 4420 „faran só for·flókane · an þat fiur êwig,
 þat þár gi·garēwid warð · godes and-sakun,
 4422 fiundo folke · be firin-werkun,
 hwand gí mí ni hulpun, · þan mí hunger endi þurst
 4424 wēgde te wundrun · efþa ik ge·wádjes lōs
 géng jámer-mód, · was mí grōtun þarf,
 4426 þan ni habde ik þár ênige helpe, · þan ik ge·hēftid was,
 an liðo-kospun bi·lokan, · efþa mí legar bi·fēng,
 4428 swára suhti: · þan ni weldun gí mín siokes þár
 wíson mid wihti: · ni was iu werð eo-wiht,
 4430 þat gí mín ge·hugdin. · Be·þiu gí an hēllje skulun
 þolon an þiustre.“ · Þan sprikid imu eft þiu þiod an·gēgin:
 4432 „Wola waldand god“, (kweðad sie,) „hwí wilt þú só wið þit werod
 sprekan,
 mahljen wið þese mēnegi? · Hwan was þí io manno þarf,
 4434 gumono gódes? · Hwat sie it al be þínun geþun êgun,
 welon an þesaro wer-oldi“. · Þan sprikid eft waldand god:
 4436 „þan gí þea armostun“, (kwiðid hé,) „êldi-barno,
 manno þea minniston · an iuwomu mód-sebon
 4438 hēliðos far·hugdun, · létun sea iu an iuwomu hugi lêðe,
 be·dêldun sie iuwaro diurða, · þan dádun gí iuwana drohtin só
 sama,
 4440 gi·wērnidun imu iuwaro welono: · be·þiu ni wili iu waldand
 god,
 ant·fáhen fader iuwa, · ak gí an þat fiur skulun,

4442 an þene **diopun** **dôð**, · **diu**blun þionon,
wrêðun **wiðer**-sakun, · hwand **gí** só **war**tun bi·foran.“
 4444 Þan aftar þem **wordun** skêðit · þat **werod** an **twê**,
 þea **gôdun** **endi** þea ubilon: · farad þea far·**griponon** man
 4446 an þea **hêtan** **hêl** · **hriuwig**-môde,
 þea far·**warhton** **weros**, · **wíti** ant·fáhat,
 4448 **ubil** **endi**-lôs. · Lêdid **up** þanen
hêr **heban**-kuning · þea **hluttaron** þeoda
 4450 an þat **lang**-same **lioht**: · þár is **lif** êwig,
gi·garêwid **godes** ríki · **gôdaro** þiado.“

TODO.

Passion.

4452 **54** Só ge·fragn ik þat þem **rínkun** þó · **ríki** drohtin
 umbi þesaro **wer**-oldes **gi·wand** · **wordun** talde,
 4454 hwó þiu **forð** **fêrid**, · þan lango þe sie **firiho** barn
ardon môtun, · ia hwó siu an þemu **endi** skal
 4456 te·**gliden** **endi** te·**gangen**. · Hé sagde ôk is **jungarun** þár
wárun **wordun**: · „Hwat **gí** **witun** alle“, kwað hé,
 4458 „þat nú oðar **twá** naht · sind **tídi** kumana,
Judeono paskha, · þat sie skulun iro **gode** þionon,
 4460 **weros** an þemu **wíhe**. · Þes nis ge·**wand** ênig,
 þat þár **wirðid** **mannes** sunu · te þeru **mêgin**-þiodu
 4462 **kraftag** far·**kôpot** · **endi** an **krúke** a·slagan,
þolod **þiad**-kwála.“ · Þó warð þár **þegan** manag
 4464 **slíð**-mód **gi·samnod**, · **sûðar**-liudjo,
Judeono **gum**-skêpi, · þár sie skoldun iro **gode** þionon.
 4466 **wurðun** **êo**-sagon · **alle** kumane,
 an **warf** **weros**, · þe sie þó **wísostun**
 4468 undar þeru **mênegi** · **manno** taldun,
kraftag **kuni**-burd. · Þár **Kaiphas** was,
 4470 **biskop** þero **liudjo**. · Sie **rédiun** þó an þat **barn** godes,
 hwó sie ina a·**luogin** · **sundja** lōsan,
 4472 kwáðun þat sie ina an þemu **hêlagon** daga · **hrínen** ni skoldin
 undar þero **manno** **mênegi**, · „þat ni werðe þius **mêgin**-þioda,
 4474 **hêliðos** an **hróru**, · hwand ina þit **hêri**-skêpi wili
 far·**standen** mid **strídu**. · Wí só **stillo** skulun

4476 frêson is ferahes, · þat þit folk Judeono
 an þesun wih-dagun · wróht ni af-hëbbjen.“
 4478 Þó géng imu þár Júdas forð, · jungaro Kristes,
 ên þero twe-libjo, · þár þat aðali sat,
 4480 Judeono gum-skëpi; · kwað þat hé is im góðan ráð
 seggjan mahti: · „hwat willjad gí mí selljen hér“, kwað hé,
 4482 „mêðmo te médu, · ef ik iu þene man giþu
 áno wíg ęndi áno wróht?“ · Þó warð þes werodes hugi,
 4484 þero liudjo an lustun: · „ef þú wili gi-lêstjen só“, kwáðun sie,
 „þín word gi-wáron, · þan þú gi-wald habes,
 4486 hwat þú at þesaru þiodu · þiggjan willjes
 góðaro mêðmo.“ · Þó gi-hét imu þat gum-skëpi þár
 4488 an is selbes dóm · silubar-skatto
 þrí-tig at-samne, · ęndi hé te þeru þiodu gi-sprak
 4490 dëreþjun wordun, · þat hé gábi is drohtin wið þiu.
 węnde ina þó fān þemu werode: · was im wrêð hugi,
 4492 talode im só treu-lôs, · hwan êr wurði imu þiu tíð kuman,
 þat hé ina mahti fār-wisjen · wrêðaro þiodo,
 4494 fiundo folke. · Þan wisse þat friðu-barn godes,
 wár waldand Krist, · þat hé þese wer-old skolde,
 4496 a-geþen þese gardos · ęndi sókjen imu godes ríki,
 gi-fāren is fader-óðil. · Þó ni gi-sah ênig firiho barno
 4498 mēron minnje, · þan hé þó te þem mannun gi-nam,
 te þem is góðun jungaron: · gôme warhte,
 4500 sętte sie swás-líko · ęndi im sagde filu
 wāroro wordo. · Skrêd westęr dag,
 4502 sunne te sedle. · Þó hé selbo gi-bôð,
 waldand mid is wordun, · hét im water dragan
 4504 hluttar te handun, · ęndi rês þó þe hêlago Krist,
 þe gódo at þem gômun · ęndi þár is jungarono þwóg
 4506 fôti mid is folmun · ęndi swarf sie mid is fānon aftar,
 druknide sie diur-líka. · Þó wið is drohtin sprak
 4508 Símon Petrus: · „Ni þunkid mí þit sómi þing“, kwað hé,
 „frô mín þe gódo, · þat þú míne fôti þwahes
 4510 mid þem þínun hêlagun handun.“ · Þó sprak imu eft is hêrro
 an-gegin,
 waldand mid is wordun: · „Ef þú is willjan ni habes“, kwað hé,
 4512 „te ant-fāhanne, · þat ik þíne fôti þwahes
 þurh su-líka minnja, · só ik þesun ôðrun mannun hér

- 4514 dóm þurh diurða, · þan ni habes þú ênigan dël mid mí
an heban-ríkja.“ · Hugi warð þó gi·wëndid
4516 Símon Petruse: · „Þú haba þí selbo gi·wald“, kwað hé,
„frô mín þe gódo, · fôti êndi hando
êndi mínes hôbdes só sama, · handun þínun,
4518 þiadan, te þwahanne, · te þiu þat ik móti þína forð
huldi hebbjan · êndi heban-ríkjes
4520 su-lík gi·dêli, · só þú mí, drohtin, wili
far·geben þurh þína gódi.“ · Jungaron Kristes,
4522 þene ambaht-skêpi · erlos þolodun,
þegnos mid gi·þuldjon, · só hwat só im iro þiadan dede,
4524 mahtig þurh þea minnja, · êndi mênde imu al méra þing
frihlon te gi·frummjenne.

TODO.

4517' *bandun þínun* | *emend. accepted by most eds.; om. MC*

4517' frô ... *þínun* | Treated as one line by Sievers (1878) (who does not emend the b-verse *bandun þínun*), whence the skipped numbering.

55

Friðu-barn godes

- 4526 géng imu þó eft gi·sittjen · under þat ge·sīðo folk
êndi im sagða filu lang-samna rád. · Warð eft lioht kuman,
4528 morgen te mannun. · Mahtigne Krist
gróttun is jungaron êndi frágodun, · hwár sie is gôma þó
4530 an þemu wih-dage · wirkjen skoldin,
hwar hé weldi halden · þea hêlagon tídi
4532 selbo mid is ge·sīðun. · Þó hé sie sókjen hét,
þea gumon Jerusalem: · „só gí þan gangan kumad“, kwað hé,
4534 „an þea burg innan · —þár is braht mikil,
mêgin-þiodo gi·mang—, · þár mugun gí ênan man sehan
4536 an is handun dragen · hluttres watares
ful mid folmun. · Þemu gí folgon skulun
4538 an só hwi-líke gardos, · só gí ina gangan gi·sehat,
ia gí þan þemu hêrron, · þe þie hobos êgi,
4540 selbon sæggjad, · þat ik iu sênde þarod
te gi·garuwenne mína gôma. · Þan tôgid hé iu ên gód-lík hús,
4542 hôhan sóleri, · þe is bi·hangen al
fagarun fratahun. · Þár gí frummjen skulun
4544 werd-skêpi mínan. · Þár bium ik wis-kumo

selbo mid mínun ge·siðun.“ · Þó wurðun sán aftar þiu
 4546 þár te Jerusalem · jungaron Kristes
 forð·ward an ferdí, · fundun all só hé sprak
 4548 word·têkən wár: · ni was þes gi·wand ênig.
 Þár ge·fæwidun sie þea gôma. · Warð þe godes sunu,
 4550 hêlag drohtin · an þat hús kuman,
 þár sie þe land·wíse · lêstjen skoldun,
 4552 ful·gangan godes gi·bode, · al só Judeono was
 êo êndi ald·sidu · an êr·dagun.
 4554 Gi·wêt imu þó an þemu ábande · alo·waldand Krist
 an þene sæli sittjen; · hét þár is ge·siðos te imu
 4556 twe·libi gangan, · þea im gi·triuwiston
 an iro mód·sebon · manno wárun
 4558 bi wordun êndi bi wísun: · wisse imu selbo
 iro hugi·skefti · hêlag drohtin.
 4560 Grótte sie þó oðar þem gômun: · „Gern bium ik swíðo“, kwað
 hé,
 „þat ik samad mid iu · sittjen móti,
 4562 gômono neoten, · Judeono paskha
 dêljén mid iu só diurjun. · Nú ik iu iuwes drohtines skal
 4564 willjon sæggjan, · þat ik an þesaro wer·oldi ni mót
 mid mannun mêt · móses an·bíten
 4566 furður mid firihun, · êr þan gi·fullod wirðid
 himilo ríki. · Mí is an handun nú
 4568 wíti êndi wundêr·kwále, · þea ik for þesumu werode skal,
 þolon for þesaru þiodu.“ · Só hé þó só te þem þegnun sprak,
 4570 hêlag drohtin, · só warð imu is hugi dróbi,
 warð imu gi·sworcen sebo, · êndi eft te þem ge·siðun sprak,
 4572 þe gódo te þem is jungarun: · „Hwat ik iu godes ríki“, kwað
 hé,
 „gi·hét himiles lioht, · êndi gí mí hold·líko
 4574 iuwan þegan·skæpi. · Nú ni willjat gí a·þengjan só,
 ak wénkjat þero wordo. · Nú sæggju ik iu te wáran hér,
 4576 þat wili iuwar twe·libjo ên · treuwana swíkan,
 wili mí far·kôpon · undar þit kunni Judeono,
 4578 gi·selljen wiðer silubre, · êndi wili imu þár sink niman,
 diurje mêðmos, · êndi geþen is drohtin wið þiu,
 4580 holdan hêrran. · Þat imu þoh te harme skal,
 werðan te wítje; · be þat hé þea wurdi far·sihit

4620 þea tídi sind nú gi·náhid.“ · Só þó þe treu·logo
 þat mós ant·féng · ɛndi mid is müðu an·bêt,
 4622 só af·gaf ina þó þiu godes kraft, · gramon in ge·witun
 an þene lík·hamon, · lēða wihti,
 4624 warð imu Satanas · sêro bi·tengi,
 hardo umbi is herte, · siður ine þiu helpe godes
 4626 far·lét an þesumu liohte. · Só is þena liudjo wê,
 þe só undar þesumu himile skal · hêrron wehslon.

TODO.

4628 **56** Gi·wêt imu þó út þanen · in·widjas gern
 Judas gangan: · habde imu grimmen hugi
 4630 þegan wið is þiodan. · Was þó iu þiustri naht,
 swiðo gi·sworcen. · Sunu drohtines
 4632 was ima at þem gômun forð · ɛndi is jungarun þár
 waldand win ɛndi brôð · wíhide bêðju,
 4634 hêlagode heban·kuning, · mid is handun brak,
 gaf it undar þem is jungarun · ɛndi gode þankode,
 4636 sagde þem á·lát, · þe þár al gi·skóp,
 wer·old ɛndi wunnja, · ɛndi sprak word manag:
 4638 „gi·lôbjot gí þes liohto“, (kwað hé,) „þat þit is mín lík·hamo
 ɛndi mín blód só same: · giþu ik iu hér bêðju samad
 4640 etan ɛndi drinkan. · Þit ik an erðu skal
 geþan ɛndi geotan · ɛndi iu te godes ríkje
 4642 lósjen mid mínu lík·hamen · an líf êwig,
 an þat himiles lioht. · Gi·huggjat gí simlun,
 4644 þat gí þiu ful·gangan, · þiu ik an þesun gômun dón;
 márjad þit for mɛnegi: · þit is mahtig þing,
 4646 mid þius skulun gí iuwomu drohtine · diuriða frummjen,
 habbjad þit mín te gi·hugdjun, · hêlag biliði,
 4648 þat it ɛlði·barn · aftar léstjen,
 waron an þesaru wer·oldi, · þat þat witin alle,
 4650 man oþar þesan middil·gard, · þat it is þurh mína minnja
 gi·duan
 hêrron te huldi. · Ge·huggjad gí simlun,
 4652 hweo ik iu hér ge·biudu, · þat gí iuwan bróðer·skɛpi
 fasto frummjad: · habbjad ferhtan hugi,
 4654 minnjod iu an iuwomu móde, · þat þat manno barn
 oþar irmin·þiod · alle far·standen,

- 4656 þat **gí** sind **gegnungo** · **j**ungaron **míne**.
 Òk skal ik iu **küðjen**, · **hwó** hér wili **kraftag** fiund,
 4658 **hettjand** **heru**-grim, · umbi iuwan **hugi** niusjen,
Satanas selbo: · **hé** kumid iuwaro **seolono** herod
 4660 **frókno frêson**. · Simlun **gí** **fasto** te gode
berad iuwa **breost-gi-þáht**: · ik skal an iuwaru **bedu** standen,
 4662 þat iu ni **mugi þe mên-skaðo** · **mód** ge·twíffjan;
 ik **ful-lêstju** iu wiðer þemu **fiunde**. · Òk kwam **hé** herod giu
frêson mín,
 4664 þoh imu is **willjon** hér · **wiht** ne gi·stódi,
liobes an þemu **mínumu lík**-hamon. · Nú ni willju ik iu **leng**
helen,
 4666 hwat iu hér nú **sniumo** skal · te **sorgu** gi·standen:
gí skulun mí ge·**swíkan**, · ge·**síðos** **míne**,
 4668 iuwes **þegan**-skępjes, · **êr** þan þius **þiustrje** naht
liudi far·**líða** · **endi** eft **lioht** kume,
 4670 **morgan** te **mannun**.“ · Þó warð **mód** gumon
swíðo gi·**sworken** · **endi** **sêr** hugi,
 4672 **hriuwig** umbi iro **herte** · **endi** iro **hêrron** word
swíðo an **sorgun**. · **Símon** Petrus þó,
 4674 **þegan** wið is **þiodan** · **þrist**-wordun sprak
bí **huldi** *wið is **hêrron**: · „þoh þí all þit **heliðo** folk“, kwaþ-hie,
 4676 „gi·**swíkan** þína gi·**síðos**, · þoh ik **sinnon** mid þí
 at allon **þaraþon** · **þolojan** willju.
 4678 Ik biun **garo** sinnon, · ef mí **god** látið,
 þat ik an þínon **ful-lêstje** · **fasto** gi·stande;
 4680 þoh sia þi an **karkarjes** · **klústron** hardo,
 þesa **liudi** bi·**lúkan**, · þoh ist mí **luttill** tweho,
 4682 ne ik an þem **þendjon** mid þi · **bídan** willje,
liggjan mid þi só **lieben**; · ef sia þínes **líbes** þan
 4684 þuru **eggja** níð · **áhtjan** willjad,
frô mín þie guodo, · ik giþu mín **ferah** furi þik
 4686 an **wáþno** spil: · nis mí **werð** iowiht
 te bi·**míðanne**, · só lango só mí **mín** warod
 4688 **hugi** **endi** **hand-kraft**.“ · Þuo sprak im eft is **hêrro** an·gegin:
 „Hwat þú þik bi·**wánis**“, (kwaþ-hie,) „**wissaro** treuwono,
 4690 **þrístero þingo**: · þú **hábis** **þegnes** hugi,
willjon guodan. · Ik mag þí **seggjan**, **hwó** it þoh gi·**werðan**
skal,

4692 þat þú wirðis só wêk-muod, · þoh þú nú ni wánjes só,
 þat þú þines þiadnes te naht · þriwo far·lôgnis
 4694 êr hano·krádi êndi kwiðis, · þak ik þín hêrro ni sí,
 ak þú far·manst mína mund-burd.“ · Þuo sprak eft þie man
 an·gegin:
 4696 „ef it gio an wer-oldi“, (kwaþ-hie,) „gi·werðan muosti,
 þat ik samad mid þí · sweltan muosti,
 4698 dôjan diur·líko, · þan ne wurði gio þie dag kuman,
 þat ik þín far·lôgnidi, · liebo drohtin,
 4700 gerno for þeson Juðeon.“ · Þuo kwáðun alla þia jungron só,
 þat sia þár an þem þingon mid im · þoljan weldin.

TODO. Then Simon Peter,
 the thane, to his theeden spoke brave words
 out of loyalty to his lord: “Although this whole host of heroes,” quoth he,
 “and thy followers should forsake thee, yet I nevertheless
 with thee will suffer through all hardships.
 I am nevertheless ready, if God lets me,
 that I should stand steadfast as thy support.
 Although this people should lock thee
 behind the hard bars of prison, still I have little doubt
 that I in those bonds will abide with thee,
 and lie by thee so dear. If they then through the hatred
 of blades wish to take thy life,
 O my good Lord, I will give my breath for thee
 in the play of weapons. There is nothing worth for me
 to avoid for as long as I possess
 my heart and strength of hand.” Then his Lord spoke back to him:
 “How thou thinkest thyself capable”, quoth he, “of certain loyalty,
 of bold conflicts! Thou hast a thane’s heart,
 a good will. Yet I can tell thee how it shall turn out
 that thou in one night wilt thrice deny thy theeden
 ere the cock-crow, and say that I am not thy lord;
 instead thou wilt renounce my protection.” Then the man spoke back to
 him:
 “If it ever in this world must turn out so
 that I alongside thee must perish
 die dearly, evenso the day will never come
 that I should deny thee, beloved lord,
 eagerly before these Jews.” Then all the disciples said so,
 that there in the conflicts with him they would suffer.

4702 57 Þuo im eft mid is wordon gi·bôd · waldand selbo,
 hêr heban-kuning, · þat sia im ni lietin iro hugi twífljan,

- 4704 hiet þat sia ni weldin [...] · diopa gi·þáhti:
 „Ne druobje iuwa herta · þuru iuwes drohtines word,
 4706 ne forøhtjat te filo: · ik skal fader úsan
 selþan suokjan · ęndi iu sęndjan skal
 4708 fan heban-rikje · hêlagna gêst:
 þie skal iu eft gi·fruoþrjan · ęndi te frumu werðan,
 4710 manon iu þero mahlo, · þie ik iu manag hebbju
 wordon gi·wísid. · Hie gibit iu gi·wit an briost,
 4712 lust-sama lêra, · þat gí lęstjan forð
 þiu word ęndi þiu werk, · þia ik iu an þesaro wer-oldi gi·bôð.“
 4714 A·rêš im þuo þe ríkjo · an þemo rakode innan,
 nęrjendo Krist · ęndi gi·wêt im nahtes þanan
 4716 selþo mid is gi·sïðon: · sêrago géngun
 swíðo gornondja · jungron Kristes,
 4718 hriuwig-muoda. · Þuo hie im an þena hôhan gi·wêt
 Oliueti-berg: · þár was hie up gi·wuno
 4720 gangan mid is jungron. · Þat wissa Judas wel,
 balo-hugdig man, · hwand hie was oft an þem berege mid im.
 4722 Þár gruotta þie godes suno · jûgron sína:
 „Gí sind nú só druobja“, (kwaþ-hie,) „nú gí mínan dôð witun;
 4724 nú gornonð gí ęndi griotand, · ęndi þesa Juðeon sind an
 luston,
 męndit þius męnigi, · sindun an iro muode fráha,
 4726 þius wer-old ist an wunnjon. · Þes wirðit þoh gi·wand kuman
 sniumo tulgo: · þan wirðit im sêr hugi,
 4728 þan mornjat sia an iro móde, · ęndi gí męndjan skulun
 after te êwon-dage, · hwand gio ęndi ni kumið,
 4730 iuwes wel·líbes gi·wand: · be·þiu ne þurbun iu þius werk
 tregan,
 hreuwán mín hin-fard, · hwand þanan skal þiu helpa kuman
 4732 gumono barnon.“ · Þuo hiet hie is jungron þár
 bíðan uppan þemo berge, · kwað þat hie ti bedu weldi
 4734 an þiu holm-kliðu · hôhor stígan;
 hiet þuo þria mid im · þegnos gangan,
 4736 Jakobe ęndi Johannese · ęndi þena guodan Petruse,
 þrist-muodjan þegan. · Þuo sia mid iro þiedne samad
 4738 gerno géngun. · Þuo hiet sia þie godes suno
 an berge uppan · te bedu hnígan,
 4740 hiet sia god gruotjan, · *gerno biddjan,

þat hé im þero **kostondero** · **kraft** far-stódi,
 4742 **wrêðaro willjon**, · þat im þe **wiðer-sako**,
 ni **mahti** þe **mên-skaðo** · **mód** gi·twífljan,
 4744 iak imu þó **selbo** gi·hnêg · **sunu** drohtines
kraftag an **knio-beda**, · **kuningo** ríkjust,
 4746 **forð-ward** te **foldu**: · **fader** alo-þiado
góðan grótte, · **gorn-wordun** sprak
 4748 **hriuwig-líko**: · was imu is **hugi** dróbi,
 bi þeru **męnniski** · **mód** gi·hrórid,
 4750 is **flêsk** was an **forhtun**: · **fellun** imo trahni,
drôp is **diur-lík swêt**, · al só **drôr** kumid
 4752 **wallan fan wundun**. · Was an ge·winne þó
 an þemu **godes barne** · þe **gêst** ęndi þe **lík-hamo**:
 4754 **ôðar** was **fúsid** · an **forð-wegos**,
 þe **gêst** an **godes ríki**, · **ôðar jámar stód**,
 4756 **lík-hamo** Kristes: · ni welde þit **lioht** a·geben,
 ak **dróbde** for þemu **dôðe**. · Simla hé hreop te **drohtine** forð
 4758 þiu **mêr** aftar þiu · **mahtigna grótte**,
hóhan himil-fader, · **hêlagna** god,
 4760 **waldand** mid is **wordun**: · „ef nú **werðen** ni mag“, **kwað** hé,
 „**man-kunni** ge·nęrid, · ne sí þat ik **mínan** gebe
 4762 **lioban lík-hamon** · for **liudjo** barn
 te **węjanne** te **wundrun**, · it sí þan þín **willjo** só,
 4764 ik **willju** is þan gi·**koston**: · ik nimu þene **kęlik** an hand,
drinku ina þi te **diurðu**, · **drohtin** frô mín,
 4766 **mahtig mund-boro**. · Ni seh þú **mínes** hér
flêskes gi·fórjes. · Ik **fullon** skal
 4768 **willjon** þínen: · þú habes ge·**wald** obar al.“
 Gi·wêt imu þó **gangen**, · þár hé êr is **jungaron lét**
 4770 **bíðan** uppan þemu **berge**; · fand sie þat **barn** godes
slápen sorgandje: · was im **sêr** hugi,
 4772 þes sie fan iro **drohtine** · **dêljen** skoldun.
 Só sind þat **mód-þraka** · **manno** ge·hwi-líkumu,
 4774 þat hé far·**lâten** skal · **liabane** hêrron,
 af·**geben** þene só **góðene**. · Þó hé te is **jungarun** sprak,
 4776 **wahte** sie **waldand** · ęndi **wordun** grótte:
 „**Hwí** **willjad** gí **só slápen**?“ (kwað hé;) „ni mugun **samad** mid mí
 4778 **wakon** êne tíð? · Þiu **wurd** is at handun,
 þat it só gi·**gangen** skal, · só it **god** fader

4780 gi·markode mahtig. · Mí nis an mínumu móde tweho:
 mín gêst is garu · an godes willjan,
 4782 fûs te faranne: · mín flêsk is an sorgun,
 lêtîd mik mín lík-hamo: · lêð is imu swíðo
 4784 wíti te polonne. · Ik þoh willjan skal
 mínes fader ge·frummjen; · hebbjad gí fasten hugi.“
 4786 Gi·wêt imu þó eft þanan · ôðer-síðu
 an þene berg uppen · te bedu gangan,
 4788 mári drohtin, · êndi þár só manag gi·sprak
 góðoro wordo. · Godes êngil kwam
 4790 hêlag fan himile, · is hugi fastnode,
 bêldide te þem bændjun. · Hé was an þeru bedu simla
 4792 forð an flíte · êndi is fader grótte,
 waldand mid is wordun: · „ef it nú wesen ni mag“, kwað hé,
 4794 „mári drohtin, · nebu ik for þit manno folk
 þiod-kwále þoloje, · ik an þínan skal
 4796 willjan wonjan.“ · Gi·wêt imu þó eft þanen
 sókjan is ge·síðos: · fand sie sláþandje,
 4798 grótte sie gáhun. · Géng imu eft þanen
 þriddjon síðu te bedu · êndi sprak þiod-kuning
 4800 al þiu selbon word, · sunu drohtines,
 te þemu alo-waldon fader, · só hé êr dede,
 4802 manode mahtigna · manno frumana
 swíðo niud-líko · nêrjando Krist,
 4804 géng imu þó eft te þem is jungarun, · grótte sie sáno:
 „sláþad gí êndi rêstjad“, (kwað hé,) „nú wirðid sniumo herod
 4806 kuman mid kraftu, · þe mí far·kôpot haþad,
 sundja lósan gi·sald.“ · Ge·síðos Kristes
 4808 wakodun þó aftar þem wordun · êndi gi·sáhun þó þat werod
 kuman
 an þene berg uppen · brahtmu þiu mikilon,
 4810^a wrêða wáþan-berand.

TODO.

4810^b 58

Wíside im Judas,
 gram-hugdig man; · Judeon aftar sigun,
 4812 fiundo folk-skepi; · dróg man fiur an gi·mang,
 logna an lioht-fatun, · lédde man faklon
 4814 brinnandja fan burg, · þár sie an þene berg uppan

stigun mid strídu. · Þea stędi wisse Judas wel,
 4816 hwár hé þea liudi · tó lēdjan skolde.
 Sagde imu þó te tēkne, · þó sie þár tó fórun
 4818 þemu folke bi·foran, · te þiu þat sie ni far·fēngin þár,
 erlos ôðren man: · „ik gangu imu at êrist tó“, kwað hé,
 4820 „kussju ine ęndi kwaddju: · þat is Krist selbo.
 Þene gí fāhen skulun · folko kraftu,
 4822 binden ina uppan þemu berge · ęndi ina te burg hinan
 lēdjen undar þea liudi: · hé is líbes habad
 4824 mid is wordun far·werkod.“ · Werod siðode þó,
 ant-tat sie te Kriste · kumane wurðun,
 4826 grim folk Judeono, · þár hé mid is jungarun stód,
 mári drohtin: · bēd metodo-gi·skapu,
 4828 torhtero tídjo. · Þó gēng imu treu-lôs man,
 Judas te·gēgnes · ęndi te þemu godes barne
 4830 hnēg mid is hōbdu · ęndi is hērron kwēdde,
 kuste ina kraftagne · ęndi is kwidi lēste,
 4832 wísde ina þemu werode, · al só hé êr mid wordun ge·hét.
 Þat þolode al mid gi·þuldjun · þiодо drohtin,
 4834 waldand þesara wer-oldes · ęndi sprak imu mid is wordun tó,
 frágode ine frókno: · „be·hwí kumis þú só mid þius folku te
 mí,
 4836 be·hwí lēdis þú mí só þese liudi tó · ęndi mí te þesare lēðan
 þiode sprekan,
 far·kôpos mid þínu kussu · under þit kunni Judeono,
 4838 meldos mí te þesaru mēnegi?“ · Gēng imu þó wið þea man
 wið þat werod ôðar · ęndi sie mid is wordun fragn,
 4840 hwene sie mid þiu ge·siðju · sókjan kwámin
 só niud-liko an naht, · „so gí willjan nōd frummjen
 4842 manno hwi-likumu.“ · Þó sprak imu eft þiu mēnegi an·gēgin,
 kwáðun þat im hêljand · þár an þemu holme uppan
 4844 ge·wísid wári, · „þe þit gi·wer frumid
 Judeo liudjun · ęndi ina godes sunu
 4846 selbon hētid. · Ina kwámun wí sókjan herod,
 weldin ina gerno bi·geten: · hé is fan Galileo lande,
 4848 fan Nazareth-burg.“ · Só im þó þe nęrjendjo Krist
 sagde te sōðan, · þat hé it selbo was,
 4850 só wurðun þó an forhtun · folk Judeono,
 wurðun under·badode, · þat sie under bak fellun

4852 alle efno sán, · erðe gi·sóhtun,
 wiðer·wardes þat werod: · ni mahte þat word godes,
 4854 þie stemnje ant·standan: · wárun þoh só strídige man,
 a·hliopun eft up an þemu holme, · hugi fastnodun,
 4856 bundun briost-gi·þáht, · gi·bolgane géngun
 náhor mid níðu, · ant-tat sie þene ne·rjendjon Krist
 4858 werodo bi·wurpun. · Stóðun wíse man,
 swíðo gornundje · jungaron Kristes
 4860 bi·foran þeru dēreþjon dádi · ęndi te iro drohtine sprákun:
 „wári it nú þín willjo“, (kwáðun sie,) „waldand frô mín,
 4862 þat sie ős hér an speres ordun · spildjen móstin
 wápnun wunde, · þan ni wári ős wiht só gód,
 4864 só þat wí hér for ősumu drohtine · dóan móstin
 bēniðjun blēka“. · Þó gi·bolgan warð
 4866 snel swerd-þegan, · Símon Petrus,
 well imu innan hugi, · þat hé ni mahte ęnig word sprekan:
 4868 só harm warð imu an is hertan, · þat man is hērron þar
 binden welde. · Þó hé gi·bolgan géng,
 4870 swíðo þrist-mód þegan · for is þiodan standen,
 hard for is hērron: · ni was imu is hugi twíflī,
 4872 blóð an is breostun, · ak hé is bil a·tôh,
 swerd bi sídu, · slóg imu te·gegnes
 4874 an þene furiston fiund · folmo krafto,
 þat þó Malkhus warð · mákjas eggjun,
 4876 an þea swíðaron half · swerdu gi·málod:
 þiu hlust warð imu far·hawan, · hé warð an þat hōbid wund,
 4878 þat imu heru-drôrag · hlear ęndi ôre
 bēni-wundun brast: · blóð aftar sprang,
 4880 well fan wundun. · Þó was an is wangun skard
 þe furisto þero fiundo. · Þó stóð þat folk an rúm:
 4882 an·drédun im þes billes biti. · Þó sprak þat barn godes
 selbo te Símon Petruse, · hét þat hé is swerd dedi
 4884 skarp an skēðja: · „ef ik wið þesa skola weldi“, kwað hé,
 „wið þeses werodes ge·win · wíg-saka frummjen,
 4886 þan manodi ik þene mārjon · mahtigne god,
 hēlagne fader · an himil-ríkja,
 4888 þat hé mí só managan ęngil herod · obana sandi
 wíges só wísen, · só ni mahtin iro wápan-þreki
 4890 man a·dôgjan: · iro ni stódi gio su-lík megin samad,

folkes gi·fastnod, · þat im iro ferh aftar þiu
 4892 werðen mahti. · Ak it habad waldand god,
 alo-mahtig fader · an ôðar gi·markot,
 4894 þat wí gi·polojan skulun, · só hwat só ús þius þioda tó
 bittres bręngit: · ni skulun ús belgan wiht,
 4896 wrêðjan wið iro ge·winne; · hwand só hwe só wápno níð,
 grimman gêr-hęti wili · gerno frummjen,
 4898 hé swilit imu · eft swerdes eggjun,
 dóit im bi·drôregan: · wí mid úsun dádjun ni skulun
 4900 wiht a·werðjan.“ · Géng hé þó te þemu wundon manne,
 lęgde mid listjun · lík te·samne,
 4902 hōbid-wundon, · þat siu sán gi·hêlid warð,
 þes billes biti, · ęndi sprak þat barn godes
 4904 wið þat wrêðe werod: · „mí þunkid wunder mikil“, kwað hé,
 „ef gí mí lēðes wiht · lēstjen weldun,
 4906 hwi gí mí þó ni fęngun, · þan ik undar iuwomu folke stód,
 an þemu wihe innan · ęndi þár word manag
 4908 sōð-lík sagde. · Þan was sunnon skín,
 diur-lik dages lioht, · þan ni weldun gí mí dóan eo-wiht
 4910 lēðes an þesumu liohte, · ęndi nú lēðjad mí iuwa liudi tó
 an þiustrje naht, · al só man þioþe dót,
 4912 þan man þene fāhan wili · ęndi hé is ferhes habad
 far·werkot, wam-skaðo.“ · werod Judeono
 4914 gripun þó an þene godes sunu, · grimma þioda,
 hatandjero hóp, · hwurbun ina umbi
 4916 módag manno folk · —mênes ni sáhun—,
 heftun heru-bęndjun · handi te·samne,
 4918 faðmos mid fiterjun. · Im ni was su-líkaro firin-kwála
 þarf te gi·polonne, · þiod-arbêðjes,
 4920 te winnane su-lík wíti, · ak hé it þurh þit werod deda,
 hwand hé liudjo barn · lōsjen welda,
 4922 halon fan hęllju · an himil-ríki,
 an þene wídon welon: · be·þiu hé þes wiht ne bi·sprak,
 4924 þes sie imu þurh in·wid-níð · ógjan weldun.

TODO.

59 Þó wurðun þes só malske · módag folk Judeono,
 4926 þiu hêri warð þes só hrómeg, · þes sie þena hêlagon Krist
 an liðo-bęndjon · lēðjan muostun,

4966 þe hêrdislo fan þemu hertan. · Hwarabondi géng
 forð undar þemu folke, · ant-tat hé te þemu fiure kwam;
 gi·wêt ina þó warmjen. · Þár im ôk ên wíf bi·gan
 4968 fêlgjan firin-sprâka: · „hér mugun gí“, kwað siu, „an iuwan
 fiund sehan:
 þit is gegnungo · jungaro Kristes,
 4970 is selbes ge·sið.“ · Þó géngun imu sán aftar þiu
 náhor nið-hwata · çndi ina niud-líko
 4972 frágodun fiundo barn, · hwi-líkes hé folkes wári:
 “ni bist þú þesoro burg-liudjo“, (kwaðun sie,) „þat mugun wí an
 þínumu gi·bárje gi·sehan,
 4974 an þínun wordun çndi an þínaru wíson, · þat þú þeses werodes
 ni bist,
 ak þú bist galiléísk man.“ · hé ni welda þes þó gehan eo-wiht,
 4976 ak stód þó çndi stridda · çndi starkan êð
 swið-líko ge·swôr, · þat hé þes ge·siðes ni wári.
 4978 Ni habda is wordo ge·wald: · it skolde gi·werðen só,
 só it þe ge·markode, · þe man-kunnjes
 4980 far·wardot an þesaru wer-oldi. · Þó kwam imu ôk an þemu
 warbe tó
 þes mannes mág-wini, · þe hé êr mid is mákjo gi·hêw,
 4982 swerdu þiu skarpon, · kwað þat hé ina sáhi þár
 an þemu berge uppan, · „þár wí an þemu bôm-gardon
 4984 hêrron þínumu · hçndi bundun,
 fastnodun is folmos.“ · Hé þó þurh forhtan hugi
 4986 for·lôgnide þes is liobes hêrron, · kwað þat hé weldi wesán þes
 líbes skolo,
 ef it mahti ênig þár · irmin-manno
 4988 gi·sëggjan te sôðan, · þat hé þes ge·siðes wári,
 folgodi þeru fêrði. · Þó warð an þena formon sið
 4990 hano-krád af·haben. · Þó sah þe hêlago Krist,
 barno þat bêtste, · þár hé ge·bunden stód,
 4992 selbo te Símon Petruse, · sunu drohtines
 te þemu erle obar is ahsla. · Þó warð imu an innan sán,
 4994 Símon Petruse · sêr an is móde,
 harm an is hertan · çndi is hugi dróbi,
 4996 swiðo warð imu an sorgun, · þat hé êr selbo ge·sprak:
 gi·hugde þero wordo þó, · þe imu êr waldand Krist
 4998 selbo sagda, · þat hé an þeru swartan naht

- 5000 êr hano-krádi · is hêrron skoldi
 þríwo far·lôgnjen. · Þes þram imu an innan mód
 bittro an is breostun, · êndi géng imu þó gi·bolgan þanen
 5002 þe man fan þeru mēnigi · an mód·karu,
 swíðo an sorgun, · êndi is selbes word,
 5004 wam·skefti weop, · ant·tat imu wallan kwámun
 þurh þea hert·kara · hête trahni,
 5006 blóðage fan is breostun. · Hé ni wánde þat hé is mahti
 gi·bótjen wiht,
 firin·werko furðor · eþa te is frâhon kuman,
 5008 hêrron huldi: · nis ênig hēliðo só ald,
 þat io mannes sunu · mēr gi·sáhi
 5010 is selbes word · sêrur hreuwun,
 karon eþa kúmjen: · „Wola krafteg god“, kwað hé,
 5012 þat ik hēbbju mí só for·werkot, · só ik mínaro wer·oldes ni þarf
 ó·lát seggjan. · Ef ik nú te aldre skal
 5014 huldjo þínaro · êndi heban·ríkjas,
 þeoden, þolojan, · þan ni þarf mí þes ênig þank wesan,
 5016 liobo drohtin, · þat ik io te þesumu liohte kwam.
 Ni bium ik nú þes wirðig, · waldand frô mín,
 5018 þat ik under þíne jungaron · gangan móti,
 þus sundig under þíne ge·sīðos: · ik iro selbo skal
 5020 mīðan an mínumu móde, · nú ik mí su·lík mēn ge·sprak.“
 Só gornode · gumono bēstta,
 5022 hrau im só hardo, · þat hé habde is hêrron þó
 leobes far·lôgnid. · Ðan ni þurbun þes liudjo barn,
 5024 weros wundrojan, · be·hwí it weldi god,
 þat só lioben man · lēð gi·stódi,
 5026 þat hé só hōn·liko · hêrron sines
 þurh þera þiwun word, · þegno snellost,
 5028 far·lôgnide só liobes: · it was al bi þesun liudjun gi·duan,
 firiho barnun te frumu. · Hé welde ina te furiston dóan,
 5030 hêrost oðar is híwiski, · hêlag drohtin:
 lét ina ge·kunnon, · hwi·líke kraft hæbet
 5032 þe mēnniska mód · áno þe maht godes;
 lét ina ge·sundjon, · þat hé sīðor þiu bēt
 5034 liudjun gi·lōbdi, · hwó liof is þár
 manno gi·hwi·líkumu, · þan hé mēn ge·frumit,
 5036 þat man ina a·láte · lēðes þinges,

5038 sakono ċndi sundjono, · só im þó selbo dede
heban-riki god · harm-ge·wurhti.

TODO.

‘So lamented the best of men,
he was so greatly troubled that he had then denied
his beloved lord. Then did the children of men,
the heroes, not need wonder at why God
would have it that such a beloved man should stand in pain,
that he, the most valiant of thanes, had so shamefully
denied his own lord so beloved
through those three speeches. It was all done on behalf of these men,
to the profit of the children of folk. He, the Holy Lord,
would make him the foremost, the noblest, over His retinue.
He made him experience just what strength
the human mind has without the might of God.
He let him sin so that he afterwards could
yet better make men believe what love there exists
for whichever man has committed evil,
that men may forgive him for his loathsome deed,
for his crimes and sins, as him did the very
God of the Heavenly Realm [forgive] for his works of harm.

60 Be þiu nis mannes bág · mikilun bi·þerþi,
5040 hagu-staldes hróm: · ef imu þiu helpe godes
ge·swíkid þurh is sundjon, · þan is imu sán aftar þiu
5042 breost-hugi blóðora, · þoh hé êr bi·hêt spreka,
hrómje fan is hildi · ċndi fan is hand-krafti,
5044 þe man fan is meġine. · Þat warð þár an þemu márjon skín,
þegno betston, · þó imu is þiodanes gi·swék
5046 hêlag helpe. · Be·þiu ni skoldi hrómjen man
te swíðo fan imu selbon, · hwand imu þár swíkid oft
5048 wán ċndi willjo, · ef imu waldand god,
hêr heban-kuning · herte ni stêrkit.
5050 Þan bêd allaro barno betst, · bēndi þolode
þurh man-kunni. · Hwurbun ina managa umbi
5052 Judeono liudi, · sprákun gelp mikil,
habdun ina te hoska, · þár hé gi·hêftid stód,
5054 þolode mid ge·þuldjun, · só hwat só imu þiu þiod deda,
liudi lêðes. · Þó warð eft lioht kuman,
5056 morgan te mannun. · Manag samnoda
hêri Judeono: · habdun im hugi wulbo,
5058 in·wid an innan. · Warð þár êo·sago

an **morgan-tíd** · **manag** gi·samnod
 5060 **irri** **endi** **ên-hard**, · **in-widjas** gern,
wrêðes **willjan**. · Géngun im an **warf** samad
 5062 **rinkos** an **rúna**, · bi·gunnun im **ráðan** þó,
 hwó sie ge·**wísadin** · mid **wár-lôs**un,
 5064 **mannun** **mên-ge-witun** · an **mahtigna** Krist
 te gi·**sëggjanne** **sundja** · þurh is **selbes** word,
 5066 þat sie ina þan te **wunder-kwálu** · **wëgjan** móstin,
a·dêljen te **dôðe**. · Sie ni mahtun an þemu **dage** finden
 5068 só **wrêð** ge·**wit-skëpi**, · þat sie imu **wíti** be·þiu
a·dêljen gi·**dorstin** · eþþa **dôð** frummjen,
 5070 **líbu** bi·**lôsjen**. · Þó kwámun þár at **latstan** forð
 an þena **warf wero** · **wár-lôse** man
 5072 **twêne** gangan · **endi** bi·gunnun im **tëlljen** an,
 kwáðun þat sie ina **selbon** · **sëggjan** gi·hòrdin,
 5074 þat hé mahti te·**werpen** · þena **wih** godes,
 allaro **húso** **hóhost** · **endi** þurh is **hand-mëgin**,
 5076 þurh is **ênes** kraft · **up a-rihtjen**
 an **þriddjon** daga, · só is **elkor** ni þorfti be·þihan man.
 5078 Hé þagoda **endi** **þoloda**: · ni sprak imu io þiu **þiod** só filu,
 þea liudi mid **luginun**, · þat hé it mid **lêðun** an·gëgin
 5080 **wordun** **wráki**. · Þó þár undar þemu **werode** a·rêš
balu-hugdig man, · **biskop** þero liudjo,
 5082 þe **furisto** þes **folkes** · **endi** **frágode** Krist
 iak ina be imu **selbon** bi·**swór** · **swiðon** êðun,
 5084 **grótte** ina an **godes** namon · **endi** **gerno** bad,
 þat hé im þat gi·**sagdi**, · ef hé **sunu** wári
 5086 þes libbjendjes godes: · „þes þit **lioht** ge·skóp,
Krist **kuning** êwig. · **Wí** ni mugun is ant·**kiënnjen** wiht
 5088 ne an þínun **wordun** ni an þínun **werkun**.“ · Þó sprak imu eft
 þe **wáro** an·gëgin,
 þe **gódo** **godes** sunu: · „þú kwiðis it for þesun **Judeon** nú,
 5090 **sôð-liko** **sëgis**, · þat ik it **selbo** bium.
 Þes ni gi·**lôbjad** mí þese liudi: · ni willjad mí for·**látan** be·þiu;
 5092 ni sind im mín **word** **wirðig**. · Nú seggju ik iu te **wárun** þoh,
 þat gí noh skulun **sittjen** gi·**sehan** · an þe **swiðaron** half godes
 5094 **márjan** **mannes** sunu, · an **mëgin**-krafte
 þes **alo-walden** fader, · **endi** þanan eft kuman
 5096 an **himil-wolknun** **herod** · **endi** allumu **hëliðo** kunnje

mid is wordun a·dêljen, · al só iro ge·wurhti sind.“
 5098 Þo balg ina þe biskop, · habde bittren hugi,
 wrêðida wið þemu worde · ɛndi is gi·wádi slét,
 5100 brak for is breostun: · „Nú ni þurbun gí bídan leng“, kwað hé,
 „þit werod ge·wit·skeþjes, · nú im su·lík word farad,
 5102 mên·spráka fan is müðe. · Þat gi·hórid hér nú manno filu,
 rínko an þesumu rakude, · þat hé ina só ríkjan telit,
 5104 gihid þat hé god sí. · Hwat willjad gí Judeon þes
 a·dêljen te dôme? · Is hé dōðes nú
 5106^a wirðig be su·líkun wordun?“

Therefore man's boasting is not of much avail,
 the young warrior's bragging, if the help of God fails him
 due to his sins. Then very soon afterwards
 is the heart in his breast bloodier, although he may earlier have spoken a vow,
 bragged about his zeal and strength of hand—
 that man, about his might. That was made clear to the famed
 best of thanes when the theoden's holy
 help failed him. Therefore man should not boast
 too much about himself, for often his hope
 and will fail him if the wielder God,
 the noble King of Heaven, does not strengthen his heart.
 TODO.

5106^b 61 Þat werod al ge·sprak,
 folk Judeono, · þat hé wári þes ferhes skolo,
 5108 wítes só wirðig. · Ni was it þoh be is ge·wurhtjun gi·dóen,
 þat ine þár an Jerusalem · Judeo liudi,
 5110 sunu drohtines · sundja lōsen
 a·dêldun te dōðe. · Þó was þero dádjo hróm
 5112 Judeo liudjun, · hwat sie þemu godes barne
 mahtin só haftemu mēst, · harmes ge·frummjen.
 5114 Be·wurpun ina þó mid werodu · ɛndi ina an is wangan slógun,
 an is hleor mid iro handun · —al was imu þat te hoske
 gi·dóen—,
 5116 fêlgidun imu firin·word · fiundo mēnegi,
 bismerspráka. · Stód þat barn godes
 5118 fast under fiundun: · wárun imu is faðmos ge·bundene,
 þolode mid gi·þuldjun, · só hwat só imu þiu þioda tó
 5120 bittres bráhte: · ni balg ina n·eo·wiht
 wið þes werodes ge·win. · Þó námon ina wrêðe man
 5122 só gi·bundanan, · þat barn godes,

- 5124 ɛndi ina þó lêddun, · þár þero liudjo was,
 þere þiade þing-hús. · Þár þegan manag
 5126 hwurbun umbi iro hɛri-togon. · Þár was iro hêrron bodo
 fan Rúmu-burg, · þes þe þó þes ríkjas gi-wéld:
 kumen was hé fan þemu kêsure, · gi-sɛndid was hé undar þat
 kunni Judeono
 5128 te rihtjenne þat ríki, · was þár rád-gebo:
 Pilatus was hé hêten; · hé was fan Ponto lande
 5130 knósles kɛnnit. · Habde imu kraft mikil,
 an þemu þing-húse · þiod gi-samnod,
 5132 an warf weros; · wár-lôse man
 a·gábun þó þena godes sunu, · Judeo liudi,
 5134 under fiundo folk, · kwáðun þat hé wári þes ferhes skolo,
 þat man ina wítnodi · wápnes ɛggjun,
 5136 skarpun skúrún. · Ni welde þiu skole Judeono
 þringan an þat þing-hús, · ak þiu þiod úte stóð,
 5138 mahlidun þanen wið þea mɛnegi: · ni weldun an þat gi·mang
 faren,
 an ɛli-landige man, · þat sie þár un-reht word,
 5140 an þemu dage dɛrbjes wiht · a·dêljan ne gi·hôrdin,
 ak kwáðun þat sie im só hluttro · hêlaga tídi,
 5142 weldin iro paskha halden. · Pilatus ant·féng
 at þem wam-skaðun · waldandes barn,
 5144 sundja lôsen. · Þó an sorgun warð
 Judases hugi, · þó hé a·geþan gi·sah
 5146 is drohtin te dōðe, · þó bi-gan imu þiu dád aftar þiu
 an is hugja hreuwan, · þat hé habde is hêrron êr
 5148 sundja lôsen gi·sald. · Nam imu þó þat siluþbar an hand,
 þrí-tig skatto, · þat man imu êr wið is þiodane gaf,
 5150 géng imu þó te þem Judiun · ɛndi im is grimmon dád,
 sundjon sagde, · ɛndi im þat siluþbar bōð
 5152 gerno te a·geþanne: · „ik heþbju it só grio-liko“, kwað hé,
 „mínes drohtines · drôru gi·kôpot,
 5154 só ik wêt þat it mí ni þíhit.“ · Þiod Judeono
 ni weldun it þó ant·fahan, · ak hétun ina forð aftar þiu
 5156 umbi su-líka sundja · selbon ahton,
 hwat hé wið is frâhon · ge·frumid habdi:
 5158 „Þú sáhi þi selbo þes“, (kwáðun sie;), „hwat wili þú þes nú sóken te
 ús?

Ne wít þú þat þesumu werode!“ · Þó gi·wêt imu eft þanan
 5160 Judas gangan · te þemu godes wihe
 swiðo an sorgun · ęndi þat siluþar warp
 5162 an þena alah innan, · ne gi·dorste it ęgan leng;
 fôr imu þó só an forhtun, · só ina fiundo barn
 5164 módage manodun: · habdun þes mannes hugi
 gramon under·gripanen, · was imu god a·bolgan,
 5166 þat hé imu selbon þó · símon warhte,
 hnêg þó an heru·sêl · an hinginna,
 5168 warag an wurgil · ęndi wíti ge·kôs,
 hard hêlje ge·þwing, · hêt ęndi þiustri,
 5170 diap dôðes dalu, · hwand hé êr umbi is drohtin swêk.

TODO.

62 Þan bêd þat barn godes · —bęndi þolode
 5172 an þemu þing·húse—, · hwan êr þiu þiod under im,
 erlos ên·wordje · alle wurðin,
 5174 hwat sie imu þan te ferah·kwálu · frummjan weldin.
 Þó þar an þem bęnkjun a·rês · bodo kêsures
 5176 fan Rúmu·burg · ęndi géng imu wið þat ríki Judeono
 módag mahljen, · þar þiu męnigi stód
 5178 aftar þemu hobe hwarbon: · ni weldun an þat hús kuman
 an þemu paskha·dage. · Pilatus bi·gan
 5180 frókno frágon · obar þat folk Judeono,
 mid hwiu þe man habdi · morðes gi·skuldit,
 5182 wítjes gi·werkot: · „be hwí gí imu só wrêðe sind,
 an iuwomu hugja hótje?“ · Sie kwáðun þat hé im habdi
 harmes só filu,
 5184 lêðes gi·lêstid: · „ni gábin ina þesa liudi þi,
 þar sie ina êr bi·foran · ubilan ni wissin,
 5186 wordun far·warhten. · Hé habat þeses werodes só filu
 far·lêdid mid is lêrun · —ęndi þesa liudi męrrid,
 5188 dóit im iro hugi twiþljen—, · þat wí ni mótun te þemu hobe
 kêsures
 tinsi gelden; · þat mugun wí ina gi·têlljen an
 5190 mid wáru ge·wit·skepi. · Hé sprikid ôk word mikil,
 kwiðit þat hé Krist sí, · kuning obar þit ríki,
 5192 be·gihit ina só grôtes.“ · Þó im eft te·gegnes sprak
 bodo kêsures: · „ef hé só bar·líko“, kwað hé,

- 5194 „under þesaru mēnigi · mēn-werk frumid,
ant-fāhad ina þan eft under iuwe folk-skēpi, · ef hē sī is ferhes
skolo,
- 5196 ęndi imu sō a·dēljad, · ef hē sī dōðes werð,
sō it an iuwaro aldrono · ēo ge-biode.“
- 5198 Sie kwāðun þó, þat sie ni móstin · manno nig-ēnumu
an þea hēlagon tíð · te hand-banon,
- 5200 werðen mid wápnun · an þemu wih-dage.
Þó wēnde ina fan þemu werode · wrēð-hugdig man,
- 5202 þegan kēsures, · þe obar þea þioda was
bodo fan Rúmu-burg—: · hét imu þó þat barn godes
- 5204 náhor gangan · ęndi ina niud-líko,
frágoda frókno, · ef hē obar þat folk kuning
- 5206 þes werodes wári. · Þó habde eft is word garu
sunu drohtines: · „hweðer þú þat fan þi selbumu sprikis“,
kwað hē,
- 5208 „þe it þi öðre hér · erlos sagdun,
kwāðun umbi mínan kuning-duom?“ · Þó sprak eft þe kēsures
bodo
- 5210 wlank ęndi wrēð-mód, · þár hē wið waldand Krist
ręðjode an þem rakude: · „ni bium ik þeses rikjes hinan“,
kwað hē,
- 5212 „Judeo liudjo, · ni gadoling þín,
þesaru manno mág-wini, · ak mí þi þius mēnigi bi-falāh,
5214 a·gábun þi þína gadulingos mí, · Judeo liudi,
haftan te handun. · Hwat habas þú harmes gi-duan,
5216 þat þú sō bittro skalt · bęndi þolojan,
kwalm undar þínumu kunnje?“ · Þó sprak imu eft Krist
an-gęgin,
- 5218 hēlendero bętst, · þár hē gi·hęftid stód
an þemu rakude innan: · „nis mín riki hinan“, kwað hē,
- 5220 „fan þesaru wer-old-stundu. · Ef it þoh wári sō,
þan wárin sō stark-móde · wiðer strid-hugi,
5222 wiðer grama þioda · jungaron míne,
sō man mí ni gábi · Judeo liudjun,
5224 hęttendjun an hand · an heru-bęndjun
te węgianne te wundrun. · Te þiu warð ik an þesaru wer-oldi
gi-boran,
5226 þat ik ge-wit-skēpi giu · wáres þinges

mid mínun kumjun küðdi. · Þat mugun ant·kennjen wel
 5228 þe weros, þe sind fan wære kumane: · þe mugun mín word
 far·standen,
 gi·lôbjen mínun lêrun.“ · Þó ni mahte lasteres wiht
 5230 an þem barne godes · bodo kêsures,
 findan fêknja word, · þat hé is ferhes be·þiu
 5232 skuldig wári. · Þó géng hé im eft wið þea skola Judeono
 módag mahljen ·  ndi þeru m nigi sagde
 5234 oþar hlust mikil, · þat hé an þemu hafton manne
 su·líka firin·spráka · finden ni mahti
 5236 for þem folk·skipje, · só hé wári is ferhes skolo,
 d   es wir ig. · Þan st dun dol·m de
 5238 Judeo liudi ·  ndi þane godes sunu
 wordun wr gdun: · kw   un þat hé gi·wer  rist
 5240 be·gunni an Galileo lande, · „ ndi oþar Judeon f r
 herod·wardes þanan, · hugi twi lode,
 5242 manno m d·sebon, · só hé is mor  es wer ,
 þat man ina w tnoje · w pnes  ggjun,
 5244 ef eo man mid su·líkun d   jun mag · d   es ge·skuldjen.“

TODO.

63 S  wr gdun ina mid wordun · werod Judeono
 5246 þurh h tjan hugi. · Þ  þe h ri·togo,
 sli ·m dig man · se ggjan gi·h rde,
 5248 fan hwi·líkumu kunnje was · Krist a·f did,
 manno þe b tsto: · hé was fan þeru m rjan þiadu,
 5250 þe g do fan Galilea·lande; · þ r was gum·sk pi
   iljero manno; · Erodos bi·held þ r
 5252 kraftagne kuning·d m, · s  ina imu þe k sur far·gaf,
 þe r kjo fan R umu, · þat hé þ r rehto ge·hwi·lík
 5254 ge·frumidi undar þemu folke ·  ndi fri u l sti,
 d mos a·d ldi. · H  was  k an þemu dage selbo
 5256 an Jerusalem · mid is gum·sk pi,
 mid is werode at þemu wihe: · s  was iro w se þan,
 5258 þat sie þ r þia h lagun t d · haldan skoldun,
 paskha Judeono. · Pilatus gi·b d þ ,
 5260 þat þena hafton man · h li os n min
 s  gi·bundanan, · þat barn godes,
 5262 h t þat sie ina Erodese, · erlos br htin

haften te handun, · hwand hé fan is hēri-skēpi was,
 5264 fan is werodes ge·wald. · Wīgand frumidun
 iro hērron word: · hēlagne Krist
 5266 fōrdun an fiterjun · for þena folk-togun,
 allaro barno bēst, · þero þe io gi·boren wurði
 5268 an liudjo lioht; · an liðu-bēndjun gēng,
 ant-tat sie ina bráhtun, · þár hé an is bēnkja sat,
 5270 kuning Eroles: · umbi·hwarf ina kraft wero,
 wlanke wīgandos: · was im willjo mikil,
 5272 þat sie þár selbon Krist · gi·sehan móstin:
 wándun þat hé im sum tēkan · þár tōgjan skoldi,
 5274 mári ėndi mahtig, · só hé managun dede
 þurh is god-kundi · Judeo *liudjon.
 5276 Frágoda ina þuo þie folk-kuning · firi-wit-líko
 managon wordon, · wolda is muod-sebon
 5278 forð undar·findan, · hwat hie te frumu mohti
 mannon gi·markon. · Þan stuod mahtig Krist,
 5280 þagoda ėndi þoloda: · ne wolda þem þied-kuninge,
 Erodese ne is erlon · ant-swór geban
 5282 wordo nig·ēnon. · Þan stuod þiu wrēða þiod,
 Judeo liudi · ėndi þena godes suno
 5284 wurrun ėndi wruogdun, · anþat im warð þie wer-old-kuning
 an is huge huoti · ėndi all is hēri-skipi,
 5286 far·muonstun ina an iro muode: · ne ant·kēndun maht godes,
 himiliskan hērron, · ak was im iro hugi þiustri,
 5288 baluweš gi·blandan. · Barn drohtines
 iro wrēðun werk, · word ėndi dádi
 5290 þuru ôd-muodi · all gi·þoloda,
 só hwat só sia im tionono þuo · tuogjan woldun.
 5292 Sia hietun im þuo te hoske · hwít gi·wádi
 umbi is liði lēggjan, · þiu mēr hie wurði þem liudjon þár,
 5294 jungron te gamne. · Judeon faganodun,
 þuo sia ina te hoske · hēbbjan gi·sáhun,
 5296 erlos oþar-muoda. · Þuo sēnda ina eft þanan
 Eroles sé kuning · an þat ôðer folk;
 5298 a·lêdjan hiet ina lungra mann, · ėndi lastar sprákun,
 felgidun im firin-word, · þár hie an feteron gēng
 5300 bi·hlagan mid hosku: · ni was im hugi twíflī,
 neþa hie it þuru ôd-muodi · all gi·þoloda;

5302 ne welda iro ubilun word · idug-lônön,
hosk ɛndi harm-kwidi. · Þuo bráhtun sia ina eft an þat hús
innan,
5304 an þia palenkja uppan, · þár Pilatus was
an þero þing-stædi. · Þegnos a-gáþun
5306 barno þat bæsta · banon te handon
sundi-lôsjan, · só hie selbo gi-kôs:
5308 welda manno barn · morðes a-tuomjan,
nērjan af nōdi. · Stuodun nīð-hwata,
5310 Judeon far þem gast-selje: · habdun sia gramono barn,
þia skola far-skundid, · þat sia ne be-skribun iowiht
5312 grimmera dádjo. · Þuo gi-wêt im gangan þarod
þegan kêsures · wið þia þiod sprekan,
5314 hard hēri-togo: · „Hwat gí mí þesan haftan mann“, kwap-hie,
„an þesan sēli sēndun · ɛndi selbon an-budun,
5316 þat hie iuwes werodes só filo · a-werdit habdi,
far-lêdid mid is lēron. · Nú ik mid þeson liudon ni mag,
5318 findan mid þius folku, · þat hie is ferāhes sí
furi þesaro skolu skuldig. · Skín was þat hiudu:
5320 Erodes mohta, · þie iuwan êo bi-kan,
iuwaro liudo land-reht, · hie ni mahta is líbes gi-frêson,
5322 þat hie hier þuru êniga sundja te dage · sweltan skoldi,
líf far-látan. · Nú willju ik ina for þeson liudjon hier
5324 gi-þróon mid þingon, · þristjon wordun,
buotjan im is briost-hugi, · látan ina brúkan forð
5326 ferāhes mid firjon.“ · Folk Judeono
hreopun þuo alla samad · hlúdero stemnu,
5328 hietun flít-líko · ferāhes áhtjan
Krist mid kwalmu · ɛndi an krúki slahan,
5330 wêgjan te wundron: · „hie mid is wordon hábit
dôðes gi-skuldid: · sagit þat hie drohtin sí,
5332 gegnungo godes suno. · Þat hie a-geldan skal,
in-wid-spráka, · só is an uson êwe gi-skríban,
5334 þat man su-líka firin-kwidi · ferahu kôpo.“

TODO.

64 Þuο warð þie an for̃ahton, · þie þes folkes gi·wélð,
5336 mikilon an is muode, · þuο hie gi·hórða þia man sprekan,
 þat sia ina selbon · seggjan gi·hórdin,

- 5338 gehan fur þem gum-skiþe, · þat hie wári godes suno.
 Þuo hwarf im eft þie hēri-togo · an þat hús innan
 5340 te þero þing-stēdi, · þristjon wordon
 gruotta þena godes suno · ėndi frágoda, hwat hie gumono
 wári:
 5342 „hwat bist þú manno?“ (kwaþ-hie,) „Te hwí þú mí só þinan muod
 hilis,
 dęrnis diop-gi-þáht? · Wēst þú þat it all an mínon duome stéd
 5344 umbi þines líbes gi-lagu? · Mí þi hębbjat þesa liudi far-geban,
 werod Judeono, · þat ik gi-waldan muot
 5346 só þik te spildjanne · an speres orde,
 só ti kwęlljanne an krúkjum, · só kwikan látan,
 5348 só hweðer sí mí selbon · suotera þunkit
 te gi-frummjanne mid mínu folku.“ · Þuo sprak eft þat
 friðu-barn godes:
 5350 „Wēst þú þat te wáron“, (kwaþ-hie,) „þat þú gi-wald oþar mik
 hębbjan ni mohtis, · ne wári þat it þi hēlag god
 5352 selbo far-gábi? · Ōk hębbjat þia sundjono mēr,
 þia mik þi bi-fulhun · þuru fiond-skipi,
 5354 gi-saldun an símon haftan.“ · Þuo welda ina sið after þiu
 gram-hugdig man · gerno far-látan,
 5356 þegan kēsures, · þár hie is hābdi for þero þioda gi-wald;
 ak sia węridun im þena willjon · wordu gi-hwi-líku,
 5358 kunni Judeono: · „ne bist þú“, kwáðun sia, „þes kēsures
 friund,
 þínon hērren hold, · ef þú ina hinan látis
 5360 siðon gi-sundon: · þat þi noh te soragan mag,
 werðan te wíte, · hwand só hwe só su-lík word spriket,
 5362 a-habið ina só hōho, · kwiðit þat hie hębbjan mugi
 kuning-duomes namon, · ne sí þat ina im þie kēsur geþe,
 5364 hie wirrid im is wer-uld-ríki · ėndi is word far-hugid,
 far-man ina an is muode. · Be-þiu skalt þú su-lík mēn wrekan,
 5366 hosk-word manag, · ef þú umbi þines hērren ruokis,
 umbi þines frōhon friund-skipi, · þan skalt þú ina þiu ferhu
 be-niman.“
 5368 Þuo gi-hōrda þie hēri-togo · þia hēri Juðeono
 þręgjan fan is þiodne; · þuo hie far þero þing-stēdi géng
 5370 selbo gi-sittjan, · þár gi-samnod was
 só mikil warf werodes, · hiet waldand Krist

5372 lêdjan for þia liudi. · Langoda Judeon,
 hwan êr sia þat hêlaga barn · hangon gi·sáwin,
 5374 kweġan an krúkje; · sia kwáðun þat sia kuning óðran
 ne habdin undar iro hêri-skipje, · neban þena hêran kêsar
 5376 fan Rúmu-burg; · „þie habit hier ríki ober ús.
 Be-þiu ni skalt þú þesan far·látan; · hie habit ús só filo lêðes
 gi·sprokan,
 5378 far·duan habit hie im mid is dádjon. · Hie skal dôð þolon,
 wíti ċndi wundar-kwála.“ · Werod Judeono
 5380 só manag mis·lík þing · an mahtigna Krist
 sagdun te sundjun. · Hie swigondi stuod
 5382 þuru ôð-muodi, · ne ant-wordida n·io-wiht
 wið iro wrêðun word: · wolda þesa wer-old alla
 5384 lôsjan mid is líbu: · bi-þiu liet hie ina þia lêðun þiod
 wêgjan te wundron, · all só iro willjo géng:
 5386 ni wolda im opan·líko · allon küðjan
 Judeo liudjon, · þat hie was god selbo;
 5388 hwand wissin sia þat te wáron, · þat hie su·líka gi·wald habdi
 obar þeson middil-gard, · þan wurði im iro muod-sebo
 5390 gi·blôðit an iro brioston: · þan ne gi·dorstin sia þat barn godes
 handon ant·hrínan: · þan ni wurði heðan-ríki,
 5392 ant·lokan liohto mêt · liudjo barnon.
 Be-þiu mêð hie is só an is muode, · ne lét þat manno folk
 5394 witan, hwat sia warahtun. · Þiu wurd náhida þuo,
 mári maht godes · ċndi middi dag,
 5396 þat sia þia ferah-kwála · frummjan skoldun.
 Þan lag þár ôk an bëndjon · an þero burg innan
 5398 ên ruof rëgin-skaðo, · þie habda under þem ríke só filo
 morðes gi·rádan · ċndi man-slahta gi·frumid,
 5400 was mári mëgin-þiof: · ni was þár is gi·mako hwërgin;
 was þár ôk bi sínon · sundjon gi·hëftid,
 5402 Barrabas was hie hêtan; · hie after þem burgjon was
 þuru is mên-dádi · manogon gi·küðid.
 5404 Þan was land-wisa · liudjo Judeono,
 þat sia járo gi·hwen · an godes minnja
 5406 an þem hêlagon dage · ênna haftan mann
 a·biddjan skoldun, · þat im iro burges ward,
 5408 iro folk-togo · ferah far·gábi.
 Þuo bi·gan þie hêri-togo · þia hêri Judeono,

5410 þat folk frágojan, · þár sia im fora stuodun,
 hweðeron sia þero twejo · tuomjan weldin,
 5412 ferahes biddjan: · „þia hier an feteron sind
 haft undar þeson hēri-skipje?“ · Þiu hēri Judeono
 5414 habdun þuo þia arāmun man · alla gi-spanana,
 þat sia þemo land-skaðen · lif a-bádin,
 5416 gi·þingodin þem þioþe, · þie oft an þiustrja naht
 wam gi·warāhta, · ėndi waldand Krist
 5418 kwēlidin an krúkje. · Þuo warð þat kũð obar all,
 hwó þiu þiod habda duomos a·dēlid. · Þuo skoldun sia þia dád
 frummjan,
 5420 háhan þat hēlaga barn. · Þat warð þem hēri-togen
 sīðor te sorgon, · þat hie þia saka wissa,
 5422 þat sia þuru nīð-skipi · nērjendon Krist,
 hatoda þiu hēri, · ėndi hie im hōrda te þiu,
 5424 warāhta iro willjon: · þes hie wíti ant·féng,
 lōn an þeson liohte · ėndi lang after,
 5426 wói sīðor wann, · sīðor hie þesa wer-old a·gaf.

TODO.

Then it was made known to all,
 how that people had dealt out their judgments. Then they were to carry out
 that deed:
 to hang the Holy Child. TODO.

65 Þuo warð þas þie wrēðo gi·waro, · wam-skaðono mēst,
 5428 Satanas selþo, · þuo þiu seola kwam
 Judases an grund · grimmaro hēlljun—
 5430 þuo wissa hie te wāren, · þat þat was waldand Krist,
 barn drohtines, · þat þár gi·bundan stuod;
 5432 wissa þuo te wāron, · þat hie welda þesa wer-old alla
 mid is hēnginnja · hēllja gi·þwinges,
 5434 liudi a·lōsjan · an lioht godes.
 Þat was Satanasē · sēr an muode,
 5436 tulgo harm an is hugje: · welda is helpan þuo,
 þat im liudjo barn · lif ne bi·nāmin,
 5438 ne kwēlidin an krúkje, · ak hie welda, þat hie kwik libdi,
 te þiu þat firihō barn · fernes ne wurðin,
 5440 sundjono sikura. · Satanas gi·wēt im þuo,
 þár þes hēri-togen · hiwiski was

5442 an þero burg innan. · Hie þero is brúdi bi·gann,
 þera idis opan-líko · un-hiuri fiond
 5444 wundŕ tōgjan, · þat sia an word-helpon
 Kriste wári, · þat hie muosti kwik libbjan,
 5446 drohtin manno · —hie was iu þan te dōðe gi·skŕid—
 wissa þat te wáron, · þat hie im skoldi þia gi·wald bi·niman,
 5448 þat hie sia oþar þesan middil-gard · só mikila ni habdi,
 oþar wída wer-old. · Pat wíf warð þuo an for̆hton,
 5450 swíðo an sorogon, · þuo iru þiu gi·siuni kwámun
 þuru þes dŕnjen dád · an dages liohte,
 5452 an hēlið-helme bi·helid. · Þuo siu te iru hêrren an·bôd,
 þat wíf mid iro wordon · ĕndi im te wáren hiet
 5454 selbon seggjan, · hwat iro þár te gi·siunjon kwam
 þuru þena hêlagan mann, · ĕndi im helpen bad,
 5456 formon is ferhe: · „ik hēbbju hier só filo þuru ina
 seld·líkes gi·sewan, · só ik wêt, þat þia sundjun skulun
 5458 allaro erlo gi·hwem · ubilo gi·þīhan,
 só im fruokno tuo · fer̆hes áhtið.“
 5460 Þie segg warð þuo an siðe, · ant-tat hie sittjan fand
 þena hēri-togon · an hwarāþe innan
 5462 an þem stēn-wege, · þár þiu stráta was
 felison gi·fuogid. · Þár hie te is frōhon géng,
 5464 sagda im þes wíbes word. · Þuo warð im wrēð hugi,
 þem hēri-togen, · —hwarāþoda an innan—,
 5466 gi·blôðit briost-gi·þáht: · was im bêðjes wê,
 gie þat sea ina sluogin · sundja lôsan,
 5468 gie it bi þem liudjon þuo · for·látan ne gi·dorsta
 þuru þes werodes word. · Warð im gi·wēndid þuo
 5470 hugi an herten · after þero hēri Judeono,
 te werkjanne iro willjon: · ne wardoda im nie-wiht
 5472 þia swárun sundjun, · þia hie im þár þuo selbo gi·deda.
 Hiet im þuo te is handon dragan · hluttran brunnjon,
 5474 watar an wégje, · þár hie furi þem werode sat,
 þwóg ina þár for þero þioda · þegan kêsures,
 5476 hard hēri-togo · ĕndi þuo fur þero hêri sprak,
 kwað þat hie ina þero sundjono þár · sikoran dádi,
 5478 wrēðero werko: · „ne willju ik þes wihtes plegan“, kwaþ-hie,
 „umbi þesan hêlagan mann, · ak hleotad gí þes alles,
 5480 gie wordo gie werko, · þes gí im hér te wítje gi·duan.“

- 5482 Þuo hreop all saman · h̅eri-skipi Judeono,
 þiu mikila m̅e̅nigi, · kwáðun þat sia weldin umbi þena man
 plegan
 5484 d̅e̅raþoro dádjo: · „Fare is dr̅or obar ús,
 is bluod ̅en̅di is baneði · ̅en̅di obar úsa barn só samo,
 obar úsa a̅ba̅ron þár after · —wí willjat is alles plegan“,
 kwaðun sia,
 5486 „umbi þena sle̅gi selbon,— · ef wí þár ̅e̅niga sundja gi·duan!“
 A·geban warð þár þuo furi þem Judeon · allaro gumono b̅e̅sta
 5488 h̅e̅ttendjon an hand, · an heru-b̅e̅ndjon
 nar̅awo gi·n̅ôdid, · þár ina nið-hwata,
 5490 fi̅ond ant·f̅engun: · folk ina umbi·hwarf,
 m̅e̅n-skaðono m̅e̅gin. · Mahtig drohtin
 5492 þoloda gi·þuldjon, · só hwat só im þiu þi̅oda deda.
 Sia hietun ina þuo filljan, · ̅e̅r þan sia im fer̅a̅hes tuo,
 5494 aldres áhtin, · ̅en̅di im undar is ô̅gun spiwun,
 dedun im þat te hoske, · þat sia mid iro handon sl̅ôgun,
 5496 weros an is wangun · ̅en̅di im is gi·wádi bi·námun,
 r̅ô̅bodun ina þia r̅e̅gin-skaðon, · r̅ô̅des lakanes
 5498 dedun im eft ô̅ðer an · þuru un-huldi;
 hietun þuo h̅ô̅bid-band · hardaro þorno
 5500 wundron windan · ̅en̅di an waldand Krist
 selbon s̅e̅ttjan, · ̅en̅di géngun im þia gi·si̅ðos tuo,
 5502 kw̅e̅ddun ina an kuning-wísu · ̅en̅di þár an knio fellun,
 hnigun im mid iro h̅ô̅bdu: · all was im þat te hoske gi·duan,
 5504 þoh hie it all gi·þolodi, · þi̅odo drohtin,
 mahtig þuru þia minnja · manno kunnjes.
 5506 Hietun sia þuo wirkjan · wápn̅es ̅e̅ggjon
 h̅e̅liðos mid iro handon · hardes b̅ô̅mes
 5508 kraftiga kr̅úki · ̅en̅di hietun sia Kristan þuo,
 sálig barn godes · selbon fuorjan,
 5510 dragan hietun sia úsan drohtin, · þár hie be·dr̅ô̅ragad skolda
 sweltan sundjono l̅ô̅s. · Si̅ðodun Judeon,
 5512 weros an willon, · l̅e̅ddun waldand Krist,
 drohtin te d̅ô̅ðe. · Þár mohta man þuo der̅e̅þi þing
 5514 harm-lík gi·h̅ôrjan: · hiobandi þár after
 géngun wí̅f mid wópu, · weros gnornodun,
 5516 þia fan Galilea mid im · gangan kwámun,
 folgodun obar ferr-wegos: · was im iro fr̅ô̅hon d̅ô̅ð

5518 swiðo an soragan. · Þuo hie selbo sprak,
 barno þat beṣta · ɛndi under bak be-sah,
 5520 hiet þat sia ni wépin: · „ni þarf iu wiht tregan“, kwaṑ-hie,
 „mínero hin-fêrdjo, · ak gí mid hofnu mugun
 5522 iuwa wrêðan werk · wópu kúmjan,
 tornon trahnon. · Noh wirðið þiu tíð kuman,
 5524 þat þia muoder þes · mēðendja sind,
 brúdi Judeono, · þem gio barn ni warð
 5526 ôðan an aldre. · Þan gí iuwa in-wid skulun
 grimmo an-geldan; · þan gí só gerna sind,
 5528 þat iu hier bi-hlidan · hôha bergos,
 diopo be-delban; · dôð wári iu þan allon
 5530 liobera an þeson lande · þan su-lík liudjo kwalm
 te gi·þoljanne, · só hier þan þesaro þioda kumid.“

TODO.

5532 **66** Þuo sia þár an griete · galgon rihtun,
 an þem felde uppan · folk Judeono,
 5534 bôm an berege, · ɛndi þár an þat barn godes
 kwêlidun an krúkje: · slógun kald isarn,
 5536 niuwa naglos · níðon skarpa
 hardo mid hamuron · þuru is hēndi ɛndi þuru is fuoti,
 5538 bittra beṅdi: · is blód ran an erða,
 drôr fan úson drohtine. · Hie ni welda þoh þia dád wrekan
 5540 grimma an þem Judeon, · ak hie þes god fader
 mahtigna bad, · þat hie ni wári þem manno folke,
 5542 þem werode þiu wrêðra: · „hwand sia ni witun, hwat sia
 duot“, kwaṑ-hie.
 Þuo þia wíganos · gi·wádi Kristes,
 5544 drohtines dêldun, · deṛeṑja mann,
 þes riken gi·rôbi. · Þia rinkos ni mahtun
 5546 umbi þena selbon [...] · sam-wurdi gi·sprekan,
 êr sia an iro hwaræbe · hlôtos wurpun,
 5548 hwi-lík iro skoldi heṑbbjan · þia hêlagun pêda,
 allaro gi·wádjo wun-samost. · Þes werodes hirdi
 5550 hiet þuo, þe heṛi-togo, · obar þem hôbde selbes
 Kristes an krúke skríban, · þat þat wári kuning Judeono,
 5552 Jesus fan Nazareth-burh, · þie þár neḡlid stuod
 an niuwon galgon · þuru níð-skipi,

- 5554 an bômin treo. · Þuo bádun þia liudi
 þat word wëndjan, · kwáðun þat hie im só an is willjon spráki,
 5556 selbo sagdi, · þat hie habdi þes gi·sīðes gi·wald,
 kuning wári obar Judeon. · Þuo sprak eft þie kēsures bodo,
 5558 hard hēri-togo: · „it ist iu só obar is hōbde gi·skriban,
 wís-liko gi·writan, · só ik it nú wëndjan ni mag.“
 5560 Dádun þuo þár te wítje · werod Judeono
 twêna fār-talda man · an twá halba
 5562 Kristes an krúki: · lietun sia kwalm þolon
 an þem warag-trewe · werko te lône,
 5564 lêðaro dádjo. · Þia liudi sprákun
 hosk-word manag · hêlagon Kriste,
 5566 grottun ina mid gelpu: · sáwun allaro gumono þen bēston
 kwêlan an þemo krúkje: · „ef þú síš kuning obar all“, kwáðun
 sia,
 5568 „suno drohtines, · só þú hábis selbo gi·sprokan,
 nēri þik fan þero nōdi · ęndi níðes a·tuomi,
 5570 gang þi hêl herod; · þan welljat an þik hēliðo barn,
 þesa liudi gi·lōþjan.“ · Sum imo ôk lastar sprak
 5572 swíðo gêl-hert Judeo, · þár hie fur þem galgon stuod:
 „Wah warð þesaro wer-oldi“, (kwaþ-hie,) „ef þú iro skoldis
 gi·wald êgan.
 5574 Þú sagdas þat þú mahtis an ênon dage · all te·werpan
 þat hōha hús · heban-kuninges,
 5576 stên-werko mêst · ęndi eft standan gi·duon
 an þriddjon dage, · só is ęlkor ni þorftri bi·þiðhan mann
 5578 þeses folkes furðor. · Sínu hwó þú nú gi·fastnod stés,
 swíðo gi·sêrid: · ni maht þi selbon wiht
 5580 balowes gi·buotjan.“ · Þuo þár ôk an þem bęndjon sprak
 þero þeobo ôðer, · all só hie þia þioda gi·hōrda,
 5582 wrêðon wordon · —ne was is willjo guod,
 þes þegnes gi·þáht—: · „ef þú síš þiod-kuning“, kwaþ-hie,
 5584 „Krist, godes suno, · gang þi þan fan þem krúke niðer,
 slópi þi fan þem símon · ęndi ùs samad allon
 5586 hilp ęndi hêli. · Ef þú síš heban-kuning,
 waldand þesaro wer-oldes, · gi·duo it þan an þínon werkon
 skín,
 5588 mári þik fur þesaro męnigi.“ · Þuo sprak þero manno ôðer
 an þero hęnginna, · þár hie gi·hęftid stuod,

5590 wan wunder-kwála: · „Be·hwí wilt þú su·lík word sprekan,
 gruotis ina mid gelpu? · Stés þí hier an galgen haft,
 5592 gi·brokan an bôme. · Wit hier bêðja þolod
 sêr þuru unka sundjun: · is unk unkero selbero dád
 5594 worðan te witje. · Hie stéd hier wammes lôs,
 allaro sundjono sikur, · só hie selbo gio
 5596 firina ni gi·frumida, · botan þat hie þuru þeses folkes nið
 willendi an þesaro wer·uldi · wíti ant·fahid.
 5598 Ik willju þár gi·lôbjan tuo“, (kwaþ·hie,) „endi willju þena landes
 ward,
 þena godes suno · gerno biddjan,
 5600 þat þú mín gi·huggjes · endi an helpun sís,
 rádendero bêt, · þan þú an þín ríki kumis:
 5602 wes mi þan gi·náðig.“ · Þuo sprak im eft nêrjendo Krist
 wordon te·gegnes: · „Ik seggju þí te wáron hier“, kwaþ·hie,
 5604 „þat þú noh hiu·du móst · an himil·ríke
 mid mí samad · sehan lioht godes,
 5606 an þemo Paradyse, · þoh þú nú an su·líkoro pínu sís.“
 Þan stuod þár ôk Maria, · muoder Kristes,
 5608 blêk under þem bôme, · gi·sah iro barn þolon,
 winnan wunder-kwála. · Ôk wárun þár wif mid iro
 5610 an só mahtiges · minnja kumana—
 þan stuod þár ôk Johannes, · jungro Kristes,
 5612 hriwi undar is hêrren, · was im is hugi sêrag—
 drúbodun fur þem dôðe. · Þár sprak drohtin Krist
 5614 mahtig te þero muoder: · „nú ik þí hier mínemo skal
 jungron be·felhan, · þem þí hier gegin·ward stéd:
 5616 wis þí an is gi·siðje samad: · þú skalt ina furi suno hêbbjan.“
 Grótta hie þuo Johannes, · hiet þat hie iru ful·gengi wel,
 5618 minnjodi sia só mildo, · só man is muoder skal,
 idis un·wamma. · Þuo hie sia an is êra ant·fêng
 5620 þuru hluttran hugi, · só im is hêrro gi·bôd.

TODO.

67 Þuo warð þár an middjan dag · mahtig têkan,
 5622 wundar·lík gi·warəht · oðar þesan wer·old allan,
 þuo man þena godes suno · an þena galgon huof,
 5624 Krist an þat krúki: · þuo warð it kúð oðar all,
 hwó þiu sunna warð gi·sworcan: · ni mahta swigli lioht

- 5626 skôni gi·skínan, · ak sia skado far·féng,
 þimm çndi þiustri · çndi só gi·þrusmod nebal.
 5628 Warð allaro dago druobost, · dunkar swiðo
 oþar þesan wíðun wer·uld, · só lango só waldand Krist
 5630 kwal an þemo krúkje, · kuningo ríkost,
 ant nuon dages. · Þuo þie nebal ti·skréð,
 5632 þat gi·swerk warð þuo te·swungan, · bi·gan sunnun lioht
 hêðron an himile. · Þuo hreop up te gode
 5634 allaro kuningo kraftigost, · þuo hie an þemo krúkje stuod
 faðmon gi·fastnot: · „fader alo·mahtig“, kwaþ·hie,
 5636 „te hwí þú mik só far·lieti, · liebo drohtin,
 hêlag heban·kuning, · çndi þína helpa dedos,
 5638 fullisti só ferr? · Ik standu under þeson fiondon hier
 wundron gi·wêgid.“ · Werod Judeono
 5640 hlógun is im þuo te hoske: · gi·hórdun þena hêlagun Krist,
 drohtin furi þem dôðe · drinkan biddjan,
 5642 kwað þat ina þurstidi. · Þiu þioda ne latta,
 wrêða wiðar·sakon: · was im willjo mikil,
 5644 hwat sia im bittres tuo · bringan mahtin.
 Habdun im un·swóti · çkid çndi galla
 5646 gi·mængid þia mên·hwaton; · stuod ên mann garo,
 swiðo skuldig skaðo, · þena habdun sia gi·skçrid te þiu,
 5648 far·spanan mid sprákon, · þat hie sia en êna spunsja nam,
 liðo þes lêðosten, · druog it an ênon langan skafte,
 5650 gi·bundan an ênon bôme · çndi deda it þem barne godes,
 mahtigon te müðe. · Hie an·kçnda iro mirkjun dádi,
 5652 gi·fuolda iro fégnas: · furðor ni welda
 is só bittres an·bítan, · ak hreop þat barn godes
 5654 hlúdo te þem himiliskon fader: · „ik an þína hçndi be·filhu“,
 kwaþ·hie,
 „mínon gçst an godes willjon; · hie ist nú garo te þiu,
 5656 fús te faranne.“ · Firiho drohtin
 gi·hnêgida þuo is hôðid, · hêlagon áðom
 5658 liet fan þemo lík·hamen. · Só þuo þie landes ward
 swalt an þem símon, · só warð sán after þiu
 5660 wundar·têkan gi·waráht, · þat þár waldandes dôð
 un·kweðandes só filo · ant·kçnnjan skolda,
 5662 þiadnes ên·dagon: · erða biboda,
 hrisidun þia hôhun bergos, · harda stênos klúbun,

5664 felisos after þem felde, · ęndi þat fêha lakan te·brast
 an middjon an twê, · þat êr managan dag
 5666 an þemo wihe innan · wundron gi·striunid
 hêl hangoda · —ni muostun hêlîðo barn,
 5668 þia liudi skawon, · hwat under þemo lakane was
 hêlages be·hangan: · þuo mohtun an þat horð sehan
 5670 Judeo liudi— · grabu wurðun gi·opanol
 dôðero manno, · ęndi sia þuru drohtines kraft
 5672 an iro lík-hamon · libbjandi a·stuodun
 up fan erðu · ęndi wurðun gi·ôgida þár
 5674 mannon te mârðu. · Þat was só mahtig þing,
 þat þár Kristes dôð · ant·kennjan skoldun,
 5676 só filo þes gi·fuoljan, · þie gio mid firihon ne sprak
 word an þesaro wer-oldi. · Werod Judeono
 5678 sáwun seld-lík þing, · ak was im iro slíði hugi
 só far·hardod an iro herten, · þat þár io só hêlag ni warð
 5680 têkan gi·tôgid, · þat sia trúodin þiu bat
 an þia Kristes kraft, · þat hie kuning obar all,
 5682 þes werodes wári. · Suma sia þár mid iro wordon gi·sprákon,
 þia þes hrêwes þár · huodjan skoldun,
 5684 þat þat wári te wáren · waldandes suno,
 godes gegnungo, · þat þár an þem galgon swalt,
 5686 barno þat bęsta. · Slógun an iro briost filo
 wópjandero wíbo: · was im þiu wundęr-kwála
 5688 harm an iro herten · ęndi iro hêrren dôð
 swíðo an sorogon. · Þan was sido Judeono,
 5690 þat sia þia haftun þuru þena hêlagon dag · hangon ni lietin
 lęngerun hwíla, · þan im þat líf skriði,
 5692 þiu seola be·sunki: · slíð-muoda mann
 géngun im mid níð-skipju náhor, · þár só be·nęglida stuodun
 5694 þeobos twêna, · þolodun bêðja
 kwála bi Kriste: · wárun im kwika noh þan,
 5696 unt·þat sia þia grimmun · Judeo liudi
 bēnon be·brákon, · þat sia bēðja samad
 5698 líf far·lietun, · suohtun im lioht ôðer.
 Sia ni þorftun drohtin Krist · dôðes bēdjan
 5700 furðor mid ênigon firinon: · fundun ina gi·faranan þuo iu:
 is seola was gi·sęndid · an suôðan weg,
 5702 an lang-sam lioht, · is líði kuolodun;

5704 þat ferah was af þem flêske. · Þuo géng im ên þero fiondo tuo
 an níð-hugi, · druog nêgilid sper
 5706 hard an is handon, · mid heru-þrummjón stak,
 liet wápnes ord · wundum sníðan,
 þat an selbes warð · sídu Kristes
 5708 ant-lokan is lík-hamo. · Þia liudi gi-sáwun,
 þat þanan bluod êndi water · bêðju sprungun,
 5710 wellun fan þero wundun, · all só is willjo géng
 êndi hie habda gi-markod êr · manno kunnje,
 5712 firiho barnon te frumu: · þuo was it all gi-fullid só.

TODO.

68 Só þuo gi-sêgid warð · sedle náhor
 5714 hêdra sunna · mid heban-tunglón
 an þem druoben dage, · þuo géng im úses drohtines þegan
 5716 —was im glau gumo, · jungro Kristes
 managa hwíla, · só it þár manno filo
 5718 ne wissa te wáron, · hwand hie it mid is wordon hal
 Judeono gum-skipje: · Joseph was hie hêtan,
 5720 darnungo was hie úses drohtines jungro: · hie ni welda þero
 far-duanun þiod
 folgon te ênigon firin-werkon, · ak hie béd im under þem
 folke Judeono,
 5722 hêlag himilo ríkjes— · hie géng im þuo wið þena hêri-togon
 mahljan,
 þingon wið þena þegan kêsures, · þigida ina gerno,
 5724 þat hie muosti a-lôsjan · þena lík-hamon
 Kristes fan þemo krúkje, · þie þár gi-kwêlmid stuod,
 5726 þes guoden fan þem galgen · êndi an graf leggjan,
 foldu bi-felahan. · Im ni welda þie folk-togo þuo
 5728 wernjan þes willjen, · ak im gi-wald far-gaf,
 þat hie só muosti gi-frummjan. · Hie gi-wêt im þuo forð
 þanan
 5730 gangan te þem galgon, · þár hie wissa þat godes barn,
 hrêo hangondi · hêrren sínes,
 5732 nam ina þuo an þero niuwun ruodun · êndi ina fan naglón
 a-tuomda,
 ant-féng ina mid is faðmon, · só man is frôhon skal,
 5734 liobes lík-hamon, · êndi ina an líne bi-wand,

druog ina diur-liko · —só was þie drohtin werð—,
 5736 þár sia þia stēdi habdun · an ênon stêne innan
 handon gi·hauwan, · þár gio hēliðo barn
 5738 gumon ne bi·gruobon. · Þár sia þat godes barn
 te iro land-wisu, · liko hēlgost
 5740 foldu bi·fulhun · ėndi mid ênu felisu be·lukun
 allaro grabo guod-likost. · Griotandi sātun
 5742 idisi arm-skapana, · þia þat all for·sāwun,
 þes gumen grimman dōð. · Gi·witun im þuo gangan þanan
 5744 wópjandi wíf · ėndi wara námun,
 hwó sia eft te þem grabe · gangan mahtin:
 5746 habdun im far·sewana · soroga gi·nuogja,
 mikila muod-kara: · Maria wārun sia hētana,
 5748 idisi arm-skapana. · Þuo warð áband kuman,
 naht mid neffu. · Nīð-folk Judeono
 5750 warð an moragan eft, · mēnigi gi·samnod,
 rēkidun an rúnōn: · „Hwat þú wēst, hwó þit rīki was
 5752 þuru þesan ênan man · all gi·twíflid,
 werod gi·worran: · nú ligid hie wundon siok,
 5754 diopa bi·dolban. · Hie sagda simnen, þat hie skoldi fan dōðe
 a·standan
 an þriddjan dage. · Þius þiod gi·lōbit te filo,
 5756 þit werod after is wordon. · Nú þú hier wardon hét,
 obar þem grabe gōmjan, · þat ina is jungron þár
 5758 ne far·stelan an þemo stêne · ėndi seggjan þan, þat hie
 a·standan sí,
 rīki fan raston: · þan wirðit þit rinko folk
 5760 mēr gi·mērrid, · ef sia it bi·ginnat mārjan hier.“
 Þuo wurðun þár gi·skērida · fan þero skolu Judeono
 5762 weros te þero wahtu: · gi·witun im mid iro gi·wāpnjon þarod
 te þem grabe gangan, · þár sia skoldun þes godes barnes
 5764 hrēwes huodjan. · Warð þie hēlago dag
 Judeono far·gangan. · Sia obar þemo grabe sātun,
 5766 weros an þero wahtun · wannom nahton,
 bidun undar iro bordon, · hwan êr þie berēhto dag
 5768 obar middil-gard · mannon kwāmi,
 liudon te liohte. · Þuo ni was lang te þiu,
 5770 þat þár warð þie gēst kuman · be godes krafte,
 hālag áðom · undar þena hardon stēn

5772 an þena lík-hamon. · Lioht was þuo gi-opanod
 friho barnon te frumu: · was ferkal manag
 5774 ant-heftid fan hełł-doron · ęndi te himile weg
 gi-waraht fan þesaro wer-oldi. · Wánom up a-stuod
 5776 friðu-barn godes, · fuor im þuo þár hie welda,
 só þia wardos þes · wiht ni af-swobun,
 5778 dęrbja liudi, · hwan hie fan þem dōðe a-stuod,
 a-rēs fan þero rastun. · Rinkos sátun
 5780 umbi þat graf útan, · Judeo liudi,
 skola mid iro skildjon. · Skrêd forð-wardes
 5782 swigli sunnun lioht. · Sīðodun idisi
 te þem grabe gangan, · gum-kunnjes wif,
 5784 Mariun muni-lika: · habdun mēðmo filo
 gi-sald wiðer salbum, · silūbres ęndi goldes,
 5786 werðes wiðer wurtjon, · só sia mahtun a-winnan mēst,
 þat sia þena lík-hamon · liobes hērren,
 5788 suno drohtines, · salbon muostin,
 wundun writanan. · Þiu wif sorāgodun
 5790 an iro sebon swīðo, · ęndi suma sprákun,
 hwie im þena grôtan stên · fan þemo grabe skoldi
 5792 gi-hwęřþjan an halba, · þe sia obar þat hrêo sáwun
 þia liudi lęggjan, · þuo sia þena lík-hamon þár
 5794 be-fulhun an þemo felise. · Só þiu frí habdun
 ge-gangan te þem gardon, · þat sia te þem grabe mahtun
 5796 gi-sehan selbon, · þuo þár swógan kwam
 ęngil þes alo-waldon · obana fan radure,
 5798 faran an feðer-hamon, · þat all þiu folda an skian,
 þiu erða dunida · ęndi þia erlos wurðun
 5800 an wêkan hugje, · wardos Juðeono,
 bi-fellun bi þem forahton: · ne wándun ira ferah ęgan,
 5802^a lif langerun hwil.

TODO.

5802^b 69 Lágun þá wardos,
 þia gi-sīðos sām-kwika: · sán up a-hlād
 5804 þie grôto stên fan þem grabe, · só ina þie godes ęngil
 gi-hwęřþida an halba, · ęndi im uppan þem hlêwe gi-sat
 5806 diur-lík drohtines bodo. · Hie was an is dādjon ge-lík,

an is an-siunjon, · só hwem só ina muosta undar is ôgon
 skawon,
 5808 só berêht êndi só blîdi · all só bliksmun lioht;
 was im is gi-wádi · wintar-kaldon
 5810 snêwe gi-líkost. · Þuo sáwun sia ina sittjan þár,
 þiu wíf uppan þem gi-wëndidan stêne, · êndi im fan þem
 wlitje kwámun,
 5812 þem idison su-líka egison te·gegnes: · all wurðun fan þem
 grurje
 þiu frí an forahton mikilon, · furðor ne gi·dorstun
 5814 te þemo grabe gangan, · êr sia þie godes engil,
 waldandes bodo · wordon gruotta,
 5816 kwað þat hie iro ârundi · all bi·kunsti,
 werk êndi willjon · êndi þero wíbo hugi,
 5818 hiet þat sia im ne an·drédin: · „ik wêt þat gí iuwan drohtin
 suokat,
 nerjendon Krist · fan Nazareth-burg,
 5820 þena þi hier kwêlidun · êndi an krúki slógun
 Judeo liudi · êndi an graf lagdun
 5822 sundi-lôsjan. · Nú nist hie selbo hier,
 ak hie ist a·standan iu, · êndi sind þesa stêdi lárja,
 5824 þit graf an þeson griote. · Nú mugun gí gangan herod
 náhor mikilu · —ik wêt þat is iu ist niud sehan
 5826 an þeson stêne innan—: · hier sind noh þia stêdi skína,
 þár is lík-hamo lag.“ · Lungra féngun
 5828 gi·bada an iro brioston · blêka idisi,
 wlití-skôni wíf: · was im wil-spell mikil
 5830 te gi·hôrjanne, · þat im fan iro hêrren sagda
 engil þes alo-walden. · Hiet sia eft þanan
 5832 fan þem grabe gangan êndi faran · te þem jungron Kristes,
 sêggjan þem is gi·siðon · suoðon wordon,
 5834 þat iro drohtin was · fan dôðe a·standan.
 Hiet ôk an sundron · Símon Petrus
 5836 will-spell mikil · wordon kúðjan,
 kumi drohtines, · gie þat Krist selbo
 5838 was an Galileo land, · „þár ina eft is jungron skulun,
 gi·sehan is gi·siðos, · só hie im êr selbo gi·sprak
 5840 wárom wordon.“ · Reht só þuo þiu wíf þanan
 gangan weldun, · só stuodun im te·gegnes þár

5842 ɛngilos twêna · an ala-hwiton
 wánamon gi·wádjom · ɛndi sprákun im mid iro wordon tuo
 5844 hêlag-líko: · hugi warð gi·blôðid
 þen idison an ɛgison: · ne mahtun an þia ɛngilos godes
 5846 bi þemo wlite skawon: · was im þiu wánami te strang,
 te swiði te sehanne. · Þuo sprákun im sán an·gegin
 5848 waldandes bodun · ɛndi þiu wif frágodun,
 te hwí sia Kristan þarod · kwikan mid dôdon,
 5850 suno drohtines · suokjan kwámin
 ferahes fullan; · „nú gí ina ni findat hier
 5852 an þeson stên-grabe, · ak hie ist a·standan nú
 an is lík-hamon: · þes gí gi·lôbjan skulun
 5854 ɛndi gi·huggjan þero wordo, · þe hie iu te wáron oft
 selbo sagda, · þan hie an iuwon ge·siðja was
 5856 an Galilea-lande, · hwó hie skoldi gi·geban werðan,
 gi·sald selbo · an sundigaro manno,
 5858 hettjandero hand, · hêlag drohtin,
 þat sea ina kwêlidin · ɛndi an krúki slógin,
 5860 dôdan gi·dádin · ɛndi þat hie skoldi þuruh drohtines kraft
 an þridjon dage · þioda te willjan
 5862 libbjandi a·standan. · Nú habat hie all gi·lêstid só,
 ge·frumid mid firihon: · íljat gí nú forð hinan,
 5864 gangat gáh-líko · ɛndi duot it þem is jungron küð.

TODO.

5847 im sán | so C; om. L

70 Hie habat sia iu fur·farana · ɛndi ist im forð hinan
 5866 an Galileo land, · þár ina eft is jungron skulun,
 gi·sehan is ge·siðos.“ · Þuo warð sán after þiu
 5868 þem wíbon an willjon, · þat sia gi·hórdun su·lík word sprekan,
 küðjan þia kraft godes · —wárun im só a·kumana þuo noh
 5870 gie só forahra ge·frumida—: · gi·witun im forð þanan
 fan þem grabe gangan · ɛndi sagdun þem jungron Kristes
 5872 seld-lík gi·siuni, · þár sia sorogondi
 bidun su·líkero buota. · Þuo wurðun ôk an þia burg kumana
 5874 Judeono wardos, · þia ôbar þemo grabe sátun
 alla langa naht · ɛndi þes lík-hamen þár,
 5876 huodun þes hrêwes. · Sia sagdun þero hêri Judeono,
 hwi-líka im þár and-warda · ɛgison kwámun,

5878 seld-lík gi·siuni, · sagdun mid wordon,
 al só it gi·duan was · an þero drohtines kraft,
 5880 ni miðun an iro muode. · Þuo budun im mēðmo filo
 Judeo liudi, · gold ėndi siluþar,
 5882 saldun im sink manag, · te þiu þat sia it ni sagdin forð,
 ne máridin þero mēnigi: · „ak kweðat þat iu móði hugi
 5884 an·swebidi mid slápu · ėndi þat þár kwámin is gi·siðos tuo,
 far·stálin ina an þem stēne. · Simnen wesat gí an stride mid
 þiu,
 5886 forð an flíte: · ef it wirðit þem folk-togen kũð,
 wí gi·helpat iu wið þena hērosten, · þat hie iu harmes wiht,
 5888 lēðes ni gi·lêstid.“ · Þuo námun sia an þem liudon filo
 diurero mēðmo, · dádun all só sia bi·gunnun
 5890 —ne gi·weldun iro willjon— · dádun só wído kũð
 þem liudon after þem lande, · þat sia su-líka lugina woldun
 5892 a·hēbbjan be þan hêlagan drohtin. · Þan was eft gi·hêlid hugi
 jungron Kristes, · þuo sia gi·hōrdun þiu guodun wíf
 5894 márjan þia maht godes; · þuo wárun sia an iro muode fráha,
 gie im te þem grabe bēðja, · Johannes ėndi Petrus
 5896 runnun obast-líko: · warð êr kuman
 Johannes þie guodo, · ėndi im obar þem grabe gi·stuod,
 5898 ant-at þár sán after kwam · Símon Petrus,
 erl ęllan-ruof · ėndi im þár in gi·wêt
 5900 an þat graf gangan: · gi·sah þár þes godes barnes,
 hrêo-gi·wádi · hêrren sines
 5902 línin liggjan, · mid þiu was êr þie lík-hamo
 fagaro bi·fangan; · lag þie fano sundar,
 5904 mit þem was þat hōbid bi·helid · hêlages Kristes,
 ríkjes drohtines, · þan hie an þesaro rastu was.
 5906 Þuo géng im ôk Johannes · an þat graf innan
 sehan seld-lík þing; · warð im sán after þiu
 5908 ant·lokan is gi·lôbo, · þat hie wissa, þat skolda eft an þit lioht
 kuman
 is drohtin diur-líko, · fan dôðe a·standan
 5910 up fan erðu. · Þuo gi·witun im eft þanan
 Johannes ėndi Petrus, · ėndi kwámun þia jungron Kristes,
 5912 þia gi·siðos te·samne. · Þan stuod sêrag-muod
 ên þera idiso · ôðer-siðu
 5914 griotandi obar þem grabe, · was iro jámar muod—

- 5916 Maria was þat Magdalena—, · was iro muod-gi·þäht,
 sebo mit sorogon gi·blandan, · ne wissa hwárod siu sókjan
 skolda
 þena hêrron, þár iro wárun at þia helpa gi·langa. · Siu ni
 mohta þuo hofnu a·wisan,
 5918 þat wíf ni mahta wóp for·látan: · ne wissa hwárod siu sia
 wëndjan skolda;
 gi·merrid wárun iro þes muod-gi·þähti. · Þuo gi·sah siu þena
 mahtigan þár
 5920 *Kriste standan*, · þuoh siu ina küð·líko
 ant·kennjan ni mohti, · êr þan hie ina küðjan welda,
 seggjan þat hie it selbo wári. · Hie frágoda hwat siu só sêro
 bi·wiepi,
 5922 só harmo mid hêton trahnin. · Siu kwað, þat siu umbi iro
 hêrron ni wissi
 te wáren, hwárod hie werðan skoldi: · „ef þú ina mí gi·wisan
 mohtis,
 5924 frô mín, ef ik þik frágon gi·dorsti, · ef þú ina hier an þeson
 felise gi·námis,
 wísi ina mí mid wordon þínon: · þan wári mí allaro willjono
 mēsta,
 5926 þat ik ina selbo gi·sáhi.“ · Sia ni wissa, þat sia þie suno
 drohtines
 gruotta mid gódaro sprákun: · siu wánda þat it þie gardari
 wári,
 5928 hof·ward hêrron sines. · Þuo gruotta sia þie hêlago drohtin,
 bi namen nêrjendero bēst: · siu géng im þuo náhor sniumo,
 5930 þat wíf mid willjon guodan, · ant·kēnda iro waldand selban,
 mīðan siu is þuru þia minnja ni wissa: · welda ina mid iro
 mundon grípan,
 5932 þiu fêhmja an þena folko drohtin, · noþan þat iro friðu·barn
 godes
 wērida mid wordon sínon, · kwað þat siu ina mid wihti ni
 mósti
 5934 handon ant·hrínan: · „ik ni stêg noh“, kwaþ·hie, „te þem
 himiliskon fader;
 ak íli þú nú ofst·líko · ėndi þem erlon küði,
 5936 bruoðron mínon, · þat ik úser bēðero fader
 ala·waldan, · iuwan ėndi mínan

5938 suóð-fastan god · suokjan willju.“

TODO.

5867 sán | so L; om. C 5920' Kriste ... welda | Numbering follows Sievers (1878), who takes standan as part of 5919b and sees 5920 and 5920' as one line. 5920 Kriste standan | metr. emend.; rev. C

71 Þat wíf warð þuo an wunnon, · þat siu muosta su-líkan willjon
kūðjan,
5940 seggjjan fan im gi·sundon: · warð sán garo
þiu iðis an þat ârundi · êndi þem erlon bráhta,
5942 will-spel weron, · þat siu waldand Krist
gi·sundan gi·sáwi, · êndi sagda hwó hé iru selbo gi·bôð
5944 torðtero tēkno. · Sia ni weldun gi·trúojan þuo noh
þes wíbes wordon, · þat siu su-lík will-spel bráhte
5946 gegnungo fan þemo godes suno, · ak sia sátun im
jámor-muoda,
hēliðos hriuwonda. · Þuo warð þie hēlago Krist
5948 eft opan-líko · ôðer-siðu,
drohtin gi·tôgid, · siðor hie fan dôðe a·stuod,
5950 þan wíbon an willjon, · þat hie im þár an wege muotta.
kwēdda sia kūð-líko, · êndi sia te is kneohon hnigun,
5952 fellun im tó fuoton. · Hie hét þat sia foráhtan hugi
ne bárin an iro brioston: · „ak gí mínon bruoðron skulun
5954 þesa kwidi kūðjan, · þat sia kuman after mí
an Galileo land; · þár ik im eft te·gegnes biun.“
5956 Þan fuorun im ôk fan Jerusalem · þero jungrono twēna
an þem selbon daga · sán an morgán,
5958 erlos an iro ârundi: · weldun im te Emaus
þat kastel suokan. · Þuo bi·gunnun im kwidi managa
5960 under þem weron wahsan, · þár sia after þem wege fuorun,
þem hēliðon umbi iro hêrron. · Þuo kwam im þár þie hēlago
tuo
5962 gangandi godes suno. · Sia ni mahtun ina garo-líko
ant·kennan kraftigna: · hie ni welda ina þuo noh kūðjan te im;
5964 was im þoh an iro gi·siðje samad · êndi frágoda, umbi
hwi-líka sia saka sprákin:
„hwi gangat gí só gornondja?“ (kwaþ-hie); „Ist ink jámer hugi,
5966 sebo soragono full.“ · Sia sprákun im sán an·geggin,
þia erlos and-wurdi: · „te hwi þú þes êskos só“, kwáðun sia;

5968 „bist þí fan Jerusalem · Judeono folkas
[...]"

TODO.

5970 „[...] hêlagumu gêste · fan heþan-wange,
mid þem grôtun godes kraft.“ · Nam is jungaron þó,
5972 erlos góde, · lêdda sie út þanan,
ant-tat hé sie bráhte · an Bethanía;
þár hóf hé is hendi up · endi hêlegoda sie alle,
5974 wíhida sie mid is wordun. · Gi·wêt imo up þanan,
sóhta imo þat hôha himilo ríki · endi þena is hêlagon stól:
5976 sitit imo þár · an þea swíðron half godes,
alo-mahtiges fader · endi þanan all ge-sihit
5978 waldandjo Krist, · só hwat só þius wer-old be-habet.
Þó an þeru selþon stędi · ge-siðos góde
5980 te bedu fellun · endi im eft te burg þanan
þár te Jerusalem · jungaron Kristes
5982 fórun faganondi: · was im fráh-mód hugi,
wárun im þár at þemu wíthe. · Waldandes kraft
5984 [...]

TODO.

5969–5983 hêlagumu ... kraft | Only in *M*. 5969 hêlagumu gêste · fan heþan-wange | Partly scraped off, but still just about readable. 5984 [...] | Four lines are scraped off and entirely illegible in *M*.

Old Saxon Genesis

Dating: C9th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The normalization follows that adapted for *Heli*. There is only one ms., Palatinus latinus 1447 (V, https://digi.vatlib.it/view/MSS_Pal.lat.1447/0005), where the poem is found written on a few fragmentary pages between Latin theological texts. In this ms. a small fragment of the *Heli* is also found.

Much of the poem, including parts not extant in V, was closely translated into Old English and later inserted into an English poem on Genesis. The translation is called *Genesis B*, and will be edited below. Lines 1–26 of the present poem correspond almost exactly with lines 791–817 of that poem.

Text

After the Fall

- 1 „Wela, þat þú nú, Éwa, habas,“ (kwad Adam,) „uþilo gi·marȳkot [V 1r/TODO]
 2 unkaro selbaro sīd. · Nú maht þú sehan þia swarton heġl
 ginon grādaga; · nú þú sia grimman maht
 4 hinana gi·hōrjan, · nis heban-rīki
 ge·lih̄k sulikaro lōgnun: · þit was alloro lando skōnjust,
 6 þat wit hier þuruh unkas hērran þank · hebbjan muostun
 þār þú þem ni hōrdis · þie unk þesan harām gi·ried,
 8 þat wit waldandas · word far·brākun,
 heban-kuningas. · Nú wit hriwig mugon
 10 sorogon for þem sīda, · wand hé unk selbo gi·bōd,
 þat wit unk su·lik wīti · wardon skoldin,
 12 harāmo mēstan— · nú þwingit mī giu hungar endi þrust,
 bitter balo-werēk, · þero wáron wit ēr bêdero tuom.
 14 Hú skulun wit nu libbjan, · efto hú skulun wit an þesum
 liahta wesan?
 Nú hier hwílum wind kumit · westan efto ôstan,
 16 sūðan efto nordan? · gi·swerēk upp drībit,
 kumit hagas skion · himile bi·tengi,
 18 fērid ford an gi·mang · (þat is firinum kald):
 hwílum þanne fan himile · hēto skínit,
 20 blíkit þiu berāhto sunna: · wit hier þus bara standat,
 un·wērid mid gi·wādi: · nis unk hier wiht bi·foran
 22 ni te skadowa ni te skúra, · unk nis hier skattas wiht
 te mēti gi·markot: · wit hebbjat unk gi·duan mahtigna god,
 24 waldand wrēdan. · Te hwí skulun wit werdán nu?
 Nu mag mī þat hreuwán, · þat ik is io bad heban-ríkjan god,
 26 waldand þ[...]

TODO.

 2 sehan | sean V 10 unk | hunk V 11 unk | hunk V

26 waldand þ[...]. The bottom part of V 1r has been trimmed, resulting in the loss of a few lines. For the continuation cf. *Genesis B* 817 ff., which translates this and the following lines.

After Cain's slaying of Abel

2 2 Sīdoda im þuo te sēlidon; · habda im sundja gi-waraht
bittra an is bruodar; · liet ina undar baka liggjan
an ênam diapun dala · drôr-wóragana,
4 líbas lôsan, · legar-bedd waran,
guman an griata. · Þuo sprak im god selbo tuo,
6 waldand mid is wordun · (was im wrêd an is hugi,
þem banan gi·bolgan), · frágoda hwar he habdi is bródar þuo
8 kind-jungan guman. · Þó sprak im eft Kain an·gegen
-habda im mid is handun · haraṃ-wereḡ mikil
10 wam-dádjun gi·waraht, · þius werold was só swído
be·smitan an sundjun-: · „Ni ik þes sorogun ni skal,“ kwad he,
12 „gômjan hwar hie ganga, · ni it mi god ni gi·bôd,
þat is hwērgin hier · huodjan þorofiti,
14 wardon an þesaro weroldi.“ · Wánde he swído,
þat he bi·helan mahti · hêrran sínum,
16 þia dádi bi·dērnjan. · Þuo sprak im eft ūsa drohtin tuo:
„All habas þu só gi·wereḡot,“ (kwad he,) „só þi ti þínaro wer-oldi
mag
18 wesan þín hugi hriuwig, · þes þu mid þínum handon gi·dedos,
þat þú wurdi þínes bruodar bano: · nu he bluodig ligit,
20 wundun wórig; · þes ni habda he êniga ge·wurūhte te þi,
sundja gi·suohta, · þoh þu ina nu a·slagan hēbbjas,
22 dōdan gi·duanan. · Is drôr sinkit nu an erda,
swêt sundar ligit; · þiu seola hwaroþat
24 þie gēst gǫ́amar-muod · an godas willjan;
drôr hruopit is te drohtina selbun · endi sagat hwe þea dádi
frumida,
26 þat mēn an þesun middil-gardun: · ni mag im ênig mann þan
swídor
wero far·wirīkjan · an werold-ríkja
28 an bittron balo-dádjon, · þan þú an þínum bruodar habas
firin-wereḡ gi·frēmid.“ · Þuo an forahtun ward
30 Kain aftar þem kwidjun drohtinas, · kwad þat hie wisse garwo,
þat is ni mahti werdan waldand wiht, · an werold-stundu
32 dádjo bi·dērnid, · „só ik is nu mag drubundjan hugi,“ kwad he,
„beran an mínun breostun · þes ik mínan bruodar sluog
34 þuru mín hand-mēgin. · Nu wêt ik, þat ik skal an þínum hēti
libbjan,
ford an þínum fiund-skēpi, · nu ik mí þesa firina gi·deda,

- 36 só mí mína **sundja** nu · **swí**darón þunkjat,
 mis-dád **mêra**, · þan þín **mildi** hugi,
 38 só ik þes nu **wirdig** ni bium, · **waldand** þie guodo,
 þat þú mí a-látas · **lêdas** þingas,
 40 tianono a-tuemjas. · Nu ik ni welda mína **triuwa** haldan,
 hugi wid þem þínum **hlutron** muoda, · nu wêt ik, þat ik hier
 ni mag êniga **hwíla** libbjan,
 42 hwand mí ant-wirikit, · só hwat só mi an þisun **wega** findit,
 a-slêhit mi bi þesun **sundjun**.“ · Þuo sprak im eft **selbo**
 an-gëgin
 44 hebanes waldand: · „Hier skalt þu noh nu“, kwad he,
 „libbjan **lango** hwíla. · Þo þu sus a-lêdit sís,
 46 mid **fírinum** bi-fangan, · þoh will ik þi **friðu** settjan,
 tôgjan su-lik **têkjan**, · só þu an **treuwa** maht
 48 **wesan** an þesero **werolde**, · þoh þu is **wirdik** ni sís:
fluhtik skalt þu þoh endi **frêdig** · **ford**-wardas nu
 50 libbjan an þesum **landa**, · só **lango** só þu þit **liaht** waros;
 for-hwátan skulun þi **hluttra** liudi, · þu ni salt io furður
 kuman te þínes **hêrron** spráko,
 52 **wesljan** þár mid **wordon** þínon: · **waldandi** stêt
 þínes **bróðor** wráka · **bitter** an hëlli.“

TODO.

- 54 Þó géng im þanan mid **grimmo** hugi, · habda ina **god** selbo [V 2v/TODO]
 swído far-sakanan. · **Soroga** warð þár þuo gi-kúdit
 56 **Adama** endi **Êwun**, · in-widd mikil,
 iro **kindes** **kwalm**, · þat he ni muosta **kwik** libbjan.
 58 Þes ward **Adamas** hugi · **innan** breostun
 swído an **sorogun**, · þuo he wissa is **sunu** dôðan:
 60 só ward is ôk þiu **muodar**, · þe þana **magu** fuodda,
 barn bi iro **breostun**. · Þuo siu **bluodag** wuosk
 62 **hrêu-gi-wádi**, · þuo ward iro **hugi** sêrag.
Bêþo was im þó an **sorogun** · iak iro **barnas** dôð,
 64 þes **hëlliðas** **hin**-fard, · iak þat im mid is **handun** for-dæda
Kain an su-likun **kwalma**: · siu ni habdun þuo noh **kindo** þan
 mêt
 66 **libbendero** an þem **liahta**, · botan þana ênna, þie þuo a-lêdit
 was

waldanda be is far·wurϥhtjun: · þar ni habdun siu êniga
wunja tuo
niud-líko gi·numan, · wand hie su-likan níð a·huofof,
þat he ward is bruodar bano. · Þes im þuo bêðjun ward,
sin-híun twêm · sêr umbi herta.
Oft siu þes gornunde · an griata gi·stuoðun,
sin-híun samad, · kwáðun, þat sia wissin, þat im þat iro sundja
gi·dedin,
þat im ni muostin aftar · ęřbi·wardos
þegnas þian. · Þolodun siu bêðju
mikila mord-kwála, · unt þat im ęft mahtig god,
hêr hebanes ward · iro hugi buotta,
þat im wurðun ôðana · ęřbi·wardos,
þegnos endi þiornun, · þigun aftar wel,
wóhsun wán-líko, · ge·witt línodun,
spáha spráka. · Spuoðda þie mahta
is hand-gi·weręk, · hêlag drohtin,
þat im ward sunu gi·boran; · þem skuopun siu Seð te naman
wárom wordum: · þem wastom lêh
hebanas waldand · endi hugi guodan,
gam-likan gang · -he was goda wirðig-,
mildi was hie im an is muoda. · Só þana is manno wel,
þie io mið su-likaro huldi muot · hêrron þionun.
Hie loboda þuo mêt · liodjo barnun,
godas huldi: · gumun þanan kwámun
guoda mann, ·
wordun wísa, · ge·witt línodun,
þegnos gi·þáhte · endi þigun aftar wel.
Þann kwámun ęft fan Kaina · kraftaga liudi,
hêlidos hard-muoda, · habdun im hugi strangan,
wrêðan willjan, · wí weldun waldandas
lêra lêstjan, · ak habdun im lêðan stríd;
wuohsun im wrisi-liko: · þat was þiu wirsa gi·burd,
kuman fan Kaina. · Bi·gunnun im kôpun þuo
weros wíb undor twisk: · þas ward a·werðit sán
Seðas ge·sidi, · warð sęggo folk
mênu gi·męngid · endi wurðun manno barn,
liudi lêða, · þem þitt lioht gi·skuop,
botan þat iro ên habda · erlas gi·hugdi,

- 104 began-líka gi·þáht; · was im gi·þungin mann,
wís endi word-spáh, · habda gi·witt mikil:
106 Enokh was hie hêtan. · Þie hier an erðu warð
mannum te mārðum · obar þesan middil-garð,
108 þat ina hier só kwikana · kungo þie þetsto,
libbendjan an is lík-haman, · só hie io an þesun liahta ni staraf
-
110 ak só gi·haloda ina hier · hebanas waldand
endi ina þár gi·setta, · þár hie simlon muot
112 wesan an wunnjon, · untat ina eft an þesa werold sendit
hêr hebanas ward · hēliðo barnum,
114 liodjun te lêro. · Þann hier ôk þie lêdo kumit,
þat hier Anti-krist · alla þioda,
116 werod a·werðit, · þann he mid wápnu skal
werðan Enokha te banon, · eggjun skarapun
118 þuruh is hand-megin; · hwiřibit þiu sêola,
þie gêst an guodan weg, · endi godas engil kumit,
120 wrikit ina, wamm-skaðon · wápnas eggjun:
wirðit Anti-krist · aldru bi·lôsid,
122 þie fiund bi·fēllid. · Folk wirðit eft gi·hworðban
te godas ríkja, · gumuno gi·sīði
124 langa hwíla, · endi stéd im sídor þit land gi·sund.

TODO.

54 Þó | Introduced with large initial. 81 drohtin | Here the poem ends on fol. 2v; it picks back up on fol. 10v. 122 bi·fēllid | biuēllid V

The Destruction of Sodom

- 3 Þuo habdun im eft só swiðo · Sodomo-liudi, [V 2r/1]
2 weros só far·werkot, · þat im was úsa waldand gram,
mahtig drohtin, · wand sia mên dribun,
4 frēmidun firin-dádi, · habdun im só vilu fiunda barn
wammas ge·wísid: · þuo ni welda þat waldand god,
6 þiadan þolojan, · ak hiet sie þrea faran,
is engelos ôstan · an is árundi,
8 sīðon te Sodoma, · endi was im selbo þár mið.
Þuo sea obar Mambra · mahtige fuorun,
10 þuo fundun sia Abrahama · bi ênum ala standan,

waran enna wið-stæði, · endi skolda úsas waldandas
 geld gi-frummjan, · endi skolda þár goda þeonan
 an middjan dag · manna þie bætsto.
 Þuo ant-kenda hé kraft godas, · só he sea kuman gi-sakh:
 géng im þuo ti-gegnes · endi goda selbun hnêg,
 bôg endi bedode · endi bad gerno,
 þat hie is huldi forð · hëbbjan muosti:
 „warod wil þu nu, · waldand, frô mín,
 alo-mahtig fadar? · ik biun þín êgan skalk,
 hold endi gi-hôrig; · þú bist mí hêrro só guod,
 mēðmo só mildi: · wil þu mínas wiht,
 drohtin, hëbbjan? · Hwat, it all an þinum duoma stéd,
 ik libbjo bi þinum lêhene, · endi ik gi-lôbi an þi,
 frô mín þe guoda: · muot ik þi frágon nu,
 warod þu sigi-drohtin · siðon willjas?“
 Þuo kwam im eft te-gegnes · godas and-wordi,
 mahtig muotta: · „Ni willi ik is þi mīðan nu,“ kwað he,
 „helan holdan man, · hú mín hugi gengit.
 Siðan skulun wí sūðar hinan: · hëbbjat him umbi
 Sodomaland
 weros só for-werkot. · Nú hruopat þæx wardas te mī
 dages endi nahtes, · þe þe iro dádi tēlljat,
 sēggjat hiro sundjon. · Nú willi ik selbo witan,
 ef þia mann under him · su-lik mēn frēmmtat,
 weros wam-dádi. · Þanna skal sea wallande
 fiur bi-vallan, · skulun sia hira firin-sundjon
 swára bi-senkjan: · sweþal fan himile
 fallit mid fiure, · fēknja stereþat,
 mēn-dádige mēn, · reht só morgan kumit.“
 Abraham þuo gi-mahalda · (habda im ēlljan guod,
 wísa word-kwidi), · endi wiðer is waldand sprak:
 „Hwat, þú góðas só vilu,“ (kwað hie, „god heþan-ríki,
 drohtin gi-duomis, · all bi þinum dádjun stéd
 þius werold an þinum willjan; · þu gi-wald hábas
 oþar þesan middil-gard · manna kunnjas,
 só þat gio werðan ni skal, · waldand frô mín,
 þat þú þár te ênum duogas · ubila endi guoda,
 lioba endi lêða, · wand sia gi-líka ni sind.
 Þu ruomes só rehtæs, · ríki drohtin,

- só þu ni wili, þat þár ant·geldan · guod-willige mann
 50 wam-skaðono werek, · þoh þu is gi·wald habes
 te gi·frummjanna. · Muot ik þi frágon nu,
 52 só þú mí þiu gramara ni sís, · god heban-ríki?
 ef þú þár fiðis fiftig · ferāhtaro manno,
 54 liubigaro liodo, · muot þanna þat land gi·sund,
 waldand, an þinum willjan · gi·wērid standan?“
 56 Þuo kwam im eft te·gegnes · godas and·wordi:
 „Ef ik þár findo fiftig,“ (kwað he,) „ferāhtara manno,
 58 guodaro gumono, · þea te goda hebbjan
 fasto gi·fangan, · þanna willi ik im iro ferāh far·geban
 60 þuru þat ik þea hluttron man · haldan wille.“
 Abraham þuo gi·mahalda · āðar siðe,
 62 forð frágoda · frāhon sínan:
 „Hwat duos þu is þanna,“ (kwað he,) „drohtin frô mín,
 64 ef þu þár þritig maht · þegno fiðan,
 wam-lôsa weros? · wil þu sia noh þanna
 66 látan te líba, · þat sia muotin þat land waran?“
 Þuo im þe guoda, · god heban-ríki,
 68 sniumo gi·sagda, · þat hie só weldi
 lēstjan an þen landa: · „Ef ik þár lubigaro mahg,“ kwað he,
 70 „þritig undar þero þiодо · þegno fiðan
 god-forōhta gumon: · þanna willi ik im far·geban allum
 72 þat mēn endi þea mis-dád · endi látan þat manno folk
 sittjan umbi Sodoma · endi ge·sund wesan.“
 74 Abraham þuo gi·mahalda · agalēt-líko
 -folgoda is frôjan-, · filo worda gi·sprak:
 76 „Nu skal ik is þi biddjan“, (kwað he,) „þat þú þi ni belges ti mí,
 frô mín þie guoda, · hú ik sus filu mahlja,
 78 weslja wiðer þi mid mínum wordum: · ik wēt, þat ik þas
 wirðig ni bium
 ni sí þat þu it willjas bi þínaro guodi, · god heban-ríki
 80 þiadan, gi·þolojan: · mí is þarāf mikil
 te witanna þínne willjan, · hweðer þat werad gi·sund
 82 libbjan muoti, · þe sea liggjan skulun,
 fēgja bi·vallon: · hwat wilis þu is þanna, frô mín, duoan,
 84 ef þu þár tehani · treu-hafte maht
 fiðan under þemo folka ferāhtera manno · wil þu im þanna
 hiro ferh far·geban,

86 þat sia umbi Sodomaland · sittjan muotin
 búan an þem burugjum, · só þu im a·bolgan ni síš?“
 88 Þuo kwam im eft te·gēnes · godas and·wordi:
 „Ef ik þár tehani,“ (kwað he,) „treu·haftera mag
 90 an þem lande noh · liodjo fiðan,
 þanna látu ik sia alla þuru þie ferāhtun man · ferēhas brúkan.“
 92 Þuo ni dorste Abraham lēng · drohtin sinan
 furðour frāgon, · ak hé fell im after te bedu
 94 an kneo kraftag, · kwað hé gerno
 is geld gērewedi · endi gode þeonodi,
 96 warāhti after is willjan. · Gi·wēt im eft þanan
 gangan te is gēst·sēli; · godes engilos fort
 98 siðodun te Sodomā, · so im selbo ge·bôd
 waldand mid is wordo, · þuo hie sea hiet an þana weg faran.

TODO.

30 þeæ wardas | þe æuuardas V 46 ĕnum | henum V 93 ak | hak ms.

100 Skoldun sie be·fiðan, · hwat þár ferāhtera
 umbi Sodomaburg, · sundjono tuomera
 102 manna wāri, · þie ni habdin mēnes filu,
 firin·werko gi·frumid. · Þó gi·hōrdun siæ fēgero karm
 104 an allaro sēliðu gi·hwen, · sundiga liudi
 firin·werk frēmmjan: · was þár fiundo gi·mang,
 106 wrēðaro wihtjo, · þea an þat wam habdun
 þea liudi far·lēdid: · þat lōn was þuo hat handum
 108 mikil mið morðu, · þat sia oft mēn dribun.
 Þanna sat im þár an innan · aðal·burdig man,
 110 Loth mið þem liudjum, · þie oft lof godas
 warāhte an þesaro weroldi: · habda im þár welono gi·nuog,
 112 guodas gi·wunnan: · he was gode wirðig.
 He was Abrahamas · aðali·knóslas,
 114 his bróðer barn: · ni was bē tara man
 umbi Giordanas staðos · mið gum·kustjum,
 116 gi·wērid mið ge·wittjo: · him was ūsa waldand hold.
 Þuo te sedla hnēg · sunna þiu hwita,
 118 alloro bókno berāhtost, · þuo stuond hie fore þes buruges dore.
 Þuo gi·sah hé an āband · engilos twēne
 120 gangan an þea gardos, · só sea fan gode kwámun

[V 2r/36]

ge·wēride mid ge·wittjo; · þuo sprak he im sán mid is wordum
tuó.

122 Géng þuo te·gegnes · endi gode þankade,
heban-kuninga, · þes hé im þea helpa fer·lélkh,
124 þat he muosta sea mið is ôgum · an luokojan,
iak he sea an kneo kusta · endi kúsko bad,
126 þat sea suohtin his sēliða: · kwað þat he im selbas duom
gáu su·líkas guodas, · só im god habdi
128 far·liwen an þem landa: · sea ni wurðun te lata hwęgin,
ak se gengun im an is gęst-sēli, · endi he im giungar-duom
130 fręmide ferāht-líka, · sea im filo sagdun
wáraro wordu. · Þár he an wahtu sat,
132 held is hęrran bodan · hēlag-líka,
godas engilos. · Sia him guodas só filo,
134 suôðas gi·sagdun. · Swart furðour skrêð,
narowa naht an skion, · náhida moragan
136 an allara sēliða gi·hwem. · Uht-fugal sang
fora daga-hruoma. · Þó habdun úsas drohtinas bodon
138 þea firina bi·fundan, · þea þár fręmidun mēn
umbi Sodoma-burug. · Þó sagdun sia Loða,
140 þat þár morð mikil · manno barno,
skolda þera liodjo werðan · endi ôk þes landas só samo.
142 Hietun ina þuo gęrewjan, · endi hietun þó gangan þanan,
firrjan hina fon þem fiundum · endi lēðjan is frí mið him,
144 idis aðal-borana. · He ni habda þár his aðaljas þan mēr,
botan is dohtar twá, · mid þem gi·hietun sie, þat hie êr daga
wári

146 an ênum berga uppan, · þat hina brinnandi
fiur ni bi·vengi. · Þó he te þere ferði warð
148 gāhun gi·gęrewid, · gengun engilos,
habdun hina bi handum · heban-kuningas bodon,
150 lēddun hina endi lērdun · lango hwíla,
untat sea ina gi·bráhtun · bi þera burug útan.
152 Hietun, þat sia io ni ge·hōrdin · sulik ge·hlunn mikil
brakon an þem burugjum, · þat sia io under bak sáwen,
154 an þiu þie sea an þem landæ · libbjan weldin.
Þuo þwurbun eft wiðer · hēlega wardos,
156 godas engilos, · gengun sniumo,
siðodun te Sodom: · þanan sūðar fuor

158 Loth þoro hira lēra, · flôh þera liodjo gi-mang,
 dēreþjoro manno: · þó warð dag kuman.
 160 Þuo warð þár gi-hlunn mikil · himile bi-tengi,
 brast endi brakoda, · warð þero buruġjo gi-hwilik
 162 rôkas gi-fullit, · warð þár fan radura só vilu
 fiures gi-fallin, · warð fêgero karm,
 164 lēðaro liodjo: · logna all bi-ueng
 brêd buruġu-gi-setu: · bran all samað,
 166 stên endi erða, · endi só manag strîdin man
 swultun endi sunkun: · swebal brinnandi
 168 wel after wîkjom; · waragas þolodun
 lēðas lôn-geld. · þat land inn bi-sank,
 170 þiu erða an af-grundi; · al warð far-spildit
 Sodoma-rîki, · þat is ênig sêg ni gi-nas,
 172 iak só bi-dôðit an dôð-sêu, · so it noh te daga stêndit
 fluodas gi-fullit. · Þuo habdun hiro firin-dâdi
 174 all Sodomo-þiod · sêro ant-goldan,
 botan þat þár iro ênna · út ent-lêdde
 176 waldand an is willjan · endi þiu wif mid im,
 þriu mið þem þegna. · Þó gi-hôrdun sea þero þiodo kwalm,
 178 buruġi brinnan. · Þó þár under bak bi-sakh
 idis aðal-boren · —siu ni welde þera engilo
 180 lēra lêstjan; · þat was Lohthas brúd,
 þan lang þe siu an þem landa · libbjan muosta—
 182 þuo siu an þem berega gi-stuod · endi under bak bi-sakh,
 þuo warð siu te stêne, · þár siu standan skal
 184 mannum te mârðu · oþar middil-gard
 after te êwan-dage, · só lango só þius erða lêbot.

TODO.

100 Skoldun | *Introduced by large initial.* 100 hwat þár | huattar V 119 áband | haband V 137
 daga-hruoma | *emend.*; 'daga huom' V 141 werðan | 'huuerthan' V 144 aðaljas | 'hadalias'
 V 155 hwurubun | *metr. emend.*; uurubun V 185 lêbot. | *add. EXPL V*

185 lêbot. | The *EXPL* in the ms. stands for 'explicit', customarily placed at the end of a text in mediaeval mss. This line also serves as a fitting conclusion to the poem.

Wessobrunn Hymn

Dating: late C8th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

Textual preservation and transmission

The so-called **Wessobrunn Hymn** (abbrev. *Wessobrunn*) is found on foll. 65v–66r of the Bavarian ms. BSB Clm 22053 (henceforth known as 22053), previously located at the Wessobrunn abbey in Upper Bavaria. 22053 consists of 100 foll. containing a number of Latin texts dealing with varied themes, including theology, chronology, geography, and Latin-German glosses. On the basis of a note on 99v mentioning the death of Charlemagne (748–814), 22053 is dated to ca. 814 CE or some years before. *Wessobrunn* is written in the same uncial hand as the rest of the ms., and is therefore not marginalia. (Bierbrauer 1990, pp. 83–84).

Contents

Wessobrunn is introduced by the Latin heading *De poeta* ‘By the poet’. The text itself is divided by the scribe into three sections, each introduced by a capital letter adorned with dots of red ink. The first two sections are poetic (‘the poem’), and the third is in prose (‘the prayer’)

The poem consists of 9 long-lines in alliterative meter, detailing the earliest beginning of the world. The first 5 lines describe “the greatest of wonders”, namely that the universe was once void, without earth or heaven, wood or mountain, sun or moon or sea. These lines are very similar to pre-Christian Norse stanzas about the creation of the world, and in fact contain formulaic word-pairs also found in those stanzas (see notes to ll. 2, 3), suggesting a repurposing of older Heathen motifs and expressions in the new, Christian context. With this in mind, we see that the latter 4 lines constitute a subversion of the earlier Heathen tradition, for they place into this early emptiness the Almighty God, Jesus Christ, and His many ghosts—presumably the Heavenly Host or the Angels. This is the Christian creation *ex nihilo*,

rather than the Indo-European creation *ex materia* through sacrifice of a primordial being (cf. *Vaff* 21, *Grm* 41–42). The prayer is in prose. The author first thanks God for creating the earth and heaven—this is presumably why the poem was included—and for giving boons to mankind. He then asks for faith, strength, and wisdom to help him in his mission.

Language

TODO: Krogmann (1937).

Dating

Since *Wessobrunn* is not marginalia the *terminus ante quem* of its composition is 814 CE. However, on the basis of the evidently poor preservation of the poem (ll. 3–4) it is unlikely that the scribe of 22053 is the direct author of *Wessobrunn*; the title *De poeta* ‘By the poet’ also suggests that the scribe was not, in fact, the poet. With this in mind we are probably dealing with an older composition, allowing us to push the date back to the late 8th century.

Text

T1 De poeta
Regarding the Poet.

1 poeta ‘the Poet’ | This word has traditionally been interpreted as ‘the Creator’, viz. God. TODO.

- 1 Dat ga·f̥reġin ih mit fir̥ahim · firi-wizzo mę̊sta,
2 dat erdo ni was · noh úf-himil
noh paum · noh perek ni was
4 ni [...] nohh-ċinig · noh sunna ni skę̊in
noh máno ni liuh̊ta · noh der m̊arjo sę̊o.

I HAVE LEARNT AMONG MEN that greatest of wonders,
that Earth was not, nor Up-heaven
nor wood, nor was there mountain.
No [...] did [...], nor did the sun shine,
nor the moon give off light nor the famous sea.

1 Dat | *The D is a large capital decorated with red dots inside of it* 22053 1 ga·f̥reġin | ga- abbrev. by the rune-like symbol ꝥ. This symbol is used for all other occurrences of ga- in the present text except for ga-náda and ga-laupa in P1 below. 2 erdo | ero 22053 4 skę̊in | emend. after Grienberger (1921, p. 237), who notes that the ft-ligature here is slightly different than at other places in the text, reflecting original *f̥c; ‘f̥cin’ 22053

1 Dat ga·f̥reġin ih mit fir̥ahim · firi-wizzo mę̊sta ‘I have learned among men this greatest of wonders’ | A formulaic opening to a Germanic poem, expressing that the narrating poet’s knowledge of the events described is reportative. For other parallels see note to *Gbu* 1/1, which contains a word-for-word cognate expression. — *ga·f̥reġin ih* ‘I have learned’ has often been taken as an (Anglo-)Saxonism on the basis of the vowel *e* for the expected **a* (cf. poetic OE *ġi·fræġn iē* ‘id.’, OS *gi·fragn ik*). This would discredit the present OHG attestation of the formula, since it would be a borrowing rather than a native reflex. However, Krogmann (1937, pp. 144–145) irrefutably demonstrates that the vowel quality is in fact the result of a well-attested OHG development where the following *ih* ‘I’ induces *i*-umlaut in the preceding verb **ga·frag(i)n*; note that *-i-* is a svarabhakti vowel. The formula is therefore native, and the expression is thus found in all four Germanic alliterative poetic traditions: ON, OE, OS, and OHG.

1 fir̥ahim ‘men’ | Dat. of *fir(a)ha*, a plurale tantum poetic synonym for ‘men, people’ found throughout the Old Germanic languages. See *Hild* 10 n. for etymology and distribution.

2 erdo ... úf-himil ‘Earth ... Up-heaven’ | A formulaic merism attested in OHG, OS, OE, and ON; it expresses the totality of the universe and is usually used in the context of the creation or destruction of the world. For its use in creation cf. esp. *Vsp* 3/3, where it is said, about the time before the World existed, that “Earth and Up-heaven were never found” and *Vafþ* 21, where the god Woden asks the etrin Webthrinthner about the origin of “Earth and Up-heaven”. For a list of occurrences see Index: Earth and Up-heaven.

2 erdo | The ms. form *ero* has been interpreted in a variety of ways, usually as a m. *wan*-stem derived from the same root as the more common synonym **erþō* ‘earth’. This is however problematic, since the expected form in that case would be **er(a)wo* (EWA, s.v. *ero*). The present emendation is based on the formulaic nature of the merism (see other note), but also has problems, since the regular final vowel of *erda* ‘earth’ in OHG is *-a*, not *-o* (EWA, s.v. *ero*).

3 *paum* ... *perek* 'wood ... mountain' | The same word-pair is found in *Musp* 50, describing the Christian destruction of the world prior to the Judgment. It is also found in ON in *Grm* 41/3, describing the pre-Christian creation of the world from Yimer's body by the Gods. — The line is clearly defective; *nob paum* is not a metrically acceptable a-verse.

4 *ni* [...] 'No [...] did [...]' | No gap is marked in 22053 but the negative *ni* implies a following verb, so the missing text here should be a verb and a subject noun; if we were only missing a noun we would expect the preceding word *nob* 'nor' instead. The common emendation **sterro* 'star' falls since *st-* never alliterates with *s-* in Germanic poetry, not even in OHG.

- 6 Dó dár ni-wiht ni was · ęntjo ni węntjo,
 ęnti dó was der ęino · al-mahtiko kot,
 8 manno miltisto, · ęnti dar wárun auh manaké mit inan
 kót-líhhe gęista, · ęnti kot heilak.

Then there was no kind of end nor border,
 and then was the one Almighty God,
 the most giving of men, and there were also many
 glorious ghosts with Him, and Holy God.

6 Dó | The D is a capital, smaller than the one in line 1, decorated with red dots inside of it 22053

8 manno miltisto 'the most giving of men' | The expression refers to God in the form of Jesus, who is held to be coeternal with God the Father. Cf. *Heli* 338, et.c.: *allaro barno bętst* 'best of all children', Otfrid's *Evangelienbuch* 1.22.43: *manno liobosta* 'loveliest of all men'.

- P1 Kot al-mahtiko, dú himil ęnti erda ga-worahtós, ęnti dú mannun
 2 só manak kót for-gápi, for-gip mir in dína ga-náda rehta ga-laupa,
 ęnti kótan willjon; wís-tóm ęnti spáhida ęnti kraft tiuflun za
 4 widar-stantanne, ęnti ark za pi-wísanne, ęnti dínan willjon za
 ga-wurkhanne.

O God almighty! Thou wroughtest heaven and earth and Thou gavest men
 so much good. Give me in Thy mercy right belief and good will, wisdom and
 foresight and power, to withstand devils and to reproach queerness and to
 work thy will.

1 Kot | Cot 22053; the C is a capital, smaller than the one in line 1, decorated with red dots inside of it 22053

Muspell

(*Muspilli*)

Dating: C9th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Muspell** (*Musp*) is an Old High German Christian poem dealing with the Day of Judgment.

Textual preservation and transmission

Musp survives in a single copy, found scribbled in a Latin-language theological manuscript from the 820s CE with the signum BSB Clm 14098 (henceforth denoted as 14098). Lines 1–18a are found on fol. 61r while the rest of the poem is found on foll. 119v–121v. Foll. 61r and 120v–121v are blank, and on these the poem occupies the whole page; on foll. 119v–120r the main text is in Latin and the text of the German poem thus occupies the lower third of the page, below the main text.

From 61v–120r the main text of 14098 is a pseudo-Augustinian sermon, which ends on 120r with a dedication by the archbishop of Salzburg Ethelram (Latin *Adalrammus*) to the young duke Ludwig (Latin *Hludowicus*, later Louis the German). It is important to note that the poem and main text are written in different hands. The hand of the poem is unsteady and not finely wrought, which may suggest that its author was not very used to writing; he may perhaps even have been Ludwig himself. From the start on fol. 61r we can presume that the writer of the poem originally meant to write down just a part of it as marginalia, beginning on the back leaf (61r) of the already written sermon, and continuing on its last two leaves (119v–120r). When he ran out of space, he acquired another blank leaf, 121r–v. The abrupt ending of the poem may suggest that further blank leaves were also originally present.

Due to the low quality of the digitally available scans of the already very poorly preserved manuscript, the pres. ed. has had to rely partly on the text

found in the 17th edition of Braune's *Althochdeutsche Lesebuch* published in 1994.

Content

Musp is a Catholic sermon that describes the events of the Judgment Day and advises its readers to do penance and give alms to assure their safety. The poem is not a masterpiece, and in the original at times comes off as stilted. Still, it has a certain charm, and its meter is notably regular when compared to the other comparable High German alliterative poems *Hild* and *Wessobrunn*.

Relation to Otfrid

The use of end-rhymed Otfridian meter in ll. 60–61 suggests a relation between *Musp* and Otfrid's *Evangelienbuch* (written 863–871 CE), something which is strongly supported by the exact correspondence between *Musp* 14 and *Evangelienbuch* 1.18.9. Since there appears to be a relation between these two texts, we ought to try to determine the direction of influence. I believe that we may reasonably conclude on the basis of literary history and the internal metrical variation of the *Evangelienbuch* that the direction of influence is more likely to be from *Musp* to the *Evangelienbuch* rather than the reverse, and will lay out my argument as follows.

With the exception of a very small number of irregular, often alliterating lines found exclusively in the first book (e.g. 1.4.9, 1.5.5, 1.7.19, 1.7.27–28, 1.18.9; cf. 1.5.6, 1.5.10–12, 3.1.31–32 which combine alliteration with end-rhyme), the *Evangelienbuch* is fully end-rhymed. With the exception of 1.18.9 these lines are all found in the first fourth of the first book, which runs to 28 chapters. This distribution suggests that Otfrid was still finding his footing, as it were, and either borrowed older lines or experimented with compensating for a lack of rhyme with alliteration before deciding against it.

Of these lines, the only one that fully accords with Sieversian metrics is 1.18.9. This unusual regularity, along with its late relative position, points to the borrowing of 1.18.9 from another source. Even in his irregular non-rhyming lines, Otfrid does not follow the Sieversian rule of four positions, nor always the linking of alliteration between couplets; what is more, by the 18th chapter of book 1, he was comfortable enough with the end-rhymed meter not to need to insert an alliterative line of his own.

From the viewpoint of literary history, it would be highly unusual for a poet active in a clerical context after the success of the *Evangelienbuch* to still employ alliteration, especially when he was clearly familiar with the end-rhymed form as proven by ll. 60–61. The natural choice for such a writer would be to use end-rhyme throughout. Indeed, the *Evangelienbuch*, along with related works like the *Georgslied* and *Ludwigslied*, seems to have definitively put an end to the alliterative tradition as a whole in Germany, since no German alliterative poetry younger than the 9th century survives.

Moreover, while *Musp* 14 is a perfectly regular alliterative long-line, entirely unremarkable within the metrical context of *Musp*, its direct equivalent *Evangelienbuch* 1.18.9 is, from the perspective of Otfridian meter, deficient. This again gives support to *Musp* being the giver, for it makes little sense for an alliterative poet working after Otfrid to borrow just that particular deficient line for his own work, whereas it makes much more sense for the end-rhyming poet Otfrid to borrow an older line from an alliterative work.

Another more archaic trait found in *Musp* is its use of originally pre-Christian expressions like the alliterative pair *poum*, *perga* (l. 50), *Mittila-gart* (l. 53), and *Mú-spell* (l. 56), none of which are found in Otfrid. It must, however, be said that these expressions, on their own, do not prove that *Musp* is the older poem. The archaic expressions could be argued simply to be a part of *Musp*'s more rustic style, use of alliteration, and less theologically informed content. Indeed, it is certainly plausible that a later poet more strongly anchored in vernacular tradition would retain archaic traits discarded by an earlier poet working in an Ecclesiastical milieu. However, when weighed together with the circumstances discussed above, these expressions do yield further support for *Musp* preceding Otfrid.

If *Musp* indeed is the older poem, there arises the question of how Otfrid would have come into contact with it. Yet, of the problems associated with the relation between the two texts, this one is perhaps the most easily answered, owing to a surprising historical circumstance. As shown by Haubrichs (1978, p. 406), several decades before Otfrid dedicated his *Evangelienbuch* to Ludwig the German in ca. 870 CE, he had spent a number of years as a scribe at Ludwig's court—the very same court where 14098 containing *Musp* must have been located after its dedication (see Textual preservation above).

We may then imagine the following scenario: In poring over the pseudo-Augustinian sermon contained in 14098, a young Otfrid would have discovered *Musp* written in the margins and, taken by its contents, put the poem to memory. When, as an old man, he set out to write his *Evangelienbuch* and arrived at the description of Paradise, he remembered, if not the whole *Muspilli*, at least this one evocative line—"There life is without death, light without darkness"—and included it.

Language

The dialect of the poem is that of the southern High German area, most likely Bavaria, where Regensburg was the seat of Emperor Ludwig's government. This is seen by the consistent application of the most extensive form of the second sound shift, where *g*, *b*, *k* change to *k*, *p*, *kh*. That this sound change had occurred at the time of composition and is not merely a scribal feature is proven by the fact that Germanic roots originally beginning with *b* consistently alliterate with Latin borrowings beginning with *p*, namely in:

- l. 5: *pebbe* (< Latin *pix*) : *págant* (= ON *bága*),

- l. 16: *pú* (= OS *bú*) : *pardísu* (< Latin *paradísus*),
- l. 21: *piutit* (= OS *biudid*) : *pehbhes*, *pína* (< Latin *poena*),
- l. 25: *prinnan* (= OS *brinnan*), *palw-* (= OS *baluw-*) : *pebbe*.

Interestingly, the alliteration also shows that the poet sporadically retained old *b-* before *l* (l. 72, but cf. 82), by extension almost certainly also before *r* and *n*, and probably also before *w* (l. 7). This sound is, however, consistently omitted by the scribe.

Dating

Since the poem is marginalia (see Textual preservation), the dating of the manuscript can unfortunately only serve as a *terminus post quem* for the poem itself, viz. the 820s CE. The likely direction of influence on the *Evangelienbuch*, composed ca. 863–871 CE (see Contents) serves as a *terminus ante quem*. The poem was, therefore, most likely composed in Bavaria, sometime between 820 and 870 CE, though probably in the earlier part of that span.

Summary

The poem begins with a description of the fate of the soul immediately after death (ll. 1–29). This is followed by a short sermon about the importance of doing good works before the Judgment (30–35). After this follows the description of the destruction of the world and Judgment Day. First comes the fight between Elijah and the Anti-Christ (36–49), then the burning of the world and the Muspell (50–61). The narrative is broken up by a second sermon warning against corruption by describing how the Devil keeps track of evil deeds to recount them at the Judgment (62–71). Next the Judgment itself begins: An angel blows a horn, and God and his angels are on the move (72–80); then the dead come back to life to be judged (81–84). They gather in a court before God and the angels (85–89). The poet stresses that all must become known at the Judgment, and even a man's own limbs will bear witness against him (90–96); the only way to avoid punishment is through good deeds on earth (97–100). After this, the Holy Cross is brought forth, and the poem abruptly ends (101–104).

Text

Sín tak pi·kweme, · daz er touwan skal.
 2 Hwanta sár só sih diu sêla · in den sind ar·hëvit,
 ęnti sí den lîh-hamun · likkan lázzit,
 4 só kwimit ęin hęri · fona himil-zungalon;
 daz andar fona pehhe: · dár págant siu umpi.

HIS DAY WILL COME when he must die.
 For as soon as the soul lifts itself on its way
 and leaves the body behind to lie,
 then comes an army from the heavenly stars,
 the other from the Pitch; there they fight over it.

1 Sín tak pi·kweme, · daz er touwan skal 'His day will come when he must die.' | It is traditionally assumed that the beginning of the poem is incomplete, there originally being other lines before this one, but there is nothing in 14098 to suggest this. I find the opening line, with its generic *sín*, *er* 'his, he', rather powerful.

3 likkan lázzit | The double alliteration in the b-verse is unusual, but probably not due to any scribal corruption. Since the second word does not partake in regular alliteration, it has not been marked.

5 pehhe 'the Pitch' | The burning hellfire.

6 Sorgén mak diu sêla, · unzi diu suona ar·gét,
 za bwederemo hęje · si gi·halót werde.
 8 Hwanta ipu sia daz Satanazses · ki·sindi ki·winnit,
 daz lęitit sia sár · dár iru lęid wirdit,
 10 in fuir ęnti in finstrí: · daz ist rehto virin-lîh ding.

The soul must worry until the [time of] atonement begins
 about which of the armies will receive it,
 for if Satan's following wins it,
 then it is soon led whither it must face torment,
 into fire and darkness. That is surely a wicked thing.

7 bwederemo | 'wederemo' 14098

7 bwederemo | Restoration of the initial *b*- is not strictly required for the line to alliterate properly, but it is done on the basis of l. 72.

Upi sia *avar ki·halónt die · die dár fona himile kwemant,
 12 ęnti sí dero ęngilo · ęigan wirdit,
 die pringent sia sár úf · in himilo rihi:
 14 dár ist lip áno tōd, · liobt áno finstrí,

sęlida áno sorgun: · dár n·ist neo-man siuh.

16

Denne der man in pardísu · pú ki·winnit,

hús in himile, · dár kwimit imo hilfa ki·nuok.

If, however, it is received by those who come from heaven
and the angels are to have it for themselves,
they soon bring it up into the realm of the heavens.
There life is without death, light without darkness,
happiness without sorrow; there no man is sick.
When the man wins his dwelling in Paradise,
his house in heaven, he will get help aplenty.

11 *avar | 'hauar' 14098 14 liobt | 'lihot' 14098 14 finstri | 'finsti' 14098 15 sorgun | partly illegible in 14098 15 dár n·ist | emend.; illegible in 14098 16 pardísu | partly illegible in 14098

13 die pringent sia sár úf · in himilo rihi: | The line lacks alliteration, but no obvious emendation presents itself. On the basis of the occasional spelling of vowel-words with *b-*, suggesting confusion over that sound, it is possible that the alliteration should fall on *úf* and *'imilo*, but that is highly speculative.

14 dár ist líp áno tód, · liobt áno finstri 'There life is without death, light without darkness' | This line also appears in Otfrid's *Evangelienbuch* 1.18.9, where it begins a description of Paradise, in the form: *Thár ist líb ána tód, · liobt ána finstri*. It is one of Otfrid's rhymeless lines where alliteration compensates for the expected end-rhyme. For the relevance of this shared line to the relation between *Musp* and *Evangelienbuch*, see Introduction above.

18

Pi·diu ist durft mihhil allero manno bwe-líhemo, · daz in es

sín muot ki·spane,

daz er kotes willun · kerno tue

20

ęnti hęlla fuir · harto wise,

pehhes pína: · dár piutit der Satanasz altist

22

hęzzan lauk. · Só mak hukkan za diu,

sorgén dráto, · der sih suntigen węiz.

Therefore it is most needful for every man that he persuade his heart
that it might gladly do the will of God
and stalwartly avoid the fire of Hell,
the torture of the Pitch; there the oldest Satan offers
hot flame. So he must think about that,
worry greatly, whoever knows that he sins.

18 bwe-líhemo | end 61r, the text continues on 119v. 19 tue | metr. and gramm. emend.; tuo 14098

21 der Satanasz altist 'the oldest Satan' | Not a reference to any specific 'Satan' but rather denoting Satan as the primeval, ancient enemy of God.

24

Wê demo in vinstrí skal · síno viriná stuén,

prinnan in pehhe: · daz ist rehto palwík dink,

- 26 daz der man **harét** ze gote · **ę**nti imo **hilfa** ni kwimit.
Wánit sih ki·náda · diu **w**ênaga sêla:
 28 ni ist in ki·**h**uktin · **h**imiliskin gote,
hwanta hiar in **w**er-olti · after ni **w**erkóta.

Woe to him who in the darkness shall atone for his wickedness,
 burn in the Pitch; that is surely a baleful thing,
 that the man calls out to God and no help for him comes.
 She expects mercy, that wretched soul;
 she is not in the thoughts of the heavenly God,
 for here in this world she left no works behind.

25 **p**ehhe | 'phhe' 14098

- 30 Só denne der **ma**htigo khunink · daz **ma**hal ki·pannit,
 dara skal **k**weman · **kh**unno ki·líhaz:
 32 denne ni ki·tar **p**arno nohheın · den **pan** furi·sizzan,
 ni allero **man**no **h**we-líh; · ze demo **ma**hale skuli.
 34 Dár skal er vora demo **r**ihhe · az **ra**hhu stantan,
 pí daz er in **w**er-olti eo · ki·**w**erkót hapéta.

So, when the mighty King summons the court
 whither every race shall come,
 then none of the children dare sit out the summons,
 nor any man whatsoever—he must go to the court.
 There before that power shall he stand on trial
 for the works he has done earlier in the world.

32 **p**arno 'the children' | The children of men, i.e., human beings.

- 36 Daz hôrt' ih **ra**hhón · dia wer-olt-**re**ht-wíson,
 daz skuli der **A**nti-khristo · mit **E**líase págan.
 38 Der **w**arkh ist ki·**w**áfanit, · denne wirdit untar in **w**ík
 ar·hapan.
Kheınfun sint só **k**reftík; · diu **k**ôsa ist só mihhil.
 40 **E**lías strítit · pí den **ę**wigon líp,
 wili dén **re**ht-kernón · daz **r**íhhi ki·starkan:
 42 pí·diu skal imo **h**elfan · der **h**imiles ki·waltit.

This I heard the righteous of the world narrate:
 that the Anti-Christ shall fight with Elijah—
 the warg is armed—then the battle will commence between them.
 The champions are so strong; the struggle is so great;
 Elijah fights for the eternal life,

wishes to strengthen the power of the righteous;
therefore he will have help from Him Who rules heaven.

36 rahhón ‘narrate’ | The related verb **rēkkjan* is also found for the narrating of ancient events in *Beow* 91 and *Heli* 3.

44 Der Anti-khristo · stét pí demo alt-fiante,
stét pí demo Satanase, · der inan var-sēnkan skal:
46 pi·diu skal er in deru wík-stēti · wunt pi·vallon
ēnti in demo sinde · siga-lôs werdan.

The Anti-Christ stands beside the Fiend of Old,
stands beside Satan who shall cause him to fall.
Therefore shall he on that battlefield fall wounded
and in the incursion be victory-less.

43 alt-fiante ‘Fiend of Old’ | Or ‘the Ancient Enemy’, i.e., Satan.

48 Doh wānit des vila got-manno,
daz Elías in demo wige · ar-wartit werde,
só daz Elíases pluot · in erda ki·triuft.

Yet many godly men expect
that Elijah in that battle will be maimed,
so that Elijah’s blood pours into the earth.

50 Só in·prinnant die perga, · poum ni ki·stēntit
ēnihk in erdu, · ahá ar·truknēt,
52 muor var·swilhit sih, · swilizót lougiu der himil,
máno vallit, · prinnit mittila-gart,
54 stēn ni ki·stēntit*, · vërit denne stúa-tago in lant,
vërit mit diu vuiru · viriho wísón.

So the mountains burn down, no tree stands
anywhere upon the earth, the rivers turn dry,
the swamp is swallowed up, the heaven glows with flame,
the moon falls, Middenyard burns,
no stone stands. Then the Judgment Day comes upon the land,
comes with the fire to visit the folk.

54 stēn ni ki·stēntit* | *add.* ēnihk in erdu 14098 (*dittography through homoioarcton from ll. 50b–51a*)

50 perga ... poum ‘mountains ... tree’ | Formulaic word-pair; see note to *Wessobrunn* 3.

55 viriho ‘folk’ | Gen. of *fīr(a)ba*, a *plurale tantum* poetic synonym for ‘men, people’ found throughout the Old Germanic languages. See *Hild* 10 n. for etymology and distribution.

- 56 Dár ni mak denae **mák** andremo · helfan vora demo **Mú·spille**,
denne daz **prẽita** wasal · allaz var·**prinnit**,
58 **ęnti** **vuir** **ęnti** luft · iz allaz ar·**furpit**.
Hwár ist denne diu **marha**, · dár man dár eo mit sínén **mágon**
piehk?
60 Diu marha ist far·prunнан, · diu sēla stét pi·*du*wungan,
ni *węiz* mit *hwiu* puaze: · só *węit* sí za *wíze*.

There may no kinsman help another one before the Muspell
when the broad damp earth all burns up
and fire and air cleanse it all.

Where is then the ground where man once with his kinsmen fought?
The ground is burnt up; the soul is defeated,
knows no remedy; so it goes to punishment.

56 *Mú·spille* ‘the Muspell’ | The word which has given the poem its modern name, probably ‘the Destruction of the Earth’. *Mú·spille* is a hapax in OHG, but corresponds to OS *Múd·spelli* ~ *Mút·spelli* (*Heli* 2591, 4358) and ON *Mú·spell* (see *Vsp* 49/1 n.). Its exact sense and origin are hard to pin down.

In all cases the word seems to refer to at least an element of the eschatological destruction of the world, whether Heathen (as in the Norse *Vsp* and *Gylf*) or Christian (as in the High German *Musp* and the Old Saxon *Heli*). In *Musp* the word refers to the culmination of the destruction of the world by fire. In *Heli* 2591–92, *Múd·spelles megin* ‘Muspell’s might’ is said to pass over mankind together with the *ęndi þesaro wer·oldes* ‘end of this world’, and in *Heli* 4358–4361, Muspell is said to come like a thief in the night, along with the Last Day. In *Vsp* 49 *Mú·spells lýðir* ‘Muspell’s people’ are said to come from the south on a great ship during the Rakes of the Reins, while in *Gylf* 4:5–7 Muspell or Muspellsham is said to be a burning realm in the south ruled over by the fire-ettn Surt. Etymologically the word is clearly a cpd., segmented between *mú(d)* and *spilli*; it is a *ja*-stem in OS and OHG and an *a*-stem in ON; its gender is m. in ON and m. or neuter in OS and OHG (EWA, s.v. *múspili*). The first element, the root length of which is uncertain, has been explained as reflecting either PGmc. **múbō* ‘heap (of earth)’ or, on the basis of the OS dental, PGmc. **munþaz* ‘mouth’ (EWA). On the basis of sound-laws the latter is unlikely since the Ingvaenic nasal spirant law (/Vnθ/ > /Ṽ:θ/) does not affect OHG or ON, which for ‘mouth’ have *mund* and *munnr*, respectively. Still, the OS dental poses a formal difficulty and opens up the possibility of borrowing, although the direction is unclear. It is notable that both ON and OHG, at the geographical extremes, agree about the lack of a dental. The second element is prob. an agent noun derived either from the verb **spilþjǫnǫ* ‘to spoil, ruin; kill, murder’ (OE *spillan*, *spildan*, OS *spildjan*, ON *spilla*) or from **spellōnǫ* ‘to tell, talk’ (EWA). Due to the lack of breaking in ON the former is probably more likely.

To conclude, due to the possibility of borrowing between languages, the lack of any glosses, and the formal difficulties, any derivation must be considered uncertain. Still, its undoubtedly Germanic linguistic origin does make a pagan origin more likely. If it really is a purely Christian word, one has to ask why it does not appear in West Germanic prose or even non-alliterative poetry like Otfrid, and why it should signify a fiery realm in the Norse mythology.

59 *Hwár* ist denne diu marha, · dár man dár eo mit sínén mágon piehk? ‘Where is then the ground where man once with his kinsmen fought?’ | An example of the *ubi sunt* motif common in medieval literature from both Europe and the Arab world. This literary motif, originally drawing on the Book of Baruch (3:16–19) and in Old Germanic poetry most famously found in *The Wanderer* (ll. 92–96), illustrates the vanity of life by listing various things and people, before asking ‘where are they?’ The German poet here extends the motif to the Day of Judgment and takes the opportunity to comment on his own time by condemning the internecine feuds that plagued all medieval monarchies.

60–61 Diu ... wize | In these two lines the poet replaces the usual alliteration with end-rhyme between each half-line (60: *prunnan* : *duungan*, 61: *puaze* : *wize*). The very same meter, including the looseness of the rhymes, is used by Otfrid throughout the whole of his *Evangelienbuch*, written sometime between 863 and 871 CE. The direction of influence between *Musp* and that work is uncertain owing to the difficulties of dating the present poem, though *Musp* is most likely the older work. See l. 14 and Introduction above.

- 62 Pi·diu ist demo manne só guot, · denne 'r ze demo mahale
kwimit,
daz er rahóno hwe-líha · rehto ar·teile;
64 denne ni darf er sorgén, · denne er ze deru suonu kwimit.
Ni wëiz der wênago man, · hwie-líhan wartil er habét,
66 denne 'r mit den miatón · marrit daz rehta,
daz der tiuval dár pí · ki·tarnit stëntit.

Therefore it is so good for the man when he comes to the court
that he rightly consider every charge;
then he need not worry when he comes to the atonement.
The wretched man knows not what sort of overseer he has
when with bribes he obstructs what is right:
that the Devil stands hidden by his side.

- 68 Der hapét in ruovu · rahóno hwe-líha,
daz der man êr ęnti síd · upiles ki·frumita,
70 daz er iz allaz ki·sagét, · denne er ze deru suonu kwimit;
ni skolta síd manno nohhęin · miatun int·fáhan.

In silence, *he* keeps every evil charge
which the man, early or late, has committed,
so that he tells it all when he comes to the atonement;
for that reason should no man take bribes.

68 Der 'He' | The Devil, as just mentioned.

- 72 Só daz himiliska horn · ki·blútít wirdit,
ęnti sih der suanari · ana den sind ar·hęvit
74 der dár suannan skal · tôten ęnti lepentén;
denne hęvit sih mit imo · herjo męista,
76 daz ist allaz só pald, · daz imo nio-man ki·págan ni mak.
Denne vęrit er ze deru mahal-stęti, · deru dár ki·markhót ist:
78 dár wirdit diu suona, · dia man dár io sagéta.

So the heavenly horn is sounded,
and the Judge lifts Himself on His way,
He who shall judge the dead and the living.

Then rises with Him the greatest of armies;
it is all so bold that no man may fight it.
Then He journeys to the place of the court which is there marked out;
there begins the atonement as was once foretold.

72 ki·blútít ‘sounded’ | *metr. emend.*: ki·lútít 14098

72 Só daz himiliska horn · ki-*blútít* wírdit 'So the heavenly horn is sounded' | In Revelation 8–11, seven trumpets are sounded. With the sounding of the seventh trumpet, the kingdom of God is announced (Revelation 11:15). Cf. *Vsp* 45, where the god Homedall sounds the famous Yellhorn and this precedes the destruction.

72 *ki·blútít* ‘sounded’ | Restoration of the cluster *bl-* is required by the alliteration; cf. l. 7.

Denne varant ęngila · uper dio marha,
80 wękhant deota, · wissant ze dinge.
Denne skal manno gi·lih · fona deru moltu ar·stén,
82 lóssan sih ar dero lēwo vazzón: · skal imo avar sín líp
pi·kweman,
daz er sín reht allaz · ki·rahhón muozzi,
84 ęnti imo after sínén tátin · ar·teilit werde.

Then the angels journey over the ground;
they wake the nations, show them to the Thing.
Then shall every man arise out of the earth,
free himself from the burdens of the grave; further he shall come to life
that he may fully plead his case
and according to his deeds be considered.

82 *dero lēwo vazzón* 'the burdens of the grave' | Lit. 'the burdens of the graves'. — *lēwo* (gen. pl. of *hlēō* 'grave') is the same word as OE *blēw* 'mound', PN *blaiwa* 'grave' (N KJ77, 78), and Gothic *blaiw* (translating Greek τάφος 'tomb' and μνημείον 'memorial'). The sound change *bl-* > *l-* is strongly suggested by the meter. The verse is a hypermetrical type A1A1 scanning Px:xxxxPxPx, and such verses, at least in *Heli*, without exception require double alliteration (Suzuki 2004, pp. 295–96). Although the meter of *Musp* and *Heli* is not identical, the rule is so strong that it most likely applies in *Musp* too. This marks an inconsistent handling of the old sound *bl-* in *Musp*; cf. l. 72 above.

82 skal imo ... sín líp pi-kweman 'he shall come to life' | Lit. 'his life shall come to him.'

Denne der gi-sizzit, · der dár suonnan skal
86 ɛnti ar-tɛʃillan skal · tótén ɛnti kwekkhén,
denne stét dár umpi · ɛngilo mɛnigí,
88 guotero gomóno: · gart ist só mihhil:
dara kwimit ze deru rihtungu só vilo · dia dár ar restí ar-stént.

Then sits he who there shall judge
and shall consider the dead and the living.

Then there around him stands a throng of angels,
[and] of good men. The enclosure is so great;
there to that tribunal come so many who have arisen from their rest.

90 Só dár manno nohheïn · wiht pi·mídan ni mak;
 dár skal denne hant sprehhan, · houpit sagén,
92 allero lido hwe-líhk · unzi in den luzígún vinger,
 bwaz er untar desen mannun · mordes ki·frumita.

So there may no man elude the smallest thing;
there the hand shall speak, the head shall tell,
[and] every single limb whatsoever down to the little finger,
what sort of murder it committed in the midst of these men.

91 dár skal denne hant sprehhan, · houpit sagén 'there the hand shall speak, the head shall tell | The idea that a man's own limbs shall bear witness against him is well known from the Islamic Day of Judgment (*Qur'án* 36:65, 41:20–21, 24:24), but is not found in the New Testament. It is likely an apocryphal motif that influenced Muḥammad and has made its way into this 9th c. text.

94 Dár ni ist eo só listík man · der dár io·wiht ar·liugan megi,
 daz er ki·tarnan megi · táto dehheina,
96 niz al fora demo khuninge · ki·khundit werde,
 úzzan er iz · mit alamusanu furi·megi
98 ęnti mit fastún · dio viriná ki·puazti.
 Denne der paldét · der gi·puazzit hapét,
100 denne 'r ze deru suonu kwimit.

There no man is ever so clever that he may lie about the smallest thing,
that he may hide away any deed,
so that it would not fully be made known to the King,
unless he overcame it through the giving of alms
and through fasting did penance for the wickedness.
Then is he emboldened who has done penance,
when he comes to the atonement.

 Wirdit denne furi ki·tragan · daz frôno khrúki,
102 dár der hêligo Khríst · ana ar·hangan ward.
 Denne augit er dio másún, · dio er in deru meñniskí an·fénk,
104 dio er duruh desse man-kunnes · minna far·doléta.

Then is brought forth the Lordly Cross,
whereon the Holy Christ was made to hang.
Then He reveals the wounds which He as a man received
which for the love of Mankind He suffered.

Cadman's Hymn

Dating: C7th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

Cadman's Hymn is a short Old English poem found in numerous recensions of Bede's English history, attributed to the illiterate shepherd Cadman (OE *Cædmon*). It employs several traditional Germanic poetic formulae and clearly draws on earlier, now-lost pagan compositions.

The hymn has two rhetorical parts. Lines 1–4 serve as an introductory prayer and declaration of purpose, while ll. 5–9 describe the creation, first of the Heaven (5–6) and then of Middenyard and the Earth (7–9).

Based on Kaluza's law in the younger *Beow* the pres. ed. marks etymologically long unstressed vowels.

Text

Cadman's Hymn

Nú scylun heƿgan · heþæn-ricæs ward,
 2 metudæs mæhti · end his mód-gi-þanc,
 weƿc wuldur-fadur, · swé hé wundrá gi-hwæs,
 4 éci dryhtin · ór á-stelidæ.
 Hé árist scóp · ældá barnum
 6 heþæn til hrófæ, · hâlig sceppend.
 þá middun-geard · mon-cynnæs ward,
 8 éci dryhtin · æfter tiadæ,
 firþum foldú · fréa al-mæhtig.

NOW SHALL WE PRAISE the heavenly realm's Guardian,
 the Measurer's might and His thinking mind,
 the works of the Glory-Father, as He every wonder,
 the everlasting Lord, in the beginning set up.
 He first created for the children of men
 the heaven as a roof, the holy Creator.
 Then Middenyard did Mankind's Guardian,
 the everlasting Lord afterwards make:
 the land for humans, the Lord Almighty.

Galders (INCOMPLETE!)

Introduction to Galders

The Germanic word “galdar” (PGmc. **galdra*) is a verbal noun derived from the old verb “gale” (PGmc. **galan*), meaning ‘to sing, to chant’. A “galdar” is therefore what is chanted or sung, more specifically a magical chant, whether for the purpose of healing or cursing.

In the present section the reader will find gathered a number of such galders attested across the Old Germanic languages. Not all of these texts may be true galders, but they share a magical purpose and many formulae and stylistic features reoccur throughout.

Note that this section will only include written charms containing likely or certain pre-Christian tradition elements, e.g. the invocation of the Heathen Gods or the use of old poetic formulae. Syncretic texts which mix traditional and Christian elements (e.g. SJy 41, most of the OE galders) are also included. Thoroughly Christian prayers, however, even if metrical, are excluded from this section and may instead be found under “Poetry on Christian Subjects”.

Continental Germanic Galders

The Merseburg Galders

Dating: C9th–10th

Meter: Ancient-words-law, Galders-law

Introduction

The two **Merseburg galders** are some of the only surviving examples of genuine Heathen galders from continental West Germanic Europe, and the only ones to actually invoke the pre-Christian Germanic gods.

Textual preservation and transmission

The galders are preserved on fol. 85r of the theological manuscript Merseburger Domstiftsbibliothek Codex 136 (in the present critical edition given the signum 136) where they are written in a neat and well-trained hand. Immediately below them follows a thoroughly Christian prayer written in the same hand (Murdoch 1988, p. 360), edited below as an Appendix to the galders. The theological contents of the manuscript, the trained hand and the Latin prayer together suggest that the scribe was most likely a monk.

Summary

Both galders share a common two-part structure, each beginning with an *historiola*, a mythological account describing the successful effects of the galder in the distant mythic past, followed by an imperative *incantatio* or the galder-proper, commanding that the willed magic effect take place in the present.

The first galder (*Mers I*) begins with the *historiola* describing a group of supernatural women in the midst of a battle, affecting its outcome by fastening or loosening fetters. The *incantatio* then commands that the present fetters be destroyed so that captives may escape the enemy.

The second galder (*Mers II*) begins with the *historiola* describing a group of Gods riding through the woods. Among them is Balder, whose young foal sprains its foot. Three Gods—the otherwise unknown goddess Sithguth, the goddess Sun, the god Weden—in turn chant a healing galder over it. The

incantatio—apparently the galder sung by Weden—then commands that a present sprain be healed.

Cultural context

I generally agree with Murdoch (1988) when he convincingly argues that the galders ought to be seen as incantations written down to be sung alongside the application of salves or other instruments in the context of Christian(ized) mediæval medicine. This is important for the context of *Mers I*, since the preservation of a galder for actually removing shackles is quite unlikely. For one its effectivity must have been quite limited, and it is very unlikely that it would have been of any use in the monastic medicinal context. Considering that likely context a more reasonable use case is for a cramp, which would then be symbolically likened within the sphere of the galder to the fetters on the battlefield.

As mentioned above, the two galders are followed by a Latin liturgical formula written in the same hand. As Murdoch (1988, pp. 362–363) shows, the same formula is also found in a cure against possession in the Anglo-Saxon Bald's Leechbook, and this firmly anchors the galders within the Christian medicinal framework. Indeed, when one compares the Merseburg galders with OE galders like *Nwyr*t and Norse galders like the Ribe galder-stick (SJy 41) it becomes clear that the mixing of pagan and Christian elements in this type of text was not unusual. Monk or not, the traditional invocation of Weden must have been felt to have a particularly strong healing effect, and it was only later that he was entirely excised and demonised.

Of course this does not mean that the galders themselves are fully Christian, like Murdoch (1988) suggests. The gods they invoke are Germanic and pre-Christian, as is their alliterative poetic form and their contents (especially *Mers II*). As Murdoch (1988, pp. 360–361) himself brings up, contemporary mediæval Christian authors condemn pagan charms; and how could a galder invoking Weden himself not be considered pagan when the god is even mentioned by name in the contemporary Old Saxon Baptismal Vow (edited under Christian Poetry)? In any case, Murdoch rightly makes an important distinction: regardless of whether the galders themselves are pagan or not, they are preserved in a Christian manuscript and in that context their healing magic appears to function alongside a Latin prayer.

Parallels

Moving away from the immediate cultural context we ought to look at parallels for both galders. These will help us anchor them in a broader European tradition of magical song or galder.

Close verbal parallels to *Mers I* are found in the Norse *Háv* 150 and *Grg* 10, but those are literary monuments. As discussed above it is questionable whether it was ever actually meant to be used by shackled captives, and to my knowledge no actual galders to that effect survive.

Mers II has an impressive number of later parallels across Celtic and Germanic-speaking Northern Europe (for an overview see Hopkins 2025). These charms generally mirror both the historiola and the incantatio of *Mers II*, but almost always replace the healer with Jesus Christ. They are generally used to heal sprains or broken bones. Many are found as incantations to be recited together with the sign of the cross. Further afield the incantatio has a notable parallel in the Vedic material, for which see ll. 6–9 n.

Text

- 1 Ēinis sázun idisi · sázun hera duo dér; [136 85r/1–4]
 2 suma hapt hēptidun · suma hēri lēzidun
 suma klubodun · umbi kuonjo widi
 4 in·sprink hapt-bandun · in·var vīgandun
 .H.

ONCE DISES SAT—sat here, then there.

Some fastened fetters, some hindered armies,
 some cut asunder strong withies.

Destroy the fetter-bonds, lead the way from the foes!

.H.

1 Ēinis ‘Once’ | eiris 136

1 Ēinis ‘Once’ | This word places the historiola in a mythic or legendary past. — The ms. form *eiris* must be a spelling error. It cannot be equated with *ērist* ‘earliest’ or *ēr* ‘early, of yore’, because **ei* > *ē* before *r* is an early sound change in continental West Germanic and cannot be disregarded.

3 kuonjo widi ‘strong withies’ | This difficult phrase (in 136 written ‘*cuonio uuidi*’) is traditionally identified with the word *kuna-wid* ‘chain, fetter’ found in a few OHG glosses, which is further cognate with Gothic *kuna-wida* ‘fetter; ἄλυσίς (Streitberg 1910, p. 76)’. This interpretation, however, faces formal difficulties due to the quality of the vowel *uo* and the infix *-jo-*, neither of which match *kuna-*. I instead follow a newer interpretation and take *kuonjo* as the f. acc. pl. of the adjective *kuoni* ‘strong; keen, brave’. Cf. EWA (s.v. *kunawid*).

5 .H. | The meaning of this letter, which is very clearly visible and written in the same hand as the galders, is uncertain. To me the most convincing suggestion is that it is to be read as *.N.*, a common abbreviation for Latin *nomen* ‘name’ (cf. the Appendix below), and here presumably the name of the patient for whom the healer is chanting (Murdoch 1988, p. 363).

- 2 Fol ęnde Wuodan · vuorun zi holza [136 85r/5–12]
 2 dú wart demo Balderes volon · sín vuoz bi·ręnkít
 þú bi·guol en Sinhtgunt · Sunna era swister
 4 þú bi·guol en Frija · Volla era swister
 þú bi·guol en Wuodan · só hé wola konda:
 6 „Só-se bēn-ręnkí · só-se bluot-ręnkí · só-se lidi-ręnkí
 bēn zi bēna
 8 bluot zi bluoda

lid zi ge·liden · só-se ge·límida sín!“

FOL AND WEDEN journeyed through the woods;
 then was the foot of Balder's foal sprained.
 Then Sithguth galed over it—Sun her sister;
 then Frie galed over it—Full her sister;
 then Weden galed over it as he could well do:
 “Like bone-sprain, like blood-sprain, like joint-sprain!
 Bone to bone,
 blood to blood,
 joint to joints, like were they glued together!”

1 Fol ‘Fol’ | ‘phol’ 136 1 Wuodan ‘Weden’ | ‘uuodan’ 136 4 Frija ‘Frie’ | ‘friia’ 136

1 Fol ‘Fol’ | An otherwise unknown God; he may possibly be identified with Balder of l. 2, seeing as it is his horse whose leg is sprained. The manuscript spelling *pb-* is unusual but the alliteration with *vuoz* ‘foot’ confirms that we are dealing with the same consonant, viz. an old *f*, probably voiced to *v*.

1 Wuodan ‘Weden’ | Weden, the chief of the Gods in the Norse mythology, here appearing in his role as healer (for which cf. *Háv* 147–165, *Núryrt* 11/2). This is Weden's only literary occurrence in OHG, although his name is also found on the Runic Nordendorf fibula (cf. *Vsp* 17/4 n.) and in the Latin form *godan* in the Longbeardish Origin Myth (see Appendix to *Grm*).

3 bi·guol en ‘galed over it’ | Sang a galder over the horse; *bi·guol* the 3rd sg. past ind. of *bi·galan* ‘sing (a galder) over, begale’, the transitive of *galan* ‘gale, sing (a galder)’. Cf. *Háv* 153/4, *Oddr* 7/3–4.

4 Frija ‘Frie’ | Weden's wife, cognate with ON *Frigg*. Cf. the Longbeardish Origin Myth, where she appears as *Frea*.

4 Volla ‘Full’ | An otherwise unknown goddess in OHG. Her name is clearly cognate with ON *Fulla*, Frie's handmaiden and confidante (*Grm* P2, *Gylf* 35:6, *Skm* 1).

6–9 Só-se ... sín! ‘Like ... together!’ | As discussed above the incantatio has numerous Celtic and Germanic parallels, yet the oldest parallel by far is from Vedic India, in *AV* 4.15.1–3 (ca. 1200–900 BCE), a spell used alongside an herb to heal a broken bone. The present quotation is from the likely more original *Pippalādā* recension, but the same sts. occur in variant form as *AV* 4.12.3–5 in the more famous *Śāunaka* recension, for which see Zysk 1996, pp. 72–74. In OI (norm. N. S. Dwibhashyam): 1 *Sām majjā majjñā b^havatu*; / *sām u tē páruṣā páruḥ*; / *sām tē māṁśasya víśrastam*; / *sām snáva sām u páruva tē*. // 2 *Majjā majjñā sām-d^hiyatām*. / *Ast^hnā āst^hi āpi-rōbatu*. / *Snáva tē sām-dad^hmaḥ snávnā*. / *Cārmaṇā cārma rōbatu*. // 3 *Lōma lōmnā sām-d^hiyatām*. / *Tvacā sām-kalpaya tvācam*. / *Āśṛk tē asnā rōbatu*. / *Māṁśsām māṁśēna rōbatu*. ‘1 Let marrow be together with marrow, and let joint be together with joint for thee. Let the severed part of thy flesh be together; let sinew be together, and let limb be together for thee. 2 Let marrow be put together with marrow; let bone also grow with bone. We put together thy sinew with sinew; let skin grow with skin. 3 Let hair be put together with hair; fit together skin with skin. Let thy blood grow with blood; let flesh grow with flesh.’

Appendix

Immediately below the galders the following Latin prayer is written. Abbreviations have been resolved according to Murdoch (1988, p. 369). The prayer is closely related to the Anglican *Prayer for the Clergy and People* as found in the Book of Common Prayer (Church of England 1892, p. 58), which the present translation aims to follow where possible.

P1 Omnipotens sancte pater noster deus, qui facis mirabilia magna
 2 solus, pretende super famulum tuum N. et super cunctas con-
 gregationes illis commissas spiritum gratie salutaris, et ut in ver-
 4 itate tibi conplaceant perpetuum eis rorem tue benedictionis in-
 fundo. Per dominum nostrum Jesum Christum.

Almighty, holy Father, our God, who alone workest great marvels: send down upon thy servant N., and upon all the congregations committed to their charge, the spirit of saving grace; and, that they may truly please thee, pour upon them the continual dew of thy blessing. Through our Lord Jesus Christ.

2 famulum tuum N. 'thy servant N.' | N. abbreviating *nomen* 'name', viz. the subject of the blessing. The singular "thy servant" appears to have taken place of an earlier plural subject, for many of the following words (*illis* '(to) their (charge)' etc.) are still written in the plural—"their" is **not** to be understood as a gender neutral singular pronoun. This hints that the German scribe, in spite of his pleasing hand, may not have been fully competent in Latin.

German Wyrn-galders

Against wyrms (*Contra vermes*)

Dating: 9th c.

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

Against wyrms (abbrev. *ContVerm*) is an Old Saxon manuscript charm against wyrms located in the bone-marrow, presumably thought to cause aches.

Textual preservation and transmission

ContVerm is found as marginalia in the 9th c. manuscript Cod. Vind. (ÖNB) 751 on fol. 188v.

Contents

The galder is a sort of exorcism. It calls upon Nesse, the chief injurious wyrn-dæmon, to depart from the patient along with its nine offspring. The galder lays out a path for the wyrms to leave the sufferer's body and instead go into an arrow or sharp point (*strála*), perhaps a ritual implement used to draw blood from the affected area.

A closely related galder is found in Old High German form under the title *Pro Nessia* 'Against Nesse' (*ProNessia*), edited immediately below.

The structure "Go from X to Y, from Y to Z" may be very old, for it is also found in some of the Romani charms collected by Leland (1891, pp. 27, 28, 95), for which see note to ll. 2–3.

Text

2 Gang út, Nesso, · mid nigun nessi-klínon,
 út fana þemo marge an þat bēn, · fan þemo bēne an þat fleşg,
 út fan þemo fleşgke an þia húd, · út fan þera húd an þesa strála.

4

Drohtin, werþe só.

Go OUT, NESSE, with nine small Nesses!

Out from the marrow into the bone, from the bone into the flesh,

out from the flesh into the skin, out from the skin into this arrow.

Lord, may it be so.

1 Nesso ‘Nesse’ | An otherwise unknown dæmon, entitled *Nessia* in the Latin title to the version of this spell (*ProNessia*). The *naming* of the dæmon or spirit which is to be excised is commonplace in ancient magic, including several other galders edited here. The idea is that knowledge of the name of the entity gives the magician power over it.

2–3 út ... strála ‘Out ... arrow.’ | As mentioned in the Introduction, one of Leland’s charms is particularly similar to *ContVerm* and by extension *ProNessia*. In both the Germanic and Romani charms, the wyrms (Romani *kirmora* < Sanskrit *kṛmi*, which is probably related to PGmc. **wurmiz*, although the irregular variation in the initial consonant is unusual and perhaps due to a taboo deformation) are to leave the body and instead go into the ritual implement, in the Gypsy charm an ointment. I take the freedom to reproduce the charm in full with Leland’s introduction and translation, but line-breaks in the verse replaced by slashes:

“Before sunrise wolf’s milk (Wolfsmilch, rukeskro tçud) is collected, mixed with salt, garlic, and water, put into a pot, and boiled down to a brew. With a part of this the afflicted spot is rubbed, the rest is thrown into a brook, with the words:—

Kirmora jánen ándre tçud / Andráł tçud, andré sir / Andráł sir, andré páñi, / Panensá kiyá dádeske, / Kiyá Niváseske / Pçándel tumen sbelebá / Eñáúárdesh teñá!

‘Worms go in the milk, / From the milk into the garlic, / From the garlic into the water, / With the water to (your) father, / To the Nivasi, / He shall bind you with a rope, / Ninety-nine (yards long).’” (Leland 1891, p. 95).

For Nesse (*Pro Nessia*)

Dating: 9th c.

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

Against Nesse (abbrev. *ProNessia*) is an Old High German variant of the same spell as the Old Saxon *ContVerm*, edited above.

Textual preservation and transmission

The galder is marginalia, found in the 9th c. ms. BSB Clm 18524b, on fol. 203v.

Contents

The language of *ProNessia* is Bavarian, having undergone the second sound shift. The wording is strikingly similar to the Old Saxon *ContVerm*, which is likewise directed against the dæmon Nesse and his/her nine offspring. The main difference between the two galders is in the use of the words describing the path Nesse is to take, but the core conception is identical: the dæmon is to be drawn out from the patient and into some external object.

Text

2 Gang úz, Nesso, · mit niun nessi-khīlinon,
 úz fonna marge in deo ádra, · vonna den ádrún in daz flēisk,
 fonna demu flēiske in daz fel, · fona demo velle in diz tullī.
4 Ter paternoster.

GO OUT, NESSE, with nine small Nesses!
Out from the marrow into the veins, from the veins into the flesh,
from the flesh into the skin, from the skin into this quiver.
Thrice ‘pater noster’.

3 tullī ‘quiver’ | The translation is uncertain. TODO: look up.

4 Ter paternoster “Thrice ‘pater noster’” | This Latin instruction seals the galder and places it in a thoroughly Christian medicinal context. Cf. the Introduction to *Mers*.

The Knosping Galder

Dating: C9th–10th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Knospink galder** is a short OHG galder for blessing a house.

Textual preservation and transmission

The galder is found in Ms. Car. C 176, presently in Zürich. It is found on fol. 154r amidst a number of magical charms in Latin. It is given the title *Ad signandum domum contra diabolum* ‘To bless a house against devils’.

Interpretation

The galder begins by addressing the “wight” explicitly, recognising it as such. This recognition is the equivalent of the naming of it and brings the dæmonic spirit out into the open, vulnerable to the effects of the exorcism.

The titular *chnospinci* ‘Knosping’ serves to drive away the wight. It is undoubtedly a magic word and has no clear meaning. Metrically it appears that the suffix *-pinci* has secondary stress which suggests the segmentation *chnos-pinci*, though this does not help much with its etymology.

Text

- 1 **W**ola, wiht, taz tú **w**ēist, · taz tu **w**iht heizist,
2 taz tú ne wēist noch ne **chanst** · cheden **chnos-pinci**.

Lo, wight, thou knowest that thou art called a wight,
that thou neither knowest nor canst say [the word] ‘Knosping’.

Old English Galders

There survive twelve OE metrical charms, although it is questionable whether they all qualify as galders. Notably for these texts is that they are preserved as the main text in manuscripts rather than marginalia, and that they have substantial ritual instructions alongside the words of the galders themselves.

The first four, *Nwyr̥t*, *Dweorh*, *Færst*, and “Childbirth”, are from the text known as the *Lâcnunga* (abbrev. *Lâcn*) in the manuscript Harley MS 585 (ca. 1000 CE, siglum L). One galder from *Lâcn*, “For Loss of Cattle” (A), on fol. 180v–181r, is excluded due to being entirely Christian.

The following two, “For Theft of Cattle” and *Ymbe*, both belong to Corpus Christi College, Cambridge MS 41 (abbrev. CCCC 41). Two other galders in CCCC 41, “For Loss of Cattle” (B), a variant of (A) same-named galder found in *Lâcn*, and “A Journey Charm” are thoroughly Christian and therefore excluded.

The last three galders, “Against Wen”, “Against Water-Elf-Disease”, and *Æcer*, are from various sources which will be discussed for each individual galder.

The Galder of Nine Worts

(*Nigon wyrta galdor*)

Dating: ?

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO: introduction

Numerous lines begin with small crosses which appear to serve as section markers. The present division into stanzas is largely based on these. TODO: note which.

Preserved in *Lâcn*.

Text

- 1 Ge·myne ðú mug-wyrt · hwæt þú á·meldodest
2 hwæt þu renadest · æt Regen-melde?

Rememberest thou, Mugwort, what thou didst declare,
what thou didst arrange at Reinmeld?

- 2 Una þú hâttest · yldost wyrta
2 þú miht wið *þrim* · and wið *þrí·tigum*
 þú miht wiþ *attre* · and wið *ǫn·flyge*
4 þú miht wiþ þâm *lāpan* · ðe geond lǫnd færð.

Un thou art called, the oldest of worts;
thou availest against three and against thirty;
thou availest against the venom and against the onfler;
thou availest against the loathsome one that journeys through the lands.

2 wið *þrim* · and wið *þrí-tigum* ‘against three and against thirty’ | I.e. ‘against a great number of foes’. ‘Three and thirty’ is formulaic and appears in many later English and Scottish folk-songs, viz. Child 4EFG, 18B, 20C, 30, 53BCDEIKM, 63EFH, 73I, 97AC, 100AG, 110BGH, 156G, 185A, 187A, 187C, 190A, 192A, 193B, 203C, 211A, 217GHLN, 244A, 268A, 269C, 281ABC. Things described include horses, heads of cattle, warriors, days, years, winters.

- 3 Ond þú weg-bráde · wyrta módor
 2 éastan opene · innan mihtigu
 ofer ðy cræte curron · ofer ðy cwéne reodon
 4 ofer ðy brýde brýodedon
 ofer ðy fearras fnærdon.

And thou, Waybroad, mother of worts,
 open from the east, mighty within.
 Over thee TODO.

TODO
 TODO

- 4 Eallum þu þon wið-stóde · and wið-stunest
 2 swá ðú wið-stonde attre · and qn-flyge
 and þæm lāðan · þe geond lōnd fereð.

Them all didst thou then withstand, and didst stop;
 so mayst thou withstand the venom and the onflier,
 and the loathsome one that journeys through the lands.

- 5 Stune hætte þeos wurt, · héo on stâne ge-weox
 2 stōnd héo wið attre, · stunað héo wærce
 Stiðe héo hatte, · wið-stunað héo attre
 4 wreceð héo wrāðan, · weorpeð út attor.

Stun is this wort called, she grew on stone;
 she withstands venom, she stops aches.
 Stithe is she called, she stops the venom;
 she drives away the wroth one, casts out the venom.

- 6 Þis is séo wurt · séo wiþ wrym ge-feaht
 2 þeos mæg wið attre, · héo mæg wið qn-flyge;
 héo mæg wið ðām lāpan · ðe geond lōnd fereþ.

This is the wort that fought against the Wrym;
 this one avails against the venom, she avails against the onflier;
 she avails against the loathsome one that journeys through the lands.

- 7 Fleoh þú nú attor-lāðe, · séo lāsse ðá mārān
 2 séo mære þá læssan, · oððæt him beigra bót sý!

TODO
 TODO.

- 8 Ge·myne þú, mægðe, · hwæt þú á·meldodest
 2 hwæt ðú ge·ændadest · æt Alor-forda
 þæt nǣfre for ge·floge · feorh ne ge·sealde
 4 syððan him mōn mægðan · tú mēte ge·gyrede.

TODO
 TODO
 TODO
 TODO

- 9 Þis is séo wýrt · ðe wer-gulu hatte
 2 ðás on·sænde seolh · ofer sæs hrygc
 ondan attres · oþres tó bóte.

TODO
 TODO
 TODO

- 10 Ðás *nygon* magon · wið *nygon* attrum.

These nine avail against nine venoms.

- 11 Wýrm cóm snícan, · to·slât hé *man*
 2 ðá ge·nam Wóden · *nygon* wuldor-tânas
 slóh ðá þá nǣddran · þæt héo on *nygon* tó·fléah
 4 Þær ge·ændade æppel · and attor
 þæt héo nǣfre ne wolde · qn hús búgan.

A Wýrm came crawling; he tore apart a man.
 Then took Weden nine glory-twigs,
 slew then that adder, that it sprung into nine [parts].
 There ended apple and venom,
 that she would never wish to enter a house.

- 12 Fille and finule, · fela-mihtigu twá
 2 þá wýrte ge·sceop · wítig drihten
 hǣlig on heofonum, · þá hé hōngode;

- 4 **s**eſte and **s**eſnde · on *seofon* worulde
 earmum and **é**adigum · **e**allum tó bóte.

Fill and Fennel, the many-mighty two;
 those worts the wise lord shaped,
 holy in heaven when he hung.
 He set and sent them into seven worlds,
 for wretched men and for wealthy, for all men as a remedy.

- 13 **S**tōnd héo wið wærce, · **s**tunað héo wið attre
 2 séo mæg wið *þrim* · and wið *þrí-tigum*
 wið *fēondes* hōnd · and wið *fár*-bregde
 4 wið **m**alscrunge · **m**ânra wihta.

She stands against ache, she stands against venom; she avails against three
 and against thirty; against the TODO of evil wights.

- 14 Nu magon þás *nygon* **w**yrta · wið *nygon* **w**uldor-ge·flogenum
 2 wið *nygon* **a**ttрум · and wið *nygon* **o**n-flygnum
 wið ðý **r**éadan attre, · wið ðý **r**unlan attre
 4 wið ðý **h**witan attre, · wið ðý *þewenan* attre
 wið ðý **g**eolwan attre, · wið ðý **g**rénan attre
 6 wið ðý **w**onnan attre, · wið ðý **w**edenan attre
 wið ðý **b**rúnan attre, · wið ðý **b**asewan attre
 8 wið **w**urm-ge·blæd, · wið **w**æter-ge·blæd
 wið **þ**orn-ge·blæd, · wið **þ**ystel-ge·blæd
 10 wið **ý**s-ge·blæd, · wið **a**ttor-ge·blæd

Now these nine worts avail against glory-onfliers:
 against nine venoms and against nine onfliers;
 against the red venom; against the TODO venom;
 against the white venom; against the TODO venom;
 against the yellow venom; against the green venom;
 against the TODO venom; against the TODO venom;
 against the brown venom; against the TODO venom;
 against worm-TODO; against water-TODO;
 against thorn-TODO; against thistle-TODO;
 against ice-TODO; against venom-TODO.

- 15 Gif ænig **a**ttor cume · **é**astan fleógan
 2 oððe ænig norðan cume
 oððe ænig **w**estan · ofer **w**er-þeode

If any venom should come flying from the east;

or any come from the north;
or any from the west, over mankind.

- 16 Críst stód ofer ádle · ængan cundes.
2 Ic âna wât · éa rinnende
 þær þá nygon nædran · néan be·healdað.

Christ stood over TODO;
I know one river running,
where the nine adds TODO.

- 17 Motan ealle wéoda · nu wýrtum á·springan
2 sæs tó·slúpan, · eal sealt wæter
 ðonne ic þis attor · of þé ge·bláwe.

TODO

- P1 Mucgwyr, weg-brade þe eastan open sy, lombes-cyrse, attor-
2 laðan, mageðan, netelan, wudu-sur-æppel, fille and finul, ealde
 sapan. Ge·wyrce ða wyrta to duste, mængc wiþ þa sapan and wiþ
4 þæs æpples gor. Wyrce slypan of wætere and of axsan, ge·nim
 finol, wyl on þære slyppan and beþe mid æggemongc, þonne he
6 þa sealf on do, ge ær ge æfter. Sing þæt galdor on æcre þara
 wyrta, :III: ær he hy wyrce and on þone æppel eal-swa; ond singe
8 þon mæn in þone müð and in þá éaran búta and on ðá wunde þæt
 ilce gealdor, ær he þa sealf on dó.

TODO.

Against a Dwarf

(*Wið dweorh*)

Dating: TODO

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO: Introduction.

Text

P1 Mann sceal niman *seofon* lytle of-lætan swylce mann mid ofrað,
2 ond wītan þás naman on ælcra oflætan: Maximianus, Malchus,
Johannes, Martinianus, Dionisius, Constantinus, Serafion. Þænne
4 eft þæt galdor þæt hér æfter cweð[eð] mann sceal singan, ærest
on þæt wynstre éare, þænne on þæt swiðre éare, þænne búfan
6 þæs mannes moldan; ond gá þænne ân mæden-mann tó, ond hó
hit on his sweoran, ond dó mann swá þrý dagas. Him bið sóna
8 sél.

One shall take seven small wafers, such as one offers [during the Mass], and write these names on each wafer: Maximianus, Malchus, Johannes, Martinianus, Dionysius, Constantinus, Seraphion. After that shall one sing this galder which is henceforth said; first into the left ear, then into the right ear, then over the man's head; and thereafter a maiden go forth, and hang it on his neck; and one do so for three days. He will soon be well.

1 Hér cóm in·gangan · in·spiden wiht,
2 hæfde him his haman on handa; · cwæð þæt þú his hæncest
wære,

- legeþe þe his téage ʒn sweoran; · ʒn·gunnan him ʒf þæm
 lande líðan.
 4 Sóna swá hý ʒf þæm lande cóman · þá ʒn·gunnan him þá
 leomu cólian.—
 Þá cóm in·gangan · déores sweostar;
 6 þá ge·ændode héo · ond áðas swór,
 þæt næfre þis þæm adlegan · eglían ne móste
 8 né þæm þe þis galdor · be·gýtan mihte
 oððe þe þis galdor · on·galan cūðe.
 10 Amen fíað.

Here an inspiden wight came walking in,
 had his harness in his hands, said that thou wert his horse,
 laid his reins on thy neck; they began to ride away from the land.
 As soon as they came away from the land then they began to cool limbs.
 Then the beast's sister came walking in;
 then she made an end to it and swore oaths
 that this never should torment the ailing man,
 nor him who this galder might get,
 nor whomever this galder could gale.
 Amen, let it be.

Against a Sudden Stitch

(*Wið fær-stice*)

Dating: ?

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

Attested in *Lâcn*.

Text

- 1 **H**lúde wáron hý, lá, **h**lúde, · þá hý ofer þone **h**læw ridon,
2 wáron **â**n-móde, · þá hý **o**fer land ridan.
 Scyld þú þe nú, þú þysne **n**ið · ge·**n**esan móte.
4 **Ú**t, lýtel spere, · gif hér **i**nne síe!

Loud were they, lo, loud, when they rode over the mound;
they were steadfast when they rode over land.
Shield thyself now; thou must escape this evil!
Out little spear if here within it be!

- 2 Stód under **l**inde, · under **l**eohtum scylde,
2 þær þá **m**ihtigan wíf · hýra **m**ægen be·ræddon
 and hý **g**yllende · **g**âras sændon;
4 ic him **ó**ðerne · **e**ft wille sændan,
 fléogende **f**lâne · **f**orane tó·géanes.
6 **Ú**t, lýtel spere, · gif hit her **i**nne sý!

I stood under the linden [SHIELD]—under the light shield—
where those mighty women arrayed their might
and their yelling spears did send.

To them I will send back another one:
a flying arrow, aimed against them.
Out little spear if here within it be!

- 3 Sæt smið, · slóh seax,
2 lytel ísærna, · wund swiðe.
 Ūt, lytel spere, · gif her inne sý!

A smith sat, forged the sax:
a little iron-thing—a great wound.
Out little spear if here within it be!

- 4 Syx smiðas sæton,
2 wæl-spera worhton.
 Ūt, spere, · næs in, spere!
4 Gif her inne sý · ísenes dæl,
 hæg-tessan ge-weorc, · hit sceal ge-myltan.

Six smiths sat,
wrought slaughter-spears.
Out, spear! Be not in, spear!
If here within be a piece of iron,
the work of a hagtess—it shall melt!

- 5 Gif þú wære on fell scoten · oððe wære on flæsc scoten
2 oððe wære on blód scoten · [...]
 oððe wære on lið scoten, · næfre ne sý þín líf atæsed;

If thou wert shot in the skin or wert shot in the flesh,
or wert shot in the blood, [...],
or wert shot in the limb—never be thy life injured.

- 6 Gif hit wære esa ge-scot · oððe hit wære ylfa ge-scot
2 oððe hit wære hæg-tessan ge-scot, · nú ic wille þín helpan:
 þis þé tó bóte esa ge-scotes, · þis þé tó bóte ylfa ge-scotes,
4 þis þé tó bóte hæg-tessan ge-scotes; · ic þín wille helpan.

If it were a shot of Eese or it were a shot of Elves
or it were a shot of a hagtess—now I will help thee!
This for thee as remedy against shot of Eese; this for thee as remedy against
shot of Elves;
this for thee as remedy against shot of a hagtess—I will help thee!

1 *ësa ... ylfā* ‘of Eese ... of Elves’ | Formulaic; see Eese and Elves. That they are held in the same category as the *hagtes*—a witch—indicates Christian influence. Also among the West Germanic peoples the Elves and Eese were originally beneficial beings as seen by numerous names like *Alfred* (OE *Elf-rād* ‘Elf-counsel’), *Oswald* (OE *Ōs-weald* ‘Os-power’), *Elfwin* (Lomb. *Alb-oin* ‘Elf-friend’), *Oshelm* (Lomb. *Anselm* ‘Os-helmet’).

3 *þis þe tó bóte* ‘This for thee as remedy’ | The three-fold repetition of this phrase is formulaic; cf. *Birþ* I 1.

- 7 **F**leo þær on · **f**yr̃gen-hæfde!
 2 **H**āl wes-tu, · **h**elpe þīn drihten!
 Nim þonne þæt seax, á·dó on wætan.

TODO.

Hale be thou, may the Lord help thee.

Take then the knife, TODO.

Three Galders for Birth

Dating: TODO
Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO: Introduction.

This text properly seems to consist of three separate galders/rituals for childbirth.

Found in *Lácn*, fol. 185r–v.

Text

Galder I

- P1 Sé wíf-man, sé hire cild a·fédan ne mæg, gange tó ge·witenes mannes
birgenne and stæppe þonne þriwa ofer þá byrgenne and cweþe
þonne þriwa þás word:

TODO: translation.

- 1 þis mé tó bóte þære lāðan læt-byrde,
2 þis mé tó bóte þære swæran swært-byrde,
þis mé tó bóte þære lāðan lam-byrde.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

¹ þis mé tó bóte ‘This for me as remedy’ | The three-fold repetition of this phrase is formulaic; cf. *Férst* 6/3 n.

- P2 And þonne þæt wíf séo mid bearne and héo tó hyre hlāforde on
2 reste gá, þonne cweþe héo:

TODO: translation.

- 2 **U**p ic gonge, · ofer þe stæppe
 2 mid cwican cilde, · nalæs mid cwellendum,
 mid ful-borenum, · nalæs mid fægan.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- P3** And þonne seo módor ge·fele þæt þæt bearn sí cwic, gá þonne
 2 tó cyrican, and þonne héo tó·foran þan weofode cume, cweþe
 þonne:

TODO: translation.

- 3 **C**riste, ic sǣde, · þis ge·cýþed!

TODO: TRANSLATION.

Galder II

- P1** Se wíf-mōn, se hyre bearn a·fēdan ne mæge, ge·nime héo sylf
 2 hyre āgenes cildes ge·byrgenne dǣl, wry æfter þonne on blace
 wulle and be·bicge tó cēpe-mannum and cweþe þonne:

TODO: translation.

- 1 Ic hit be·bicge, · ge hit be·bicgan,
 2 þás sweartan wulle · and þysse sorge corn.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

Galder III

- P1** Se man se þe mæge bearn a·fēdan, nime þonne ánes bleos cú
 2 meoluc on hyre handæ and ge·supe þonne mid hyre múþe and
 gange þonne tó yrnendum wætere and spiwe þær in þá meolc
 4 and hlade þonne mid þære ylcan hand þæs wæteres múð fulne
 and for·swelge. Cweþe þonne þás word:

TODO: translation.

- 1 Ge·hwer férde ic mé þone mǣran · maga þihtan,
2 mid þysse mǣran · mēte þihtan;
 þonne ic mé wille habban · and hām gáan.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- P2 þonne héo tó þan broce gá, þonne ne be·seo héo, nó ne eft þonne
2 héo þanan gá, and þonne gá héo in óþer hús óþer héo út of·éode
 and þær ge·byrge metes.

TODO: translation.

For Theft of Cattle

Dating: TODO.

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO: Introduction.

Likely Christianized, but may still contain some pre-Christian elements.

From Corpus Christi College, Cambridge MS 41, p.206.

Note the curious overuse of the prefix *oð-*.

Text

P1 Ne for·stolen ne for·holen nanuht, þæs ðe ic age, þe ma ðe mi-
2 hte Herod urne drihten. Ic ge·þohte sancte Ead-Elenan and ic
 ge·þóhte Crist on róde á·hangen; swa ic þence þis feoh to find-
4 anne, næs to oð·feorrganne, and to witanne, næs to oð·wyrceanne,
 and to lufianne, næs to oð·lædanne.

TODO: translation

1 Gar·mund, · Godes ðegen,
2 find þæt feoh · and fere þæt feoh
 and hafa þæt feoh · and heald þæt feoh
4 and fere hām þæt feoh.
 þæt he næfre næbbe landes, · þæt he hit oð·læde,
6 ne foldan, · þæt hit oð·ferie,
 ne hūsa, · þæt he hit oð·healde.
8 Gif hyt hwa ge·dó, · ne ge·dige hit him næfre.
 Binnan þrym nihtum · cunne ic his mihta,
10 his mægen and his mihta · and his mund·cræftas.

Eall he weornige, · swa fyer wudu weornie,
12 swa breðel · beo swa þystel,
se ðe ðis feoh · oð·fergean þence
14 oððe ðis orf · oð·ehtian ðence.

Amen.

TODO: translation

Against a Swarm

(*Wið ymbe*)

Dating: ?

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO. That bees are called “victory-wives” is interesting.

Text

P1 Wið ymbe nim eorþan, ofer-weorp mid þínre swiþran handa un-
2 der þínum swiþran fêt, and cwet:

Against a swarm take earth, throw it with thy right hand under thy right foot, and say:

1 Fó ic under fót, · funde ic hit.
2 Hwæt eorðe mæg · wið ealra wihta ge·hwilce
and wið andan · and wið æminde
4 and wið þá micelan · mannes tungan.

I catch under foot, I may have found it.
How, earth works against everywhich wight
and against mischief and against neglect
and against that mighty tongue of man.

4 þá micelan · mannes tungan ‘that mighty tongue of man’ | The tongue is surely here standing in for “speech”, specifically galder; i.e., if the swarming of the bees were caused by an enemy’s cursing, the earth will disarm it.

P2 And wiððon for-weorp ofer greót, þonne hí swirman, and cweð:

And with that throw the grit over, when they swarm, and say:

1 for-weorp ofer greót 'throw the grit over' | i.e., "throw the earth over the swarm".

- 2 Sitte gé, **s**ige-wíf, · **s**ígað to eorþan!
 2 Næfre gé **w**ilde · to **w**uda fleogan.
 Beo gé swá ge·**m**indige · **m**ínes gódes,
 4 swá bið **m**anna ge·hwilc · **m**etes and éþeles.

Sit ye, victory-wives; sink to the earth!
 Never ye would fly to the woods.
 Be ye so mindful of *my* good,
 like is every man of his measure and homestead.

Against Wen

(*Wið Wennan*)

Dating: ca. 1150 CE
Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO: Introduction.

British Library MS Royal 4.A.xiv, fol. 106v.

An exorcistic galder. The text has early Middle English features like the turning of old *f* to *v*.

Text

- 1 **W**enne, **W**enne · **W**enchichenne,
2 hér ne scealt þú **t**imbrien, · ne nenne **t**ún habben,
 ac þú scealt **n**orþ heonene · tó þan **n**ihgan berhge,
4 þer þú havest **e**rming, · **é**ne bróþer.
 Hé þe sceal **l**egge · **l**eaft et héafde.
6 Under **f**ót wolmes, · under **v**eþer earnes,
 under **e**arnes cléa, · **á** þú ge·weornie.

O WEN, O WEN, O little Wen!

Here shalt thou not make a home nor have any dwelling,
but thou shalt go north hence to the nearest barrow,
where thou, wretched thing, hast a brother.
He shall lay a leaf by thy head.

Under the foot of the TODO, under the feather of the eagle,
under the claw of the eagle mayst thou ever be.

- 8 **C**linge þú · al-swa **c**ol on heorþe,

- 10 *scringe þú · al-swa **s**cerne awage,*
 and ***w**eorne þú · al-swa **w**eter on anbre.*
 Swá litel þú ge·wurþe · al-swa lín-sét-corn,
12 and miccli lesse al-swa ánes hand-wurmes hupeban,
 and al-swa litel þú ge·wurþe þet þú ná-wiht ge·wurþe.

TODO: translation,
and mayst thou become so little that thou becomest nothing.

Against Water-Elf Disease

(*Wið Wæter-ælf-ádle*)

Dating: TODO

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO: Introduction.

Text

P1 Gif mon biþ on wæter-ælf-adle, þonne beoþ him þa hand-næglas
2 wonne and þa eagan tearige and wile locian niþer. Do him þis
to læce-dome: efor-þrote, cassuc, fone niþo-weard, eowberge,
4 elehtre, eolone, mersc-mealwan crop, fen-minte, dile, lilie, attor-
laþe, polleie, marubie, docce, ellen, felterre, wermod, streaw-
6 bergean leaf, consolde; of-geot mid ealaþ, do halig-wæter tó, sing
þis gealdor ofer þriwa:

TODO: translation

1 Ic bēnne a-wrāt · bēst beado-wræda,
2 swa bēnne ne burnon, · ne burston,
ne fundian, · ne feologan,
4 ne hoppettan,
ne wund wæxsian,
6 ne dolh diopian;
ac him self healde · hale-wæge,
8 ne ace þe þon mâ, · þe eorþan on eare ace.

TODO: translation

- P2** Sing þis manegum sibum: Eorþe þe on·bere eallum hire mihtum
2 and mægenum. Þas galdor mon mæg singan on wunde.

TODO: translation

Acre-Boot

(*Æcer-bót*)

Dating: ca. 1000

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The **Acre-Boot** (i.e., ‘Field-Remedy’, abbrev. *Æcer*) is an unusually long text mixing Catholic, Germanic, and Celtic elements.

Æcer is preserved in Cotton MS Caligula A VII, foll. 176r–178r.

Text

P1 Hér ys seo bót, hú þú meaht þíne æceras bétan gif hí nellap wel
2 wexan oþþe þær hwilc un·ge·défe þing on ge·dón bið on dry oððe
 on lyb-lâce. Ge·nim þonne on niht, ær hyt dagige, feower tyrf
4 on feower healfa þæs landes, and ge·mearca hú hý ær stódon.
 Nim þonne ele and hunig and beorman, and ælces feos meolc þe
6 on þæm lande sý, and ælces treow-cynnes dæl þe on þæm lande
 sý ge·wexen, bútan heardan béaman, and ælcra nam cúpre wyrte
8 dæl, bútan glappan ánon, and dó þonne hâlig-wæter ðær on, and
 drype þonne þriwa on þone staðol þára turfa, and cweþe ðonne
10 ðás word: „Crescite, wexe, et multiplicamini, and ge·mænig
 fealda, et replete, and ge·fyllle, terre, þás eorðan. In nomine pa-
12 tris et filii et spiritus sancti sit benedicti.“ And Pater Noster swá
 oft swá þæt óðer. And bere siþþan ðá turf to circean, and mæsse-
14 preost á-singe feower mæssan ofer þan turfon, and wende man
 þæt gréne to ðan weofode, and siþþan ge·bringe man þá turf þær
16 hí ær wæron ær sunnan setl-gange. And hæbbe him gæ·worht

of cwic-béame feower Cristes mælo and a·wite on ælcon ende:
 18 „Matheus and Marcus, Lucas and Iohannes.“ Lege þæt Cristes
 mæl on þone pyt neoþe-weardne, cweðe ðonne: „Crux Matheus,
 20 crux Marcus, crux Lucas, crux Sanctus Iohannes.“

TODO.

P2 Nim ðonne þá turf and sete ðær ufon on and cweþe ðonne nigon
 2 siþon þás word: Crescite, and swa oft Pater Noster, and wende
 þe þonne éast-weard, and on·lút nigon siðon éad-mód=lice, and
 4 cweð þonne þás word:

TODO.

1 „Éast-weard ic stande, · ârena ic mé bidde,
 2 bidde ic þone mæran domine, · bidde ðone miclan drihten,
 bidde ic ðone háligan · heofon-rices weard,
 4 eorðan ic bidde · and up-heofon
 and ðá sóþan · sancta Marian
 6 and heofones meaht · and héah-reced,
 þæt ic móte þis gealdor · mid gife drihtnes
 8 tóðum on·týnan · þurh trumne ge·þanc,
 á·weccean þas wæstmas · ús to woruld-nytte,
 10 ge·fyllen þas foldan · mid fæste ge·léafan
 wlitigigan þas wancg-turf, · swá sé witega cwæð
 12 þæt sé hæfde áre on eorþ-ríce, · sé þe ælmyssan
 dæalde dóm-lice · drihtnes þances.“

“Turned eastwards I stand; for mercies I bid;
 I bid the famous *dominus*; I bid the great Lord;
 I bid the holy Guardian of the Heavenly Kingdom;
 Earth I bid and Up-heaven
 and the true Saint Mary,
 and Heaven's might and the high hall,
 that I this galder with the grace of the Lord
 may TODO...”

P3 Wende þe þonne III sun-ganges, a·strece þonne on and-lang and
 2 a·rim þær letanias and cweð þonne: „Sanctus, sanctus, sanctus
 oþ ende.“

TODO.

- P4 Sing þonne Benedicite a·þenedon earmon and Magnificat and
 2 Pater Noster III, and be·béod hit Criste and sancta Marian and
 þære hâlgan rôde tó lofe and to weorþinga and þâm âre þe þæt
 4 land âge and eallon þâm þe him under·ðeodde synt.

TODO.

- P5 Ðonne þæt eall síe ge·dón, þonne nime man un·cúp sáð æt ælmes-
 2 mannum and selle him twá swylc, swylce man æt him nime, and
 ge·gaderie ealle his sulh-ge·teogo to·gædere; borige þonne on
 4 þam béame stor and finol and ge·hâlgode sápan and ge·hâlgod
 sealt. Nim þonne þæt sáð, sete on þæs sules bodig, cweð þonne:

TODO.

- 2 „Erce, Erce, Erce, · eorþan módor,
 2 ge·unne þe se al-walda, · éce drihten,
 æcera wexendra · and wrídendra,
 4 eacniendra · and elniendra;
 sceafta héhre · scíre wæstma,
 6 and þære brádan · bere-wæstma,
 and þære hwítan · hwæte-wæstma,
 8 and ealra · eorþan wæstma.

“Erc, Erc, Erc, mother of the earth,

TODO...”

- 3 Ge·unne him · éce drihten
 2 and his hâlige, · þe on heofonum synt,
 þæt hys yrþ sí ge·friþod · wið ealra feonda ge·hwæne,
 4 and heo sí ge·borgen · wið ealra bealwa ge·hwylc,
 þára lyb-lâca · geond land sáwen.

TODO.

- 4 Nú ic bidde ðone waldend, · sé ðe ðás wor-uld ge·sceóp,
 2 þæt ne sý nán tó þæs cwíðol wíf · ne tó þæs cræftig man
 þæt á·wendan ne mæge · word þus ge·cwedene.“

Now I bid the Wielder who created this world,
 that there may be no wife so cunning in song nor no man so strong
 that he may turn about the words thus spoken.”

- P6 Þonne man þá sulh forð drife þá forman furh on·scéote, cweð
 2 þonne:

TODO.

- 5 „Hál wes þú, Folde, · firþa módor!
 2 Beo þú grówende · on Godes fæþme,
 fódre ge·fyllen · firþum tó nytte.“

“Hale be thou, Fold, mother of men!
 Be thou growing in God’s embrace,
 filled with fodder as a boon to men.”

- P7 Nim þonne ælces cynnes melo and a·bacæ man inn·werdre handa
 2 brádnæ hláf and ge·cneð hine mid meolce and mid hálīg-wætere
 and lecge under þa forman furh. Cweþe þonne:

TODO.

- 6 „Ful æcer fódres · firþa cinne,
 2 beorht·blowende, · þú ge·blétsod weorþ
 þæs hálīgan nōman · þe ðás heofon ge·sceop
 4 and þas eorþan · þe wé on lifiaþ;
 sé god, sé þas grundas ge·worhte, · ge·unne ús growende gife,
 6 þæt ús corna ge·hwylc · cume tó nytte.“

“Acre full of fodder for the race of men,
 brightly blooming! Thou wast blessed
 by the holy name which created this heaven
 and this earth upon which we live.
 The God who wrought these lands, grant us growing grace
 that each kind of grain may be for us a boon.”

- P8 Cweð þonne III: „Crescite in nomine patris, sit benedicti. Amen“,
 2 and Pater Noster þriwa.

TODO.

Old Norse galders

SJy 41 (SJy 41; Ribe galder-stick)

Dating: Mediæval.

Meter: Ancient-words-law, Galders-law

Introduction

A wooden stick from the Danish city of Ribe. The galder is syncretic and contains numerous pre-Christian elements in a Christian(ised) context.

The inscription may be conveniently divided into four parts. Part one (ll. 1–4) contains an introductory prayer where the healer asks for the aid of natural forces (Earth, Up-heaven and the Sun) and Christian divinities (God and Saint Mary) so that the healing may be successful. Part two (ll. 5–8) ritually exorcises any sickness which may have entered any part of the body. Part three (ll. 9–14) apparently warns the addressee that they will be haunted by “nine needs” (an old Heathen formula; see note) until they say the charm. Part four (ll. 15, which is probably prose) gives the personal name “Bonde”, perhaps the addressee, and concludes with an “Amen”.

Transliteration

Note that the part of § C following ¶ is deliberately scraped off.

§ A + io[^]rp ÷ biþ a[^]k ÷ ua[^]rp ÷ o[^]k ÷ uphimæn ÷ so[^]l ÷ o[^]k ÷ sa[^]nt[^]Λ[^]maria ÷ o[^]k ÷ salfaen ÷ gud | |drotæn ÷ þæt han ÷ læ mik ÷ læknæs+ha[^]nd ÷ o[^]k lif-tuggæ ÷ at[^]liuæ

§ B uiuindnæ ÷ þær ÷ botæ ÷ þa[^]rf ÷ or ÷ ba[^]k ÷ o[^]k or bræst ÷ or lækæ ÷ o[^]k or lim ÷ or øuæn ÷ o[^]k or øræn ÷ or ÷ a[^]llæ þe ÷ þær ÷ ilt ÷ kan i at

§ C kumæ ÷ suart ÷ hetær ÷ sten ÷ ha[^]n ÷ stær ÷ i ÷ hafæ ÷ utæ ÷ þær ÷ ligær ÷ a ÷ þe ÷ ni ÷ no[^]uþær ÷ þæ[^]lr ÷ l---r(a) ÷ (þ)en-nþæþeskulhuærki

§ D skulæ ÷ huærki ÷ sötæn ÷ sofæ ÷ æþ ÷ uarmnæn ÷ uakæ ÷ förr æn ÷ þu ÷ þæssa ÷ bot ÷ biþær ÷ þær ÷ a[^]k o[^]rp ÷ at kæþæ ÷ ro[^]nti ÷ amæn ÷ o[^]k þæt ÷ se +

Text

- Iorð bið ak varðe · ok up-himen
 2 sól ok sante María · ok salfen Guð dróttan
 þet hann lē mik lēknes-hand · ok lyf-tunge
 4 at lyfe *bifjande* · þer bóte þarf.

I bid Earth to guard and Up-heaven,
 the Sun and Saint Mary, and the very Lord God
 that he lend me a leecher's hand and a medicine-tongue
 as medicine for the trembler who needs the remedy.

1 Iorð bið ak varðe · ok up-himen 'I bid Earth to guard and Up-heaven' | *Iorð ... ok up-himen* 'Earth ... and Up-heaven' is a formulaic and originally pre-Christian merism representing the totality of the Cosmos; cf. *Vsp* 3. It is here used in a syncretic magical context; the *galer* (galder-singer) asks the Cosmos itself to watch over and protect him/her as he/she utters the magic words. A notable parallel to the present instance is found in the OE *Æcer* 1/4 (ca. 1000 CE), edited above. Cf. also a 14th c. version of the Icelandic *Gríða-mál* 'Grith-speech', a legal formula for the establishments of truces between former enemies, where we read that: *Jorð rēðr gríðum fyrir neðan, en upp-himinn varðar fyrir ofan, en sjór fyrir útan, sá er kringir um öll lönd*. 'The earth rules the griths from below, and Up-heaven guards them from above, and the sea from without which encircles all lands' (*DI* II, p. 659). For an older version of the *Gríða-mál* lacking the just-cited passage cf. *Gr* 73. Due to its invocation of pre-Christian cosmology and its use of likely pre-Christian legal formulae like *rēkr ok rekinn* 'fit to be driven out and exiled' and *gríð-niðings nafn* 'name of a grith-nothing' (which in *Vatn* 26 is paired with the certainly pagan legal term *gōða-gremi* 'wrath of the gods'; cf. *Hárð* 60 n.) it is likely that the *Gríða-mál* reflects a late remnant of pre-Christian law. Together with the present galder and *Æcer* 1/4 all three texts appear to reflect a common pre-Christian Germanic ritual expression.

- Ór bak ok ór brýst
 6 ór líke ok ór lim
 ór øven ok ór øren
 8 ór alle þé · þer illt kann í at-kume.

Out of back and out of breast!
 Out of body and out of limb!
 Out of eyes and out of ears!
 Out of everything, where evil might come in!

- Svart hēter stēnn · hann stér í hafē úte,
 10 þer ligger á þé níu nauðer;
 þē skule hverki sōten sofe;
 12 eð varmen vake;
 fōrr en þú þessa bót biðer,
 14 þer ak orð · at-kvęðe rúnti.
 Amen ok þat sé.

Swart is a stone called; it stands out in the ocean.

There lie on it nine needs;

they will neither sleep sweetly

nor wake warmly,

until thou prayest this remedy

to which I have spoken the runic(?) words.

Amen and let it be so.

11 þé | *add., but scraped off and poorly legible* † ÷ þæſr ÷ l---r(a) ÷ (þ)en-nþþæþeskulhuærki† (*a poorly carved form of ll. 9–10*) SJy 41

The Canterbury Galder (E DR419)

Dating: ca. 1075
Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

This Old Norse galder (abbrev. *Cant*, with runological signum E DR419) is found in the Anglo-Saxon manuscript Cotton Caligula A XV. It runs across the bottom margin of the two facing pages 123v and 124r and is written in very clear runes of Wiking Age long-stave type. One rune, **g** in **vigi** *vegi* ‘smite’ is stung. The text has no word separators.

The galder is very similar to U Fv1933;134 and U NOR1998;25 from Sig-tuna, Sweden. They all belong to a type of magical healing where an illness-causing devil is commanded to leave the suffering person. The final line, *viðr áðra-vari* ‘against pus of veins’ is probably a declaration of purpose.

Text

Gyrils sár-þvara!
2 Far þú nú, · fundinn es-tu!
Þórr vegi þik · þursa dróttinn!
4 Jórils sár-þvara!
Viðr áðra-vari.

O Gyrel’s wound-borer!
Go thou now; found art thou!
May Thunder smite thee, lord of Thurses!
O Erel’s wound-borer!
Against pus of veins.

3 þursa dróttinn ‘lord of Thurses’ | Formulaic, also found in U Fv1933;134 and *Þrk* 6/2 (n), 11/2 et c.

Sigtuna rib (U NOR1998;25)

Dating: ca. 1100

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO: Introduction.

Text

- Jórls vrið, ... vaksna úr Króki!
2 Batt han riðu · barði hann riðu,
 auk síða sarð · sára rann.
4 Vara hafir fullt fengit; · flý braut, riða!

O Erel's trembling, grow out of Crook!
He bound the fever; he beat the fever,
and thereafter fucked(?) the house of wounds.
The pus has he fully caught—fly away, fever!

Sigtuna Plate I (U Fv1933;134)

Dating: C11th
Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO: Introduction

Text

Þurs sár-riðu, · þursa dróttinn;
2 fliu þú nú · fundinn es!
'Af þér þríar þráar, ulfr;
4 'af þér níu nððir, ulfr!
'Efir þessi sér, auk es unir ulfr.
6 Niut lyfja!

O thurse of the wound-fever, O lord of Thurses;
fly thou now; found art thou!
Have for thee three yearnings, O wolf!
Have for thee nine needs, O wolf!
He has this for himself, and the wolf is content.
Benefit from the medicine!

Galders from Bryggen

Introduction

Several galders or magical inscriptions are part of the cache of mediæval rune-inscribed objects found at Bryggen in the city of Bergen, Norway. For simplicity's sake, they are here listed in ascending order of their runological numbers.

N B257

Dating: ca. 1335

Meter: Galders-law

A stick inscribed on four planed sides. Part of the stick is broken off, which renders the text incomplete. The inscription is clearly a “love-charm” (that is, a piece of sexually coercive magic), addressed—as shown by the feminine dative *sjalfri þér* ‘thy self’ on side D—to a woman. The language closely resembles that of *Skí* 36, in which Shirner, Free’s servant, threatens to carve a runic inscription which will curse the ettin-woman Gird with *ęrgi* ‘queerness, degeneracy’, *óði* ‘madness’, and *ó-þoli* ‘restlessness, impatience’ unless she sleep with his master. It seems that we are here dealing with just such a surviving runic curse, and that *Skí* 36 is reflecting an authentic form of Norse “love magic” (for it is unlikely that the present inscription should derive directly from that poem) by which a woman is cursed with sexual restlessness until she succumb to the will of the male curser.

A more distant parallel may be seen in the curse-formula found on the two C7th runic inscriptions from Stentoften and Björketorp (see TODO), wherein the destroyer of the respective monuments is cursed to become *herma-lauser argjú* ‘restless (a different root from *ó-þoli* above!) with queerness’, i.e., ‘incessantly randy’.

Side D ends with a string of fake-Latin gibberish, a clear sign of Christian syncretic influence on the Old Norse-Germanic magical tradition.

A Ríst ek **b**ót-rúnar · ríst ek **b**jarg-rúnar
 ein-falt við **q**lfum

- 4 **tví**-falt við **trollum**
 þrí-falt við **þursum**

I carve remedy-runes, I carve rescue-runes:
 onefold against elves,
 twofold against trolls,
 threefold against thurses.

1 bót-rúnar ... bjarg-rúnar 'remedy-runes ... rescue-runes' | Cf. *Sigrdr* 17/1.

- B** Við inni **skóðu** · **skag**-val-kyrju
 2 svá't **ei** megí · þó at **é** vili
 lé-vís kona · lífi þínu *granda*.

Against the scatheful shag-walkirrie,
 so that she may not—though she always wants to—
 that guile-wise woman—harm thy life.

- C** Ek **sendir** þér · ek **sé** á þér
 2 **ylgjar** **ergi** · ok **ó**-þola;
 á þér hríni **ó**-þoli · ok **jǫ**tuns móðr;
 4 **sit**-tu aldri, · **sop**-tu aldri.

I send to thee, I see on thee
 a she-wolf's queerness and restlessness;
 may restlessness stick on thee, and an ettin's wrath!
 Never sit, never sleep!

- D** Ant mér sem sjalfri þér.
 2 †**Beirist rubus rabus et arantabus laus abus rosa gava**†

Love me like thy self.

...

2 †**Beirist rubus rabus et arantabus laus abus rosa gava**† '...' | Latin-like gibberish.

N B380

Dating: ?

Meter: Galders-law

A short little charm explicitly invoking the two most important Heathen Gods, Thunder and Weden. The inscription postdates the official conversion of Norway by over a hundred years, and it is an open question whether the two mentioned gods were still seen in a good light or whether they had already been assimilated into the Catholic system of demons and devils. This question is important since it determines the context of the letter: was it well-wishing, assuming that the receiver was of like mind to the sender, or did he have more sinister intent than the first line lets on? Judging from the first line, and from the half-Heathen contents of many other inscriptions found at Bryggen (some from as late as the C14th), I see it as crypto-Heathen.

2 Hēill sé þú · ok í hugum góðum;
 Þórr þik þiggi,
 Óðinn þik ęigi.

Mayst thou be hale and in good spirits;
 may Thunder receive thee,
 may Weden own thee.

1 Hēill sé þú · ok í hugum góðum 'Mayst thou be hale and in good spirits' | A formulaic greeting. The very same line is found in *Hym* 41; see note there for parallels.

3 Óðinn þik ęigi 'may Weden own thee' | See note to *Vsp* 23.

Runic Poetry

Introduction to Runic Poetry

Not all poetry preserved in Runic inscriptions is included here. Magical inscriptions will be edited under Galders and the Runic version of the *Dream of the Rood* under Poetry on Christian Subjects.

Metrically the poetry is generally in Ancient-words-law. A few fragments from Jutland are in Leeds-meter and two from Sweden are in Court-spoken meter.

Introduction to the Rune Poems

Runes and other European alphabets

The *runes* are the earliest recorded script for writing the Germanic languages and as such of great cultural importance. Runic inscriptions survive from all three Germanic branches: East Germanic, West Germanic, and North Germanic, and the script remained in unbroken use by Germanic speakers for a period spanning almost twenty centuries. The earliest known inscription is the stone from Høle, Norway (TODO: cite) from around 100 CE, and as late as the 19th century farmers in Dalarna, Sweden, were still using a form of runes to communicate with each other (TODO: cite).

Like the Latin or Greek the runes are an *alphabet*, which means that each symbol or letter stands for a phoneme or sound, rather than a syllable or an idea. The runes must ultimately derive from the Greek alphabet, which in turn derives from the Phoenician abjad, an adaptation of the Egyptian Hieroglyphs. The runes cannot be directly derived from the Greek

The Rune poems

The order and names of the letters in the Runic alphabets or *futharks* stayed relatively consistent throughout the many centuries and countries in which they were used. This can probably be ascribed to the *rune poems*—poetic lists of the names of each rune with a short explanation, passed down orally as mnemonic devices to aid early Germanic learners who were doubtless far more accustomed to learn poems by heart than symbols and would greatly have profited from them in their gradual ascent to literacy.

Three such rune poems survive, from three countries: England, Norway, and Iceland. The English rune poem documents the English *futhorc*, while the Norwegian and Icelandic document the Scandinavian *younger futhark*.

When compared to the Common Germanic *elder futhark*, these two daughter scripts have taken opposing paths. Whereas the English futhorc has appended several letters for new vowels to the end of the rune row, the Scandinavian futhark has instead done away with numerous runes, namely those for *ng*, plosives *d*, *g*, *p*, the semi-vowel *w* and the vowels *o* and *e*, along with the obscure hook-shaped rune (TODO). That much of this simplification was

probably intentional, rather than the result of neglect or language change, is seen from the following facts.

First, several of the lost runes stood for sounds that did not undergo any major sound shifts in the North Germanic languages in the relevant time period. For instance, all modern Scandinavian dialects still clearly distinguish between the initial consonants in the descendants of *dagr* 'day' and *Týr* 'Tew', and most even have the same articulation of these consonants as modern English.

Second, in two archaic runic inscriptions we find clear proof that the names and sound values of some of the lost runes were still remembered and passed down even after the adoption of the simplified younger futhark. On the Swedish Rök stone (Ög 136), which is mostly composed in the younger futhark, runes of the elder futhark are used in a cipher, which works in the following way: Every younger futhark rune representing two distinct phonemes, where one of those was the sound value of that rune in the elder futhark system, and the other has been assimilated from a lost rune, is replaced by the elder futhark rune whose value it assimilated. For instance, the **k** rune, which in the elder futhark stood for only /k/, but which in the younger futhark stands for both /k/ and /g/, is replaced with the old **g** rune. A similar instance of two-scriptedness is found on the Ingelsta stone (Ög 43), where the old **d** rune is used in an otherwise younger futhark inscription, probably standing for its name *dagr* 'day', which is also attested as a male given name.

Third, there is virtually no regional variation in which runes disappear in the transition from elder to younger futhark. There is some variation in their shapes, but there is no region which, say, simplifies only the plosive consonants *t/d*, *k/g*, *b/p* > *t*, *k*, *b*, but retains the written distinction between *o* and *u*—they all go away at once.

These facts point away from neglect or a natural development of the script—they instead suggest deliberate reform. Since we lack historical sources, the motivations behind such a reform can only be guessed at, but making the script simpler may have been intended to increase literacy by making it easier to learn and faster to write. If this were the case it was certainly successful: the transition to the simplified younger futhark brings with it a huge increase in inscriptions in Scandinavia, along with interest in various ciphers, and a new tradition of inscribed stones in Denmark, where they were previously unknown.

This new system also quickly gave rise to even more simplified systems, like the "short-stave" runes found already on the C9th Rök stone, or the "staveless" runes known from northern Sweden. Both of these variants make it even faster to write on materials like wood, wax and bone; the runes also take up less space—very useful for carvers writing on limited surfaces.

In any case, the names of the runes seem to have survived these developments. Of the 16 runes found in both the English and Icelandic (which appears to be more conservative than the Norwegian) rune poems, 10—**f**, **r**, **h**, **n**, **i**, **j**, **s**, **b**, **m** and **l**—have etymologically identical names. Three of the remaining six—**þ**, **a** and **t**—in the Icelandic stand for words with clear Hea-

then associations—Thurse, Os, and Tew—and so may have been changed deliberately after the conversion of England, rather than lost in the process of oral transmission. Two more—**u** and **k**—have names which agree in form but not in meaning. Thus it is only for the old **ᚱ**-rune where there is complete disagreement about the original name. This is easily understood, since the sound which that rune designated was lost in early Old English.

The English Rune Poem

Dating: C8th–C10th
Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

Textual preservation and transmission

[TODO: abbreviation command] only survives in the printed edition of Hickes (1703–1705, vol. 1, pp. 135), based on the original manuscript which was certainly destroyed in the Cottonian fire of 1731.

Hickes introduces the poem with the following words (original emphasis kept): *E Codice MS. Bibliothecæ Cottonianæ, cujus nota, Otho, B. 10.* ‘From a manuscript codex of the Cotton Library, whose shelfmark is Otho B. 10.’

Text

ƿ (feoh) byþ ƿrofur · ƿira ge·hwylcum.
2 Sceal ðeah manna ge·hwylc · miclun hyt dælan
gif he wile ƿor drihtne · dômes hleotan.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

ᚱ (ur) byþ ʀn-mód · and ofer-hyrned,
2 ƿela-ƿrécne deor, · ƿeohteþ mid hornum,
mære mór-stapa; · þæt is módig wuht.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

ᚷ (ðorn) byþ ðearle scearp; · ðegna ge·hwylcum
2 an-feng ys yfyl, · un-ge·metun reþe
manna ge·hwylcun · ðe him mid resteð.

- I (is) byþ ofer-ceald, · un-ge·metum slidor,
 2 glisnaþ glæs-hluttur, · gimumm ge·licust,
 flor forste ge·woruht, · fæger an-sýne.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- † (ger) byþ gumena hiht, · ðon God læteþ,
 2 hālig heofones cyning, · hrusan syllan
 beorhte bleða · beornum and ðearfum.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- J (eoh) byþ utan · un-smeþe treow,
 2 heard, hrusan fæst, · hyrde fyres,
 wurt-rumun under·wreþyd, · wynan on éþle.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- K (peorð) byþ symble · plega and hlehter
 2 [...] wlancum · ðar wigan sittað
 on beor-sele · bliþe æt·somne.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- Y (eolhx)-secg eard hæfþ · oftust on fenne,
 2 wexeð on wature, · wundaþ grimme,
 blode breneð · beorna ge·hwylcne
 4 ðe him ænigne · on-feng ge·deð.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- H (sigel) sé-mannum · symble biþ on hihte,
 2 ðonn hi hine feriaþ · ofer fises beþ,
 oþ hí brim-hengest · bringeþ to lande.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- T (tir) biþ tæcna sum, · healdeð trywa wel
 2 wiþ æþelingas, · â biþ on færylde,
 ofer nihta ge·nipu · næfre swiceþ.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- B** (beorc) byþ **b**leda leas, · **b**ereþ efne swa ðeah
 2 **t**ânas b-ûtan **t**udder, · biþ on **t**elgum wlitig,
heah on **h**elme · **h**rysted fægere,
 4 ge-**l**oden **l**eafulum, · **l**yfte ge-tenge.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- M** (eh) byþ for **e**orlum · æþelinga wyn,
 2 **h**ors **h**ófum wlanc, · ðær him **h**æleþe ymb,
welege on **w**icgum, · **w**rixlaþ spræce,
 4 and biþ **u**n-styllum · æfre frofur.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- M** (man) byþ on **m**yrge · his **m**agan leof;
 2 sceal þeah **â**nra ge-hwylc · **o**ðrum swícan,
 for ðam **d**ryhten wyle · **d**óme sine
 4 þæt **e**arme flæsc · **e**orþan be-tæcan.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- l** (lagu) byþ **l**eodum · **l**ang-sum ge-þuht,
 2 gif hí sculun **n**eþun · on **n**acan tealtum,
 and hi **s**æyþa · **s**wýþe bregaþ,
 4 and se **b**rim-hengest · **b**ridles ne gymeð.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- ŷ** (ing) wæs **á**rest · mid Éast-Denum
 2 ge-sewen **s**ēcgun, · oþ he **s**iððan éast
 ofer **w**æg ge-wât, · **w**æn æfter rann;
 4 ðus **h**earingas · ðone **h**æle nemdun.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- æ** (eþel) byþ **o**fer-leof · æg-hwylcum men,
 2 gif he mot ðær **r**ihtes · and ge-**r**ysena on
brúcan on **b**lode · **b**leadum ofast.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- M** (dæg) byþ **d**rihtnes sond, · **d**eore mannum,

- 2 **m**ære **m**etodes leoht, · **m**yrġþ and to·hiht
 eadgum and **e**armum, · **e**allum brice.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- F** (ac) byþ on **e**orþan · **e**lda bearnum
 2 **f**læsces **f**ódor, · **f**ereþ ge·lome
 ofer **g**anotes bæþ; · **g**âr-sęcg fandaþ
 4 hwæþer **â**c hæbbe · **æ**þele treowe.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- F** (æsc) biþ ofer-heah, · **e**ldum dýre,
 2 **st**iþ on **st**aþule, · **st**ęde rihte hylt,
 ðeah him **f**eohtan on · **f**irbas mōnige.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- Æ** (yr) byþ **æ**þelinga · and **e**orla ge·hwæs
 2 **w**yn and **w**yrþ-mynd, · byþ on **w**icge fæger,
 fæst-lic on **f**ær-elde, · **f**yrd-geatewa sum.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- *** (iar, ior) byþ **é**a-fixa, · and ðeah **á** bruceþ
 2 **f**ódres on **f**oldan, · hafað **f**ægerne eard,
 wætre be·**w**orpen, · ðær he **w**ynnum leofað.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

- T** (ear) byþ egle · **e**orla ge·hwylcun,
 2 ðonn **f**æst-lice · **f**læsc on·ginneþ,
 hraw colian, · **h**rusan ceosan
 4 **b**lac to ge·beddan; · **b**leda ge·dreosaþ,
 wynna ge·witaþ, · **w**era ge·swicaþ.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

The Icelandic Rune Poem

Dating: Mediæval.

Meter: Unclear.

Introduction

The **Icelandic Rune Poem** (abbrev. *RunI*) is one of two West Norse rune poems describing the Younger Futhark.

The text is highly formulaic. All lines begin with the respective rune's name, followed by three kennings for it. It is only attested in late manuscripts which often have major disagreements with each other.

TODO: reference Mikael Males article about rune poems

Textual preservation and transmission

RunI is preserved in several manuscripts, none mediæval. The oldest is AM 687 d 4to (henceforth 687d), dating to ca. 1500 CE, where the poem takes up the leaf 1v. In this ms. each rune takes up one line. The names of the runes are not given, but the name is written out by the rune, so that the first stanza begins *ℱ er frēnda róg*, the second *Λ er skýgia grátur*, and so forth. 687d/1v is complete, but much of the ink has faded and

Text

- 1 **ℱ** es frēnda róg · ok flóðar viti
2 ok graf-seiðs gata.

Wealth is strife of kinsmen and beacon of the sea
and grave-saithe's [SERPENT'S] street.

- 2 **Λ** er skýja grátr · ok skára þverrir
2 ok hirðis hatr.

Drizzle is weeping of clouds and ...
and shepherd's hatred.

- 3 Þurs es kvenna kvöl · ok kletta í-búi
2 ok varð-rúnar verr.

Thurse is women's torment and indweller of hills
and husband of the cairn-whisperess [TROLLWOMAN].

- 4 Öss es aldinn gautr · ok Ös-garðs jöfurr,
2 ok Val-hallar vísi.

Os is ancient Geat, and Osyrd's chief,
and Walhall's overseer.

- 5 Reïð es sitjandi sēla · ok snúðig ferð
2 ok jóð ęrfiði.

Chariot is sitting bliss and twirling journey
and horse's heavy work.

- 6 Kaun es barna bøl · ok bar-dagi
2 ok hold-fúa hús.

Boil is children's curse and TODO
and house of flesh-rot.

- 7 Hagall es kalda korn · ok knappa drífa
2 ok snáka sótt.

Hail is cold kernel and storm of beads
and sickness of snakes.

- 8 Nauð es þýjar þrý · ok þungr kostr
2 ok vās-samlig verk.

Need is maidservant's yearning and scant choice
and working in wet-cold weather.

- 9 Íss es áar bęrkr · ok unnar þękja
2 ok ęęgra manna fār.

Ice is river's bark and wave's roof
and fey men's danger.

- 10 Ár es gumna góði · ok gótt sumar
2 ok al-gróinn akr.

Year is men's boon and good summer
(and) all-grown acre.

- 11 Sól es skýja skjöldr · ok skínandi røðull
2 ok ísa aldr-tregi.

Sun is the shield of clouds and shining wheel
and ice-sheets' life-sorrow.

- 12 Týr es ein-hendr oss · ok ulfs leifar
2 ok hofa hilmir.

Tew is the one-handed Os and the wolf's leftovers
and lord of hoves.

- 13 Bjarkan es laufgat lim · ok lítit tré
2 ok ung-samligr viðr.

Birch is leafy branch and little tree
and youthful wood.

- 14 Maðr es manns gaman · ok moldar auki
2 ok skipa skreytir.

Man is man's joy and the product of dust
and adorning of ships.

- 15 Løgr es vellanda vatn · ok víðr ketill
2 ok glömmungr grund.

Liquid is boiling water and wide kettle
and TODO.

- 16 Ýr es bændr bogi · ok brot-gjarnt járn
2 ok fęnju fleygir.

Yew is a bent bow and easily broken iron
and arrow's hurler.

The Norwegian Rune Poem

Dating: Mediæval.

Meter: Unclear.

Introduction

The **Norwegian rune poem** is one of two Scandinavian rune poems along with the Icelandic, with which it is clearly very closely related.

Textual preservation and transmission

TODO.

Style and contents

As said above the Norwegian rune poem is closely related to the Icelandic. With the exception of runes 2 (𐌺 *úr* 'spark') and 4 (𐌿 *óss* 'river-mouth'), the names of the runes are identical, as are many of the kennings used to describe them.

Each rune is described by a couplet of 2 verses linked by end-rhyme and alliteration. The meter is noticeably trochaic, and each verse ends with a rhyming trochée. The a-verse in 15 out of 16 lines has 2 alliterations; the b-verse always has 1 falling on its very first word.

The description of all runes consists of two clauses or sentences, generally one in each verse. The first clause gives the name of the rune and a short description of it, while the second clause is more mysterious and often seems to have nothing to do with the name. A clever solution to this problem is that the second clause connects to the visual shape of the rune (TODO: cite). For some of the runes this turns out to be a rewarding line of inquiry, and potential links between the shape of a rune and the second clause are explored in the notes.

Language

The language is unmistakably that of mediæval Norway. As can be seen from the rhymes and alliteration the following uniquely Norwegian sound changes have occurred:

- *hl, hn, hr > l, n, r* (2 *lęyr* < *hlęyr*; 8 *nęppa* < *hnęppa*; 5 *rosum* < *brosum*).
- *rst > st* (5 *vęsta* < *vęrsta*)

Text

Ʀ Fé veldr frénda rógi; · fōðisk ulfr í skógi.

‘Wealth’ causes the strife of kinsmen; the wolf rears itself in the wood.

1 fōðisk ulfr í skógi ‘the wolf rears itself in the wood’ | Almost certainly visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and the upwards curving branches of the pine tree; the keyword is *skógr* ‘wood, forest’.

ᚱ Úr er af eldu jarni; · opt leypr reinn á hjarni.

‘Spark’ comes from glowing iron; oft leaps the reindeer on the snow.

1 Úr ‘Spark’ | Properly ‘drizzle’, but here used metaphorically for the sparks or tiny particles of hot metal that flow out of burning iron when struck.

1 opt leypr reinn á hjarni ‘oft leaps the reindeer on the snow’ | Likely visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and the hoof-print of a reindeer in the snow; the keyword is *reinn* ‘reindeer’.

ᚢ Þurs veldr kvinna kvillu; · kátr verðr fár af illu.

‘Thurse’ causes women’s ailment; few are gladdened by evil.

1 kátr verðr fár af illu ‘few are gladdened by evil’ | Lit. ‘few a man becomes glad from evil’. Visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and a smiling face; the keyword is *kátr* ‘glad, happy’.

ᚦ Óss er flestra fęrða · fęr, en skalpr er sverða.

‘River-mouth’ is the route of most journeys, but the scabbard-mouth of swords.

1 en skalpr er sverða ‘but the scabbard-mouth of swords’ | Perhaps visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and a sword in its scabbard, although that is uncertain.

ᚷ Reįð kveða rossum vęsta; · Ręinn sló sverđit bęsta.

‘Chariot’ they say is worst for the horses; Rein forged the best sword.

ᚱ Kaun er barna bęlván; · bęl gęrvir ná fęlván.

‘Ulcer’ is the curse of children; a bale makes a corpse pale.

ᚠ Hagall er kaldastr korna; · Kristr skóp hęim’inn forna.

‘Hail’ is coldest of kernels; Christ created the world of yore.

1 Krístr skóp heim'inn förna 'Christ created the world of yore' | Visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and the chi-rho; the keyword is *Krístr* 'Christ'.

† Nauðr gørir neppa kosti; · nøktan kælir í frosti.

'Need' gives scant choice; the naked man freezes in the cold.

1 nøktan kælir í frosti 'the naked man freezes in the cold' | Perhaps visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and the human body in the form of a naked stick-figure; the keyword is *nøkr* 'naked'.

l Ís kollum brú breiða; · blindan þarf at leiða.

'Ice' we call a broad bridge; the blind man must be lead.

1 blindan þarf at leiða 'the blind man must be lead' | Perhaps visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and a blind man's cane or walking stick; the keyword is *blindr* 'blind'.

† Ár er gumna góði; · get'k at qrr var Fróði.

'Year' is men's boon; I recall that Frood was generous.

1 get'k at qrr var Fróði 'I recall that Frood was generous' | Frood, or as he is often known, Frith-Frood (ON *fríð-Fróði*), was a legendarily generous Danish king during whose reign good harvests and peace (*ár ok fríðr* 'year and frith') abounded. He is thus mentioned due to his connection with the rune's name, not due to any visual elements of the rune.

h Sól er landa ljómi; · lúti'k hēlgum dómi.

'Sun' is the light of the lands; I bow to the holy shrine.

1 lúti'k hēlgum dómi 'I bow to the holy shrine' | Visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and the shape of a kneeling man; the keyword is *lúti'k* 'I bow'.

† Týr er ein-ēndr ása; · opt verðr smiðr blása.

'Tew' is the one-handed of the Eese; often the smith must blow.

1 opt verðr smiðr blása 'often the smith must blow' | Perhaps visually alluding to the similarity between the shape of the rune and a hammer; the keyword is *smiðr* 'smith'.

ᛒ Bjarkan er lauf-grónstr lima; · Loki bar flérða tíma.

'Birch' is the leaf-greenest of branches; Lock was successful in cunning.

𐀚 Maðr er moldar auki; · mikil er greip á hauki.

‘Man’ is the product of dust; mighty is the grip on the hawk.

1 mikil er greip á hauki ‘mighty is the grip on the hawk’ | Visually alluding to the shape of the bird’s talon; the keyword is *hawk* ‘hawk’.

𐀛 Løgr er þar er fellr ór fjalli · foss; en gull eru nossir.

‘Water’ is when from the fell falls a torrent, but jewels are gold.

𐀜 Ýr er vetr-grónstr viðá; · vęnt er, er brennr, at sviða.

‘Yew’ is winter-greenest of trees; ’tis expected, when it burns, to get singed.

Runic Poetry from Sweden and Gotland

Introduction

The inscriptions are sorted according to their runological signa as found in the Scandinavian Runic-text Data Base (SRDB). For most inscriptions the signum derives from the standard corpus edition *Sveriges runinskrifter* ('Runic inscriptions of Sweden') and consists of two elements, the abbreviated traditional province and the number given in the corpus edition. For example Sm 39 is the inscription given number 39 in the Småland volume of *Sveriges runinskrifter*.

Inscriptions discovered after the publication of the corpus edition describing the relevant province have instead of the number an abbreviated bibliographical reference to the *editio princeps*. For example Sö Fv1948;289 is a inscription from Södermanland first published in the 1948 volume of *Fornvännen*, page 289.

The province of Scania, although part of Sweden since 1658, was in the Wiking Age and the mediæval period an integral part of Denmark and as such its metrical inscriptions are found under Runic poetry from Denmark below.

Abbreviations of Swedish provinces

- G = Gotland
- Nä = Närke
- Sm = Småland
- Sö = Södermanland
- U = Uppland
- Vg = Västergötland
- Vs = Västmanland

- Ög = Östergötland
- Öl = Öland

G 113 (Ardre)

Dating: C12th

Location: Ardre church

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A picture stone. The palatal *r* has in several places been restored for the stone's *r*.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A ÷ utar + ak + kairuatr + ak + aiuatr + þar + setu + stain + ebtir + likna(t)
+ faþur ÷ sen +

§ B ÷ rapialbr + ak + kairaiu(t)- + þair kiarpu + merki + kuþ + ubtir + man
+ saaran ÷ likraibr + risti + runar ÷

Text

A Ótt·arr ok Gair·hvatr ok Ai·hvatr þair settu stain eptir Líkn·hvat,
faður sinn.

Oughter and Garwhat and Eanwhat, they set the stone after Likenwhat, their father.

2 B Ráð·þialfr ok Gair·niautr,
þair giörðu mērki góð · eptir mann snaran.
4 Líkn·raifr risti rúnar.

Redthelf and Garneat,
they made good landmarks after a swift man.
Likenraf carved the runes.

G 188

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A damaged and unusually difficult stone to interpret. Most of the inscription survives only in older depictions which are likely not entirely faithful.

Runes

R1B1T + Y1B1T1N

B1T + 11T1N1

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

[... auk × botaiþr × þaun litu × raisa s... ... haito × mirki mirlakt eftir man
koþ-n × kiarn uar × hann arla × a × kuþ troa × rumshafþ ×] rap(e)t × miþ
r(e)tu m[iug × tyrlak × ta · ta × uam · la · reksþe... ...](b)in × sialu h-... [lit ×
kjarþi stain × uataruek...]

Text

- ... auk Bót·aiðr, þaun létu raisa *stain* †*haito*†
2 *m*erki *m*ér-lekt · eptir *m*ann góðan;
*g*iarn var hann árla · á *G*uð tróa.
4 †*r*umshafþ† ráðit með réttu
miuk dýr-lek †*t*a:*t*a:*u*am:*l*a:*r*eksþe†
6 ... *b*ialpin síálu *h*ans.
†*l*it† giarði stain †*u*ataruek†

... and Bootheath they had the stain raised ...

A glorious landmark after a good man.

He was early eager to believe in God;

... rightly interpreted,

very glorious ...

... help his soul.

... made the stone ...

1 þaun 'they' | The neuter pl. form indicates that the raisers are a mixed-sex group.

G 203 (Hogräns)

Dating: C12th

Location: Hogräns church

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

sigmutr let rasa sain eftir bruþr : sina : auk : bro : kierua : eftir : sikbiern
 : santa mikal hie[lbi]ans auk : at : botraif auk at sigraif : auk : at
 aibiern : faþur þaira : altr : auk bikui han : i by : sunarst kairuiþr lekþi
 ormalur nemr : in[t]i ur ¶ sikmutr [--fir :] sliku : unit kuml ¶ karmanum
 : þet ar [:] ... kun : hier : mun : stanta stain : a[t] : merki bietr a : bierki
 in bro furir ¶ roþ(b)iern risti run(i)r [þ]esa kairl-ifr sumar ar karla kan

Text

Sig-mundr lét raisa stain eptir brýðr sína, auk bró gierva eptir
 Sig-biern—Sankta Mikál hielpi *siál hans*—auk at Bót-raif auk at
 Sig-raif auk at Ai-biern, faður þaira aldra,

Syemund had this stone raised after his brothers and the bridge made af-
 ter Syebeorn—may Saint Michael help his soul—and after Bootraf and after
 Syeraf and after Eanbeorn, the father of them all,

2 auk byggvi hann · ï bý sunnarst.

and he lived on the southernmost farm.

Gairviðr lögði orm-álur; némr innti ýr.

Garwith laid the serpent-tracks; TODO.

4 Sig-mundr *befir* · s·líku unnit
 kuml karl-mannum. · Þet ar †ke...† kunn.

6 Hier mun standa · stainn at merki,

8 **b**iertr á **b**iergi, · en **b**ró fyrir;
 Róð·biern **r**ísti · **r**únir þessar,
 Gair·laifr sumar, · ar **g**arla kann.

Syemund has suchwise accomplished
 a monument for men; that is known to ...
 Here the stone will stand as a mark,
 bright on the hill and the bridge below.
 Rothbeorn carved these runes,
 [and] Garlaf, who knows clearly, some.

G 207

Dating: C12th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A damaged stone. TODO. The same people also commissioned the likewise damaged G 208 below.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

butmuntr : auk : butraifr : auk : kunu[-r : þair : raistu : stain ...arþi
: karþ] : auk : sunarla : sat : miþ : skinum : auk : han : entaþis : at :
ulfshala : þa : [¶ han : hil(k)(i)...]

Text

2 Bót·mundr auk Bót·raifr auk Gunn·*bvatr*, þair raistu stain ...
 †arþi† garð,
 auk sunnar-la · sat mið skinum;
4 auk hann endaðis · at Ulfshala,
 þa hann †hil(k)(i)† ...

Bootmund and Bootraf and Guthwhat, they raised the stone ... the enclosure,
and in the south sat with skins,
and he met his end by Wolfshale
when he ...

G 208

Dating: C12th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A damaged stone. TODO. The same people also commissioned the likewise damaged G 207 above.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

[b]u[t]muntr : auk : butraifr : auk : kunua-(r) [: -]... ...tu : stain : þ...
[at : faþur : si]n : kuþ : h(i)albi : (s)elu : hans : auk : kus : muþir :
 (b)etr : þen : uir : biþia : kunin · ¶l -(a)... ... (a)-(n) (:)

Text

Bot·mundr ok Bót·raifr ok Gunnþvatr þair raistu stain þenna
 eptir ... -þvat, faður sinn.

2 Guð hialpi sélu hans · ok Guðs móðir
 betr þen vír · biðja kunnin ...

Bootmund and Bootraf and Guthwhat, they raised this stone in memory of
 ...-what, their father.

God help his soul and God's mother,
 better than we were able to pray. ...

G 343

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A ...n : raisti : kubl : eftir : hailkair : fa... ... ¶ (k)-... ... -aulu : hans :
 eu : miþan : uaralt : uakir : ligr : merki : hier : yfir : mani : þaim : ar :
 erfiki : iftir -erþi ¶ ... auk : þorlaifr : þau/þair : ristu stain
 § B f-----...

Text

- ... raisti kumbl eftir Hail·gair, faður ... sáulu hans.
- 2 Ey, miðan ver·ald vakir,
 liggr mērki hier · yfir manni þaim,
 4 ar erfingi · eftir gięðoi.
 ... auk Þor·laifr, þau ristu stain.

TODO: trans

G 370**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

uatar : auk hilkair : raistu : stain iftir hailka fþur : sin : hn : uahr -istr :
farin miþ uikikum

Text

- Hvatarr ok Hail·gair raistu stain eptir Hailga, faður sinn.*
2 Hann var *v*estr farinn · með *v*íkingum.

TODO: trans

Nä 29

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

bofriþr : let resa eftir biurn : bruþur : si(n) : han uar farin fultrekila

Text

Bó·friðr lét rêsa eftir Biorn, bróður sinn.

2 Hann var farinn · full-dręgi=la.

TODO: trans

Sm 5

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO. The carver seems to struggle with consonant clusters. Thus he spells 2b *mestr* as **mesr** and 3b *aldri* as **ali**(!). Line 2 is found near-identically in Ög 77 and Sm 37 and line 3 in Vg 187.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A : kotr : sati : sten : þana : eftir : ketil :

§ B : sun : sin : han : far :

§ C : mana : mesr o:nipikr : er a : eklati : ali : tunþi

Text

2 Gøtr satti stên þenna eptir Ketil sun sinn.
 Hann var **man**na · **m**estr ó-níðingr
 er á **E**ng-landi · **a**ldri týnði.

Geat set this stone after Kettle, his son.
 He was of men the greatest un-nothing,
 who in England lost his life.

3 *aldri* | *ali* Sm 5

2 *mestr* ó-níðingr 'greatest un-nothing' | An instance of *litotes*; Kettle was a very virtuous man.

Sm 16

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A not very tall stone, inscribed on two sides. Side A (1 *Hró-stęinn* ... 3 *kęnni=ligt*) is marked with a large cross while side B (3 *ęptir* ... 5 *ręna*) is entirely unadorned.

The inscription uses the stung runes *e* and *y* and writes the vowel *o* with the old *q*-runes.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A rostein · auk · eilifr · aki : auk · hakun : reisþu · þeir · sueinar · eftir
sin · 𐌺 𐌻𐌰𐌿𐌹𐌿 · kubl 𐌺 𐌻𐌰𐌿𐌹𐌿 · likt ·

§ B ftir · kala · taþan : þy : mun · ko... .. -m kitit · uerþa · meþ · sin · lifir
· auk · stafir · run

Text

- 2 Hró·stęinn auk E_i·lifr, · Āki auk Hō·kun,
 reistu þeir svęinar · ęptir sinn fōður
 kumbl kęnni=ligt · ęptir Kala dauðan.
4 Þý mun góðs manns · um getit verða,
 með stęinn lifir · ok stafir ręna.

Rothstan and Anlif, Onick and Hathkin,
these lads raised after their father
a remarkable monument, after the dead Cale.
Therefore will the good man be spoken of
while the stone lives and the staves of the runes.

Sm 29**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

...r · rŕþi · stin · eftir · þur(k)ir · faþur · sin · saR · (e)(t)aþis · ą · -klanti ·

Text

2 ...r rŕþi stŕn ęptir Þŕr·gŕR, fŕður sinn;
 sár ęndaðis · à *E*nglandi.

... raised the stone after Thurgar, his father.
 He met his end in England.

Sm 35 (Replösa)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A stone still standing at its original location. To its south is a stone ship original consisting of 12 stones.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

: kutraþr : karþi : kubl : þisi : iftir : astraþ : faþur : sin : þan : frita : ak :
þih:na : bistan : ir a : fin:iþi : forþum : uf|fari :

Text

2 Gaut-ráðr gerði kuml þessi eptir Öst-ráð, fôður sinn.
þann frënda · ok þegna bætstan, er á Finn-eyði · forðum of
vári.

Geatred made these monuments after Estred, his father,
the best of kinsmen and of thanes
who erstwhile lived upon the Finnheath.

2 Finn·eiði ‘the Finnheath’ | Finnveden, the folkland of Småland in which the stone is located.

Sm 37 (Rörbro)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A stone still standing at its original location.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

[:] a[**sur**] · **kar**þi : **kubl** : þesi : eftir : uit : faþur : sin · [h]an uar : mana
 : **mestr** : uníþikr [:] uar : i[n]tr : matar : uk umun hats : kuþr · þi(k)[n]
 kus tru : kuþa : hafþi :

Text

- Qssurr gerði kumbl þessi eftir Eýnd, fðður sinn.
 2 Hann var **manna** · **mę**str ð-níðingr,
 var **y**ndr matar · ok ð·munr hatrs.
 4 **Góðr** þegn **G**uðs tró · **góða** hafði.

Answer made these monuments after Eanwind, his father.
 He was of men the greatest un-nothing,
 was giving with food and late to hatred.
 The good thane had good faith in God.

Sm 39

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A standing stone inscribed on two sides, one of which has a large cross. The expression is formulaic; cf. Sm 44, Sö 130, U 703, U 739, and U 805. For “good of meat” cf. *Háv* 39. The first line is not poetic.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A : kuni : sati : stin : þana : iftir

§ B : suna : faþr : sin : milan : u... ... matar kuþa... :

Text

2 Gunni satti stên þenna eptir Sûna, fœður sinn,
 mildan orða · auk matar góðan.

Guthe set this stone after Sown, his father,
generous in words and good of meat.

Sm 44

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A heavily damaged stone. The inscription is more visible in Bautil on which the reading has to rely. The expression is formulaic; cf. Sm 39, Sö 130, U 703, U 739, and U 805.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A [: uim]ut[r] : [sa]ti : sten : þana ...

§ B [b]ruþr : s[in ...(i)n mi(l)... ... sina] ...

§ A m[a]tr : kuþan : [i] urþ[l]ufi : at[ra : m...r]

Text

2 Vé·mundr satti stên þenna *ęptir* bróður sinn ...**in**
mildan við sinna · *ok* **matar** góðan,
 i orð-lofi · **allra** miklu.

Wighmund set this stone after his brother, ...,
 generous with his kin and good of meat,
 held in great praise by all.

1 ...**in** '...' | The name of the brother cannot be restored, but the gap only leaves room for at most two runes, and so the main candidate names are Swayn (***suin** *Svënn*) and Stan (***stin** *Stënn*).

Sm 45

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

· uest-n · karþ- · (k)ub- · þesi · efter · esburn · bruþur · sin · uitrik · þesi · a
uiki-muti

Text

2 Vé·steinn gerði kumb/ þessi eptir Ēs·biorn, bróður sinn,
vitring þessi · à vega-móti.

Wighstan made these monuments after Osbeorn, his brother,
this memento at the crossroads.

Sm 46**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

The stone is lost.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

[...-nui krþi : kubl : þessi : iftir suin : sun : sin : im ÷ itaþisk ou-tr i krikum]

Text

2 ...n-ví geŕði kumbl þessi eptir Svên, sun sinn,
 e_{ER} **ę**ndaðisk · **a**ustr i Grikkjum.

...we made these monuments after Swayn, her son,
 who met his end to the east in Greece.

Sm 60

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A · sen · uk u·starki · karþu ·

§ B · kubl · þesi · efeir · kuþmut · faþur · sin · uitrk · þasi · ǧ ueha·muti ·

Text

Svênn ok Ó·starki gērðu kumbl þessi ęptir Guð·mund, fǫður
sinn,

² vitring þási · ǧ vega·móti.

Swayn and Unstark made these monuments after Godmund, their father,
this memento at the crossroads.

Sö 9 (Lifsinge)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

barkuiþr × auk × þu : helka × raistu × stain × þansi : at · ulf : sun · sin · han
 × entaþis + miþ : ikuari + ¶l kuþ + hialbi + salu ulfs ×

Text

- 2 Bark-viðr ok þau Hēlga reistu stēin þannsi at Ulf, sun sinn.
 Hann ęndaðis · með Ing-vari.
 Guð hialpi sōlu Ulfs.

TODO

Sö 14 (Gåsinge)

Dating: C11th
Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

rakna · raisti · stain · þansi · at · suin · buta · sit · auk · sifa · auk · r-knburk
 · at · sit · faþur · kuþ · hil[b]i · at · [hat]s · uit · iak · þet · uar · sui- · uestr ·
 miþ · kuti

Text

Ragna reisti stēin þannsi at Svein, bónda sinn, auk Sefa auk
 Ragn·borg at sinn fǫður. Guð hialpi and hans.

2 Veið iak þet var Sveinn · vestr með Knúti.

Rainie raised this stone after Swayn, her husband, and Seve and Rainbury
 after their father. God help his spirit.
 I know that Swayn was in the west with Canute.

Sö 33**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

+ gñubha ÷ liþ : raisa : stain : þinsa : hibtir : kulaif : brupur sin ¶ han :
 antaþis : austr : at þikum

Text

- 2 Gnúpa lét reisa stein þennsa eptir Gulleif, bróður sinn.
 Hann **endaðis** · **austr** at þingum.

TODO: trans

Sö 34–35 (Tjuvstigen)

Dating: C11th–C12th
Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

Two paired stones standing next to each other. The last two lines of Sö 35 is not poetic.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

Sö 34: styrlaugr · auk · hulmbr · staina · raistu · at · bryþr · sina · brau(t)u
 · nesta · þair · entaþus · i · austruiki · þurkil · auk sturbiarn þiagnar · kuþir
 Sö 35: lit · igiker · anan · raisa · stain · at · suni · sina · su[n-]a · kiarþi · kuþ
 · hialbi · ant · þaira × þurir · hiu ·

Text

Sö 34

Styr·laugr ok Holmbr · stęina ręistu
 2 at brōðr sına, · brautu nęsta.
 Þęir ęndaðus · i austr-vegi,
 4 Þor·kęll ok Styr·bięrn, · þiagnar góðir.

Sturley and Holm raised the stones
 after their brothers, nearest to the road.
 They met their end in the Eastern way,
 Thurkettle and Sturbeorn, good thanes.

2 brautu nęsta ‘nearest to the road’ | Cf. *Háv* 72.

Sö 35

Lét Ingi·geirr · annan ręisa stęin
 2 at syni sına, · sýna gięrði.
 Guð hialpi ęnd þęira.
 4 Þórir hjó.

Inggar let another stone be raised
after his sons; he made it seen.
God help their spirit.
Thurer hewed.

Sö 41

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

tati + iok + eftir + faþur + sin × skaka × mirki| lit + mikla + man + (i)aurn

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

Sö 47**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

...(R)-kR : kiarþi : kuml : þat:si : eftir : ašmunt : sun : sin + han : is :
krafín : a · ku... <raur> : <uart/fart> : at : ryr:iks : sun

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

Sö 54

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A þurstain : auk : aystain : auk : natfari : raistu : stain : at : finuiþ : auk
 : ulif : þurkil buruþr sin ¶ uaru · alir · uikiks · sunir ¶ latburnir · man ·
 litu · rita · stain

§ B stankil · rist · runar

Text

Þór·steinn auk Ey·steinn auk Nátt·fari reistu stein at Finn·við
 auk Ó·leif, Þór·kell, bróðr sína.

2 Vǫru allir · Víkings synir;
 land·burnir menn · létu rétta stein.

4 Stein·kell reist runar.

Thurstan and Eanstan and Nightfarer raised the stone after Finnwood and
 Anlaf [and] Thurkettle, their brothers.

They were all the sons of Wiking;
 land-born men had the stone erected.
 Stankettle carved the runes.

Sö 55 (Bjudby)

Dating: C11th

Location: Bjudby, Blacksta parish, Oppunda hundred

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO: INTRODUCTION.

The language is later than most other England stones. The os-rune is used for /o/, palatal *r* has dropped after all consonants, and stung *e* is used.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

þorstain (l)(i)... ...sa : stain : þena : ... sik : sialfan : auk : sun : sin : hefni :
 uar til : enklans : ukr : trenkr : farin : uarþ : þa · haima : at : harmi tauþr
 ¶ kup hialbi : sialu : þaima ¶ bruni : auk : sloþi : þair ...(u) stan þena

Text

- Þór-stéinn lét rēisa stēin þenna ēptir sik sialfan auk sun sinn
 Hefni.
 2 Var til Eṅg-lands · ungr dreṅgr farinn,
 varð þa hēima · at harmi dauðr.
 4 Guð hialpi sialu þeira.
 Brúni auk Slóði þeir ristu stēin þenna.

Thurstan had this stone raised after himself and his son Hefner.
 To England had the young dreng travelled,
 then at home he died tragically.
 God help their souls.
 Brown and Sloth they carved this stone.

Sö 56 (Fyrby)

Dating: C11th–C12th
Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO: INTRODUCTION.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

iaċ · uait : hastain : þa : hulmstain : bryþr · menr : rýnasta : a : miþkarþi
 : setu : stain : auk : stafa : marga eftir · fraystain · faþur · sin ·

Text

Iak veit Há·stęin · þá Holm·stęin bróðr
 2 męnnr rýnasta · à Mið·garði
 settu stęin · auk stafa marga
 4 eptir Frey·stęin · fǫður sinn.

I know Highstan and Holmstan, the brothers,
 the most rune-cunning men in Middenyard.
 They set the stone and many staves
 after Freestan, their father.

Sö 61

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

þorstain : lit · þina : rita : stain : e(f)ila : stetr : eftir : þorbiarn : salui ·
 auk : simiþr : at · sen boropur

Text

2 Þör-stęinn lét · þęnna rétta
 stęin; éfila · stęndr ęptir Þör-biorn.
 Sęlvi auk Smiðr · at sinn bróður.

Thurstan let erect this stone;
 fittingly it stands after Thurbeorn.
 Sallow and Smith [raised it] after their brother.

Sö 65 (Djulefors)

Dating: C11th–C12th

Meter: Ancient-words-law with hendings in the b-verses

Introduction

A standing stone inscribed on one side with a large cross. Already on the earliest depictions the stone was damaged, but an even larger part has now gone missing. Other stones that mention Longbeardland (Lombardy, northern Italy) are the paired U 133 and U 141; it may also be mentioned on Sö Fv1954;22, although only the first two letters **la** survive.

The meter is highly unusual for runic Swedish poetry by its reliance on hendings (in line 2 an ethel-hending *arð-* : *barð-*, in line 3 a shot-hending *land-* : *end-*). Although unparalleled in Sweden, the meter is documented by Snorre (TODO).

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

[inka : raisti : stāin : þānsi : at : ulai](f) : sin : [a...k] : han : austarla :
arþi : barþi : auk : ā : lakbarþilanti : [anlaþis +]

Text

2 Inga reṣisti stēin þānsi at Ò·lēif sinn **a...k**.
 Hann **austar**=la · **arði** barði
 auk ā **L**ang-barði- · **l**andi andaðis.

Inge raised this stone after Anlaf, her ...
Easterly he ploughed with the prow,
and in Longbeardland met his end.

2 arði barði ‘ploughed with the prow’ | I.e. ‘sailed’. The same verse is found in an anonymous Lay-meter-line from the Third Grammatical Treatise (Anon (*TGT*) 14 in SkP 3), which reads: *sá's af l̥s-landi · arði barði* ‘he who [away] from Iceland ploughed with the prow’.

Sö 85

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

: ansuar : auk : ern... ... [: faþur sin : han : enta]þis : ut i : krikum (r)uþr
: ---...unk-----an-----

Text

- 2 Ansvarr ok Ern..., fǫður sinn.
 Hann ęndaðis · út i Grikkum.
 †...(r)uþr:...unk...an...†

TODO: trans

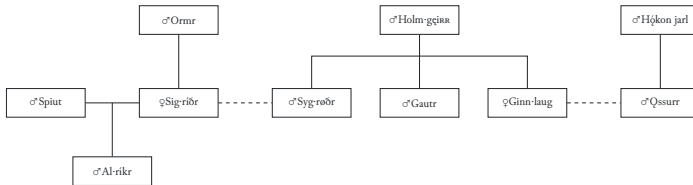
Sö 106

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The aristocratic family involved in raising this stone were quite prolific in raising runestones and also raised U 617 and the non-metrical Sö 101. Based on these 3 inscriptions the family tree may be reconstructed as follows:



Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

alrikr □ raisti □ stain × sun × sirīþar × at × sin faþur × sbiut × 𐌹 × sār ×
 uisitaula × um × uarit : hafþi × burg × um brutna : i : auk × um barþa +×
 firþ × han × kar(s)ar + kuni + alar ×

Text

- Al-rikr reisti stein, sunn Sig-riðar, at sinn faður Spiut;
 2 sár **vestar**=la · um **varit** hafði,
borg um **brutna** · i ok um **barða**;
 4 fæð hann **kastrar** · **kunni** allar.

TODO: trans

Sö 122 (Skresta)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A standing stone at Skresta. The semantic division between the words *dauðan* and *Ös-gautr* is marked in the inscription by a large space.

The commissioner, Osgeat, also raised another stone in memory of Highstan, the unmetrical Sö 123. That stone also stands at Skresta and reads: *askutr : rsþi : stan : þansi : at : hastin Ös-gautr reišþi stęin þannsi at Há-stęin* ‘Osgeat raised this stone after Highstan.’

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

: stain : stanr : it : histain : raisþi stalfr : faþir : at : sun tauþan askutr :
kiarþi : tre

Text

- 2 Stęinn stęndr at Há-stęin;
 reišþi *s*ialfr faðir · at *s*un dauðan.
 Ös-gautr gearði tré.

TODO: trans

Sö 126

Dating: C11th
Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

hu(l)(m)(f)riþ · ilin--r · [p]ar · litu · hakua · stain · eftir ¶l eskil · faþur · sin
 · han · trauh · orustu · i · austru[i]hi ¶l aþaa · fulks · krimr · fala · orþi

Text

Holm·fríðr, †ilin?...r†, þár létu hoggva stēin eftir Ēs·kēl, fōður
 sinn.

2 Hann draug orrustu · i austr-vegi,
 áðan folks Grímr · falla orði.

TODO: trans

Sö 130

Dating: C11th–C12th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A standing stone. TODO. The expression is formulaic; cf. Sm 39, Sm 44, U 703, U 739, and U 805.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A *fiurir* : *kirþu* : *at* : *faþur* : *kuþan* : *tyrþ* : *trikela* : *at* : *tumara* : *miltan*
: *urþa uk* : *matar kuþan* : *þat* · (u)-(h)---(u)--(u)(k)(þ)

§ PB h^a l^ʰf kirþu <o>

§ QB h^a <h> kirþu <o/þ>...

Text

- 2 *Fiurir* gērðu · at *fōður* góðan
dýrð *drengi*=la · at *Dómara*
mildan orða · ok *matar* góðan.
4 þat ...

Four men made after their good father,
honourably a mark of praise after Doomer
generous in words and good of meat.
This ...

3 *mildan* orða · ok *matar* góðan ‘generous in words and good of meat’ | The same line is found in Sm 39.

Sö 131

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

: sbiuti : halftan : þair : raisþu : stain : þansi : eftir : skarþa : ʀ brupur
sin : fur : austr : hiþan : miþ : ikuari : ʀ sirkʀllanti : likr : sunr iuintar

Text

Spiuti, Half-dan, þeir reišþu stēin þannsi ęptir Skarða, bróður
sinn.

2 Fór austr heðan · með Ing-vari;
à Sęrk-landi liggr · sonr Ey-vindar.

TODO: trans

Sö 136

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The stone is lost.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

[: suain : iuk : sluia · þair : raisþu : ---... ... -nu · at : faþur : sin : hirsir ·
uksniauin ian uas : unt hifni bistr]

Text

2 Svęinn ok †sluia†, þęir ręisþu †?-...-nu† at fęður sinn, hęrsi
 þug-sniallan, · ian vas und hifni bętztr.

TODO: trans

Sö 137 (Aspa)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

The last line of side B (**sunr þat ... mar**) is, with the exception of the final word **mar**, enciphered. The first 7 runes, **sunrþat**, are written along a single vertical stave, while **rakna ... i(f)** are written in staveless runes. This line is difficult to read, employs no word separators, and has not been convincingly deciphered.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A þura : raisþi : stin : þ--si at : ubi : buanti : sin

§ BP : stain : sar:si : stanr : at : ybi : ǥ þik·stapi : at ǥ : þuru : uar : han :

uestarla : uakti : karla ǥ [sa þar] · sunr þaþ · traknasuatau(k)i(f)mar[sua]

§ BQ : stain : sar:si : stanr : at : ybi : ǥ þik·stapi : at ǥ : þuru : uar : han :

uestarla : uakti : karla ǥ · sunr þat raknasuatau-i(f) mar

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

Sö 145

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A [: tusti : austin : þir : raistu : at : tuka : snir : kiarþu · at : san ::
 faþur :: snialan :]

§ B [: tuki : ati : ru harfan : krimulfu :: ati : hafan : iu : ata i :: uþuli]

Text

- 2 Tósti, Ey-steinn, þeir reistu at Tóka,
 synir giðrðu · at sinn fōður snjallan.
 Tóki átti *bý* halfan, Grím·ulfr átti *halfan bý*, átti í óðuli.

TODO: trans

Sö 148

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

The words **han uas antaþ austr** are carved with staveless runes.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

þiupulfr : bui : þair : raisþu : stain þansi : at : farulf : faþur : sin : han
uas antaþ austr i kaþ(u)(m)

Text

2 Þiuð·ulfr, Bói, þeir reisþu stein þannsi at Fər·ulf, fōður sinn.
Hann vas andaðr · austr i Gørðum.

Thedwolf, Bowe—they raised this stone after Farulf, their father.
He met his end to the east in the Yards.

Sö 154 (Skarpåker)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A stone.

The couplet at the end, expressing a father's grief for his son, serves as a good example of the Wiking Age preoccupation with the End Times. The stone is decorated with a cross, but the text has no signs of Christian influence, and the language is traditional.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

kunar : raisþi : stain : þansi : at : lyþbiurn : sun : sin : iarþ sal rifna uk
ubhimin

Text

Gunn·arr reisti stēin þannsi at Lýð·biorn, son sinn.

2 Iqrð sal rifna · ok upp-himinn.

Guthur raised this stone after Leodbeorn, his son.
Earth shall rend, and Up-heaven.

2 Iqrð sal rifna · ok upp-himinn. | The verse line (with the exception of **h** and **m** in **ubhimin** *upp-himinn*) is written with staveless runes and without punctuation. Since there is clearly place for more runes on the stone the reason is unlikely to be strictly economical, especially considering that staveless runes are very rare in the Wiking Age outside of Helsingland and also used especially for poetry in other inscriptions from Södermanland (Sö 148 above). Rather the motivation is almost certainly to encrypt the verse and thereby accord it greater sanctity, perhaps also to obscure a reference to the pagan eschatology at a time when Christianity was increasingly hegemonic. For the expression cf. *Vsp* 50, Arn *Hryn* 3/7–8 (in SkP 2, see also note there): *meiri verði þinn an þeira · þrífnuðr allr, und's himinn rifnar*. 'greater than theirs may all thy wealth be until heaven rends.'

2 Iqrð ... upphiminn 'Earth ... Up-heaven' | A formulaic merism; see Index for other occurrences.

2 sal 'shall' | An early example of a dialectal form of *skal* 'id.,' cf. dialectal Swedish *sa*.

Sö 159

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

: ikialtr : ak : aluir : raisþu : stain : þansi : at : þurbiurn : faþur : sin
 : han uaistr hafir/(a)fir uf/(u)f uarit leki ¶ rorikr · kumytr biu · kunlaifr
 hiuk ru-ar

Text

2 Ingi·aldr auk Ql·vír reišþu stein þannsi at Þór·biorn, fǫður sinn.
 Hann vestr hafir · of varit lengi.
 Hró·ríkr, Guð·mundr †biu†. Gunn·lǫifr hiogg rúnar.

Ingeld and Alewigh raised this stone after Thurbeorn, his father.
 He has been in the west for a long time.
 Rethric, Godmund Guthlaf hewed the runes.

Sö 163

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

Þruríkr : stáin : at : suni : sína : snialla : trákia : for : ulaifr : i : krikium :
uli : siftri :

Text

2 Þrý·ríkr stęin
 at syni sína, · snialla dręngja;
 fór Ó·lęifr i Grikkjum, · gulli skipti.

Thriric [raised] the stone
after his sons, valiant drengs;
Anlaf went to Greece, dealt out gold.

1 Þrý·ríkr stęin ‘Thriric [raised] the stone’ | This line is an orphan. The verb is left out.

Sö 164

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ P kuþbirn : uti : þair r(a)isþu : stan þansi : at : kuþmar : f(a)þur : sin :
stuþ : triki:l(a) : i · stafn skibi : likr uistarla uf huln sar tu :
§ Q kuþbirn : uti : þair r(a)isþu : stan þansi : at : kuþmar : f(a)þur : sin :
stuþ : triki:l(a) : i · stafn skibi : likr uistarla <uf> <hul>n bar--

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

Sö 165**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ P kuþrun : raisti : stain : at : hiþin : uar : nafi suais : uar : han : ƿ : i :
krikum iuli skifti ƿ : kristr : hialb : ant : kristunia :
§ Q kuþrun : raisti : stain : at : hiþin : uar : nafi suais : uar : han : ƿ : i :
krikum iuli skifti ƿ : kristr : hialb : ant : krist uni a :

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

Sö 171

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

(i)nk(i)f(a)[s]tr · l[i](t) (h)(a)ku... st(a)...n · eftir · sihuiþ · faþ-r · si[n · han
· fial · i h]ul(m)[karþi · skaiþar · uisi mi]þ · ski...ra

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

Sö 173 (Tystberga)

Dating: C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

The stone is closely connected to Sö 374 which at present stands beside it. Sö 374 is somewhat younger, and was raised by Mish (there **musku** gen. sg.) after Manny.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A mes:kia : a(u)[k :] (m)an(i) : litu : rasa : ku[(m)(l) : þausi : at : b]ruþur
 · (s)in : hr(u)þkair · auk : faþur sin hulm:stain ·

§ B · han hafþi · ystarla u(m) : uarit · lenki : tuu : a:ustarla : meþ : inkuari

Text

2 Mýskja auk Manni létu rēisa kumbl þausi at bróður sinn Hróð·gęir
 fęður Holm·stęin.

4 Hann hafði vestar=la · um varit lęngi;
 dóu austar=la · með Ing·vari.

TODO: trans

Sö 174 (Aspö)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

[ub]lubr · lit · kira : kuml : likhus : auk : bru · at sun sin : biurn : uar
trebin : a : kut:lanti : þy : lit : fiur · sit : fluþu : kankir : þair uiþ[ulkur] :
uiltu iki halta : guþ : hilbi : anta : hans

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

Sö 179 (Gripsholm)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO: INTRODUCTION. The three-line stanza is a biographical addition following a typical prose memorial formula.

Runes

+ ᚠᚢᚱᚢ : ᚠᚢᚠ : ᚱᚢᚢᚢ : ᚢᚠᚢᚢ : ᚢᚠᚢᚢᚠ : ᚢᚢᚢ : ᚢᚢᚢ : ᚠᚠᚢᚠᚠ : ᚢᚱᚢᚱᚱ : ᚢᚠᚢᚱᚢ
 : ᚢᚠᚢᚢ ᚱᚱᚱᚱ : ᚠᚱᚱᚱᚱᚢᚢ : ᚱᚢᚱᚱ : ᚠᚠᚢᚢᚢ : ᚠᚢᚢᚢ : ᚠᚢᚢᚢᚢᚱᚱᚱ ᚠᚱᚱᚱ : ᚱᚠᚱᚱᚱ : ᚠᚢᚢᚢ
 ᚢᚢᚢᚱᚱᚱᚱᚱ : ᚠᚢᚱᚱᚱᚱᚱᚱᚱᚱ

Transliteration

× tula : lit : raisa : stain : þinsa| lat : sun : sin : haralt : bruþur : inkuars
 : þair furu : trikila : fiari : at : kuli : auk : a:ustarla| lar:ni : kafu : tuu :
 sunar:la : a sirk:lan:ti

Text

Tóla lét reisa stein þennsa at son sinn Har-ald, bróður Ing-vars.

Toole had this stone raised after her son Harold, brother of Ingwar.

- 2 Þeir fóru dręngi=la · fiarri at gulli
 auk austar=la · arni gófu,
 4 dóu sunnar=la · à Sęrk-landi.

Like drengs they journeyed far for gold
 and easterly gave to the eagle;
 they died southerly in Serkland.

3 arni gófu 'gave to the eagle' | They provided a feast for the eagle, namely with the carnage of slain foes; for eagles and ravens as eaters of corpses and drinkers of blood cf. Meissner (1921, pp. 118, 203, 207–208). Similar things are said of kings in numerous Scaldic poems from Iceland and Norway, and the lack of an object to *gófu* 'gave' reveals that this expression must have been well known also in Sweden.

Sö 198 (Mervalla)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

sirip · lit · resa · stan · [þin](a) [-] (a)(t) · suen · sin · [b]unta · h[n] · uft ·
siklt · til · simk(a)(l)(a) · t(u)ru[m] · knari · um · tumisnis

Text

2 Sig·ríðr lét rêsa stên þenna at Svên, sinn bónda.
 Hann opt siglt · til Sêmgala,
 dýrum knarri · um Dómis-nęs.

Syerid had this stone raised after Swayn, her husband.
He had often sailed to the Semigallians
on his costly knarr around Domeness.

3 Dómis-nęs ‘Domeness’ | The old Germanic name for Cape Kolka in Latvia, corresponding to German *Domesnes*.

Sö 204 (Överselö church)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The inscription is heavily damaged, but can be reconstructed on the basis of the verse in Sö 206.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

: hier : skal : stenta : stei(n)kia(l)t : run(u)... ... (u)arfaitr : (i)(f)tir
: faþurs:broþur · sen ·

Text

2 Hiar skal standa · steinn at Ingjald,
 rúnum roðinn · reisti Var·feitr
 eptir fǫðurs bróður sinn.

TODO: trans

Sö 206/208

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

Two stones raised by a mother and her daughter.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

Sö 206: : hir : skal : stenta : staena : þisir : runum : ru-nir :∴ raisti :
k---auk : at syni : sina : auk : hielmlauk : at bryþr : sina ·
Sö 208: : kuþlauk · auk : hielmlaug : þar : --- (u) · raistu :ern : auk :
at : þorstain :: boanta : koþan : buki : i frayslutum : arfi : fu(l)... .. sum
ir : sustursun inibratar :

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

Sö 207**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

kuþr... ... (f) a þ u r s i n · f u r · h f i l a · h n · t i l · i k l a n s · k u þ h a l b i · s i l h n s

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

Sö 213

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

s[^]tain : hiuk : esbern : stintn : at : uitum : bat miþ : runum : raisti : kyla
: at : gairbern : boanta : sin : auk · kofriþ : at : faþur : sin : han uar :
boanti : bestr i : kili : raþi : sar : kuni :

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

Sö 320

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law or Lay-meter

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

: ƿHlAƿſR : ƿNſ : ƿſNR : ƿNſ : AſſYR : Rſſ : Hſſſ : ƿſ : BARKſſſſ : BRNPNR :
 Hſſ : HſA NſA : ƿNſR : ƿſB ſſNR : ſRſſ : Hſſſſſ : Hſſ : Nſſſſſ

Transliteration

: kairuatr : auk : anutr : auk : utamr : rita : stain : at : byrst(a)in · brupur
 : sin : sar uar : austr · miþ ikuari : trik : snialan : sun : lifayar x

Text

- 2 Gęir·hvatr auk Qnundr auk Ö·tamr rétta stęin at Býr·stęin, bróður
 sinn,
 sár var austr · með Ing·vari,
 4 dręng sniallan, · sunn Hlífęyjar.

TODO: trans

Sö 335

Dating: C11th
Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

uulf[^]ui : raisti : stain þana| lat brufur sin : u:snikin sar furs : a:ust:arla :
maþ : i:ikn:u:ari : ksibari hulumstains

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

Sö 338

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A · ketil : auk + biorn + þair + raistu + stain + þin[a] + at + þourstain :
 faþur + sin + anuntr + at + bruþur + sin + auk : hu[skar]lar + hifir + iafna
 + ketilau at + buanta sin · ¶ bruþr uaru þar bistra mana : a : lanti auk : i
 lipi : uti : h(i)(l)(t)u sini huska(r)la : ui- +
 § B han + fial + i + urustu + austr + i + garþum + lis + furugi + lanmana +
 bestr

Text

Ketill auk Biorn, þeir reistu stein þenna at Þór·stein, fōður sinn,
 Qnundr at bróður sinn auk hús-karlar *ęptir iafna, Ketil·ey at
 bóanda sinn.

2 Bróðr vōru þeir · bętstra manna
 á landi auk i liði úti;

4 heldu sinna · hús-karla vel.

Hann fial i orrustu · austr i Gørðum,

6 liðs forungi, · land-manna bętstr.

TODO: trans.

They were brothers of the best men,

on land and out in the troop. He fell in battle to the east in the Yards,
 the steward of the troop, the best of lended men.

Sö 340

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

[: stin : sār:si sār : at · frusta ik]irunār : [sun : aik : kuþlifs : ulifr :
raisti aftir brupur sin ¶ kus]

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

Sö 345**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

... ..in × þinsa × at × kai(Ṛ)... ..-n · eṚ · e[n-a]þr × ut - × kr...

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

Sö Fv1948;289 (Aspa)

Dating: C11th
 Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO: INTRODUCTION.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

ḁstriþ : lit : -ira : ku(m)... ...usi ÷ at : anunt ÷ auk : raknualt : sun : sin ÷ :
 urþu : ta...r : - (t)an...-(k)u : ua-u : rikir : ḁ rauniki : ak : snialastir : i :
 suiþiuþu

Text

2 Ḙst·ríðr lét gęra kumbl þausi at Qn·und ok Ragn·vald, sun sinn.
 Urðu **d**auðir · ĩ **D**an·morku,
 vǫru **r**ikir · á **R**auningi
 4 auk **s**niallastir · ĩ **S**vé·þiuðu.

Estfrid had these monuments made after Anund and Rainwald, her son.
 They died in Denmark,
 were powerful in Reening,
 and the most valiant men in Sweden.

Sö Fv1954;22

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

...i : risti : ---...in... ... sin : han : ir : entaþr : i : austruiki : ut : ą :
la...

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 11

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

raþ| þu : runar : ret : lit : rista : tolir : bry[t]i : i roþ : kunuki : tolir
: a(u)k : gyla : litu : ris... ..- : þaun : hion : eftir ...k : merki ¶ srni... ¶
haku(n) · (b)aþ : rista

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 69

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

raknilfr × lit × kirua × bru × þasi × iftir × anunt + sun + s[i](n) [× k]uþan ×
 kuþ ---bi × ʌns × ant × uk × salu × bitr × þan × ʌn krþi × til × munu × iki ×
 mirki × miri × uirþa × muþir × karþi × i(f)tir × sun × sín × ainika ×

Text

Ragn-elfr lét gerva bró þási eptir Qnund, sun sinn góðan. Guð
 hialpi hans ʊnd ok sólu beþr þan hann gærði til.

2 Munu eigi mērki · mēiri verða.

Móðir gærði eptir sun sinn einiga.

TODO: trans

U 102

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The inscription is very hard to read.

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

kal lit hkua heli þisa iftir · suni sina toa · auk þau ikiþora · br- (a)ina kiarþu
mukit mirki furir arkum mani

Text

2 Káll lét hoggva · helli þessa
eptir syni · sīna tvá,
auk þau Ingi-þóra bró · ɛina giðrðu,
4 mykit mērki · fyrir mǫrgum manni.

TODO: trans

U 112

Dating: C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A · rahnuatr · lit · rista · runar · efr · fastui · moþur · sina · onems · totr
 · to i · aip̃i · kuþ hialbi · ant · hena ·
 § B runa · rista · lit · rahnuatr · huar a x griklanti · uas · lis · forunki ·

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 114

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A ikriþ' l[i]t · laþbo · kiara' auk · stain · haku[a eftir] ikim[a]r (b)(o)[ta
s]in · auk · eftar · tan · auk · eftir · baka · suni · sina
§ B' þair byku' i rynby' auk' bo atu' [kr]istr · ialbi' s(a)(l)(u) · þai[r- ·]
(þ)it skal' at minum · mana' miþan · min li[fa]

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 127/164/165/261

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

These four stones all share a near-identical inscription and visual layout. They originally belong to the so-called Earlbánke's bridge, at which U 164–5 are still standing whereas U 127 and 261 have been moved to different locations.

Since the inscription is near-identical it was thought simplest to include them all under the same section, and note the differences between them by means of critical apparatus. Note that punctuation is not included in the apparatus.

Like many other one-line verses, the poetic nature of these inscriptions is doubtful, especially since the transposition of *allan* in U 127, which is not inferior to the others in terms of execution, renders the line deficient and makes one question whether Earlbánke really intended a poetic line.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

U 127: *iarla**x**baki *lit raisa [x] staina *þasa at sik *kuikuan ¶ *auk bru þisa karþi *fur ąnt sina *auk *ain ati tabu ala- U 164: *iarlabaki *lit *raisa *stain *þisa *at sik *kuikuan *¶ *auk bru *þisa *karþi *fur ąnt *sina *auk ain ati *alan *tabu *kuþ hialbi ąnt hans U 165: ia[r]labaki *li---sa *staina *þisa *at sik *kuikuan *auk bru þis(a) [x karþi fur ąnt x] si-- -- *ati + (a)lan *tabu + U 261: iarlaba... lit *raisa *s[ta]ina *þasa *a]t sik *kuikuan *¶ auk *bru *þisa *karþi *fur ąnt [x] s[in]a *auk *ain ati alan tabu

Text

- 2 Iarla·banki lét reisa steina þása at sik kvikvan, auk bró þessa gerði
fyr qnd sīna,
auk ęinn átti · allan Tà·bý.
Guð hialpi qnd hans.

Earlbánke had these stones raised after himself while alive, and made this bridge for his spirit,
and he alone owned all Toughby.
God help his spirit.

1 Iarla·banki | **iarlaba...** U 261 1 lét rēisa | li- ---**sa** U 165 1 steina | **stain** U 164 1 þása |
 þessa ('þisa') U 164/165 1.a-2 sīna, auk ċinn | si- --- U 165 2 **allan** Tā·bý | *rev.* ('**tabu ala**·')
 U 127 3 Guð hialpi qnd hans. | *om.* U 164/165/261

U 136

Dating: C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

× astriþr × la(t) + raisa × staina × þasa × [a]t austain × buta sin × is × suti ×
iursalir auk antaþis ub i × kirkum

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 153

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

...[(u)](a)i- × [(a)]uk × ulf- litu × raisa × stai-(a) × e(f)tir × hlftan · auk · eftir
× kunar × bryþr × sina × þair · antaþus × aust... ...(u)m

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 166**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

ku lit · rasa · kuþlah · iftir · sun · miuk · nutan · trik · mirki · þisa · an it ·
sihuastr ·

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 207–8

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

U 207: ulfr ' auk ' þurmontr ' auk ' kamal ' lata ' reis(a) þisa ' stina ' þar +
eftR ' faþur ' sin ' U 208: ristu ' merk(i) at ' man ' metan ' sunir ' alkoþir '
at ÷ sin ' faþur sterkar usiti ' rsti stina

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 214–15

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

Two paired stones with a single continuous inscription. U 215 should be read before 214 in the series.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

U 214: uk × inkiber × eftir × buanta × sin ' han ' troknafi ÷ a ' holms ' hafi
' skreþ ' knar ' hans ' i ' kaf þrir ' enir ' kamo ' af

U 215: [þaniltr · uk · olfil](r) · [li](t)(u) s[t]ain × e(f)[tir faþor · uk broþor
sin ·]

Text

Ragn·hildr ok Ulf·hildr létu stein eptir fǫður ok bróður sinn,
Ingi·berg eptir bóanda sinn.

2 Hann drunknaði · à Holms·hafi;
 skrêð knarr hans i kaf;

4 þrír ênir kǫmu af.

TODO: trans

U 225–6 (Bällsta)

Dating: C11th

Location: Arkils tingstad, Bällsta, Vallentuna

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

Two stones standing in their original location, namely at the thingstead mentioned in U 225. In the 18th century the two runestones were connected by a line of smaller stones going between them, but these have since been lost. The inscription is continuous and consists of 7 alliterative long-lines.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

U 225: ... uk · arkil · uk · kui · þir · kariþu · iar · þikstaþunu · iki mirki
 · mairi · uirþa · þan · ulfs · sunir · iftir · kir... ..ir · suinar · at · sin · faþur
 U 226: ristu · stina · uk · staf · uan · uk · in · mikla · at · iartiknum uk kuriþi
 · kas at · uiri · þu mon i krati · kiatit lata ¶ kunar ik stin

Text

PU 225 ... ok Arnkell ok Gýi þeir gerðu 'iar þing-stað ...

2 Munu eigi merki · meiri verða,

þan Ulfs synir · eptir gerðu,

4 sniallir sveinar · at sinn fōður,

... and Arnkettle and Gew they made the thingstead here, ...

No greater landmarks will there be

than Wolf's sons afterwards made,

valiant swains, for their father.

U 226 reistu stēina · ok staf ofan

2 ok inn mikla · at iar-tēiknum,

ok Gý·ríði · gats at veri;

4 þý man i gráti · giatit láta.

Gunnarr 'iogg stēin.

They raised the stones and the staff above,

and the great ... as tokens of remembrance;

also Gufrid cared for her husband.

Thus will they have it spoken of in weeping.
Guthur hewed the stone.

1 *of*an | **uan** U 226; unnu *most other eds.*

1 staf *of*an ‘the staff above’ | Unclear; perhaps a tall wooden staff or column?

2 inn mikla ‘the great ...’ | The word *inn* may either be read as the article *inn*, *hinn* ‘the’ or as a f. noun of unclear sense. The latter is preferable since the weakly stressed article cannot uphold alliteration, and since *hinn mikla* ‘the great one’ is meaningless.

4 *ī* grāti ‘in weeping’ | Or ‘in a dirge’, if *grátr* refers uniquely to a lost genre of poems of lamentation, in which case the line probably refers to a longer oral poem serving as a complement to the necessarily quite limited runic poem.

U 300 (Skånela)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

[þyrui + lit + raisa + stain × eftir + hlftain + merki + mukit + eftir × man
kuþan]

Text

þýr·ví lét reisa stein eftir Halfda*n,
2 mērki mykit · eftir mann góðan.

TODO: trans

U 323 (Sälma)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

An exceptionally tall standing stone. No decorations, but explicitly Christian. Note the sporadic loss of initial *h* and use of stung runes *h*, *þ*, *ʀ*, *y*, *g*, *e*.

Runes

× 1A4T1T × 1A4 × 1A4N4T4 × 1A4 × 81A4T × 1A4 [× 8A4A4T4 × 81A4N]4T1T ×
 T4N4Y4 × 4[1A4N4] × 41T × 4N4 × 1A4T4 × 1A4 × 1A4T × 1A4 × 41A4 × 4N4 × 41A4 ×
 1A4N4 × 41A4T4 × 1A4 4A4T1A4 ×
 × 41 × 4N4 × 1A4T4 × 41A4 × 1A4T4 × 1A4T4 × 81A4 × 4A4T4 × 41A4T4 × 81A4 × 1A4T4
 4N4T4-- 4A4T4T4 4T4[4A4N4] 1A4 × 41T × 4A4T4N4 × 4T4 × 1A4 × 8A4T4T4 × 4A4T4 × 8A4T4T4
 × 1A4T4T4 +

Transliteration

× iystin × auk × iuruntr × auk × biurn × þir [× byryþr × risþu]stin ×
 trums × f[aþur] × sin × kuþ × ihlbi × ʀns × ʀnt × auk × selu + fur+kifi × ʀnum
 × sakar × auk × sutir × ʀ
 × hi × mun × ligia × meþ + altr + lifir × bru × hrþ×slagin × briþ × e[ft × k]uþ-
 suenar k[arþu ×] at × sin × faþur × ma × igi × brutar×kuml × betra × uerþa +

Text

Ey·stên auk Iuruntr auk Biorn, þêr bróðr rêsþu ... *ęptir* ...stên
trums fōður sinn.

2 Guð 'ialpi 'ans ʀnd auk sêlu, for·gifi 'ʀnum sakar auk syndir.

Eanstan and Earwind and Beorn—those brothers raised ... [after] -stan ...,
 their father.

God help his breath and soul, forgive him his crimes and sins.

4 *Ēi* mun liggja · með *aldr* lifir
bró harð-slagin · *brēð eft góðan*;
svēnar kęrðu · at *sinn* fōður
 6 má *ęgi* *brótar*-kuml · *bętra* verða.

For ever will lie while the age lives
 the hard-hammered bridge, broad, after a good man.

The swains made it after their father;
no roadside monument can be greater.

U 336

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

[ul]fr × lit × risa stin × þi[n]a × iftir × unim × faþurs×bruþr sin þir × buku ×
baþir × i × baristam ’

Text

- 2 Ulfr lét rêsa stên þenna eptir Ó·ném, fǫðurs-bróður sinn.
 þêr byggu báðir · i Bári-stǫm.

TODO: trans

U 349

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The stone is lost but survives as a well executed drawing.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

[uikitil × uk × usur -...u × risa × stin × þina · iftir × ustin × faþ...þan ×
an furs × uti × miþ × ala × skibin × kuþ × ialbi × (a)t]

Text

2 Vi·ketill ok Qssurr ...létu rêsa stên þenna eptir Ô·stên, fôður sinn
gôðan. 'Ann fórs úti með alla skipan.
Guð 'ialpi ɔnd.

TODO: trans

U 358

Dating: C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Note the loss of initial *b*-.**Runes**

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

fulkmar × lit × risa × stin × þina × iftir × fulkbiarn × sun × sin × sar × itaþis
 × uk miþ krkum × kuþ × ialbi × ans × ȳt uk salu

Text

- 2 Folk·marr lét rêsa stên þenna ȳptir Folk·biorn, sun sinn.
 Sár ȳndaðis · ok með Grikkum.
 Guð 'ialpi 'ans ȳnd ok sôlu.

TODO: trans

U 437 (Broby)

Dating: C11th
Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

kuna : a[uk su]tari : ristu : s(t)[... ... sikbiar- sati : iftir : sin faþur : stin :
almykin : i : s...]

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 512

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A fryb... ...i × huk f(r)... ...(f)-þr × þir ristu × sti- -(n)a × iftir × kuþ-ar
 × ...(a)þur × sin kuþan × huk tuma + (b)...þur × sin ×× kuþ ...i ąt × þira × huk
 × salu × hu... ...uþir × bitr × þan × þir × -ar- × h...

§ B ...ir × skal × stan^ta × stin × uiþ- bryku × sunir × at × faþur satu · kuþan
 · kair -... ...

§ C --(u)-ar × mirki × at × bua-... ...

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 605

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A lost runestone.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

[· iskirun · harþir · totir · lit · risti · runir · ati · sik · sialfan · hn · uil · austr
· fara · auk · ut · til · iursala · fair · risti · runir ·]

Text

Ingi·rún, Harðar dóttir, lét rísta rúnar at* sik sialfa*.
2 Hón vill austr fara · auk út til Íór-sala.
Fótr rísti rúnir.

Ingrun, Hareth's daughter, had these runes carved after herself.
She wants to go east and out to Jerusalem.
Foot carved the runes.

U 614**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

· skuli · auk · folki · lata · reisa · þinsa · stein · iftr · broþur · sin · husbiorn
· hn us| |siok · uti · þa þir · kialt · toku · a kutlanti ·

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 617 (Bro)

Dating: C11th
Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

A beautiful rectangular stone. The family involved in raising this stone were quite prolific; see Sö 106 above.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

kinluk x hulmkis x tutir x systir x sukrufar x auk x þaira x kaus x aun x lit
 x keara x bru x þesi x auk x raisa x stain x þina x eftir x asur x bunta x sin x
 sun x hakunar x iarls x sar x uar x uikika x uaurþr x miþ x kaeti x kuþ x ialbi
 x ans x nu x aut x uk x salu

Text

Ginn·laug, Holm·geirs dóttir, systir Syg·røðar auk þeira Gauts,
 hön let giöra bró þessi auk reisa stein þenna eftir Qssur, bónda
 sinn, sun Hó·konar iarls.

2 SáR var vikinga · vörðr með Geiti.

Guð hialpi hans nú ond ok sölú.

Yinlie, Holmgar's daughter, the sister of Syferth and Geat—she had this bridge made and this stone raised after Answer, her husband, the son of Earl Hathkin.

He was the watchman against Wikings with Goater.
 God now help his spirit and soul.

1.b Hó·konar iarls 'Earl Hathkin' | Unclear, but he is probably not the Norwegian Earl of Lade Hathkin Siwardson (c. 937–995).

U 644

Dating: C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

an(u)(i)(t)r : auk · kiti : auk · kar : auk · blisi · auk · tiarfr · þir · raistu ·
stain þina · aftir · kunlaif · fǫður : sin han : fil · austr : mið : ikuari ¶ kup
heabi ǫntini

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 654

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

+ a-itr : auk · ka(r) auk : kiti : auk : -[l]isi : auk · tiarfr : ris[t]u : stain :
þena : aftir : kunlaif : fǫþur sin 𐌺 is u[a]s nus(t)(r) · m[i](þ) ikuari : tribin
kuþ : hialbi : ǫ(t) þaira 𐌺 al-ikr| 𐌺raistik · runar 𐌺 is kuni + ual · knari stura

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 661**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

kairui × auk × kula × ristū × stain þina × aftir × ʀnunt × fap̥ur sia is uas × austr
× tauþr × miþ × ikuari × kuþ × hialbi ʀt × ʀnutar

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 703 (Västra Väppeby)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A standing stone inscribed on one side. There is no cross present, but a large four-legged beast with a long tail. The stone is heavily damaged but mostly readable. The expression is formulaic; cf. Sm 39, Sm 44, Sö 130, U 739, and U 805. For “good of meat”, which also occurs in *Háv* see Index. The first line is not poetic.

The carver notably struggles with distinguishing the mirrored runes **a** and **n**.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

: -sui · let [·] rnisa · stain [·] þisa · at · anulf · sun · sen · koþan · han · byki
· her ... · mantr · matar · -o-r · auk · mls · ri(s)ia ·

Text

Ós·vi lét reisa stein þenna at Arn·ulf, son sinn góðan. Hann
byggi hér ...,
mandr matar góðr · ok mál's risinn.

Oswye let raise this stone after Arnolf, her good son. He lived here ...,
a man good of meat and proud of speech.

1 ... | In this lacuna there is room for around 5 runes; not enough for a half-line, which suggests that *Hann byggi hér* is not poetic.

U 707/710 (Husby)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

Two pieces of a single stone. U 707 is the larger fragment while U 710, originally not identified with U 707, is smaller and contains the words **(h)...****(n)** · **byki** | **li** · **h(u)**.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

U 707/U 710: · **ysurkr** --... · **stan** · **þina** · **nt** · **ka(u)bm...****(n)** · **faþur** · **sen** · **koþan** · **(h)...****(n)** · **byki** | **li** · **h(u)...** ¶ · **bali** · **risti** · **r(u)--r** · **þis-(r)** · **hier** · **man** · **stanta** · **stan** · **ne(r)** **(b)(r)...****u** ·

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 729

Dating: C11th
Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

· uifugsi · lit · raisa · stain · þiasn · iftir · seref · faþur · sen · koþan · han ·
bykil | li · agurstam · hier mn · stanta · stan · miþli · bua · raþi · tekr · þar ·
ryn si · runum · þim sum · bali · risti ·

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 735

Dating: C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

· ueþralti ' lit ' ur · lakarni · stan · almikin · ur · staþi · fyra · auk · arker '
þau ' litu ' kubl ' raisa · þisa · at ' siktryk ' sun · sen '

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 739 (Gådi)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A standing stone inscribed on one side, with a large cross present. There are no major difficulties with the reading. The expression is formulaic; cf. Sm 39, Sm 44, Sö 130, U 703, and U 805. “mild of meat” appears to be a variant of “good of meat”, which also occurs in *Háv*; see Index. The first line is not poetic. For other stones raised by someone in memory of themselves, see TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

· hulbiorn · lit · raisa · stan · at ’ sik · sialfan 𐌺 · hau|n| |u|nar · miltr · matar
· auk · mals-risin ·

Text

Hol·biørn lét reisa stein at sik sialfan.

2 Hann var mildr matar · ok mál̥s risinn.

Holbeorn had this stone raised after himself.

He was mild of meat and proud of speech.

2 Hann var | haunar (for *hanuar) U 739

U 778

Dating: C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

The original location of the stone is unknown, but judging from the inscription it must have been part of a larger monument consisting of several stones.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

þialfi × auk × hulmnlauk × litu × raisa × staina þisa × ala × at baka × sun sin ×
 is ati × ain 𐌺 × sir × skib × auk × austr × stu[rþi ×] i × ikuars × liþ × kuþ hialbi
 × ȁt × baka × ask(i)l × raist

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 792

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

kar lit · risa · stin · þtina · at · mursa · faþur · sin · auk · kabi · at · mah sin ·
fu- hfila · far · aflap̃i ut i · kri[k]um · arfa · sinum

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 805

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The stone is lost and the interpretation must rely on old depictions which makes the reading, especially two of the personal names, uncertain.

The expression is formulaic; cf. Sm 39, Sm 44, Sö 130, U 703, and U 739. For “good of meat”, which also occurs in *Háv*; see Index. The first line is not poetic.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ P [fulkir : lit : risa : st... --r : iel : bruþur : sin : auk : kunimar : eftir : menk : faþur : sin bunta : kuþan : matar : buki| |i uikby]

§ Q [fulkir · lit : risa : st... --- : mer : bruþur : sin : auk : kuni:mar : eftir : m·enk : faþur : sin bunta : kuþan : matar : brike -ukni ·]

§ R [fulkir : lit : risa : st... ...(r)ir : mei- : bruþur : sih auk : kuni:mar : eftir : mink : faþur : sin bunta : kuþan : matar : buki| |i : uiki]

Text

Fylkir lét reisa stęin eptir **†iel†**, bróður sinn, ok Gunni·marr eptir **†menk†**, fęður sinn,

² **bóna** góðan matar; · **b**yggi ĩ Vík-bý.

Filch had this stone raised after ..., his brother, and Guthmar after ..., his father,
a farmer good of meat; he lived in Wickby.

U 838

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

þufr · auk · þorfatr · þair · litu ' raisa ' stan · at · þorborn · faþur · sen · koþan
· ¶l · hir maa ' stanta ' stain ' ner ' brautu ' auk ' (k)ilauk ' riþ · kirua ' merki
' [at] (b)(o)a--- · sen :

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U 887

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

× ioker × auk × fastker × auk × au(r)(i)(k)r × litu · rita · sten × yftir × borker
 × faþur sin frehn ¶ selfr · hiok × aurikr × yfti : sin · faþur · runi · þisa · roþi
 ' sa ' kuni

Text

Io·gêr auk Fast·gêr auk Ey·ríkr létu rétta stên øpti Borg·gêr
 fõður sinn frégan.

2 Sialfr hiogg Ey·ríkr · øpti sinn fõður
 rùni þessa: · ráði sá kunni.

TODO: trans

U 1016

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ P · liutr : sturimaþr · riti : stain : þinsa : aftir : sunu · sina : sa hit :
aki : sims uti furs : sturþ(i) · -(n)ari · kuam :: hn krik::hafnir : haima tu :
...-mu-... ...(k)(a)(r)... (i)uk (r)(u)-(a) · ...

§ Q · liutr : sturimaþr · riti : stain : þinsa : aftir : sunu · sina : sa hit : aki
: sims uti furs : sturþ(i) · -(n)ari · kuam :: hn krik · : hafnir : haima tu :
...-mu-... ...(k)(a)(r)... (i)uk (r)(u)-(a) · ...

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U Fv1983;228

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

× nesbiurn : (l)it : raisa : sta-n : þensa : eftir : (o)laif : sun : sin : hiar :
skal : stanta : stain · a : l(a)(i)...au...

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U Fv1986;84

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

asmu-tr ... ris-- · runar · eftir × stein · faþurs·faþur · sin · auk · faþur · siba
· ok × geirbiarnar × aok ... ulfs · ear · merki · mikit · at · man · koþan ×

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U Fv1992;157

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

× kunar : auk biurn : auk × þurkrimr × ra-... ..tain : þina · at þurst... ×
brupur sin : is uas austr : tauþr · m... ..ari × auk × karþ... ..u þisi

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

U Fv1912;8

Dating: C11th

Meter: Court-spoken meter

Introduction

U Fv1912;8 is a small box, in which were originally found some Wiking Age scales along with a powdered organic material, probably the pouch in which the scales were originally contained. The inscription has the rare honour of containing the only authentically East Norse poetry in the Court-spoken meter.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A *tiarfr × fik af × simskum × maṇi × skálar × þis...* (×) i ...(*ǧ*)t(*i*) × in
uirmuntr × f(*a*)þi × runar × þisar

§ B *fuhl × ualua × slait × (f)aluṇ × faṇ kauk × ǧ naṣ au-a*

Text

Djarfr fekk af sǣmskum manni skálar þessar i ...-landi, en Vermundr fáði rúnar þessar.

2 Fugl vǣlva slǣit fǫlván · fann -gauk á nás- auka.

Derve got these scales from a Sambian man in ...-land, but Wermund carved these runes.

The fowl tore apart the death-pale robber; one observed the swelling on the corpse-cuckoo [RAVEN/EAGLE].

2 vǣlva 'robber' | A hapax in the entire Old Norse corpus, the word appears to be a cognate with Gothic *wilwa* 'robber, bandit' which translates Greek ἄρπᾰξ (Streitberg 1910, p. 175).

2 -gauk ... nás- 'corpse-cuckoo' | Taken as a compound *nás-gaukr* 'corpse-cuckoo [RAVEN/EAGLE]'.

2 auka 'swelling' | Viz. from the robber's flesh.

Vg 32

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO. The poetic nature of the inscription is proven by the unusual word-order where the verb *rêþu* ‘raised’ is bracketed by the object *þenna stên* ‘this stone’.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

þurþr × uk : þurun × þana × risþu × stin × efti × era × alkuþan : trik

Text

2 þò·rðr ok þór·unn · þenna rêþu
 stên efti Erra · all-góðan dreng.

Thurfrith and Thurun raised this stone
after Er, an all-good dreng.

Vg 59

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A large standing stone. The arrangement of the lines makes the division into three parts clear. First the prose memorial formula, then the first two lines (Eesie's poem) and finally the raisers' line.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

rífniṛ : auk : kiali : auk : brunulṛ : auk : kifulṛ : satu : stin : þānsi :
iftir : fut : faþur : sin : harþa : kuþan : þign ʒ : sua : hifir : āsa : as : igi
: mun : sum : kuin : ift : uir : siþan : kaurua : ʒ : hialmṛ : auk : hiali :
hiaku : runar ·

Text

*Hrēfningr auk Gialli auk Bryn·ulṛ auk Gef·ulṛ sōttu stēn þannsi
ēptir Fót, fōður sinn, harða góðan þegn.*

Rafning and Yeller and Byrnulf and Yevulf set this stone after Foot, their father, a very good thane.

- 2 Svá hafir Ása, · es ēgi mun
sum kvēn ēpt vēr · síðan gōrva.
4 Hialmṛ ok Hialli · hiōggv rúnar.

So has Eesie [made a monument], like never a wife
henceforth after her husband will make.
Helm and Helle hewed the runes.

Vg 61 (Härlingstorp)**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

: tula : sati : sten : þ... ...[ir kr : sun] : sin : harþa × kuþan : traþk : sa × 𐌹
uarþ : tuþr : ǣ : uastr:uakm : i : uikiku :

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

Vg 187

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A large standing stone decorated with a cross. The runes are well preserved.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

+ giri · sati · stin · þana · eftir · kuþa · bruþur · sin · er · a aḱ·lanti · altri ·
tynþi x

Text

2 Gêri satti stên þenna eftir Goða, bróður sinn,
 er á Eṅg-landi · aldri tynði.

Gare set this stone after Gid, his brother,
who in England lost his life.

Vs 15 (Málhammar)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A × higulfr × lit × kira × merki × þisa × at × ʀ knut × faþur san × uk × kuþlug
 · u×k sistur × hanis × bali × riti × istaen ʀ × bali o knutr ×
 § B × sten : hafir × ritan × þan × stanta × ma × bali (h)i- rauþi × yftir × bruþ[u]r
 × ʀ bali

Text

Heg·ulfr lét gæra merki þessa at Knút, fǫður sinn, ok Guð·lôg,*
 systur han*s. Balli rétti stæin.

2 Balli. Knútr.

TODO: trans

Stæn hafir réttan, · þann standa man,
 Balli hinn rauði, · optir bróður.
 Balli.

4

TODO: trans

Vs 24

Dating: C11th
Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Orthographically the os-rune is used for both the oral vowels *o* (**oþintisu**) and *ø* (**hulmkoetr, roþbalir**) and for nasal-adjacent *a* (**buonti, seno, þon**)

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

buonti × kuþr × hulmkoetr × lit × resa × ufter × oþintisu × kunu × seno ×
 kumbr × hifrya × til × hasmuimura × iki betr × þon × byi raþr roþbalir × risti
 × runi × þisa × sikmuntar × uar ... sestr × kuþ

Text

- Bóandi góðr Holm·gôtr lét rêsa øptir Óðin·Dísu, konu sína.
 2 Kombr **h**í-fręyja · til **H**as*u*-mýra
 êgi **b**ętri, · þan **b**ýi ráðr.
 4 **R**ôð-Ballir **r**ísti · **r**úniŕ þęssar.
 Sig·mundar var ... systir góð.

TODO: trans

Ög 8 (Kälvesten)

Dating: C9th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A remarkably old stone. Both orthography and the shape of runes agree very closely with the Ög 136 Rök.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A stikur (ʻ) karþi kubl þ(a)^(u) aft auint sunu sin ' sa fial austr
§ B mīr aiuisli ' uikikr faþi auk| |krimulfr

Text

2 Styggr gerði kumbl þau apt Ey-vind, sunu sinn.
 Sá fiall austr · meðr Eiv-ísli.
 Vikingr fáði ok Grím·ulfr.

Stig made these monuments after Eanwind, his son.
He fell in the east with Awyils.
Wiking and Grimwolf painted.

Ög 66

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The incorrect use of **h** (**halkuþan** **all-góðan*, *it* 'ét' for **hét*) indicates that the sound has been dropped

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

: ikiualtr : ristþi : stin : þisi : eftir : stufialt : bruþur : sin : suain :
halkuþan : sun sbialbuþa : it : inik : ant

Text

2 Ingi·valdr reisti stēin þēnnsi eptir Styfj·ald, bróður sinn,
 svein *all-góðan, · sun Spiall·buða.
 'Êt inni'k ēnt.

Ingwald raised this stone after Stivold, his brother,
an all-good swain, Spellbid's son.
I declare the promise fulfilled.

Ög 68

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

suina × karþi × bru × þesi × eftir × ouint × bruþur × sin × han × uas × uester
 × tauþer × i × uereks × (k)ai-i

Text

Svęina gęrði bró þęssi ęptir Eý·vind, bróður sinn.

2 Hann vas **v**estr dauðr · i **V**ęrings †**kai-i**†.

Swanie made this bridge after Eanwind, her brother.

He died in the west in the Weering's ...

Ög 77

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

: tuna : sati : stin : þ... --tr : sin : uar : þurfast : uas han : man : mist :
unþik ·

Text

2 Tonna satti stên þenna ęptir sinn vęr Þor·fast.
 Vas hann **man**na · **mę**str ó·níðingr

Tonne set this stone after her husband, Thurfast.
He was of men the greatest un-nothing.

2 **man**na | **man** Ög 77 2 **mę**str | **mist** Ög 77 2 ó·níðingr | **unþik** Ög 77

2 Vas hann manna · męstr ó·níðingr 'He was of men the greatest un-nothing' | Found near-identically in Sm 5 and Sm 37.

Ög 81 (Högby)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A stone standing at the former site of the mediæval Högby church, into which it was once bricked in. The stone is inscribed on 2 sides, A and B.

The orthography is notable in that older *ei* is consistently written as a monophthong, while *au* is still written as a diphthong. This unusual variation is reflected in the standardized orthography.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A · þukir · resþi · stin · þansi · eftir · asur · sen · muþur·bruþur · sin · iar · eataþis · austr · i · krikum ·

§ B · kuþr · karl · kuli · kat · fim · syni · feal · ą · furi · frukn · treks · asmutr · aitaþis · asur · austr · i krikum · uarþ · ą hulmi · halftan · tribin · kari · uarþ · at uti · 𐌱 auk · tauþr · bui · þurkil · rist · runar ·

Text

2 Þor·geððr rêsþi stên þanssi ęptir Qss·ur sên, móður·bróður sinn,
iar ęndaðis · austr i Grikkjum.

Thurgerd raised this stone after Answer the slow, her mother's brother
who met his end to the east in Greece.

4 Góðr karl Gulli · gat fimm syni;
fiall á Fýri · frókn drengr Qs·mundr,
ęndaðis Qss·urr · austr i Grikkjum,
6 varð á Holmi · Half·dan drepinn,
Kári varð at Uddi, · auk dauðr Bói.
8 Þor·kell rêst rúnar.

The good churl Gull begat five sons.
On Fyre fell the brave dreng Osmund,
Answer met his end to the east in Greece,
upon Holm was Halfdene slain,

Cheer was [slain] by Orde, also dead is Bo.
Thurkettle carved the runes.

Ög 136 (Rök)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Due to its great length, use of ciphers, unique content and damage in one part the Rök stone is certainly the most difficult runestone to interpret and explain. A full-length treatment could easily take up a 300-page book and therefore the present is only an excerpt of the immediately introductory prose passage followed by the 4-line stanza.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

[...] ' þat sakum ʒnaʒrt huar fur niu altum ʒ n urþi fiaru ʒ mir hraiþku-
tum auk tu ʒ mir ʒn ubsakar ʒ raiþ| þþiaurikr hin þurmuþi stilir ʒ flutna
strʒntu hraiþmarar sitir nu karur ʒ
ʒ B kuta sinum skialti ub fatlaþr skati marika

Text

[...] Þat sǫgum annart, hvar fór níu aldum á, en urði fiaru meðr
Hręð-gutum, ok dó meðr ʒn of-sakar.

This I say secondly, who journeyed upon the nine waves but struck the shore
amidst the Reth-Gots and died amidst them without guilt.

- 2 Ręð þiau·ríkr, · hinn þor·móði
 stillir flutna, · stręndu Hręð·marar;
4 sitir nú gęrur · á guta sīnum,
 skialdi of fatlaðr, · skati Męringa.

Theðric rode, the daring-minded
controller of sailors, upon the Rethmare shore.
Now he sits ready upon his horse,
his shield strapped, the lord of Meerings.

Ög 155

Dating: C11th
Meter: Speeches-meter

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

þurfriþ × risti × eftir × askut × auk × kauta sunu × sina × stin × þasi × han ×
 kuti × etapiþ × i × ikuars × hilfniþi ×

Text

þór·fríðr rêsti eftir Ós·gaut ok Gauta, sunu sina, stên þannsi.
 2 Hann Gauti endaðis · i Ing·vars helfningi.

Thurfride raised after Osgeat and Geat, her sons, this stone.
 Geat met his end in Ingwar's ship-troop.

Ög 165 (Skänninge)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A tall standing stone from Skänninge. The carver Thurkettle is the same as that of Ög 81.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

§ A (·) þurun · risti · auk × þir × bruþr × sunir :

§ B × tusta × iftir · sin · faþur

§ C × þurkil×k rist × stin : þansi : aufti : tusta :

Text

2 Þör·unn rêsti · auk þêr bróðr,
synir Tosta, · ęptir sinn fōður.
Þör·kell 'k rêst stên þannsi ępti Tosta.

Thurun raised [the stone] along with her brothers
the sons of Toste, after their father.
I, Thurkettle, carved this stone after Toste.

1 rêsti 'raised [the stone]' | The wording is so formulaic that the object can be left out without any injury to the sense.

Ög 212

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The stone is lost. TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

[tula : risti : stina : iftir · buka : auk · bru þa:si : ai : buna · þn]

Text

2 Tóla rêsti stêna eftir Bukka
 auk bró þási · at bónda þann.

Toole raised these stones after Bucke,
and this bridge after that husband.

Öl 1 (Karlevi)

Dating: C10th–C11th

Meter: Court-spoken meter

Introduction

Although technically outside of the scope of the present edition by virtue of its being a Scaldic composition in the Court-spoken meter, the Karlevi runestone is of such importance that its inclusion was felt imperative.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

+ s-a... --(s)- i(a)s · satr · aiftir · si(b)(a) · kuþa · sun · fultars · in h̄ans · liþi
 · sati · at · u · (t)ausaiþ?... +: fulkin : likr : hins : fulkþu : flaistr (:): uisi
 · þat · maistar · taiþir : tulka · þruþar : traukr : i : þaimsi · huki · munat
 : raiþ:uiþur : raþa : ruk:starkr · i · tanmarku : --ntils : iarmun·kruntar :
 urkr̄antari : l̄anti

Text

Steinn sási ias sattr ęptir Sibba góða son Foldars, en hans liði
 satti at   †(t)ausaiþ?...†

This stone is set after Sib the Good, son of Folder, but his retinue set it upon the island ...

- 2 Folginn liggr hinn's fylgðu, · —flęstr vissi þat—męstar
 dęđir, dolga Þrúðar · draugr, i þęimsi haugi;
 4 mun-at ręið-Viðurr ráða, · róg-starkr, i Dan-mqrku,
  ndils jormun-grundar, ·  r-grandari, landi.

Hidden lies the one whom the greatest deeds followed—most men knew that—the tree of the enmities of Thrith [BATTLES > WARRIOR] within this mound.

No more upright strife-strong Wither of the chariot of Andle's immense ground [SEA > SHIP > SEAFARER] will wield land in Denmark.

Öl 39 (Bägbý)

Dating: C11th
Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Runes

TODO: Runes

Transliteration

× sua(i)(n) kiarþi × iftir × sin × faþur × uikar × sun × ainiki × sialfr × raisti ×
stain ×

Text

2 Svęinn giarði ęptir sinn fęður, Vik·ar,
sunn ęinęigi · sialfr ręisti stęin.
...

Index of proper nouns

TODO.

Runic Poetry from Denmark and Scania

Introduction

The signa used for Danish inscriptions vary. According to the more common system all Danish inscriptions are numbered according to a unitary system based on the Danish corpus edition, which unlike the Swedish one is not divided into provinces. The online database *Danske Runeindskrifter* ('Danish Runic Inscriptions') does however follow a system identical to the Swedish one, and since those signa are easier to work with due to the ability to immediately identify the origin of any given inscription it has been adopted here, although references to the DR signa are given in parentheses following the origin.

Abbreviations of Danish regions

- Bh = Bornholm
- MJy = Midtjylland (Middle Jutland)
- NJy = Nordjylland (North Jutland)
- Sj = Sjælland (Zealand)
- SJy = Sønderjylland (South Jutland)
- SlB = Slesvig By (the town of Slesvig)
- Sk = Skåne (Scania)
- Syd = Lolland-Falster

Bh 33 (DR 379; Nylarsker-sten 1)

Dating: C11th–12th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Transliteration

sasur · lit · resa · sten · eftir · aluarþ · faður · sin · truknaði · han · uti · með
 · ala · sklibara · etki · i · kristr · hab(i) i siolu i has i sten · þesi · stai i
 eftir

Text

- Sassurr lét rêsa stên eftir Hall·varð, fǫður sinn.
 2 Druknaði hann **ú**ti · með **a**lla skipara.
 †etki† é Kristr hialpi siólu hans.
 4 **S**tênn þessi · **s**tái eftir.

Saswer had this stone raised after Hallward, his father.
 He drowned far out with all the shipmen.
 ...may Christ always help his soul.
 May this stone afterwards stand.

Bh 34 (DR 380; Nylarsker-sten 2)

Dating: C11th–12th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Transliteration

kobu:suain : raisti : stain : þ(e)na : a(f)tir : bausa : sun : sin : tr(i)... ..n :
þan : is : tribin : ua(r)þ : i : (u)(r)ostu : at : ut:la(n)(k)iu : kuþ : tr(u)tin :
hi(a)lbi : hans : ont : auk : sata : mikial :

Text

- 2 Kópu-Sveinn reisti stein þenna eftir Bausa, sun sinn,
dræng góðan, · þann es drepinn varð
i orrostu · at Út-længju.
4 Guð dróttinn hialpi hans ond auk santa Mikael.

Cloak-Swain raised this stone after Beaze, his son,
the good dreng who was slain
in battle by Utlengie.
Lord God and Saint Michael help his spirit.

4 santa Mikael ‘Saint Michael’ | Something of a patron saint on Bornholm, also invoked in Bh 1, Bh 4, and Bh 49. Cf. Syd 11 below.

Bh 42 (DR 387; Vestermarie-sten 5)

Dating: C11th–12th

Meter: Leeds-meter

Introduction

TODO.

Transliteration

: asualdi : risti : stein : þinsa : iftr : alfar : brupur : sin : drinr : koþr ¶ :
trebin u:syni : auk : skogi : suek : saklausan :

Text

2 Ös·valdi rísti stēin þennsa ęptir Alf·ar, bróður sinn,
 dręngr góðr · drepinn ú·sýni,
 auk Skógi svęik sak·lausan.

Oswald carved this stone after Elver, his brother;
the good dreng [was] shamefully slain
and Skoog betrayed him, guiltless.

MJy 37 (DR 94; Ålum-sten 1)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Transliteration

tuli : (r)(i)s-(i) : stin : þasi : aft 𐌺 ikal:t : sun : sin : miuk (:)(k)𐌺(u)... ...k
: þau : mun(u) 𐌺 mini : m-(r)gt : 𐌺 iuf (:)(:) þirta :

Text

2 Tóli rêþþi stên þannsi apt Ingj·ald sun sinn, miok góðan *dreng*.
 Þau munu minni · męřkt ê of birta.

Toole raised this stone after Ingeld, his son, a very good dreng.
TODO.

Mjy 71 (DR 131; Års-sten)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Transliteration

§ A : ʒsur : sati : stin : þansi : aft : ual:tuka : trutin : ʒ × sin

§ B × stin : kuask : hirs : stanta : laki : sar : ual:tuka × ʒ × uarþa : nafni

Text

Qnsurr satti stên þannsi apt Val-Tóka, dróttin sinn.
 2 Stênn kweðsk hérsi · standa lengi;
 sár Val-Tóka · varða nefni.

Answer set this stone after Wal-Took, his lord.

The stone proclaims it will stand here for long;

may it name Wal-Took's cairn.

3 varða 'cairn' | Acc. sg. of *varði* 'cairn or beacon raised as a landmark'. The word still survives in Danish *varde* 'id.', Faroese *varði* 'id.'

MJy 79 (DR 68; Århus-sten 5)

Dating: C10th–11th

Meter: Leeds-meter

Introduction

A well-preserved stone with a small piece struck off at the lower corner at the very beginning of the inscription.

Transliteration

§ A (·)usti × auk × hufi × auk × þir × frebiurn × riþu × stin × þansi × eftir ×
 ¶ × asur × saksa × filaka × sin × harþa ×

§ B kuþan × trik × sar × tu × ¶ × mana × mest × uniþikr × ¶ sar × ati × skib ×
 miþ × arnā +

Text

Tosti auk Hófi þær Frø·biorn rêsþu stên þannsi eftir Qnsur saxa,
 fé·laga sinn, harða góðan dreng.

2 Sár dó **m**anna · **m**est ú·níðingr;
 sár **a**tti skip með **A**rna.

Toste and Hove, they and Freebern raised this stone after Answer the seax,
 his partner, a very good dreng.

He died the greatest un-nithing of men;

he owned a ship with Arnle.

NJy 41 (DR 149; Ydby-sten)

Dating: C10th–11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The inscription is entirely poetic. The stone is heavily damaged and divided into several parts but the inscription survives in older depictions.

Transliteration

§ A þurkisl : [sati · au(k) (·) sunir (·) lifa · i] : s[t]aþ [· þa]¶l:nsi :

§ B [sti](n) (÷) (u)[ftir · lifa]

Text

þór·gísl satti · ok synir Lêfa
 2 ï stað þannsi · stên øptir Lêfa.

Thuryils set and the sons of Lofe
 in this place the stone after Lofe.

Sj 93 (DR 229; Sandby-sten 3)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

A heavily damaged stone, the verse can be tentatively reconstructed based on Syd 11.

Transliteration

§ A sylfa : rest... ...i : sbalklusu : cyfti : susur : faþur(r)þi : bru :
þisi : iki : ¶ þurils : brþur : sin :
§ B i mun · san... ¶ ...if · uitrik · susi · er · uan · sil...

Text

Sylfa rêsti stên þannsi i Spalk-lôsu øpti Susur, fôður sinn, ok ggrœi
bró þessi epti Þôr·ils, bróður sinn.
2 Ê mun standa, · með stênn á líf,
vitring súsi, · er vann Sylfa.

Silve raised this stone in Spalklease after Saswer, his father, and made this
bridge after Thuryils, his brother.
Ever will stand while the stone has life
this memento which Silve accomplished.

SJy 5 (DR 37; Egtved-sten)

Dating: C10th–11th

Meter: Unclear

Introduction

A fragmented stone; the remaining piece is easily read, but a large part is missing.

Transliteration

... ..at ' fai(n) ['] (t)u ÷ i suiu ' raist ¶uþir ' aft ' bruþur ¶ stain ' sasi ' skarni ' ...

Text

- ... at fáinn; dó i Svíu.
 2 Rēist *ia*k *rū*nar,
*bróð*ir apt *bróð*ur;
 4 stēin sási skęrni ...

the painted; died in Sweden.
 I carved the runes,
 a brother after [my] brother;
 may this stone TODO ...

Sjy 14 (DR 40; Randbøl-sten)

Dating: C10th

Meter: Leeds-meter

Introduction

A rare instance of a stone carved by a man for his wife.

Transliteration

tufi ÷ bruti ÷ risþi ÷ stin ÷ þansi ÷ aft ÷ lika ÷ ¶ brutia ÷ þir ÷ stafar ÷
munu ÷ ¶ þurkuni ÷ miuk ÷ liki ÷ lifa ÷

Text

2 Tófi bryti rêþi stên þannsi apt líka brytja.
 Þêr stafar · munu Þôr·gunni
 miok lēngi lifa.

Tove the bailiff raised this stone after the bailiff's helpmate.
These staves will for Thurguth
for a very long time live.

1 líka 'helpmate' | Or 'equal, match'. Although grammatically masculine (the nom. sg. is *líki*) the word can be used for both genders, as here.

3 lifa 'live' | Stones and staves 'living' is a common expression.

Sk 5 (DR 263; Skabersjö-fibula)**Dating:** C8th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Transliteration

§ P ... RRRRRRRRRRRRRRR -aþi tuk fauka fiar sis in a iak as(u) (þ)ui launat

¶ ... auab-k sua fakat...

§ Q ... (R)(R)RRRRRRRRRRRRRR (r)aþi (t)(u)k fauka fiar sis in a iak asa þui

launat ¶ ... auab-k sua fakat...

Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

Sk 42 (DR 337; Valleberga-sten)**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

A stone. TODO.

Transliteration

§ A : suin : auk : þurgutr : kiaurþu : kubl : þisi Ƿ eftir : mana Ƿ auk ·
suina

§ B kuþ : hialbi : siaul : þera : uel : ian : þer : likia : i : luntunum

Text

Svênn auk Þòr·gôtr giðrðu kumbl þessi ęptir Manna auk Svenna.

Guð hialpi siðl þêra vël,

2 ian þêr liggja · ï Londúnum.

Swayn and Thurgeat made these monuments after Manny and Swenny. God
help their soul well,
but they lie in London.

Sk 51 (DR 279; Sjörup-sten)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Leeds-meter

Introduction

TODO.

The incorrect use of **h** in **huptir** *øptir* and the lack of it in **an** *'ann* (= ON *bann* 'he') **a(f)þi** *'afði* (= ON *hafði* 'had') indicates the common East Norse loss of that phoneme.

Transliteration

[+ sa]ksi : sati : st[in] : þasi : huftir : a[s]biurn : (s)in : fil(a)ga 'ŋ (t)u-a[s]
: sun :] ŋ sar : flu : aki : a[t :] ub:sa(l)u)m : an : ua : maþ : an : uŋlabn :
a(f)þi '

Text

- 2 Saxi satti stên þannsi øptir Æs·biorn, sinn fé-laga, Tóka* sun.
 Sár fló ægi · at Upp-solum,
 en vá, með 'ann vöpn 'afði.

Saxe set this stone after Osbern, his partner, Took's son.

He did not flee at Upsele

but fought as long as he had weapons.

Sk 80 (DR 295; Hällestad-sten 1)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

TODO.

Transliteration

§ A : askil : sati : stin : þansi : ift[ir] ¶ : tuka : kurms : sun : sar : hulan

: ¶ trutin : sar : flu : aigi : at : ub:¶:salum

§ B satu : trikar : iftir : sin : bruþr ¶ stin : ą : biarki : stuþan : runum :

þir :

§ C (k)(u)(r)(m)(s) (: (t)(u)(k)(a) : kiku : (n)(i)(s)(t)[ir]

Text

Ös·kell satti stên þanssi ęptir Tóka, Gorms sun, sér hollan drót-
tin;

2 sár fló ęigi · at Upp-solum.

Sęttu drengar · ęptir sinn bróður

4 stên á biargi · stuððan rúnum;

þêr Gorms Tóka · gingu néstir.

Oskettle set this stone after Took, Gorm's son, to him a trusty lord;
he did not flee at Upsele.

The drengs set after their brother
a stone on the hill propped up by runes;
they marched closest to Gorm's Took.

Sk 81 (DR 296; Hällestad-sten 2)**Dating:** C11th**Meter:** Ancient-words-law**Introduction**

TODO.

Transliteration

: ąskautr : ristþi : stin : þansi (:) Ǻ (:) (i)ftir : airu : brþur : sin : ian : Ǻ :
 sar : uas : himþiki : tuka : nu : Ǻ : skal : statą : stin : ą : biarki :

Text

Ǫs·gautr rêsþi stên þannsi ęptir Ęiru, bróður sinn, ian sár vas
 hêm-þęgi Tóka.Nú skal standa · stên á biargi.

Osgaet raised this stone after Ore, his brother, and he was Took's retainer.
 Now shall stand the stone on the hill.

SIB 3 (DR Schl3; Slesvig-pind)

Dating: C11th
Meter: Leeds-meter

Introduction

A rune-inscribed stick containing a puerile curse.

Transliteration

§ A runar ÷ iag ÷ risti ÷ a ÷ rikiata ÷ tre sua
§ B reþ ÷ sar ÷ riki ÷ mo(g)r ÷ asir ÷ a ÷ artagum
§ C hular ÷ auk ÷ bular ÷ meli ÷ þer
§ D ars ÷ sum ÷ magi

Text

2 Rúnar iak rísti · á ríkjanda tré
 svá réð sár ríki mōgr;
4 ęsir á ár-dōgum · hullar ok bullar
 mēli þēr ars sum magi.

Runes I carve on the powerful wood;
so did the powerful boy counsel:
Eese in days of yore, hurlies and burlies,
may thy arse speak like thy belly!

Syd 11 (DR 212; Tillitse-sten)

Dating: C11th

Meter: Ancient-words-law

Introduction

The stone actually has three sides, but § C is by a different carver and dedicated to a different person; as such it ought to be treated as a separate inscription and not included.

Transliteration

§ A eskil : sulka : sun : let : res(a) ¶ sten : þena : eft : sialfan ¶ sik · e mun
 · stanta · meþ · sten ¶ lifir · uitrint · su · iar · uan · eskil
 § B kristr · hialbi · siol · hans ¶ aok · santa · migael

Text

- Ës·kil, Súlka sun, lét rêsa stên þenna ept sialfan sik.
 2 É mun standa, · með stênn lifir,
 vitrind sú · iar vann Ës·kil.
 4 Kristr hialpi siól hans auk santa Mikael.

Oskettle, Sulk's son, had this stone raised after himself.
 Ever will stand while the stone lives
 this memento which Oskettle accomplished.
 Christ and Saint Michael help his soul.

Index

Index (INCOMPLETE!)

NOTE: This index is both incomplete and inconsistently formatted and should not be relied on. New entries will be added and old ones corrected and expanded in the future. For an example of a complete entry see Yimer.

Cultural and religious terms and expressions (C)

ape (ON *api*, OE *apa*, OS *apo*, OHG *affo*, PNWGmc. **apô*) In the Old Norse the word seems to mean ‘fool, buffoon’, in the other old languages apparently ‘monkey’, though this sense should be a later development of the former; why would the early Germanic tribes have a word for an animal that they had never encountered?

aught (ON *étt*, OE *éht* ‘possession, property’) The Nordic (paternal) clan or family line.

begale (OHG *bi-galan*) To enchant, bewitch something or someone by singing a galder. Transitive of gale.

bigh (ON *baugr*, OE *béag*, OHG *boug*) Armlets used as currency during the Migration Period. — The giving of rings and armlets in exchange for loyalty (holdness being the word used for a warrior’s loyalty towards his lord, and of a lord’s grace towards his servants) was common across all of Germanic Europe, as seen in the many poetic ruler-kennings of the type “breaker of rings” (e.g. *béaga brytta* ‘the breaker of bighs’ in *Beow* ll. 35, 352, 1487). An illustrative example of this is *Hild* 33–35. This is also connected with the oath-ring, and the famous ring-swords. TODO? reference some literature on this.

bloot (ON *blót*, OE *blôt*, OHG *bluoz*) A sacrifice or a sacrificial feast, one of the best attested Germanic pagan practices. The animals would be sacrificed by the host, cooked in large kettles and eaten communally. See also bloot-house.

bloot-house (ON *blót-hús*, OHG *bluoz-hús*) A heathen temple. Glosses Latin *fānum* in OHG. See also harrow, hove, wigh.

Doom (ON *dómr*, OE *dóm*) ‘judgment, verdict’ (whence Doomsday, ‘Judgment Day’), but also ‘fame’. See *Háv* 77.

feather-hame (ON *fjáðr-hamr*, OE *fēðer-hama*, OS *fēðar-*, *fēðer-hamo*) A plumage which when donned by the wearer lets him fly like, or become a bird. One is owned by Frow and used by Lock to fly between the homes in *Þrk*. In the Christian *Heli* feather-hames are donned by angels who fly from heaven to earth. See also hame.

fee (ON *fé*, OE *fēoh*) Originally ‘cattle, kine’, however also used in a broader sense to refer to one’s mobile wealth; for that cf. particularly *Háv*.

fey (ON *fēigr*, OE *fēge*, OHG *feigi* ‘cowardly’) Being doomed or fated to die, with a sense of predestination and inevitability. Its earliest documented Scandinavian use is on the Rök stone: **aft uamuþ stanta runar þar + n uarin faþi faþir aft faikiān sunu** *Aft Vāmóð standa rúnar þár, en Varinn fáði, fáðir aft feigjan sonu* ‘After Woemood (*Vámóðr*) stand these runes, but Warren (*Varinn*) painted, the father after the **fey** son.’ See PCRN HS II:35, p. 928 ff. (TODO)

feyness (ON *fēigð*) The state of being fey.

fimble- (ON *fimbul-*) The ultimate, final, greatest. See Fimblethyle, Fimble-Winter.

five days (ON *fimm dagar*) The Old Scandinavian (and perhaps Germanic) week was originally five days long, the seven-day week being a later import, as seen by the names of the days, which are obviously calqued from the Latin (*Dies Mercurii* = Weden’s day, et.c.). According to the *Gula* there were six weeks in a month, and “five days” is used as a generic period of time in *Háv* 51 and 74; in st. 74 it is contrasted with month. Related to this is the legal term *fifth* (ON *fimmt*, OSw. *femt*), a meeting or gathering set to be held at a five-day notice. See *fimt* in CV, LMNL for further discussion.

galder (ON *galdr*, OE *gealdor*, OHG *galdar*) A magical song or incantation, probably synonymous with leed. Verbal noun formed to gale ‘to sing, chant’.

gale (ON *gala*, OE *galan*, OHG *galan*) To sing, chant, especially of magical songs; verbal root of galder ‘something sung, chanted’.

gand (ON *gandr*, Latin *gandus*) A witch’s familiar or foul spirit sent out to do her bidding. See PCRN HS I:17, p. 361 and II:26, p. 656. TODO

gid (ON *goði*, OE *Gydda* m. given name) A heathen priest or master of ceremonies.

gidden (ON *gyðja*, OE *gyden* ‘goddess’) The womanly equivalent or wife of a gid.

good of meat (ON *matar góðr*, *góðr matar*) An old formula appearing in *Háv* 39 and numerous Swedish Wiking Age Runic inscriptions Sm 39, Sm 44, Sö 130, U 703, and U 805. Cf. U 739 which has the related *mildr matar* ‘mild of meat’. Antonyms are *matar illr* ‘evil of meat’ and meat-nothing.

guest (ON *gestr*, OE *giest*, OS *gast*, OHG *gast*, Got. *gasts*, PGmc. *gastiz*) Guests were often strangers, wanderers, who would come to beg for food and lodgings. The Old Germanic peoples placed great value on hospitality. TODO.

hame (ON *hamr*) A skin, shape. People could “shift hames” (ON *skipta hǫmum*), leaving their human hames behind and instead entering into the shapes of wolves, bears, birds. During this process the original hame, that is, the human body, would be sleeping in a vulnerable state. A concise description of this is found in *Yng* 7: *Óðinn skipti hǫmum, lá þá búkr’inn sem sofinn eða dauðr, en hann var þá fugl eða dýr, fiskr eða ormr, ok fór á einni svípstund á fjarlæg lǫnd at sínum erendum eða annarra manna*. ‘Weden shifted hames; then lay the trunk of his body as if sleeping or dead, but he was then a fowl or beast, a fish or serpent, and journeyed in a short while to foreign lands with his errands or those of other men.’

See also feather-hame, fence-rideresses, evening-rideresses.

harrow (ON *hǫgr*, OE *hearg*, PNWGmc. **harugar*) A hallowed stone structure. *Hdl* 10 describes the construction of one. The Norwegian laws prescribe the “breaking of harrows and burning of hoves”. — See also hove, wigh.

hold (ON *holtr*, OE *hold*, OS *hold*, OHG *hold*) ‘Favourable, loyal, gracious’, often of a ruler towards his subject (in the sense of ‘gracious, benevolent’) or vice-versa (in the sense of ‘loyal, devoted’). Mirroring these earthly relationships, it is often used to refer to divine grace, both of the Christian God—thus in the *Ecclesiastical Laws of King Cnut* ALIE I (p. 372): *þam by þu witod-lice God hold, þe bið his hlāforde riht-lice hold* ‘Indeed God is **hold** to him who is rightly **hold** to his lord’—but in the oldest Scandinavian material likewise of the Heathen gods. So *Lok* 4 (e.): *holl regin ‘hold Reins’, and Oddr 9/1: Svá hjalpi þér · hollar véttir* ‘So help thee **hold** wights’.

This word is common in old Scandinavian oath formulæ, e.g. in the elder redaction of the West-Geatish Law: *Svá sé mér goð holl* ‘So may the Gods(!) be **hold** to me,’ in mediæval Norwegian laws (NGL II [197,397]) and Grey-Goose (TODO: cite): *Guð sé mér hollr ef ek satt segi, gramr ef ek lýg* ‘God be **hold** to me if I speak truly, wroth if I lie,’ in Grey-Goose (TODO) also: *Sé guð hollr þeim er heldr gríðum, en gramr þeim er gríð rýfr* ‘God be **hold** to him who keeps the truce, but wroth against him who breaks the truce’. I refer to Löffler (1895) for further discussion on these formulæ.

holdness (ON *hylli*, OE *hyldu*, OHG *buldí*) Abstract noun formed to hold, meaning ‘favour, loyalty, grace,’ with the same semantics as the adjective.

Notably, this word appears three times in connection with the grace of gods in the poetry, namely in *Grm* 43, where (according to my interpretation) the preparer of food at the bloot is said to earn the “**holdness** of Wolder and of all the gods;” and *Grm* 53 where the disgraced king Garfrith is said to have been bereft of the support *gengi* of Weden and all the Oneharriers, and of “Weden’s **holdness**” (*Öðins hylli*). “Weden’s holdness” is also mentioned in a stanza by Hallfrith (edited as Hfr Lv 7 by Diana Whaley in SkP V), who laments that: “The whole race of man has wrought songs to win the **holdness** of Weden; I recall the fully rewarded works of our kinsmen/ancestors.”

From the semantics of this word the Germanic view on heavenly grace is clear: the Gods are **hold** towards those who do good works, which include swearing true oaths, faithfully observing truces, partaking in the bloot, following rules of hospitality, and composing poetry—and gram ‘wroth’ towards those who do the opposite.

Home (ON *heimr*, OE *hám*, PNWGmc. **haimar*) In the Norse often referring to a realm in the cosmology (*Vsp* 2: “I remember nine **Homes**”, *Vafþ* TODO: “From the runes of the Ettins and of all the gods I can speak truly, for I have come into each **Home**”). Thus Ettinham is the ‘**Home**/realm of the ettins’. When used on its own it means ‘the world (that we inhabit)’. See also Nine Homes, Thrithham.

holy (ON *heilagr*) TODO.

hove (ON *hof*) A pre-Christian temple. See bloot-house, harrow.

leat (ON *blaut*) In some saws explained as the blood drained from the offered animal; the verbal root is *bljóta* ‘to get by lot’ and this word certainly refers to the use of the blood for auguries.

leat-twig (ON *blaut-tǣinn*) A twig used to sprinkle the leat. The pattern of the blood would presumably be inspected for the augury; cf. *Hym* 1.

leek (ON *laukr*, OE *léac*, PNWGmc *laukar*) The leek was a plant of great cultural importance. It was seen as the noblest plant, so 2 *Guðr* 2, where Siward’s superiority to the Yivickings is compared to a stag among wild beasts, gold among silver, and a green leek in grass; and *Vsp* 4, where the earth of the Golden Age was grown with green leek.

The leek was highly valued in folk magic, as seen already on gold bracteates from the C5th and C6th, where it often appears as a charm word in the old form *línkǫf* *laukar*; in one inscription also paired with *lín* *lína* ‘linen’. Classical Norse attestations of magic use include *Sigrðr* 8, where the leek is thrown into mead against poison; and the *Vǫlsa*, where a horse penis is said to be *lín* *góddr* · *en laukum studdr* ‘endowed with linen and supported by leeks’ in a poetic line. The

fragment.) Thus, Weden's taking of the *runes* should not be interpreted as merely a myth for the invention of profane writing, but rather the origin of esoteric incantations, not at all unlike Indian *māntrās*. The word for letter was instead stave, see also there.

saw

scold (ON *skald*) A Scandinavian court poet. The name probably comes from their ability to slander with words.

simble (ON *sumbl*, OE *symbol*) A banquet, symposium.

spae (ON *spó*) Prophecy, foresight.

Tables (ON *tafl*, OE *tæfl*) Generic term for board games (e.g. chess). In the golden age the Eese played such games (*Vsp* 8). Pre-Christian Germanic burials commonly feature boards and bricks (TODO: reference, maybe to the Salme ship burials).

thill (ON *þylja*) To recite poetry learned by heart. Cf. the so called thules (poetic lists) and the title thyle.

Thing (ON, OE *þing*, OS *thing*, OHG *ding*) The Old Germanic assembly, where cases were settled and the law determined. In connection with the Thing certain rituals were in order, viz. the enclosing of the space wherein the judges sat by means of wigh-bonds or sacred ropes. Cf. *Háv* 61 for an excerpt from *Germania* ch. 22. See also the Thing of the Gods.

thule (ON *þula*) A poetic list, typically of various items of a category (e.g. gods, legendary horses) or poetic synonyms (e.g. for swords, men, Weden). Decoratively also a ditty, poorly composed poem. See thyle.

thyle (ON *þulr*, OE *þyle*, PNWGmc. **þulir*) A sage who through rote learning has acquired a large amount of mythological lore (cf. thule 'a list in poetic form; a ditty, bad poem' and thill 'to recite, to chant'). Thus Weden is the Fimblethyle, being the unbeaten master of lore, as can be seen in his wisdom contests (like *Váff*). Runic inscription DR 248 (Snoldelev) suggests that the thyle may have tied to a specific place, and in *Beow* it seems to have been a court position, with the poet Unferth being described (l. 1456) as the "Rothgar's thyle".

wale (ON *vǫlr*) The staff or sceptre of a wallow. TODO: archeological finds, mention Sutton Hoo.

wallow (ON *vǫlva*, OE **wealwe* (cf. ON *svǫlva*, OE *swealwe* 'swallow')) A sibyl, seeress, oracle. The word derives from the wale, a staff or sceptre probably used for ritual purposes.

waste (ON *sóa*) To ritually waste, to slay in a sacrificial context. *Háv* 109/4, 144/4 (n.), 145/3 (in *ofsóa* 'waste, kill too much').

wigh (ON *vé*, OE *wéoh*, *wib*, PNWGmc. **wibą*) A holy place or sanctuary. It seems that where the harrow was a pile of stones or cairn used for carrying out rituals, the **wigh** was an enclosed space. The earliest Norse attestation is the runic inscription Ög N288 (Oklunda), which reads: “Guthēr <= Gunn:arr> painted these runes, and he fled, charged (with a crime, sought out this wigh, and he fled into this clearing. [...]” The implication seems to be that the wigh was considered so sacred that Guthēr could not be apprehended or punished for his crime while in it.

In OE the word means ‘pagan idol’. It is not immediately clear which meaning is the original one, but in the present edition the Norse sense has been adopted, since the Anglo-Saxon sources are all of a Christian nature. The name *Wighstone* (*Wib-* or *Wēohstān*) as found in *Beow* in any case suggests it is the Norse meaning, since ‘idol-stone’ makes little sense.

wode (ON *óðr*, OE *wód*, PNWGmc. **wódur*) Heener’s gift to men, though the name may suggest it be from Weden. The word has several related meanings: ‘mind, (poetic) inspiration, rage’. See also *Woderear*.

wyrm (ON *ormr*, OE *wyrm*, PNWGmc. **wurmīr*) A dragon, serpent. The distinction between “wyrm” and “worm; snake” is purely editorial and not made in the original languages.

yin- (ON *ginn-*) A rare augmentative prefix. TODO.

yin-holy (ON *ginn-heilagr*) High holy, sacrosanct. Used of the Gods in the formula *ginn-heilög goð* ‘yin-holy Gods’.

Proper nouns (P)

Indirect mentions (e.g. *Vafþ* 54/4 for Balder) follow the main entry; mentions based on textual emendation are italicized.

For names of people in Runic inscriptions see the end of each section.

Ash of Ugdrassle m.a., ON askr Ygg-drasils: *the world tree and site of the Thing of the Gods*; *Vsp* 45/5 (Ygg-drasils askr), *Grm* 36/1, 45/1; acc. sg. ask Ygg-drasils, *Vsp* 18/1 (Ask vęit’k standa, heitir Ygg-drasils); dat. sg. aski Ygg-drasils, *Grm* 29/4 & 30/5 (dag hvern es dōma ferr/fara at ~), 31/2, 32/2, 34/1. [Likely Yggr ‘Ug, Weden’ + *drasill, variant of drǫsull ‘horse, steed’, referring to Weden’s hanging (cf. *Háv* 138).] — See Leered, Hoard-mimer’s Wood.

Attle 1 m.a., *king of the Huns, historically from 434–453 CE*. ON Atli, TODO. — OE *Ætla*, *Wid* 18; gen. sg. *Ætlan*: ~ léodum, *Wid* 122. [PGmc. **Attilō* whence MHG. *Etzel*. Latin *Attila* borrowed from Gothic.]

Attle 2 [2] m.a., ON Atli: *son of the earl Idmund*; *HHj* P1 (thrice), 2/pr, 3/pr, P2, P3 (thrice), P6 (thrice), 13/pr, 15/pr, 15/1, 18/pr, 21/pr, 23/pr, 30/pr, 30/2; acc. sg. *Atla*, *HHj* 2/1; voc. sg. *Atli*, *HHj* 19/1, 20/1, 20/3, 22/1.

Attle 3 [3] m.an., ON *Atli*: *son of King Ring*; dat. sg. *Atla*, 1 *HHund* 52/2.

Balder m., *god, son of Woden, husband of Nan*. ON *Baldr*, *Vsp* 59/2, 59/3, *Grm* 12/1, *Hdl* 28/2, *Gylf* 49:77 (*Eddbr V*), *Hamð* 25/2 (kenning; cf. *Ermenric*); acc. sg. *Baldr*, *Lok* 28/4, *Gylf* 49:81 (*Eddbr V*); gen. sg. *Baldrs*: *Eddbr V* 1/2; ~ *bróðir*, *Vsp* 32/3; ~ *faðir*, *Hdl* 29/1; ~ *and-skota*, *Vsp* 33/2, *Bdr* 11/4; ~ *bana*, *Bdr* 10/4; dat. sg. *Baldri*, *Vsp* 31/1 (n.), *Bdr* 1/4, 7/1, 8/3 & 9/2, *Lok* 27/2. — Note: áðr à bál of *bar/berr Baldrs and-skota*: *Vsp* 33/2, *Bdr* 11/4; *hverr/hann man Baldri at bana verða*: *Bdr* 8/3, 9/2. — Cpds.: **host-Balder** [WARRIOR], ON *her-Baldr*: *Sigsk* 18/3. — Indirect: ON *Óðins barni*: *Vsp* 31/2; *syni Vafþ* 54/4 & 55/2; *ungum Óðins syni*: *Ski* 21/2 & 22/2 (cf. *Dreepner*). — OHG *Balter*; gen. sg. *Balderes*, *Mers II* 2. [PNWGmc. **baldrar* 'lord' (> OE *bealdor*). OE *Bældæg*, son of Wóden in the AS genealogies, cannot be a direct cognate.]

Balethorn m., ON *Bölþorn*: *obscure ettin, father of Bestle*; gen. sg. *Bölþorns*: *syni* ~, *Háv* 140/1–2 (n.).

Barrey m., ON *Barri*: *holy grove*; *Ski* 39/1 (n.) & 41/1 (*Barri heitir etc.*).

Beadhild f. *king Nithad's daughter*. ON *Böðv-ildr*, *Vkv* P1, 19/1, 26/1, 29/4, 36/3; acc. sg. *Böðv-ild*, *Vkv* 39/2; gen. sg. *Böðv-ildar*, *Vkv* 17/2; dat. sg. *Böðv-ildi*, *Vkv* P2, 25/4 & 36/2 (*sló('k) brjóst-kringlur, sændi/sænðak* *Böðv-ildi*); voc. sg. *Böðv-ildr*, *Vkv* 40/1. — OE *Beado-hild*, dat. sg. *Beado-hilde*, *Déor* 8.

Beal f., ON *Beyla*: *minor agricultural goddess, wife of Bewer (1)*; *Lok* P1, 55/pr; voc. sg. ~, *Lok* 56/1.

Beck m.an., ON *Bikki*: *a cruel general associated with Attle or Ermenric*; *Glv* P1 (twice); gen. sg. *Bikka*, *Sigsk* 64/1, *Akv* 15/2. — OE *Becca*: *obscure king, but likely the same as the Norse figure*; *Wid* 19; acc. sg. *Beccan*, *Wid* 115.

Bellower m.jan., ON *Bēli*: *obscure monster slain by Free*; gen. sg. *Bēlja*: *bani* ~, *Vsp* 51/3 (n.).

Bestle f., ON *Bęstla*: *wife of Byre, daughter of Balethorn, mother of Weden, Will and Wigb*; gen. sg. *Bęstlu*: ~ *föður*, *Háv* 140/2 (n.).

Bewer [Bewer 1] m., ON *Byggvir*: *minor god of barley, Free's servant, husband of Beal*; *Lok* P1, 43/pr, 45/1; gen. sg. *Byggvis*: ~ *kvęn*, *Lok* 56/1; voc. sg. *Byggvir*, *Lok* 46/1.

Bewer 2 [2] m., OE *Béow*: *legendary Danish king, son of Shield*; *TODO*.

Bray [Bray 1] m.an., ON *Bragi*: *god of poetry, husband of Idin*; *Grm* 45/4, *Lok* P1, 8/pr, 11/4, 12/pr, 12/2, 14/pr; acc. sg. *Braga*, *Lok* 18/3; gen. sg. *Braga*, *Sigrdr* 15/5; voc. sg. *Bragi*, *Lok* 13/3, 15/2, 16/1.

Bray 2 [2] m.an., ON *Bragi*: *TODO. 2 HHund*.

- Byre** m.i., ON Burr: *early god, father of Weden, Will, and Wigh*; gen. sg. Burs, *Hdl* 29/1; ~ synir, *Vsp* 4/1 (n.). See Sons of Byre. [burr 'son' < PGmc. *buriz 'id.', whence OE byre 'id.']
- Danes** m.i.pl., *tribe in eastern Denmark and southern Sweden*. ON Danir: gen. pl. Dana, *Helr* 11/4; dat. pl. Dǫnum, 2 *Guðr* 18/1. — Cpds.: **mountain-Danes** [ETINS], ON berg-Danir: gen. pl. berg-Dana, *Hym* 17/4. — OE Dēni: TODO. — See Danish.
- Dene** m.i., ON Danr: *legendary ancestor of the Danes*; *Rþ* 46/1 (n.).
- Dreepner** m.ja., OE Draupnir: *mythological duplicating ring*. Indirect: baug; *Ski* 21/1 (n.), 22/1.
- Dreepner 2** [2] m.ja., OE Draupnir: *dwarf*; *Vsp* 15/1.
- Dwarfs** (ON *dvergar*, OE *dweorgas*, OHG *twerca*, PNWGmc. **dwerǵór*) Earthly (chthonic) supernatural beings, living in rocks and the earth. Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO
- Earp 1** m.a., ON Erpr: *son of Enacker and half-brother of Hamthw and Sarle*; *Ghv* P1 (n.), *Hamð* 12/1, 28/1.
- Earp 2** [2] m.a., ON Erpr : *murdered son of Attle and Gutbrun, always paired with Oatle*; 2 *Guðr* P1; acc. Erp, *Akv* 41/2; gen. Erps, *Hamð* 8/1.
- Earth** (ON *jørð*, OE *eorþe*, OHG *erda*, PNWGmc. **erþu*, PGmc. **erþó*) The personified Earth. By Weden the mother of Thunder.
- Eastern Way** (ON *Austr-vegr*) In the mythology the eastern lands of the Ettins, to which Thunder goes to fight the Ettins and protect the realms of Gods and Men; see also Ettinham. In geography referring to Eastern Europe and Asia, but with a connotation of barbaric wilderness.
- Edgethew** m.a., ON Eggþér: *obscure ettin herdsman*; *Vsp* 41/2. [PNWGmc. *Sinþa-gunþir(?)]
- Eese** (rhyming with *geese*; ON *ésir*, OE *ése*, PNWGmc. **ansiwīr*; sg. *os*, ON *óss*, OE *ós*, PNWGmc. **ansur*) The (male) gods. *Gylf* and *Yng* present them as a separate tribe from the Waners. See also Bonds, Gods, Reins, Farrowes Tews; for the goddesses see Ossens. Noted members: Balder, Free, Hath, Homedall, Tew, Thunder, Weden Occurrences: TODO
- Elves** (ON *alfar*, OE *ielfe*, PNWGmc. **alþíR*) Earthly (chthonic) minor deities. Possibly ancestral spirits? Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO
- Enacker** m., ON Jön-akr: *third husband of Gutbrun, father of Earp (1), Hamthw and Sarle*; gen. sg. Jön-akrs, *Sigsk* 62/4, *Ghv* P1; ~ sonum, *Sigsk* 63/1; ~ sonu, *Ghv* 14/4, *Hamð* 25/4. [? + *wakraz 'quick, awake']

- Ermenric** m. *king of the Eastern Gots, historically ca. 300–376 CE.* ON *Jǫrmun-rek(k)r*, *Sigs* 64/2, *Ghv* 2/3, *Hamð* 3/2, 20/1; dat. sg. *Jǫrmun-rekki*, *Ghv* 5/3, *Hamð* 19/1; *Jǫrmun-rekk*: ~ *inum ríkja*, *Ghv* P1; voc. sg. *Jǫrmun-rek(k)r*, *Hamð* 24/2, 24/5. — OE *Eorman-ric*, *Wid* 18; gen. sg. *Eorman-rices*, *Wid* 8, 111, *Déor* 21; dat. sg. *Eorman-rice*, *Wid* 88. [Latin (H)ermanaricus from Gothic *airman ‘great, immense’ + reiks ‘king’. Cf. MHG Ermen-rich in legendary ballads.]
- Ettinham** m.a., ON *Jǫtun-heimr*: *the “Ettin-Home”, eastern realm of chaotic enemies of the Gods*; *Vsp* 46/2. See Ettin-Homes, Homes of the Ettins, Eastern Way, Outyards.
- Ettin-Homes** m.a.pl., ON *Jǫtun-heimar*: *see Ettinham*; acc. pl. -heima, *Ski* P1, 40/3, *Drk* 7/2 (n.), 12/4, 13/5, 20/3, 21/4, 26/4 & 28/4; dat. pl. -heimum, *Vsp* 8/4. [*Jǫtunn* ‘ettin’ + *heimar* ‘homes, realms’.]
- Ettins** (ON *jǫtnar*, OE *eotenas*, PNWGmc. **etunór*) The fundamental enemies of the Gods, the agents of chaos and disorder. See Rises, Thurses. Noted members: Hymer, Thrim, Webthritner, Yimer Occurrences: TODO
- Fallowhooven** m.ja., ON *Fal-hófnir*: *one of the gods’ horses*; *Grm* 30/1. [*fǫlr* + *hófr* + -nir]
- Fathomer** m.ja., ON *Fáfnir*: *the wyrm slain by Siward, son of Rethmar, brother of Otter and Rein*; acc. sg. *Fáfnir*, TODO; gen. sg. *Fáfnis*, *Grip* 13/1, 15/4, TODO, 2 *Guðr* P1; bani ~, *Oddr* 17/4; dat. sg. *Fáfnir*, *Grip* 11/4, TODO, *Helr* 10/4.
- Fenhalls** m.i.pl., ON *Fen-salir*: *Frie’s dwellings*; dat. pl. *Fen-solum*, *Vsp* 33/3 (n.).
- Fenrer** m.ja., ON *Fenrir*: *evil wolf, one of Lock’s three children*; *Vafþ* 46/4 (n.), 47/2; *Lok* 38/4.
- Fenrerswolf** m., ON *Fenris-ulfr*: *synonymous with Fenrer*; TODO.
- Fimblethyle** m.i., ON *Fimbul-þulr*: *name for Weden*; *Háv* 80/4 & 142/4. [‘Great Thyle’.]
- Fimble-Winter** m., ON *fimbul-vetr*: *the Great Winter before the destruction of the earth*; *Vafþ* 44/4. [*fimbul-* ‘fimble-, great’ + *vetr* ‘winter’.]
- Fold** (ON *Fold*, OE *Folde*) A poetic or ritual name of Earth, especially in her role as Mother Earth. In Germanic poetry the word *fold* is typically used to simply refer to ‘land’, however. It is cognate with Sanskrit TODO.
- Folkwong** m., ON *Folk-vangr*: *Frow’s heavenly dwelling*; *Grm* 14/1 (n.). [*folk* ‘troop, army’ + *vangr* ‘meadow’.]
- Foresitter** m.an., ON *For-seti*: *god associated with legal proceedings (Things), son of Balder and Nan*; *Grm* 15/3 (n.) [TODO. ‘Presider’.]

- Free** m.ja., ON Freyr: *god, son of Nearth, brother of Frow; Skí* P1, 4/pr, 6/pr, 9/pr, 20/3 (vit ~), 33/2, P4, 42/pr, *Lok* P1, 37/1, 41/pr, *Hdl* 29/2; acc. sg. Frey, *Skí* P1, 19/3; gen. sg. Freys, *Lok* 44/3; skó-sveinn ~, *Skí* P1; þjónustu-menn ~, *Lok* P1; ~ vinar, *Sigsk* 24/4; dat. sg. Frey, *Grm* 5/3, 44/3 (skírum ~); voc. sg. Freyr, *Skí* 3/1. [$<$ PNWGmc. *frawjar 'lord', = OE fréa 'id.'. Likely from earlier Yngvi-Freyr 'Lord Ing', see *Lok* 43/1 n.] — Cpds.: **Ingwin-Free**, ON Ingunar-Freyr: *Lok* 43/1 (n.). — Indirect: bani Belja, bjartr: *Vsp* 51/3 (n.); folk-valdi goða: *Skí* 3/1; nýtum Njarðar bur: *Grm* 44/4; inum þroska Njarðar syni: *Skí* 38/4; Njarðar syni: *Skí* 39/3 & 41/3; okkarn mög: *Skí* 1/2; mög: *Skí* 2/2; ykkrum syni: *Skí* 2/1; inn fróði afi: *Skí* 1/3–4 & 2/3–4; seggr: *Skí* 5/2; minn dróttinn: *Skí* 3/4. — See Ing, Ingwin, Waning.
- Frie** f.ō. *goddess, wife of Weden, (in the Norse:) mother of Balder*. ON Frigg: *Vsp* 33/3, *Vafþ* 2/pr, 4/pr, *Grm* P2 (3 times), *Lok* P1, 25/pr, 27/pr, 29/3, G1/3, *Gylf* 35:1 (in *Eddbr* IV), *Oddr* 9/2; gen. sg. Friggjar, *Vsp* 51/4; voc. sg. Frigg, *Vafþ* 1/1, *Lok* 26/1, 28/1. — OHG Frijia: *Mers II* 4. — Latin Frea: *Origo Gentis Langbardorum* 1:9 (n.), 1:10, 1:12; acc. sg. Fream, *Origo Gentis Langbardorum* 1:8. [PGmc. *Frijjō, orig. f. sg. of lost adj. *frijjaz 'dear, beloved'. Latin Frea is from Longbeardish. Cf. OE *Frīg (gen. sg. frīge, e.g. in frīge-dæg 'Friday', lit. 'Frie's day').] — See Line.
- Frow** f.ōn., ON Freyja: *goddess, daughter of Nearth, sister of Free, wife of Wode; Grm* 14/1 (n.), *Lok* P1, 29/pr, 31/pr, *Prk* 13/1, 26/3 & 28/3, *Oddr* 9/2, *Hdl* 1/1, 7/1; acc. sg. Freyju, *Prk* 8/4 & 11/4, 12/1, 22/3; gen. sg. ~, *Prk* 3/1, 23/4 27/3; voc. sg. Freyja, *Lok* 30/1 & 32/1, 32/4, *Prk* 3/3, 12/3, *Hdl* 6/1. [PNWGmc. *frawjō 'lady', = OHG frouwa 'id.']. — Note: föri(ð ...) Freyju at kvæn/kvön: *Prk* 8/4, 11/4, 22/3; át/svaf vétr Freyja átta nóttum: *Prk* 26/3, 28/3; þegi þú, Freyja: *Lok* 30/1, 32/1. — Indirect: Óðs mey: *Vsp* 24/4 (n.); Njarðar dóttur ór Nóa-tünum: *Prk* 22/4.
- Full** f.ōn., ON Fulla: *maid-servant of Frie; acc. sg. Fullu, Grm* P2. — OHG Volla: *sister of Frie; Mers II* 4.
- Gagglewood** m.u., ON Gagl-viðr: *forest in the East, perhaps = Ironwood; dat. sg. Gagl-viði, Vsp* 41/3.
- Gangred** m.pl., ON Gang-ráðr: *name for Weden; Vafþ* 8/1 (~ heiti'k); voc. sg. ~, *Vafþ* 9/1, *Vafþ* 11/1, *Vafþ* 13/1, *Vafþ* 15/1, *Vafþ* 17/1. [gangr 'a walk' + -ráðr 'decider, counsellor', i.e., 'one who chooses to wander'.]
- Gap of Hawks** n., ON gap ginnunga: *the air in-between Earth and Up-heaven; Vsp* 3/4 (n.).
- Geatland** (ON *Gaut-land, Gauta-land*) The land of the Geats in southwestern Sweden.

Geats (ON *gautar*, OE *géatas*, PNWGmc. **gautór* from **geut-* ‘to pour’, perhaps ‘the libators’) A tribe in what is today southern-central Sweden. See also Geatland, Swedes. Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO

god n., ON *goð*: *a god, regardless of gender*; dat. sg. *goði*: *inu skír-ļeita goði*, *Grm* 40/1–2; *skínanda ~*, *Grm* 39/2, *Sigrdr* 15/1. [OE *god*, OHG *got*, PGmc. **gudā*.]

Gods n.pl., ON *goð*: *the Gods, often used in a pantheistic sense in the pl.*; *Hym* 22/3, *Lok* 49/4 & 50/2, *Fáfn* 15/2, *Oddr* 9/2; *goð'in qll*, *Vsp* 22/4; *goð qll*, *Lok* 45/2, 55/4; *qll ~*, *Hdl* 49/4; *in svōsu ~*, *Vafþ* 17/4 & 18/2; *ginn-heilog ~*, *Vsp* 6/2, 9/2, 22/2, 24/2; acc. pl. *goð*, *Hym* 3/2, *Lok* 12/4, *Lok* 55/4; gen. pl. *goða*, *Vafþ* 50/3, *Skí* 33/4, *Reg* 19/2; *gørðum ~*, *Vafþ* 2/2; *vé ~*, *Vafþ* 51/1; *hodd ~*, *Grm* 27/5; *þing ~*, *Hym* 39/1; *skír brúðr ~* (*kenning for Shede*), *Grm* 11/3; *vørðr ~* (*kenning for Homedall*), *Grm* 13/3, *Lok* 48/4; *folk-valdi ~* (*kenning for Free*), *Skí* 3/1; *þrúð-valdr ~* (*kenning for Thunder*), *Hárb* 9/4; *allra ~*, *Vafþ* 42/3 & 43/1, *Grm* 43/1; dat. pl. *goðum*, *Vafþ* 15/4 & 16/2, 39/2, *Grm* 51/2, 56/4, *Lok* T1, 34/2 & 35/2, *Alv* 4/4, 12/1, 14/1, 16/1, 18/1, 20/1, 22/1, 24/1, 28/1, 30/1, 32/1, *Hdl* 8/3, 27/5, *Am* 54/5; *vørðr með ~*, *Skí* 28/4; voc. pl. *goð*, *Lok* 7/1; *qll ginn-heilog ~*, *Lok* 11/2. [OE *godu*, OHG *gota*, PNWGmc. **gudō*, pl. of **gudā*.]

Goldencomb ON Gollin-kambi: *cock which awakens the men of Walkhall*; *Vsp* 42/1.

Guthur (ON *Gunn·arr*, MHG *Gunther*) The lord of the Gots. In the Norse sources the brother of Hawn. Historically he is based on king *Gundabarius* (**Gunþibarjaz*) of the Burgundians.

Guthlathe f.ō., ON *Gunn·lōð*: *daughter of the ettin Sutting who guarded the Mead of Poetry*; *Háv* 105/1; acc. sg. *Gunn·lōðu*, *Háv* 110/4; gen. sg. *Gunn·laðar*, *Háv* 13/4, 108/3. [*gunnr* ‘battle, war’ + *lōð* ‘invitation’]

Guthrun (ON *Guð·rún*) Daughter of king Yivick, sister of Guthur and Hawn. The wife of Attle.

Hamthew m.ja., ON *Ham·ðir*: *son of Enacker and Guthrun, brother of Sarle and Earp* (1); *Gbv* P1, 4/1, 8/1, *Hamð* 6/1, 24/1, 26/1, 31/2; acc. sg. *Ham·ði*, *Hamð* 21/2; gen. sg. *Ham·ðis*, *Hamð* T1, P1; voc. sg. *Ham·ðir*, *Hamð* 27/1. — Note: *Þà kvað þat Ham·ðir inn hugum stóri*, *Gbv* 4/1, 8/1; *Hitt kvað þà Ham·ðir inn hugum stóri*, *Hamð* 6/1, 24/1, 26/1. [= Ammius in Jordanes, *Getica*; see Introduction to *Gbv*.]

Hate 1 m.an., ON *Hati*: *ettin, father of Rimegerd*; *HHj* 17/1; acc. sg. *Hata*, *HHj* P6, 24/2; gen. sg. *Hata*: ~ *dóttir*, *HHj* P6.

Hate 2 [2] m.an., ON *Hati*: *wolf that chases the moon*; *Grm* 40/3. See Sholl, Rothwitner.

- Hath** m.u., ON Hǫðr: *blind god, Balder's killer*; *Vsp* 32/2, 59/3, *Bdr* 9/1; dat. sg. Hęði, *Bdr* 10/3.
- Hawn** [Hawn 1] (ON *Hogni*, OE *Haguna*, *Hagena*, OHG *Hagano*, Ger. *Hagen*, PNWGmc. **Hagunō*) A Nivling and Yivicking, son of king Yivick, brother of Guthur and Guthrun. In *Akv* he defeats seven warriors before being captured by Attle, who has his heart cut out at the request of Guthur.
- Hawn 2** [2] A petty king of East Geatland, contemporary with Granmer, the king of Southmanland and Ingeld Illred, the Ingling king of Upland.
- Heener** m.ja., ON Hǫnir: *obscure (bird?-)god*; *Vsp* 17/3 (n.), 60/1, *Reg* P1. [PNWGmc. *Hónijar 'the little swan(?)']
- Hell** [Hell 1] (ON *hēll*, OE *hēll*, PNWGmc. **halju*, Got. *halja*) The Underworld, personified as and formally identical to Hell, the goddess. After the arrival of Christianity this word came to refer to the Christian hell-fire (= *Gebenna*), which is the case in all attested languages apart from the Old Norse. Cf. Nivelhell.
- Hell 2** [2] (ON *Hēll*) Goddess of death and Hell (the Underworld).
- Hindle** (ON *Hynlla*) A witch awoken by Frow in *Hdl*.
- Homedall** m.a., ON Hęim·dallr: *god born of nine mothers, Watchman of the Gods*; *Vsp* 45/3, *Lok* 47/pr, *Þrk* 15/1 (~, hvitastr Ása), *Rþ* P1, *Gylf* 27:1 (under *Eddbr* III); acc. sg. Hęim·dall, *Grm* 13/1; gen. sg. Hęim·dalar, *Vsp* 26/1; mögu ~, *Vsp* 1/2; Hęim·dallar, *Gylf* 27:15 (under *Eddbr* III); voc. sg. Hęim·dallr, *Lok* 48/1. [hęimr 'home, (the settled) world' + *dallr 'brilliant, shining'. See *Vafþ* 25/1 n., *Þrk* 13/3 n.] — Indirect: TODO.
- Homes of the Ettins** m.a.pl., ON jǫtna hęimar: *see Ettinbam*; gen. pl. jǫtna hęima, *Þrk* 5/3 (n.) & 9/2.
- Huns** (ON *búnir*, OE *Húne*, OHG *Húni*, *Hunni*, PNWGmc. **búnir*) Invading Asiatic tribe in the Migration Period. In the Scandinavian legends they have been assimilated into the Germanic framework, and are not presented as racially or culturally distinct; part of this is undoubtedly due to their confusion with a Danish tribe (TODO). Noted members: Attle, TODO Occurrences: TODO
- Hymir** m., ON Hymir: *ettin, Tew's father according to Hym*; 5/2, 7/4, 10/2, 16/3pr, 17/3pr, 19/3pr, 21/1, 25/3, 26/pr, 32/pr, 39/2; gen. sg. Hymis, *Hym* T1 (in A), 15/4, 30/3; ~ meyjar, *Lok* 34/3; dat. sg. Hymi, *Hym* 29/4, 35/3; voc. sg. *Hym* 11/1 (ves hęill, Hymir). — Indirect: minn faðir: *Hym* 5/3 (n.); minn fríi: *Hym* 9/3; karl: *Hym* 32/3; gen. sg. karls: *Hym* 10/4 (n.); dat. sg. karli: *Hym* 31/3; jǫtunn, *Hym* 14/4, 20/3, 28/1; gen. sg. jǫtuns: *Hym* 27/4; forn jǫtunn: *Hym* 13/3; ballr jǫtunn: *Hym* 17/2; ò-teitr jǫtunn: *Hym* 25/1; kost-móðs jǫtuns: *Hym* 30/4; hǫrum

Hrungnis spjalla: *Hym* 16/1; kjóla valdi: *Hym* 19/4; átt-runns apa: *Hym* 20/2.

Idewold m.u., ON *Iða-völlr*: *the 'Plain of Industry', where the Gods settle and build Osyrd*; dat. sg. -velli: *Vsp* 7/1, 57/1.

Idin f.i., ON *Ið-unn*: *goddess, keeper of the golden apples of immortality (cf. Skí 19/1 n.), wife of Bray*; *Lok* P1, 16/pr, 18/pr; voc. sg. ~, *Lok* 17/1. [ið + -unnr.]

Ilewaves m.pl., ON *Éli-vágar*: *chaotic (primæval) salty waters*; acc. pl. *Éli-vága*, *Hym* 5/1 (n.); dat. pl. *Éli-vógum*, *Vafþ* 31/1 (n.).

Ing (ON *Yngvi*, OE *Ing*) Probably an older name of Free. The legendary ancestor of the Inglingas. Cf. Ingwin-Free, Ing-Free. Occurrences: TODO, the Old English Rune Poem.

Inglingas (ON *Ynglingar*, PNWGmc. **Ingwalingóŕ* 'the descendants of Ing') The oldest known Swedish kingly lineage. The difference between Inglingas and Shilvingas is a bit unclear; they seem to be used synonymously in the Norse sources but *Beow* knows them only as Shilvingas.

Inwithies f.ö.pl., ON *ī-viðjur*: *troll-women (?)*; *Vsp* 2/3 (n.).

Ironwood m.u., ON *Éarn-viðr*, *Járn-viðr*: *forest in the East where wolves are reared, perhaps = Gaggglewood*; dat. sg. *Éarn-viði*, *Vsp* 39/1.

Kneefrith m.u., ON *Kné-frøðr*: *Atle's messenger*; *Akv* 1/2, 2/3; acc. sg. *Kné-frøð**, 2 *Guðr* P1. See Winge.

Leered m.a., ON *Lē-raðr*: *name for the Ash of Ugdrassle*; gen. sg. *Lē-raðs*: *Grm* 25/2 (n.) & 26/2 (ok bitr af ~ limum).

Life and Lafthrasher f. & m.ja., ON *Líf ok Lēif-þrasir*: *the only surviving humans who repopulate the earth after Rakes of the Reins*; *Vafþ* 45/1 (n.).

Lithshelf f.ö., ON *Hlið-skjölfr*: *high lookout post of the Gods from which they can see the whole world*; acc. sg. *Hlið-skjölfr*, *Skí* P1; dat. sg. *Hlið-skjölfu*, *Grm* P2 (n.). [hlið 'cliff, slope' + *skjölfr* 'shelf', i.e., the 'Cliffside Shelf', probably situating it on a high mountain.]

Lock (ON *Loki*) The bound Os. TODO.

Loride m., ON *Hlór-riði*: *poetic name for Thunder*; *Hym* 27/1, 29/1; acc. sg. *Hlór-riða*, *Lok* 55/2; gen. sg. *Hlór-riða*, *Hym* 16/2, 37/2; ~ hamar, *Þrk* 7/4 & 8/1 (~ hamar of folginn), 14/4; dat. sg. *Hlór-riða*, *Hym* 4/3, *Lok* 54/4, *Þrk* 31/1. — ['Loud/Roaring Rider']

Lothar m., ON *Lóðurr*, OS *Logaþore*, PNWGmc. **Loga-þorjar* 'Flame-darer(?)', *obscure god*; *Vsp* 17/4 (n.).

- Middenyard** m.a., (*the 'Middle Enclosure', the inhabited world*). ON Mið-garðr: acc. sg. -garð, *Vsp* 4/2 (n.), *Grm* 42/2 (n.); gen. sg. -garðs: ~ Vê·urr, *Vsp* 53/5; dat. sg. -garði, *Hárð* 23/4, *Hdl* 11/6, 16/4, *Sö* 56 2. — OE Middan-gæard: TODO. — OS Middil-gard (*also* f.cons.): TODO. — OHG Mittila-gart: *Musp* 53. [Cf. Gothic midjun-gards 'the world'.] See Osyard, Wighward, Middenyardswyrm.
- Millner** m.ja., ON Mjöllnir: *Thunder's hammer*; *Lok* 57/2, 59/2, 61/2, 63/2; acc. sg. Mjöllni, *Vafþ* 51/3, *Þrk* 30/3; dat. sg. Mjöllni, *Hym* 36/2 (Mjöllni morð-gjörnum). — Note: þér skal minn þrúð-hamarr, Mjöllnir, mál fyr·nema: *Lok* 57/2, 59/2, 61/2, 63/2. — [PGmc. *Meldunjar.]
- Moon** m.an., ON Máni: *the personified moon in the Eddas, son of Mundfalarer and brother of the Sun*; *Vsp* 5/4, *Vafþ* 22/3, *Alv* 13/3, 14/1; acc. sg. *Háv* 137/7; gen. sg. Mána: sinni ~, *Vsp* 5/1; ~ faðir, *Vafþ* 23/1; systur ~, *Reg* 23/2. — For the moon in general see Index to cultural terms above.
- Mundfalarer** m.an., ON Mundil·fóri: *father of Sun and Moon*; *Vafþ* 23/1 (n.). [*Gylf* 11:2 has Mundil·fari. *mundill (= mōndull 'mill-handle') + fóri 'driver, mover'. The simplex form mōndull has prob. been influenced by the cognate of OE handle < PWGmc. *handulā (*handu 'hand' + *-lā), but the cpd. element mundil- < PN *mundilar (*mundu 'hand' + *-ilar) preserves the original root vowel.]
- Narrow** m.wa., ON Nǫrr: *father of Night*; dat. sg. Nǫrvi, *Vafþ* 25/2 (n.), *Alv* 29/3. [*nǫrr 'narrow' (an adj. only surviving in this name) < PGmc. *narwaz, cognate with OE nearu 'narrow, constrained'. Also found in the weak form Nǫrvi 'the Narrow One' in *Gylf* 10 (cited in *Vafþ* 11/ALL n.).]
- Nears** m. pl., ON Njárar ~ Niarar: *Swedish tribe in Vkv, ruled by king Nithad*; gen. pl. Niara: ~ dróttinn, *Vkv* 7/1 (n.), 14/1, 30/4.
- Nearth** m.u., ON Njörðr: *a god, one of the Wanes, father of Free and Frow*; *Vafþ* 38/3, *Grm* 16/1, *Ski* P1, *Lok* P1, 33/pr, 35/pr, *Gylf* 23:1, 6, 7, 8, 10 (under *Eddbr* II); gen. sg. Njarðar: ~ bur, *Grm* 44/4; sonr ~, *Ski* P1; ~ syni, *Ski* 38/4, 39/3 & 41/3 (þar mun Njarðar syni etc.); ~ dóttur, *Þrk* 22/4; voc. sg. Njörðr, *Lok* 34/1, 36/1. [= OE *Neorþ] — Cpds.: **spear-Nearth** [WARRIOR], ON geir-Njörðr: *Ghv* 8/3.
- Nithad** m.u., *tyrant that imprisons Wayland, father of Beadbild, lord of the Nears*. ON Nið-uðr, *Vkv* P1 (twice), 7/1, 14/1, P2, 31/pr, 32/pr, 38/2, 41/1; gen. sg. Nið-aðar, 20/4, 29/2; kvön ~, 16/1 & 30/1 (Úti stóð kunnig kvön ~), 25/2 & 35/4 (sendi/senda'k kunnigri kvön ~); dat. sg. Nið-aði, *Vkv* T2, 18/1, 20/2, 24/4 & 35/2 (sveip('k) útan silfri, seldi/selda'k ~); voc. sg. *Vkv* 30/4. — Note: Nið-uðr, Niara dróttinn: *Vkv* 7/1, 14/1, 30/4. — OE Nīþ·had, *Déor* 1/5; gen. sg. Nið·hades: ~ máæg, *Wald* B 8. [PNWGmc. *Nīþa·haduz < *nīþaz 'shame, emnity'; *haþuz 'war, battle'.]
- Nithehewer** m., ON Nið·hoggr: *watery dragon and corpse-eater*; *Vsp* 38/4, 62/4, *Grm* 36/4; dat. sg. Nið·hoggvi, *Grm* 32/4.

- Nivelhell** f.ö., ON *nifl-hel*: *a synonym for Hell, lower Underworld*; acc. sg. *nifl-hel*, *Vafþ* 43/4; gen. sg. *nifl-heljar*, *Bdr* 2/3. [*nifl* ‘mist, shade’ + *hel* ‘Hell, the Underworld’; ‘Mist-Hell’, ‘Shady Hell’.]
- Norns** f.i.pl., ON *nornir*: *(not infrequently malevolent) women who shape the orlays of men*; nom. sg. *norn*, *Reg* 2/3 (auml.ig ~); gen. sg. *nornar*, *Sigrdr* 15/12; nom. pl. *nornir*, 1 *HHund* 2/1, *Fáfn* 12/3, 13/1, *Sigsk* 7/3 (*ljótar* ~), 2 *Guðr* 36/1; acc. pl. ~, 2 *HHund* 20/2, *Akv* 18/4 (n.); gen. pl. *norna*, *Fáfn* 11/1 (n.), 44/4, *Hamð* 29/3, 30/4; dat. pl. *nornum*, *Ghv* 13/1. — See *orlay*, *Dises*, *Mothers*, *Weird*, *Vsp* 19.
- Nowetons** n.pl., ON *Nóa-tún*: *Nearth’s watery dwellings*; *Grm* 16/1, *Gylf* 23:2 (under *Eddbr* II); gen. pl. -túna, *Gylf* 23:10 (under *Eddbr* II); dat. pl. -túnun, *Þrk* 22/4, *Gylf* 23:9 (under *Eddbr* II). [*nór* ‘ship’ + *tún* ‘town, fence’]
- Oatle** m.a., ON *Ēitill*: *murdered son of Attle and Guthrun, always paired with Earp* (2); 2 *Guðr* P1; acc. *Ēitil*, *Akv* 41/2; gen. *Ēitils*, *Hamð* 8/2.
- Onecharriers** m.pl., ON *ein-herjar*: *Weden’s chosen warriors who train in Walhall for the Rakes of the Reins*; *Vafþ* 41/1, *Grm* 18/4, 1 *HHund* 38/3; gen. pl. *ein-herja*, *Grm* 24/3; dat. pl. *ein-herjum*, *Grm* 37/6, 53/3.
- Ossens** f.ön.pl., ON *ösynjur*: *the goddesses, wives of the Eese*; *Bdr* 1/2, *Lok* 31/3, *Þrk* 14/2; acc. pl. ~, *Hdl* 10/4; voc. pl. ~, *Lok* 11/1, *Sigrdr* 4/1. [PGmc. **ansuz* ‘Os’ + **unjō* f. ‘-ess, -en’; cf. *vargr*, *vargynja*.] — Note: *ok ösynjur allar á máli*: *Bdr* 1/2, *Þrk* 14/2; *Heilir észir, heilar ösynjur*: *Lok* 11/1, *Sigrdr* 4/1.
- Osyard** m.a., ON *Ös-garðr*: *the stronghold (yard, enclosure) of the Eese*; acc. sg. -garð, *Þrk* 18/3; gen. sg. -garðs: ~ *jöfurr*, *RunI* 4; dat. sg. -garði, *Hym* 7/2, *Skm* 42:2 (in *Eddbr* VII). [*öss* ‘Os, god’ + *garðr* ‘enclosure’, i.e., the ‘Enclosure of the Eese’.] — See *Middenyard*, *Outyards*.
- Oughter** (ON *Óttarr*, OE *Óththere*, PNWGmc. **Óhta-barjar*) *Legendary Swedish Ingling king*.
- Outyards** (ON *Út-garðar*) *Not Eddic. The ‘Outer Enclosures’, described in Gylf. See also Ettinham, Middenyard, Osyard.*
- Rakes of the Age** n.pl., ON *aldar rök*: *the Rakes of the Reins*; acc. pl. *aldar rök*, *Vafþ* 39/3. [*öld* ‘age, generation’, *rök* ‘unfolding, events’.]
- Rakes of the Reins** n.pl., ON *ragna rök*: *the destruction of the world in pre-Christian eschatology* (cf. *Vsp* 39–55, *Vafþ* 44–53); *Bdr* 14/4 (n.), 1 *HHund* 40/2; nom. pl. *rök ragna*, *Am* 21/3; acc. pl. *ragna rök*, *Vsp* 43/4, 47/4, 55/4, *Vafþ* 55/4. [*regin* ‘Reins, Gods’, *rök* ‘unfolding, events’.] — See *Rakes of the Age*, *Ripping of the Age*, *Twilight of the Reins*, *Rippers*.
- Reading** m.a., ON *Hrauðungr*: *legendary king of the Gots*; ~ *konungr*, *Grm* P1; gen. sg. *Hrauðungs*: *sonum* ~ *konungs*, *Grm* T1; dat. sg. *Hrauðungi*, *Hdl* 25/2.

- Reins** (ON *rogn*, *regin*) The 'Powers, Counsels'. Judging from *Vafþ* TODO the term may be more closely associated with the Wanæs than the Eese.
- Rimefax** m.an., ON *Hrím-faxi*: *horse that pulls the night*; *Vafþ* 14/1. See Shinefax.
- Ripping of the Age** n., ON *aldar rof*: *the Rakes of the Reins*; 2 *HHund* 41/2. [old 'age, generation', *rof* 'ripping, destruction'.]
- Rotholf** (ON *Hrólfr kraki*, OE *Hrópulf*, PNWGmc. **Hrópi-wulfar*) A king of the Shieldings (see family tree). As foreshadowed in *Beow* 1017–9, 1180–90, he betrays the sons of Rothgar, his cousins Rethric and Rothmund, in order to take the throne for himself. In the later Icelandic tradition this has been forgotten, and he is consistently portrayed as a heroic king.
- Rothwitner** m.ja., ON *Hróð-vitnir*: *father of the wolf Hate* (2); gen. sg. -vitnis, *Grm* 40/3. Cf. *Lok* 39/1. [*hróðr* 'fame, glory' + *vitnir* 'wolf']
- Rothgar** (ON *Hróarr*, OE *Hrópgár*, PNWGmc. **Hrópi-gairar*) A king of the Shieldings (see family tree), one of the main characters in *Beow*.
- Rungner** (ON *Hrungnir*) Famous ettin fought by Thunder. The full story is told in *Haustl* 14–20 and *Skm* 24–25, which cites the former.
- Sarle** m.an., ON *Sorli*: *son of Enacker and Guthrun, brother of Hamthæw and Earp* (1); *Ghv* P1, *Hamð* 9/1, 31/2; acc. sg. *Sorla*, *Hamð* 21/2. [PGmc. **Sarulô*, diminutive of *Sarus* in *Jordanes*, *Getica*; see Introduction to *Ghv*.]
- Saxons** (ON *saxar*, OE *Seaxan*, *Seaxe*) TODO. Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO
- Shede** f.in., ON *Skaði*: *goddess, daughter of Thedse, wife of Nearth*; *Grm* 11/3, *Ski* P1, *Lok* P1, 49/pr, 51/pr, P8, *Hdl* 29/5, *Gylf* 23:7, 8, 11, 12 (*Eddbr* II). — [OE **Scedi*, PGmc. **Skađi* (not to be confused with *skaði* 'injury' < PGmc. **skapô*). Most likely = OE *Scedi*- in *Shedeny* and the *Shedelands*; *Shede* was presumably thought to guard the Scandinavian peninsula.]
- Shilvings** (ON *skilfingar*, OE *scilfingas*, PNWGmc. **skilþingór*) The descendants of Shelf; the legendary Swedish royal dynasty. The exact difference between the terms *Shilvings* and *Inglings* is unclear, but the first may have referred to the old royal family in Sweden, while the latter to the Norwegian branch which claimed descent from the former. TODO Noted members: TODO Occurrences: *Hdl* 15, 20
- Shield** (ON *Skjoldr*, OE *Scyld*, PNWGmc. **Skelduz*) Legendary Danish king, founder of the Shieldings.
- Shieldings** (ON *skjoldungar*, OE *Scyldingas*, PNWGmc. **skeldungór*) The descendants of Shield; the legendary Danish royal dynasty. With *Harward's* death after his slaying of *Rotholf* their rule ended. TODO Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO

- Shinefax** m.an., ON *Skin-faxi*: *horse that pulls the day*; *Vǫfþ* 12/1. See Rimefax, Allswith, Yorewaker.
- Shirner** m., ON *Skirnir*: *Free's servant*; *Ski* P1, 1/1, 2/pr, 3/pr, 5/pr, 8/pr, P2, P3, 13/pr, 18/pr, 21/pr, 23/pr, 25/pr, 38/pr, P4, 40/1, 41/pr,
- Sholl** m.?, ON *Skoll*: *wolf that chases the sun*; *Grm* 40/1. See Hate (2), Roth-witner.
- Sithguth** f., OHG *Sinthgunt*: *obscure goddess, sister of Sun*; *Mers II* 3. [PN-WGmc. **Sinþa-gunþir*(?)]
- Siward** (ON *Sig-urðr*) A hero of the Walsings, slayer of the wyrm Fathomer.
- Slopner** m.ja., ON *Slēipnir*: *Weden's eight-legged horse*; *Grm* 45/3; acc. sg. *Slēipni*, *Bdr* 2/2, *Hdl* 39/2; gen. sg. *Slēipnis*, *Sigrdr* 15/4. See *Vsp* 19 n.
- Sons of Byre** m.i., ON *Burs synir*: *group of early gods*; *Vsp* 4/1 (n.). See Byre.
- Sun** (ON *Sól*, OHG *Sunna*) The personified Sun, who in the Germanic mythology is a woman. In *Vǫfþ* 22 the daughter of Mundlefarer and sister of Moon. In *Mers II* the sister of Sithguth.
- Sutting** m.a., ON *Suttungr*: *ettin who possessed the Mead of Poetry, father of |inx[P]Guthlathe*; *Háv* 109/4; acc. sg. *Suttung*, *Háv* 110/3; gen. sg. *Suttungs*, *Háv* 104/4; ~ *synir*, *Alv* 34/4; gen. sg. *Suttunga* [*with nom. sg. *Suttungi* (?): *synir* ~, *Ski* 34/2.
- Swanhild** f.i., ON *Svan-hildir*: *daughter of Siward and Guthrun trampled by King Ermenric*; *Sigsk* 55/3, 2 *Guðr* P1, *Ghv* P1, 15/3, *Hamð* 3/1; acc. sg. -hildi, *Sigsk* 63/2, *Ghv* P1, 8/5, 15/1; gen. sg. -hildar, *Ghv* 16/4, *Hamð* 2/5. (For her historicity see *Getica* 129, cited in Introduction to *Ghv*.) [ON *svanr* 'swan' + *hildir* 'battle, Hild (a walkirie)' but this is prob. later reanalysis; the form *Sunilda* (*Getica* 129) suggests Gothic *sunja* 'truth' + **hilds* 'battle, Hild'.]
- Swedes** (ON *svíar*, OE *swéon*, PNWGmc. **swihanír*) The tribe around the Mälar valley in eastern Sweden. Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO
- Syemund** (ON *Sig-mundr*, OE *Sige-mund*, MHG. *Sieg-mund*, PNWGmc. **Sigi-mundur*) In the Norse tradition the son of king Walsing. He begets Siward, the slayer of the wyrm Fathomer. In *Beow* it is Syemund himself who slays an unnamed wyrm. Connected with his nephew Sinfittle.
- Tew** m.wa., ON *Týr*: *one-handed god, possibly son of Hymer* (cf. *Hym* 5/3 n.); *Hym* 4/3, 6/2pr, 33/3, *Lok* P1, 37/pr, 39/pr; acc. sg. *Tý*, *Sigrdr* 6/4; voc. sg. *Týr*: *Þegi þú*, ~, *Lok* 38/1, 40/1. [OE *Tiw* (Tiwes dæg 'Tuesday'), PGmc. **tiwaz* 'god' < PIE **deywós* 'id.', directly cognate with OI *devā* 'id.', Latin *deus* 'id.'. Tew is not linguistically or mythologically identical to OI *Dyāús*, Greek *Ζεύς*, Latin *Iuppiter* which derive from a different derivation of the same root.]

- Tews** m.wa.pl., ON *tívar*: *the Gods*; *Grm* 5/4; *ríkir tívar*, *Bdr* 1/3 & *Þrk* 14/3 (ok umb þat réðu ~); *mérir tívar*, *Hym* 4/1; acc. pl. *tíva*, *Háv* 160/2; gen. sg. *tíva*, *Vafþ* 38/1 & 42/1 (þú ~ røk qll Vafþrúðnir vitir). [PGmc. **tīwōz*, pl. of **tīwaz*; see *Tew* above.] — Cpds.: **slain-Tews**, ON *val-tívar*: *Vsp* 59/4 (n.), *Hym* 1/1; gen. pl. *val-tíva*, *Vsp* 50/2 (n.). **victory-Tews**, ON *sig-tívar*: gen. pl. *sig-tíva*: of *ragna røk*, *rømm* ~, *Vsp* 43/4, 47/4, 55/4; ~ *sonum*, *Grm* 46/1; ~ *synir*, *Lok* 1/4, 2/2, *Fáfn* 24/2; *Guð-rún* ~, *Akv* 32/3.
- Thedse** m.an., ON *Þjatsi*: *ettin, father of Shede*; *Grm* 11/1, *Hdl* 29/4; acc. sg. *Þjatsa*, *Hárb* 19/1; gen. sg. *Þjatsa*: *dóttir* ~ *jötuns*, *Gylf* 23:7 (*Eddbr* II); dat. sg. *Þjatsa*, *Lok* 50/4 & 51/2.
- Thing of the Gods** ON *þing goða*: *the Heavenly Council, the Assembly where the Gods convene and make decisions*; acc. sg. ~, *Hym* 39/1. — Indirectly: *þingi* ‘Thing’ *Vsp* 46/2, *Bdr* 1/1 (n.), *Þrk* 14/1; *røk-stóla* ‘council-seats’, *Vsp* 6/1 (n.), 9/1, 22/1, 24/1; *Grm* 29–30. — See *Vsp* 6/1–2 n., *Bdr* 1/1–3 n.
- Thrim** m., ON *Þrymr*: *ettin who steals Thunder’s hammer in Þrk*; *Þrk* 6/1, 7/þr, 8/þr, 11/2, 22/1, 25/1, 30/1; acc. sg. *Þrym* *Þrk* 31/3; gen. sg. *Þryms* *Þrk* T1. — Note: *Þrym(r)* ... *þursa dróttin*: *Þrk* 6/1, 11/2, 31/3; *þá kvað þat Þrymr, þursa dróttin*: *Þrk* 22/1, 25/1, 30/1.
- Thrithham** m., ON *Þrúð-heimr*: *Thunder’s heavenly abode*; dat. sg. -*heimi* *Grm* 4/3.
- Thrithyelm** m.ja., ON *Þrúð-gelmir*: *ettin, father of Bareyelm*; *Vafþ* 29/3.
- Thunder** m., (ON *Þörr*, OE **Þunor*, OS *Þuner*, OHG *Donar*, PNWGmc. **Þonarar*) ON *Þörr*: *god of Thunder, son of Woden and Earth*; *Vsp* 25/1, *Grm* 4/3, 29/2, *Hárb* P1, 3/þr, 5/þr, 7/þr, 9/þr, 11/þr, 13/þr, 15/þr, 17/þr, 19/þr, 23/þr, 24/4, 25/þr, 26/1, 26/3, 27/þr, 29/þr, 31/þr, 33/þr, 35/þr, 37/þr, 39/þr, 41/þr, 43/þr, 45/þr, 47/þr, 49/þr, 50/2, 51/þr, 53/þr, 55/þr, 57/þr, 59/þr, *Hym* T1 (in R), 23/1 (Þöarr), *Lok* P1, P7, 59/þr, 60/4, 61/þr, 63/þr, *Þrk* 17/1, *Alv* 2/þr, 4/þr, 6/þr, 8/þr, 11/þr, 13/þr, 15/þr, 17/þr, 19/þr, 21/þr, 23/þr, 25/þr, 27/þr, 29/þr, 31/þr, 33/þr, 35/þr, *Skm* TODO (*Eddbr* VI P1 (3 times), P2 (2 times), P3 (3 times)), *Cant* 3, N B380/2; acc. sg. *Þör*, *Hárb* 9/4, 56/4, *Hym* 28/2 (Þöar), *Þrk* 9/4, 15/3, 19/1, *Hdl* 4/1; gen. sg. *Þörs*, *Hárb* P1, *Skm* TODO (*Eddbr* VI P2); voc. sg. *Þörr*, *Hárb* 18/9, 22/3, 28/2, 32/1, 36/1, 38/1, *Lok* 58/2; *þegi þú*, ~, *Þrk* 18/2. — Cpds.: **Thunder of the Eese**, ON *Ása-Þörr*: gen. sg. *Ása-Þörs*, *Hárb* 52/1. **Wing-Thunder**, ON *Ving-Þörr*: *Þrk* 1/1 (n.), *Alv* 6/1. — See Loride, Wighward, Wingner, TODO.
- Thurses** (sg. *Thurse*; ON *þurs*, OE *þyrs*, OS *thuris*, OHG *duris*, PNWGmc. **þurisar*) Possibly a poetic synonym for *Ettins*. See also *Rime-Thurses*. Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO
- Twilight of the Reins** n., ON *ragna røkr*: *the Rakes of the Reins*; gen. sg. *ragna røkr*s, *Lok* 39/4. [regin ‘Reins, Gods’, røk(k)r ‘twilight’]

- Ugdrassle** m.a., ON Ygg·drasil: “Weden’s steed”, where he hung on the World Tree; only in *Ash of Ugdrassle*
- Up-heaven** (ON *upp-biminn*, OE *up-beofon*, OS *upp-bimil*, OHG *uf-bimil*) Highest Heaven; used in Earth and Up-heaven.
- Wadyelmer** m.ja., ON *Vað·gęlmir*: acc. sg. *Vað·gęlmi*, *Reg* 4/2. [*vað* n. ‘shoal, water shallow enough to wade’ + *gęlmir* ‘screamer(?)’]
- Waleshelf** f.ö., ON *Vala-skjölf*: *mythological place*; *Grm* 6/3.
- Walfather** (ON *Val-fęðr*) ‘Father of the Slain’; name for Weden.
Vsp 1/3a, 26/4a, 28/4a, *Grm* 49/2a
- Walhall** f., ON *Val-hęll*: *Weden’s hall*; *Grm* 8/2; gen. sg. *Val-hallar*, *Vsp* 33/4, 2 *HHund* P2, Icelandic Rune Poem 4/2, *Skm* 42 (*Eddbr* VII); dat. sg. *Val-hęllu*, *Grm* 24/2, *Hdl* 1/4, *Akv* 2/2(?), 16/2(?).
- Walsings** (ON *Vęlsungar*) Descendants of king Walsing.
- Wanes** (ON *vanir*, OE *wan-?*) A subgroup or tribe of the gods, associated with fertility, harvests and the sea. Noted members: Nearth, Free, Frow Occurrences: TODO
- Wayland** m.u., *legendary smith*. ON *Vęlundr*, *Vkv* P1 (thrice), 4/2, 5/3 & 7/2, 9/4, 13/pr, 15/pr, P2, P3, 22/pr, 27/pr, 28/pr, 29/1, 29/3, 33/pr, 38/1, 41/2 (vit *Vęlundr*); voc. sg. *Vęlundr*, *Vkv* 14/2 & 32/1 (~, *visi alfa*), 37/2, 40/2 (it *Vęlundr*). — Note: *Vęlundr* liðandi of *langan veg*: *Vkv* 4/2, 9/4; çinn *Vęlundr* sat i *Ulf-dęlum*: *Vkv* 5/3, 7/2; hlęjandi *Vęlundr*: *Vkv* 29/3, 38/1. — OE *Węlund*, *Dęor* 1; gen. sg. *Węlandes*, *Beow* 455, *Wald* A 2; ~ bearn, *Wald* B 9.
- Webthrithner** , m.ja., ON *Vaf·þręðnir*: *ettin defeated by Weden in a wisdom contest*; *Vafþ* 6/1, 7/pr, 9/pr, 11/pr, 13/pr, 15/pr, 17/pr, 19/pr, 21/pr, 23/pr, 25/pr, 27/pr, 29/pr, 31/pr, 33/pr, 35/pr, 37/pr, 39/pr, 41/pr, 43/pr, 45/pr, 47/pr, 49/pr, 51/pr, 53/pr, 55/pr; acc. sg. *Vaf·þręðni*, *Vafþ* 2/4; gen. sg. *Vaf·þręðnis*, *Vafþ* T1, 1/2, 3/3.
- Weden** (ON *Óðinn*, OE *Wóden*, *Węden*, OHG *Wuotan*, PNWGmc. **Wó-danar* ‘Lord of wode (poetry, intelligence)’) Chief of the Eese, God of Wisdom, Galder, Poetry, War. Husband of Frie, and by her father of Balder. Father of Thunder by Earth. Brother of Heener and Lother or Will and Wigh.
- Weird** m.an., ON *Urðr*: *one of three Norms at the Ash of Ugdrassle (for non-personified use, see under cultural terms above)*; 1 *Guðr* 24/3; acc. sg. *Urð*, *Vsp* 19/3 (n.). [PNGmc. **wurdiz* ‘fate, destiny’]. — See Shild, Well of Weird, Werthing.

- Wider** m., ON Við-arr: *son and avenger of Weden against the Fenrerswolf*; *Vsp* 52/2, *Vafþ* 51/1, 53/2, *Lok* P1, P4; gen. sg. Við-ars, *Vsp* H48/4, *Grm* 17/2; voc. sg. Við-arr, *Lok* 10/1. — [OE *Wid-heri, PGmc. *Wida-harjar ‘Broad Warrior’, a fitting name considering he props the jaws of the Wolf apart, which are said to reach up to the very Heaven (*Vsp* H48 n.).]
- Wigh** m.an., ON Véi: *brother of Weden and Will, son of Byre* (cf. *Vsp* 4/1, 16/2 nn.); acc. sg. Vēa, *Lok* 26/3 (n.). [PNGmc. *wihá ‘hallower, (heathen) priest’.]
- Wighward** m.a., ON Véurr: *poetic name for Thunder*; *Vsp* 53/5 (Mið-garðs ~), *Hym* 11/5, 17/1, 21/4 (Óðni sifjaðr ~). [PN *Wiba-warjar, *wibq ‘wigh, sanctuary’ + *warjaz ‘defender’.]
- Will** m.an., ON Vili: *brother of Weden and Wigh, son of Byre* (cf. *Vsp* 4/1, 16/2 nn.); acc. sg. Vilja, *Lok* 26/3 (n.). [PNWGmc. *wiljá ‘willpower’.]
- Wingner** m.a., ON Vingnir: *poetic name for Thunder*; gen. sg. Vingnis, *Vafþ* 51/4. [Probably ‘swinger’, viz. of the Hammer Millner.]
- Wing-Thunder** m., ON Ving-Þorr: *name for Thunder*; see there under *Cpds*.
- Wode** m.a.(or u.), ON Óðr: *obscure husband of Frow*; gen. sg. Óðs: ~ meý, *Vsp* 24/4. [OE wód]
- Woderearer** m.ja., ON Óð-rórir: *one of the vats of the Mead of Poetry*; *Háv* 107/3; dat. sg. Óð-róri, *Háv* 140/4.
- Wolder** m.u., ON Ullr: *obscure winter-god*; *Grm* 5/1; gen. sg. Ullar, *Grm* 43/1 (n.), *Akv* 33/4. [PGmc. *wulþuz ‘glory, splendour’, OE *Wuldor.]
- Wonnel** m.an., ON Váli: *god, son of Weden and Wrind who avenges his brother Balder by killing his half-brother Hath*; *Vsp* H31 (n.), *Vafþ* 51, *Hdl* 28/3; acc. sg. Vála, *Bdr* 11/1. [$\leq$ PGmc. *Wānilô ‘the little Wane’ (uncertain).] — Indirectly: Baldrs bróðir: *Vsp* 32/3; Óðins sonr: *Vsp* 32/4, *Bdr* 11/2.
- Wrate** m.an., ON Rati: *Weden’s drill*; gen. sg. Rata, *Háv* 106/1.
- Wrind** f., ON Vrind, Rind: *mother of Wonnel* (cf. *Vsp* 31 n.); *Bdr* 11/1 (n.). [‘Ivy’(?)]; *Bdr* 11/1 n.]
- Yimer** m.ja., ON Ymir: *first ettin sacrificed by the Gods who created the world from his corpse*; *Vsp* 3/1 (n.); gen. sg. Ymis, *Vafþ* 21/1 & *Grm* 41/1 (Ór Ymis holdi et c.), *Vafþ* 28/3; dat. sg. Ymi, *Hdl* 32/4. [OE *Ġyme, PGmc. *Jumjaz. See *Vsp* 3/1 for etymology.]
- Yin-Reins** (ON *ginn-ręgin*) yin- + Reins. The sacrosanct, highest Divine Powers.

Yivick m.an., *king of the Burgends (historically from late 4th c.–407 CE)*. ON Gjúki: 2 *Guðr* P1, 1/3, *Am* 102/2; acc. sg. Gjúka, *Stigs* 1/1; TODO. — OE Gifca: *Wid* 19. [Cf. OHG Gibicho, MHG. Gibeche (in legendary ballads).]

Yivickings m.pl., ON Gjúkungar: *descendants of Yivick*; TODO. [Gjúki ‘Yivick’ + -ungar ‘sons, descendants of’]

Poetic formulæ (F)

All formulæ are given in English translation, their attested forms and a Proto-Germanic rendition. For those consisting of two words bound together by a conjunction, & is written in its place.

Earth and Up-heaven (ON *ǵrð & upphiminn*, OE *eorþe & upheofon*, OS *erþa & uphimil*, OHG *erdo & úfbimil*, PGmc. **erþō & uphīminaz*) An old merism; earth and heaven and everything in between, i.e., the whole universe. It has a particular connection to the creation and destruction of the world, and in prayers. ON: *Vsp* 3/3, *Vafþ* 20, *Þrk* 2, *Oddr* 17, *Sjy* 41 (under Galders), *Sö* 154 (under Runic Poetry); OE: *Acreboot*; OS: *Heli* 2886; OHG: *Wessobrunn* 2.

Eese and Elves (ON *ésir & alfar*, OE *ése & ielfe*, PNWGmc. **alþír & ansiwīr*) A merism; both heavenly and earthly spiritual beings. Notably the two words always occur in this order (never ‘Elves and Eese’), even in OE.

words and works (ON *orð & verk*, OE *word & weorc*, PGmc. **wurdó & werkó*) *Beow* 289, 1100, 1833

*History takes many turns:
A man is born. Another burns.
(And who can tell where e'er it goes?)
The dust that was his body blows
And plays upon the mellow air
And lands upon some white, washed hand.
The girl that combs her yellow hair
Takes pause, then blows away the man.*